POETRY

Poems of American History

Unknown

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POEMS OF AMERICAN HISTORY

AMERICA

My country, 'tis of thee, Sweet land of liberty, Of thee I sing; Land where my fathers died, Land of the pilgrims' pride, From every mountain-side Let freedom ring.

My native country, thee, Land of the noble free, Thy name I love; I love thy rocks and rills, Thy woods and templed hills; My heart with rapture thrills Like that above.

Let music swell the breeze, And ring from all the trees Sweet freedom's song; Let mortal tongues awake, Let all that breathe partake, Let rocks their silence break,--The sound prolong.

Our fathers' God, to Thee, Author of liberty, To Thee we sing; Long may our land be bright With freedom's holy light; Protect us by Thy might, Great God, our King.

SAMUEL FRANCIS SMITH.

POEMS OF AMERICAN HISTORY

COLLECTED AND EDITED

BY

BURTON EGBERT STEVENSON

[Illustration]

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TO

E. B. S.

HELPMATE

One who underrates the significance of our literature, prose or verse, as both the expression and stimulant of national feeling, as of import in the past and to the future of America, and therefore of the world, is deficient in that critical insight which can judge even of its own day unwarped by personal taste or deference to public impression. He shuts his eyes to the fact that at times, notably throughout the years resulting in the Civil War, this literature has been a "force."--EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

INTRODUCTION

The poetry relating to American history falls naturally into two classes: that written, so to speak, from the inside, on the spot, and that written from the outside, long afterwards. Of the first class, "The Star-Spangled Banner" is the most famous example, as well as perhaps the best. Even at this distant day, reading it with a

knowledge of the circumstances which produced it, it has a power of touching the heart and gripping the imagination which goes far toward proving the genuineness of its art. Of the second class, "Paul Revere's Ride" is probably the most widely known, though Mr. Longfellow's own "Ballad of the French Fleet" is a better poem.

It is evident that, in compiling an anthology such as this, different standards must be used in judging these two classes. The first, aside from any quality as poetry which it may have, is of value because of its historical or political interest, because it is an expression and an interpretation of the hour which gave it birth. With it, poetic merit is not the first consideration, which is, perhaps, as well. Yet, however slight their merit as poetry may be, many of the early ballads possess an admirable energy, directness, and aptness of phrase, and there is about them a childlike simplicity impossible of reproduction in this sophisticated age--as where Stephen Tilden, in his epitaph on Braddock, requests the great commanders who have preceded that unfortunate soldier to the grave to

"Edge close and give him room."

With the retrospective ballad, on the other hand, poetic merit is a sine qua non. It has little value historically, however accurate its facts. It differs from the contemporary ballad in the same way that the "New Canterbury Tales" differ from Froissart; or as the "Idylls of the King" differ from "Le Morte Arthur." It is less authentic, less convincing, less vital. It may have atmosphere, but there is no infallible way of telling whether the atmosphere is right. Unless it is something more, then, than mere metrical history, the modern ballad has little claim to consideration.

These are the two principles which the present compiler has had constantly in mind. Yet the second principle has been violated more than once, since, in a collection such as this, one must cut one's coat according to the cloth; or, rather, one must make sure that one is decently covered, though the covering may here and there be somewhat inferior in quality. So it has been necessary, in order to keep the thread of history unbroken, to admit some strands anything but silken; and if the choice has sometimes been of ills, rather than of goods, the compiler can only hope that he chose wisely.

The most difficult and trying portion of his task has been, not to get his material together, but to compress it into reasonable limits. Especially in the colonial period was the temptation great to include more early American verse. Peter Folger's "A Looking-Glass for the Times," Benjamin Tompson's "New England's Crisis," Michael Wigglesworth's "God's Controversy with New England," the "Sot-Weed Factor," and many others, which it is recalling an old sorrow to name here, were excluded only after long and bitter debate. No doubt other exclusions will be noticed by nearly every reader of the volume--and it may interest him to know that the material gathered together would have made four such books as this.

The thread of narrative upon which the poems have been strung together has been made as slight as possible, just strong enough to carry the reader understandingly from one poem to the next. The notes, too, have been limited to the explanation of such allusions as are not likely to be found in the ordinary works of reference, with

here and there an account of the circumstances which caused the lines to be written, or an indication of source, where the source is unusual. Every available source has been drawn upon--the works of all the better known and many of the minor American and English poets, anthologies, newspaper collections, magazines, collections of Americana and especially of broadsides--in a word, American and English poetry generally.

In this connection, the compiler wishes to make grateful acknowledgment of the assistance he has received on every hand, especially from Mr. Herbert Putnam and Miss Margaret McGuffey, of the Library of Congress; Mr. N. D. C. Hodges, librarian of the Cincinnati, Ohio, Public Library; Mr. C. B. Galbreath, librarian of the Ohio State Library; Mr. Charles F. Lummis, librarian of the Los Angeles, California, Public Library; Dr. Edward Everett Hale, Mr. William Henry Venable, Mr. Isaac R. Pennypacker, Mr. Arthur Guiterman, and Mr. Wallace Rice. He might add that it is a matter of deep personal gratification to him that in no instance has any author refused to permit the use of his work in this collection. On the contrary, many of them have been most helpful in suggestions.

A special effort has been made to secure accuracy of text,--no light task, especially with the early ballads. Where the text varied, as was often the case, that has been followed which seemed to have the greater authority, except that obvious misprints have been corrected. In this, the compiler has had the coöperation of The Riverside Press, and has had frequent occasion to admire the care and knowledge of the corrector and his assistants.

B. E. S.

CHILLICOTHE, OHIO, July 23, 1908.

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PART I

THE COLONIAL PERIOD

AMERICA

Oh, who has not heard of the Northmen of yore, How flew, like the sea-bird, their sails from the shore; How westward they stayed not till, breasting the brine, They hailed Narragansett, the land of the vine?

Then the war-songs of Rollo, his pennon and glaive, Were heard as they danced by the moon-lighted wave, And their golden-haired wives bore them sons of the soil, While raged with the redskins their feud and turmoil.

And who has not seen, mid the summer's gay crowd, That old pillared tower of their fortalice proud, How it stands solid proof of the sea chieftains' reign Ere came with Columbus those galleys of Spain?

'Twas a claim for their kindred: an earnest of sway,-- By the stout-hearted Cabot made good in its day,-- Of the Cross of St. George on the Chesapeake's tide, Where lovely Virginia arose like a bride.

Came the pilgrims with Winthrop; and, saint of the West, Came Robert of Jamestown, the brave and the blest; Came Smith, the bold rover, and Rolfe--with his ring, To wed sweet Matoäka, child of a king.

Undaunted they came, every peril to dare, Of tribes fiercer far than the wolf in his lair; Of the wild irksome woods, where in ambush they lay; Of their terror by night and their arrow by day.

And so where our capes cleave the ice of the poles, Where groves of the orange scent sea-coast and shoals, Where the froward Atlantic uplifts its last crest, Where the sun, when he sets, seeks the East from the West.

The clime that from ocean to ocean expands, The fields to the snow-drifts that stretch from the sands, The wilds they have conquered of mountain and plain, Those pilgrims have made them fair Freedom's domain.

And the bread of dependence if proudly they spurned, 'Twas the soul of their fathers that kindled and burned, 'Twas the blood of the Saxon within them that ran; They held--to be free is the birthright of man.

So oft the old lion, majestic of mane, Sees cubs of his cave breaking loose from his reign; Unmeet to be his if they braved not his eye, He gave them the spirit his own to defy.

ARTHUR CLEVELAND COXE.

POEMS OF AMERICAN HISTORY

CHAPTER I

THE DISCOVERY OF AMERICA

Bjarni, son of Herjulf, speeding westward from Iceland in 986, to spend the Yuletide in Greenland with his father, encountered foggy weather and steered by guesswork for many days. At last he sighted land, but a land covered with dense woods,--not at all the land of fiords and glaciers he was seeking. So, without stopping, he turned his prow to the north, and ten days later was telling his story to the listening circle before the blazing logs in his father's house at Brattahlid. The tale came, in time, to the ears of Leif, the famous son of Red Eric, and in the year 1000 he set out from Greenland, with a crew of thirty-five, in search of the strange land to the south. He reached the barren coast of Labrador and named it Helluland, or "slate-land;" south

of it was a coast so densely wooded that he named it Markland, or "woodland." At last he ran his ship ashore at a spot where "a river, issuing from a lake, fell into the sea." Wild grapes abounded, and he named the country Vinland.

THE STORY OF VINLAND[1]

From "Psalm of the West"

Far spread, below, The sea that fast hath locked in his loose flow All secrets of Atlantis' drownèd woe Lay bound about with night on every hand, Save down the eastern brink a shining band Of day made out a little way from land. Then from that shore the wind upbore a cry: _Thou Sea, thou Sea of Darkness! why, oh why Dost waste thy West in unthrift mystery?_ But ever the idiot sea-mouths foam and fill, And never a wave doth good for man, or ill, And Blank is king, and Nothing hath his will; And like as grim-beaked pelicans level file Across the sunset toward their nightly isle On solemn wings that wave but seldom while, So leanly sails the day behind the day To where the Past's lone Rock o'erglooms the spray, And down its mortal fissures sinks away.

Master, Master, break this ban: The wave lacks Thee. Oh, is it not to widen man Stretches the sea? Oh, must the sea-bird's idle van Alone be free?

Into the Sea of the Dark doth creep Björne's pallid sail, As the face of a walker in his sleep, Set rigid and most pale, About the night doth peer and peep In a dream of an ancient tale.

Lo, here is made a hasty cry: _Land, land, upon the west!-- God save such land! Go by, go by: Here may no mortal rest, Where this waste hell of slate doth lie And grind the glacier's breast._

The sail goeth limp: hey, flap and strain! Round eastward slanteth the mast; As the sleep-walker waked with pain, White-clothed in the midnight blast, Doth stare and quake, and stride again To houseward all aghast.

Yet as--_A ghost!_ his household cry: _He hath followed a ghost in flight. Let us see the ghost_--his household fly With lamps to search the night-- So Norsemen's sails run out and try The Sea of the Dark with light.

Stout Are Marson, southward whirled From out the tempest's hand, Doth skip the sloping of the world To Huitramannaland, Where Georgia's oaks with moss-beards curled Wave by the shining strand,

And sway in sighs from Florida's Spring Or Carolina's Palm-- What time the mocking-bird doth bring The woods his artist's-balm, Singing the Song of Everything Consummate-sweet and calm--

Land of large merciful-hearted skies, Big bounties, rich increase, Green rests for Trade's blood-shotten eyes, For o'er-beat brains surcease, For Love the dear woods' sympathies, For Grief the wise woods' peace.

For Need rich givings of hid powers In hills and vales quick-won, For Greed large exemplary flowers That ne'er have toiled nor spun, For Heat fair-tempered winds and showers, For Cold the neighbor sun.

* * * * *

Then Leif, bold son of Eric the Red, To the South of the West doth flee-- Past slaty Helluland is sped, Past Markland's woody lea, Till round about fair Vinland's head, Where Taunton helps the sea,

The Norseman calls, the anchor falls, The mariners hurry a-strand: They wassail with fore-drunken skals Where prophet wild grapes stand; They lift the Leifsbooth's hasty walls, They stride about the land--

New England, thee! whose ne'er-spent wine As blood doth stretch each vein, And urge thee, sinewed like thy vine, Through peril and all pain To grasp Endeavor's towering Pine, And, once ahold, remain--

Land where the strenuous-handed Wind With sarcasm of a friend Doth smite the man would lag behind To frontward of his end; Yea, where the taunting fall and grind Of Nature's Ill doth send

Such mortal challenge of a clown Rude-thrust upon the soul, That men but smile where mountains frown Or scowling waters roll, And Nature's front of battle down Do hurl from pole to pole.

Now long the Sea of Darkness glimmers low With sails from Northland flickering to and fro-- Thorwald, Karlsefne, and those twin heirs of woe, Hellboge and Finnge, in treasonable bed Slain by the ill-born child of Eric Red, Freydisa false. Till, as much time is fled, Once more the vacant airs with darkness fill, Once more the wave doth never good nor ill, And Blank is king, and Nothing works his will; And leanly sails the day behind the day To where the Past's lone Rock o'erglooms the spray, And down its mortal fissures sinks away, As when the grim-beaked pelicans level file Across the sunset to their seaward isle On solemn wings that wave but seldomwhile.

SIDNEY LANIER.

[1] From Poems by Sidney Lanier; copyright, 1884, 1891, by Mary D. Lanier; published by Charles Scribner's Sons.

Leif and his crew spent the winter in Vinland, and in the following spring took back to Greenland news of the pleasant country they had discovered. Other voyages followed, but the newcomers became embroiled with the natives, who attacked them in such numbers that all projects of colonization were abandoned; and finally, in 1012, the Norsemen sailed away forever from this land of promise.

THE NORSEMEN

[On a fragment of statue found at Bradford.]

Gift from the cold and silent Past! A relic to the present cast; Left on the ever-changing strand Of shifting and unstable sand, Which wastes beneath the steady

chime And beating of the waves of Time! Who from its bed of primal rock First wrenched thy dark, unshapely block? Whose hand, of curious skill untaught, Thy rude and savage outline wrought?

The waters of my native stream Are glancing in the sun's warm beam; From sail-urged keel and flashing oar The circles widen to its shore; And cultured field and peopled town Slope to its willowed margin down. Yet, while this morning breeze is bringing The home-life sound of school-bells ringing, And rolling wheel, and rapid jar Of the fire-winged and steedless car, And voices from the wayside near Come quick and blended on my ear,-- A spell is in this old gray stone, My thoughts are with the Past alone!

A change!--The steepled town no more Stretches along the sail-thronged shore; Like palace-domes in sunset's cloud, Fade sun-gilt spire and mansion proud: Spectrally rising where they stood, I see the old, primeval wood; Dark, shadow-like, on either hand I see its solemn waste expand; It climbs the green and cultured hill, It arches o'er the valley's rill, And leans from cliff and crag to throw Its wild arms o'er the stream below. Unchanged, alone, the same bright river Flows on, as it will flow forever! I listen, and I hear the low Soft ripple where its waters go; I hear behind the panther's cry, The wild-bird's scream goes thrilling by, And shyly on the river's brink The deer is stooping down to drink.

But hark!--from wood and rock flung back, What sound comes up the Merrimac? What sea-worn barks are those which throw The light spray from each rushing prow? Have they not in the North Sea's blast Bowed to the waves the straining mast? Their frozen sails the low, pale sun Of Thulë's night has shone upon; Flapped by the sea-wind's gusty sweep Round icy drift, and headland steep. Wild Jutland's wives and Lochlin's daughters Have watched them fading o'er the waters, Lessening through driving mist and spray, Like white-winged sea-birds on their way!

Onward they glide,--and now I view Their iron-armed and stalwart crew; Joy glistens in each wild blue eye, Turned to green earth and summer sky. Each broad, seamed breast has cast aside Its cumbering vest of shaggy hide; Bared to the sun and soft warm air, Streams back the Northmen's yellow hair. I see the gleam of axe and spear, A sound of smitten shields I hear, Keeping a harsh and fitting time To Saga's chant, and Runic rhyme; Such lays as Zetland's Scald has sung, His gray and naked isles among; Or muttered low at midnight hour Round Odin's mossy stone of power. The wolf beneath the Arctic moon Has answered to that startling rune; The Gael has heard its stormy swell, The light Frank knows its summons well; Iona's sable-stoled Culdee Has heard it sounding o'er the sea, And swept, with hoary beard and hair, His altar's foot in trembling prayer!

'Tis past,--the 'wildering vision dies In darkness on my dreaming eyes! The forest vanishes in air, Hill-slope and vale lie starkly bare; I hear the common tread of men, And hum of work-day life again; The mystic relic seems alone A broken mass of common stone; And if it be the chiselled limb Of Berserker or idol grim, A fragment of Valhalla's Thor, The stormy Viking's god of War, Or Praga of the Runic lay, Or love-awakening Siona, I know not,--for no graven line, Nor Druid mark, nor Runic

sign, Is left me here, by which to trace Its name, or origin, or place. Yet, for this vision of the Past, This glance upon its darkness cast, My spirit bows in gratitude Before the Giver of all good, Who fashioned so the human mind, That, from the waste of Time behind, A simple stone, or mound of earth, Can summon the departed forth; Quicken the Past to life again, The Present lose in what hath been, And in their primal freshness show The buried forms of long ago. As if a portion of that Thought By which the Eternal will is wrought, Whose impulse fills anew with breath The frozen solitude of Death, To mortal mind were sometimes lent, To mortal musings sometimes sent, To whisper--even when it seems But Memory's fantasy of dreams-- Through the mind's waste of woe and sin, Of an immortal origin!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

This, in mere outline, is the story of Vinland, as told in the Icelandic Chronicle. Of its substantial accuracy there can be little doubt. Many proofs of Norse occupation have been found on the shores of Massachusetts Bay. The "skeleton in armor," however, which was unearthed in 1835 near Fall River, Mass., was probably that of an Indian.

THE SKELETON IN ARMOR

"Speak! speak! thou fearful guest! Who, with thy hollow breast Still in rude armor drest, Comest to daunt me! Wrapt not in Eastern balms, But with thy fleshless palms Stretched, as if asking alms, Why dost thou haunt me?"

Then, from those cavernous eyes Pale flashes seemed to rise, As when the Northern skies Gleam in December; And, like the water's flow Under December's snow, Came a dull voice of woe From the heart's chamber.

"I was a Viking old! My deeds, though manifold, No Skald in song has told, No Saga taught thee! Take heed, that in thy verse Thou dost the tale rehearse, Else dread a dead man's curse; For this I sought thee.

"Far in the Northern Land, By the wild Baltic's strand, I, with my childish hand, Tamed the gerfalcon; And, with my skates fast-bound, Skimmed the half-frozen Sound, That the poor whimpering hound Trembled to walk on.

"Oft to his frozen lair Tracked I the grisly bear, While from my path the hare Fled like a shadow; Oft through the forest dark Followed the were-wolf's bark, Until the soaring lark Sang from the meadow.

"But when I older grew, Joining a corsair's crew, O'er the dark sea I flew With the marauders. Wild was the life we led; Many the souls that sped, Many the hearts that bled, By our stern orders.

"Many a wassail-bout Wore the long winter out; Often our midnight shout Set the cocks crowing, As we the Berserk's tale Measured in cups of ale, Draining the oaken pail, Filled to o'erflowing.

"Once as I told in glee Tales of the stormy sea, Soft eyes did gaze on me, Burning yet tender; And as the white stars shine On the dark Norway pine, On that dark heart

of mine Fell their soft splendor.

"I wooed the blue-eyed maid, Yielding, yet half afraid, And in the forest's shade Our vows were plighted. Under its loosened vest Fluttered her little breast, Like birds within their nest By the hawk frighted.

"Bright in her father's hall Shields gleamed upon the wall, Loud sang the minstrels all, Chanting his glory; When of old Hildebrand I asked his daughter's hand, Mute did the minstrels stand To hear my story.

"While the brown ale he quaffed, Loud then the champion laughed, And as the wind-gusts waft The sea-foam brightly, So the loud laugh of scorn, Out of those lips unshorn, From the deep drinking-horn Blew the foam lightly.

"She was a Prince's child, I but a Viking wild, And though she blushed and smiled, I was discarded! Should not the dove so white Follow the sea-mew's flight, Why did they leave that night Her nest unguarded?

"Scarce had I put to sea, Bearing the maid with me, Fairest of all was she Among the Norsemen! When on the white sea-strand, Waving his armèd hand, Saw we old Hildebrand, With twenty horsemen.

"Then launched they to the blast, Bent like a reed each mast, Yet we were gaining fast, When the wind failed us; And with a sudden flaw Came round the gusty Skaw, So that our foe we saw Laugh as he hailed us.

"And as to catch the gale Round veered the flapping sail, 'Death!' was the helmsman's hail, 'Death without quarter!' Mid-ships with iron keel Struck we her ribs of steel! Down her black hulk did reel Through the black water!

"As with his wings aslant, Sails the fierce cormorant, Seeking some rocky haunt, With his prey laden.-- So toward the open main, Beating to sea again, Through the wild hurricane, Bore I the maiden.

"Three weeks we westward bore, And when the storm was o'er, Cloud-like we saw the shore Stretching to leeward; There for my lady's bower Built I the lofty tower, Which, to this very hour, Stands looking seaward.

"There lived we many years; Time dried the maiden's tears; She had forgot her fears, She was a mother; Death closed her mild blue eyes, Under that tower she lies; Ne'er shall the sun arise On such another!

"Still grew my bosom then, Still as a stagnant fen! Hateful to me were men, The sunlight hateful! In the vast forest here, Clad in my warlike gear, Fell I upon my spear, Oh, death was grateful!

"Thus, seamed with many scars, Bursting these prison bars, Up to its native stars My soul ascended! There from the flowing bowl Deep drinks the warrior's soul, _Skoal!_ to the Northland! _skoal!_" Thus the tale ended.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

The centuries passed, and no more of the white-skinned race came to the New World. But a new era was at hand; the day drew near when a little fleet was to put out from Spain and turn its prows westward on the grandest voyage the world has ever known.

PROPHECY

From "Il Morgante Maggiore"

1485

His bark The daring mariner shall urge far o'er The Western wave, a smooth and level plain. Albeit the earth is fashioned like a wheel. Man was in ancient days of grosser mould, And Hercules might blush to learn how far Beyond the limits he had vainly set The dullest sea-boat soon shall wing her way. Man shall descry another hemisphere, Since to one common centre all things tend. So earth, by curious mystery divine Well balanced, hangs amid the starry spheres. At our antipodes are cities, states, And throngèd empires, ne'er divined of yore. But see, the sun speeds on his western path To glad the nations with expected light.

LUIGI PULCI.

About 1436 a son was born to Dominico Colombo, wool-comber, of Genoa, and in due time christened Cristoforo. Of his boyhood little is known save that he early went to sea. About 1470 he followed his brother Bartholomew to Lisbon, and in 1474 he was given a map by Toscanelli, the Florentine astronomer, showing Japan and the Indies directly west of Portugal, together with a long letter in which Toscanelli explained his reasons for believing that by sailing west one could reach the East. Columbus, studying the problem month by month, became convinced of the feasibility of such a route to the Indies, and determined himself to traverse it.

THE INSPIRATION

From "The West Indies"

Long lay the ocean-paths from man conceal'd; Light came from heaven,--the magnet was reveal'd, A surer star to guide the seaman's eye Than the pale glory of the northern sky; Alike ordain'd to shine by night and day, Through calm and tempest, with unsetting ray; Where'er the mountains rise, the billows roll, Still with strong impulse turning to the pole, True as the sun is to the morning true, Though light as film, and trembling as the dew.

Then man no longer plied with timid oar, And failing heart, along the windward shore; Broad to the sky he turn'd his fearless sail, Defied the adverse, woo'd the favoring gale, Bared to the storm his adamantine breast, Or soft on ocean's lap lay down to rest; While free, as clouds the liquid ether sweep, His white-wing'd vessels coursed the unbounded deep; From clime to clime the wanderer loved to roam, The waves his heritage, the world his home.

Then first Columbus, with the mighty hand Of grasping genius, weigh'd the sea and land; The floods o'erbalanced:--where the tide of light, Day after day, roll'd down the gulf of night, There seem'd one waste of waters:--long in vain His spirit brooded o'er the Atlantic main; When sudden, as creation burst from nought, Sprang a new world through his stupendous thought, Light, order, beauty!--While his mind explored The unveiling mystery, his heart adored; Where'er sublime imagination trod, He heard the voice, he saw the face of God.

Far from the western cliffs he cast his eye, O'er the wide ocean stretching to the sky: In calm magnificence the sun declined, And left a paradise of clouds behind: Proud at his feet, with pomp of pearl and gold, The billows in a sea of glory roll'd.

"--Ah! on this sea of glory might I sail, Track the bright sun, and pierce the eternal veil That hides those lands, beneath Hesperian skies, Where daylight sojourns till our morrow rise!"

Thoughtful he wander'd on the beach alone; Mild o'er the deep the vesper planet shone, The eye of evening, brightening through the west Till the sweet moment when it shut to rest: "Whither, O golden Venus! art thou fled? Not in the ocean-chambers lies thy bed; Round the dim world thy glittering chariot drawn Pursues the twilight, or precedes the dawn; Thy beauty noon and midnight never see, The morn and eve divide the year with thee."

Soft fell the shades, till Cynthia's slender bow Crested the furthest wave, then sunk below: "Tell me, resplendent guardian of the night, Circling the sphere in thy perennial flight, What secret path of heaven thy smiles adorn, What nameless sea reflects thy gleaming horn?"

Now earth and ocean vanish'd, all serene The starry firmament alone was seen; Through the slow, silent hours, he watch'd the host Of midnight suns in western darkness lost, Till Night himself, on shadowy pinions borne, Fled o'er the mighty waters, and the morn Danced on the mountains:--"Lights of heaven!" he cried, "Lead on;--I go to win a glorious bride; Fearless o'er gulfs unknown I urge my way, Where peril prowls, and shipwreck lurks for prey: Hope swells my sail;--in spirit I behold That maiden-world, twin-sister of the old, By nature nursed beyond the jealous sea, Denied to ages, but betroth'd to me."

JAMES MONTGOMERY.

In 1484 Columbus laid his plan before King John II, of Portugal, but became so disgusted with his treachery and double-dealing, that he left Portugal and entered the service of Ferdinand and Isabella. The Spanish monarchs listened to him with attention, and ordered that the greatest astronomers and cosmographers of the kingdom should assemble at Salamanca and pass upon the feasibility of the project.

COLUMBUS

[January, 1487]

St. Stephen's cloistered hall was proud In learning's pomp that day, For there a robed and stately crowd Pressed on in long array. A mariner with simple chart Confronts that conclave high, While strong ambition stirs his heart, And burning thoughts of wonder part From lip and sparkling eye.

What hath he said? With frowning face, In whispered tones they speak, And lines upon their tablets trace, Which flush each ashen cheek; The Inquisition's mystic doom Sits on their brows severe, And bursting forth in visioned gloom, Sad heresy from burning tomb Groans on the startled ear.

Courage, thou Genoese! Old Time Thy splendid dream shall crown; Yon Western Hemisphere sublime, Where unshorn forests frown, The awful Andes' cloud-wrapt brow, The Indian hunter's bow, Bold streams untamed by helm or prow, And rocks of gold and diamonds, thou To thankless Spain shalt show.

Courage, World-finder! Thou hast need! In Fate's unfolding scroll, Dark woes and ingrate wrongs I read, That rack the noble soul. On! on! Creation's secrets probe, Then drink thy cup of scorn, And wrapped in fallen Cæsar's robe, Sleep like that master of the globe, All glorious,--yet forlorn.

LYDIA HUNTLEY SIGOURNEY.

The council convened at Salamanca and examined Columbus; but it presented to him an almost impenetrable wall of bigotry and prejudice. Long delays and adjournments followed; and for three years the suppliant was put off with excuses and evasions. At last, worn out with waiting and anxiety, he appealed to Ferdinand to give him a definite answer.

COLUMBUS TO FERDINAND

[January, 1491]

Illustrious monarch of Iberia's soil, Too long I wait permission to depart; Sick of delays, I beg thy list'ning ear-- Shine forth the patron and the prince of art.

While yet Columbus breathes the vital air, Grant his request to pass the western main: Reserve this glory for thy native soil, And what must please thee more--for thy own reign.

Of this huge globe, how small a part we know-- Does heaven their worlds to western suns deny?-- How disproportion'd to the mighty deep The lands that yet in human prospect lie!

Does Cynthia, when to western skies arriv'd, Spend her sweet beam upon the barren main, And ne'er illume with midnight splendor, she, The natives dancing on the lightsome green?--

Should the vast circuit of the world contain Such wastes of ocean, and such scanty land?-- 'Tis reason's voice that bids me think not so, I think more nobly of the Almighty hand.

Does yon fair lamp trace half the circle round To light the waves and monsters of the seas?-- No--be there must beyond the billowy waste Islands, and men, and animals, and trees.

An unremitting flame my breast inspires To seek new lands amidst the barren waves, Where falling low, the source of day descends, And the blue sea his evening visage laves.

Hear, in his tragic lay, Cordova's sage: "_The time shall come, when numerous years are past, The ocean shall dissolve the bonds of things, And an extended region rise at last;_

"_And Typhis shall disclose the mighty land Far, far away, where none have rov'd before; Nor shall the world's remotest region be Gibraltar's rock, or Thule's savage shore._"

Fir'd at the theme, I languish to depart, Supply the barque, and bid Columbus sail; He fears no storms upon the untravell'd deep; Reason shall steer, and skill disarm the gale.

Nor does he dread to lose the intended course, Though far from land the reeling galley stray, And skies above and gulphy seas below Be the sole objects seen for many a day.

Think not that Nature has unveil'd in vain The mystic magnet to the mortal eye: So late have we the guiding needle plann'd Only to sail beneath our native sky?

Ere this was found, the ruling power of all Found for our use an ocean in the land, Its breadth so small we could not wander long, Nor long be absent from the neighboring strand.

Short was the course, and guided by the stars, But stars no more shall point our daring way; The Bear shall sink, and every guard be drown'd, And great Arcturus scarce escape the sea,

When southward we shall steer--O grant my wish, Supply the barque, and bid Columbus sail, He dreads no tempests on the untravell'd deep, Reason shall steer, and skill disarm the gale.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

Early in 1491 the council of Salamanca reported that the proposed enterprise was vain and impossible of execution, and Ferdinand accepted the decision. Indignant at thought of the years he had wasted, Columbus started for Paris, to lay his plan before the King of France. He was accompanied by his son, Diego, and stopped one night at the convent of La Rabida, near Palos, to ask for food and shelter. The prior, Juan Perez de Marchena, became interested in his project, detained him, and finally secured for him another audience of Isabella.

COLUMBUS AT THE CONVENT

[July, 1491]

Dreary and brown the night comes down, Gloomy, without a star. On Palos town the night comes down; The day departs with a stormy frown; The sad sea moans afar.

A convent-gate is near; 'tis late; Ting-ling! the bell they ring. They ring the bell, they ask for bread-- "Just for my child," the father said. Kind hands the bread will bring.

White was his hair, his mien was fair, His look was calm and great. The porter ran and called a friar; The friar made haste and told the prior; The prior came to the gate.

He took them in, he gave them food; The traveller's dreams he heard; And fast the midnight moments flew, And fast the good man's wonder grew, And all his heart was stirred.

The child the while, with soft, sweet smile Forgetful of all sorrow, Lay soundly sleeping in his bed. The good man kissed him then, and said: "You leave us not to-morrow!

"I pray you rest the convent's guest; The child shall be our own-- A precious care, while you prepare Your business with the court, and bear Your message to the throne."

And so his guest he comforted. O wise, good prior! to you, Who cheered the stranger's darkest days, And helped him on his way, what praise And gratitude are due!

JOHN T. TROWBRIDGE.

Isabella and Ferdinand were with their army before Granada, and received Columbus well; but his demands for emoluments and honors in the event of success were pronounced absurd; the negotiations were broken off, and again Columbus started for France. The few converts to his theories were in despair, and one of them, Luis de Santangel, receiver of the ecclesiastical revenues of Aragon, obtained an audience of the Queen, and enkindled her patriotic spirit. When Ferdinand still hesitated, she exclaimed, "I undertake the enterprise for my own crown of Castile. I will pledge my jewels to raise the money that is needed!" Santangel assured her that he himself was ready to provide the money, and advanced seventeen thousand florins from the coffers of Aragon, so that Ferdinand really paid for the expedition, after all.

THE FINAL STRUGGLE

From "The New World"

[January 6--April 17, 1492]

Yet had his sun not risen; from his lips Fell in swift fervid accents his desire, And Talavera's eyes of smouldering fire Shone with a myriad doubts, a dark eclipse Of faith hung round him, and the longed-for ships Ploughed but the ocean of his star-lit dreams; Time had not tried his soul enough with whips And scorns, for so the rigid Master deems He makes his servants fit For the hard toils which knit The perfect garment, firm and without seams, The world shall wear at last; his hurt brain teems

With indignation and he turns away Undaunted, and he girds him for the fray Once more; but first he hears the words of his good friend, Marchena, strong with trust in the far-shining end.

His wanderings reached at last the lonely door Of calm La Rabida; there the silence came Grateful upon his grief's consuming flame; The simple cloisters gave him peace once more, And the live ocean rolled up to the shore In ceaseless voice of promise; through the pines The sun looked down benignant, and the roar Of the far world of rivalries declines Into an inward murmur With each day growing firmer, Whose sense is conquest at the last; as shines A lamp across a rocky path's confines, Making the outlet clear, Juan Perez' faith Who heard him and conceived his words no wraith Of fevered fancy but the very truth, was light To bring the Queen to know his purposes aright.

O noble priest and friend! you reached the court And turned the Queen from conquest's mid career To hearken; other triumphs glittered clear Before her, and again from Huelva's port The seeker came; he saw Granada's fort Open its gates reluctant, and the King, El Zogoibi, bewail his bitter sort And loss which made the rich _Te Deums_ ring When on La Vela's tower The cross bloomed like a flower Of heaven's own growing; but the sudden spring, Loud with birds silent long that strove to sing, After the winter's weary voiceless reign, Was overcast with storms of cold disdain; Haughtily forth he fared and reached Granada's gates When the clouds lifted and the persecuting fates

Relented from their fury; for the Queen Listened unto the urgings manifold Of Santangel, and counsel, wise and bold, Of the far-seeing Marchioness, whose keen Divinings pierced the misty ocean's screen And felt the deed must surely come to pass; So they recalled him, and his life's changed scene Grew bright with blooms and smile of thickening grass; O royal woman then Your hand received again The keys of a great realm; in the clear glass Of actions yet to be whose fires amass Infinite stores of impulse toward the good, Your image permanent lies; forth from the wood Of beasts malicious and the unrelenting dread You showed the way, but sought not from the gloom to tread.

The wind was fair, the ships lay in the bay, And the blue sky looked down upon the earth; Prophetic time laughed toward the nearing birth Of the strong child with whom should come a day That dulled all earlier hours. Forth on the way With holy blessings said, and bellied sails, And mounting joy that knows not let nor stay! Lo! the undaunted purpose never fails! O patient master, seer, For whom the far is near, The vision true, and the mere present pales Its lustre, what mild seas and blossomed vales Awaited you? haply a paradise But not the one which drew your swerveless eyes; Could you have known what lands were there beyond the main, You surelier would have turned to gladsomeness from pain.

LOUIS JAMES BLOCK.

With the greatest difficulty, Columbus managed to secure three little vessels, the Santa Maria, the Pinta, and the Niña, and to enlist about a hundred and twenty men for the enterprise. Early in the morning of Friday, August 3, 1492, this tiny fleet

sailed out from Palos and turned their prows to the west.

STEER, BOLD MARINER, ON!

[August 3, 1492]

Steer, bold mariner, on! albeit witlings deride thee, And the steersman drop idly his hand at the helm. Ever and ever to westward! there must the coast be discovered, If it but lie distinct, luminous lie in thy mind. Trust to the God that leads thee, and follow the sea that is silent; Did it not yet exist, now would it rise from the flood. Nature with Genius stands united in league everlasting; What is promised by one, surely the other performs.

FRIEDRICH VON SCHILLER.

The fleet reached the Canaries without misadventure, but when the shores of Ferro sank from sight, the sailors gave themselves up for lost. Their terror increased day by day; the compass behaved strangely, the boats became entangled in vast meadows of floating seaweed; and finally the trade-winds wafted them so steadily westward that they became convinced they could never return. By October 4 there were ominous signs of mutiny, and finally, on the 11th, affairs reached a crisis.

THE TRIUMPH[2]

From "Psalm of the West"

[Dawn, October 12, 1492]

Santa Maria, well thou tremblest down the wave, Thy Pinta far abow, thy Niña nigh astern: Columbus stands in the night alone, and, passing grave, Yearns o'er the sea as tones o'er under-silence yearn. Heartens his heart as friend befriends his friend less brave, Makes burn the faiths that cool, and cools the doubts that burn:--

"'Twixt this and dawn, three hours my soul will smite With prickly seconds, or less tolerably With dull-blade minutes flatwise slapping me. Wait, Heart! Time moves.--Thou lithe young Western Night, Just-crownèd king, slow riding to thy right, Would God that I might straddle mutiny Calm as thou sitt'st yon never-managed sea, Balk'st with his balking, fliest with his flight, Giv'st supple to his rearings and his falls, Nor dropp'st one coronal star above thy brow Whilst ever dayward thou art steadfast drawn! Yea, would I rode these mad contentious brawls No damage taking from their If and How, Nor no result save galloping to my Dawn!

"My Dawn? my Dawn? How if it never break? How if this West by other Wests is pieced, And these by vacant Wests on Wests increased-- One Pain of Space, with hollow ache on ache Throbbing and ceasing not for Christ's own sake?-- Big perilous theorem, hard for king and priest: _Pursue the West but long enough, 'tis East!_ Oh, if this watery world no turning take! Oh, if for all my logic, all my dreams, Provings of that which is by that which seems, Fears, hopes, chills, heats, hastes, patiences, droughts, tears, Wife-grievings, slights on love, embezzled years, Hates, treaties, scorns, upliftings, loss and gain,-- This earth, no sphere, be all one sickening plane!

"Or, haply, how if this contrarious West, That me by turns hath starved, by turns hath fed, Embraced, disgraced, beat back, solicited, Have no fixed heart of Law within his breast, Or with some different rhythm doth e'er contest Nature in the East? Why, 'tis but three weeks fled I saw my Judas needle shake his head And flout the Pole that, East, he Lord confessed! God! if this West should own some other Pole, And with his tangled ways perplex my soul Until the maze grow mortal, and I die Where distraught Nature clean hath gone astray, On earth some other wit than Time's at play, Some other God than mine above the sky!

"Now speaks mine other heart with cheerier seeming: _Ho, Admiral! o'er-defalking to thy crew Against thyself, thyself far overfew To front yon multitudes of rebel scheming?_ Come, ye wild twenty years of heavenly dreaming! Come, ye wild weeks since first this canvas drew Out of vexed Palos ere the dawn was blue, O'er milky waves about the bows full-creaming! Come set me round with many faithful spears Of confident remembrance--how I crushed Cat-lived rebellions, pitfalled treasons, hushed Scared husbands' heart-break cries on distant wives, Made cowards blush at whining for their lives, Watered my parching souls, and dried their tears.

"Ere we Gomera cleared, a coward cried, _Turn, turn: here be three caravels ahead, From Portugal, to take us: we are dead!_-- _Hold Westward, pilot,_ calmly I replied. So when the last land down the horizon died, _Go back, go back!_ they prayed: _our hearts are lead_.-- _Friends, we are bound into the West_, I said. Then passed the wreck of a mast upon our side. _See_ (so they wept) _God's Warning! Admiral, turn!_-- _Steersman_, I said, _hold straight into the West_. Then down the night we saw the meteor burn. _So do the very heavens in fire protest: Good Admiral, put about! O Spain, dear Spain!_-- _Hold straight into the West_, I said again.

"Next drive we o'er the slimy-weeded sea. _Lo! here beneath_ (another coward cries) _The cursèd land of sunk Atlantis lies! This slime will suck us down--turn while thou'rt free!_-- _But no!_ I said, _Freedom bears West for me!_ Yet when the long-time stagnant winds arise, And day by day the keel to westward flies, My Good my people's Ill doth come to be: _Ever the winds into the West do blow; Never a ship, once turned, might homeward go; Meanwhile we speed into the lonesome main. For Christ's sake, parley, Admiral! Turn, before We sail outside all bounds of help from pain!_-- _Our help is in the West_, I said once more.

"So when there came a mighty cry of _Land!_ And we clomb up and saw, and shouted strong _Salve Regina!_ all the ropes along, But knew at morn how that a counterfeit band Of level clouds had aped a silver strand; So when we heard the orchard-bird's small song, And all the people cried, _A hellish throng To tempt us onward by the Devil planned, Yea, all from hell--keen heron, fresh green weeds, Pelican, tunny-fish, fair tapering reeds, Lie-telling lands that ever shine and die In clouds of nothing round the empty sky. Tired Admiral, get thee from this hell, and rest!_-- _Steersman,_ I said, _hold straight into the West_.

"I marvel how mine eye, ranging the Night, From its big circling ever absently Returns, thou large low Star, to fix on thee. _Maria!_ Star? No star: a Light, a Light! Wouldst leap ashore, Heart? Yonder burns--a Light. Pedro Gutierrez, wake! come up

to me. I prithee stand and gaze about the sea: What seest? _Admiral, like as land--a Light!_ Well! Sanchez of Segovia, come and try: What seest? _Admiral, naught but sea and sky!_ Well! but _I_ saw It. Wait! the Pinta's gun! Why, look, 'tis dawn, the land is clear: 'tis done! Two dawns do break at once from Time's full hand-- God's, East--mine, West: good friends, behold my Land!"

SIDNEY LANIER.

[2] From Poems by Sidney Lanier; copyright, 1884, 1891, by Mary D. Lanier; published by Charles Scribner's Sons.

At daybreak of Friday, October 12 (N. S. October 22), the boats were lowered and Columbus, with a large part of his company, went ashore, wild with exultation. They found that they were on a small island, and Columbus named it San Salvador. It was one of the Bahamas, but which one is not certainly known.

COLUMBUS

Behind him lay the gray Azores, Behind the Gates of Hercules; Before him not the ghost of shores, Before him only shoreless seas. The good mate said: "Now must we pray, For lo! the very stars are gone. Brave Admiral, speak, what shall I say?" "Why, say 'Sail on! sail on! and on!'"

"My men grow mutinous day by day; My men grow ghastly wan, and weak." The stout mate thought of home; a spray Of salt wave washed his swarthy cheek. "What shall I say, brave Admiral, say, If we sight naught but seas at dawn?" "Why, you shall say at break of day, 'Sail on! sail on! sail on! and on!'"

They sailed and sailed, as winds might blow, Until at last the blanched mate said: "Why, now not even God would know Should I and all my men fall dead. These very winds forget their way, For God from these dread seas is gone. Now speak, brave Admiral, speak and say"-- He said: "Sail on! sail on! and on!"

They sailed. They sailed. Then spake the mate: "This mad sea shows his teeth to-night. He lifts his lip, he lies in wait, With lifted teeth, as if to bite! Brave Admiral, say but one good word: What shall we do when hope is gone?" The words leapt like a leaping sword: "Sail on! sail on! sail on! and on!"

Then, pale and worn, he kept his deck, And peered through darkness. Ah, that night Of all dark nights! And then a speck-- A light! a light! a light! a light! It grew, a starlit flag unfurled! It grew to be Time's burst of dawn. He gained a world; he gave that world Its grandest lesson: "On! sail on!"

JOAQUIN MILLER.

Columbus reached Spain again on March 15, 1493, and at once sent word of his arrival to Ferdinand and Isabella, who were at Barcelona. He was summoned to appear before them and was received with triumphal honors. The King and Queen arose at his approach, directed him to seat himself in their presence, and listened with intense interest to his story of the voyage. When he had finished, they sank to their knees, as did all present, and thanked God for this mark of his favor.

THE THANKSGIVING FOR AMERICA

[Barcelona, April, 1493]

I

'Twas night upon the Darro. The risen moon above the silvery tower Of Comares shone, the silver sun of night, And poured its lustrous splendors through the halls Of the Alhambra. The air was breathless, Yet filled with ceaseless songs of nightingales, And odors sweet of falling orange blooms; The misty lamps were burning odorous oil; The uncurtained balconies were full of life, And laugh and song, and airy castanets And gay guitars. Afar Sierras rose, Domes, towers, and pinnacles, over royal heights, Whose crowns were gemmed with stars. The Generaliffe, The summer palace of old Moorish kings In vanished years, stood sentinel afar, A pile of shade, as brighter grew the moon, Impearling fountain sprays, and shimmering On seas of citron orchards cool and green, And terraces embowered with vernal vines And breathing flowers. In shadowy arcades Were loitering priests, and here and there A water-carrier passed with tinkling bells. There came a peal of horns That woke Granada, city of delights, From its long moonlight reverie. Again:-- The suave lute ceased to play, the castanet; The water-bearer stopped, and ceased his song The wandering troubadour. Then rent the air Another joyous peal, and oped the gates And entered there a train of cavaliers, Their helmets glittering in the low red moon, The streets and balconies All danced with wondering life. The train moved on, And filled the air again the horns melodious, And loud the heralds shouted:--

"_Thy name, O Fernando, through all earth shall be sounded, Columbus has triumphed, his foes are confounded!_"

A silence followed. Could such tidings be? Men heard and whispered, Eyes glanced to eyes, feet uncertain moved, Never on mortal ears had fallen words Like these. And was the earth a star? On marched the cavaliers, And pealed again the horns, and again cried The heralds:--

"_Thy name, Isabella, through all earth shall be sounded, Columbus has triumphed, his foes are confounded!_"

All hearts were thrilled. "Isabella!" That name breathed faith and hope And lofty aim. Emotion swayed the crowds: Tears flowed, and acclamations rose, and rushed The wondering multitudes toward the plaza. "Isabella! Isabella!" it filled The air--that one word "Isabella!" And now 'Tis noon of night. The moon hangs near the earth-- A golden moon in golden air; the peaks Like silver tents of shadowy sentinels Glint 'gainst the sky. The plaza gleams and surges Like a sea. The joyful horns peal forth again, And falls a hush, and cry the heralds:--

"_Thy name, Isabella, shall be praised by all the living; Haste, haste to Barcelona, and join the Great Thanksgiving!_"

What nights had seen Granada! Yet never one like this! The moon went down And fell the wings of shadow, yet the streets Still swarmed with people hurrying on and

on.

II

Morn came, With bursts of nightingales and quivering fires. The cavaliers rode forth toward Barcelona. The city followed, throbbing with delight. The happy troubadour, the muleteer, The craftsmen all, the boy and girl, and e'en The mother--'twas a soft spring morn; The fairest skies of earth those April morns In Andalusia. Long was the journey, But the land was flowers and the nights were not, And birds sang all the hours, and breezes cool Fanned all the ways along the sea. The roads were filled With hurrying multitudes. For well 'twas known That he, the conqueror, viceroy of the isles, Was riding from Seville to meet the king. And what were conquerors before to him whose eye Had seen the world a star, and found the star a world? Once he had walked The self-same ways, roofless and poor and sad, A beggar at old convent doors, and heard The very children jeer him in the streets, And ate his crust and made his roofless bed Upon the flowers beside his boy, and prayed, And found in trust a pillow radiant With dreams immortal. Now?

III

That was a glorious day That dawned on Barcelona. Banners filled The thronging towers, the old bells rung, and blasts Of lordly trumpets seemed to reach the sky Cerulean. All Spain had gathered there, And waited there his coming; Castilian knights, Gay cavaliers, hidalgos young, and e'en the old Puissant grandees of far Aragon, With glittering mail, and waving plumes, and all The peasant multitude with bannerets And charms and flowers. Beneath pavilions Of brocades of gold, the Court had met. The dual crowns of Leon old and proud Castile There waited him, the peasant mariner. The trumpets waited Near the open gates; the minstrels young and fair Upon the tapestried and arrased walls, And everywhere from all the happy provinces The wandering troubadours. Afar was heard A cry, a long acclaim. Afar was seen A proud and stately steed with nodding plumes, Bridled with gold, whose rider stately rode, And still afar a long and sinuous train Of silvery cavaliers. A shout arose, And all the city, all the vales and hills, With silver trumpets rung. He came, the Genoese, With reverent look and calm and lofty mien, And saw the wondering eyes and heard the cries And trumpet peals, as one who followed still Some Guide unseen. Before his steed Crowned Indians marched with lowly faces, And wondered at the new world that they saw; Gay parrots shouted from their gold-bound arms, And from their crests swept airy plumes. The sun Shone full in splendor on the scene, and here The old and new world met. But--

IV

Hark! the heralds! How they thrill all hearts and fill all eyes with tears! The very air seems throbbing with delight; Hark! hark! they cry, in chorus all they cry:--

"_Á Castilla y á Leon, á Castilla y á Leon, Nuevo mundo dio Colon!_"

Every heart now beats with his, The stately rider on whose calm face shines A heaven-born inspiration. Still the shout: "_Nuevo mundo dio Colon!_" how it rings! From wall to wall, from knights and cavaliers, And from the multitudinous throngs, A mighty chorus of the vales and hills! "_Á Castilla y á Leon!_" And now the golden steed Draws near the throne; the crowds move back, and rise The reverent crowns of Leon and Castile; And stands before the tear-filled eyes of all The multitudes the form of Isabella. Semiramis? Zenobia? What were they To her, as met her eyes again the eyes of him Into whose hands her love a year before Emptied its jewels! He told his tale: The untried deep, the green Sargasso Sea, The varying compass, the affrighted crews, The hymn they sung on every doubtful eve, The sweet hymn to the Virgin. How there came The land birds singing, and the drifting weeds, How broke the morn on fair San Salvador, How the _Te Deum_ on that isle was sung, And how the cross was lifted in the name Of Leon and Castile. And then he turned His face towards Heaven, "O Queen! O Queen! There kingdoms wait the triumphs of the cross!"

V

Then Isabella rose, With face illumined: then overcome with joy She sank upon her knees, and king and court And nobles rose and knelt beside her, And followed them the sobbing multitude; Then came a burst of joy, a chorus grand, And mighty antiphon--

"_We praise thee, Lord, and, Lord, acknowledge thee, And give thee glory!--Holy, Holy, Holy!_"

Loud and long it swelled and thrilled the air, That first Thanksgiving for the new-found world!

VI

The twilight roses bloomed In the far skies o'er Barcelona. The gentle Indians came and stood before The throne, and smiled the queen, and said: "I see my gems again." The shadow fell, And trilled all night beneath the moon and stars The happy nightingales.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

Royal favor is capricious and Columbus had his full share of enemies at court. These, in the end, succeeded in gaining the King's ear; Columbus was arrested in San Domingo and sent back to Spain in chains. Isabella ordered them struck off, and promised him that he should be reimbursed for his losses and restored to all his dignities; but the promise was never kept.

COLUMBUS IN CHAINS

[August, 1500]

Are these the honors they reserve for me, Chains for the man who gave new worlds to Spain! Rest here, my swelling heart!--O kings, O queens, Patrons of monsters, and their progeny, Authors of wrong, and slaves to fortune merely! Why was I seated by my prince's side, Honor'd, caress'd like some first peer of Spain? Was it that I might fall most suddenly From honor's summit to the sink of scandal? 'Tis done, 'tis done!--what madness is ambition! What is there in that little breath of men, Which they call Fame, that should induce the brave To forfeit ease and that domestic bliss Which is the lot of happy ignorance, Less glorious aims, and dull humility?-- Whoe'er thou art that shalt aspire to honor, And on the strength and vigor of the mind Vainly depending, court a monarch's favor, Pointing the way to vast extended empire; First count your pay to be ingratitude, Then chains and prisons, and disgrace like mine! Each wretched pilot now shall spread his sails, And treading in my footsteps, hail new worlds, Which, but for me, had still been empty visions.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

On November 7, 1504, Columbus landed in Spain after a fourth voyage to America, during which he had endured sufferings and privations almost beyond description. He was a broken man, and the last blow was the death of Isabella, nineteen days after he reached Seville. Her death left him without patron or protector, and the last eighteen months of his life were spent in sickness and poverty. He died at Valladolid, May 20, 1506.

COLUMBUS DYING

[May 20, 1506]

Hark! do I hear again the roar Of the tides by the Indies sweeping down? Or is it the surge from the viewless shore That swells to bear me to my crown? Life is hollow and cold and drear With smiles that darken and hopes that flee; And, far from its winds that faint and veer, I am ready to sail the vaster sea!

Lord, Thou knowest I love Thee best; And that scorning peril and toil and pain, I held my way to the mystic West, Glory for Thee and Thy Church to gain. And Thou didst lead me, only Thou, Cheering my heart in cloud and calm, Till the dawn my glad, victorious prow Greeted Thine isles of bloom and balm.

And then, O gracious, glorious Lord, I saw Thy face, and all heaven came nigh And my soul was lost in that rich reward, And ravished with hope of the bliss on high, So, I can meet the sovereign's frown-- My dear Queen gone--with a large disdain; For the time will come when his chief renown Will be that I sailed from his realm of Spain.

I have found new Lands--a World, maybe, Whose splendor will yet the Old outshine; And life and death are alike to me, For earth will honor, and heaven is mine Is mine!--What songs of sweet accord! What billows that nearer, gentler roll! Is mine!--Into Thy hands, O Lord, Into Thy hands I give my soul!

EDNA DEAN PROCTOR.

COLUMBUS

Give me white paper! This which you use is black and rough with smears Of sweat and grime and fraud and blood and tears, Crossed with the story of men's sins and fears, Of battle and of famine all these years, When all God's children had forgot their birth, And drudged and fought and died like beasts of earth.

"Give me white paper!" One storm-trained seaman listened to the word; What no man saw he saw; he heard what no man heard. In answer he compelled the sea To eager man to tell The secret she had kept so well! Left blood and guilt and tyranny behind,-- Sailing still West the hidden shore to find; For all mankind that unstained scroll unfurled, Where God might write anew the story of the World.

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

COLUMBUS AND THE MAYFLOWER

O little fleet! that on thy quest divine Sailedst from Palos one bright autumn morn, Say, has old Ocean's bosom ever borne A freight of faith and hope to match with thine?

Say, too, has Heaven's high favor given again Such consummation of desire as shone About Columbus when he rested on The new-found world and married it to Spain?

Answer,--thou refuge of the freeman's need,-- Thou for whose destinies no kings looked out, Nor sages to resolve some mighty doubt,-- Thou simple Mayflower of the salt-sea mead!

When thou wert wafted to that distant shore, Gay flowers, bright birds, rich odors met thee not, Stern Nature hailed thee to a sterner lot,-- God gave free earth and air, and gave no more.

Thus to men cast in that heroic mould Came empire such as Spaniard never knew, Such empire as beseems the just and true; And at the last, almost unsought, came gold.

But He who rules both calm and stormy days, Can guard that people's heart, that nation's health, Safe on the perilous heights of power and wealth, As in the straitness of the ancient ways.

LORD HOUGHTON.

CHAPTER II

IN THE WAKE OF COLUMBUS

The news of Columbus's discoveries soon spread through western Europe, and in May, 1497, John Cabot sailed from Bristol, England, in the Matthew, and discovered what he supposed to be the Chinese coast on June 24. The thrifty Henry VII gave him

the sum of £10 as a reward for this achievement. Cabot was the first European since the vikings to set foot on the North American continent.

THE FIRST VOYAGE OF JOHN CABOT

[1497]

"He chases shadows," sneered the British tars. "As well fling nets to catch the golden stars As climb the surges of earth's utmost sea." But for the Venice pilot, meagre, wan, His swarthy sons beside him, life began With that slipt cable, when his dream rode free.

And Henry, on his battle-wrested throne, The Councils done, would speak in musing tone Of Cabot, not the cargo he might bring. "Man's heart, though morsel scant for hungry crow, Is greater than a world can fill, and so Fair fall the shadow-seekers!" quoth the king.

Colonies were planted by the Spaniards in Cuba and Hispaniola, but the New World continued to be for them a land of wonder and mystery. They were quite ready to believe any marvel,--among others, that somewhere to the north lay an island named Bimini, on which was a fountain whose waters gave perpetual youth to all who bathed therein.

THE LEGEND OF WAUKULLA

[1513]

Through darkening pines the cavaliers marched on their sunset way, While crimson in the trade-winds rolled far Appalachee Bay, Above the water-levels rose palmetto crowns like ghosts Of kings primeval; them, behind, the shadowy pines in hosts. "O cacique, brave and trusty guide, Are we not near the spring, The fountain of eternal youth that health to age doth bring?" The cacique sighed, And Indian guide, "The fount is fair, Waukulla!

"But vainly to the blossomed flower will come the autumn rain, And never youth's departed days come back to age again; The future in the spirit lies, the earthly life is brief, 'Tis _you_ that say the fount hath life," so said the Indian chief. "Nay, Indian king; nay, Indian king, Thou knowest well the spring, And thou shalt die if thou dost fail our feet to it to bring." The cacique sighed, And Indian guide, "The spring is bright, Waukulla!"

Then said the guide, "O men of Spain, a wondrous fountain flows From deep abodes of gods below, and health on men bestows. Blue are its deeps and green its walls, and from its waters gleam The water-stars, and from it runs the pure Waukulla's stream. But men of Spain, but men of Spain, 'Tis _you_ who say that spring Eternal youth and happiness to men again will bring." The cacique sighed, And Indian guide, "The fount is clear, Waukulla!"

"March on, the land enchanted is; march on, ye men of Spain; Who would not taste the bliss of youth and all its hopes again. Enchanted is the land; behold! enchanted is

the air; The very heaven is domed with gold; there's beauty everywhere!" So said De Leon. "Cavaliers, We're marching to the spring, The fountain of eternal youth that health to age will bring!" The cacique sighed, And Indian guide, "The fount is pure, Waukulla!"

Beneath the pines, beneath the yews, the deep magnolia shades, The clear Waukulla swift pursues its way through floral glades; Beneath the pines, beneath the yews, beneath night's falling shade, Beneath the low and dusky moon still marched the cavalcade. "The river widens," said the men; "Are we not near the spring, The fountain of eternal youth that health to age doth bring?" The cacique sighed, And Indian guide, "The spring is near, Waukulla!"

"The fount is fair and bright and clear, and pure its waters run; Waukulla, lovely in the moon and beauteous in the sun. But vainly to the blossomed flower will come the autumn rain, And never youth's departed days come back to man again. O men of Spain! O men of Spain! 'Tis you that say the spring Eternal youth and happiness to withered years will bring!" The cacique sighed, And Indian guide, "The fount is deep, Waukulla!"

The river to a grotto led, as to a god's abode; There lay the fountain bright with stars; stars in its waters flowed; The mighty live-oaks round it rose, in ancient mosses clad; De Leon's heart beat high for joy; the cavaliers were glad, "O men of Spain! O men of Spain! This surely is the spring, The fountain fair that health and joy to faces old doth bring!" The cacique sighed, And Indian guide, "The spring is old, Waukulla!"

"Avalla, O my trusty friend that we this day should see! Strip off thy doublet and descend the glowing fount with me!" "The saints! I will," Avalla said. "Already young I feel, And younger than my sons shall I return to old Castile." Then plunged De Leon in the spring And then Avalla old, Then slowly rose each wrinkled face above the waters cold. The cacique sighed, And Indian guide, "The fount is false, Waukulla!"

O vainly to the blossomed flower will come the autumn rain, And never youth's departed days come back to man again; The crowns Castilian could not bring the withered stalk a leaf, But came a sabre flash that morn, and fell the Indian chief. Another sabre flash, and then The guide beside him lay, And red the clear Waukulla ran toward Appalachee Bay. Then from the dead The Spaniards fled, And cursed the spring, Waukulla.

"Like comrades life was left behind, the years shall o'er me roll, For all the hopes that man can find lies hidden in the soul. Ye white sails lift, and drift again across the southern main; There wait for me, there wait us all, the hollow tombs of Spain!" Beneath the liquid stars the sails Arose and went their way, And bore the gray-haired cavaliers from Appalachee Bay. The young chief slept, The maiden wept, Beside the bright Waukulla.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

In 1512 Juan Ponce de Leon received a grant to discover and settle this fabulous island. He sailed from Porto Rico in search of it in March, 1513, and found an island but no fountain. Pushing on, he discovered the mainland March 27, and, on April 2,

landed and took possession of the country for the King of Spain, calling it Florida.

THE FOUNTAIN OF YOUTH

A DREAM OF PONCE DE LEON

[1513]

I

A story of Ponce de Leon, A voyager, withered and old, Who came to the sunny Antilles, In quest of a country of gold. He was wafted past islands of spices, As bright as the Emerald seas, Where all the forests seem singing, So thick were the birds on the trees; The sea was as clear as the azure, And so deep and so pure was the sky That the jasper-walled city seemed shining Just out of the reach of the eye. By day his light canvas he shifted, And rounded strange harbors and bars; By night, on the full tides he drifted, 'Neath the low-hanging lamps of the stars. Near the glimmering gates of the sunset, In the twilight empurpled and dim, The sailors uplifted their voices, And sang to the Virgin a hymn. "Thank the Lord!" said De Leon, the sailor, At the close of the rounded refrain; "Thank the Lord, the Almighty, who blesses The ocean-swept banner of Spain! The shadowy world is behind us, The shining Cèpango, before; Each morning the sun rises brighter On ocean, and island, and shore. And still shall our spirits grow lighter, As prospects more glowing enfold; Then on, merry men! to Cèpango, To the west, and the regions of gold!"

II

There came to De Leon, the sailor, Some Indian sages, who told Of a region so bright that the waters Were sprinkled with islands of gold. And they added: "The leafy Bimini, A fair land of grottos and bowers, Is there; and a wonderful fountain Upsprings from its gardens of flowers. That fountain gives life to the dying, And youth to the aged restores; They flourish in beauty eternal, Who set but their foot on its shores!" Then answered De Leon, the sailor: "I am withered, and wrinkled, and old; I would rather discover that fountain Than a country of diamonds and gold."

III

Away sailed De Leon, the sailor; Away with a wonderful glee, Till the birds were more rare in the azure, The dolphins more rare in the sea. Away from the shady Bahamas, Over waters no sailor had seen, Till again on his wondering vision, Rose clustering islands of green. Still onward he sped till the breezes Were laden with odors, and lo! A country embedded with flowers, A country with rivers aglow! More bright than the sunny Antilles, More fair than the shady Azores. "Thank the Lord!" said De Leon, the sailor As feasted his eye on the shores, "We have come to a region, my brothers, More lovely than earth, of a truth; And here is the life-giving fountain,-- The beautiful

Fountain of Youth."

IV

Then landed De Leon, the sailor, Unfurled his old banner, and sung; But he felt very wrinkled and withered, All around was so fresh and so young. The palms, ever-verdant, were blooming, Their blossoms e'en margined the seas; O'er the streams of the forests bright flowers Hung deep from the branches of trees. "Praise the Lord!" sung De Leon, the sailor; His heart was with rapture aflame; And he said: "Be the name of this region By Florida given to fame. 'Tis a fair, a delectable country. More lovely than earth, of a truth; I soon shall partake of the fountain,-- The beautiful Fountain of Youth!"

V

But wandered De Leon, the sailor, In search of that fountain in vain; No waters were there to restore him To freshness and beauty again. And his anchor he lifted, and murmured, As the tears gathered fast in his eye, "I must leave this fair land of the flowers, Go back o'er the ocean, and die." Then back by the dreary Tortugas, And back by the shady Azores, He was borne on the storm-smitten waters To the calm of his own native shores. And that he grew older and older, His footsteps enfeebled gave proof, Still he thirsted in dreams for the fountain, The beautiful Fountain of Youth.

* * * * *

VI

One day the old sailor lay dying On the shores of a tropical isle, And his heart was enkindled with rapture, And his face lighted up with a smile. He thought of the sunny Antilles, He thought of the shady Azores, He thought of the dreamy Bahamas, He thought of fair Florida's shores. And, when in his mind he passed over His wonderful travels of old, He thought of the heavenly country, Of the city of jasper and gold. "Thank the Lord!" said De Leon, the sailor, "Thank the Lord for the light of the truth, I now am approaching the fountain, The beautiful Fountain of Youth."

VII

The cabin was silent: at twilight They heard the birds singing a psalm, And the wind of the ocean low sighing Through groves of the orange and palm. The sailor still lay on his pallet, 'Neath the low-hanging vines of the roof; His soul had gone forth to discover The beautiful Fountain of Youth.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

In March, 1521, De Leon led a large party to Florida and attempted to plant a colony there, but they were driven away by the Indians. De Leon himself was wounded in the thigh by an arrow. The wound was unskillfully treated, and the old

adventurer died of it in Cuba shortly afterwards.

PONCE DE LEON

[1521]

You that crossed the ocean old, Not from greed of Inca's gold, But to search by vale and mount, Wood and rock, the wizard fount Where Time's harm is well undone,-- Here's to Ponce de Leon, And your liegemen every one! Surely, still beneath the sun, In some region further west, You live on and have your rest, While the world goes spinning round, And the sky hears the resound Of a thousand shrill new fames, Which your jovial silence shames! Strength and joy your days endow, Youth's eyes glow beneath your brow; Wars and vigils are forgot, And the Scytheman threats you not. Tell us, of your knightly grace, Tell us, left you not some trace Leading to that wellspring true Where old souls their age renew?

EDITH M. THOMAS.

The Spaniards, meanwhile, had pushed on across the Caribbean Sea and founded Darien, whither, in 1510, came one Vasco Nuñez Balboa. He made numerous explorations, and, learning from the Indians that there was a great sea to the south, determined to search for it. He started from Darien September 1, 1513, and on the 25th reached the top of a mountain from which he first saw the Pacific. He gained the shore four days later, and, wading into the water, took possession of it for the King of Spain.

BALBOA

[September 25, 1513]

With restless step of discontent, Day after day he fretting went Along the old accustomed ways That led to easeful length of days.

But far beyond the fragrant shade Of orange groves his glances strayed To where the white horizon line Caught from the sea its silvery shine.

He knew the taste of that salt spray, He knew the wind that blew that way; Ah, once again to mount and ride Upon that pulsing ocean tide,--

To find new lands of virgin gold, To wrest them from the savage hold, To conquer with the sword and brain Fresh fields and fair for royal Spain!

This was the dream of wild desire That set his gallant heart on fire, And stirred with feverish discontent That soul for nobler issues meant.

Sometimes his children's laughter brought A thrill that checked his restless thought; Sometimes a voice more tender yet Would soothe the fever and the fret.

Thus day by day, until one day Came news that in the harbor lay A ship bound outward to explore The treasures of that western shore,

Which bold adventurers as yet Had failed to conquer or forget; "Yet where they failed, and failing died, My will shall conquer!" Balboa cried.

But when on Darien's shore he stept, And fast and far his vision swept, He saw before him, white and still, The Andes mocking at his will.

Then like a flint he set his face; Let others falter from their place, His hand and foot, his sturdy soul Should seek and gain that distant goal!

With speech like this he fired the land, And gathered to his bold command A troop of twenty score or more, To follow where he led before.

They followed him day after day O'er burning lands where ambushed lay The waiting savage in his lair, And fever poisoned all the air.

But like a sweeping wind of flame A conqueror through all he came; The savage fell beneath his hand, Or led him on to seek the land

That richer yet for golden gain Stretched out beyond the mountain chain. Steep after steep of rough ascent They followed, followed, worn and spent,

Until at length they came to where The last peak lifted near and fair; Then Balboa turned and waved aside His panting troops. "Rest here," he cried,

"And wait for me." And with a tread Of trembling haste, he quickly sped Along the trackless height, alone To seek, to reach, his mountain throne.

Step after step he mounted swift; The wind blew down a cloudy drift; From some strange source he seemed to hear The music of another sphere.

Step after step; the cloud-winds blew Their blinding mists, then through and through Sun-cleft, they broke, and all alone He stood upon his mountain throne.

Before him spread no paltry lands, To wrest with spoils from savage hands; But, fresh and fair, an unknown world Of mighty sea and shore unfurled

Its wondrous scroll beneath the skies. Ah, what to this the flimsy prize Of gold and lands for which he came With hot ambition's sordid aim!

Silent he stood with streaming eyes In that first moment of surprise, Then on the mountain-top he bent, This conqueror of a continent,

In wordless ecstasy of prayer,-- Forgetting in that moment there, With Nature's God brought face to face, All vainer dreams of pomp and place.

Thus to the world a world was given. Where lesser men had vainly striven, And striving died,--this gallant soul, Divinely guided, reached the goal.

NORA PERRY.

In 1518 a great expedition, under Hernando Cortez, sailed from Cuba in search of a land of marvellous wealth which was said to exist somewhere north of Darien. The result was the discovery of Mexico, which the Spaniards subdued with indescribable cruelties.

WITH CORTEZ IN MEXICO

[1519]

"Mater á Dios, preserve us And give us the Mexican gold, Viva España forever!" Light-hearted, treacherous, bold, With clashing of drums and of cymbals, With clatter of hoofs and of arms, Into the Tezcucan city, Over the Tezcucan farms; In through the hordes of Aztecs, Past glitter of city and lake, Brave for death or for conquest, And the Mother of God's sweet sake.

Perchance from distant Granada, Perchance from the Danube's far blue, He had fought with Moor and Saracen, Where the death hail of battle-fields flew. Down through the smoke and the battle, Trolling an old Moorish song, Chanting an Ave or Pater, To whiten the red of his wrong, Dreaming of Seville, Toledo, And dark, soft catholic eyes, Light-hearted, reckless, and daring, He rides under Mexican skies.

Child of valor and fortune, Nurtured to ride and to strike, Fearless in defeat or in conquest, Of man and of devil alike; Out through the clamor of battle, Up through rivers of blood, "Viva España forever! God and the bold Brotherhood! Strike for the memories left us, Strike for the lives that we keep, Strike for the present and future, In the name of our comrades who sleep; Strike! for Jesus' sweet Mother, For the arms and the vows that we hold; Strike for fortune and lover, God, and the Mexican gold!"

* * * * *

At morning gay, careless in battle, With love on his lips, in his eyes; At even stretched pallid and silent, Out under Mexican skies. And far in some old Spanish city, Two dark eyes wait patient and long For a lover who sailed to the westward, Trolling an old Moorish song.

W. W. CAMPBELL.

Shortly afterwards, Pizarro completed the conquest of Peru. Heavily-laden treasure-ships were sent homeward across the Atlantic, and at last the Spanish lust of gold seemed in a fair way to be satisfied.

THE LUST OF GOLD

From "The West Indies"

Rapacious Spain Follow'd her hero's triumphs o'er the main, Her hardy sons in fields of battle tried, Where Moor and Christian desperately died. A rabid race, fanatically bold, And steel'd to cruelty by lust of gold, Traversed the waves, the unknown world explored, The cross their standard, but their faith the sword; Their steps were graves; o'er prostrate realms they trod; They worshipp'd Mammon while they vow'd to God.

Let nobler bards in loftier numbers tell How Cortez conquer'd, Montezuma fell; How fierce Pizarro's ruffian arm o'erthrew The sun's resplendent empire in Peru; How, like a prophet, old Las Casas stood, And raised his voice against a sea of blood, Whose chilling waves recoil'd while he foretold His country's ruin by avenging gold.

--That gold, for which unpitied Indians fell, That gold, at once the snare and scourge of hell, Thenceforth by righteous Heaven was doom'd to shed Unmingled curses on the spoiler's head; For gold the Spaniard cast his soul away,-- His gold and he were every nation's prey.

But themes like these would ask an angel-lyre, Language of light and sentiment of fire; Give me to sing, in melancholy strains, Of Charib martyrdoms and Negro chains; One race by tyrants rooted from the earth, One doom'd to slavery by the taint of birth!

* * * * *

Dreadful as hurricanes, athwart the main Rush'd the fell legions of invading Spain; With fraud and force, with false and fatal breath (Submission bondage, and resistance death), They swept the isles. In vain the simple race Kneel'd to the iron sceptre of their grace, Or with weak arms their fiery vengeance braved; They came, they saw, they conquer'd, they enslaved, And they destroy'd;--the generous heart they broke, They crush'd the timid neck beneath the yoke; Where'er to battle march'd their fell array, The sword of conquest plough'd resistless way; Where'er from cruel toil they sought repose, Around the fires of devastation rose. The Indian, as he turn'd his head in flight, Beheld his cottage flaming through the night, And, midst the shrieks of murder on the wind, Heard the mute bloodhound's death-step close behind.

The conflict o'er, the valiant in their graves, The wretched remnant dwindled into slaves; Condemn'd in pestilential cells to pine, Delving for gold amidst the gloomy mine. The sufferer, sick of life-protracting breath, Inhaled with joy the fire-damp blast of death: --Condemn'd to fell the mountain palm on high, That cast its shadow from the evening sky, Ere the tree trembled to his feeble stroke, The woodman languish'd, and his heart-strings broke; --Condemn'd in torrid noon, with palsied hand, To urge the slow plough o'er the obdurate land, The laborer, smitten by the sun's quick ray, A corpse along the unfinish'd furrow lay. O'erwhelm'd at length with ignominious toil, Mingling their barren ashes with the soil, Down to the dust the Charib people pass'd, Like autumn foliage withering in the blast: The whole race sunk beneath the oppressor's rod, And left a blank among the works of God.

JAMES MONTGOMERY.

Although Pope Alexander VI had, in 1493, issued a bull dividing the New World between Spain and Portugal, neither France nor England paid any heed to it. One of France's most active corsairs was Giovanni da Verazzano. In 1524 he crossed the Atlantic, and, sighting the coast at Cape Fear, turned northward, discovered the Hudson, landed at Rhode Island, and kept on, perhaps, as far as Newfoundland.

VERAZZANO

AT RHODES AND RHODE ISLAND

[1524]

In the tides of the warm south wind it lay, And its grapes turned wine in the fires of noon, And its roses blossomed from May to May, And their fragrance lingered from June to June.

There dwelt old heroes at Ilium famed, There, bards reclusive, of olden odes; And so fair were the fields of roses, they named The bright sea-garden the Isle of Rhodes.

Fair temples graced each blossoming field, And columned halls in gems arrayed; Night shaded the sea with her jewelled shield, And sweet the lyres of Orpheus played.

The Helios spanned the sea: its flame Drew hither the ships of Pelion's pines, And twice a thousand statues of fame Stood mute in twice a thousand shrines.

And her mariners went, and her mariners came, And sang on the seas the olden odes, And at night they remembered the Helios' flame, And at morn the sweet fields of the roses of Rhodes.

From the palm land's shade to the land of pines, A Florentine crossed the Western Sea; He sought new lands and golden mines, And he sailed 'neath the flag of the Fleur-de-lis.

He saw at last in the sunset's gold, A wonderful island so fair to view That it seemed like the Island of Roses old That his eyes in his wondering boyhood knew.

'Twas summer time, and the glad birds sung In the hush of noon in the solitudes; From the oak's broad arms the green vines hung; Sweet odors blew from the resinous woods.

He rounded the shores of the summer sea, And he said as his feet the white sands pressed, And he planted the flag of the Fleur-de-lis: "I have come to the Island of Rhodes in the West.

"While the mariners go, and the mariners come, And sing on lone waters the olden odes Of the Grecian seas and the ports of Rome, They will ever think of the roses of Rhodes."

To the isle of the West he gave the name Of the isle he had loved in the Grecian sea; And the Florentine went away as he came, 'Neath the silver flag of the Fleur-de-lis.

O fair Rhode Island, thy guest was true, He felt the spirit of beauteous things; The sea-wet roses were faint and few, But memory made them the gardens of kings.

The Florentine corsair sailed once more, Out into the West o'er a rainy sea, In search of another wonderful shore For the crown of France and the Fleur-de-lis.

But returned no more the Florentine brave To the courtly knights of fair Rochelle; 'Neath the lilies of France he found a grave, And not 'neath the roses he loved so well.

But the lessons of beauty his fond heart bore From the gardens of God were never lost; And the fairest name of the Eastern shore Bears the fairest isle of the Western coast.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

The Spaniards still dreamed of a great empire somewhere in Florida, and in 1528 Pánfilo de Narvaez set out with an expedition in search of it. Only four members of the party got back to Cuba alive, the others having been killed or captured by the Indians. Among those captured and enslaved was Juan Ortiz. He was rescued by De Soto nearly ten years later.

ORTIZ

[1528]

"Go bring the captive, he shall die," He said, with faltering breath; "Him stretch upon a scaffold high, And light the fire of death!" The young Creeks danced the captive round, And sang the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Fly, wings of the warrior's plume!"

They brought the fagots for the flame, The braves and maids together, When came the princess--sweet her name: The Red Flamingo Feather. Then danced the Creeks the scaffold round, And sang the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Fly, wings of the warrior's plume!"

In shaded plumes of silver gray, The young Creeks danced together, But she danced not with them that day, The Red Flamingo Feather. Wild sped the feet the scaffold round, Wild rose the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Fly, wings of the warrior's plume!"

They stretched the stranger from the sea, Above the fagots lighted,-- Ortiz,--a courtly man was he, With deeds heroic knighted. And sped the feet the scaffold round, And rose the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Fly, wings of the warrior's plume!"

The white smoke rose, the braves were gay, The war drums beat together, But sad in heart and face that day Was Red Flamingo Feather. They streaked with flames the dusky air, They streaked the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Fly, wings of the warrior's plume!"

"Dance, dance, my girl, the torches gleam, Dance, dance, the gray plumes gather, Dance, dance, my girl, the war-hawks scream, Dance, Red Flamingo Feather!" More swiftly now the torches sped, Amid the Dance of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Fly, wings of the warrior's plume!"

She knelt upon the green moss there, And clasped her father's knees: "My heart is weak, O father, spare The wanderer from the seas!" Like madness now swept on the dance, And rose the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Ye wings of the warrior's plume!"

"Grand were the men who sailed away, And he is young and brave; 'Tis small in heart the weak to slay, 'Tis great in heart to save." He saw the torches sweep the air, He heard the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Fly, wings of the warrior's plume!"

"My girl, I know thy heart would spare The wanderer from the sea." "The man is fair, and I am fair, And thou art great," said she. The dance of fire went on and on, And on the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, Fly, wings of the warrior's plume!"

The dark chief felt his pride abate: "I will the wanderer spare, My Bird of Peace, since I am great, And he, like thee, is fair!" They dropped the torches, stopped the dance, And died the Song of Doom,-- "Fly, fly, ye hawks, in the open sky, _Away_ with the warrior's plume!"

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

In 1538 Hernando de Soto was appointed governor of Cuba and Florida, with orders to explore and settle the latter country. He landed at Tampa Bay with nearly a thousand men and started into the interior. He was forced to fight his way across the country against the tribes of the Creek confederacy, and in October, 1540, had a desperate battle with them at a palisaded village called Maubila, at the mouth of the Alabama River.

THE FALL OF MAUBILA

[October 18, 1540]

Hearken the stirring story The soldier has to tell, Of fierce and bloody battle, Contested long and well. Ere walled Maubila, stoutly held, Before our forces fell.

Now many years have circled Since that October day, When proudly to Maubila De Soto took his way, With men-at-arms and cavaliers In terrible array.

Oh, never sight more goodly In any land was seen; And never better soldiers Than those he led have been, More prompt to handle arquebus, Or wield their sabres keen.

The sun was at meridian, His hottest rays fell down Alike on soldier's corselet And on the friar's gown; The breeze was hushed as on we rode Right proudly to the town.

First came the bold De Soto, In all his manly pride, The gallant Don Diego, His nephew, by his side; A yard behind Juan Ortiz rode, Interpreter and guide.

Baltasar de Gallegos, Impetuous, fierce and hot; Francisco de Figarro, Since by an arrow shot; And slender Juan de Guzman, who In battle faltered not.

Luis Bravo de Xeres, That gallant cavalier; Alonzo de Carmono, Whose spirit knew no fear; The marquis of Astorga, and Vasquez, the cannoneer.

Andres de Vasconcellos, Juan Cales, young and fair, Roma de Cardenoso, Him of the yellow hair-- Rode gallant in their bravery, Straight to the public square.

And there, in sombre garments, Were monks of Cuba four, Fray Juan de Gallegos, And other priests a score, Who sacramental bread and wine And holy relics bore.

And next eight hundred soldiers In closest order come, Some with Biscayan lances, With arquebuses some, Timing their tread to martial notes Of trump and fife and drum.

Loud sang the gay Mobilians, Light danced their daughters brown; Sweet sounded pleasant music Through all the swarming town; But 'mid the joy one sullen brow Was lowering with a frown.

The haughty Tuscaloosa, The sovereign of the land, With moody face, and thoughtful, Rode at our chief's right hand, And cast from time to time a glance Of hatred at the band.

And when that gay procession Made halt to take a rest, And eagerly the people To see the strangers prest, The frowning King, in wrathful tones, De Soto thus addressed:

"To bonds and to dishonor By faithless friends trepanned, For days beside you, Spaniard, The ruler of the land Has ridden as a prisoner, Subject to your command.

"He was not born the fetters Of baser men to wear, And tells you this, De Soto, Hard though it be to bear-- Let those beware the panther's rage Who follow to his lair.

"Back to your isle of Cuba! Slink to your den again, And tell your robber sovereign, The mighty lord of Spain, Whoso would strive this land to win Shall find his efforts vain.

"And, save it be your purpose Within my realm to die, Let not your forces linger Our deadly anger nigh, Lest food for vultures and for wolves Your mangled forms should lie."

Then, spurning courtly offers He left our chieftain's side, And crossing the enclosure With quick and lengthened stride, He passed within his palace gates, And there our wrath defied.

Now came up Charamilla, Who led our troop of spies, And said unto our captain, With tones that showed surprise, "A mighty force within the town, In wait to crush us, lies.

"The babes and elder women Were sent at break of day Into the forest yonder, Five leagues or more away: Within yon huts ten thousand men Wait eager for the fray."

"What say ye now, my comrades?" De Soto asked his men; "Shall we, before these traitors, Go backward, baffled, then; Or, sword in hand, attack the foe Who crouches in his den?"

Before their loud responses Had died upon the ear, A savage stood before them, Who said, in accents clear, "Ho! robbers base and coward thieves! Assassin Spaniards, hear!

"No longer shall our sovereign, Born noble, great, and free, Be led beside your master, A shameful sight to see, While weapons here to strike you down Or hands to grasp them be."

As spoke the brawny savage, Full wroth our comrades grew-- Baltasar de Gallegos His heavy weapon drew, And dealt the boaster such a stroke As clove his body through.

Then rushed the swart Mobilians Like hornets from their nest; Against our bristling lances Was bared each savage breast; With arrow-head and club and stone, Upon our band they prest.

"Retreat in steady order! But slay them as ye go!" Exclaimed the brave De Soto, And with each word a blow That sent a savage soul to doom He dealt upon the foe.

"Strike well who would our honor From spot or tarnish save! Strike down the haughty Pagan, The infidel and slave! Saint Mary Mother sits above, And smiles upon the brave.

"Strike! all my gallant comrades! Strike! gentlemen of Spain! Upon the traitor wretches Your deadly anger rain, Or never to your native land Return in pride again!"

Then hosts of angry foemen We fiercely held at bay, Through living walls of Pagans We cut our bloody way; And though by thousands round they swarmed, We kept our firm array.

At length they feared to follow; We stood upon the plain, And dressed our shattered column; When, slacking bridle rein, De Soto, wounded as he was, Led to the charge again.

For now our gallant horsemen Their steeds again had found, That had been fastly tethered Unto the trees around, Though some of these, by arrows slain, Lay stretched upon the ground.

And as the riders mounted, The foe, in joyous tones, Gave vent to shouts of triumph, And hurled a shower of stones; But soon the shouts were changed to wails, The cries of joy to moans.

Down on the scared Mobilians The furious rush was led; Down fell the howling victims Beneath the horses' tread; The angered chargers trod alike On dying and on dead.

Back to the wooden ramparts, With cut and thrust and blow, We drove the panting savage, The very walls below, Till those above upon our heads Huge rocks began to throw.

Whenever we retreated The swarming foemen came-- Their wild and matchless courage Put even ours to shame-- Rushing upon our lances' points, And arquebuses' flame.

Three weary hours we fought them, And often each gave way; Three weary hours, uncertain The fortune of the day; And ever where they fiercest fought De Soto led the fray.

Baltasar de Gallegos Right well displayed his might; His sword fell ever fatal, Death rode its flash of light; And where his horse's head was turned The foe gave way in fright.

At length before our daring The Pagans had to yield, And in their stout enclosure They sought to find a shield, And left us, wearied with our toil, The masters of the field.

Now worn and spent and weary, Our force was scattered round, Some seeking for their comrades, Some seated on the ground, When sudden fell upon our ears A single trumpet's sound.

"Up! ready make for storming!" That speaks Moscoso near; He comes with stainless sabre, He comes with spotless spear; But stains of blood and spots of gore Await his weapons here.

Soon, formed in four divisions, Around the order goes-- "To front with battle-axes! No moment for repose. At signal of an arquebus, Rain on the gates your blows."

Not long that fearful crashing, The gates in splinters fall; And some, though sorely wounded, Climb o'er the crowded wall: No rampart's height can keep them back, No danger can appall.

Then redly rained the carnage-- None asked for quarter there; Men fought with all the fury Born of a wild despair; And shrieks and groans and yells of hate Were mingled in the air.

Four times they backward beat us, Four times our force returned; We quenched in bloody torrents The fire that in us burned; We slew who fought, and those who knelt With stroke of sword we spurned.

And what are these new forces, With long, black, streaming hair? They are the singing maidens Who met us in the square; And now they spring upon our ranks Like she-wolves from their lair.

Their sex no shield to save them, Their youth no weapon stayed; De Soto with his falchion A lane amid them made, And in the skulls of blooming girls Sank battle-axe and blade.

Forth came a wingèd arrow, And struck our leader's thigh; The man who sent it shouted, And looked to see him die; The wound but made the tide of rage Run twice as fierce and high.

Then came our stout camp-master, "The night is coming down; Already twilight darkness Is casting shadows brown; We would not lack for light on strife If once we burned the town."

With that we fired the houses; The ranks before us broke; The fugitives we followed, And dealt them many a stroke, While round us rose the crackling flame, And o'er us hung the smoke.

And what with flames around them, And what with smoke o'erhead, And what with cuts of sabre, And what with horses' tread, And what with lance and arquebus, The town was filled with dead.

Six thousand of the foemen Upon that day were slain, Including those who fought us Outside upon the plain-- Six thousand of the foemen fell, And eighty-two of Spain.

Not one of us unwounded Came from the fearful fray; And when the fight was over And scattered round we lay, Some sixteen hundred wounds we bore As tokens of the day.

And through that weary darkness, And all that dreary night, We lay in bitter anguish, But never mourned our plight, Although we watched with eagerness To see the morning light.

And when the early dawning Had marked the sky with red, We saw the Moloch incense Rise slowly overhead From smoking ruins and the heaps Of charred and mangled dead.

I knew the slain were Pagans, While we in Christ were free, And yet it seemed that moment A spirit said to me: "Henceforth be doomed while life remains This sight of fear to see."

And ever since that dawning Which chased the night away, I wake to see the corses That thus before me lay: And this is why in cloistered cell I wait my latter day.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

Early in 1540 a great expedition under Francisco de Coronado started northward from Mexico in search of the Seven Cities of Cibola, of whose glories and riches many stories had been told. The cities were really the pueblos of the Zuñis, and the ballad tells the story of the march.

QUIVÍRA

[1540-1541]

Francisco Coronado rode forth with all his train, Eight hundred savage bowmen, three hundred spears of Spain, To seek the rumored glory that pathless deserts hold-- The city of Quivíra whose walls are rich with gold.

Oh, gay they rode with plume on crest and gilded spur at heel, With gonfalon of Aragon and banner of Castile! While High Emprise and Joyous Youth, twin marshals of the throng, Awoke Sonora's mountain peaks with trumpet-note and song.

Beside that brilliant army, beloved of serf and lord, There walked as brave a soldier as ever smote with sword, Though nought of knightly harness his russet gown revealed-- The cross he bore as weapon, the missal was his shield.

But rugged oaths were changed to prayers, and angry hearts grew tame, And fainting spirits waxed in faith where Fray Padilla came; And brawny spearmen bowed their heads to kiss the helpful hand Of him who spake the simple truth that brave men understand.

What pen may paint their daring--those doughty cavaliers! The cities of the Zuñi were humbled by their spears. Wild Arizona's barrens grew pallid in the glow Of blades that won Granada and conquered Mexico.

They fared by lofty Acoma; their rally-call was blown Where Colorado rushes down through God-hewn walls of stone; Still, North and East, where deserts spread, and treeless prairies rolled, A Fairy City lured them on with pinnacles of gold.

Through all their weary marches toward that flitting goal They turned to Fray Padilla for aid of heart and soul. He bound the wounds that lance-thrust and flinty arrow made; He cheered the sick and failing; above the dead he prayed.

Two thousand miles of war and woe behind their banners lay: And sadly fever, drought and toil had lessened their array, When came a message fraught with hope to all the steadfast band: "Good tidings from the northward, friends! Quivíra lies at hand!"

How joyously they spurred them! How sadly drew the rein! There shone no golden palace, there blazed no jewelled fane. Rude tents of hide of bison, dog-guarded, met their view-- A squalid Indian village; the lodges of the Sioux!

Then Coronado bowed his head. He spake unto his men: "Our quest is vain, true hearts of Spain! Now ride we home again. And would to God that I might give that phantom city's pride In ransom for the gallant souls that here have sunk and died!"

Back, back to Compostela the wayworn handful bore; But sturdy Fray Padilla took up the quest once more. His soul still longed for conquest, though not by lance and sword; He burned to show the Heathen the pathway to the Lord.

Again he trudged the flinty hills and dazzling desert sands, And few were they that walked with him, and weaponless their hands-- But and the trusty man-at-arms, Docampo, rode him near Like Great Heart, guarding Christian's way through wastes of Doubt and Fear.

Where still in silken harvests the prairie-lilies toss, Among the dark Quivíras Padilla reared his cross. Within its sacred shadow the warriors of the Kaw In wonder heard the Gospel of Love and Peace and Law.

They gloried in their Brown-robed Priest; and oft in twilight's gold The warriors grouped, a silent ring, to hear the tale he told, While round the gentle man-at-arms their lithe-limbed children played And shot their arrows at his shield and rode his guarded blade.

When thrice the silver crescent had filled its curving shell, The Friar rose at dawning and spake his flock farewell: "--And if your Brothers northward be cruel, as ye say, My Master bids me seek them--and dare I answer 'Nay'?"

Again he strode the path of thorns; but ere the evening star A savage cohort swept the plain in paint and plumes of war. Then Fray Padilla spake to them whose hearts were most his own: "My children, bear the tidings home--let me die here alone."

He knelt upon the prairie, begirt by yelling Sioux.-- "Forgive them, oh, my Father! they know not what they do!" The twanging bow-strings answered. Before his eyes, unrolled The City of Quivíra whose streets are paved with gold.

ARTHUR GUITERMAN.

The Spaniards were not the only people who searched in vain for fabulous cities. South of Cape Breton lay a country which the early French explorers named Norembega, and there was supposed to exist, somewhere within its boundaries, a

magnificent city of the same name. Roberval and Jacques Cartier spent a number of years after 1541 seeking it, and in 1604 Champlain explored the Penobscot River, on whose banks it was supposed to be situated, but found no trace of it, nor any evidence of civilization except a cross, very old and mossy, in the woods.

NOREMBEGA

[c. 1543]

The winding way the serpent takes The mystic water took, From where, to count its beaded lakes, The forest sped its brook.

A narrow space 'twixt shore and shore, For sun or stars to fall, While evermore, behind, before, Closed in the forest wall.

The dim wood hiding underneath Wan flowers without a name; Life tangled with decay and death, League after league the same.

Unbroken over swamp and hill The rounding shadow lay, Save where the river cut at will A pathway to the day.

Beside that track of air and light, Weak as a child unweaned, At shut of day a Christian knight Upon his henchman leaned.

The embers of the sunset's fires Along the clouds burned down; "I see," he said, "the domes and spires Of Norembega town."

"Alack! the domes, O master mine, Are golden clouds on high; Yon spire is but the branchless pine That cuts the evening sky."

"Oh, hush and hark! What sounds are these But chants and holy hymns?" "Thou hear'st the breeze that stirs the trees Through all their leafy limbs."

"Is it a chapel bell that fills The air with its low tone?" "Thou hear'st the tinkle of the rills, The insect's vesper drone."

"The Christ be praised!--He sets for me A blessed cross in sight!" "Now, nay, 'tis but yon blasted tree With two gaunt arms outright!"

"Be it wind so sad or tree so stark, It mattereth not, my knave; Methinks to funeral hymns I hark, The cross is for my grave!

"My life is sped; I shall not see My home-set sails again; The sweetest eyes of Normandie Shall watch for me in vain.

"Yet onward still to ear and eye The baffling marvel calls; I fain would look before I die On Norembega's walls.

"So, haply, it shall be thy part At Christian feet to lay The mystery of the desert's heart My dead hand plucked away.

"Leave me an hour of rest; go thou And look from yonder heights; Perchance the valley even now Is starred with city lights."

The henchman climbed the nearest hill, He saw nor tower nor town, But, through the drear woods, lone and still, The river rolling down.

He heard the stealthy feet of things Whose shapes he could not see, A flutter as of evil wings, The fall of a dead tree.

The pines stood black against the moon, A sword of fire beyond; He heard the wolf howl, and the loon Laugh from his reedy pond.

He turned him back; "O master dear, We are but men misled; And thou hast sought a city here To find a grave instead."

"As God shall will! what matters where A true man's cross may stand, So Heaven be o'er it here as there In pleasant Norman land?

"These woods, perchance, no secret hide Of lordly tower and hall; Yon river in its wanderings wide Has washed no city wall;

"Yet mirrored in the sullen stream The holy stars are given: Is Norembega, then, a dream Whose waking is in Heaven?

"No builded wonder of these lands My weary eyes shall see; A city never made with hands Alone awaiteth me--

"'_Urbs Syon mystica_;' I see Its mansions passing fair, '_Condita coelo_;' let me be, Dear Lord, a dweller there!"

Above the dying exile hung The vision of the bard, As faltered on his failing tongue The song of good Bernard.

The henchman dug at dawn a grave Beneath the hemlocks brown, And to the desert's keeping gave The lord of fief and town.

Years after, when the Sieur Champlain Sailed up the unknown stream, And Norembega proved again A shadow and a dream,

He found the Norman's nameless grave Within the hemlock's shade, And, stretching wide its arms to save, The sign that God had made,

The cross-boughed tree that marked the spot And made it holy ground: He needs the earthly city not Who hath the heavenly found.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

Until the middle of the sixteenth century, Spain was the only nation which had succeeded in establishing colonies in the New World. In 1583 Sir Humphrey Gilbert secured permission from Queen Elizabeth to set out on a voyage of discovery and colonization, for the glory of England. He landed at St. John's, Newfoundland, August 5, and established there the first English colony in North America. Then he sailed away to explore further, and met the fate described in the poem. The colony proved a failure.

SIR HUMPHREY GILBERT

[1583]

Southward with fleet of ice Sailed the corsair Death; Wild and fast blew the blast, And the east-wind was his breath.

His lordly ships of ice Glisten in the sun; On each side, like pennons wide, Flashing crystal streamlets run.

His sails of white sea-mist Dripped with silver rain; But where he passed there were cast Leaden shadows o'er the main.

Eastward from Campobello Sir Humphrey Gilbert sailed; Three days or more seaward he bore, Then, alas! the land-wind failed.

Alas! the land-wind failed, And ice-cold grew the night; And nevermore, on sea or shore, Should Sir Humphrey see the light.

He sat upon the deck, The Book was in his hand; "Do not fear! Heaven is as near," He said, "by water as by land!"

In the first watch of the night, Without a signal's sound, Out of the sea, mysteriously, The fleet of Death rose all around.

The moon and the evening star Were hanging in the shrouds; Every mast, as it passed, Seemed to rake the passing clouds.

They grappled with their prize, At midnight black and cold! As of a rock was the shock; Heavily the ground-swell rolled.

Southward through day and dark, They drift in close embrace, With mist and rain, o'er the open main; Yet there seems no change of place.

Southward, forever southward, They drift through dark and day; And like a dream, in the Gulf-Stream Sinking, vanish all away.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

With the destruction of the Armada in 1588, Spain's sea power was so shattered that the Atlantic ceased to be a battleground. English sailors could come and go with a fair degree of safety, and before long the American coast was alive with these daring and adventurous voyagers.

THE FIRST AMERICAN SAILORS

Five fearless knights of the first renown In Elizabeth's great array, From Plymouth in Devon sailed up and down-- American sailors they; Who went to the West, For they all knew best Where the silver was gray As a moonlit night, And the gold as bright As a midsummer day-- A-sailing away Through the salt sea spray, The first American sailors.

Sir HUMPHREY GILBERT, he was ONE _And Devon was heaven to him_, He loved the sea as he loved the sun _And hated the Don as the Devil's limb-- Hated him up to the brim_: In Holland the Spanish hide he tanned, He roughed and routed their

braggart band, And God was with him on sea and land; Newfoundland knew him, and all that coast For he was one of America's host-- And now there is nothing but English speech For leagues and leagues, and reach on reach, From near the Equator away to the Pole; While the billows beat and the oceans roll On the Three Americas.

Sir FRANCIS DRAKE, and he was TWO _And Devon was heaven to him_, He loved in his heart the waters blue _And hated the Don as the Devil's limb-- Hated him up to the brim_! At Cadiz he singed the King's black beard, The Armada met him and fled afeard, Great Philip's golden fleece he sheared; Oregon knew him, and all that coast, For he was one of America's host-- And now there is nothing but English speech For leagues and leagues, and reach on reach, From California away to the Pole; While the billows beat and the oceans roll On the Three Americas.

Sir WALTER RALEIGH, he was THREE _And Devon was heaven to him_, There was nothing he loved so well as the sea-- _He hated the Don as the Devil's limb-- Hated him up to the brim_! He settled full many a Spanish score, Full many's the banner his bullets tore On English, American, Spanish shore; Guiana knew him, and all that coast, For he was one of America's host-- And now there is nothing but English speech For leagues and leagues, and reach on reach, From Guiana northward to the Pole; While the billows beat and the oceans roll On the Three Americas.

Sir RICHARD GRENVILLE, he was FOUR _And Devon was heaven to him_, He loved the waves and their windy roar _And hated the Don as the Devil's limb-- Hated him up to the brim_! He whipped him on land and mocked him at sea, He laughed to scorn his sovereignty, And with the Revenge beat his fifty-three; Virginia knew him, and all that coast, For he was one of America's host-- And now there is nothing but English speech For leagues and leagues, and reach on reach, From the Old Dominion away to the Pole; While the billows beat and the oceans roll On the Three Americas.

And Sir JOHN HAWKINS, he was FIVE _And Devon was heaven to him_, He worshipped the water while he was alive _And hated the Don as the Devil's limb-- Hated him up to the brim_! He chased him over the Spanish Main, He scoffed and defied the navies of Spain-- His cities he ravished again and again; The Gulf it knew him, and all that coast, For he was one of America's host-- And now there is nothing but English speech For leagues and leagues, and reach on reach, From the Rio Grandè away to the Pole; While the billows beat and the oceans roll On the Three Americas.

Five fearless knights have filled gallant graves This many and many a day, Some under the willows, some under the waves-- American sailors they; And still in the West Is their valor blest, Where a banner bright With the ocean's blue And the red wrack's hue And the spoondrift's white Is smiling to-day Through the salt sea spray Upon American sailors.

WALLACE RICE.

CHAPTER III

THE SETTLEMENT OF VIRGINIA

England laid claim to the continent of North America by virtue of the discoveries of John Cabot in 1497, but little effort was made toward colonization until 1584, when an expedition sent out by Sir Walter Raleigh explored Albemarle Sound and the adjacent coast, and brought back so glowing a description of the country that Elizabeth named the whole region Virginia, in honor of her maidenhood. An abortive attempt to settle Roanoke Island was made in 1585, and in 1587 another expedition under John White landed there. White returned to England in the fall to represent the needs of the settlement, leaving behind him his daughter and little granddaughter,--Virginia Dare, the first white child born in America. He promised to return within a year, but was intercepted by Spaniards, and it was not until August, 1590, that he again dropped anchor off the island. When he went ashore next day, not a trace of the colonists could be found, nor was their fate ever certainly discovered.

THE MYSTERY OF CRO-A-TÀN

I

[August 27, 1587]

The home-bound ship stood out to sea, And on the island's marge, Sir Richard waited restlessly To step into the barge.

"The Governor tarrieth long," he chode, "As he were loth to go: With food before, and want behind, There should be haste, I trow."

Even as he spake, the Governor came:-- "Nay, fret not, for the men Have held me back with frantic let, To have them home again.

"The women weep;--'Ay, ay, the ship Will come again' (he saith), 'Before the May;--Before the May We shall have starved to death!'

"I've sworn return by God's dear leave, I've vowed by court and crown, Nor yet appeased them. Comrade, thou, Mayhap, canst soothe them down."

Sir Richard loosed his helm, and stretched Impatient hands abroad:-- "Have ye no trust in man?" he cried, "Have ye no faith in God?

"Your Governor goes, as needs he must, To bear through royal grace, Hither, such food-supply, that want May never blench a face.

"Of freest choice ye willed to leave What so ye had of ease; For neither stress of liege nor law Hath forced you over seas.

"Your Governor leaves fair hostages As costliest pledge of care,-- His daughter yonder, and her child, The child Virginia Dare!

"Come hither, little sweetheart! Lo! Thou'lt be the first, I ween, To bend the knee, and send through me Thy birthland's virgin fealty Unto its Virgin Queen.

"And now, good folk, for my commands: If ye are fain to roam Beyond this island's narrow bounds, To seek elsewhere a home,--

"Upon some pine-tree's smoothen trunk Score deep the Indian name Of tribe or village where ye haunt, That we may read the same.

"And if ye leave your haven here Through dire distress or loss, Cut deep within the wood above The symbol of the cross.

"And now on my good blade, I swear, And seal it with this sign, That if the fleet that sails to-day Return not hither by the May, The fault shall not be mine!"

II

[August 15, 1590]

The breath of spring was on the sea; Anon the Governor stepped His good ship's deck right merrily,-- His promise had been kept.

"See, see! the coast-line comes in view!" He heard the mariners shout,-- "We'll drop our anchors in the Sound Before a star is out!"

"Now God be praised!" he inly breathed, "Who saves from all that harms; The morrow morn my pretty ones Will rest within my arms."

At dawn of day they moored their ship, And dared the breakers' roar: What meant it? not a man was there To welcome them ashore!

They sprang to find the cabins rude; The quick green sedge had thrown Its knotted web o'er every door, And climbed the chimney-stone.

The spring was choked with winter's leaves, And feebly gurgled on; And from the pathway, strewn with wrack, All trace of feet was gone.

Their fingers thrid the matted grass, If there, perchance, a mound Unseen might heave the broken turf; But not a grave was found.

They beat the tangled cypress swamp, If haply in despair They might have strayed into its glade: But found no vestige there.

"The pine! the pine!" the Governor groaned; And there each staring man Read in a maze, one single word, Deep carven,--CRO-A-TÀN!

But cut above, no cross, no sign, No symbol of distress; Naught else beside that mystic line Within the wilderness!

And where and what was "CRO-A-TÀN"? But not an answer came; And none of all who read it there Had ever heard the name.

The Governor drew his jerkin sleeve Across his misty eyes; "Some land, maybe, of savagery Beyond the coast that lies;

"And skulking there the wily foe In ambush may have lain: God's mercy! Could such sweetest heads Lie scalped among the slain?

"O daughter! daughter! with the thought My harrowed brain is wild! Up with the anchors! I must find The mother and the child!"

They scoured the mainland near and far: The search no tidings brought; Till mid a forest's dusky tribe They heard the name they sought.

The kindly natives came with gifts Of corn and slaughtered deer; What room for savage treachery Or foul suspicion here?

Unhindered of a chief or brave, They searched the wigwam through; But neither lance nor helm nor spear, Nor shred of child's nor woman's gear, Could furnish forth a clue.

How could a hundred souls be caught Straight out of life, nor find Device through which to mark their fate, Or leave some hint behind?

Had winter's ocean inland rolled An eagre's deadly spray, That overwhelmed the island's breadth And swept them all away?

In vain, in vain, their heart-sick search! No tidings reached them more; No record save that silent word Upon that silent shore.

The mystery rests a mystery still, Unsolved of mortal man: Sphinx-like untold, the ages hold The tale of CRO-A-TÀN!

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

In April, 1606, James I sanctioned the formation of two Virginia colonies, and the first colony set sail on the following New Year's day--three vessels, with one hundred and five men, under command of Christopher Newport. Twelve weeks later, they landed at a place they named "Point Comfort," and proceeded up a great river which they named the King's and afterwards the James. On May 13, 1607, the colonists landed on a low peninsula fifty miles up the river, and Captain Newport selected this, against many protests, as the site for the settlement. They christened the place Jamestown. Captains Newport, Gosnold, Smith, and Sickelmore were named as the resident council for the colony, but time soon proved Smith the ablest man in the company, and the leadership fell to him.

JOHN SMITH'S APPROACH TO JAMESTOWN

[May 13, 1607]

I pause not now to speak of Raleigh's dreams, Though they might give a loftier bard fit themes: I pause not now to tell of Ocracock, Where Saxon spray broke on the red-brown rock; Nor of my native river which glides down Through scenes where rose a happy Indian town; But, leaving these and Chesapeake's broad bay, Resume my story in the month of May, Where England's cross--St. George's ensign--flowed Where ne'er before emblazoned banner glowed; Where English breasts throbbed fast as English eyes Looked o'er the waters with a glad surprise,-- Looked gladly out upon the varied scene Where stretched the woods in all their pomp of green; Flinging great shadows, beautiful and vast As e'er upon Arcadian lake were cast. Turn where they

would, in what direction rove, They found some bay, or wild, romantic cove, On which they coasted through those forests dim, Wherein they heard the never-ceasing hymn That swelled from all the tall, majestic pines,-- Fit choristers of Nature's sylvan shrines.

For though no priest their solitudes had trod, The trees were vocal in their praise of God. And then, when, capes and jutting headlands past, The sails were furled against each idle mast, They saw the sunset in its pomp descend, And sky and water gloriously contend For gorgeousness of colors, red and gold, And tints of amethyst together rolled, Making a scene of splendor and of rest As vanquished day lit camp-fires in the West. And when the light grew faint on wave and strand, New beauties woke in this enchanted land, For through heaven's lattice-work of crimson bars Like angels looked the bright eternal stars, And then, when gathered tints of purplish brown, A golden sickle, reaping darkness down, The new moon shone above the lofty trees, Which made low music in the evening breeze,-- The breeze which floating blandly from the shore The perfumed breath of flowering jasmine bore; For smiling Spring had kissed its clustering vines, And breathed her fragrance on the lofty pines.

JAMES BARRON HOPE.

Captain Smith proved himself an energetic and effective leader, and led numerous expeditions into the country in search of food. On one of these, in December, 1607, he was taken prisoner and was conducted to the camp of Powhatan, over-king of the tribes from the Atlantic coast to the "falls of the river." According to the story he sent to England a few months later, he was well treated, and was sent back to Jamestown with an escort. Eight years afterwards, when writing an account of Powhatan's younger daughter, Pocahontas, who was then in England, for the entertainment of Queen Anne, he embellished this plain and probably truthful tale with the romantic incidents so long received as history.

POCAHONTAS

[January 5, 1608]

Wearied arm and broken sword Wage in vain the desperate fight; Round him press a countless horde, He is but a single knight. Hark! a cry of triumph shrill Through the wilderness resounds, As, with twenty bleeding wounds, Sinks the warrior, fighting still.

Now they heap the funeral pyre, And the torch of death they light; Ah! 'tis hard to die by fire! Who will shield the captive knight? Round the stake with fiendish cry Wheel and dance the savage crowd, Cold the victim's mien and proud, And his breast is bared to die.

Who will shield the fearless heart? Who avert the murderous blade? From the throng with sudden start See, there springs an Indian maid. Quick she stands before the knight: "Loose the chain, unbind the ring! I am daughter of the king, And I claim the Indian right!"

Dauntlessly aside she flings Lifted axe and thirsty knife, Fondly to his heart she clings, And her bosom guards his life! In the woods of Powhatan, Still 'tis told by Indian fires How a daughter of their sires Saved a captive Englishman.

WILLIAM MAKEPEACE THACKERAY.

The way in which the Pocahontas incident has been handled by the poets is an interesting and joyous study. These stanzas of Morris's are too delicious to be omitted.

POCAHONTAS

Upon the barren sand A single captive stood; Around him came, with bow and brand, The red men of the wood. Like him of old, his doom he hears, Rock-bound on ocean's brim-- The chieftain's daughter knelt in tears, And breathed a prayer for him.

Above his head in air The savage war-club swung: The frantic girl, in wild despair, Her arms about him flung. Then shook the warriors of the shade, Like leaves on aspen limb, Subdued by that heroic maid Who breathed a prayer for him!

"Unbind him!" gasped the chief: "It is your king's decree!" He kiss'd away the tears of grief, And set the captive free! 'Tis ever thus, when in life's storm Hope's star to man grows dim, An angel kneels, in woman's form, And breathes a prayer for him.

GEORGE POPE MORRIS.

The colony did not flourish as had been hoped, and in May, 1609, the King granted a new charter with larger powers and privileges, and a new company was formed, of which Sir Thomas Gates, Lord De La Warr, and Sir George Somers were made the officers. A large expedition sailed from England June 2, 1609, in charge of Gates, Somers, and Captain Newport, who were on the Sea Venture. During a violent hurricane, their ship was separated from the rest of the fleet and cast ashore upon the Bermudas, whose beauties were so eloquently sung by Andrew Marvell.

BERMUDAS

Where the remote Bermudas ride In the ocean's bosom unespied, From a small boat, that rowed along, The listening winds received this song:

"What should we do but sing His praise, That led us through the watery maze, Unto an isle so long unknown, And yet far kinder than our own? Where He the huge sea-monsters wracks, That lift the deep upon their backs, He lands us on a grassy stage, Safe from the storms, and prelates' rage. He gave us this eternal Spring Which here enamels every thing, And sends the fowls to us in care, On daily visits through the air; He hangs in shades the orange bright, Like golden lamps in a green night, And does in the pomegranates close Jewels more rich than Ormus shows; He makes the figs our mouths to meet, And throws the melons at our feet; But apples plants of such a price, No tree could ever bear them twice. With cedars chosen by His hand From Lebanon He stores the land, And makes the hollow seas that roar Proclaim the ambergris on shore; He cast (of which we rather boast) The Gospel's pearl upon our

coast, And in these rocks for us did frame A temple where to sound His name. Oh! let our voice His praise exalt, Till it arrive at Heaven's vault, Which thence (perhaps) rebounding may Echo beyond the Mexique Bay."

Thus sung they, in the English boat, A holy and a cheerful note: And all the way, to guide their chime, With falling oars they kept the time.

ANDREW MARVELL.

The passengers and crew of the Sea Venture managed to get to land, and finally built two pinnaces, in which they reached Virginia May 24, 1610. They found the colonists in a desolate and miserable condition, and only the timely arrival of Lord De La Warr in the following month (June 9, 1610), with fresh supplies and colonists, prevented them from burning the town and sailing back to England. Among the passengers on the Sea Venture was one Richard Rich. He shared in all the adventures and hardships of the voyage, and finally got back to England in the fall of 1610. On October 1 he published an account of the voyage, called "Newes from Virginia," the first poem written by a visitor to America.

NEWES FROM VIRGINIA

[September, 1610]

It is no idle fabulous tale, nor is it fayned newes: For Truth herself is heere arriv'd, because you should not muse. With her both Gates and Newport come, to tell Report doth lye, Which did divulge unto the world, that they at sea did dye.

Tis true that eleaven months and more, these gallant worthy wights War in the shippe Sea-venture nam'd depriv'd Virginia's sight. And bravely did they glyde the maine, till Neptune gan to frowne, As if a courser proudly backt would throwe his ryder downe.

The seas did rage, the windes did blowe, distressèd were they then; Their ship did leake, her tacklings breake, in daunger were her men. But heaven was pylotte in this storme, and to an iland nere, Bermoothawes call'd, conducted then, which did abate their feare.

But yet these worthies forcèd were, opprest with weather againe, To runne their ship betweene two rockes, where she doth still remaine. And then on shoare the iland came, inhabited by hogges, Some foule and tortoyses there were, they only had one dogge.

To kill these swyne, to yeild them foode that little had to eate, Their store was spent, and all things scant, alas! they wanted meate. A thousand hogges that dogge did kill, their hunger to sustaine, And with such foode did in that ile two and forty weekes remaine.

And there two gallant pynases did build of seader-tree; The brave Deliverance one was call'd; of seaventy tonne was shee. The other Patience had to name, her burthen thirty tonne; Two only of their men which there pale death did overcome.

And for the losse of these two soules, which were accounted deere, A son and daughter then was borne, and were baptizèd there. The two and forty weekes being past, they hoyst sayle and away; Their ships with hogges well freighted were, their harts with mickle joy.

And so unto Virginia came, where these brave soldiers finde The English-men opprest with greife and discontent in minde. They seem'd distracted and forlorne, for those two worthyes losse, Yet at their home returne they joy'd, among'st them some were crosse.

And in the mid'st of discontent came noble Delaware; He heard the greifes on either part, and sett them free from care. He comforts them and cheeres their hearts, that they abound with joy; He feedes them full and feedes their souls with Gods word every day.

A discreet counsell he creates of men of worthy fame, That noble Gates leiftenant was the admirall had to name. The worthy Sir George Somers knight, and others of commaund; Maister Georg Pearcy, which is brother unto Northumberland.

Sir Fardinando Wayneman Knight, and others of good fame, That noble lord his company, which to Virginia came, And landed there; his number was one hundred seaventy; then Ad to the rest, and they make full foure hundred able men.

Where they unto their labour fall, as men that meane to thrive; Let's pray that heaven may blesse them all, and keep them long alive. Those men that vagrants liv'd with us, have there deserved well; Their governour writes in their praise, as divers letters tel.

And to th' adventurers thus he writes be not dismayed at all, For scandall cannot doe us wrong, God will not let us fall. Let England knowe our willingnesse, for that our worke is goode; Wee hope to plant a nation, where none before hath stood.

To glorifie the lord tis done; and to no other end; He that would crosse so good a work, to God can be no friend. There is no feare of hunger here for corne much store here growes, Much fish the gallant rivers yeild, tis truth without suppose.

Great store of fowle, of venison, of grapes and mulberries, Of chestnuts, walnuts, and such like, of fruits and strawberries, There is indeed no want at all, but some, condiciond ill, That wish the worke should not goe on with words doe seeme to kill.

And for an instance of their store, the noble Delaware Hath for the present hither sent, to testify his care In mannaging so good a worke, to gallant ships, by name, The Blessing and the Hercules, well fraught, and in the same

Two ships, as these commodities, furres, sturgeon, caviare, Black walnut-tree, and some deale boards, with such they laden are; Some pearle, some wainscot and clapboards, with some sassafras wood, And iron promist, for tis true their mynes are very good.

Then maugre scandall, false report, or any opposition, Th' adventurers doe thus devulge to men of good condition, That he that wants shall have reliefe, be he of honest minde, Apparel, coyne, or any thing, to such they will be kinde.

To such as to Virginia do purpose to repaire; And when that they shall hither come, each man shall have his share. Day wages for the laborer, and for his more content, A house and garden plot shall have; besides, tis further ment

That every man shall have a part, and not thereof denaid, Of generall profit, as if that he twelve pounds ten shillings paid; And he that in Virginia shall copper coyne receive, For hyer or commodities, and will the country leave

Upon delivery of such coyne unto the Governour, Shall by exchange at his returne be by their treasurer Paid him in London at first sight, no man shall cause to grieve, For tis their generall will and wish that every man should live.

The number of adventurers, that are for this plantation, Are full eight hundred worthy men, some noble, all of fashion. Good, discreete, their worke is good, and as they have begun, May Heaven assist them in their worke, and thus our newes is done.

RICHARD RICH.

Lord Delaware's stay in Virginia marked the turning-point in the fortunes of the colony. New settlements were made, tobacco culture was begun, and Virginia seemed at last fairly started on the road to prosperity.

TO THE VIRGINIAN VOYAGE

[1611]

You brave heroic minds, Worthy your country's name, That honor still pursue, Go and subdue, Whilst loitering hinds Lurk here at home, with shame.

Britons, you stay too long: Quickly aboard bestow you, And with a merry gale Swell your stretch'd sail, With vows as strong As the winds that blow you.

Your course securely steer, West and by south forth keep! Rocks, lee-shores, nor shoals, When Eolus scowls, You need not fear, So absolute the deep.

And cheerfully at sea, Success you still entice, To get the pearl and gold, And ours to hold Virginia, Earth's only paradise.

Where nature hath in store Fowl, venison, and fish, And the fruitful'st soil, Without your toil, Three harvests more, All greater than your wish.

And the ambitious vine Crowns with his purple mass The cedar reaching high To kiss the sky, The cypress, pine, And useful sassafras.

To whom the Golden Age Still nature's laws doth give, No other cares attend, But them to defend From winter's rage, That long there doth not live.

When as the luscious smell Of that delicious land, Above the seas that flows, The clear wind throws, Your hearts to swell Approaching the dear strand;

In kenning of the shore (Thanks to God first given) O you the happiest men, Be frolic then! Let cannons roar, Frighting the wide heaven;

And in regions far Such heroes bring ye forth As those from whom we came, And plant our name Under that star Not known unto our North;

And as there plenty grows Of laurel everywhere,-- Apollo's sacred tree,-- You it may see, A poet's brows To crown, that may sing there.

Thy _Voyages_ attend Industrious Hackluit, Whose reading shall inflame Men to seek fame, And much commend To after-times thy wit.

MICHAEL DRAYTON.

Among the planters at Jamestown was John Rolfe, a zealous Christian, who became interested in Pocahontas. Finally, either captivated by her grace and beauty as the romancists believe, or in spite of personal scruples and "for the good of the colony," as Hamor wrote, he proposed marriage. The Princess was willing, her father consented, though he refused to be present at the ceremony (April 5, 1614), and the bride was given away by her uncle Opachisco. They had one son, Thomas Rolfe, whose descendants are still living in Virginia.

THE MARRIAGE OF POCAHONTAS

[April 5, 1614]

That balmy eve, within a trellised bower, Rudely constructed on the sounding shore, Her plighted troth the forest maiden gave Ere sought the skiff that bore them o'er the wave To the dark home-bound ship, whose restless sway Rocked to the winds and waves, impatient of delay.

* * * * *

Short was the word that pledged triumphant love; That vow, that claims its registry above. And low the cadence of that hymn of praise Whose hallowed incense rose, as rose its lays; And few the worshippers 'neath that pure cope Which emblems to the soul eternal hope.

One native maiden waited the command Of the young Princess of Virginia's strand; And that dark youth, the Page of Cedar Isle, Who wept her woes, and shared her sad exile, With his loved bride, who owned the royal blood, And near the forest Queen majestically stood.

Some others bent beside the rural shrine In adoration to the Power divine; When at the altar knelt, with minds serene, The gallant Soldier and the dark-browed Queen.

These, for the love they bore her guileless youth, Paid the high fealty of the warm heart's truth; And with its homage satisfied, gone o'er Each vision bright that graced their natal shore.

Those, with forebodings dread and brimful eyes, Bade holy angels guard the destinies Of one on whom had fallen the chrism of light With unction pure; the youthful neophyte Of that fair clime where millions yet unborn Shall raise the choral hymn from eve till morn.

MRS. M. M. WEBSTER.

In 1616 Pocahontas was taken to England, where she was received with marked attention by the Queen and court. She renewed her acquaintance with Captain John Smith, who was busy weaving fairy tales about her, had her portrait painted and led a fashionable life generally. It did not agree with her, she developed consumption, and died at Gravesend, March 27, 1617.

THE LAST MEETING OF POCAHONTAS AND THE GREAT CAPTAIN

[June, 1616]

In a stately hall at Brentford, when the English June was green, Sat the Indian Princess, summoned that her graces might be seen, For the rumor of her beauty filled the ear of court and Queen.

There for audience as she waited, with half-scornful, silent air All undazzled by the splendor gleaming round her everywhere, Dight in broidered hose and doublet, came a courtier down the stair.

As with striding step he hasted, burdened with the Queen's command, Loud he cried, in tones that tingled, "_Welcome, welcome, to my land!_" But a tremor seized the Princess, and she drooped upon her hand.

"What! no word, my Sparkling-Water? must I come on bended knee? I were slain within the forest, I were dead beyond the sea; On the banks of wild Pamunkey, I had perished _but for thee_.

"Ah, I keep a heart right loyal, that can never more forget! I can hear the rush, the breathing; I can see the eyelids wet; I can feel the sudden tightening of thine arms about me yet.

"Nay, look up. Thy father's daughter never feared the face of man, Shrank not from the forest darkness when her doe-like footsteps ran To my cabin, bringing tidings of the craft of Powhatan."

With extended arms, entreating, stood the stalwart Captain there, While the courtiers press around her, and the passing pages stare; But no sign gave Pocahontas underneath her veil of hair.

All her lithe and willowy figure quivered like an aspen-leaf, And she crouched as if she shrivelled, frost-touched by some sudden grief, Turning only on her husband, Rolfe, one glance, sharp, searching, brief.

At the Captain's haughty gesture, back the curious courtiers fell, And with soothest word and accent he besought that she would tell Why she turned away, nor greeted him whom she had served so well.

But for two long hours the Princess dumbly sate and bowed her head, Moveless as the statue near her. When at last she spake, she said: "White man's tongue is false. It told me--told me--_that my brave was dead_.

"And I lay upon my deer-skins all one moon of falling leaves (Who hath care for song or corn-dance, when the voice within her grieves?), Looking westward where the souls go, up the path the sunset weaves.

"Call me 'child' now. It is over. On my husband's arm I lean; Never shadow, _Nenemoosa_, our twain hearts shall come between; Take my hand, and let us follow the great Captain to his Queen."

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

In 1676 the colony was shaken by a struggle which presaged that other one which was to occur just a century later. An Indian war had broken out along the frontier, but Governor Berkeley disbanded the forces gathered to repress it. Whereupon a young man named Nathaniel Bacon gathered a force of his own, marched against the Indians, and was proclaimed a rebel and traitor by the royal governor, who had collected at Jamestown a force of nearly a thousand men. Bacon, after a campaign in which the hostile Indians were practically wiped out of existence, marched back to Jamestown and besieged the place. After a sally in which he was repulsed, Berkeley sailed away and left the town to its fate. Bacon entered it next morning (September 19, 1676), and, deciding that he could not hold it, set fire to it that evening. It was totally destroyed.

THE BURNING OF JAMESTOWN

[September 19, 1676]

Mad Berkeley believed, with his gay cavaliers, And the ruffians he brought from the Accomac shore, He could ruffle our spirit by rousing our fears, And lord it again as he lorded before: It was--"Traitors, be dumb!" And--"Surrender, ye scum!" And that Bacon, our leader, was rebel, he swore.

A rebel? Not he! He was true to the throne; For the King, at a word, he would lay down his life; But to listen unmoved to the piteous moan When the redskin was plying the hatchet and knife, And shrink from the fray, Was not the man's way-- It was Berkeley, not Bacon, who stirred up the strife.

On the outer plantations the savages burst, And scattered around desolation and woe; And Berkeley, possessed by some spirit accurst, Forbade us to deal for our kinsfolk a blow; Though when, weapons in hand, We made our demand, He sullenly suffered our forces to go.

Then while we were doing our work for the crown, And risking our lives in the perilous fight, He sent lying messengers out, up and down, To denounce us as outlaws--mere malice and spite; Then from Accomac's shore Brought a thousand or more, Who swaggered the country around, day and night.

Returning in triumph, instead of reward For the marches we made and the battles we won, There were threats of the fetters or bullet or sword-- Were these a fair guerdon for what we had done? When this madman abhorred Appealed to the sword, And our leader said "fight!" did he think we would run?

Battle-scarred, and a handful of men as we were, We feared not to combat with lord or with lown, So we took the old wretch at his word--that was fair; But he dared not come out from his hold in the town Where he lay with his men, Like a wolf in his den; And in siege of the place we sat steadily down.

He made a fierce sally,--his force was so strong He thought the mere numbers would put us to flight,-- But we met in close column his ruffianly throng, And smote it so sore that we filled him with fright; Then while ready we lay For the storming next day, He embarked in his ships, and escaped in the night.

The place was our own; could we hold it? why, no! Not if Berkeley should gather more force and return; But one course was left us to baffle the foe-- The birds would not come if the nest we should burn; So the red, crackling fire Climbed to roof-top and spire, A lesson for black-hearted Berkeley to learn.

That our torches destroyed what our fathers had raised On that beautiful isle, is it matter of blame? That the houses we dwelt in, the church where they praised The God of our Fathers, we gave to the flame? That we smiled when there lay Smoking ruins next day, And nothing was left of the town but its name?

We won; but we lost when brave Nicholas died; The spirit that nerved us was gone from us then; And Berkeley came back in his arrogant pride To give to the gallows the best of our men; But while the grass grows And the clear water flows, The town shall not rise from its ashes again.

So, you come for your victim! I'm ready; but, pray, Ere I go, some good fellow a full goblet bring. Thanks, comrade! Now hear the last words I shall say With the last drink I take. Here's a health to the King, Who reigns o'er a land Where, against his command, The rogues rule and ruin, while honest men swing.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

Jamestown soon avenged itself. Before Bacon left the place he was ill with fever, and on the first day of October, at the house of a friend in Gloucester County, he "surrendered up that fort he was no longer able to keep, into the hands of the grim and all-conquering Captain, Death." His death was celebrated in a poem which is perhaps the most brilliant example of sustained poetic art produced in Colonial America. It was written "by his man," of whom absolutely nothing is known.

BACON'S EPITAPH, MADE BY HIS MAN

[October 1, 1676]

Death, why so cruel? What! no other way To manifest thy spleen, but thus to slay Our hopes of safety, liberty, our all, Which, through thy tyranny, with him must fall To its late chaos? Had thy rigid force Been dealt by retail, and not thus in gross, Grief had been silent. Now we must complain, Since thou, in him, hast more than thousands slain, Whose lives and safeties did so much depend On him their life, with him their lives must end. If 't be a sin to think Death brib'd can be We must be guilty; say 'twas bribery Guided the fatal shaft. Virginia's foes, To whom for secret crimes

just vengeance owes Deservèd plagues, dreading their just desert, Corrupted Death by Paracelsian art Him to destroy; whose well-tried courage such, Their heartless hearts, nor arms, nor strength could touch. Who now must heal those wounds, or stop that blood The Heathen made, and drew into a flood? Who is't must plead our cause? nor trump, nor drum, Nor Deputation; these, alas! are dumb And cannot speak. Our arms (though ne'er so strong) Will want the aid of his commanding tongue, Which conquer'd more than Cæsar. He o'erthrew Only the outward frame; this could subdue The rugged works of nature. Souls replete With dull chill cold, he'd animate with heat Drawn forth of reason's limbec. In a word, Mars and Minerva both in him concurred For arts, for arms, whose pen and sword alike As Cato's did, may admiration strike Into his foes; while they confess withal It was their guilt styl'd him a criminal. Only this difference does from truth proceed: They in the guilt, he in the name must bleed. While none shall dare his obsequies to sing In deserv'd measures; until time shall bring Truth crown'd with freedom, and from danger free To sound his praises to posterity. Here let him rest; while we this truth report, He's gone from hence unto a higher Court To plead his cause, where he by this doth know Whether to Cæsar he was friend or foe.

Jamestown never recovered from the blow which Bacon dealt it. The location was so unhealthy that it could not attract new settlers, and though some of the houses which had been burned were subsequently rebuilt, the town's day of greatness was past. The seat of government was removed to Williamsburg, and the old settlement dropped gradually to decay.

ODE TO JAMESTOWN

Old cradle of an infant world, In which a nestling empire lay, Struggling awhile, ere she unfurled Her gallant wing and soared away; All hail! thou birthplace of the glowing west, Thou seem'st the towering eagle's ruined nest!

What solemn recollections throng, What touching visions rise, As, wandering these old stones among, I backward turn mine eyes, And see the shadows of the dead flit round, Like spirits, when the last dread trump shall sound.

The wonders of an age combined In one short moment memory supplies; They throng upon my wakened mind, As time's dark curtains rise. The volume of a hundred buried years, Condensed in one bright sheet, appears.

I hear the angry ocean rave, I see the lonely little bark Scudding along the crested wave, Freighted like old Noah's ark, As o'er the drownèd earth 'twas hurled, With the forefathers of another world.

I see the train of exiles stand, Amid the desert, desolate, The fathers of my native land, The daring pioneers of fate, Who braved the perils of the sea and earth, And gave a boundless empire birth.

I see the sovereign Indian range His woodland empire, free as air; I see the gloomy forest change, The shadowy earth laid bare; And where the red man chased the bounding deer, The smiling labors of the white appear.

I see the haughty warrior gaze In wonder or in scorn, As the pale faces sweat to raise Their scanty fields of corn, While he, the monarch of the boundless wood, By sport, or hair-brained rapine, wins his food.

A moment, and the pageant's gone; The red men are no more; The pale-faced strangers stand alone Upon the river's shore; And the proud wood-king, who their arts disdained, Finds but a bloody grave where once he reigned.

The forest reels beneath the stroke Of sturdy woodman's axe; The earth receives the white man's yoke, And pays her willing tax Of fruits, and flowers, and golden harvest fields, And all that nature to blithe labor yields.

Then growing hamlets rear their heads, And gathering crowds expand, Far as my fancy's vision spreads, O'er many a boundless land, Till what was once a world of savage strife Teems with the richest gifts of social life.

Empire to empire swift succeeds, Each happy, great, and free; One empire still another breeds, A giant progeny, Destined their daring race to run, Each to the regions of yon setting sun.

Then, as I turn my thoughts to trace The fount whence these rich waters sprung, I glance towards this lonely place, And find it these rude stones among. Here rest the sires of millions, sleeping round, The Argonauts, the golden fleece that found.

Their names have been forgotten long; The stone, but not a word, remains; They cannot live in deathless song, Nor breathe in pious strains. Yet this sublime obscurity to me More touching is than poet's rhapsody.

They live in millions that now breathe; They live in millions yet unborn, And pious gratitude shall wreathe As bright a crown as e'er was worn, And hang it on the green-leaved bough, That whispers to the nameless dead below.

No one that inspiration drinks, No one that loves his native land, No one that reasons, feels, or thinks, Can mid these lonely ruins stand Without a moistened eye, a grateful tear Of reverent gratitude to those that moulder here.

The mighty shade now hovers round, Of him whose strange, yet bright career Is written on this sacred ground In letters that no time shall sere; Who in the Old World smote the turbaned crew, And founded Christian empires in the New.

And she! the glorious Indian maid, The tutelary of this land, The angel of the woodland shade, The miracle of God's own hand, Who joined man's heart to woman's softest grace, And thrice redeemed the scourges of her race.

Sister of charity and love, Whose life-blood was soft Pity's tide, Dear goddess of the sylvan grove, Flower of the forest, nature's pride, He is no man who does not bend the knee, And she no woman who is not like thee!

Jamestown, and Plymouth's hallowed rock To me shall ever sacred be,-- I care not who my themes may mock, Or sneer at them and me. I envy not the brute who here can stand Without a thrill for his own native land.

And if the recreant crawl her earth, Or breathe Virginia's air, Or in New England claim his birth, From the old pilgrims there, He is a bastard if he dare to mock Old Jamestown's shrine or Plymouth's famous rock.

JAMES KIRKE PAULDING.

In the early part of the eighteenth century, pirates did a thriving trade along the American coast. One of the most redoubtable of these was Captain Teach, better known as "Blackbeard." After a long career of variegated villainy, he was cornered in Pamlico Inlet, in 1718, and killed, together with most of his crew, by a force sent after him by Governor Spottiswood of Virginia. His death was celebrated in a ballad said to have been written by Benjamin Franklin.

THE DOWNFALL OF PIRACY

[November 22, 1718]

Will you hear of a bloody Battle, Lately fought upon the Seas? It will make your Ears to rattle, And your Admiration cease; Have you heard of _Teach_ the Rover, And his Knavery on the Main; How of Gold he was a Lover, How he lov'd all ill-got Gain?

When the Act of Grace appeared, Captain _Teach_, with all his Men, Unto _Carolina_ steered, Where they kindly us'd him then; There he marry'd to a Lady, And gave her five hundred Pound, But to her he prov'd unsteady, For he soon march'd off the Ground.

And returned, as I tell you, To his Robbery as before, Burning, sinking Ships of value, Filling them with Purple Gore; When he was at _Carolina_, There the Governor did send To the Governor of _Virginia_, That he might assistance lend.

Then the Man-of-War's Commander, Two small Sloops he fitted out, Fifty Men he put on board, Sir, Who resolv'd to stand it out; The Lieutenant he commanded Both the Sloops, and you shall hear How, before he landed, He suppress'd them without fear.

Valiant _Maynard_ as he sailed, Soon the Pirate did espy, With his Trumpet he then hailed, And to him they did reply: Captain _Teach_ is our Commander, _Maynard_ said, he is the Man Whom I am resolv'd to hang, Sir, Let him do the best he can.

Teach replyed unto _Maynard_, You no Quarter here shall see, But be hang'd on the Mainyard, You and all your Company; _Maynard_ said, I none desire Of such Knaves as thee and thine, None I'll give, _Teach_ then replyed, My Boys, give me a Glass of Wine.

He took the Glass, and drank Damnation Unto _Maynard_ and his Crew; To himself and Generation, Then the Glass away he threw; Brave _Maynard_ was resolv'd to have him, Tho' he'd Cannons nine or ten; _Teach_ a broadside quickly gave him, Killing sixteen valiant Men.

Maynard boarded him, and to it They fell with Sword and Pistol too; They had Courage, and did show it, Killing of the Pirate's Crew. _Teach_ and _Maynard_ on the

Quarter, Fought it out most manfully, _Maynard's_ Sword did cut him shorter, Losing his head, he there did die.

Every Sailor fought while he, Sir, Power had to wield the Sword, Not a Coward could you see, Sir, Fear was driven from aboard; Wounded Men on both Sides fell, Sir, 'Twas a doleful Sight to see, Nothing could their Courage quell, Sir, O, they fought courageously.

When the bloody Fight was over, We're informed by a Letter writ, _Teach's_ Head was made a Cover, To the Jack Staff of the Ship; Thus they sailed to _Virginia_, And when they the Story told, How they kill'd the Pirates many, They'd Applause from young and old.

BENJAMIN FRANKLIN. (?)

On the twenty-second day of February, 1732 (February 12, O. S.), there was born in Westmoreland County, Virginia, a son to Augustine and Mary (Ball) Washington. The baby was christened George, and lived to become the most famous personage in American history.

FROM POTOMAC TO MERRIMAC

[February 11, 1732]

I. POTOMAC SIDE

Do you know how the people of all the land Knew at last that the time was at hand When He should be sent to give command To armies and people, to father and son! How the glad tidings of joy should run Which tell of the birth of Washington?

Three women keep watch of the midnight sky Where Potomac ripples below; They watch till the light in the window hard by The birth of the child shall show. Is it peace? Is it strife? Is it death? Is it life? The light in the window shall show! Weal or woe! We shall know!

The women have builded a signal pile For the birthday's welcome flame, That the light may show for many a mile To tell when the baby came! And south and north The word go forth That the boy is born On that blessèd morn; The boy of deathless fame!

II. SIGNAL FIRES

The watchmen have waited on Capitol Hill And they light the signal flame; And at Baltimore Bay they waited till The welcome tidings came; And then across the starlit night, At the head of Elk the joyful light Told to the Quaker town the story Of new-born life and coming glory! To Trenton Ferry and Brooklyn Height They sent the signal clear and bright, And far away, Before the day, To Kaatskill and Greylock the joyful flame And everywhere the message came, As the signal flew The people knew That the man of men was born!

III. MERRIMAC SIDE, AND AGIOCHOOK

So it is, they say, that the men in the bay, In winter's ice and snow, See the welcome light on Wachusett Height While the Merrimac rolls below. The cheery fire Rose higher and higher, Monadnock and Carrigain catch the flame, And on and on, and on it came, And as men look Far away in the north The word goes forth, To Agiochook. The welcome fire Flashed higher and higher To our mountain ways, And the dome, and Moat and Pequawket blaze!

So the farmers in the Intervale See the light that shall never fail, The beacon light which shines to tell To all the world to say That the boy has been born On that winter's morn By Potomac far away. Whose great command Shall bless that land Whom the land shall bless In joy and distress Forever and a day!

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

CHAPTER IV

THE DUTCH AT NEW AMSTERDAM

On the fourth day of April, 1609, there put out from the port of Amsterdam a little craft of about eighty tons, called the Half Moon. It had been chartered by the Dutch East India Company to search for the Northwest Passage. Its captain was Henry Hudson, and on September 3 he cast anchor inside Sandy Hook.

HENRY HUDSON'S QUEST

[1609]

Out from the harbor of Amsterdam The Half Moon turned her prow to sea; The coast of Norway dropped behind, Yet Northward still kept she Through the drifting fog and the driving snow, Where never before man dared to go: "O Pilot, shall we find the strait that leads to the Eastern Sea?" "A waste of ice before us lies--we must turn back," said he.

Westward they steered their tiny bark, Westward through weary weeks they sped, Till the cold gray strand of a stranger-land Loomed through the mist ahead. League after league they hugged the coast, And their Captain never left his post: "O Pilot, see you yet the strait that leads to the Eastern Sea?" "I see but the rocks and the barren shore; no strait is there," quoth he.

They sailed to the North--they sailed to the South-- And at last they rounded an arm of sand Which held the sea from a harbor's mouth-- The loveliest in the land; They kept their course across the bay, And the shore before them fell away: "O Pilot, see you not the strait that leads to the Eastern Sea?" "Hold the rudder true! Praise Christ Jesu! the strait is here," said he.

Onward they glide with wind and tide, Past marshes gray and crags sun-kist; They skirt the sills of green-clad hills, And meadows white with mist-- But alas! the hope

and the brave, brave dream! For rock and shallow bar the stream: "O Pilot, can this be the strait that leads to the Eastern Sea?" "Nay, Captain, nay; 'tis not this way; turn back we must," said he.

Full sad was Hudson's heart as he turned The Half Moon's prow to the South once more; He saw no beauty in crag or hill, No beauty in curving shore; For they shut him away from that fabled main He sought his whole life long, in vain: "O Pilot, say, can there be a strait that leads to the Eastern Sea?" "God's crypt is sealed! 'Twill stand revealed in His own good time," quoth he.

BURTON EGBERT STEVENSON.

A few days were spent in exploring the bay, and on September 6 occurred the only fatality that marked the voyage. A seaman named John Colman, with four sailors, was sent out in a small boat to sound the Narrows, and encountered some Indians, who sent a flight of arrows toward the strangers. One of the arrows pierced Colman's throat, killing him.

THE DEATH OF COLMAN

[September 6, 1609]

'Twas Juet spoke--the Half Moon's mate And they who Holland's ship of state Compass'd with wisdom, listening sate:

Discovery's near-extinguished spark Flared up into a blaze, When Man-na-hat-ta's virgin hills, Enriched by Autumn's days, First fell on our impatient sight, And soothed us with a strange delight.

Bidden by fevered trade, our keel Had ploughed unbeaten deeps; From many a perfume-laden isle To the dark land that sleeps Forever in its winter robe, Th' unsocial hermit of the globe.

But we, who sought for China's strand By ocean ways untried, Forgot our mission when we cast Our anchor in a tide That kissed a gem too wondrous fair For any eastern sea to wear!

Entranced, we saw the golden woods Slope gently to the sands; The grassy meads, the oaks that dwarfed Their kin of other lands; And from the shore the balmy wind Blew sweeter than the spice of Ind.

As he whose eyes, though opened wide, Are fixed upon a dream, So Colman--one who long had held Our Hudson's warm esteem-- Gazed on the gorgeous scene, and said, "Ere even's shades are overspread,

"Proudly our flag on yonder height Shall tell of Holland's gain; Proclaiming her to all the earth The sovereign of the main." And quickly from the Half Moon's bow We turned the longboat's yielding prow.

The measured flashing of the oars Broke harshly on the ear; And eye asked eye--for lips were mute-- What Holland hearts should fear; For true it is our hearts were soft, Save his, who held the flag aloft.

And suddenly our unshaped dread Took direful form and sound. For from a near nook's rocky shade, Swift as pursuing hound, A savage shallop sped, to hold From stranger feet that strand of gold.

And rageful cries disturbed the peace That on the waters slept; And Echo whispered on the hills, As though an army crept, With flinty axe and brutal blade, Through the imperforate forest shade.

"What! are ye cravens?" Colman said; For each had shipped his oar. He waved the flag: "For Netherland, Pull for yon jutting shore!" Then prone he fell within the boat, A flinthead arrow through his throat!

And now full many a stealthy skiff Shot out into the bay; And swiftly, sadly, pulled we back To where the Half Moon lay; But he was dead--our master wept-- He smiled, brave heart, as though he slept.

Then to the seaward breeze our sail With woful hearts we threw; And anchored near a sandy strip That looks o'er ocean blue: And there we kissed and buried him, While surges sang his funeral hymn.

And many a pitying glance we gave, And many a prayer we said, As from that grave we turned, and left The dark sea with her dead; For--God of Waves!--none could repress One choking thought--_the loneliness_!

THOMAS FROST.

Hudson ascended the river to a point a little above the present town of Albany, then turned back and returned to Holland. His report of the rich country he had discovered was received with enthusiasm there, and preparations were begun on an extensive scale to colonize the new country. Dutch voyagers explored all the adjacent coasts, among the most active being Adrian Block.

ADRIAN BLOCK'S SONG

[July, 1615]

Hard aport! Now close to shore sail! Starboard now, and drop your foresail! See, boys, what yon bay discloses, What yon open bay discloses! Where the breeze so gently blows is Heaven's own land of ruddy roses.

Past the Cormorant we sail, Past the rippling Beaver Tail, Green with summer, red with flowers, Green with summer, fresh with showers, Sweet with song and red with flowers, Is this new-found land of ours!

Roses close above the sand, Roses on the trees on land, I shall take this land for my land, Rosy beach and rosy highland, And I name it Roses Island.

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

But troubles at home prevented any extensive effort at colonization until 1621, when the States-General chartered the Dutch West India Company, which in 1623 sent Captain Cornelius Jacobsen Mey, with thirty families, to start the colony.

THE PRAISE OF NEW NETHERLAND

With sharpened pen and wit, one tunes his lays, To sing the vanity of fame and praise; His moping thoughts, bewildered in a maze, In darkness wander. What brings disgrace, what constitutes a wrong, These form the burden of the tuneful song: And honor saved, his senses then among The dark holes ponder. For me, it is a nobler thing I sing. New Netherland springs forth my heroine; Where Amstel's folk did erst their people bring, And still they flourish. New Netherland, thou noblest spot of earth, Where Bounteous Heaven ever poureth forth The fulness of His gifts, of greatest worth, Mankind to nourish. Whoe'er to you a judgment fair applies, And knowing, comprehends your qualities, Will justify the man who, to the skies, Extols your glories. Who studies well your natural elements, And with the plumb of science, gains a sense Of all the four: fails not in their defence, Before free juries. Your _Air_, so clear, so sharp to penetrate, The western breezes softly moderate; And, tempering the heat, they separate It from all moisture. From damp, and mist, and fog, they set it free; From smells of pools, they give it liberty: The struggling stenches made to mount on high, And be at peace there. No deadly pest its purity assails, To spread infection o'er your hills and vales, Save when a guilty race, great sins bewails In expiating. Your Sun, th' original of _Fire_ and heat, The common nutriment of both to eat, Is warm and pure; in plants most delicate, Much sap creating. Nor turf, nor dried manure,--within your doors, Nor coal, extracted from earth's secret stores, Nor sods, uplifted from the barren moors, For fuel given; Which, with foul stench the brain intoxicate, And thus, by the foul gas which they create. The intellects of many, wise and great, Men are out-driven. The forests do, with better means, supply The hearth and house; the stately hickory, Not planted, does the winter fell defy,-- A valiant warden; So closely grained, so rich with fragrant oil, Before its blaze both wet and cold recoil; And sweetest perfumes float around the while, Like 'n Eden's garden. The _Water_ clear and fresh, and pure and sweet, Springs up continually beneath the feet, And everywhere the gushing fountains meet, In brooks o'erflowing, Which animals refresh, both tame and wild; And plants conduce to grow on hill and field; And these to man unnumbered comforts yield, And quickly growing. The _Earth_ in soils of different shades appears, Black, blue and white, and red; its bosom bears Abundant harvests; and, what pleases, spares Not to surrender. No bounds exist to their variety. They nourishment afford most plenteously To creatures which, in turn, man's wants supply And health engender. O fruitful land! heaped up with blessings kind, Whoe'er your several virtues brings to mind,-- Its proper value to each gift assigned, Will soon discover, If ever land perfection have attained, That you in all things have that glory gained; Ungrateful mortal, who, your worth disdained, Would pass you over. In North America, behold your _Seat_, Where all that heart can wish you satiate, And where oppressed with wealth inordinate, You have the power To bless the people with whate'er they need, The melancholy, from their sorrows lead, The light of heart, exulting pleasures cede, Who never cower. The _Ocean_ laves secure the outer shore, Which, like a dyke, is raised your fields before; And streams, like arteries, all veinèd o'er, The woods refreshing; And rolling down from mountains and the hills, Afford, upon their banks, fit sites for mills; And furnish, what the heart with transport fills, The finest fishing.

JACOB STEENDAM.

Other expeditions followed, but though the colony prospered, the mother country could provide little means of defence, and it was practically at the mercy of the English--the "swine" of Steendam's verses.

THE COMPLAINT OF NEW AMSTERDAM

[1659]

I'm a grandchild of the gods Who on th' Amstel have abodes; Whence their orders forth are sent, Swift for aid and punishment. I, of Amsterdam, was born, Early of her breasts forlorn; From her care so quickly weaned Oft have I my fate bemoaned. From my youth up left alone, Naught save hardship have I known; Dangers have beset my way From the first I saw the day. Think you this a cause for marvel? This will then the thread unravel, And the circumstances trace, Which upon my birth took place. Would you ask for my descent? Long the time was it I spent In the loins of warlike Mars. 'T seems my mother, seized with fears, Prematurely brought me forth. But I now am very loth To inform how this befel; Though 'twas thus, I know full well, Bacchus, too,--it is no dream,-- First beheld the daylight's beam From the thigh of Jupiter. But my reasons go too far. My own matter must I say, And not loiter by the way, E'en though Bacchus oft has proven Friend to me in my misfortune. Now the midwife who received me, Was Bellona; in suspense, she Long did sit in trembling fear, For the travail was severe. From the moment I was born, Indian neighbors made me mourn. They pursued me night and day, While my mother kept away. But my sponsors did supply Better my necessity; They sustained my feeble life; They procured a bounteous wife As my nurse, who did not spare To my lips her paps to bear. This was Ceres; freely she Rendered what has nurtured me. Her most dearly I will prize; She has made my horns to rise; Trained my growth through tender years, 'Midst my burdens and my cares. True both simple 'twas and scant, What I had to feed my want. Oft 'twas naught except Sapawn And the flesh of buck or fawn. When I thus began to grow, No more care did they bestow, Yet my breasts are full and neat, And my hips are firmly set. Neptune shows me his good will; Merc'ry, quick, exerts his skill Me t' adorn with silk and gold; Whence I'm sought by suitors bold. Stricken by my cheek's fresh bloom, By my beauteous youthful form, They attempt to seize the treasure To enjoy their wanton pleasure. They, my orchards too, would plunder, Truly 'tis a special wonder, That a maid with such a portion Does not suffer more misfortune: For, I venture to proclaim, No one can a maiden name Who with richer land is blessed Than th' estate by me possessed. See: two streams my garden bind, From the East and North they wind,-- Rivers pouring in the sea, Rich in fish, beyond degree. Milk and butter: fruits to eat No one can enumerate; Ev'ry vegetable known; Grain the best that e'er was grown. All the blessings man e'er knew, Here does Our Great Giver strew (And a climate ne'er more pure), But for me,--yet immature, Fraught with danger, for the swine Trample down these crops of mine; Up-root, too, my choicest land; Still and dumb, the while, I stand, In the hope, my mother's arm Will protect me from the harm. She can succor my distress. Now my wish, my sole request,-- Is for men to till my land; So I'll not in silence stand. I have lab'rors almost none; Let my

household large become; I'll my mother's kitchen furnish With my knick-knacks, with my surplus; With tobacco, furs and grain; So that Prussia she'll disdain.

JACOB STEENDAM, noch vaster.

In spite of this neglect, the new town thrived apace. Friendly relations were established with the settlers at Plymouth, and the colony seemed to be moving steadily toward a golden future. In May, 1647, there arrived from Holland the new director, Peter Stuyvesant. He ruled supreme until 1664, when New Amsterdam surrendered to an English fleet.

PETER STUYVESANT'S NEW YEAR'S CALL

[I. Jan. A. C. 1661]

Where nowadays the Battery lies, New York had just begun, A new-born babe, to rub its eyes, In Sixteen Sixty-One. They christened it Nieuw Amsterdam, Those burghers grave and stately, And so, with schnapps and smoke and psalm, Lived out their lives sedately.

Two windmills topped their wooden wall, On Stadthuys gazing down, On fort, and cabbage-plots, and all The quaintly gabled town; These flapped their wings and shifted backs, As ancient scrolls determine, To scare the savage Hackensacks, Paumanks, and other vermin.

At night the loyal settlers lay Betwixt their feather-beds; In hose and breeches walked by day, And smoked, and wagged their heads. No changeful fashions came from France, The freulen to bewilder, And cost the burgher's purse, perchance, Its every other guilder.

In petticoats of linsey-red, And jackets neatly kept, The vrouws their knitting-needles sped And deftly spun and swept. Few modern-school flirtations there Set wheels of scandal trundling, But youths and maidens did their share Of staid, old-fashioned bundling.

--The New Year opened clear and cold; The snow, a Flemish ell In depth, lay over Beeckman's Wold And Wolfert's frozen well. Each burgher shook his kitchen-doors, Drew on his Holland leather, Then stamped through drifts to do the chores, Beshrewing all such weather.

But--after herring, ham, and kraut-- To all the gathered town The Dominie preached the morning out, In Calvinistic gown; While tough old Peter Stuyvesant Sat pewed in foremost station,-- The potent, sage, and valiant Third Governor of the nation.

Prayer over, at his mansion hall, With cake and courtly smile, He met the people, one and all, In gubernatorial style; Yet missed, though now the day was old, An ancient fellow-feaster,-- Heer Govert Loockermans, that bold Brewer and burgomeester;

Who, in his farmhouse, close without The picket's eastern end, Sat growling at the twinge of gout That kept him from his friend. But Peter strapped his wooden peg, When tea and cake were ended (Meanwhile the sound remaining leg Its high jack-boot defended),

A woolsey cloak about him threw, And swore, by wind and limb, Since Govert kept from Peter's view, Peter would visit him; Then sallied forth, through snow and blast, While many a humbler greeter Stood wondering whereaway so fast Strode bluff Hardkoppig Pieter.

Past quay and cowpath, through a lane Of vats and mounded tans, He puffed along, with might and main, To Govert Loockermans; Once there, his right of entry took, And hailed his ancient crony: "Myn Gód! in dese Manhattoes, Loock, Ve gets more snow as money!"

To which, and after whiffs profound, With doubtful wink and nod, There came at last responsive sound: "Yah, Peter; yah, Myn Gód!" Then goedevrouw Marie sat her guest Beneath the chimney-gable, And courtesied, bustling at her best To spread the New Year's table.

She brought the pure and genial schnapps, That years before had come-- In the "Nieuw Nederlandts," perhaps-- To cheer the settlers' home; The long-stemmed pipes; the fragrant roll Of pressed and crispy Spanish; Then placed the earthen mugs and bowl, Nor long delayed to vanish.

Thereat, with cheery nod and wink, And honors of the day, The trader mixed the Governor's drink As evening sped away. That ancient room! I see it now: The carven nutwood dresser; The drawers, that many a burgher's vrouw Begrudged their rich possessor;

The brace of high-backed leathern chairs, Brass-nailed at every seam; Six others, ranged in equal pairs; The bacon hung abeam; The chimney-front, with porcelain shelft; The hearty wooden fire; The picture, on the steaming delft, Of David and Goliah.

I see the two old Dutchmen sit Like Magog and his mate, And hear them, when their pipes are lit, Discuss affairs of state: The clique that would their sway demean; The pestilent importation Of wooden nutmegs, from the lean And losel Yankee nation.

But when the subtle juniper Assumed its sure command, They drank the buxom loves that were,-- They drank the Motherland; They drank the famous Swedish wars, Stout Peter's special glory, While Govert proudly showed the scars Of Indian contests gory.

Erelong, the berry's power awoke Some music in their brains, And, trumpet-like, through rolling smoke, Rang long-forgotten strains,-- Old Flemish snatches, full of blood, Of phantom ships and battle; And Peter, with his leg of wood, Made floor and casement rattle.

Then round and round the dresser pranced, The chairs began to wheel, And on the board the punch-bowl danced A Netherlandish reel; Till midnight o'er the farmhouse

spread Her New Year's skirts of sable, And inch by inch, each puzzled head Dropt down upon the table.

But still to Peter, as he dreamed, The table spread and turned; The chimney-log blazed high, and seemed To circle as it burned; The town into the vision grew From ending to beginning; Fort, wall, and windmill met his view, All widening and spinning.

The cowpaths, leading to the docks, Grew broader, whirling past, And checkered into shining blocks,-- A city fair and vast; Stores, churches, mansions, overspread The metamorphosed island, While not a beaver showed his head From Swamp to Kalchook highland.

Eftsoons the picture passed away; Hours after, Peter woke To see a spectral streak of day Gleam in through fading smoke; Still slept old Govert, snoring on In most melodious numbers; No dreams of Eighteen Sixty-One Commingled with his slumbers.

But Peter, from the farmhouse door, Gazed doubtfully around, Rejoiced to find himself once more On sure and solid ground. The sky was somewhat dark ahead, Wind east, the morning lowery; And on he pushed, a two-miles' tread, To breakfast at his Bouwery.

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

CHAPTER V

THE SETTLEMENT OF NEW ENGLAND

The Northern or Plymouth Branch of the Virginia Company, which had been chartered by James I in 1606, did, to some extent, for the north what the sister company did for the south. Sir Ferdinando Gorges was its Raleigh, and sent out a number of exploring ships, one of which made what is now reckoned the first permanent settlement in New England. Captain George Popham was in command, and in August, 1607, three months after the planting of Jamestown, built Fort Popham, or Fort St. George, at the mouth of the Kennebec. But it is not this settlement which has been celebrated in song and story. It is that made at New Plymouth in the winter of 1620 by a shipload of Separatists from the Church of England, who have come down through history as the "Pilgrim Fathers."

Driven from England by religious persecution, the Separatist congregation from the little town of Scrooby, about a hundred in number, had fled to Amsterdam, and finally, in 1609, to Leyden. But they were not in sympathy with the Dutch, and their thoughts turned to America. The Plymouth company was approached, but could not guarantee religious freedom. It gave the suppliants to understand, however, that there was little likelihood they would be interfered with, and after long debate and hesitation, they decided to take the risk.

THE WORD OF GOD TO LEYDEN CAME

[August 15 (N. S.), 1620]

The word of God to Leyden came, Dutch town by Zuyder Zee: Rise up, my children of no name, My kings and priests to be. There is an empire in the West, Which I will soon unfold; A thousand harvests in her breast, Rocks ribbed with iron and gold.

Rise up, my children, time is ripe! Old things are passed away. Bishops and kings from earth I wipe; Too long they've had their day. A little ship have I prepared To bear you o'er the seas; And in your souls my will declared Shall grow by slow degrees.

Beneath my throne the martyrs cry; I hear their voice, How long? It mingles with their praises high, And with their victor song. The thing they longed and waited for, But died without the sight; So, this shall be! I wrong abhor, The world I'll now set right.

Leave, then, the hammer and the loom, You've other work to do; For Freedom's commonwealth there's room, And you shall build it too. I'm tired of bishops and their pride, I'm tired of kings as well; Henceforth I take the people's side, And with the people dwell.

Tear off the mitre from the priest, And from the king, his crown; Let all my captives be released; Lift up, whom men cast down. Their pastors let the people choose, And choose their rulers too; Whom they select, I'll not refuse, But bless the work they do.

The Pilgrims rose, at this, God's word, And sailed the wintry seas: With their own flesh nor blood conferred, Nor thought of wealth or ease. They left the towers of Leyden town, They left the Zuyder Zee; And where they cast their anchor down, Rose Freedom's realm to be.

JEREMIAH EAMES RANKIN.

A vessel of one hundred and eighty tons, named the Mayflower, was fitted out, and, on August 5 (N. S. 15), 1620, the emigrants sailed from Southampton, whither they had gone to join the ship. There were ninety persons aboard the Mayflower and thirty aboard a smaller vessel, the Speedwell. But the Speedwell proved unseaworthy, and after twice putting back for repairs, twelve of her passengers were crowded into the Mayflower, which finally, on September 6 (N. S. 16), turned her prow to the west, and began the most famous voyage in American history, after that of Columbus.

SONG OF THE PILGRIMS

[September 16 (N. S.), 1620]

The breeze has swelled the whitening sail, The blue waves curl beneath the gale, And, bounding with the wave and wind, We leave Old England's shores behind--Leave behind our native shore, Homes, and all we loved before.

The deep may dash, the winds may blow, The storm spread out its wings of woe, Till sailors' eyes can see a shroud Hung in the folds of every cloud; Still, as long as life shall last, From that shore we'll speed us fast.

For we would rather never be, Than dwell where mind cannot be free, But bows beneath a despot's rod Even where it seeks to worship God. Blasts of heaven, onward sweep! Bear us o'er the troubled deep!

O see what wonders meet our eyes! Another land, and other skies! Columbian hills have met our view! Adieu! Old England's shores, adieu! Here, at length, our feet shall rest, Hearts be free, and homes be blessed.

As long as yonder firs shall spread Their green arms o'er the mountain's head,-- As long as yonder cliffs shall stand, Where join the ocean and the land,-- Shall those cliffs and mountains be Proud retreats for liberty.

Now to the King of kings we'll raise The pæan loud of sacred praise; More loud than sounds the swelling breeze, More loud than speak the rolling seas! Happier lands have met our view! England's shores, adieu! adieu!

THOMAS COGSWELL UPHAM.

On November 19 (N. S.), nine weeks after leaving Plymouth, land was sighted, and in the evening of that day, the "band of exiles moored their bark" in Cape Cod harbor.

LANDING OF THE PILGRIM FATHERS

[November 19 (N. S.), 1620]

The breaking waves dashed high On the stern and rock-bound coast, And the woods, against a stormy sky, Their giant branches tossed;

And the heavy night hung dark The hills and waters o'er, When a band of exiles moored their bark On the wild New England shore.

Not as the conqueror comes, They, the true-hearted, came: Not with the roll of the stirring drums, And the trumpet that sings of fame;

Not as the flying come, In silence and in fear,-- They shook the depths of the desert's gloom With their hymns of lofty cheer.

Amidst the storm they sang, And the stars heard, and the sea; And the sounding aisles of the dim woods rang To the anthem of the free!

The ocean-eagle soared From his nest by the white wave's foam, And the rocking pines of the forest roared: This was their welcome home!

There were men with hoary hair Amidst that pilgrim band; Why have they come to wither there, Away from their childhood's land?

There was woman's fearless eye, Lit by her deep love's truth; There was manhood's brow, serenely high, And the fiery heart of youth.

What sought they thus afar? Bright jewels of the mine? The wealth of seas, the spoils of war?-- They sought a faith's pure shrine!

Aye, call it holy ground, The soil where first they trod! They have left unstained what there they found-- Freedom to worship God!

FELICIA HEMANS.

Two days later, on Saturday, November 21, the Mayflower dropped her anchor in what is now the harbor of Provincetown, and a force of sixteen, "every one his Musket, Sword and Corslet, under the command of Captaine Myles Standish," went ashore to explore. The next day, being Sunday, praise service was held on board, and on the following Monday occurred the first washing-day.

THE FIRST PROCLAMATION OF MILES STANDISH

[November 23 (N. S.), 1620]

"Ho, Rose!" quoth the stout Miles Standish, As he stood on the Mayflower's deck, And gazed on the sandy coast-line That loomed as a misty speck

On the edge of the distant offing,-- "See! yonder we have in view Bartholomew Gosnold's 'headlands.' 'Twas in sixteen hundred and two

"That the Concord of Dartmouth anchored Just there where the beach is broad, And the merry old captain named it (Half swamped by the fish)--Cape Cod.

"And so as his mighty 'headlands' Are scarcely a league away, What say you to landing, sweetheart, And having a washing-day?

"For did not the mighty Leader Who guided the chosen band Pause under the peaks of Sinai, And issue his strict command--

"(For even the least assoilment Of Egypt the spirit loathes)-- Or ever they entered Canaan, The people should wash their clothes?

"The land we have left is noisome,-- And rank with the smirch of sin; The land that we seek should find us Clean-vestured without and within."

"Dear heart"--and the sweet Rose Standish Looked up with a tear in her eye; She was back in the flag-stoned kitchen Where she watched, in the days gone by,

Her mother among her maidens (She should watch them no more, alas!), And saw as they stretched the linen To bleach on the Suffolk grass.

In a moment her brow was cloudless, As she leaned on the vessel's rail, And thought of the sea-stained garments, Of coif and of farthingale;

And the doublets of fine Welsh flannel, The tuckers and homespun gowns, And the piles of the hosen knitted From the wool of the Devon downs.

So the matrons aboard the Mayflower Made ready with eager hand To drop from the deck their baskets As soon as the prow touched land.

And there did the Pilgrim Mothers, "On a Monday," the record says, Ordain for their new-found England The first of her washing-days.

And there did the Pilgrim Fathers, With matchlock and axe well slung, Keep guard o'er the smoking kettles That propt on the crotches hung.

For the trail of the startled savage Was over the marshy grass, And the glint of his eyes kept peering Through cedar and sassafras.

And the children were mad with pleasure As they gathered the twigs in sheaves, And piled on the fire the fagots, And heaped up the autumn leaves.

"Do the thing that is next," saith the proverb, And a nobler shall yet succeed:-- 'Tis the motive exalts the action; 'Tis the doing, and not the deed;

For the earliest act of the heroes Whose fame has a world-wide sway Was--to fashion a crane for a kettle, And order a washing-day!

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

A shallop which the Pilgrims had brought with them in the Mayflower was put together, and in it a party explored the neighboring shores, in search of a suitable place for the settlement. They finally selected Plymouth Harbor, and on Monday, December 21 (O. S. 11), they "marched into the land and found divers corn-fields and little running brooks,--a place (as they supposed) fit for situation; at least it was the best they could find."

THE MAYFLOWER

Down in the bleak December bay The ghostly vessel stands away; Her spars and halyards white with ice, Under the dark December skies. A hundred souls, in company, Have left the vessel pensively,-- Have reached the frosty desert there, And touched it with the knees of prayer. And now the day begins to dip, The night begins to lower Over the bay, and over the ship Mayflower.

Neither the desert nor the sea Imposes rites: their prayers are free; Danger and toil the wild imposes, And thorns must grow before the roses. And who are these?--and what distress The savage-acred wilderness On mother, maid, and child may bring, Beseems them for a fearful thing; For now the day begins to dip, The night begins to lower Over the bay, and over the ship Mayflower.

But Carver leads (in heart and health A hero of the commonwealth) The axes that the camp requires, To build the lodge and heap the fires, And Standish from his warlike store Arrays his men along the shore, Distributes weapons resonant, And dons his harness militant; For now the day begins to dip, The night begins to lower Over the bay, and over the ship Mayflower;

And Rose, his wife, unlocks a chest-- She sees a Book, in vellum drest, She drops a tear and kisses the tome, Thinking of England and of home: Might they--the Pilgrims, there and then Ordained to do the work of men-- Have seen, in visions of the air, While pillowed on the breast of prayer (When now the day began to dip, The night began to lower Over the bay, and over the ship Mayflower),

The Canaan of their wilderness A boundless empire of success; And seen the years of future nights Jewelled with myriad household lights; And seen the honey fill the hive; And seen a thousand ships arrive; And heard the wheels of travel go; It would have cheered a thought of woe, When now the day began to dip, The night began to

lower Over the bay, and over the ship Mayflower.

ERASTUS WOLCOTT ELLSWORTH.

On March 16 an Indian came into the hamlet, and in broken English bade the strangers "Welcome." He said his name was Samoset, that he came from Monhegan, distant five days' journey toward the southeast, where he had learned something of the language from the crews of fishing-boats, and that he was an envoy from "the greatest commander in the country," a sachem named Massasoit. Massasoit himself appeared a few days later (March 21), and a treaty offensive and defensive was entered into, which remained in force for fifty-four years.

THE PEACE MESSAGE

[March 16, 1621]

At the door of his hut sat Massasoit, And his face was lined with care, For the Yellow Pest had stalked from the West And swept his wigwams bare; Mother and child had it stricken down, And the warrior in his pride, Till for one that lived when the plague was past, A full half-score had died.

Now from the Eastern Shore there came Word of a white-skinned race Who had risen from out the mighty deep In search of a dwelling-place. Houses they fashioned of tree and stone, Turkey and deer they slew With a breath of flame like the lightning-flash Of the great God, Manitu.

Was it war or peace? The Chief looked round On the wreck of his mighty band. His heart was sad as he rose from the ground And held on high his hand. "We must treat with the stranger, my children," he said, And he called to him Samoset: "You will go to the men on the Eastern Shore With wampum and calumet."

Warm was the welcome he received, For the Pilgrims' hearts did thrill At the message he brought from Massasoit, With its earnest of good-will. They bade him eat and they bade him drink, Gave bracelet, knife, and ring, And sent him again to Monhegan To lay them before his king.

So the treaty was made, and the treaty was kept For fifty years and four; The white men wrought, and waked, and slept Secure on the Eastern Shore; From the door of his hut, old Massasoit Noted their swift increase, And blessed the day he had sent that way His messenger of peace.

BURTON EGBERT STEVENSON.

The colonists set about the work of planting their fields as soon as spring opened. The harvest proved a good one; "there was great store of wild turkeys, of which they took many, besides venison," the fowlers having been sent out by the governor, "that so they might, after a special manner, rejoice together after they had gathered the fruit of their labors." This festival was New England's "First Thanksgiving Day." For three days a great feast was spread not only for the colonists, but for Massasoit and some ninety of his people, who had contributed five deer to the larder.

THE FIRST THANKSGIVING DAY

[November, 1621]

"And now," said the Governor, gazing abroad on the piled-up store Of the sheaves that dotted the clearings and covered the meadows o'er, "'Tis meet that we render praises because of this yield of grain; 'Tis meet that the Lord of the harvest be thanked for His sun and rain.

"And therefore, I, William Bradford (by the grace of God to-day, And the franchise of this good people), Governor of Plymouth, say, Through virtue of vested power--ye shall gather with one accord, And hold, in the month November, thanksgiving unto the Lord.

"He hath granted us peace and plenty, and the quiet we've sought so long; He hath thwarted the wily savage, and kept him from wrack and wrong; And unto our feast the Sachem shall be bidden, that he may know We worship his own Great Spirit who maketh the harvests grow.

"So shoulder your matchlocks, masters: there is hunting of all degrees; And fishermen, take your tackle, and scour for spoil the seas; And maidens and dames of Plymouth, your delicate crafts employ To honor our First Thanksgiving, and make it a feast of joy!

"We fail of the fruits and dainties--we fail of the old home cheer; Ah, these are the lightest losses, mayhap, that befall us here; But see, in our open clearings, how golden the melons lie; Enrich them with sweets and spices, and give us the pumpkin-pie!"

So, bravely the preparations went on for the autumn feast; The deer and the bear were slaughtered; wild game from the greatest to least Was heaped in the colony cabins; brown home-brew served for wine, And the plum and the grape of the forest, for orange and peach and pine.

At length came the day appointed: the snow had begun to fall, But the clang from the meeting-house belfry rang merrily over all, And summoned the folk of Plymouth, who hastened with glad accord To listen to Elder Brewster as he fervently thanked the Lord.

In his seat sate Governor Bradford; men, matrons, and maidens fair; Miles Standish and all his soldiers, with corselet and sword, were there; And sobbing and tears and gladness had each in its turn the sway, For the grave of the sweet Rose Standish o'ershadowed Thanksgiving Day.

And when Massasoit, the Sachem, sate down with his hundred braves, And ate of the varied riches of gardens and woods and waves, And looked on the granaried harvest,--with a blow on his brawny chest, He muttered, "The good Great Spirit loves His white children best!"

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

The colonists, through the friendship of Massasoit, had had little trouble with the Indians, but in April, 1622, a messenger from the Narragansetts brought to Plymouth a sheaf of arrows tied round with a rattlesnake skin, which the Indians there interpreted as a declaration of war. Governor Bradford, at the advice of the doughty Standish, stuffed the skin with powder and ball, and sent it back to the Narragansetts. Their chief, Canonicus, was so alarmed at the look of this missive that he refused to receive it, and it finally found its way back to Plymouth.

THE WAR-TOKEN

From "The Courtship of Miles Standish"

[April 1, 1622]

Meanwhile the choleric Captain strode wrathful away to the council, Found it already assembled, impatiently waiting his coming; Men in the middle of life, austere and grave in deportment, Only one of them old, the hill that was nearest to heaven, Covered with snow, but erect, the excellent Elder of Plymouth. God had sifted three kingdoms to find the wheat for this planting, Then had sifted the wheat, as the living seed of a nation; So say the chronicles old, and such is the faith of the people! Near them was standing an Indian, in attitude stern and defiant, Naked down to the waist, and grim and ferocious in aspect; While on the table before them was lying unopened a Bible, Ponderous, bound in leather, brass-studded, printed in Holland, And beside it outstretched the skin of a rattlesnake glittered, Filled, like a quiver, with arrows; a signal and challenge of warfare, Brought by the Indian, and speaking with arrowy tongues of defiance. This Miles Standish beheld, as he entered, and heard them debating What were an answer befitting the hostile message and menace, Talking of this and of that, contriving, suggesting, objecting; One voice only for peace, and that the voice of the Elder, Judging it wise and well that some at least were converted, Rather than any were slain, for this was but Christian behavior! Then out spake Miles Standish, the stalwart Captain of Plymouth, Muttering deep in his throat, for his voice was husky with anger, "What! do you mean to make war with milk and the water of roses? Is it to shoot red squirrels you have your howitzer planted There on the roof of the church, or is it to shoot red devils? Truly the only tongue that is understood by a savage Must be the tongue of fire that speaks from the mouth of the cannon!" Thereupon answered and said the excellent Elder of Plymouth, Somewhat amazed and alarmed at this irreverent language: "Not so thought St. Paul, nor yet the other Apostles; Not from the cannon's mouth were the tongues of fire they spake with!" But unheeded fell this mild rebuke on the Captain, Who had advanced to the table, and thus continued discoursing: "Leave this matter to me, for to me by right it pertaineth. War is a terrible trade; but in the cause that is righteous, Sweet is the smell of powder; and thus I answer the challenge!"

Then from the rattlesnake's skin, with a sudden, contemptuous gesture, Jerking the Indian arrows, he filled it with powder and bullets Full to the very jaws, and handed it back to the savage, Saying, in thundering tones: "Here, take it! this is your answer!" Silently out of the room then glided the glistening savage, Bearing the serpent's skin,

and seeming himself like a serpent, Winding his sinuous way in the dark to the depths of the forest.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

The period of prosperity, which had been marked by the first Thanksgiving, was short-lived. Through nearly the whole of the next two years, the colony was pinched with famine. A crisis was reached in the month of April, 1622, when, so tradition says, the daily ration for each person was reduced to five kernels of corn.

FIVE KERNELS OF CORN

[April, 1622]

I

'Twas the year of the famine in Plymouth of old, The ice and the snow from the thatched roofs had rolled; Through the warm purple skies steered the geese o'er the seas, And the woodpeckers tapped in the clocks of the trees; And the boughs on the slopes to the south winds lay bare, And dreaming of summer, the buds swelled in the air. The pale Pilgrims welcomed each reddening morn; There were left but for rations Five Kernels of Corn. Five Kernels of Corn! Five Kernels of Corn! But to Bradford a feast were Five Kernels of Corn!

II

"Five Kernels of Corn! Five Kernels of Corn! Ye people, be glad for Five Kernels of Corn!" So Bradford cried out on bleak Burial Hill, And the thin women stood in their doors, white and still. "Lo, the harbor of Plymouth rolls bright in the Spring, The maples grow red, and the wood robins sing, The west wind is blowing, and fading the snow, And the pleasant pines sing, and the arbutuses blow. Five Kernels of Corn! Five Kernels of Corn! To each one be given Five Kernels of Corn!"

III

O Bradford of Austerfield haste on thy way. The west winds are blowing o'er Provincetown Bay, The white avens bloom, but the pine domes are chill, And new graves have furrowed Precisioners' Hill! "Give thanks, all ye people, the warm skies have come, The hilltops are sunny, and green grows the holm, And the trumpets of winds, and the white March is gone, And ye still have left you Five Kernels of Corn. Five Kernels of Corn! Five Kernels of Corn! Ye have for Thanksgiving Five Kernels of Corn!"

IV

"The raven's gift eat and be humble and pray, A new light is breaking, and Truth leads your way; One taper a thousand shall kindle: rejoice That to you has been given

the wilderness voice!" O Bradford of Austerfield, daring the wave, And safe through the sounding blasts leading the brave, Of deeds such as thine was the free nation born, And the festal world sings the "Five Kernels of Corn." Five Kernels of Corn! Five Kernels of Corn! The nation gives thanks for Five Kernels of Corn! To the Thanksgiving Feast bring Five Kernels of Corn!

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

In June, 1622, a colony of adventurers from England settled at Wessagusset, now Weymouth, and when their supplies ran short, the following winter, broke open and robbed some of the Indian granaries. The Indians were naturally enraged, and formed a plot for the extirpation of the whites. Warned by Massasoit, the Plymouth settlers determined to strike the first blow, and on March 23, 1623, Standish and eight men were dispatched to Wessagusset. The poem tells the story of the events which followed.

THE EXPEDITION TO WESSAGUSSET

From "The Courtship of Miles Standish"

[March, 1623]

Just in the gray of the dawn, as the mists uprose from the meadows, There was a stir and a sound in the slumbering village of Plymouth; Clanging and clicking of arms, and the order imperative, "Forward!" Given in tone suppressed, a tramp of feet, and then silence. Figures ten, in the mist, marched slowly out of the village. Standish the stalwart it was, with eight of his valorous army, Led by their Indian guide, by Hobomok, friend of the white men, Northward marching to quell the sudden revolt of the savage. Giants they seemed in the mist, or the mighty men of King David; Giants in heart they were, who believed in God and the Bible,-- Ay, who believed in the smiting of Midianites and Philistines. Over them gleamed far off the crimson banners of morning; Under them loud on the sands, the serried billows, advancing, Fired along the line, and in regular order retreated.

* * * * *

Meanwhile the stalwart Miles Standish was marching steadily northward, Winding through forest and swamp, and along the trend of the sea-shore.

* * * * *

After a three days' march he came to an Indian encampment Pitched on the edge of a meadow, between the sea and the forest; Women at work by the tents, and warriors, horrid with war-paint, Seated about a fire, and smoking and talking together; Who, when they saw from afar the sudden approach of the white men, Saw the flash of the sun on breastplate and sabre and musket, Straightway leaped to their feet, and two, from among them advancing, Came to parley with Standish, and offer him furs as a present; Friendship was in their looks, but in their hearts there was hatred. Braves of the tribe were these, and brothers, gigantic in stature, Huge as Goliath of Gath, or the terrible Og, king of Bashan; One was Pecksuot named, and the

other was called Wattawamat. Round their necks were suspended their knives in scabbards of wampum, Two-edged, trenchant knives, with points as sharp as a needle. Other arms had they none, for they were cunning and crafty. "Welcome, English!" they said,--these words they had learned from the traders Touching at times on the coast, to barter and chaffer for peltries. Then in their native tongue they began to parley with Standish, Through his guide and interpreter, Hobomok, friend of the white man, Begging for blankets and knives, but mostly for muskets and powder, Kept by the white man, they said, concealed, with the plague, in his cellars, Ready to be let loose, and destroy his brother the red man! But when Standish refused, and said he would give them the Bible, Suddenly changing their tone, they began to boast and to bluster. Then Wattawamat advanced with a stride in front of the other, And, with a lofty demeanor, thus vauntingly spake to the Captain: "Now Wattawamat can see, by the fiery eyes of the Captain, Angry is he in his heart; but the heart of the brave Wattawamat Is not afraid of the sight. He was not born of a woman, But on a mountain at night, from an oak-tree riven by lightning, Forth he sprang at a bound, with all his weapons about him, Shouting, 'Who is there here to fight with the brave Wattawamat?'" Then he unsheathed his knife, and, whetting the blade on his left hand, Held it aloft and displayed a woman's face on the handle; Saying, with bitter expression and look of sinister meaning: "I have another at home, with the face of a man on the handle; By and by they shall marry; and there will be plenty of children!"

Then stood Pecksuot forth, self-vaunting, insulting Miles Standish: While with his fingers he patted the knife that hung at his bosom, Drawing it half from its sheath, and plunging it back, as he muttered, "By and by it shall see; it shall eat; ah, ha! but shall speak not! This is the mighty Captain the white men have sent to destroy us! He is a little man; let him go and work with the women!"

Meanwhile Standish had noted the faces and figures of Indians Peeping and creeping about from bush to tree in the forest, Feigning to look for game, with arrows set on their bow-strings, Drawing about him still closer and closer the net of their ambush. But undaunted he stood, and dissembled and treated them smoothly; So the old chronicles say, that were writ in the days of the fathers. But when he heard their defiance, the boast, the taunt, and the insult, All the hot blood of his race, of Sir Hugh and of Thurston de Standish, Boiled and beat in his heart, and swelled in the veins of his temples. Headlong he leaped on the boaster, and, snatching his knife from its scabbard, Plunged it into his heart, and, reeling backward, the savage Fell with his face to the sky, and a fiendlike fierceness upon it. Straight there arose from the forest the awful sound of the war-whoop. And, like a flurry of snow on the whistling wind of December, Swift and sudden and keen came a flight of feathery arrows. Then came a cloud of smoke, and out of the cloud came the lightning, Out of the lightning thunder; and death unseen ran before it. Frightened the savages fled for shelter in swamp and in thicket, Hotly pursued and beset; but their sachem, the brave Wattawamat, Fled not; he was dead. Unswerving and swift had a bullet Passed through his brain, and he fell with both hands clutching the greensward, Seeming in death to hold back from his foe the land of his fathers.

There on the flowers of the meadow the warriors lay, and above them, Silent, with folded arms, stood Hobomok, friend of the white man. Smiling at length he exclaimed to the stalwart Captain of Plymouth:-- "Pecksuot bragged very loud, of his courage, his strength, and his stature,-- Mocked the great Captain, and called him a little man; but I see now Big enough have you been to lay him speechless before you!"

Thus the first battle was fought and won by the stalwart Miles Standish. When the tidings thereof were brought to the village of Plymouth, And as a trophy of war the head of the brave Wattawamat Scowled from the roof of the fort, which at once was a church and a fortress, All who beheld it rejoiced, and praised the Lord, and took courage.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

By the end of 1624 Plymouth was in a thriving condition. Its inhabitants numbered nearly two hundred, and it boasted thirty-two dwelling-houses. Other colonies soon sprang up about the Bay--Piscataqua (Portsmouth), Naumkeag (Salem), Nantasket (Hull), and Winnisimmet (Chelsea). The trials and pleasures of life in New England at about this time are humorously described in what are perhaps the first verses written by an American colonist.

NEW ENGLAND'S ANNOYANCES

[1630]

New England's annoyances, you that would know them, Pray ponder these verses which briefly doth shew them.

The Place where we live is a wilderness Wood, Where Grass is much wanting that's fruitful and good: Our Mountains and Hills and our Vallies below Being commonly cover'd with Ice and with Snow; And when the North-west Wind with violence blows, Then every Man pulls his Cap over his Nose: But if any's so hardy and will it withstand, He forfeits a Finger, a Foot, or a Hand.

But when the Spring opens, we then take the Hoe, And make the Ground ready to plant and to sow; Our Corn being planted and Seed being sown, The Worms destroy much before it is grown; And when it is growing, some spoil there is made By Birds and by Squirrels that pluck up the Blade; And when it is come to full Corn in the Ear, It is often destroy'd by Raccoon and by Deer.

And now do our Garments begin to grow thin, And Wool is much wanted to card and to spin; If we can get a Garment to cover without, Our other In-Garments are Clout upon Clout: Our Clothes we brought with us are apt to be torn, They need to be clouted soon after they're worn; But clouting our Garments they hinder us nothing: Clouts double are warmer than single whole Clothing.

If fresh Meat be wanting, to fill up our Dish, We have Carrots and Turnips as much as we wish; And is there a mind for a delicate Dish, We repair to the Clam-banks, and there we catch Fish. For Pottage and Puddings, and Custards and Pies, Our Pumpkins and Parsnips are common supplies; We have Pumpkins at morning, and Pumpkins at

noon; If it was not for Pumpkins we should be undone.

If Barley be wanting to make into Malt, We must be contented, and think it no fault; For we can make Liquor to sweeten our Lips Of Pumpkins and Parsnips and Walnut-Tree Chips.

* * * * *

Now while some are going let others be coming, For while Liquor's boiling it must have a scumming; But I will not blame them, for Birds of a Feather, By seeking their Fellows, are flocking together. But you whom the Lord intends hither to bring, Forsake not the Honey for fear of the Sting; But bring both a quiet and contented Mind, And all needful Blessings you surely will find.

The Old Colony's palmy days were of short duration, for it was soon overshadowed by a more wealthy and vigorous neighbor, founded by the powerful Puritan party.

THE PILGRIM FATHERS

I

Well worthy to be magnified are they Who, with sad hearts, of friends and country took A last farewell, their loved abodes forsook, And hallowed ground in which their fathers lay; Then to the new-found World explored their way, That so a Church, unforced, uncalled to brook Ritual restraints, within some sheltering nook Her Lord might worship and his word obey In freedom. Men they were who could not bend; Blest Pilgrims, surely, as they took for guide A will by sovereign Conscience sanctified; Blest while their Spirits from the woods ascend Along a Galaxy that knows no end, But in His glory who for Sinners died.

II

From Rite and Ordinance abused they fled To Wilds where both were utterly unknown; But not to them had Providence foreshown What benefits are missed, what evils bred, In worship neither raised nor limited Save by Self-will. Lo! from that distant shore, For Rite and Ordinance, Piety is led Back to the Land those Pilgrims left of yore, Led by her own free choice. So Truth and Love By Conscience governed do their steps retrace.-- Fathers! your Virtues, such the power of grace, Their spirit, in your Children, thus approve. Transcendent over time, unbound by place, Concord and Charity in circles move.

WILLIAM WORDSWORTH.

When Charles I came to the throne, in 1625, with the expressed determination to harry the Puritans out of England, the latter decided to seek an asylum in the New World. In 1628 John Endicott and a few others secured a patent from the New England Council for a trading-company, the grant including a strip of land across the continent from a line three miles north of the Merrimac to another three miles south of the Charles. It was into this colony, known as Massachusetts, that the older colony

of Plymouth was finally absorbed.

THE PILGRIM FATHERS

The Pilgrim Fathers,--where are they? The waves that brought them o'er Still roll in the bay, and throw their spray As they break along the shore; Still roll in the bay, as they rolled that day When the Mayflower moored below; When the sea around was black with storms, And white the shore with snow.

The mists that wrapped the Pilgrim's sleep Still brood upon the tide; And his rocks yet keep their watch by the deep To stay its waves of pride. But the snow-white sail that he gave to the gale, When the heavens looked dark, is gone,-- As an angel's wing through an opening cloud Is seen, and then withdrawn.

The pilgrim exile,--sainted name! The hill whose icy brow Rejoiced, when he came, in the morning's flame, In the morning's flame burns now. And the moon's cold light, as it lay that night On the hillside and the sea, Still lies where he laid his houseless head,-- But the Pilgrim! where is he?

The Pilgrim Fathers are at rest: When summer's throned on high, And the world's warm breast is in verdure drest, Go, stand on the hill where they lie. The earliest ray of the golden day On that hallowed spot is cast; And the evening sun, as he leaves the world, Looks kindly on that spot last.

The Pilgrim spirit has not fled: It walks in noon's broad light; And it watches the bed of the glorious dead, With the holy stars by night. It watches the bed of the brave who have bled, And still guard this ice-bound shore, Till the waves of the bay, where the Mayflower lay, Shall foam and freeze no more.

JOHN PIERPONT.

King Charles, little suspecting that he was providing an asylum for the Puritans, confirmed the patent by a royal charter to "The Governor and Company of the Massachusetts Bay in New England." No place for the meetings of the company had been named in the charter, and the audacious plan was formed to remove it, patents, charter, and all, to New England. Secret meetings were held, the old officers were finally got rid of, and John Winthrop was elected governor. Winthrop sailed for America on April 7, 1630, and arrived at Salem June 12. It was the beginning of a great emigration, for, in the four months that followed, seventeen ships arrived, with nearly a thousand passengers.

THE THANKSGIVING IN BOSTON HARBOR

[June 12, 1630]

"Praise ye the Lord!" The psalm to-day Still rises on our ears, Borne from the hills of Boston Bay Through five times fifty years, When Winthrop's fleet from Yarmouth crept Out to the open main, And through the widening waters swept, In April sun and rain. "Pray to the Lord with fervent lips," The leader shouted, "pray;" And prayer arose from all the ships As faded Yarmouth Bay.

They passed the Scilly Isles that day, And May-days came, and June, And thrice upon the ocean lay The full orb of the moon. And as that day, on Yarmouth Bay, Ere England sunk from view, While yet the rippling Solent lay In April skies of blue, "Pray to the Lord with fervent lips," Each morn was shouted, "pray;" And prayer arose from all the ships, As first in Yarmouth Bay;

Blew warm the breeze o'er Western seas, Through Maytime morns, and June, Till hailed these souls the Isles of Shoals, Low 'neath the summer moon; And as Cape Ann arose to view, And Norman's Woe they passed, The wood-doves came the white mists through, And circled round each mast. "Pray to the Lord with fervent lips," Then called the leader, "pray;" And prayer arose from all the ships, As first in Yarmouth Bay.

Above the sea the hill-tops fair-- God's towers--began to rise, And odors rare breathe through the air, Like balms of Paradise. Through burning skies the ospreys flew, And near the pine-cooled shores Danced airy boat and thin canoe, To flash of sunlit oars. "Pray to the Lord with fervent lips," The leader shouted, "pray!" Then prayer arose, and all the ships Sailed into Boston Bay.

The white wings folded, anchors down, The sea-worn fleet in line, Fair rose the hills where Boston town Should rise from clouds of pine; Fair was the harbor, summit-walled, And placid lay the sea. "Praise ye the Lord," the leader called; "Praise ye the Lord," spake he. "Give thanks to God with fervent lips, Give thanks to God to-day," The anthem rose from all the ships, Safe moored in Boston Bay.

"Praise ye the Lord!" Primeval woods First heard the ancient song, And summer hills and solitudes The echoes rolled along. The Red Cross flag of England blew Above the fleet that day, While Shawmut's triple peaks in view In amber hazes lay. "Praise ye the Lord with fervent lips, Praise ye the Lord to-day," The anthem rose from all the ships Safe moored in Boston Bay.

The Arabella leads the song-- The Mayflower sings below, That erst the Pilgrims bore along The Plymouth reefs of snow. Oh! never be that psalm forgot That rose o'er Boston Bay, When Winthrop sang, and Endicott, And Saltonstall, that day: "Praise ye the Lord with fervent lips, Praise ye the Lord to-day;" And praise arose from all the ships, Like prayers in Yarmouth Bay.

That psalm our fathers sang we sing, That psalm of peace and wars, While o'er our heads unfolds its wing The flag of forty stars. And while the nation finds a tongue For nobler gifts to pray, 'Twill ever sing the song they sung That first Thanksgiving Day: "Praise ye the Lord with fervent lips, Praise ye the Lord to-day;" So rose the song from all the ships, Safe moored in Boston Bay.

Our fathers' prayers have changed to psalms, As David's treasures old Turned, on the Temple's giant arms, To lily-work of gold. Ho! vanished ships from Yarmouth's tide, Ho! ships of Boston Bay, Your prayers have crossed the centuries wide To this Thanksgiving Day! We pray to God with fervent lips, We praise the Lord to-day, As prayers arose from Yarmouth ships, But psalms from Boston Bay.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

But the condition of the colonists was for the most part pitiful, and food was so scarce that shell-fish served for meat and acorns for bread. Winthrop had foreseen this and had engaged Captain William Pierce, of the ship Lion, to go in all haste to the nearest port in Ireland for provisions. Food-stuffs were nearly as scarce there as in America, and Pierce was forced to go on to London, where he was again delayed. A fast was appointed throughout the settlements for February 22, 1631, to implore divine succor. On the 21st, as Winthrop "was distributing the last handful of meal in the barrel unto a poor man distressed by the wolf at the door, at that instant they spied a ship arrived at the harbour's mouth, laden with provisions for them all." The ship was the Lion, and the fast day was changed into a day of feasting and thanksgiving.

THE FIRST THANKSGIVING

[February 22, 1631]

It was Captain Pierce of the Lion who strode the streets of London, Who stalked the streets in the blear of morn and growled in his grisly beard; _By Neptune!_ quoth this grim sea-dog, _I fear that my master's undone! 'Tis a bitter thing if all for naught through the drench of the deep I've steered_!

He had come from out of the ultimate West through the spinning drift and the smother, Come for a guerdon of golden grain for a hungry land afar; And he thought of many a wasting maid, and of many a sad-eyed mother, And how their gaze would turn and turn for a sail at the harbor bar.

But famine lay on the English isle, and grain was a hoarded treasure, So ruddy the coin must gleam to loose the lock of the store-house door; And under his breath the Captain groaned because of his meagre measure, And the grasping souls of those that held the keys to the precious store.

But he flung a laugh and a fleer at doubt, and braving the roaring city He faced them out--those moiling men whose greed had grown to a curse-- Till at last he found in the strenuous press a heart that was moved to pity, And he gave the Governor's bond and word for what he lacked in his purse.

So the Lion put her prow to the West in the wild and windy weather, Her sails all set, though her decks were wet with the driving scud and the foam; Never an hour would the Captain hold his staunch little craft in tether, For the haunting thought of hungry eyes was the lure that called him home.

Sooth, in the streets of Boston-town was the heavy sound of sorrow, For an iron frost had bound the wold, and the sky hung bleak and dread; Despair sat dark on the face of him who dared to think of the morrow, When not a crust could the goodwife give if the children moaned for bread.

But hark, from the wintry waterside a loud and lusty cheering, That sweeps the sullen streets of the town as a wave the level strand! _A sail! a sail!_ upswelled the cry, speeding the vessel steering Out of the vast of the misty sea in to the waiting land.

Turn the dimming page of the past that the dust of the years is dry on. And see the tears in the eyes of Joy as the ship draws in to the shore, And see the genial glow on the face of Captain Pierce of the Lion, As the Governor grips his faithful hand and blesses him o'er and o'er!

Oh, the rapture of that release! Feasting instead of fasting! Happiness in the heart of the home, and hope with its silver ray! Oh, the songs of prayer and praise to the Lord God everlasting That mounted morn and noon and eve on that first Thanksgiving Day!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

In the four years that followed, the worst hardships of the new plantation were outlived, and between three and four thousand Englishmen were distributed among the twenty hamlets along and near the sea-shore. The fight for a foothold had been won.

NEW ENGLAND'S GROWTH

From a fragmentary poem on "New England"

Famine once we had, But other things God gave us in full store, As fish and ground-nuts to supply our strait, That we might learn on Providence to wait; And know, by bread man lives not in his need. But by each word that doth from God proceed. But a while after plenty did come in, From His hand only who doth pardon sin, And all did flourish like the pleasant green, Which in the joyful spring is to be seen.

Almost ten years we lived here alone, In other places there were few or none; For Salem was the next of any fame, That began to augment New England's name; But after multitudes began to flow, More than well knew themselves where to bestow; Boston then began her roots to spread, And quickly soon she grew to be the head, Not only of the Massachusetts Bay, But all trade and commerce fell in her way. And truly it was admirable to know, How greatly all things here began to grow. New plantations were in each place begun, And with inhabitants were filled soon. All sorts of grain which our own land doth yield, Was hither brought and sown in every field: As wheat and rye, barley, oats, beans and pease, Here all thrive, and they profit from them raise. All sorts of roots and herbs in gardens grow, Parsnips, carrots, turnips, or what you'll sow. Onions, melons, cucumbers, radishes, Skirets, beets, coleworts, and fair cabbages. Here grow fine flowers many, and 'mongst those, The fair white lily and sweet fragrant rose. Many good wholesome berries here you'll find, Fit for man's use, almost of every kind, Pears, apples, cherries, plumbs, quinces, and peach, Are _now_ no dainties; you may have of each. Nuts and grapes of several sorts are here, If you will take the pains them to seek for.

WILLIAM BRADFORD.

There remained but one danger, the Indians; and most feared of all were the Pequots, who dwelt just west of what is now Rhode Island, and in 1637 began open hostilities. A force of about a hundred men marched against the principal Pequot

stronghold, a palisaded village which stood on a hilltop near the Mystic. The attack was made on the night of May 25, 1637, the Indians were taken by surprise, their thatched houses were set on fire, and of the six or seven hundred persons in the village, scarcely one escaped.

THE ASSAULT ON THE FORTRESS

From "The Destruction of the Pequods"

[May 25, 1637]

Through verdant banks where Thames's branches glide, Long held the Pequods an extensive sway; Bold, savage, fierce, of arms the glorious pride, And bidding all the circling realms obey. Jealous, they saw the tribes, beyond the sea, Plant in their climes; and towns, and cities, rise; Ascending castles foreign flags display; Mysterious art new scenes of life devise; And steeds insult the plains, and cannon rend the skies.

The rising clouds the savage chief descried, And, round the forest, bade his heroes arm; To arms the painted warriors proudly hied, And through surrounding nations rung the alarm. The nations heard; but smiled, to see the storm, With ruin fraught, o'er Pequod mountains driven And felt infernal joy the bosom warm, To see their light hang o'er the skirts of even, And other suns arise, to gild a kinder heaven.

Swift to the Pequod fortress Mason sped, Far in the wildering wood's impervious gloom; A lonely castle, brown with twilight dread; Where oft the embowelled captive met his doom, And frequent heaved, around the hollow tomb, Scalps hung in rows, and whitening bones were strew'd; Where, round the broiling babe, fresh from the womb, With howls the Powow fill'd the dark abode, And screams and midnight prayers invoked the evil god.

But now no awful rites, nor potent spell, To silence charm'd the peals of coming war; Or told the dread recesses of the dell, Where glowing Mason led his bands from far; No spirit, buoyant on his airy car, Controll'd the whirlwind of invading fight: Deep died in blood, dun evening's falling star Sent sad o'er western hills its parting light, And no returning morn dispersed the long, dark night.

On the drear walls a sudden splendor glow'd, There Mason shone, and there his veterans pour'd. Anew the hero claim'd the fiends of blood, While answering storms of arrows round him shower'd, And the war-scream the ear with anguish gored. Alone, he burst the gate; the forest round Reëchoed death; the peal of onset roar'd, In rush'd the squadrons; earth in blood was drown'd; And gloomy spirits fled, and corses hid the ground.

Not long in dubious fight the host had striven, When, kindled by the musket's potent flame, In clouds, and fire, the castle rose to heaven, And gloom'd the world, with melancholy beam. Then hoarser groans, with deeper anguish, came; And fiercer fight the keen assault repell'd: Nor e'en these ills the savage breast could tame; Like hell's deep caves, the hideous region yell'd, Till death, and sweeping fire, laid waste the hostile field.

TIMOTHY DWIGHT.

Sassacus, the Pequot chief, escaped and sought refuge with the Mohawks, but was slain by them.

DEATH SONG

[1673]

Great Sassacus fled from the eastern shores, Where the sun first shines, and the great sea roars, For the white men came from the world afar, And their fury burnt like the bison star.

His sannops were slain by their thunder's power, And his children fell like the star-eyed flower; His wigwams were burnt by the white man's flame, And the home of his youth has a stranger name--

His ancestor once was our countryman's foe, And the arrow was plac'd in the new-strung bow, The wild deer ranged through the forest free, While we fought with his tribe by the distant sea.

But the foe never came to the Mohawk's tent, With his hair untied, and his bow unbent, And found not the blood of the wild deer shed, And the calumet lit and the bear-skin bed.

But sing ye the Death Song, and kindle the pine, And bid its broad light like his valor to shine; Then raise high his pile by our warriors' heaps, And tell to his tribe that his murderer sleeps.

ALONZO LEWIS.

OUR COUNTRY

On primal rocks she wrote her name; Her towers were reared on holy graves; The golden seed that bore her came Swift-winged with prayer o'er ocean waves.

The Forest bowed his solemn crest, And open flung his sylvan doors; Meek Rivers led the appointed guest To clasp the wide-embracing shores;

Till, fold by fold, the broidered land To swell her virgin vestments grew, While sages, strong in heart and hand, Her virtue's fiery girdle drew.

O Exile of the wrath of kings! O Pilgrim Ark of Liberty! The refuge of divinest things, Their record must abide in thee!

First in the glories of thy front Let the crown-jewel, Truth, be found; Thy right hand fling, with generous wont, Love's happy chain to farthest bound!

Let Justice, with the faultless scales, Hold fast the worship of thy sons; Thy Commerce spread her shining sails Where no dark tide of rapine runs!

So link thy ways to those of God, So follow firm the heavenly laws, That stars may greet thee, warrior-browed, And storm-sped angels hail thy cause!

O Lord, the measure of our prayers, Hope of the world in grief and wrong, Be thine the tribute of the years, The gift of Faith, the crown of Song!

JULIA WARD HOWE.

CHAPTER VI

RELIGIOUS PERSECUTIONS IN NEW ENGLAND

The Puritans, who had come to New England to escape a religious despotism, lost no time in establishing one of their own. At the first meeting of the General Council, in the autumn of 1630, it was agreed that no one should be admitted to membership in the company who was not a member of some church approved by it, and a religious oligarchy was thus established which kept itself in power for over thirty years.

PROLOGUE

From "John Endicott"

To-night we strive to read, as we may best, This city, like an ancient palimpsest; And bring to light, upon the blotted page, The mournful record of an earlier age, That, pale and half effaced, lies hidden away Beneath the fresher writing of to-day.

Rise, then, O buried city that hast been; Rise up, rebuilded in the painted scene, And let our curious eyes behold once more The pointed gable and the pent-house door, The meeting-house with leaden-latticed panes, The narrow thoroughfares, the crooked lanes!

Rise, too, ye shapes and shadows of the Past, Rise from your long-forgotten graves at last; Let us behold your faces, let us hear The words ye uttered in those days of fear! Revisit your familiar haunts again,-- The scenes of triumph, and the scenes of pain, And leave the footprints of your bleeding feet Once more upon the pavement of the street!

Nor let the Historian blame the Poet here, If he perchance misdate the day or year, And group events together, by his art, That in the Chronicles lie far apart; For as the double stars, though sundered far, Seem to the naked eye a single star, So facts of history, at a distance seen, Into one common point of light convene.

"Why touch upon such themes?" perhaps some friend May ask, incredulous; "and to what good end? Why drag again into the light of day The errors of an age long passed away?" I answer: "For the lesson that they teach: The tolerance of opinion and of speech. Hope, Faith, and Charity remain,--these three; And greatest of them all is Charity."

Let us remember, if these words be true, That unto all men Charity is due; Give what we ask; and pity, while we blame, Lest we become copartners in the shame, Lest we condemn, and yet ourselves partake, And persecute the dead for conscience' sake.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

One of the earliest to feel the displeasure of the ruling powers of the Colony was Roger Williams, who came to Boston in 1631. He made himself obnoxious to the government by denying the right of the magistrates to punish Sabbath breaking; and continued to occasion so much excitement that it was decided to send him back to England. Williams got wind of this, and took to the woods in January, 1636.

ROGER WILLIAMS

[January, 1636]

Why do I sleep amid the snows, Why do the pine boughs cover me, While dark the wind of winter blows Across the Narragansett's sea?

O sense of right! O sense of right, Whate'er my lot in life may be, Thou art to me God's inner light, And these tired feet must follow thee.

Yes, still my feet must onward go, With nothing for my hope but prayer, Amid the winds, amid the snow, And trust the ravens of the air.

But though alone, and grieved at heart, Bereft of human brotherhood, I trust the whole and not the part, And know that Providence is good.

Self-sacrifice is never lost, But bears the seed of its reward; They who for others leave the most, For others gain the most from God.

O sense of right! I must obey, And hope and trust, whate'er betide; I cannot always know my way, But I can always know my Guide.

And so for me the winter blows Across the Narragansett's sea. And so I sleep beneath the snows, And so the pine boughs cover me.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

Williams had a hard time of it. Thirty years later, he related how he was "sorely tossed for fourteen weeks in a bitter winter season, not knowing what bread or bed did mean."

GOD MAKES A PATH

God makes a path, provides a guide, And feeds in wilderness! His glorious name while breath remains, O that I may confess.

Lost many a time, I have had no guide, No house, but hollow tree! In stormy winter night no fire, No food, no company:

In him I found a house, a bed, A table, company: No cup so bitter, but's made sweet, When God shall sweetning be.

ROGER WILLIAMS.

Williams went to Narragansett Bay, where he bargained with Canonicus for the land he wanted, and laid the foundations of the present city of Providence.

CANONICUS AND ROGER WILLIAMS

[1636]

Content within his wigwam warm, Canonicus sate by the fire; Without, the voices of the storm Shrieked ever high and higher.

Eager and wild, the spiteful wind Tore at the thatch with fingers strong; The Sachem fed the fire within And hummed a hunting-song.

Sudden upon the crusted snow He caught a sound not of the storm-- A sound of footsteps dragging slow Towards his shelter warm.

He drew aside the flap of skin; A stranger at the threshold stood; Canonicus bade him enter in, And gave him drink and food.

His hand he gave in friendship true, Land for a home gave he; And he learned of the love of Christ Jesu, Who died upon the tree.

To the stranger guest sweet life he gave; For a State he saved its Sire; Yea, and his own soul did he save From burning in hell-fire.

Scarcely were the Massachusetts magistrates rid of Williams, when they found themselves engaged in a much more threatening controversy with Mrs. Anne Hutchinson and her adherents, who believed in various "dangerous errors," and carried their contempt for the constituted ministry to the point of rising and marching out of the Boston church when its respected pastor, John Wilson, arose to speak. The other ministers of the colony rallied to Wilson's support, the General Court summoned Mrs. Hutchinson before it in November, 1637, and pronounced sentence of banishment, which was put into effect March 28, 1638.

ANNE HUTCHINSON'S EXILE

[March 28, 1638]

"Home, home--where's my baby's home? Here we seek, there we seek, my baby's home to find. Come, come, come, my baby, come! We found her home, we lost her home, and home is far behind. Come, my baby, come! Find my baby's home!"

The baby clings; the mother sings; the pony stumbles on; The father leads the beast along the tangled, muddy way; The boys and girls trail on behind; the sun will soon be gone, And starlight bright will take again the place of sunny day. "Home, home--where's my baby's home? Here we seek, there we seek, my baby's home to find. Come, come, come, my baby, come! We found her home, we lost her home, and home is far behind. Come, my baby, come! Find my baby's home!"

The sun goes down behind the lake; the night fogs gather chill, The children's clothes are torn; and the children's feet are sore. "Keep on, my boys, keep on, my

girls, till all have passed the hill; Then ho, my girls, and ho, my boys, for fire and sleep once more!" And all the time she sings to the baby on her breast, "Home, my darling, sleep, my darling, find a place for rest; Who gives the fox his burrow will give my bird a nest. Come, my baby, come! Find my baby's home!"

He lifts the mother from the beast; the hemlock boughs they spread, And make the baby's cradle sweet with fern-leaves and with bays. The baby and her mother are resting on their bed; He strikes the flint, he blows the spark, and sets the twigs ablaze. "Sleep, my child; sleep, my child! Baby, find her rest, Here beneath the gracious skies, upon her father's breast; Who gives the fox his burrow will give my bird her nest. Come, come, with her mother, come! Home, home, find my baby's home!"

The guardian stars above the trees their loving vigil keep; The cricket sings her lullaby, the whippoorwill his cheer. The father knows his Father's arms are round them as they sleep; The mother knows that in His arms her darling need not fear. "Home, home, my baby's home is here; With God we seek, with God we find the place for baby's rest. Hist, my child, list, my child; angels guard us here. The God of heaven is here to make and keep my birdie's nest. Home, home, here's my baby's home!"

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

Among the converts made by Mrs. Hutchinson during her stay in Boston was John Underhill, commander of the colony's troops. He became involved in the controversy that followed, and as a result was disarmed, disfranchised, and finally banished. In September, 1638, he betook himself to Cocheco (Dover), on the Piscataqua, where some of Mrs. Hutchinson's adherents had started a settlement, and where he afterwards held various offices.

JOHN UNDERHILL

[September, 1638]

A score of years had come and gone Since the Pilgrims landed on Plymouth stone, When Captain Underhill, bearing scars From Indian ambush and Flemish wars, Left three-hilled Boston and wandered down, East by north, to Cocheco town.

With Vane the younger, in council sweet, He had sat at Anna Hutchinson's feet, And, when the bolt of banishment fell On the head of his saintly oracle, He had shared her ill as her good report, And braved the wrath of the General Court.

He shook from his feet as he rode away The dust of the Massachusetts Bay. The world might bless and the world might ban, What did it matter the perfect man, To whom the freedom of earth was given, Proof against sin, and sure of heaven?

He cheered his heart as he rode along With screed of Scripture and holy song, Or thought how he rode with his lances free By the Lower Rhine and the Zuyder-Zee, Till his wood-path grew to a trodden road, And Hilton Point in the distance showed.

He saw the church with the block-house nigh, The two fair rivers, the flakes thereby, And, tacking to windward, low and crank, The little shallop from Strawberry

Bank; And he rose in his stirrups and looked abroad Over land and water, and praised the Lord.

Goodly and stately and grave to see, Into the clearing's space rode he, With the sun on the hilt of his sword in sheath, And his silver buckles and spurs beneath, And the settlers welcomed him, one and all, From swift Quampeagan to Gonic Fall.

And he said to the elders: "Lo, I come As the way seemed open to seek a home. Somewhat the Lord hath wrought by my hands In the Narragansett and Netherlands, And if here ye have work for a Christian man, I will tarry, and serve ye as best I can.

"I boast not of gifts, but fain would own The wonderful favor God hath shown, The special mercy vouchsafed one day On the shore of Narragansett Bay, As I sat, with my pipe, from the camp aside, And mused like Isaac at eventide.

"A sudden sweetness of peace I found, A garment of gladness wrapped me round; I felt from the law of works released, The strife of the flesh and spirit ceased, My faith to a full assurance grew, And all I had hoped for myself I knew.

"Now, as God appointeth, I keep my way, I shall not stumble, I shall not stray; He hath taken away my fig-leaf dress, I wear the robe of His righteousness; And the shafts of Satan no more avail Than Pequot arrows on Christian mail."

"Tarry with us," the settlers cried, "Thou man of God, as our ruler and guide." And Captain Underhill bowed his head, "The will of the Lord be done!" he said. And the morrow beheld him sitting down In the ruler's seat in Cocheco town.

And he judged therein as a just man should; His words were wise and his rule was good; He coveted not his neighbor's land, From the holding of bribes he shook his hand; And through the camps of the heathen ran A wholesome fear of the valiant man.

But the heart is deceitful, the good Book saith, And life hath ever a savor of death. Through hymns of triumph the tempter calls, And whoso thinketh he standeth falls. Alas! ere their round the seasons ran, There was grief in the soul of the saintly man.

The tempter's arrows that rarely fail Had found the joints of his spiritual mail; And men took note of his gloomy air, The shame in his eye, the halt in his prayer, The signs of a battle lost within, The pain of a soul in the coils of sin.

Then a whisper of scandal linked his name With broken vows and a life of blame; And the people looked askance on him As he walked among them sullen and grim, Ill at ease, and bitter of word, And prompt of quarrel with hand or sword.

None knew how, with prayer and fasting still, He strove in the bonds of his evil will; But he shook himself like Samson at length, And girded anew his loins of strength, And bade the crier go up and down And call together the wondering town.

Jeer and murmur and shaking of head Ceased as he rose in his place and said: "Men, brethren, and fathers, well ye know How I came among you a year ago, Strong in the faith that my soul was freed From sin of feeling, or thought, or deed.

"I have sinned, I own it with grief and shame, But not with a lie on my lips I came. In my blindness I verily thought my heart Swept and garnished in every part. He chargeth His angels with folly; He sees The heavens unclean. Was I more than these?

"I urge no plea. At your feet I lay The trust you gave me, and go my way. Hate me or pity me, as you will, The Lord will have mercy on sinners still; And I, who am chiefest, say to all, Watch and pray, lest ye also fall."

No voice made answer: a sob so low That only his quickened ear could know Smote his heart with a bitter pain, As into the forest he rode again, And the veil of its oaken leaves shut down On his latest glimpse of Cocheco town.

Crystal-clear on the man of sin The streams flashed up, and the sky shone in; On his cheek of fever the cool wind blew, The leaves dropped on him their tears of dew, And angels of God, in the pure, sweet guise Of flowers, looked on him with sad surprise.

Was his ear at fault that brook and breeze Sang in their saddest of minor keys? What was it the mournful wood-thrush said? What whispered the pine-trees overhead? Did he hear the Voice on his lonely way That Adam heard in the cool of day?

Into the desert alone rode he, Alone with the Infinite Purity; And, bowing his soul to its tender rebuke, As Peter did to the Master's look, He measured his path with prayers of pain For peace with God and nature again.

And in after years to Cocheco came The bruit of a once familiar name; How among the Dutch of New Netherlands, From wild Danskamer to Haarlem sands, A penitent soldier preached the Word, And smote the heathen with Gideon's sword!

And the heart of Boston was glad to hear How he harried the foe on the long frontier. And heaped on the land against him barred The coals of his generous watch and ward. Frailest and bravest! the Bay State still Counts with her worthies John Underhill.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

In 1656 a new danger threatened, for in July the first Quakers landed in New England. The preachers of this sect were generally believed to be either Franciscan monks in disguise, or publishers of irreligious fancies, and in an evil hour the authorities resolved to keep them out of Massachusetts. When the General Court met in October, it passed the law of which Mr. Longfellow gives an accurate résumé. This law was "forthwith published, in several places of Boston, by beat of drum," October 21, 1656.

THE PROCLAMATION

From "John Endicott"

[October 21, 1656]

COLE

Here comes the Marshal.

MERRY (_within_)

Make room for the Marshal.

KEMPTHORN

How pompous and imposing he appears! His great buff doublet bellying like a mainsail, And all his streamers fluttering in the wind. What holds he in his hand?

COLE

A proclamation.

Enter the MARSHAL, _with a proclamation; and_ MERRY, _with a halberd. They are preceded by a drummer, and followed by the hangman, with an armful of books, and a crowd of people, among whom are_ UPSALL _and_ JOHN ENDICOTT. _A pile is made of the books._

MERRY

Silence, the drum! Good citizens, attend To the new laws enacted by the Court.

MARSHAL (_reads_)

"Whereas a cursed sect of Heretics Has lately risen, commonly called Quakers, Who take upon themselves to be commissioned Immediately of God, and furthermore Infallibly assisted by the Spirit To write and utter blasphemous opinions, Despising Government and the order of God In Church and Commonwealth, and speaking evil Of Dignities, reproaching and reviling The Magistrates and Ministers, and seeking To turn the people from their faith, and thus Gain proselytes to their pernicious ways;-- This Court, considering the premises, And to prevent like mischief as is wrought By their means in our land, doth hereby order, That whatsoever master or commander Of any ship, bark, pink, or catch shall bring To any roadstead, harbor, creek, or cove Within this Jurisdiction any Quakers, Or other blasphemous Heretics, shall pay Unto the Treasurer of the Commonwealth One hundred pounds, and for default thereof Be put in prison, and continue there Till the said sum be satisfied and paid."

COLE

Now, Simon Kempthorn, what say you to that?

KEMPTHORN

I pray you, Cole, lend me a hundred pounds!

MARSHAL (_reads_)

"If any one within this Jurisdiction Shall henceforth entertain, or shall conceal Quakers, or other blasphemous Heretics, Knowing them so to be, every such person Shall forfeit to the country forty shillings For each hour's entertainment or concealment, And shall be sent to prison, as aforesaid, Until the forfeiture be wholly paid."

Murmurs in the crowd.

KEMPTHORN

Now, Goodman Cole, I think your turn has come!

COLE

Knowing them so to be!

KEMPTHORN

At forty shillings The hour, your fine will be some forty pounds!

COLE

Knowing them so to be! That is the law.

MARSHAL (_reads_)

"And it is further ordered and enacted, If any Quaker or Quakers shall presume To come henceforth into this Jurisdiction, Every male Quaker for the first offence Shall have one ear cut off; and shall be kept At labor in the Workhouse, till such time As he be sent away at his own charge. And for the repetition of the offence Shall have his other ear cut off, and then Be branded in the palm of his right hand. And every woman Quaker shall be whipt Severely in three towns; and every Quaker, Or he or she, that shall for a third time Herein again offend, shall have their tongues Bored through with a hot iron, and shall be Sentenced to Banishment on pain of Death."

Loud murmurs. The voice of CHRISTISON _in the crowd_

O patience of the Lord! How long, how long, Ere thou avenge the blood of Thine Elect?

MERRY

Silence, there, silence! Do not break the peace!

MARSHAL (_reads_)

"Every inhabitant of this Jurisdiction Who shall defend the horrible opinions Of Quakers, by denying due respect To equals and superiors, and withdrawing From

Church Assemblies, and thereby approving The abusive and destructive practices Of this accursed sect, in opposition To all the orthodox received opinions Of godly men, shall be forthwith committed Unto close prison for one month; and then Refusing to retract and to reform The opinions as aforesaid, he shall be Sentenced to Banishment on pain of Death. By the Court. Edward Rawson, Secretary." Now, hangman, do your duty. Burn those books.

Loud murmurs in the crowd. The pile of books is lighted.

UPSALL

I testify against these cruel laws! Forerunners are they of some judgment on us; And, in the love and tenderness I bear Unto this town and people, I beseech you, O Magistrates, take heed, lest ye be found As fighters against God!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

The law was soon to be enforced, and among the earliest to endure its penalties were Christopher Holden and John Copeland, who were whipped and imprisoned, while Lawrence and Cassandra Southwick, of Salem, were also imprisoned for having harbored them. The Southwicks were in advanced years, and had three grown children--Provided, Josiah, and Daniel. The whole family had united with the Society of Friends, and the parents were banished from the colony upon pain of death. While they and one son, Josiah, were in prison, Provided and Daniel were fined ten pounds for not attending public worship at Salem. They refused to pay, and were ordered to be sold into slavery in Virginia or Barbadoes, but no master of a vessel could be found to carry out the sentence.

CASSANDRA SOUTHWICK

[1658]

To the God of all sure mercies let my blessing rise to-day, From the scoffer and the cruel He hath plucked the spoil away; Yea, He who cooled the furnace around the faithful three, And tamed the Chaldean lions, hath set His handmaid free!

Last night I saw the sunset melt through my prison bars, Last night across my damp earth-floor fell the pale gleam of stars; In the coldness and the darkness all through the long night-time, My grated casement whitened with autumn's early rime.

Alone, in that dark sorrow, hour after hour crept by; Star after star looked palely in and sank adown the sky; No sound amid night's stillness, save that which seemed to be The dull and heavy beating of the pulses of the sea;

All night I sat unsleeping, for I knew that on the morrow The ruler and the cruel priest would mock me in my sorrow, Dragged to their place of market, and bargained for and sold, Like a lamb before the shambles, like a heifer from the fold!

Oh, the weakness of the flesh was there,--the shrinking and the shame; And the low voice of the Tempter like whispers to me came: "Why sit'st thou thus forlornly," the

wicked murmur said, "Damp walls thy bower of beauty, cold earth thy maiden bed?

"Where be the smiling faces, and voices soft and sweet, Seen in thy father's dwelling, heard in the pleasant street? Where be the youths whose glances, the summer Sabbath through, Turned tenderly and timidly unto thy father's pew?

"Why sit'st thou here, Cassandra?--Bethink thee with what mirth Thy happy schoolmates gather around the warm, bright hearth; How the crimson shadows tremble on foreheads white and fair, On eyes of merry girlhood, half hid in golden hair.

"Not for thee the hearth-fire brightens, not for thee kind words are spoken, Not for thee the nuts of Wenham woods by laughing boys are broken; No first-fruits of the orchard within thy lap are laid, For thee no flowers of autumn the youthful hunters braid.

"O weak, deluded maiden!--by crazy fancies led, With wild and raving railers an evil path to tread; To leave a wholesome worship, and teaching pure and sound, And mate with maniac women, loose-haired and sackcloth bound,--

"Mad scoffers of the priesthood, who mock at things divine, Who rail against the pulpit, and holy bread and wine; Sore from their cart-tail scourgings, and from the pillory lame, Rejoicing in their wretchedness, and glorying in their shame.

"And what a fate awaits thee!--a sadly toiling slave, Dragging the slowly lengthening chain of bondage to the grave! Think of thy woman's nature, subdued in hopeless thrall, The easy prey of any, the scoff and scorn of all!"

Oh, ever as the Tempter spoke, and feeble Nature's fears Wrung drop by drop the scalding flow of unavailing tears, I wrestled down the evil thoughts, and strove in silent prayer, To feel, O Helper of the weak! that Thou indeed wert there!

I thought of Paul and Silas, within Philippi's cell, And how from Peter's sleeping limbs the prison shackles fell, Till I seemed to hear the trailing of an angel's robe of white, And to feel a blessed presence invisible to sight.

Bless the Lord for all his mercies!--for the peace and love I felt, Like dew of Hermon's holy hill, upon my spirit melt; When "Get behind me, Satan!" was the language of my heart, And I felt the Evil Tempter with all his doubts depart.

Slow broke the gray cold morning; again the sunshine fell, Flecked with the shade of bar and grate within my lonely cell; The hoar-frost melted on the wall, and upward from the street Came careless laugh and idle word, and tread of passing feet.

At length the heavy bolts fell back, my door was open cast, And slowly at the sheriff's side, up the long street I passed; I heard the murmur round me, and felt, but dared not see, How, from every door and window, the people gazed on me.

And doubt and fear fell on me, shame burned upon my cheek, Swam earth and sky around me, my trembling limbs grew weak: "O Lord! support thy handmaid; and from her soul cast out The fear of man, which brings a snare, the weakness and the doubt."

Then the dreary shadows scattered, like a cloud in morning's breeze, And a low deep voice within me seemed whispering words like these: "Though thy earth be as the iron, and thy heaven a brazen wall, Trust still His loving-kindness whose power is over all."

We paused at length, where at my feet the sunlit waters broke On glaring reach of shining beach, and shingly wall of rock; The merchant-ships lay idly there, in hard clear lines on high, Tracing with rope and slender spar their network on the sky.

And there were ancient citizens, cloak-wrapped and grave and cold, And grim and stout sea-captains with faces bronzed and old, And on his horse, with Rawson, his cruel clerk at hand, Sat dark and haughty Endicott, the ruler of the land.

And poisoning with his evil words the ruler's ready ear, The priest leaned o'er his saddle, with laugh and scoff and jeer; It stirred my soul, and from my lips the seal of silence broke, As if through woman's weakness a warning spirit spoke.

I cried, "The Lord rebuke thee, thou smiter of the meek, Thou robber of the righteous, thou trampler of the weak! Go light the dark, cold hearth-stones,--go turn the prison lock Of the poor hearts thou hast hunted, thou wolf amid the flock!"

Dark lowered the brows of Endicott, and with a deeper red O'er Rawson's wine-empurpled cheek the flush of anger spread; "Good people," quoth the white-lipped priest, "heed not her words so wild, Her Master speaks within her,--the Devil owns his child!"

But gray heads shook, and young brows knit, the while the sheriff read That law the wicked rulers against the poor have made, Who to their house of Rimmon and idol priesthood bring No bended knee of worship, nor gainful offering.

Then to the stout sea-captains the sheriff, turning, said,-- "Which of ye, worthy seamen, will take this Quaker maid? In the Isle of fair Barbadoes, or on Virginia's shore, You may hold her at a higher price than Indian girl or Moor."

Grim and silent stood the captains; and when again he cried, "Speak out, my worthy seamen!"--no voice, no sign replied; But I felt a hard hand press my own, and kind words met my ear,-- "God bless thee, and preserve thee, my gentle girl and dear!"

A weight seemed lifted from my heart, a pitying friend was nigh,-- I felt it in his hard, rough hand, and saw it in his eye; And when again the sheriff spoke, that voice, so kind to me, Growled back its stormy answer like the roaring of the sea,--

"Pile my ship with bars of silver, pack with coins of Spanish gold, From keel-piece up to deck-plank, the roomage of her hold, By the living God who made me!--I would sooner in your bay Sink ship and crew and cargo, than bear this child away!"

"Well answered, worthy captain, shame on their cruel laws!" Ran through the crowd in murmurs loud the people's just applause. "Like the herdsman of Tekoa, in Israel of old, Shall we see the poor and righteous again for silver sold?"

I looked on haughty Endicott; with weapon half-way drawn, Swept round the throng his lion glare of bitter hate and scorn; Fiercely he drew his bridle-rein, and turned in silence back, And sneering priest and baffled clerk rode murmuring in his track.

Hard after them the sheriff looked, in bitterness of soul; Thrice smote his staff upon the ground, and crushed his parchment roll. "Good friends," he said, "since both have fled, the ruler and the priest, Judge ye, if from their further work I be not well released."

Loud was the cheer which, full and clear, swept round the silent bay, As, with kind words and kinder looks, he bade me go my way; For He who turns the courses of the streamlet of the glen, And the river of great waters, had turned the hearts of men.

Oh, at that hour the very earth seemed changed beneath my eye, A holier wonder round me rose the blue walls of the sky, A lovelier light on rock and hill and stream and woodland lay, And softer lapsed on sunnier sands the waters of the bay.

Thanksgiving to the Lord of life! to Him all praises be, Who from the hands of evil men hath set his handmaid free; All praise to Him before whose power the mighty are afraid, Who takes the crafty in the snare which for the poor is laid!

Sing, O my soul, rejoicingly, on evening's twilight calm Uplift the loud thanksgiving, pour forth the grateful psalm; Let all dear hearts with me rejoice, as did the saints of old, When of the Lord's good angel the rescued Peter told.

And weep and howl, ye evil priests and mighty men of wrong, The Lord shall smite the proud, and lay His hand upon the strong. Woe to the wicked rulers in His avenging hour! Woe to the wolves who seek the flocks to raven and devour!

But let the humble ones arise, the poor in heart be glad, And let the mourning ones again with robes of praise be clad. For He who cooled the furnace, and smoothed the stormy wave, And tamed the Chaldean lions, is mighty still to save!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

In September, 1661, Edward Burrough, a prominent Quaker of England, obtained an audience of King Charles II and laid the grievances of the New England Quakers before him. That careless King, who always found it more easy to grant a request than to refuse it, so long as it cost him nothing, directed that a letter be written to Endicott and the governors of the other New England colonies, commanding that "if there were any of those people called Quakers amongst them, now already condemned to suffer death, or other corporal punishment, or that were imprisoned, and obnoxious to the like condemnation, they were to forbear to proceed any further therein," and to send such persons to England for trial. This letter was given in charge to Samuel Shattuck, a Quaker of Salem, then in England under sentence of banishment, with the usual condition of being hanged should he return. He reached Boston in November, 1661, and presented himself with all haste at the governor's door. The ballad very accurately describes the interview which followed.

THE KING'S MISSIVE

[November, 1661]

Under the great hill sloping bare To cove and meadow and Common lot, In his council chamber and oaken chair, Sat the worshipful Governor Endicott. A grave, strong man, who knew no peer In the pilgrim land, where he ruled in fear Of God, not man, and for good or ill Held his trust with an iron will.

He had shorn with his sword the cross from out The flag, and cloven the May-pole down, Harried the heathen round about, And whipped the Quakers from town to town. Earnest and honest, a man at need To burn like a torch for his own harsh creed, He kept with the flaming brand of his zeal The gate of the holy common weal.

His brow was clouded, his eye was stern, With a look of mingled sorrow and wrath; "Woe's me!" he murmured: "at every turn The pestilent Quakers are in my path! Some we have scourged, and banished some, Some hanged, more doomed, and still they come, Fast as the tide of yon bay sets in, Sowing their heresy's seed of sin.

"Did we count on this? Did we leave behind The graves of our kin, the comfort and ease Of our English hearths and homes, to find Troublers of Israel such as these? Shall I spare? Shall I pity them? God forbid! I will do as the prophet to Agag did: They come to poison the wells of the Word, I will hew them in pieces before the Lord!"

The door swung open, and Rawson the clerk Entered, and whispered under breath, "There waits below for the hangman's work A fellow banished on pain of death-- Shattuck, of Salem, unhealed of the whip, Brought over in Master Goldsmith's ship At anchor here in a Christian port, With freight of the devil and all his sort!"

Twice and thrice on the chamber floor Striding fiercely from wall to wall, "The Lord do so to me and more," The Governor cried, "if I hang not all! Bring hither the Quaker." Calm, sedate, With the look of a man at ease with fate, Into that presence grim and dread Came Samuel Shattuck, with hat on head.

"Off with the knave's hat!" An angry hand Smote down the offence; but the wearer said, With a quiet smile, "By the king's command I bear his message and stand in his stead." In the Governor's hand a missive he laid With the royal arms on its seal displayed, And the proud man spake as he gazed thereat, Uncovering, "Give Mr. Shattuck his hat."

He turned to the Quaker, bowing low,-- "The king commandeth your friends' release; Doubt not he shall be obeyed, although To his subjects' sorrow and sin's increase. What he here enjoineth, John Endicott, His loyal servant, questioneth not. You are free! God grant the spirit you own May take you from us to parts unknown."

So the door of the jail was open cast, And, like Daniel, out of the lion's den Tender youth and girlhood passed, With age-bowed women and gray-locked men. And the voice of one appointed to die Was lifted in praise and thanks on high, And the little maid from New Netherlands Kissed, in her joy, the doomed man's hands

And one, whose call was to minister To the souls in prison, beside him went, An ancient woman, bearing with her The linen shroud for his burial meant. For she, not counting her own life dear, In the strength of a love that cast out fear, Had watched and served where her brethren died, Like those who waited the cross beside.

One moment they paused on their way to look On the martyr graves by the Common side. And much scourged Wharton of Salem took His burden of prophecy up and cried: "Rest, souls of the valiant! Not in vain Have ye borne the Master's cross of pain; Ye have fought the fight, ye are victors crowned, With a fourfold chain ye have Satan bound!"

The autumn haze lay soft and still On wood and meadow and upland farms; On the brow of Snow Hill the great windmill Slowly and lazily swung its arms; Broad in the sunshine stretched away, With its capes and islands, the turquoise bay; And over water and dusk of pines Blue hills lifted their faint outlines.

The topaz leaves of the walnut glowed, The sumach added its crimson fleck, And double in air and water showed The tinted maples along the Neck; Through frost flower clusters of pale star-mist, And gentian fringes of amethyst, And royal plumes of golden-rod, The grazing cattle on Centry trod.

But as they who see not, the Quakers saw The world about them; they only thought With deep thanksgiving and pious awe On the great deliverance God had wrought. Through lane and alley the gazing town Noisily followed them up and down; Some with scoffing and brutal jeer, Some with pity and words of cheer.

One brave voice rose above the din. Upsall, gray with his length of days, Cried from the door of his Red Lion Inn: "Men of Boston, give God the praise! No more shall innocent blood call down The bolts of wrath on your guilty town. The freedom of worship, dear to you, Is dear to all, and to all is due.

"I see the vision of days to come, When your beautiful City of the Bay Shall be Christian liberty's chosen home, And none shall his neighbor's rights gainsay. The varying notes of worship shall blend And as one great prayer to God ascend, And hands of mutual charity raise Walls of salvation and gates of praise."

So passed the Quakers through Boston town, Whose painful ministers sighed to see The walls of their sheep-fold falling down, And wolves of heresy prowling free. But the years went on, and brought no wrong; With milder counsels the State grew strong, As outward Letter and inward Light Kept the balance of truth aright.

The Puritan spirit perishing not, To Concord's yeomen the signal sent, And spake in the voice of the cannon-shot That severed the chains of a continent. With its gentler mission of peace and good-will The thought of the Quaker is living still, And the freedom of soul he prophesied Is gospel and law where the martyrs died.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

CHAPTER VII

KING PHILIP'S WAR AND THE WITCHCRAFT DELUSION

Metacomet, or Philip, had succeeded his father, Massasoit, as chief of the Wampanoags, and endeavored to maintain friendly relations with the English, but in June, 1675, some of his young men attacked the village of Swansea, and started the desperate struggle known as King Philip's War. For months the Indians ravaged the frontier, and on September 18 all but annihilated a picked force of eighty men, the "Flower of Essex," under Captain Thomas Lathrop, which had been sent to Deerfield to save a quantity of grain which had been abandoned there. Only nine of the eighty survived.

THE LAMENTABLE BALLAD OF THE BLOODY BROOK

[September 18, 1675]

Come listen to the Story of brave Lathrop and his Men,-- How they fought, how they died, When they marched against the Red Skins in the Autumn Days, and then How they fell, in their pride, By Pocumtuck Side.

"Who will go to Deerfield Meadows and bring the ripened Grain?" Said old Mosely to his men in Array. "Take the Wagons and the Horses, and bring it back again; But be sure that no Man stray All the Day, on the Way."

Then the Flower of Essex started, with Lathrop at their head, Wise and brave, bold and true. He had fought the Pequots long ago, and now to Mosely said, "Be there Many, be there Few, I will bring the Grain to you."

They gathered all the Harvest, and marched back on their Way Through the Woods which blazed like Fire. No Soldier left the Line of march to wander or to stray, Till the Wagons were stalled in the Mire, And the Beasts began to tire.

The Wagons have all forded the Brook as it flows, And then the Rear-Guard stays To pick the Purple Grapes that are hanging from the Boughs, When, crack!--to their Amaze, A hundred Fire-locks blaze!

Brave Lathrop, he lay dying; but as he fell he cried, "Each Man to his Tree," said he, "Let no one yield an Inch;" and so the Soldier died; And not a Man of all can see Where the Foe can be.

And Philip and his Devils pour in their Shot so fast, From behind and before, That Man after Man is shot down and breathes his last. Every Man lies dead in his Gore To fight no more,--no more!

Oh, weep, ye Maids of Essex, for the Lads who have died,-- The Flower of Essex they! The Bloody Brook still ripples by the black Mountain-side, But never shall they come again to see the ocean-tide, And never shall the Bridegroom return to his Bride, From that dark and cruel Day,--cruel Day!

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

At the approach of winter, the Indians withdrew to the Narragansett country, and the colonists decided to strike a decisive blow. An army of a thousand men was raised and on the morning of Sunday, December 19, approached the Narragansett stronghold, a well-fortified position on an island in the midst of a swamp. A murderous fire greeted the assailants, but they forced an entrance into the fort, set fire to the wigwams, and after a terrific struggle, in which they lost nearly three hundred killed and wounded, drove the Indians out and destroyed their store of winter provisions.

THE GREAT SWAMP FIGHT

[December 19, 1675]

I

Oh, rouse you, rouse you, men at arms, And hear the tale I tell, From Pettaquamscut town I come, Now hear what there befell.

The houses stand upon the hill, Not large, each house is full, But largest of them all there stood The house of Justice Bull.

'Twas there the court sat every year, The governor came in state, From there the couriers through the town Served summons soon and late.

And there, 'tis but three years agone, George Fox preached, you remember; That was in May when he preached peace, And now it is December.

Peace, peace, he cried, but righteous God, How can there be true peace, When war and tumult stalk at night, And deeds of blood increase?

Revenge, revenge, good captains bold, Revenge, my people cry; Where stood the house of Justice Bull But piled-up ashes lie.

How fared it then, who may dare tell? The shutters barred the light, As one by one the windows closed, And all was black as night.

Strong was the house, and strong brave men All armed lay down to sleep, And women fair, and children, too, They were to guard and keep.

And then a horror in the night, And shouts, and fire, and knives, And demons yelling in delight, As men fought for their lives.

And where there stood that goodly house And lived those goodly men, Full seven goodly souls are gone. Revenge, we cry again!

II

Up, up, ye men of English blood! The gallant governor cried, And we shall dare to find their lair, Where'er it be they hide.

For never men of English blood Could brook so foul a deed, For all these sins the fierce redskins Shall reap their lawful meed.

Up rose the little army then, All armed as best they could, With pike and sword and axes broad, Flint-locks and staves of wood.

And motley was the company, Recruits from wood and field, But strong young men were with them then, Who'd sooner die than yield.

Connecticut had sent her men With Major Robert Treat; Each colony in its degree Sent in its quota meet.

And Massachusetts led the way, And Plymouth had next post, Winslow commands the gathered bands, A thousand men they boast.

The winter sun hung in the sky And frost bound all things fast; As they set forth, from out the north, There blew a bitter blast.

The meadow grass was stiff with rime, The frozen brook lay dead; Like stone did sound the frozen ground Beneath the martial tread.

All day they marched in bitter cold, And when, as fell the night, They reached the hill and gazed their fill Upon the piteous sight,

No need to urge the rapid chase, The cinders did that well, And in the air a woman's hair Told more than words could tell.

In stern resolve they lay them down, For rest they needed sore, But long ere dawn the swords were drawn And open stood the door.

Out to the gloom of morning passed Full silently those men, And what 'twixt light and fall of night Should come, no soul might ken.

III

They turned their faces toward the west, The morning air was cold, And softly stepped, while still men slept, With courage high and bold.

An Indian they met ere long, 'Twas Peter, whom they knew; They asked their way, naught would he say, To his own comrades true.

In anger cried the governor: Then let the man be hung, For he can tell, he knows full well, So let him find his tongue.

To save his life that wretched man Agreed to be their guide, As they marched on, the Indian Marched onward by their side.

And soon they reached a dreadful swamp, With cedar trees o'ergrown, And thick and dark with dead trees stark And great trunks lying prone.

'Twas frozen hard, and Indians there! They fired as they ran, And with a bound that spurned the ground, The fierce assault began.

And then a wonder in the wood,-- A little rising ground, With palisade for shelter made Of timber planted round.

And but one place of entrance there Across a watery way, A tall felled tree gave access free, From shore to shore it lay.

Full many a gallant man that day His life left at that tree, The bravest men pressed forward then, And there fell captains three.

A dreadful day, and of our men Short work would have been made, But that by grace they found a place Weak in the palisade.

Then they poured in, within the fort Soon filled with Indians dead, And many a one great deeds had done Within that place of dread.

Then with a torch the whole was fired, The wigwams caught the blaze, The fire roared and spread abroad And fed on tubs of maize.

The night came on, the governor called, The soldiers gathered round; The fort was theirs, and dying prayers Were rising from the ground.

With care they gathered up their dead, The few who had been spared, All through the cold, in pain untold, To Warwick they repaired.

So was the Indians' power gone, Avenged were Englishmen, For from the night of that Swamp fight They never rose again.

In Narragansett there was peace, The soldiers went their way, All that remains are some few grains Of corn parched on that day.

Gone is the wrong, the toil, the pain, The Indians, they are gone. Please God we use, and not abuse The land so hardly won!

CAROLINE HAZARD.

This assault by the colonists drove the Narragansetts, who had hitherto taken no active part in the war, into alliance with Philip, and two months later, on February 21, 1676, Medfield, less than twenty miles from Boston, was attacked and partially burned. Groton soon suffered a similar fate, and the leaders of the savages boasted that they would march on Cambridge, Concord, Roxbury, and Boston itself. It was at this juncture that the "Amazonian Dames" mentioned in the poem became so frightened at the prospect that they resolved to fortify Boston neck.

ON A FORTIFICATION AT BOSTON BEGUN BY WOMEN

DUX FOEMINA FACTI

[March, 1676]

A grand attempt some Amazonian Dames Contrive whereby to glorify their names, A ruff for Boston Neck of mud and turfe, Reaching from side to side, from surf to surf, Their nimble hands spin up like Christmas pyes, Their pastry by degrees on high doth

rise. The wheel at home counts it an holiday, Since while the mistress worketh it may play. A tribe of female hands, but manly hearts, Forsake at home their pasty crust and tarts, To knead the dirt, the samplers down they hurl, Their undulating silks they closely furl. The pick-axe one as a commandress holds, While t'other at her awk'ness gently scolds. One puffs and sweats, the other mutters why Can't you promove your work so fast as I? Some dig, some delve, and others' hands do feel The little waggon's weight with single wheel. And least some fainting-fits the weak surprize, They want no sack nor cakes, they are more wise. These brave essays draw forth male, stronger hands, More like to dawbers than to marshal bands; These do the work, the sturdy bulwarks raise, But the beginners well deserve the praise.

BENJAMIN TOMPSON.

On April 21 an attack was made on Sudbury; a portion of the town was burned, and a relief party of over fifty which hurried up was lured into an ambush and all but annihilated. The Indians in this battle were bolder than they had ever been before, and their strategy was unusually effective.

THE SUDBURY FIGHT

[April 21, 1676]

Ye sons of Massachusetts, all who love that honored name, Ye children of New England, holding dear your fathers' fame, Hear tell of Sudbury's battle through a day of death and flame!

The painted Wampanoags, Philip's hateful warriors, creep Upon the town at springtide while the skies deny us rain; We see their shadows lurking in the forest's whispering deep, And speed the sorry tidings past dry field and rustling lane: _Come hastily or never when the wild beast lusts for gore, And send your best and bravest if you wish to see us more!_

The Commonwealth is quiet now, and peace her measure fills, Content in homes and farmsteads, busy marts and buzzing mills From the Atlantic's roaring to the tranquil Berkshire hills.

But through that day our fathers, speaking low their breathless words, Their wives and babes in safety, toil to save their little all; They fetch their slender food-stores, drive indoors their scanty herds, They clean the bell-mouthed musket, melt the lead and mould the ball; Please God they'll keep their battle till their countrymen shall haste With succor from the eastward, iron-hearted, flinty-faced.

A hundred dragging twelvemonths ere the welcome joy-bells ring The dawn of Independence did King Philip's devils spring Through April on the little spot, like wolves a-ravening.

The morning lifts in fury as they come with torch in hand, And howl about the houses in the shrunken frontier town; Our garrisons hold steady while the flames by breezes fanned Disclose the painted demons, fierce and cunning, lithe and brown; At every loophole firing, women close at hand to load, The children bringing bullets,

thus the Sudbury men abode.

By night, through generations, have the eager children come Beside their grandsire's settle, listening to the droning hum Of this old tale, with backward glances, open-mouthed and dumb.

The burning hours stretch slowly--then a welcome sight appears! Along the tawny upland where stout Haynes keeps faithful guard From Watertown speeds Mason, young in everything but years; Our men rush down to meet him; then, together, swift and hard, They force the Indians backward to the Musketaquid's side, And slaying, ever slaying, drive them o'er the reddened tide.

There stand stout Haynes and Mason by the bridge upon the flood; In vain the braves attack them, thick as saplings in the wood: Praise God for men so valiant, who have such a foe withstood!

But Green Hill looks with anguish down upon the painted horde Their stealthy ambush keeping as the Concord men draw near, To dart with hideous noises as they reach the lower ford, A thousand 'gainst a dozen; but their every life costs dear As, sinking 'neath such numbers, one by one our neighbors fail: One sole survivor in his blood brings on the dreadful tale.

Through sun and evening shadow, through the night till weary morn, Speeds Wadsworth with his soldiers, forth from Boston, spent and worn, And Brocklebank at Marlboro' joins that little hope forlorn.

They hear the muskets snap afar, they hear the savage whoop-- All weariness forgotten, on they hasten in relief; They see the braves before them--with a cheer the little group Bends down and charges forward; from above the cunning Chief, His wild-cat eyes dilating, sees his bushes bloom with fire, The tree-trunks at his bidding blaze with fiendish lust and ire.

A thousand warriors lurk there, and a thousand warriors shout, Exulting, aiming, flaming, happy in our coming rout; But Wadsworth never pauses, every musket ringing out.

He gains the lifting hillside, and his sixscore win their way Defiant through the coppice till upon the summit placed; With every bullet counting, there they load and aim and slay, Against all comers warring, iron-hearted, flinty-faced; Hold Philip as for scorning, drive him down the bloodstained slope, And stand there, firm and dauntless, steadfast in their faith and hope.

With Mason at the river, Wadsworth staunch upon the hill, The certain reinforcements, and black night the foe to chill, An hour or less and hideous Death might have been baffled still.

But in that droughty woodland Philip fires the leaves and grass: The flames dance up the hillside, in their rear less savage foes. No courage can avail us, down the slope the English pass-- A day in flame beginning lights with hell its awful close, As swifter, louder, fiercer, o'er the crest the reek runs past And headlong hurls bold Wadsworth, conquered by the cruel blast.

Ye men of Massachusetts, weep the awful slaughter there! The panther heart of Philip drives the English to despair, As scalping-knife and tomahawk gleam in th' affrighted glare.

There Wadsworth yields his spirit, Brocklebank must meet his doom; Within the stone mill's shelter fights the remnant of their force; When swift upon the foemen, rushing through the gathering gloom, Cheer Cowell's men from Brookfield, gallant Prentice with his horse! And Mason from the river, and Haynes join in the fight, Till Philip's host is routed, hurled on shrieking through the night.

Defeated, cursing, weeping, flees King Philip to his den, Our speedy vengeance glutted on the flower of his men; In pomp and pride the Wampanoags ne'er shall march again.

We mourn our stricken Captains, but not vainly did they fall: The King of Pocanoket has received their stern command; Their lives were laid down gladly at their country's trumpet-call, And on their savage foemen have they set the heavier hand; Against our day-long valor was the red man's fortune spent And that one day at Sudbury has saved a continent.

In graves adown the hemisphere, in graves across the seas, The sons of Massachusetts sleep, as here beneath her trees, Nor Brocklebank nor Wadsworth is the first or last of these.

Oh, blue hills of New England, slanting to the morning beams Where suns and clouds of April have their balmy power sped; Oh, greening woods and meadows, pleasant ponds and babbling streams, And clematis soft-blooming where War once his banners led; How hungers many an exile for that homeland far away, And all the happy dreaming of a bygone April day!

Wherever speaks New England, wheresoever spreads her shade, We praise our fathers' valor, and our fathers' prayer is said, That, fearing God's Wrath only, firm may stand the State they made.

WALLACE RICE.

The victory at Sudbury was the last considerable success the Indians gained in the war. Jealousies broke out among them, many deserted to the whites, and the final blow was struck when, at daybreak of August 12, 1676, Captain Church surprised Philip's camp at Mt. Hope, and Philip himself was shot by an Indian while trying to escape. His head was cut off, sent to Plymouth, and fixed upon a pole, where it remained for twenty years. His wife and son, a boy of nine, were taken prisoners and sold into slavery. With them, the race of Massasoit, that true and tried friend of the early settlers, vanishes from the pages of history.

KING PHILIP'S LAST STAND

[August 12, 1676]

'Twas Captain Church, bescarred and brown, And armèd cap-a-pie. Came ambling into Plymouth-town; And from far riding up and down A weary man was he.

Now, where is my good wife? he quoth Before the goodmen all; And they replied, _What of thine oath?_ And he looked on them lorn and loath, As he were like to fall.

What of thine oath? to him they cried, _And wilt thou let him slip Who harrieth fair New England-side Till every path is slaughter-dyed,-- The murderous King Philip!_

His cheek went flush and swelled his girth; _Upon him be God's ban!_ His voice ran loud in grisly mirth: _Now, who with me will run to earth This bloody Indiàn?_

Then _I!_ and _I!_ the lusty peal Made thrill the Plymouth air; And forth with him for woe or weal, Their hands agrip on musket-steel, Hied many a godly pair.

They sped them through the summer-land By ferry and by ford, Until they saw before them stand A redman of that cursèd band, His features ochre-scored.

Would the pale-faces find, he said, _Where lurks their fiercest foe? Now, by the spirit of the dead,-- My brother, whose heart's blood he shed,-- Follow, and they shall know!_

This Indian brave, they followed him; In caution crawled and crept; Till in a marish deep and dim They came to where the Sachem grim In leafy hiding slept.

(The quiet August morn's at bud, King Philip, woe's the day! And woe that one of thine own blood, Now that ill-fortune roars to flood, Should be the man to slay!)

Around him spread a girdling line; The fatal snare was laid; And when down aisles of birch and pine They saw the first slant sun-rays shine, They sprang their ambuscade.

And did he slink, or did he shrink From that relentless ring? Nay, not a coward did he sink, But leaped across Death's darkling brink A savage, yet a king!

Then unto him whose bolt of lead Had struck King Philip down, They gave the Sachem's hand and head; Then back they marched, with triumph tread, To joyful Plymouth-town.

On Philip's name a bloody blot The white man's writ has thrown,-- The ruthless raid, the inhuman plot; _And yet what one of us would not Do battle for his own!_

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

The Indians conquered, the people of Massachusetts set themselves resolutely to fight the devil. They were firm believers in the actual presence of the powers of darkness, and almost from the beginning of the colony there had been prosecutions for witchcraft. But it was not until 1692 that the great outbreak of superstition, vindictiveness, and fear occurred, which forms the darkest blot on New England's history.

PROLOGUE

From "Giles Corey of the Salem Farms"

Delusions of the days that once have been, Witchcraft and wonders of the world unseen, Phantoms of air, and necromantic arts That crushed the weak and awed the stoutest hearts,-- These are our theme to-night; and vaguely here, Through the dim mists that crowd the atmosphere, We draw the outlines of weird figures cast In shadow on the background of the Past.

Who would believe that in the quiet town Of Salem, and amid the woods that crown The neighboring hillsides, and the sunny farms That fold it safe in their paternal arms,-- Who would believe that in those peaceful streets, Where the great elms shut out the summer heats, Where quiet reigns, and breathes through brain and breast The benediction of unbroken rest,-- Who would believe such deeds could find a place As these whose tragic history we retrace?

'Twas but a village then: the goodman ploughed His ample acres under sun or cloud; The goodwife at her doorstep sat and spun, And gossiped with her neighbors in the sun; The only men of dignity and state Were then the Minister and the Magistrate, Who ruled their little realm with iron rod, Less in the love than in the fear of God; And who believed devoutly in the Powers Of Darkness, working in this world of ours, In spells of Witchcraft, incantations dread, And shrouded apparitions of the dead.

Upon this simple folk "with fire and flame," Saith the old Chronicle, "the Devil came; Scattering his firebrands and his poisonous darts, To set on fire of Hell all tongues and hearts! And 'tis no wonder; for, with all his host, There most he rages where he hateth most, And is most hated; so on us he brings All these stupendous and portentous things!"

Something of this our scene to-night will show; And ye who listen to the Tale of Woe, Be not too swift in casting the first stone, Nor think New England bears the guilt alone. This sudden burst of wickedness and crime Was but the common madness of the time, When in all lands, that lie within the sound Of Sabbath bells, a Witch was burned or drowned.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

The outbreak occurred in that part of Salem then called Salem Village, now the separate town of Danvers, and was brought about by three or four children who pretended to be bewitched and who "cried out" against various persons. They were countenanced, not to say encouraged, by Samuel Parris, the minister of the place, and there is evidence to show that he used them to gratify his private enmities.

SALEM

[A.D. 1692]

Soe, Mistress Anne, faire neighboure myne, How rides a witch when night-winds blowe? Folk say that you are none too goode To joyne the crewe in Salem woode, When one you wot of gives the signe: Righte well, methinks, the pathe you knowe.

In meetinge-time I watched you well, Whiles godly Master Parris prayed: Your folded hands laye on your booke; But Richard answered to a looke That fain would tempt him unto hell, Where, Mistress Anne, your place is made.

You looke into my Richard's eyes With evill glances shamelesse growne; I found about his wriste a hair, And guesse what fingers tyed it there! He shall not lightly be your prize-- Your Master first shall take his owne.

'Tis not in nature he should be (Who loved me soe when Springe was greene) A childe, to hange upon your gowne! He loved me well in Salem towne Until this wanton witcherie His heart and myne crept dark betweene.

Last Sabbath nighte, the gossips saye, Your goodman missed you from his side. He had no strength to move, until Agen, as if in slumber still, Beside him at the dawne you laye. Tell, nowe, what meanwhile did betide.

Dame Anne, mye hate goe with you fleete As drifts the Bay fogg overhead-- Or over yonder hill-topp, where There is a tree ripe fruit shall bear When, neighbour myne, your wicked feet The stones of Gallows Hill shall tread.

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

A special jury, instituted to try the suspects, went to work without delay. On June 2, 1692, Bridget Bishop was tried and condemned and was hanged a week later. On June 30 the court sentenced five persons to death, and all of them were executed soon afterwards. Among those condemned was Rebecca Nourse, seventy-one years of age, universally beloved and of excellent character. The jury was with great difficulty persuaded to convict her; the governor granted a reprieve, but Parris, who had an ancient grudge against her, finally got it repealed, and on July 19, 1692, she was carted to the summit of Gallows Hill and hanged.

THE DEATH OF GOODY NURSE

[July 19, 1692]

The chill New England sunshine Lay on the kitchen floor; The wild New England north wind Came rattling at the door.

And by the wide old fire-place, Deep in her cushioned chair, Lay back an ancient woman, With shining snow-white hair.

The peace of God was on her face, Her eyes were sweet and calm, And when you heard her earnest voice It sounded like a psalm.

In all the land they loved her well; From country and from town Came many a heart for counsel, And many a soul cast down.

Her hands had fed the hungry poor With blessing and with bread; Her face was like a comforting From out the Gospel read.

So weak and silent as she lay, Her warm hands clasped in prayer, A sudden knocking at the door Came on her unaware.

And as she turned her hoary head, Beside her chair there stood Four grim and grisly Puritans-- No visitants for good.

They came upon her like a host, And bade her speak and tell Why she had sworn a wicked oath To serve the powers of hell;

To work the works of darkness On children of the light, A witch they might not suffer here Who read the Word aright.

Like one who sees her fireside yawn, A pit of black despair, Or one who wakes from quiet dreams Within a lion's lair,

She glared at them with starting eyes, Her voice essayed no sound; She gasped like any hunted deer The eager dogs surround.

"Answer us!" hoarse and loud they cry; She looked from side to side-- No human help--"Oh, gracious God!" In agony she cried.

Then, calling back her feeble life, The white lips uttered slow, "I am as pure as babe unborn From this foul thing, ye know.

"If God doth visit me for sin, Beneath His rod I bend," But pitiless and wroth were they, And bent upon their end.

They tortured her with taunt and jeer, They vexed her night and day-- No husband's arm nor sister's tears Availed their rage to stay.

Before the church they haled her then; The minister arose And poured upon her patient head The worst of all its woes:

He bade her be accursed of God Forever here and there; He cursed her with a heavy curse No mortal man may bear.

She stood among the cowering crowd As calm as saints in heaven, Her eyes as sweet as summer skies, Her face like summer's even.

The devils wrought their wicked will On matron and on maid. "Thou hast bewitched us!" cried they all, But not a word she said.

They fastened chains about her feet, And carried her away; For many days in Salem jail Alone and ill she lay

She heard the scythe along the field Ring through the fragrant air, She smelt the wild-rose on the wind That bloweth everywhere.

Reviled and hated and bereft, The soul had plenteous rest, Though sorrow like a frantic flood Beat sore upon her breast.

At last the prison door stood wide, They led the saint abroad; By many an old familiar place Her trembling footsteps trod.

Till faint with weakness and distress, She climbed a hillside bleak, And faced the gallows built thereon, Still undisturbed and meek.

They hanged this weary woman there, Like any felon stout; Her white hairs on the cruel rope Were scattered all about.

The body swung upon the tree In every flitting wind, Reviled and mocked by passengers And folk of evil mind.

A woman old and innocent, To die a death of shame, With kindred, neighbors, friends thereby, And none to utter blame.

Oh, God, that such a thing should be On earth which Thou hast made! A voice from heaven answered me, "Father forgive," He said.

ROSE TERRY COOKE.

At the August session, six persons were tried and, of course, condemned, among them Elizabeth and John Proctor. The former had been arrested April 11, and when her husband came to her defence, he was also arrested. They were tried together August 5, and both were convicted and sentenced to be hanged. Proctor was executed August 19. His wife escaped by pleading pregnancy. Some months later she gave birth to a child, and her execution was again ordered early in 1693, but Governor Phips granted a reprieve, and she ultimately escaped.

A SALEM WITCH

[August 19, 1692]

The wind blows east,--the wind blows west,-- It blows upon the gallows tree: Oh, little babe beneath my breast, He died for thee!--he died for me!

The judges came,--the children came (Some mother's heart o'er each had yearned), They set their black lies on my name:-- "A God-accursèd witch who learned

"Each night (they said) the Devil's art, Through Salem wood by devils drawn."-- I, whose heart beat against his heart From dark till dawn!--from dark till dawn!

He faced them in his fearless scorn (The sun was on him as he stood): "No purer is her babe unborn; I prove her sinless with my blood."

They spared the babe beneath my breast,-- They bound his hands,--they set me free,-- Hush, hush, my babe! hush, hush and rest; He died for thee!--he died for me!

They dragged him, bound, to Gallows Hill (I saw the flowers among the grass); The women came,--I hear them still,-- They held their babes to see him pass.

God curse them!--Nay,--Oh God forgive! He said it while their lips reviled; He kissed my lips,--he whispered: "Live! The father loves thee in the child."

Then earth and sky grew black,--I fell-- I lay as stone beside their stone. They did their work. They earned their Hell. I woke on Gallows Hill, alone.

Oh Christ who suffered, Christ who blessed, Shield him upon the gallows tree! O babe, his babe, beneath my breast, He died for thee!--he died for me!

EDNAH PROCTOR CLARKE.

The case of Giles Corey is one of the most tragic in all this hideous drama. When arrested and brought before the court, he refused to plead--"stood mute," as the law

termed it. The penalty for "standing mute," according to the English law of the time, was that the prisoner "be remanded to prison ... and there be laid on his back on the bare floor...; that there be placed upon his body as great a weight of iron as he can bear, and more," until death should ensue. This was the penalty Giles Corey suffered.

THE TRIAL

From "Giles Corey of the Salem Farms"

[September 7, 1692]

SCENE II.--_Interior of the Meeting-house._ MATHER _and the Magistrates seated in front of the pulpit. Before them a raised platform._ MARTHA _in chains_. COREY _near her_. MARY WALCOT _in a chair. A crowd of spectators, among them_ GLOYD. _Confusion and murmurs during the scene._

HATHORNE

CALL Martha Corey.

MARTHA

I am here.

HATHORNE

Come forward.

She ascends the platform.

The Jurors of our Sovereign Lord and Lady The King and Queen, here present, do accuse you Of having on the tenth of June last past, And divers other times before and after, Wickedly used and practised certain arts Called Witchcrafts, Sorceries, and Incantations, Against one Mary Walcot, single woman, Of Salem Village: by which wicked arts The aforesaid Mary Walcot was tormented, Tortured, afflicted, pined, consumed, and wasted, Against the peace of our Sovereign Lord and Lady The King and Queen, as well as of the Statute Made and provided in that case. What say you?

MARTHA

Before I answer, give me leave to pray.

HATHORNE

We have not sent for you, nor are we here, To hear you pray, but to examine you In whatsoever is alleged against you Why do you hurt this person?

MARTHA

I do not. I am not guilty of the charge against me.

MARY

Avoid, she-devil! You may torment me now! Avoid, avoid, Witch!

MARTHA

I am innocent. I never had to do with any Witchcraft Since I was born. I am a gospel woman.

MARY

You are a gospel Witch!

MARTHA (_clasping her hands_)

Ah me! ah me! Oh, give me leave to pray!

MARY (_stretching out her hands_)

She hurts me now. See, she has pinched my hands!

HATHORNE

Who made these marks Upon her hands?

MARTHA

I do not know. I stand Apart from her. I did not touch her hands.

HATHORNE

Who hurt her then?

MARTHA

I know not.

HATHORNE

Do you think She is bewitched?

MARTHA

Indeed I do not think so. I am no Witch, and have no faith in Witches.

HATHORNE

Then answer me: When certain persons came To see you yesterday, how did you know Beforehand why they came?

MARTHA

I had had speech; The children said I hurt them, and I thought These people came to question me about it.

HATHORNE

How did you know the children had been told To note the clothes you wore?

MARTHA

My husband told me What others said about it.

HATHORNE

Goodman Corey, Say, did you tell her?

COREY

I must speak the truth; I did not tell her. It was some one else.

HATHORNE

Did you not say your husband told you so? How dare you tell a lie in this assembly? Who told you of the clothes? Confess the truth.

MARTHA _bites her lips, and is silent_.

You bite your lips, but do not answer me!

MARY

Ah, she is biting me! Avoid, avoid!

HATHORNE

You said your husband told you.

MARTHA

Yes, he told me The children said I troubled them.

HATHORNE

Then tell me, Why do you trouble them?

MARTHA

I have denied it.

MARY

She threatened me; stabbed at me with her spindle; And, when my brother thrust her with his sword, He tore her gown, and cut a piece away. Here are they both, the spindle and the cloth.

Shows them.

HATHORNE

And there are persons here who know the truth Of what has now been said. What answer make you?

MARTHA

I make no answer. Give me leave to pray.

HATHORNE

Whom would you pray to?

MARTHA

To my God and Father.

HATHORNE

Who is your God and Father?

MARTHA

The Almighty!

HATHORNE

Doth he you pray to say that he is God? It is the Prince of Darkness, and not God.

MARY

There is a dark shape whispering in her ear.

HATHORNE

What does it say to you?

MARTHA

I see no shape.

HATHORNE

Did you not hear it whisper?

MARTHA

I heard nothing.

MARY

What torture! Ah, what agony I suffer!

Falls into a swoon.

HATHORNE

You see this woman cannot stand before you. If you would look for mercy, you must look In God's way, by confession of your guilt. Why does your spectre haunt and hurt this person?

MARTHA

I do not know. He who appeared of old In Samuel's shape, a saint and glorified, May come in whatsoever shape he chooses. I cannot help it. I am sick at heart!

COREY

O Martha, Martha! let me hold your hand.

HATHORNE

No; stand aside, old man.

MARY (_starting up_)

Look there! Look there! I see a little bird, a yellow bird, Perched on her finger; and it pecks at me. Ah, it will tear mine eyes out!

MARTHA

I see nothing.

HATHORNE

'Tis the Familiar Spirit that attends her.

MARY

Now it has flown away. It sits up there Upon the rafters. It is gone; is vanished.

MARTHA

Giles, wipe these tears of anger from mine eyes. Wipe the sweat from my forehead. I am faint.

She leans against the railing.

MARY

Oh, she is crushing me with all her weight!

HATHORNE

Did you not carry once the Devil's Book To this young woman?

MARTHA

Never.

HATHORNE

Have you signed it, Or touched it?

MARTHA

No; I never saw it.

HATHORNE

Did you not scourge her with an iron rod?

MARTHA

No, I did not. If any Evil Spirit Has taken my shape to do these evil deeds, I cannot help it. I am innocent.

HATHORNE

Did you not say the Magistrates were blind? That you would open their eyes?

MARTHA (_with a scornful laugh_)

Yes, I said that; If you call me a sorceress, you are blind! If you accuse the innocent, you are blind! Can the innocent be guilty?

HATHORNE

Did you not On one occasion hide your husband's saddle To hinder him from coming to the Sessions?

MARTHA

I thought it was a folly in a farmer To waste his time pursuing such illusions.

HATHORNE

What was the bird that this young woman saw Just now upon your hand?

MARTHA

I know no bird.

HATHORNE

Have you not dealt with a Familiar Spirit?

MARTHA

No, never, never!

HATHORNE

What then was the Book You showed to this young woman, and besought her To write in it?

MARTHA

Where should I have a book? I showed her none, nor have none.

MARY

The next Sabbath Is the Communion Day, but Martha Corey Will not be there!

MARTHA

Ah, you are all against me. What can I do or say?

HATHORNE

You can confess.

MARTHA

No, I cannot, for I am innocent.

HATHORNE

We have the proof of many witnesses That you are guilty.

MARTHA

Give me leave to speak. Will you condemn me on such evidence,-- You who have known me for so many years? Will you condemn me in this house of God, Where I so long have worshipped with you all? Where I have eaten the bread and drunk the wine So many times at our Lord's Table with you? Bear witness, you that hear me; you all know That I have led a blameless life among you, That never any whisper of suspicion Was breathed against me till this accusation. And shall this count for nothing? Will you take My life away from me, because this girl, Who is distraught, and not in her right mind, Accuses me of things I blush to name?

HATHORNE

What! is it not enough? Would you hear more? Giles Corey!

COREY

I am here.

HATHORNE

Come forward, then.

COREY _ascends the platform_.

Is it not true, that on a certain night You were impeded strangely in your prayers? That something hindered you? and that you left This woman here, your wife, kneeling

alone Upon the hearth?

COREY

Yes; I cannot deny it.

HATHORNE

Did you not say the Devil hindered you?

COREY

I think I said some words to that effect.

HATHORNE

Is it not true, that fourteen head of cattle, To you belonging, broke from their enclosure And leaped into the river, and were drowned?

COREY

It is most true.

HATHORNE

And did you not then say That they were overlooked?

COREY

So much I said. I see; they're drawing round me closer, closer, A net I cannot break, cannot escape from!

(_Aside._)

HATHORNE

Who did these things?

COREY

I do not know who did them.

HATHORNE

Then I will tell you. It is some one near you; You see her now; this woman, your own wife.

COREY

I call the heavens to witness, it is false! She never harmed me, never hindered me In anything but what I should not do. And I bear witness in the sight of heaven, And in God's house here, that I never knew her As otherwise than patient, brave, and true, Faithful, forgiving, full of charity, A virtuous and industrious and good wife!

HATHORNE

Tut, tut, man; do not rant so in your speech; You are a witness, not an advocate! Here, Sheriff, take this woman back to prison.

MARTHA

O Giles, this day you've sworn away my life!

MARY

Go, go and join the Witches at the door. Do you not hear the drum? Do you not see them? Go quick. They're waiting for you. You are late!

[_Exit_ MARTHA; COREY _following_.

COREY

The dream! the dream! the dream!

HATHORNE

What does he say? Giles Corey, go not hence. You are yourself Accused of Witchcraft and of Sorcery By many witnesses. Say, are you guilty?

COREY

I know my death is foreordained by you,-- Mine and my wife's. Therefore I will not answer.

During the rest of the scene he remains silent.

HATHORNE

Do you refuse to plead?--'Twere better for you To make confession, or to plead Not Guilty.-- Do you not hear me?--Answer, are you guilty? Do you not know a heavier doom awaits you, If you refuse to plead, than if found guilty? Where is John Gloyd?

GLOYD (_coming forward_)

Here am I.

HATHORNE

Tell the Court; Have you not seen the supernatural power Of this old man? Have you not seen him do Strange feats of strength?

GLOYD

I've seen him lead the field, On a hot day, in mowing, and against Us younger men; and I have wrestled with him. He threw me like a feather. I have seen him Lift up a barrel with his single hands, Which two strong men could hardly lift together, And, holding it above his head, drink from it.

HATHORNE

That is enough; we need not question further. What answer do you make to this, Giles Corey?

MARY

See there! See there!

HATHORNE

What is it? I see nothing.

MARY

Look! Look! It is the ghost of Robert Goodell, Whom fifteen years ago this man did murder By stamping on his body! In his shroud He comes here to bear witness to the crime! _The crowd shrinks back from_ COREY _in horror_.

HATHORNE

Ghosts of the dead and voices of the living Bear witness to your guilt, and you must die! It might have been an easier death. Your doom Will be on your own head, and not on ours. Twice more will you be questioned of these things; Twice more have room to plead or to confess. If you are contumacious to the Court, And if, when questioned, you refuse to answer, Then by the Statute you will be condemned To the _peine forte et dure_! To have your body Pressed by great weights until you shall be dead! And may the Lord have mercy on your soul!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

GILES COREY

[September 19, 1692]

Giles Corey was a Wizzard strong, A stubborn wretch was he; And fitt was he to hang on high Upon the Locust-tree.

So when before the magistrates For triall he did come, He would no true confession make, But was compleatlie dumbe.

"Giles Corey," said the Magistrate, "What hast thou heare to pleade To these that now accuse thy soule Of crimes and horrid deed?"

Giles Corey, he said not a worde, No single worde spoke he. "Giles Corey," saith the Magistrate, "We'll press it out of thee."

They got them then a heavy beam, They laid it on his breast; They loaded it with heavy stones, And hard upon him prest.

"More weight!" now said this wretched man; "More weight!" again he cried; And he did no confession make, But wickedly he dyed.

One of the most assiduous of the prosecutors had been John Hale, minister of the First Church at Beverly. In October the accusers "cried out" against his wife, who was widely known for generous and disinterested virtues. Hale knew the "innocence and piety of his wife, and stood between her and the storm he had helped to raise. The whole community became convinced that the accusers in crying out upon Mrs. Hale had perjured themselves, and from that moment their power was destroyed."

MISTRESS HALE OF BEVERLY

[October, 1692]

The roadside forests here and there were touched with tawny gold; The days were shortening, and at dusk the sea looked blue and cold; Through his long fields the minister paced, restless, up and down; Before, the land-locked harbor lay; behind, the little town.

No careless chant of harvester or fisherman awoke The silent air; no clanging hoof, no curling weft of smoke, Where late the blacksmith's anvil rang; all dumb as death,--and why? Why? echoed back the minister's chilled heart, for sole reply.

His wife was watching from the door; she came to meet him now A weary sadness in her voice, a care upon her brow. A vague, oppressive mystery, a hint of unknown fear, Hung hovering over every roof: it was the witchcraft year.

She laid her hand upon his arm, and looked into his face, And as he turned away she turned, beside him keeping pace: And, "Oh, my husband, let me speak!" said gentle Mistress Hale, "For truth is fallen in the street, and falsehoods vile prevail.

"The very air we breathe is thick with whisperings of hell; The foolish trust the quaking bog, where wise men sink as well, Who follow them: O husband mine, for love of me, beware Of touching slime that from the pit is oozing everywhere!

"The rulers and the ministers, tell me, what have they done, Through all the dreadful weeks since this dark inquest was begun, Save to encourage thoughtless

girls in their unhallowed ways, And bring to an untimely end many a good woman's days?

"Think of our neighbor, Goodwife Hoar; because she would not say She was in league with evil powers, she pines in jail to-day. Think of our trusty field-hand, Job,--a swaggerer, it is true,-- Boasting he feared no Devil, they have condemned him, too.

"And Bridget Bishop, when she lived yonder at Ryal-side, What if she kept a shovel-board, and trimmed with laces wide Her scarlet bodice: grant she was too frivolous and vain; How dared they take away the life they could not give again?

"Nor soberness availeth aught; for who hath suffered worse, Through persecutions undeserved, than good Rebecca Nurse? Forsaken of her kith and kin, alone in her despair, It almost seemed as if God's ear were closed against her prayer.

"They spare not even infancy: poor little Dorcas Good, The vagrant's child--but four years old!--who says that baby could To Satan sign her soul away condemns this business blind, As but the senseless babbling of a weak and wicked mind.

"Is it not like the ancient tale they tell of Phaeton, Whose ignorant hands were trusted with the horses of the sun? Our teachers now by witless youths are led on and beguiled: Woe to the land, the Scripture saith, whose ruler is a child!

"God grant this dismal day be short! Except help soon arrive, To ruin these deluded ones will our fair country drive. If I to-morrow were accused, what further could I plead Than those who died, whom neither judge nor minister would heed?

"I pray thee, husband, enter not their councils any more! My heart aches with forebodings! Do not leave me, I implore! Yet if to turn this curse aside my life might but avail, In Christ's name would I yield it up," said gentle Mistress Hale.

The minister of Beverly dreamed a strange dream that night: He dreamed the tide came up, blood-red, through inlet, cove, and bight, Till Salem village was submerged; until Bass River rose, A threatening crimson gulf, that yawned the hamlet to inclose.

It rushed in at the cottage-doors whence women fled and wept; Close to the little meeting-house with serpent curves it crept; The grave-mounds in the burying-ground were sunk beneath its flood; The doorstone of the parsonage was dashed with spray of blood.

And on the threshold, praying, knelt his dear and honored wife, As one who would that deluge stay at cost of her own life.-- "Oh, save her! save us, Christ!" the cry unlocked him from his dream, And at his casement in the east he saw the day-star gleam.

The minister that morning said, "Only this once I go, Beloved wife; I cannot tell if witches be or no. We on the judgment-throne have sat in place of God too long; I fear me much lest we have done His flock a grievous wrong:

"And this before my brethren will I testify to-day." Around him quiet wooded isles and placid waters lay, As unto Salem-Side he crossed. He reached the court-room small, Just as a shrill, unearthly shriek echoed from wall to wall.

"Woe! Mistress Hale tormenteth me! She came in like a bird, Perched on her husband's shoulder!" Then silence fell; no word Spake either judge or minister, while with profound amaze Each fixed upon the other's face his horror-stricken gaze.

But, while the accuser writhed in wild contortions on the floor, One rose and said, "Let all withdraw! the court is closed!" no more: For well the land knew Mistress Hale's rare loveliness and worth; Her virtues bloomed like flowers of heaven along the paths of earth.

The minister of Beverly went homeward riding fast; His wife shrank back from his strange look, affrighted and aghast. "Dear wife thou ailest! Shut thyself into thy room!" said he; "Whoever comes, the latch-string keep drawn in from all save me!"

Nor his life's treasure from close guard did he one moment lose, Until across the ferry came a messenger with news That the bewitched ones acted now vain mummeries of woe; The judges looked and wondered still, but all the accused let go.

The dark cloud rolled from off the land; the golden leaves dropped down Along the winding wood-paths of the little sea-side town: In Salem Village there was peace; with witchcraft-trials passed The nightmare-terror from the vexed New England air at last.

Again in natural tones men dared to laugh aloud and speak; From Naugus Head the fisher's shout rang back to Jeffrey's Creek; The phantom-soldiery withdrew, that haunted Gloucester shore; The teamster's voice through Wenham Woods broke into psalms once more.

The minister of Beverly thereafter sorely grieved That he had inquisition held with counsellors deceived; Forsaking love's unerring light and duty's solid ground, And groping in the shadowy void, where truth is never found.

Errors are almost trespasses; rarely indeed we know How our mistakes hurt other hearts, until some random blow Has well-nigh broken our own. Alas! regret could not restore To lonely hearths the presences that gladdened them before.

As with the grain our fathers sowed sprang up Old England's weeds, So to their lofty piety clung superstition's seeds. Though tares grow with it, wheat is wheat: by food from heaven we live: Yet whoso asks for daily bread must add, "Our sins forgive!"

Truth made transparent in a life, tried gold of character, Were Mistress Hale's, and this is all that history says of her; Their simple force, like sunlight, broke the hideous midnight spell, And sight restored again to eyes obscured by films of hell.

The minister's long fields are still with dews of summer wet; The roof that sheltered Mistress Hale tradition points to yet. Green be her memory ever kept all over Cape-Ann-Side, Whose unobtrusive excellence awed back delusion's tide!

LUCY LARCOM.

CHAPTER VIII

THE STRUGGLE FOR THE CONTINENT

While England was colonizing the Atlantic seaboard, France was firmly establishing herself to the north along the St. Lawrence. It was inevitable that war should follow; and as early as 1613 the English had destroyed the French settlements in Nova Scotia. The country had scarcely rallied from the blow, when it was torn asunder by the contest between Charles la Tour and the Chevalier D'Aulnay--a contest which, after twelve years, resulted in victory for the latter.

ST. JOHN

[April, 1647]

"To the winds give our banner! Bear homeward again!" Cried the Lord of Acadia, Cried Charles of Estienne! From the prow of his shallop He gazed, as the sun From its bed in the ocean, Streamed up the St. John.

O'er the blue western waters That shallop had passed, Where the mists of Penobscot Clung damp on her mast. St. Saviour had looked On the heretic sail, As the songs of the Huguenot Rose on the gale.

The pale, ghostly fathers Remembered her well, And had cursed her while passing, With taper and bell; But the men of Monhegan, Of Papists abhorred, Had welcomed and feasted The heretic Lord.

They had loaded his shallop With dun-fish and ball, With stores for his larder, And steel for his wall. Pemaquid, from her bastions And turrets of stone, Had welcomed his coming With banner and gun.

And the prayers of the elders Had followed his way, As homeward he glided, Down Pentecost Bay. Oh, well sped La Tour! For, in peril and pain, His lady kept watch, For his coming again.

O'er the Isle of the Pheasant The morning sun shone, On the plane-trees which shaded The shores of St. John. "Now, why from yon battlements Speaks not my love! Why waves there no banner My fortress above?"

Dark and wild, from his deck St. Estienne gazed about, On fire-wasted dwellings, And silent redoubt; From the low, shattered walls Which the flame had o'errun, There floated no banner, There thundered no gun!

But beneath the low arch Of its doorway there stood A pale priest of Rome, In his cloak and his hood. With the bound of a lion, La Tour sprang to land, On the throat of the Papist He fastened his hand.

"Speak, son of the Woman Of scarlet and sin! What wolf has been prowling My castle within?" From the grasp of the soldier The Jesuit broke, Half in scorn, half in sorrow, He smiled as he spoke:

"No wolf, Lord of Estienne, Has ravaged thy hall, But thy red-handed rival, With fire, steel, and ball! On an errand of mercy I hitherward came, While the walls of thy

castle Yet spouted with flame.

"Pentagoet's dark vessels Were moored in the bay, Grim sea-lions, roaring Aloud for their prey." "But what of my lady?" Cried Charles of Estienne. "On the shot-crumbled turret Thy lady was seen:

"Half-veiled in the smoke-cloud, Her hand grasped thy pennon, While her dark tresses swayed In the hot breath of cannon! But woe to the heretic, Evermore woe! When the son of the church And the cross is his foe!

"In the track of the shell, In the path of the ball, Pentagoet swept over The breach of the wall! Steel to steel, gun to gun, One moment,--and then Alone stood the victor, Alone with his men!

"Of its sturdy defenders, Thy lady alone Saw the cross-blazoned banner Float over St. John." "Let the dastard look to it!" Cried fiery Estienne, "Were D'Aulnay King Louis, I'd free her again!"

"Alas for thy lady! No service from thee Is needed by her Whom the Lord hath set free; Nine days, in stern silence, Her thraldom she bore, But the tenth morning came, And Death opened her door!"

As if suddenly smitten La Tour staggered back; His hand grasped his sword-hilt, His forehead grew black. He sprang on the deck Of his shallop again. "We cruise now for vengeance! Give away!" cried Estienne.

"Massachusetts shall hear Of the Huguenot's wrong, And from island and creekside Her fishers shall throng! Pentagoet shall rue What his Papists have done, When his palisades echo The Puritan's gun!"

Oh, the loveliest of heavens Hung tenderly o'er him, There were waves in the sunshine, And green isles before him; But a pale hand was beckoning The Huguenot on; And in blackness and ashes Behind was St. John!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The rivalry between the colonists for the fur trade grew steadily more bitter, and in 1690 (King William's War) Canada undertook the conquest of New York and destroyed a number of frontier towns. The English made some reprisals; Sir William Phips capturing Acadia and Major Peter Schuyler leading a raid into the country south of Montreal, where he defeated a considerable body of French and Indians under Valrennes, in a spirited fight at La Prairie.

THE BATTLE OF LA PRAIRIE

[1691]

That was a brave old epoch, Our age of chivalry, When the Briton met the Frenchman At the fight of La Prairie; And the manhood of New England, And the Netherlanders true And Mohawks sworn, gave battle To the Bourbon's lilied blue.

That was a brave old governor Who gathered his array, And stood to meet, he knew not what, On that alarming day. Eight hundred, amid rumors vast That filled the wild wood's gloom, With all New England's flower of youth, Fierce for New France's doom.

And the brave old half five hundred! Theirs should in truth be fame; Borne down the savage Richelieu, On what emprise they came! Your hearts are great enough, O few: Only your numbers fail,-- New France asks more for conquerors, All glorious though your tale.

It was a brave old battle That surged around the fort, When D'Hosta fell in charging, And 'twas deadly strife and short; When in the very quarters They contested face and hand, And many a goodly fellow Crimsoned yon La Prairie sand.

And those were brave old orders The colonel gave to meet That forest force with trees entrenched Opposing the retreat: "De Callière's strength's behind us, And in front your Richelieu; We must go straightforth at them; There is nothing else to do."

And then the brave old story comes, Of Schuyler and Valrennes, When "Fight" the British colonel called, Encouraging his men, "For the Protestant Religion And the honor of our King!"-- "Sir, I am here to answer you!" Valrennes cried, forthstepping.

Were not those brave old races? Well, here they still abide; And yours is one or other, And the second's at your side; So when you hear your brother say, "Some loyal deed I'll do," Like old Valrennes, be ready with "I'm here to answer you!"

WILLIAM DOUW SCHUYLER-LIGHTHALL.

Peace was declared in 1697, but hostilities began again five years later, and early in 1704 Vaudreuil, governor of Canada, dispatched a force of three hundred, under Hertel de Rouville, against Deerfield, on the northwestern frontier of Massachusetts. They reached their destination a little before daylight of February 29, and, finding the sentinels asleep and the snow drifted over the palisades, rushed the place, and carried it, with the exception of one block-house, which held out successfully.

THE SACK OF DEERFIELD

[February 29, 1704]

Of the onset, fear-inspiring, and the firing and the pillage Of our village, when De Rouville with his forces on us fell, When, ere dawning of the morning, with no death-portending warning, With no token shown or spoken, came the foeman, hear me tell.

High against the palisadoes, on the meadows, banks, and hill-sides, At the rill-sides, over fences, lay the lingering winter snow; And so high by tempest rifted, at our pickets it was drifted, That its frozen crust was chosen as a bridge to bear the foe.

We had set at night a sentry, lest an entry, while the sombre Heavy slumber was upon us, by the Frenchman should be made; But the faithless knave we posted, though of wakefulness he boasted, 'Stead of keeping watch was sleeping, and his

solemn trust betrayed.

Than our slumber none profounder; never sounder fell on sleeper, Never deeper sleep its shadow cast on dull and listless frames; But it fled before the crashing of the portals, and the flashing, And the soaring, and the roaring, and the crackling of the flames.

Fell the shining hatchets quickly 'mid the thickly crowded women, Growing dim in crimson currents from the pulses of the brain; Rained the balls from firelocks deadly, till the melted snow ran redly With the glowing torrent flowing from the bodies of the slain.

I, from pleasant dreams awaking at the breaking of my casement, With amazement saw the foemen enter quickly where I lay; Heard my wife and children's screaming, as the hatchets woke their dreaming, Heard their groaning and their moaning as their spirits passed away.

'Twas in vain I struggled madly as the sadly sounding pleading Of my bleeding, dying darlings fell upon my tortured ears; 'Twas in vain I wrestled, raging, fight against their numbers waging, Crowding round me there they bound me, while my manhood sank in tears.

At the spot to which they bore me, no one o'er me watched or warded; There unguarded, bound and shivering, on the snow I lay alone; Watching by the firelight ruddy, as the butchers dark and bloody, Slew the nearest friends and dearest to my memory ever known.

And it seemed, as rose the roaring blaze, up soaring, redly streaming O'er the gleaming snow around me through the shadows of the night, That the figures flitting fastly were the fiends at revels ghastly, Madly urging on the surging, seething billows of the fight.

Suddenly my gloom was lightened, hope was heightened, though the shrieking, Malice-wreaking, ruthless wretches death were scattering to and fro; For a knife lay there--I spied it, and a tomahawk beside it Glittering brightly, buried lightly, keen edge upward, in the snow.

Naught knew I how came they thither, nor from whither; naught to me then If the heathen dark, my captors, dropped those weapons there or no; Quickly drawn o'er axe-edge lightly, cords were cut that held me tightly, Then, with engines of my vengeance in my hands, I sought the foe.

Oh, what anger dark, consuming, fearful, glooming, looming horrid, Lit my forehead, draped my figure, leapt with fury from my glance; 'Midst the foemen rushing frantic, to their sight I seemed gigantic, Like the motion of the ocean, like a tempest my advance.

Stoutest of them all, one savage left the ravage round and faced me; Fury braced me, for I knew him--he my pleading wife had slain. Huge he was, and brave and brawny, but I met the slayer tawny, And with rigorous blow, and vigorous, clove his tufted skull in twain-- Madly dashing down the crashing bloody hatchet in his brain.

As I brained him rose their calling, "Lo! appalling from yon meadow The Monedo of the white man comes with vengeance in his train!" As they fled, my blows Titanic falling fast increased their panic, Till their shattered forces scattered widely o'er the snowy plain.

Stern De Rouville then their error, born of terror, soon dispersing, Loudly cursing them for folly, roused their pride with words of scorn; Peering cautiously they knew me, then by numbers overthrew me; Fettered surely, bound securely, there again I lay forlorn.

Well I knew their purpose horrid, on each forehead it was written-- Pride was smitten that their bravest had retreated at my ire; For the rest the captive's durance, but for me there was assurance Of the tortures known to martyrs--of the terrible death by fire.

Then I felt, though horror-stricken, pulses quicken as the swarthy Savage, or the savage Frenchman, fiercest of the cruel band, Darted in and out the shadows, through the shivered palisadoes, Death-blows dealing with unfeeling heart and never-sparing hand.

Soon the sense of horror left me, and bereft me of all feeling; Soon, revealing all my early golden moments, memory came; Showing how, when young and sprightly, with a footstep falling lightly, I had pondered as I wandered on the maid I loved to name.

Her, so young, so pure, so dove-like, that the love-like angels whom a Sweet aroma circles ever wheresoe'er they move their wings, Felt with her the air grow sweeter, felt with her their joy completer, Felt their gladness swell to madness, silent grow their silver strings.

Then I heard her voice's murmur breathing summer, while my spirit Leaned to hear it and to drink it like a draught of pleasant wine; Felt her head upon my shoulder drooping as my love I told her; Felt the utterly pleased flutter of her heart respond to mine.

Then I saw our darlings clearly that more nearly linked our gladness; Saw our sadness as a lost one sank from pain to happy rest; Mingled tears with hers and chid her, bade her by our love consider How our dearest now was nearest to the blessed Master's breast.

I had lost that wife so cherished, who had perished, passed from being, In my seeing--I, unable to protect her or defend; At that thought dispersed those fancies, born of woe-begotten trances, While unto me came the gloomy present hour my heart to rend.

For I heard the firelocks ringing fiercely flinging forth the whirring, Blood-preferring leaden bullets from a garrisoned abode; There it stood so grim and lonely, speaking of its tenants only, When the furious leaden couriers from its loopholes fastly rode.

And the seven who kept it stoutly, though devoutly triumph praying, Ceased not slaying, trusting somewhat to their firelocks and their wives; For while they the house were holding, balls the wives were quickly moulding-- Neither fearful, wild, nor tearful, toiling earnest for their lives.

Onward rushed each dusky leaguer, hot and eager, but the seven Rained the levin from their firelocks as the Pagans forward pressed; Melting at that murderous firing, back that baffled foe retiring, Left there lying, dead or dying, ten, their bravest and their best.

Rose the red sun, straightly throwing from his glowing disk his brightness On the whiteness of the snowdrifts and the ruins of the town-- On those houses well defended, where the foe in vain expended Ball and powder, standing prouder, smoke-begrimed and scarred and brown.

Not for us those rays shone fairly, tinting rarely dawning early With the pearly light and glistering of the March's snowy morn; Some were wounded, some were weary, some were sullen, all were dreary, As the sorrow of that morrow shed its cloud of woe forlorn.

Then we heard De Rouville's orders, "To the borders!" and the dismal, Dark abysmal fate before us opened widely as he spoke; But we heard a shout in distance--into fluttering existence, Brief but splendid, quickly ended, at the sound our hopes awoke.

'Twas our kinsmen armed and ready, sweeping steady to the nor'ward, Pressing forward fleet and fearless, though in scanty force they came-- Cried De Rouville, grimly speaking, "Is't our captives you are seeking? Well, with iron we environ them, and wall them round with flame.

"With the toil of blood we won them, we've undone them with our bravery; Off to slavery, then, we carry them or leave them lifeless here. Foul my shame so far to wander, and my soldiers' blood to squander 'Mid the slaughter free as water, should our prey escape us clear.

"Off, ye scum of peasants Saxon, and your backs on Frenchmen turning, To our burning, dauntless courage proper tribute promptly pay; Do you come to seize and beat us? Are you here to slay and eat us? If your meat be Gaul and Mohawk, we will starve you out to-day."

How my spirit raged to hear him, standing near him bound and helpless! Never whelpless tigress fiercer howled at slayer of her young, When secure behind his engines, he has baffled her of vengeance, Than did I there, forced to lie there while his bitter taunts he flung.

For I heard each leaden missile whirr and whistle from the trusty Firelock rusty, brought there after long-time absence from the strife, And was forced to stand in quiet, with my warm blood running riot, When for power to give an hour to battle I had bartered life.

All in vain they thus had striven; backward driven, beat and broken, Leaving token of their coming in the dead around the dell, They retreated--well it served us! their retreat from death preserved us, Though the order for our murder from the dark De Rouville fell.

As we left our homes in ashes, through the lashes of the sternest Welled the earnest tears of anguish for the dear ones passed away; Sick at heart and heavily loaded, though with cruel blows they goaded, Sorely cumbered, miles we numbered four alone that weary day.

They were tired themselves of tramping, for encamping they were ready, Ere the steady twilight newer pallor threw upon the snow; So they built them huts of branches, in the snow they scooped out trenches, Heaped up firing, then, retiring, let us sleep our sleep of woe.

By the wrist--and by no light hand--to the right hand of a painted, Murder-tainted, loathsome Pagan, with a jeer, I soon was tied; And the one to whom they bound me, 'mid the scoffs of those around me, Bowing to me, mocking, drew me down to slumber at his side.

As for me, be sure I slept not: slumber crept not on my senses; Less intense is lover's musing than a captive's bent on ways To escape from fearful thralling, and a death by fire appalling; So, unsleeping, I was keeping on the Northern Star my gaze.

There I lay--no muscle stirring, mind unerring, thought unswerving, Body nerving, till a death-like, breathless slumber fell around; Then my right hand cautious stealing, o'er my bed-mate's person feeling, Till each finger stooped to linger on the belt his waist that bound.

'Twas his knife--the handle clasping, firmly grasping, forth I drew it, Clinging to it firm, but softly, with a more than robber's art; As I drove it to its utter length of blade, I heard the flutter Of a snow-bird--ah! 'twas _no_ bird! 'twas the flutter of my heart.

Then I cut the cord that bound me, peered around me, rose uprightly, Stepped as lightly as a lover on his blessed bridal day; Swiftly as my need inclined me, kept the bright North Star behind me, And, ere dawning of the morning, I was twenty miles away.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

Under French officers and priests, the war continued to be conducted with a cruelty as aimless as it was brutal. Isolated hamlets were burned, and their inhabitants tortured or taken prisoners, only, for the most part, to be butchered on the way to Canada. On August 29, 1708, a party of French and Indians, under De Chaillons and the infamous De Rouville, surprised the town of Haverhill. Rushing upon it, as their custom was, just before daylight, they fired several houses, plundered others, and killed some thirty or forty of the inhabitants. The townspeople rallied, and after an hour's fighting drove away the assailants, killing nearly thirty, among them De Rouville himself.

PENTUCKET

[August 29, 1708]

How sweetly on the wood-girt town The mellow light of sunset shone! Each small, bright lake, whose waters still Mirror the forest and the hill, Reflected from its waveless breast The beauty of a cloudless west, Glorious as if a glimpse were given Within the western gates of heaven, Left, by the spirit of the star Of sunset's holy hour, ajar!

Beside the river's tranquil flood The dark and low-walled dwellings stood, Where many a rood of open land Stretched up and down on either hand, With corn-leaves waving freshly green The thick and blackened stumps between Behind, unbroken, deep and dread, The wild, untravelled forest spread, Back to those mountains, white and cold, Of which the Indian trapper told, Upon whose summits never yet Was mortal foot in safety set.

Quiet and calm without a fear Of danger darkly lurking near, The weary laborer left his plough, The milkmaid carolled by her cow; From cottage door and household hearth Rose songs of praise, or tones of mirth. At length the murmur died away, And silence on that village lay. --So slept Pompeii, tower and hall, Ere the quick earthquake swallowed all, Undreaming of the fiery fate Which made its dwellings desolate!

Hours passed away. By moonlight sped The Merrimac along his bed. Bathed in the pallid lustre, stood Dark cottage-wall and rock and wood, Silent, beneath that tranquil beam, As the hushed grouping of a dream. Yet on the still air crept a sound, No bark of fox, nor rabbit's bound, No stir of wings, nor waters flowing, Nor leaves in midnight breezes blowing.

Was that the tread of many feet, Which downward from the hillside beat? What forms were those which darkly stood Just on the margin of the wood? Charred tree-stumps in the moonlight dim, Or paling rude, or leafless limb? No,--through the trees fierce eyeballs glowed, Dark human forms in moonshine showed, Wild from their native wilderness, With painted limbs and battle-dress!

A yell the dead might wake to hear Swelled on the night air, far and clear; Then smote the Indian tomahawk On crashing door and shattering lock; Then rang the rifle-shot, and then The shrill death-scream of stricken men,-- Sank the red axe in woman's brain, And childhood's cry arose in vain. Bursting through roof and window came, Red, fast, and fierce, the kindled flame, And blended fire and moonlight glared On still dead men and scalp-knives bared.

The morning sun looked brightly through The river willows, wet with dew. No sound of combat filled the air, No shout was heard, nor gunshot there; Yet still the thick and sullen smoke From smouldering ruins slowly broke; And on the greensward many a stain, And, here and there, the mangled slain, Told how that midnight bolt had sped, Pentucket, on thy fated head!

Even now the villager can tell Where Rolfe beside his hearthstone fell, Still show the door of wasting oak, Through which the fatal death-stroke broke, And point the curious stranger where De Rouville's corse lay grim and bare; Whose hideous head, in death still feared, Bore not a trace of hair or beard; And still, within the churchyard ground, Heaves darkly up the ancient mound, Whose grass-grown surface overlies The victims of that sacrifice.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

Though the Peace of Utrecht (1714) closed the war, desultory raids continued. In April, 1725, John Lovewell, of Dunstable, with forty-six men, marched against the Indian town of Pigwacket, or Pequawket (now Fryeburg). On the morning of May 8 they were suddenly attacked by a large force of Indians who had formed an ambuscade. Twelve men fell at the first fire, among them Lovewell himself. The survivors fought against heavy odds until sunset, when the Indians drew off without having been able to scalp the dead. It was this battle, in its day "as famous in New England as was Chevy Chase on the Scottish border," which inspired the earliest military ballad, still extant, composed in America. Its author is unknown, but it was for many years "the best beloved song in all New England."

LOVEWELL'S FIGHT

[May 8, 1725]

Of worthy Captain Lovewell I purpose now to sing, How valiantly he served his country and his King; He and his valiant soldiers did range the woods full wide, And hardships they endured to quell the Indian's pride.

'Twas nigh unto Pigwacket, on the eighth day of May, They spied a rebel Indian soon after break of day; He on a bank was walking, upon a neck of land, Which leads into a pond as we're made to understand.

Our men resolv'd to have him, and travell'd two miles round, Until they met the Indian, who boldly stood his ground; Then spake up Captain Lovewell, "Take you good heed," says he, "This rogue is to decoy us, I very plainly see.

"The Indians lie in ambush, in some place nigh at hand, In order to surround us upon this neck of land; Therefore we'll march in order, and each man leave his pack That we may briskly fight them, when they make their attack."

They came unto this Indian, who did them thus defy, As soon as they came nigh him, two guns he did let fly, Which wounded Captain Lovewell, and likewise one man more, But when this rogue was running, they laid him in his gore.

Then having scalp'd the Indian, they went back to the spot Where they had laid their packs down, but there they found them not, For the Indians having spy'd them, when they them down did lay, Did seize them for their plunder, and carry them away.

These rebels lay in ambush, this very place hard by, So that an English soldier did one of them espy, And cried out, "Here's an Indian," with that they started out, As fiercely as old lions, and hideously did shout.

With that our valiant English all gave a loud huzza, To show the rebel Indians they fear'd them not a straw: So now the fight began, and as fiercely as could be, The Indians ran up to them, but soon were forced to flee.

Then spake up Captain Lovewell, when first the fight began: "Fight on, my valiant heroes! you see they fall like rain." For as we are inform'd, the Indians were so thick A man could scarcely fire a gun and not some of them hit.

Then did the rebels try their best our soldiers to surround, But they could not accomplish it, because there was a pond, To which our men retreated, and covered all the rear, The rogues were forc'd to face them, altho' they skulked for fear.

Two logs there were behind them that close together lay, Without being discovered, they could not get away; Therefore our valiant English they travell'd in a row, And at a handsome distance, as they were wont to go.

'Twas ten o'clock in the morning when first the fight begun, And fiercely did continue until the setting sun; Excepting that the Indians some hours before 'twas night Drew off into the bushes and ceas'd awhile to fight,

But soon again returned, in fierce and furious mood, Shouting as in the morning, but yet not half so loud; For as we are informed, so thick and fast they fell, Scarce twenty of their number at night did get home well.

And that our valiant English till midnight there did stay, To see whether the rebels would have another fray; But they no more returning, they made off towards their home, And brought away their wounded as far as they could come.

Of all our valiant English there were but thirty-four, And of the rebel Indians there were about fourscore. And sixteen of our English did safely home return, The rest were kill'd and wounded, for which we all must mourn.

Our worthy Captain Lovewell among them there did die, They killed Lieutenant Robbins, and wounded good young Frye, Who was our English Chaplain; he many Indians slew, And some of them he scalp'd when bullets round him flew.

Young Fullam, too, I'll mention, because he fought so well, Endeavoring to save a man, a sacrifice he fell: But yet our valiant Englishmen in fight were ne'er dismay'd, But still they kept their motion, and Wymans Captain made,

Who shot the old chief Paugus, which did the foe defeat, Then set his men in order, and brought off the retreat; And braving many dangers and hardships in the way, They safe arriv'd at Dunstable, the thirteenth day of May.

The story of Lovewell's fight is told in another ballad printed in Farmer and Moore's Historical Collections in 1824. It is an excellent example of ballad literature, describing the struggle in great detail and with unusual accuracy.

LOVEWELL'S FIGHT

[May 8, 1725]

What time the noble Lovewell came, With fifty men from Dunstable, The cruel Pequa'tt tribe to tame, With arms and bloodshed terrible,

Then did the crimson streams, that flowed, Seem like the waters of the brook, That brightly shine, that loudly dash Far down the cliffs of Agiochook.

With Lovewell brave, John Harwood came; From wife and babes 'twas hard to part, Young Harwood took her by the hand, And bound the weeper to his heart.

Repress that tear, my Mary, dear, Said Harwood to his loving wife, It tries me hard to leave thee here, And seek in distant woods the strife.

When gone, my Mary, think of me, And pray to God, that I may be, Such as one ought that lives for thee, And come at last in victory.

Thus left young Harwood babe and wife, With accent wild she bade adieu; It grieved those lovers much to part, So fond and fair, so kind and true.

Seth Wyman, who in Woburn lived (A marksman he of courage true), Shot the first Indian whom they saw, Sheer through his heart the bullet flew.

The savage had been seeking game, Two guns and eke a knife he bore, And two black ducks were in his hand, He shrieked, and fell, to rise no more.

Anon, there eighty Indians rose, Who'd hid themselves in ambush dread; Their knives they shook, their guns they aimed, The famous Paugus at their head.

Good heavens! they dance the Powow dance, What horrid yells the forest fill? The grim bear crouches in his den, The eagle seeks the distant hill.

What means this dance, this Powow dance? Stern Wyman said; with wonderous art, He crept full near, his rifle aimed, And shot the leader through the heart.

John Lovewell, captain of the band, His sword he waved, that glittered bright, For the last time he cheered his men, And led them onward to the fight.

Fight on, fight on, brave Lovewell said, Fight on, while heaven shall give you breath An Indian ball then pierced him through, And Lovewell closed his eyes in death.

John Harwood died all bathed in blood, When he had fought, till set of day; And many more we may not name, Fell in that bloody battle fray.

When news did come to Harwood's wife, That he with Lovewell fought and died, Far in the wilds had given his life, Nor more would in their home abide,

Such grief did seize upon her mind, Such sorrow filled her faithful breast; On earth, she ne'er found peace again, But followed Harwood to his rest.

'Twas Paugus led the Pequa'tt tribe;-- As runs the Fox, would Paugus run; As howls the wild wolf, would he howl, A large bear skin had Paugus on.

But Chamberlain, of Dunstable (One whom a savage ne'er shall slay), Met Paugus by the water side, And shot him dead upon that day.

Good heavens! Is this a time for pray'r? Is this a time to worship God? When Lovewell's men are dying fast, And Paugus' tribe hath felt the rod?

The Chaplain's name was Jonathan Frye; In Andover his father dwelt, And oft with Lovewell's men he'd prayed, Before the mortal wound he felt.

A man was he of comely form, Polished and brave, well learnt and kind; Old Harvard's learned halls he left, Far in the wilds a grave to find.

Ah! now his blood-red arm he lifts, His closing lids he tries to raise; And speak once more before he dies, In supplication and in praise.

He prays kind heaven to grant success, Brave Lovewell's men to guide and bless, And when they've shed their heart blood true, To raise them all to happiness.

Come hither, Farwell, said young Frye, You see that I'm about to die; Now for the love I bear to you, When cold in death my bones shall lie;

Go thou and see my parents dear, And tell them you stood by me here; Console them when they cry, Alas! And wipe away the falling tear.

Lieutenant Farwell took his hand, His arm around his neck he threw, And said, brave Chaplain, I could wish, That heaven had made me die for you.

The Chaplain on kind Farwell's breast, Bloody and languishing he fell; Nor after this said more, but this, "I love thee, soldier, fare thee well."

Ah! many a wife shall rend her hair, And many a child cry, "Wo is me!" When messengers the news shall bear, Of Lovewell's dear bought victory.

With footsteps slow shall travellers go, Where Lovewell's pond shines clear and bright, And mark the place, where those are laid, Who fell in Lovewell's bloody fight.

Old men shall shake their heads, and say, Sad was the hour and terrible, When Lovewell brave 'gainst Paugus went, With fifty men from Dunstable.

The fight near Lovewell's Pond was the ground of still another case of literary priority. Nearly a hundred years after its occurrence, on November 17, 1820, the Portland _Gazette_ printed the first poetical venture of a lad of thirteen years. It bore the title of "The Battle of Lovell's Pond." Its author was Henry Wadsworth Longfellow.

THE BATTLE OF LOVELL'S POND

[May 8, 1725]

Cold, cold is the north wind and rude is the blast That sweeps like a hurricane loudly and fast, As it moans through the tall waving pines lone and drear, Sighs a requiem sad o'er the warrior's bier.

The war-whoop is still, and the savage's yell Has sunk into silence along the wild dell; The din of the battle, the tumult, is o'er, And the war-clarion's voice is now heard no more.

The warriors that fought for their country, and bled, Have sunk to their rest; the damp earth is their bed; No stone tells the place where their ashes repose, Nor points out the spot from the graves of their foes.

They died in their glory, surrounded by fame, And Victory's loud trump their death did proclaim; They are dead; but they live in each Patriot's breast, And their names are engraven on honor's bright crest.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

The English gained a notable victory in the summer of 1745 when they captured the formidable fortress of Louisburg, which had been built by the French on the eastern coast of Cape Breton Island. News of the victory created the greatest joy throughout the colonies.

LOUISBURG

[June 17, 1745]

Neptune and Mars in Council sate To humble France's pride, Whose vain unbridled insolence All other Powers defied.

The gods having sat in deep debate Upon the puzzling theme, Broke up perplexed and both agreed Shirley should form the scheme.

Shirley, with Britain's glory fired, Heaven's favoring smile implored: "Let Louisburg return,"--he said, "Unto its ancient Lord."

At once the Camp and Fleet were filled With Britain's loyal sons, Whose hearts are filled with generous strife T' avenge their Country's wrongs.

With Liberty their breasts are filled, Fair Liberty's their shield; 'Tis Liberty their banner waves And hovers o'er their field.

Louis!--behold the unequal strife, Thy slaves in walls immured! While George's sons laugh at those walls-- Of victory assured.

One key to your oppressive pride Your Western Dunkirk's gone; So Pepperell and Warren bade And what they bade was done!

Forbear, proud Prince, your gasconades, Te Deums cease to sing,-- When Britains fight the _Grand Monarque_ Must yield to Britain's King.

BOSTON, December, 1745.

Louis XV felt the loss of Louisburg keenly, and in 1746, to avenge its fall, sent a strong fleet, under Admiral D'Anville, against Boston. The town was terror-stricken; but after many mishaps the fleet was finally dispersed by a great storm off Cape Sable, on October 15, 1746, and such of the ships as lived through it were forced to make their way back to France.

A BALLAD OF THE FRENCH FLEET

[October 15, 1746]

MR. THOMAS PRINCE, _loquitur_

A fleet with flags arrayed Sailed from the port of Brest, And the Admiral's ship displayed The signal: "Steer southwest." For this Admiral D'Anville Had sworn by cross and crown To ravage with fire and steel Our helpless Boston Town.

There were rumors in the street, In the houses there was fear Of the coming of the fleet, And the danger hovering near. And while from mouth to mouth Spread the tidings of dismay, I stood in the Old South, Saying humbly: "Let us pray!

"O Lord! we would not advise; But if in thy Providence A tempest should arise To drive the French Fleet hence, And scatter it far and wide, Or sink it in the sea, We should be satisfied, And thine the glory be."

This was the prayer I made, For my soul was all on flame, And even as I prayed The answering tempest came; It came with a mighty power, Shaking the windows and walls, And tolling the bell in the tower, As it tolls at funerals.

The lightning suddenly Unsheathed its flaming sword, And I cried: "Stand still, and see The salvation of the Lord!" The heavens were black with cloud, The sea was white with hail, And ever more fierce and loud Blew the October gale.

The fleet it overtook, And the broad sails in the van Like the tents of Cushan shook, Or the curtains of Midian. Down on the reeling decks Crashed the o'erwhelming seas; Ah, never were there wrecks So pitiful as these!

Like a potter's vessel broke The great ships of the line; They were carried away as a smoke, Or sank like lead in the brine. O Lord! before thy path They vanished and ceased to be, When thou didst walk in wrath With thine horses through the sea!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

Peace was made at Aix-la-Chapelle in 1748, but it was really only a truce. England and France could not be permanently at peace until one or the other was undisputed master of the North American continent. The French claimed all the country west of the Alleghanies and enforced their claims by building a string of forts, among them Fort Duquesne at the head of the Ohio. At last, in 1755, was "the British Lyon roused."

THE BRITISH LYON ROUSED

[1755]

Hail, great Apollo! guide my feeble pen, To rouse the august lion from his den, Exciting vengeance on the worst of men.

Rouse, _British Lion_, from thy soft repose, And take revenge upon the worst of foes, Who try to ring and hawl you by the nose.

They always did thy quiet breast annoy, Raising rebellion with the Rival boy, Seeking thy faith and interest to destroy.

Treaties and oaths they always did break thro', They never did nor would keep faith with you By popes and priests indulged so to do.

All neighboring powers and neutral standers by Look on our cause with an impartial eye, And see their falseness and their perfidy.

Their grand encroachments on us ne'er did cease. But by indulgence mightily increase, Killing and scalping us in times of peace.

They buy our scalps exciting savage clans, In children's blood for to imbue their hands, Assisted by their cruel Gallic bands.

Britains, strike home, strike home decisive blows Upon the heads of your perfidious foes, Who always truth and justice did oppose.

Go brave the ocean with your war-like ships, And speak your terror o'er the western deeps, And crush the squadrons of the Gallic fleets.

Cleave liquid mountains of the foaming flood, And tinge the billows with the Gallic blood, A faithful drubbing to their future good.

Bury their squadrons ill in watery tombs; And when the news unto Versailles it comes, Let Lewis swear by Gar and gnaw his thumbs.

Oh! ride triumphant o'er the Gallic powers, And conquer all these cursed foes of ours, And sweep the ocean with your iron showers.

While all the tribes in Neptune's spacious hall, Shall stand astonish'd at the cannon ball; To see such hail-stones down among them fall.

Some of their tribes perhaps are killed dead, And others in a vast amazement fled, While Neptune stands aghast and scratch's his head.

My roving muse the surface reach again, Search every part of the Atlantic plain, And see if any Gallics yet remain;

And if they do, let British cannon roar; And let thy thunders reach the western shore. While I shall strive to rouse her sons once more.

STEPHEN TILDEN.

Active hostilities began early in 1755. On February 20 General Edward Braddock landed at Hampton, Va., and proceeded at once to organize an expedition to march against Fort Duquesne. George Washington, who had already had some bitter experience with the French, was made one of his aides-de-camp. On May 29 the army, with an immense wagon train, began its long journey across the mountains.

THE SONG OF BRADDOCK'S MEN

[May 29, 1755]

To arms, to arms! my jolly grenadiers! Hark, how the drums do roll it along! To horse, to horse, with valiant good cheer; We'll meet our proud foe before it is long. Let not your courage fail you; Be valiant, stout and bold; And it will soon avail you,

My loyal hearts of gold. Huzzah, my valiant countrymen! again I say huzzah! 'Tis nobly done,--the day's our own,--huzzah, huzzah!

March on, march on, brave Braddock leads the foremost; The battle is begun as you may fairly see. Stand firm, be bold, and it will soon be over; We'll soon gain the field from our proud enemy. A squadron now appears, my boys; If that they do but stand! Boys, never fear, be sure you mind The word of command! Huzzah, my valiant countrymen! again I say huzzah! 'Tis nobly done,--the day's our own,--huzzah, huzzah!

See how, see how, they break and fly before us! See how they are scattered all over the plain! Now, now--now, now our country will adore us! In peace and in triumph, boys, when we return again! Then laurels shall our glory crown For all our actions told: The hills shall echo all around, My loyal hearts of gold. Huzzah, my valiant countrymen! again I say huzzah! 'Tis nobly done,--the day's our own,--huzzah, huzzah!

Braddock, with a picked force of about twelve hundred men, reached the Monongahela July 8 in excellent order, and, on the following morning, with colors flying and drums beating, marched against the fort. The French garrison, under Contrecoeur, was in a panic, and ready for flight, but a young captain of regulars named Beaujeu with difficulty obtained permission to take out a small party, mostly Indians, to harass the advancing column. They encountered the English about seven miles from the fort, marching in close order along a narrow road which the pioneers had made. The Indians opened fire, spreading along either flank, and protected by the underbrush. The English, crowded together in the open road, could not see their enemies, and were thrown into confusion. Braddock, wild with rage, refused to permit them to fight in Indian fashion, but beat them back into line with his sword. At last a bullet struck him down, and his troops fled in panic from the field.

BRADDOCK'S FATE, WITH AN INCITEMENT TO REVENGE

[July 9, 1755]

Come all ye sons of Brittany, Assist my muse in tragedy, And mourn brave Braddock's destiny, And spend a mournful day, Upon Monongahela fields, The mighty're fallen o'er their shields; And British blood bedews the hills Of western Gilboa.

July the ninth, oh! Fatal Day, They had a bold and bloody fray, Our host was smote with a dismay; Some basely did retire, And left brave Braddock in the field, Who had much rather die than yield, A while his sword he bravely wield In clouds of smoke and fire.

Some time he bravely stood his ground, A thousand foes did him surround, Till he received a mortal wound, Which forc'd him to retreat. He dy'd upon the thirteenth day, As he was home-ward on his way; Alas! alas! we all must say, A sore and sad defeat.

Now to his grave this hero's borne, While savage foes triumph and scorn, And drooping banners dress his urn, And guard him to his tomb. Heralds and monarchs of the dead, You that so many worms have fed, He's coming to your chilly bed, Edge close and give him room.

HIS EPITAPH

Beneath this stone brave Braddock lies, Who always hated cowardice, But fell a savage sacrifice Amidst his Indian foes. I charge you, heroes, of the ground, To guard his dark pavilion round, And keep off all obtruding sound, And cherish his repose.

Sleep, sleep, I say, brave valiant man, Bold death, at last, has bid thee stand And to resign thy great command, And cancel thy commission. Altho' thou didst not much incline Thy post and honors to resign; Now iron slumber doth confine; None envy's thy condition.

A SURVEY OF THE FIELD OF BATTLE

Return my muse unto the field, See what a prospect it doth yield; Ingrateful to the eyes and smell A carnage bath'd in gore, Lies scalp'd and mangled o'er the hills, While sanguine rivers fill the dales, And pale-fac'd horror spreads the fields, The like ne'er here before.

And must these sons of Brittany Be clouded, set in western skies, And fall a savage sacrifice? Oh! 'tis a gloomy hour! My blood boils high in every vein, To climb the mountains of the slain, And break the iron jaws in twain, Of savage Gallic power.

Our children with their mothers die, While they aloud for mercy cry; They kill, and scalp them instantly, Then fly into the woods, And make a mock of all their cries, And bring their scalps a sacrifice To their infernal deities, And praise their demon gods.

Revenge, revenge the harmless blood Which their inhuman dogs have shed In every frontier neighborhood, For near these hundred years. Their murdering clan in ambush lies, To kill and scalp them by surprize, And free from tender parents' eyes Ten hundred thousand tears.

Their sculking, scalping, murdering tricks Have so enraged old sixty-six, With legs and arms like withered sticks, And youthful vigor gone; That if he lives another year, Complete in armor he'll appear, And laugh at death and scoff at fear, To right his country's wrong.

Let young and old, both high and low, Arm well against this savage foe, Who all around inviron us so, The sons of black delusion. New England's sons you know their way, And how to cross them in their play, And drive these murdering dogs away, Unto their last confusion.

One bold effort, oh, let us make, And at one blow behead the snake, And then these savage powers will break, Which long have us oppress'd. And this, brave soldiers, will we do If Heaven and George shall say so too; And if we drive the matter thro', The land will be at rest.

Come every soldier charge your gun, And let your task be killing one; Take aim until the work is done; Don't throw away your fire, For he that fires without an aim, May kill his friend and be to blame, And in the end come off with shame, When forced to retire.

O mother land, we think we're sure, Sufficient is thy marine powers To dissipate all eastern showers: And if our arms be blest, Thy sons in _North America_ Will drive these hell-born dogs away As far beyond the realms of day, As east is from the west.

Forbear my muse thy barbarous song, Upon this theme thou'st dwelt too long, It is too high and much too strong, The learned won't allow. Much honor should accrue to him Who ne'er was at their Academ Come blot out every telesem; Get home unto thy plow.

STEPHEN TILDEN.

Composed August 20, 1755.

NED BRADDOCK

[July 9, 1755]

Said the Sword to the Ax, 'twixt the whacks and the hacks, "Who's your bold Berserker, cleaving of tracks? Hewing a highway through greenwood and glen, Foot-free for cattle and heart-free for men?" --"Braddock of Fontenoy, stubborn and grim, Carving a cross on the wilderness rim; In his own doom building large for the Lord, Steeple and State!" said the Ax to the Sword.

Said the Blade to the Ax, "And shall none say him Nay? Never a broadsword to bar him the way? Never a bush where a Huron may hide, Or the shot of a Shawnee spit red on his side?" --Down the long trail from the Fort to the ford, Naked and streaked, plunge a moccasin'd horde: Huron and Wyandot, hot for the bout; Shawnee and Ottawa, barring him out!

Red'ning the ridge, 'twixt a gorge and a gorge, Bold to the sky, loom the ranks of St. George; Braddock of Fontenoy, belted and horsed, For a foe to be struck and a pass to be forced. --'Twixt the pit and the crest, 'twixt the rocks and the grass, Where the bush hides the foe, and the foe holds the pass, Beaujeu and Pontiac, striving amain; Huron and Wyandot, jeering the slain!

Beaujeu, bon camarade! Beaujeu the Gay! Beaujeu and Death cast their blades in the fray. Never a rifle that spared when they spoke, Never a scalp-knife that balked in its stroke. Till the red hillocks marked where the standards had danced, And the Grenadiers gasped where their sabres had glanced. --But Braddock raged fierce in that storm by the ford, And railed at his "curs" with the flat of his sword!

Said the Sword to the Ax, "Where's your Berserker now? Lo! his bones mark a path for a countryman's cow. And Beaujeu the Gay? Give him place, right or wrong, In your tale of a camp, or your stave of a song." --"But Braddock of Fontenoy, stubborn and grim, Who but he carved a cross on the wilderness rim? In his own doom building large for the Lord, Steeple and State!" said the Ax to the Sword.

JOHN WILLIAMSON PALMER.

After Braddock's defeat, the Pennsylvania and Virginia frontiers were left, for a time, to the ravages of the Indians. The colonies were slow to defend themselves, and could get no aid whatever from England, who had her hands full elsewhere.

ODE TO THE INHABITANTS OF PENNSYLVANIA

[September 30, 1756]

Still shall the tyrant scourge of Gaul With wasteful rage resistless fall On Britain's slumbering race? Still shall she wave her bloody hand And threatening banners o'er this land, To Britain's fell disgrace?

And not one generous chieftain rise (Who dares the frown of war despise, And treacherous fear disclaim) His country's ruin to oppose, To hurl destruction on her foes, And blast their rising fame?

In Britain's cause, with valor fired, Braddock, unhappy chief! expired, And claim'd a nation's tear; Nor could Oswego's bulwarks stand The fury of a savage band, Though Schuyler's arm was there.

Still shall this motley, murderous crew Their deep, destructive arts pursue, And general horror spread? No--see Britannia's genius rise! Swift o'er the Atlantic foam she flies And lifts her laurell'd head!

Lo! streaming through the dear blue sky, Great Loudon's awful banners fly, In British pomp display'd! Soon shall the gallant chief advance; Before him shrink the sons of France, Confounded and dismay'd.

Then rise, illustrious Britons, rise! Great Freedom calls, pursue her voice, And save your country's shame! Let every hand for Britain arm'd, And every breast with virtue warm'd, Aspire at deathless fame!

But chief, let Pennsylvania wake, And on her foes let terrors shake, Their gloomy troops defy; For, lo! her smoking farms and plains, Her captured youths, and murder'd swains, For vengeance louder cry.

Why should we seek inglorious rest, Or sink, with thoughtless ease oppress'd, While war insults so near? While ruthless, fierce, athirst for blood, Bellona's sons, a desperate brood! In furious bands appear!

Rouse, rouse at once, and boldly chase From their deep haunts, the savage race, Till they confess you men. Let other Armstrongs grace the field! Let other slaves before them yield, And tremble round Duquesne.

And thou, our chief, and martial guide, Of worth approved, of valor tried In many a hard campaign, O Denny, warmed with British fire, Our inexperienced troops inspire, And conquest's laurels gain!

Pennsylvania Gazette, September 30, 1756.

Meanwhile things were in a troubled condition in Acadia, where the so-called "French neutrals" were discovered to be in arms against England. "Every resource of patience and persuasion" had been used to secure their loyalty to Great Britain, but in vain. At last it was decided to disperse them among the southern provinces, and the deportation began in October. At the end of two months, about six thousand of the Acadians had been sent away, and their homes destroyed.

THE EMBARKATION

From "Evangeline"

[October 8, 1755]

Four times the sun had risen and set; and now on the fifth day Cheerily called the cock to the sleeping maids of the farm-house. Soon o'er the yellow fields, in silent and mournful procession, Came from the neighboring hamlets and farms the Acadian women, Driving in ponderous wains their household goods to the sea-shore, Pausing and looking back to gaze once more on their dwellings, Ere they were shut from sight by the winding road and the woodland. Close at their sides their children ran, and urged on the oxen, While in their little hands they clasped some fragments of playthings.

Thus to the Gaspereau's mouth they hurried; and there on the sea-beach Piled in confusion lay the household goods of the peasants. All day long between the shore and the ships did the boats ply; All day long the wains came laboring down from the village. Late in the afternoon, when the sun was near to his setting, Echoed far o'er the fields came the roll of drums from the churchyard. Thither the women and children thronged. On a sudden the church-doors Opened, and forth came the guard, and marching in gloomy procession Followed the long-imprisoned, but patient, Acadian farmers. Even as pilgrims, who journey afar from their homes and their country, Sing as they go, and in singing forget they are weary and wayworn, So with songs on their lips the Acadian peasants descended Down from the church to the shore, amid their wives and their daughters. Foremost the young men came; and, raising together their voices, Sang with tremulous lips a chant of the Catholic Missions:-- "Sacred heart of the Saviour! O inexhaustible fountain! Fill our hearts this day with strength and submission and patience!" Then the old men, as they marched, and the women that stood by the wayside Joined in the sacred psalm, and the birds in the sunshine above them Mingled their notes therewith, like voices of spirits departed.

* * * * *

Thus to the Gaspereau's mouth moved on that mournful procession.

There disorder prevailed, and the tumult and stir of embarking. Busily plied the freighted boats; and in the confusion Wives were torn from their husbands, and mothers, too late, saw their children Left on the land, extending their arms, with wildest entreaties. So unto separate ships were Basil and Gabriel carried, While in despair on the shore Evangeline stood with her father. Half the task was not done

when the sun went down, and the twilight Deepened and darkened around; and in haste the refluent ocean Fled away from the shore, and left the line of the sand-beach Covered with waifs of the tide, with kelp and the slippery sea-weed. Farther back in the midst of the household goods and the wagons, Like to a gypsy camp, or a leaguer after a battle, All escape cut off by the sea, and the sentinels near them, Lay encamped for the night the houseless Acadian farmers. Back to its nethermost caves retreated the bellowing ocean, Dragging adown the beach the rattling pebbles, and leaving Inland and far up the shore the stranded boats of the sailors. Then, as the night descended, the herds returned from their pastures; Sweet was the moist still air with the odor of milk from their udders; Lowing they waited, and long, at the well-known bars of the farm-yard,-- Waited and looked in vain for the voice and the hand of the milk-maid. Silence reigned in the streets; from the church no Angelus sounded, Rose no smoke from the roofs, and gleamed no lights from the windows.

* * * * *

Suddenly rose from the south a light, as in autumn the blood-red Moon climbs the crystal walls of heaven, and o'er the horizon Titan-like stretches its hundred hands upon the mountain and meadow, Seizing the rocks and the rivers and piling huge shadows together. Broader and ever broader it gleamed on the roofs of the village, Gleamed on the sky and sea, and the ships that lay in the roadstead. Columns of shining smoke uprose, and flashes of flame were Thrust through their folds and withdrawn, like the quivering hands of a martyr. Then as the wind seized the gleeds and the burning thatch, and, uplifting, Whirled them aloft through the air, at once from a hundred house-tops Started the sheeted smoke with flashes of flame intermingled.

These things beheld in dismay the crowd on the shore and on shipboard. Speechless at first they stood, then cried aloud in their anguish, "We shall behold no more our homes in the village of Grand-Pré!" Loud on a sudden the cocks began to crow in the farm-yards, Thinking the day had dawned; and anon the lowing of cattle Came on the evening breeze, by the barking of dogs interrupted. Then rose a sound of dread, such as startles the sleeping encampments Far in the western prairies or forests that skirt the Nebraska, When the wild horses affrighted sweep by with the speed of the whirlwind, Or the loud bellowing herds of buffaloes rush to the river. Such was the sound that arose on the night, as the herds and the horses Broke through their folds and fences, and madly rushed o'er the meadows.

* * * * *

Lo! with a mournful sound, like the voice of a vast congregation, Solemnly answered the sea, and mingled its roar with the dirges. 'Twas the returning tide, that afar from the waste of the ocean, With the first dawn of the day, came heaving and hurrying landward. Then recommenced once more the stir and noise of embarking; And with the ebb of the tide the ships sailed out of the harbor, Leaving behind them the dead on the shore, and the village in ruins.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

In July, 1758, an army of fifteen thousand, under General James Abercromby and Brigadier Lord Howe, attempted to take Ticonderoga, where Montcalm was stationed at the head of about three thousand men. Lord Howe, the very life of the army, was killed in the first skirmish, and Abercromby handled the army so badly that it was repulsed with a loss of nearly two thousand, and fled in a panic. The French loss was less than four hundred, and the victory was hailed as one of the greatest ever achieved by French arms in America.

ON THE DEFEAT AT TICONDEROGA OR CARILONG

[July 8, 1758]

Neglected long had been my useless lyre, And heartfelt grief represt the poet's fire; But rous'd by dire alarms of wasting war, Again, O muse, the solemn dirge prepare, And join the widow's, orphan's, parent's tear. Unwept, unsung shall Britain's chiefs remain; Doomed in this stranger clime to bleed in vain: Here a last refuge hapless Braddock found, When the grim savage gave the deadly wound: Ah! hide Monongahel thy hateful head (Still as thy waves roll near the injur'd dead) On whose gore-moistened banks the num'rous slain, Now spring in vegetative life again, Whilst their wan ghosts as night's dark gloom prevail Murmur to whistling winds the mournful tale; Cease, cease, ye grisly forms, nor wail the past. Lo! a new scene of death exceeds the last; Th' empurpled fields of Carilong survey Rich with the spoils of one disastrous day! Bold to the charge the ready vet'ran stood And thrice repell'd, as oft the fight renewed, Till (life's warm current drain'd) they sunk in blood, Uncheck'd their ardor, unallay'd their fire, See Beaver, Proby, Rutherford, expire; Silent Britannia's tardy thunder lay While clouds of Gallick smoke obscur'd the day. Th' intrepid race nursed on the mountain's brow O'er-leap the mound, and dare th' astonish'd foe; Whilst Albion's sons (mow'd down in ranks) bemoan Their much lov'd country's wrongs nor feel their own; Cheerless they hear the drum discordant beat--And with slow motion sullenly retreat. But where wert thou, oh! first in martial fame, Whose early cares distinguish'd praises claim, Who ev'ry welcome toil didst gladly share And taught th' enervate warrior want to bear? Illustrious Howe! whose ev'ry deed confest The patriot wish that fill'd thy generous breast: Alas! too swift t' explore the hostile land, Thou dy'dst sad victim to an ambush band, Nor e'er this hour of wild confusion view'd Like Braddock, falling in the pathless wood; Still near the spot where thy pale corse is laid, May the fresh laurel spread its amplest shade; Still may thy name be utter'd with a sigh, And the big drops swell ev'ry grateful eye; Oh! would each leader who deplores thy fate Thy zeal and active virtues emulate, Soon should proud Carilong be humbled low Nor Montcalm's self, prevent th' avenging blow.

London Magazine, 1759.

But at last the tide turned. In 1757 William Pitt forced his way to the leadership of the government in England, and at once formed a comprehensive plan for a combined attack on the French forts in America. The first point of attack was Louisburg, which had been ceded back to France in 1748, and in the spring of 1758 a strong expedition under Lord Amherst was dispatched against it. The siege commenced June 8--the very

day of the disaster at Ticonderoga--and after a tremendous bombardment which destroyed the town and badly breached the fortress, the garrison, numbering nearly six thousand, surrendered July 26, 1758.

ON THE LATE SUCCESSFUL EXPEDITION AGAINST LOUISBOURG

[July 26, 1758]

At length 'tis done, the glorious conflict's done, And British valor hath the conquest won: Success our arms, our heroes, honor crowns, And Louisbourg an English monarch owns! Swift, to the scene where late the valiant fought, Waft me, ye muses, on the wings of thought-- That awful scene where the dread god of war O'er field of death roll'd his triumphant car: There yet, with fancy's eye, methinks I view The pressing throng, the fierce assault renew: With dauntless front advance, and boldly brave The cannon's thunder and th' expecting grave.

On yonder cliff, high hanging o'er the deep, Where trembling joy climbs the darksome steep; _Britannia_ lonely sitting, from afar Waits the event, and overlooks the war; Thence, rolls her eager wand'ring eyes about In all the dread anxiety of doubt; Sees her fierce sons, her foes with vengeance smite, Grasp deathless honors, and maintain the fight. Whilst thus her breast alternate passions sway, And hope and fear wear the slow hours away. See! from the realms of everlasting light, A radiant form wings her aerial flight. The palm she carries, and the crown she wears, Plainly denote 'tis _Victory_ appears; Her crimson vestment loosely flows behind, The clouds her chariot, and the wings her wind: Trumpets shrill sounding all around her play, And laurell'd honors gild her azure way-- Now she alights--the trumpets cease to sound, Her presence spreads expecting silence round:-- And thus she speaks; whilst from her heav'nly face Effulgent glories brighten all the place--

"Britannia, hail! thine is at length the day, And lasting triumphs shall thy cares repay; Thy godlike sons, by _this_, their names shall raise, And tongues remote shall joy to swell their praise. I to the list'ning world shall soon proclaim Of _Wolfe's_ brave deeds, the never-dying fame, And swell with glory Amherst's patriot name. Such are the heroes that shall ever bring Wealth to their country, honor to their king: Opposing foes, in vain attempt to quell The native fires that in such bosoms dwell. To thee, with joy, this laurel I resign, Smile, smile, _Britannia_! victory is thine. Long may it flourish on thy sacred brow! Long may thy foes a forc'd subjection know! See, see their pow'r, their boasted pow'r decline! Rejoice, _Britannia_! victory is thine."

Give your loose canvas to the breezes free, Ye floating thund'rers, bulwarks of the sea: Go, bear the joyful tidings to your king, And, in the voice of war, declare 'tis victory you bring: Let the wild crowd that catch the breath of fame, In mad huzzas their ruder joy proclaim: Let their loud thanks to heav'n in flames ascend, While mingling shouts the azure concave rend. But let the few, whom reason makes more wise, With glowing gratitude uplift their eyes: Oh! let their breasts dilate with sober joy. Let pious praise their hearts and tongues employ; To bless our _God_ with me let all unite, _He_ guides the conq'ring sword, _he_ governs in the fight.

FRANCIS HOPKINSON.

The fall of Louisburg was followed a few months later by the capture of Fort Duquesne (November 25, 1758), by General John Forbes. Forbes, at the head of an excellent army, had proceeded slowly and carefully. As the English approached, the French realized that to remain was simply to be captured, so they deserted the hopeless post, and Forbes marched in unmolested. He named his conquest Fort Pitt, after the great minister.

FORT DUQUESNE

A HISTORICAL CENTENNIAL BALLAD

[November 25, 1758-1858]

I

Come, fill the beaker, while we chaunt a pean of old days: By Mars! no men shall live again more worthy of our praise, Than they who stormed at Louisburg and Frontenac amain, And shook the English standard out o'er the ruins of Duquesne.

For glorious were the days they came, the soldiers strong and true, And glorious were the days, they came for Pennsylvania, too; When marched the troopers sternly on through forest's autumn brown, And where St. George's cross was raised, the oriflame went down.

Virginia sent her chivalry and Maryland her brave, And Pennsylvania to the cause her noblest yeomen gave: Oh, and proud were they who wore the garb of Indian hunters then, For every sturdy youth was worth a score of common men!

They came from Carolina's pines, from fruitful Delaware-- The staunchest and the stoutest of the chivalrous were there; And calm and tall above them all, i' the red November sun, Like Saul above his brethren, rode Colonel Washington.

O'er leagues of wild and waste they passed, they forded stream and fen, Where danger lurked in every glade, and death in every glen; They heard the Indian ranger's cry, the Frenchman's far-off hail, From purple distance echoed back through the hollows of the vale.

And ever and anon they came, along their dangerous way, Where, ghastly, 'mid the yellow leaves, their slaughtered comrades lay; The tartans of Grant's Highlanders were sodden yet and red, As routed in the rash assault, they perished as they fled.

--Ah! many a lass ayont the Tweed shall rue the fatal fray, And high Virginian dames shall mourn the ruin of that day, When gallant lad and cavalier i' the wilderness were slain, 'Twixt laurelled Loyalhanna and the outposts of Duquesne.

And there before them was the field of massacre and blood, Of panic, rout and shameful flight, in that disastrous wood Where Halket fell and Braddock died, with many a noble one Whose white bones glistened through the leaves i' the pale

November sun.

Then spoke the men of Braddock's Field, and hung their heads in shame, For England's tarnished honor and for England's sullied fame; "And, by St. George!" the soldiers swore, "we'll wipe away the stain Before to-morrow's sunset, at the trenches of Duquesne."

II

'Twas night along the autumn hills, the sun's November gleam Had left its crimson on the leaves, its tinge upon the stream; And Hermit Silence kept his watch 'mid ancient rocks and trees, And placed his finger on the lip of babbling brook and breeze.

The bivouac's set by Turtle Creek; and while the soldiers sleep, The swarthy chiefs around the fires an anxious council keep; Some spoke of murmurs in the camp, scarce whispered to the air, But tokens of discouragement, the presage of despair.

Some a retreat advised; 'twas late; the winter drawing on; The forage and provision, too,--so Ormsby said,--were gone. Men could not feed on air and fight; whatever Pitt might say; In praise or censure, still, they thought, 'twere wiser to delay.

Then up spoke iron-headed Forbes, and through his feeble frame There ran the lightning of a will that put them all to shame! "I'll hear no more," he roundly swore; "we'll storm the fort amain! I'll sleep in hell to-morrow night, or sleep in Fort Duquesne!"

So said: and each to sleep addressed his wearied limbs and mind, And all was hushed i' the forest, save the sobbing of the wind, And the tramp, tramp, tramp of the sentinel, who started oft in fright At the shadows wrought 'mid the giant trees by the fitful camp-fire light.

Good Lord! what sudden glare is that that reddens all the sky, As though hell's legions rode the air and tossed their torches high! Up, men! the alarm drum beats to arms! and the solid ground seems riven By the shock of warring thunderbolts in the lurid depth of heaven!

O there was clattering of steel, and mustering in array, And shouts and wild huzzas of men, impatient of delay, As came the scouts swift-footed in--"They fly! the foe! they fly! They've fired the powder magazine and blown it to the sky!"

III

Now morning o'er the frosty hills in autumn splendor came, And touched the rolling mists with gold, and flecked the clouds with flame; And through the brown woods on the hills--those altars of the world-- The blue smoke from the settler's hut and Indian's wigwam curled.

Yet never, here, had morning dawned on such a glorious din Of twanging trump, and rattling drum, and clanging culverin, And glittering arms and sabre gleams and

serried ranks of men, Who marched with banners high advanced along the river glen.

Oh, and royally they bore themselves who knew that o'er the seas Would speed the glorious tidings from the loyal colonies, Of the fall of French dominion with the fall of Fort Duquesne, And the triumph of the English arms from Erie to Champlain.

Before high noon they halted; and while they stood at rest, They saw, unfolded gloriously, the "Gateway of the West," There flashed the Allegheny, like a scimetar of gold, And king-like in its majesty, Monongahela rolled.

Beyond, the River Beautiful swept down the woody vales, Where Commerce, ere a century passed, should spread her thousand sails; Between the hazy hills they saw Contrecoeur's armed batteaux, And the flying, flashing, feathery oars of the Ottawa's canoes.

Then, on from rank to rank of men, a shout of triumph ran, And while the cannon thundered, the leader of the van, The tall Virginian, mounted on the walls that smouldered yet, And shook the English standard out, and named the place Fort Pitt.

Again with wild huzzas the hills and river valleys ring, And they swing their loyal caps in air, and shout--"Long live the King! Long life unto King George!" they cry, "and glorious be the reign That adds to English statesmen Pitt, to English arms Duquesne!"

FLORUS B. PLIMPTON.

Pitt determined to strike a blow at the very centre of French power, and on June 26, 1759, an English fleet of twenty-two ships of the line, with frigates, sloops-of-war, and transports carrying nine thousand regulars, appeared before Quebec. In command of this great expedition was Major-General James Wolfe, who had played so dashing a part in the capture of Louisburg the year before, and was soon to win immortal glory.

HOT STUFF

[June, 1759]

Come, each death-doing dog who dares venture his neck, Come, follow the hero that goes to Quebec; Jump aboard of the transports, and loose every sail, Pay your debts at the tavern by giving leg-bail; And ye that love fighting shall soon have enough: Wolfe commands us, my boys; we shall give them Hot Stuff.

Up the River St. Lawrence our troops shall advance, To the Grenadiers' March we will teach them to dance. Cape Breton we have taken, and next we will try At their capital to give them another black eye. Vaudreuil, 'tis in vain you pretend to look gruff,-- Those are coming who know how to give you Hot Stuff.

With powder in his periwig, and snuff in his nose, Monsieur will run down our descent to oppose; And the Indians will come: but the light infantry Will soon oblige _them_ to betake to a tree. From such rascals as these may we fear a rebuff? Advance, grenadiers, and let fly your Hot Stuff!

When the forty-seventh regiment is dashing ashore, While bullets are whistling and cannon do roar, Says Montcalm: "Those are Shirley's--I know the lappels." "You lie," says Ned Botwood, "we belong to Lascelles'! Tho' our clothing is changed, yet we scorn a powder-puff; So at you, ye bitches, here's give you Hot Stuff."

EDWARD BOTWOOD.

About the end of August a place was found where the heights might be scaled, and an assault was ordered for the night of Wednesday, September 12. The night arrived; every preparation had been made and every order given; it only remained to wait the turning of the tide. Wolfe was on board the flagship Sutherland, and to while away the hours of waiting he is said to have written the little song, "How Stands the Glass Around?"

HOW STANDS THE GLASS AROUND?

[September 12, 1759]

How stands the glass around? For shame ye take no care, my boys, How stands the glass around? Let mirth and wine abound, The trumpets sound, The colors they are flying, boys, To fight, kill, or wound, May we still be found Content with our hard fate, my boys, On the cold ground.

Why, soldiers, why, Should we be melancholy, boys? Why, soldiers, why? Whose business 'tis to die! What, sighing? fie! Don't fear, drink on, be jolly, boys! 'Tis he, you or I! Cold, hot, wet or dry, We're always bound to follow, boys, And scorn to fly!

'Tis but in vain,-- I mean not to upbraid you, boys,-- 'Tis but in vain, For soldiers to complain: Should next campaign Send us to him who made us, boys, We're free from pain! But if we remain, A bottle and a kind landlady Cure all again.

JAMES WOLFE.

Montcalm, riding out from Quebec early in the morning of Thursday, September 13, 1759, found the English drawn up in line of battle on the Plains of Abraham--they had scaled the cliffs in safety. He attacked about ten o'clock, but his troops were repulsed at the second volley and fled in confusion back to the fort. Wolfe was killed in the charge which followed, and Montcalm was fatally wounded and died that night. The French were demoralized; a council was called and the incredible resolution reached to abandon the fort without further resistance. The retreat commenced at once, and Quebec was left to its fate. It was never again to pass into the hands of France.

BRAVE WOLFE

[September 13, 1759]

Cheer up, my young men all, Let nothing fright you; Though oft objections rise, Let it delight you.

Let not your fancy move Whene'er it comes to trial; Nor let your courage fail At the first denial.

I sat down by my love, Thinking that I woo'd her; I sat down by my love, But sure not to delude her.

But when I got to speak, My tongue it doth so quiver, I dare not speak my mind, Whenever I am with her.

Love, here's a ring of gold, 'Tis long that I have kept it, My dear, now for my sake, I pray you to accept it.

When you the posy read, Pray think upon the giver, My dear, remember me, Or I'm undone forever.

Then Wolfe he took his leave, Of his most lovely jewel; Although it seemed to be To him, an act most cruel.

Although it's for a space I'm forced to leave my love, My dear, where'er I rove, I'll ne'er forget my dove.

So then this valiant youth Embarked on the ocean, To free America From faction's dire commotion.

He landed at Quebec, Being all brave and hearty; The city to attack, With his most gallant party.

Then Wolfe drew up his men, In rank and file so pretty, On Abraham's lofty heights, Before this noble city.

A distance from the town The noble French did meet them, In double numbers there, Resolved for to beat them.

A Parley: WOLFE _and_ MONTCALM _together_

Montcalm and this brave youth, Together they are walking; So well they do agree, Like brothers they are talking.

Then each one to his post, As they do now retire; Oh, then their numerous hosts Began their dreadful fire.

Then instant from his horse, Fell this most noble hero, May we lament his loss In words of deepest sorrow.

The French are seen to break, Their columns all are flying; Then Wolfe he seems to wake, Though in the act of dying.

And lifting up his head (The drums and trumpets rattle), And to his army said, "I pray how goes the battle?"

His aide-de-camp replied, "Brave general, 'tis in our favor, Quebec and all her pride, 'Tis nothing now can save her.

"She falls into our hands, With all her wealth and treasure." "O then," brave Wolfe replied, "I quit the world with pleasure."

Wolfe's death almost overshadowed the victory. Major Knox, in his diary, writes, "our joy at this success is inexpressibly damped by the loss we sustained of one of the greatest heroes which this or any other age can boast of."

THE DEATH OF WOLFE

[September 13, 1759]

Thy merits, Wolfe, transcend all human praise, The breathing marble or the muses' lays. Art is but vain--the force of language weak, To paint thy virtues, or thy actions speak. Had I Duché's or Godfrey's magic skill, Each line to raise, and animate at will-- To rouse each passion dormant in the soul, Point out its object, or its rage control-- Then, Wolfe, some faint resemblance should we find Of those great virtues that adorned thy mind. Like Britain's genius shouldst thou then appear, Hurling destruction on the Gallic rear-- While France, astonished, trembled at thy sight, And placed her safety in ignoble flight. Thy last great scene should melt each Briton's heart, And rage and grief alternately impart. With foes surrounded, midst the shades of death, These were the words that closed the warrior's breath-- "My eyesight fails!--but does the foe retreat? If they retire, I'm happy in my fate!" A generous chief, to whom the hero spoke, Cried, "Sir, they fly!--their ranks entirely broke: Whilst thy bold troops o'er slaughtered heaps advance, And deal due vengeance on the sons of France." The pleasing truth recalls his parting soul, And from his lips these dying accents stole:-- "I'm satisfied!" he said, then wing'd his way, Guarded by angels to celestial day. An awful band!--Britannia's mighty dead, Receives to glory his immortal shade. Marlborough and Talbot hail the warlike chief-- Halket and Howe, late objects of our grief, With joyful song conduct their welcome guest To the bright mansions of eternal rest-- For those prepared who merit just applause By bravely dying in their country's cause.

Pennsylvania Gazette, November 8, 1759.

The fall of Quebec settled the fate of Canada. On September 8, 1760, Vaudreuil surrendered Montreal to a great besieging force under Amherst. By the terms of the capitulation, Canada and all its dependencies passed to the British crown. The fight for the continent was ended. Indian hostilities continued for some years, and it was not until October, 1764, that peace was made with them. One of its conditions was the return of all captives taken by the Indians, and they were assembled at Carlisle, Pa., December 31, 1764. It was there the incident took place which is related in the following verses.

THE CAPTIVE'S HYMN

(Carlisle, Pa., December 31, 1764)

The Indian war was over, And Pennsylvania's towns Welcomed the blessed calm that comes When peace a conflict crowns. Bitter and long had been the strife, But gallant Colonel Bouquet Had forced the foe to sue for grace, And named the joyful day When Shawnees, Tuscarawas, Miamis, Delawares, And every band that roved the land And called a captive theirs-- From the pathless depths of the forest, By stream and dark defile, Should bring their prisoners, on their lives, In safety to Carlisle; Carlisle in the Cumberland valley, Where Conodogwinnet flows, And the guardian ranges, north and south, In mountain pride repose.

Like the wind the Colonel's order To hamlet and clearing flew; And mourning mothers and wives and sons From banks where Delaware seaward runs, From Erie's wave, and Ohio's tide, And the vales where the southern hills divide, Flocked to the town, perchance to view, At last, 'mid the crowds by the startled square, The faces lost, but in memory fair.

How strange the scene on the village green That morning cold and gray! To right the Indian tents were set, And in groups the dusky warriors met, While their captives clung to the captors yet, As wild and bronzed as they-- In rags and skins, with moccasined feet, Some loath to part, some fain to greet The friends of a vanished day; And, eagerly watching the tents, to left Stood mothers and sons and wives bereft, While, beyond, were the throngs from hill and valley, And, waiting the keen-eyed Colonel's rally, The troops in their brave array.

Now friends and captives mingle, And cries of joy or woe Thrill the broad street as loved ones meet, Or in vain the tale of the past repeat, And back in anguish go. Among them lingered a widow-- From the Suabian land was she-- And one fell morning she had lost Husband and children three, All slain save the young Regina, A captive spared to be. Nine weary years had followed, But the wilderness was dumb, And never a word to her aching heart Through friend or foe had come, And now, from Tulpehocken, Full seventy miles away, She had walked to seek her daughter, The Lord her only stay.

She scanned the sun-browned maidens; But the tunic's rough disguise, The savage tongue, the forest ways, Baffled and mocked her yearning gaze, And with sobs and streaming eyes She turned to the Colonel and told him How hopeless was her quest-- Moaning, "Alas, Regina! The grave for me is best!" "Nay, Madam," gently he replied, "Don't be disheartened yet, but bide, And try some other test. What pleasant song or story Did she love from your lips to hear?" "O Sir, I taught her 'Our Father;' And the 'Creed' we hold so dear, And she said them over and over While I was spinning near; And every eve, by her little bed, When the light was growing dim, I sung her to sleep, my darling! With Schmolke's beautiful hymn." "Then sing it _now_," said the Colonel, And close to the captive band He brought the mother with her hymn From the far Suabian land; And with faltering voice and quivering lips, While all was hushed, she sung The strain of lofty faith and cheer In her rich German tongue:

"Allein, und doch nicht ganz allein" (How near the listeners press!), Alone, yet not alone am I, Though all may deem my days go by In utter dreariness; The Lord is still my company, I am with Him, and He with me, The solitude to bless.

He speaks to me within His word As if His very voice I heard, And when I pray, apart, He meets me in the quiet there With counsel for each cross and care, And comfort for my heart.

The world may say my life is lone, With every joy and blessing flown Its vision can descry; I shall not sorrow nor repine, For glorious company is mine With God and angels nigh.

As she sung, a maid of the captives Threw back her tangled hair, And forward leaned as if to list The lightest murmur there; Her breath came fast, her brown cheek

flushed, Her eyes grew bright and wide As if some spell the song had cast, And, ere the low notes died, With a bound like a deer in the forest She sprang to the singer's side, And, "Liebe, kleine Mutter!" Enfolding her, she cried-- "My dear, dear, little Mother!"-- Then swift before her knelt As in the long, long buried days When by the wood they dwelt; And, "Vater unser, der du bist Im Himmel," chanted she, The sweet "Our Father" she had learned Beside that mother's knee; And then the grand "Apostles' Creed" That in her heart had lain: "Ich glaube an Gott den Vater," Like a child she said again-- "I believe in God the Father"-- Down to the blest "Amen." Stooping and clasping the maiden Whose soul the song had freed, "Now God be praised!" said the mother, "This is my child indeed!-- My own, my darling Regina, Come back in my sorest need, For she knows the Hymn, and 'Our Father,' And the holy 'Apostles' Creed'!" Then, while the throng was silent, And the Colonel bowed his head, With tears and glad thanksgivings Her daughter forth she led; And the sky was lit with sunshine, And the cold earth caught its smile For the mother and ransomed maiden, That morning in Carlisle.

EDNA DEAN PROCTOR.

A PROPHECY

[1764]

Ere five score years have run their tedious rounds,-- If yet Oppression breaks o'er human bounds, As it has done the last sad passing year, Made the New World in anger shed the tear,-- Unmindful of their native, once-loved isle, They'll bid Allegiance cease her peaceful smile, While from their arms they tear Oppression's chain, And make lost Liberty once more to reign. But let them live, as they would choose to be, Loyal to King, and as true Britons free, They'll ne'er by fell revolt oppose that crown Which first has raised them, though now pulls them down; If but the rights of subjects they receive, 'Tis all they ask--or all a crown can give.

ARTHUR LEE (?).

PART II

THE REVOLUTION

FLAWLESS HIS HEART

Flawless his heart and tempered to the core Who, beckoned by the forward-leaning wave, First left behind him the firm-footed shore, And, urged by every nerve of sail and oar, Steered for the Unknown which gods to mortals gave, Of thought and action the mysterious door, Bugbear of fools, a summons to the brave: Strength found he in the unsympathizing sun, And strange stars from beneath the horizon won, And the dumb ocean pitilessly grave: High-hearted surely he; But bolder they who first off-cast Their moorings from the habitable Past And ventured chartless on the sea Of storm-engendering Liberty: For all earth's width of waters is a span, And their

convulsed existence mere repose, Matched with the unstable heart of man, Shoreless in wants, mist-girt in all it knows, Open to every wind of sect or clan, And sudden-passionate in ebbs and flows.

JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL.

CHAPTER I

THE COMING OF DISCONTENT

The close of the struggle with the French for the possession of the continent may be fairly said to mark the beginning of that series of aggressions on the part of England which ended in the revolt of her colonies. True there had been before that arbitrary and tyrannical royal governors, and absurdly perverse enactments on the part of the Lords of Trade; but not until the French troubles had been disposed of did the British government bend its energies seriously to regulating the affairs of a people which it considered fractious and turbulent. In the _Virginia Gazette_ for May 2, 1766, appeared one of the first of those songs, afterwards so numerous, which expressed the discontent of the colonies under this régime.

THE VIRGINIA SONG

[May 2, 1766]

Sure never was picture drawn more to the life, Or affectionate husband more fond of his wife, Than America copies and loves Britain's sons, Who, conscious of Freedom, are bold as great guns, "Hearts of Oak are we still, for we're sons of those men Who always are ready, steady, boys, steady, To fight for their freedom again and again."

Tho' we feast and grow fat on America's soil, Yet we own ourselves subjects of Britain's fair isle; And who's so absurd to deny us the name, Since true British blood flows in every vein? "Hearts of Oak," etc.

Then cheer up, my lads, to your country be firm, Like kings of the ocean, we'll weather each storm; Integrity calls out, fair liberty, see, Waves her Flag o'er our heads and her words are _be free_! "Hearts of Oak," etc.

To King George, as true subjects, we loyal bow down, But hope we may call Magna Charta our own. Let the rest of the world slavish worship decree, Great Britain has ordered her sons to be free. "Hearts of Oak," etc.

Poor Esau his birthright gave up for a bribe, Americans scorn th' mean soul-selling tribe; Beyond life our freedom we chuse to possess, Which thro' life we'll defend, and abjure a broad S. "Hearts of Oak are we still, and we're sons of those men Who fear not the ocean, brave roarings of cannon, To stop all oppression, again and again."

On our brow while we laurel-crown'd Liberty wear, What Englishmen ought we Americans dare; Though tempests and terrors around us we see, Bribes nor fears can prevail o'er the hearts that are free. "Hearts of Oak," etc.

With Loyalty, Liberty let us entwine, Our blood shall for both flow as free as our wine; Let us set an example, what all men should be, And a Toast give the World, "Here's to those dare be free." "Hearts of Oak," etc.

In 1766 William Pitt, perhaps the most enlightened friend America had in England, became Prime Minister, and adopted toward the colonies a policy so conciliatory that it occasioned much disgust in England--as is evident from the following verses which appeared originally in the _Gentleman's Magazine_.

THE WORLD TURNED UPSIDE DOWN

OR, THE OLD WOMAN TAUGHT WISDOM

[1767]

Goody Bull and her daughter together fell out, Both squabbled, and wrangled, and made a ---- rout, But the cause of the quarrel remains to be told, Then lend both your ears, and a tale I'll unfold.

The old lady, it seems, took a freak in her head, That her daughter, grown woman, might earn her own bread: Self-applauding her scheme, she was ready to dance; But we're often too sanguine in what we advance.

For mark the event; thus by fortune we're crossed, Nor should people reckon without their good host; The daughter was sulky, and wouldn't come to, And pray, what in this case could the old woman do?

In vain did the matron hold forth in the cause, That the young one was able; her duty, the laws; Ingratitude vile, disobedience far worse; But she might e'en as well sung psalms to a horse.

Young, froward, and sullen, and vain of her beauty, She tartly replied, that she knew well her duty, That other folks' children were kept by their friends, And that some folks loved people but for their own ends.

"Zounds, neighbor!" quoth Pitt, "what the devil's the matter? A man cannot rest in his house for your clatter;" "Alas!" cries the daughter, "here's dainty fine work, The old woman grown harder than Jew or than Turk."

"She be ----," says the farmer, and to her he goes, First roars in her ears, then tweaks her old nose, "Hallo, Goody, what ails you? Wake! woman, I say; I am come to make peace, in this desperate fray.

"Adzooks, ope thine eyes, what a pother is here! You've no right to compel her, you have not, I swear; Be ruled by your friends, kneel down and ask pardon, You'd be sorry, I'm sure, should she walk Covent Garden."

"Alas!" cries the old woman, "and must I comply? But I'd rather submit than the huzzy should die;" "Pooh, prithee be quiet, be friends and agree, You must surely be right, _if you're guided by me_."

Unwillingly awkward, the mother knelt down, While the absolute farmer went on with a frown, "Come, kiss the poor child, there come, kiss and be friends! There, kiss your poor daughter, and make her amends."

"No thanks to you, mother," the daughter replied: "But thanks to my friend here, I've humbled your pride."

But Pitt was soon incapacitated by illness from taking any active part in the government, and Charles Townshend, chancellor of the exchequer, was able to pass his "port bills," and other oppressive measures. Many prominent Americans, among them Samuel Adams, decided that the colonies must be independent.

A SONG

[January 26, 1769]

Come, cheer up, my lads, like a true British band, In the cause of our country who join heart and hand; Fair Freedom invites--she cries out, "Agree! And be steadfast for those that are steadfast for me." Hearts of oak are we all, hearts of oak we'll remain: We always are ready-- Steady, boys, steady-- To give them our voices again and again.

With the brave sons of Freedom, of every degree, Unite all the good--and united are we: But still be the lot of the villains disgrace, Whose foul, rotten hearts give the lie to their face. Hearts of oak, etc.

See! their unblushing chieftain! perverter of laws! His teeth are the shark's, and a vulture's his claws-- As soon would I venture, howe'er he may talk, My lambs with a wolf, or my fowls with a hawk. Hearts of oak, etc.

First--the worth of good Cruger let's crown with applause, Who has join'd us again in fair Liberty's cause-- Sour Envy, herself, is afraid of his name, And weeps that she finds not a blot in his fame. Hearts of oak, etc.

To Jauncey, my souls, let your praises resound! With health and success may his goodness be crown'd: May the cup of his joy never cease to run o'er-- For he gave to us all when he gave to the poor! Hearts of oak, etc.

What Briton, undaunted, that pants to be free, But warms at the mention of brave De Launcey? "Happy Freedom!" said Fame, "what a son have you here! Whose head is approved, and whose heart is sincere." Hearts of oak, etc.

For worth and for truth, and good nature renown'd, Let the name and applauses of Walton go round: His prudence attracts--but his free, honest soul Gives a grace to the rest, and enlivens the whole. Hearts of oak, etc.

Huzza! for the patriots whose virtue is tried-- Unbiass'd by faction, untainted by pride: Who Liberty's welfare undaunted pursue, With heads ever clear, and hearts ever true. Hearts of oak, etc.

New York Journal, January 26, 1769.

Associations known as Sons of Liberty were organized in the larger cities, and in February, 1770, the first Liberty Pole in America was raised at New York city, in what is now City Hall Park. A struggle ensued with the British troops, during which the pole was twice cut down, but it was hooped with iron and set up a third time. A Tory versifier celebrated the event in a burlesque cantata, from which the following description of the pole is taken.

THE LIBERTY POLE

[February, 1770]

Come listen, good neighbors of every degree, Whose hearts, like your purses, are open and free, Let this pole a monument ever remain, Of the folly and arts of the time-serving train. Derry down, down, hey derry down.

Its bottom, so artfully fix'd under ground, Resembles their scheming, so low and profound; The dark underminings, and base dirty ends, On which the success of the faction depends. Derry down, etc.

The vane, mark'd with freedom, may put us in mind, As it varies, and flutters, and turns, with the wind, That no faith can be plac'd in the words of our foes, Who change as the wind of their interest blows. Derry down, etc.

The iron clasp'd around it, so firm and so neat, Resembles too closely their fraud and deceit, If the outside's but guarded, they care not a pin How rotten and hollow the heart is within. Derry down, etc.

Then away, ye pretenders to freedom, away, Who strive to cajole us in hopes to betray; Leave the pole for the stroke of the lightning to sever, And, huzzah for King George and our country forever! Derry down, etc.

Two regiments of British troops arrived at Boston on March 5, 1768, and annoyed the people in many ways. Brawls were frequent, and by the beginning of 1770 the tension of feeling had reached the snapping point. The "Massachusetts Liberty Song" and "The British Grenadier" did not go well together.

THE BRITISH GRENADIER

Come, come fill up your glasses, And drink a health to those Who carry caps and pouches, And wear their looped clothes. For be you Whig or Tory, Or any mortal thing, Be sure that you give glory To George, our gracious King. For if you prove rebellious, He'll thunder in your ears Huzza! Huzza! Huzza! Huzza! For the British Grenadiers!

And when the wars are over, We'll march by beat of drum, The ladies cry "So, Ho girls, The Grenadiers have come! The Grenadiers who always With love our hearts do cheer. Then Huzza! Huzza! Huzza! Huzza! For the British Grenadier!"

On the evening of March 5 a crowd collected near the barracks and some blows were exchanged; a sentinel in King Street knocked down a boy, and was about to be

mobbed, when Captain Preston and seven privates came to his assistance. The crowd pressed upon their levelled pieces, which were suddenly discharged, killing four men and wounding seven. Crispus Attucks, a mulatto slave, was the first to fall.

CRISPUS ATTUCKS

[March 5, 1770]

Where shall we seek for a hero, and where shall we find a story? Our laurels are wreathed for conquest, our songs for completed glory. But we honor a shrine unfinished, a column uncapped with pride, If we sing the deed that was sown like seed when Crispus Attucks died.

Shall we take for a sign this Negro slave with unfamiliar name-- With his poor companions, nameless too, till their lives leaped forth in flame? Yea, surely, the verdict is not for us, to render or deny; We can only interpret the symbol; God chose these men to die-- As teachers and types, that to humble lives may chief award be made; That from lowly ones, and rejected stones, the temple's base is laid!

When the bullets leaped from the British guns, no chance decreed their aim; Men see what the royal hirelings saw--a multitude and a flame; But beyond the flame, a mystery; five dying men in the street, While the streams of severed races in the well of a nation meet!

O blood of the people! changeless tide, through century, creed, and race! Still one as the sweet salt air is one, though tempered by sun and place; The same in the ocean currents, and the same in the sheltered seas; Forever the fountain of common hopes and kindly sympathies; Indian and Negro, Saxon and Celt, Teuton and Latin and Gaul-- Mere surface shadow and sunshine; while the sounding unifies all! One love, one hope, one duty theirs! No matter the time or ken, There never was separate heart-beat in all the races of men!

But alien is one--of class, not race--he has drawn the line for himself; His roots drink life from inhuman soil, from garbage of pomp and pelf; His heart beats not with the common beat, he has changed his life-stream's hue; He deems his flesh to be finer flesh, he boasts that his blood is blue: Patrician, aristocrat, Tory--whatever his age or name, To the people's rights and liberties, a traitor ever the same. The natural crowd is a mob to him, their prayer a vulgar rhyme; The freeman's speech is sedition, and the patriot's deed a crime. Wherever the race, the law, the land,--whatever the time or throne, The Tory is always a traitor to every class but his own.

Thank God for a land where pride is clipped, where arrogance stalks apart; Where law and song and loathing of wrong are words of the common heart; Where the masses honor straightforward strength, and know, when veins are bled, That the bluest blood is putrid blood--that the people's blood is red!

And honor to Crispus Attucks, who was leader and voice that day; The first to defy and the first to die, with Maverick, Carr, and Gray. Call it riot or revolution, his hand first clenched at the crown; His feet were the first in perilous place to pull the king's flag down; His breast was the first one rent apart that liberty's stream might flow;

For our freedom now and forever, his head was the first laid low.

Call it riot or revolution, or mob or crowd, as you may, Such deaths have been seed of nations, such lives shall be honored for aye. They were lawless hinds to the lackeys--but martyrs to Paul Revere; And Otis and Hancock and Warren read spirit and meaning clear. Ye teachers, answer: what shall be done when just men stand in the dock; When the caitiff is robed in ermine, and his sworders keep the lock; When torture is robbed of clemency, and guilt is without remorse; When tiger and panther are gentler than the Christian slaver's curse; When law is a satrap's menace, and order the drill of a horde-- Shall the people kneel to be trampled, and bare their neck to the sword?

Not so! by this Stone of Resistance that Boston raises here! By the old North Church's lantern, and the watching of Paul Revere! Not so! by Paris of 'Ninety-Three, and Ulster of 'Ninety-Eight! By Toussaint in St. Domingo! by the horror of Delhi's gate! By Adams's word to Hutchinson! by the tea that is brewing still! By the farmers that met the soldiers at Concord and Bunker Hill!

Not so! not so! Till the world is done, the shadow of wrong is dread; The crowd that bends to a lord to-day, to-morrow shall strike him dead. There is only one thing changeless: the earth steals from under our feet, The times and manners are passing moods, and the laws are incomplete; There is only one thing changes not, one word that still survives-- The slave is the wretch who wields the lash, and not the man in gyves!

There is only one test of contract: is it willing, is it good? There is only one guard of equal right: the unity of blood; There is never a mind unchained and true that class or race allows; There is never a law to be obeyed that reason disavows; There is never a legal sin but grows to the law's disaster, The master shall drop the whip, and the slave shall enslave the master!

Oh, Planter of seed in thought and deed has the year of right revolved, And brought the Negro patriot's cause with its problem to be solved? His blood streamed first for the building, and through all the century's years, Our growth of story and fame of glory are mixed with his blood and tears. He lived with men like a soul condemned--derided, defamed, and mute; Debased to the brutal level, and instructed to be a brute. His virtue was shorn of benefit, his industry of reward; His love!--O men, it were mercy to have cut affection's cord; Through the night of his woe, no pity save that of his fellow-slave; For the wage of his priceless labor, the scourging block and the grave!

And now, is the tree to blossom? Is the bowl of agony filled? Shall the price be paid and the honor said, and the word of outrage stilled? And we who have toiled for freedom's law, have we sought for freedom's soul? Have we learned at last that human right is not a part but the whole? That nothing is told while the clinging sin remains part unconfessed? That the health of the nation is perilled if one man be oppressed?

Has he learned--the slave from the rice-swamps, whose children were sold--has he, With broken chains on his limbs, and the cry in his blood, "I am free!" Has he learned

through affliction's teaching what our Crispus Attucks knew-- When Right is stricken, the white and black are counted as one, not two? Has he learned that his century of grief was worth a thousand years In blending his life and blood with ours, and that all his toils and tears Were heaped and poured on him suddenly, to give him a right to stand From the gloom of African forests, in the blaze of the freest land? That his hundred years have earned for him a place in the human van Which others have fought for and thought for since the world of wrong began?

For this, shall his vengeance change to love, and his retribution burn, Defending the right, the weak, and the poor, when each shall have his turn; For this, shall he set his woeful past afloat on the stream of night; For this, he forgets as we all forget when darkness turns to light; For this, he forgives as we all forgive when wrong has changed to right.

And so, must we come to the learning of Boston's lesson to-day; The moral that Crispus Attucks taught in the old heroic way; God made mankind to be one in blood, as one in spirit and thought; And so great a boon, by a brave man's death, is never dearly bought!

JOHN BOYLE O'REILLY.

This insignificant street riot was the famous "Boston Massacre." It created a great stir, and the victims were buried with military honors on March 8, the bodies being deposited in a single vault. A few days later, Paul Revere engraved and printed a large hand-bill giving a picture of the scene, accompanied by the following lines:

UNHAPPY BOSTON

[March 8, 1770]

Unhappy Boston! see thy sons deplore Thy hallowed walks besmear'd with guiltless gore. While faithless Preston and his savage bands, With murderous rancor stretch their bloody hands; Like fierce barbarians grinning o'er their prey, Approve the carnage and enjoy the day. If scalding drops, from rage, from anguish wrung, If speechless sorrows lab'ring for a tongue, Or if a weeping world can aught appease The plaintive ghosts of victims such as these; The patriot's copious tears for each are shed, A glorious tribute which embalms the dead. But know, Fate summons to that awful goal, Where justice strips the murderer of his soul: Should venal C----ts, the scandal of the land, Snatch the relentless villain from her hand, Keen execrations on this plate inscrib'd Shall reach a judge who never can be bribed.

PAUL REVERE.

A conflict of a much more serious nature took place at Alamance, N. C., on May 7, 1771, between a body of colonists, goaded to rebellion by repeated acts of extortion, and a force of British regulars under Governor Tryon. The colonists were totally defeated and left two hundred dead and wounded on the field.

ALAMANCE

[May 7, 1771]

No stately column marks the hallowed place Where silent sleeps, un-urned, their sacred dust: The first free martyrs of a glorious race, Their fame a people's wealth, a nation's trust.

The rustic ploughman at the early morn The yielding furrow turns with heedless tread, Or tends with frugal care the springing corn, Where tyrants conquered and where heroes bled.

Above their rest the golden harvest waves, The glorious stars stand sentinels on high, While in sad requiem, near their turfless graves, The winding river murmurs, mourning, by.

No stern ambition moved them to the deed: In Freedom's cause they nobly dared to die. The first to conquer, or the first to bleed, "God and their country's right" their battle cry.

But holier watchers here their vigils keep Than storied urn or monumental stone; For Law and Justice guard their dreamless sleep, And Plenty smiles above their bloody home.

Immortal youth shall crown their deathless fame; And as their country's glories shall advance, Shall brighter blaze, o'er all the earth, thy name, Thou first-fought field of Freedom--Alamance.

SEYMOUR W. WHITING.

The first American "victory" occurred on the night of June 9, 1772, when the British eight-gun schooner Gaspee was captured and burned to the water's edge. For some months the crew of the Gaspee, commissioned to enforce the revenue acts in Narragansett Bay, had been stopping vessels, seizing goods, stealing sheep and hogs, and committing other depredations along the shore. On June 9, while pursuing the Providence Packet, the schooner ran aground, and that night was boarded by a party of Rhode Islanders, the crew overpowered, and the boat burned.

A NEW SONG CALLED THE GASPEE

[June 9-10, 1772]

'Twas in the reign of George the Third The public peace was much disturb'd By ships of war, that came and laid Within our ports to stop our trade.

In seventeen hundred seventy-two, In Newport harbor lay a crew That play'd the parts of pirates there, The sons of Freedom could not bear.

Sometimes they'd weigh and give them chase-- Such actions, sure, were very base; No honest coasters could pass by But what they would let some shot fly.

Which did provoke to high degree Those true-born sons of Liberty, So that they could no longer bear Those sons of Belial staying there.

But 'twas not long 'fore it fell out, That William Doddington so stout, Commander of the Gaspee tender, Which he had reason to remember--

Because, as people do assert, He almost had his just desert Here, on the tenth day of last June, Between the hours of twelve and one--

Did chase the sloop call'd the Hannah, Of whom one Linsey was commander; They dogg'd her up to Providence Sound, And there the rascal got aground.

The news of it flew, that very day, That they on Nanquit Point did lay, That night, about half after ten, Some Narragansett Indian-men--

Being sixty-four, if I remember, Soon made this stout coxcomb surrender: And what was best of all their tricks, They in his breech a ball did fix.

They set the men upon the land, And burn'd her up, we understand; Which thing provoked the king so high, He said, "those men should surely die."

So, if he can but find them out, The hangman he'll employ, no doubt: For he has declared, in his passion, "He'll have them tried in a new fashion."

Now for to find those people out, King George has offered, very stout, One thousand pounds to find out one That wounded William Doddington.

One thousand more he says he'll spare, For those who say they sheriffs were: One thousand more there doth remain For to find out the leader's name.

Likewise, one hundred pounds per man, For any one of all the clan. But let him try his utmost skill, I'm apt to think he never will Find out any of those hearts of gold, Though he should offer fifty fold.

The duty on tea, imposed five years before by Townshend, had been retained by the British government as a matter of principle, and in the autumn of 1773 the King determined to assert the obnoxious principle which the tax involved. Several ships loaded with tea were accordingly started for America. On Sunday, November 28, the first of these arrived at Boston, and two others came in a few days later. The town went wild, meeting after meeting was held, and on the night of Tuesday, December 16, 1773, a band of about twenty, disguised as Indians, boarded the ships, cut open the tea-chests and flung the contents into the water.

A BALLAD OF THE BOSTON TEA-PARTY

[December 16, 1773]

No! never such a draught was poured Since Hebe served with nectar The bright Olympians and their Lord, Her over-kind protector,-- Since Father Noah squeezed the grape And took to such behaving As would have shamed our grandsire ape Before the days of shaving,-- No! ne'er was mingled such a draught In palace, hall, or arbor, As freemen brewed and tyrants quaffed That night in Boston Harbor! It kept King George so long awake His brain at last got addled, It made the nerves of Britain shake, With sevenscore millions saddled; Before that bitter cup was drained Amid the roar of cannon, The Western war-cloud's crimson stained The Thames, the Clyde, the

Shannon; Full many a six-foot grenadier The flattened grass had measured, And many a mother many a year Her tearful memories treasured; Fast spread the tempest's darkening pall, The mighty realms were troubled, The storm broke loose, but first of all The Boston teapot bubbled!

An evening party,--only that, No formal invitation, No gold-laced coat, no stiff cravat, No feast in contemplation, No silk-robed dames, no fiddling band, No flowers, no songs, no dancing,-- A tribe of red men, axe in hand,-- Behold the guests advancing! How fast the stragglers join the throng, From stall and workshop gathered! The lively barber skips along And leaves a chin half-lathered; The smith has flung his hammer down,-- The horseshoe still is glowing; The truant tapster at the Crown Has left a beer-cask flowing; The cooper's boys have dropped the adze, And trot behind their master; Up run the tarry ship-yard lads,-- The crowd is hurrying faster,-- Out from the Millpond's purlieus gush The streams of white-faced millers, And down their slippery alleys rush The lusty young Fort-Hillers; The ropewalk lends its 'prentice crew,-- The tories seize the omen: "Ay, boys, you'll soon have work to do For England's rebel foemen, 'King Hancock,' Adams, and their gang, That fire the mob with treason,-- When these we shoot and those we hang The town will come to reason."

On--on to where the tea-ships ride! And now their ranks are forming,-- A rush, and up the Dartmouth's side The Mohawk band is swarming! See the fierce natives! What a glimpse Of paint and fur and feather, As all at once the full-grown imps Light on the deck together! A scarf the pigtail's secret keeps, A blanket hides the breeches,-- And out the cursèd cargo leaps, And overboard it pitches!

O woman, at the evening board So gracious, sweet, and purring, So happy while the tea is poured, So blest while spoons are stirring, What martyr can compare with thee, The mother, wife, or daughter, That night, instead of best Bohea, Condemned to milk and water!

Ah, little dreams the quiet dame Who plies with rock and spindle The patient flax, how great a flame Yon little spark shall kindle! The lurid morning shall reveal A fire no king can smother Where British flint and Boston steel Have clashed against each other! Old charters shrivel in its track, His Worship's bench has crumbled, It climbs and clasps the union-jack, Its blazoned pomp is humbled, The flags go down on land and sea Like corn before the reapers; So burned the fire that brewed the tea That Boston served her keepers!

The waves that wrought a century's wreck Have rolled o'er whig and tory; The Mohawks on the Dartmouth's deck Still live in song and story; The waters in the rebel bay Have kept the tea-leaf savor; Our old North-Enders in their spray Still taste a Hyson flavor; And Freedom's teacup still o'erflows With ever fresh libations, To cheat of slumber all her foes And cheer the wakening nations!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

Next morning, Paul Revere, booted and spurred, started for Philadelphia with the news that Boston had at last thrown down the gauntlet. The following song appeared in the _Pennsylvania Packet_ a few days after Revere reached Philadelphia.

A NEW SONG

[December 16, 1773]

As near beauteous Boston lying, On the gently swelling flood, Without jack or pendant flying, Three ill-fated tea-ships rode.

Just as glorious Sol was setting, On the wharf, a numerous crew, Sons of freedom, fear forgetting, Suddenly appeared in view.

Armed with hammers, axe, and chisels, Weapons new for warlike deed, Towards the herbage-freighted vessels, They approached with dreadful speed.

O'er their heads aloft in mid-sky, Three bright angel forms were seen; This was Hampden, that was Sidney, With fair Liberty between.

"Soon," they cried, "your foes you'll banish, Soon the triumph shall be won; Scarce shall setting Phoebus vanish, Ere the deathless deed be done."

Quick as thought the ships were boarded, Hatches burst and chests displayed; Axes, hammers help afforded; What a glorious crash they made.

Squash into the deep descended, Cursed weed of China's coast; Thus at once our fears were ended; British rights shall ne'er be lost.

Captains! once more hoist your streamers, Spread your sails, and plough the wave; Tell your masters they were dreamers, When they thought to cheat the brave.

News of the insurrection was received in England with the greatest indignation, and measures of reprisal were at once undertaken. No ships were to be allowed to enter the port of Boston until the rebellious town should have repaid the East India Company for the loss of its tea; the charter of Massachusetts was annulled and her free government destroyed; and General Gage was sent over with four regiments to take possession of the town.

HOW WE BECAME A NATION

[April 15, 1774]

When George the King would punish folk Who dared resist his angry will-- Resist him with their hearts of oak That neither King nor Council broke-- He told Lord North to mend his quill, And sent his Parliament a Bill.

The Boston Port Bill was the thing He flourished in his royal hand; A subtle lash with scorpion sting, Across the seas he made it swing, And with its cruel thong he planned To quell the disobedient land.

His minions heard it sing, and bare The port of Boston felt his wrath; They let no ship cast anchor there, They summoned Hunger and Despair,-- And curses in an aftermath Followed their desolating path.

No coal might enter there, nor wood, Nor Holland flax, nor silk from France; No drugs for dying pangs, no food For any mother's little brood. "Now," said the King,

"we have our chance, We'll lead the haughty knaves a dance."

No other flags lit up the bay, Like full-blown blossoms in the air, Than where the British war-ships lay; The wharves were idle; all the day The idle men, grown gaunt and spare, Saw trouble, pall-like, everywhere.

Then in across the meadow land, From lonely farm and hunter's tent, From fertile field and fallow strand, Pouring it out with lavish hand, The neighboring burghs their bounty sent, And laughed at King and Parliament.

To bring them succor, Marblehead Joyous her deep-sea fishing sought. Her trees, with ringing stroke and tread, Old many-rivered Newbury sped, And Groton in her granaries wrought, And generous flocks old Windham brought.

Rice from the Carolinas came, Iron from Pennsylvania's forge, And, with a spirit all aflame, Tobacco-leaf and corn and game The Midlands sent; and in his gorge The Colonies defied King George!

And Hartford hung, in black array, Her town-house, and at half-mast there The flags flowed, and the bells all day Tolled heavily; and far away In great Virginia's solemn air The House of Burgesses held prayer.

Down long glades of the forest floor The same thrill ran through every vein, And down the long Atlantic's shore; Its heat the tyrant's fetters tore And welded them through stress and strain Of long years to a mightier chain.

That mighty chain with links of steel Bound all the Old Thirteen at last, Through one electric pulse to feel The common woe, the common weal. And that great day the Port Bill passed Made us a nation hard and fast.

HARRIET PRESCOTT SPOFFORD.

Gage arrived at Boston in May, 1774, and at once issued a proclamation calling upon the inhabitants to be loyal, and warning them of his intention to maintain the authority of the King at any cost.

A PROCLAMATION

[May, 1774]

America! thou fractious nation, Attend thy master's proclamation! Tremble! for know, I, Thomas Gage, Determin'd come the war to wage.

With the united powers sent forth, Of Bute, of Mansfield, and of North; To scourge your insolence, my choice, While England mourns and Scots rejoice!

Bostonia first shall feel my power, And gasping midst the dreadful shower Of ministerial rage, shall cry, Oh, save me, Bute! I yield! and die.

Then shall my thundering cannons rattle, My hardy veterans march to battle, Against Virginia's hostile land, To humble that rebellious band.

At my approach her trembling swains Shall quit well-cultivated plains, To seek the inhospitable wood; Or try, like swine of old, the flood.

Rejoice! ye happy Scots rejoice! Your voice lift up, a mighty voice, The voice of gladness on each tongue, The mighty praise of Bute be sung.

The praise of Mansfield, and of North, Let next your hymns of joy set forth, Nor shall the rapturous strain assuage, Till sung's your own proclaiming Gage.

Whistle ye pipes! ye drones drone on. Ye bellows blow! Virginia's won! Your Gage has won Virginia's shore, And Scotia's sons shall mourn no more.

Hail, Middlesex! oh happy county! Thou too shalt share thy master's bounty, Thy sons obedient, naught shall fear, Thy wives and widows drop no tear.

Thrice happy people, ne'er shall feel The force of unrelenting steel; What brute would give the ox a stroke Who bends his neck to meet the yoke?

To Murray bend the humble knee; He shall protect you under me; His generous pen shall not be mute, But sound your praise thro' Fox to Bute.

By Scotchmen lov'd, by Scotchmen taught, By all your country Scotchmen thought; Fear Bute, fear Mansfield, North and me, And be as blest as slaves can be.

The Virginia Gazette, 1774.

The colonies rallied nobly to Boston's support; provisions of all sorts were sent over-land to the devoted city; the 1st of June, the day on which the Port Bill went into effect, was observed as a day of fasting and prayer throughout the country, and it became a point of honor with all good patriots to refrain from indulgence in "the blasted herb."

THE BLASTED HERB

[1774]

Rouse every generous, thoughtful mind, The rising danger flee, If you would lasting freedom find, Now then abandon tea.

Scorn to be bound with golden chains, Though they allure the sight; Bid them defiance, if they claim Our freedom and birthright.

Shall we our freedom give away, And all our comfort place, In drinking of outlandish tea, Only to please our taste?

Forbid it Heaven, let us be wise, And seek our country's good; Nor ever let a thought arise That tea should be our food.

Since we so great a plenty have, Of all that's for our health, Shall we that blasted herb receive, Impoverishing our wealth?

When we survey the breathless corpse, With putrid matter filled, For crawling worms a sweet resort, By us reputed ill.

Noxious effluvia sending out From its pernicious store, Not only from the foaming mouth, But every lifeless pore.

To view the same enrolled in tea, Besmeared with such perfumes, And then the herb sent o'er the sea, To us it tainted comes--

Some of it tinctured with a filth Of carcasses embalmed; Taste of this herb, then, if thou wilt! Sure me it cannot charm.

Adieu! away, oh tea! begone! Salute our taste no more; Though thou art coveted by some, Who're destined to be poor.

MESECH WEARE.

Fowle's _Gazette_, July 22, 1774.

EPIGRAM

ON THE POOR OF BOSTON BEING EMPLOYED IN PAVING THE STREETS, 1774

In spite of _Rice_, in spite of _Wheat_, Sent for the Boston Poor--to eat: In spite of _Brandy_, one would think, Sent for the Boston Poor--to drink: Poor are the Boston Poor, indeed, And needy, tho' there is no Need: They cry for Bread; the mighty Ones Instead of _Bread_, give only _Stones_.

Rivington's _New York Gazetteer_, September 2, 1774.

It was plain that, in this crisis, the colonies must stick together, and the proposal for a Continental Congress, first made by the Sons of Liberty in New York, was approved by colony after colony, and the Congress was finally called to meet at Philadelphia, September 1.

THE DAUGHTER'S REBELLION

When fair Columbia was a child, And mother Britain on her smil'd With kind regard, and strok'd her head, And gave her dolls and gingerbread, And sugar plumbs, and many a toy, Which prompted gratitude and joy-- Then a more duteous maid, I ween, Ne'er frisked it o'er the playful green; Whate'er the mother said, approv'd, And with sincere affection lov'd-- With reverence listen'd to her dreams, And bowed obsequious to her schemes-- Barter'd the products of her garden, For trinkets, worth more than a farthing-- And whensoe'er the mother sigh'd, She, sympathetic daughter, cri'd, Fearing the heavy, long-drawn breath, Betoken'd her approaching death. But when at puberty arriv'd, Forgot the power in whom she liv'd, And 'gan to make preposterous splutter, 'Bout spreading her own bread and butter, And stubbornly refus'd t' agree, In form, to drink her bohea-tea, And like a base, ungrateful daughter, Hurl'd a whole tea box in the water-- 'Bout writing paper made a pother, And dared to argue with her mother-- Contended pertly, that the nurse, Should not be keeper of the purse; But that herself, now older grown, Would have a pocket of her own, In which the purse

she would deposit, As safely as in nurse's closet.

FRANCIS HOPKINSON.

The Whig papers generally at this time adopted for a headpiece a snake broken into parts representing the several colonies, with the motto, "Unite or Die."

ON THE SNAKE

DEPICTED AT THE HEAD OF SOME AMERICAN NEWSPAPERS

Ye sons of Sedition, how comes it to pass That America's typ'd by a Snake--in the grass? Don't you think 'tis a scandalous, saucy reflection, That merits the soundest, severest correction? New-England's the Head, too;--New-England's abus'd, For the Head of the Serpent we know should be bruis'd.

From Rivington's _New York Gazetteer_, August 25, 1774.

The feeling of the entire country was aptly voiced in "Free America," which appeared at that time, and which was ascribed to Dr. Joseph Warren.

FREE AMERICA

[1774]

That seat of Science, Athens, And earth's proud mistress, Rome; Where now are all their glories? We scarce can find a tomb. Then guard your rights, Americans, Nor stoop to lawless sway; Oppose, oppose, oppose, oppose, For North America.

We led fair Freedom hither, And lo, the desert smiled! A paradise of pleasure Was opened in the wild! Your harvest, bold Americans, No power shall snatch away! Huzza, huzza, huzza, huzza, For free America.

Torn from a world of tyrants, Beneath this western sky, We formed a new dominion, A land of liberty: The world shall own we're masters here; Then hasten on the day: Huzza, huzza, huzza, huzza, For free America.

Proud Albion bowed to Cæsar, And numerous lords before; To Picts, to Danes, to Normans, And many masters more: But we can boast, Americans, We've never fallen a prey; Huzza, huzza, huzza, huzza, For free America.

God bless this maiden climate, And through its vast domain May hosts of heroes cluster, Who scorn to wear a chain: And blast the venal sycophant That dares our rights betray; Huzza, huzza, huzza, huzza, For free America.

Lift up your hands, ye heroes, And swear with proud disdain, The wretch that would ensnare you, Shall lay his snares in vain: Should Europe empty all her force, We'll meet her in array, And fight and shout, and shout and fight For North America.

Some future day shall crown us, The masters of the main, Our fleets shall speak in thunder To England, France, and Spain; And the nations over the ocean spread Shall tremble and obey The sons, the sons, the sons, the sons Of brave America.

JOSEPH WARREN.

The Continental Congress assembled at Philadelphia, September 5, 1774, and, after four weeks' deliberation, agreed upon a declaration of rights, claiming for the American people the right of free legislation and calling for the repeal of eleven acts of Parliament.

LIBERTY TREE

In a chariot of light from the regions of day, The Goddess of Liberty came; Ten thousand celestials directed the way And hither conducted the dame. A fair budding branch from the gardens above, Where millions with millions agree, She brought in her hand as a pledge of her love, And the plant she named _Liberty Tree_.

The celestial exotic struck deep in the ground, Like a native it flourished and bore; The fame of its fruit drew the nations around, To seek out this peaceable shore. Unmindful of names or distinction they came, For freemen like brothers agree; With one spirit endued, they one friendship pursued, And their temple was _Liberty Tree_.

Beneath this fair tree, like the patriarchs of old, Their bread in contentment they ate, Unvexed with the troubles of silver and gold, The cares of the grand and the great. With timber and tar they Old England supplied, And supported her power on the sea; Her battles they fought, without getting a groat, For the honor of _Liberty Tree_.

But hear, O ye swains, 'tis a tale most profane, How all the tyrannical powers, Kings, Commons, and Lords, are uniting amain, To cut down this guardian of ours; From the east to the west blow the trumpet to arms Through the land let the sound of it flee, Let the far and the near, all unite with a cheer, In defence of our _Liberty Tree_.

THOMAS PAINE.

Pennsylvania Magazine, 1775.

The duty of presenting to the British government the Declaration of Rights prepared by the Congress devolved upon Benjamin Franklin, who was in England at the time. Lord Dartmouth received the document, but permission was refused Franklin to present the case for the Continental Congress, and to defend it, before the House of Commons.

THE MOTHER COUNTRY

[1775]

We have an old mother that peevish is grown; She snubs us like children that scarce walk alone; She forgets we're grown up and have sense of our own; Which

nobody can deny, deny, Which nobody can deny.

If we don't obey orders, whatever the case, She frowns, and she chides, and she loses all pati- Ence, and sometimes she hits us a slap in the face; Which nobody, etc.

Her orders so odd are, we often suspect That age has impaired her sound intellect; But still an old mother should have due respect; Which nobody, etc.

Let's bear with her humors as well as we can; But why should we bear the abuse of her man? When servants make mischief, they earn the rattan; Which nobody, etc.

Know, too, ye bad neighbors, who aim to divide The sons from the mother, that still she's our pride; And if ye attack her, we're all of her side; Which nobody, etc.

We'll join in her lawsuits, to baffle all those Who, to get what she has, will be often her foes; For we know it must all be our own, when she goes; Which nobody can deny, deny, Which nobody can deny.

BENJAMIN FRANKLIN.

Very few Englishmen believed that the Americans would fight. Lord Sandwich said that they were a lot of undisciplined cowards, who would take to their heels at the first sound of a cannon, and that it would be easy to frighten them into submission. The "Pennsylvania Song" was evidently written to answer this assertion.

PENNSYLVANIA SONG

We are the troop that ne'er will stoop To wretched slavery, Nor shall our seed, by our base deed, Despisèd vassals be; Freedom we will bequeath to them, Or we will bravely die; Our greatest foe, ere long shall know, How much did Sandwich lie. And all the world shall know, Americans are free; Nor slaves nor cowards we will prove, Great Britain soon shall see.

We'll not give up our birthright, Our foes shall find us men; As good as they, in any shape, The British troops shall ken. Huzza! brave boys, we'll beat them On any hostile plain; For Freedom, wives, and children dear, The battle we'll maintain. And all the world, etc.

What! can those British tyrants think, Our fathers cross'd the main, And savage foes, and dangers met, To be enslav'd by them? If so, they are mistaken, For we will rather die; And since they have become our foes, Their forces we defy. And all the world, etc.

Dunlap's _Packet_, 1775.

About the middle of December, 1774, deputies appointed by the freemen of Maryland met at Annapolis, and unanimously resolved to resist the attempts of Parliament to tax the colonies and to support the acts of the Continental Congress. They also recommended that every man should provide himself with "a good firelock, with bayonet attached, powder and ball," to be in readiness to act in any emergency.

MARYLAND RESOLVES

[December, 1774]

On Calvert's plains new faction reigns, Great Britain we defy, sir, True Liberty lies gagg'd in chains, Though freedom is the cry, sir.

The Congress, and their factious tools, Most wantonly oppress us, Hypocrisy triumphant rules, And sorely does distress us.

The British bands with glory crown'd, No longer shall withstand us; Our martial deeds loud fame shall sound Since mad Lee now commands us.

Triumphant soon a blow he'll strike, That all the world shall awe, sir, And General Gage, Sir Perseus like, Behind his wheels he'll draw, sir.

When Gallic hosts, ungrateful men, Our race meant to extermine, Pray did committees save us then, Or Hancock, or such vermin?

Then faction spurn! think for yourselves! Your parent state, believe me, From real griefs, from factious elves, Will speedily relieve ye.

Rivington's _Gazetteer_.

Such effusions as the "Massachusetts Liberty Song" became immensely popular, and bands of liberty-loving souls met nightly to sing them.

MASSACHUSETTS SONG OF LIBERTY

Come swallow your bumpers, ye _Tories_, and roar That the Sons of fair Freedom are hamper'd once more; But know that no _Cut-throats_ our spirits can tame, Nor a host of _Oppressors_ shall smother the flame. _In Freedom we're born, and, like Sons of the brave, Will never surrender, But swear to defend her, And scorn to survive, if unable to save._

Our grandsires, bless'd heroes, we'll give them a tear, Nor sully their honors by stooping to fear; Through deaths and through dangers their _Trophies_ they won, We dare be their _Rivals_, nor will be outdone. _In Freedom we're born, etc._

Let tyrants and minions presume to despise, Encroach on our RIGHTS, and make FREEDOM their prize; The fruits of their rapine they never shall keep, Though Vengeance may nod, yet how short is her sleep. _In Freedom we're born, etc._

The tree which proud _Haman_ for _Mordecai_ rear'd Stands recorded, that virtue endanger'd is spared; That _rogues_, whom no bounds and no laws can restrain, Must be stripp'd of their honors and humbled again. _In Freedom we're born, etc._

Our wives and our babes, still protected, shall know Those who dare to be free shall forever be so; On these arms and these hearts they may safely rely For in freedom we'll live, or like _Heroes_ we'll die. _In Freedom we're born, etc._

Ye insolent _Tyrants_! who wish to enthrall; Ye _Minions_, ye _Placemen_, _Pimps_, _Pensioners_, all; How short is your triumph, how feeble your trust, Your honor must

wither and nod to the dust. _In Freedom we're born, etc._

When oppress'd and approach'd, our KING we implore, Still firmly persuaded our RIGHTS he'll restore; When our hearts beat to arms to defend a just right, Our monarch rules there, and forbids us to fight. _In Freedom we're born, etc._

Not the glitter of arms nor the dread of a fray Could make us submit to their chains for a day; Withheld by affection, on _Britons_ we call, Prevent the fierce conflict which threatens your fall. _In Freedom we're born, etc._

All ages should speak with amaze and applause Of the prudence we show in support of our cause: Assured of our safety, a BRUNSWICK still reigns, Whose free loyal subjects are strangers to chains. _In Freedom we're born, etc._

Then join hand in hand, brave Americans all, To be free is to live, to be slaves is to fall; Has the land such a dastard as scorns not a LORD, Who dreads not a fetter much more than a sword? _In Freedom we're born, etc._

Attributed to MRS. MERCY WARREN.

EPIGRAM

Rudely forced to drink tea, Massachusetts, in anger, Spills the tea on John Bull. John falls on to bang her. Massachusetts, enraged, calls her neighbors to aid And give Master John a severe bastinade. Now, good men of the law, who is at fault, The one who begins or resists the assault?

Anderson's _Constitutional Gazette_, 1775.

TO THE BOSTON WOMEN

O Boston wives and maids, draw near and see Our delicate Souchong and Hyson tea, Buy it, my charming girls, fair, black, or brown, If not, we'll cut your throats, and burn your town.

St. James Chronicle.

It was evident that, in the excited state of the country, a single incident might turn the balance between peace and war and produce a general explosion. That incident was not long in coming.

"PROPHECY"

[1774]

Hail, happy Britain, Freedom's blest retreat, Great is thy power, thy wealth, thy glory great, But wealth and power have no immortal day, For all things ripen only to decay. And when that time arrives, the lot of all, When Britain's glory, power and wealth shall fall; Then shall thy sons by Fate's unchanged decree In other worlds another Britain see, And what thou art, America shall be.

GULIAN VERPLANCK.

CHAPTER II

THE BURSTING OF THE STORM

All through the winter of 1774-75, the people of Massachusetts had offered a passive but effective resistance to General Gage. Not a councillor, judge, sheriff, or juryman could be found to serve under the royal commission; and for nine months the ordinary functions of government were suspended. At eventide, on every village-green, a company of yeomen drilled, and a supply of powder and ball was gradually collected at Concord; but every man in the province was given to understand that England must fire the first shot. At the beginning of spring, Gage received peremptory orders to arrest Samuel Adams and John Hancock, and send them to England to be tried for treason. He learned that they would be at a friend's house at Lexington, during the middle of April, and on the night of April 18 dispatched a force of eight hundred men to seize them, and then to proceed to Concord and destroy the military stores collected there. Although the movement was conducted with the greatest secrecy, Joseph Warren divined its purpose, and sent out Paul Revere by way of Charlestown to give the alarm.

PAUL REVERE'S RIDE

[April 18-19, 1775]

Listen, my children, and you shall hear Of the midnight ride of Paul Revere, On the eighteenth of April, in Seventy-five; Hardly a man is now alive Who remembers that famous day and year.

He said to his friend, "If the British march By land or sea from the town to-night, Hang a lantern aloft in the belfry arch Of the North Church tower as a signal light,-- One, if by land, and two, if by sea; And I on the opposite shore will be, Ready to ride and spread the alarm Through every Middlesex village and farm, For the country folk to be up and to arm."

Then he said, "Good night!" and with muffled oar Silently rowed to the Charlestown shore, Just as the moon rose over the bay, Where swinging wide at her moorings lay The Somerset, British man-of-war; A phantom ship, with each mast and spar Across the moon like a prison bar, And a huge black hulk, that was magnified By its own reflection in the tide.

Meanwhile, his friend, through alley and street, Wanders and watches with eager ears, Till in the silence around him he hears The muster of men at the barrack door, The sound of arms, and the tramp of feet, And the measured tread of the grenadiers, Marching down to their boats on the shore.

Then he climbed the tower of the Old North Church, By the wooden stairs, with stealthy tread, To the belfry-chamber overhead, And startled the pigeons from their perch On the sombre rafters, that round him made Masses and moving shapes of shade,-- By the trembling ladder, steep and tall, To the highest window in the wall,

Where he paused to listen and look down A moment on the roofs of the town, And the moonlight flowing over all.

Beneath, in the churchyard, lay the dead, In their night-encampment on the hill, Wrapped in silence so deep and still That he could hear, like a sentinel's tread, The watchful night-wind, as it went Creeping along from tent to tent, And seeming to whisper, "All is well!" A moment only he feels the spell Of the place and the hour, and the secret dread Of the lonely belfry and the dead; For suddenly all his thoughts are bent On a shadowy something far away, Where the river widens to meet the bay,-- A line of black that bends and floats On the rising tide, like a bridge of boats.

Meanwhile, impatient to mount and ride, Booted and spurred, with a heavy stride On the opposite shore walked Paul Revere. Now he patted his horse's side, Now gazed at the landscape far and near, Then, impetuous, stamped the earth, And turned and tightened his saddle-girth; But mostly he watched with eager search The belfry-tower of the Old North Church, As it rose above the graves on the hill, Lonely and spectral and sombre and still. And lo! as he looks, on the belfry's height A glimmer, and then a gleam of light! He springs to the saddle, the bridle he turns, But lingers and gazes, till full on his sight A second lamp in the belfry burns!

A hurry of hoofs in a village street, A shape in the moonlight, a bulk in the dark, And beneath, from the pebbles, in passing, a spark Struck out by a steed flying fearless and fleet: That was all! And yet, through the gloom and the light, The fate of a nation was riding that night; And the spark struck out by that steed, in his flight, Kindled the land into flame with its heat.

He has left the village and mounted the steep, And beneath him, tranquil and broad and deep, Is the Mystic, meeting the ocean tides; And under the alders that skirt its edge, Now soft on the sand, now loud on the ledge, Is heard the tramp of his steed as he rides.

It was twelve by the village clock, When he crossed the bridge into Medford town. He heard the crowing of the cock, And the barking of the farmer's dog, And felt the damp of the river fog, That rises after the sun goes down.

It was one by the village clock, When he galloped into Lexington. He saw the gilded weathercock Swim in the moonlight as he passed, And the meeting-house windows, blank and bare, Gaze at him with a spectral glare, As if they already stood aghast At the bloody work they would look upon.

It was two by the village clock, When he came to the bridge in Concord town. He heard the bleating of the flock, And the twitter of birds among the trees, And felt the breath of the morning breeze Blowing over the meadows brown. And one was safe and asleep in his bed Who at the bridge would be first to fall, Who that day would be lying dead, Pierced by a British musket-ball.

You know the rest. In the books you have read, How the British Regulars fired and fled,-- How the farmers gave them ball for ball, From behind each fence and farm-yard wall, Chasing the red-coats down the lane, Then crossing the fields to emerge again Under the trees at the turn of the road, And only pausing to fire and

load.

So through the night rode Paul Revere; And so through the night went his cry of alarm To every Middlesex village and farm,-- A cry of defiance and not of fear, A voice in the darkness, a knock at the door, And a word that shall echo forevermore! For, borne on the night-wind of the Past, Through all our history, to the last, In the hour of darkness and peril and need, The people will waken and listen to hear The hurrying hoof-beats of that steed, And the midnight message of Paul Revere.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

At the same time Warren dispatched William Dawes by way of Roxbury; but though Dawes played an important part in the events of the night, his exploits have been completely overshadowed in the popular imagination by those of the other courier.

WHAT'S IN A NAME?

I am a wandering, bitter shade; Never of me was a hero made; Poets have never sung my praise, Nobody crowned my brow with bays; And if you ask me the fatal cause, I answer only, "My name was Dawes."

'Tis all very well for the children to hear Of the midnight ride of Paul Revere; But why should my name be quite forgot, Who rode as boldly and well, God wot? Why should I ask? The reason is clear-- My name was Dawes and his Revere.

When the lights from the old North Church flashed out, Paul Revere was waiting about, But I was already on my way. The shadows of night fell cold and gray As I rode, with never a break or pause; But what was the use, when my name was Dawes?

History rings with his silvery name; Closed to me are the portals of fame. Had he been Dawes and I Revere, No one had heard of him, I fear. No one has heard of me because He was Revere and I was Dawes.

HELEN F. MORE.

Revere galloped at top speed to Lexington, and warned Hancock and Adams, who left the town shortly before daybreak. Meanwhile the minute-men of the village had gathered, and the vanguard of the English column was confronted by about fifty colonials under command of Captain John Parker. The British commander, Major Pitcairn, ordered them to disperse, and as they stood motionless, he gave the order to fire. His men hesitated, but he discharged his own pistol and repeated the order, whereupon a deadly volley killed eight of the minute-men and wounded ten. A moment later, the main body of the British came up, and Parker, seeing the folly of resistance, ordered his men to retire.

LEXINGTON[3]

[April 19, 1775]

From "Psalm of the West"

O'er Cambridge set the yeoman's mark: Climb, patriot, through the April dark. O lanthorn! kindle fast thy light, Thou budding star in the April night, For never a star more news hath told, Or later flame in heaven shall hold. Ay, lanthorn on the North Church tower, When that thy church hath had her hour, Still from the top of Reverence high Shalt thou illume Fame's ampler sky; For, statured large o'er town and tree, Time's tallest Figure stands by thee, And, dim as now thy wick may shine, The Future lights his lamp at thine.

Now haste thee while the way is clear, Paul Revere! Haste, Dawes! but haste thou not, O Sun! To Lexington.

Then Devens looked and saw the light: He got him forth into the night, And watched alone on the river-shore, And marked the British ferrying o'er.

John Parker! rub thine eyes and yawn, But one o'clock and yet 'tis Dawn! Quick, rub thine eyes and draw thy hose: The Morning comes ere darkness goes. Have forth and call the yeomen out, For somewhere, somewhere close about Full soon a Thing must come to be Thine honest eyes shall stare to see-- Full soon before thy patriot eyes Freedom from out of a Wound shall rise.

Then haste ye, Prescott and Revere! Bring all the men of Lincoln here; Let Chelmsford, Littleton, Carlisle, Let Acton, Bedford, hither file-- Oh hither file, and plainly see Out of a wound leap Liberty. Say, Woodman April! all in green, Say, Robin April! hast thou seen In all thy travel round the earth Ever a morn of calmer birth? But Morning's eye alone serene Can gaze across yon village-green To where the trooping British run Through Lexington.

Good men in fustian, stand ye still; The men in red come o'er the hill. _Lay down your arms, damned Rebels!_ cry The men in red full haughtily. But never a grounding gun is heard; The men in fustian stand unstirred; Dead calm, save maybe a wise bluebird Puts in his little heavenly word. O men in red! if ye but knew The half as much as bluebirds do, Now in this little tender calm Each hand would out, and every palm With patriot palm strike brotherhood's stroke Or ere these lines of battle broke.

O men in red! if ye but knew The least of the all that bluebirds do, Now in this little godly calm Yon voice might sing the Future's Psalm-- The Psalm of Love with the brotherly eyes Who pardons and is very wise-- Yon voice that shouts, high-hoarse with ire, _Fire!_ The red-coats fire, the homespuns fall: The homespuns' anxious voices call, _Brother, art hurt?_ and _Where hit, John?_ And, _Wipe this blood_, and, _Men, come on_, And, _Neighbor, do but lift my head_, And, _Who is wounded? Who is dead? Seven are killed. My God! my God! Seven lie dead on the village sod. Two Harringtons, Parker, Hadley, Brown, Monroe and Porter,--these are down. Nay, look! Stout Harrington not yet dead!_ He crooks his elbow, lifts his head. He lies at the step of his own house-door; He crawls and makes a path of gore. The wife from the window hath seen, and rushed; He hath reached the step, but the blood hath gushed; He hath crawled to the step of his own house-door, But his head hath dropped: he will crawl no more. Clasp, Wife, and kiss, and lift the head: Harrington lies at his doorstep dead.

But, O ye Six that round him lay And bloodied up that April day! As Harrington fell, ye likewise fell-- At the door of the House wherein ye dwell; As Harrington came, ye likewise came And died at the door of your House of Fame.

SIDNEY LANIER.

[3] From Poems by Sidney Lanier, copyright, 1884, 1891, by Mary D. Lanier; published by Charles Scribner's Sons.

LEXINGTON

[April 19, 1775]

Slowly the mist o'er the meadow was creeping, Bright on the dewy buds glistened the sun, When from his couch, while his children were sleeping, Rose the bold rebel and shouldered his gun. Waving her golden veil Over the silent dale, Blithe looked the morning on cottage and spire; Hushed was his parting sigh, While from his noble eye Flashed the last sparkle of liberty's fire.

On the smooth green where the fresh leaf is springing Calmly the first-born of glory have met; Hark! the death-volley around them is ringing! Look! with their life-blood the young grass is wet! Faint is the feeble breath, Murmuring low in death, "Tell to our sons how their fathers have died;" Nerveless the iron hand, Raised for its native land, Lies by the weapon that gleams at its side.

Over the hillsides the wild knell is tolling, From their far hamlets the yeomanry come; As through the storm-clouds the thunder-burst rolling, Circles the beat of the mustering drum. Fast on the soldier's path Darken the waves of wrath,-- Long have they gathered and loud shall they fall; Red glares the musket's flash, Sharp rings the rifle's crash, Blazing and clanging from thicket and wall.

Gayly the plume of the horseman was dancing, Never to shadow his cold brow again; Proudly at morning the war-steed was prancing, Reeking and panting he droops on the rein; Pale is the lip of scorn, Voiceless the trumpet horn, Torn is the silken-fringed red cross on high; Many a belted breast Low on the turf shall rest Ere the dark hunters the herd have passed by.

Snow-girdled crags where the hoarse wind is raving, Rocks where the weary floods murmur and wail, Wilds where the fern by the furrow is waving, Reeled with the echoes that rode on the gale; Far as the tempest thrills Over the darkened hills, Far as the sunshine streams over the plain, Roused by the tyrant band, Woke all the mighty land, Girdled for battle, from mountain to main.

Green be the graves where her martyrs are lying! Shroudless and tombless they sunk to their rest, While o'er their ashes the starry fold flying Wraps the proud eagle they roused from his nest. Borne on her Northern pine, Long o'er the foaming brine Spread her broad banner to storm and to sun; Heaven keep her ever free, Wide as o'er land and sea Floats the fair emblem her heroes have won!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

The British pressed on to Concord, but the greater part of the stores had been hidden, and minute-men were gathering from all directions. Colonel Smith, commanding the British, began to realize the dangers of his position and about noon started to retreat to Boston. And none too soon, for the whole country was aroused. Minute-men swarmed in from all directions, and taking advantage of every tree and hillock by the roadside, poured into the British a fire so deadly that the retreat soon became a disorderly flight. The timely arrival of strong reinforcements was all that saved the British from annihilation.

NEW ENGLAND'S CHEVY CHASE

[April 19, 1775]

'Twas the dead of the night. By the pine-knot's red light Brooks lay, half-asleep, when he heard the alarm,-- Only this, and no more, from a voice at the door: "The Red-Coats are out, and have passed Phips's farm."

Brooks was booted and spurred; he said never a word; Took his horn from its peg, and his gun from its rack; To the cold midnight air he led out his white mare, Strapped the girths and the bridle, and sprang to her back.

Up the North Country road at her full pace she strode, Till Brooks reined her up at John Tarbell's to say, "We have got the alarm,--they have left Phips's farm; You rouse the East Precinct, and I'll go this way."

John called his hired man, and they harnessed the span; They roused Abram Garfield, and Abram called me: "Turn out right away; let no minute-man stay; The Red-Coats have landed at Phips's," says he.

By the Powder-House Green seven others fell in; At Nahum's, the men from the Saw-Mill came down; So that when Jabez Bland gave the word of command, And said, "Forward, march!" there marched forward THE TOWN.

Parson Wilderspin stood by the side of the road, And he took off his hat, and he said, "Let us pray! O Lord, God of might, let thine angels of light Lead thy children to-night to the glories of day! And let thy stars fight all the foes of the Right As the stars fought of old against Sisera."

And from heaven's high arch those stars blessed our march, Till the last of them faded in twilight away; And with morning's bright beam, by the bank of the stream, Half the county marched in, and we heard Davis say:

"On the King's own highway I may travel all day, And no man hath warrant to stop me," says he; "I've no man that's afraid, and I'll march at their head." Then he turned to the boys,--"Forward, march! Follow me."

And we marched as he said, and the Fifer he played The old "White Cockade," and he played it right well. We saw Davis fall dead, but no man was afraid; That bridge we'd have had, though a thousand men fell.

This opened the play, and it lasted all day. We made Concord too hot for the Red-Coats to stay; Down the Lexington way we stormed, black, white, and gray; We were first in the feast, and were last in the fray.

They would turn in dismay, as red wolves turn at bay. They levelled, they fired, they charged up the road. Cephas Willard fell dead; he was shot in the head As he knelt by Aunt Prudence's well-sweep to load.

John Danforth was hit just in Lexington Street, John Bridge at that lane where you cross Beaver Falls, And Winch and the Snows just above John Munroe's,-- Swept away by one swoop of the big cannon-balls.

I took Bridge on my knee, but he said, "Don't mind me; Fill your horn from mine,--let me lie where I be. Our fathers," says he, "that their sons might be free, Left their king on his throne, and came over the sea; And that man is a knave or a fool who, to save His life for a minute, would live like a slave."

Well, all would not do! There were men good as new,-- From Rumford, from Saugus, from towns far away,-- Who filled up quick and well for each soldier that fell; And we drove them, and drove them, and drove them, all day. We knew, every one, it was war that begun, When that morning's marching was only half done.

In the hazy twilight, at the coming of night, I crowded three buckshot and one bullet down. 'Twas my last charge of lead; and I aimed her and said, "Good luck to you, lobsters, in old Boston Town."

In a barn at Milk Row, Ephraim Bates and Munroe And Baker and Abram and I made a bed. We had mighty sore feet, and we'd nothing to eat; But we'd driven the Red-Coats, and Amos, he said: "It's the first time," says he, "that it's happened to me To march to the sea by this road where we've come; But confound this whole day, but we'd all of us say We'd rather have spent it this way than to home."

* * * * *

The hunt had begun with the dawn of the sun, And night saw the wolf driven back to his den. And never since then, in the memory of men, Has the Old Bay State seen such a hunting again.

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

April 19, 1882.

THE KING'S OWN REGULARS

AND THEIR TRIUMPH OVER THE IRREGULARS

Since you all will have singing, and won't be said nay, I cannot refuse, when you so beg and pray; So I'll sing you a song,--as a body may say, 'Tis of the King's Regulars, who ne'er ran away. _Oh! the old soldiers of the King, and the King's own Regulars._

At Prestonpans we met with some rebels one day, We marshalled ourselves all in comely array; Our hearts were all stout, and bid our legs stay, But our feet were wrong-headed and took us away.

At Falkirk we resolved to be braver, And recover some credit by better behavior: We wouldn't acknowledge feet had done us a favor, So feet swore they would stand, but--legs ran however.

No troops perform better than we at reviews, We march and we wheel, and whatever you choose, George would see how we fight, and we never refuse, There we all fight with courage--you may see 't in the news.

To Monongahela, with fifes and with drums, We marched in fine order, with cannon and bombs; That great expedition cost infinite sums, But a few irregulars cut us all into crumbs.

It was not fair to shoot at us from behind trees, If they had stood open, as they ought, before our great guns, we should have beat them with ease, They may fight with one another that way if they please, But it is not _regular_ to stand, and fight with such rascals as these.

At Fort George and Oswego, to our great reputation, We show'd our vast skill in fortification; The French fired three guns;--of the fourth they had no occasion; For we gave up those forts, not through fear, but mere persuasion.

To Ticonderoga we went in a passion, Swearing to be revenged on the whole French nation; But we soon turned tail, without hesitation, Because they fought behind trees, which is not the _regular_ fashion.

Lord Loudon, he was a regular general, they say; With a great regular army he went on his way, Against Louisburg, to make it his prey, But returned--without seeing it,--for he didn't _feel bold_ that day.

Grown proud at reviews, great George had no rest, Each grandsire, he had heard, a rebellion suppressed, He wish'd a rebellion, looked round and saw none, So resolved a rebellion to make--of his own.

The Yankees he bravely pitched on, because he thought they wouldn't fight, And so he sent us over to take away their right; But lest they should spoil our review clothes, he cried braver and louder, For God's sake, brother kings, don't sell the cowards any powder.

Our general with his council of war did advise How at Lexington we might the Yankees surprise; We march'd--and re-marched--all surprised--at being beat; And so our wise general's plan of _surprise_--was complete.

For fifteen miles, they follow'd and pelted us, we scarce had time to pull a trigger; But did you ever know a retreat performed with more vigor? For we did it in two hours, which saved us from perdition; 'Twas not in _going out_, but in _returning_, consisted our EXPEDITION.

Says our general, "We were forced to take to our _arms_ in our defence (For _arms_ read _legs_, and it will be both truth and sense), Lord Percy (says he), I must say something of him in civility, And that is--'I can never enough praise him for his great--agility.'"

Of their firing from behind fences he makes a great pother; Every fence has two sides, they made use of one, and we only forgot to use the other; Then we turned our backs and ran away so fast; don't let that disgrace us, 'Twas only to make good what Sandwich said, that the Yankees--could not face us.

As they could not get before us, how could they look us in the face? We took care they shouldn't, by scampering away apace. That they had not much to brag of, is a very plain case; For if they beat us in the fight, we beat them in the race.

Pennsylvania Evening Post, March 30, 1776.

How the alarm of the fight spread through the countryside, how men left the plough, the loom, the anvil, and hastened, musket in hand, to the land's defence that day, has been told and retold in song and story. Here is the story of Morgan Stanwood, one among hundreds such.

MORGAN STANWOOD

CAPE ANN, 1775

Morgan Stanwood, patriot! Little more is known; Nothing of his home is left But the door-step stone.

Morgan Stanwood, to our thought You return once more; Once again the meadows lift Daisies to your door.

Once again the morn is sweet, Half the hay is down,-- Hark! what means that sudden clang From the distant town?

Larum bell and rolling drum Answer sea-borne guns; Larum bell and rolling drum Summon Freedom's sons!

And the mower thinks to him Cry both bell and drum, "Morgan Stanwood, where art thou? Here th' invaders come!"

"Morgan Stanwood" need no more Bell and drum-beat call; He is one who, hearing once, Answers once for all.

Ne'er the mower murmured then, "Half my grass is mown, Homespun isn't soldier-wear, Each may save his own."

Fallen scythe and aftermath Lie forgotten now; Winter need may come and find But a barren mow.

Down the musket comes. "Good wife,-- Wife, a quicker flint!" And the face that questions face Hath no color in 't.

"Wife, if I am late to-night, Milk the heifer first;-- Ruth, if I'm not home at all,-- Worse has come to worst."

Morgan Stanwood sped along, Not the common road; Over wall and hill-top straight, Straight to death, he strode;

Leaving her to hear at night Tread of burdened men, By the gate and through the gate, At the door, and then--

Ever after that to hear, When the grass is sweet, Through the gate and through the night, Slowly coming feet.

Morgan Stanwood's roof is gone; Here the door-step lies; One may stand thereon and think,-- For the thought will rise,--

Were we where the meadow was, Mowing grass alone, Would we go the way he went, From this very stone?

Were we on the door-step here, Parting for a day, Would we utter words as though Parting were for aye?

Would we? Heart, the hearth is dear, Meadow-math is sweet; Parting be as parting may, After all, we meet.

HIRAM RICH.

Tidings of the fight reached Northboro' early in the afternoon, while a company of minute-men were listening to a patriotic address. They shouldered their muskets and started at once for the firing line.

THE MINUTE-MEN OF NORTHBORO'

[April 19, 1775]

'Tis noonday by the buttonwood, with slender-shadowed bud; 'Tis April by the Assabet, whose banks scarce hold his flood; When down the road from Marlboro' we hear a sound of speed-- A cracking whip and clanking hoofs--a case of crying need! And there a dusty rider hastes to tell of flowing blood, Of troops a-field, of war abroad, and many a desperate deed.

The Minute-Men of Northboro' were gathering that day To hear the Parson talk of God, of Freedom and the State; They throng about the horseman, drinking in all he should say, Beside the perfumed lilacs blooming by the Parson's gate:

"The British march from Boston through the night to Lexington; Revere alarms the countryside to meet them ere the sun; Upon the common, in the dawn, the red-coat butchers slay; On Concord march, and there again pursue their murderous way; We drive them back; we follow on; they have begun to run: All Middlesex and Worcester's up: Pray God, ours is the day!"

The Minute-Men of Northboro' let rust the standing plough, The seed may wait, the fertile ground up-smiling to the spring. They seize their guns and powder-horns; there is no halting now, At thought of homes made fatherless by order of the King.

The pewter-ware is melted into bullets--long past due, The flints are picked, the powder's dry, the rifles shine like new. Within their Captain's yard enranked they hear the Parson's prayer Unto the God of armies for the battles they must share; He asks that to their Fathers and their Altars they be true, For Country and for Liberty unswervingly to dare.

The Minute-Men of Northboro' set out with drum and fife; With shining eyes they've blest their babes and bid their wives good-by. The hands that here release the plough have taken up a strife That shall not end until all earth has heard the battle-cry.

At every town new streams of men join in the mighty flow; At every crossroad comes the message of a fleeing foe: The British force, though trebled, fails against the advancing tide. Our rifles speak from fence and tree--in front, on every side. The British fall: the Minute-Men have mixed with bitterest woe Their late vainglorious vaunting and their military pride.

The Minute-Men of Northboro' they boast no martial air; No uniforms gleam in the sun where on and on they plod; But generations yet unborn their valor shall declare; They strike for Massachusetts Bay; they serve New England's God.

The hirelings who would make us slaves themselves are backward hurled, On Worcester and on Middlesex their flag's forever furled. Theirs was the glinting pomp of war; ours is the victor's prize: That day of bourgeoning has seen a race of freemen rise. A Nation born in fearlessness stands forth before the world With God her shield, the Right her sword, and Freedom in her eyes.

The Minute-Men of Northboro' sit down by Boston-town; They fight and bleed at Bunker Hill; they cheer for Washington. In thankfulness they speed their bolt against the British Crown; And take the plough again in peace, their warrior's duty done.

WALLACE RICE.

LEXINGTON

[1775]

No Berserk thirst of blood had they, No battle-joy was theirs, who set Against the alien bayonet Their homespun breasts in that old day.

Their feet had trodden peaceful ways; They loved not strife, they dreaded pain; They saw not, what to us is plain, That God would make man's wrath His praise.

No seers were they, but simple men; Its vast results the future hid: The meaning of the work they did Was strange and dark and doubtful then.

Swift as their summons came they left The plough mid-furrow standing still, The half-ground corn grist in the mill, The spade in earth, the axe in cleft.

They went where duty seemed to call, They scarcely asked the reason why; They only knew they could but die, And death was not the worst of all!

Of man for man the sacrifice, All that was theirs to give, they gave. The flowers that blossomed from their grave Have sown themselves beneath all skies.

Their death-shot shook the feudal tower, And shattered slavery's chain as well; On the sky's dome, as on a bell, Its echo struck the world's great hour.

That fateful echo is not dumb: The nations listening to its sound Wait, from a century's vantage-ground, The holier triumphs yet to come,--

The bridal time of Law and Love, The gladness of the world's release, When, war-sick, at the feet of Peace The hawk shall nestle with the dove!--

The golden age of brotherhood Unknown to other rivalries Than of the mild humanities, And gracious interchange of good,

When closer strand shall lean to strand, Till meet, beneath saluting flags, The eagle of our mountain-crags, The lion of our Motherland!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The news of the fight at Lexington spread with remarkable rapidity throughout the whole country, and nearly every colony at once took steps for the enlistment and training of a colonial militia. No stronger proof of the electric condition of the country could be offered than the way in which men everywhere rushed to arms.

THE RISING

From "The Wagoner of the Alleghanies"

Out of the North the wild news came, Far flashing on its wings of flame, Swift as the boreal light which flies At midnight through the startled skies.

And there was tumult in the air, The fife's shrill note, the drum's loud beat, And through the wild land everywhere The answering tread of hurrying feet, While the first oath of Freedom's gun Came on the blast from Lexington; And Concord, roused, no longer tame, Forgot her old baptismal name, Made bare her patriot arm of power, And swell'd the discord of the hour.

* * * * *

Within its shade of elm and oak The church of Berkeley Manor stood; There Sunday found the rural folk, And some esteem'd of gentle blood. In vain their feet with loitering tread Pass'd mid the graves where rank is naught; All could not read the lesson taught In that republic of the dead.

* * * * *

The pastor rose; the prayer was strong; The psalm was warrior David's song; The text, a few short words of might,-- "The Lord of hosts shall arm the right!" He spoke of wrongs too long endured, Of sacred rights to be secured; Then from his patriot tongue of flame The startling words for Freedom came. The stirring sentences he spake Compell'd the heart to glow or quake, And, rising on his theme's broad wing, And grasping in his nervous hand The imaginary battle-brand, In face of death he

dared to fling Defiance to a tyrant King.

Even as he spoke, his frame, renewed In eloquence of attitude, Rose, as it seem'd, a shoulder higher; Then swept his kindling glance of fire From startled pew to breathless choir; When suddenly his mantle wide His hands impatient flung aside, And, lo! he met their wondering eyes Complete in all a warrior's guise.

A moment there was awful pause,-- When Berkeley cried, "Cease, traitor! cease! God's temple is the house of peace!" The other shouted, "Nay, not so, When God is with our righteous cause; His holiest places then are ours, His temples are our forts and towers That frown upon the tyrant foe; In this, the dawn of Freedom's day, There is a time to fight and pray!"

And now before the open door-- The warrior priest had order'd so-- The enlisting trumpet's sudden soar Rang through the chapel, o'er and o'er, Its long reverberating blow, So loud and clear, it seem'd the ear Of dusty death must wake and hear. And there the startling drum and fife Fired the living with fiercer life; While overhead, with wild increase, Forgetting its ancient toll of peace, The great bell swung as ne'er before. It seemed as it would never cease; And every word its ardor flung From off its jubilant iron tongue Was, "War! war! war!"

"Who dares"--this was the patriot's cry, As striding from the desk he came-- "Come out with me, in Freedom's name, For her to live, for her to die?" A hundred hands flung up reply, A hundred voices answer'd, "I!"

THOMAS BUCHANAN READ.

Early in May, news of the fight at Lexington reached Machias, Maine, and on the 11th a party of young men boarded the British armed schooner, Margaretta, which was in the harbor there, and forced her to surrender, after a loss of about twenty on each side.

THE PRIZE OF THE MARGARETTA[4]

[May 11, 1775]

I

Four young men, of a Monday morn, Heard that the flag of peace was torn;

Heard that "rebels" with sword and gun, Had fought the British at Lexington,

While they were far from that bloody plain, Safe on the green-clad shores of Maine.

With eyes that glittered, and hearts that burned, They talked of the glory their friends had earned,

And asked each other, "What can we do, So our hands may prove that our hearts are true?"

II

Silent the Margaretta lay, Out on the bosom of the bay;

On her masts rich bunting gleamed; Bravely the flag of England streamed.

The young men gazed at the tempting prize-- They wistfully glanced in each other's eyes;

Said one, "We can lower that cloth of dread And hoist the pine-tree flag instead.

"We are only boys to the old and sage; We have not yet come to manhood's age;

"But we can show them that, when there's need, Men may follow and boys may lead."

Tightly each other's hand they pressed, Loudly they cried, "We will do our best;

"The pine-tree flag, ere day is passed, Shall float from the Margaretta's mast."

III

They ran to a sloop that lay near by; They roused their neighbors, with hue and cry;

They doffed their hats, gave three loud cheers, And called for a crew of volunteers.

Their bold, brave spirit spread far and wide, And men came running from every side.

Curious armed were the dauntless ones, With axes, pitchforks, scythes, and guns;

They shouted, "Ere yet this day be passed, The pine-tree grows from the schooner's mast!"

IV

With sails all set, trim as could be, The Margaretta stood out to sea.

With every man and boy in place, The gallant Yankee sloop gave chase.

Rippled and foamed the sunlit seas; Freshened and sung the soft May breeze;

And came from the sloop's low deck, "Hurray! We're gaining on her! We'll win the day!"

A sound of thunder, echoing wide, Came from the Margaretta's side;

A deadly crash, and a loud death-yell, And one of the brave pursuers fell.

They aimed a gun at the schooner then, And sent the compliment back again;

He who at the helm of the schooner stood, Covered the deck with his rich life-blood.

V

Each burning to pay a bloody debt, The crews of the hostile vessels met;

The Western nation now to be, Made her first fight upon the sea.

And not till forty men were slain, Did the pine-tree flag a victory gain;

But at last the hearts of the Britons quailed, And grandly the patriot arm prevailed.

One of the youths, the deed to crown, Grasped the colors and pulled them down;

And raised, 'mid cries of wild delight, The pine-tree flag of blue and white.

And the truth was shown, for the world to read, That men may follow and boys may lead.

WILL CARLETON.

[4] From _Poems for Young Americans_, published by Harper & Bros.

In North Carolina, the men of Mecklenburg County met, May 31, and adopted their famous "Resolves," declaring that each provincial congress was invested with all legislative and executive powers for the government of the colonies, and should exercise them independently of Great Britain, until Parliament should resign its arbitrary pretensions. It was from these "Resolves" that the legend of the Mecklenburg "Declaration of Independence, said to have been signed May 20," originated.

THE MECKLENBURG DECLARATION

[May 20, 1775]

Oppressed and few, but freemen yet, The men of Mecklenburg had met Determined to be free, And crook no coward knee, Though Might in front and Treason at the back Brought death and ruin in their joint attack.

The tyrant's heel was on the land When Polk convoked his gallant band, And told in words full strong The bitter tale of wrong, Then came a whisper, like the storm's first waves: "We must be independent, or be slaves!"

But, hark! What hurried rider, this, With jaded horse and garb amiss, Whose look some woe proclaims, Ere he his mission names? He rides amain from far-off Lexington, And tells the blood-red news of war begun!

Then Brevard, Balch, and Kennon spoke The wise bold words that aye invoke Men to defend the right And scorn the despot's might; Until from all there rose the answering cry: "We will be independent, or we die."

When Alexander called the vote, No dastard "nay's" discordant note Broke on that holy air-- For dastard none was there! But in prompt answer to their country's call, They pledged life, fortune, sacred honor--all!

In solemn hush the people heard; With shout and cheer they caught the word: Independence! In that sign We grasp our right divine; For the tyrant's might and the traitor's hate Must yield to men who fight for God and State!

The hero shout flew on the breeze; Rushed from the mountains to the seas; Till all the land uprose, Their faces to their foes, Shook off the thraldom they so long had borne, And swore the oath that Mecklenburg had sworn!

And well those men maintained the right; They kept the faith, and fought the fight; Till Might and Treason both Fled fast before the oath Which brought the God of Freedom's battles down To place on patriot brows the victor's crown!

WILLIAM C. ELAM.

Up and down the land, in every city, town, and hamlet, men were drilling--with brooms and corn-stalks, when no muskets were available. The storm, which had been gathering for years, had burst at last.

A SONG

Hark! 'tis Freedom that calls, come, patriots, awake! To arms, my brave boys, and away: 'Tis Honor, 'tis Virtue, 'tis Liberty calls, And upbraids the too tedious delay. What pleasure we find in pursuing our foes, Thro' blood and thro' carnage we'll fly; Then follow, we'll soon overtake them, huzza! The tyrants are seized on, they die!

Triumphant returning with Freedom secur'd, Like men, we'll be joyful and gay--With our wives and our friends, we'll sport, love, and drink, And lose the fatigues of the day. 'Tis freedom alone gives a relish to mirth, But oppression all happiness sours; It will smooth life's dull passage, 'twill slope the descent, And strew the way over with flowers.

Pennsylvania Journal, May 31, 1775.

CHAPTER III

THE COLONISTS TAKE THE OFFENSIVE

A rustic army of nearly twenty thousand men quickly gathered about Boston to besiege Gage there; but its warlike spirit ran too high to be contented with passive and defensive measures. Benedict Arnold suggested that expeditions be sent against the fortresses at Ticonderoga and Crown Point, which commanded the northern approach to the Hudson and were of great strategic importance. The suggestion was at once adopted. Arnold was created colonel and set out to raise a regiment among the Berkshire Hills. When he arrived there, he found that Ethan Allen had already raised a force of Vermonters and started for Ticonderoga.

THE GREEN MOUNTAIN BOYS

[May 9, 1775]

I

Here halt we our march, and pitch our tent On the rugged forest-ground, And light our fire with the branches rent By winds from the beeches round. Wild storms have torn this ancient wood, But a wilder is at hand, With hail of iron and rain of blood, To sweep and waste the land.

II

How the dark wood rings with our voices shrill, That startle the sleeping bird! To-morrow eve must the voice be still, And the step must fall unheard. The Briton lies by the blue Champlain, In Ticonderoga's towers, And ere the sun rise twice again, Must they and the lake be ours.

III

Fill up the bowl from the brook that glides Where the fire-flies light the brake; A ruddier juice the Briton hides In his fortress by the lake. Build high the fire, till the panther leap From his lofty perch in flight, And we'll strengthen our weary arms with sleep For the deeds of to-morrow night.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

Arnold overtook Allen and his "Green Mountain Boys" on May 9, and accompanied the expedition as a volunteer. At daybreak of the 10th, Allen and Arnold, with eighty-three men, crossed Lake Champlain and entered Ticonderoga side by side. The garrison was completely surprised and surrendered the stronghold without a blow.

THE SURPRISE AT TICONDEROGA

[May 10, 1775]

'Twas May upon the mountains, and on the airy wing Of every floating zephyr came pleasant sounds of spring,-- Of robins in the orchards, brooks running clear and warm, Or chanticleer's shrill challenge from busy farm to farm.

But, ranged in serried order, attent on sterner noise, Stood stalwart Ethan Allen and his "Green Mountain Boys,"-- Two hundred patriots listening, as with the ears of one, To the echo of the muskets that blazed at Lexington!

"My comrades,"--thus the leader spake to his gallant band,-- "The key of all the Canadas is in King George's hand, Yet, while his careless warders our slender armies mock, Good Yankee swords--God willing--may pick his rusty lock!"

At every pass a sentinel was set to guard the way, Lest the secret of their purpose some idle lip betray, As on the rocky highway they marched with steady feet To the rhythm of the brave hearts that in their bosoms beat.

The curtain of the darkness closed 'round them like a tent, When, travel-worn and weary, yet not with courage spent, They halted on the border of slumbering Champlain, And saw the watch lights glimmer across the glassy plain.

O proud Ticonderoga, enthroned amid the hills! O bastions of old Carillon, the "Fort of Chiming Rills!" Well might your quiet garrison have trembled where they lay, And, dreaming, grasped their sabres against the dawn of day!

In silence and in shadow the boats were pushed from shore, Strong hands laid down the musket to ply the muffled oar; The startled ripples whitened and whispered in their wake, Then sank again, reposing, upon the peaceful lake.

Fourscore and three they landed, just as the morning gray Gave warning on the hilltops to rest not or delay; Behind, their comrades waited, the fortress frowned before, And the voice of Ethan Allen was in their ears once more:

"Soldiers, so long united--dread scourge of lawless power! Our country, torn and bleeding, calls to this desperate hour. One choice alone is left us, who hear that high behest-- To quit our claims to valor, or put them to the test!

"I lead the storming column up yonder fateful hill, Yet not a man shall follow save at his ready will! There leads no pathway backward--'tis death or victory! Poise each his trusty firelock, ye that will come with me!"

From man to man a tremor ran at their captain's word (Like the "going" in the mulberry-trees that once King David heard),-- While his eagle glances sweeping adown the triple line, Saw, in the glowing twilight, each even barrel shine!

"Right face, my men, and forward!" Low-spoken, swift-obeyed! They mount the slope unfaltering--they gain the esplanade! A single drowsy sentry beside the wicket-gate, Snapping his aimless fusil, shouts the alarm--too late!

They swarm before the barracks--the quaking guards take flight, And such a shout resultant resounds along the height, As rang from shore and headland scarce twenty years ago, When brave Montcalm's defenders charged on a British foe!

Leaps from his bed in terror the ill-starred Delaplace, To meet across his threshold a wall he may not pass! The bayonets' lightning flashes athwart his dazzled eyes, And, in tones of sudden thunder, "Surrender!" Allen cries.

"Then in whose name the summons?" the ashen lips reply. The mountaineer's stern visage turns proudly to the sky,-- "In the name of great Jehovah!" he speaks with lifted sword, "And the Continental Congress, who wait upon his word!"

Light clouds, like crimson banners, trailed bright across the east, As the great sun rose in splendor above a conflict ceased, Gilding the bloodless triumph for equal rights and laws, As with the smile of heaven upon a holy cause.

Still, wave on wave of verdure, the emerald hills arise, Where once were heroes mustered from men of common guise, And still, on Freedom's roster, through all her glorious years, Shine the names of Ethan Allen and his bold volunteers!

MARY A. P. STANSBURY.

The Continental army at Cambridge, meanwhile, was busy day and night, drilling and getting into shape. It was at this time that "a gentleman of Connecticut," whose name, it is said, was Edward Bangs, described his visit to the camp in verses destined

to become famous. They were printed originally as a broadside.

THE YANKEE'S RETURN FROM CAMP

[June, 1775]

Father and I went down to camp, Along with Captain Gooding, And there we see the men and boys, As thick as hasty pudding. _Chorus_--Yankee Doodle, keep it up, Yankee Doodle, dandy, Mind the music and the step, And with the girls be handy.

And there we see a thousand men, As rich as 'Squire David; And what they wasted every day I wish it could be savèd.

The 'lasses they eat every day Would keep an house a winter; They have as much that, I'll be bound, They eat it when they're a mind to.

And there we see a swamping gun, Large as a log of maple, Upon a deucèd little cart, A load for father's cattle.

And every time they shoot it off, It takes a horn of powder, And makes a noise like father's gun, Only a nation louder.

I went as nigh to one myself As Siah's underpinning; And father went as nigh again, I thought the deuce was in him.

Cousin Simon grew so bold, I thought he would have cocked it; It scared me so, I shrinked it off, And hung by father's pocket.

And Captain Davis had a gun, He kind of clapt his hand on 't, And stuck a crooked stabbing iron Upon the little end on 't.

And there I see a pumpkin shell As big as mother's bason; And every time they touched it off, They scampered like the nation.

I see a little barrel, too, The heads were made of leather, They knocked upon 't with little clubs And called the folks together.

And there was Captain Washington, And gentlefolks about him, They say he's grown so tarnal proud He will not ride without 'em.

He got him on his meeting clothes, Upon a strapping stallion, He set the world along in rows, In hundreds and in millions.

The flaming ribbons in his hat, They looked so tearing fine ah, I wanted pockily to get, To give to my Jemimah.

I see another snarl of men A digging graves, they told me, So tarnal long, so tarnal deep, They 'tended they should hold me.

It scared me so, I hooked it off, Nor stopped, as I remember, Nor turned about, till I got home, Locked up in mother's chamber.

EDWARD BANGS.

Howe, Clinton, and Burgoyne arrived, May 25, with reinforcements which raised the British force in Boston to ten thousand men, and plans were at once made to extend the lines to cover Charlestown and Dorchester, the occupation of which by the Americans would render Boston untenable. Confident of victory, Gage, on June 12, issued a proclamation offering pardon to all rebels who should lay down their arms and return to their allegiance, save only John Hancock and Samuel Adams. At the same time, all who remained in arms were threatened with the gallows.

TOM GAGE'S PROCLAMATION;

OR BLUSTERING DENUNCIATION (REPLETE WITH DEFAMATION) THREATENING DEVASTATION, AND SPEEDY JUGULATION, OF THE NEW ENGLISH NATION.--WHO SHALL HIS PIOUS WAYS SHUN?

[June 12, 1775]

Whereas the rebels hereabout Are stubborn still, and still hold out; Refusing yet to drink their tea, In spite of Parliament and me; And to maintain their bubble, Right, Prognosticate a real fight; Preparing flints, and guns, and ball, My army and the fleet to maul; Mounting their guilt to such a pitch, As to let fly at soldiers' breech; Pretending they design'd a trick, Tho' ordered not to hurt a chick; But peaceably, without alarm, The men of Concord to disarm; Or, if resisting, to annoy, And every magazine destroy:-- All which, tho' long obliged to bear, Thro' want of men, and not of fear; I'm able now by augmentation, To give a proper castigation; For since th' addition to the troops, Now reinforc'd as thick as hops; I can, like Jeremey at the Boyne, Look safely on--fight you, Burgoyne; And now, like grass, the rebel Yankees, I fancy not these doodle dances:-- Yet, e'er I draw the vengeful sword, I have thought fit to send abroad, This present gracious proclamation, Of purpose mild the demonstration, That whosoe'er keeps gun or pistol, I'll spoil the motion of his systole; Or, whip his ----, or cut his weason, As haps the measure of his treason:-- But every one that will lay down His hanger bright, and musket brown, Shall not be beat, nor bruis'd, nor bang'd, Much less for past offences hang'd; But on surrendering his toledo, Go to and fro unhurt as we do:-- But then I must, out of this plan, lock Both Samuel Adams and John Hancock; For those vile traitors (like debentures) Must be tucked up at all adventures; As any proffer of a pardon, Would only tend those rogues to harden:-- But every other mother's son, The instant he destroys his gun (For thus doth run the King's command), May, if he will, come kiss my hand.-- And to prevent such wicked game, as Pleading the plea of ignoramus, Be this my proclamation spread To every reader that can read:-- And as nor law nor right was known Since my arrival in this town, To remedy this fatal flaw, I hereby publish martial law. Meanwhile, let all, and every one Who loves his life, forsake his gun; And all the council, by mandamus, Who have been reckoned so infamous, Return unto their habitation, Without or let or molestation.-- Thus graciously the war I wage, As witnesseth my hand,--TOM GAGE.

By command of MOTHER CARY, Thomas Flucker, Secretary.

Pennsylvania Journal, June 28, 1775.

The Committee of Safety received intelligence of Gage's plans and ordered out a force of twelve hundred men to take possession of Bunker Hill in Charlestown. At sunset of June 16 this brigade started from Cambridge, under command of Colonel William Prescott, a veteran of the French War. On reaching Bunker Hill, a consultation was held, and it was decided to push on to Breed's Hill, and erect a fortification there. Breed's Hill was reached about midnight, and the work of throwing up intrenchments began at once.

THE EVE OF BUNKER HILL

[June 16, 1775]

'Twas June on the face of the earth, June with the rose's breath, When life is a gladsome thing, and a distant dream is death; There was gossip of birds in the air, and a lowing of herds by the wood, And a sunset gleam in the sky that the heart of a man holds good; Then the nun-like Twilight came, violet-vestured and still, And the night's first star outshone afar on the eve of Bunker Hill.

There rang a cry through the camp, with its word upon rousing word; There was never a faltering foot in the ranks of those that heard;-- Lads from the Hampshire hills, and the rich Connecticut vales, Sons of the old Bay Colony, from its shores and its inland dales; Swiftly they fell in line; no fear could their valor chill; Ah, brave the show as they ranged a-row on the eve of Bunker Hill!

Then a deep voice lifted a prayer to the God of the brave and the true, And the heads of the men were bare in the gathering dusk and dew; The heads of a thousand men were bowed as the pleading rose,-- _Smite Thou, Lord, as of old Thou smotest Thy people's foes! Oh, nerve Thy servants' arms to work with a mighty will!_ A hush, and then a loud _Amen!_ on the eve of Bunker Hill!

Now they are gone through the night with never a thought of fame, Gone to the field of a fight that shall win them a deathless name; Some shall never again behold the set of the sun, But lie like the Concord slain, and the slain of Lexington, Martyrs to Freedom's cause. Ah, how at their deeds we thrill, The men whose might made strong the height on the eve of Bunker Hill!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

June 17 dawned fair and bright, and the intrenchments were at once discovered by the British. A lively cannonade was opened upon them by the ships in the harbor, but without effect. At noon, three thousand veterans were ordered forward to rout out the "peasants," and by three o'clock in the afternoon had crossed the river and were ready to storm the intrenchments. Commanded by General Howe and General Pigot, they advanced steadily up the hill, only to be met by so terrific a fire that they gave way and retreated in disorder.

WARREN'S ADDRESS TO THE AMERICAN SOLDIERS

[June 17, 1775]

Stand! the ground's your own, my braves! Will ye give it up to slaves? Will ye look for greener graves? Hope ye mercy still? What's the mercy despots feel? Hear it in that battle-peal! Read it on yon bristling steel! Ask it,--ye who will.

Fear ye foes who kill for hire? Will ye to your homes retire? Look behind you! they're a-fire! And, before you, see Who have done it!--From the vale On they come!--And will ye quail?-- Leaden rain and iron hail Let their welcome be!

In the God of battles trust! Die we may,--and die we must; But, oh, where can dust to dust Be consigned so well, As where Heaven its dews shall shed On the martyred patriot's bed, And the rocks shall raise their head, Of his deeds to tell!

JOHN PIERPONT.

A pause followed, during which Charlestown was set on fire by shells from the fleet and was soon in a roaring blaze. Then a second time the British advanced to the assault; again the Americans held their fire, and again, at thirty yards, poured into the Redcoats so deadly a volley that they were forced to retreat.

THE BALLAD OF BUNKER HILL

We lay in the Trenches we'd dug in the Ground While _Phoebus_ blazed down from his glory-lined Car, And then from the lips of our Leader renown'd, These lessons we learn'd in the _Science of War_. "Let the Foeman draw nigh, Till the white of his Eye Is in range with your Rifles, and then, Lads, let fly! And shew to _Columbia_, to _Britain_, and _Fame_, How _Justice_ smiles aweful, when _Freemen_ take _aim_!"

The Regulars from Town to the Foot of the Hill Came in Barges and Rowboats, some great and some small, But they potter'd and dawdl'd, and twaddled, until We fear'd there would be no _Attack_ after all! Two men in red Coats Talk'd to one in long Boots, And all of them _pinted_ and _gestur'd_ like _Coots_, And we said,--as the Boys do upon _Training-Day_-- "If they waste all their _Time_ so, the _Sham-fight_ won't pay."

But when they got Ready, and All came along, The way they march'd up the _Hill-side_ wasn't slow, But we were not a-fear'd, and we welcomed 'em strong, Held our _Fire_ till the Word, and then laid the Lads low! ... But who shall declare The _End_ of the Affair? At Sundown there wasn't a Man of us there! But we didn't depart till we'd given them _Some_! When we burned up our Powder, we had to go _Home_!

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

So long a time elapsed after the second assault that it seemed for a time that the Americans would be left in possession of the field. In the confusion of the moment, no reinforcements were sent them, and Prescott, to his dismay, discovered that his supply of powder and ball was nearly exhausted.

BUNKER HILL

"Not yet, not yet; steady, steady!" On came the foe, in even line: Nearer and nearer to thrice paces nine. We looked into their eyes. "Ready!" A sheet of flame! A roll of death! They fell by scores; we held our breath! Then nearer still they came; Another sheet of flame! And brave men fled who never fled before. Immortal fight! Foreshadowing flight Back to the astounded shore.

Quickly they rallied, reinforced. Mid louder roar of ship's artillery, And bursting bombs and whistling musketry And shouts and groans, anear, afar, All the new din of dreadful war, Through their broad bosoms calmly coursed The blood of those stout farmers, aiming For freedom, manhood's birthrights claiming. Onward once more they came; Another sheet of deathful flame! Another and another still: They broke, they fled: Again they sped Down the green, bloody hill.

Howe, Burgoyne, Clinton, Gage, Stormed with commander's rage. Into each emptied barge They crowd fresh men for a new charge Up that great hill. Again their gallant blood we spill: That volley was the last: Our powder failed. On three sides fast The foe pressed in; nor quailed A man. Their barrels empty, with musket-stocks They fought, and gave death-dealing knocks, Till Prescott ordered the retreat. Then Warren fell; and through a leaden sleet, From Bunker Hill and Breed, Stark, Putnam, Pomeroy, Knowlton, Read, Led off the remnant of those heroes true, The foe too shattered to pursue. The ground they gained; but we The victory.

The tidings of that chosen band Flowed in a wave of power Over the shaken, anxious land, To men, to man, a sudden dower. From that stanch, beaming hour History took a fresh higher start; And when the speeding messenger, that bare The news that strengthened every heart, Met near the Delaware Riding to take command, The leader, who had just been named, Who was to be so famed, The steadfast, earnest Washington With hand uplifted cries, His great soul flashing to his eyes, "Our liberties are safe; the cause is won." A thankful look he cast to heaven, and then His steed he spurred, in haste to lead such noble men.

GEORGE H. CALVERT.

There was, in fact, a difference of opinion among the British generals as to continuing the assault. But Howe insisted that a third attempt be made, and at five o'clock it was ordered. For a moment, the advancing column was again shaken by the American fire, but the last cartridges were soon spent, and, at the bayonet point, the Americans were driven from their works and forced to retreat across Charlestown neck.

GRANDMOTHER'S STORY OF BUNKER-HILL BATTLE

AS SHE SAW IT FROM THE BELFRY

'Tis like stirring living embers when, at eighty, one remembers All the achings and the quakings of "the times that tried men's souls;" When I talk of _Whig_ and _Tory_, when I tell the _Rebel_ story, To you the words are ashes, but to me they're burning coals.

I had heard the muskets' rattle of the April running battle; Lord Percy's hunted soldiers, I can see their red coats still; But a deadly chill comes o'er me, as the day looms up before me, When a thousand men lay bleeding on the slopes of Bunker's Hill.

'Twas a peaceful summer's morning, when the first thing gave us warning Was the booming of the cannon from the river and the shore: "Child," says grandma, "what's the matter, what is all this noise and clatter? Have those scalping Indian devils come to murder us once more?"

Poor old soul! my sides were shaking in the midst of all my quaking, To hear her talk of Indians when the guns began to roar: She had seen the burning village, and the slaughter and the pillage, When the Mohawks killed her father with their bullets through his door.

Then I said, "Now, dear old granny, don't you fret and worry any, For I'll soon come back and tell you whether this is work or play; There can't be mischief in it, so I won't be gone a minute"-- For a minute then I started. I was gone the livelong day.

No time for bodice-lacing or for looking-glass grimacing; Down my hair went as I hurried, tumbling half-way to my heels; God forbid your ever knowing, when there's blood around her flowing, How the lonely, helpless daughter of a quiet household feels!

In the street I heard a thumping; and I knew it was the stumping Of the Corporal, our old neighbor, on that wooden leg he wore, With a knot of women round him,--it was lucky I had found him, So I followed with the others, and the Corporal marched before.

They were making for the steeple,--the old soldier and his people; The pigeons circled round us as we climbed the creaking stair. Just across the narrow river--oh, so close it made me shiver!-- Stood a fortress on the hill-top that but yesterday was bare.

Not slow our eyes to find it; well we knew who stood behind it, Though the earthwork hid them from us, and the stubborn walls were dumb: Here were sister, wife, and mother, looking wild upon each other, And their lips were white with terror as they said, THE HOUR HAS COME!

The morning slowly wasted, not a morsel had we tasted And our heads were almost splitting with the cannons' deafening thrill, When a figure tall and stately round the rampart strode sedately; It was PRESCOTT, one since told me; he commanded on the hill.

Every woman's heart grew bigger when we saw his manly figure, With the banyan buckled round it, standing up so straight and tall; Like a gentleman of leisure who is strolling out for pleasure, Through the storm of shells and cannon-shot he walked around the wall.

At eleven the streets were swarming, for the redcoats' ranks were forming; At noon in marching order they were moving to the piers; How the bayonets gleamed and glistened, as we looked far down, and listened To the trampling and the

drum-beat of the belted grenadiers!

At length the men have started, with a cheer (it seemed faint-hearted), In their scarlet regimentals, with their knapsacks on their backs, And the reddening, rippling water, as after a sea-fight's slaughter, Round the barges gliding onward blushed like blood along their tracks.

So they crossed to the other border, and again they formed in order; And the boats came back for soldiers, came for soldiers, soldiers still: The time seemed everlasting to us women faint and fasting,-- At last they're moving, marching, marching proudly up the hill.

We can see the bright steel glancing all along the lines advancing,-- Now the front rank fires a volley,--they have thrown away their shot; For behind their earthwork lying, all the balls above them flying, Our people need not hurry; so they wait and answer not.

Then the Corporal, our old cripple (he would swear sometimes and tipple),-- He had heard the bullets whistle (in the old French war) before,-- Calls out in words of jeering, just as if they all were hearing,-- And his wooden leg thumps fiercely on the dusty belfry floor:--

"Oh! fire away, ye villains, and earn King George's shillin's, But ye'll waste a ton of powder afore a 'rebel' falls; You may bang the dirt and welcome, they're as safe as Dan'l Malcolm Ten foot beneath the gravestone that you've splintered with your balls!"

In the hush of expectation, in the awe and trepidation Of the dread approaching moment, we are well-nigh breathless all; Though the rotten bars are failing on the rickety belfry railing, We are crowding up against them like the waves against a wall.

Just a glimpse (the air is clearer), they are nearer,--nearer,--nearer, When a flash--a curling smoke-wreath--then a crash--the steeple shakes-- The deadly truce is ended; the tempest's shroud is rended; Like a morning mist it gathered, like a thundercloud it breaks!

Oh the sight our eyes discover as the blue-black smoke blows over! The redcoats stretched in windrows as a mower rakes his hay; Here a scarlet heap is lying, there a headlong crowd is flying Like a billow that has broken and is shivered into spray.

Then we cried, "The troops are routed! they are beat--it can't be doubted! God be thanked, the fight is over!"--Ah! the grim old soldier's smile! "Tell us, tell us why you look so?" (we could hardly speak, we shook so),-- "Are they beaten? _Are_ they beaten? ARE they beaten?"--"Wait a while."

Oh the trembling and the terror! for too soon we saw our error: They are baffled, not defeated; we have driven them back in vain; And the columns that were scattered, round the colors that were tattered, Toward the sullen, silent fortress turn their belted breasts again.

All at once, as we are gazing, lo the roofs of Charlestown blazing! They have fired the harmless village; in an hour it will be down! The Lord in heaven confound them,

rain his fire and brimstone round them,-- The robbing, murdering redcoats, that would burn a peaceful town!

They are marching, stern and solemn; we can see each massive column As they near the naked earth-mound with the slanting walls so steep. Have our soldiers got faint-hearted, and in noiseless haste departed? Are they panic-struck and helpless? Are they palsied or asleep?

Now! the walls they're almost under! scarce a rod the foes asunder! Not a firelock flashed against them! up the earthwork they will swarm! But the words have scarce been spoken, when the ominous calm is broken, And a bellowing crash has emptied all the vengeance of the storm!

So again, with murderous slaughter, pelted backwards to the water, Fly Pigot's running heroes and the frightened braves of Howe; And we shout, "At last they're done for, it's their barges they have run for: They are beaten, beaten, beaten; and the battle's over now!"

And we looked, poor timid creatures, on the rough old soldier's features, Our lips afraid to question, but he knew what we would ask: "Not sure," he said; "keep quiet,--once more, I guess, they'll try it-- Here's damnation to the cut-throats!"--then he handed me his flask,

Saying, "Gal, you're looking shaky; have a drop of old Jamaiky; I'm afeard there'll be more trouble afore the job is done;" So I took one scorching swallow; dreadful faint I felt and hollow, Standing there from early morning when the firing was begun.

All through those hours of trial I had watched a calm clock dial, As the hands kept creeping, creeping,--they were creeping round to four, When the old man said, "They're forming with their bagonets fixed for storming: It's the death-grip that's a-coming,--they will try the works once more."

With brazen trumpets blaring, the flames behind them glaring, The deadly wall before them, in close array they come; Still onward, upward toiling, like a dragon's fold uncoiling,-- Like the rattlesnake's shrill warning the reverberating drum!

Over heaps all torn and gory--shall I tell the fearful story, How they surged above the breastwork, as a sea breaks over a deck; How, driven, yet scarce defeated, our worn-out men retreated, With their powder-horns all emptied, like the swimmers from a wreck?

It has all been told and painted; as for me, they say I fainted, And the wooden-legged old Corporal stumped with me down the stair: When I woke from dreams affrighted the evening lamps were lighted,-- On the floor a youth was lying; his bleeding breast was bare.

And I heard through all the flurry, "Send for WARREN! hurry! hurry! Tell him here's a soldier bleeding, and he'll come and dress his wound!" Ah, we knew not till the morrow told its tale of death and sorrow, How the starlight found him stiffened on the dark and bloody ground.

Who the youth was, what his name was, where the place from which he came was, Who had brought him from the battle, and had left him at our door, He could not speak to tell us; but 'twas one of our brave fellows, As the homespun plainly showed us which the dying soldier wore.

For they all thought he was dying, as they gathered round him crying,-- And they said, "Oh, how they'll miss him!" and, "What _will_ his mother do?" Then, his eyelids just unclosing like a child's that has been dozing, He faintly murmured, "Mother!"--and--I saw his eyes were blue.

"Why, grandma, how you're winking!" Ah, my child, it sets me thinking Of a story not like this one. Well, he somehow lived along; So we came to know each other, and I nursed him like a--mother, Till at last he stood before me, tall, and rosy-cheeked, and strong.

And we sometimes walked together in the pleasant summer weather,-- "Please to tell us what his name was?" Just your own, my little dear,-- There's his picture Copley painted: we became so well acquainted, That--in short, that's why I'm grandma, and you children all are here!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

In this last charge, the Americans met with an irreparable loss in the death of General Joseph Warren, who was shot through the head as he lingered on the field, loath to join in the retreat. He had hastened to the battlefield in the early morning, replying to the remonstrance of a friend, "Dulce et decorum est pro patria mori." He had just been appointed major-general, but refused the command tendered him by Prescott, saying that he was only too glad to serve as a volunteer aid.

THE DEATH OF WARREN

[June 17, 1775]

When the war-cry of Liberty rang through the land, To arms sprang our fathers the foe to withstand; On old Bunker Hill their entrenchments they rear, When the army is joined by a young volunteer. "Tempt not death!" cried his friends; but he bade them good-by, Saying, "Oh! it is sweet for our country to die!"

The tempest of battle now rages and swells, 'Mid the thunder of cannon, the pealing of bells; And a light, not of battle, illumes yonder spire-- Scene of woe and destruction;--'tis Charlestown on fire! The young volunteer heedeth not the sad cry But murmurs, "'Tis sweet for our country to die!"

With trumpets and banners the foe draweth near: A volley of musketry checks their career! With the dead and the dying the hill-side is strown, And the shout through our lines is, "The day is our own!" "Not yet," cries the young volunteer, "do they fly! Stand firm!--it is sweet for our country to die!"

Now our powder is spent, and they rally again;-- "Retreat!" says our chief, "since unarmed we remain!" But the young volunteer lingers yet on the field, Reluctant to fly, and disdaining to yield. A shot! Ah! he falls! but his life's latest sigh Is, "'Tis sweet,

oh, 'tis sweet for our country to die!"

And thus Warren fell! Happy death! noble fall! To perish for country at Liberty's call! Should the flag of invasion profane evermore The blue of our seas or the green of our shore, May the hearts of our people reëcho that cry,-- "'Tis sweet, oh, 'tis sweet for our country to die!"

EPES SARGENT.

The British loss in killed and wounded was 1054, while the American loss, incurred mainly in the last hand-to-hand struggle, was 449. The British had gained the victory, but the moral advantage was wholly with the Americans.

THE BATTLE OF BUNKER HILL

COMPOSED BY A BRITISH OFFICER, THE DAY AFTER THE BATTLE

It was on the seventeenth, by break of day, The Yankees did surprise us, With their strong works they had thrown up To burn the town and drive us.

But soon we had an order come, An order to defeat them; Like rebels stout, they stood it out, And thought we ne'er could beat them.

About the hour of twelve that day, An order came for marching, With three good flints and sixty rounds, Each man hoped to discharge them.

We marchèd down to the Long Wharf, Where boats were ready waiting; With expedition we embark'd, Our ships kept cannonading.

And when our boats all fillèd were With officers and soldiers, With as good troops as England had, To oppose who dare controul us?

And when our boats all fillèd were, We row'd in line of battle, Where showers of ball like hail did fly, Our cannon loud did rattle.

There was Copps' Hill battery, near Charlestown, Our twenty-fours they played; And the three frigates in the stream, That very well behaved.

The Glasgow frigate clear'd the shore, All at the time of landing, With her grape-shot and cannon-balls, No Yankee e'er could stand them.

And when we landed on the shore, We draw'd up all together; The Yankees they all mann'd their works, And thought we'd ne'er come thither.

But soon they did perceive brave Howe, Brave Howe, our bold commander; With grenadiers, and infantry, We made them to surrender.

Brave William Howe, on our right wing, Cried, "Boys, fight on like thunder; You soon will see the rebels flee, With great amaze and wonder."

Now some lay bleeding on the ground, And some fell fast a-running O'er hills and dales, and mountains high, Crying, "Zounds! brave Howe's a-coming."

They 'gan to play on our left wing, Where Pigot, he commanded; But we returned it back again, With courage most undaunted.

To our grape-shot and musket-balls, To which they were but strangers, They thought to come with sword in hand, But soon they found their danger.

And when their works we got into, And put them to the flight, sirs, Some of them did hide themselves, And others died of fright, sirs.

And when their works we got into, Without great fear or danger, The works they'd made were firm and strong, The Yankees are great strangers.

But as for our artillery, They all behavèd dinty; For while our ammunition held, We gave it to them plenty.

But our conductor, he got broke For his misconduct sure, sir; The shot he sent for twelve-pound guns, Were made for twenty-fours, sir.

There's some in Boston pleased to say, As we the field were taking, We went to kill their countrymen, While they their hay were making.

For such stout whigs I never saw, To hang them all I'd rather; For making hay with musket-balls, And buckshot mixt together.

Brave Howe is so considerate, As to guard against all dangers: He allows us half a pint a day-- To rum we are no strangers.

Long may he live by land and sea, For he's belov'd by many; The name of Howe the Yankees dread, We see it very plainly.

And now my song is at an end: And to conclude my ditty, It is the poor and ignorant, And only them, I pity.

But as for their king, John Hancock, And Adams, if they're taken, Their heads for signs shall hang up high, Upon that hill call'd Beacon.

On July 2, 1775, George Washington, who had, a fortnight before, been appointed commander-in-chief of the Continental army by the Congress then assembled in Philadelphia, arrived at Cambridge, and on the following day, under the shade of the great elm which is still standing near Cambridge Common, he took command of the sixteen thousand men composing the American forces.

THE NEW-COME CHIEF

From "Under the Old Elm"

[July 3, 1775]

Beneath our consecrated elm A century ago he stood, Famed vaguely for that old fight in the wood Whose red surge sought, but could not overwhelm The life foredoomed to wield our rough-hewn helm:-- From colleges, where now the gown To arms had yielded, from the town, Our rude self-summoned levies flocked to see The new-come chief and wonder which was he. No need to question long; close-lipped and

tall, Long trained in murder-brooding forests lone To bridle others' clamors and his own, Firmly erect, he towered above them all, The incarnate discipline that was to free With iron curb that armed democracy.

A motley rout was that which came to stare, In raiment tanned by years of sun and storm, Of every shape that was not uniform, Dotted with regimentals here and there; An army all of captains, used to pray And stiff in fight, but serious drill's despair, Skilled to debate their orders, not obey; Deacons were there, selectmen, men of note In half-tamed hamlets ambushed round with woods, Ready to settle Freewill by a vote, But largely liberal to its private moods; Prompt to assert by manners, voice, or pen, Or ruder arms, their rights as Englishmen, Nor much fastidious as to how and when: Yet seasoned stuff and fittest to create A thought-staid army or a lasting state: Haughty they said he was, at first; severe; But owned, as all men own, the steady hand Upon the bridle, patient to command, Prized, as all prize, the justice pure from fear, And learned to honor first, then love him, then revere. Such power there is in clear-eyed self-restraint And purpose clean as light from every selfish taint.

* * * * *

Never to see a nation born Hath been given to mortal man, Unless to those who, on that summer morn, Gazed silent when the great Virginian Unsheathed the sword whose fatal flash Shot union through the incoherent clash Of our loose atoms, crystallizing them Around a single will's unpliant stem, And making purpose of emotion rash, Out of that scabbard sprang, as from its womb, Nebulous at first but hardening to a star, Through mutual share of sunburst and of gloom, The common faith that made us what we are.

That lifted blade transformed our jangling clans, Till then provincial, to Americans, And made a unity of wildering plans; Here was the doom fixed; here is marked the date When this New World awoke to man's estate, Burnt its last ship and ceased to look behind: Nor thoughtless was the choice; no love or hate Could from its poise move that deliberate mind, Weighing between too early and too late Those pitfalls of the man refused by Fate: His was the impartial vision of the great Who see not as they wish, but as they find. He saw the dangers of defeat, nor less The incomputable perils of success; The sacred past thrown by, an empty rind; The future, cloud-land, snare of prophets blind; The waste of war, the ignominy of peace; On either hand a sullen rear of woes, Whose garnered lightnings none could guess, Piling its thunder-heads and muttering "Cease!" Yet drew not back his hand, but gravely chose The seeming-desperate task whence our new nation rose.

JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL.

Tory balladists found rich material for their rhymes in the undisciplined and motley army of which Washington was the head, but, strangely enough, the commander himself was the object of very few attacks of this kind. The following is almost the only one which has survived.

THE TRIP TO CAMBRIDGE

[July 3, 1775]

When Congress sent great Washington All clothed in power and breeches, To meet old Britain's warlike sons And make some rebel speeches;

'Twas then he took his gloomy way Astride his dapple donkeys, And travelled well, both night and day, Until he reach'd the Yankees.

Away from camp, 'bout three miles off, From Lily he dismounted. His sergeant brush'd his sun-burnt wig While he the specie counted.

All prinkèd up in _full_ bag-wig; The shaking notwithstanding, In leathers tight, oh! glorious sight! He reach'd the Yankee landing.

The women ran, the darkeys too; And all the bells, they tollèd; For Britain's sons, by Doodle doo, We're sure to be--consolèd.

Old mother Hancock with a pan All crowded full of butter, Unto the lovely Georgius ran, And added to the splutter.

Says she, "Our brindle has just calved, And John is wondrous happy. He sent this present to you, dear, As you're the 'country's papa.'"--

"You'll butter bread and bread butter, But do not butt your speeches. You'll butter bread and bread butter, But do not grease your breeches."

Full many a child went into camp, All dressed in homespun kersey, To see the greatest rebel scamp That ever cross'd o'er Jersey.

The rebel clowns, oh! what a sight! Too awkward was their figure. 'Twas yonder stood a pious wight, And here and there a nigger.

Upon a stump he placed (himself), Great Washington did he, And through the nose of lawyer Close, Proclaimed great Liberty.

The patriot brave, the patriot fair, From fervor had grown thinner, So off they march'd, with patriot zeal, And took a patriot dinner.

The Colonials, on the other hand, among whom he seems to have inspired almost instant respect and affection, made him the subject of many songs, the most popular of which was Sewall's "War and Washington," which was sung by soldiers and civilians during the whole Revolution.

WAR AND WASHINGTON

Vain Britons, boast no longer with proud indignity, By land your conquering legions, your matchless strength at sea, Since we, your braver sons incensed, our swords have girded on, Huzza, huzza, huzza, huzza, for war and Washington.

Urged on by North and vengeance those valiant champions came, Loud bellowing Tea and Treason, and George was all on flame, Yet sacrilegious as it seems, we rebels still live on, And laugh at all their empty puffs, huzza for Washington!

Still deaf to mild entreaties, still blind to England's good, You have for thirty pieces betrayed your country's blood. Like Esop's greedy cur you'll gain a shadow for your bone, Yet find us fearful shades indeed inspired by Washington.

Mysterious! unexampled! incomprehensible! The blundering schemes of Britain their folly, pride, and zeal, Like lions how ye growl and threat! mere asses have you shown, And ye shall share an ass's fate, and drudge for Washington!

Your dark unfathomed councils our weakest heads defeat, Our children rout your armies, our boats destroy your fleet, And to complete the dire disgrace, cooped up within a town, You live the scorn of all our host, the slaves of Washington!

Great Heaven! is this the nation whose thundering arms were hurled, Through Europe, Afric, India? whose navy ruled a world? The lustre of your former deeds, whole ages of renown, Lost in a moment, or transferred to us and Washington!

Yet think not thirst of glory unsheaths our vengeful swords To rend your bands asunder, or cast away your cords, 'Tis heaven-born freedom fires us all, and strengthens each brave son, From him who humbly guides the plough, to god-like Washington.

For this, oh could our wishes your ancient rage inspire, Your armies should be doubled, in numbers, force, and fire. Then might the glorious conflict prove which best deserved the boon, America or Albion, a George or Washington!

Fired with the great idea, our Fathers' shades would rise, To view the stern contention, the gods desert their skies; And Wolfe, 'midst hosts of heroes, superior bending down, Cry out with eager transport, God save great Washington!

Should George, too choice of Britons, to foreign realms apply, And madly arm half Europe, yet still we would defy Turk, Hessian, Jew, and Infidel, or all those powers in one, While Adams guards our senate, our camp great Washington!

Should warlike weapons fail us, disdaining slavish fears, To swords we'll beat our ploughshares, our pruning-hooks to spears, And rush, all desperate, on our foe, nor breathe till battle won, Then shout, and shout America! and conquering Washington!

Proud France should view with terror, and haughty Spain revere, While every warlike nation would court alliance here; And George, his minions trembling round, dismounting from his throne Pay homage to America and glorious Washington!

JONATHAN MITCHELL SEWALL.

While the army at Cambridge was getting into shape to assume the offensive, the British were by no means idle. They recovered St. John's, which Arnold had captured in May, and a fleet under Admiral Wallace ravaged the shores of Narragansett Bay. On October 7, 1775, he bombarded the town of Bristol, which had refused to furnish him with supplies,--an incident which is described in one of the most ingenuous and amusing of Revolutionary ballads.

THE BOMBARDMENT OF BRISTOL

[October 7, 1775]

In seventeen hundred and seventy-five, Our Bristol town was much surprised By a pack of thievish villains, That will not work to earn their livings.

October 'twas the seventh day, As I have heard the people say, Wallace, his name be ever curst, Came on our harbor just at dusk.

And there his ship did safely moor, And quickly sent his barge on shore, With orders that should not be broke, Or they might expect a smoke.

Demanding that the magistrates Should quickly come on board his ship, And let him have some sheep and cattle, Or they might expect a battle.

At eight o'clock, by signal given, Our peaceful atmosphere was riven By British balls, both grape and round, As plenty afterwards were found.

But oh! to hear the doleful cries Of people running for their lives! Women, with children in their arms, Running away to the farms!

With all their firing and their skill They did not any person kill; Neither was any person hurt But the Reverend Parson Burt.

And he was not killed by a ball, As judged by jurors one and all; But being in a sickly state, He, frightened, fell, which proved his fate.

Another truth to you I'll tell, That you may see they levelled well; For aiming for to kill the people, They fired their shot into a steeple.

They fired low, they fired high, The women scream, the children cry; And all their firing and their racket Shot off the topmast of a packet.

From the moment, almost, of the fight at Lexington, the conquest of Canada had been dreamed of, and in September, 1775, a force of two thousand men, under General Richard Montgomery, started for Quebec. He was joined by another force under Benedict Arnold, and an attempt was made to carry the citadel by storm. But Montgomery fell as he led the way over the walls, Arnold was wounded, and the Americans were beaten back.

MONTGOMERY AT QUEBEC

[December 31, 1775]

Round Quebec's embattled walls Moodily the patriots lay; Dread disease within its thralls Drew them closer day by day; Till from suffering man to man, Mutinous, a murmur ran.

Footsore, they had wandered far, They had fasted, they had bled; They had slept beneath the star With no pillow for the head; Was it but to freeze to stone In this cruel icy zone?

Yet their leader held his heart, Naught discouraged, naught dismayed; Quelled with unobtrusive art Those that muttered; unafraid Waited, watchful, for the hour

When his golden chance should flower.

'Twas the death-tide of the year; Night had passed its murky noon; Through the bitter atmosphere Pierced nor ray of star nor moon; But upon the bleak earth beat Blinding arrows of the sleet.

While the trumpets of the storm Pealed the bastioned heights around, Did the dauntless heroes form, Did the low, sharp order sound. "Be the watchword _Liberty_!" Cried the brave Montgomery.

Here, where he had won applause, When Wolfe faced the Gallic foe, For a nobler, grander cause Would he strike the fearless blow,-- Smite at Wrong upon the throne, At Injustice giant grown.

"Men, you will not fear to tread Where your general dares to lead! On, my valiant boys!" he said, And his foot was first to speed; Swiftly up the beetling steep, Lion-hearted, did he leap.

Flashed a sudden blinding glare; Roared a fearsome battle-peal; Rang the gloomy vasts of air; Seemed the earth to rock and reel; While adown that fiery breath Rode the hurtling bolts of death.

Woe for him, the valorous one, Now a silent clod of clay! Nevermore for him the sun Would make glad the paths of day; Yet 'twere better thus to die Than to cringe to tyranny!--

Better thus the life to yield, Striking for the right and God, Upon Freedom's gory field, Than to kiss Oppression's rod! Honor, then, for all time be To the brave Montgomery!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

Though the Americans had lost Canada, they were soon to gain Boston. During the winter of 1775-76, a great number of captured cannon had been dragged on sledges from Ticonderoga, the drilling of the army had gone steadily on, and at last Washington felt that he was able to assume the offensive, and on the night of March 4, 1776, he seized and fortified Dorchester Heights.

A SONG

[1776]

Smile, Massachusetts, smile, Thy virtue still outbraves The frowns of Britain's isle, The rage of home-born slaves. Thy free-born sons disdain their ease, When purchased by their liberties.

Thy genius, once the pride Of Britain's ancient isle, Brought o'er the raging tide By our forefathers' toil; In spite of North's despotic power, Shines glorious on this western shore.

In Hancock's generous mind Awakes the noble strife, Which so conspicuous shined In gallant Sydney's life; While in its cause the hero bled, Immortal honors crown'd his

head.

Let zeal your breasts inspire; Let wisdom guide your plans; 'Tis not your cause entire, On doubtful conflict hangs; The fate of this vast continent, And unborn millions share th' event.

To close the gloomy scenes Of this alarming day, A happy union reigns Through wide America. While awful Wisdom hourly waits To adorn the councils of her states.

Brave Washington arrives, Arrayed in warlike fame, While in his soul revives Great Marlboro's martial flame, To lead your conquering armies on To lasting glory and renown.

To aid the glorious cause, Experienc'd Lee has come, Renown'd in foreign wars, A patriot at home. While valiant Putnam's warlike deeds Amongst the foe a terror spreads.

Let Britons proudly boast, "That their two thousand braves Can drive our numerous host, And make us all their slaves;" While twice six thousand quake with fear, Nor dare without their lines appear.

Kind Heaven has deign'd to own Our bold resistance just, Since murderous Gage began The bloody carnage first. Near ten to one has been their cost, For each American we've lost.

Stand firm in your defence, Like Sons of Freedom fight, Your haughty foes convince That you'll maintain your right. Defiance bid to tyrants' frown, And glory will your valor crown.

The Connecticut Gazette, 1776.

Howe realized that Boston was untenable unless the Americans could be dislodged; but with the memory of Bunker Hill before him, he had no heart for the enterprise. While he hesitated, the American works were made well-nigh impregnable, and Howe decided to abandon the town. On March 17, 1776, the British troops, eight thousand in number, sailed away for Halifax. Washington at once took possession of the city.

A POEM CONTAINING SOME REMARKS ON THE PRESENT WAR

[March 17, 1776]

Britons grown big with pride And wanton ease, And tyranny beside, They sought to please Their craving appetite, They strove with all their might, They vow'd to rise and fight, To make us bow.

The plan they laid was deep Even like hell; With sympathy I weep, While here I tell Of that base murderous brood, Void of the fear of God, Who came to spill our blood In our own land.

They bid their armies sail Though billows roar, And take the first fair gale For Boston's shore; They cross'd the Atlantic sea A long and watery way, Poor Boston fell a prey To tyranny.

* * * * *

Gage was both base and mean, He dare not fight, The men he sent were seen Like owls in night: It was in Lexington Where patriots' blood did run Before the rising sun In crimson gore.

Here sons of freedom fell Rather than flee, Unto those brutes of hell They fell a prey; But they shall live again, Their names shall rise and reign Among the noble slain In all our land.

But oh! this cruel foe Went on in haste, To Concord they did go, And there did waste Some stores in their rage, To gratify old Gage, His name in every page Shall be defam'd.

Their practice thus so base, And murder too, Rouz'd up the patriot race, Who did pursue, And put this foe to flight, They could not bear the light, Some rued the very night They left their den.

And now this cruelty Was spread abroad, The sons of liberty This act abhorr'd, Their noble blood did boil, Forgetting all the toil, In troubles they could smile, And went in haste.

Our army willingly Did then engage, To stop the cruelty Of tyrants' rage! They did not fear our foe, But ready were to go, And let the tyrants know Whose sons they were.

But when old Gage did see All us withstand, And strive for liberty Through all our land, He strove with all his might, For rage was his delight, With fire he did fight, A monster he.

On Charlestown he display'd His fire abroad; He it in ashes laid, An act abhorr'd By sons of liberty, Who saw the flames on high Piercing their native sky, And now lies waste.

To Bunker-Hill they came Most rapidly, And many there were slain, And there did die. They call'd it bloody hill, Altho' they gain'd their will In triumph they were still, 'Cause of their slain.

Here sons of freedom fought Right manfully, A wonder here was wrought Though some did die. Here WARREN bow'd to death, His last expiring breath, In language mild he saith, Fight on, brave boys.

Oh! this did stain the pride Of British troops, They saw they were deny'd Of their vain hopes Of marching thro' our land, When twice a feeble band, Did fight and boldly stand In our defence.

Brave WASHINGTON did come To our relief; He left his native home, Filled with grief, He did not covet gain, The cause he would maintain And die among the slain Rather than flee.

His bosom glow'd with love For liberty, His passions much did move To orphans' cry, He let proud tyrants know, How far their bounds should go And then his bombs did throw Into their den.

This frighted them full sore When bombs were sent, When cannon loud did roar They left each tent: Oh! thus did the tyrants fly, Went precipitately, Their shipping being nigh, They sailed off.

And now Boston is free From tyrants base, The sons of liberty Possess the place; They now in safety dwell. Free from those brutes of hell, Their raptur'd tongues do tell Their joys great.

A portion of the British fleet remained in Boston harbor, and apprehensions began to be felt that an effort would be made to recapture the town. It was at this juncture that Captain James Mugford, of the schooner Franklin, captured the British ship Hope, bound for Boston with supplies and fifteen hundred barrels of powder. Two days later, on May 19, the Franklin ran aground at Point Shirley, at the mouth of the harbor, and was at once attacked by boats from the British vessels. A sharp engagement ensued, in which Mugford was killed. His last words are said to have been those used by Lawrence nearly forty years later: "Don't give up the ship! You will beat them off!" And they did.

MUGFORD'S VICTORY

[May 17-19, 1776]

Our mother, the pride of us all, She sits on her crags by the shore, And her feet they are wet with the waves Whose foam is as flowers from the graves Of her sons whom she welcomes no more, And who answer no more to her call.

Amid weeds and sea-tangle and shells They are buried far down in the deep,-- The deep which they loved to career. Oh, might we awake them from sleep! Oh, might they our voices but hear, And the sound of our holiday bells!

Can it be she is thinking of them, Her face is so proud and so still, And her lashes are moistened with tears? Ho, little ones! pluck at her hem, Her lap with your jollity fill, And ask of her thoughts and her fears.

"Fears!"--we have roused her at last; See! her lips part with a smile, And laughter breaks forth from her eyes,-- "Fears! whence should they ever arise In our hearts, O my children, the while We can remember the past?

"Can remember that morning of May, When Mugford went forth with his men, Twenty, and all of them ours. 'Tis a hundred years to a day, And the sea and the shore are as then, And as bright are the grass and the flowers; But our twenty--they come not again!

"He had heard of the terrible need Of the patriot army there In Boston town. Now for a deed To save it from despair! To thrill with joy the great commander's heart, And hope new-born to all the land impart!

"Hope! ay; that was the very name Of the good ship that came From England far away, Laden with enginery of death, Food for the cannon's fiery breath; Hope-laden for great Washington, Who, but for her, was quite undone A hundred years ago to-day.

"'Oh, but to meet her there, And grapple with her fair, Out in the open bay!' Mugford to Glover said. How could he answer nay? And Mugford sailed away, Brave heart and newly wed.

"But what are woman's tears, And rosy cheeks made pale, To one who far off hears The generations hail A deed like this we celebrate to-day, A hundred years since Mugford sailed away!

"I love to picture him, Clear-eyed and strong of limb, Gazing his last upon the rocky shore His feet should press no more; Seeing the tall church-steeples fade away In distance soft and gray; So dropping down below the horizon's rim Where fame awaited him.

"Slow sailing from the east his victim came. They met; brief parley; struggle brief and tame, And she was ours; In Boston harbor safe ere set of sun, Great joy for Washington! But heavy grew the hours On Mugford's hands, longing to bring to me, His mother proud, news of his victory; But that was not to be!

"Abreast Nantasket's narrow strip of gray The British cruisers lay: They saw the daring skipper dropping down From the much-hated rebel-haunted town, And in the twilight dim Their boats awaited him, While wind and tide conspired To grant what they desired.

"Thickly they swarmed about his tiny craft; But Mugford gayly laughed And gave them blow for blow; And many a hapless foe Went hurtling down below. Upon the schooner's rail Fell, like a thresher's flail, The strokes that beat the soul and sense apart, And pistol-crack through many an eager heart Sent deadly hail. But when the fight was o'er, Brave Mugford was no more. Crying, with death-white lip, 'Boys, don't give up the ship!' His soul struck out for heaven's peaceful shore.

"We gave him burial meet; Through every sobbing street A thousand men marched with their arms reversed; And Parson Story told, In sentences of gold, The tale since then a thousand times rehearsed."

Such is the story she tells, Our mother, the pride of us all. Ring out your music, O bells, That ever such things could befall! Ring not for Mugford alone, Ring for the twenty unknown, Who fought hand-to-hand at his side, Who saw his last look when he died, And who brought him, though dead, to his own!

JOHN WHITE CHADWICK.

A month later, on June 14, 1775, the Continentals occupied various islands and points in the bay, and opened so hot a fire upon the British ships that they were finally forced to weigh anchor and sail away. The news of the capture of Boston and departure of the British was received with the greatest rejoicing throughout the country. Among the many songs composed to celebrate the event, one, "Off from

Boston," gained wide popularity.

OFF FROM BOSTON

Sons of valor, taste the glories Of celestial liberty, Sing a triumph o'er the Tories, Let the pulse of joy beat high.

Heaven hath this day foil'd the many Fallacies of George the King; Let the echo reach Britan'y, Bid her mountain summits ring.

See yon navy swell the bosom Of the late enragèd sea; Where'er they go, we shall oppose them, Sons of valor must be free.

Should they touch at fair Rhode Island, There to combat with the brave, Driven from each dale and highland, They shall plough the purple wave.

Should they thence to fair Virginia, Bend a squadron to Dunmore, Still with fear and ignominy, They shall quit the hostile shore.

To Carolina or to Georg'y, Should they next advance their fame, This land of heroes shall disgorge the Sons of tyranny and shame.

Let them rove to climes far distant, Situate under Arctic skies, Call on Hessian troops assistant, And the savages to rise.

Boast of wild brigades from Russia, To fix down the galling chain, Canada and Nova Scotia, Shall disgorge these hordes again.

In New York state, rejoin'd by Clinton, Should their standards mock the air, Many a surgeon shall put lint on Wounds of death receivèd there.

War, fierce war, shall break their forces, Nerves of Tory men shall fail, Seeing Howe, with alter'd courses, Bending to the western gale.

Thus from every bay of ocean, Flying back with sails unfurl'd, Tossed with ever-troubled motion, They shall quit this smiling world.

Like Satan banishèd from heaven, Never see the smiling shore; From this land, so happy, driven, Never stain its bosom more.

CHAPTER IV

INDEPENDENCE

At the outbreak of the Revolution very few, even of the more radical colonial leaders, thought of or desired complete independence from Great Britain. Samuel Adams was perhaps the first to proclaim this as the only solution of the problem which confronted the colonies. But the sentiment for independence grew steadily.

EMANCIPATION FROM BRITISH DEPENDENCE

[1775]

Libera nos, Domine--Deliver us, O Lord, Not only from British dependence, but also,

From a junto that labor for absolute power, Whose schemes disappointed have made them look sour; From the lords of the council, who fight against freedom Who still follow on where delusion shall lead 'em.

From groups at St. James's who slight our Petitions, And fools that are waiting for further submissions; From a nation whose manners are rough and abrupt, From scoundrels and rascals whom gold can corrupt.

From pirates sent out by command of the king To murder and plunder, but never to swing; From Wallace, and Graves, and _Vipers_, and _Roses_, Whom, if Heaven pleases, we'll give bloody noses.

From the valiant Dunmore, with his crew of banditti Who plunder Virginians at Williamsburg city, From hot-headed Montague, mighty to swear, The little fat man with his pretty white hair.

From bishops in Britain, who butchers are grown, From slaves that would die for a smile from the throne, From assemblies that vote against Congress' proceedings (Who now see the fruit of their stupid misleadings).

From Tryon, the mighty, who flies from our city, And swelled with importance, disdains the committee (But since he is pleased to proclaim us his foes, What the devil care we where the devil he goes).

From the caitiff, Lord North, who would bind us in chains, From our noble King Log, with his toothful of brains, Who dreams, and is certain (when taking a nap), He has conquered our lands as they lay on his map.

From a kingdom that bullies, and hectors, and swears, I send up to Heaven my wishes and prayers That we, disunited, may freemen be still, And Britain go on--to be damn'd if she will.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

On June 8 Richard Henry Lee submitted to the Continental Congress a motion "That these United Colonies are, and of right ought to be, free and independent States; that they are absolved from all allegiance to the British Crown; and that all political connection between them and the state of Great Britain is, and ought to be, totally dissolved." The debate on the motion began July 1.

RODNEY'S RIDE

[July 3, 1776]

In that soft mid-land where the breezes bear The North and South on the genial air, Through the county of Kent, on affairs of state, Rode Cæsar Rodney, the delegate.

Burly and big, and bold and bluff, In his three-cornered hat and coat of snuff, A foe to King George and the English State, Was Cæsar Rodney, the delegate.

Into Dover village he rode apace, And his kinsfolk knew, from his anxious face, It was matter grave that brought him there, To the counties three on the Delaware.

"Money and men we must have," he said, "Or the Congress fails and our cause is dead; Give us both and the King shall not work his will. We are men, since the blood of Bunker Hill!"

Comes a rider swift on a panting bay: "Ho, Rodney, ho! you must save the day, For the Congress halts at a deed so great, And your vote alone may decide its fate."

Answered Rodney then: "I will ride with speed; It is Liberty's stress; it is Freedom's need. When stands it?" "To-night. Not a moment to spare, But ride like the wind from the Delaware."

"Ho, saddle the black! I've but half a day, And the Congress sits eighty miles away-- But I'll be in time, if God grants me grace, To shake my fist in King George's face."

He is up; he is off! and the black horse flies On the northward road ere the "God-speed" dies; It is gallop and spur, as the leagues they clear, And the clustering mile-stones move a-rear.

It is two of the clock; and the fleet hoofs fling The Fieldboro's dust with a clang and a cling; It is three; and he gallops with slack rein where The road winds down to the Delaware.

Four; and he spurs into New Castle town, From his panting steed he gets him down-- "A fresh one, quick! not a moment's wait!" And off speeds Rodney, the delegate.

It is five; and the beams of the western sun Tinge the spires of Wilmington gold and dun; Six; and the dust of Chester Street Flies back in a cloud from the courser's feet.

It is seven; the horse-boat broad of beam, At the Schuylkill ferry crawls over the stream-- And at seven-fifteen by the Rittenhouse clock, He flings his reins to the tavern jock.

The Congress is met; the debate's begun, And Liberty lags for the vote of one-- When into the hall, not a moment late, Walks Cæsar Rodney, the delegate.

Not a moment late! and that half day's ride Forwards the world with a mighty stride; For the act was passed; ere the midnight stroke O'er the Quaker City its echoes woke.

At Tyranny's feet was the gauntlet flung; "We are free!" all the bells through the colonies rung, And the sons of the free may recall with pride The day of Delegate Rodney's ride.

The motion was put to a vote the following day, July 2, 1776, and was adopted by the unanimous vote of twelve colonies, the delegates from New York being excused

from voting, as they had no sufficient instructions. This having been decided, the Congress at once went into committee of the whole, to consider the form of declaration which should be adopted.

AMERICAN INDEPENDENCE

Make room, all ye kingdoms, in history renown'd, Whose arms have in battle with victory been crown'd, Make room for America, another great nation; She rises to claim in your councils a station.

Her sons fought for freedom, and by their own bravery Have rescued themselves from the shackles of slavery; America is free; and Britain's abhorr'd; And America's fame is forever restored.

Fair Freedom in Britain her throne had erected; Her sons they grew venal, and she disrespected. The goddess, offended, forsook that base nation, And fix'd on our mountains: a more honor'd station.

With glory immortal she here sits enthroned, Nor fears the vain vengeance of Britain disown'd, Great Washington guards her, with heroes surrounded; Her foes he, with shameful defeat, has confounded.

To arms! we to arms flew! 'twas Freedom invited us, The trumpet, shrill sounding, to battle excited us; The banners of virtue, unfurl'd, did wave o'er us, Our hero led on, and the foe flew before us.

In Heaven and Washington we placed reliance, We met the proud Britons, and bid them defiance; The cause we supported was just, and was glorious; When men fight for freedom, they must be victorious.

FRANCIS HOPKINSON.

A committee had already been appointed to draw up a paper which should be worthy this solemn occasion. Thomas Jefferson was its chairman, and was chosen to be the author of the Declaration. On the evening of July 4, 1776, the Declaration of Independence was unanimously adopted by twelve colonies, the New York delegates being still unable to act.

THE FOURTH OF JULY

Day of glory! Welcome day! Freedom's banners greet thy ray; See! how cheerfully they play With thy morning breeze, On the rocks where pilgrims kneeled, On the heights where squadrons wheeled, When a tyrant's thunder pealed O'er the trembling seas.

God of armies! did thy stars On their courses smite his cars; Blast his arm, and wrest his bars From the heaving tide? On our standard, lo! they burn, And, when days like this return, Sparkle o'er the soldier's urn Who for freedom died.

God of peace! whose spirit fills All the echoes of our hills, All the murmur of our rills, Now the storm is o'er, O let freemen be our sons, And let future Washingtons

Rise, to lead their valiant ones Till there's war no more!

JOHN PIERPONT.

News of its adoption was received throughout the country with the greatest rejoicing. On the 9th of July it was ratified by New York, and the soldiers there celebrated the occasion by throwing down the leaden statue of George III on the Bowling Green, and casting it into bullets. Everywhere there were bonfires, torchlight processions, and ratification meetings.

INDEPENDENCE DAY

Squeak the fife, and beat the drum, Independence day is come! Let the roasting pig be bled, Quick twist off the cockerel's head, Quickly rub the pewter platter, Heap the nutcakes, fried in butter. Set the cups and beaker glass, The pumpkin and the apple sauce; Send the keg to shop for brandy; Maple sugar we have handy. Independent, staggering Dick, A noggin mix of swingeing thick; Sal, put on your russet skirt, Jotham, get your _boughten_ shirt, To-day we dance to tiddle diddle. --Here comes Sambo with his fiddle; Sambo, take a dram of whiskey, And play up Yankee Doodle frisky. Moll, come leave your witched tricks, And let us have a reel of six. Father and mother shall make two; Sal, Moll, and I stand all a-row; Sambo, play and dance with quality; This is the day of blest equality. Father and mother are but _men_, And Sambo--is a citizen. Come foot it, Sal--Moll, figure in, And mother, you dance up to him; Now saw as fast as e'er you can do, And father, you cross o'er to Sambo. --Thus we dance, and thus we play, On glorious independence day.-- Rub more rosin on your bow, And let us have another go. Zounds! as sure as eggs and bacon, Here's ensign Sneak, and Uncle Deacon, Aunt Thiah, and their Bets behind her, On blundering mare, than beetle blinder. And there's the 'Squire too, with his lady-- Sal, hold the beast, I'll take the baby, Moll, bring the 'Squire our great armchair; Good folks, we're glad to see you here. Jotham, get the great case bottle, Your teeth can pull its corn-cob stopple. Ensign,--Deacon, never mind; 'Squire, drink until you're blind. Come, here's the French, the Guillotine, And here is good 'Squire Gallatin, And here's each noisy Jacobin. Here's friend Madison so hearty, And here's confusion to the treaty. Come, one more swig to Southern Demos Who represent our brother negroes. Thus we drink and dance away, This glorious INDEPENDENCE DAY!

ROYALL TYLER.

ON INDEPENDENCE

[August 17, 1776]

Come all you brave soldiers, both valiant and free, It's for Independence we all now agree; Let us gird on our swords and prepare to defend Our liberty, property, ourselves and our friends.

In a cause that's so righteous, come let us agree, And from hostile invaders set America free, The cause is so glorious we need not to fear But from merciless tyrants

we'll set ourselves clear.

Heaven's blessing attending us, no tyrant shall say That Americans e'er to such monsters gave way, But fighting we'll die in America's cause Before we'll submit to tyrannical laws.

George the Third, of Great Britain, no more shall he reign, With unlimited sway o'er these free States again; Lord North, nor old Bute, nor none of their clan, Shall ever be honor'd by an American.

May Heaven's blessing descend on our United States, And grant that the union may never abate; May love, peace, and harmony ever be found, For to go hand in hand America round.

Upon our grand Congress may Heaven bestow Both wisdom and skill our good to pursue; On Heaven alone dependent we'll be. But from all earthly tyrants we mean to be free.

Unto our brave Generals may Heaven give skill Our armies to guide, and the sword for to wield, May their hands taught to war, and their fingers to fight, Be able to put British armies to flight.

And now, brave Americans, since it is so, That we are independent, we'll have them to know That united we are, and united we'll be, And from all British tyrants we'll try to keep free.

May Heaven smile on us in all our endeavors, Safe guard our seaports, our towns, and our rivers, Keep us from invaders by land and by sea, And from all who'd deprive us of our liberty.

JONATHAN MITCHELL SEWALL.

THE AMERICAN PATRIOT'S PRAYER

[1776]

Parent of all, omnipotent In heav'n, and earth below, Thro' all creation's bounds unspent, Whose streams of goodness flow.

Teach me to know from whence I rose, And unto what design'd; No private aims let me propose, Since link'd with human kind.

But chief to hear my country's voice, May all my thoughts incline, 'Tis reason's law, 'tis virtue's choice, 'Tis nature's call and thine.

Me from fair freedom's sacred cause Let nothing e'er divide; Grandeur, nor gold, nor vain applause, Nor friendship false misguide.

Let me not faction's partial hate Pursue to _this land's_ woe; Nor grasp the thunder of the state To wound a private foe.

If, for the right, to wish the wrong My country shall combine, Single to serve th' erron'ous throng, Spite of themselves, be mine.

COLUMBIA

Columbia, Columbia, to glory arise, The queen of the world, and the child of the skies; Thy genius commands thee; with rapture behold, While ages on ages thy splendor unfold, Thy reign is the last, and the noblest of time, Most fruitful thy soil, most inviting thy clime; Let the crimes of the east ne'er encrimson thy name, Be freedom, and science, and virtue thy fame.

To conquest and slaughter let Europe aspire; Whelm nations in blood, and wrap cities in fire; Thy heroes the rights of mankind shall defend, And triumph pursue them, and glory attend. A world is thy realm; for a world be thy laws, Enlarged as thine empire, and just as thy cause; On Freedom's broad basis, that empire shall rise, Extend with the main, and dissolve with the skies.

Fair science her gates to thy sons shall unbar, And the east see the morn hide the beams of her star. New bards, and new sages, unrivalled shall soar To fame unextinguished, when time is no more; To thee, the last refuge of virtue designed, Shall fly from all nations the best of mankind; Here, grateful to heaven, with transport shall bring Their incense, more fragrant than odors of spring,

Nor less shall thy fair ones to glory ascend, And genius and beauty in harmony blend; The graces of form shall awake pure desire, And the charms of the soul ever cherish the fire; Their sweetness unmingled, their manners refined, And virtue's bright image, instamped on the mind, With peace and soft rapture shall teach life to glow, And light up a smile in the aspect of woe.

Thy fleets to all regions thy power shall display, The nations admire and the ocean obey; Each shore to thy glory its tribute unfold, And the east and the south yield their spices and gold. As the day-spring unbounded, thy splendor shall flow, And earth's little kingdoms before thee shall bow; While the ensigns of union, in triumph unfurled, Hush the tumult of war and give peace to the world.

Thus, as down a lone valley, with cedars o'er-spread, From war's dread confusion I pensively strayed, The gloom from the face of fair heaven retired; The winds ceased to murmur; the thunders expired; Perfumes as of Eden flowed sweetly along, And a voice as of angels, enchantingly sung: "Columbia, Columbia, to glory arise, The queen of the world, and the child of the skies."

TIMOTHY DWIGHT.

CHAPTER V

THE FIRST CAMPAIGN

News of the Declaration of Independence was accompanied over the country by that of a brilliant success at the South. Early in June, the British, under Sir Peter Parker, Sir Henry Clinton, and Lord Cornwallis, prepared to capture Charleston, S. C. To oppose them there was practically nothing but a fort of palmetto logs built on Sullivan's Island in Charleston harbor by Colonel William Moultrie. On June 28, 1776,

the British advanced to the attack, but were beaten off with heavy loss.

THE BOASTING OF SIR PETER PARKER

[June 28, 1776]

'Twas the proud Sir Peter Parker came sailing in from the sea, With his serried ships-of-line a-port, and his ships-of-line a-lee; _A little lead for a cure_, he said, _for these rebel sires and sons_! And the folk on the Charleston roof-tops heard the roar of the shotted guns; They heard the roar of the guns off shore, but they marked, with a hopeful smile, The answering ire of a storm of fire from Sullivan's sandy isle.

'Twas the proud Sir Peter Parker who saw with the climbing noon Ruin and wreck on each blood-stained deck that day in the wane of June,-- The shivered spar and the shattered beam and the torn and toppling mast And the grimy gunners wounded sore, and the seamen falling fast; But from the stubborn fort ashore no sight of a single sign That the rebel sires and sons had quailed before his ships-of-the-line.

'Twas the proud Sir Peter Parker who saw the fall of the flag From the fortress wall; then rang his call:--_They have lost their rebel rag!_ And the fifty guns of the Bristol flamed, and the volumed thunder rolled; _'Tis now_, the haughty Admiral cried, _we'll drive them out of their hold_! But little he knew, and his British crew, how small was their vaunted power, For lo, to the rampart's crest there leaped the dauntless man of the hour!

'Twas the proud Sir Peter Parker who saw with a wild amaze This hero spring from the fortress height 'mid the hail and the fiery haze; Under the wall he strode, each step with the deadliest danger fraught, And up from the sand with a triumph hand the splintered staff he caught. Then, still unscathed by the iron rain, he clambered the parapet, And 'mid the burst of his comrades' cheers the flag on the bastion set.

'Twas the proud Sir Peter Parker who slunk through the night to sea, With his shattered ships-of-line a-port and his ships-of-line a-lee; Above there was wreck, and below was wreck, and the sense of loss and woe, For the sneered-at rebel sires and sons had proved them a direful foe; But War's dark blight on the land lay light, and they hailed with a joyful smile The stars of victory burning bright over Sullivan's sandy isle.

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

The British fleet remained in the neighborhood for three weeks to refit and then sailed away to New York to coöperate with Howe. Charleston was saved and for two years the Southern States were free from the invader.

A NEW WAR SONG BY SIR PETER PARKER

My lords, with your leave, An account I will give, Which deserves to be written in metre; How the rebels and I Have been pretty nigh, Faith, 'twas almost too nigh for Sir Peter!

De'il take 'em! their shot Came so swift and so hot, And the cowardly dogs stood so stiff, sirs, That I put ship about And was glad to get out, Or they would not have left me a skiff, sirs.

With much labor and toil Unto Sullivan's Isle, I came, swift as Falstaff, or Pistol; But the Yankees, od rat 'em-- I could not get at 'em, They so terribly maul'd my poor Bristol.

Behold, Clinton, by land, Did quietly stand, While I made a thundering clatter; But the channel was deep, So he only could peep, And not venture over the water.

Now, bold as a Turk, I proceeded to York, Where, with Clinton and Howe, you may find me: I've the wind in my tail, And am hoisting my sail, To leave Sullivan's Island behind me.

But, my lords, do not fear, For, before the next year, Although a small island should fret us, The continent, whole, We will take, by my soul, If the cowardly Yankees will let us.

The victory at Charleston was the last success which American arms were to achieve for many months. The British had decided to capture and hold the line of the Hudson in order to cut the colonies in two. Howe, with a trained army of twenty-five thousand men, prepared to attack New York, while, to oppose him, Washington had only eighteen thousand undisciplined levies. Half this force was concentrated at Brooklyn Heights, which was strongly fortified, and here, on August 27, 1776, Howe delivered his attack. Overwhelming superiority of numbers enabled the British to press back their opponents to their works on the heights. Not daring to storm, the British prepared to lay siege to this position. Washington had no way to withstand a siege, which must have resulted in the loss of his whole army, and after nightfall of August 29, he succeeded in ferrying the entire force, with their cannon, arms, ammunition, horses, and larder, over to the New York side.

THE MARYLAND BATTALION

[August 27, 1776]

Spruce Macaronis, and pretty to see, Tidy and dapper and gallant were we; Blooded fine gentlemen, proper and tall, Bold in a fox-hunt and gay at a ball; Prancing soldados, so martial and bluff, Billets for bullets, in scarlet and buff-- But our cockades were clasped with a mother's low prayer. And the sweethearts that braided the sword-knots were fair.

There was grummer of drums humming hoarse in the hills, And the bugles sang fanfaron down by the mills, By Flatbush the bagpipes were droning amain, And keen cracked the rifles in Martense's lane; For the Hessians were flecking the hedges with red, And the Grenadiers' tramp marked the roll of the dead.

Three to one, flank and rear, flashed the files of St. George, The fierce gleam of their steel as the glow of a forge. The brutal boom-boom of their swart cannoneers Was sweet music compared with the taunt of their cheers-- For the brunt of their

onset, our crippled array, And the light of God's leading gone out in the fray!

Oh, the rout on the left and the tug on the right! The mad plunge of the charge and the wreck of the flight! When the cohorts of Grant held stout Stirling at strain, And the mongrels of Hesse went tearing the slain; When at Freeke's Mill the flumes and the sluices ran red, And the dead choked the dyke and the marsh choked the dead!

"Oh, Stirling, good Stirling! How long must we wait? Shall the shout of your trumpet unleash us too late? Have you never a dash for brave Mordecai Gist, With his heart in his throat, and his blade in his fist? Are we good for no more than to prance in a ball, When the drums beat the charge and the clarions call?"

Tralára! Tralára! Now praise we the Lord, For the clang of His call and the flash of His sword! Tralára! Tralára! Now forward to die; For the banner, hurrah! and for sweethearts, good-by! "Four hundred wild lads!" Maybe so. I'll be bound 'Twill be easy to count us, face up, on the ground. If we hold the road open, though Death take the toll, We'll be missed on parade when the States call the roll-- When the flags meet in peace and the guns are at rest, And fair Freedom is singing Sweet Home in the West.

JOHN WILLIAMSON PALMER.

On September 15, 1776, the British took possession of New York, and the American lines were withdrawn to the line of the Harlem River. On September 16 the British attempted to break through their centre at Harlem Heights. The attack was repulsed, and for nearly a month the lines remained where they had been formed.

HAARLEM HEIGHTS

Captain Stephen Brown of Knowlton's Connecticut Rangers tells of the affair of September 16, 1776.

They've turned at last! Good-by, King George, Despite your hireling band! The farmer boys have borne a brunt, The 'prentice lads will stand!

Though Peace may lag and Fortune flag, Our fight's as good as won; We've made them yield in open field! We've made the Redcoats run!

Our Rangers sallied forth at dawn With Knowlton at their head To rout the British pickets out And spend a little lead.

We gave them eight brisk rounds a-piece, And hurried, fighting, back; For, eighteen score, the Light Armed Corps Were keen upon our track.

Along the vale of Bloomingdale They pressed our scant array; They swarmed the crag and jeered our flag Across the Hollow Way.

Their skirmishers bawled "Hark, away!" Their buglers, from the wall, In braggart vaunt and bitter taunt Brayed out the hunting call!

Oh, sound of shame! It woke a flame In every sunburned face, And every soul was hot as coal To cleanse the foul disgrace.

And some that blenched on Brooklyn Heights And fled at Turtle Bay Fair wept for wrath, and thronged my path And clamored for the fray.

Our General came spurring!-- There rolled a signal drum.-- His eye was bright; he rose his height; He knew the time had come.

He gave the word to Knowlton To lead us on once more-- The pick of old Connecticut,-- And Leitch with Weedon's corps

Of proud Virginia Riflemen, Tall hunters of the deer,-- To round the boastful Briton's flank And take him in the rear.

We left the dell, we scaled the fell, And up the crest we sprang, When swift and sharp along the scarp A deadly volley rang;

And down went Leitch of Weedon's corps! Deep hurt, but gallant still; And down went Knowlton!--he that bore The sword of Bunker Hill.

I raised his head. But this he said, Death-wounded as he lay: "Lead on the fight! I hold it light If we but get the day!"

In open rank we struck their flank, And oh! the fight was hot! Up came the Hessian Yagers! Up came the kilted Scot!

Up came the men of Linsingen, Von Donop's Grenadiers! But soon we sped the vengeful lead A-whistling 'bout their ears!

They buckled front to Varnum's brunt; We crumpled up their right, And hurling back the crimson wrack We swept along the height.

The helmets of the Hessians Are tumbled in the wheat; The tartan of the Highlander Shall be his winding-sheet!

A mingled rout, we drove them out From orchard, field, and glen; In goodly case it seemed to chase Our hunters home again!

We flaunted in their faces The flag they thought to scorn, And left them with a loud "Hurrah!" To choke their bugle-horn!

Upon a ledge embattled Above the Hudson's shore We dug the grave for Knowlton And Leitch of Weedon's corps.

And though in plight of War's despite We yield this island throne, Upon that ledge we left a pledge That we shall claim our own!

ARTHUR GUITERMAN.

At this time occurred the first of the two most dramatic and moving tragedies of the Revolution. It was important that Washington should obtain detailed and accurate information as to the position and intentions of the British, and Nathan Hale, a captain in Knowlton's regiment, volunteered for the service, and passed into the British lines in disguise. He was captured and taken before Sir William Howe, to whom he frankly acknowledged his errand. Howe ordered him hanged next day.

NATHAN HALE

[September 22, 1776]

The breezes went steadily thro' the tall pines, A-saying "Oh! hu-ush!" a-saying "Oh! hu-ush!" As stilly stole by a bold legion of horse, For Hale in the bush; for Hale in the bush.

"Keep still!" said the thrush as she nestled her young, In a nest by the road; in a nest by the road. "For the tyrants are near, and with them appear What bodes us no good; what bodes us no good."

The brave captain heard it, and thought of his home, In a cot by the brook; in a cot by the brook. With mother and sister and memories dear, He so gayly forsook; he so gayly forsook.

Cooling shades of the night were coming apace, The tattoo had beat; the tattoo had beat. The noble one sprang from his dark lurking-place, To make his retreat; to make his retreat.

He warily trod on the dry rustling leaves, As he pass'd thro' the wood; as he pass'd thro' the wood; And silently gain'd his rude launch on the shore, As she play'd with the flood; as she play'd with the flood.

The guards of the camp, on that dark, dreary night, Had a murderous will; had a murderous will. They took him and bore him afar from the shore, To a hut on the hill; to a hut on the hill.

No mother was there, nor a friend who could cheer, In that little stone cell; in that little stone cell. But he trusted in love, from his Father above. In his heart, all was well; in his heart, all was well.

An ominous owl with his solemn bass voice, Sat moaning hard by; sat moaning hard by. "The tyrant's proud minions most gladly rejoice, For he must soon die; for he must soon die."

The brave fellow told them, no thing he restrain'd, The cruel gen'ral; the cruel gen'ral. His errand from camp, of the ends to be gain'd, And said that was all; and said that was all.

They took him and bound him and bore him away, Down the hill's grassy side; down the hill's grassy side. 'Twas there the base hirelings, in royal array, His cause did deride; his cause did deride.

Five minutes were given, short moments, no more, For him to repent; for him to repent. He pray'd for his mother, he ask'd not another, To Heaven he went; to Heaven he went.

The faith of a martyr, the tragedy show'd, As he trod the last stage; as he trod the last stage. And Britons will shudder at gallant Hale's blood, As his words do presage; as his words do presage.

"Thou pale king of terrors, thou life's gloomy foe, Go frighten the slave; go frighten the slave; Tell tyrants, to you their allegiance they owe. No fears for the brave; no fears for the brave."

The execution took place shortly after sunrise, the scaffold being erected in an orchard near the present junction of Market Street and East Broadway. Hale's last words were the famous, "I only regret that I have but one life to lose for my country."

NATHAN HALE

[September 22, 1776]

To drum-beat and heart-beat, A soldier marches by; There is color in his cheek, There is courage in his eye, Yet to drum-beat and heart-beat In a moment he must die.

By the starlight and moonlight, He seeks the Briton's camp; He hears the rustling flag And the armèd sentry's tramp; And the starlight and moonlight His silent wanderings lamp.

With slow tread and still tread, He scans the tented line; And he counts the battery guns, By the gaunt and shadowy pine; And his slow tread and still tread Gives no warning sign.

The dark wave, the plumed wave, It meets his eager glance; And it sparkles 'neath the stars, Like the glimmer of a lance-- A dark wave, a plumed wave, On an emerald expanse.

A sharp clang, a still clang, And terror in the sound! For the sentry, falcon-eyed, In the camp a spy hath found; With a sharp clang, a steel clang, The patriot is bound.

With calm brow, and steady brow, He listens to his doom; In his look there is no fear, Nor a shadow-trace of gloom; But with calm brow and steady brow, He robes him for the tomb.

In the long night, the still night, He kneels upon the sod; And the brutal guards withhold E'en the solemn word of God! In the long night, the still night, He walks where Christ hath trod.

'Neath the blue morn, the sunny morn, He dies upon the tree; And he mourns that he can lose But one life for Liberty; And in the blue morn, the sunny morn, His spirit wings are free.

But his last words, his message-words, They burn, lest friendly eye Should read how proud and calm A patriot could die, With his last words, his dying words, A soldier's battle-cry.

From Fame-leaf and Angel-leaf, From monument and urn, The sad of earth, the glad of heaven, His tragic fate shall learn; But on Fame-leaf and Angel-leaf The name of HALE shall burn!

FRANCIS MILES FINCH.

Washington soon found himself unable to cope with Howe's superior force, retreated across New Jersey, and on December 8 reached the west bank of the Delaware River. The British came up the next day and took a position on the east bank, with their centre at Trenton. Never did America's future look darker than on that Christmas night of 1776.

THE BALLAD OF SWEET P

[December 25, 1776]

Mistress Penelope Penwick, she, Called by her father, "My Sweet P," Painted by Peale, she won renown In a clinging, short-waisted satin gown; A red rose touched by her finger-tips And a smile held back from her roguish lips.

Thus, William Penwick, the jolly wight, In clouds of smoke, night after night, Would tell a tale in delighted pride, To cronies, who came from far and wide; Always ending (with candle, he) "And this is the picture of my Sweet P!"

The tale? 'Twas how Sweet P did chance To give to the British a Christmas dance. Penwick's house past the outpost stood, Flanked by the ferry and banked by the wood. Hessian and British quartered there Swarmed through chamber and hall and stair.

Fires ablaze and candles alight, Soldier and officer feasted that night. The enemy? Safe, with a river between, Black and deadly and fierce and keen; A river of ice and a blinding storm!-- So they made them merry and kept them warm.

But while they mirth and roistering made, Up in her dormer window stayed Mistress Penelope Penwick apart, With fearful thought and sorrowful heart. Night by night had her candle's gleam Sent through the dark its hopeful beam.

But the nights they came and they passed again, With never a sign from her countrymen; For where beat the heart so brave, so bold, Which could baffle that river's bulwark cold? Penelope's eyes and her candle's light Were mocked by the storm that Christmas night.

But lo, full sudden a missile stung And shattered her casement pane and rung At her feet! 'Twas a word from the storm outside. She opened her dormer window wide. A wind-swept figure halted below-- The ferryman, old and bent and slow. Then a murmur rose upward--only one, Thrilling and powerful--"_Washington!_"

With jest and laughter and candles bright, 'Twas two by the stairway clock that night, When Penelope Penwick tripped her down, Dressed in a short-waisted satin gown, With a red rose (cut from her potted bush). There fell on the rollicking crowd a hush.

She stood in the soldiers' midst, I ween, The daintiest thing they e'er had seen! And swept their gaze with her eyes most sweet, And patted her little slippered feet. "'Tis Christmas night, sirs," quoth Sweet P, "I should like to dance! Will you dance with me?"

Oh, but they cheered; ran to and fro, And each for the honor bowed him low. With smiling charm and witching grace She chose him pranked with officer's lace And shining buttons and dangling sword; No doubt he strutted him proud as a lord!

Doffed with enmity, donned with glee,-- Oh, she was charming, that Sweet P! And when it was over, and blood aflame, Came an eager cry for "A game!" "A game!" "We'll play at forfeits," Penelope cried. "If one holdeth aught in his love and pride,

"Let each lay it down at my feet in turn, And a fine from me shall he straightway learn!" What held they all in their love and pride? Straight flew a hand unto every side; Each man had a sword and nothing more, And the swords they clanged in a heap on the floor.

Standing there, in her satin gown, With candlelight on her yellow crown, And at her feet a bank of steel (I'll wager that look was caught by Peale!) Penelope held her rose on high-- "I fine each one for a leaf to try!"

She plucked the petals and blew them out, A rain of red they fluttered about. Over the floor and through the air Rushed the officers here and there; When lo! a cry! The door burst in! "_The enemy!_" Tumult, terror, and din!

Flew a hand unto every side,-- Swords?--Penelope, arms thrown wide Leapt that heap of steel before; Swords behind her upon the floor; Facing her countrymen staunch and bold, Who dared the river of death and cold, Who swept them down on a rollicking horde, And found they never a man with sword!

And so it happened (but not by chance), In '76 there was given a dance By a witch with a rose and a satin gown (Painted in Philadelphia town), Mistress Penelope Penwick, she, Called by her father, "My Sweet P."

VIRGINIA WOODWARD CLOUD.

The British soldiers, thinking the war virtually ended, had grown careless, and Howe and Cornwallis had returned to New York to celebrate Christmas. It was at this juncture that Washington decided to attack. More than ten hours were consumed in getting across the river, which was blocked with ice. At daybreak on the 26th, Washington entered Trenton, and surprised the enemy.

ACROSS THE DELAWARE

The winter night is cold and drear, Along the river's sullen flow; The cruel frost is camping here-- The air has living blades of snow. Look! pushing from the icy strand, With ensigns freezing in the air, There sails a small but mighty band, Across the dang'rous Delaware.

Oh, wherefore, soldiers, would you fight The bayonets of a winter storm? In truth it were a better night For blazing fire and blankets warm! We seek to trap a foreign foe, Who fill themselves with stolen fare; We carry freedom as we go Across the storm-swept Delaware!

The night is full of lusty cheer Within the Hessians' merry camp; And faint and fainter on the ear Doth fall the heedless sentry's tramp. O hirelings, this new nation's rage Is something 'tis not well to dare; You are not fitted to engage These men from o'er the Delaware!

A rush--a shout--a clarion call, Salute the early morning's gray: Now, roused invaders, yield or fall: The refuge-land has won the day! Soon shall the glorious news be hurled Wherever men have wrongs to bear; For freedom's torch illumes the world, And God has crossed the Delaware!

WILL CARLETON.

The surprise was complete. Eighteen of the enemy were killed and over a thousand made prisoners, while the American loss was only four. The remainder of the enemy retreated in disorder to Princeton, leaving their sick and wounded, and all their heavy arms and baggage behind them.

THE BATTLE OF TRENTON

On Christmas-day in seventy-six, Our ragged troops, with bayonets fixed, For Trenton marched away. The Delaware see! the boats below! The light obscured by hail and snow! But no signs of dismay.

Our object was the Hessian band, That dared invade fair freedom's land, And quarter in that place. Great Washington he led us on, Whose streaming flag, in storm or sun, Had never known disgrace.

In silent march we passed the night, Each soldier panting for the fight, Though quite benumbed with frost. Greene on the left at six began, The right was led by Sullivan Who ne'er a moment lost.

Their pickets stormed, the alarm was spread, That rebels risen from the dead Were marching into town. Some scampered here, some scampered there, And some for action did prepare; But soon their arms laid down.

Twelve hundred servile miscreants, With all their colors, guns, and tents, Were trophies of the day. The frolic o'er, the bright canteen, In centre, front, and rear was seen Driving fatigue away.

Now, brothers of the patriot bands, Let's sing deliverance from the hands Of arbitrary sway. And as our life is but a span, Let's touch the tankard while we can, In memory of that day.

At Princeton Cornwallis joined them, and on January 2, 1777, advanced against Trenton at the head of eight thousand men. By the time he reached there, Washington had withdrawn his whole force beyond a little stream called the Assunpink, where he repelled two British assaults. That night, he marched toward Princeton, routed a British detachment of two thousand, and took up a strong position on the heights at Morristown.

TRENTON AND PRINCETON

[December 26, 1776--January 3, 1777]

On December, the sixth And the twentieth day, Our troops attacked the Hessians, And show'd them gallant play.

Our roaring cannon taught them Our valor for to know; We fought like brave Americans Against a haughty foe.

The chiefs were kill'd or taken, The rest were put to flight, And some arrived at Princeton, Half-fainting with affright.

The third of January, The morning being clear, Our troops attack'd the regulars, At Princeton, we do hear.

About a mile from Princeton, The battle is begun, And many a haughty Briton fell Before the fight was done.

And what our gallant troops have done We'll let the British know; We fought like brave Americans Against a haughty foe.

The British, struck with terror, And frighted, ran away: They ran across the country Like men in deep dismay,

Crying to every one they met, "Oh! hide us! hide us! do! The rebels will devour us, So hotly they pursue."

Oh, base, ungenerous Britons! To call us by that name; We're fighting for our liberty, Our just and lawful claim.

We trust in Heaven's protection, Nor fear to win the day; When time shall come we'll crown our deeds With many a loud huzza!

Our foes are fled to Brunswick, Where they are close confined; Our men they are unanimous, In Freedom's cause combined.

Success to General Washington, And Gates and Putnam, too, Both officers and privates, Who liberty pursue.

ASSUNPINK AND PRINCETON

[January 3, 1777]

Glorious the day when in arms at Assunpink, And after at Princeton the Briton we met; Few in both armies--they'd skirmishes call them, Now hundreds of thousands in battle are set. But for the numbers engaged, let me tell you, Smart brushes they were, and two battles that told; There 'twas I first drew a bead on a foeman-- I, a mere stripling, not twenty years old.

Tell it? Well, friends, that is just my intention; There's nothing a veteran hates and abhors More than a chance lost to tell his adventures, Or give you his story of battles and wars. Nor is it wonder old men are loquacious, And talk, if you listen, from sun unto sun; Youth has the power to be up and be doing, While age can but tell of the

deeds it has done.

Ranged for a mile on the banks of Assunpink, There, southward of Trenton, one morning we lay, When, with his red-coats all marshalled to meet us, Cornwallis came fiercely at close of the day-- Driving some scouts who had gone out with Longstreet, From where they were crossing at Shabbaconk Run-- Trumpets loud blaring, drums beating, flags flying-- Three hours, by the clock, before setting of sun.

Two ways were left them by which to assail us, And neither was perfectly to their desire-- One was the bridge we controlled by our cannon, The other the ford that was under our fire. "Death upon one side, and Dismal on t' other," Said Sambo, our cook, as he gazed on our foes: Cheering and dauntless they marched to the battle, And, doubtful of choice, both the dangers they chose.

Down at the ford, it was said, that the water Was reddened with blood from the soldiers who fell: As for the bridge, when they tried it, their forces Were beaten with terrible slaughter as well. Grape-shot swept causeway, and pattered on water, And riddled their columns, that broke and gave way; Thrice they charged boldly, and thrice they retreated; Then darkness came down, and so ended the fray.

How did I get there? I came from our corn-mill At noon of the day when the battle begun, Bringing in flour to the troops under Proctor; 'Twas not very long ere that errand was done. Up to that time I had never enlisted, Though Jacob, my brother, had entered with Wayne; But the fight stirred me; I sent back the horses, And made up my mind with the rest to remain.

_We_ camped on _our_ side--the south--of Assunpink, While _they_ bivouacked for the night upon _theirs_; Both posting sentries and building up watchfires, With those on both sides talking over affairs. "Washington's caught in a trap!" said Cornwallis, And smiled with a smile that was joyous and grim; "Fox! but I have him!"--the earl had mistaken; The fox, by the coming of daylight, had him.

Early that night, when the leaders held council, Both St. Clair and Reed said our action was clear; Useless to strike at the van of our foemen-- His force was too strong; we must fall on his rear. Washington thought so, and bade us replenish Our watchfires till nearly the dawn of the day; Setting some more to make feint of intrenching, While swiftly in darkness the rest moved away.

Marching by Sandtown, and Quaker Bridge crossing, We passed Stony Creek a full hour before dawn, Leaving there Mercer with one scant battalion Our foes to amuse, should they find we were gone; Then the main force pushed its way into Princeton, All ready to strike those who dreamed of no blow; Only a chance that we lost not our labor, And slipped through our fingers, unknowing, the foe.

Mawhood's brigade, never feeling its danger, Had started for Trenton at dawn of the day, Crossed Stony Creek, after we had gone over, When Mercer's weak force they beheld on its way; Turning contemptuously back to attack it, They drove it with ease in disorder ahead-- Firelocks alone were no match for their cannon-- A fight, and then flight, and brave Mercer lay dead.

Murdered, some said, while imploring for quarter-- A dastardly deed, if the thing had been true-- Cruel our foes, but in that thing we wronged them, And let us in all give the demon his due. Gallant Hugh Mercer fell sturdily fighting, So long as his right arm his sabre could wield, Stretching his enemies bleeding around him, And then, overpowered, fell prone on the field.

Hearing the firing, we turned and we met them, Our cannon replying to theirs with a will; Fiercely with grape and with canister swept them, And chased them in wrath from the brow of the hill. Racing and chasing it was into Princeton, Where, seeking the lore to be taught in that hall, Redcoats by scores entered college, but stayed not-- We rudely expelled them with powder and ball.

Only a skirmish, you see, though a sharp one-- It did not last over the fourth of an hour; But 'twas a battle that did us this service-- No more, from that day, had we fear of their power. Trenton revived us, Assunpink encouraged, But Princeton gave hope that we held to the last; Flood-tide had come on the black, sullen water And ebb-tide for ever and ever had passed.

Yes! 'twas the turn of the tide in our favor-- A turn of the tide to a haven that bore. Had Lord Cornwallis crossed over Assunpink That day we repelled him, our fighting were o'er. Had he o'ertaken us ere we smote Mawhood, All torn as we were, it seems certain to me, I would not chatter to you about battles, And you and your children would not have been free.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

"Thus in a brief campaign of three weeks, Washington had rallied the fragments of a defeated and broken army, fought two successful battles, taken nearly two thousand prisoners, and recovered the state of New Jersey."

SEVENTY-SIX

What heroes from the woodland sprung, When, through the fresh-awakened land, The thrilling cry of freedom rung And to the work of warfare strung The yeoman's iron hand!

Hills flung the cry to hills around, And ocean-mart replied to mart, And streams, whose springs were yet unfound, Pealed far away the startling sound Into the forest's heart.

Then marched the brave from rocky steep, From mountain-river swift and cold; The borders of the stormy deep, The vales where gathered waters sleep, Sent up the strong and bold,--

As if the very earth again Grew quick with God's creating breath, And, from the sods of grove and glen, Rose ranks of lion-hearted men To battle to the death.

The wife, whose babe first smiled that day The fair fond bride of yestereve, And aged sire and matron gray, Saw the loved warriors haste away, And deemed it sin to grieve.

Already had the strife begun; Already blood, on Concord's plain, Along the springing grass had run, And blood had flowed at Lexington, Like brooks of April rain.

That death-stain on the vernal sward Hallowed to freedom all the shore; In fragments fell the yoke abhorred-- The footstep of a foreign lord Profaned the soil no more.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

The question of a national flag, which had been under consideration for a long time, was now finally settled. There is a tradition that in June, 1776, General Washington and a committee of Congress had called upon Mrs. John Ross, of Philadelphia, and requested her to make a flag after a design which Washington furnished, which she did, producing the first "stars and stripes."

BETSY'S BATTLE FLAG

From dusk till dawn the livelong night She kept the tallow dips alight, And fast her nimble fingers flew To sew the stars upon the blue. With weary eyes and aching head She stitched the stripes of white and red, And when the day came up the stair Complete across a carven chair Hung Betsy's battle flag.

Like shadows in the evening gray The Continentals filed away, With broken boots and ragged coats, But hoarse defiance in their throats; They bore the marks of want and cold, And some were lame and some were old, And some with wounds untended bled, But floating bravely overhead Was Betsy's battle flag.

When fell the battle's leaden rain, The soldier hushed his moans of pain And raised his dying head to see King George's troopers turn and flee. Their charging column reeled and broke, And vanished in the rolling smoke, Before the glory of the stars, The snowy stripes, and scarlet bars Of Betsy's battle flag.

The simple stone of Betsy Ross Is covered now with mold and moss, But still her deathless banner flies, And keeps the color of the skies. A nation thrills, a nation bleeds, A nation follows where it leads, And every man is proud to yield His life upon a crimson field For Betsy's battle flag!

MINNA IRVING.

It was not, however, until Saturday, June 14, 1777, that a flag was formally adopted by Congress. On that day, Congress "Resolved, That the flag of the thirteen United States be thirteen stripes alternate red and white; that the union be thirteen stars, white in a blue field, representing a new constellation." Save for the addition of a star for each new state admitted to the Union, this is the flag of the United States to-day.

THE AMERICAN FLAG

I

When Freedom from her mountain height Unfurled her standard to the air, She tore the azure robe of night, And set the stars of glory there; She mingled with its gorgeous dyes The milky baldric of the skies, And striped its pure, celestial white With streakings of the morning light; Then from his mansion in the sun She called her eagle bearer down, And gave into his mighty hand The symbol of her chosen land.

II

Majestic monarch of the cloud! Who rear'st aloft thy regal form, To hear the tempest-trumpings loud, And see the lightning lances driven, When strive the warriors of the storm, And rolls the thunder-drum of heaven-- Child of the sun! to thee 'tis given To guard the banner of the free, To hover in the sulphur smoke, To ward away the battle-stroke, And bid its blendings shine afar, Like rainbows on the cloud of war, The harbingers of victory!

III

Flag of the brave! thy folds shall fly, The sign of hope and triumph high, When speaks the signal trumpet tone, And the long line comes gleaming on; Ere yet the life-blood, warm and wet, Has dimmed the glistening bayonet, Each soldier eye shall brightly turn To where thy sky-born glories burn, And, as his springing steps advance, Catch war and vengeance from the glance And when the cannon-mouthings loud Heave in wild wreaths the battle-shroud And gory sabres rise and fall, Like shoots of flame on midnight's pall; Then shall thy meteor-glances glow, And cowering foes shall sink beneath Each gallant arm that strikes below That lovely messenger of death.

IV

Flag of the seas! on ocean wave Thy stars shall glitter o'er the brave; When death, careering on the gale, Sweeps darkly round the bellied sail, And frighted waves rush wildly back Before the broadside's reeling rack, Each dying wanderer of the sea Shall look at once to heaven and thee, And smile to see thy splendors fly In triumph o'er his closing eye.

V

Flag of the free heart's hope and home, By angel hands to valor given; The stars have lit the welkin dome, And all thy hues were born in heaven. Forever float that standard sheet! Where breathes the foe but falls before us, With Freedom's soil beneath our feet, And Freedom's banner streaming o'er us?

JOSEPH RODMAN DRAKE.

CHAPTER VI

"THE FATE OF SIR JACK BRAG"

Defeated in Jersey, the English turned with increased vigor to the task of securing the line of the Hudson. An army under General Burgoyne, starting from Canada, was to march down the Hudson to Albany; a second, under Colonel Saint Leger, was to descend the Mohawk valley and unite with Burgoyne; while a third, under Sir William Howe, was to ascend the river to Albany, thus completing the conquest of New York. Burgoyne began his advance early in June with an army of eight thousand men; but soon ran short of supplies, and finally, on August 13, detached an expedition to the little village of Bennington, where the Americans had collected horses and stores. Word of its approach was sent forward and Colonel John Stark prepared to give it a warm reception.

THE RIFLEMAN'S SONG AT BENNINGTON

Why come ye hither, stranger? Your mind what madness fills? In our valleys there is danger, And danger on our hills! Hear ye not the singing Of the bugle, wild and free? Full soon ye'll know the ringing Of the rifle from the tree! The rifle, the sharp rifle! In our hands it is no trifle!

Ye ride a goodly steed; He may know another master: Ye forward come with speed, But ye'll learn to back much faster, When ye meet our mountain boys And their leader, Johnny Stark! Lads who make but little noise, But who always hit the mark With the rifle, the true rifle! In their hands will prove no trifle!

Had ye no graves at home Across the briny water, That hither ye must come, Like bullocks to the slaughter? If we the work must do, Why, the sooner 'tis begun, If flint and trigger hold but true, The quicker 'twill be done By the rifle, the good rifle! In our hands it is no trifle!

Within a day, eight hundred yeomen were marching under Stark's orders. He was joined by a regiment under Colonel Seth Warner, and on August 15, 1777, in the midst of a drenching rain, set out to meet the enemy.

THE MARCHING SONG OF STARK'S MEN

[August 15, 1777]

March! March! March! from sunrise till it's dark, And let no man straggle on the way! March! March! March! as we follow old John Stark, For the old man needs us all to-day.

Load! Load! Load! Three buckshot and a ball, With a hymn-tune for a wad to make them stay! But let no man dare to fire till he gives the word to all, Let no man let the buckshot go astray.

Fire! Fire! Fire! Fire all along the line, When we meet those bloody Hessians in array! They shall have every grain from this powder-horn of mine, Unless the cowards turn and run away.

Home! Home! Home! When the fight is fought and won, To the home where the women watch and pray! To tell them how John Stark finished what he had begun, And

to hear them thank our God for the day.

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

Stark found Baum and his Hessians about six miles distant, and the latter hastily took up a strong position on some rising ground, and began to throw up intrenchments. Stark laid his plans to storm this position on the morrow. During the night, a company of Berkshire militia arrived, and with them the warlike parson of Pittsfield, Thomas Allen.

PARSON ALLEN'S RIDE

[August 15, 1777]

The "Catamount Tavern" is lively to-night. The boys of Vermont and New Hampshire are here, Assembled and grouped in the lingering light, To greet Parson Allen with shout and with cheer.

Over mountain and valley, from Pittsfield green, Through the driving rain of that August day, The "Flock" marched on with martial mien, And the Parson rode in his "one-hoss shay."

"Three cheers for old Berkshire!" the General said, As the boys of New England drew up face to face, "Baum bids us a breakfast to-morrow to spread, And the Parson is here to say us the 'grace.'"

"The lads who are with me have come here to fight, And we know of no grace," was the Parson's reply, "Save the name of Jehovah, our country and right, Which your own Ethan Allen pronounced at Fort Ti."

"To-morrow," said Stark, "there'll be fighting to do, If you think you can wait for the morning light, And, Parson, I'll conquer the British with you, Or Molly Stark sleeps a widow at night."

What the Parson dreamed in that Bennington camp, Neither Yankee nor Prophet would dare to guess; A vision, perhaps, of the King David stamp, With a mixture of Cromwell and good Queen Bess.

But we know the result of that glorious day, And the victory won ere the night came down; How Warner charged in the bitter fray, With Rossiter, Hobart, and old John Brown:

And how in the lull of the three hours' fight, The Parson harangued the Tory line, As he stood on a stump, with his musket bright, And sprinkled his texts with the powder fine:--

The sword of the Lord is our battle-cry, A refuge sure in the hour of need, And freedom and faith can never die, Is article first of the Puritan creed.

"Perhaps the 'occasion' was rather rash," He remarked to his comrades after the rout, "For behind a bush I saw a flash, But I fired that way and put it out."

And many the sayings, eccentric and queer, Repeated and sung through the whole country side, And quoted in Berkshire for many a year, Of the Pittsfield march and the Parson's ride.

All honor to Stark and his resolute men, To the Green Mountain Boys all honor and praise, While with shout and with cheer we welcome again, The Parson who came in his one-horse chaise.

WALLACE BRUCE.

The next day, August 16, 1777, dawned clear and bright, and the morning was consumed in preparations for the attack. Stark managed to throw half his force on Baum's rear and flanks, and, early in the afternoon, assaulted the enemy on all sides. The Germans stood their ground and fought desperately, but they were soon thrown into disorder, and at the end of two hours were all either killed or captured.

THE BATTLE OF BENNINGTON

[August 16, 1777]

Up through a cloudy sky, the sun Was buffeting his way, On such a morn as ushers in A sultry August day. Hot was the air--and hotter yet Men's thoughts within them grew: They Britons, Hessians, Tories saw-- They saw their homesteads too.

They thought of all their country's wrongs, They thought of noble lives Pour'd out in battle with her foes, They thought upon their wives, Their children, and their aged sires, Their firesides, churches, God-- And these deep thoughts made hallow'd ground Each foot of soil they trod.

Their leader was a brave old man, A man of earnest will; His very presence was a host-- He'd fought at Bunker Hill. A living monument he stood Of stirring deeds of fame, Of deeds that shed a fadeless light On his own deathless name.

Of Charlestown's flames, of Warren's blood, His presence told the tale, It made each hero's heart beat high Though lip and cheek grew pale; It spoke of Princeton, Morristown, Told Trenton's thrilling story-- It lit futurity with hope, And on the past shed glory.

Who were those men--their leader who? Where stood they on that morn? The men were Berkshire yeomanry, Brave men as e'er were born,-- Who in the reaper's merry row Or warrior rank could stand Right worthy such a noble troop, John Stark led on the band.

Wollamsac wanders by the spot Where they that morning stood; Then roll'd the war-cloud o'er the stream, The waves were tinged with blood; And the near hills that dark cloud girt, And fires like lightning flash'd, And shrieks and groans, like howling blasts, Rose as the bayonets clash'd.

The night before, the Yankee host Came gathering from afar, And in each belted bosom glow'd The spirit of the war. As full of fight, through rainy storm, Night, cloudy, starless, dark, They came, and gathered as they came, Around the valiant

Stark.

There was a Berkshire parson--he And all his flock were there, And like true churchmen militant The arm of flesh made bare. Out spake the Dominie and said, "For battle have we come These many times, and after this We mean to stay at home."

"If now we come in vain," said Stark, "What! will you go to-night To battle it with yonder troops, God send us morning light, And we will give you work enough: Let but the morning come, And if ye hear no voice of war Go back and stay at home."

The morning came--there stood the foe, Stark eyed them as they stood-- Few words he spake--'twas not a time For moralizing mood. "See there the enemy, my boys! Now strong in valor's might, Beat them, or Molly Stark will sleep In widowhood to-night."

Each soldier there had left at home A sweetheart, wife, or mother, A blooming sister, or, perchance, A fair-hair'd, blue-eyed brother. Each from a fireside came, and thoughts Those simple words awoke That nerved up every warrior's arm And guided every stroke.

Fireside and woman--mighty words! How wondrous is the spell They work upon the manly heart, Who knoweth not full well? And then the women of this land, That never land hath known A truer, prouder hearted race, Each Yankee boy must own.

Brief eloquence was Stark's--nor vain-- Scarce utter'd he the words, When burst the musket's rattling peal Out-leap'd the flashing swords; And when brave Stark in after time Told the proud tale of wonder, He said the battle din was one "Continual clap of thunder."

Two hours they strove--then victory crown'd The gallant Yankee boys. Nought but the memory of the dead Bedimm'd their glorious joys; Ay--there's the rub--the hour of strife, Though follow years of fame, Is still in mournful memory link'd With some death-hallow'd name.

The cypress with the laurel twines-- The pæan sounds a knell, The trophied column marks the spot Where friends and brothers fell. Fame's mantle a funereal pall Seems to the grief-dimm'd eye, For ever where the bravest fall The best beloved die.

THOMAS P. RODMAN.

Just at this moment, when the Americans, thinking the battle over, began to scatter to the plunder of the German camp, a relieving force of five hundred men, sent by Burgoyne, came upon the scene. Luckily, Seth Warner also arrived with fresh men at this juncture, charged furiously upon the British, and by nightfall had killed or captured the entire column, with the exception of six men, who succeeded in reaching the British camp.

BENNINGTON

[August 16, 1777]

A cycle was closed and rounded, A continent lost and won, When Stark and his men went over The earthworks at Bennington.

Slowly down from the northward, Billowing fold on fold, Whelming the land and crushing, The glimmering glacier rolled.

Down from the broad St. Lawrence, Bright with its thousand isles, Through the Canadian woodlands, Sweet with the summer smiles,

On over field and fastness, Village and vantage coigne, Rolled the resistless legions Led by the bold Burgoyne.

Roared the craggy ledges Looming o'er Lake Champlain; Red with the blaze of navies Quivered the land-locked main;

Soared the Vancour eagle, Screaming, across the sun; Deep dived the loon in terror Under Lake Horicon.

Panther and hart together Fled to the wilds afar, From the flash and the crash of the cannon And the rush of the southward war.

But at last by the lordly river The trampling giant swayed, And his massive arm swung eastward Like a blindly-plunging blade.

New England felt her bosom Menaced with deadly blow, And her minute-men sprang up again And flew to bar the foe.

But Stark in his Hampshire valley Watched like a glowering bear, That hears the cry go sweeping by Yet stirs not from his lair;

For on his daring spirit A wrath lay like a spell,-- The wrath of one rewarded ill For a great work wrought right well.

Neighbor and friend and brother Flocked to his side in vain,-- "What, can it be that they long for me To ruin their cause again?

"Surely the northern lights are bright. Surely the South lies still. Would they have more?--Lo, I left my sword On the crest of Bunker Hill."

But at last from his own New Hampshire An urgent summons came, That stirred his heart like the voice of God From Sinai's walls of flame.

He bowed his head, and he rose aloft; Again he grasped the brand,-- "For the cause of man and my native State, Not for an ingrate land!"

Through the mist-veil faintly struggling, The rays of the setting sun Reddened the leafy village Of white-walled Bennington.

Then out of the dismal weather Came many a sound of war,-- The straggling shots and the volleys And the cries, now near now far.

For forms half seen were chasing The phantom forms that fled; And ghostly figures grappled And spectres fought and bled;

Till the mist on a sudden settled And they saw before them fair, Over a hill to the westward, An island in the air.

There were tree-trunks and waving branches, And greensward and flowers below; It rose in a dome of verdure From the mist-waves' watery flow.

A flag from its summit floated And a circling earthwork grew, As the arms of the swarming soldiers At their toil unwonted flew.

"Aha!" cried the Yankee leader, "So the panther has turned at bay With his claws of steel and his breath of fire Behind that wall of clay!

"_Our_ steel is in muscle and sinew. But I know,"--and his voice rang free,-- "Right well I know we shall strike a blow That the world will leap to see."

I stood by a blazing city Till the fires had died away, Save a flickering gleam in the ruins And a fitful gleam on the bay.

But a swarthy cove by the water Blue-bristled from point to base, With the breath of demons, bursting Through the crust of their prison-place;

And another beside it flaunted A thousand rags of red, Like the Plague King's dancing banners On a mound of the swollen dead.

Twin brothers of flame and evil, In their quivering living light, They ruled with a frightful beauty The desolate waste of night.

Thus did the battle mountain Blazon with flashes dire; The leaguered crest responded In a coronal of fire.

The tough old fowling-pieces In huddling tumult rang. Louder the muskets' roaring! Shriller the rifles' clang!

Hour after hour the turmoil Gathered and swelled apace, Till the hill seemed a volcano Bursting in every place.

Then the lights grew faint and meagre, Though the hideous noise rolled on; And out of a bath of glory Uprose the noble sun.

It brightened the tossing banner; It yellowed the leafy crest; It smote on the serried weapons, On helmet and scarlet breast.

It drove on the mist below them Where Stark and his foremost stood, Flashing volley for volley Into the stubborn wood.

A thousand stalwart figures Sprang from the gulf profound, A thousand guns uplifted Went whirling round and round.

Like some barbarian onslaught On a lofty Roman hold; Like the upward rush of Titans On Olympian gods of old;

With a swirl of the wrangling torrents As they dash on a castle wall; With the flame-seas skyward surging At the mountain demon's call,

Heedless of friend and brother Stricken to earth below, The sons of New England bounded On the breastwork of the foe.

Each stalwart form on the ramparts Swaying his battered gun Seemed a vengeful giant, looming Against the rising sun.

The pond'rous clubs swept crashing Through the bayonets round their feet As a woodman's axe-edge crashes Through branches mailed in sleet,

Shattering head and shoulder, Splintering arm and thigh, Hurling the redcoats earthward Like bolts from an angry sky.

Faster each minute and faster The yeomen swarm over the wall, And narrower grows the circle And thicker the Britons fall;

Till Baum with his Hessian swordsmen Swift to the rescue flies, The frown of the Northland on their brows And the war-light in their eyes.

Back reeled the men of Berkshire, The mountaineers gave back, But Stark and his Hampshire yeomen Flung full across their track.

The stern Teutonic mother Well might she grandly eye The prowess dread of her war-swarms red As they racked the earth and sky.

Like rival wrestling athletes Grappled the East and West. With straining thews and staring eyes They swayed and strove for the royal prize, A continent's virgin breast.

Till at last as a strong man's wrenching Shatters a brittle vase, The lustier arms of the Westland Shattered the elder race.

Baum and his bravest cohorts Lay on the trampled sod, And Stark's strong cry rose clear and high, "Yield in the name of God!"

Then the sullen Hessians yielded, Girt by an iron ring, And down from the summit fluttered The flag of the British king.

Vainly the tardy Breyman May strive that height to gain; More work for the Hampshire war-clubs! More room for the Hessian slain!

The giant's arm is severed, The giant's blood flows free, And he staggers in the pathway That leads to the distant sea.

The Berkshire and Hampshire yeomen With the men of the Hudson join, And the gathering flood rolls over The host of the bold Burgoyne.

For a cycle was closed and rounded, A continent lost and won, When Stark and his men went over The earthworks at Bennington.

W. H. BABCOCK.

Saint Leger, meanwhile, had landed at Oswego and advanced against Fort Stanwix. General Nicholas Herkimer, commander of the militia of Tryon County, at the head of eight hundred men, started to the rescue. He met the enemy, on August 5, at Oriskany, and there followed the most obstinate and murderous battle of the Revolution. Both sides claimed the victory.

THE BATTLE OF ORISKANY

[August 6, 1777]

As men who fight for home and child and wife, As men oblivious of life In holy martyrdom, The yeomen of the valley fought that day, Throughout thy fierce and deadly fray,-- Blood-red Oriskany.

From rock and tree and clump of twisted brush The hissing gusts of battle rush,-- Hot-breathed and horrible! The roar, the smoke, like mist on stormy seas, Sweep through thy splintered trees,-- Hard-fought Oriskany.

Heroes are born in such a chosen hour; From common men they rise, and tower, Like thee, brave Herkimer! Who wounded, steedless, still beside the beech Cheered on thy men, with sword and speech, In grim Oriskany.

But ere the sun went toward the tardy night, The valley then beheld the light Of freedom's victory; And wooded Tryon snatched from British arms The empire of a million farms-- On bright Oriskany.

The guns of Stanwix thunder to the skies; The rescued wilderness replies; Forth dash the garrison! And routed Tories, with their savage aids, Sink reddening through the sullied shades-- From lost Oriskany.

CHARLES D. HELMER.

Saint Leger rallied his shaken columns and settled down to besiege the fort, which laughed at his summons to surrender. Soon afterwards, news of Oriskany and of the siege arrived at General Schuyler's headquarters at Stillwater, and Benedict Arnold set out at once for Fort Stanwix at the head of twelve hundred men. Such exaggerated reports of the size of his force were conveyed to Saint Leger that, on August 22, he raised the siege and retreated to Canada.

SAINT LEGER

[August, 1777]

From out of the North-land his leaguer he led, Saint Leger, Saint Leger; And the war-lust was strong in his heart as he sped; _Their courage_, he cried, _it shall die i' the throat When they mark the proud standards that over us float-- See rover and ranger, redskin and redcoat_! Saint Leger, Saint Leger.

He hurried by water, he scurried by land, Saint Leger, Saint Leger, Till closely he cordoned the patriot band: _Surrender_, he bade, _or I tighten the net!_ _Surrender?_ they mocked him, _we laugh at your threat!_ _By Heaven!_ he thundered, _you'll live to regret_ Saint Leger, Saint Leger!

He mounted his mortars, he smote with his shell, Saint Leger, Saint Leger; Then fumed in a fury that futile they fell; But he counselled with rum till he chuckled, elate, As he sat in his tent-door, _Egad, we can wait, For famine is famous to open a gate_! Saint Leger, Saint Leger.

But lo! as he waited, was borne to his ear-- Saint Leger, Saint Leger-- A whisper of dread and a murmur of fear! _They come, and as leaves are their numbers enrolled! They come, and their onset may not be controlled, For 'tis Arnold who heads them, 'tis Arnold the bold_-- Saint Leger, Saint Leger!

Retreat! Was the word e'er more bitterly said, Saint Leger, Saint Leger, Than when to the North-land your leaguer you led? Alas, for Burgoyne in his peril and

pain-- Who lists in the night for the tramp of that train! And, alas, for the boasting, the vaunting, the vain Saint Leger!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

Saint Leger's retreat, joined to the disaster at Bennington, left Burgoyne in an exceedingly critical condition. The Americans hemmed him in, front and rear, and increased rapidly in numbers; he had received no news from Howe, who was supposed to be on his way up the Hudson to join him; and he found it more and more difficult to get provisions.

THE PROGRESS OF SIR JACK BRAG

Said Burgoyne to his men, as they passed in review, Tullalo, tullalo, tullalo, boys! These rebels their course very quickly will rue, And fly as the leaves 'fore the autumn tempest flew, When him who is your leader they know, boys! They with men have now to deal, And we soon will make them feel-- Tullalo, tullalo, tullalo, boys! That a loyal Briton's arm, and a loyal Briton's steel, Can put to flight a rebel, as quick as other foe, boys! Tullalo, tullalo, tullalo, Tullalo, tullalo, tullalo-o-o-o, boys!

As to Sa-ra-tog' he came, thinking how to jo the game, Tullalo, tullalo, tullalo, boys! He began to see the grubs, in the branches of his fame, He began to have the trembles, lest a flash should be the flame For which he had agreed his perfume to forego, boys! No lack of skill, but fates, Shall make us yield to Gates, Tullalo, tullalo, tullalo, boys! The devils may have leagued, as you know, with the States. But we never will be beat by any mortal foe, boys! Tullalo, tullalo, tullalo, Tullalo, tullalo, tullalo-o-o-o, boys!

The American army was stationed along the western bank of the Hudson; while Burgoyne's troops were encamped along the eastern bank. For nearly a month the armies remained in this position; then Burgoyne determined to advance to Albany, and on September 13, 1777, the British army crossed on a pontoon bridge to the west bank of the Hudson. Two desperate attempts were made to break through the American lines, but the British were routed by Benedict Arnold's superb and daring generalship, and forced to retreat to Saratoga.

ARNOLD AT STILLWATER

[October 7, 1777]

Ah, you mistake me, comrades, to think that my heart is steel! Cased in a cold endurance, nor pleasure nor pain to feel; Cold as I am in my manner, yet over these cheeks so seared Teardrops have fallen in torrents, thrice since my chin grew beard.

Thrice since my chin was bearded I suffered the tears to fall; Benedict Arnold, the traitor, he was the cause of them all! Once, when he carried Stillwater, proud of his valor, I cried; Then, with my rage at his treason--with pity when André died.

Benedict Arnold, the traitor, sank deep in the pit of shame, Bartered for vengeance his honor, blackened for profit his fame; Yet never a gallanter soldier, whatever his

after crime, Fought on the red field of honor than he in his early time.

Ah, I remember Stillwater, as it were yesterday! Then first I shouldered a firelock, and set out the foemen to slay. The country was up all around us, racing and chasing Burgoyne, And I had gone out with my neighbors, Gates and his forces to join.

Marched we with Poor and with Learned, ready and eager to fight; There stood the foemen before us, cannon and men on the height; Onward we trod with no shouting, forbidden to fire till the word; As silent their long line of scarlet--not one of them whispered or stirred.

Suddenly, then, from among them smoke rose and spread on the breeze; Grapeshot flew over us sharply, cutting the limbs from the trees; "What! did you follow me, Armstrong? Pray, do you think it quite right, Leaving your duties out yonder, to risk your dear self in the fight?"

"General Gates sent his orders"--faltering the aide-de-camp spoke-- "You're to return, lest some rashness--" Fiercely the speech Arnold broke: "Rashness! Why, yes, tell the general the rashness he dreaded is done! Tell him his kinsfolk are beaten! tell him the battle is won!"

Oh, that a soldier so glorious, ever victorious in fight, Passed from a daylight of honor into the terrible night!-- Fell as the mighty archangel, ere the earth glowed in space, fell-- Fell from the patriot's heaven down to the loyalist's hell!

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

Burgoyne was hotly pursued, and when he reached the place where he had crossed the Hudson, found it occupied in force by the Americans. The British army, in short, was surrounded, and, after a week's indecision, Burgoyne sent a flag of truce to Gates, inquiring what terms of surrender would be accepted. Three days were spent in a discussion of terms, and on October 17, 1777, Burgoyne surrendered to the American forces.

THE FATE OF JOHN BURGOYNE

[October 17, 1777]

When Jack the King's commander Was going to his duty, Through all the crowd he smiled and bowed To every blooming beauty.

The city rung with feats he'd done In Portugal and Flanders, And all the town thought he'd be crowned The first of Alexanders.

To Hampton Court he first repairs To kiss great George's hand, sirs; Then to harangue on state affairs Before he left the land, sirs.

The "Lower House" sat mute as mouse To hear his grand oration; And "all the peers," with loudest cheers, Proclaimed him to the nation.

Then off he went to Canada, Next to Ticonderoga, And quitting those away he goes Straightway to Saratoga.

With great parade his march he made To gain his wished-for station, While far and wide his minions hied To spread his "Proclamation."

To such as stayed he offers made Of "pardon on submission; But savage bands should waste the lands Of all in opposition."

But ah, the cruel fates of war! This boasted son of Britain, When mounting his triumphal car, With sudden fear was smitten.

The sons of Freedom gathered round, His hostile bands confounded, And when they'd fain have turned their back They found themselves surrounded!

In vain they fought, in vain they fled; Their chief, humane and tender, To save the rest soon thought it best His forces to surrender.

Brave St. Clair, when he first retired, Knew what the fates portended; And Arnold and heroic Gates His conduct have defended.

Thus may America's brave sons With honor be rewarded, And be the fate of all her foes The same as here recorded.

SARATOGA SONG

[October 17, 1777]

Come unto me, ye heroes Whose hearts are true and bold, Who value more your honor Than others do their gold; Give ear unto my story, And I the truth will tell, Concerning many a soldier Who for his country fell.

Burgoyne, the King's commander, From Canada set sail; With full eight thousand regulars, He thought he could not fail; With Indians and Canadians, And his cursèd Tory crew, On board his fleet of shipping He up the Champlain flew.

Before Ticonderoga, The first day of July, Appeared his ships and army, And we did them espy. Their motions we observed, Full well both night and day, And our brave boys prepared To have a bloody fray.

Our garrison, they viewed them, And straight their troops did land; And when St. Clair, our chieftain, The fact did understand, That they the Mount Defiance Were bent to fortify, He found we must surrender, Or else prepare to die.

The fifth day of July, then, He ordered a retreat; And when next morn we started, Burgoyne thought we were beat. And closely he pursued us, Till when near Hubbardton, Our rear guards were defeated, He thought the country won.

And when 'twas told in Congress That we our forts had left, To Albany retreated, Of all the North bereft, Brave General Gates they sent us, Our fortunes to retrieve, And him, with shouts of gladness, The army did receive.

Where first the Mohawk's waters Do in the sunshine play, For Herkimer's brave soldiers Sellinger ambushed lay; And them he there defeated, But soon he had his due, And scared by Brooks and Arnold, He to the north withdrew.

To take the stores and cattle That we had gathered then, Burgoyne sent a detachment Of fifteen hundred men; By Baum they were commanded, To Bennington they went; To plunder and to murder Was fully their intent.

But little did they know then With whom they had to deal; It was not quite so easy Our stores and stocks to steal, Bold Stark would give them only A portion of his lead; With half his crew, ere sunset, Baum lay among the dead.

The nineteenth of September, The morning cool and clear, Brave Gates rode through our army, Each soldier's heart to cheer; "Burgoyne," he cried, "advances, But we will never fly; No--rather than surrender, We'll fight him till we die!"

The news was quickly brought us, The enemy was near, And all along our lines then, There was no sign of fear; It was above Stillwater We met at noon that day, And every one expected To see a bloody fray.

Six hours the battle lasted, Each heart as true as gold, The British fought like lions, And we like Yankees bold; The leaves with blood were crimson, And then did brave Gates cry, "'Tis diamond now cut diamond! We'll beat them, boys, or die."

The darkness soon approaching, It forced us to retreat Into our lines till morning, Which made them think us beat; But ere the sun was risen, They saw before their eyes Us ready to engage them, Which did them much surprise.

Of fighting they seem weary, Therefore to work they go Their thousand dead to bury, And breastworks up to throw; With grape and bombs intending Our army to destroy, Or from our works our forces By stratagem decoy.

The seventh day of October The British tried again, Shells from their cannon throwing, Which fell on us like rain; To drive us from our stations, That they might thus retreat; For now Burgoyne saw plainly He never could us beat.

But vain was his endeavor Our men to terrify; Though death was all around us, Not one of us would fly. But when an hour we'd fought them, And they began to yield, Along our lines the cry ran, "The next blow wins the field!"

Great God who guides their battles Whose cause is just and true, Inspired our bold commander The course he should pursue! He ordered Arnold forward, And Brooks to follow on; The enemy was routed! Our liberty was won!

Then, burning all their luggage, They fled with haste and fear, Burgoyne with all his forces, To Saratoga did steer; And Gates, our brave commander, Soon after him did hie, Resolving he would take them, Or in the effort die.

As we came nigh the village, We overtook the foe; They'd burned each house to ashes, Like all where'er they go. The seventeenth of October, They did capitulate, Burgoyne and his proud army Did we our prisoners make.

Now here's a health to Arnold, And our commander Gates, To Lincoln and to Washington, Whom every Tory hates; Likewise unto our Congress, God grant it long to reign; Our Country, Right, and Justice Forever to maintain.

Now finished is my story, My song is at an end; The freedom we're enjoying We're ready to defend; For while our cause is righteous, Heaven nerves the soldier's arm, And vain is their endeavor Who strive to do us harm.

CHAPTER VII

THE SECOND STAGE

News of the reverse at Saratoga was received in England with amazement and consternation, and its effect on the government was soon discernible. On February 17, 1778, Lord North astonished the House of Commons by rising in his place and moving that Parliament repeal the tea tax and other measures obnoxious to the Americans, that it renounce forever the right of raising a revenue in America, and that commissioners be sent to Congress, with full powers for negotiating a peace. So complete a political somersault has seldom been turned by an English minister.

LORD NORTH'S RECANTATION

[February 17, 1778]

When North first began With his taxation plan, The Colonies all to supplant, To Britain's true cause, And her liberty, laws, Oh, how did he scorn to recant.

Oh! how did he boast Of his pow'r and his host, Alternately swagger and cant; Of freedom so dear, Not a word would he hear, Nor believe he'd be forc'd to recant.

That freedom he swore They ne'er should have more, Their money to give and to grant; Whene'er they addressed, What disdain he express'd, Not thinking they'd make him recant.

He armies sent o'er To America's shore, New government there to transplant; But every campaign Prov'd his force to be vain, Yet still he refus'd to recant.

But with all their bombast, They were so beat at last, As to silence his impious rant; Who for want of success, Could at last do no less Than draw in his horns, and recant.

With his brother Burgoyne, He's forc'd now to join, And a treaty of peace for to want; Says he ne'er will fight, But will give up his right To taxation, and freely recant.

With the great General Howe, He'd be very glad now, He ne'er had engag'd in the jaunt; And ev'ry proud Scot In the devilish plot, With his Lordship, are forc'd to recant.

Old England, alas! They have brought to such pass, Too late are proposals extant; America's lost, Our glory at most Is only that--tyrants recant.

But these proposals came too late. America had just concluded with France a treaty by which she agreed, in consideration of armed support to be furnished by that power, never to entertain proposals of peace from Great Britain until her

independence should be acknowledged. On March 13 this action on the part of France was communicated to the British government, and war against France was instantly declared.

A NEW BALLAD

[1778]

Rouse, Britons! at length, And put forth your strength Perfidious France to resist; Ten Frenchmen will fly, To shun a black eye, If an Englishman doubles his fist. Derry down, down, hey derry down.

But if they feel stout, Why let them turn out, With their maws stuff'd with frogs, soups, and jellies, Brave Hardy's sea thunder Shall strike them with wonder, And make the frogs leap in their bellies!

For their Dons and their ships We care not three skips Of a flea--and their threats turn into jest, O! We'll bang their bare ribs For the infamous fibs Cramm'd into their fine manifesto.

Our brethren so frantic Across the Atlantic, Who quit their old friends in a huff, In spite of their airs, Are at their last prayers, And of fighting have had quantum suff.

Then if powers at a distance Should offer assistance, Say boldly, "we want none, we thank ye," Old England's a match And more for old scratch, A Frenchman, a Spaniard, a Yankee! Derry down, down, hey derry down.

In spite of this change in the complexion of affairs abroad, the situation in America was still critical. Howe had abandoned Burgoyne to his fate, but he had not been inactive. He had set his heart upon the capture of Philadelphia, and in June, 1777, assembled his army at New Brunswick, but finding Washington strongly posted on the Heights of Middlebrook and not daring to attack him, was forced to retire to New York.

GENERAL HOWE'S LETTER

The substance of Sir W.'s last letter from New York, versified.

[June, 1777]

As to kidnap the Congress has long been my aim, I lately resolv'd to accomplish the same; And, that none, in the glory, might want his due share, All the troops were to Brunswick desir'd to repair. Derry down, down, hey derry down.

There I met them in person, and took the command, When I instantly told them the job upon hand; I did not detain them with long-winded stuff, But made a short speech, and each soldier look'd bluff.

With this omen elated, towards Quibbletown I led them, concluding the day was our own; For, till we went thither, the coast was quite clear,-- But Putnam and Washington, d--n them, were there!

I own I was stagger'd, to see with what skill The rogues were intrenched, on the brow of the hill; With a view to dismay them, I show'd my whole force, But they kept their position, and car'd not a curse.

There were then but two ways,--to retreat or attack, And to me it seem'd wisest, by far, to go back; For I thought, if I rashly got into a fray, There might both be the Devil and Piper to pay.

Then, to lose no more time, by parading in vain, I determin'd elsewhere to transfer the campaign; So just as we went, we return'd to this place, With no other diff'rence,--than mending our pace.

Where next we proceed, is not yet very clear, But, when we get there, be assur'd you shall hear; I'll settle that point, when I meet with my brother,-- Meanwhile, we're embarking for some place or other.

Having briefly, my lord, told you,--how the land lies, I hope there's enough--for a word to the wise; 'Tis a good horse, they say, that never will stumble,-- But, fighting or flying,--I'm your very humble.

Howe, finding the approach to the "rebel capital" by land cut off, determined to reach it by water, and about the middle of July put to sea with a fleet of two hundred and twenty-eight sail, carrying an army of eighteen thousand men. Not until the 25th of August did he succeed in landing this force at the head of Chesapeake Bay. Washington, though he had only eleven thousand men, decided to offer battle, rather than let Philadelphia be taken without a blow, and on September 11, 1777, the armies met at Brandywine Creek. The Americans were forced to retire, with a loss of about a thousand men, and the British entered Philadelphia two weeks later.

CARMEN BELLICOSUM

In their ragged regimentals Stood the old Continentals, Yielding not, When the grenadiers were lunging, And like hail fell the plunging Cannon-shot; When the files Of the isles, From the smoky night-encampment, bore the banner of the rampant Unicorn, And grummer, grummer, grummer, rolled the roll of the drummer, Through the morn!

Then with eyes to the front all, And with guns horizontal, Stood our sires; And the balls whistled deadly, And in streams flashing redly Blazed the fires: As the roar Of the shore, Swept the strong battle-breakers o'er the green-sodded acres Of the plain; And louder, louder, louder, cracked the black gunpowder, Cracking amain!

Now like smiths at their forges Worked the red St. George's Cannoneers; And the "villainous saltpetre" Rung a fierce, discordant metre Round their ears; As the swift Storm-drift, With hot sweeping anger, came the horse-guards' clangor On our flanks: Then higher, higher, higher, burned the old-fashioned fire Through the ranks!

Then the bareheaded Colonel Galloped through the white infernal Powder-cloud; And his broadsword was swinging And his brazen throat was ringing Trumpet-loud. Then the blue Bullets flew, And the trooper-jackets redden at the touch of the leaden

Rifle-breath; And rounder, rounder, rounder, roared the iron six-pounder, Hurling Death.

GUY HUMPHREYS MCMASTER.

Washington retired to winter quarters at Valley Forge, where, through the neglect and mismanagement of Congress, the patriot army was so ill-provided with food, clothing, and shelter, and endured sufferings so intense that, from disease and desertion, it dwindled at times to less than two thousand effective men.

VALLEY FORGE

From "The Wagoner of the Alleghanies"

[1777-78]

O'er town and cottage, vale and height, Down came the Winter, fierce and white, And shuddering wildly, as distraught At horrors his own hand had wrought.

His child, the young Year, newly born, Cheerless, cowering, and affrighted, Wailed with a shivering voice forlorn, As on a frozen heath benighted. In vain the hearths were set aglow, In vain the evening lamps were lighted, To cheer the dreary realm of snow: Old Winter's brow would not be smoothed, Nor the young Year's wailing soothed.

How sad the wretch at morn or eve Compelled his starving home to leave, Who, plunged breast-deep from drift to drift, Toils slowly on from rift to rift, Still hearing in his aching ear The cry his fancy whispers near, Of little ones who weep for bread Within an ill-provided shed!

But wilder, fiercer, sadder still, Freezing the tear it caused to start, Was the inevitable chill Which pierced a nation's agued heart,-- A nation with its naked breast Against the frozen barriers prest, Heaving its tedious way and slow Through shifting gulfs and drifts of woe, Where every blast that whistled by Was bitter with its children's cry.

Such was the winter's awful sight For many a dreary day and night, What time our country's hope forlorn, Of every needed comfort shorn, Lay housed within a hurried tent, Where every keen blast found a rent, And oft the snow was seen to sift Along the floor its piling drift, Or, mocking the scant blankets' fold, Across the night-couch frequent rolled; Where every path by a soldier beat, Or every track where a sentinel stood, Still held the print of naked feet, And oft the crimson stains of blood; Where Famine held her spectral court, And joined by all her fierce allies: She ever loved a camp or fort Beleaguered by the wintry skies,-- But chiefly when Disease is by, To sink the frame and dim the eye, Until, with seeking forehead bent, In martial garments cold and damp, Pale Death patrols from tent to tent, To count the charnels of the camp.

Such was the winter that prevailed Within the crowded, frozen gorge; Such were the horrors that assailed The patriot band at Valley Forge.

It was a midnight storm of woes To clear the sky for Freedom's morn; And such must ever be the throes The hour when Liberty is born.

THOMAS BUCHANAN READ.

Howe's army, meanwhile, spent the winter in Philadelphia; very pleasantly, for the most part, and yet not without various alarms, one of which was celebrated by Francis Hopkinson in some famous verses to the tune of "Yankee Doodle," published in the _Pennsylvania Packet_, March 4, 1778.

BRITISH VALOR DISPLAYED;

OR, THE BATTLE OF THE KEGS

[January 5, 1778]

Gallants attend, and hear a friend Trill forth harmonious ditty; Strange things I'll tell which late befel In Philadelphia city.

'Twas early day, as Poets say, Just when the sun was rising, A soldier stood on a log of wood, And saw a sight surprising.

As in a maze he stood to gaze (The truth can't be deny'd, Sir), He spy'd a score of kegs, or more, Come floating down the tide, Sir.

A sailor, too, in jerkin blue, This strange appearance viewing, First damn'd his eyes, in great surprise, Then said "Some mischief's brewing:

"These kegs now hold, the rebels bold, Packed up like pickl'd herring; And they're come down t' attack the town In this new way of ferry'ng."

The soldier flew, the sailor too, And, scar'd almost to death, Sir, Wore out their shoes to spread the news, And ran 'til out of breath, Sir.

Now up and down, throughout the town Most frantic scenes were acted; And some ran here, and others there, Like men almost distracted.

Some fire cry'd, which some deny'd, But said the earth had quaked; And girls and boys, with hideous noise, Ran thro' the streets half naked.

Sir William he, snug as a flea, Lay all this time a snoring; Nor dream'd of harm as he lay warm In bed with Mrs. Loring.

Now in a fright, he starts upright, Awaked by such a clatter; He rubs both eyes, and boldly cries, "For God's sake, what's the matter?"

At his bedside he then espy'd, _Sir Erskine_ at command, Sir; Upon one foot he had one boot, And t' other in his hand, Sir.

"Arise, arise," _Sir Erskine_ cries, "The rebels--more's the pity-- Without a boat, are all afloat, And rang'd before the city.

"The motley crew, in vessels new, With Satan for their guide, Sir, Pack'd up in bags, and wooden kegs, Come driving down the tide, Sir.

"Therefore prepare for bloody war; These kegs must all be routed; Or surely we dispis'd shall be, And British valor doubted."

The royal band now ready stand, All ranged in dread array, Sir, On every slip, on every ship, For to begin the fray, Sir.

The cannons roar from shore to shore; The small-arms loud did rattle; Since wars began I'm sure no man E'er saw so strange a battle.

The _rebel_ dales, the _rebel_ vales, With _rebel_ trees surrounded, The distant woods, the hills and floods, With _rebel_ echoes sounded.

The fish below swam to and fro, Attack'd from every quarter; Why, sure (thought they), the De'il's to pay 'Mong folks above the water.

The kegs, 'tis said, though strongly made Of _rebel_ staves and hoops, Sir, Could not oppose their pow'rful foes, The conq'ering British troops, Sir.

From morn to night these men of might Display'd amazing courage; And when the sun was fairly down, Retired to sup their porridge.

A hundred men, with each a pen, Or more, upon my word, Sir, It is most true, would be too few, Their valor to record, Sir.

Such feats did they perform that day Against these wicked kegs, Sir, That years to come, _if they get home_, They'll make their boasts and brags, Sir.

FRANCIS HOPKINSON.

Another pleasant story of the same period, which also has its foundation in fact, is told by Mr. Carleton in "The Little Black-Eyed Rebel." The heroine's name was Mary Redmond, and she succeeded more than once in helping to smuggle through letters from soldiers in the Continental army to their wives in Philadelphia.

THE LITTLE BLACK-EYED REBEL[5]

A boy drove into the city, his wagon loaded down With food to feed the people of the British-governed town; And the little black-eyed rebel, so innocent and sly, Was watching for his coming from the corner of her eye.

His face looked broad and honest, his hands were brown and tough, The clothes he wore upon him were homespun, coarse, and rough; But one there was who watched him, who long time lingered nigh, And cast at him sweet glances from the corner of her eye.

He drove up to the market, he waited in the line; His apples and potatoes were fresh and fair and fine; But long and long he waited, and no one came to buy, Save the black-eyed rebel, watching from the corner of her eye.

"Now who will buy my apples?" he shouted long and loud; And "Who wants my potatoes?" he repeated to the crowd; But from all the people round him came no word of a reply, Save the black-eyed rebel, answering from the corner of her eye.

For she knew that 'neath the lining of the coat he wore that day, Were long letters from the husbands and the fathers far away, Who were fighting for the freedom that they meant to gain or die; And a tear like silver glistened in the corner of her eye.

But the treasures--how to get them? crept the question through her mind, Since keen enemies were watching for what prizes they might find: And she paused awhile and pondered, with a pretty little sigh; Then resolve crept through her features, and a shrewdness fired her eye.

So she resolutely walked up to the wagon old and red; "May I have a dozen apples for a kiss?" she sweetly said: And the brown face flushed to scarlet; for the boy was somewhat shy, And he saw her laughing at him from the corner of her eye.

"You may have them all for nothing, and more, if you want," quoth he. "I will have them, my good fellow, but can pay for them," said she; And she clambered on the wagon, minding not who all were by, With a laugh of reckless romping in the corner of her eye.

Clinging round his brawny neck, she clasped her fingers white and small, And then whispered, "Quick! the letters! thrust them underneath my shawl! Carry back again _this_ package, and be sure that you are spry!" And she sweetly smiled upon him from the corner of her eye.

Loud the motley crowd were laughing at the strange, ungirlish freak, And the boy was scared and panting, and so dashed he could not speak; And, "Miss, _I_ have good apples," a bolder lad did cry; But she answered, "No, I thank you," from the corner of her eye.

With the news of loved ones absent to the dear friends they would greet, Searching them who hungered for them, swift she glided through the street, "There is nothing worth the doing that it does not pay to try," Thought the little black-eyed rebel, with a twinkle in her eye.

WILL CARLETON.

[5] From _Poems for Young Americans_, published by Harper & Bros.

Early in May, Sir Henry Clinton succeeded Howe in command of the British forces, and on June 18, 1778, evacuated Philadelphia, and started, with his whole army, for New York. Washington started in pursuit, and on Sunday, June 28, ordered General Charles Lee, in command of the advance guard, to fall upon the British left wing near Monmouth Court-House. Instead of pressing forward, Lee ordered his men to retire, and they began to fall into disorder. At that moment, Washington, summoned by Lafayette, galloped up, white with rage, ordered Lee to the rear, re-formed the troops, and drove the British back. Night put an end to the conflict, and Clinton managed to get away under cover of the darkness, leaving his wounded behind.

THE BATTLE OF MONMOUTH

[June 28, 1778]

Whilst in peaceful quarters lying We indulge the glass till late, Far remote the thought of dying, Hear, my friends, the soldier's fate: From the summer's sun hot beaming, Where yon dust e'en clouds the skies, To the plains where heroes bleeding, Shouts and dying groans arise. Halt! halt! halt! form every rank here; Mark yon dust that climbs the sky, To the front close up the long rear, See! the enemy is nigh; Platoons march at proper distance, Cover close each rank and file, They will make a bold resistance, Here, my lads, is gallant toil.

Now all you from downy slumber Roused to the soft joys of love, Waked to pleasures without number, Peace and ease your bosoms prove: Round us roars Bellona's thunder, Ah! how close the iron storm, O'er the field wild stalks pale wonder, Pass the word there, form, lads, form. To the left display that column, Front, halt, dress, be bold and brave; Mark in air yon fiery volume, Who'd refuse a glorious grave; Ope your boxes, quick, be ready, See! our light-bobs gain the hill; Courage, boys, be firm and steady, Hence each care, each fear lie still.

Now the dismal cannon roaring Speaks loud terror to the soul, Grape shot wing'd with death fast pouring, Ether rings from pole to pole; See, the smoke, how black and dreary, Clouds sulphureous hide the sky, Wounded, bloody, fainting, weary, How their groans ascend on high! Firm, my lads; who breaks the line thus? Oh! can brave men ever yield, Glorious danger now combines us, None but cowards quit the field. To the rear each gun dismounted; Close the breach, and brisk advance. All your former acts recounted This day's merit shall enhance.

Now half-choked with dust and powder, Fiercely throbs each bursting vein: Hark! the din of arms grows louder, Ah! what heaps of heroes slain! See, from flank to flank wide flashing, How each volley rends the gloom; Hear the trumpet; ah! what clashing, Man and horse now meet their doom; Bravely done! each gallant soldier Well sustained this heavy fire; Alexander ne'er was bolder; Now by regiments retire. See, our second line moves on us, Ope your columns, give them way, Heaven perhaps may smile upon us, These may yet regain the day.

Now our second line engaging, Charging close, spreads carnage round, Fierce revenge and fury raging, Angry heroes bite the ground. The souls of brave men here expiring Call for vengeance e'en in death, Frowning still, the dead, the dying, Threaten with their latest breath. To the left obliquely flying, Oh! be ready, level well, Who could think of e'er retiring, See, my lads, those volleys tell. Ah! by heavens, our dragoons flying, How the squadrons fill the plain! Check them, boys, ye fear not dying, Sell your lives, nor fall in vain.

Now our left flank they are turning; Carnage is but just begun; Desperate now, 'tis useless mourning, Farewell, friends, adieu the sun! Fix'd to die, we scorn retreating, To the shock our breasts oppose, Hark! the shout, the signal beating, See, with bayonets they close: Front rank charge! the rear make ready! Forward, march--reserve your fire! Now present, fire brisk, be steady, March, march, see their lines retire! On the left, our light troops dashing, Now our dragoons charge the rear, Shout! huzza! what glorious slashing, They run, they run, hence banish fear!

Now the toil and danger's over, Dress alike the wounded brave, Hope again inspires the lover, Old and young forget the grave; Seize the canteen, poise it higher, Rest to each brave soul that fell! Death for this is ne'er the nigher, Welcome mirth, and fear farewell.

R. H.

THE BATTLE OF MONMOUTH

[June 28, 1778]

Four-and-eighty years are o'er me; great-grandchildren sit before me; These my locks are white and scanty, and my limbs are weak and worn; Yet I've been where cannon roaring, firelocks rattling, blood outpouring, Stirred the souls of patriot soldiers, on the tide of battle borne; Where they told me I was bolder far than many a comrade older, Though a stripling at that fight for the right.

All that sultry day in summer beat his sullen march the drummer, Where the Briton strode the dusty road until the sun went down; Then on Monmouth plain encamping, tired and footsore with the tramping, Lay all wearily and drearily the forces of the crown, With their resting horses neighing and their evening bugles playing, And their sentries pacing slow to and fro.

Ere the day to night had shifted, camp was broken, knapsacks lifted, And in motion was the vanguard of our swift-retreating foes; Grim Knyphausen rode before his brutal Hessians, bloody Tories-- They were fit companions, truly, hirelings these and traitors those-- While the careless jest and laughter of the teamsters coming after Rang around each creaking wain of the train.

'Twas a quiet Sabbath morning; nature gave no sign of warning Of the struggle that would follow when we met the Briton's might; Of the horsemen fiercely spurring, of the bullets shrilly whirring, Of the bayonets brightly gleaming through the smoke that wrapped the fight; Of the cannon thunder-pealing, and the wounded wretches reeling, And the corses gory red of the dead.

Quiet nature had no prescience; but the Tories and the Hessians Heard the baying of the bugles that were hanging on their track; Heard the cries of eager ravens soaring high above the cravens; And they hurried, worn and worried, casting startled glances back, Leaving Clinton there to meet us, with his bull-dogs fierce to greet us, With the veterans of the crown, scarred and brown.

For the fight our souls were eager, and each Continental leaguer, As he gripped his firelock firmly, scarce could wait the word to fire; For his country rose such fervor, in his heart of hearts, to serve her, That it gladdened him and maddened him and kindled raging ire. Never panther from his fastness, through the forest's gloomy vastness, Coursed more grimly night and day for his prey.

I was in the main force posted; Lee, of whom his minions boasted, Was commander of the vanguard, and with him were Scott and Wayne. What they did I know not, cared not; in their march of shame I shared not; But it startled me to see them

panic-stricken back again, At the black morass's border, all in headlong, fierce disorder, With the Briton plying steel at their heel.

Outward cool when combat waging, howsoever inward raging, Ne'er had Washington shown feeling when his forces fled the foe; But to-day his forehead lowered, and we shrank his wrath untoward, As on Lee his bitter speech was hurled in hissing tones and low: "Sir, what means this wild confusion? Is it cowardice or collusion? Is it treachery or fear brings you here?"

Lee grew crimson in his anger--rang his curses o'er the clangor, O'er the roaring din of battle, as he wrathfully replied; But his raging was unheeded; fastly on our chieftain speeded, Rallied quick the fleeing forces, stayed the dark, retreating tide; Then, on foaming steed returning, said to Lee, with wrath still burning, "Will you now strike a blow at the foe?"

At the words Lee drew up proudly, curled his lip and answered loudly; "Ay!" his voice rang out, "and will not be the first to leave the field;" And his word redeeming fairly, with a skill surpassed but rarely, Struck the Briton with such ardor that the scarlet column reeled; Then, again, but in good order, past the black morass's border, Brought his forces rent and torn, spent and worn.

As we turned on flanks and centre, in the path of death to enter, One of Knox's brass six-pounders lost its Irish cannoneer; And his wife who, 'mid the slaughter, had been bearing pails of water For the gun and for the gunner, o'er his body shed no tear. "Move the piece!"--but there they found her loading, firing that six-pounder, And she gayly, till we won, worked the gun.

Loud we cheered as Captain Molly waved the rammer; then a volley Pouring in upon the grenadiers, we sternly drove them back; Though like tigers fierce they fought us, to such zeal had Molly brought us That, though struck with heat, and thirsting, yet of drink we felt no lack: There she stood amid the clamor, busily handling sponge and rammer, While we swept with wrath condign on their line.

From our centre backward driven, with his forces rent and riven, Soon the foe re-formed in order, dressed again his shattered ranks; In a column firm advancing, from his bayonets hot rays glancing Showed in waving lines of brilliance as he fell upon our flanks, Charging bravely for his master: thus he met renewed disaster From the stronghold that we held back repelled.

Monckton, gallant, cool, and fearless, 'mid his bravest comrades peerless, Brought his grenadiers to action but to fall amid the slain; Everywhere their ruin found them; red destruction rained around them From the mouth of Oswald's cannon, from the musketry of Wayne; While our sturdy Continentals, in their dusty regimentals, Drove their plumed and scarlet force, man and horse.

Beamed the sunlight fierce and torrid o'er the raging battle horrid, Till, in faint exhaustion sinking, death was looked on as a boon; Heat, and not a drop of water--heat, that won the race of slaughter, Fewer far with bullets dying than beneath the sun of June; Only ceased the terrible firing, with the Briton slow retiring, As the sunbeams in the west sank to rest.

On our arms so heavily sleeping, careless watch our sentries keeping, Ready to renew the contest when the dawning day should show; Worn with toil and heat, in slumber soon were wrapt our greatest number, Seeking strength to rise again and fall upon the wearied foe; For we felt his power was broken! but what rage was ours outspoken When, on waking at the dawn, he had gone.

In the midnight still and sombre, while our force was wrapt in slumber, Clinton set his train in motion, sweeping fast to Sandy Hook; Safely from our blows he bore his mingled Britons, Hessians, Tories-- Bore away his wounded soldiers, but his useless dead forsook; Fleeing from a worse undoing, and too far for our pursuing: So we found the field our own, and alone.

How that stirring day comes o'er me! How those scenes arise before me! How I feel a youthful vigor for a moment fill my frame! Those who fought beside me seeing, from the dim past brought to being, By their hands I fain would clasp them--ah! each lives but in a name; But the freedom that they fought for, and the country grand they wrought for, Is their monument to-day, and for aye.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

The most famous incident of the fight, next to Washington's encounter with Lee, is the exploit of a camp follower named Molly Pitcher or Molly McGuire. She was a sturdy, red-haired, freckle-faced Irishwoman, and during the battle was engaged in carrying water to her husband, who was a cannoneer. A bullet killed him at his post and Molly, seizing his rammer as it fell, sprang to take his place. She served the gun with skill and courage, and on the following morning, covered with dirt and blood, she was presented by General Greene to Washington, who conferred upon her a sergeant's commission.

MOLLY PITCHER

[June 28, 1778]

'Twas hurry and scurry at Monmouth town, For Lee was beating a wild retreat; The British were riding the Yankees down, And panic was pressing on flying feet.

Galloping down like a hurricane Washington rode with his sword swung high, Mighty as he of the Trojan plain Fired by a courage from the sky.

"Halt, and stand to your guns!" he cried. And a bombardier made swift reply. Wheeling his cannon into the tide, He fell 'neath the shot of a foeman nigh.

Molly Pitcher sprang to his side, Fired as she saw her husband do. Telling the king in his stubborn pride Women like men to their homes are true.

Washington rode from the bloody fray Up to the gun that a woman manned. "Molly Pitcher, you saved the day," He said, as he gave her a hero's hand.

He named her sergeant with manly praise, While her war-brown face was wet with tears-- A woman has ever a woman's ways, And the army was wild with cheers.

KATE BROWNLEE SHERWOOD.

MOLLY PITCHER

All day the great guns barked and roared; All day the big balls screeched and soared; All day, 'mid the sweating gunners grim, Who toiled in their smoke-shroud dense and dim, Sweet Molly labored with courage high, With steady hand and watchful eye, Till the day was ours, and the sinking sun Looked down on the field of Monmouth won, And Molly standing beside her gun.

Now, Molly, rest your weary arm! Safe, Molly, all is safe from harm. Now, woman, bow your aching head, And weep in sorrow o'er your dead!

Next day on that field so hardly won, Stately and calm stands Washington, And looks where our gallant Greene doth lead A figure clad in motley weed-- A soldier's cap and a soldier's coat Masking a woman's petticoat. He greets our Molly in kindly wise; He bids her raise her tearful eyes; And now he hails her before them all Comrade and soldier, whate'er befall, "And since she has played a man's full part, A man's reward for her loyal heart! And Sergeant Molly Pitcher's name Be writ henceforth on the shield of fame!"

Oh, Molly, with your eyes so blue! Oh, Molly, Molly, here's to you! Sweet honor's roll will aye be richer To hold the name of Molly Pitcher.

LAURA E. RICHARDS.

About the middle of July, a strong French fleet, commanded by Count D'Estaing, arrived off Sandy Hook, bringing with it M. Gérard, the first minister from France to the United States. It was found that the ships could not pass the bar at the mouth of New York harbor, and it was decided to attempt the capture of the British force which held Newport, R. I., but the expedition proved a failure, and the French sailed away to Boston to refit.

YANKEE DOODLE'S EXPEDITION TO RHODE ISLAND

[August, 1778]

From Lewis, Monsieur Gérard came, To Congress in this town, sir, They bow'd to him, and he to them, And then they all sat down, sir.

Begar, said Monsieur, one grand coup You shall bientôt behold, sir; This was believ'd as gospel true, And Jonathan felt bold, sir.

So Yankee Doodle did forget The sound of British drum, sir, How oft it made him quake and sweat, In spite of Yankee rum, sir.

He took his wallet on his back, His rifle on his shoulder, And veow'd Rhode Island to attack Before he was much older.

In dread array their tatter'd crew Advanc'd with colors spread, sir, Their fifes played Yankee doodle, doo, King Hancock at their head, sir.

What numbers bravely cross'd the seas, I cannot well determine, A swarm of rebels and of fleas, And every other vermin.

Their mighty hearts might shrink they tho't, For all flesh only grass is, A plenteous store they therefore bought Of whiskey and molasses.

They swore they'd make bold Pigot squeak, So did their good ally, sir, And take him pris'ner in a week, But that was all my eye, sir.

As Jonathan so much desir'd To shine in martial story, D'Estaing with politesse retir'd, To leave him all the glory.

He left him what was better yet, At least it was more use, sir, He left him for a quick retreat A very good excuse, sir.

To stay, unless he rul'd the sea, He thought would not be right, sir, And Continental troops, said he, On islands should not fight, sir.

Another cause with these combin'd To throw him in the dumps, sir, For Clinton's name alarmed his mind, And made him stir his stumps, sir.

Lord Howe came up, soon afterwards, with the British fleet, and made a pretence of blockading the French in Boston harbor, but prudently withdrew when he saw the French were ready to put to sea again. The latter abandoned all attempt to coöperate with the Americans and sailed away for the West Indies.

RUNNING THE BLOCKADE

[September, 1778]

When the French fleet lay In Massachusetts bay In that day

When the British squadron made Its impudent parade Of blockade;

All along and up and down The harbor of the town,-- The brave, proud town

That had fought with all its might Its bold, brave fight For the right,

To win its way alone And hold and rule its own, Such a groan

From the stanch hearts and stout Of the Yankees there went out: But to rout

The British lion then Were maddest folly, when One to ten

Their gallant allies lay, Scant of powder, day by day In the bay.

Chafing thus, impatient, sore, One day along the shore Slowly bore

A clipper schooner, worn And rough and forlorn, With its torn

Sails fluttering in the air: The British sailors stare At her there,

So cool and unafraid. "What! she's running the blockade, The jade!"

They all at once roar out, Then--"Damn the Yankee lout!" They shout.

Athwart her bows red hot They send a challenge shot; But not

An inch to right or left she veers, Straight on and on she steers, Nor hears

Challenge or shout, until Rings forth with British will A shrill

"Heave to!" Then sharp and short Question and quick retort Make British sport.

"What is it that you say,-- Where do I hail from pray, What is my cargo, eh?

"My cargo? I'll allow You can hear 'em crowin' now, At the bow.

"And I've long-faced gentry too, For passengers and crew, Just a few,

"To fatten up, you know, For home use, and a show Of garden sass and so.

"And from Taunton town I hail; Good Lord, it was a gale When I set sail!"

The British captain laught As he leaned there abaft: "'Tis a harmless craft,

"And a harmless fellow too, With his long-faced gentry crew; Let him through,"

He cried; and a gay "Heave ahead!" Sounded forth, and there sped Down the red

Sunset track, unafraid, Straight through the blockade, This jade

Of a harmless craft, Packed full to her draught, Fore and aft,

With powder and shot, One day when, red hot The British got

Their full share and more Of this cargo, they swore, With a roar,

At the trick she had played, This "damned Yankee jade" Who had run the blockade!

NORA PERRY.

The abortive expedition against Rhode Island practically ended the war at the north, and for a time the scene of activity was transferred to the frontier. The Indians had naturally allied themselves with the British at the beginning of the war, and early in September, 1777, attacked Fort Henry, near Wheeling, but were beaten off after a desperate fight, during which the garrison was saved by the famous exploit of Elizabeth Zane.

BETTY ZANE

[September, 1777]

Women are timid, cower and shrink At show of danger, some folk think; But men there are who for their lives Dare not so far asperse their wives. We let that pass--so much is clear, Though little perils they may fear, When greater perils men environ, Then women show a front of iron; And, gentle in their manner, they Do bold things in a quiet way, And so our wondering praise obtain, As on a time did Betty Zane.

A century since, out in the West, A block-house was by Girty pressed-- Girty, the renegade, the dread Of all that border, fiercely led Five hundred Wyandots, to gain Plunder and scalp-locks from the slain; And in this hold--Fort Henry then, But Wheeling now--twelve boys and men Guarded with watchful ward and care Women and prattling children there, Against their rude and savage foes, And Betty Zane was one of those.

There had been forty-two at first When Girty on the border burst; But most of those who meant to stay And keep the Wyandots at bay, Outside by savage wiles were

lured, And ball and tomahawk endured, Till few were left the place to hold, And some were boys and some were old; But all could use the rifle well, And vainly from the Indians fell, On puncheon roof and timber wall, The fitful shower of leaden ball.

Now Betty's brothers and her sire Were with her in this ring of fire, And she was ready, in her way, To aid their labor day by day, In all a quiet maiden might. To mould the bullets for the fight, And, quick to note and so report, Watch every act outside the fort; Or, peering through the loopholes, see Each phase of savage strategy-- These were her tasks, and thus the maid The toil-worn garrison could aid.

Still, drearily the fight went on Until a week had nearly gone, When it was told--a whisper first, And then in loud alarm it burst-- Their powder scarce was growing; they Knew where a keg unopened lay Outside the fort at Zane's--what now? Their leader stood with anxious brow. It must be had at any cost, Or toil and fort and lives were lost. Some one must do that work of fear; What man of men would volunteer?

Two offered, and so earnest they, Neither his purpose would give way; And Shepherd, who commanded, dare Not pick or choose between the pair. But ere they settled on the one By whom the errand should be done, Young Betty interposed, and said, "Let me essay the task instead. Small matter 'twere if Betty Zane, A useless woman, should be slain; But death, if dealt on one of those, Gives too much vantage to our foes."

Her father smiled with pleasure grim-- Her pluck gave painful pride to him; And while her brothers clamored "No!" He uttered, "Boys, let Betty go! She'll do it at less risk than you; But keep her steady in your view, And be your rifles shields for her. If yonder foe make step or stir, Pick off each wretch who draws a bead, And so you'll serve her in her need. Now I recover from surprise, I think our Betty's purpose wise."

The gate was opened, on she sped; The foe, astonished, gazed, 'tis said, And wondered at her purpose, till She gained that log-hut by the hill. But when, in apron wrapped, the cask She backward bore, to close her task, The foemen saw her aim at last, And poured their fire upon her fast. Bullet on bullet near her fell, While rang the Indians' angry yell; But safely through that whirring rain, Powder in arms, came Betty Zane.

They filled their horns, both boys and men, And so began the fight again. Girty, who there so long had stayed, By this new feat of feet dismayed, Fired houses round and cattle slew, And moved away--the fray was through. But when the story round was told How they maintained the leaguered hold, It was agreed, though fame was due To all who in that fight were true, The highest meed of praise, 'twas plain, Fell to the share of Betty Zane.

A hundred years have passed since then; The savage never came again. Girty is dust; alike are dead Those who assailed and those bestead. Upon those half-cleared, rolling lands, A crowded city proudly stands; But of the many who reside By green Ohio's rushing tide, Not one has lineage prouder than (Be he or poor or rich) the man Who boasts that in his spotless strain Mingles the blood of Betty Zane.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

Early in July, 1778, the Indians struck a blow at which the whole country stood aghast. The valley of Wyoming, in northeastern Pennsylvania, had, by its fertility, attracted many settlers. The position of the settlement was peculiarly exposed, and yet it had sent the best part of its militia to serve with Washington. This circumstance did not escape the eyes of the enemy, and on July 3, 1778, a force of twelve hundred Indians and Tories fell upon the settlement, routed the garrison, tortured the prisoners to death, and plundered and burned the houses. The settlers fled to the woods, where nearly a hundred women and children perished of fatigue and starvation.

THE WYOMING MASSACRE

[July 3, 1778]

Kind Heaven, assist the trembling muse, While she attempts to tell Of poor Wyoming's overthrow By savage sons of hell.

One hundred whites, in painted hue, Whom Butler there did lead, Supported by a barb'rous crew Of the fierce savage breed.

The last of June the siege began, And several days it held, While many a brave and valiant man Lay slaughtered on the field.

Our troops marched out from Forty Fort The third day of July, Three hundred strong, they marched along, The fate of war to try.

But oh! alas! three hundred men Is much too small a band To meet eight hundred men complete, And make a glorious stand.

Four miles they marchèd from the Fort Their enemy to meet, Too far indeed did Butler lead, To keep a safe retreat.

And now the fatal hour is come-- They bravely charge the foe, And they, with ire, returned the fire, Which prov'd our overthrow.

Some minutes they sustained the fire, But ere they were aware, They were encompassed all around, Which prov'd a fatal snare.

And then they did attempt to fly, But all was now in vain, Their little host--by far the most-- Was by those Indians slain.

And as they fly, for quarters cry; Oh hear! indulgent Heav'n! Hard to relate--their dreadful fate, No quarters must be given.

With bitter cries and mournful sighs, They seek some safe retreat, Run here and there, they know not where, Till awful death they meet.

Their piercing cries salute the skies-- Mercy is all their cry: "Our souls prepare God's grace to share, We instantly must die."

Some men yet found are flying round Sagacious to get clear; In vain to fly, their foes too nigh! They front the flank and rear.

And now the foe hath won the day, Methinks their words are these: "Ye cursed, rebel, Yankee race, Will this your Congress please?

"Your pardons crave, you them shall have, Behold them in our hands; We'll all agree to set you free, By dashing out your brains.

"And as for you, enlisted crew, We'll raise your honors higher: Pray turn your eye, where you must lie, In yonder burning fire."

Then naked in those flames they're cast, Too dreadful 'tis to tell, Where they must fry, and burn and die, While cursed Indians yell.

Nor son, nor sire, these tigers spare,-- The youth, and hoary head, Were by those monsters murdered there, And numbered with the dead.

Methinks I hear some sprightly youth His mournful state condole: "Oh, that my tender parents knew The anguish of my soul!

"But oh! there's none to save my life, Or heed my dreadful fear; I see the tomahawk and knife, And the more glittering spear.

"When years ago, I dandled was Upon my parents' knees, I little thought I should be brought To feel such pangs as these.

"I hoped for many a joyful day, I hoped for riches' store-- These golden dreams are fled away; I straight shall be no more.

"Farewell, fond mother; late I was Locked up in your embrace; Your heart would ache, and even break, If you could know my case.

"Farewell, indulgent parents dear, I must resign my breath; I now must die, and here must lie In the cold arms of death.

"For oh! the fatal hour is come, I see the bloody knife,-- The Lord have mercy on my soul!" And quick resigned his life.

A doleful theme; yet, pensive muse, Pursue the doleful theme; It is no fancy to delude, Nor transitory dream.

The Forty Fort was the resort For mother and for child, To save them from the cruel rage Of the fierce savage wild.

Now, when the news of this defeat Had sounded in our ears, You well may know our dreadful woe, And our foreboding fears.

A doleful sound is whispered round, The sun now hides his head; The nightly gloom forebodes our doom, We all shall soon be dead.

How can we bear the dreadful spear, The tomahawk and knife? And if we run, the awful gun Will rob us of our life.

But Heaven! kind Heaven, propitious power! His hand we must adore. He did assuage the savage rage, That they should kill no more.

The gloomy night now gone and past, The sun returns again, The little birds from every bush Seem to lament the slain.

With aching hearts and trembling hands, We walkèd here and there, Till through the northern pines we saw A flag approaching near.

Some men were chose to meet this flag, Our colonel was the chief, Who soon returned and in his mouth He brought an olive leaf.

This olive leaf was granted life, But then we must no more Pretend to fight with Britain's king, Until the wars are o'er.

And now poor Westmoreland is lost, Our forts are all resigned, Our buildings they are all on fire,-- What shelter can we find?

They did agree in black and white, If we'd lay down our arms, That all who pleased might quietly Remain upon their farms.

But oh! they've robbed us of our all, They've taken all but life, And we'll rejoice and bless the Lord, If this may end the strife.

And now I've told my mournful tale, I hope you'll all agree To help our cause and break the jaws Of cruel tyranny.

URIAH TERRY.

CHAPTER VIII

THE WAR ON THE WATER

At the outbreak of the Revolution, the colonies had no navy, but a number of cruisers and privateers were soon fitted out, and by the end of 1776 nearly three hundred British vessels had fallen into the hands of the Americans. This activity was kept up during the succeeding year, the cruise of the Fair American, as described in the old ballad of that name, being one of the most noteworthy.

THE CRUISE OF THE FAIR AMERICAN

[1777]

The twenty-second of August, Before the close of day, All hands on board of our privateer, We got her under weigh; We kept the Eastern shore along, For forty leagues or more, Then our departure took for sea, From the isle of Mauhegan shore.

Bold Hawthorne was commander, A man of real worth, Old England's cruel tyranny Induced him to go forth; She, with relentless fury, Was plundering all our coast, And thought, because her strength was great, Our glorious cause was lost.

Yet boast not, haughty Britons, Of power and dignity, By land thy conquering armies, Thy matchless strength at sea; Since taught by numerous instances Americans can fight, With valor can equip their stand, Your armies put to flight.

Now farewell to fair America, Farewell our friends and wives; We trust in Heaven's peculiar care For to protect their lives; To prosper our intended cruise Upon the

raging main, And to preserve our dearest friends Till we return again.

The wind it being leading, It bore us on our way, As far unto the southward As the Gulf of Florida; Where we fell in with a British ship, Bound homeward from the main; We gave her two bow-chasers, And she returned the same.

We haulèd up our courses, And so prepared for fight; The contest held four glasses, Until the dusk of night; Then having sprung our main-mast, And had so large a sea, We dropped astern and left our chase Till the returning day.

Next morn we fished our main-mast, The ship still being nigh, All hands made for engaging, Our chance once more to try; But wind and sea being boisterous, Our cannon would not bear, We thought it quite imprudent And so we left her there.

We cruisèd to the eastward, Near the coast of Portugal, In longitude of twenty-seven We saw a lofty sail; We gave her chase, and soon perceived She was a British snow Standing for fair America, With troops for General Howe.

Our captain did inspect her With glasses, and he said, "My boys, she means to fight us, But be you not afraid; All hands repair to quarters, See everything is clear, We'll give her a broadside, my boys, As soon as she comes near."

She was prepared with nettings, And her men were well secured, And bore directly for us, And put us close on board; When the cannon roared like thunder, And the muskets fired amain, But soon we were alongside And grappled to her chain.

And now the scene it altered, The cannon ceased to roar, We fought with swords and boarding-pikes One glass or something more, Till British pride and glory No longer dared to stay, But cut the Yankee grapplings, And quickly bore away.

Our case was not so desperate As plainly might appear; Yet sudden death did enter On board our privateer. Mahoney, Crew, and Clemmons, The valiant and the brave, Fell glorious in the contest, And met a watery grave.

Ten other men were wounded Among our warlike crew, With them our noble captain, To whom all praise is due; To him and all our officers Let's give a hearty cheer; Success to fair America And our good privateer.

The Americans were not without their losses, and one of the most serious occurred early in 1778. On the morning of March 7, the 32-gun frigate Randolph, Captain Nicholas Biddle, while cruising off Barbadoes, fell in with the English 64-gun ship of the line Yarmouth, and attacked immediately. The fight had lasted about an hour when the Randolph's magazine was in some way fired, and the ship blew up. Of the crew of three hundred and fifteen, only four were saved.

ON THE DEATH OF CAPTAIN NICHOLAS BIDDLE

[March 7, 1778]

What distant thunders rend the skies, What clouds of smoke in volumes rise, What means this dreadful roar! Is from his base Vesuvius thrown, Is sky-topt Atlas tumbled down, Or Etna's self no more!

Shock after shock torments my ear; And lo! two hostile ships appear, Red lightnings round them glow: The Yarmouth boasts of sixty-four, The Randolph thirty-two--no more-- And will she fight this foe!

The Randolph soon on Stygian streams Shall coast along the land of dreams, The islands of the dead! But fate, that parts them on the deep, Shall save the Briton, still to weep His ancient honors fled.

Say, who commands that dismal blaze, Where yonder starry streamer plays; Does Mars with Jove engage! 'Tis Biddle wings those angry fires, Biddle, whose bosom Jove inspires With more than mortal rage.

Tremendous flash! and hark, the ball Drives through old Yarmouth, flames and all; Her bravest sons expire; Did Mars himself approach so nigh, Even Mars, without disgrace, might fly The Randolph's fiercer fire.

The Briton views his mangled crew, "And shall we strike to _thirty-two_" (Said Hector, stained with gore); "Shall Britain's flag to these descend-- Rise, and the glorious conflict end, Britons, I ask no more!"

He spoke--they charged their cannon round, Again the vaulted heavens resound, The Randolph bore it all, Then fixed her pointed cannons true-- Away the unwieldy vengeance flew; Britain, the warriors fall.

The Yarmouth saw, with dire dismay, Her wounded hull, shrouds shot away, Her boldest heroes dead-- She saw amidst her floating slain The conquering Randolph stem the main-- She saw, she turned, and fled!

That hour, blest chief, had she been thine, Dear Biddle, had the powers divine Been kind as thou wert brave; But fate, who doomed thee to expire, Prepared an arrow tipped with fire, And marked a watery grave,

And in that hour when conquest came Winged at his ship a pointed flame That not even _he_ could shun-- The conquest ceased, the Yarmouth fled, The bursting Randolph ruin spread, And lost what honor won.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

Among the most successful of the Yankee privateers was the Providence, and her most famous exploit was performed in July, 1779, when she attacked a fleet of merchantmen, under convoy of a ship of the line and some cruisers, and captured ten prizes, nine of which, valued at over a million dollars, were got safely to Boston. The Providence was commanded by Abraham Whipple, the hero of the Gaspee exploit and of a hundred others.

THE YANKEE PRIVATEER

[July, 1779]

Come listen and I'll tell you How first I went to sea, To fight against the British And earn our liberty. We shipped with Cap'n Whipple Who never knew a fear, The Captain of the Providence, The Yankee Privateer.

We sailed and we sailed And made good cheer, There were many pretty men On the Yankee Privateer.

The British Lord High Admiral He wished old Whipple harm, He wrote that he would hang him At the end of his yard arm. "My Lord," wrote Cap'n Whipple back, "It seems to me it's clear That if you want to hang him, You must catch your Privateer."

We sailed and we sailed And made good cheer, For not a British frigate Could come near the Privateer.

We sailed to the south'ard, And nothing did we meet, Till we found three British frigates And their West Indian fleet. Old Whipple shut our ports As we crawled up near, And he sent us all below On the Yankee Privateer.

So slowly he sailed We dropped to the rear, And not a soul suspected The Yankee Privateer.

At night we put the lights out And forward we ran And silently we boarded The biggest merchantman. We knocked down the watch,-- And the lubbers shook for fear, She's a prize without a shot To the Yankee Privateer.

We sent the prize north While we lay near And all day we slept On the bold Privateer.

For ten nights we followed, And ere the moon rose, Each night a prize we'd taken Beneath the Lion's nose. When the British looked to see Why their ships should disappear, They found they had in convoy A Yankee Privateer.

But we sailed and sailed And made good cheer! Not a coward was on board Of the Yankee Privateer.

The biggest British frigate Bore round to give us chase, But though he was the fleeter Old Whipple wouldn't race, Till he'd raked her fore and aft, For the lubbers couldn't steer, Then he showed them the heels Of the Yankee Privateer.

Then we sailed and we sailed And we made good cheer, For not a British frigate Could come near the Privateer.

Then northward we sailed To the town we all know, And there lay our prizes All anchored in a row; And welcome were we To our friends so dear, And we shared a million dollars On the bold Privateer.

We'd sailed and we'd sailed And we made good cheer, We had all full pockets On the bold Privateer.

Then we each manned a ship And our sails we unfurled, And we bore the Stars and Stripes O'er the oceans of the world. From the proud flag of Britain We swept the seas clear, And we earned our independence On the Yankee Privateer.

Then landsmen and sailors, One more cheer! Here is three times three For the Yankee Privateer!

ARTHUR HALE.

The achievements of other American naval captains were soon eclipsed by those of John Paul Jones, a Scotch sailor, settled in Virginia, who, at the outbreak of the war, offered his services to Congress. In 1776, on board the Alfred, in the Delaware River, he raised the first flag of the Revolution,--a pine tree, with a rattlesnake coiled at the foot, and the motto, "Don't tread on me."

PAUL JONES

A song unto Liberty's brave Buccaneer, Ever bright be the fame of the patriot Rover, For our rights he first fought in his "black privateer," And faced the proud foe ere our sea they cross'd over, In their channel and coast, He scattered their host, And proud Britain robbed of her sea-ruling boast, And her rich merchants' barks shunned the ocean in fear Of Paul Jones, fair Liberty's brave Buccaneer.

In the first fleet that sailed in defence of our land, Paul Jones forward stood to defend freedom's arbor, He led the bold Alfred at Hopkins' command, And drove the fierce foeman from Providence harbor, 'Twas his hand that raised The first flag that blazed, And his deeds 'neath the "Pine tree" all ocean amaz'd, For hundreds of foes met a watery bier From Paul Jones, fair Liberty's brave Buccaneer.

His arm crushed the Tory and mutinous crew That strove to have freemen inhumanly butchered; Remember his valor at proud Flamborough, When he made the bold Serapis strike to the Richard; Oh! he robbed of their store The vessels sent o'er To feed all the Tories and foes on our shore, He gave freemen the spoils and long may they revere The name of fair Liberty's bold Buccaneer.

In 1778 he was sent with the 18-gun ship Ranger to prowl about the British coasts. He entered the Irish Channel, seized the Lord Chatham, set fire to the shipping at Whitehaven, and captured the British 20-gun sloop Drake, after a fierce fight. With the Drake and several merchant prizes, he made his way to Brest, and prepared for a more important expedition which was fitting out for the following year.

THE YANKEE MAN-OF-WAR

[1778]

'Tis of a gallant Yankee ship that flew the stripes and stars, And the whistling wind from the west-nor'-west blew through the pitch-pine spars,-- With her starboard tacks aboard, my boys, she hung upon the gale, On an autumn night we raised the light on the old head of Kinsale.

It was a clear and cloudless night, and the wind blew steady and strong, As gayly over the sparkling deep our good ship bowled along; With the foaming seas beneath her bow the fiery waves she spread, And bending low her bosom of snow, she buried her lee cat-head.

There was no talk of short'ning sail by him who walked the poop, And under the press of her pond'ring jib, the boom bent like a hoop! And the groaning water-ways told the strain that held her stout main-tack, But he only laughed as he glanced aloft

at a white and silv'ry track.

The mid-tide meets in the channel waves that flow from shore to shore, And the mist hung heavy upon the land from Featherstone to Dunmore, And that sterling light in Tusker Rock where the old bell tolls each hour, And the beacon light that shone so bright was quench'd on Waterford Tower.

The nightly robes our good ship wore were her own top-sails three, Her spanker and her standing jib--the courses being free; "Now, lay aloft! my heroes bold, let not a moment pass!" And royals and top-gallant sails were quickly on each mast.

What looms upon our starboard bow? What hangs upon the breeze? 'Tis time our good ship hauled her wind abreast the old Saltee's, For by her ponderous press of sail and by her consorts four We saw our morning visitor was a British man-of-war.

Up spake our noble Captain then, as a shot ahead of us past-- "Haul snug your flowing courses! lay your top-sail to the mast!" Those Englishmen gave three loud hurrahs from the deck of their covered ark, And we answered back by a solid broadside from the decks of our patriot bark.

"Out booms! out booms!" our skipper cried, "out booms and give her sheet," And the swiftest keel that was ever launched shot ahead of the British fleet, And amidst a thundering shower of shot with stun'-sails hoisting away, Down the North Channel Paul Jones did steer just at the break of day.

The new squadron sailed for the English coast in the summer of 1779. It consisted of the flagship--a clumsy old Indiaman called the Duras, whose name Jones changed to Bon Homme Richard--and four consorts. The summer was spent in cruising about the British coast and so much damage was done that Paul Jones became a sort of bogey to all England.

PAUL JONES--A NEW SONG

Of heroes and statesmen I'll just mention four, That cannot be match'd, if we trace the world o'er, For none of such fame ever stept o'er the stones, As Green, Jemmy Twitcher, Lord North, and Paul Jones.

Thro' a mad-hearted war, which old England will rue, At London, at Dublin, and Edinburgh, too, The tradesmen stand still, and the merchant bemoans The losses he meets with from such as Paul Jones.

How happy for England, would Fortune but sweep At once all her treacherous foes to the deep; For the land under burthens most bitterly groans, To get rid of some that are worse than Paul Jones.

To each honest heart that is Britain's true friend, In bumpers I'll freely this toast recommend, May Paul be converted, the Ministry purg'd, Old England be free, and her enemies scourg'd!

If success to our fleets be not quickly restor'd, The Leaders in office to shove from the board; May they all fare alike, and the De'il pick the bones Of Green, Jemmy

Twitcher, Lord North, and Paul Jones!

On September 23, 1779, the little squadron sighted a British fleet of forty sail off Flamborough Head. They were merchantmen bound for the Baltic under convoy of the Serapis, forty-four, and the Countess of Scarborough, twenty. Captain Jones instantly gave chase, ordering his consorts to form in line of battle, but the Alliance, whose command had been given to a Frenchman, ran off to some distance, leaving the Richard to attack the Serapis single-handed, while the Pallas took care of the Scarborough.

PAUL JONES

[September 23, 1779]

An American frigate from Baltimore came, Her guns mounted forty, the Richard by name; Went to cruise in the channel of old England, With a noble commander, Paul Jones was the man.

We had not sail'd long before we did espy A large forty-four, and a twenty close by: These two warlike ships, full laden with store, Our captain pursued to the bold Yorkshire shore.

At the hour of twelve, Pierce came alongside. With a loud speaking-trumpet, "Whence came you?" he cried; "Quick give me an answer, I hail'd you before, Or this very instant a broadside I'll pour."

Paul Jones he exclaimed, "My brave boys, we'll not run: Let every brave seaman stand close to his gun;" When a broadside was fired by these brave Englishmen, We bold buckskin heroes return'd it again.

We fought them five glasses, five glasses most hot, Till fifty brave seamen lay dead on the spot, And full seventy more lay bleeding in their gore, Whilst Pierce's loud cannon on the Richard did roar.

Our gunner, affrighted, unto Paul Jones he came, "Our ship is a-sinking, likewise in a flame;" Paul Jones he replied, in the height of his pride, "If we can do no better, we'll sink alongside."

At length our shot flew so quick, they could not stand: The flag of proud Britain was forced to come down, The Alliance bore down and the Richard did rake, Which caused the heart of Richard to ache.

Come now, my brave buckskin, we've taken a prize, A large forty-four, and a twenty likewise; They are both noble vessels, well laden with store! We will toss off the can to our country once more.

God help the poor widows, who shortly must weep For the loss of their husbands, now sunk in the deep! We'll drink to brave Paul Jones, who, with sword in hand, Shone foremost in action, and gave us command.

The Serapis was greatly superior to the Richard in armament and fighting qualities, but Jones succeeded in running his vessel into her and lashing fast. So close

did they lie that their yardarms interlocked and both ships were soon covered with dead and wounded. At the end of two hours, the Serapis was on fire; but the Richard was already sinking. Half an hour later the Serapis surrendered. The Richard was kept afloat with great difficulty until morning, when she sank.

THE BONHOMME RICHARD AND SERAPIS

[September 23, 1779]

O'er the rough main, with flowing sheet, The guardian of a numerous fleet, Serapis from the Baltic came: A ship of less tremendous force Sail'd by her side the self-same course, Countess of Scarb'ro' was her name.

And now their native coasts appear, Britannia's hills their summits rear Above the German main; Fond to suppose their dangers o'er, They southward coast along the shore, Thy waters, gentle Thames, to gain.

Full forty guns Serapis bore, And Scarb'ro's Countess twenty-four, Mann'd with Old England's boldest tars-- What flag that rides the Gallic seas Shall dare attack such piles as these, Design'd for tumults and for wars!

Now from the top-mast's giddy height A seaman cry'd--"Four sail in sight Approach with favoring gales." Pearson, resolv'd to save the fleet, Stood off to sea, these ships to meet, And closely brac'd his shivering sails.

With him advanc'd the Countess bold, Like a black tar in wars grown old: And now these floating piles drew nigh. But, muse, unfold what chief of fame In the other warlike squadron came, Whose standards at his mast-head fly.

'Twas Jones, brave Jones, to battle led As bold a crew as ever bled Upon the sky-surrounded main; The standards of the western world Were to the willing winds unfurl'd, Denying Britain's tyrant reign.

The Good-Man-Richard led the line; The Alliance next: with these combine The Gallic ship they Pallas call, The Vengeance arm'd with sword and flame; These to attack the Britons came-- But _two_ accomplish'd all.

Now Phoebus sought his pearly bed: But who can tell the scenes of dread, The horrors of that fatal night! Close up these floating castles came: The Good-Man-Richard bursts in flame; Serapis trembled at the sight.

She felt the fury of _her_ ball: Down, prostrate, down the Britons fall; The decks were strew'd with slain: Jones to the foe his vessel lash'd; And, while the black artillery flash'd, Loud thunders shook the main.

Alas! that mortals should employ Such murdering engines to destroy That frame by heaven so nicely join'd; Alas! that e'er the god decreed That brother should by brother bleed, And pour'd such madness in the mind.

But thou, brave Jones, no blame shalt bear, The rights of man demand your care: For _these_ you dare the greedy waves. No tyrant, on destruction bent, Has plann'd thy conquest--thou art sent To humble tyrants and their slaves.

See!--dread Serapis flames again-- And art thou, Jones, among the slain, And sunk to Neptune's caves below?-- He lives--though crowds around him fall, Still he, unhurt, survives them all; Almost alone he fights the foe.

And can your ship these strokes sustain? Behold your brave companions slain, All clasp'd in ocean's cold embrace; STRIKE, OR BE SUNK--the Briton cries-- SINK IF YOU CAN--the chief replies, Fierce lightnings blazing in his face.

Then to the side three guns he drew (Almost deserted by his crew), And charg'd them deep with woe; By Pearson's flash he aim'd hot balls; His main-mast totters--down it falls-- O'erwhelming half below.

Pearson had yet disdain'd to yield, But scarce his secret fears conceal'd, And thus was heard to cry-- "With hell, not mortals, I contend; What art thou--human, or a fiend, That dost my force defy?

"Return, my lads, the fight renew!"-- So call'd bold Pearson to his crew; But call'd, alas! in vain; Some on the decks lay maim'd and dead; Some to their deep recesses fled, And hosts were shrouded in the main.

Distress'd, forsaken, and alone, He haul'd his tatter'd standard down, And yielded to his gallant foe; Bold Pallas soon the Countess took,-- Thus both their haughty colors struck, Confessing what the brave can do.

But, Jones, too dearly didst thou buy These ships possest so gloriously, Too many deaths disgrac'd the fray: Thy barque that bore the conquering flame, That the proud Briton overcame, Even she forsook thee on thy way;

For when the morn began to shine, Fatal to her, the ocean brine Pour'd through each spacious wound; Quick in the deep she disappear'd; But Jones to friendly Belgia steer'd, With conquest and with glory crown'd.

Go on, great man, to scourge the foe, And bid these haughty Britons know They to our _Thirteen Stars_ shall bend; Those _Stars_ that, veil'd in dark attire, Long glimmer'd with a feeble fire, But radiant now ascend.

Bend to the Stars that flaming rise In western, not in eastern, skies, Fair Freedom's reign restored-- So when the Magi, come from far, Beheld the God-attending Star, They trembled and ador'd.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

Another remarkable action was that between the Hyder Ali and the General Monk. The latter, a cruiser mounting twenty nine-pounders, had been harassing the American shipping in Delaware Bay, and the merchants of Philadelphia finally equipped the Hyder Ali, an old merchantman, with sixteen six-pounders, put Joshua Barney in command and started him after the British ship.

BARNEY'S INVITATION

[April, 1782]

Come all ye lads who know no fear, To wealth and honor with me steer In the Hyder Ali privateer, Commanded by brave Barney.

She's new and true, and tight and sound, Well rigged aloft, and all well found-- Come away and be with laurel crowned, Away--and leave your lasses.

Accept our terms without delay, And make your fortunes while you may, Such offers are not every day In the power of the jolly sailor.

Success and fame attend the brave, But death the coward and the slave, Who fears to plough the Atlantic wave, To seek the bold invaders.

Come, then, and take a cruising bout, Our ship sails well, there is no doubt, She has been tried both in and out, And answers expectation.

Let no proud foes whom Europe bore, Distress our trade, insult our shore-- Teach them to know their reign is o'er, Bold Philadelphia sailors!

We'll teach them how to sail so near, Or to venture on the Delaware, When we in warlike trim appear And cruise without Henlopen.

Who cannot wounds and battle dare Shall never clasp the blooming fair; The brave alone their charms should share, The brave are their protectors.

With hand and heart united all, Prepared to conquer or to fall, Attend, my lads, to honor's call, Embark in our Hyder Ali.

From an Eastern prince she takes her name, Who, smit with Freedom's sacred flame, Usurping Britons brought to shame, His country's wrongs avenging;

See, on her stern the waving stars-- Inured to blood, inured to wars, Come, enter quick, my jolly tars, To scourge these warlike Britons.

Here's grog enough--then drink a bout, I know your hearts are firm and stout; American blood will never give out, And often we have proved it.

Though stormy oceans round us roll, We'll keep a firm undaunted soul, Befriended by the cheering bowl, Sworn foes to melancholy:

When timorous landsmen lurk on shore, 'Tis ours to go where cannons roar-- On a coasting cruise we'll go once more, Despisers of all danger;

And Fortune still, who crowns the brave, Shall guard us over the gloomy wave; A fearful heart betrays the knave-- Success to the Hyder Ali.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

The Hyder Ali sailed down the bay April 8, 1782, and met the Englishman near the capes. By skilful manoeuvring, Barney was able to rake his antagonist; then, lashing fast, poured several broadsides in rapid succession into the enemy, who struck their colors at the end of thirty minutes.

SONG

ON CAPTAIN BARNEY'S VICTORY OVER THE SHIP GENERAL MONK

[April 8, 1782]

O'er the waste of waters cruising, Long the General Monk had reigned; All subduing, all reducing, None her lawless rage restrained: Many a brave and hearty fellow Yielding to this warlike foe, When her guns began to bellow Struck his humbled colors low.

But grown bold with long successes, Leaving the wide watery way, She, a stranger to distresses, Came to cruise within Cape May: "Now we soon (said Captain Rogers) Shall their men of commerce meet; In our hold we'll have them lodgers, We shall capture half their fleet.

"Lo! I see their van appearing-- Back our topsails to the mast-- They toward us full are steering With a gentle western blast: I've a list of all their cargoes, All their guns, and all their men: I am sure these modern Argos Can't escape us one in ten:

"Yonder comes the Charming Sally Sailing with the General Greene-- First we'll fight the Hyder Ali, Taking her is taking them: She intends to give us battle, Bearing down with all her sail-- Now, boys, let our cannon rattle! To take her we cannot fail.

"Our eighteen guns, each a nine-pounder, Soon shall terrify this foe; We shall maul her, we shall wound her, Bringing rebel colors low."-- While he thus anticipated Conquests that he could not gain, He in the Cape May channel waited For the ship that caused his pain.

Captain Barney then preparing, Thus addressed his gallant crew-- "Now, brave lads, be bold and daring, Let your hearts be firm and true; This is a proud English cruiser, Roving up and down the main, We must fight her--must reduce her, Though our decks be strewed with slain.

"Let who will be the survivor, We must conquer or must die, We must take her up the river, Whate'er comes of you or I: Though she shows most formidable With her eighteen pointed nines, And her quarters clad in sable, Let us balk her proud designs.

"With four nine-pounders, and twelve sixes We will face that daring band; Let no dangers damp your courage, Nothing can the brave withstand. Fighting for your country's honor, Now to gallant deeds aspire; Helmsman, bear us down upon her, Gunner, give the word to fire!"

Then yardarm and yardarm meeting, Strait began the dismal fray, Cannon mouths, each other greeting, Belched their smoky flames away: Soon the langrage, grape and chain shot, That from Barney's cannons flew, Swept the Monk, and cleared each round top, Killed and wounded half her crew.

Captain Rogers strove to rally But they from their quarters fled, While the roaring Hyder Ali Covered o'er his decks with dead. When from their tops their dead men tumbled, And the streams of blood did flow, Then their proudest hopes were humbled By their brave inferior foe.

All aghast, and all confounded, They beheld their champions fall, And their captain, sorely wounded, Bade them quick for quarters call. Then the Monk's proud flag descended, And her cannon ceased to roar; By her crew no more defended, She confessed the contest o'er.

Come, brave boys, and fill your glasses, You have humbled one proud foe, No brave action this surpasses, Fame shall tell the nation so-- Thus be Britain's woes completed, Thus abridged her cruel reign, Till she ever, thus defeated, Yields the sceptre of the main.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

The last naval action of the war occurred December 19, 1782, when the American ship, South Carolina, forty guns, was chased and captured, off the Delaware, by the British ships Quebec, Diomede, and Astrea, carrying ninety-eight guns. A few days later a ballad describing the affair appeared in the loyalist papers as a letter "from a dejected Jonathan, a prisoner taken in the South Carolina, to his brother Ned at Philadelphia."

THE SOUTH CAROLINA

[December 19, 1782]

My dear brother Ned, We are knock'd on the head, No more let America boast; We may all go to bed, And that's enough said, For the South Carolina we've lost.

The pride of our eyes, I swear is a prize, You never will see her again, Unless thro' surprise, You are brought where she lies, A prisoner from the false main.

Oh Lord! what a sight!-- I was struck with affright, When the Diomede's shot round us fell, I feared that in spite, They'd have slain us outright, And sent us directly to h--l.

The Quebec did fire, Or I'm a curs'd liar, And the Astrea came up apace; We could not retire From the confounded fire, They all were so eager in chase.

The Diomede's shot Was damnation hot, She was several times in a blaze; It was not my lot To go then to pot, But I veow, I was struck with amaze.

And Ned, may I die, Or be pok'd in a sty, If ever I venture again Where bullets do fly, And the wounded do cry, Tormented with anguish and pain.

The Hope, I can tell, And the brig Constance fell, I swear, and I veow, in our sight; The first I can say, Was taken by day, But the latter was taken at night.

I die to relate What has been our fate, How sadly our navies are shrunk; The pride of our State Begins to abate, For the branches are lopp'd from the trunk.

The Congress must bend, We shall fall in the end, For the curs'd British sarpents are tough; But, I think as you find, I have enough penn'd Of such cursèd, such vexatious stuff.

Yet how vexing to find We are left all behind, That by sad disappointment we're cross'd; Ah, fortune unkind! Thou afflicted'st my mind, When the South Carolina we

lost.

Our enemy vile, Cunning Digby does smile, Is pleasèd at our mischance; He useth each wile Our fleets to beguile, And to check our commerce with France.

No more as a friend, Our ships to defend, Of South Carolina we boast; As a foe in the end, She will us attend, For the South Carolina we've lost.

CHAPTER IX

NEW YORK AND THE "NEUTRAL GROUND"

For more than a year following the battle of Monmouth, Sir Henry Clinton remained cooped up in New York, while Washington, established in camp at White Plains, kept a sharp eye upon him. The thirty miles between their lines, embracing nearly all of Westchester County, was known as the "Neutral Ground." New York was naturally crowded with Royalist refugees, whom Clinton put to work on the fortifications.

SIR HENRY CLINTON'S INVITATION TO THE REFUGEES

[1779]

Come, gentlemen Tories, firm, loyal, and true, Here are axes and shovels, and something to do! For the sake of our King, Come labor and sing. You left all you had for his honor and glory, And he will remember the suffering Tory. We have, it is true, Some small work to do; But here's for your pay, twelve coppers a day, And never regard what the rebels may say, But throw off your jerkins and labor away.

To raise up the rampart, and pile up the wall, To pull down old houses and dig the canal, To build and destroy, Be this your employ, In the daytime to work at our fortifications, And steal in the night from the rebels your rations. The King wants your aid, Not empty parade; Advance to your places, ye men of long faces, Nor ponder too much on your former disgraces; This year, I presume, will quite alter your cases.

Attend at the call of the fifer and drummer, The French and the rebels are coming next summer, And the forts we must build Though the Tories are killed. Take courage, my jockies, and work for your King, For if you are taken, no doubt you will swing. If York we can hold, I'll have you enroll'd; And after you're dead, your names shall be read, As who for their monarch both labor'd and bled, And ventur'd their necks for their beef and their bread.

'Tis an hour to serve the bravest of nations, And be left to be hanged in their capitulations. Then scour up your mortars, And stand to your quarters, 'Tis nonsense for Tories in battle to run, They never need fear sword, halberd, or gun; Their hearts should not fail 'em, No balls will assail 'em, Forget your disgraces, and shorten your faces, For 'tis true as the gospel, believe it or not, Who are born to be hang'd, will never be shot.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

On the last day of May, Clinton had succeeded in capturing the fortress at Stony Point, on the Hudson, had thrown a garrison of six hundred men into it, and added two lines of fortifications, rendering it almost impregnable. Washington, nevertheless, determined to recapture it, and intrusted the task to General Anthony Wayne, giving him twelve hundred men for the purpose. At midnight of July 15, the Americans crossed the swamp which divided the fort from the mainland, reached the outworks before they were discovered, and carried the fort by storm.

THE STORMING OF STONY POINT

[July 16, 1779]

Highlands of Hudson! ye saw them pass, Night on the stars of their battle-flag, Threading the maze of the dark morass Under the frown of the Thunder Crag;

Flower and pride of the Light Armed Corps, Trim in their trappings of buff and blue, Silent, they skirted the rugged shore, Grim in the promise of work to do.

"Cross ye the ford to the moated rock! Let not a whisper your march betray! Out with the flint from the musket lock! Now! let the bayonet find the way!"

"Halt!" rang the sentinel's challenge clear. Swift came the shot of the waking foe. Bright flashed the axe of the Pioneer Smashing the abatis, blow on blow.

Little they tarried for British might! Lightly they recked of the Tory jeers! Laughing, they swarmed to the craggy height, Steel to the steel of the Grenadiers!

Storm King and Dunderberg! wake once more Sentinel giants of Freedom's throne, Massive and proud! to the Eastern shore Bellow the watchword: "The fort's our own!"

Echo our cheers for the Men of old! Shout for the Hero who led his band Braving the death that his heart foretold Over the parapet, "spear in hand!"

ARTHUR GUITERMAN.

WAYNE AT STONY POINT

[July 16, 1779]

'Twas the heart of the murky night, and the lowest ebb of the tide, Silence lay on the land, and sleep on the waters wide, Save for the sentry's tramp, or the note of a lone night bird, Or the sough of the haunted pines as the south wind softly stirred. Gloom above and around, and the brooding spirit of rest; Only a single star over Dunderberg's lofty crest.

Through the drench of ooze and slime at the marge of the river fen File upon file slips by. See! are they ghosts or men? Fast do they forward press, on by a track unbarred; Now is the causeway won, now have they throttled the guard; Now have they parted line to storm with a rush on the height, Some by a path to the left, some by a path to the right.

Hark,--the peal of a gun! and the drummer's rude alarms! Ringing down from the height there soundeth the cry, _To arms!_ Thundering down from the height there cometh the cannon's blare; Flash upon blinding flash lightens the livid air: Look! do the stormers quail? Nay, for their feet are set Now at the bastion's base, now on the parapet!

Urging the vanguard on prone doth the leader fall, Smitten sudden and sore by a foeman's musket-ball; Waver the charging lines; swiftly they spring to his side,-- Madcap Anthony Wayne, the patriot army's pride! _Forward, my braves!_ he cries, and the heroes hearten again; _Bear me into the fort, I'll die at the head of my men!_

Die!--did he die that night, felled in his lusty prime? Answer many a field in the stormy aftertime! Still did his prowess shine, still did his courage soar, From the Hudson's rocky steep to the James's level shore; But never on Fame's fair scroll did he blazon a deed more bright Than his charge on Stony Point in the heart of the murky night.

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

The raids over the "Neutral Ground" continued, and among the boldest of the leaders on the American side was Colonel Aaron Burr. But not all of his nights were occupied in warlike expeditions. Fifteen miles away, across the Hudson, dwelt the charming Widow Prevost, whom he afterwards married, and on at least two occasions, Burr, with a boldness to touch the heart of any woman, succeeded in getting across to spend a few hours with her.

AARON BURR'S WOOING

From the commandant's quarters on Westchester height The blue hills of Ramapo lie in full sight: On their slope gleam the gables that shield his heart's queen, But the redcoats are wary--the Hudson's between. Through the camp runs a jest: "There's no moon--'twill be dark; 'Tis odds little Aaron will go on a spark!" And the toast of the troopers is: "Pickets, lie low, And good luck to the colonel and Widow Prevost!"

Eight miles to the river he gallops his steed, Lays him bound in the barge, bids his escort make speed, Loose their swords, sit athwart, through the fleet reach yon shore. Not a word--not a plash of the thick-muffled oar! Once across, once again in the seat and away-- Five leagues are soon over when love has the say; And "Old Put" and his rider a bridle-path know To the Hermitage manor of Madame Prevost.

Lightly done! but he halts in the grove's deepest glade, Ties his horse to a birch, trims his cue, slings his blade, Wipes the dust and the dew from his smooth, handsome face. With the 'kerchief she broidered and bordered in lace; Then slips through the box-rows and taps at the hall. Sees the glint of a waxlight, a hand white and small, And the door is unbarred by herself all aglow-- Half in smiles, half in tears--Theodosia Prevost.

Alack for the soldier that's buried and gone! What's a volley above him, a wreath on his stone, Compared with sweet life and a wife for one's view Like this dame, ripe and warm in her India fichu? She chides her bold lover, yet holds him more dear, For

the daring that brings him a night-rider here; British gallants by day through her doors come and go, But a Yankee's the winner of Theo. Prevost.

Where's the widow or maid with a mouth to be kist, When Burr comes a-wooing, that long would resist? Lights and wine on the beaufet, the shutters all fast, And "Old Put" stamps in vain till an hour has flown past-- But an hour, for eight leagues must be covered ere day; Laughs Aaron, "Let Washington frown as he may, When he hears of me next, in a raid on the foe, He'll forgive this night's tryst with the Widow Prevost!"

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

In June, 1780, Clinton made a desperate attempt to capture the American stores at Morristown, N. J. At dawn of the 23d, he advanced in great force upon Springfield, where General Greene was stationed. Overwhelming numbers compelled the Americans to fall back to a strong position, which the enemy dared not attack, and after setting fire to the village, Clinton retreated toward Elizabethtown.

THE MODERN JONAS

[June 23, 1780]

You know there goes a tale, How Jonas went on board a whale, Once, for a frolic; And how the whale Set sail And got the cholic; And, after a great splutter, Spew'd him up upon the coast, Just like woodcock on a toast, With trail and butter.

There also goes a joke, How Clinton went on board the Duke Count Rochambeau to fight; As he didn't fail To set sail The first fair gale, For once we thought him right; But, after a great clutter, He turn'd back along the coast, And left the French to make their boast, And Englishmen to mutter.

Just so, not long before, Old Knyp, And old Clip Went to the Jersey shore, The rebel rogues to beat; But, at Yankee farms, They took alarms, At little harms, And quickly did retreat.

Then after two days' wonder, March'd boldly up to Springfield town, And swore they'd knock the rebels down. But as their foes Gave them some blows, They, like the wind, Soon changed their mind. And, in a crack, Returned back, From not one third their number.

On June 6, while on their way to Springfield, the British passed through a village called Connecticut Farms. They set it on fire, destroying almost every house, and one of them shot and killed the wife of Rev. James Caldwell, as she was kneeling at prayer in her bedroom. Her husband took the revenge described in Mr. Harte's poem.

CALDWELL OF SPRINGFIELD

[June 23, 1780]

Here's the spot. Look around you. Above on the height Lay the Hessians encamped. By that church on the right Stood the gaunt Jersey farmers. And here ran

a wall,-- You may dig anywhere and you'll turn up a ball. Nothing more. Grasses spring, waters run, flowers blow, Pretty much as they did ninety-three years ago.

Nothing more, did I say? Stay one moment; you've heard Of Caldwell, the parson, who once preached the Word Down at Springfield? What, No? Come--that's bad; why he had All the Jerseys aflame. And they gave him the name Of the "rebel high-priest." He stuck in their gorge, For he loved the Lord God,--and he hated King George!

He had cause, you might say! When the Hessians that day Marched up with Knyphausen they stopped on their way At the "Farms," where his wife, with a child in her arms, Sat alone in the house. How it happened none knew But God--and that one of the hireling crew Who fired the shot! Enough!--there she lay, And Caldwell, the chaplain, her husband, away!

Did he preach--did he pray? Think of him as you stand By the old church to-day;--think of him and his band Of militant ploughboys! See the smoke and the heat Of that reckless advance,--of that straggling retreat! Keep the ghost of that wife, foully slain, in your view,-- And what could you, what should you, what would you do?

Why, just what he did! They were left in the lurch For the want of more wadding. He ran to the church, Broke the door, stripped the pews, and dashed out in the road With his arms full of hymn-books and threw down his load At their feet! Then above all the shouting and shots, Rang his voice,--"Put Watts into 'em,--Boys, give 'em Watts!"

And they did. That is all. Grasses spring, flowers blow Pretty much as they did ninety-three years ago. You may dig anywhere and you'll turn up a ball,-- But not always a hero like this,--and that's all.

BRET HARTE.

Among the posts occupied by the British on the Hudson was a blockhouse just above Bergen Neck. Pastured on the neck was a large number of cattle and horses, and on July 21, 1780, General Wayne was sent, with some Pennsylvania and Maryland troops, to storm this blockhouse and drive the stock within the American lines. The attack on the blockhouse was repulsed by the British, the Americans losing heavily. It was this affair which was celebrated by Major John André in the verses called "The Cow-Chace."

THE COW-CHACE

[July 21, 1780]

CANTO I

To drive the kine one summer's morn, The Tanner took his way; The calf shall rue that is unborn The jumbling of that day.

And Wayne descending steers shall know, And tauntingly deride; And call to mind in every low, The tanning of _his_ hide.

Yet Bergen cows still ruminate, Unconscious in the stall, What mighty means were used to get, And loose them after all.

For many heroes bold and brave, From Newbridge and Tappan, And those that drink Passaic's wave, And those who eat supawn;

And sons of distant Delaware, And still remoter Shannon, And Major Lee with horses rare, And Proctor with his cannon.

All wond'rous proud in arms they came, What hero could refuse To tread the rugged path to fame, Who had a pair of shoes!

At six, the host with sweating buff, Arrived at Freedom's pole; When Wayne, who thought he'd time enough, Thus speechified the whole:

"O ye, whom glory doth unite, Who Freedom's cause espouse; Whether the wing that's doom'd to fight, Or that to drive the cows,

"Ere yet you tempt your further way, Or into action come, Hear, soldiers, what I have to say, And take a pint of rum.

"Intemp'rate valor then will string Each nervous arm the better; So all the land shall I O sing, And read the Gen'ral's letter.

"Know that some paltry refugees, Whom I've a mind to fright, Are playing h--l amongst the trees That grow on yonder height.

"Their fort and blockhouses we'll level, And deal a horrid slaughter; We'll drive the scoundrels to the devil, And ravish wife and daughter.

"I, under cover of th' attack, Whilst you are all at blows, From English neighb'rhood and Nyack, Will drive away the cows;

"For well you know the latter is The serious operation, And fighting with the refugees Is only demonstration."

His daring words, from all the crowd, Such great applause did gain, That every man declar'd aloud For serious work with Wayne.

Then from the cask of rum once more, They took a heady gill; When one and all, they loudly swore, They'd fight upon the hill.

But here--the Muse hath not a strain Befitting such great deeds; Huzza! they cried, huzza! for Wayne, And shouting,--did their needs.

CANTO II

Near his meridian pomp, the sun Had journey'd from th' horizon; When fierce the dusky tribe mov'd on, Of heroes drunk as pison.

The sounds confus'd of boasting oaths, Reëchoed through the wood; Some vow'd to sleep in dead men's clothes, And some to swim in blood.

At Irving's nod 'twas fine to see The left prepare to fight; The while, the drovers, Wayne and Lee, Drew off upon the right.

Which Irving 'twas, fame don't relate, Nor can the Muse assist her; Whether 'twas he that cocks a hat, Or he that gives a clyster.

For greatly one was signaliz'd, That fought on Chestnut Hill; And Canada immortaliz'd The vender of the pill.

Yet their attendance upon Proctor, They both might have to boast of; For there was business for the doctor, And hats to be disposed of.

Let none uncandidly infer, That Stirling wanted spunk; The self-made peer had sure been there, But that the peer was drunk.

But turn we to the Hudson's banks, Where stood the modest train, With purpose firm, tho' slender ranks, Nor car'd a pin for Wayne.

For them the unrelenting hand Of rebel fury drove, And tore from ev'ry genial band Of friendship and of love.

And some within the dungeon's gloom, By mock tribunals laid, Had waited long a cruel doom Impending o'er each head.

Here one bewails a brother's fate, There one a sire demands, Cut off, alas! before their date, By ignominious hands.

And silver'd grandsires here appear'd In deep distress serene, Of reverent manners that declar'd The better days they'd seen.

Oh, curs'd rebellion, these are thine, Thine all these tales of woe; Shall at thy dire insatiate shrine Blood never cease to flow?

And now the foe began to lead His forces to th' attack; Balls whistling unto balls succeed, And make the blockhouse crack.

No shot could pass, if you will take The Gen'ral's word for true; But 'tis a d----ble mistake, For ev'ry shot went thro'.

The firmer as the rebels press'd, The loyal heroes stand; Virtue had nerv'd each honest breast, And industry each hand.

In valor's frenzy, Hamilton Rode like a soldier big, And Secretary Harrison, With pen stuck in his wig.

But lest their chieftain, Washington, Should mourn them in the mumps, The fate of Withrington to shun, They fought behind the stumps.

But ah, Thaddeus Posset, why Should thy poor soul elope? And why should Titus Hooper die, Ay, die--without a rope?

Apostate Murphy, thou to whom Fair Shela ne'er was cruel, In death shalt hear her mourn thy doom, "Och! would ye die, my jewel?"

Thee, Nathan Pumpkin, I lament, Of melancholy fate; The gray goose stolen as he went, In his heart's blood was wet.

Now, as the fight was further fought, And balls began to thicken, The fray assum'd, the gen'rals thought, The color of a lickin'.

Yet undismay'd the chiefs command, And to redeem the day, Cry, SOLDIERS, CHARGE! they hear, they stand, They turn and run away.

CANTO III

Not all delights the bloody spear, Or horrid din of battle; There are, I'm sure, who'd like to hear A word about the cattle.

The chief whom we beheld of late, Near Schralenberg haranging, At Yan Van Poop's unconscious sat Of Irving's hearty banging.

Whilst valiant Lee, with courage wild, Most bravely did oppose The tears of woman and of child, Who begg'd he'd leave the cows.

But Wayne, of sympathizing heart, Required a relief, Not all the blessings could impart Of battle or of beef.

For now a prey to female charms, His soul took more delight in A lovely hamadryad's arms, Than cow-driving or fighting.

A nymph the refugees had drove Far from her native tree, Just happen'd to be on the move, When up came Wayne and Lee.

She, in Mad Anthony's fierce eye, The hero saw portray'd, And all in tears she took him by-- The bridle of his jade.

"Hear," said the nymph, "oh, great commander! No human lamentations; The trees you see them cutting yonder, Are all my near relations.

"And I, forlorn! implore thine aid, To free the sacred grove; So shall thy prowess be repaid With an immortal's love."

Now some, to prove she was a goddess, Said this enchanting fair Had late retirèd from the Bodies In all the pomp of war.

The drums and merry fifes had play'd To honor her retreat, And Cunningham himself convey'd The lady through the street.

Great Wayne, by soft compassion sway'd, To no inquiry stoops, But takes the fair afflicted maid Right into Yan Van Poop's.

So Roman Anthony, they say, Disgraced th' imperial banner, And for a gypsy lost a day, Like Anthony the tanner.

The hamadryad had but half Receiv'd redress from Wayne, When drums and colors, cow and calf, Came down the road amain.

And in a cloud of dust was seen The sheep, the horse, the goat, The gentle heifer, ass obscene, The yearling and the shoat.

And pack-horses with fowls came by, Be-feather'd on each side, Like Pegasus, the horse that I And other poets ride.

Sublime upon his stirrups rose The mighty Lee behind, And drove the terror-smitten cows Like chaff before the wind.

But sudden see the woods above Pour down another corps, All helter-skelter in a drove, Like that I sung before.

Irving and terror in the van, Came flying all abroad; And cannon, colors, horse, and man, Ran tumbling to the road.

Still as he fled, 'twas Irving's cry, And his example too, "Run on, my merry men--for why? The shot will not go thro'."

As when two kennels in the street, Swell'd with a recent rain, In gushing streams together meet And seek the neighboring drain;

So met these dung-born tribes in one, As swift in their career, And so to Newbridge they ran on-- But all the cows got clear.

Poor Parson Caldwell, all in wonder, Saw the returning train, And mourn'd to Wayne the lack of plunder For them to steal again.

For 'twas his right to steal the spoil, and To share with each commander, As he had done at Staten Island With frost-bit Alexander.

In his dismay, the frantic priest Began to grow prophetic; You'd swore, to see his laboring breast, He'd taken an emetic.

"I view a future day," said he, "Brighter than this dark day is; And you shall see what you shall see, Ha! ha! one pretty Marquis!

"And he shall come to Paulus Hook, And great achievements think on; And make a bow and take a look, Like Satan over Lincoln.

"And every one around shall glory To see the Frenchman caper; And pretty Susan tell the story In the next Chatham paper."

This solemn prophecy, of course, Gave all much consolation, Except to Wayne, who lost his horse Upon that great occasion.

His horse that carried all his prog, His military speeches, His corn-stalk whiskey for his grog, Blue stockings and brown breeches.

And now I've clos'd my epic strain, I tremble as I show it, Lest this same warrior-drover, Wayne, Should ever catch the poet.

JOHN ANDRÉ.

The last stanza was singularly prophetic. The Americans relied for the defence of the Hudson upon the impregnable position at West Point, to the command of which Benedict Arnold had been appointed in July, 1780. Arnold, one of the most brilliant officers in the army, had been treated with great injustice by Congress, and to revenge himself determined to betray West Point into the hands of the British. He

therefore opened communication with Clinton, and on September 21 Major André was sent to confer with the traitor. While returning to the British lines the following night, he was captured by an American outpost, who searched him, discovered the papers giving the details of the plot, and took him back to the American lines, refusing his offers of reward for his release.

BRAVE PAULDING AND THE SPY

[September 23, 1780]

Come all you brave Americans, And unto me give ear, And I'll sing you a ditty That will your spirits cheer, Concerning a young gentleman Whose age was twenty-two; He fought for North America, His heart was just and true.

They took him from his dwelling, And they did him confine, They cast him into prison, And kept him there a time. But he with resolution Resolv'd not long to stay; He set himself at liberty, And soon he ran away.

He with a scouting-party Went down to Tarrytown, Where he met a British officer, A man of high renown, Who says unto these gentlemen, "You're of the British cheer, I trust that you can tell me If there's any danger near?"

Then up stept this young hero, John Paulding was his name, "Sir, tell us where you're going, And, also, whence you came?" "I bear the British flag, sir; I've a pass to go this way, I'm on an expedition, And have no time to stay."

Then round him came this company, And bid him to dismount; "Come, tell us where you're going, Give us a strict account; For we are now resolvèd That you shall ne'er pass by." Upon examination They found he was a spy.

He beggèd for his liberty, He plead for his discharge, And oftentimes he told them, If they'd set him at large, "Here's all the gold and silver I have laid up in store, But when I reach the city, I'll give you ten times more."

"I scorn the gold and silver You have laid up in store, And when you get to New York, You need not send us more; But you may take your sword in hand To gain your liberty, And if that you do conquer me, Oh, then you shall be free."

"The time it is improper Our valor for to try, For if we take our swords in hand, Then one of us must die; I am a man of honor, With courage true and bold, And I fear not the man of clay, Although he's cloth'd in gold."

He saw that his conspiracy Would soon be brought to light; He begg'd for pen and paper, And askèd leave to write A line to General Arnold, To let him know his fate, And beg for his assistance; But now it was too late.

When the news it came to Arnold, It put him in a fret; He walk'd the room in trouble, Till tears his cheek did wet; The story soon went through the camp, And also through the fort; And he callèd for the Vulture And sailèd for New York.

Now Arnold to New York has gone, A-fighting for his king, And left poor Major André On the gallows for to swing; When he was executed, He look'd both meek and

mild; He look'd upon the people, And pleasantly he smil'd.

It mov'd each eye with pity, Caus'd every heart to bleed, And every one wished him releas'd And Arnold in his stead. He was a man of honor, In Britain he was born; To die upon the gallows Most highly he did scorn.

A bumper to John Paulding! Now let your voices sound, Fill up your flowing glasses, And drink his health around; Also to those young gentlemen Who bore him company; Success to North America, Ye sons of liberty!

Arnold learned of André's capture just in time to escape to a British ship in the river, and Washington, arriving soon after, prevented his treacherous disposition of the American forces from being taken advantage of by the enemy.

ARNOLD

THE VILE TRAITOR

[September 25, 1780]

Arnold! the name, as heretofore, Shall now be Benedict no more: Since, instigated by the devil, Thy ways are turned from good to evil.

'Tis fit we brand thee with a name To suit thy infamy and shame; And, since of treason thou'rt convicted, Thy name shall be maledicted. Unless, by way of contradiction, We style thee Britain's Benediction. Such blessings she, with lavish hand, Confers on this devoted land.

For instance, only let us mention Some proof of her benign intention; The slaves she sends us o'er the deep, And bribes to cut our throats in sleep. To take our lives and scalps away, The savage Indians keeps in pay, And Tories worse, by half, than they.

Then, in this class of Britain's heroes,-- The Tories, savage Indians, negroes,-- Recorded Arnold's name shall stand, While Freedom's blessings crown our land, And odious for the blackest crimes, Arnold shall stink to latest times.

EPIGRAM

Quoth Satan to Arnold: "My worthy good fellow, I love you much better than ever I did; You live like a prince, with Hal may get mellow,-- But mind that you both do just what I bid."

Quoth Arnold to Satan: "My friend, do not doubt me! I will strictly adhere to all your great views; To you I'm devoted, with all things about me-- You'll permit me, I hope, to die in my shoes."

New Jersey Gazette, November 1, 1780.

André was tried by court-martial September 29, and condemned to be hanged as a spy. Clinton, with whom André was a warm personal favorite, made a desperate effort

to save him, but in vain; and a petition from André himself that he might be shot instead of hanged was also rejected.

ANDRÉ'S REQUEST TO WASHINGTON

[October 1, 1780]

It is not the fear of death That damps my brow, It is not for another breath I ask thee now; I can die with a lip unstirr'd And a quiet heart-- Let but this prayer be heard Ere I depart.

I can give up my mother's look-- My sister's kiss; I can think of love--yet brook A death like this! I can give up the young fame I burn'd to win-- All--but the spotless name I glory in.

Thine is the power to give, Thine to deny, Joy for the hour I live-- Calmness to die. By all the brave should cherish, By my dying breath, I ask that I may perish By a soldier's death!

NATHANIEL PARKER WILLIS.

Accordingly, on Monday, October 2, 1780, the adjutant-general of the British army was led to the gallows, and shared the fate which had befallen Nathan Hale four years before.

ANDRÉ

This is the place where André met that death Whose infamy was keenest of its throes, And in this place of bravely yielded breath His ashes found a fifty years' repose;

And then, at last, a transatlantic grave, With those who have been kings in blood or fame, As Honor here some compensation gave For that once forfeit to a hero's name.

But whether in the Abbey's glory laid, Or on so fair but fatal Tappan's shore, Still at his grave have noble hearts betrayed The loving pity and regret they bore.

In view of all he lost,--his youth, his love, And possibilities that wait the brave, Inward and outward bound, dim visions move Like passing sails upon the Hudson's wave.

The country's Father! how do we revere His justice,--Brutus-like in its decree,-- With André-sparing mercy, still more dear Had been his name,--if that, indeed, could be!

CHARLOTTE FISKE BATES.

But Arnold, the chief offender, had escaped, and a plan was set on foot to abduct him from the midst of the British and bring him back to the American lines. The execution of this plot was intrusted to John Champe, a sergeant-major in Lee's cavalry. On the night of October 20, Champe mounted his horse and seemingly deserted to the British, escaping a hot pursuit. He gained Arnold's confidence, and made every arrangement to abduct him, but was foiled at the last moment by Arnold's

embarkation on an expedition to the south.

SERGEANT CHAMPE

[October 20, 1780]

Come sheathe your swords! my gallant boys, And listen to the story, How Sergeant Champe, one gloomy night, Set off to catch the Tory.

You see the general had got mad To think his plans were thwarted, And swore by all, both good and bad, That Arnold should be carted.

So unto Lee he sent a line, And told him all his sorrow, And said that he must start the hunt Before the coming morrow.

Lee found a sergeant in his camp, Made up of bone and muscle, Who ne'er knew fear, and many a year With Tories had a tussle.

Bold Champe, when mounted on old Rip, All button'd up from weather, Sang out, "good-by!" crack'd off his whip, And soon was in the heather.

He gallop'd on towards Paulus Hook, Improving every instant-- Until a patrol, wide awake, Descried him in the distance.

On coming up, the guard call'd out And asked him where he's going-- To which he answer'd with his spur, And left him in the mowing.

The bushes pass'd him like the wind, And pebbles flew asunder, The guard was left far, far behind, All mix'd with mud and wonder.

Lee's troops paraded, all alive, Although 'twas one the morning, And counting o'er a dozen or more, One sergeant is found wanting.

A little hero, full of spunk, But not so full of judgment, Press'd Major Lee to let him go, With the bravest of his reg'ment.

Lee summon'd cornet Middleton, Expressèd what was urgent, And gave him orders how to go To catch the rambling sergeant.

Then forty troopers, more or less, Set off across the meader; 'Bout thirty-nine went jogging on A-following their leader.

At early morn, adown a hill, They saw the sergeant sliding; So fast he went, it was not ken't Whether he's rode, or riding.

None lookèd back, but on they spurr'd, A-gaining every minute. To see them go, 'twould done you good, You'd thought old Satan in it.

The sergeant miss'd 'em, by good luck, And took another tracing, He turn'd his horse from Paulus Hook, Elizabethtown facing.

It was the custom of Sir Hal To send his galleys cruising, And so it happenèd just then That two were at Van Deusen's.

Strait unto these the sergeant went, And left old Rip, all standing, A-waiting for the blown cornet, At Squire Van Deusen's landing.

The troopers didn't gallop home, But rested from their labors; And some 'tis said took gingerbread And cider from the neighbors.

'Twas just at eve the troopers reach'd The camp they left that morning. Champe's empty saddle, unto Lee, Gave an unwelcome warning.

"If Champe has suffered, 'tis my fault;" So thought the generous major; "I would not have his garment touch'd For millions on a wager!"

The cornet told him all he knew, Excepting of the cider. The troopers, all, spurred very well, But Champe was the best rider!

And so it happen'd that brave Champe Unto Sir Hal deserted, Deceiving him, and you, and me, And into York was flirted.

He saw base Arnold in his camp, Surrounded by the legion, And told him of the recent prank That threw him in that region.

Then Arnold grinn'd, and rubb'd his hands, And e'enmost choked with pleasure, Not thinking Champe was all the while A "taking of his measure."

"Come now," says he, "my bold soldier, As you're within our borders, Let's drink our fill, old care to kill, To-morrow you'll have orders."

Full soon the British fleet set sail! Say! wasn't that a pity? For thus it was brave Sergeant Champe Was taken from the city.

To southern climes the shipping flew, And anchored in Virginia, When Champe escaped and join'd his friends Among the picininni.

Base Arnold's head, by luck, was sav'd, Poor André was gibbeted; Arnold's to blame for André's fame, And André's to be pitied.

After the flurry consequent upon André's capture and execution, affairs at New York settled back into the old routine. A sort of lethargy seemed to possess the British leaders, and the Americans grew bolder and bolder, sometimes pushing their foraging expeditions within the British lines, and on one occasion seizing a quantity of hay and setting fire to some houses within sight of Clinton's quarters. The next day, the Loyalist disgust was voiced in some verses written by Joseph Stansbury and stuck up about the town.

A NEW SONG

[1780]

"Has the Marquis La Fayette Taken off all our hay yet?" Says Clinton to the wise heads around him: "Yes, faith, Sir Harry, Each stack he did carry, And likewise the cattle--confound him!

"Besides, he now goes, Just under your nose, To burn all the houses to cinder." "If that be his project, It is not an object Worth a great man's attempting to hinder.

"For forage and house I care not a louse; For revenge, let the Loyalists bellow: I swear I'll not do more To keep them in humor, Than play on my violoncello.

"Since Charleston is taken, 'Twill sure save my bacon,-- I can live a whole year on that same, sir; Ride about all the day, At night, concert or play; So a fig for the men that dare blame, sir.

"If growlers complain, I inactive remain-- Will do nothing, nor let any others! 'Tis sure no new thing To serve thus our king-- Witness Burgoyne, and two famous Brothers!"

JOSEPH STANSBURY.

Another of Stansbury's lyrics, and perhaps the best he ever wrote, is "The Lords of the Main," intended for the use of the British sailors then engaged in fighting their ancient foes, France and Spain.

THE LORDS OF THE MAIN

[1780]

When Faction, in league with the treacherous Gaul, Began to look big, and paraded in state, A meeting was held at Credulity Hall, And Echo proclaimed their ally good and great. By sea and by land Such wonders are planned-- No less than the bold British lion to chain! "Well hove!" says Jack Lanyard, "French, Congo, and Spaniard, Have at you!--remember, we're Lords of the Main. Lords of the Main, aye, Lords of the Main; The Tars of old England are Lords of the Main!"

Though party-contention awhile may perplex, And lenity hold us in doubtful suspense, If perfidy rouse, or ingratitude vex, In defiance of hell we'll chastise the offence. When danger alarms, 'Tis then that in arms United we rush on the foe with disdain; And when the storm rages, It only presages Fresh triumphs to Britons as Lords of the Main! Lords of the Main, aye, Lords of the Main-- Let thunder proclaim it, we're Lords of the Main!

Then, Britons, strike home--make sure of your blow: The chase is in view--never mind a lea shore. With vengeance o'ertake the confederate foe: 'Tis now we may rival our heroes of yore! Brave Anson, and Drake, Hawke, Russell, and Blake, With ardor like yours, we defy France and Spain! Combining with treason, They're deaf to all reason; Once more let them feel we are Lords of the Main. Lords of the Main, aye, Lords of the Main-- The first-born of Neptune are Lords of the Main!

JOSEPH STANSBURY.

Among the desperate and foolish expedients to which the British resorted in the hope of winning America back to her allegiance was that of sending Prince William Henry, afterwards William IV, to New York in 1781. The Tory authorities of the city overwhelmed him with adulation, but in the country at large, his visit excited only

derision.

THE ROYAL ADVENTURER

[1781]

Prince William, of the Brunswick race, To witness George's sad disgrace The royal lad came over, Rebels to kill, by right divine-- Derived from that illustrious line, The beggars of Hanover.

So many chiefs got broken pates In vanquishing the rebel states, So many nobles fell, That George the Third in passion cried: "Our royal blood must now be tried; 'Tis that must break the spell;

"To you [the fat pot-valiant swain To Digby said], dear friend of mine, To you I trust my boy; The rebel tribes shall quake with fears, Rebellion die when he appears, My Tories leap with joy."

So said, so done--the lad was sent, But never reached the continent, An island held him fast-- Yet there his friends danced rigadoons, The Hessians sung in high Dutch tunes, "Prince William's come at last!"

"Prince William's come!"--the Briton cried-- "Our labors now will be repaid-- Dominion be restored-- Our monarch is in William seen, He is the image of our queen, Let William be adored!"

The Tories came with long address, With poems groaned the royal press, And all in William's praise-- The youth, astonished, looked about To find their vast dominions out, Then answered in amaze:

"Where all your vast domain can be, Friends, for my soul I cannot see; 'Tis but an empty name; Three wasted islands and a town In rubbish buried--half burnt down, Is all that we can claim;

"I am of royal birth, 'tis true. But what, my sons, can princes do, No armies to command? Cornwallis conquered and distrest-- Sir Henry Clinton grown a jest-- I curse--and quit the land."

PHILIP FRENEAU.

The war in the North thereafter was confined, on the part of the British, to predatory raids along the coasts, of which "The Descent on Middlesex" is a fair example. On the afternoon of July 22, 1781, a party of Royalist refugees surrounded the church, where the people of Middlesex were at prayer, and took fifty of them captive, among them Schoolmaster St. John, of Norwalk, the author of the following ingenuous ballad describing their experiences.

THE DESCENT ON MIDDLESEX

[July 22, 1781]

July the twenty-second day, The precise hour I will not say, In seventeen hundred and eighty-one, A horrid action was begun.

While to the Lord they sing and pray, The Tories who in ambush lay, Beset the house with brazen face, At Middlesex, it was the place.

A guard was plac'd the house before, Likewise behind and at each door; Then void of shame, those men of sin The sacred temple enter'd in.

The reverend Mather closed his book, How did the congregation look! Those demons plunder'd all they could, Either in silver or in gold.

The silver buckles which we use, Both at the knees and on the shoes, These caitiffs took them in their rage, Had no respect for sex or age.

As they were searching all around, They several silver watches found; While they who're plac'd as guards without, Like raging devils rang'd about.

Run forty horses to the shore, Not many either less or more; With bridles, saddles, pillions on; In a few minutes all was done.

The men from hence they took away, Upon that awful sacred day, Was forty-eight, besides two more They chanc'd to find upon the shore.

On board the shipping they were sent, Their money gone, and spirits spent, And greatly fearing their sad end, This wicked seizure did portend.

They hoisted sail, the Sound they cross'd, And near Lloyd's Neck they anchor'd first; 'Twas here the Tories felt 'twas wrong To bring so many men along.

Then every man must tell his name, A list they took, and kept the same; When twenty-four of fifty men Were order'd to go home again.

The twenty-six who stay'd behind, Most cruelly they were confin'd; On board the brig were order'd quick, And then confin'd beneath the deck.

A dismal hole with filth besmear'd, But 'twas no more than what we fear'd; Sad the confinement, dark the night, But then the devil thought 'twas right.

But to return whence I left off. They at our misery made a scoff; Like raving madmen tore about, Swearing they'd take our vitals out.

They said no quarter they would give Nor let a cursèd rebel live; But would their joints in pieces cut, Then round the deck like turkeys strut.

July, the fourth and twentieth day, We all marched off to Oyster Bay; To increase our pains and make it worse, They iron'd just six pair of us.

But as they wanted just one pair, An iron stirrup lying there Was taken and on anvil laid, On which they with a hammer paid.

And as they beat it inch by inch, They bruis'd their wrists, at which they flinch; Those wretched caitiffs standing by, Would laugh to hear the sufferers cry.

Although to call them not by name, From Fairfield county many came; And were delighted with the rout, To see the rebels kick'd about.

At night we travell'd in the rain, All begg'd for shelter, but in vain, Though almost naked to the skin; A dismal pickle we were in.

Then to the half-way house we came, The "Half-way House" 'tis called by name, And there we found a soul's relief; We almost miss'd our dreadful grief.

The people gen'rously behav'd, Made a good fire, some brandy gave, Of which we greatly stood in need, As we were wet and cold indeed.

But ere the house we did attain, We trembled so with cold and rain, Our irons jingled--well they might-- We shiver'd so that stormy night.

In half an hour or thereabout, The orders were, "Come, all turn out! Ye rebel prisoners, shabby crew, To loiter thus will never do."

'Twas now about the break of day, When all were forc'd to march away; With what they order'd we complied, Though cold, nor yet one quarter dried.

We made a halt one half mile short Of what is term'd Brucklyn's fort; Where all were hurried through the street: Some overtook us, some we met.

We now traversing the parade, The awful figure which we made, Caus'd laughter, mirth, and merriment, And some would curse us as we went.

Their grandest fort was now hard by us; They show'd us that to terrify us; They show'd us all their bulwarks there, To let be known how strong they were.

Just then the Tory drums did sound, And pipes rang out a warlike round; Supposing we must thence conclude That Britain ne'er could be subdued.

Up to the guard-house we were led, Where each receiv'd a crumb of bread; Not quite one mouthful, I believe, For every man we did receive.

In boats, the ferry soon we pass'd, And at New York arriv'd at last; As through the streets we pass'd along, Ten thousand curses round us rang.

But some would laugh, and some would sneer, And some would grin, and others leer; A mixèd mob, a medley crew, I guess as e'er the devil knew.

To the Provost we then were haul'd, Though we of war were prisoners call'd; Our irons now were order'd off, And we were left to sneeze and cough.

But oh! what company we found. With great surprise we look'd around: I must conclude that in that place, We found the worst of Adam's race.

Thieves, murd'rers, and pickpockets too, And everything that's bad they'd do; One of our men found to his cost, Three pounds, York money, he had lost.

They pick'd his pocket quite before We had been there one single hour; And while he lookèd o'er and o'er, The vagrants from him stole some more.

We soon found out, but thought it strange We never were to be exchang'd By a cartel, but for some men Whom they desir'd to have again.

A pack with whom they well agree, Who're call'd the loyal company, Or "Loyalists Associated," As by themselves incorporated.

Our food was call'd two-thirds in weight Of what a soldier has to eat; We had no blankets in our need, Till a kind friend did intercede.

Said he, "The prisoners suffer so, 'Tis quite unkind and cruel, too; I'm sure it makes my heart to bleed, So great their hardship and their need."

And well to us was the event, Fine blankets soon to us were sent; Small the allowance, very small, But better far than none at all.

An oaken plank, it was our bed, An oaken pillow for the head, And room as scanty as our meals, For we lay crowded head and heels.

In seven days or thereabout, One Jonas Weed was taken out, And to his friends he was resign'd, But many still were kept behind.

Soon after this some were parol'd, Too tedious wholly to be told; And some from bondage were unstrung, Whose awful sufferings can't be sung.

The dread smallpox to some they gave, Nor tried at all their lives to save, But rather sought their desolation, As they denied 'em 'noculation.

To the smallpox there did succeed A putrid fever, bad indeed; As they before were weak and spent, Soon from the stage of life they went.

For wood we greatly stood in need, For which we earnestly did plead; But one tenth part of what we wanted Of wood, to us was never granted.

The boiling kettles which we had, Were wanting covers, good or bad; The worst of rum that could be bought, For a great price, to us was brought.

For bread and milk, and sugar, too, We had to pay four times their due; While cash and clothing which were sent, Those wretched creatures did prevent.

Some time it was in dark November, But just the day I can't remember, Full forty of us were confin'd In a small room both damp and blind,

Because there had been two or three, Who were not of our company, Who did attempt the other day, The Tories said, to get away.

In eighteen days we were exchang'd, And through the town allowed to range; Of twenty-five that were ta'en, But just nineteen reach'd home again.

Four days before December's gone, In seventeen hundred eighty-one, I hail'd the place where months before, The Tories took me from the shore.

PETER ST. JOHN.

CHAPTER X

THE WAR IN THE SOUTH

After the surrender of Burgoyne, the military attitude of the British in the Northern States was, as has been seen, purely defensive, but the Southern States were the scene of vigorous fighting. The King had set his heart on the reduction of Georgia and

the Carolinas, and it looked for a time as though he would be gratified. In General Augustine Prevost there was at last found a man after the King's own heart, and his barbarities and vandalism were among the most monstrous of the war. General Benjamin Lincoln was sent south to oppose him, and was soon joined by Count Pulaski and his legion.

HYMN OF THE MORAVIAN NUNS OF BETHLEHEM

AT THE CONSECRATION OF PULASKI'S BANNER

When the dying flame of day Through the chancel shot its ray, Far the glimmering tapers shed Faint light on the cowlèd head; And the censer burning swung, Where, before the altar, hung The crimson banner, that with prayer Had been consecrated there. And the nuns' sweet hymn was heard the while, Sung low, in the dim, mysterious aisle.

"Take thy banner! May it wave Proudly o'er the good and brave; When the battle's distant wail Breaks the sabbath of our vale, When the clarion's music thrills To the hearts of these lone hills, When the spear in conflict shakes, And the strong lance shivering breaks.

"Take thy banner! and, beneath The battle-cloud's encircling wreath, Guard it, till our homes are free! Guard it! God will prosper thee! In the dark and trying hour, In the breaking forth of power, In the rush of steeds and men, His right hand will shield thee then.

"Take thy banner! But when night Closes round the ghastly fight, If the vanquished warrior bow, Spare him! By our holy vow, By our prayers and many tears, By the mercy that endears, Spare him! he our love hath shared! Spare him! as thou wouldst be spared!

"Take thy banner! and if e'er Thou shouldst press the soldier's bier, And the muffled drum should beat To the tread of mournful feet, Then this crimson flag shall be Martial cloak and shroud for thee."

The warrior took that banner proud, And it was his martial cloak and shroud!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

In August, 1779, the French fleet under D'Estaing appeared off the coast of Georgia, and plans were made for the capture of Savannah. The place was closely invested by the French and Americans, and for nearly a month the siege was vigorously carried on. But D'Estaing grew impatient, and on October 9 an attempt was made to carry the place by storm. The assailants were totally defeated, losing more than a thousand men, while the British loss was only fifty-five. Count Pulaski was among the slain.

ABOUT SAVANNAH

[October 9, 1779]

Come let us rejoice, With heart and with voice, Her triumphs let loyalty show, sir, While bumpers go round, Reëcho the sound, Huzza for the King and Prevost, sir.

With warlike parade, And his Irish brigade, His ships and his spruce Gallic host, sir, As proud as an elf, D'Estaing came himself, And landed on Georgia's coast, sir.

There joining a band Under Lincoln's command, Of rebels and traitors and Whigs, sir, 'Gainst the town of Savannah He planted his banner, And then he felt wondrous big, sir.

With thund'ring of guns, And bursting of bombs, He thought to have frighten'd our boys, sir: But amidst all their din, Brave Maitland push'd in, And Moncrieffe cried, "A fig for your noise," sir.

Chagrined at delay, As he meant not to stay, The Count form'd his troops in the morn, sir. Van, centre, and rear March'd up without fear, Cock sure of success, by a storm, sir.

Though rude was the shock, Unmov'd as a rock, Stood our firm British bands to their works, sir, While the brave German corps, And Americans bore Their parts as intrepid as Turks, sir.

Then muskets did rattle, Fierce ragèd the battle, Grape shot it flew thicker than hail, sir. The ditch fill'd with slain, Blood dyed all the plain, When rebels and French turnèd tail, sir.

See! see! how they run! Lord! what glorious fun! How they tumble, by cannon mowed down, sir! Brains fly all around, Dying screeches resound, And mangled limbs cover the ground, sir.

There Pulaski fell, That imp of old Bell, Who attempted to murder his king, sir. But now he is gone Whence he'll never return; But will make hell with treason to ring, sir.

To Charleston with fear The rebels repair; D'Estaing scampers back to his boats, sir, Each blaming the other, Each cursing his brother, And--may they cut each other's throats, sir.

Scarce three thousand men The town did maintain, 'Gainst three times their number of foes, sir, Who left on the plain, Of wounded and slain, Three thousand to fatten the crows, sir.

Three thousand! no less! For the rebels confess Some loss, as you very well know, sir. Then let bumpers go round, And reëcho the sound, Huzza for the King and Prevost, sir.

As soon as Clinton learned of this victory, he determined to capture Charleston, where General Lincoln was stationed with three thousand men. Lincoln decided to withstand a siege, hoping for reinforcements; but none came, and on May 12, 1780, to avoid a wanton waste of life, he surrendered his army and the city to the British.

A SONG ABOUT CHARLESTON

[May 12, 1780]

King Hancock sat in regal state, And big with pride and vainly great, Address'd his rebel crew: "These haughty Britons soon shall yield The boasted honors of the field, While our brave sons pursue.

"Six thousand fighting men or more, Protect the Carolina shore, And Freedom will defend; And stubborn Britons soon shall feel, 'Gainst Charleston, and hearts of steel, How vainly they contend."

But ere he spake, in dread array, To rebel foes, ill-fated day, The British boys appear; Their mien with martial ardor fir'd, And by their country's wrongs inspir'd, Shook Lincoln's heart with fear.

See Clinton brave, serene, and great, For mighty deeds rever'd by fate, Direct the thund'ring fight, While Mars, propitious god of war, Looks down from his triumphal car With wonder and delight.

"Clinton," he cries, "the palm is thine, 'Midst heroes thou wert born to shine A great immortal name, And Cornwallis' mighty deeds appear Conspicuous each revolving year, The pledge of future fame."

Our tars, their share of glories won, For they among the bravest shone, Undaunted, firm, and bold; Whene'er engag'd, their ardor show'd Hearts which with native valor glow'd, Hearts of true British mould.

The whole of South Carolina was soon overrun by the British; estates were confiscated, houses were burned, and alleged traitors hanged without trial. Organized resistance was impossible, but there soon sprang up in the state a number of partisan leaders, foremost among whom was Francis Marion, perhaps the most picturesque figure of the Revolution. No act of cruelty ever sullied the brightness of his fame, but no partisan leader excelled him in ability to distress the enemy in legitimate warfare.

THE SWAMP FOX

We follow where the Swamp Fox guides, His friends and merry men are we; And when the troop of Tarleton rides, We burrow in the cypress-tree. The turfy hammock is our bed, Our home is in the red deer's den, Our roof, the tree-top overhead, For we are wild and hunted men.

We fly by day and shun its light, But, prompt to strike the sudden blow, We mount and start with early night, And through the forest track our foe. And soon he hears our chargers leap, The flashing sabre blinds his eyes, And ere he drives away his sleep, And rushes from his camp, he dies.

Free bridle-bit, good gallant steed, That will not ask a kind caress To swim the Santee at our need, When on his heels the foemen press,-- The true heart and the ready hand, The spirit stubborn to be free, The twisted bore, the smiting brand,-- And

we are Marion's men, you see.

Now light the fire and cook the meal, The last perhaps that we shall taste; I hear the Swamp Fox round us steal, And that's a sign we move in haste. He whistles to the scouts, and hark! You hear his order calm and low. Come, wave your torch across the dark, And let us see the boys that go.

We may not see their forms again, God help 'em, should they find the strife! For they are strong and fearless men, And make no coward terms for life; They'll fight as long as Marion bids, And when he speaks the word to shy, Then, not till then, they turn their steeds, Through thickening shade and swamp to fly.

Now stir the fire and lie at ease,-- The scouts are gone, and on the brush I see the Colonel bend his knee, To take his slumbers too. But hush! He's praying, comrades; 'tis not strange; The man that's fighting day by day May well, when night comes, take a change, And down upon his knees to pray.

Break up that hoe-cake, boys, and hand The sly and silent jug that's there; I love not it should idly stand When Marion's men have need of cheer. 'Tis seldom that our luck affords A stuff like this we just have quaffed, And dry potatoes on our boards May always call for such a draught.

Now pile the brush and roll the log; Hard pillow, but a soldier's head That's half the time in brake and bog Must never think of softer bed. The owl is hooting to the night, The cooter crawling o'er the bank, And in that pond the flashing light Tells where the alligator sank.

What! 'tis the signal! start so soon, And through the Santee swamp so deep, Without the aid of friendly moon, And we, Heaven help us! half asleep! But courage, comrades! Marion leads, The Swamp Fox takes us out to-night; So clear your swords and spur your steeds, There's goodly chance, I think, of fight.

We follow where the Swamp Fox guides, We leave the swamp and cypress-tree, Our spurs are in our coursers' sides, And ready for the strife are we. The Tory camp is now in sight, And there he cowers within his den; He hears our shouts, he dreads the fight, He fears, and flies from Marion's men.

WILLIAM GILMORE SIMMS.

SONG OF MARION'S MEN

Our band is few, but true and tried, Our leader frank and bold; The British soldier trembles When Marion's name is told. Our fortress is the good greenwood, Our tent the cypress-tree; We know the forest round us As seamen know the sea. We know its walls of thorny vines, Its glades of reedy grass, Its safe and silent islands Within the dark morass.

Woe to the English soldiery That little dread us near! On them shall light at midnight A strange and sudden fear: When, waking to their tents on fire, They grasp their arms in vain, And they who stand to face us Are beat to earth again; And they who fly in terror deem A mighty host behind, And hear the tramp of thousands Upon

the hollow wind.

Then sweet the hour that brings release From danger and from toil; We talk the battle over, We share the battle's spoil. The woodland rings with laugh and shout, As if a hunt were up, And woodland flowers are gathered To crown the soldier's cup. With merry songs we mock the wind That in the pine-top grieves, And slumber long and sweetly On beds of oaken leaves.

Well knows the fair and friendly moon The band that Marion leads-- The glitter of their rifles, The scampering of their steeds. 'Tis life to guide the fiery barb Across the moonlight plain; 'Tis life to feel the night-wind That lifts his tossing mane. A moment in the British camp-- A moment--and away, Back to the pathless forest Before the peep of day.

Grave men there are by broad Santee, Grave men with hoary hairs; Their hearts are all with Marion, For Marion are their prayers. And lovely ladies greet our band With kindliest welcoming, With smiles like those of summer, And tears like those of spring. For them we wear these trusty arms, And lay them down no more Till we have driven the Briton Forever from our shore.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

Among the members of Marion's band was a gigantic Scotsman named Macdonald, the hero of many daring escapades, of which his raid through Georgetown, S. C., with only four troopers, was the most remarkable. Georgetown was a fortified place, defended by a garrison of three hundred men.

MACDONALD'S RAID

[1780]

I remember it well; 'twas a morn dull and gray, And the legion lay idle and listless that day, A thin drizzle of rain piercing chill to the soul, And with not a spare bumper to brighten the bowl, When Macdonald arose, and unsheathing his blade, Cried, "Who'll back me, brave comrades? I'm hot for a raid. Let the carbines be loaded, the war harness ring, Then swift death to the Redcoats, and down with the King!"

We leaped up at his summons, all eager and bright, To our finger-tips thrilling to join him in fight; Yet he chose from our numbers _four_ men and no more. "Stalwart brothers," quoth he, "you'll be strong as fourscore, If you follow me fast wheresoever I lead, With keen sword and true pistol, stanch heart and bold steed. Let the weapons be loaded, the bridle-bits ring, Then swift death to the Redcoats, and down with the King!"

In a trice we were mounted; Macdonald's tall form Seated firm in the saddle, his face like a storm When the clouds on Ben Lomond hang heavy and stark, And the red veins of lightning pulse hot through the dark; His left hand on his sword-belt, his right lifted free, With a prick from the spurred heel, a touch from the knee, His lithe Arab was off like an eagle on wing-- Ha! death, death to the Redcoats, and down with the King!

'Twas three leagues to the town, where, in insolent pride, Of their disciplined numbers, their works strong and wide, The big Britons, oblivious of warfare and arms, A soft _dolce_ were wrapped in, not dreaming of harms, When fierce yells, as if borne on some fiend-ridden rout, With strange cheer after cheer, are heard echoing without, Over which, like the blast of ten trumpeters, ring, "Death, death to the Redcoats, and down with the King!"

Such a tumult we raised with steel, hoof-stroke, and shout, That the foemen made straight for their inmost redoubt, And therein, with pale lips and cowed spirits, quoth they, "Lord, the whole rebel army assaults us to-day. Are the works, think you, strong? God of heaven, what a din! 'Tis the front wall besieged--have the rebels rushed in? It must be; for, hark! hark to that jubilant ring Of 'death to the Redcoats, and down with the King!'"

Meanwhile, through the town like a whirlwind we sped, And ere long be assured that our broadswords were red; And the ground here and there by an ominous stain Showed how the stark soldier beside it was slain: A fat sergeant-major, who yawed like a goose, With his waddling bow-legs, and his trappings all loose, By one back-handed blow the Macdonald cuts down, To the shoulder-blade cleaving him sheer through the crown, And the last words that greet his dim consciousness ring With "Death, death to the Redcoats, and down with the King!"

Having cleared all the streets, not an enemy left Whose heart was unpierced, or whose headpiece uncleft, What should we do next, but--as careless and calm As if we were scenting a summer morn's balm 'Mid a land of pure peace--just serenely drop down On the few constant friends who still stopped in the town. _What_ a welcome they gave us! One dear little thing, As I kissed her sweet lips, did I dream of the King?--

Of the King or his minions? No; war and its scars Seemed as distant just then as the fierce front of Mars From a love-girdled earth; but, alack! on our bliss, On the close clasp of arms and kiss showering on kiss, Broke the rude bruit of battle, the rush thick and fast Of the Britons made 'ware of our rash _ruse_ at last; So we haste to our coursers, yet flying, we fling The old watch-words abroad, "Down with Redcoats and King!"

As we scampered pell-mell o'er the hard-beaten track We had traversed that morn, we glanced momently back, And beheld their long earth-works all compassed in flame: With a vile plunge and hiss the huge musket-balls came, And the soil was ploughed up, and the space 'twixt the trees Seemed to hum with the war-song of Brobdingnag bees; Yet above them, beyond them, victoriously ring The shouts, "Death to the Redcoats, and down with the King!"

Ah! _that_ was a feat, lads, to boast of! What men Like you weaklings to-day had durst cope with _us_ then? Though I say it who should not, I am ready to vow I'd o'ermatch a half score of your fops even now-- The poor puny prigs, mincing up, mincing down, Through the whole wasted day the thronged streets of the town: Why, their dainty white necks 'twere but pastime to wring-- Ay! _my_ muscles are firm still; _I_ fought 'gainst the King!

Dare you doubt it? well, give me the weightiest of all The sheathed sabres that hang there, unlooped on the wall; Hurl the scabbard aside; yield the blade to my clasp; Do you see, with one hand how I poise it and grasp The rough iron-bound hilt? With this long hissing sweep I have smitten full many a foeman with sleep-- That forlorn, final sleep! God! what memories cling To those gallant old times when we fought 'gainst the King.

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

Second alone to Marion in this wild warfare was Thomas Sumter, a Virginian, destined to serve his country in other ways. During the summer of 1780, he kept up so brisk a guerrilla warfare that Cornwallis called him "the greatest plague in the country."

SUMTER'S BAND

When Carolina's hope grew pale Before the British lion's tread, And Freedom's sigh in every gale Was heard above her martyr'd dead;

When from her mountain heights subdued, In pride of place forbid to soar, Her Eagle banner, quench'd in blood, Lay sullen on the indignant shore,

Breathing revenge, invoking doom, Tyrant! upon thy purple host, When all stood wrapt in steadfast gloom, And silence brooded o'er her coast,

Stealthy, as when from thicket dun, The Indian springs upon his bow, Up rose, South Mount, thy warrior son, And headlong darted on the foe.

Not in the pride of war he came, With bugle note and banner high, And nodding plume, and steel of flame, Red battle's gorgeous panoply!

With followers few, but undismay'd, Each change and chance of fate withstood, Beneath her sunshine and her shade, The same heroic brotherhood!

From secret nook, in other land, Emerging fleet along the pine, Prone down he flew before his band, Like eagle on the British line!

Catacoba's waters smiled again, To see her Sumter's soul in arms; And issuing from each glade and glen, Rekindled by war's fierce alarms,

Throng'd hundreds through the solitude Of the wild forest, to the call Of him whose spirit, unsubdued, Fresh impulse gave to each, to all.

By day the burning sands they ply, Night sees them in the fell ravine; Familiar to each follower's eye, The tangled brake, the hall of green.

Roused by their tread from covert deep, Springs the gaunt wolf, and thus while near Is heard, forbidding thought of sleep, The rattling serpent's sound of fear!

Before or break of early morn, Or fox looks out from copse to close, Before the hunter winds his horn. Sumter's already on his foes!

He beat them back! beneath the flame Of valor quailing, or the shock! And carved, at last, a hero's name Upon the glorious Hanging Rock!

And time, that shades or sears the wreath, Where glory binds the soldier's brow, Kept bright her Sumter's fame in death, His hour of proudest triumph, now.

And ne'er shall tyrant tread the shore Where Sumter bled, nor bled in vain; A thousand hearts shall break, before They wear the oppressor's chains again.

O never can thy sons forget The mighty lessons taught by thee; Since--treasured by the eternal debt-- Their watchword is thy memory!

J. W. SIMMONS.

South Carolina was too important to be left dependent upon the skill of partisan commanders, and General Gates was hurried to the scene, only to be ignominiously defeated by Cornwallis at Camden, and routed with a loss of two thousand men. Cornwallis, elated by this victory, started for North Carolina; but the country was thoroughly aroused, and on October 7 a detachment of twelve hundred men was brought to bay on King's Mountain, and either killed or captured.

THE BATTLE OF KING'S MOUNTAIN

[October 7, 1780]

'Twas on a pleasant mountain The Tory heathens lay, With a doughty major at their head, One Ferguson, they say.

Cornwallis had detach'd him A-thieving for to go, And catch the Carolina men, Or bring the rebels low.

The scamp had rang'd the country In search of royal aid, And with his owls, perchèd on high, He taught them all his trade.

But ah! that fatal morning, When Shelby brave drew near! 'Tis certainly a warning That ministers should hear.

And Campbell, and Cleveland, And Colonel Sevier, Each with a band of gallant men, To Ferguson appear.

Just as the sun was setting Behind the western hills, Just then our trusty rifles sent A dose of leaden pills.

Up, up the steep together Brave Williams led his troop, And join'd by Winston, bold and true, Disturb'd the Tory coop.

The royal slaves, the royal owls, Flew high on every hand; But soon they settled--gave a howl, And quarter'd to Cleveland.

I would not tell the number Of Tories slain that day, But surely it is certain That none did run away.

For all that were a-living, Were happy to give up; So let us make thanksgiving, And pass the bright tin-cup.

To all the brave regiments, Let's toast 'em for their health, And may our good country Have quietude and wealth.

This brilliant victory restored hope to the patriots of the South, and Cornwallis soon found himself in a dangerous position. He was finally forced to detach Tarleton, with eleven hundred men, to attack Daniel Morgan's little army of nine hundred men, which was threatening his line of communications. On Tarleton's approach, Morgan retreated to a grazing ground known as the Cowpens near King's Mountain, and here, on January 17, 1781, Tarleton attacked him, only to be completely routed.

THE BATTLE OF THE COWPENS

[January 17, 1781]

To the Cowpens riding proudly, boasting loudly, rebels scorning, Tarleton hurried, hot and eager for the fight; From the Cowpens, sore confounded, on that January morning, Tarleton hurried somewhat faster, fain to save himself by flight.

In the morn he scorned us rarely, but he fairly found his error, When his force was made our ready blows to feel; When his horsemen and his footmen fled in wild and pallid terror At the leaping of our bullets and the sweeping of our steel.

All the day before we fled them, and we led them to pursue us, Then at night on Thickety Mountain made our camp; There we lay upon our rifles, slumber quickly coming to us, Spite the crackling of our camp-fires and our sentries' heavy tramp.

Morning on the mountain border ranged in order found our forces, Ere our scouts announced the coming of the foe; While the hoar-frost lying near us, and the distant water-courses, Gleamed like silver in the sunlight, seemed like silver in their glow.

Morgan ranged us there to meet them, and to greet them with such favor That they scarce would care to follow us again; In the rear, the Continentals--none were readier, nor braver; In the van, with ready rifles, steady, stern, our mountain men.

Washington, our trooper peerless, gay and fearless, with his forces Waiting panther-like upon the foe to fall, Formed upon the slope behind us, where, on raw-boned country horses, Sat the sudden-summoned levies brought from Georgia by McCall.

Soon we heard a distant drumming, nearer coming, slow advancing-- It was then upon the very nick of nine. Soon upon the road from Spartanburg we saw their bayonets glancing, And the morning sunlight playing on their swaying scarlet line.

In the distance seen so dimly, they looked grimly; coming nearer, There was naught about them fearful, after all, Until some one near me spoke in voice than falling water clearer, "Tarleton's quarter is the sword-blade, Tarleton's mercy is the ball."

Then the memory came unto me, heavy, gloomy, of my brother Who was slain while asking quarter at their hand; Of that morning when was driven forth my sister and my mother From our cabin in the valley by the spoilers of the land.

I remembered of my brother slain, my mother spurned and beaten. Of my sister in her beauty brought to shame; Of the wretches' jeers and laughter, as from mud-sill up to rafter Of the stripped and plundered cabin leapt the fierce, consuming flame.

But that memory had no power there in that hour there to depress me-- No! it stirred within my spirit fiercer ire; And I gripped my sword-hilt firmer, and my arm and heart grew stronger; And I longed to meet the wronger on the sea of steel and fire.

On they came, our might disdaining, where the raining bullets leaden Pattered fast from scattered rifles on each wing; Here and there went down a foeman, and the ground began to redden; And they drew them back a moment, like the tiger ere his spring.

Then said Morgan, "Ball and powder kill much prouder men than George's; On your rifles and a careful aim rely. They were trained in many battles--we in workshops, fields, and forges; But we have our homes to fight for, and we do not fear to die."

Though our leader's words we cheered not, yet we feared not; we awaited, Strong of heart, the threatened onset, and it came: Up the sloping hill-side swiftly rushed the foe so fiercely hated; On they came with gleaming bayonet 'mid the cannon's smoke and flame.

At their head rode Tarleton proudly; ringing loudly o'er the yelling Of his men we heard his voice's brazen tone; With his dark eyes flashing fiercely, and his sombre features telling In their look the pride that filled him as the champion of the throne.

On they pressed, when sudden flashing, ringing, crashing, came the firing Of our forward line upon their close-set ranks; Then at coming of their steel, which moved with steadiness untiring. Fled our mountaineers, re-forming in good order on our flanks.

Then the combat's raging anger, din, and clangor, round and o'er us Filled the forest, stirred the air, and shook the ground; Charged with thunder-tramp the horsemen, while their sabres shone before us, Gleaming lightly, streaming brightly, through the smoky cloud around.

Through the pines and oaks resounding, madly bounding from the mountain, Leapt the rattle of the battle and the roar; Fierce the hand-to-hand engaging, and the human freshet raging Of the surging current urging past a dark and bloody shore.

Soon the course of fight was altered; soon they faltered at the leaden Storm that smote them, and we saw their centre swerve. Tarleton's eye flashed fierce in anger; Tarleton's face began to redden; Tarleton gave the closing order--"Bring to action the reserve!"

Up the slope his legion thundered, full three hundred; fiercely spurring, Cheering lustily, they fell upon our flanks; And their worn and wearied comrades, at the sound so spirit-stirring, Felt a thrill of hope and courage pass along their shattered ranks.

By the wind the smoke-cloud lifted lightly drifted to the nor'ward, And displayed in all their pride the scarlet foe; We beheld them, with a steady tramp and fearless, moving forward, With their banners proudly waving, and their bayonets levelled low.

Morgan gave his order clearly--"Fall back nearly to the border Of the hill and let the enemy come nigher!" Oh! they thought we had retreated, and they charged in fierce disorder, When out rang the voice of Howard--"To the right about, face!--Fire!"

Then upon our very wheeling came the pealing of our volley, And our balls made red a pathway down the hill; Broke the foe and shrank and cowered; rang again the voice of Howard-- "Give the hireling dogs the bayonet!"--and we did it with a will.

In the meanwhile one red-coated troop, unnoted, riding faster Than their comrades on our rear in fury bore; But the light-horse led by Washington soon brought it to disaster, For they shattered it and scattered it, and smote it fast and sore.

Like a herd of startled cattle from the battlefield we drove them; In disorder down the Mill-gap road they fled; Tarleton led them in the racing, fast he fled before our chasing, And he stopped not for the dying, and he stayed not for the dead.

Down the Mill-gap road they scurried and they hurried with such fleetness-- We had never seen such running in our lives! Ran they swifter than if seeking homes to taste domestic sweetness, Having many years been parted from their children and their wives.

Ah! for some no wife to meet them, child to greet them, friend to shield them! To their home o'er ocean never sailing back; After them the red avengers, bitter hate for death had sealed them, Yelped the dark and red-eyed sleuth-hound unrelenting on their track.

In their midst I saw one trooper, and around his waist I noted Tied a simple silken scarf of blue and white; When my vision grasped it clearly to my hatred I devoted Him, from all the hireling wretches who were mingled there in flight.

For that token in the summer had been from our cabin taken By the robber-hands of wrongers of my kin; 'Twas my sister's--for the moment things around me were forsaken; I was blind to fleeing foemen, I was deaf to battle's din.

Olden comrades round me lying dead or dying were unheeded; Vain to me they looked for succor in their need. O'er the corses of the soldiers, through the gory pools I speeded, Driving rowel-deep my spurs within my madly-bounding steed.

As I came he turned, and staring at my glaring eyes he shivered; Pallid fear went quickly o'er his features grim; As he grasped his sword in terror, every nerve within him quivered, For his guilty spirit told him why I solely sought for him.

Though the stroke I dealt he parried, onward carried, down I bore him-- Horse and rider--down together went the twain:

"Quarter!"--He! that scarf had doomed him! stood a son and brother o'er him; Down through plume and brass and leather went my sabre to the brain-- Ha! no music like that crushing through the skull-bone to the brain.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

Tarleton's defeat deprived Cornwallis of nearly a third of his forces, and his situation became more desperate than ever. He kept on across North Carolina and engaged Greene in an indecisive action at Guilford Court-House on March 15, and then retreated to Wilmington. Greene, with splendid strategy, started at once for South Carolina, captured nearly all the forts there in British hands, and on September 8 fell upon the British at Eutaw Springs, compelling them to retreat to Charleston.

THE BATTLE OF EUTAW

[September 8, 1781]

Hark! 'tis the voice of the mountain, And it speaks to our heart in its pride, As it tells of the bearing of heroes Who compassed its summits and died! How they gathered to strife as the eagles, When the foeman had clambered the height! How, with scent keen and eager as beagles, They hunted him down for the fight.

Hark! through the gorge of the valley, 'Tis the bugle that tells of the foe; Our own quickly sounds for the rally, And we snatch down the rifle and go. As the hunter who hears of the panther, Each arms him and leaps to his steed, Rides forth through the desolate antre, With his knife and his rifle at need.

From a thousand deep gorges they gather, From the cot lowly perched by the rill, The cabin half hid in the heather, 'Neath the crag which the eagle keeps still; Each lonely at first in his roaming, Till the vale to the sight opens fair, And he sees the low cot through the gloaming, When his bugle gives tongue to the air.

Thus a thousand brave hunters assemble For the hunt of the insolent foe, And soon shall his myrmidons tremble 'Neath the shock of the thunderbolt's blow. Down the lone heights now wind they together, As the mountain-brooks flow to the vale, And now, as they group on the heather, The keen scout delivers his tale:

"The British--the Tories are on us, And now is the moment to prove To the women whose virtues have won us, That our virtues are worthy their love! They have swept the vast valleys below us With fire, to the hills from the sea; And here would they seek to o'erthrow us In a realm which our eagle makes free!"

No war-council suffered to trifle With the hours devote to the deed; Swift followed the grasp of the rifle, Swift followed the bound to the steed; And soon, to the eyes of our yeomen, All panting with rage at the sight, Gleamed the long wavy tents of the foeman, As he lay in his camp on the height.

Grim dashed they away as they bounded, The hunters to hem in the prey, And, with Deckard's long rifles surrounded, Then the British rose fast to the fray; And never with arms of more vigor Did their bayonets press through the strife. Where, with every swift pull of the trigger, The sharpshooters dashed out a life!

'Twas the meeting of eagles and lions; 'Twas the rushing of tempests and waves; Insolent triumph 'gainst patriot defiance, Born freemen 'gainst sycophant slaves; Scotch Ferguson sounding his whistle, As from danger to danger he flies. Feels the

moral that lies in Scotch thistle, With its "touch me who dare" and he dies!

An hour, and the battle is over; The eagles are rending the prey; The serpents seek flight into cover, But the terror still stands in the way: More dreadful the doom that on treason Avenges the wrongs of the state; And the oak-tree for many a season Bears fruit for the vultures of fate!

WILLIAM GILMORE SIMMS.

EUTAW SPRINGS

TO THE MEMORY OF THE BRAVE AMERICANS, UNDER GENERAL GREENE, IN SOUTH CAROLINA, WHO FELL IN THE ACTION OF SEPTEMBER 8, 1781, AT EUTAW SPRINGS.

At Eutaw Springs the valiant died: Their limbs with dust are covered o'er-- Weep on, ye springs, your tearful tide; How many heroes are no more!

If in this wreck of ruin they Can yet be thought to claim a tear, O smite thy gentle breast, and say The friends of freedom slumber here!

Thou who shalt trace this bloody plain, If goodness rules thy generous breast, Sigh for the wasted, rural reign; Sigh for the shepherds, sunk to rest!

Stranger, their humble graves adorn; You too may fall and ask a tear; 'Tis not the beauty of the morn That proves the evening shall be clear--

They saw their injured country's woe; The flaming town, the wasted field; Then rushed to meet the insulting foe; They took the spear,--but left the shield.

Led by thy conquering genius, Greene, The Britons they compelled to fly; None distant viewed the fatal plain, None grieved, in such a cause, to die--

But, like the Parthians famed of old, Who, flying, still their arrows threw, These routed Britons, full as bold, Retreated, and retreating slew.

Now rest in peace, our patriot band; Though far from Nature's limits thrown, We trust they find a happier land, A brighter sunshine of their own.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

Cornwallis, meanwhile, had marched off toward Virginia, reaching Petersburg May 20, 1781, joining the British forces there and raising his army to five thousand men. He marched down the peninsula and established himself at Yorktown, adding the garrison of Portsmouth to his army, so that it numbered over seven thousand men.

THE DANCE

Cornwallis led a country dance, The like was never seen, sir, Much retrograde and much advance, And all with General Greene, sir.

They rambled up and rambled down, Joined hands, then off they run, sir. Our General Greene to Charlestown, The earl to Wilmington, sir.

Greene in the South then danced a set, And got a mighty name, sir, Cornwallis jigged with young Fayette, But suffered in his fame, sir.

Then down he figured to the shore, Most like a lordly dancer, And on his courtly honor swore He would no more advance, sir.

Quoth he, my guards are weary grown With footing country dances, They never at St. James's shone, At capers, kicks, or prances.

Though men so gallant ne'er were seen, While sauntering on parade, sir, Or wriggling o'er the park's smooth green, Or at a masquerade, sir.

Yet are red heels and long-laced skirts, For stumps and briars meet, sir? Or stand they chance with hunting-shirts, Or hardy veteran feet, sir?

Now housed in York, he challenged all, At minuet or all 'amande, And lessons for a courtly ball His guards by day and night conned.

This challenge known, full soon there came A set who had the bon ton, De Grasse and Rochambeau, whose fame Fut brillant pour un long tems.

And Washington, Columbia's son, Whom easy nature taught, sir, That grace which can't by pains be won, Or Plutus's gold be bought, sir.

Now hand in hand they circle round This ever-dancing peer, sir; Their gentle movements soon confound The earl as they draw near, sir.

His music soon forgets to play-- His feet can move no more, sir, And all his bands now curse the day They jiggèd to our shore, sir.

Now Tories all, what can ye say? Come--is not this a griper, That while your hopes are danced away, 'Tis you must pay the piper?

Here an unexpected factor entered upon the scene. A magnificent French fleet under Count de Grasse had sailed for the Chesapeake, and Washington, with a daring worthy of Cæsar or Napoleon, decided to transfer his army from the Hudson to Virginia and overwhelm Cornwallis. On August 19 Washington's army crossed the Hudson at King's Ferry and started on its four hundred mile march. On September 18 it appeared before Yorktown. The French squadron was already on the scene, and Cornwallis was in the trap. There was no escape. On October 17 he hoisted the white flag, and two days later the British army, over seven thousand in number, laid down its arms.

CORNWALLIS'S SURRENDER

[October 19, 1781]

When British troops first landed here, With Howe commander o'er them, They thought they'd make us quake for fear, And carry all before them; With thirty thousand men or more, And she without assistance, America must needs give o'er, And make no more resistance.

But Washington, her glorious son, Of British hosts the terror, Soon, by repeated overthrows, Convinc'd them of their error; Let Princeton, and let Trenton tell, What gallant deeds he's done, sir, And Monmouth's plains where hundreds fell, And thousands more have run, sir.

Cornwallis, too, when he approach'd Virginia's old dominion, Thought he would soon her conqu'ror be; And so was North's opinion. From State to State with rapid stride, His troops had march'd before, sir, Till quite elate with martial pride, He thought all dangers o'er, sir.

But our allies, to his surprise, The Chesapeake had enter'd; And now too late, he curs'd his fate, And wish'd he ne'er had ventur'd, For Washington no sooner knew The visit he had paid her, Than to his parent State he flew, To crush the bold invader.

When he sat down before the town, His Lordship soon surrender'd; His martial pride he laid aside, And cas'd the British standard; Gods! how this stroke will North provoke, And all his thoughts confuse, sir! And how the Peers will hang their ears, When first they hear the news, sir.

Be peace, the glorious end of war, By this event effected; And be the name of Washington To latest times respected; Then let us toast America, And France in union with her; And may Great Britain rue the day Her hostile bands came hither.

THE SURRENDER OF CORNWALLIS

Come, all ye bold Americans, to you the truth I tell, 'Tis of a sad disaster, which late on Britain fell; 'Twas near the height of Old Yorktown, where the cannons loud did roar, A summons to Cornwallis, to fight or else give o'er.

A summons to surrender was sent unto the lord, Which made him feel like poor Burgoyne and quickly draw his sword, Saying, "Must I give o'er those glittering troops, those ships and armies too, And yield to General Washington, and his brave noble crew?"

A council to surrender this lord did then command; "What say you, my brave heroes, to yield you must depend; Don't you hear the bomb-shells flying, boys, and the thundering cannon's roar? De Grasse is in the harbor, and Washington's on shore."

'Twas on the nineteenth of October, in the year of '81, Cornwallis did surrender to General Washington; Six thousand chosen British troops march'd out and grounded arms; Huzza, ye bold Americans, for now sweet music charms.

Six thousand chosen British troops to Washington resign'd, Besides some thousand Hessians that could not stay behind; Both refugees and Tories all, when the devil gets his due, O now we have got thousands, boys, but then we should have few.

Unto New York this lord has gone, surrendering you see, And for to write these doleful lines unto his majesty; For to contradict those lines, which he before had sent, That he and his brave British crew were conquerors where they went.

Here's a health to General Washington, and his brave noble crew, Likewise unto De Grasse, and all that liberty pursue; May they scourge these bloody tyrants, all from our Yankee shore, And with the arms of Freedom cause the wars they are all o'er.

"Early on a dark morning of the fourth week in October, an honest old German, slowly pacing the streets of Philadelphia on his night watch, began shouting, 'Basht dree o'glock, und Gornvallis ish dakendt!' and light sleepers sprang out of bed and threw up their windows." The whole country burst into jubilation at the news, and every village green was ablaze with bonfires.

NEWS FROM YORKTOWN

OCTOBER, 1781

"Past two o'clock and Cornwallis is taken." How the voice rolled down the street Till the silence rang and echoed With the stir of hurrying feet! In the hush of the Quaker city, As the night drew on to morn, How it startled the troubled sleepers, Like the cry for a man-child born!

"Past two o'clock and Cornwallis is taken." How they gathered, man and maid, Here the child with a heart for the flint-lock, There the trembling grandsire staid! From the stateliest homes of the city, From hovels that love might scorn, How they followed that ringing summons, Like the cry for a king's heir born!

"Past two o'clock and Cornwallis is taken." I can see the quick lights flare, See the glad, wild face at the window, Half dumb in a breathless stare. In the pause of an hour portentous, In the gloom of a hope forlorn, How it throbbed to the star-deep heavens, Like the cry for a nation born!

"Past two o'clock and Cornwallis is taken." How the message is sped and gone To the farm and the town and the forest Till the world was one vast dawn! To distant and slave-sunk races, Bowed down in their chains that morn, How it swept on the winds of heaven, Like a cry for God's justice born!

LEWIS WORTHINGTON SMITH.

AN ANCIENT PROPHECY

(Written soon after the surrender of Cornwallis)

When a certain great King, whose initial is G., Forces stamps upon paper and folks to drink tea; When these folks burn his tea and stampt-paper, like stubble, You may guess that this King is then coming to trouble.

But when a Petition he treads under feet, And sends over the ocean an army and fleet, When that army, half famished, and frantic with rage, Is cooped up with a leader whose name rhymes to _cage_; When that leader goes home, dejected and sad; You may then be assur'd the King's prospects are bad.

But when B. and C. with their armies are taken This King will do well if he saves his own bacon: In the year Seventeen hundred and eighty and two A stroke he shall get, that will make him look blue; And soon, very soon, shall the season arrive, When Nebuchadnezzar to pasture shall drive.

In the year eighty-three, the affair will be over And he shall eat turnips that grow in Hanover; The face of the Lion will then become pale, He shall yield fifteen teeth and be sheared of his tail-- O King, my dear King, you shall be very sore, From the _Stars_ and the _Stripes_ you will mercy implore, And your Lion shall growl, but hardly bite more.--

PHILIP FRENEAU.

CHAPTER XI

PEACE

The news of Cornwallis's surrender was received with consternation in Great Britain. The King declared that he would abdicate rather than acknowledge the independence of the United States, Lord North resigned, Lord Germaine was dismissed, and Sir Henry Clinton was superseded in command of the army by Sir Guy Carleton.

ON SIR HENRY CLINTON'S RECALL

[May, 1782]

The dog that is beat has a right to complain-- Sir Harry returns, a disconsolate swain, To the face of his master, the devil's anointed, To the country provided for thieves disappointed.

Our freedom, he thought, to a tyrant must fall: He concluded the weakest must go to the wall. The more he was flatter'd, the bolder he grew: He quitted the old world to conquer the new.

But in spite of the deeds he has done in his garrison (And they have been curious beyond all comparison), He now must go home, at the call of his king, To answer the charges that Arnold may bring.

But what are the acts which this chief has achieved? If good, it is hard he should now be aggrieved: And the more, as he fought for his national glory, Nor valued, a farthing, the _right_ of the story.

This famous great man, and two birds of his feather, In the Cerberus frigate came over together: But of all the bold chiefs that remeasure the trip, Not two have been known to return in one ship.

Like children that wrestle and scuffle in sport, They are very well pleased as long as unhurt; But a thump on the nose, or a blow in the eye, Ends the fray; and they go to their daddy and cry.

Sir Clinton, thy deeds have been mighty and many! You said all our paper was not worth a penny: ('Tis nothing but rags, quoth honest Will Tryon: Are rags to discourage the sons of the lion?)

But Clinton thought thus: "It is folly to fight, When things may by easier methods come right: There is such an art as counterfeit-ation, And I'll do my utmost to honor our nation:

"I'll show this damn'd country that I can enslave her, And that by the help of a skilful engraver; And then let the rebels take care of their bacon; We'll play 'em a trick, or I'm vastly mistaken."

But the project succeeded not quite to your liking; So you paid off your artist, and gave up bill-striking: But 'tis an affair I am glad you are quit on: You had surely been hang'd had you tried it in Britain.

At the taking of Charlestown you cut a great figure, The terms you propounded were terms full of rigor, Yet could not foresee poor Charley's disgrace, Nor how soon your own colors would go to the case.

When the town had surrender'd, the more to disgrace ye (Like another true Briton that did it at 'Statia), You broke all the terms yourself had extended, Because you supposed the rebellion was ended.

Whoever the Tories mark'd out as a Whig, If gentle, or simple, or little, or big, No matter to you--to kill 'em and spite 'em, You soon had 'em up where the dogs couldn't bite 'em.

Then, thinking these rebels were snug and secure, You left them to Rawdon and Nesbit Balfour (The face of the latter no mask need be draw'd on, And to fish for the devil, my bait should be Rawdon).

Returning to York with your ships and your plunder, And boasting that rebels must shortly knock under, The first thing that struck you as soon as you landed Was the fortress at West Point where Arnold commanded.

Thought you, "If friend Arnold this fort will deliver, We then shall be masters of all Hudson's river; The east and the south losing communication, The Yankees will die by the act of starvation."

So off you sent André (not guided by Pallas), Who soon purchased Arnold, and with him the gallows; Your loss, I conceive, than your gain was far greater, You lost a good fellow and got a damn'd traitor.

Now Carleton comes over to give you relief; A knight, like yourself, and commander-in-chief; But the _chief_ he will get, you may tell the dear honey, Will be a black eye, hard knocks, and no money.

Now, with "Britons, strike home!" your sorrows dispel; Away to your master, and honestly tell, That his arms and his artists can nothing avail; His men are too few, and his tricks are too stale.

Advise him, at length to be just and sincere, Of which not a symptom as yet doth appear; As we plainly perceive from his sending Sir Guy, Commission'd to steal, and commission'd to lie.

Freeman's Journal, May 22, 1782.

George III also declared that he would retain the cities of New York and Charleston at all hazards, but it was soon out of his power to retain Charleston, at least. General Leslie, in command there, found himself in dire straits for supplies, and on December 14, 1782, evacuated the city and sailed away for Halifax.

ON THE DEPARTURE OF THE BRITISH FROM CHARLESTON

[December 14, 1782]

His triumphs of a moment done; His race of desolation run, The Briton, yielding to his fears, To other shores with sorrow steers:

To other shores--and coarser climes He goes, reflecting on his crimes, His broken oaths, a murder'd _Hayne_, And blood of thousands, spilt in vain.

To _Cooper's_ stream, advancing slow, _Ashley_ no longer tells his woe, No longer mourns his limpid flood Discolor'd deep with human blood.

Lo! where those social streams combine Again the friends of Freedom join; And, while they stray where once they bled, Rejoice to find their tyrants fled,

Since memory paints that dismal day When British squadrons held the sway, And circling close on every side, By sea and land retreat deny'd--

Shall she recall that mournful scene, And not the virtues of a GREENE, Who great in war--in danger try'd, Has won the day, and crush'd their pride.

Through barren wastes and ravag'd lands He led his bold undaunted bands, Through sickly climes his standard bore Where never army marched before:

By fortitude, with patience join'd (The virtues of a noble mind), He spread, where'er our wars are known, His country's honor and his own.

Like Hercules, his generous plan Was to redress the wrongs of men; Like him, accustom'd to subdue, He freed a world from _monsters_ too.

Through every want and every ill We saw him persevering still, Through Autumn's damps and Summer's heat, Till his great purpose was complete.

Like the bold eagle, from the skies That stoops, to seize his trembling prize, He darted on the slaves of kings At Camden heights and Eutaw Springs.

Ah! had our friends that led the fray Surviv'd the ruins of that day, We should not damp our joy with pain, Nor, sympathizing, now complain.

Strange! that of those who nobly dare Death always claims so large a share, That those of virtue most refin'd Are soonest to the grave consign'd!--

But fame is theirs--and future days On pillar'd brass shall tell their praise; Shall tell--when cold neglect is dead-- "These for their country fought and bled."

PHILIP FRENEAU.

However the King might froth and bluster, it was evident that he was beaten. He was forced to bow to the inevitable, and on December 5, 1782, in his speech at the opening of Parliament, he recommended that peace be made with the colonies in America, and that they be declared free and independent.

ON THE BRITISH KING'S SPEECH

RECOMMENDING PEACE WITH THE AMERICAN STATES

[December 5, 1782]

Grown sick of war, and war's alarms, Good George has changed his note at last-- Conquest and death have lost their charms; He and his nation stand aghast, To think what fearful lengths they've gone, And what a brink they stand upon.

Old Bute and North, twin sons of hell, If you advised him to retreat Before our vanquished thousands fell, Prostrate, submissive at his feet: Awake once more his latent flame, And bid us yield you all you claim.

The Macedonian wept and sighed Because no other world was found Where he might glut his rage and pride, And by its ruin be renowned; The world that Sawney wished to view George fairly had--and lost it too!

Let jarring powers make war or peace, Monster!--no peace can greet your breast! Our murdered friends can never cease To hover round and break your rest! The Furies will your bosom tear, Remorse, distraction, and despair And hell, with all its fiends, be there!

Cursed be the ship that e'er sets sail Hence, freighted for your odious shore; May tempests o'er her strength prevail, Destruction round her roar! May Nature all her aids deny, The sun refuse his light, The needle from its object fly, No star appear by night: Till the base pilot, conscious of his crime, Directs the prow to some more Christian clime.

Genius! that first our race designed, To other kings impart The finer feelings of the mind, The virtues of the heart; Whene'er the honors of a throne Fall to the bloody and the base, Like Britain's tyrant, pull them down, Like his, be their disgrace!

Hibernia, seize each native right! Neptune, exclude him from the main; Like her that sunk with all her freight, The Royal George, take all his fleet, And never let them rise again; Confine him to his gloomy isle, Let Scotland rule her half, Spare him to curse his fate awhile, And Whitehead, thou to write his epitaph.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

ENGLAND AND AMERICA IN 1782

O Thou, that sendest out the man To rule by land and sea, Strong mother of a Lion-line, Be proud of those strong sons of thine Who wrench'd their rights from thee!

What wonder if in noble heat Those men thine arms withstood, Retaught the lesson thou had'st taught, And in thy spirit with thee fought,-- Who sprang from English blood!

But thou rejoice with liberal joy, Lift up thy rocky face, And shatter, when the storms are black, In many a streaming torrent back, The seas that shock thy base!

Whatever harmonies of law The growing world assume, Thy work is thine--the single note From that deep chord which Hampden smote Will vibrate to the doom.

ALFRED TENNYSON.

A preliminary treaty of peace was finally agreed upon. Carleton received orders to evacuate New York, and on October 18, 1783, Congress issued a general order disbanding the American army.

ON DISBANDING THE ARMY

[October 18, 1783]

Ye brave Columbian bands! a long farewell! Well have ye fought for freedom--nobly done Your martial task--the meed immortal won-- And Time's last records shall your triumphs tell.

Once friendship made their cup of suff'rings sweet-- The dregs how bitter, now those bands must part! Ah! never, never more on earth to meet; Distill'd from gall that inundates the heart, What tears from heroes' eyes are seen to start!

Ye, too, farewell, who fell in fields of gore, And chang'd tempestuous toil for rest serene; Soon shall we join you on the peaceful shore (Though gulfs irremeable roll between), Thither by death-tides borne, as ye full soon have been.

DAVID HUMPHREYS.

November 25 was fixed upon as the date for the evacuation of New York. Early on that day, Carleton got his troops on shipboard, and by the middle of the afternoon the city was in the hands of the Americans. The song which is given below was composed for and sung upon this occasion.

EVACUATION OF NEW YORK BY THE BRITISH

[November 25, 1783]

They come!--they come!--the heroes come With sounding fife, with thundering drum; Their ranks advance in bright array,-- The heroes of America!

He comes!--'tis mighty Washington (Words fail to tell all he has done), Our hero, guardian, father, friend! His fame can never, never end.

He comes!--he comes!--our Clinton comes! Justice her ancient seat resumes: From shore to shore let shouts resound, For Justice comes, with Freedom crown'd.

She comes!--the angelic virgin--Peace, And bids stern War his horrors cease; Oh! blooming virgin, with us stay, And bless, oh! bless America.

Since Freedom has our efforts crown'd, Let flowing bumpers pass around: The toast is, "Freedom's favorite son, Health, peace, and joy to Washington!"

On Thursday, December 4, the principal officers of the army assembled at Fraunce's Tavern to take a final leave of their beloved chief. A few days later, at Annapolis, Washington resigned his commission, and betook himself to the quiet of his estate at Mount Vernon.

OCCASIONED BY GENERAL WASHINGTON'S ARRIVAL IN PHILADELPHIA, ON HIS WAY TO HIS RESIDENCE IN VIRGINIA

[December, 1783]

The great unequal conflict past, The Briton banished from our shore, Peace, heaven-descended, comes at last, And hostile nations rage no more; From fields of death the weary swain Returning, seeks his native plain.

In every vale she smiles serene, Freedom's bright stars more radiant rise, New charms she adds to every scene, Her brighter sun illumes our skies. Remotest realms admiring stand, And hail the _Hero_ of our land:

He comes!--the Genius of these lands-- Fame's thousand tongues his worth confess, Who conquer'd with his suffering bands, And grew immortal by distress: Thus calms succeed the stormy blast, And valor is repaid at last.

O WASHINGTON!--thrice glorious name, What due rewards can man decree-- Empires are far below thy aim, And sceptres have no charms for thee; _Virtue_ alone has your regard, And she must be your great reward.

Encircled by extorted power, _Monarchs_ must envy your _Retreat_ _Who_ cast, in some ill-fated hour, Their country's freedom at their feet; 'Twas yours to act a nobler part, For injur'd Freedom had your heart.

For ravag'd realms and conquer'd seas Rome gave the great imperial prize, And, swell'd with pride, for feats like these, Transferr'd her heroes to the skies:-- A brighter scene your deeds display, You gain those heights a different way.

When _Faction_ rear'd her bristly head, And join'd with tyrants to destroy, Where'er you march'd the monster fled, Timorous her arrows to employ: Hosts catch'd from you a bolder flame, And despots trembled at your name.

Ere war's dread horrors ceas'd to reign, What leader could your place supply?-- Chiefs crowded to the embattled plain, Prepar'd to conquer or to die-- Heroes arose--but none, like you, Could save our lives and freedom too.

In swelling verse let kings be read, And princes shine in polish'd prose; Without such aid your triumphs spread Where'er the convex ocean flows, To Indian worlds by seas embrac'd, And Tartar, tyrant of the waste.

Throughout the east you gain applause, And soon the _Old World_, taught by you, Shall blush to own her barbarous laws, Shall learn instruction from the _New_. Monarchs shall hear the humble plea, Nor urge too far the proud decree.

Despising pomp and vain parade, At home you stay, while France and Spain The secret, ardent wish convey'd, And hail'd you to their shores in vain: In _Vernon's_ groves you shun the throne, Admir'd by kings, but seen by none.

Your fame, thus spread to distant lands, May envy's fiercest blasts endure, Like Egypt's pyramids it stands, Built on a basis more secure; Time's latest age shall own in you The patriot and the statesman too.

Now hurrying from the busy scene, Where thy _Potowmack's_ waters flow, May'st thou enjoy thy rural reign, And every earthly blessing know; Thus he, who Rome's proud legions sway'd, Return'd, and sought his sylvan shade.

Not less in wisdom than in war _Freedom_ shall still employ your mind, _Slavery_ must vanish, wide and far, Till not a trace is left behind; Your counsels not bestow'd in vain, Shall still protect this infant reign.

So, when the bright, all-cheering sun From our contracted view retires, Though folly deems his race is run, On other worlds he lights his fires: Cold climes beneath his influence glow, And frozen rivers learn to flow.

O say, thou great, exalted name! What Muse can boast of equal lays, Thy worth disdains all vulgar fame, Transcends the noblest poet's praise. Art soars, unequal to the flight, And genius sickens at the height.

For States redeem'd--our western reign Restor'd by thee to milder sway, Thy conscious glory shall remain When this great globe is swept away And _all_ is lost that pride admires, And all the pageant scene expires.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

Early in January, word reached America that the definite treaty of peace had been signed at Paris on November 30, 1783. The independence of the United States was acknowledged; the Mississippi was set as the western boundary of the country, the St. Croix and the Great Lakes as the northern, and the Gulf of Mexico as the southern. On January 14, 1784, this treaty was ratified by Congress.

THE AMERICAN SOLDIER'S HYMN

'Tis God that girds our armor on, And all our just designs fulfils; Through Him our feet can swiftly run, And nimbly climb the steepest hills.

Lessons of war from Him we take, And manly weapons learn to wield; Strong bows of steel with ease we break, Forced by our stronger arms to yield.

'Tis God that still supports our right, His just revenge our foes pursues; 'Tis He that with resistless might, Fierce nations to His power subdues.

Our universal safeguard He! From Whom our lasting honors flow; He made us great, and set us free From our remorseless bloody foe.

Therefore to celebrate His fame, Our grateful voice to Heaven we'll raise; And nations, strangers to His name, Shall thus be taught to sing His praise.

A day of solemn thanksgiving was set apart and universally observed throughout the country, which set its face toward the future, with a heart full of hope and high resolve.

THANKSGIVING HYMN

The Lord above, in tender love, Hath sav'd us from our foes; Through Washington the thing is done, The war is at a close.

America has won the day, Through Washington, our chief; Come let's rejoice with heart and voice, And bid adieu to grief.

Now we have peace, and may increase In number, wealth, and arts, If every one, like Washington, Will strive to do their parts.

Then let's agree, since we are free, All needless things to shun; And lay aside all pomp and pride, Like our great Washington.

Use industry, and frugal be, Like Washington the brave; So shall we see, 'twill easy be, Our country for to save,

From present wars and future foes, And all that we may fear; While Washington, the great brave one, Shall as our chief appear.

Industry and frugality Will all our taxes pay; In virtuous ways, we'll spend our days, And for our rulers pray.

The Thirteen States, united sets, In Congress simply grand; The Lord himself preserve their health, That they may rule the land.

Whilst every State, without its mate, Doth rule itself by laws, Will sovereign be, and always free; To grieve there is no cause.

But all should try, both low and high, Our freedom to maintain; Pray God to bless our grand Congress, And cease from every sin.

Then sure am I, true liberty Of every sort will thrive; With one accord we'll praise the Lord, All glory to Him give.

To whom all praise is due always, For He is all in all; George Washington, that noble one, On His great name doth call.

Our Congress too, before they do, Acknowledge Him supreme; Come let us all before Him fall, And glorify His name.

LAND OF THE WILFUL GOSPEL[6]

From "Psalm of the West"

Land of the Wilful Gospel, thou worst and thou best; Tall Adam of lands, new-made of the dust of the West; Thou wroughtest alone in the Garden of God, unblest Till He fashioned lithe Freedom to lie for thine Eve on thy breast-- Till out of thy heart's dear neighborhood, out of thy side, He fashioned an intimate Sweet one and brought thee a Bride. Cry hail! nor bewail that the wound of her coming was wide. Lo, Freedom reached forth where the world as an apple hung red; _Let us taste the whole radiant round of it_, gayly she said: _If we die, at the worst we shall lie as the first of the dead._ Knowledge of Good and of Ill, O Land! she hath given thee; Perilous godhoods of choosing have rent thee and riven thee; Will's high adoring to Ill's low exploring hath driven thee-- Freedom, thy Wife, hath uplifted thy life and clean shriven thee! Her shalt thou clasp for a balm to the scars of thy breast, Her shalt thou kiss for a calm to thy wars of unrest, Her shalt extol in the psalm of the soul of the West. For Weakness, in freedom, grows stronger than Strength with a chain; And Error, in freedom, will come to lamenting his stain, Till freely repenting he whiten his spirit again; And Friendship, in freedom, will blot out the bounding of race; And straight Law, in freedom, will curve to the rounding of grace; And Fashion, in freedom, will die of the lie in her face.

SIDNEY LANIER.

[6] From Poems by Sidney Lanier; copyright, 1884, 1891, by Mary D. Lanier; published by Charles Scribner's Sons.

PART III

THE PERIOD OF GROWTH

"OH MOTHER OF A MIGHTY RACE"

Oh mother of a mighty race, Yet lovely in thy youthful grace! The elder dames, thy haughty peers, Admire and hate thy blooming years. With words of shame And taunts of scorn they join thy name.

For on thy cheeks the glow is spread That tints thy morning hills with red; Thy step--the wild deer's rustling feet Within thy woods are not more fleet; Thy hopeful eye Is bright as thine own sunny sky.

Ay, let them rail--those haughty ones, While safe thou dwellest with thy sons. They do not know how loved thou art, How many a fond and fearless heart Would rise to throw Its life between thee and the foe.

They know not, in their hate and pride, What virtues with thy children bide; How true, how good, thy graceful maids Make bright, like flowers, the valley-shades; What generous men Spring, like thine oaks, by hill and glen;--

What cordial welcomes greet the guest By thy lone rivers of the West; How faith is kept, and truth revered, And man is loved, and God is feared, In woodland homes, And where the ocean border foams.

There's freedom at thy gates and rest For earth's down-trodden and opprest, A shelter for the hunted head, For the starved laborer toil and bread. Power, at thy bounds, Stops and calls back his baffled hounds.

Oh, fair young mother! on thy brow Shall sit a nobler grace than now. Deep in the brightness of the skies The thronging years in glory rise, And, as they fleet, Drop strength and riches at thy feet.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

CHAPTER I

THE NEW NATION

The war was ended, but the five years following 1783 were perhaps the most critical in the history of the American people. The country was at the verge of bankruptcy, there was discontent everywhere. In Massachusetts, the malcontents found a leader in Daniel Shays, rose in rebellion, looted the country, and were not dispersed for nearly a year.

A RADICAL SONG OF 1786

Huzza, my Jo Bunkers! no taxes we'll pay; Here's a pardon for Wheeler, Shays, Parsons, and Day; Put green boughs in your hats, and renew the old cause; Stop the courts in each county, and bully the laws: Constitutions and oaths, sir, we mind not a rush; Such trifles must yield to us lads of the bush. New laws and new charters our books shall display, Composed by conventions and Counsellor Grey.

Since Boston and Salem so haughty have grown, We'll make them to know we can let them alone. Of Glasgow or Pelham we'll make a seaport, And there we'll assemble our General Court: Our governor, now, boys, shall turn out to work, And live, like ourselves, on molasses and pork; In Adams or Greenwich he'll live like a peer On three hundred pounds, paper money, a year.

Grand jurors, and sheriffs, and lawyers we'll spurn, As judges, we'll all take the bench in our turn, And sit the whole term, without pension or fee, Nor Cushing nor Sewal look graver than we. Our wigs, though they're rusty, are decent enough; Our aprons, though black, are of durable stuff; Array'd in such gear, the laws we'll explain, That poor people no more shall have cause to complain.

To Congress and impost we'll plead a release; The French we can beat half-a-dozen apiece; We want not their guineas, their arms, or alliance; And as for the Dutchmen, we bid them defiance. Then huzza, my Jo Bunkers! no taxes we'll pay; Here's a pardon for Wheeler, Shays, Parsons and Day; Put green boughs in your hats, and renew the old cause; Stop the courts in each county, and bully the laws.

ST. JOHN HONEYWOOD.

A federal convention was proposed, and in May, 1787, there assembled at Philadelphia fifty-five men appointed by the various states to devise an adequate constitution for a federal government.

THE FEDERAL CONVENTION

[May, 1787]

Concentred here th' united wisdom shines, Of learn'd judges, and of sound divines: Patriots, whose virtues searching time has tried, Heroes, who fought, where brother heroes died; Lawyers, who speak, as Tully spoke before, Sages, deep read in philosophic lore; Merchants, whose plans are to no realms confin'd, Farmers--the noblest title 'mongst mankind: Yeomen and tradesmen, pillars of the state; On whose decision hangs Columbia's fate.

September, 1787.

George Washington was chosen president of the convention; the doors were locked, and the Herculean task of making a constitution begun. Washington himself, in a burst of noble eloquence, braced the delegates for the task before them. The problem was to devise a government which should bind all the states without impairing their sovereignty.

TO THE FEDERAL CONVENTION

[1787]

Be then your counsels, as your subject, great, A world their sphere, and time's long reign their date. Each party-view, each private good, disclaim, Each petty maxim, each colonial aim; Let all Columbia's weal your views expand, A mighty system rule a mighty land; Yourselves her genuine sons let Europe own, Not the small agents of a paltry town. Learn, cautious, what to alter, where to mend; See to what close projected measures tend. From pressing wants the mind averting still, Thinks good remotest from the present ill: From feuds anarchial to oppression's throne, Misguided nations hence for safety run; And through the miseries of a thousand years, Their fatal folly mourn in bloody tears. Ten thousand follies thro' Columbia spread; Ten thousand wars her darling realms invade. The private interest of each jealous state; Of rule th' impatience and of law the hate. But ah! from narrow springs these evils flow, A few base wretches mingle general woe; Still the same mind her manly race pervades; Still the same virtues haunt the hallow'd shades. But when the peals of war her centre shook, All private aims the anxious mind forsook. In danger's iron-bond her race was one, Each separate good, each little view unknown. Now rule, unsystem'd, drives the mind astray; Now private interest points the downward way: Hence civil discord pours her muddy stream, And fools and villains float upon the brim; O'er all, the sad spectator casts his eye, And wonders where the gems and minerals lie. But ne'er of freedom, glory, bliss, despond: Uplift your eyes those little

clouds beyond; See there returning suns, with gladdening ray, Roll on fair spring to chase this wint'ry day. 'Tis yours to bid those days of Eden shine: First, then, and last, the federal bands entwine: To this your every aim and effort bend: Let all your efforts here commence and end. O'er state concerns, let every state preside; Its private tax controul; its justice guide; Religion aid; the morals to secure; And bid each private right thro' time endure. Columbia's interests public sway demand, Her commerce, impost, unlocated land; Her war, her peace, her military power; Treaties to seal with every distant shore; To bid contending states their discord cease; To send thro' all the calumet of peace; Science to wing thro' every noble flight; And lift desponding genius into light. Be then your task to alter, aid, amend; The weak to strengthen, and the rigid bend; The prurient lop; what's wanted to supply; And grant new scions from each friendly sky.

TIMOTHY DWIGHT.

There was a natural antagonism between large and small states, and more than once the convention was on the verge of dissolution; but a compromise was finally reached, the constitution as we know it was evolved and signed by all the delegates, and on September 17, 1787, the convention adjourned. The constitution was familiarly styled the "new roof."

THE NEW ROOF

A SONG FOR FEDERAL MECHANICS

[1787]

I

Come muster, my lads, your mechanical tools, Your saws and your axes, your hammers and rules; Bring your mallets and planes, your level and line, And plenty of pins of American pine: _For our roof we will raise, and our song still shall be, Our government firm, and our citizens free_.

II

Come, up with _the plates_, lay them firm on the wall, Like the people at large, they're the groundwork of all; Examine them well, and see that they're sound, Let no rotten part in our building be found: _For our roof we will raise, and our song still shall be A government firm, and our citizens free_.

III

Now hand up the _girders_, lay each in his place, Between them the _joists_, must divide all the space; Like assemblymen _these_ should lie level along, Like _girders_, our senate prove loyal and strong: _For our roof we will raise, and our song still shall

be A government firm over citizens free_.

IV

The _rafters_ now frame; your _king-posts_ and _braces_, And drive your pins home, to keep all in their places; Let wisdom and strength in the fabric combine, And your pins be all made of American pine: _For our roof we will raise, and our song still shall be, A government firm over citizens free_.

V

Our _king-posts_ are _judges_; how upright they stand, Supporting the _braces_; the laws of the land: The laws of the land, which divide right from wrong, And strengthen the weak, by weak'ning the strong: _For our roof we will raise, and our song still shall be, Laws equal and just, for a people that's free_.

VI

Up! up! with the _rafters_; each frame is a _state_: How nobly they rise! their span, too, how great! From the north to the south, o'er the whole they extend, And rest on the walls, whilst the walls they defend: _For our roof we will raise, and our song still shall be Combined in strength, yet as citizens free_.

VII

Now enter the _purlins_, and drive your pins through; And see that your joints are drawn home and all true. The _purlins_ will bind all the rafters together: The strength of the whole shall defy wind and weather: _For our roof we will raise, and our song still shall be, United as states, but as citizens free_.

VIII

Come, raise up the _turret_; our glory and pride; In the centre it stands, o'er the whole to _preside_: The sons of Columbia shall view with delight Its pillars, and arches, and towering height: _Our roof is now rais'd, and our song still shall be, A federal head o'er a people that's free_.

IX

Huzza! my brave boys, our work is complete; The world shall admire Columbia's fair seat; Its strength against tempest and time shall be proof, And thousands shall come to dwell under our roof: _Whilst we drain the deep bowl, our toast still shall be, Our government firm, and our citizens free_.

FRANCIS HOPKINSON.

The new constitution had still to be submitted to the several states for ratification. One after another they fell into line, but Massachusetts held back. On January 9, 1788, the convention met, and week after week dragged by in fierce debate; but finally, on February 6, 1788, the Constitution was ratified by a majority of nineteen votes.

CONVENTION SONG

[February 6, 1788]

The 'Vention did in Boston meet But State House could not hold 'em, So they went to Federal Street, And there the truth was told 'em. Yankee doodle, keep it up! Yankee doodle, dandy, Mind the music and the step, And with the girls be handy.

They every morning went to prayer; And then began disputing; Till opposition silenced were, By arguments refuting.

Then 'Squire Hancock, like a man Who dearly loves the nation, By a Concil'atory plan, Prevented much vexation.

He made a _woundy_ Fed'ral speech, With sense and elocution; And then the Yankees did beseech T' adopt the Constitution.

The question being outright put (Each voter independent), The Fed'ralists agreed to adopt, And then propose amendments.

The other party seeing then The People were against them, Agreed, like honest, faithful men, To mix in peace amongst 'em.

The Boston folks are deuced lads, And always full of notions; The boys, the girls, their mams and dads, Were fill'd with joy's commotions.

So straightway they procession made, Lord, how _nation_ fine, sir! For every man of every trade Went with his tools--to dine, sir.

John Foster Williams in a ship Join'd with the social band, sir And made the lasses dance and skip, To see him sail on land, sir!

O then a whopping feast began, And all hands went to eating, They drank their toasts, shook hands and sung-- Huzza for 'Vention meeting!

Now, politicians, of all kinds, Who are not yet derided, May see how Yankees speak their minds, And yet we're not decided.

Then from this sample, let 'em cease Inflammatory writing; For freedom, happiness, and peace, Are better far than fighting.

So here I end my Federal song, Composed of thirteen verses; May agriculture flourish long, And commerce fill our purses.

Hot battles were still to be fought in some of the other states,--hottest of all in New York,--but by midsummer of 1788 all the states had ratified the Constitution, and it stood an accomplished fact.

THE FEDERAL CONSTITUTION

Poets may sing of their Helicon streams; Their gods and their heroes are fabulous dreams! They ne'er sang a line Half so grand, so divine As the glorious toast We Columbians boast-- The Federal Constitution, boys, and Liberty forever.

The man of our choice presides at the helm; No tempest can harm us, no storm overwhelm; Our sheet anchor's sure, And our bark rides secure; So here's to the toast We Columbians boast-- The Federal Constitution and the President forever.

A free navigation, commerce, and trade, We'll seek for no foe, of no foe be afraid; Our frigates shall ride, Our defence and our pride; Our tars guard our coast, And huzza for our toast-- The Federal Constitution, trade and commerce forever.

Montgomery and Warren still live in our songs; Like them our young heroes shall spurn at our wrongs: The world shall admire The zeal and the fire, Which blaze in the toast We Columbians boast-- The Federal Constitution and its advocates forever.

When an enemy threats, all party shall cease; We bribe no intruders to buy a mean peace; Columbia will scorn Friends and foes to suborn; We'll ne'er stain the toast Which as freemen we boast-- The Federal Constitution, and integrity forever.

Fame's trumpet shall swell in Washington's praise, And time grant a furlough to lengthen his days; May health weave the thread Of delight round his head. No nation can boast Such a name, such a toast, The Federal Constitution, boys, and Washington forever.

WILLIAM MILNS.

The Continental Congress, in putting an end to its troubled existence, decreed that the first presidential election should be held on the first Wednesday of January, 1789, and that the Senate and House of Representatives should assemble on the first Wednesday in March.

THE FIRST AMERICAN CONGRESS

[April 6, 1789]

Columbus looked; and still around them spread, From south to north, th' immeasurable shade; At last, the central shadows burst away, And rising regions open'd on the day. He saw, once more, bright Del'ware's silver stream, And Penn's throng'd city cast a cheerful gleam; The dome of state, that met his eager eye, Now heav'd its arches in a loftier sky. The bursting gates unfold: and lo, within, A solemn train in conscious glory shine. The well-known forms his eye had trac'd before, In diff'rent realms along th' extended shore; Here, grac'd with nobler fame, and rob'd in state, They look'd and mov'd magnificently great. High on the foremost seat, in living light, Majestic Randolph caught the hero's sight: Fair on his head, the civic crown was plac'd, And the first dignity his sceptre grac'd. He opes the cause, and points in prospect far, Thro' all the toils that wait th' impending war-- But, hapless sage, thy reign must soon be o'er, To lend thy lustre, and to shine no more. So the bright

morning star, from shades of ev'n, Leads up the dawn, and lights the front of heav'n, Points to the waking world the sun's broad way, Then veils his own, and shines above the day. And see great Washington behind thee rise, Thy following sun, to gild our morning skies; O'er shadowy climes to pour the enliv'ning flame, The charms of freedom and the fire of fame. Th' ascending chief adorn'd his splendid seat, Like Randolph, ensign'd with a crown of state; Where the green patriot bay beheld, with pride, The hero's laurel springing by its side; His sword, hung useless, on his graceful thigh, On Britain still he cast a filial eye; But sov'reign fortitude his visage bore, To meet their legions on th' invaded shore. Sage Franklin next arose, in awful mien, And smil'd, unruffled, o'er th' approaching scene; High, on his locks of age, a wreath was brac'd, Palm of all arts, that e'er a mortal grac'd; Beneath him lies the sceptre kings have borne, And crowns and laurels from their temples torn. Nash, Rutledge, Jefferson, in council great, And Jay and Laurens op'd the rolls of fate. The Livingstons, fair Freedom's gen'rous band, The Lees, the Houstons, fathers of the land, O'er climes and kingdoms turn'd their ardent eyes, Bade all th' oppressed to speedy vengeance rise; All pow'rs of state, in their extended plan, Rise from consent to shield the rights of man. Bold Wolcott urg'd the all-important cause; With steady hand the solemn scene he draws; Undaunted firmness with his wisdom join'd, Nor kings nor worlds could warp his stedfast mind. Now, graceful rising from his purple throne, In radiant robes, immortal Hosmer shone; Myrtles and bays his learned temples bound, The statesman's wreath, the poet's garland crown'd: Morals and laws expand his liberal soul, Beam from his eyes, and in his accents roll. But lo! an unseen hand the curtain drew, And snatch'd the patriot from the hero's view; Wrapp'd in the shroud of death, he sees descend The guide of nations and the muses' friend. Columbus dropp'd a tear. The angel's eye Trac'd the freed spirit mounting thro' the sky. Adams, enrag'd, a broken charter bore, And lawless acts of ministerial pow'r; Some injur'd right in each loose leaf appears, A king in terrors and a land in tears; From all the guileful plots the veil he drew, With eye retortive look'd creation through; Op'd the wide range of nature's boundless plan, Trac'd all the steps of liberty and man; Crowds rose to vengeance while his accents rung, And Independence thunder'd from his tongue.

JOEL BARLOW.

The first business was the counting of the electoral votes. There were sixty-nine of them, and every one was for George Washington, of Virginia.

WASHINGTON

God wills no man a slave. The man most meek, Who saw Him face to face on Horeb's peak, Had slain a tyrant for a bondman's wrong, And met his Lord with sinless soul and strong. But when, years after, overfraught with care, His feet once trod doubt's pathway to despair, For that one treason lapse, the guiding hand That led so far now barred the promised land. God makes no man a slave, no doubter free; Abiding faith alone wins liberty.

No angel led our Chieftain's steps aright; No pilot cloud by day, no flame by night; No plague nor portent spake to foe or friend; No doubt assailed him, faithful to the

end.

Weaklings there were, as in the tribes of old, Who craved for fleshpots, worshipped calves of gold, Murmured that right would harder be than wrong, And freedom's narrow road so steep and long; But he who ne'er on Sinai's summit trod, Still walked the highest heights and spake with God; Saw with anointed eyes no promised land By petty bounds or pettier cycles spanned, Its people curbed and broken to the ring, Packed with a caste and saddled with a King,-- But freedom's heritage and training school, Where men unruled should learn to wisely rule, Till sun and moon should see at Ajalon King's heads in dust and freemen's feet thereon.

His work well done, the leader stepped aside, Spurning a crown with more than kingly pride, Content to wear the higher crown of worth, While time endures, First Citizen of earth.

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

Washington left Mount Vernon on April 16, and started for New York, where, on April 30, 1789, he took the oath of office as President of the United States.

THE VOW OF WASHINGTON

[April 30, 1789]

The sword was sheathed: in April's sun Lay green the fields by Freedom won; And severed sections, weary of debates, Joined hands at last and were United States.

O City sitting by the Sea! How proud the day that dawned on thee, When the new era, long desired, began, And, in its need, the hour had found the man!

One thought the cannon salvos spoke, The resonant bell-tower's vibrant stroke, The voiceful streets, the plaudit-echoing halls, And prayer and hymn borne heavenward from St. Paul's!

How felt the land in every part The strong throb of a nation's heart, As its great leader gave, with reverent awe, His pledge to Union, Liberty, and Law!

That pledge the heavens above him heard, That vow the sleep of centuries stirred; In world-wide wonder listening peoples bent Their gaze on Freedom's great experiment.

Could it succeed? Of honor sold And hopes deceived all history told. Above the wrecks that strewed the mournful past, Was the long dream of ages true at last?

Thank God! the people's choice was just, The one man equal to his trust, Wise beyond lore, and without weakness good, Calm in the strength of flawless rectitude!

His rule of justice, order, peace, Made possible the world's release; Taught prince and serf that power is but a trust, And rule alone, which serves the ruled, is just;

That Freedom generous is, but strong In hate of fraud and selfish wrong, Pretence that turns her holy truth to lies, And lawless license masking in her guise.

Land of his love! with one glad voice Let thy great sisterhood rejoice; A century's suns o'er thee have risen and set, And, God be praised, we are one nation yet.

And still we trust the years to be Shall prove his hope was destiny, Leaving our flag, with all its added stars, Unrent by faction and unstained by wars.

Lo! where with patient toil he nursed And trained the new-set plant at first, The widening branches of a stately tree Stretch from the sunrise to the sunset sea.

And in its broad and sheltering shade, Sitting with none to make afraid, Were we now silent, through each mighty limb, The winds of heaven would sing the praise of him.

Our first and best!--his ashes lie Beneath his own Virginian sky. Forgive, forget, O true and just and brave, The storm that swept above thy sacred grave!

For, ever in the awful strife And dark hours of the nation's life, Through the fierce tumult pierced his warning word, Their father's voice his erring children heard!

The change for which he prayed and sought In that sharp agony was wrought; No partial interest draws its alien line 'Twixt North and South, the cypress and the pine!

One people now, all doubt beyond, His name shall be our Union-bond; We lift our hands to Heaven, and here and now Take on our lips the old Centennial vow.

For rule and trust must needs be ours; Chooser and chosen both are powers Equal in service as in rights; the claim Of Duty rests on each and all the same.

Then let the sovereign millions, where Our banner floats in sun and air, From the warm palm-lands to Alaska's cold, Repeat with us the pledge a century old!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

Benjamin Franklin had been in ill-health for many months, and the end came at Philadelphia, April 17, 1790. He was born at Boston, January 17, 1706.

ON THE DEATH OF BENJAMIN FRANKLIN

[April 17, 1790]

Thus, some tall tree that long hath stood The glory of its native wood, By storms destroyed, or length of years, Demands the tribute of our tears.

The pile, that took long time to raise, To dust returns by slow decays; But, when its destined years are o'er, We must regret the loss the more.

So long accustomed to your aid, The world laments your exit made; So long befriended by your art, Philosopher, 'tis hard to part!--

When monarchs tumble to the ground Successors easily are found; But, matchless Franklin! what a few Can hope to rival such as you, Who seized from kings their sceptred pride, And turned the lightning's darts aside!

PHILIP FRENEAU.

On November 6, 1792, George Washington was again unanimously chosen President of the United States, and was inaugurated on March 4, 1793.

GEORGE WASHINGTON

This was the man God gave us when the hour Proclaimed the dawn of Liberty begun; Who dared a deed and died when it was done Patient in triumph, temperate in power,-- Not striving like the Corsican to tower To heaven, nor like great Philip's greater son To win the world and weep for worlds unwon, Or lose the star to revel in the flower. The lives that serve the eternal verities Alone do mould mankind. Pleasure and pride Sparkle awhile and perish, as the spray Smoking across the crests of cavernous seas Is impotent to hasten or delay The everlasting surges of the tide.

JOHN HALL INGHAM.

On September 19, 1796, Washington issued his "farewell address," declining a third term as President.

WASHINGTON

Where may the wearied eye repose When gazing on the Great; Where neither guilty glory glows, Nor despicable state? Yes--one--the first--the last--the best-- The Cincinnatus of the West, Whom envy dared not hate, Bequeath the name of Washington, To make men blush there was but one!

LORD BYRON.

The election was held on November 8, 1796, and the electoral votes were counted February 8, 1797. John Adams received seventy-one, Thomas Jefferson sixty-eight, Thomas Pinckney fifty-nine, and Aaron Burr thirty. Adams assumed office March 4, 1797. Relations with both France and England had become more than ever strained, and a war, especially with the former, seemed certain. These circumstances gave birth to one of the most popular political songs ever written in America.

ADAMS AND LIBERTY

[1798]

Ye sons of Columbia, who bravely have fought For those rights which unstained from your sires have descended, May you long taste the blessings your valor has bought, And your sons reap the soil which their fathers defended. 'Mid the reign of mild peace, May your nation increase, With the glory of Rome and the wisdom of Greece; And ne'er shall the sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

In a clime, whose rich vales feed the marts of the world, Whose shores are unshaken by Europe's commotion, The trident of commerce should never be hurl'd, To incense the legitimate powers of the ocean. But should pirates invade, Though in thunder array'd, Let your cannon declare the free charter of trade. For ne'er shall the

sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

The fame of our arms, of our laws the mild sway, Had justly ennobled our nation in story, Till the dark clouds of faction obscured our young day, And enveloped the sun of American glory. But let traitors be told, Who their country have sold, And barter'd their God for his image in gold, That ne'er will the sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

While France her huge limbs bathes recumbent in blood, And society's base threats with wide dissolution; May peace, like the dove who return'd from the flood, Find an ark of abode in our mild constitution. But, though peace is our aim, Yet the boon we disclaim, If bought by our sovereignty, justice, or fame; For ne'er shall the sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

'Tis the fire of the flint, each American warms: Let Rome's haughty victors beware of collision, Let them bring all the vassals of Europe in arms, We're a world by ourselves, and disdain a division. While, with patriot pride, To our laws we're allied, No foe can subdue us, no faction divide, For ne'er shall the sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

Our mountains are crown'd with imperial oak; Whose roots, like our liberties, ages have nourish'd; But long ere our nation submits to the yoke, Not a tree shall be left on the field where it flourish'd. Should invasion impend, Every grove would descend, From the hill-tops, they shaded, our shores to defend. For ne'er shall the sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

Let our patriots destroy Anarch's pestilent worm; Lest our liberty's growth should be check'd by corrosion; Then let clouds thicken round us; we heed not the storm; Our realm fears no shock, but the earth's own explosion. Foes assail us in vain, Though their fleets bridge the main, For our altars and laws with our lives we'll maintain. For ne'er shall the sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

Should the tempest of war overshadow our land, Its bolts could ne'er rend Freedom's temple asunder; For, unmov'd, at its portal, would Washington stand, And repulse, with his breast, the assaults of the thunder! His sword from the sleep Of its scabbard would leap, And conduct, with its point, every flash to the deep! For ne'er shall the sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

Let fame to the world sound America's voice; No intrigues can her sons from their government sever; Her pride is her Adams; her laws are his choice, And shall flourish, till Liberty slumbers forever. Then unite heart and hand, Like Leonidas' band, And swear to the God of the ocean and land, That ne'er shall the sons of Columbia be slaves, While the earth bears a plant, or the sea rolls its waves.

ROBERT TREAT PAINE.

On May 28, 1798, Congress authorized a provisional army of ten thousand men and empowered the President to instruct the commanders of American ships of war to seize French armed vessels attacking American merchantmen, or hovering about

the coast for that purpose. Public excitement ran high, and when Hopkinson's "Hail Columbia" was sung one night at a Philadelphia theatre, it met with instantaneous success.

HAIL COLUMBIA

[First sung at the Chestnut Street Theatre, Philadelphia, May, 1798]

Hail! Columbia, happy land! Hail! ye heroes, heav'n-born band, Who fought and bled in freedom's cause, Who fought and bled in freedom's cause, And when the storm of war was gone, Enjoyed the peace your valor won; Let independence be your boast, Ever mindful what it cost, Ever grateful for the prize, Let its altar reach the skies.

Chorus--Firm, united let us be, Rallying round our liberty, As a band of brothers joined, Peace and safety we shall find.

Immortal patriots, rise once more! Defend your rights, defend your shore; Let no rude foe with impious hand, Let no rude foe with impious hand Invade the shrine where sacred lies Of toil and blood the well-earned prize; While offering peace, sincere and just, In heav'n we place a manly trust, That truth and justice may prevail, And ev'ry scheme of bondage fail.

Sound, sound the trump of fame! Let Washington's great name Ring thro' the world with loud applause! Ring thro' the world with loud applause! Let ev'ry clime to freedom dear Listen with a joyful ear; With equal skill, with steady pow'r, He governs in the fearful hour Of horrid war, or guides with ease The happier time of honest peace.

Behold the chief, who now commands, Once more to serve his country stands, The rock on which the storm will beat! The rock on which the storm will beat! But armed in virtue, firm and true, His hopes are fixed on heav'n and you. When hope was sinking in dismay, When gloom obscured Columbia's day, His steady mind, from changes free, Resolved on death or liberty.

JOSEPH HOPKINSON.

Word crossed the ocean that Napoleon was gathering a great fleet at Toulon and it was generally believed that he intended to invade America. The fleet, of course, was intended for his expedition to Egypt, and the idea that he hoped to conquer America seems ludicrous enough, but some verses written by Thomas Green Fessenden in July, 1798, show how seriously it was entertained.

YE SONS OF COLUMBIA

AN ODE

[July, 1798]

Ye sons of Columbia, unite in the cause Of liberty, justice, religion, and laws; Should foes then invade us, to battle we'll hie, For the GOD OF OUR FATHERS will be our ally! Let Frenchmen advance, And all Europe join France, Designing our conquest and plunder; United and free Forever we'll be, And our cannon shall tell them in thunder, That foes to our freedom we'll ever defy, Till the continent sinks, and the ocean is dry!

When Britain assail'd us, undaunted we stood, Defended the land we had purchas'd with blood, Our liberty won, and it shall be our boast, If the old world united should menace our coast:-- Should millions invade, In terrour array'd, Our liberties bid us surrender, Our country they'd find With bayonets lin'd, And Washington here to defend her, For foes to our freedom we'll ever defy Till the continent sinks, and the ocean is dry!

Should Buonapart' come with his sans culotte band, And a new sort of freedom we don't understand, And make us an offer to give us as much As France has bestow'd on the Swiss and the Dutch, His fraud and his force Will be futile of course; We wish for no _Frenchified_ Freedom: If folks beyond sea Are to bid us be free, We'll send for them when we shall need 'em. But sans culotte Frenchmen we'll ever defy, Till the continent sinks, and the ocean is dry!

We're anxious that Peace may continue her reign, We cherish the virtues which sport in her train; Our hearts ever melt, when the fatherless sigh, And we shiver at Horrour's funereal cry! But still, though we prize That child of the skies, We'll never like slaves be accosted. In a war of defence Our means are immense, And we'll fight till our _all_ is exhausted: For foes to our freedom we'll ever defy, Till the continent sinks, and the ocean is dry!

The EAGLE of FREEDOM with rapture behold, Overshadow our land with his plumage of gold! The flood-gates of glory are open on high, And Warren and Mercer descend from the sky! They come from above With a message of love, To bid us be firm and decided; "At Liberty's call, Unite one and all, For you conquer, unless you're divided. Unite, and the foes to your freedom defy, Till the continent sinks and the ocean is dry!

"Americans, seek no occasion for war; The rude deeds of rapine still ever abhor: But if in defence of your rights you should arm, Let toils ne'er discourage, nor dangers alarm. For foes to your peace Will ever increase, If freedom and fame you should barter, Let those rights be yours, While nature endures, For OMNIPOTENCE gave you the charter!" Then foes to our freedom we'll ever defy, Till the continent sinks, and the ocean is dry!

THOMAS GREEN FESSENDEN.

Though there was to be no invasion to repel, the new navy was soon to win its spurs. On February 9, 1799, the Constellation, Captain Truxton, sighted the 36-gun frigate, Insurgente, off St. Kitts, in the West Indies, and promptly gave chase. The Frenchman was overhauled about the middle of the afternoon, and after a fierce engagement was forced to surrender. Two months later, Napoleon agreed to receive the American envoy "with the respect due a powerful nation," and all danger of war

was soon over.

TRUXTON'S VICTORY

[February 9, 1799]

When Freedom, fair Freedom, her banner display'd, Defying each foe whom her rights would invade, Columbia's brave sons swore those rights to maintain, And o'er ocean and earth to establish her reign; United they cry, While that standard shall fly, Resolved, firm, and steady, We always are ready To fight, and to conquer, to conquer or die.

Tho' Gallia through Europe has rushed like a flood, And deluged the earth with an ocean of blood: While by faction she's led, while she's governed by knaves, We court not her smiles, and will ne'er be her slaves; Her threats we defy, While our standard shall fly, Resolved, firm, and steady, We always are ready To fight, and to conquer, to conquer or die.

Tho' France with caprice dares our Statesmen upbraid, A tribute demands, or sets bounds to our trade; From our young rising Navy our thunders shall roar, And our Commerce extend to the earth's utmost shore. Our cannon we'll ply, While our standard shall fly; Resolved, firm, and steady, We always are ready To fight, and to conquer, to conquer or die.

To know we're resolved, let them think on the hour, When Truxton, brave Truxton off Nevis's shore, His ship mann'd for battle, the standard unfurl'd, And at the Insurgente defiance he hurled; And his valiant tars cry, While our standard shall fly, Resolved, firm, and steady, We always are ready To fight, and to conquer, to conquer or die.

Each heart beat exulting, inspir'd by the cause; They fought for their country, their freedom and laws; From their cannon loud volleys of vengeance they pour'd, And the standard of France to Columbia was lower'd. Huzza! they now cry, Let the Eagle wave high; Resolved, firm, and steady, We always are ready To fight, and to conquer, to conquer or die.

Then raise high the strain, pay the tribute that's due To the fair Constellation, and all her brave Crew; Be Truxton revered, and his name be enrolled, 'Mongst the chiefs of the ocean, the heroes of old. Each invader defy, While such heroes are nigh, Who always are ready, Resolved, firm, and steady To fight, and to conquer, to conquer or die.

THE CONSTELLATION AND THE INSURGENTE

[February 9, 1799]

Come all ye Yankee sailors, with swords and pikes advance, 'Tis time to try your courage and humble haughty France, The sons of France our seas invade, Destroy our commerce and our trade, 'Tis time the reck'ning should be paid! To brave Yankee boys.

On board the Constellation, from Baltimore we came, We had a bold commander and Truxton was his name! Our ship she mounted forty guns, And on the main so swiftly runs, To prove to France Columbia's sons Are brave Yankee boys.

We sailed to the West Indies in order to annoy The invaders of our commerce, to burn, sink, and destroy; Our Constellation shone so bright, The Frenchmen could not bear the sight, And away they scamper'd in affright, From the brave Yankee boys.

'Twas on the 9th of February, at Montserrat we lay, And there we spy'd the Insurgente just at the break of day, We raised the orange and the blue, To see if they our signals knew, The Constellation and her crew Of brave Yankee boys.

Then all hands were called to quarters, while we pursued in chase, With well-prim'd guns, our tompions out, well spliced the main brace. Soon to the French we did draw nigh, Compelled to fight, they were, or fly, The word was passed, "CONQUER OR DIE," My brave Yankee boys.

Lord! our Cannons thunder'd with peals tremendous roar, And death upon our bullets' wings that drenched their decks with gore, The blood did from their scuppers run, Their chief exclaimed, "We are undone!" Their flag they struck, the battle won, By the brave Yankee boys.

Then to St. Kitts we steered, we bro't her safe in port, The grand salute was fired and answered from the fort, John Adams in full bumpers toast, George Washington, Columbia's boast, And now "the girl we love the most!" My brave Yankee boys.

1813.

On December 14, 1799, George Washington died at Mount Vernon after an illness lasting only a few days. The funeral took place four days later, with only such ceremonials as the immediate neighborhood provided.

WASHINGTON'S MONUMENT

For him who sought his country's good In plains of war, mid scenes of blood; Who, in the dubious battle's fray, Spent the warm noon of life's bright day, That to a world he might secure Rights that forever shall endure, Rear the monument of fame! Deathless is the hero's name.

For him, who, when the war was done, And victory sure, and freedom won, Left glory's theatre, the field, The olive branch of peace to wield; And proved, when at the helm of state, Though great in war, in peace as great; Rear the monument of fame! Deathless is the hero's name!

For him, whose worth, though unexpress'd, Lives cherish'd in each freeman's breast, Whose name, to patriot souls so dear, Time's latest children shall revere, Whose brave achievements praised shall be, While beats one breast for liberty; Rear the monument of fame! Deathless is the hero's name!

But why for him vain marbles raise? Can the cold sculpture speak his praise? Illustrious shade! we can proclaim Our gratitude, but not thy fame. Long as Columbia

shall be free, She lives a monument of thee; And may she ever rise in fame, To honor thy immortal name!

Since 1785 it had been necessary to protect American commerce from the Barbary corsairs by paying tribute, but their demands grew so exorbitant that war was at last declared against Tripoli, and a squadron dispatched to the Mediterranean. One of this squadron was the Philadelphia, which ran aground and was captured by the pirates on October 31, 1803. The ship was towed into the harbor of Tripoli and anchored under the guns of the fortress. On the night of February 15, 1804, a party of seventy-five headed by Lieutenants Decatur and Lawrence and Midshipman Bainbridge, entered the harbor, boarded the Philadelphia, drove the Turkish crew overboard, set fire to the ship, and escaped without losing a man, having performed what Lord Nelson called "the most daring act of the age."

HOW WE BURNED THE PHILADELPHIA

[February 15, 1804]

By the beard of the Prophet the Bashaw swore He would scourge us from the seas; Yankees should trouble his soul no more-- By the Prophet's beard the Bashaw swore, Then lighted his hookah, and took his ease, And troubled his soul no more.

The moon was dim in the western sky, And a mist fell soft on the sea, As we slipped away from the Siren brig And headed for Tripoli.

Behind us the hulk of the Siren lay, Before us the empty night; And when again we looked behind The Siren was gone from our sight.

Nothing behind us, and nothing before, Only the silence and rain, As the jaws of the sea took hold of our bows And cast us up again.

Through the rain and the silence we stole along, Cautious and stealthy and slow, For we knew the waters were full of those Who might challenge the Mastico.

But nothing we saw till we saw the ghost Of the ship we had come to see, Her ghostly lights and her ghostly frame Rolling uneasily.

And as we looked, the mist drew up And the moon threw off her veil, And we saw the ship in the pale moonlight, Ghostly and drear and pale.

Then spoke Decatur low and said: "To the bulwarks shadow all! But the six who wear the Tripoli dress Shall answer the sentinel's call."

"What ship is that?" cried the sentinel. "No ship," was the answer free; "But only a Malta ketch in distress Wanting to moor in your lee.

"We have lost our anchor, and wait for day To sail into Tripoli town, And the sea rolls fierce and high to-night, So cast a cable down."

Then close to the frigate's side we came, Made fast to her unforbid-- Six of us bold in the heathen dress, The rest of us lying hid.

But one who saw us hiding there "_Americano!_" cried. Then straight we rose and made a rush Pellmell up the frigate's side.

Less than a hundred men were we, And the heathen were twenty score; But a Yankee sailor in those old days Liked odds of one to four.

And first we cleaned the quarter-deck, And then from stern to stem We charged into our enemies And quickly slaughtered them.

All around was the dreadful sound Of corpses striking the sea, And the awful shrieks of dying men In their last agony.

The heathen fought like devils all, But one by one they fell, Swept from the deck by our cutlasses To the water, and so to hell.

Some we found in the black of the hold, Some to the fo'c's'le fled, But all in vain; we sought them out And left them lying dead;

Till at last no soul but Christian souls Upon that ship was found; The twenty score were dead, and we, The hundred, safe and sound.

And, stumbling over the tangled dead, The deck a crimson tide, We fired the ship from keel to shrouds And tumbled over the side.

Then out to sea we sailed once more With the world as light as day, And the flames revealed a hundred sail Of the heathen there in the bay.

All suddenly the red light paled, And the rain rang out on the sea; Then--a dazzling flash, a deafening roar, Between us and Tripoli!

Then, nothing behind us, and nothing before, Only the silence and rain; And the jaws of the sea took hold of our bows And cast us up again.

By the beard of the Prophet the Bashaw swore He would scourge us from the seas; Yankees should trouble his soul no more-- By the Prophet's beard the Bashaw swore, Then lighted his hookah and took his ease, And troubled his soul no more.

BARRETT EASTMAN.

Arrangements were made to bombard the port and a concerted attack was made August 3, 1804. Two gunboats were captured and three sunk, and the shore batteries badly damaged. Attack after attack followed, and the war was finally ended by Tripoli renouncing all claim to tribute and releasing all American prisoners. It was during the first assault that Reuben James saved Decatur's life.

REUBEN JAMES

[August 3, 1804]

Three ships of war had Preble when he left the Naples shore, And the knightly king of Naples lent him seven galleys more, And never since the Argo floated in the middle sea Such noble men and valiant have sailed in company As the men who went with Preble to the siege of Tripoli. Stewart, Bainbridge, Hull, Decatur--how their names

ring out like gold!-- Lawrence, Porter, Trippe, Macdonough, and a score as true and bold; Every star that lights their banner tells the glory that they won; But one common sailor's glory is the splendor of the sun.

Reuben James was first to follow when Decatur laid aboard Of the lofty Turkish galley and in battle broke his sword. Then the pirate captain smote him, till his blood was running fast, And they grappled and they struggled, and they fell beside the mast. Close behind him Reuben battled with a dozen, undismayed, Till a bullet broke his sword-arm, and he dropped the useless blade. Then a swinging Turkish sabre clove his left and brought him low, Like a gallant bark, dismasted, at the mercy of the foe. Little mercy knows the corsair: high his blade was raised to slay, When a richer prize allured him where Decatur struggling lay. "Help!" the Turkish leader shouted, and his trusty comrade sprung, And his scimetar like lightning o'er the Yankee captain swung.

Reuben James, disabled, armless, saw the sabre flashed on high, Saw Decatur shrink before it, heard the pirate's taunting cry, Saw, in half the time I tell it, how a sailor brave and true Still might show a bloody pirate what a dying man can do. Quick he struggled, stumbling, sliding in the blood around his feet, As the Turk a moment waited to make vengeance doubly sweet. Swift the sabre fell, but swifter bent the sailor's head below, And upon his 'fenceless forehead Reuben James received the blow!

So was saved our brave Decatur; so the common sailor died; So the love that moves the lowly lifts the great to fame and pride. Yet we grudge him not his honors, for whom love like this had birth-- For God never ranks His sailors by the Register of earth!

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

In the spring of 1808 the schooner Betsy, of Marblehead, commanded by "Skipper Ireson," sighted a wreck while passing Cape Cod on her way home from the West Indies. It was dark at the time, and the sea was running high, so that she was unable to render any assistance. Another vessel soon afterwards rescued the people on the wreck, and they reached shore in season for news of the occurrence to reach Marblehead before the Betsy's arrival. A crowd met the vessel at the wharf, and the sailors, when called to account, protested that Ireson would not let them go to the relief of the wrecked vessel. The mob thereupon seized the unfortunate skipper, and putting him into an old dory, started to drag him to Beverly, where they said he belonged, in order to show him to his own people.

SKIPPER IRESON'S RIDE

[1808]

Of all the rides since the birth of time, Told in story or sung in rhyme,-- On Apuleius's Golden Ass, Or one-eyed Calender's horse of brass, Witch astride of a human back, Islam's prophet on Al-Borák,-- The strangest ride that ever was sped Was Ireson's out from Marblehead! Old Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart, Tarred and

feathered and carried in a cart By the women of Marblehead!

Body of turkey, head of fowl, Wings a-droop like a rained-on fowl, Feathered and ruffled in every part, Skipper Ireson stood in the cart. Scores of women, old and young, Strong of muscle, and glib of tongue, Pushed and pulled up the rocky lane, Shouting and singing the shrill refrain: "Here's Flud Oirson, fur his horrd horrt, Torr'd an' futherr'd an' corr'd in a corrt By the women o' Morble'ead!"

Wrinkled scolds with hands on hips, Girls in bloom of cheek and lips, Wild-eyed, free-limbed, such as chase Bacchus round some antique vase, Brief of skirt, with ankles bare, Loose of kerchief and loose of hair, With conch-shells blowing and fish-horns' twang, Over and over the Mænads sang: "Here's Flud Oirson, fur his horrd horrt, Torr'd an' futherr'd an' corr'd in a corrt By the women o' Morble'ead!"

Small pity for him!--He sailed away From a leaking ship in Chaleur Bay,-- Sailed away from a sinking wreck, With his own town's-people on her deck! "Lay by! lay by!" they called to him. Back he answered, "Sink or swim! Brag of your catch of fish again!" And off he sailed through the fog and rain! Old Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart, Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart By the women of Marblehead!

Fathoms deep in dark Chaleur That wreck shall lie forevermore. Mother and sister, wife and maid, Looked from the rocks of Marblehead Over the moaning and rainy sea,-- Looked for the coming that might not be! What did the winds and the sea-birds say Of the cruel captain who sailed away?-- Old Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart, Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart By the women of Marblehead!

Through the street, on either side, Up flew windows, doors swung wide; Sharp-tongued spinsters, old wives gray, Treble lent the fish-horn's bray. Sea-worn grandsires, cripple-bound, Hulks of old sailors run aground, Shook head, and fist, and hat, and cane, And cracked with curses the hoarse refrain: "Here's Flud Oirson, fur his horrd horrt, Torr'd an' futherr'd an' corr'd in a corrt By the women o' Morble'ead!"

Sweetly along the Salem road Bloom of orchard and lilac showed. Little the wicked skipper knew Of the fields so green and the sky so blue. Riding there in his sorry trim, Like an Indian idol glum and grim, Scarcely he seemed the sound to hear Of voices shouting, far and near: "Here's Flud Oirson, fur his horrd horrt, Torr'd an' futherr'd an' corr'd in a corrt By the women o' Morble'ead!"

"Hear me, neighbors!" at last he cried,-- "What to me is this noisy ride? What is the shame that clothes the skin To the nameless horror that lives within? Waking or sleeping, I see a wreck, And hear a cry from a reeling deck! Hate me and curse me,--I only dread The hand of God and the face of the dead!" Said old Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart, Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart By the women of Marblehead!

Then the wife of the skipper lost at sea Said, "God has touched him! why should we!" Said an old wife mourning her only son, "Cut the rogue's tether and let him run!" So with soft relentings and rude excuse, Half scorn, half pity, they cut him loose, And gave him a cloak to hide him in, And left him alone with his shame and sin. Poor Floyd Ireson, for his hard heart, Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart By the women of Marblehead!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

Later investigation proved that Ireson was in no way responsible for the abandonment of the disabled ship, and that his crew had lied in order to save themselves.

A PLEA FOR FLOOD IRESON

[1808]

Old Flood Ireson! all too long Have jeer and gibe and ribald song Done thy memory cruel wrong.

Old Flood Ireson, bending low Under the weight of years and woe, Crept to his refuge long ago.

Old Flood Ireson sleeps in his grave; Howls of a mad mob, worse than the wave, Now no more in his ear shall rave!

* * * * *

Gone is the pack and gone the prey, Yet old Flood Ireson's ghost to-day Is hunted still down Time's highway.

Old wife Fame, with a fish-horn's blare Hooting and tooting the same old air, Drags him along the old thoroughfare.

Mocked evermore with the old refrain, Skilfully wrought to a tuneful strain, Jingling and jolting he comes again

Over that road of old renown, Fair broad avenue, leading down Through South Fields to Salem town,

Scourged and stung by the Muses' thong, Mounted high on the car of song, Sight that cries, O Lord! how long

Shall heaven look on and not take part With the poor old man and his fluttering heart, Tarred and feathered and carried in a cart?

Old Flood Ireson, now when Fame Wipes away with tears of shame Stains from many an injured name,

Shall not, in the tuneful line, Beams of truth and mercy shine Through the clouds that darken thine?

Take henceforth, perturbèd sprite, From the fever and the fright, Take the rest,--thy well-earned right.

Along the track of that hard ride The form of Penitence oft shall glide, With tender Pity by her side;

And their tears, that mingling fall On the dark record they recall, Shall cleanse the stain and expiate all.

CHARLES TIMOTHY BROOKS.

CHAPTER II

THE SECOND WAR WITH ENGLAND

The treaty of peace with England which closed the Revolution provided for the payment of English creditors and the restoration of confiscated estates, but the individual states refused to carry out this agreement, and England, in consequence, retained possession of some of the Western posts. To this were soon added other causes of annoyance, principal among which was the right claimed by England to impress into her service seamen of British birth, wherever found, and to stop and search the ships of the United States for this purpose.

THE TIMES

Ye brave sons of Freedom, come join in the chorus, At the dangers of war do not let us repine, But sing and rejoice at the prospect before us, And drink it success in a bumper of wine. At the call of the nation, Let each to his station, And resist depredation, Which our country degrades; Ere the conflict is over, Our rights we'll recover, Or punish whoever Our honor invades.

We're abused and insulted, our country's degraded, Our rights are infringed both by land and by sea; Let us rouse up, indignant, when those rights are invaded, And announce to the world, "We're united and free!" By our navy's protection We'll make our election, And in every direction Our trade shall be free; No British oppression, No Gallic aggression Shall disturb the possession We claim to the sea.

Then Columbia's ships shall sail on the ocean, And the nations of Europe respect us at last: Our stars and our stripes shall command their devotion, And Liberty perch on the top of the mast. Though _Bona_ and _John Bull_ Continue their long pull, Till ambition's cup-full Be drain'd to the lees; By wisdom directed, By tyrants respected, By cannon protected, We'll traverse the seas.

Though vile combinations to sever the Union Be projected with caution and managed with care, Though traitors and Britons, in sweetest communion, Their patriot virtue unite and compare, American thunder Shall rend it asunder, And ages shall wonder At the deeds we have done: And every Tory When he hears of the story, Shall repine at the glory Our heroes have won.

Let local attachments be condemn'd and discarded, Distrust and suspicion be banish'd the mind, Let union, our safety, be ever regarded, When improved by example, by virtue refined. Our ancestors brought it, Our sages have taught it, Our Washington bought it, 'Tis our glory and boast! No factions shall ever Our government sever, But "Union forever," Shall be our last toast.

Measures so outrageous made war seemingly inevitable; but Washington, through the Jay Treaty, managed to patch up a peace. In 1805 England, hard-pressed by Napoleon, again asserted the "right of search," and her war-vessels stopped merchantmen and cruisers alike and took off all persons whom the British

commanders chose to regard as British subjects. Congress retaliated by prohibiting commerce with England. The embargo went into effect in January, 1808, and aroused sectional feeling to such an extent that New England threatened secession from the Union.

REPARATION OR WAR

WRITTEN DURING THE EMBARGO

Rejoice, rejoice, brave patriots, rejoice! Our martial sons take a bold and manly stand! Rejoice, rejoice, exulting raise your voice, Let union pervade our happy land. The altar of Liberty shall never be polluted, But freedom expand and flourish, firm and deeply rooted. Our eagle, towering high, Triumphantly shall fly, While men like JEFFERSON preside to serve their country! Huzza! huzza! boys, etc., etc. With firmness we'll resent our wrongs sustain'd at sea; Huzza! huzza! etc., etc. For none but slaves will bend to tyranny.

To arms, to arms, with ardor rush to arms, Our injured rights have long for vengeance cried. To arms, to arms, prepare for war's alarms, If honest reparation be denied. Though feeble counteracting plans, or foreign combinations, May interdict awhile our trade, against the law of nations, The embargo on supplies Shall open Europe's eyes; Proclaiming unto all the world, "Columbia will be free." Huzza! huzza! etc., etc. With honor we'll maintain a just neutrality. Huzza! huzza! etc., etc. For none but slaves will bend to tyranny.

Defend, defend, ye heroes and ye sages, The gift divine--your independency! Transmit with joy, down to future ages, How Washington achieved your liberty. When freemen are insulted, they send forth vengeful thunder, Determined to maintain their rights, strike the foe with wonder. They cheerfully will toil, To cultivate the soil, And rather live on humble fare than feast ignobly. Huzza! huzza! etc., etc. United, firm we stand, invincible and free, Huzza! huzza! etc., etc. Then none but slaves shall bend to tyranny.

The opponents of the embargo termed the conflict a "terrapin war,"--the nation, by extinguishing commerce, drawing within its own shell like a terrapin; and at gatherings of the Federalists, a song by that title was very popular.

TERRAPIN WAR

Huzza for our liberty, boys, These are the days of our glory-- The days of true national joys, When terrapins gallop before ye! There's Porter and Grundy and Rhea, In Congress who manfully vapor, Who draw their six dollars a day, And fight bloody battles _on paper_! Ah! this is true Terrapin war.

Poor Madison the tremors has got, 'Bout this same arming the nation; Too far to retract, he cannot Go on--and he loses his station. Then bring up your "regulars," lads, In "attitude" nothing ye lack, sirs, Ye'll frighten to death the Danads, With

fire-coals blazing aback, sirs! Oh, this is true Terrapin war!

As to powder and bullets and swords, For, as they were never intended, They're a parcel of high-sounding words, But never to _action_ extended. Ye must _frighten_ the rascals away, In "_rapid descent_" on their quarters; Then the plunder divide as ye may, And drive them headlong in the waters. Oh, this is _great_ Terrapin war!

But the hostility to Great Britain grew steadily more bitter, and the war party was led by such able men as Henry Clay and John C. Calhoun. Various incidents tended to fan the flames, and on June 18, 1812, war was declared.

FAREWELL, PEACE

[June 18, 1812]

Farewell, Peace! another crisis Calls us to "the last appeal," Made when monarchs and their vices Leave no argument but _steel_. When injustice and oppression Dare avow the tyrant's plea. Who would recommend submission? Virtue bids us to be free.

History spreads her page before us, Time unrolls his ample scroll; Truth unfolds them, to assure us, States, united, ne'er can fall. See, in annals Greek and Roman, What immortal deeds we find; When those gallant sons of woman In their country's cause combined.

Sons of Freedom! brave descendants From a race of heroes tried, To preserve our independence Let all Europe be defied. Let not all the world, united, Rob us of one sacred right: Every patriot heart's delighted In his country's cause to fight.

Come then, War! with hearts elated To thy standard we will fly; Every bosom animated Either to live free or die. May the wretch that shrinks from duty, Or deserts the glorious strife, Never know the smile of beauty, Nor the blessing of a wife.

The Federalists claimed that war had been declared, not to avenge the country's wrongs upon the ocean, but to conquer Canada. Canada was, indeed, the first objective, and troops were enlisted and hurried forward to the various northern posts.

COME, YE LADS, WHO WISH TO SHINE

Come, ye lads, who wish to shine Bright in future story, Haste to arms, and form the line That leads to martial glory. Beat the drum, the trumpet sound, Manly and united, Danger face, maintain your ground, And see your country righted.

Columbia, when her eagle's roused, And her flag is rearing Will always find her sons disposed To drub the foe that's daring. Beat the drum, etc.

Hearts of oak, protect the coast, Pour your naval thunder, While on shore a mighty host Shall strike the world with wonder. Beat the drum, etc.

Haste to Quebec's towering walls, Through the British regions; Hark! Montgomery's spirit calls, Drive the hostile legions. Beat the drum, etc.

Honor for the brave to share Is the noblest booty; Guard your rights, protect the fair, For that's a soldier's duty. Beat the drum, etc.

Charge the musket, point the lance, Brave the worst of dangers; Tell to Britain and to France, That we to fear are strangers. Beat the drum, etc.

The Canadian campaign was soon to end ignominiously enough. In July, General Hull, governor of Michigan territory, crossed from Detroit into Canada, then crossed back again, and on August 16, without striking a blow, surrendered Detroit and his entire army to the British under General Brock. Hull was afterwards tried by court-martial, convicted of cowardice, and sentenced to be shot, but the sentence was commuted.

HULL'S SURRENDER

OR, VILLANY SOMEWHERE

[August 16, 1812]

Ye Columbians so bold, attend while I sing; Sure treason and treachery's not quite the thing, At a time like the present, we ought, one and all, In defence of our rights, to stand nobly or fall.

Chorus

Then let traitors be banish'd Columbia's fair shore, And treason be known in her borders no more.

With a brave, gallant army HULL went to Detroit, And swore he'd accomplish a noble exploit; That the British and Indians he'd conquer outright, And give cause to his country of joy and delight.

Chorus

But if traitors still dwell on Columbia's fair shore, O let it be known in her borders no more.

Ah! quickly alas! defeat and disgrace Star'd our brave noble soldiers quite full in the face, When they thought that the victory was sure to be won, Their general gave up, _without firing a gun_.

Chorus

Then do traitors still dwell on Columbia's fair shore, IF THEY DO, let them dwell in her borders no more!

Those heroes, who bravely on the Wabash had fought, Who for glory successfully nobly had sought, Where the _favor_ denied of asserting their wrongs, And deprived of that _right_ which to freemen belongs.

Chorus

Then if treason still dwell on Columbia's fair shore, O let it be known in her borders no more!

Is it true that our soldiers were wrongfully us'd? Is it true that they've been by their GENERAL abus'd? Is it true that an army so gallant were _sold_? Is it true that COLUMBIANS were barter'd for gold?

Chorus

If it is, then does treason still dwell on our shore, But let it be known in our country no more!

Ye heroes who fought by the side of brave _Floyd_, Ye heroes, conducted to glory by _Boyd_, Think not that your brethren will quietly bear, From your brows that a traitor your laurels should tear.

Chorus

No--if treason still dwell on Columbia's fair shore, It shall soon be expell'd to reside here no more.

Then rouse ye brave freemen, and heed no alarms, Your dear native country now calls you to arms, Away to the battle, and count not the cost Till the glory you gain, which so basely was lost.

Chorus

For if treason still dwell on Columbia's fair shore, By our fathers we swear it shall dwell here no more.

The fury which the news of this disaster aroused was tempered by rejoicing for a remarkable victory on the ocean. Anxious to meet some of the famous British frigates, Captain Isaac Hull put out from Boston with the Constitution on August 2. He sailed without orders, and had the cruise resulted disastrously, he would probably have been court-martialed and shot. On the afternoon of August 19, a sail was sighted off Halifax and proved to be the British frigate Guerrière. Hull at once attacked, and soon reduced the enemy to a "perfect wreck." The Constitution sustained little injury and got safely back to port.

THE CONSTITUTION AND THE GUERRIÈRE

[August 19, 1812]

I often have been told That the British seamen bold Could beat the tars of France neat and handy O; But they never found their match, Till the Yankees did them catch, For the Yankee tars for fighting are the dandy O.

O, the Guerrière so bold On the foaming ocean rolled, Commanded by Dacres the grandee O; For the choice of British crew That a rammer ever drew Could beat the Frenchmen two to one quite handy O.

When the frigate hove in view, "O," said Dacres to his crew, "Prepare ye for action and be handy O; On the weather-gauge we'll get her." And to make his men fight

better, He gave to them gunpowder and good brandy O.

Now this boasting Briton cries, "Make that Yankee ship your prize, You can in thirty minutes do it handy O, Or twenty-five, I'm sure You'll do it in a score, I will give you a double share of good brandy O.

"When prisoners we've made them, With switchell we will treat them, We will treat them with 'Yankee Doodle Dandy' O;" The British balls flew hot, But the Yankees answered not, Until they got a distance that was handy O.

"O," cried Hull unto his crew, "We'll try what we can do; If we beat those boasting Britons we're the dandy O." The first broadside we poured Brought the mizzen by the board, Which doused the royal ensign quite handy O.

O Dacres he did sigh, And to his officers did cry, "I did not think these Yankees were so handy O." The second told so well That the fore and main-mast fell, Which made this lofty frigate look quite handy O.

"O," says Dacres, "we're undone," So he fires a lee gun. Our drummer struck up "Yankee Doodle Dandy" O; When Dacres came on board To deliver up his sword, He was loth to part with it, it looked so handy O.

"You may keep it," says brave Hull. "What makes you look so dull? Cheer up and take a glass of good brandy O;" O Britons now be still, Since we've hooked you in the gill, Don't boast upon Dacres the grandee O.

HALIFAX STATION

[August 19, 1812]

From Halifax station a bully there came, To take or be taken, call'd Dacres by name: But 'twas who but a Yankee he met on his way-- Says the Yankee to him, "Will you stop and take tea?"

Then Dacres steps up, thus addressing his crew:-- "Don't you see that d--d flag that is red, white, and blue; Let us drum all to quarters, prepare for to fight, For in taking that ship boys, it will make me a knight."

Then up to each mast-head he straight sent a flag, Which shows, on the ocean, a proud British brag; But Hull, being pleasant, he sent up but one, And told every seaman to stand true to his gun.

Then Hull, like a hero, before them appears, And with a short speech his sailors he cheers, Saying, "We'll batter their sides, and we'll do the neat thing: We'll conquer their bully, and laugh at their king."

Then we off with our hats and gave him a cheer, Swore we'd stick by brave Hull, while a seaman could steer; And at it we went with mutual delight, For to fight and to conquer's a sailor's free right.

Then we crowded all sail, and we ran alongside, And we wellfed our bull-dogs with true Yankee pride. 'Twas broadside for broadside we on them did pour, While

cannon's loud mouths at each other did roar.

Says Dacres, "Fight on, and we'll have her in tow, We will drink to Great Britain, and the cans they shall flow; So strike, you d--d Yankee, I'll make you with ease:" But the man they call Hull, says, "O no, if you please."

Then Dacres wore ship, expecting to rake; But quite in a hurry, found out his mistake; For we luff'd round his bow, boys, and caught his jib-boom, And, in raking them aft, we soon gave him his doom.

Then Dacres look'd wild, and then sheath'd his sword, When he found that his masts were all gone by the board, And dropping astern cries out to the steward, "Come up and be d--d, fire a gun to the leeward."

Then we off with our hats, and we gave them three cheers, Which bitterly stung all those Englishmen's ears; Saying, "We'll fight for our country, do all things that's right, And let the world know, that green Yankees can fight."

ON THE CAPTURE OF THE GUERRIÈRE

[August 19, 1812]

Long the tyrant of our coast Reigned the famous Guerrière; Our little navy she defied, Public ship and privateer: On her sails in letters red, To our captains were displayed Words of warning, words of dread, "All who meet me, have a care! I am England's Guerrière."

On the wide, Atlantic deep (Not her equal for the fight) The Constitution, on her way, Chanced to meet these men of might; On her sails was nothing said, But her waist the teeth displayed That a deal of blood could shed, Which, if she would venture near, Would stain the decks of the Guerrière.

Now our gallant ship they met-- And, to struggle with John Bull-- Who had come, they little thought, Strangers, yet, to Isaac Hull: Better soon to be acquainted: Isaac hailed the Lord's anointed-- While the crew the cannon pointed, And the balls were so directed With a blaze so unexpected;

Isaac so did maul and rake her That the decks of Captain Dacre Were in such a woful pickle As if death with scythe and sickle, With his sling, or with his shaft Had cut his harvest fore and aft. Thus, in thirty minutes ended, Mischiefs that could not be mended; Masts, and yards, and ship descended, All to David Jones's locker-- Such a ship in such a pucker!

Drink a bout to the Constitution! She performed some execution, Did some share of retribution For the insults of the year When she took the Guerrière. May success again await her, Let who will again command her, Bainbridge, Rodgers, or Decatur-- Nothing like her can withstand her. With a crew like that on board her Who so boldly called "to order" One bold crew of English sailors, Long, too long our seamen's jailors, Dacre and the Guerrière!

PHILIP FRENEAU.

FIRSTFRUITS IN 1812

[August 19, 1812]

What is that a-billowing there Like a thunderhead in air? Why should such a sight be whitening the seas? That's a Yankee man-o'-war, And three things she's seeking for-- For a prize, and for a battle, and a breeze.

When the war blew o'er the sea Out went Hull and out went we In the Constitution, looking for the foe; But five British ships came down-- And we got to Boston-town By a mighty narrow margin, you must know!

Captain Hull can't fight their fleet, But he fairly aches to meet Quite the prettiest British ship of all there were; So he stands again to sea In the hope that on his lee He'll catch Dacres and his pretty Guerrière.

'Tis an August afternoon Not a day too late or soon, When we raise a ship whose lettered mainsail reads: _All who meet me have a care, I am England's Guerrière;_ So Hull gayly clears for action as he speeds.

Cheery bells had chanted five On the happiest day alive When we Yankees dance to quarters at his call; While the British bang away With their broadsides' screech and bray; But the Constitution never fires a ball.

We send up three times to ask If we sha'n't begin our task? Captain Hull sends back each time the answer _No_; Till to half a pistol-shot The two frigates he had brought, Then he whispers, _Lay along!_--and we let go.

Twice our broadside lights and lifts, And the Briton, crippled, drifts With her mizzen dangling hopeless at her poop: Laughs a Yankee, _She's a brig!_ Says our Captain, _That's too big; Try another, so we'll have her for a sloop!_

We hurrah, and fire again, Lay aboard of her like men, And, like men, they beat us off, and try in turn; But we drive bold Dacres back With our muskets' snap and crack-- All the while our crashing broadsides boom and burn.

'Tis but half an hour, bare, When that pretty Guerrière Not a stick calls hers aloft or hers alow, Save the mizzen's shattered mast, Where her "meteor flag" 's nailed fast Till, a fallen star, we quench its ruddy glow.

Dacres, injured, o'er our side Slowly bears his sword of pride, Holds it out, as Hull stands there in his renown: _No, no!_ says th' American, _Never, from so brave a man-- But I see you're wounded, let me help you down._

All that night we work in vain Keeping her upon the main, But we've hulled her far too often, and at last In a blaze of fire there Dies the pretty Guerrière; While away we cheerly sail upon the blast.

Oh, the breeze that blows so free! Oh, the prize beneath the sea! Oh, the battle!--was there ever better won? Still the happy Yankee cheers Are a-ringing in our ears From old Boston, glorying in what we've done.

What is that a-billowing there Like a thunderhead in air? Why should such a sight be whitening the seas? That's Old Ir'nsides, trim and taut, And she's found the things she sought-- Found a prize, a bully battle, and a breeze!

WALLACE RICE.

This victory, needless to say, greatly encouraged the Americans, and General Stephen van Rensselaer, in command of the northern army, determined to try another stroke at Canada. On October 13, 1812, he started to cross the Niagara River with six hundred men; but the crossing was mismanaged, the militia refused to obey orders, and after a gallant fight lasting all day, the Americans were forced to surrender to an overwhelming force of British and Indians.

THE BATTLE OF QUEENSTOWN

[October 13, 1812]

When brave Van Rensselaer cross'd the stream, Just at the break of day, Distressing thoughts, a restless dream, Disturb'd me where I lay.

But all the terrors of the night Did quickly flee away: My opening eyes beheld the light, And hail'd the new-born day.

Soon did the murdering cannon's roar Put blood in all my veins; Columbia's sons have trod the shore Where the proud Britain reigns.

To expose their breast to cannon's ball, Their country's rights to save, O what a grief to see them fall! True heroes, bold and brave!

The musket's flash, the cannon's glow, Thunder'd and lighten'd round, Struck dread on all the tawny foe, And swept them to the ground.

I thought what numbers must be slain, What weeping widows left! And aged parents full of pain, Of every joy bereft.

The naked savage yelling round Our heroes where they stood, And every weapon to be found Was bathed in human blood.

But bold Van Rensselaer, full of wounds, Was quickly carried back; Brave Colonel Bloom did next command The bloody fierce attack.

Where Brock, the proud insulter, rides In pomp and splendor great; Our valiant heroes he derides, And dared the power of fate.

"Here is a mark for Yankee boys, So shoot me if you can:" A Yankee ball soon closed his eyes, Death found him but a man.

They slaughter'd down the tawny foe, And Britons that were near; They dealt out death at every blow, The battle was severe.

Five battles fought all in one day, Through four victorious stood, But ah! the fifth swept all away, And spilt our heroes' blood.

The tomahawk and scalping-knife On them did try their skill; Some wounded, struggling for their life, Did black barbarians kill.

Brave Wadsworth boldly kept the field Till their last bullets flew; Then all were prisoners forced to yield, What could the general do?

Militia men! O fie for shame! Thus you your country flee. 'Tis you at last will bear the blame For loss of victory.

When mild Van Rensselaer did command, You would not him obey; But stood spectators on the strand, To see the bloody fray.

The number kill'd was seventy-four, Prisoners, seven hundred sixty-nine, Wounded, two hundred or more, Who languish'd in great pain.

Some have already lost their lives, And others like to go; But few, I fear, will tell their wives The doleful tale of wo.

WILLIAM BANKER, JR.

But disasters on land seemed fated to be followed by victories on the water. About noon of October 18, 1812, the American 18-gun sloop of war, Wasp, encountered the 20-gun British brig, Frolic, off Albemarle Sound, and, after a severe action, boarded and compelled her to surrender. Shortly afterwards, a sail hove in sight, which proved to be the British 74, Poictiers, and, running down on the sloops, she seized both the Wasp and her prize and carried them to Bermuda.

THE WASP'S FROLIC

[October 18, 1812]

'Twas on board the sloop of war Wasp, boys, We set sail from Delaware Bay, To cruise on Columbia's fair coast, sirs, Our rights to maintain on the sea.

Three days were not passed on our station, When the Frolic came up to our view; Says Jones, "Show the flag of our nation;" Three cheers were then gave by our crew.

We boldly bore up to this Briton, Whose cannon began for to roar; The Wasp soon her stings from her side ran, When we on them a broadside did pour.

Each sailor stood firm at his quarters, 'Twas minutes past forth and three, When fifty bold Britons were slaughtered, Whilst our guns swept their masts in the sea.

Their breasts then with valor still glowing, Acknowledged the battle we'd won, On us then bright laurels bestowing, When to leeward they fired a gun.

On their decks we the twenty guns counted, With a crew for to answer the same; Eighteen was the number we mounted, Being served by the lads of true game.

With the Frolic in tow, we were standing, All in for Columbia's fair shore; But fate on our laurels was frowning, We were taken by a seventy-four.

A more signal victory was soon to be recorded. On the morning of October 25, 1812, near the Canary Islands, the British 38-gun frigate, Macedonian, was

overhauled by the American 44, United States, and an hour after the action began, was reduced to a wreck by the terrible fire of the American. A prize crew was put aboard, repaired her, and got her safely to New York.

THE UNITED STATES AND THE MACEDONIAN

[October 25, 1812]

How glows each patriot bosom that boasts a Yankee heart, To emulate such glorious deeds and nobly take a part; When sailors with their thund'ring guns, Prove to the English, French, and Danes That Neptune's chosen fav'rite sons Are brave Yankee boys.

The twenty-fifth of October, that glorious happy day, When we beyond all precedent, from Britons bore the sway,-- 'Twas in the ship United States, Four and forty guns the rates, That she should rule, decreed the Fates, And brave Yankee boys.

Decatur and his hardy tars were cruising on the deep, When off the Western Islands they to and fro did sweep, The Macedonian they espied, "Huzza! bravo!" Decatur cried, "We'll humble Britain's boasted pride, My brave Yankee boys."

The decks were cleared, the hammocks stowed, the boatswain pipes all hands, The tompions out, the guns well sponged, the Captain now commands; The boys who for their country fight, Their words, "Free Trade and Sailor's Rights!" Three times they cheered with all their might, Those brave Yankee boys.

Now chain-shot, grape, and langrage pierce through her oaken sides, And many a gallant sailor's blood runs purpling in the tides; While death flew nimbly o'er their decks, Some lost their legs, and some their necks, And Glory's wreath our ship be-decks, For brave Yankee boys.

My boys, the proud St. George's Cross, the stripes above it wave, And busy are our gen'rous tars, the conquered foe to save, To Carden then, in tones so bland, Our Captain cries "Give me your hand," Then of the ship who took command But brave Yankee boys?

Our enemy lost her mizzen, her main and fore-topmast, For ev'ry shot with death was winged, which slew her men so fast, That they lost five to one in killed, And ten to one their blood was spilled, So Fate decreed and Heaven had willed, For brave Yankee boys.

Then homeward steered the captive ship, now safe in port she lies, The old and young with rapture viewed our sailors' noble prize; Through seas of wine their health we'll drink, And wish them sweet-hearts, friends, and chink, Who 'fore they'd strike, will nobly sink Our brave Yankee boys.

THE UNITED STATES AND MACEDONIAN

[October 25, 1812]

The banner of Freedom high floated unfurled, While the silver-tipt surges in low homage curled, Flashing bright round the bow of Decatur's brave bark, In contest, an "eagle"--in chasing, a "lark." The bold United States, Which four-and-forty rates, Will ne'er be known to yield--be known to yield or fly, Her motto is "Glory! we conquer or we die."

All canvas expanded to woo the coy gale, The ship cleared for action, in chase of a sail; The foemen in view, every bosom beats high, All eager for conquest, or ready to die.

Now havoc stands ready, with optics of flame, And battle-hounds "strain on the start" for the game; The blood demons rise on the surge for their prey, While Pity, rejected, awaits the dread fray.

The gay floating streamers of Britain appear, Waving light on the breeze as the stranger we near; And now could the quick-sighted Yankee discern "Macedonian," emblazoned at large on her stern.

She waited our approach, and the contest began, But to waste ammunition is no Yankee plan; In awful suspense every match was withheld, While the bull-dogs of Britain incessantly yelled.

Unawed by her thunders, alongside we came, While the foe seemed enwrapped in a mantle of flame; When, prompt to the word, such a flood we return, That Neptune, aghast, thought his trident would burn.

Now the lightning of battle gleams horridly red, With a tempest of iron and hail-storm of lead; And our fire on the foe we so copiously poured, His mizzen and topmasts soon went by the board.

So fierce and so bright did our flashes aspire, They thought that their cannon had set us on fire, "The Yankee's in flames!"--every British tar hears, And hails the false omen with three hearty cheers.

In seventeen minutes they found their mistake, And were glad to surrender and fall in our wake; Her decks were with carnage and blood deluged o'er, Where welt'ring in blood lay an hundred and four.

But though she was made so completely a wreck, With blood they had scarcely encrimsoned our deck; Only five valiant Yankees in the contest were slain, And our ship in five minutes was fitted again.

Let Britain no longer lay claim to the seas, For the trident of Neptune is ours, if we please, While Hull and Decatur and Jones are our boast, We dare their whole navy to come on our coast.

Rise, tars of Columbia!--and share in the fame, Which gilds Hull's, Decatur's, and Jones's bright name; Fill a bumper, and drink, "Here's success to the cause, But Decatur supremely deserves our applause." The bold United States, Which four-and-forty rates, Shall ne'er be known to yield--be known to yield or fly, Her motto is "Glory! we conquer or we die."

The United States was commanded by Captain Stephen Decatur, and just before she engaged the Macedonian an incident occurred which showed his crew's unbounded confidence in him.

JACK CREAMER

[October 25, 1812]

The boarding nettings are triced for fight; Pike and cutlass are shining bright; The boatswain's whistle pipes loud and shrill; Gunner and topman work with a will; Rough old sailor and reefer trim Jest as they stand by the cannon grim; There's a fighting glint in Decatur's eye, And brave Old Glory floats out on high.

But many a heart beats fast below The laughing lips as they near the foe; For the pluckiest knows, though no man quails, That the breath of death is filling the sails. Only one little face is wan; Only one childish mouth is drawn; One little heart is sad and sore To the watchful eye of the Commodore. Little Jack Creamer, ten years old, In no purser's book or watch enrolled, Must mope or skulk while his shipmates fight,-- No wonder his little face is white!

"Why, Jack, old man, so blue and sad? Afraid of the music?" The face of the lad With mingled shame and anger burns. Quick to the Commodore he turns: "I'm not a coward, but I think if you-- Excuse me, Capt'n, I mean if you knew (I s'pose it's because I'm young and small) I'm not on the books! I'm no one at all! And as soon as this fighting work is done, And we get our prize-money, every one Has his share of the plunder--_I_ get none."

"And you're sure we shall take her?" "Sure? Why, sir, She's only a blessed Britisher! We'll take her easy enough, I bet; But glory's all that I'm going to get!" "Glory! I doubt if I get more, If I get so much," said the Commodore; "But faith goes far in the race for fame, And down on the books shall go your name."

Bravely the little seaman stood To his post while the scuppers ran with blood, While grizzled veterans looked and smiled And gathered new courage from the child; Till the enemy, crippled in pride and might, Struck his crimson flag and gave up the fight. Then little Jack Creamer stood once more Face to face with the Commodore.

"You have got your glory," he said, "my lad, And money to make your sweetheart glad. Now, who may she be?" "My mother, sir; I want you to send the half to her." "And the rest?" Jack blushed and hung his head; "I'll buy some schoolin' with that," he said.

Decatur laughed; then in graver mood: "The first is the better, but both are good. Your mother shall never know want while I Have a ship to sail, or a flag to fly; And schooling you'll have till all is blue, But little the lubbers can teach to you."

Midshipman Creamer's story is told-- They did such things in the days of old, When faith and courage won sure reward, And the quarter-deck was not triply barred, To the forecastle hero; for men were men, And the Nation was close to its Maker then.

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

Encouraged by these successes, Congress, on January 2, 1813, appropriated $2,500,000 to build four 74-gun ships and six 44-gun ships. England also took them to heart, and toward the end of the month the entire British fleet was sent to blockade the Atlantic coast.

YANKEE THUNDERS

[1813]

Britannia's gallant streamers Float proudly o'er the tide, And fairly wave Columbia's stripes, In battle side by side. And ne'er did bolder seamen meet, Where ocean's surges pour; O'er the tide now they ride, While the bell'wing thunders roar, While the cannon's fire is flashing fast, And the bell'wing thunders roar.

When Yankee meets the Briton, Whose blood congenial flows, By Heav'n created to be friends, By fortune rendered foes; Hard then must be the battle fray, Ere well the fight is o'er; Now they ride, side by side, While the bell'wing thunders roar, While her cannon's fire is flashing fast, And the bell'wing thunders roar.

Still, still, for noble England Bold D'Acres' streamers fly; And for Columbia, gallant Hull's As proudly and as high; Now louder rings the battle din, And thick the volumes pour; Still they ride, side by side, While the bell'wing thunders roar, While the cannon's fire is flashing fast, And the bell'wing thunders roar.

Why lulls Britannia's thunder, That waked the wat'ry war? Why stays the gallant Guerrière, Whose streamers waved so fair? That streamer drinks the ocean wave, That warrior's fight is o'er! Still they ride, side by side, While the bell'wing thunders roar, While the cannon's fire is flashing fast, And the bell'wing thunders roar.

Hark! 'tis the Briton's lee gun! Ne'er bolder warrior kneeled! And ne'er to gallant mariners Did braver seamen yield. Proud be the sires, whose hardy boys Then fell to fight no more: With the brave, mid the wave; When the cannon's thunders roar, Their spirits then shall trim the blast, And swell the thunder's roar.

Vain were the cheers of Britons, Their hearts did vainly swell, Where virtue, skill, and bravery With gallant Morris fell. That heart so well in battle tried, Along the Moorish shore, And again o'er the main, When Columbia's thunders roar, Shall prove its Yankee spirit true, When Columbia's thunders roar.

Hence be our floating bulwark Those oaks our mountains yield; 'Tis mighty Heaven's plain decree-- Then take the wat'ry field! To ocean's farthest barrier then Your whit'ning sail shall pour; Safe they'll ride o'er the tide, While Columbia's thunders roar, While her cannon's fire is flashing fast, And her Yankee thunders roar.

On March 11, 1813, the little privateer schooner, General Armstrong, Captain Guy R. Champlin, was cruising off Surinam River, when she sighted a sail, and on investigation found it to be a large vessel, apparently a British privateer. Champlin bore down and endeavored to board. The stranger kept off, and, suddenly raising her port covers, disclosed herself as a British 44-gun frigate. For forty-five minutes the

Americans stood to their guns and endeavored to dismast the enemy, then gradually drew away and escaped.

THE GENERAL ARMSTRONG

[March 11, 1813]

Come, all you sons of Liberty, that to the seas belong, It's worth your attention to listen to my song; The history of a privateer I will detail in full, That fought a "six-and-thirty" belonging to John Bull.

The General Armstrong she is called, and sailèd from New York, With all our hearts undaunted, once more to try our luck; She was a noble vessel, a privateer of fame: She had a brave commander, George Champlin was his name.

We stood unto the eastward, all with a favoring gale, In longitude of fifty we spied a lofty sail: Our mainsail being lower'd and foresail to repair, Our squaresail being set, my boys, the wind it provèd fair.

We very soon perceivèd the lofty sail to be Bearing down upon us while we lay under her lee; All hands we call'd, and sail did make, then splicèd the main-brace, Night coming on, we sail'd so fast, she soon gave up the chase.

Then to Barbadoes we were bound, our course so well did steer; We cruisèd there for several days, and nothing did appear. 'Twas on the 11th of March, to windward of Surinam, We spied a lofty ship, my boys, at anchor near the land; All hands we call'd to quarters, and down upon her bore, Thinking 'twas some merchant-ship then lying near the shore.

She quickly weighèd anchor and from us did steer, And setting her top-gallant sail as if she did us fear, But soon we were alongside of her, and gave her a gun, Determinèd to fight, my boys, and not from her to run.

We hoisted up the bloody flag and down upon her bore, If she did not strike, my boys, no quarters we would show her; Each man a brace of pistols, a boarding-pike and sword, We'll give her a broadside, my boys, before we do her board.

All hands at their quarters lay, until we came alongside, And gave them three hearty cheers, their British courage tried. The lower ports she had shut in, the Armstrong to decoy, And quickly she her ports did show, to daunt each Yankee boy.

The first broadside we gave them true, their colors shot away, Their topsail, haulyards, mizen rigging, main and mizen stay, Two ports we did knock into one, his starboard quarter tore, They overboard their wounded flung, while cannons loud did roar.

She wore directly round, my boys, and piped all hands on deck, For fear that we would board and serve a Yankee trick; To board a six-and-thirty it was in vain to try, While the grape, round, and langrage, like hailstones they did fly.

Brave Champlin on the quarter-deck so nobly gave command: "Fight on, my brave Americans, dismast her if you can." The round, grape, and star-shot so well did play,

A musket-ball from the maintop brave Champlin low did lay.

His wound was quickly dress'd, while he in his cabin lay; The doctor, while attending, these words he heard him say: "Our Yankee flag shall flourish," our noble captain cried, "Before that we do strike, my boys, we'll sink alongside."

She was a six-and-thirty, and mounted forty-two, We fought her four glasses, what more then could we do; Till six brave seamen we had kill'd, which grievèd us full sore, And thirteen more wounded lay bleeding in their gore.

Our foremast being wounded, and bowsprit likewise; Our lower rigging fore and aft, and headstay beside; Our haulyards, braces, bowling, and foretop sheet also, We found we could not fight her, boys, so from her we did go.

Our foremast proving dangerous, we could not carry sail, Although we had it fish'd and welded with a chain; It grieved us to the heart to put up with such abuse, For this damn'd English frigate had surely spoil'd our cruise.

Here's success attend brave Champlin, his officers and men, That fought with courage keen, my boys, our lives to defend; We fought with much superior force, what could we do more? Then haul'd our wind and stood again for Freedom's happy shore.

On the land, the year opened badly with the disastrous defeat of an American column, under General Winchester, at Raisin River, Michigan; but on April 27 General Pike, at the head of fifteen hundred men, stormed and captured the British fort at York, now Toronto.

CAPTURE OF LITTLE YORK

[April 27, 1813]

When Britain, with envy and malice inflamed, Dared dispute the dear rights of Columbia's bless'd union, We thought of the time when our freedom we claim'd, And fought 'gainst oppression with fullest communion. Our foes on the ocean have been forced to yield, And fresh laurels we now gather up in the field.

Freedom's flag on the wilds of the west is unfurl'd, And our foes seem to find their resistance delusion; For our eagle her arrows amongst them has hurl'd And their ranks of bold veterans fill'd with confusion. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

On the lakes of the west, full of national pride, See our brave little fleet most triumphantly riding! And behold the brave tars on the fresh-water tide, In a noble commander, brave Chauncey, confiding. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

Their deeds of proud valor shall long stand enroll'd On the bright shining page of our national glory: And oft, in the deep winter's night, shall be told The exploits of the tars of American story. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

Nor less shall the soldiers come in for their praise, Who engaged to accomplish the great expedition; And a monument Fame shall for them cheerily raise, And their deeds shall in history find repetition. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

Let Britons still boast of their prowess and pluck; We care not a straw for their muskets and cannon. In the field we will beat them, unless they've the luck To run from their foes like Tenedos and Shannon. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

Our sweet little bull-dogs, they thunder'd away, And our sailors and soldiers the foe still kept mauling, Till they grew very sick of such tight Yankee play, And poor Sheaffe and his troops then ran away bawling. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

But the rascals on malice quite fully were bent: And as from the fort they were cowardly going, In pursuance to what was at first their intent, The magazine they had resolved on up-blowing. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

Two hundred brave soldiers there met with their death; And while for their country they nobly were dying, Full fifty bold Britons at once lost their breath, And with them in the air were their carcasses flying. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

The brave General Pike there met with his end; But his virtues his country forever will cherish: And while o'er his grave fair Freedom shall bend, She will swear that his memory never shall perish. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

Let the minions of Britain swarm over our coast; Columbians, all cowardly conduct disdaining, We'll teach the invaders how vain is their boast, And contend, whilst a drop of their blood is remaining. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

Then, freemen, arise, and gird on your swords, And declare, while you still have the means of resistance, That you ne'er will give up for the threatening of words, Nor of arms, those dear rights which you prize as existence. Our foes on the ocean, etc.

Forty of the enemy and more than two hundred Americans were killed or wounded by the explosion of a magazine, just as the place surrendered. General Pike was mortally wounded, and died with his head on the British flag which had been brought to him.

THE DEATH OF GENERAL PIKE

[April 27, 1813]

'Twas on the glorious day When our valiant triple band Drove the British troops away From their strong and chosen stand; When the city York was taken, And the Bloody Cross hauled down From the walls of the town Its defenders had forsaken.

The gallant Pike had moved A hurt foe to a spot A little more removed From the death-shower of the shot; And he himself was seated On the fragment of an oak, And to a captive spoke, Of the troops he had defeated.

He was seated in a place, Not to shun the leaden rain He had been the first to face, And now burned to brave again, But had chosen that position Till the officer's return The truth who'd gone to learn Of the garrison's condition.

When suddenly the ground With a dread convulsion shook, And arose a frightful sound, And the sun was hid in smoke; And huge stones and rafters, driven Athwart the heavy rack, Fell, fatal on their track As the thunderbolt of Heaven.

Then two hundred men and more, Of our bravest and our best, Lay all ghastly in their gore, And the hero with the rest. On their folded arms they laid him; But he raised his dying breath: "On, men, avenge the death Of your general!" They obeyed him.

They obeyed. Three cheers they gave, Closed their scattered ranks, and on. Though their leader found a grave, Yet the hostile town was won. To a vessel straight they bore him Of the gallant Chauncey's fleet, And, the conquest complete, Spread the British flag before him.

O'er his eyes the long, last night Was already falling fast; But came back again the light For a moment; 'twas the last. With a victor's joy they fired, 'Neath his head by signs he bade The trophy should be laid; And, thus pillowed, Pike expired.

LAUGHTON OSBORN.

General William Henry Harrison, meanwhile, at the head of the western army, was besieged in Fort Meigs, at the mouth of the Maumee, by a large force of Indians and British. On May 1 the British made a determined assault, but were beaten off; a few days later, after a desperate battle with a relief column, the British raised the siege and retreated to Canada.

OLD FORT MEIGS

[April 28--May 9, 1813]

Oh! lonely is our old green fort, Where oft, in days of old, Our gallant soldiers bravely fought 'Gainst savage allies bold; But with the change of years have pass'd That unrelenting foe, Since we fought here with Harrison, A long time ago.

It seems but yesterday I heard, From yonder thicket nigh, The unerring rifle's sharp report, The Indian's startling cry. Yon brooklet flowing at our feet, With crimson gore did flow, When we fought here with Harrison, A long time ago.

The river rolls between its banks, As when of old we came, Each grassy path, each shady nook, Seems to me still the same; But we are scatter'd now, whose faith Pledged here, through weal or woe, With Harrison our soil to guard, A long time ago.

But many a soldier's lip is mute, And clouded many a brow, And hearts that beat for honor then, Have ceased their throbbing now. We ne'er shall meet again in life As then we met, I trow, When we fought here with Harrison, A long time ago.

The remarkable list of victories on the ocean was soon to be broken, for on June 1, 1813, the 36-gun frigate, Chesapeake, was defeated and captured by the British 38-gun frigate, Shannon.

THE SHANNON AND THE CHESAPEAKE

[June 1, 1813]

The captain of the Shannon came sailing up the bay, A reeling wind flung out behind his pennons bright and gay; His cannon crashed a challenge; the smoke that hid the sea Was driven hard to windward and drifted back to lee.

The captain of the Shannon sent word into the town: Was Lawrence there, and would he dare to sail his frigate down And meet him at the harbor's mouth and fight him, gun to gun, For honor's sake, with pride at stake, until the fight was won?

Now, long the gallant Lawrence had scoured the bitter main; With many a scar and wound of war his ship was home again; His crew, relieved from service, were scattered far and wide, And scarcely one, his duty done, had lingered by his side.

But to refuse the challenge? Could he outlive the shame? Brave men and true, but deadly few, he gathered to his fame. Once more the great ship Chesapeake prepared her for the fight,-- "I'll bring the foe to town in tow," he said, "before to-night!"

High on the hills of Hingham that overlooked the shore, To watch the fray and hope and pray, for they could do no more, The children of the country watched the children of the sea When the smoke drove hard to windward and drifted back to lee.

"How can he fight," they whispered, "with only half a crew, Though they be rare to do and dare, yet what can brave men do?" But when the Chesapeake came down, the Stars and Stripes on high, Stilled was each fear, and cheer on cheer resounded to the sky.

The Captain of the Shannon, he swore both long and loud: "This victory, where'er it be, shall make two nations proud! Now onward to this victory or downward to defeat! A sailor's life is sweet with strife, a sailor's death as sweet."

And as when lightnings rend the sky and gloomy thunders roar, And crashing surge plays devil's dirge upon the stricken shore, With thunder and with sheets of flame the two ships rang with shot, And every gun burst forth a sun of iron crimson-hot.

And twice they lashed together and twice they tore apart, And iron balls burst wooden walls and pierced each oaken heart. Still from the hills of Hingham men watched with hopes and fears, While all the bay was torn that day with shot that rained like tears.

The tall masts of the Chesapeake went groaning by the board; The Shannon's spars were weak with scars when Broke cast down his sword; "Now woe," he cried, "to England, and shame and woe to me!" The smoke drove hard to windward and drifted back to lee.

"Give them one breaking broadside more," he cried, "before we strike!" But one grim ball that ruined all for hope and home alike Laid Lawrence low in glory, yet from his pallid lip Rang to the land his last command: "Boys, don't give up the ship!"

* * * * *

The wounded wept like women when they hauled her ensign down. Men's cheeks were pale as with the tale from Hingham to the town They hurried in swift silence,

while toward the eastern night The victor bore away from shore and vanished out of sight.

Hail to the great ship Chesapeake! Hail to the hero brave Who fought her fast, and loved her last, and shared her sudden grave! And glory be to those that died for all eternity; They lie apart at the mother-heart of God's eternal sea.

THOMAS TRACY BOUVÉ.

A British versifier celebrated the victory by composing a ballad in imitation of the famous one about the Constitution and Guerrière.

CHESAPEAKE AND SHANNON

[June 1, 1813]

The Chesapeake so bold Out of Boston, I've been told, Came to take a British Frigate Neat and handy O! While the people of the port Flocked out to see the sport, With their music playing Yankee Doodle Dandy O!

Now the British Frigate's name Which for the purpose came Of cooling Yankee courage Neat and handy O! Was the Shannon, Captain Broke, Whose crew were heart of oak, And for the fighting were confessed To be the dandy O!

The engagement scarce begun Ere they flinched from their guns, Which at first they thought of working Neat and handy O! The bold Broke he waved his sword, Crying, "Now, my lads, on board, And we'll stop their playing Yankee Doodle Dandy O!"

They no sooner heard the word Than they quickly rushed aboard And hauled down the Yankee ensign Neat and handy O! Notwithstanding all their brag, Now the glorious British flag At the Yankee's mizzen-peak Was quite the dandy O!

Successful Broke to you, And your officers and crew, Who on board the Shannon frigate Fought so handy O! And may it ever prove That in fighting as in love The true British tar is the dandy O!

James Lawrence, commander of the Chesapeake, had been fatally wounded early in the action. Until the last, he kept crying from the cockpit, "Keep the guns going! Fight her till she strikes or sinks!" His last words were the famous, "Don't give up the ship!"

DEFEAT AND VICTORY

[June 1, 1813]

Through the clangor of the cannon, Through the combat's wreck and reek, Answer to th' o'ermastering Shannon Thunders from the Chesapeake: Gallant Lawrence, wounded, dying, Speaks with still unconquered lip Ere the bitter draught he drinks: _Keep the Flag flying! Fight her till she strikes or sinks! Don't give up the ship!_

Still that voice is sounding o'er us, So bold Perry heard it call; Farragut has joined its chorus; Porter, Dewey, Wainwright--all Heard the voice of duty crying; Deathless word from dauntless lip That our past and future links: _Keep the Flag flying! Fight her till she strikes or sinks! Don't give up the ship!_

WALLACE RICE.

Another action which resulted very differently was that between the American 16-gun schooner, Enterprise, and the British 14-gun brig, Boxer. The ships came together off Monhegan on September 5, 1813, and after a fierce fight lasting an hour, the Englishman surrendered.

ENTERPRISE AND BOXER

[September 5, 1813]

Again Columbia's stripes, unfurl'd, Have testified before the world, How brave are those who wear 'em; The foe has now been taught again His streamers cannot shade the main While Yankees live to share 'em. Huzza! once more for Yankee skill! The brave are very generous still But teach the foes submission: Now twice three times his flag we've gain'd, And more, much more can be obtain'd Upon the same condition.

The gallant Enterprise her name, A vessel erst of little fame, Had sail'd and caught the foe, sirs; 'Twas hers the glory and the gain, To meet the Boxer on the main, And bring her home in tow, sirs. Huzza! once more for Yankee skill, etc.

Fierce lightnings gleam and thunders roar, While round and grape in torrents pour, And echo through the skies, sirs; When minutes forty-five had flown, Behold the Briton's colors down!-- She's yielded up a prize, sirs. Huzza! once more for Yankee skill, etc.

The victory gain'd, we count the cost, We mourn, indeed, a hero lost! Who nobly fell, we know, sirs; But Burrows, we with Lawrence find, Has left a living name behind, Much honor'd by the foe, sirs. Huzza! once more for Yankee skill, etc.

And while we notice deeds of fame, In which the gallant honors claim; As heroes of our story, The name of Blyth a meed demands, Whose tomb is deck'd by freemen's hands, Who well deserve the glory. Huzza! once more for Yankee skill, etc.

Then, while we fill the sparkling glass, And cause it cheerly round to pass, In social hours assembled; Be Hull, Decatur, Bainbridge, Jones, Lawrence and Burrows--Victory's sons, With gratitude remember'd. Huzza! once more for Yankee skill, etc.

This little victory was soon overshadowed by a far more brilliant and important one on Lake Erie, where, on September 10, 1813, Oliver Hazard Perry, in command of a hastily constructed fleet of nine ships, defeated and captured a British squadron of superior strength.

PERRY'S VICTORY

[September 10, 1813]

We sailed to and fro in Erie's broad lake, To find British bullies or get into their wake, When we hoisted our canvas with true Yankee speed, And the brave Captain Perry our squadron did lead.

We sailed through the lake, boys, in search of the foe, In the cause of Columbia our brav'ry to show, To be equal in combat was all our delight, As we wished the proud Britons to know we could fight.

And whether like Yeo, boys, they'd taken affright, We could see not, nor find them by day or by night; So cruising we went in a glorious cause, In defence of our rights, our freedom, and laws.

At length to our liking, six sails hove in view, Huzzah! says brave Perry, huzzah! says his crew, And then for the chase, boys, with our brave little crew, We fell in with the bullies and gave them "burgoo."

Though the force was unequal, determined to fight, We brought them to action before it was night; We let loose our thunder, our bullets did fly, "Now give them your shot, boys," our commander did cry.

We gave them a broadside, our cannon to try, "Well done," says brave Perry, "for quarter they'll cry, Shot well home, my brave boys, they shortly shall see, That quite brave as they are, still braver are we."

Then we drew up our squadron, each man full of fight, And put the proud Britons in a terrible plight, The brave Perry's movements will prove fully as bold, As the fam'd Admiral Nelson's prowess of old.

The conflict was sharp, boys, each man to his gun, For our country, her glory, the vict'ry was won, So six sail (the whole fleet) was our fortune to take, Here's a health to brave Perry, who governs the Lake.

THE BATTLE OF ERIE

[September 10, 1813]

Avast, honest Jack! now, before you get mellow, Come tip us that stave just, my hearty old fellow, 'Bout the young commodore, and his fresh-water crew, Who keelhaul'd the Britons, and captured a few.

"'Twas just at sunrise, and a glorious day, Our squadron at anchor snug in Put-in-Bay, When we saw the bold Britons, and cleared for a bout, Instead of put in, by the Lord we put out.

"Up went union-jack, never up there before, 'Don't give up the ship' was the motto it bore; And as soon as that motto our gallant lads saw, They thought of their Lawrence, and shouted huzza!

"Oh! then it would have raised your hat three inches higher, To see how we dash'd in among them like fire! The Lawrence went first, and the rest as they could, And a

long time the brunt of the action she stood.

"'Twas peppering work,--fire, fury, and smoke, And groans that from wounded lads, spite of 'em, broke. The water grew red round our ship as she lay, Though 'twas never before so till that bloody day.

"They fell all around me like spars in a gale; The shot made a sieve of each rag of a sail; And out of our crew scarce a dozen remain'd; But these gallant tars still the battle maintain'd.

"'Twas then our commander--God bless his young heart-- Thought it best from his well-peppered ship to depart, And bring up the rest who were tugging behind-- For why--they were sadly in want of a wind.

"So to Yarnall he gave the command of his ship, And set out, like a lark, on this desperate trip, In a small open yawl, right through their whole fleet, Who with many a broadside our cockboat did greet.

"I steer'd her and damme if every inch Of these timbers of mine at each crack didn't flinch: But our tight little commodore, cool and serene, To stir ne'er a muscle by any was seen.

"Whole volleys of muskets were levell'd at him, But the devil a one ever grazed e'en a limb, Though he stood up aloft in the stern of the boat, Till the crew pull'd him down by the skirt of his coat.

"At last, through Heaven's mercy, we reached t'other ship, And the wind springing up, we gave her the whip, And run down their line, boys, through thick and through thin, And bother'd their crews with a horrible din.

"Then starboard and larboard, and this way and that, We bang'd them and raked them, and laid their masts flat, Till, one after t'other, they haul'd down their flag, And an end, for that time, put to Johnny Bull's brag.

"The Detroit, and Queen Charlotte, and Lady Prevost, Not able to fight or run, gave up the ghost: And not one of them all from our grapplings got free, Though we'd fifty-four guns, and they just sixty-three.

"Smite my limbs! but they all got their bellies full then, And found what it was, boys, to buckle with men, Who fight, or, what's just the same, think that they fight For their country's free trade and their own native right.

"Now give us a bumper to Elliott and those Who came up, in good time, to belabor our foes: To our fresh-water sailors we'll toss off one more, And a dozen, at least, to our young commodore.

"And though Britons may brag of their ruling the ocean, And that sort of thing, by the Lord, I've a notion, I'll bet all I'm worth--who takes it--who takes? Though they're lords of the sea, we'll be lords of the lakes."

Immediately on receiving the surrender, Perry wrote with a pencil on the back of an old letter, using his cap for a desk, his famous message, "We have met the enemy and they are ours--two ships, two brigs, one schooner, and one sloop," and dispatched

it to General Harrison.

PERRY'S VICTORY--A SONG

[September 10, 1813]

Columbia, appear!--To thy mountains ascend, And pour thy bold hymn to the winds and the woods; Columbia, appear!--O'er thy tempest-harp bend, And far to the nations its trumpet-song send,-- Let thy cliff-echoes wake, with their sun-nourish'd broods, And chant to the desert--the skies--and the floods, And bid them remember, The Tenth of September, When our Eagle came down from her home in the sky-- And the souls of our heroes were marshall'd on high.

Columbia, ascend!--Let thy warriors behold Their flag like a firmament bend o'er thy head. The wide rainbow-flag with its star-clustered fold! Let the knell of dark Battle beneath it be tolled, While the anthem of Peace shall be pealed for the dead, And the rude waters heave, on whose bosom they bled: Oh, they will remember, The Tenth of September, When their souls were let loose in a tempest of flame, And wide Erie shook at the trumpet of Fame.

Columbia, appear!--Let thy cloud minstrels wake, As they march on the storm, all the grandeur of song, Till the far mountain reel--and the billowless lake Shall be mantled in froth, and its Monarch shall quake On his green oozy throne, as their harping comes strong, With the chime of the winds as they're bursting along. For he will remember, The Tenth of September, When he saw his dominions all covered with foam, And heard the loud war in its echoless home.

Columbia, appear!--Be thine olive displayed, O cheer with thy smile, all the land and the tide! Be the anthem we hear not the song that was made, When the victims of slaughter stood forth, all arrayed In blood-dripping garments--and shouted--and died. Let the hymning of peace o'er the blue heavens ride; O let us remember, The Tenth of September, When the dark waves of Erie were brightened to-day, And the flames of the Battle were quenched in the spray.

Harrison, at the head of his army, started in hot pursuit of the British and Indians, who had been compelled to evacuate Detroit, and on October 5 overtook them on the bank of the Thames, and routed them with great loss, the Indian chief Tecumseh being among the slain.

THE FALL OF TECUMSEH

[October 5, 1813]

What heavy-hoofed coursers the wilderness roam, To the war-blast indignantly tramping? Their mouths are all white, as if frosted with foam, The steel bit impatiently champing.

'Tis the hand of the mighty that grasps the rein, Conducting the free and the fearless. Ah! see them rush forward, with wild disdain, Through paths unfrequented and cheerless.

From the mountains had echoed the charge of death, Announcing that chivalrous sally; The savage was heard, with untrembling breath, To pour his response from the valley.

One moment, and nought but the bugle was heard, And nought but the war-whoop given; The next, and the sky seemed convulsively stirred, As if by the lightning riven.

The din of the steed, and the sabred stroke, The blood-stifled gasp of the dying, Were screened by the curling sulphur-smoke, That upward went wildly flying.

In the mist that hung over the field of blood, The chief of the horsemen contended; His rowels were bathed in purple flood, That fast from his charger descended.

That steed reeled, and fell, in the van of the fight, But the rider repressed not his daring, Till met by a savage, whose rank and might Were shown by the plume he was wearing.

The moment was fearful; a mightier foe Had ne'er swung the battle-axe o'er him; But hope nerved his arm for a desperate blow, And Tecumseh fell prostrate before him.

O ne'er may the nations again be cursed With conflict so dark and appalling!-- Foe grappled with foe, till the life-blood burst From their agonized bosoms in falling.

Gloom, silence, and solitude rest on the spot Where the hopes of the red man perished; But the fame of the hero who fell shall not, By the virtuous, cease to be cherished.

He fought, in defence of his kindred and king, With a spirit most loving and loyal. And long shall the Indian warrior sing The deeds of Tecumseh the royal.

The lightning of intellect flashed from his eye, In his arm slept the force of the thunder, But the bolt passed the suppliant harmlessly by, And left the freed captive to wonder.

Above, near the path of the pilgrim, he sleeps, With a rudely built tumulus o'er him; And the bright-bosomed Thames, in his majesty, sweeps, By the mound where his followers bore him.

The British took care to maintain as strictly as possible the blockade of the American coast, and the coast towns were kept in a constant state of terror lest they be bombarded and burned.

THE LEGEND OF WALBACH TOWER

SCENE.--_Fort Constitution on the Island of Newcastle, off Portsmouth, N. H., Colonel Walbach, commanding. Period, the fall of 1813._

More ill at ease was never man than Walbach, that Lord's day, When, spent with speed, a trawler cried, "A war-ship heads this way!"

His pipe, half filled, to shatters flew; he climbed the ridge of knolls; And, turning spy-glass toward the east, swept the long reach of Shoals.

An hour he watched: behind his back the Portsmouth spires waxed red; Its harbor like a field of war, a brazen shield o'erhead.

Another hour: the sundown gun the Sabbath stillness brake; When loud a second voice hallooed, "Two war-ships hither make!"

Again the colonel scanned the east, where soon white gleams arose: Behind Star Isle they first appeared, then flashed o'er Smuttynose.

Fleet-wing'd they left Duck Isle astern; when, rounding full in view, Lo! in the face of Appledore three Britishers hove to.

"To arms, O townsfolk!" Walbach cried, "Behold these black hawk three! Whether they pluck old Portsmouth town rests now with you and me.

"The guns of Kittery, and mine, may keep the channel clear, If but one pintle-stone be raised to ward me in the rear.

"But scarce a score my muster-roll; the earthworks lie unmanned (Whereof some mouthing spy, no doubt, has made them understand);

"And if, ere dawn, their long-boat keels once kiss the nether sands, My every port-hole's mouth is stopped, and we be in their hands!"

Then straightway from his place upspake the parson of the town: "Let us beseech Heaven's blessing first!"--and all the folk knelt down.

"O God, our hands are few and faint; our hope rests all with thee: Lend us thy hand in this sore strait,--and thine the glory be!"

"Amen! Amen!" the chorus rose; "Amen!" the pines replied; And through the churchyard's rustling grass an "Amen" softly sighed.

Astir the village was awhile, with hoof and iron clang; Then all grew still, save where, aloft, a hundred trowels rang.

None supped, they say, that Lord's-day eve; none slept, they say, that night; But all night long, with tireless arms, each toiled as best he might.

Four flax-haired boys of Amazeen the flickering torches stay, Peopling with titan shadow-groups the canopy of gray;

Grandsires, with frost above their brows, the steaming mortar mix; Dame Tarlton's apron, crisp at dawn, helps hod the yellow bricks;

While pilot, cooper, mackerelman, parson and squire as well, Make haste to plant the pintle-gun, and raise its citadel.

And one who wrought still tells the tale, that as his task he plied, An unseen fellow-form he felt that labored at his side;

And still to wondering ears relates, that as each brick was squared, Lo! unseen trowels clinked response, and a new course prepared.

O night of nights! The blinking dawn beheld the marvel done, And from the new martello boomed the echoing morning gun.

One stormy cloud its lip upblew; and as its thunder rolled, Old England saw, above the smoke, New England's flag unfold.

Then, slowly tacking to and fro, more near the cruisers made, To see what force unheralded had flown to Walbach's aid.

"God be our stay," the parson cried, "who hearkened Israel's wail!" And as he spake,--all in a line, seaward the ships set sail.

GEORGE HOUGHTON.

In order to draw British ships from this blockade, the government adopted the policy of sending light squadrons into distant seas, and in October, 1812, the 32-gun frigate Essex, Captain David Porter, sailed to join the Constitution and Hornet for a cruise in the Indian Ocean. Porter failed to find the other ships and decided to double Cape Horn and cruise in the Pacific. He captured a number of prizes, and completely destroyed British commerce in the south Pacific. A strong force of British cruisers was sent out to intercept him, and finally, on March 28, 1814, he was caught in a disabled condition at Valparaiso by two British ships, and attacked, notwithstanding the neutrality of the port. After a desperate fight, he was forced to surrender.

THE BATTLE OF VALPARAISO

Proeliis audax, neque te silebo.--HOR.

[March 28, 1814]

From the laurel's fairest bough, Let the muse her garland twine, To adorn our Porter's brow, Who, beyond the burning line, Led his caravan of tars o'er the tide. To the pilgrims fill the bowl, Who, around the southern pole, Saw new constellations roll, For their guide.

"Heave the topmast from the board, And our ship for action clear, By the cannon and the sword, We will die or conquer here. The foe, of twice our force, nears us fast: To your posts, my faithful tars! Mind your rigging, guns, and spars, And defend your stripes and stars To the last."

At the captain's bold command, Flew each sailor to his gun, And resolved he there would stand, Though the odds was two to one, To defend his flag and ship with his life: High on every mast display'd, "God, Our Country, and Free Trade," E'en the bravest braver made For the strife.

Fierce the storm of battle pours: But unmoved as ocean's rock, When the tempest round it roars, Every seaman breasts the shock, Boldly stepping where his brave messmates fall. O'er his head, full oft and loud, Like the vulture in a cloud, As it cuts the twanging shroud, Screams the ball.

Before the siroc blast From its iron caverns driven, Drops the sear'd and shiver'd mast, By the bolt of battle riven, And higher heaps the ruin of the deck-- As the sailor, bleeding, dies, To his comrades lifts his eyes, "Let our flag still wave," he cries, O'er the wreck.

In echo to the sponge, Hark! along the silent lee, Oft is heard the solemn plunge, In the bosom of the sea. 'Tis not the sullen plunge of the dead, But the self-devoted tar, Who, to grace the victor's car, Scorns from home and friends afar To be led.

Long live the gallant crew Who survived that day of blood: And may fortune soon renew _Equal_ battle on the flood. Long live the glorious names of the brave O'er these martyrs of the deep, Oft the roving tar shall weep, Crying, "Sweetly may they sleep 'Neath the wave."

With the opening of the spring of 1814, the campaign along the Canadian border was begun with unusual activity. The army there was under Major-General Jacob Brown, and on July 25 met the British in the fiercely contested battle of Lundy's Lane, or Bridgewater.

THE BATTLE OF BRIDGEWATER

[July 25, 1814]

O'er Huron's wave the sun was low, The weary soldier watch'd the bow Fast fading from the cloud below The dashing of Niagara. And while the phantom chain'd his sight, Ah! little thought he of the fight-- The horrors of the dreamless night, That posted on so rapidly.

Soon, soon is fled each softer charm; The drum and trumpet sound alarm, And bid each warrior nerve his arm For boldest deeds of chivalry; The burning red-cross, waving high, Like meteor in the evening sky, Proclaims the haughty foemen nigh To try the strife of rivalry.

Columbia's banner floats as proud, Her gallant band around it crowd, And swear to guard or make their shroud The starred flag of liberty. "Haste, haste thee, Scott, to meet the foe, And let the scornful Briton know, Well strung the arm and firm the blow Of him who strikes for liberty."

Loud, loud, the din of battle rings, Shrill through the ranks the bullet sings, And onward fierce each foeman springs To meet his peer in gallantry. Behind the hills descends the sun, The work of death is but begun, And red through twilight's shadows dun Blazes the vollied musketry.

"Charge, Miller, charge the foe once more," And louder than Niagara's roar Along the line is heard, encore, "On, on to death or victory." From line to line, with lurid glow, High arching shoots the rocket's bow, And lights the mingled scene below Of carnage, death, and misery.

The middle watch has now begun, The horrid battle-fray is done, No longer beats the furious drum, To death, to death or victory. All, all is still--with silent tread The watchman steals among the dead, To guard his comrade's lowly bed, Till morning give him sepulture.

Low in the west, of splendor shorn, The midnight moon with bloody horn Sheds her last beam on him, forlorn, Who fell in fight so gloriously; Oh! long her crescent wax and wane Ere she behold such fray again, Such dismal night, such heaps of slain, Foe

mix'd with foe promiscuously.

Colonel Winfield Scott commanded a battalion at this battle, and by a series of desperate charges drove the British from the field. But so shaken was the American army that it was compelled to retreat to camp, after spending the night upon the conquered ground.

THE HERO OF BRIDGEWATER

[July 25, 1814]

Seize, O seize the sounding lyre, With its quivering string! Strike the chords, in ecstasy, Whilst loud the valleys ring! Sing the chief, who, gloriously, From England's veteran band, Pluck'd the wreaths of victory, To grace his native land!

Where Bridgewater's war-famed stream Saw the foemen reel, Thrice repulsed, with burnish'd gleam Of bayonet, knife, and steel; And its crimson'd waters run Red with gurgling flow, As Albion's gathering hosts his arm, His mighty arm, laid low.

Strike the sounding string of fame, O lyre! Beat loud, ye drums! Ye clarion blasts, exalt his name! Behold the hero comes! I see Columbia, joyously, Her palmy circlet throw Around his high victorious brow Who laid her foemen low!

Take him, Fame! for thine he is! On silvery columns, rear The name of Scott, whence envious Time Shall ne'er its honors tear! And thou, O Albion, quake with dread! Ye veterans shrink, the while, Whene'er his glorious name shall sound To shake your sea-girt isle!

CHARLES L. S. JONES.

The British, meanwhile, had extended their blockade to the whole coast of the United States, and were ordered to "destroy and lay waste all towns and districts of the United States found accessive to the attack of the British armaments." In pursuance of these orders, town after town along the coast was bombarded and burned. On August 9, 1814, a squadron descended on the little village of Stonington, but met a warm reception.

THE BATTLE OF STONINGTON ON THE SEABOARD OF CONNECTICUT

[August 9-12, 1814]

Four gallant ships from England came Freighted deep with fire and flame, And other things we need not name, To have a dash at Stonington.

Now safely moor'd, their work begun; They thought to make the Yankees run, And have a mighty deal of fun In stealing sheep at Stonington.

A deacon then popp'd up his head, And parson Jones's sermon read, In which the reverend doctor said That they must fight for Stonington.

A townsman bade them, next, attend To sundry resolutions penn'd, By which they promised to defend With sword and gun old Stonington.

The ships advancing different ways, The Britons soon began to blaze, And put th' old women in amaze, Who fear'd the loss of Stonington.

The Yankees to their fort repair'd, And made as though they little cared For all that came--though very hard The cannon play'd on Stonington.

The Ramillies began the attack, Despatch came forward--bold and black-- And none can tell what kept them back From setting fire to Stonington.

The bombardiers with bomb and ball, Soon made a farmer's barrack fall, And did a cow-house sadly maul That stood a mile from Stonington.

They kill'd a goose, they kill'd a hen, Three hogs they wounded in a pen-- They dash'd away, and pray what then? This was not taking Stonington.

The shells were thrown, the rockets flew, But not a shell, of all they threw, Though every house was full in view, Could burn a house at Stonington.

To have their turn they thought but fair;-- The Yankees brought two guns to bear, And, sir, it would have made you stare, This smoke of smokes at Stonington.

They bored Pactolus through and through, And kill'd and wounded of her crew So many, that she bade adieu T' the gallant boys of Stonington.

The brig Despatch was hull'd and torn-- So crippled, riddled, so forlorn, No more she cast an eye of scorn On the little fort at Stonington.

The Ramillies gave up th' affray, And, with her comrades, sneak'd away, Such was the valor, on that day, Of British tars near Stonington.

But some assert, on certain grounds (Besides the damage and the wounds), It cost the king ten thousand pounds To have a dash at Stonington.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

Occasionally, an American ship would manage to deal a telling blow. The Wasp, cruising in the English Channel, did especially effective work, among her most famous actions being that with the Avon on the night of September 1, 1814, in which, after a spirited fight, the Avon was sunk.

THE OCEAN-FIGHT

[September 1, 1814]

The sun had sunk beneath the west, When two proud barks to battle press'd, With swelling sail and streamers dress'd, So gallantly.

Proud Britain's pennon flouts the skies: Columbia's flag more proudly flies, Her emblem stars of victories Beam gloriously.

Sol's lingering rays, through vapors shed, Have streak'd the sky of bloody red, And now the ensanguined lustre spread Heaven's canopy.

Dread prelude to that awful night When Britain's and Columbia's might Join'd in the fierce and bloody fight, Hard rivalry.

Now, lowering o'er the stormy deep, Dank, sable clouds more threatening sweep: Yet still the barks their courses keep Unerringly.

The northern gales more fiercely blow, The white foam dashing o'er the prow; The starry crescent round each bow Beams vividly.

Near and more near the war-ships ride, Till, ranged for battle, side by side, Each warrior's heart beats high with pride Of chivalry.

'Twas awful, ere the fight begun, To see brave warriors round each gun, While thoughts on home and carnage run, Stand silently.

As death-like stillness reigns around, Nature seems wrapp'd in peace profound, Ere fires, volcanic, mountain bound, Burst furiously.

So, bursting from Columbia's prow, Her thunder on the red-cross foe, The lurid cloud's sulphuric glow Glares awfully.

Reëchoing peals more fiercely roar, Britannia's shatter'd sides run gore, The foaming waves that raged before, Sink, tremulous.

Columbia's last sulphuric blaze, That lights her stripes and starry rays, The vanquish'd red-cross flag betrays, Struck fearfully.

And, hark! their piercing shrieks of wo! Haste, haste and save the sinking foe: Haste, e'er their wreck to bottom go, Brave conquerors.

Now, honor to the warriors brave, Whose field of fame, the mountain wave, Their corses bear to ocean's cave, Their sepulchre.

Their country's pæans swell their praise; And whilst the warm tear, gushing, strays, Full many a bard shall chant his lays, Their requiem.

The Wasp herself never returned to port. On September 21 she captured the Atalanta and put a crew on board to take the prize to America. They parted company, and the Wasp was never seen again.

THE LOST WAR-SLOOP

(THE WASP, 1814)

O the pride of Portsmouth water, Toast of every brimming beaker,-- Eighteen hundred and fourteen on land and sea,-- Was the Wasp, the gallant war-sloop, Built of oaks Kearsarge had guarded, Pines of Maine to lift her colors high and free! Every timber scorning cowards; Every port alert for foemen From the masthead seen on weather-side or lee;-- With eleven guns to starboard, And eleven guns to larboard, All

for glory on a morn of May sailed she.

British ships were in the offing; Swift and light she sped between them,-- Well her daring crew knew shoal and wind and tide; They had come from Portsmouth river, Sea-girt Marblehead and Salem, Bays and islands where the fisher-folk abide; Come for love of home and country, Come with wrongs that cried for vengeance,-- Every man among them brave and true and tried. "Hearts of oak" are British seamen? Hearts of fire were these, their kindred, Flaming till the haughty foe should be descried!

From the mountains, from the prairies, Blew the west winds glad to waft her;-- Ah, what goodly ships before her guns went down! Ships with wealth of London laden, Ships with treasures of the Indies, Till her name brought fear to British wharf and town; Till the war-sloops Reindeer, Avon, To her valor struck their colors, Making coast and ocean ring with her renown; While her captain cried, exultant, "Britain, to the bold Republic, Of the empire of the seas shall yield the crown!"

Oh, the woful, woful ending Of the pride of Portsmouth water! Never more to harbor nor to shore came she! Springs returned but brought no tidings; Mothers, maidens, broken-hearted, Wept the gallant lads that sailed away in glee. Did the bolts of heaven blast her? Did the hurricanes o'erwhelm her With her starry banner and her tall masts three? Was a pirate-fleet her captor? Did she drift to polar oceans? Who shall tell the awful secret of the sea!

Who shall tell? yet many a sailor In his watch at dawn or midnight, When the wind is wildest and the black waves moan, Sees a stanch three-master looming; Hears the hurried call to quarters, The drum's quick beat and the bugle fiercely blown;-- Then the cannon's direful thunder Echoes far along the billows; Then the victor's shout for the foe overthrown;-- And the watcher knows the phantom Is the Wasp, the gallant war-sloop, Still a rover of the seas and glory's own!

EDNA DEAN PROCTOR.

The abdication of Napoleon enabled England to turn her undivided attention to the war with America, and a large body of troops was detailed for service here. Having lost control of Lake Erie and Lake Ontario, England determined to secure Lake Champlain and to invade New York by this route. A force of twelve thousand regulars, under General George Prevost, started from Montreal early in August, while the British naval force on the lake was augmented to nineteen vessels.

ON THE BRITISH INVASION

[1814]

From France, desponding and betray'd, From liberty in ruins laid, Exulting Britain has display'd Her flag, again to invade us.

Her myrmidons, with murdering eye, Across the broad Atlantic fly, Prepared again their strength to try, And strike our country's standard.

Lord Wellington's ten thousand slaves, And thrice ten thousand, on the waves, And thousands more of brags and braves Are under sail, and coming,

To burn our towns, to seize our soil, To change our laws, our country spoil, And Madison to Elba's isle To send without redemption.

In Boston state they hope to find A Yankee host of kindred mind, To aid their arms, to rise and bind Their countrymen in shackles.

But no such thing--it will not do-- At least, not while a Jersey Blue Is to the cause of freedom true, Or the bold Pennsylvanian.

A curse on England's frantic schemes! Both mad and blind, her monarch dreams Of crowns and kingdoms in these climes, Where kings have had their sentence.

Though Washington has left our coast, Yet other Washingtons we boast, Who rise, instructed by his ghost, To punish all invaders.

Go where they will, where'er they land, This pilfering, plundering, pirate band, They liberty will find at hand To hurl them to perdition!

If in Virginia they appear, Their fate is fix'd, their doom is near, Death in their front, and hell their rear; So says the gallant buckskin.

All Carolina is prepared, And Charleston doubly on her guard; Where, once, Sir Peter badly fared, So blasted by Fort Moultrie.

If farther south they turn their views, With veteran troops, or veteran crews, The curse of Heaven their march pursues, To send them all a-packing.

The tallest mast that sails the wave, The longest keel its waters lave, Will bring them to an early grave On the shores of Pensacola.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

The American commander on the lake was Thomas Macdonough, and by almost herculean efforts he managed to build and launch a ship, a schooner, and a number of gunboats, so that his total force was raised to fourteen sail. With this fleet, he proceeded to Plattsburg and anchored in Plattsburg Bay. On September 11 the British fleet, certain of victory, sailed in and attacked him, but was ignominiously defeated.

THE BATTLE OF LAKE CHAMPLAIN

[September 11, 1814]

Parading near Saint Peter's flood Full fourteen thousand soldiers stood; Allied with natives of the wood, With frigates, sloops, and galleys near; Which southward, now, began to steer; Their object was, Ticonderogue.

Assembled at Missisqui bay A feast they held, to hail the day, When all should bend to British sway From Plattsburgh to Ticonderogue.

And who could tell, if reaching there They might not other laurels share And England's flag in triumph bear To the capitol, at Albany!

Sir George advanced, with fire and sword, The frigates were with vengeance stored, The strength of Mars was felt on board,-- When Downie gave the dreadful word, Huzza! for death or victory!

Sir George beheld the prize at stake, And, with his veterans, made the attack, Macomb's brave legions drove him back; And England's fleet approached, to meet A desperate combat, on the lake.

From Isle La Motte to Saranac With sulphurous clouds the heavens were black; We saw advance the Confiance, Shall blood and carnage mark her track, To gain dominion on the lake.

Then on our ships she poured her flame, And many a tar did kill or maim, Who suffered for their country's fame, Her soil to save, her rights to guard.

Macdonough, now, began his play, And soon his seamen heard him say, "No Saratoga yields, this day, To all the force that Britain sends.

"Disperse, my lads, and man the waist, Be firm, and to your stations haste, And England from Champlain is chased, If you behave as you see me."

The fire began with awful roar; At our first flash the artillery tore, From his proud stand, their commodore, A presage of the victory.

The skies were hid in flame and smoke, Such thunders from the cannon spoke, The contest such an aspect took As if all nature went to wreck!

Amidst his decks, with slaughter strewed, Unmoved, the brave Macdonough stood, Or waded through a scene of blood, At every step that round him streamed:

He stood amidst Columbia's sons, He stood amidst dismounted guns, He fought amidst heart-rending groans, The tattered sail, the tottering mast.

Then, round about, his ship he wore, And charged his guns with vengeance sore, And more than Etna shook the shore-- The foe confessed the contest vain.

In vain they fought, in vain they sailed, That day; for Britain's fortune failed, And their best efforts naught availed To hold dominion on Champlain.

So, down their colors to the deck The vanquished struck--their ships a wreck-- What dismal tidings for Quebec, What news for England and her prince!

For, in this fleet, from England won, A favorite project is undone; Her sorrows only are begun-- And she may want, and very soon, Her armies for her own defence.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

THE BATTLE OF PLATTSBURG BAY

[September 11, 1814]

Plattsburg Bay! Plattsburg Bay! Blue and gold in the dawning ray, Crimson under the high noonday With the reek of the fray!

It was Thomas Macdonough, as gallant a sailor As ever went scurrying over the main; And he cried from his deck, _If they think I'm a quailer, And deem they can capture this Lake of Champlain, We'll show them they're not fighting France, sir, nor Spain_!

So from Cumberland Head to the little Crab Island He scattered his squadron in trim battle-line; And when he saw Downie come rounding the highland, He knelt him, beseeching for guidance divine, Imploring that Heaven would crown his design.

Then thundered the Eagle her lusty defiance; The stout Saratoga aroused with a roar; Soon gunboat and galley in hearty alliance Their resonant volley of compliments pour; And ever Macdonough's the man to the fore!

And lo, when the fight toward its fiercest was swirling, A game-cock, released by a splintering ball, Flew high in the ratlines, the smoke round him curling, And over the din gave his trumpeting call, An omen of ultimate triumph to all!

Then a valianter light touched the powder-grimed faces; Then faster the shot seemed to plunge from the gun; And we shattered their yards and we sundered their braces, And the fume of our cannon--it shrouded the sun; Cried Macdonough--_Once more, and the battle is won!_

Now, the flag of the haughty Confiance is trailing; The Linnet in woe staggers in toward the shore; The Finch is a wreck from her keel to her railing; The galleys flee fast to the strain of the oar; Macdonough! 'tis he is the man to the fore!

Oh, our main decks were grim and our gun decks were gory, And many a brave brow was pallid with pain; And while some won to death, yet we all won to glory Who fought with Macdonough that day on Champlain, And humbled her pride who is queen of the main!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

While the naval battle was in progress, Prevost made an assault on the American lines, but was repulsed with loss, and learning of the fleet's defeat, ordered a retreat. This was so precipitate that it was almost a flight, and great quantities of artillery, stores, and provisions fell into the hands of the Americans.

THE BATTLE OF PLATTSBURG

[September 11, 1814]

Sir George Prevost, with all his host, March'd forth from Montreal, sir, Both he and they as blithe and gay As going to a ball, sir. The troops he chose were all of those That conquer'd Marshall Soult, sir; Who at Garonne (the fact is known) Scarce brought they to a halt, sir.

With troops like these, he thought with ease To crush the Yankee faction: His only thought was how he ought To bring them into action. "Your very names," Sir George

exclaims, "Without a gun or bayonet, Will pierce like darts through Yankee hearts, And all their spirits stagnate.

"Oh! how I dread lest they have fled And left their puny fort, sir, For sure Macomb won't stay at home, T' afford us any sport, sir. Good-by!" he said to those that stay'd: "Keep close as mice or rats snug: We'll just run out upon a scout, To burn the town of Plattsburg."

Then up Champlain with might and main He marched in dress array, sir; With fife and drum to scare Macomb, And drive him quite away, sir. And, side by side, their nation's pride Along the current beat, sir: Sworn not to sup till they ate up McDonough and his fleet, sir.

Still onward came these men of fame, Resolved to give "no quarter:" But to their cost they found at last That they had caught a Tartar. At distant shot awhile they fought, By water and by land, sir: His knightship ran from man to man, And gave his dread command, sir.

"Britons, strike home! this dog Macomb-- So well the fellow knows us-- Will just as soon jump o'er the moon As venture to oppose us. With quick despatch light every match, Man every gun and swivel, Cross in a crack the Saranac, And drive 'em to the devil!"

The Vermont ranks that lined the banks, Then poised the unerring rifle, And to oppose their haughty foes They found a perfect trifle. Meanwhile the fort kept up such sport, They thought the devil was in it; Their mighty train play'd off in vain-- 'Twas silenced in a minute.

Sir George, amazed, so wildly gazed, Such frantic gambols acted, Of all his men, not one in ten But thought him quite distracted. He cursed and swore, his hair he tore, Then jump'd upon his pony, And gallop'd off towards the bluff, To look for Captain Downie.

But when he spied McDonough ride, In all the pomp of glory, He hasten'd back to Saranac, To tell the dismal story: "My gallant crews--Oh! shocking news-- Are all or killed or taken! Except a few that just withdrew In time to save their bacon.

"Old England's pride must now subside. Oh! how the news will shock her, To have her fleet not only beat, But sent to Davy's locker. From this sad day, let no one say Britannia rules the ocean: We've dearly bought the humbling thought, That this is all a notion.

"With one to ten I'd fight 'gainst men, But these are Satan's legions, With malice fraught, some piping hot From Pluto's darkest regions! Hélas! mon Dieu! what shall I do? I smell the burning sulphur-- Set Britain's isle all rank and file, Such men would soon engulf her.

"That's full as bad--Oh! I'll run mad! Those western hounds are summon'd; Gaines, Scott, and Brown are coming down, To serve me just like Drummond. Thick, too, as bees, the Vermontese Are swarming to the lake, sir; And Izard's men, come back again, Lie hid in every brake, sir.

"Good Brisbane, beat a quick retreat, Before their forces join, sir: For, sure as fate, they've laid a bait To catch us like Burgoyne, sir. All round about, keep good look out: We'll surely be surrounded; Since I could crawl, my gallant soul Was never so astounded."

The rout begun, Sir George led on, His men ran helter skelter, Each tried his best t' outrun the rest To gain a place of shelter; To hide their fear, they gave a cheer, And thought it mighty cunning-- He'll fight, they say, another day, Who saves himself by running!

Although the blow at New York had been turned aside, another, aimed at the Nation's Capital, fell with deadly effect. On August 24, 1814, a strong force landed in Chesapeake Bay, routed a force of militia at Bladensburg, entered Washington, and burned the Capitol, White House, and many other public buildings. A few days later, Baltimore was attacked.

THE BATTLE OF BALTIMORE

[September 12, 1814]

Old Ross, Cockburn, and Cochrane too, And many a bloody villain more, Swore with their bloody savage crew, That they would plunder Baltimore. But General Winder being afraid That his militia would not stand, He sent away to crave the aid Of a few true Virginians. Then up we rose with hearts elate, To help our suffering sister state.

When first our orders we received, For to prepare without delay, Our wives and sweethearts for to leave, And to the army march away, Although it grieved our hearts full sore, To leave our sweet Virginia shore, We kiss'd our sweethearts o'er and o'er, And march'd like true Virginians. Adieu awhile, sweet girls, adieu, With honor we'll return to you.

With rapid marches on we went, To leave our sweet Virginia shore, No halt was made, no time was spent, Till we arrived at Baltimore. The Baltimoreans did us greet, The ladies clapt their lily-white hands, Exclaiming as we passed the street, "Welcome, ye brave Virginians. May Heaven all your foes confound, And send you home with laurels crown'd."

We had not been in quarters long, Before we heard the dread alarms, The cannon roar'd, the bells did ring, The drum did beat to arms, to arms. Then up we rose to face our foes, Determined to meet them on the strand, And drive them back from fair Freedom's shore, Or die like brave Virginians. In Heaven above we placed our trust, Well knowing that our cause is just.

Then Ross he landed at North Point, With seven thousand men or more, And swore by that time next night, That he would be in Baltimore. But Striker met him on the strand, Attended by a chosen band, Where he received a fatal shot From a brave Pennsylvanian-- Whom Heaven directed to the field, To make this haughty Briton yield.

Then Cockburn he drew up his fleet, To bombard Fort McHenry, A thinking that our men, of course, Would take affright and run away. The fort was commanded by a patriotic band, As ever graced fair Freedom's land, And he who did the fort command Was a true blue Virginian. Long may we have brave Armstead's name Recorded on the book of fame.

A day and a night they tried their might, But found their bombs did not prevail, And seeing their army put to flight, They weigh'd their anchor and made sail, Resolving to return again, To execute their former plan; But if they do, they'll find us still That we are brave Virginians. And they shall know before they've done, That they are not in Washington.

But now their shipping's out of sight, And each man takes a parting glass, Drinks to his true love and heart's delight, His only joy and bosom friend, For I might as well drink a health, For I hate to see good liquor stand, That America may always boast That we are brave Virginians.

The next day, Admiral Cochrane moved his fleet into position to attack Fort McHenry, two miles above the city, and began a terrific bombardment, which lasted all the night. The fort answered with such guns as would reach the ships, and when morning dawned, the Stars and Stripes were still floating over it. The British feared to attack an intrenchment so gallantly defended, and the next day retreated to their shipping.

FORT McHENRY

[September 13, 1814]

Thy blue waves, Patapsco, flow'd soft and serene, Thy hills and thy valleys were cheerful and gay, While the day-star of Peace shed its beams on the scene, And youth, love, and beauty reflected its ray.

Where white-bosom'd commerce late reign'd o'er thy tide, And zephyrs of gladness expanded each sail, I saw hostile squadrons in dread array ride, While their thunders reëchoed o'er hill and o'er vale.

But our heroes, thy sons, proud in panoply rose, For their homes,--for their altars,--to conquer or die; With the lightning of freedom encounter'd their foes; Taught the veteran to tremble,--the valiant to fly.

Now, how tranquil thy scenes when the clangors of war Late broke the soft dreams of the fair and the young! To the tombs of thy heroes shall beauty repair, And their deeds by our bards shall forever be sung.

On the iron-crown'd fortress "that frowns o'er thy flood," And tells the sad fate of the gay and the brave, In mournful reflection Eliza late stood, And paid a soft tribute--a tear on their grave.

To the manes of the fallen, oh! how grateful that tear! Far sweeter to me than the Spring's richest bloom: Such rewards light the fire of Chivalry here, And when the brave fall--ever hallow their tomb.

Just before the bombardment began, Francis Scott Key had put out to the admiral's frigate to arrange for an exchange of prisoners, and was directed to remain till the action was over. All that night he watched the flaming shells, and when, by the first rays of the morning, he saw his country's flag still waving above the fort, he hastily wrote the stirring verses which have since become America's national song.

THE STAR-SPANGLED BANNER

[September 13, 1814]

O say, can you see, by the dawn's early light, What so proudly we hailed at the twilight's last gleaming? Whose broad stripes and bright stars, through the perilous fight, O'er the ramparts we watched were so gallantly streaming! And the rocket's red glare, the bombs bursting in air, Gave proof through the night that our flag was still there: O say, does that star-spangled banner yet wave O'er the land of the free and the home of the brave?

On the shore, dimly seen through the mists of the deep, Where the foe's haughty host in dread silence reposes, What is that which the breeze, o'er the towering steep, As it fitfully blows, now conceals, now discloses? Now it catches the gleam of the morning's first beam, In full glory reflected now shines on the stream: 'Tis the star-spangled banner! O long may it wave O'er the land of the free and the home of the brave!

And where is that band who so vauntingly swore That the havoc of war and the battle's confusion A home and a country should leave us no more? Their blood has washed out their foul footsteps' pollution. No refuge could save the hireling and slave From the terror of flight, or the gloom of the grave: And the star-spangled banner in triumph doth wave O'er the land of the free and the home of the brave!

Oh! thus be it ever, when freemen shall stand Between their loved homes and the war's desolation! Blest with victory and peace, may the heaven-rescued land Praise the Power that hath made and preserved us a nation. Then conquer we must, for our cause it is just, And this be our motto: "In God is our trust." And the star-spangled banner in triumph shall wave O'er the land of the free and the home of the brave.

FRANCIS SCOTT KEY.

The destruction of Washington, besides being perhaps the most outrageous act of vandalism ever committed by a Christian army, was a grave tactical error. One feeling of wrath and cry for vengeance swept the land; party differences were forgotten, and the whole country pressed forward to prosecute the war with an enthusiasm and vigor which had before been sadly wanting.

YE PARLIAMENT OF ENGLAND

Ye parliament of England, You lords and commons, too, Consider well what you're about, And what you're going to do; You're now to fight with Yankees, I'm sure you'll rue the day You roused the sons of liberty, In North America.

You first confined our commerce, And said our ships shan't trade, You next impressed our seamen, And used them as your slaves; You then insulted Rogers, While ploughing o'er the main, And had not we declarèd war, You'd have done it o'er again.

You thought our frigates were but few And Yankees could not fight, Until brave Hull your Guerrière took And banished her from your sight. The Wasp then took your Frolic, We'll nothing say to that, The Poictiers being of the line, Of course she took her back.

The next, your Macedonian, No finer ship could swim, Decatur took her gilt-work off, And then he sent her in. The Java, by a Yankee ship Was sunk, you all must know; The Peacock fine, in all her plume, By Lawrence down did go.

Then next you sent your Boxer, To box us all about, But we had an Enterprising brig That beat your Boxer out; We boxed her up to Portland, And moored her off the town, To show the sons of liberty The Boxer of renown.

The next upon Lake Erie, Where Perry had some fun, You own he beat your naval force, And caused them for to run; This was to you a sore defeat, The like ne'er known before-- Your British squadron beat complete-- Some took, some run ashore.

There's Rogers in the President, Will burn, sink, and destroy; The Congress, on the Brazil coast, Your commerce will annoy; The Essex, in the South Seas, Will put out all your lights, The flag she waves at her mast-head-- "Free Trade and Sailor's Rights."

Lament, ye sons of Britain, Far distant is the day, When you'll regain by British force What you've lost in America; Go tell your king and parliament, By all the world 'tis known, That British force, by sea and land, By Yankees is o'erthrown.

Use every endeavor, And strive to make a peace, For Yankee ships are building fast, Their navy to increase; They will enforce their commerce, The laws by heaven are made, That Yankee ships in time of peace To any port may trade.

Nor was the outrage universally applauded, even in England. An anti-war party had arisen there, and was constantly growing in strength.

THE BOWER OF PEACE

From "Ode Written during the War with America, 1814"

When shall the Island Queen of Ocean lay The thunderbolt aside, And, twining olives with her laurel crown, Rest in the Bower of Peace?

Not long may this unnatural strife endure Beyond the Atlantic deep; Not long may men, with vain ambition drunk, And insolent in wrong, Afflict with their misrule the indignant land Where Washington hath left His awful memory A light for after-times! Vile instruments of fallen Tyranny In their own annals, by their countrymen. For lasting shame shall they be written down. Soon may the better Genius there prevail! Then will the Island Queen of Ocean lay The thunderbolt aside, And, twining olives with her laurel crown, Rest in the Bower of Peace.

ROBERT SOUTHEY.

One of the most remarkable naval battles of the war occurred on September 26, 1814, in Fayal Roads. The General Armstrong, the famous privateer schooner, Captain Samuel Chester Reid, had anchored there, trusting to the neutrality of the harbor, and was attacked after nightfall by the boats of a strong British squadron. A fearful struggle followed, the British being finally beaten off.

REID AT FAYAL

[September 26, 1814]

A cliff-locked port and a bluff sea wall, And a craggy rampart, brown and bold; Proud Pico's bastions towering tall, And a castle dumb and cold.

The scream of a gull where a porpoise rolls; And the flash of a home-bound fisher's blade, Where the ghostly boom of the drum fish tolls For wrecks that the surf has made.

A grim dun ridge, and a thin gray beach, And the swish and the swash of the sleepless tide; And the moonlight masking the reef's long reach, Where the lurking breakers bide.

And under the castle's senseless walls (Santa Cruz, old and cold and dumb), Where only the prying sea-mew calls, And the harbor beetles hum,

A Yankee craft at her cable swings: "All's well!" the cheery lookout sings. But the skipper counts his sleeping crew, His guns, and his drowsy ensign, too. --Says he, "They'll do!"

For the skipper marks, tho' he makes no sign, Frigate and corvette and ship of the line, Rounding the headland into the light: "Three Union Jacks and a moonlight night!" --Says he, "We'll fight!"

Twelve launches cutting the silver bay; Twenty score boarders called away. And it's "Lively, hearties, and let her go!" With a rouse and a cheer and a "Yeo, ho, ho!" --Says Reid, "Lie low!"

'Tis a song of havoc the rowlocks sing, And Death marks time in the rower's swing; 'Tis a baleful glow on the spouting spray, As the keels in their cruel lust make way. "Now, up and slay!"

Now up and play in the mad old game-- Axe and cutlass, fury and flame! White breasts red-wat in the viler muck, Proud hearts hurled back in the sprawling ruck. --Says Reid, "Well struck!"

Pike and pistol and dripping blade (So are the ghosts and the glory made); A curse for a groan, and a cheer for a yell; Pale glut of Hate and red rapture of Hell! --Says Reid, "All's well!"

All's well for the banner that dances free, Where the mountains are shouting the news to the sea. All's well for the bold, and all's ill for the strong, In the fight and the

flight that shall hold us long, In tale and song.

JOHN WILLIAMSON PALMER.

THE FIGHT OF THE ARMSTRONG PRIVATEER

Tell the story to your sons Of the gallant days of yore, When the brig of seven guns Fought the fleet of seven score, From the set of sun till morn, through the long September night-- Ninety men against two thousand, and the ninety won the fight In the harbor of Fayal the Azore.

Three lofty British ships came a-sailing to Fayal: One was a line-of-battle ship, and two were frigates tall; Nelson's valiant men of war, brave as Britons ever are, Manned the guns they served so well at Aboukir and Trafalgar. Lord Dundonald and his fleet at Jamaica far away Waited eager for their coming, fretted sore at their delay. There was loot for British valor on the Mississippi coast In the beauty and the booty that the Creole cities boast; There were rebel knaves to swing, there were prisoners to bring Home in fetters to old England for the glory of the King!

At the setting of the sun and the ebbing of the tide Came the great ships one by one, with their portals opened wide, And their cannon frowning down on the castle and the town And the privateer that lay close inside; Came the eighteen-gun Carnation, and the Rota, forty-four, And the triple-decked Plantagenet an Admiral's pennon bore: And the privateer grew smaller as their topmasts towered taller, And she bent her springs and anchored by the castle on the shore.

Spoke the noble Portuguese to the stranger: "Have no fear; They are neutral waters these, and your ship is sacred here As if fifty stout armadas to shelter you from harm, For the honor of the Briton will defend you from his arm." But the privateersman said, "Well we know the Englishmen, And their faith is written red in the Dartmoor slaughter-pen. Come what fortune God may send, we will fight them to the end, And the mercy of the sharks may spare us then."

"Seize the pirate where she lies!" cried the English Admiral: "If the Portuguese protect her, all the wors for Portugal!" And four launches at his bidding leaped impatient for the fray, Speeding shoreward where the Armstrong, grim and dark and ready, lay. Twice she hailed and gave them warning; but the feeble menace scorning, On they came in splendid silence, till a cable's length away. Then the Yankee pivot spoke; Pico's thousand echoes woke; And four baffled, beaten launches drifted helpless on the bay.

Then the wrath of Lloyd arose till the lion roared again, And he called out all his launches and he called five hundred men; And he gave the word "No quarter!" and he sent them forth to smite. Heaven help the foe before him when the Briton comes in might! Heaven helped the little Armstrong in her hour of bitter need; God Almighty nerved the heart and guided well the arm of Reid.

Launches to port and starboard, launches forward and aft, Fourteen launches together striking the little craft. They hacked at the boarding-nettings, they swarmed above the rail; But the Long Tom roared from his pivot and the grape-shot fell like

hail; Pike and pistol and cutlass, and hearts that knew not fear, Bulwarks of brawn and mettle, guarded the privateer. And ever where fight was fiercest the form of Reid was seen: Ever where foes drew nearest, his quick sword fell between. Once in the deadly strife The boarder's leader pressed Forward of all the rest Challenging life for life; But ere their blades had crossed A dying sailor tossed His pistol to Reid, and cried, "Now riddle the lubber's hide!" But the privateersman laughed, and flung the weapon aside, And he drove his blade to the hilt, and the foeman gasped and died. Then the boarders took to their launches, laden with hurt and dead, But little with glory burdened, and out of the battle fled.

Now the tide was at flood again, and the night was almost done, When the sloop-of-war came up with her odds of two to one, And she opened fire; but the Armstrong answered her, gun for gun, And the gay Carnation wilted in half an hour of sun.

Then the Armstrong, looking seaward, saw the mighty seventy-four, With her triple tier of cannon, drawing slowly to the shore. And the dauntless captain said: "Take our wounded and our dead, Bear them tenderly to land, for the Armstrong's days are o'er; But no foe shall tread her deck, and no flag above it wave-- To the ship that saved our honor we will give a shipman's grave." So they did as he commanded, and they bore their mates to land With the figurehead of Armstrong and the good sword in his hand. Then they turned the Long Tom downward, and they pierced her oaken side, And they cheered her, and they blessed her, and they sunk her in the tide.

Tell the story to your sons, When the haughty stranger boasts Of his mighty ships and guns And the muster of his hosts, How the word of God was witnessed in the gallant days of yore When the twenty fled from one ere the rising of the sun, In the harbor of Fayal the Azore!

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

Three boats, loaded with dead and dying, were captured by the Americans, the survivors having escaped by jumping overboard and swimming ashore. At daybreak the whole British fleet moved in to attack, and Captain Reid was forced to scuttle his ship and abandon her.

THE ARMSTRONG AT FAYAL

[September 26, 1814]

Oh, the sun sets red, the moon shines white, And blue is Fayal's clear sky; The sun and moon and sky are bright, And the sea, and stars on high; But the name of Reid and the fame of Reid And the flag of his ship and crew Are brighter far than sea or star Or the heavens' red, white, and blue: So lift your voices once again For the land we love so dear, For the fighting Captain and the men Of the Yankee Privateer!

The moonbeams, like fine silver, shine Upon the blue Azores, As twilight pours her purple wine Upon those storied shores; The General Armstrong's flag of stars In the harbor of Fayal Flies forth, remote from thought of wars, Until the sunset call.

No glistening guns in serried line The slender schooner boasts, A pivot and eight hearty nines Shall meet her foeman's hosts; Her sides are oak, her masts are tall, Her captain's one to trust, Her ninety men are free men all, Her quarrel wholly just.

On far Fayal the moon is fair To-night as it was when, Glad in the gay September air, Reid laughed beside his men; On far Fayal the sun to-day Was lord of all the sky As when the General Armstrong lay, Our banner flung on high; But now there rests a holier light Than theirs on land or sea: The splendor of our sailors' might, And glorious bravery.

A moment, and the flag will sink As sinks the sun to rest Beyond the billows' western brink Where towers the Eagle's nest, When round the azure harbor-head Where sparkling ocean brims, Her British ensign streaming red, The brig Carnation swims.

Ere with the sun her sails are set The Rota frigate glides And the great ship Plantagenet To stations at her sides: They carry six score guns and ten, They serve the British crown, They muster o'er a thousand men-- To win were small renown.

'Twas by Fayal, where Portugal Still flaunts her Blue-and-White; What cares their Floyd for Portugal Or what cares he for right? He starts his signals down the line-- Our flag is flying free-- His weapons in the moonbeams shine, His boats drop on the sea. Straight to the Armstrong swift they come. _Speak, or I fire!_ shouts Reid-- Their rattling rowlocks louder hum To mark their heightened speed.

Fierce o'er their moonlit path there stream Bright glares of crimson flame; Our muskets but an instant gleam, Yet leave them wounded, lame. They try a feeble, brief reply Ere back their course is sped. Before our marksmanship they fly, Their living with their dead.

Floyd swears upon his faith and all The Armstrong shall be his; He scorns rebuke from Portugal, But not such enemies; So guns are charged with canister And picked men go to fight: Brave hearts and doomed full many were In the Azores that night.

From nine until the nick of twelve Their boats are seen to throng Where rocky islets slant and shelve Safe from our bullets' song; Then out they dash, their small arms flash, While blare their carronades, Their boarding-pikes and axes clash, Their guns and cutlass blades. Our Long Tom speaks, our shrapnel shrieks; But ere we load again, On every side the battle reeks Of thrice a hundred men.

Our rail is low, and there the foe Cling as they shoot and hack. We stab them as they climb a-row, Slaying, nor turning back. They dash up now upon our bow, And there our hearties haste; Now at our stern their muskets burn, And now along our waist.

Our fo'c'sle weeps when Williams dies, When Worth falls in his blood, But bleeding through the battle-cries Our gallant Johnson stood; The British muskets snapt and spat Till Reid came in his wrath, His brow so pale with purpose that It glistened down his path.

Forth from the quarter-deck he springs, He and his men with cheers; On British skulls his cutlass rings, His pistols in their ears; His men beside him hold him good Till spent the foeman's breath; Where at our sides a Briton stood, A Briton sank in death; Though weak our men with blood and sweat, Our sides a riddled wreck, Yet ne'er a British foot is set Upon the Armstrong's deck.

Three hundred men their Admiral sent Our schooner's ways to mend: A hundred British sailors went Down to a warrior's end. Two of our lads in death are red, But safe the flag above: God grant that never worse be sped The fray for all we love!

The General Armstrong lies beneath The waves in far Fayal, But still his countrymen shall wreathe Reid's name with laurels tall; The sun and moon are fair to see Above the blue Azores, But fairer far Reid's victory Beside their storied shores.

Oh, the sun sets red, the moon shines white, And blue is Fayal's clear sky; The sun and moon and sky are bright, And the sea, and stars on high; But the name of Reid and the fame of Reid And the flag of his ship and crew Are brighter far than sea or star Or the heavens' red, white, and blue: So lift your voices once again For the land we love so dear, For the fighting Captain and the men Of the Yankee Privateer.

WALLACE RICE.

Major-General Andrew Jackson had been intrusted with the task of defending the South, and especially New Orleans, from the expected British invasion. On September 15, 1814, a British fleet and land force invested Fort Bowyer, which commanded the entrance to Mobile, but were beaten off and forced to retire, after a desperate struggle, in which one of the British ships was blown up.

FORT BOWYER

[September 15, 1814]

Where the wild wave, from ocean proudly swelling, Mexico's shores, wide stretching, with its billowy Surge, in its sweep laves, and, with lashing foam, breaks, Rough in its whiteness;

See where the flag of Freedom, with its light wreaths, Floats on the wind, in buoyancy expanded High o'er the walls of Bowyer's dauntless breastwork, Proudly and fearless.

Loud roll thy thunders, Albion; and thy missile Boasts throng the air with lightning flash tremendous, Whilst the dark wave, illuminated bright, shines Sparkling with death-lights.

Shrink then that band of freemen, at the onslaught? Palsy those arms that wield the unerring rifles? Strikes chill the breast dread fear? or coward paleness Whiten the blanch'd cheek?

No! round that flag, undaunted, midst the loud din, Like their own shores, which mountain surges move not Breasted and firm, and heedless of the war-shock, Rallying they stand fast.

"Look," Lawrence cries, "brave comrades; how the foe proud Quails at our charge, with recreant spirit flying:" Like Rome's bold chief, he came and saw, but neither Awed us, nor conquer'd.

CHARLES L. S. JONES.

Jackson hastened to New Orleans, and reached there just as a great British fleet appeared in the offing. He determined to attack the enemy as soon as they started to land, and on the night of December 23 he drove in their advance guard. Then he intrenched his little army, and on January 8, 1815, was attacked by the full British force, seven thousand strong. Their advance was checked by the steady fire of Jackson's riflemen, and the enemy was finally routed with a loss of over two thousand. The American loss was eight killed and thirteen wounded.

THE BATTLE OF NEW ORLEANS

[January 8, 1815]

Here, in my rude log cabin, Few poorer men there be Among the mountain ranges Of Eastern Tennessee. My limbs are weak and shrunken, White hairs upon my brow, My dog--lie still old fellow!-- My sole companion now. Yet I, when young and lusty, Have gone through stirring scenes, For I went down with Carroll To fight at New Orleans.

You say you'd like to hear me The stirring story tell, Of those who stood the battle And those who fighting fell. Short work to count our losses-- We stood and dropped the foe As easily as by firelight Men shoot the buck or doe. And while they fell by hundreds Upon the bloody plain, Of us, fourteen were wounded And only eight were slain.

The eighth of January, Before the break of day, Our raw and hasty levies Were brought into array. No cotton-bales before us-- Some fool that falsehood told; Before us was an earthwork Built from the swampy mould And there we stood in silence, And waited with a frown. To greet with bloody welcome The bull-dogs of the Crown.

The heavy fog of morning Still hid the plain from sight, When came a thread of scarlet Marked faintly in the white. We fired a single cannon, And as its thunders rolled, The mist before us lifted In many a heavy fold-- The mist before us lifted And in their bravery fine Came rushing to their ruin The fearless British line.

Then from our waiting cannon Leaped forth the deadly flame, To meet the advancing columns That swift and steady came. The thirty-twos of Crowley And Bluchi's twenty-four To Spotts's eighteen-pounders Responded with their roar, Sending the grape-shot deadly That marked its pathway plain, And paved the road it travelled With corpses of the slain.

Our rifles firmly grasping, And heedless of the din, We stood in silence waiting For orders to begin. Our fingers on the triggers, Our hearts, with anger stirred, Grew still more fierce and eager As Jackson's voice was heard: "Stand steady! Waste no powder! Wait till your shots will tell! To-day the work you finish-- See that you do it

well!"

Their columns drawing nearer, We felt our patience tire, When came the voice of Carroll, Distinct and measured, "Fire!" Oh! then you should have marked us Our volleys on them pour-- Have heard our joyous rifles Ring sharply through the roar, And seen their foremost columns Melt hastily away As snow in mountain gorges Before the floods of May.

They soon re-formed their columns, And, mid the fatal rain We never ceased to hurtle, Came to their work again. The Forty-fourth is with them, That first its laurels won With stout old Abercrombie Beneath an eastern sun. It rushes to the battle, And, though within the rear Its leader is a laggard, It shows no signs of fear.

It did not need its colonel, For soon there came instead An eagle-eyed commander, And on its march he led. 'Twas Pakenham in person, The leader of the field; I knew it by the cheering That loudly round him pealed; And by his quick, sharp movement We felt his heart was stirred, As when at Salamanca He led the fighting Third.

I raised my rifle quickly, I sighted at his breast, God save the gallant leader And take him to his rest! I did not draw the trigger, I could not for my life. So calm he sat his charger Amid the deadly strife, That in my fiercest moment A prayer arose from me-- God save that gallant leader, Our foeman though he be!

Sir Edward's charger staggers; He leaps at once to ground. And ere the beast falls bleeding Another horse is found. His right arm falls--'tis wounded; He waves on high his left; In vain he leads the movement, The ranks in twain are cleft. The men in scarlet waver Before the men in brown, And fly in utter panic-- The soldiers of the Crown!

I thought the work was over, But nearer shouts were heard, And came, with Gibbs to head it, The gallant Ninety-third. Then Pakenham, exulting, With proud and joyous glance, Cried, "Children of the tartan-- Bold Highlanders--advance! Advance to scale the breastworks, And drive them from their hold, And show the stainless courage That marked your sires of old!"

His voice as yet was ringing, When, quick as light, there came The roaring of a cannon, And earth seemed all aflame. Who causes thus the thunder The doom of men to speak? It is the Baratarian, The fearless Dominique. Down through the marshalled Scotsmen The step of death is heard, And by the fierce tornado Falls half the Ninety-third.

The smoke passed slowly upward And, as it soared on high, I saw the brave commander In dying anguish lie. They bear him from the battle Who never fled the foe; Unmoved by death around them His bearers softly go. In vain their care, so gentle, Fades earth and all its scenes; The man of Salamanca Lies dead at New Orleans.

But where were his lieutenants? Had they in terror fled? No! Keane was sorely wounded And Gibbs as good as dead. Brave Wilkinson commanding, A major of brigade, The shattered force to rally A final effort made. He led it up our ramparts, Small glory did he gain-- Our captives some; some slaughtered, And he himself was

slain.

The stormers had retreated, The bloody work was o'er; The feet of the invaders Were soon to leave our shore. We rested on our rifles And talked about the fight, When came a sudden murmur Like fire from left to right; We turned and saw our chieftain, And then, good friend of mine, You should have heard the cheering That rang along the line.

For well our men remembered How little, when they came, Had they but native courage, And trust in Jackson's name; How through the day he labored, How kept the vigils still, Till discipline controlled us-- A stronger power than will; And how he hurled us at them Within the evening hour, That red night in December And made us feel our power.

In answer to our shouting Fire lit his eye of gray; Erect, but thin and pallid, He passed upon his bay. Weak from the baffled fever, And shrunken in each limb, The swamps of Alabama Had done their work on him; But spite of that and fasting, And hours of sleepless care, The soul of Andrew Jackson Shone forth in glory there.

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

JACKSON AT NEW ORLEANS

Hear through the morning drums and trumpets sounding, Rumbling of cannon, tramp of mighty armies; Then the mist sunders, all the plain disclosing Scarlet for England.

Batteries roll on, halt, and flashing lightnings Search out our earthworks, silent and portentous. Fierce on our right with crimson banners tossing Their lines spring forward.

Lanyards in hand, Americans and seamen, Gunners from warships, Lafitte's privateers-men, Roar out our thunders till the grape and shrapnel Shriek through their columns.

Shattered in fragments, thus their right is riven; But on our left a deadlier bolt is speeding: Wellesley's Peninsulars, never yet defeated, Charge in their valor.

Closing their files, our cannon fire disdaining, Dauntless they come with vict'ry on their standards; Then slowly rise the rifles of our marksmen, Tennessee hunters.

Cradles of flame and scythes of whistling bullets Lay them in windrows, war's infernal harvest. High through the onslaught Tennessee is shouting, Joying in battle.

Pakenham falls there, Keane and his Highlanders Close from the centre, hopeless in their courage; Backward they stagger, dying and disabled, Gloriously routed.

Stilled are our rifles as our cheers grow louder: War clouds sweep back in January breezes, Showing the dreadful proof of the great triumph God hath vouchsafed us.

That gallant war-host, England's best and bravest, Met by raw levies, scores against its hundreds, Lies at our feet, a thing for woman's weeping, Reddening the meadows.

Freed are our States from European tyrants: Lift then your voices for the little army Led by our battle-loving Andrew Jackson, Blest of Jehovah.

WALLACE RICE.

The British were permitted to retire unmolested to their ships, and the sails of that mighty fleet were soon fading away along the horizon. Neither victor nor vanquished knew that a treaty of peace had been signed at Ghent two weeks before, and that the battle need never have been fought.

TO THE DEFENDERS OF NEW ORLEANS

Hail sons of generous valor, Who now embattled stand, To wield the brand of strife and blood, For Freedom and the land. And hail to him your laurelled chief, Around whose trophied name A nation's gratitude has twined The wreath of deathless fame.

Now round that gallant leader Your iron phalanx form, And throw, like Ocean's barrier rocks, Your bosoms to the storm. Though wild as Ocean's wave it rolls, Its fury shall be low, For justice guides the warrior's steel, And vengeance strikes the blow.

High o'er the gleaming columns, The bannered star appears, And proud amid its martial band, His crest the eagle rears. And long as patriot valor's arm Shall win the battle's prize, That star shall beam triumphantly, That eagle seek the skies.

Then on, ye daring spirits, To danger's tumults now, The bowl is filled and wreathed the crown, To grace the victor's brow; And they who for their country die, Shall fill an honored grave; For glory lights the soldier's tomb, And beauty weeps the brave.

JOSEPH RODMAN DRAKE.

Prominent among the forces under Jackson was a brigade of eight hundred Kentucky riflemen, commanded by General John Coffee. They had marched eight hundred miles through a wilderness, having covered the last hundred miles in less than two days--a march almost unequalled in history. Jackson spoke of this brigade as the right arm of his army.

THE HUNTERS OF KENTUCKY

Ye gentlemen and ladies fair, Who grace this famous city, Just listen, if you've time to spare, While I rehearse a ditty; And for the opportunity Conceive yourselves quite lucky, For 'tis but seldom that you see A hunter from Kentucky. Oh! Kentucky, The hunters of Kentucky.

We are a hardy free-born race, Each man to fear a stranger; Whate'er the game, we join in chase, Despising toil and danger: And if a daring foe annoys, Whate'er his strength or force is, We'll show him that Kentucky boys Are Alligator-horses.

I s'pose you've read it in the prints, How Pakenham attempted To make old Hickory Jackson wince, But soon his schemes repented; For we, with rifles ready cock'd, Thought such occasion lucky, And soon around the general flock'd The

hunters of Kentucky.

I s'pose you've heard how New Orleans Is famed for wealth and beauty; They've gals of every hue, it seems, From snowy white to sooty: So Pakenham he made his brags If he in fight was lucky, He'd have their gals and cotton bags, In spite of Old Kentucky.

But Jackson he was wide awake, And wasn't scared at trifles, For well he knew what aim we take With our Kentucky rifles; So he led us down to Cypress Swamp, The ground was low and mucky; There stood John Bull in martial pomp-- But here was Old Kentucky.

We raised a bank to hide our breasts, Not that we thought of dying, But then we always like to rest, Unless the game is flying: Behind it stood our little force-- None wish'd it to be greater, For every man was half a horse And half an alligator.

They didn't let our patience tire Before they show'd their faces; We didn't choose to waste our fire, But snugly kept our places; And when so near we saw them wink, We thought it time to stop 'em, It would have done you good, I think, To see Kentuckians drop 'em.

They found, at length, 'twas vain to fight, When lead was all their booty, And so they wisely took to flight, And left us all the beauty. And now, if danger e'er annoys, Remember what our trade is; Just send for us Kentucky boys, And we'll protect you, ladies: Oh! Kentucky, The hunters of Kentucky.

Another useless action, but a most remarkable one, was fought by the famous old Constitution, near Madeira, on February 20, 1815. On the afternoon of that day she sighted and overhauled the British 32-gun frigate Cyane and the 20-gun sloop Levant. She attacked them simultaneously, and after a fierce fight compelled them both to surrender.

THE CONSTITUTION'S LAST FIGHT

[February 20, 1815]

A Yankee ship and a Yankee crew-- Constitution, where ye bound for? Wherever, my lad, there's fight to be had Acrost the Western ocean.

Our captain was married in Boston town And sailed next day to sea; For all must go when the State says so; Blow high, blow low, sailed we.

"Now, what shall I bring for a bridal gift When my home-bound pennant flies? The rarest that be on land or sea It shall be my lady's prize."

"There's never a prize on sea or land Could bring such joy to me As my true love sound and homeward bound With a king's ship under his lee."

The Western ocean is wide and deep, And wild its tempests blow, But bravely rides "Old Ironsides," A-cruising to and fro.

We cruised to the east and we cruised to north, And southing far went we, And at last off Cape de Verd we raised Two frigates sailing free.

Oh, God made man, and man made ships, But God makes very few Like him who sailed our ship that day, And fought her, one to two.

He gained the weather-gage of both, He held them both a-lee; And gun for gun, till set of sun, He spoke them fair and free;

Till the night-fog fell on spar and sail, And ship, and sea, and shore, And our only aim was the bursting flame And the hidden cannon's roar.

Then a long rift in the mist showed up The stout Cyane, close-hauled To swing in our wake and our quarter rake, And a boasting Briton bawled:

"Starboard and larboard, we've got him fast Where his heels won't take him through; Let him luff or wear, he'll find us there,-- Ho, Yankee, which will you do?"

We did not luff and we did not wear, But braced our topsails back, Till the sternway drew us fair and true Broadsides athwart her track.

Athwart her track and across her bows We raked her fore and aft, And out of the fight and into the night Drifted the beaten craft.

The slow Levant came up too late; No need had we to stir; Her decks we swept with fire, and kept The flies from troubling her.

We raked her again, and her flag came down,-- The haughtiest flag that floats,-- And the lime-juice dogs lay there like logs, With never a bark in their throats.

With never a bark and never a bite, But only an oath to break, As we squared away for Praya Bay With our prizes in our wake.

Parole they gave and parole they broke, What matters the cowardly cheat, If the captain's bride was satisfied With the one prize laid at her feet?

A Yankee ship and a Yankee crew-- Constitution, where ye bound for? Wherever the British prizes be, Though it's one to two, or one to three,-- "Old Ironsides" means victory, Acrost the Western ocean.

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

News of the peace did not reach America until February 11, 1815. It was hailed with rejoicing everywhere.

SEA AND LAND VICTORIES

With half the Western world at stake, See Perry on the midland lake, The unequal combat dare; Unawed by vastly stronger pow'rs, He met the foe and made him ours, And closed the savage war.

Macdonough, too, on Lake Champlain, In ships outnumbered, guns, and men, Saw dangers thick increase; His trust in God and virtue's cause He conquer'd in the lion's jaws, And led the way to peace.

To sing each valiant hero's name Whose deeds have swelled the files of fame, Requires immortal powers; Columbia's warriors never yield To equal force by sea or field, Her eagle never cowers.

Long as Niagara's cataract roars Or Erie laves our Northern shores, Great Brown, thy fame shall rise; Outnumber'd by a veteran host Of conquering heroes, Britain's boast-- Conquest was there thy prize.

At Plattsburg, see the Spartan band, Where gallant Macomb held command, The unequal host oppose; Provost confounded, vanquished flies, Convinced that numbers won't suffice Where Freemen are the foes.

Our songs to noblest strains we'll raise While we attempt thy matchless praise, Carolina's godlike son; While Mississippi rolls his flood, Or Freemen's hearts move patriots' blood, The palm shall be thine own.

At Orleans--lo! a savage band, In countless numbers gain the strand, "Beauty and spoil" the word-- There Jackson with his fearless few, The invincibles by thousands slew, And dire destruction poured.

O Britain! when the tale is told Of Jackson's deeds by fame enrolled, Should grief and madness rise, Remember God, the avenger, reigns, Who witnessed Havre's smoking plains, And Hampton's female cries.

ODE TO PEACE

Oh! breathe upon this hapless world, And bid our pains and sorrows cease; Broad be thy snowy flag unfurl'd, And may we hail thy coming, peace!

For long enough has ruin stalk'd, With force and terror o'er our earth; Around them hideous spectres walk'd, And evil nurs'd his monstrous birth.

Ah! banish'd from these happy skies, By thee, be soon these boding stars, Which erring made mankind arise, To deeds of sin, to blood and wars.

Philadelphia, 1816.

CHAPTER III

THE WEST

At the close of the Revolution, the country west of the Alleghanies was still virtually an unbroken wilderness. Boone had pushed forward into Kentucky, drawing a few settlers after him; the trading-posts in the Illinois country, which had been captured by George Rogers Clark, still dragged on a miserable existence; but these were mere pin-points in the great stretches of virgin forest, amid which the first settlers hewed out a home.

THE SETTLER

His echoing axe the settler swung Amid the sea-like solitude, And, rushing, thundering, down were flung The Titans of the wood; Loud shrieked the eagle, as he dashed From out his mossy nest, which crashed With its supporting bough, And the first sunlight, leaping, flashed On the wolf's haunt below.

Rude was the garb and strong the frame Of him who plied his ceaseless toil: To form that garb the wildwood game Contributed their spoil; The soul that warmed that frame disdained The tinsel, gaud, and glare that reigned Where men their crowds collect; The simple fur, untrimmed, unstained, This forest-tamer decked.

The paths which wound mid gorgeous trees, The stream whose bright lips kissed their flowers, The winds that swelled their harmonies Through those sun-hiding bowers, The temple vast, the green arcade, The nestling vale, the grassy glade, Dark cave, and swampy lair; These scenes and sounds majestic made His world, his pleasures, there.

His roof adorned a pleasant spot; Mid the black logs green glowed the grain, And herbs and plants the woods knew not Throve in the sun and rain. The smoke-wreath curling o'er the dell, The low, the bleat, the tinkling bell, All made a landscape strange, Which was the living chronicle Of deeds that wrought the change.

The violet sprung at spring's first tinge, The rose of summer spread its glow, The maize hung out its autumn fringe, Rude winter brought his snow; And still the lone one labored there, His shout and whistle broke the air, As cheerily he plied His garden-spade, or drove his share Along the hillock's side.

He marked the fire-storm's blazing flood Roaring and crackling on its path, And scorching earth, and melting wood, Beneath its greedy wrath; He marked the rapid whirlwind shoot, Trampling the pine-tree with its foot, And darkening thick the day With streaming bough and severed root, Hurled whizzing on its way.

His gaunt hound yelled, his rifle flashed, The grim bear hushed his savage growl; In blood and foam the panther gnashed His fangs, with dying howl; The fleet deer ceased its flying bound, Its snarling wolf-foe bit the ground, And, with its moaning cry, The beaver sunk beneath the wound Its pond-built Venice by.

Humble the lot, yet his the race, When Liberty sent forth her cry, Who thronged in conflict's deadliest place, To fight,--to bleed,--to die! Who cumbered Bunker's height of red, By hope through weary years were led, And witnessed Yorktown's sun Blaze on a nation's banner spread, A nation's freedom won.

ALFRED B. STREET.

Danger was ever present--and in its most hideous form. Northwest of the Ohio dwelt the powerful Delawares and Shawanese, ever ready to march against the border settlements and to surprise isolated dwellings. In the incessant warfare against the Indians, the frontier women played no little part.

THE MOTHERS OF THE WEST

The Mothers of our Forest-Land! Stout-hearted dames were they; With nerve to wield the battle-brand, And join the border-fray. Our rough land had no braver, In its days of blood and strife-- Aye ready for severest toil, Aye free to peril life.

The Mothers of our Forest-Land! On old Kan-tuc-kee's soil, How shared they, with each dauntless band, War's tempest and Life's toil! They shrank not from the foeman,-- They quailed not in the fight,-- But cheered their husbands through the day, And soothed them through the night.

The Mothers of our Forest-Land! Their bosoms pillowed _men_! And proud were they by such to stand, In hammock, fort, or glen. To load the sure old rifle,-- To run the leaden ball,-- To watch a battling husband's place, And fill it should he fall.

The Mothers of our Forest-Land! _Such_ were their daily deeds. Their monument!--where does it stand? Their epitaph!--who reads? No braver dames had Sparta, No nobler matrons Rome,-- Yet who or lauds or honors them, E'en in their own green home!

The Mothers of our Forest-Land! They sleep in unknown graves: And had they borne and nursed a band Of ingrates, or of slaves, They had not been more neglected! But their graves shall yet be found, And their monuments dot here and there "The Dark and Bloody Ground."

WILLIAM D. GALLAGHER.

In 1784 Virginia ceded to the national government her claim to the lands west of the mountains. New York, Massachusetts, and Connecticut soon followed suit, and the tide of emigration to the West set in with steady and ever-increasing volume.

ON THE EMIGRATION TO AMERICA AND PEOPLING THE WESTERN COUNTRY

[1784]

To western woods and lonely plains, Palemon from the crowd departs, Where Nature's wildest genius reigns, To tame the soil, and plant the arts-- What wonders there shall freedom show, What mighty states successive grow!

From Europe's proud, despotic shores Hither the stranger takes his way, And in our new-found world explores A happier soil, a milder sway, Where no proud despot holds him down, No slaves insult him with a crown.

What charming scenes attract the eye, On wild Ohio's savage stream! There Nature reigns, whose works outvie The boldest pattern art can frame; There ages past have rolled away, And forests bloomed but to decay.

From these fair plains, these rural seats, So long concealed, so lately known, The unsocial Indian far retreats, To make some other clime his own, Where other streams, less pleasing, flow, And darker forests round him grow.

Great Sire of floods! whose varied wave Through climes and countries takes its way, To whom creating Nature gave Ten thousand streams to swell thy sway! No

longer shall they useless prove, Nor idly through the forests rove;

Nor longer shall your princely flood From distant lakes be swelled in vain, Nor longer through a darksome wood Advance unnoticed to the main; Far other ends the heavens decree-- And commerce plans new freights for thee.

While virtue warms the generous breast, There heaven-born freedom shall reside, Nor shall the voice of war molest, Nor Europe's all-aspiring pride-- There Reason shall new laws devise, And order from confusion rise.

Forsaking kings and regal state, With all their pomp and fancied bliss, The traveller owns, convinced though late, No realm so free, so blest as this-- The east is half to slaves consigned, Where kings and priests enchain the mind.

O come the time, and haste the day, When man shall man no longer crush, When Reason shall enforce her sway, Nor these fair regions raise our blush, Where still the African complains, And mourns his yet unbroken chains.

Far brighter scenes a future age, The muse predicts, these States will hail, Whose genius may the world engage, Whose deeds may over death prevail, And happier systems bring to view Than all the eastern sages knew.

PHILIP FRENEAU.

In 1788 Marietta was founded at the mouth of the Muskingum by the Ohio Company, which had bought a great tract of land extending to the Scioto. Later in the same year, Matthias Denman, Robert Patterson, and John Filson laid out the town of Losantiville, now Cincinnati. Filson had been a schoolmaster and was responsible for the strange name, which he thought indicated that the town was opposite the mouth of the Licking. He was soon afterwards killed by the Indians while on an exploring expedition.

JOHN FILSON

[1788]

John Filson was a pedagogue-- A pioneer was he; I know not what his nation was, Nor what his pedigree.

Tradition's scanty records tell But little of the man, Save that he to the frontier came In immigration's van.

Perhaps with phantoms of reform His busy fancy teemed, Perhaps of new Utopias Hesperian he dreamed.

John Filson and companions bold A frontier village planned, In forest wild, on sloping hills, By fair Ohio's strand.

John Filson from three languages With pedant skill did frame The novel word Losantiville To be the new town's name.

Said Filson: "Comrades, hear my words: Ere threescore years have flown Our town will be a city vast." Loud laughed Bob Patterson.

Still John exclaimed, with prophet-tongue, "A city fair and proud, The Queen of Cities in the West!" Mat Denman laughed aloud.

Deep in the wild and solemn woods Unknown to white man's track, John Filson went, one autumn day, But nevermore came back.

He struggled through the solitude The inland to explore, And with romantic pleasure traced Miami's winding shore.

Across his path the startled deer Bounds to its shelter green; He enters every lonely vale And cavernous ravine.

Too soon the murky twilight comes, The boding night-winds moan; Bewildered wanders Filson, lost, Exhausted, and alone.

By lurking foes his steps are dogged, A yell his ear appalls! A ghastly corpse, upon the ground, A murdered man, he falls.

The Indian, with instinctive hate, In him a herald saw Of coming hosts of pioneers, The friends of light and law;

In him beheld the champion Of industries and arts, The founder of encroaching roads And great commercial marts;

The spoiler of the hunting-ground, The plougher of the sod, The builder of the Christian school And of the house of God.

And so the vengeful tomahawk John Filson's blood did spill,-- The spirit of the pedagogue No tomahawk could kill.

John Filson had no sepulchre, Except the wildwood dim; The mournful voices of the air Made requiem for him.

The druid trees their waving arms Uplifted o'er his head; The moon a pallid veil of light Upon his visage spread.

The rain and sun of many years Have worn his bones away, And what he vaguely prophesied We realize to-day.

Losantiville, the prophet's word, The poet's hope fulfils,-- She sits a stately Queen to-day Amid her royal hills!

Then come, ye pedagogues, and join To sing a grateful lay For him, the martyr pioneer, Who led for you the way.

And may my simple ballad be A monument to save His name from blank oblivion, Who never had a grave.

WILLIAM HENRY VENABLE.

These pioneers found the land northwest of the Ohio remarkably fertile; but it was the hunting-ground of the warlike Delawares and Shawanese, and the man who attempted to settle there took his life in his hands. In the fall of 1791, a large force was collected at Cincinnati, under General Arthur St. Clair, and marched against the Indians. On the morning of November 4, the Americans were surprised near the

Miami villages, and routed, with great loss. A ballad describing the defeat was written soon afterwards, and achieved a wide popularity.

SAINCLAIRE'S DEFEAT

[November 4, 1791]

'Twas November the fourth, in the year of ninety-one, We had a sore engagement near to Fort Jefferson; Sainclaire was our commander, which may remembered be, For there we left nine hundred men in t' West'n Ter'tory.

At Bunker's Hill and Quebeck, there many a hero fell, Likewise at Long Island (it is I the truth can tell), But such a dreadful carnage may I never see again As hap'ned near St. Mary's, upon the river plain.

Our army was attacked just as the day did dawn, And soon was overpowered and driven from the lawn. They killed Major Ouldham, Levin and Briggs likewise, And horrid yells of savages resounded through the skies.

Major Butler was wounded the very second fire; His manly bosom swell'd with rage when forc'd to retire; And as he lay in anguish, nor scarcely could he see, Exclaim'd, "Ye hounds of hell! Oh, revenged I will be!"

We had not been long broken when General Butler found Himself so badly wounded, was forced to quit the ground; "My God!" says he, "what shall we do? we're wounded every man; Go charge them, valiant heroes, and beat them if you can."

He leaned his back against a tree, and there resigned his breath, And like a valiant soldier sunk in the arms of death; When blessed angels did await his spirit to convey, And unto the celestial fields he quickly bent his way.

We charg'd again with courage firm, but soon again gave ground; The war-whoop then redoubled, as did the foes around. They killed Major Ferguson, which caused his men to cry, "Our only safety is in flight, or fighting here to die."

"Stand to your guns," says valiant Ford; "let's die upon them here, Before we let the sav'ges know we ever harbored fear!" Our cannon-balls exhausted, and artill'ry-men all slain, Obliged were our musketmen the enemy to sustain.

Yet three hours more we fought them, and then were forc'd to yield, When three hundred warriors lay stretched upon the field. Says Colonel Gibson to his men, "My boys, be not dismayed; I'm sure that true Virginians were never yet afraid.

"Ten thousand deaths I'd rather die than they should gain the field!" With that he got a fatal shot, which causèd him to yield. Says Major Clarke, "My heroes, I can here no longer stand; We'll strive to form in order, and retreat the best we can."

The word "Retreat!" being passed around, there was a dismal cry, Then helter-skelter through the woods like wolves and sheep they fly. This well-appointed army, who but a day before Defied and braved all danger, had like a cloud passed o'er.

Alas, the dying and wounded, how dreadful was the thought! To the tomahawk and scalping-knife in misery are brought. Some had a thigh and some an arm broke on the field that day, Who writhed in torments at the stake to close the dire affray.

To mention our brave officers, is what I wish to do; No sons of Mars e'er fought more brave, or with more courage true. To Captain Bradford I belonged, in his artillery, He fell that day amongst the slain, a valiant man was he.

After this victory, the Indians grew bolder than ever, and attacks on the border settlements were increasingly frequent. More than one family was saved from surprise and death by a queer character known as Johnny Appleseed, who travelled through the wilderness planting apple-seeds which in time grew into valuable orchards. The Indians thought him mad and would not harm him.

JOHNNY APPLESEED

A BALLAD OF THE OLD NORTHWEST

A midnight cry appalls the gloom, The puncheon door is shaken: "Awake! arouse! and flee the doom! Man, woman, child, awaken!

"Your sky shall glow with fiery beams Before the morn breaks ruddy! The scalpknife in the moonlight gleams, Athirst for vengeance bloody!"

Alarumed by the dreadful word Some warning tongue thus utters, The settler's wife, like mother bird, About her young ones flutters.

Her first-born, rustling from a soft Leaf-couch, the roof close under, Glides down the ladder from the loft, With eyes of dreamy wonder.

The pioneer flings open wide The cabin door, naught fearing; The grim woods drowse on every side, Around the lonely clearing.

"Come in! come in! nor like an owl Thus hoot your doleful humors; What fiend possesses you to howl Such crazy, coward rumors?"

The herald strode into the room; That moment, through the ashes, The back-log struggled into bloom Of gold and crimson flashes.

The glimmer lighted up a face, And o'er a figure dartled, So eerie, of so solemn grace, The bluff backwoodsman startled.

The brow was gathered to a frown, The eyes were strangely glowing, And, like a snow-fall drifting down, The stormy beard went flowing.

The tattered cloak that round him clung Had warred with foulest weather; Across his shoulders broad were flung Brown saddlebags of leather.

One pouch with hoarded seed was packed, From Penn-land cider-presses; The other garnered book and tract Within its creased recesses.

A glance disdainful and austere, Contemptuous of danger, Cast he upon the pioneer, Then spake the uncouth stranger:

"Heed what the Lord's anointed saith; Hear one who would deliver Your bodies and your souls from death; List ye to John the Giver.

"Thou trustful boy, in spirit wise Beyond thy father's measure, Because of thy believing eyes I share with thee my treasure.

"Of precious seed this handful take; Take next this Bible Holy: In good soil sow both gifts, for sake Of Him, the meek and lowly.

"Farewell! I go!--the forest calls My life to ceaseless labors; Wherever danger's shadow falls I fly to save my neighbors.

"I save; I neither curse nor slay; I am a voice that crieth In night and wilderness. Away! Whoever doubteth, dieth!"

The prophet vanished in the night, Like some fleet ghost belated: Then, awe-struck, fled with panic fright The household, evil-fated.

They hurried on with stumbling feet, Foreboding ambuscado; Bewildered hope told of retreat In frontier palisado.

But ere a mile of tangled maze Their bleeding hands had broken, Their home-roof set the dark ablaze, Fulfilling doom forespoken.

The savage death-whoop rent the air! A howl of rage infernal! The fugitives were in Thy care, Almighty Power eternal!

Unscathed by tomahawk or knife, In bosky dingle nested, The hunted pioneer, with wife And babes, hid unmolested.

The lad, when age his locks of gold Had changed to silver glory, Told grandchildren, as I have told, This western wildwood story.

Told how the fertile seeds had grown To famous trees, and thriven; And oft the Sacred Book was shown, By that weird Pilgrim given.

Remember Johnny Appleseed, All ye who love the apple; He served his kind by Word and Deed, In God's grand greenwood chapel.

WILLIAM HENRY VENABLE.

On August 20, 1794, General Anthony Wayne defeated the Indians on the Maumee and compelled them to sue for peace. At Greenville, in the following year, they ceded 25,000 square miles to the Americans, and settlers flocked into the fertile country thrown open to them.

THE FOUNDERS OF OHIO

The footsteps of a hundred years Have echoed, since o'er Braddock's Road Bold Putnam and the Pioneers Led History the way they strode.

On wild Monongahela stream They launched the Mayflower of the West, A perfect State their civic dream, A new New World their pilgrim quest.

When April robed the Buckeye trees Muskingum's bosky shore they trod; They pitched their tents, and to the breeze Flung freedom's star-flag, thanking God.

As glides the Oyo's solemn flood, So fleeted their eventful years; Resurgent in their children's blood, They still live on--the Pioneers.

Their fame shrinks not to names and dates On votive stone, the prey of time;-- Behold where monumental States Immortalize their lives sublime!

WILLIAM HENRY VENABLE.

Ohio was admitted to the Union in 1803. The serenity of the new state was rudely shaken, in 1806, by the remarkable bugbear known as the "Burr Conspiracy." Burr had incurred the enmity of Jefferson and most of the other leading politicians of the time, and they were led to believe that he was preparing an expedition against the southwest, to set up a separate empire there. Burr had interested in his plan--which was really directed against Mexico--one Harmon Blennerhassett, who owned the island of that name in the Ohio, and who undertook to finance the expedition.

BLENNERHASSETT'S ISLAND

From "The New Pastoral"

Once came an exile, longing to be free, Born in the greenest island of the sea; He sought out this, the fairest blooming isle That ever gemmed a river; and its smile, Of summer green and freedom, on his heart Fell, like the light of Paradise. Apart It lay, remote and wild; and in his breast He fancied this an island of the blest; And here he deemed the world might never mar The tranquil air with its molesting jar. Long had his soul, among the strife of men, Gone out and fought, and fighting, failed; and then Withdrew into itself: as when some fount Finds space within, and will no longer mount, Content to hear its own secluded waves Make lonely music in the new-found caves. And here he brought his household; here his wife, As happy as her children, round his life Sang as she were an echo, or a part Of the deep pleasure springing in his heart-- A silken string which with the heavier cord Made music, such as well-strung harps afford. She was the embodied spirit of the man, His second self, but on a fairer plan. And here they came, and here they built their home, And set the rose and taught the vines to roam, Until the place became an isle of bowers, Where odors, mist-like, swam above the flowers. It was a place where one might lie and dream, And see the naiads, from the river-stream, Stealing among the umbrous, drooping limbs; Where Zephyr, 'mid the willows, tuned her hymns Round rippling shores. Here would the first birds throng, In early spring-time, and their latest song Was given in autumn; when all else had fled, They half forgot to go; such beauty here was spread. It was, in sooth, a fair enchanted isle, Round which the unbroken forest, many a mile, Reached the horizon like a boundless sea;-- A sea whose waves, at last, were forced to flee On either hand, before the westward host, To meet no more upon its ancient coast. But all things fair, save truth, are frail and doomed; And brightest beauty is the first

consumed By envious Time; as if he crowned the brow With loveliest flowers, before he gave the blow Which laid the victim on the hungry shrine:-- Such was the dreamer's fate, and such, bright isle, was thine. There came the stranger, heralded by fame, Whose eloquent soul was like a tongue of flame, Which brightened and despoiled whate'er it touched. A violet, by an iron gauntlet clutched, Were not more doomed than whosoe'er he won To list his plans, with glowing words o'errun: And Blennerhassett hearkened as he planned. Far in the South there was a glorious land Crowned with perpetual flowers, and where repute Pictured the gold more plenteous than the fruit-- The Persia of the West. There would he steer His conquering course; and o'er the bright land rear His far-usurping banner, till his home Should rest beneath a wide, imperial dome, Where License, round his thronèd feet, should whirl Her dizzy mazes like an Orient girl. His followers should be lords; their ladies each Wear wreaths of gems beyond the old world's reach; And emperors, gazing to that land of bloom, With impotent fire of envy should consume. Such was the gorgeous vision which he drew. The listener saw; and, dazzled by the view,-- As one in some enchanter's misty room, His senses poisoned by the strange perfume, Beholds with fierce desire the picture fair, And grasps at nothing in the painted air,-- Gave acquiescence, in a fatal hour, And wealth, and hope, and peace were in the tempter's power. The isle became a rendezvous; and then Came in the noisy rule of lawless men. Domestic calm, affrighted, fled afar, And Riot revelled 'neath the midnight star; Continuous music rustled through the trees, Where banners danced responsive on the breeze; Or in festoons, above the astonished bowers, With flaming colors shamed the modest flowers. There clanged the mimic combat of the sword, Like daily glasses round the festive board; Here lounged the chiefs, there marched the plumèd file, And martial splendor over-ran the isle. Already, the shrewd leader of the sport The shadowy sceptre grasped, and swayed his court. In dreams, or waking, revelling or alone, Before him swam the visionary throne; Until a voice, as if the insulted woods Had risen to claim their ancient solitudes, Broke on his spirit, like a trumpet rude, Shattering his dream to nothing where he stood! The revellers vanished, and the banners fell Like the red leaves beneath November's spell. Full of great hopes, sustained by mighty will, Urged by ambition, confident of skill, As fearless to perform as to devise, A-flush, but now he saw the glittering prize Flame like a cloud in day's descending track; But, lo, the sun went down and left it black! Alone, despised, defiance in his eye, He heard the shout, and "treason!" was the cry; And that harsh word, with its unpitying blight, Swept o'er the island like an arctic night. Cold grew the hearthstone, withered fell the flowers, And desolation walked among the bowers. This was the mansion. Through the ruined hall The loud winds sweep, with gusty rise and fall, Or glide, like phantoms, through the open doors; And winter drifts his snow along the floors, Blown through the yawning rafters, where the stars And moon look in as through dull prison bars. On yonder gable, through the nightly dark, The owl replies unto the dreary bark Of lonely fox, beside the grass-grown sill; And here, on summer eves, the whip-poor-will Exalts her voice, and to the traveller's ear Proclaims how Ruin rules with full contentment here.

THOMAS BUCHANAN READ.

Soon word got abroad that a great expedition was being fitted out at Blennerhassett; the governor of Ohio called out the sheriffs and militia, who gathered in force, seized ten boats laden with corn-meal, but permitted the boats containing Blennerhassett and his followers to get away. A mob destroyed Blennerhassett's beautiful home and desolated the "fairy isle."

THE BATTLE OF MUSKINGUM

OR, THE DEFEAT OF THE BURRITES

[November 30, 1806]

Ye jovial throng, come join the song I sing of glorious feats, sirs; Of bloodless wounds, of laurels, crowns, Of charges, and retreats, sirs;

Of thundering guns, and honors won, By men of daring courage; Of such as dine on beef and wine, And such as sup their porridge.

When Blanny's fleet, so snug and neat, Came floating down the tide, sirs, Ahead was seen one-eyed Clark Green, To work them, or to guide, sirs.

Our General brave the order gave, "To arms! To arms, in season! Old Blanny's boats most careless float, Brim-full of death and treason!"

A few young boys, their mothers' joys, And five men there were found, sirs, Floating at ease--each little sees Or dreams of death and wound, sirs.

"Fly to the bank! on either flank! We'll fire from every corner; We'll stain with blood Muskingum's flood, And gain immortal honor.

"The cannon there shall rend the air, Loaded with broken spikes, boys; While our cold lead, hurled by each head, Shall give the knaves the gripes, boys.

"Let not maids sigh, or children cry, Or mothers drop a tear, boys; I have the Baron in my head, Therefore you've nought to fear, boys.

"Now to your posts, this numerous host, Be manly, firm, and steady. But do not fire till I retire And say when I am ready."

The Deputy courageously Rode forth in power and pride, sirs; Twitching his reins, the man of brains Was posted by his side, sirs.

The men in ranks stood on the banks, While, distant from its border, The active aid scours the parade And gives the general order:

"First, at command, bid them to stand; Then, if one rascal gains out Or lifts his poll, why, damn his soul And blow the traitor's brains out."

The night was dark, silent came Clark With twelve or fifteen more, sirs; While Paddy Hill, with voice most shrill, Whooped! as was said before, sirs.

The trembling ranks along the banks Fly into Shipman's manger; While old Clark Green, with voice serene, Cried, "Soldiers, there's no danger.

"Our guns, good souls, are setting-poles, _Dead_ hogs I'm sure can't bite you; Along each keel is Indian meal; There's nothing here need fright you."

Out of the barn, still in alarm, Came fifty men or more, sirs, And seized each boat and other float And tied them to the shore, sirs.

This plunder rare, they sport and share, And each a portion grapples. 'Twas half a kneel of Indian meal, And ten of Putnam's apples.

The boats they drop to Allen's shop, Commanded by O'Flannon, Where, lashed ashore, without an oar, They lay beneath the cannon.

This band so bold, the night being cold, And blacksmith's shop being handy, Around the forge they drink and gorge On whiskey and peach-brandy.

Two honest tars, who had some scars, Beheld their trepidation; Cries Tom, "Come, Jack, let's fire a crack; 'Twill fright them like damnation.

"Tyler, they say, lies at Belpré, Snug in old Blanny's quarters; Yet this pale host tremble like ghosts For fear he'll walk on waters."

No more was said, but off they sped To fix what they'd begun on; At one o'clock, firm as a rock, They fired the spun-yarn cannon.

Trembling and wan stood every man; Then bounced and shouted murder, While Sergeant Morse squealed like a horse To get the folks to order.

Ten men went out and looked about-- A hardy set of fellows; Some hid in holes behind the coals, And some behind the bellows.

The Cor'ner swore the western shore He saw with muskets bristle; Some stamp'd the ground;--'twas cannon sound, They heard the grape-shot whistle.

The Deputy mounted "Old Bay," When first he heard the rattle, Then changed his course--"Great men are scarce, I'd better keep from battle."

The General flew to meet the crew, His jacket flying loose, sirs; Instead of sword, he seized his board;-- Instead of hat, his goose, sirs.

"Tyler's" he cried, "on t'other side, Your spikes will never do it; The cannon's bore will hold some more," Then thrust his goose into it.

Sol raised his head, cold spectres fled; Each man resumed his courage; Captain O'Flan dismissed each man To breakfast on cold porridge.

WILLIAM HARRISON SAFFORD.

The whole party, including Burr, were arrested February 19, 1807 near Fort Stoddart, Ala., and taken to Richmond, Va., where Burr was put on trial for treason. The trial lasted six months, and resulted in acquittal.

TO AARON BURR, UNDER TRIAL FOR HIGH TREASON

Thou wonder of the Atlantic shore, Whose deeds a million hearts appall; Thy fate shall pity's eye deplore, Or vengeance for thy ruin call.

Thou man of soul! whose feeble form Seems as a leaf the gales defy, Though scattered in sedition's storm, Yet borne by glorious hope on high.

Such did the youthful Ammon seem, And such does Europe's scourge appear, As, of the sun, a vertic beam, The brightest in the golden year.

Nature, who many a gift bestowed, The strong herculean limbs denied, But gave--a mind, where genius glowed, A soul, to valor's self allied.

Ambition as her curse was seen, Thy every blessing to annoy; To blight thy laurels' tender green; The banner of thy fame destroy.

Ambition, by the bard defined The fault of godlike hearts alone, Like fortune in her frenzy, blind, _Here_ gives a prison, _there_ a throne.

SARAH WENTWORTH MORTON.

Scarcely had this "peril" been escaped, when another far more serious threatened the state on its western border. Tecumseh, chief of the Shawanese, was working to unite the western and southern Indians in war against the United States. William Henry Harrison had been made governor of the Indiana territory, and, collecting a force of about six hundred and fifty men, he marched into the Indian country, and, on November 7, 1811, at Tippecanoe, on the Wabash, routed the Indians and destroyed their villages.

THE BATTLE OF TIPPECANOE

[November 7, 1811]

Awake! awake! my gallant friends; To arms! to arms! the foe is nigh; The sentinel his warning sends; And hark! the treacherous savage cry. Awake! to arms! the word goes round; The drum's deep roll, the fife's shrill sound, The trumpet's blast, proclaim through night, An Indian band, a bloody fight.

O haste thee, Baen! alas! too late; A red chief's arm now aims the blow (An early, but a glorious fate); The tomahawk has laid thee low. Dread darkness reigns. On, Daviess, on. Where's Boyd? And valiant Harrison, Commander of the Christian force? And Owen? He's a bleeding corse!

"Stand, comrades brave, stand to your post: Here Wells, and Floyd, and Barton; all Must now be won, or must be lost; Ply briskly, bayonet, sword, and ball." Thus spake the general; when a yell Was heard, as though a hero fell. And, hark! the Indian whoop again-- It is for daring Daviess slain!

Oh! fearful is the battle's rage; No lady's hand is in the fray; But brawny limbs the contest wage, And struggle for the victor's bay. Lo! Spencer sinks, and Warwick's slain, And breathless bodies strew the plain: And yells, and groans, and clang, and roar, Echo along the Wabash shore.

But mark! where breaks upon the eye Aurora's beam. The coming day Shall foil a frantic prophecy, And Christian valor well display. Ne'er did Constantine's soldiers see, With more of joy for victory, A cross the arch of heaven adorn, Than these the blushing of the morn.

Bold Boyd led on his steady band, With bristling bayonets burnish'd bright: Who could their dauntless charge withstand? What stay the warriors' matchless might? Rushing amain, they clear'd the field, The savage foe constrain'd to yield To Harrison, who, near and far, Gave form and spirit to the war.

Sound, sound the charge! spur, spur the steed, And swift the fugitives pursue-- 'Tis vain: rein in--your utmost speed Could not o'ertake the recreant crew. In lowland marsh, in dell, or cave, Each Indian sought his life to save; Whence, peering forth, with fear and ire, He saw his prophet's town on fire.

Now the great Eagle of the West Triumphant wing was seen to wave! And now each soldier's manly breast Sigh'd o'er his fallen comrade's grave. Some dropp'd a tear, and mused the while, Then join'd in measured march their file; And here and there cast wistful eye, That might surviving friend descry.

But let a foe again appear, Or east, or west, or south, or north; The soldier then shall dry his tear, And fearless, gayly sally forth. With lightning eye, and warlike front, He'll meet the battle's deadly brunt: Come Gaul or Briton; if array'd For fight--he'll feel a freeman's blade.

THE TOMB OF THE BRAVE

IN COMMEMORATION OF THE BATTLE ON THE WABASH

[November 7, 1811]

When darkness prevail'd and aloud on the air No war-whoop was heard through the deep silence yelling, Till, fiercely, like lions just wild from their lair, Our chiefs found the foe on their slumbers propelling. While the mantle of night Hid the savage from sight, Undismay'd were our warriors slain in the fight: But the laurel shall ever continue to wave, And glory thus bloom o'er the tomb of the brave.

Brave Daviess, legitimate offspring of fame, Though new to the war, rush'd to battle undaunted; And ere, bearing death, the dread rifle-ball came, In the breast of the foe oft his weapon he planted. Gallant Daviess, adieu! Tears thy destiny drew; But yet o'er thy body shall tremble no yew, For the laurel, etc.

Great Owen, too bold from the fight to remain, Rush'd on to the foe, every soldier's heart firing; But he sinks, in the blood of his foes, on the plain, The pale lamp of life in its socket expiring; Closed in death are his eyes, And lamented he lies; Yet o'er the sad spot shall no cypress arise! But the laurel, etc.

Long Warwick, McMahan, and Spencer, and Baen, And Berry, 'mid darkness their banners defended, But when day drew the curtain of night, they were seen Cover'd o'er with the blood of the savage, extended. Though Freedom may weep Where they mouldering sleep, Yet shall valor their death as a jubilee keep: For the laurel, etc.

Ye chiefs of the Wabash, who gallantly fought, And fearlessly heard the dread storm of war rattle, Who lived to see conquest so terribly bought, While your brothers were lost in the uproar of battle, Still fearless remain, And, though stretch'd on the plain, You shall rise on the records of freedom again: For the laurel, etc.

Ye sons of Columbia, when danger is nigh, And liberty calls, round her standard to rally, For your country, your wives, and your children to die, Resolve undismay'd on oppression to sally. Every hero secure That his fame shall endure Till eternity time in oblivion immure; For the laurel shall ever continue to wave, And glory thus bloom o'er the tomb of the brave.

JOSEPH HUTTON.

While this struggle was waging for the country between the Alleghanies and the Mississippi, two daring explorers traversed the country to the west of the great river. On May 14, 1804, Captain Meriwether Lewis and Lieutenant William Clark, of the First Infantry, who had been appointed to seek water communication with the Pacific Coast, entered the Missouri River and started westward.

SA-CÁ-GA-WE-A

THE INDIAN GIRL WHO GUIDED LEWIS AND CLARK IN THEIR EXPEDITION TO THE PACIFIC

Sho-shó-ne Sa-cá-ga-we-a--captive and wife was she On the grassy plains of Dakota in the land of the Minnetaree; But she heard the west wind calling, and longed to follow the sun Back to the shining mountains and the glens where her life begun. So, when the valiant Captains, fain for the Asian sea, Stayed their marvellous journey in the land of the Minnetaree (The Red Men wondering, wary--Omaha, Mandan, Sioux-- Friendly now, now hostile, as they toiled the wilderness through), Glad she turned from the grassy plains and led their way to the West, Her course as true as the swan's that flew north to its reedy nest; Her eye as keen as the eagle's when the young lambs feed below; Her ear alert as the stag's at morn guarding the fawn and doe. Straight was she as a hillside fir, lithe as the willow-tree, And her foot as fleet as the antelope's when the hunter rides the lea; In broidered tunic and moccasins, with braided raven hair, And closely belted buffalo robe with her baby nestling there-- Girl of but sixteen summers, the homing bird of the quest, Free of the tongues of the mountains, deep on her heart imprest,-- Sho-shó-ne Sa-cá-ga-we-a led the way to the West!-- To Missouri's broad savannas dark with bison and deer, While the grizzly roamed the savage shore and cougar and wolf prowled near; To the cataract's leap, and the meadows with lily and rose abloom; The sunless trails of the forest, and the canyon's hush and gloom; By the veins of gold and silver, and the mountains vast and grim-- Their snowy summits lost in clouds on the wide horizon's brim; Through

sombre pass, by soaring peak, till the Asian wind blew free, And lo! the roar of the Oregon and the splendor of the Sea!

Some day, in the lordly upland where the snow-fed streams divide-- Afoam for the far Atlantic, afoam for Pacific's tide-- There, by the valiant Captains whose glory will never dim While the sun goes down to the Asian sea and the stars in ether swim, She will stand in bronze as richly brown as the hue of her girlish cheek, With broidered robe and braided hair and lips just curved to speak; And the mountain winds will murmur as they linger along the crest, "Sho-shó-ne Sa-cá-ga-we-a, who led the way to the West!"

EDNA DEAN PROCTOR.

They ascended the Missouri, crossed the mountains, and descended the Columbia, reaching its mouth November 15, 1805. They started on the return journey in March, 1806, and reached St. Louis in September. On January 14, 1807, a dinner was given at Washington to the explorers, in the course of which the following stanzas were recited.

ON THE DISCOVERIES OF CAPTAIN LEWIS

[January 14, 1807]

Let the Nile cloak his head in the clouds, and defy The researches of science and time; Let the Niger escape the keen traveller's eye, By plunging or changing his clime.

Columbus! not so shall thy boundless domain Defraud thy brave sons of their right; Streams, midlands, and shorelands elude us in vain. We shall drag their dark regions to light.

Look down, sainted sage, from thy synod of Gods; See, inspired by thy venturous soul, Mackenzie roll northward his earth-draining floods, And surge the broad waves to the pole.

With the same soaring genius thy Lewis ascends, And, seizing the car of the sun, O'er the sky-propping hills and high waters he bends, And gives the proud earth a new zone.

Potowmak, Ohio, Missouri had felt Half her globe in their cincture comprest; His long curving course has completed the belt, And tamed the last tide of the west.

Then hear the loud voice of the nation proclaim, And all ages resound the decree: Let our occident stream bear the young hero's name, Who taught him his path to the sea.

These four brother floods, like a garland of flowers, Shall entwine all our states in a band Conform and confederate their wide-spreading powers, And their wealth and their wisdom expand.

From Darien to Davis one garden shall bloom, Where war's weary banners are furl'd, And the far scenting breezes that waft its perfume, Shall settle the storms of

the world.

Then hear the loud voice of the nation proclaim And all ages resound the decree: Let our occident stream bear the young hero's name, Who taught him his path to the sea.

JOEL BARLOW.

For many years, the East showed little interest in this far western land--it was too indistinct, too distant. The British Hudson Bay Company had its eye on the country, and in October, 1842, prepared to bring in a large body of immigrants to occupy it. Dr. Marcus Whitman, of the American Board of Missions, learned of this design, and started to ride across the country to Washington, D. C., in order to lay the plot before the United States government. After enduring almost incredible fatigue and hardship, he reached Washington March 3, 1843. The tidings he brought spurred the government to retain this great territory.

WHITMAN'S RIDE FOR OREGON

[October, 1842-March 3, 1843]

I

"An empire to be lost or won!" And who four thousand miles will ride And climb to heaven the Great Divide, And find the way to Washington, Through mountain cañons, winter snows, O'er streams where free the north wind blows? Who, who will ride from Walla-Walla, Four thousand miles for Oregon?

II

"An empire to be lost or won? In youth to man I gave my all, And nought is yonder mountain wall; If but the will of Heaven be done, It is not mine to live or die, Or count the mountains low or high, Or count the miles from Walla-Walla. I, I will ride for Oregon.

III

"An empire to be lost or won? Bring me my Cayuse pony then, And I will thread old ways again, Beneath the gray skies' crystal sun. 'Twas on these altars of the air I raised the flag, and saw below The measureless Columbia flow; The Bible oped, and bowed in prayer, And gave myself to God anew, And felt my spirit newly born; And to my mission I'll be true, And from the vale of Walla-Walla, I'll ride again for Oregon.

IV

"I'm not my own, myself I've given, To bear to savage hordes the word; If on the altars of the heaven I'm called to die, it is the Lord. The herald may not wait or choose, 'Tis

his the summons to obey; To do his best, or gain or lose, To seek the Guide and not the way. He must not miss the cross, and I Have ceased to think of life or death; My ark I've builded--Heaven is nigh, And earth is but a morning's breath; Go, then, my Cayuse pony bring, The hopes that seek myself are gone, And from the vale of Walla-Walla, I'll ride again for Oregon."

V

He disappeared, as not his own, He heard the warning ice winds sigh; The smoky sun flames o'er him shone, On whitened altars of the sky, As up the mountain sides he rose; The wandering eagle round him wheeled, The partridge fled, the gentle roes, And oft his Cayuse pony reeled Upon some dizzy crag, and gazed Down cloudy chasms, falling storms, While higher yet the peaks upraised Against the winds their giant forms. On, on and on, past Idaho, On past the mighty Saline sea, His covering at night the snow, His only sentinel a tree. On, past Portneuf's basaltic heights, On where the San Juan mountains lay, Through sunless days and starless nights, Towards Taos and far Sante Fé. O'er table-lands of sleet and hail, Through pine-roofed gorges, cañons cold, Now fording streams incased in mail Of ice, like Alpine knights of old: Still on, and on, forgetful on, Till far behind lay Walla-Walla, And far the fields of Oregon.

VI

The winter deepened, sharper grew The hail and sleet, the frost and snow, Not e'en the eagle o'er him flew, And scarce the partridge's wing below. The land became a long white sea, And then a deep with scarce a coast, The stars refused their light, till he Was in the wildering mazes lost. He dropped the rein, his stiffened hand Was like a statue's hand of clay; "My trusty beast, 'tis the command, Go on, I leave to thee the way. I must go on, I must go on, Whatever lot may fall to me, On, 'tis for others' sake I ride,-- For others I may never see,-- And dare thy clouds, O Great Divide; Not for myself, O Walla-Walla, Not for myself, O Washington, But for thy future, Oregon."

VII

And on and on the dumb beast pressed, Uncertain, and without a guide, And found the mountain's curves of rest And sheltered ways of the Divide. His feet grew firm, he found the way With storm-beat limbs and frozen breath, As keen his instincts to obey As was his master's eye of faith. Still on and on, still on and on, And far and far grew Walla-Walla, And far the fields of Oregon.

VIII

That spring, a man with frozen feet Came to the marble halls of State, And told his mission but to meet The chill of scorn, the scoff of hate. "Is Oregon worth saving?" asked The treaty-makers from the coast; And him the church with questions tasked, And said, "Why did you leave your post?" Was it for this that he had braved The

warring storms of mount and sky? Yes!--yet that empire he had saved, And to his post went back to die,-- Went back to die for others' sake, Went back to die from Washington, Went back to die for Walla-Walla, For Idaho and Oregon.

IX

At fair Walla-Walla one may see The city of the Western North, And near it graves unmarked there be That cover souls of royal worth. The flag waves o'er them in the sky Beneath whose stars are cities born, And round them mountain-castled lie The hundred states of Oregon.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

Far to the south of the point reached by Lewis and Clark lay the country known as California. It had been explored by the Spaniards as early as 1540, and in 1769 an expedition under Portala discovered San Francisco Bay.

DISCOVERY OF SAN FRANCISCO BAY

[October 31, 1769]

Good Junipero, the Padre, Slowly read the King's commands, In relation to the missions To be built in heathen lands. And he said: "The good Saint Francis Surely has some little claim, Yet I find that here no mission Is assigned unto his name."

Then the Visitador answered: "If the holy Francis care For a mission to his honor, Surely he will lead you there; And it may be by the harbor That the Indian legends say Lies by greenest hills surrounded To the north of Monterey."

Spoke Junipero the Padre: "It is not for me to tell Of the truth of Indian legends, Yet of this I know full well-- If there be such hidden harbor, And our hope and trust we place In the care of good Saint Francis, He will guide us to the place."

Soon, the Governor Portala Started northward, on his way Overland, to rediscover The lost port of Monterey. Since the time within its waters Viscaino anchor cast, It remained unknown to Spaniards, Though a century had passed.

On his journey went Portala With his band of pioneers, Padres, Indian guides, and soldiers, And a train of muleteers; And said Serra, as he blessed them, As he wished them all Godspeed: "Trust Saint Francis--he will guide you In your direst hour of need."

On his journey went Portala Till he reached the crescent bay; But he dreamed not he was gazing On the wished-for Monterey. So a cross on shore he planted, And the ground about he blessed, And then he and his companions Northward went upon their quest.

On his journey went Portala, And his army northward on, And methinks I see them marching, Or in camp when day was done; Or at night when stars were twinkling, As that travel-weary band By the log-fire's light would gather, Telling of their far-off land.

And they told weird Indian legends, Tales of Cortes, too, they told, And of peaceful reign of Incas, And of Montezuma's gold; And they sang, as weary exiles Sing of home and vanished years, Sweet, heart-treasured songs that always Bring the dumb applause of tears.

When the day was sunk in ocean, And the land around was dim, On the tranquil air of midnight Rose the sweet Franciscan hymn; And when bugle told the dawning, And the matin prayers were done, On his journey went Portala, And his army northward on.

Far away they saw sierras, Clothed with an eternal spring, While at times the mighty ocean In their path her spray would fling; On amid such scenes they journeyed, Through the dreary wastes of sand, Through ravines dark, deep, and narrow, And through cañons wild and grand.

And with what a thrill of pleasure, All their toils and dangers through, Gazed they on this scene of beauty When it burst upon their view, As Portala and his army, Standing where I stand to-day, Saw before them spread in beauty Green-clad hills and noble bay.

Then the Governor Portala Broke the spell of silence thus: "To this place, through Padre Serra, Hath Saint Francis guided us; So the bay and all around it For the Spanish King I claim, And forever, in the future, Let it bear Saint Francis' name."

Thus he spoke, and I am standing On the self-same spot to-day, And my eyes rest on the landscape, And the green hills, and the bay, And upon Saint Francis' city, As, with youth and hope elate, She is gazing toward the ocean, Sitting by the Golden Gate.

Needless were such gifts as heaven Gave to holy seers of yore, To foretell the meed of glory, Fairest town, for thee in store! To foretell the seat of empire Here will be, nor for a day, Where Balboa's sea doth mingle With the waters of thy bay!

RICHARD EDWARD WHITE.

In 1822 California became a province of Mexico, and in 1844 Colonel John Charles Frémont reached Sutter's Fort with an exploring expedition. Two years later, during the war with Mexico, he assumed command of the American forces in the country, and established the authority of the United States there.

JOHN CHARLES FRÉMONT

Pathfinder--and Path-clincher! Who blazed the way, indeed, But more--who made the eternal Fact Whereto a path had need; Who, while our Websters set at naught The thing that Was to Be, Whipped-out our halting, half-way map Full to the Other Sea!

'Twas well that there were some could read The logic of the West! A Kansas-edged geography, Of provinces confessed, Became potential Union And took a Nation's span When God sent Opportunity And Benton found the Man!

CHARLES F. LUMMIS.

In 1848 California was ceded to the United States by Mexico. In the same year gold was discovered near Coloma, and within a few months the famous rush for the new El Dorado began.

"THE DAYS OF 'FORTY-NINE"

You are looking now on old Tom Moore, A relic of bygone days; A Bummer, too, they call me now, But what care I for praise? For my heart is filled with the days of yore, And oft I do repine For the Days of Old, and the Days of Gold, And the Days of 'Forty-nine. _Refrain_--Oh, my heart is filled, etc.

I had comrades then who loved me well, A jovial, saucy crew: There were some hard cases, I must confess, But they all were brave and true; Who would never flinch, whate'er the pinch, Who never would fret nor whine, But like good old Bricks they stood the kicks In the Days of 'Forty-Nine. _Refrain_--And my heart is filled, etc.

There was Monte Pete--I'll ne'er forget The luck he always had. He would deal for you both day and night, So long as you had a scad. He would play you Draw, he would Ante sling, He would go you a hatfull Blind-- But in a game with Death Pete lost his breath In the Days of 'Forty-Nine. _Refrain_--Oh, my heart is filled, etc.

There was New York Jake, a butcher boy, That was always a-getting tight; Whenever Jake got on a spree, He was spoiling for a fight. One day he ran against a knife In the hands of old Bob Cline-- So over Jake we held a wake, In the Days of 'Forty-Nine. _Refrain_--Oh, my heart is filled, etc.

There was Rackensack Jim, who could out-roar A Buffalo Bull, you bet! He would roar all night, he would roar all day, And I b'lieve he's a-roaring yet! One night he fell in a prospect-hole-- 'Twas a roaring bad design-- For in that hole he roared out his soul In the Days of 'Forty-Nine. _Refrain_--Oh, my heart is filled, etc.

There was Poor Lame Ches, a hard old case Who never did repent. Ches never missed a single meal, Nor he never paid a cent. But Poor Lame Ches, like all the rest, Did to death at last resign, For all in his bloom he went up the Flume In the Days of 'Forty-Nine. _Refrain_--Oh, my heart is filled, etc.

And now my comrades all are gone, Not one remains to toast; They have left me here in my misery, Like some poor wandering ghost. And as I go from place to place, Folks call me a "Travelling Sign," Saying "There goes Tom Moore, a Bummer, sure, From the Days of 'Forty-Nine." _Refrain_--But my heart is filled, etc.

Most of the emigrants crossed the plains, encountering dangers and hardships innumerable. The trails were soon marked by the skeletons of horses and oxen, and by the graves of those who had perished from hardship or been butchered by the Indians.

THE OLD SANTA FÉ TRAIL

It wound through strange scarred hills, down cañons lone Where wild things screamed, with winds for company; Its mile-stones were the bones of pioneers. Bronzed, haggard men, often with thirst a-moan, Lashed on their beasts of burden

toward the sea: An epic quest it was of elder years, For fabled gardens or for good, red gold, The trail men strove in iron days of old.

To-day the steam-god thunders through the vast, While dominant Saxons from the hurtling trains Smile at the aliens, Mexic, Indian, Who offer wares, keen-colored, like their past; Dread dramas of immitigable plains Rebuke the softness of the modern man; No menace, now, the desert's mood of sand; Still westward lies a green and golden land.

For, at the magic touch of water, blooms The wilderness, and where of yore the yoke Tortured the toilers into dateless tombs, Lo! brightsome fruits to feed a mighty folk.

RICHARD BURTON.

The importance of the new country grew so rapidly that on September 9, 1850, California was admitted to the Union, the thirty-first state.

CALIFORNIA

[September 9, 1850]

Land of gold!--thy sisters greet thee, O'er the mountain and the main; See,--they stretch the hand to meet thee, Youngest of our household train.

Many a form their love hath fostered Lingers 'neath thy sunny sky, And their spirit-tokens brighten Every link of sympathy.

We 'mid storms of war were cradled, 'Mid the shock of angry foes; Thou, with sudden, dreamlike splendor, Pallas-born,--in vigor rose.

Children of one common country, Strong in friendship let us stand, With united ardor earning Glory for our Mother Land.

They of gold and they of iron, They who reap the bearded wheat, They who rear the snowy cotton, Pour their treasures at her feet;

While with smiling exultation, She, who marks their filial part, Like the mother of the Gracchi, Folds her jewels to her heart.

LYDIA HUNTLEY SIGOURNEY.

CHAPTER IV

THROUGH FIVE ADMINISTRATIONS

Although Aaron Burr had been acquitted of the charge of treason, the persecution of him still continued. He was practically run out of the country, and when he returned at last in 1812, it was in disguise, under the name of Arnat. Fate soon afterwards dealt him a cruel blow, for in January, 1813, his daughter, Theodosia, the idol of his heart, perished at sea while on a voyage from Charleston to New York.

THEODOSIA BURR:

THE WRECKER'S STORY

[January, 1813]

In revel and carousing We gave the New Year housing, With wreckage for our firing, And rum to heart's desiring, Antigua and Jamaica, Flagon and stoup and breaker. Full cans and a ranting chorus; Hard hearts for the bout before us-- To brave grim Death's grimaces On dazed and staring faces.

With dirks and hangers bristling, We for a gale went whistling, Tornado or pampero, To swamp the host of Pharaoh; To goad the mad Atlantic, And drive the skippers frantic; To jar the deep with thunder, And make the waste a wonder, And plunge the coasters under, And pile the banks with plunder.

Then the wild rack came skirling, Ragged and crazed, and whirling Sea-stuff and sand in breakers, Frothing the shelvy acres: Over the banks high bounding, Inlet and sound confounding. Hatteras roared and rumbled, Currituck heaved and tumbled; And the sea-gulls screamed like witches, And sprawled in the briny ditches.

Shelter and rest we flouted, Jorum and pipe we scouted, Fiddler and wench we routed. "Fetch out the nag!" we shouted; For a craft in the offing struggled. "Now for a skipper juggled; Now for a coaster stranded, And loot in the lockers landed!" With lantern cheerly rocking On the nag's head, we went mocking-- Lilting of tipsy blisses, And Bonnibel's squandered kisses.

Straight for that hell-spark steering, Drove the doomed craft careering; Men on her fore-deck huddled, Sea in her wake all cruddled, Kitty Hawk sheer before her, And the breakers booming o'er her. Till the rocks in their lurking stove her, And her riven spars went over, And she lay on her side and shivered, And groaned to be delivered.

Boats through the black rift storming, Foes on her quarter swarming; Dirks in the torchlight flashing, And the wicked hangers slashing; Lips that were praying mangled, Throats that were screaming, strangled; Souls in the surges tumbling, Vainly for foothold fumbling; Horror of staring faces, Gruesome in Death's grimaces-- And God's wrath overpast us, With never a bolt to blast us!

By the brunt of our doings daunted, We crouched where the fore-deck slanted, Scanning each other's faces, Graved with that horror's traces. One, peering aft, wild-staring, Points through the torches flaring: "Spook of the storm, or human? Angel, or wraith, or woman?" Havoc and wreck surveying, Imploring not, nor praying, Nor death nor life refusing; Stony and still--accusing!

Black as our hearts the creature's Vesture, her matchless features White as the dead. Oh! wonder Of women high heaven under! So she moved down upon us (Though Death and the Fiend might shun us), And we made passage, cowering. Rigid and mute and towering, Never a frown she deigned us, Never with curse arraigned us. One, trembling, dropped his hanger, And swooned at the awful clangor; But she

passed on, unharking, Her steps _our_ doom-strokes marking, Straight to the plank, and mounted. "One, two, three, four!" we counted; Till she paused, o'er the flood suspended, Poised, her lithe arms extended.-- And the storm stood still and waited For the stroke of the Lord, belated!

JOHN WILLIAMSON PALMER.

Oliver Hazard Perry, the victor of Lake Erie, while in command of a squadron in the West Indies, in the summer of 1819, was attacked by yellow fever, and died after a brief illness. His body was brought to the United States in 1826 and buried at Newport.

ON THE DEATH OF COMMODORE OLIVER H. PERRY

By strangers honor'd, and by strangers mourn'd.

[August 23, 1819]

How sad the note of that funereal drum, That's muffled by indifference to the dead! And how reluctantly the echoes come, On air that sighs not o'er that stranger's bed, Who sleeps with death alone. O'er his young head His native breezes never more shall sigh; On his lone grave the careless step shall tread, And pestilential vapors soon shall dry Each shrub that buds around--each flow'r that blushes nigh.

Let Genius, poising on her full-fledg'd wing, Fill the charm'd air with thy deserved praise! Of war, and blood, and carnage let her sing, Of victory and glory!--let her gaze On the dark smoke that shrouds the cannon's blaze, On the red foam that crests the bloody billow; Then mourn the sad close of thy shorten'd days-- Place on thy country's brow the weeping willow, And plant the laurels thick around thy last cold pillow.

No sparks of Grecian fire to me belong: Alike uncouth the poet and the lay; Unskill'd to turn the mighty tide of song, He floats along the current as he may, The humble tribute of a tear to pay. Another hand may choose another theme, May sing of Nelson's last and brightest day, Of Wolfe's unequall'd and unrivall'd fame, The wave of Trafalgar--the fields of Abraham:

But if the wild winds of thy western lake Might teach a harp that fain would mourn the brave, And sweep those strings the minstrel may not wake, Or give an echo from some secret cave That opens on romantic Erie's wave, The feeble cord would not be swept in vain; And though the sound might never reach thy grave, Yet there are spirits here that to the strain Would send a still small voice responsive back again.

JOHN G. C. BRAINARD.

The death of Joseph Rodman Drake, on September 21, 1820, deserves mention here, not so much because of Drake's prominence as a poet as because of the admirable lyric which it called forth--one of the most perfect in American literature.

ON THE DEATH OF JOSEPH RODMAN DRAKE

[September 21, 1820]

Green be the turf above thee, Friend of my better days! None knew thee but to love thee, Nor named thee but to praise.

Tears fell, when thou wert dying, From eyes unused to weep, And long where thou art lying, Will tears the cold turf steep.

When hearts, whose truth was proven, Like thine, are laid in earth, There should a wreath be woven To tell the world their worth;

And I, who woke each morrow To clasp thy hand in mine, Who shared thy joy and sorrow, Whose weal and woe were thine:

It should be mine to braid it Around thy faded brow, But I've in vain essayed it, And feel I cannot now.

While memory bids me weep thee, Nor thoughts nor words are free, The grief is fixed too deeply That mourns a man like thee.

FITZ-GREENE HALLECK.

In 1824, at the invitation of Congress and President Monroe, the Marquis de Lafayette, who had played so important a part in the revolution, visited the United States. He arrived in New York August 15, and for the next fourteen months travelled through the country, visiting every state, and being everywhere received with reverence and affection. On June 17, 1825, he laid the corner-stone of the Bunker Hill Monument.

ON LAYING THE CORNER-STONE OF THE BUNKER HILL MONUMENT

[June 17, 1825]

Oh, is not this a holy spot? 'Tis the high place of Freedom's birth! God of our fathers! is it not The holiest spot of all the earth?

Quenched is thy flame on Horeb's side; The robber roams o'er Sinai now; And those old men, thy seers, abide No more on Zion's mournful brow.

But on _this_ hill thou, Lord, hast dwelt, Since round its head the war-cloud curled, And wrapped our fathers, where they knelt In prayer and battle for a world.

Here sleeps their dust: 'tis holy ground: And we, the children of the brave, From the four winds are gathering round, To lay our offering on their grave.

Free as the winds around us blow, Free as the waves below us spread, We rear a pile, that long shall throw Its shadow on their sacred bed.

But on their deeds no shade shall fall, While o'er their couch thy sun shall flame. Thine ear was bowed to hear their call, And thy right hand shall guard their fame.

JOHN PIERPONT.

Lafayette's sixty-eighth birthday was celebrated at the White House September 6, 1825, and he sailed next day for France, where he died May 20, 1834. The verses by

Dolly Madison which follow were only recently discovered.

LA FAYETTE

Born, nurtured, wedded, prized, within the pale Of peers and princes, high in camp--at court-- He hears, in joyous youth, a wild report, Swelling the murmurs of the Western gale, Of a young people struggling to be free! Straight quitting all, across the wave he flies, Aids with his sword, wealth, blood, the high emprize! And shares the glories of its victory. Then comes for fifty years a high romance Of toils, reverses, sufferings, in the cause Of man and justice, liberty and France, Crowned, at the last, with hope and wide applause. Champion of Freedom! Well thy race was run! All time shall hail thee, _Europe's noblest Son_!

DOLLY MADISON.

Washington, April 25, 1848.

John Adams, second President of the United States, died at his home in Braintree, Mass., July 4, 1826. His last words were, "Thomas Jefferson still lives." But by a curious coincidence, Jefferson had died at his home, Monticello, in Albemarle County, Va., a few hours before.

THE DEATH OF JEFFERSON

[July 4, 1826]

I

'Twas midsummer; cooling breezes all the languid forests fanned, And the angel of the evening drew her curtain o'er the land. Like an isle rose Monticello through the cooled and rippling trees, Like an isle in rippling starlight in the silence of the seas. Ceased the mocking-bird his singing; said the slaves with faltering breath, "'Tis the Third, and on the morrow Heaven will send the Angel Death."

II

In his room at Monticello, lost in dreams the statesman slept, Seeing not the still forms round him, seeing not the eyes that wept, Hearing not the old clock ticking in life's final silence loud, Knowing not when night came o'er him like the shadow of a cloud. In the past his soul is living as in fifty years ago, Hastes again to Philadelphia, hears again the Schuylkill flow--

III

Meets again the elder Adams--knowing not that far away _He_ is waiting for Death's morrow, on old Massachusetts Bay; Meets with Hancock, young and courtly, meets with Hopkins, bent and old, Meets again calm Roger Sherman, fiery Lee, and Carroll

bold, Meets the sturdy form of Franklin, meets the half a hundred men Who have made themselves immortal,--breathes the ancient morn again.

IV

Once again the Declaration in his nerveless hands he holds, And before the waiting statesmen its prophetic hope unfolds,-- Reads again the words puissant, "All men are created free," Claims again for man his birthright, claims the world's equality; Hears the coming and the going of an hundred firm-set feet, Hears the summer breezes blowing 'mid the oak trees cool and sweet.

V

Sees again tall Patrick Henry by the side of Henry Lee, Hears him cry, "And will ye sign it?--it will make all nations free! Fear ye not the axe or gibbet; it shall topple every throne. Sign it for the world's redemption!--all mankind its truth shall own! Stars may fall, but truth eternal shall not falter, shall not fail. Sign it, and the Declaration shall the voice of ages hail.

VI

"Sign, and set yon dumb bell ringing, that the people all may know Man has found emancipation; sign, the Almighty wills it so." Sees one sign it, then another, till like magic moves the pen, Till all have signed it, and it lies there, charter of the rights of men. Hears the small bells, hears the great bell, hanging idly in the sun, Break the silence, and the people whisper, awe-struck, "It is done."

VII

Then the dream began to vanish--burgesses, the war's red flames, Charging Tarleton, proud Cornwallis, navies moving on the James, Years of peace, and years of glory, all began to melt away, And the statesman woke from slumber in the night, and tranquil lay, And his lips moved; friends there gathered with love's silken footstep near, And he whispered, softly whispered in love's low and tender ear,--

VIII

"It is the Fourth?" "No, not yet," they answered, "but 'twill soon be early morn; We will wake you, if you slumber, when the day begins to dawn." Then the statesman left the present, lived again amid the past, Saw, perhaps, the peopled future ope its portals grand and vast, Till the flashes of the morning lit the far horizon low, And the sun's rays o'er the forests in the east began to glow.

IX

Rose the sun, and from the woodlands fell the midnight dews like rain, In magnolias cool and shady sang the mocking-bird again; And the statesman woke from slumber, saw the risen sun, and heard Rippling breezes 'mid the oak trees, and the lattice singing bird, And, his eye serene uplifted, as rejoicing in the sun, "It is the Fourth?" his only question,--to the world his final one.

X

Silence fell on Monticello--for the last dread hour was near, And the old clock's measured ticking only broke upon the ear. All the summer rooms were silent, where the great of earth had trod, All the summer blooms seemed silent as the messengers of God; Silent were the hall and chamber where old councils oft had met, Save the far boom of the cannon that recalled the old day yet.

XI

Silent still is Monticello--he is breathing slowly now, In the splendors of the noon-tide, with the death-dew on his brow-- Silent save the clock still ticking where his soul had given birth To the mighty thoughts of freedom, that should free the fettered earth; Silent save the boom of cannon on the sun-filled wave afar, Bringing 'mid the peace eternal still the memory of war.

XII

Evening in majestic shadows fell upon the fortress' walls; Sweetly were the last bells ringing on the James and on the Charles. 'Mid the choruses of freedom two departed victors lay, One beside the blue Rivanna, one by Massachusetts Bay. _He_ was gone, and night her sable curtain drew across the sky; Gone his soul into all nations, gone to live and not to die.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

On September 14, 1830, the Boston _Advertiser_ contained a paragraph asserting that the Secretary of the Navy had recommended to the Board of Navy Commissioners that the old frigate Constitution, popularly known as "Old Ironsides," be disposed of. Two days later appeared the famous poem by Oliver Wendell Holmes, which instantly became a sort of national battle-cry. Instead of being sold, the Constitution was rebuilt.

OLD IRONSIDES

[September 14, 1830]

Ay, tear her tattered ensign down! Long has it waved on high, And many an eye has danced to see That banner in the sky; Beneath it rung the battle shout, And burst the cannon's roar;-- The meteor of the ocean air Shall sweep the clouds no more.

Her deck, once red with heroes' blood, Where knelt the vanquished foe, When winds were hurrying o'er the flood, And waves were white below, No more shall feel the victor's tread, Or know the conquered knee;-- The harpies of the shore shall pluck The eagle of the sea!

Oh better that her shattered hulk Should sink beneath the wave; Her thunders shook the mighty deep, And there should be her grave; Nail to the mast her holy flag, Set every threadbare sail, And give her to the god of storms, The lightning and the gale!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

CONCORD HYMN

SUNG AT THE COMPLETION OF THE BATTLE MONUMENT, APRIL 19, 1836

By the rude bridge that arched the flood, Their flag to April's breeze unfurled, Here once the embattled farmers stood, And fired the shot heard round the world.

The foe long since in silence slept; Alike the conqueror silent sleeps; And Time the ruined bridge has swept Down the dark stream which seaward creeps.

On this green bank, by this soft stream, We set to-day a votive stone; That memory may their deed redeem, When, like our sires, our sons are gone.

Spirit that made those heroes dare To die, and leave their children free, Bid Time and Nature gently spare The shaft we raise to them and thee.

RALPH WALDO EMERSON.

On December 17, 1839, Longfellow wrote in his journal: "News of shipwrecks horrible on the coast. Twenty bodies washed ashore near Gloucester, one lashed to a piece of the wreck. There is a reef called Norman's Woe where many of these took place; among others the schooner Hesperus. Also the Sea-Flower on Black Rock. I must write a ballad on this." It was written twelve days later.

THE WRECK OF THE HESPERUS

[December 17, 1839]

It was the schooner Hesperus, That sailed the wintry sea; And the skipper had taken his little daughtèr, To bear him company.

Blue were her eyes as the fairy-flax, Her cheeks like the dawn of day, And her bosom white as the hawthorn buds That ope in the month of May.

The skipper he stood beside the helm, His pipe was in his mouth, And he watched how the veering flaw did blow The smoke now West, now South.

Then up and spake an old Sailòr, Had sailed to the Spanish Main, "I pray thee, put into yonder port, For I fear a hurricane.

"Last night, the moon had a golden ring, And to-night no moon we see!" The skipper, he blew a whiff from his pipe, And a scornful laugh laughed he.

Colder and louder blew the wind, A gale from the Northeast, The snow fell hissing in the brine, And the billows frothed like yeast.

Down came the storm, and smote amain The vessel in its strength; She shuddered and paused, like a frighted steed, Then leaped her cable's length.

"Come hither, come hither, my little daughtèr, And do not tremble so; For I can weather the roughest gale That ever wind did blow."

He wrapped her warm in his seaman's coat Against the stinging blast; He cut a rope from a broken spar, And bound her to the mast.

"O father! I hear the church-bells ring, O say, what may it be?" "'Tis a fog-bell on a rock-bound coast!"-- And he steered for the open sea.

"O father! I hear the sound of guns, Oh say, what may it be?" "Some ship in distress, that cannot live In such an angry sea!"

"O father! I see a gleaming light, Oh say, what may it be?" But the father answered never a word, A frozen corpse was he.

Lashed to the helm, all stiff and stark, With his face turned to the skies, The lantern gleamed through the gleaming snow On his fixed and glassy eyes.

Then the maiden clasped her hands and prayed That savèd she might be; And she thought of Christ, who stilled the wave, On the Lake of Galilee.

And fast through the midnight dark and drear, Through the whistling sleet and snow, Like a sheeted ghost, the vessel swept Tow'rds the reef of Norman's Woe.

And ever the fitful gusts between A sound came from the land; It was the sound of the trampling surf On the rocks and the hard sea-sand.

The breakers were right beneath her bows, She drifted a dreary wreck, And a whooping billow swept the crew Like icicles from her deck.

She struck where the white and fleecy waves Looked soft as carded wool, But the cruel rocks, they gored her side Like the horns of an angry bull.

Her rattling shrouds, all sheathed in ice, With the masts, went by the board; Like a vessel of glass, she stove and sank, Ho! ho! the breakers roared!

At daybreak, on the bleak sea-beach, A fisherman stood aghast, To see the form of a maiden fair, Lashed close to a drifting mast.

The salt sea was frozen on her breast, The salt tears in her eyes; And he saw her hair, like the brown sea-weed, On the billows fall and rise.

Such was the wreck of the Hesperus, In the midnight and the snow! Christ save us all from a death like this, On the reef of Norman's Woe!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

The presidential campaign of 1840 was the most exciting that had ever taken place in the United States. William Henry Harrison was the candidate of the Whigs and Martin Van Buren of the Democrats. Harrison was elected by an overwhelming majority.

OLD TIPPECANOE

[October, November, 1840]

Come, rouse up, ye bold-hearted Whigs of Kentucky, And show the nation what deeds you can do; The high-road to victory lies open before ye While led to the charge by Old Tippecanoe.

When Indians were scalping our friends and our brothers, To Ohio's frontier he gallantly flew; And thousands of innocent infants, and mothers, Were saved by the valor of Tippecanoe.

When savage Tecumseh was rallying his forces, In innocent blood his hands to imbrue; Our hero despis'd all his bloody associates, And won the proud name of Old Tippecanoe.

And when this Tecumseh and his brother Proctor, To capture Fort Meigs their utmost did do; Our gallant old hero again play'd the Doctor, And gave them a dose like at Tippecanoe.

And then on the Thames, on the fifth of October, Where musket balls whizz'd as they flew; He blasted their prospects, and rent them asunder, Just like he had done on the Tippecanoe.

Let Greece praise the deeds of her great Alexander And Rome boast of Cæsar and Scipio too; Just like Cincinnatus, that noble commander, Is our old Hero of Tippecanoe.

For when the foes of his country no longer could harm her, To the shades of retirement he quickly withdrew; And now at North Bend see the HONEST OLD FARMER, Who won the green laurel at Tippecanoe.

And when to the National Council elected, The good of his country still see him pursue, And every poor man by him thus protected, Should ever remember "Old Tippecanoe."

And now from retirement the People doth call him, Because he is Honest and Qualified too; And for One Term they soon will install him As President--"Hero of Tippecanoe."

Let _knaves_ call him "coward," and _fools_ call him "_granny_" To answer their _purpose_--this never will do; When rallied around him we'll rout _little_ Vanny, And give him a Thames--or a full _Waterloo_.

The Republican banner of Freedom is flying, The Eagle of Liberty soars in your view; Then rally my hearties--all slanders defying, And thunder huzza! for "Old Tippecanoe."

Among the supporters of brave General Jackson, There are many Republicans, honest and true, To such we say "come out from among them," And "go it for" Tyler and "Tippecanoe."

Harrison was inaugurated March 4, 1841. He was at that time sixty-eight years of age, but he took up the work of his office with a vigor almost youthful. On March 27, however, he contracted a chill, pneumonia developed, and he died April 4. The vice-president, John Tyler, at once took the oath of office as president.

THE DEATH OF HARRISON

[April 4, 1841]

What! soar'd the old eagle to die at the sun! Lies he stiff with spread wings at the goal he had won! Are there spirits more blest than the "Planet of Even," Who mount to their zenith, then melt into Heaven-- No waning of fire, no quenching of ray, But rising, still rising, when passing away? Farewell, gallant eagle! thou'rt buried in light! God-speed into Heaven, lost star of our night!

Death! Death in the White House! Ah, never before, Trod his skeleton foot on the President's floor! He is look'd for in hovel, and dreaded in hall-- The king in his closet keeps hatchment and pall-- The youth in his birthplace, the old man at home, Make clean from the door-stone the path to the tomb;-- But the lord of this mansion was cradled not here-- In a churchyard far-off stands his beckoning bier! He is here as the wave-crest heaves flashing on high-- As the arrow is stopp'd by its prize in the sky-- The arrow to earth, and the foam to the shore-- Death finds them when swiftness and sparkle are o'er-- But Harrison's death fills the climax of story-- He went with his old stride--from glory to glory!

Lay his sword on his breast! There's no spot on its blade In whose cankering breath his bright laurels will fade! 'Twas the first to lead on at humanity's call-- It was stay'd with sweet mercy when "glory" was all! As calm in the council as gallant in war, He fought for its country and not its "hurrah!" In the path of the hero with pity he trod-- Let him pass--with his sword--to the presence of God!

What more? Shall we on with his ashes? Yet, stay! He hath ruled the wide realm of a king in his day! At his word, like a monarch's, went treasure and land-- The bright gold of thousands has pass'd through his hand. Is there nothing to show of his glittering hoard? No jewel to deck the rude hilt of his sword-- No trappings--no horses?--what had he, but now? On!--on with his ashes!--HE LEFT BUT HIS PLOUGH! Brave old Cincinnatus! Unwind ye his sheet! Let him sleep as he lived--with his purse at this feet!

Follow now, as ye list! The first mourner to-day Is the nation--whose father is taken away! Wife, children, and neighbor, may moan on his knell-- He was "lover and friend" to his country, as well! For the stars on our banner, grown suddenly dim, Let

us weep, in our darkness--but weep not for him! Not for him--who, departing, leaves millions in tears! Not for him--who has died full of honor and years! Not for him--who ascended Fame's ladder so high From the round at the top he has stepp'd to the sky!

NATHANIEL PARKER WILLIS.

CHAPTER V

THE WAR WITH MEXICO

In 1821 Mexico acquired her independence of Spain, but the country became the prey of military adventurers, who were made presidents by proclamation, and retained office as long as they had an army to support them. In 1834 Santa Anna, who was in power at the time, abolished the constitution and established a military despotism. The citizens of the province of Texas, which had been largely settled from the United States, revolted and declared their independence. General Cos, the military governor, and fifteen hundred men, were besieged at Bejar, and forced to surrender, after a desperate assault led by Benjamin R. Milam.

THE VALOR OF BEN MILAM

[December 5-11, 1835]

Oh, who will follow old Ben Milam into San Antonio? Such was the thrilling word we heard in the chill December glow; Such was the thrilling word we heard, and a ringing, answering cry Went up from the dun adobe walls to the cloudless Texas sky.

He had won from the reek of a Mexique jail back without map or chart, With his mother-wit and his hero-grit and his stanch Kentucky heart; He had trudged by vale and by mountain trail, and by thorny and thirsty plain, And now, with joy on his grizzled brow, he had come to his own again.

They're the spawn of Hell! we heard him tell; _they will knife and lie and cheat; At the board of none of the swarthy horde would I deign to sit at meat; They hold it naught that I bled and fought when Spain was their ruthless foe; Oh, who will follow old Ben Milam into San Antonio?_

It was four to one, not gun for gun, but never a curse cared we, Three hundred faithful and fearless men who had sworn to make Texas free. It was mighty odds, by all the gods, this brute of the Mexique dam, But it was not much for heroes such as followed old Ben Milam!

With rifle-crack and sabre-hack we drove them back in the street; From house to house in the red carouse we hastened their flying feet; And ever that shout kept pealing out with a swift and sure death-blow: _Oh, who will follow old Ben Milam into San Antonio?_

Behind the walls from the hurtling balls Cos cowered and swore in his beard, While we slashed and slew from dawn till dew, and, Bexar, how we cheered! But ere failed

each ruse, and the white of truce on the failing day was thrown, Our fearless soul had gone to the goal, the Land of the Great Unknown.

Death brought the darksome boon too soon to this truest one of the true, Or, men of the fated Alamo, Milam had died with you! So when their names that now are Fame's--the scorner of braggart sham;-- In song be praised, let a rouse be raised for the name of Ben Milam!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

BEN MILAM

Oft shall the soldier think of thee, Thou dauntless leader of the brave, Who on the heights of Tyranny Won Freedom and a glorious grave.

And o'er thy tomb shall pilgrims weep, And pray to heaven in murmurs low That peaceful be the hero's sleep Who conquered San Antonio.

Enshrined on Honor's deathless scroll, A nation's thanks will tell thy fame; Long as her beauteous rivers roll Shall Freedom's votaries hymn thy name.

For bravest of the Texan clime, Who fought to make her children free, Was Milam, and his death sublime Linked with undying Liberty!

WILLIAM H. WHARTON.

On February 23, 1836, Santa Anna appeared at the head of two thousand men before San Antonio. The town was guarded by a fort called the Alamo, held by Colonel William Travis and one hundred and fifty Texans. Travis sent to Gonzales for reinforcements and shut himself up in the fort. A few days later, thirty-two men got through the Mexican lines, swelling his force to one hundred and eighty-three. After a terrific struggle, the Mexicans carried the fort on March 6. Not one of the garrison survived.

THE MEN OF THE ALAMO

[February 23-March 6, 1836]

To Houston at Gonzales town, ride, Ranger, for your life, Nor stop to say good-bye to-day to home, or child, or wife; But pass the word from ranch to ranch, to every Texan sword, That fifty hundred Mexicans have crossed the Nueces ford, With Castrillon and perjured Cos, Sesmá and Almontê, And Santa Anna ravenous for vengeance and for prey! They smite the land with fire and sword; the grass shall never grow Where northward sweeps that locust herd on San Antonio!

Now who will bar the foeman's path, to gain a breathing space, Till Houston and his scattered men shall meet him face to face? Who holds his life as less than naught when home and honor call, And counts the guerdon full and fair for liberty to fall? Oh, who but Barrett Travis, the bravest of them all! With seven score of riflemen to play the rancher's game, And feed a counter-fire to halt the sweeping prairie flame; For Bowie of the broken blade is there to cheer them on, With Evans of Concepcion, who

conquered Castrillon, And o'er their heads the Lone Star flag defiant floats on high, And no man thinks of yielding, and no man fears to die.

But ere the siege is held a week a cry is heard without, A clash of arms, a rifle peal, the Ranger's ringing shout, And two-and-thirty beardless boys have bravely hewed their way To die with Travis if they must, to conquer if they may. Was ever valor held so cheap in Glory's mart before In all the days of chivalry, in all the deeds of war? But once again the foemen gaze in wonderment and fear To see a stranger break their lines and hear the Texans cheer. God! how they cheered to welcome him, those spent and starving men! For Davy Crockett by their side was worth an army then. The wounded ones forgot their wounds; the dying drew a breath To hail the king of border men, then turned to laugh at death. For all knew Davy Crockett, blithe and generous as bold, And strong and rugged as the quartz that hides its heart of gold. His simple creed for word or deed true as the bullet sped, And rung the target straight: "Be sure you're right, then go ahead!"

And were they right who fought the fight for Texas by his side? They questioned not; they faltered not; they only fought and died. Who hath an enemy like these, God's mercy slay him straight!-- A thousand Mexicans lay dead outside the convent gate, And half a thousand more must die before the fortress falls, And still the tide of war beats high around the leaguered walls. At last the bloody breach is won; the weakened lines give way; The wolves are swarming in the court; the lions stand at bay. The leader meets them at the breach, and wins the soldier's prize; A foeman's bosom sheathes his sword when gallant Travis dies. Now let the victor feast at will until his crest be red-- We may not know what raptures fill the vulture with the dead. Let Santa Anna's valiant sword right bravely hew and hack The senseless corse; its hands are cold; they will not strike him back. Let Bowie die, but 'ware the hand that wields his deadly knife; Four went to slay, and one comes back, so dear he sells his life. And last of all let Crockett fall, too proud to sue for grace, So grand in death the butcher dared not look upon his face.

But far on San Jacinto's field the Texan toils are set, And Alamo's dread memory the Texan steel shall whet. And Fame shall tell their deeds who fell till all the years be run. "Thermopylæ left one alive--the Alamo left none."

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

THE DEFENCE OF THE ALAMO

[March 6, 1835]

Santa Ana came storming, as a storm might come; There was rumble of cannon; there was rattle of blade; There was cavalry, infantry, bugle and drum-- Full seven thousand in pomp and parade. The chivalry, flower of Mexico; And a gaunt two hundred in the Alamo!

And thirty lay sick, and some were shot through; For the siege had been bitter, and bloody, and long. "Surrender, or die!"--"Men, what will _you_ do?" And Travis, great Travis, drew sword, quick and strong; Drew a line at his feet.... "Will you come? Will

you go? _I_ die with my wounded, in the Alamo."

The Bowie gasped, "Lead me over that line!" Then Crockett, one hand to the sick, one hand to his gun, Crossed with him; then never a word or a sign Till all, sick or well, all, all save but one, One man. Then a woman stepped, praying, and slow Across; to die at her post in the Alamo.

Then that one coward fled, in the night, in that night When all men silently prayed and thought Of home; of to-morrow; of God and the right, Till dawn; and with dawn came Travis's cannon-shot, In answer to insolent Mexico, From the old bell-tower of the Alamo.

Then came Santa Ana; a crescent of flame! Then the red escalade; then the fight hand to hand; Such an unequal fight as never had name Since the Persian hordes butchered that doomed Spartan band. All day--all day and all night; and the morning? so slow, Through the battle smoke mantling the Alamo.

Now silence! Such silence! Two thousand lay dead In a crescent outside! And within? Not a breath Save the gasp of a woman, with gory gashed head, All alone, all alone there, waiting for death; And she but a nurse. Yet when shall we know Another like this of the Alamo?

Shout "Victory, victory, victory ho!" I say 'tis not always to the hosts that win! I say that the victory, high or low, Is given the hero who grapples with sin, Or legion or single; just asking to know When duty fronts death in his Alamo.

JOAQUIN MILLER.

A few days later, at Goliad, Colonel Fannin and four hundred soldiers surrendered to the Mexicans under solemn assurances that their lives would be spared. On March 27 the prisoners were marched out under guard and shot down like cattle in the shambles. This massacre aroused the wildest indignation, and recruits flocked to the army under Houston, and on April 21 surprised Santa Anna at San Jacinto, routed the Mexicans, and inflicted a terrible vengeance.

THE FIGHT AT SAN JACINTO

[April 21, 1836]

"Now for a brisk and cheerful fight!" Said Harman, big and droll, As he coaxed his flint and steel for a light, And puffed at his cold clay bowl; "For we are a skulking lot," says he, "Of land-thieves hereabout, And the bold señores, two to one, Have come to smoke us out."

Santa Anna and Castrillon, Almonte brave and gay, Portilla red from Goliad, And Cos with his smart array. Dulces and cigaritos, And the light guitar, ting-tum! Sant' Anna courts siesta-- And Sam Houston taps his drum.

The buck stands still in the timber-- "Is't the patter of nuts that fall?" The foal of the wild mare whinnies-- "Did he hear the Comanche call?" In the brake by the crawling bayou The slinking she-wolves howl, And the mustang's snort in the river

sedge Has startled the paddling fowl.

A soft low tap, and a muffled tap, And a roll not loud nor long-- We would not break Sant' Anna's nap, Nor spoil Almonte's song. Saddles and knives and rifles! Lord! but the men were glad When Deaf Smith muttered "Alamo!" And Karnes hissed "Goliad!"

The drummer tucked his sticks in his belt, And the fifer gripped his gun. Oh, for one free, wild Texan yell, And we took the slope in a run! But never a shout nor a shot we spent, Nor an oath nor a prayer that day, Till we faced the bravos, eye to eye, And then we blazed away.

Then we knew the rapture of Ben Milam, And the glory that Travis made, With Bowie's lunge and Crockett's shot, And Fannin's dancing blade; And the heart of the fighter, bounding free In his joy so hot and mad-- When Millard charged for Alamo, Lamar for Goliad.

Deaf Smith rode straight, with reeking spur, Into the shock and rout: "I've hacked and burned the bayou bridge, There's no sneak's back-way out!" Muzzle or butt for Goliad, Pistol and blade and fist! Oh, for the knife that never glanced, And the gun that never missed!

Dulces and cigaritos, Song and the mandolin! That gory swamp was a gruesome grove To dance fandangos in. We bridged the bog with the sprawling herd That fell in that frantic rout; We slew and slew till the sun set red, And the Texan star flashed out.

JOHN WILLIAMSON PALMER.

The victory at San Jacinto ended the war. Santa Anna at once signed a treaty recognizing the independence of Texas, and it was formally ratified May 14, 1836. The Republic of Texas was established, and commissioners were dispatched to Washington to secure recognition and proffer annexation.

SONG OF TEXAS

Make room on our banner bright That flaps in the lifting gale, For the orb that lit the fight In Jacinto's storied vale. Through clouds, all dark of hue, It arose with radiant face; Oh, grant to a sister true, Ye stars, in your train a place!

The blood of the Saxon flows In the veins of the men who cry,-- "Give ear, give ear unto those Who pine for their native sky! We call on our Motherland For a home in Freedom's hall,-- While stretching forth the hand, Oh, build no dividing wall!

"The Mexican vaunteth no more; In strife we have tamed his pride; The coward raps not at your door, Speak out! shall it open wide? Oh, the wish of our hearts is strong, That the star of Jacinto's fight Have place in the flashing throng That spangle your banner bright."

WILLIAM HENRY CUYLER HOSMER.

The question of the admission of Texas was destined to occasion the bitterest controversy that ever shook the Union. The struggle between the advocates of

freedom and of slavery was at its height; the former feared that to annex Texas, with its two hundred thousand square miles, would be to seat the slave interests more firmly than ever in power. It would also involve war with Mexico. The controversy raged with unexampled venom, but on December 29, 1845, Texas was admitted to the Union.

TEXAS

VOICE OF NEW ENGLAND

Up the hillside, down the glen, Rouse the sleeping citizen; Summon out the might of men!

Like a lion growling low, Like a night-storm rising slow, Like the tread of unseen foe;

It is coming, it is nigh! Stand your homes and altars by; On your own free thresholds die.

Clang the bells in all your spires; On the gray hills of your sires Fling to heaven your signal-fires.

From Wachuset, lone and bleak, Unto Berkshire's tallest peak, Let the flame-tongued heralds speak.

Oh, for God and duty stand, Heart to heart and hand to hand, Round the old graves of the land.

Whoso shrinks or falters now, Whoso to the yoke would bow, Brand the craven on his brow!

Freedom's soil hath only place For a free and fearless race, None for traitors false and base.

Perish party, perish clan; Strike together while ye can, Like the arm of one strong man.

Like that angel's voice sublime, Heard above a world of crime, Crying of the end of time;

With one heart and with one mouth, Let the North unto the South Speak the word befitting both:

"What though Issachar be strong! Ye may load his back with wrong Overmuch and over long:

"Patience with her cup o'errun, With her weary thread outspun, Murmurs that her work is done.

"Make our Union-bond a chain, Weak as tow in Freedom's strain Link by link shall snap in twain.

"Vainly shall your sand-wrought rope Bind the starry cluster up, Shattered over heaven's blue cope!

"Give us bright though broken rays, Rather than eternal haze, Clouding o'er the full-orbed blaze.

"Take your land of sun and bloom; Only leave to Freedom room For her plough, and forge, and loom;

"Take your slavery-blackened vales; Leave us but our own free gales, Blowing on our thousand sails.

"Boldly, or with treacherous art, Strike the blood-wrought chain apart; Break the Union's mighty heart;

"Work the ruin, if ye will; Pluck upon your heads an ill Which shall grow and deepen still.

"With your bondman's right arm bare, With his heart of black despair, Stand alone, if stand ye dare!

"Onward with your fell design; Dig the gulf and draw the line: Fire beneath your feet the mine:

"Deeply, when the wide abyss Yawns between your land and this, Shall ye feel your helplessness.

"By the hearth and in the bed, Shaken by a look or tread, Ye shall own a guilty dread.

"And the curse of unpaid toil, Downward through your generous soil Like a fire shall burn and spoil.

"Our bleak hills shall bud and blow, Vines our rocks shall overgrow, Plenty in our valleys flow;--

"And when vengeance clouds your skies, Hither shall ye turn your eyes, As the lost on Paradise!

"We but ask our rocky strand, Freedom's true and brother band, Freedom's strong and honest hand;

"Valleys by the slave untrod, And the Pilgrim's mountain sod, Blessèd of our fathers' God!"

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The Mexican minister had already demanded his passports, and the annexation of Texas to the Union was regarded by Mexico as an act of war. A Mexican army was collected on the Rio Grande, while an American army of occupation under General Zachary Taylor was thrown into Texas. The war awakened the most violent hostility in the North, and especially in New England, where it was held to be merely a pretext for extending slave territory.

MR. HOSEA BIGLOW SPEAKS

Thrash away, you'll _hev_ to rattle On them kittle-drums o' yourn,-- 'Taint a knowin' kind o' cattle Thet is ketched with mouldy corn; Put in stiff, you fifer feller, Let folks see how spry you be,-- Guess you'll toot till you are yeller 'Fore you git ahold o' me!

Thet air flag's a leetle rotten, Hope it aint your Sunday's best;-- Fact! it takes a sight o' cotton To stuff out a soger's chest: Sence we farmers hev to pay fer 't, Ef you must wear humps like these, S'posin' you should try salt hay fer 't, It would du ez slick ez grease.

'Twouldn't suit them Southun fellers, They're a dreffle graspin' set, We must ollers blow the bellers Wen they want their irons het; May be it's all right ez preachin', But _my_ narves it kind o' grates, Wen I see the overreachin' O' them nigger-drivin' States.

Them thet rule us, them slave-traders, Haint they cut a thunderin' swarth (Helped by Yankee renegaders), Thru the vartu o' the North! We begin to think it's nater To take sarse an' not be riled;-- Who'd expect to see a tater All on eend at bein' biled?

Ez fer war, I call it murder,-- There you hev it plain an' flat; I don't want to go no furder Than my Testyment fer that; God hez sed so plump an' fairly, It's ez long ez it is broad, An' you've gut to git up airly Ef you want to take in God.

'Taint your eppyletts an' feathers Make the thing a grain more right; 'Taint afollerin' your bell-wethers Will excuse ye in His sight; Ef you take a sword an' dror it, An' go stick a feller thru, Guv'ment aint to answer for it, God'll send the bill to you.

Wut's the use o' meetin'-goin' Every Sabbath, wet or dry, Ef it's right to go amowin' Feller-men like oats an' rye? I dunno but what it's pooty Trainin' round in bobtail coats,-- But it's curus Christian dooty This 'ere cuttin' folks's throats.

They may talk o' Freedom's airy Tell they're pupple in the face,-- It's a grand gret cemetary Fer the barthrights of our race; They jest want this Californy So's to lug new slave-states in To abuse ye, an' to scorn ye, An' to plunder ye like sin.

Aint it cute to see a Yankee Take sech everlastin' pains, All to get the Devil's thankee Helpin' on 'em weld their chains? Wy, it's jest ez clear es figgers, Clear ez one an' one make two, Chaps thet make black slaves o' niggers Want to make wite slaves o' you.

Tell ye jest the eend I've come to Arter cipherin' plaguy smart, An' it makes a handy sum, tu, Any gump could larn by heart; Laborin' man an' laborin' woman, Hev one glory an' one shame, Ev'y thin' thet's done inhuman Injers all on 'em the same.

'Taint by turnin' out to hack folks You're agoin' to git your right, Nor by lookin' down on black folks Coz you're put upon by wite; Slavery aint o' nary color, 'Taint the hide thet makes it wus, All it keers fer in a feller 'S jest to make him fill its pus.

Want to tackle _me_ in, du ye? I expect you'll hev to wait; Wen cold lead puts daylight thru ye You'll begin to kal'late; S'pose the crows wun't fall to pickin' All the carkiss from your bones, Coz you helped to give a lickin' To them poor half-Spanish

drones?

Jest go home an' ask our Nancy Wether I'd be such a goose Ez to jine ye,--guess you'd fancy The eternal bung wuz loose! She wants me fer home consumption, Let alone the hay's to mow,-- Ef you're arter folks o' gumption, You've a darned long row to hoe.

Take them editors thet's crowin' Like a cockerel three months old,-- Don't ketch any on 'em goin', Though they _be_ so blasted bold; _Aint_ they a prime lot o' fellers? 'Fore they think on 't guess they'll sprout (Like a peach thet's got the yellers), With the meanness bustin' out.

Wal, go 'long to help 'em stealin' Bigger pens to cram with slaves, Help the men thet's ollers dealin' Insults on your fathers' graves; Help the strong to grind the feeble, Help the many agin the few, Help the men thet call your people Witewashed slaves an' peddlin' crew!

Massachusetts, God forgive her, She's akneelin' with the rest, She, thet ough' to ha' clung ferever In her grand old eagle-nest; She thet ough' to stand so fearless W'ile the wracks are round her hurled, Holdin' up a beacon peerless To the oppressed of all the world!

Ha'n't they sold your colored seamen? Ha'n't they made your env'ys w'iz? _Wut_'ll make ye act like freemen? _Wut_'ll git your dander riz? Come, I tell you wut I'm thinkin' Is our dooty in this fix, They'd ha' done 't ez quick ez winkin' In the days o' seventy-six.

Clang the bells in every steeple, Call all true men to disown The tradoocers of our people, The enslavers o' their own; Let our dear old Bay State proudly Put the trumpet to her mouth, Let her ring this messidge loudly In the ears of all the South:--

"I'll return ye good fer evil Much ez we frail mortils can, But I wun't go help the Devil Makin' man the cus o' man; Call me coward, call me traitor, Jest ez suits your mean idees,-- Here I stand a tyrant-hater, An' the friend o' God an' Peace!"

Ef I'd _my_ way I hed ruther We should go to work an' part, They take one way, we take t'other, Guess it wouldn't break my heart; Man hed ough' to put asunder Them thet God has noways jined; An' I shouldn't gretly wonder Ef there's thousands o' my mind.

JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL.

General Taylor took up his station opposite Matamoras, where the Mexican army was, and the Mexicans finally attacked Fort Brown, which Taylor had erected opposite one of their batteries. On May 7 Taylor started to relieve the fort, with a force of twenty-one hundred men, and at noon next day found the Mexican army, six thousand strong, drawn up before him at Palo Alto. Taylor ordered Lieutenant Blake to reconnoitre the enemy's position.

THE GUNS IN THE GRASS

[May 8, 1846]

As hang two mighty thunderclouds Ere lightnings link the twain, So lie we and the Mexican On Palo Alto plain; And silence, solemn, dread, profound, Broods o'er the waiting battle-ground.

We see the foeman's musketeers Deployed upon his right, And on his left the cavalry Stand, hungry for the fight; But that blank centre--what? Alas, 'Tis hidden by the prairie grass!

Old Rough and Ready scans the foe; "I would I knew," says he, "Whether or no that lofty grass Conceals artillery. Could I but bring that spot in ken, 'Twere worth to me five thousand men!"

Then forward steps Lieutenant Blake, Touches his hat, and says, "I wait command to ride and see What 'neath that prairie lays." We stand amazed: no cowards, we: But this is more than bravery!

"'Command'!" cries Taylor; "nay, I ne'er To such a deed 'command!'" Then bends he o'er his horse's neck And takes as brave a hand As e'er a loyal sabre bore: "God bless you, Blake," he says--no more.

The soldier to his saddle springs And gayly waves good-by, Determination on his lips, A proud light in his eye: And then, as pity holds our breath, We see him dare that road of death.

To utmost pace his steed he spurs. Save that his sword hangs free, It were as though a madman charged A nation's chivalry! On, on, he flies, his steed unreined Till yonder hillock's crest is gained.

And now he checks his horse, dismounts, And coolly through his glass Surveys the phalanx of the foe That lies beyond the grass. A musket-flash! They move! Advance! Halt!--'twas the sunlight on a lance!

He turns, remounts, and speeds him back. Hark! what is that we hear? Across the rolling prairie rings-- A gun? ah, no--a cheer! A noble tribute sweeps the plain: A thousand throats take up the strain.

Safe! But the secret to unveil Taylor no longer seeks; For with a roar that shakes the earth That unmasked centre speaks! 'Gainst fearful odds, till set of sun, We battle--and the field is won!

THOMAS FROST.

Blake brought back with him an accurate description of the disposition of the Mexican forces, and Taylor resolved to attack, despite the odds against him. His artillery did great execution, and gradually advanced, as the Mexicans were forced back. Charge after charge was repulsed, and the Mexicans finally withdrew to Resaca de la Palma. There Taylor attacked them next day, routed them, and marched on to relieve Fort Brown.

RIO BRAVO--A MEXICAN LAMENT

[May 8, 1846]

Rio Bravo! Rio Bravo! Saw men ever such a sight? Since the field of Roncesvalles Sealed the fate of many a knight.

Dark is Palo Alto's story, Sad Reseca Palma's rout, On those fatal fields so gory, Many a gallant life went out.

There our best and bravest lances Shivered 'gainst the Northern steel, Left the valiant hearts that couched them 'Neath the Northern charger's heel.

Rio Bravo! Rio Bravo! Minstrel ne'er knew such a fight Since the field of Roncesvalles Sealed the fate of many a knight.

Rio Bravo, fatal river, Saw ye not while red with gore, Torrejon all headless quiver, A ghastly trunk upon thy shore!

Heard you not the wounded coursers Shrieking on your trampled banks, As the Northern winged artillery Thundered on our shattered ranks!

There Arista, best and bravest, There Raguena, tried and true, On the fatal field thou lavest, Nobly did all men could do.

Vainly there those heroes rally, Castile on Montezuma's shore, "Rio Bravo"--"Roncesvalles," Ye are names blent evermore.

Weepest thou, lorn lady Inez, For thy lover 'mid the slain, Brave La Vega's trenchant falchion Cleft his slayer to the brain.

Brave La Vega who all lonely, By a host of foes beset, Yielded up his sabre only When his equal there he met.

Other champions not less noted Sleep beneath that sullen wave; Rio Bravo, thou hast floated An army to an ocean grave.

On they came, those Northern horsemen, On like eagles toward the sun, Followed then the Northern bayonet, And the field was lost and won.

Oh! for Orlando's horn to rally His Paladins on that sad shore, "Rio Bravo"--"Roncesvalles," Ye are names blent evermore.

Translated by CHARLES FENNO HOFFMAN from the Spanish of DON JOSE DE SALTILLO.

These brilliant victories served to kindle enthusiasm for the war throughout the whole country. Congress authorized the enlistment of fifty thousand volunteers, and reinforcements were promptly started to General Taylor at Matamoras.

TO ARMS

[1846]

Awake! arise, ye men of might! The glorious hour is nigh,-- Your eagle pauses in his flight, And screams his battle-cry.

From North to South, from East to West: Send back an answering cheer, And say farewell to peace and rest, And banish doubt and fear.

Arm! arm! your country bids you arm! Fling out your banners free-- Let drum and trumpet sound alarm, O'er mountains, plain, and sea.

March onward from th' Atlantic shore, To Rio Grande's tide-- Fight as your fathers fought of yore! Die as your fathers died!

Go! vindicate your country's fame, Avenge your country's wrong! The sons should own a deathless name, To whom such sires belong.

The kindred of the noble dead As noble deeds should dare: The fields whereon their blood was shed A deeper stain must bear.

To arms! to arms! ye men of might; Away from home, away! The first and foremost in the fight Are sure to win the day!

PARK BENJAMIN.

By the last of August, Taylor had whipped his army into shape, and began to advance on Monterey, a town believed to be impregnable, and where General Arista had collected an army of ten thousand men. The American army reached the town September 19; and after two days' desperate fighting the town surrendered.

MONTEREY

[September 23, 1846]

We were not many, we who stood Before the iron sleet that day: Yet many a gallant spirit would Give half his years if but he could Have been with us at Monterey.

Now here, now there, the shot is hail'd In deadly drifts of fiery spray, Yet not a single soldier quail'd When wounded comrades round them wail'd Their dying shout at Monterey.

And on--still on our column kept Through walls of flame its withering way; Where fell the dead, the living stept, Still charging on the guns which swept The slippery streets of Monterey.

The foe himself recoil'd aghast, When, striking where he strongest lay, We swoop'd his flanking batteries past, And braving full their murderous blast, Storm'd home the towers of Monterey.

Our banners on those turrets wave, And there our evening bugles play: Where orange-boughs above their grave Keep green the memory of the brave Who fought and fell at Monterey.

We are not many--we who press'd Beside the brave who fell that day-- But who of us has not confess'd He'd rather share their warrior rest Than not have been at Monterey?

CHARLES FENNO HOFFMAN.

The city had cost the Americans five hundred in killed and wounded; but the Mexican loss was nearly twice as great. Among the American dead was Victor Galbraith, a bugler in a company of volunteer cavalry, who was shot for disobeying orders.

VICTOR GALBRAITH

[September 23, 1846]

Under the walls of Monterey At daybreak the bugles began to play, Victor Galbraith! In the mist of the morning damp and gray, These were the words they seemed to say: "Come forth to thy death, Victor Galbraith!"

Forth he came, with a martial tread; Firm was his step, erect his head; Victor Galbraith, He who so well the bugle played, Could not mistake the words it said: "Come forth to thy death, Victor Galbraith!"

He looked at the earth, he looked at the sky, He looked at the files of musketry, Victor Galbraith! And he said, with a steady voice and eye, "Take good aim; I am ready to die!" Thus challenges death Victor Galbraith.

Twelve fiery tongues flashed straight and red, Six leaden balls on their errand sped; Victor Galbraith Falls to the ground, but he is not dead: His name was not stamped on those balls of lead, And they only scath Victor Galbraith.

Three balls are in his breast and brain, But he rises out of the dust again, Victor Galbraith! The water he drinks has a bloody stain; "Oh, kill me, and put me out of my pain!" In his agony prayeth Victor Galbraith.

Forth dart once more those tongues of flame, And the bugler has died a death of shame, Victor Galbraith! His soul has gone back to whence it came, And no one answers to the name When the Sergeant saith, "Victor Galbraith!"

Under the walls of Monterey By night a bugle is heard to play, Victor Galbraith! Through the mist of the valley damp and gray The sentinels hear the sound, and say, "That is the wraith Of Victor Galbraith!"

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

Further reinforcements were hurried forward to General Taylor. Santa Anna had collected a great army, and Taylor fell back to Angostura, near the village of Buena Vista. There, on February 22, Santa Anna summoned him to surrender, stating that he was surrounded by twenty thousand men and could not avoid defeat. Taylor tartly refused, and Santa Anna advanced to the attack, only to be routed after a desperate two days' struggle.

BUENA VISTA

[February 22-23, 1847]

From the Rio Grande's waters to the icy lakes of Maine, Let all exult! for we have met the enemy again; Beneath their stern old mountains we have met them in their pride, And rolled from BUENA VISTA back the battle's bloody tide; Where the enemy came surging swift, like the Mississippi's flood, And the reaper, Death, with strong arms swung his sickle red with blood.

SANTANA boasted loudly that, before two hours were past, His Lancers through Saltillo should pursue us fierce and fast:-- On comes his solid infantry, line marching after line; Lo! their great standards in the sun like sheets of silver shine: With thousands upon thousands,--yea, with more than three to one,-- Their forests of bright bayonets fierce-flashing in the sun.

Lo! Guanajuato's regiment; Morelos' boasted corps, And Guadalajara's chosen troops!--all veterans tried before. Lo! galloping upon the right four thousand lances gleam, Where, floating in the morning wind, their blood-red pennons stream; And here his stern artillery climbs up the broad plateau: To-day he means to strike at us an overwhelming blow.

Now, WOOL, hold strongly to the heights! for, lo! the mighty tide Comes, thundering like an avalanche, deep, terrible, and wide. Now, ILLINOIS, stand steady! Now, KENTUCKY, to their aid! For a portion of our line, alas! is broken and dismayed: Great bands of shameless fugitives are fleeing from the field, And the day is lost, if Illinois and brave Kentucky yield.

One of O'Brien's guns is gone!--On, on their masses drift, Till their cavalry and infantry outflank us on the left; Our light troops, driven from the hills, retreat in wild dismay, And round us gather, thick and dark, the Mexican array. SANTANA thinks the day is gained; for, now approaching near, MIÑON'S dark cloud of Lancers sternly menaces our rear.

Now, LINCOLN, gallant gentleman, lies dead upon the field, Who strove to stay those cravens, when before the storm they reeled. Fire, WASHINGTON, fire fast and true! Fire, SHERMAN, fast and far! Lo! BRAGG comes thundering to the front, to breast the adverse war! SANTANA thinks the day is gained! On, on his masses crowd, And the roar of battle swells again more terrible and loud.

NOT YET! Our brave old General comes to regain the day; KENTUCKY, to the rescue! MISSISSIPPI, to the fray! Again our line advances! Gallant DAVIS fronts the foe, And back before his rifles, in red waves the Lancers flow. Upon them yet once more, ye brave! The avalanche is stayed! Back roll the Aztec multitudes, all broken and dismayed.

Ride! MAY!--To Buena Vista! for the Lancers gain our rear, And we have few troops there to check their vehement career. Charge, ARKANSAS! KENTUCKY, charge! YELL, PORTER, VAUGHAN, are slain. But the shattered troops cling desperately unto that crimsoned plain; Till, with the Lancers intermixed, pursuing and pursued, Westward, in combat hot and close, drifts off the multitude.

And MAY comes charging from the hills with his ranks of flaming steel, While, shattered with a sudden fire, the foe already reel: They flee amain!--Now to the left,

to stay the torrent there, Or else the day is surely lost, in horror and despair! For their hosts pour swiftly onward, like a river in the spring, Our flank is turned, and on our left their cannon thundering.

Now, good Artillery! bold Dragoons! Steady, brave hearts, be calm! Through rain, cold hail, and thunder, now nerve each gallant arm! What though their shot fall round us here, yet thicker than the hail? We'll stand against them, as the rock stands firm against the gale. Lo! their battery is silenced! but our iron sleet still showers: They falter, halt, retreat,--Hurrah! the glorious day is ours!

In front, too, has the fight gone well, where upon gallant LANE, And on stout Mississippi, the thick Lancers charged in vain: Ah! brave Third Indiana! you have nobly wiped away The reproach that through another corps befell your State to-day; For back, all broken and dismayed, before your storm of fire, SANTANA'S boasted chivalry, a shattered wreck, retire.

Now charge again, SANTANA! or the day is surely lost-- For back, like broken waves, along our left your hordes are tossed. Still faster roar his batteries,--his whole reserve moves on; More work remains for us to do, ere the good fight is won. Now for your wives and children, men! Stand steady yet once more! Fight for your lives and honors! Fight as you never fought before!

Ho! HARDIN breasts it bravely! and heroic BISSELL there Stands firm before the storm of balls that fill the astonished air: The Lancers dash upon them too! The foe swarm ten to one: HARDIN is slain; MCKEE and CLAY the last time see the sun: And many another gallant heart, in that last desperate fray, Grew cold, its last thought turning to its loved ones far away.

Speed, speed, Artillery! to the front!--for the hurricane of fire Crushes those noble regiments, reluctant to retire! Speed swiftly! Gallop! Ah! they come! Again BRAGG climbs the ridge, And his grape sweeps down the swarming foe, as a strong man moweth sedge: Thus baffled in their last attack, compelled perforce to yield, Still menacing in firm array, their columns leave the field.

The guns still roared at intervals; but silence fell at last, And on the dead and dying came the evening shadows fast. And then above the mountains rose the cold moon's silver shield, And patiently and pitying she looked upon the field. While careless of his wounded, and neglectful of his dead, Despairingly and sullenly by night SANTANA fled.

And thus on BUENA VISTA'S heights a long day's work was done, And thus our brave old General another battle won. Still, still our glorious banner waves, unstained by flight or shame, And the Mexicans among their hills still tremble at our name. SO, HONOR UNTO THOSE THAT STOOD! DISGRACE TO THOSE THAT FLED! AND EVERLASTING GLORY UNTO BUENA VISTA'S DEAD!

ALBERT PIKE.

February 28, 1847.

THE ANGELS OF BUENA VISTA

[February 22-23, 1847]

Speak and tell us, our Ximena, looking northward far away, O'er the camp of the invaders, o'er the Mexican array, Who is losing? who is winning? are they far or come they near? Look abroad, and tell us, sister, whither rolls the storm we hear.

"Down the hills of Angostura still the storm of battle rolls; Blood is flowing, men are dying; God have mercy on their souls!" Who is losing? who is winning? "Over hill and over plain, I see but smoke of cannon clouding through the mountain rain."

Holy Mother! keep our brothers! Look, Ximena, look once more. "Still I see the fearful whirlwind rolling darkly as before, Bearing on, in strange confusion, friend and foeman, foot and horse, Like some wild and troubled torrent sweeping down its mountain course."

Look forth once more, Ximena! "Ah! the smoke has rolled away; And I see the Northern rifles gleaming down the ranks of gray. Hark! that sudden blast of bugles! there the troop of Minon wheels; There the Northern horses thunder, with the cannon at their heels.

"Jesu, pity! how it thickens! now retreat and now advance! Right against the blazing cannon shivers Puebla's charging lance! Down they go, the brave young riders; horse and foot together fall; Like a ploughshare in the fallow, through them ploughs the Northern ball."

Nearer came the storm and nearer, rolling fast and frightful on! Speak, Ximena, speak and tell us, who has lost, and who has won? "Alas! alas! I know not; friend and foe together fall, O'er the dying rush the living: pray, my sisters, for them all!

"Lo! the wind the smoke is lifting. Blessed Mother, save my brain! I can see the wounded crawling slowly out from heaps of slain. Now they stagger, blind and bleeding; now they fall, and strive to rise; Hasten, sisters, haste and save them, lest they die before our eyes!

"O my heart's love! O my dear one! lay thy poor head on my knee; Dost thou know the lips that kiss thee? Canst thou hear me? canst thou see? O my husband, brave and gentle! O my Bernal, look once more On the blessed cross before thee! Mercy! mercy! all is o'er!"

Dry thy tears, my poor Ximena; lay thy dear one down to rest; Let his hands be meekly folded, lay the cross upon his breast; Let his dirge be sung hereafter, and his funeral masses said; To-day, thou poor bereaved one, the living ask thy aid.

Close beside her, faintly moaning, fair and young, a soldier lay, Torn with shot and pierced with lances, bleeding slow his life away; But, as tenderly before him the lorn Ximena knelt, She saw the Northern eagle shining on his pistol-belt.

With a stifled cry of horror straight she turned away her head; With a sad and bitter feeling looked she back upon her dead; But she heard the youth's low moaning, and his struggling breath of pain, And she raised the cooling water to his parching

lips again.

Whispered low the dying soldier, pressed her hand and faintly smiled; Was that pitying face his mother's? did she watch beside her child? All his stranger words with meaning her woman's heart supplied; With her kiss upon his forehead, "Mother!" murmured he, and died!

"A bitter curse upon them, poor boy, who led thee forth, From some gentle, sad-eyed mother, weeping, lonely, in the North!" Spake the mournful Mexic woman, as she laid him with her dead, And turned to soothe the living, and bind the wounds which bled.

Look forth once more, Ximena! "Like a cloud before the wind Rolls the battle down the mountains, leaving blood and death behind; Ah! they plead in vain for mercy; in the dust the wounded strive; Hide your faces, holy angels! O thou Christ of God, forgive!"

Sink, O Night, among thy mountains! let the cool, gray shadows fall; Dying brothers, fighting demons, drop thy curtain over all! Through the thickening winter twilight, wide apart the battle rolled, In its sheath the sabre rested, and the cannon's lips grew cold.

But the noble Mexic women still their holy task pursued, Through that long, dark night of sorrow, worn and faint and lacking food. Over weak and suffering brothers, with a tender care they hung, And the dying foeman blessed them in a strange and Northern tongue.

Not wholly lost, O Father! is this evil world of ours; Upward, through its blood and ashes, spring afresh the Eden flowers; From its smoking hell of battle, Love and Pity send their prayer, And still thy white-winged angels hover dimly in our air!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The American forces in this memorable battle totalled 4691, while the Mexicans mustered over 23,000 men. The Mexican losses exceeded 2500. The Americans lost 264 killed and 450 wounded. Theodore O'Hara's famous poem was written to commemorate them.

THE BIVOUAC OF THE DEAD

The muffled drum's sad roll has beat The soldier's last tattoo; No more on Life's parade shall meet That brave and fallen few. On Fame's eternal camping-ground Their silent tents are spread, And Glory guards, with solemn round, The bivouac of the dead.

No rumor of the foe's advance Now swells upon the wind; No troubled thought at midnight haunts Of loved ones left behind; No vision of the morrow's strife The warrior's dream alarms; No braying horn nor screaming fife At dawn shall call to arms.

Their shivered swords are red with rust; Their plumèd heads are bowed; Their haughty banner, trailed in dust, Is now their martial shroud. And plenteous funeral tears have washed The red stains from each brow, And the proud forms, by battle gashed, Are free from anguish now.

The neighing troop, the flashing blade, The bugle's stirring blast, The charge, the dreadful cannonade, The din and shout are past; Nor war's wild note, nor glory's peal, Shall thrill with fierce delight Those breasts that nevermore may feel The rapture of the fight.

Like the fierce northern hurricane That sweeps his great plateau, Flushed with the triumph yet to gain, Came down the serried foe. Who heard the thunder of the fray Break o'er the field beneath, Knew well the watchword of that day Was "Victory or Death."

Long had the doubtful conflict raged O'er all that stricken plain, For never fiercer fight had waged The vengeful blood of Spain; And still the storm of battle blew, Still swelled the gory tide; Not long our stout old chieftain knew, Such odds his strength could bide.

'Twas in that hour his stern command Called to a martyr's grave The flower of his belovèd land, The nation's flag to save. By rivers of their fathers' gore His first-born laurels grew, And well he deemed the sons would pour Their lives for glory too.

Full many a norther's breath has swept, O'er Angostura's plain-- And long the pitying sky has wept Above its mouldered slain. The raven's scream or eagle's flight Or shepherd's pensive lay, Alone awakes each sullen height That frowned o'er that dread fray.

Sons of the Dark and Bloody ground, Ye must not slumber there, Where stranger steps and tongues resound Along the heedless air. Your own proud land's heroic soil Shall be your fitter grave; She claims from war his richest spoil-- The ashes of her brave.

Thus 'neath their parent turf they rest, Far from the gory field Borne to a Spartan mother's breast On many a bloody shield; The sunshine of their native sky Smiles sadly on them here, And kindred eyes and hearts watch by The heroes' sepulchre.

Rest on, embalmed and sainted dead! Dear as the blood ye gave, No impious footstep here shall tread The herbage of your grave; Nor shall your story be forgot, While Fame her record keeps, Or Honor points the hallowed spot Where Valor proudly sleeps.

Yon marble minstrel's voiceless stone In deathless song shall tell When many a vanished age hath flown, The story how ye fell; Nor wreck, nor change, nor winter's blight, Nor Time's remorseless doom, Shall dim one ray of glory's light That gilds your deathless tomb.

THEODORE O'HARA.

Despite the victories, the war continued unpopular in New England, and particularly in Massachusetts. In the campaign of 1847, Caleb Cushing, who had

raised a regiment at his own expense and taken it to Mexico, was nominated by the Democrats for governor, but was defeated by George Nixon Briggs, his Whig opponent, by a majority of fourteen thousand.

WHAT MR. ROBINSON THINKS

[1847]

Guvener B. is a sensible man; He stays to his home an' looks arter his folks; He draws his furrer ez straight ez he can, An' into nobody's tater-patch pokes; But John P. Robinson he Sez he wunt vote fer Guvener B.

My! aint it terrible? Wut shall we du? We can't never choose him o' course,--thet's flat; Guess we shell hev to come round, (don't you?) An' go in fer thunder an' guns, an' all that; Fer John P. Robinson he Sez he wunt vote fer Guvener B.

Gineral C. is a dreffle smart man: He's ben on all sides thet give places or pelf; But consistency still wuz a part of his plan,-- He's ben true to _one_ party,--an' thet is himself;-- So John P. Robinson he Sez he shall vote fer Gineral C.

Gineral C. he goes in fer the war; He don't vally princerple more 'n an old cud; Wut did God make us raytional creeturs fer, But glory an' gunpowder, plunder an' blood? So John P. Robinson he Sez he shall vote fer Gineral C.

We were gittin' on nicely up here to our village, With good old idees o' wut's right an' wut aint, We kind o' thought Christ went agin war an' pillage, An' thet eppyletts worn't the best mark of a saint; But John P. Robinson he Sez this kind o' thing's an exploded idee.

The side of our country must ollers be took, An' Presidunt Polk, you know, _he_ is our country. An' the angel thet writes all our sins in a book Puts the _debit_ to him, an' to us the _per contry_; An' John P. Robinson he Sez this is his view o' the thing to a T.

Parson Wilbur he calls all these argiments lies; Sez they're nothin' on airth but jest _fee, faw, fum_; An' thet all this big talk of our destinies Is half on it ign'ance, an' t'other half rum; But John P. Robinson he Sez it aint no sech thing; an', of course, so must we.

Parson Wilbur sez _he_ never heerd in his life Thet th' Apostles rigged out in their swaller-tail coats, An' marched round in front of a drum an' a fife, To git some on 'em office, an' some on 'em votes; But John P. Robinson he Sez they didn't know everythin' down in Judee.

Wal, it's a marcy we've gut folks to tell us The rights an' the wrongs o' these matters, I vow,-- God sends country lawyers, an' other wise fellers, To start the world's team wen it gits in a slough; Fer John P. Robinson he Sez the world'll go right, ef he hollers out Gee!

JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL.

On March 9, 1847, General Winfield Scott arrived off Vera Cruz with twelve thousand men to march against the City of Mexico. On April 18 he met and defeated Santa Anna's army at Cerro Gordo. On August 20 he arrived before the City of Mexico, and, after an ill-advised armistice, advanced to storm the city on September 8. He chose the approach guarded by the formidable works of Malino del Rey and Chapultepec. The former was carried by assault, after a fierce hand-to-hand battle.

BATTLE OF THE KING'S MILL

[September 8, 1847]

Said my landlord, white-headed Gil Gomez, With newspaper held in his hand-- "So they've built from El Paso a railway That Yankees may visit our land. As guests let them come and be welcome, But not as they came here before; They are rather rough fellows to handle In the rush of the battle and roar.

"They took Vera Cruz and its castle; In triumph they marched through the land; We fought them with desperate daring, But lacked the right man to command. They stormed, at a loss, Cerro Gordo-- Every mile in their movement it cost; And when they arrived at Puebla, Some thousands of men they had lost.

"Ere our capital fell, and the city By foreign invaders was won, We called out among its defenders Each man who could handle a gun. Chapultepec stood in their pathway; Churubusco they had to attack; The mill of the King--well, I fought there, And they were a hard nut to crack.

"While their right was assailing the ramparts, Our force struck their left on the field, Where our colonel, in language that stirred us, To love of our country appealed. And we swore that we never would falter Before either sabre or ball; We would beat back the foeman before us, Or dead on the battle-field fall.

"Fine words, you may say, but we meant them; And so when they came up the hill, We poured on them volley on volley, And riddled their ranks with a will. Their line in a moment was broken; They closed it, and came with a cheer; But still we fired quickly and deadly, And felt neither pity nor fear.

"We smote the blue column with grape-shot, But it rushed as the wild torrent runs; At the pieces they slew our best gunners, And took in the struggle our guns. We sprang in a rage to retake them, And lost nearly half of our men; Then, baffled and beaten, retreated, And gained our position again.

"Ceased their yell, and in spite of our firing They dressed like an arrow in line, Then, standing there moveless a moment, Their eyes flashed with purpose malign, All still as the twilight in summer, No cloud on the sky to deform, Like the lull in the voices of nature Ere wakens the whirlwind and storm.

"We had fought them with death-daring spirit, And courage unyielding till then; No man could have forced us to falter, But these were more demons than men. Our ranks had been torn by their bullets, We filled all the gaps they had made; But the pall of that terrible silence The hearts of our boldest dismayed.

"Before us no roaring of cannon, Rifle-rattle, or musketry peal; But there on the ocean of battle Surged steady the billow of steel. Fierce we opened our fire on the column, We pierced it with ball here and there; But it swept on in pitiless sternness Till we faltered and fled in despair.

"After that all their movements were easy; At their storming Chapultepec fell, And that ended the war--we were beaten: No story is left me to tell. And now they come back to invade us, Though not with the bullet and blade; They are here with their goods on a railway, To conquer the country by trade."

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

Chapultepec still remained, and on the morning of September 13 two storming parties rushed it, swarmed over the walls, swept back the garrison, and planted the American flag on the ramparts. The Mexican army hastened to evacuate the city, and on September 14 the Stars and Stripes floated over the capital of Mexico.

THE SIEGE OF CHAPULTEPEC

[September 13, 1847]

Wide o'er the valley the pennons are fluttering, War's sullen story the deep guns are muttering, Forward! blue-jackets, in good steady order, Strike for the fame of your good northern border; Forever shall history tell of the bloody check Waiting the foe at the siege of Chapultepec.

Let the proud deeds of your fathers inspire ye still, Think ye of Monmouth, and Princeton, and Bunker Hill, Come from your hallowed graves, famous in story, Shades of our heroes, and lead us to glory. Side by side, son and father with hoary head Struggle for triumph, or death on a gory bed.

Hark! to the charge! the war-hail is pattering, The foe through our ranks red rain is scattering; Huzza! forward! no halting or flagging till Proudly the red stripes float o'er yon rocky hill. Northern and Southerner, let your feuds smolder; Charge! for our banner's fame, shoulder to shoulder!

Flash the fort guns, and thunders their stunning swell Far o'er the valley to white Popocatapetl, Death revels high in the midst of the bloody sport, Bursting in flame from each black-throated castle-port, Press on the line with keen sabres dripping wet, Cheer, as ye smite with the death-dealing bayonet!

Our bold Northern eagle, king of the firmament, Shares with no rival the skies of the continent. Yields the fierce foeman; down let his flag be hurled, Shout, as our own from the turret is wide unfurled! Shout! for long shall Mexico mourn the wreck Of her proud state at the siege of Chapultepec.

WILLIAM HAINES LYTLE.

While these victories were being won in Mexico, General Stephen W. Kearny, at the head of the Army of the West, had seized the territory of New Mexico, and established a civil government at Santa Fé. He then proceeded to California, defeated

the Mexicans at Sacramento, and took possession of that province.

ILLUMINATION FOR VICTORIES IN MEXICO

Light up thy homes, Columbia, For those chivalric men Who bear to scenes of warlike strife Thy conquering arms again, Where glorious victories, flash on flash, Reveal their stormy way,-- Resaca's, Palo Alto's fields, The heights of Monterey!

They pile with thousands of thy foes Buena Vista's plain; With maids and wives, at Vera Cruz, Swell high the list of slain! They paint upon the Southern skies The blaze of burning domes,-- Their laurels dew with blood of babes! Light up, light up thy homes!

Light up your homes, O fathers! For those young hero bands, Whose march is still through vanquished towns, And over conquered lands! Whose valor, wild, impetuous, In all its fiery glow, Pours onward like a lava-tide, And sweeps away the foe!

For those whose dead brows glory crowns, On crimson couches sleeping, And for home faces wan with grief, And fond eyes dim with weeping. And for the soldier, poor, unknown, Who battled, madly brave, Beneath a stranger soil to share A shallow, crowded grave.

Light up thy home, young mother! Then gaze in pride and joy Upon those fair and gentle girls, That eagle-eyed young boy; And clasp thy darling little one Yet closer to thy breast, And be thy kisses on its lips In yearning love impressed.

In yon beleaguered city Were homes as sweet as thine; Where trembling mothers felt loved arms In fear around them twine,-- The lad with brow of olive hue, The babe like lily fair, The maiden with her midnight eyes, And wealth of raven hair.

The booming shot, the murderous shell, Crashed through the crumbling walls, And filled with agony and death Those sacred household halls! Then, bleeding, crushed, and blackened, lay The sister by the brother, And the torn infant gasped and writhed On the bosom of the mother!

O sisters, if ye have no tears For fearful tales like these, If the banners of the victors veil The victim's agonies, If ye lose the babe's and mother's cry In the noisy roll of drums, If your hearts with martial pride throb high, Light up, light up your homes!

GRACE GREENWOOD.

The Mexican people knew themselves defeated, and were eager for peace. The treaty was finally signed February 2, 1848. Mexico accepted the Rio Grande as her northern boundary, and ceded New Mexico and California to the United States. For this territory the United States was to pay her $15,000,000, and to assume debts to the amount of $3,500,000.

THE CRISIS

Across the Stony Mountains, o'er the desert's drouth and sand, The circles of our empire touch the western ocean's strand; From slumberous Timpanogos to Gila, wild and free, Flowing down from Nuevo-Leon to California's sea; And from the mountains of the east, to Santa Rosa's shore, The eagles of Mexitli shall beat the air no more.

O Vale of Rio Bravo! Let thy simple children weep; Close watch about their holy fire let maids of Pecos keep; Let Taos send her cry across Sierra Madre's pines, And Santa Barbara toll her bells amidst her corn and vines; For lo! the pale land-seekers come, with eager eyes of gain, Wide scattering, like the bison herds on broad Salada's plain.

Let Sacramento's herdsmen heed what sound the winds bring down Of footsteps on the crisping snow, from cold Nevada's crown! Full hot and fast the Saxon rides, with rein of travel slack, And, bending o'er his saddle, leaves the sunrise at his back; By many a lonely river, and gorge of fir and pine, On many a wintry hill-top, his nightly camp-fires shine.

O countrymen and brothers! that land of lake and plain, Of salt wastes alternating with valleys fat with grain; Of mountains white with winter, looking downward, cold, serene, On their feet with spring-vines tangled and lapped in softest green; Swift through whose black volcanic gates, o'er many a sunny vale, Wind-like the Arapahoe sweeps the bison's dusty trail!

Great spaces yet untravelled, great lakes whose mystic shores The Saxon rifle never heard, nor dip of Saxon oars; Great herds that wander all unwatched, wild steeds that none have tamed, Strange fish in unknown streams, and birds the Saxon never named; Deep mines, dark mountain crucibles, where Nature's chemic powers Work out the Great Designer's will; all these ye say are ours!

Forever ours! for good or ill, on us the burden lies: God's balance, watched by angels, is hung across the skies. Shall Justice, Truth, and Freedom turn the poised and trembling scale? Or shall the Evil triumph, and robber Wrong prevail? Shall the broad land o'er which our flag in starry splendor waves, Forego through us its freedom, and bear the tread of slaves?

The day is breaking in the East of which the prophets told, And brightens up the sky of Time the Christian Age of Gold; Old Might to Right is yielding, battle blade to clerkly pen, Earth's monarchs are her peoples, and her serfs stand up as men; The isles rejoice together, in a day are nations born, And the slave walks free in Tunis, and by Stamboul's Golden Horn!

Is this, O countrymen of mine! a day for us to sow The soil of new-gained empire with slavery's seeds of woe? To feed with our fresh life-blood the Old World's cast-off crime, Dropped, like some monstrous early birth, from the tired lap of Time? To run anew the evil race the old lost nations ran, And die like them of unbelief of God, and wrong of man?

Great Heaven! Is this our mission? End in this the prayers and tears, The toil, the strife, the watchings of our younger, better years? Still as the Old World rolls in light, shall ours in shadow turn, A beamless Chaos, cursed of God, through outer darkness

borne? Where the far nations looked for light, a blackness in the air? Where for words of hope they listened, the long wail of despair?

The Crisis presses on us; face to face with us it stands, With solemn lips of question, like the Sphinx in Egypt's sands! This day we fashion Destiny, our web of Fate we spin; This day for all hereafter choose we holiness or sin; Even now from starry Gerizim, or Ebal's cloudy crown, We call the dews of blessing or the bolts of cursing down!

By all for which the martyrs bore their agony and shame; By all the warning words of truth with which the prophets came; By the Future which awaits us; by all the hopes which cast Their faint and trembling beams across the blackness of the Past; And by the blessed thought of Him who for Earth's freedom died, O my people! O my brothers! let us choose the righteous side.

So shall the Northern pioneer go joyful on his way; To wed Penobscot's waters to San Francisco's bay, To make the rugged places smooth, and sow the vales with grain; And bear, with Liberty and Law, the Bible in his train: The mighty West shall bless the East, and sea shall answer sea, And mountain unto mountain call, Praise God, for we are free!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

On June 12, 1848, the last of the United States troops left the City of Mexico. They were received at home with the wildest enthusiasm. Never had a nation, in modern times, fought so successful a war in so short a time.

THE VOLUNTEERS

[1849]

The Volunteers! the Volunteers! I dream, as in the by-gone years, I hear again their stirring cheers, And see their banners shine, What time the yet unconquered North Pours to the wars her legions forth, For many a wrong to strike a blow With mailèd hand at Mexico.

The Volunteers! Ah, where are they Who bade the hostile surges stay, When the black forts of Monterey Frowned on their dauntless line? When, undismayed amid the shock Of war, like Cerro Gordo's rock, They stood, or rushed more madly on Than tropic tempest o'er San Juan?

On Angostura's crowded field Their shattered columns scorned to yield, And wildly yet defiance pealed Their flashing batteries' throats; And echoed then the rifle's crack, As deadly as when on the track Of flying foe, of yore, its voice Bade Orleans' dark-eyed girls rejoice.

Blent with the roar of guns and bombs, How grandly from the dim past comes The roll of their victorious drums, Their bugle's joyous notes, When over Mexico's proud towers, And the fair valley's storied bowers, Fit recompense of toil and scars, In triumph waved their flag of stars.

Ah, comrades, of your own tried troop, Whose honor ne'er to shame might stoop, Of lion heart and eagle swoop, But you alone remain; On all the rest has fallen the hush Of death; the men whose battle-rush Was wild as sun-loosed torrent's flow From Orizaba's crest of snow.

The Volunteers! the Volunteers! God send us peace through all our years, But if the cloud of war appears, We'll see them once again. From broad Ohio's peaceful side, From where the Maumee pours its tide, From storm-lashed Erie's wintry shore, Shall spring the Volunteers once more.

WILLIAM HAINES LYTLE.

CHAPTER VI

FOURTEEN YEARS OF PEACE

In his message to Congress at the opening of the December session of 1847, President Polk recommended, among other things, the construction of a ship canal across the Isthmus of Panama--a recommendation which was not to bear fruit for sixty years.

THE SHIP CANAL FROM THE ATLANTIC TO THE PACIFIC

AN ODE TO THE AMERICAN PEOPLE AND THEIR CONGRESS, ON READING THE MESSAGE OF THE UNITED STATES PRESIDENT IN DECEMBER, 1847

Rend America asunder And unite the Binding Sea That emboldens man and tempers-- Make the ocean free.

Break the bolt that bars the passage, That our River richly pours Western wealth to western nations; Let that sea be ours--

Ours by all the hardy whalers, By the pointing Oregon, By the west-impelled and working, Unthralled Saxon son.

Long indeed they have been wooing, The Pacific and his bride; Now 'tis time for holy wedding-- Join them by the tide.

Have the snowy surfs not struggled Many centuries in vain That their lips might seal the Union? Lock them main to main.

When the mighty God of nature Made this favored continent, He allowed it yet unsevered, That a race be sent,

Able, mindful of his purpose, Prone to people, to subdue, And to bind the land with iron, Or to force it through.

What the prophet-navigator, Seeking straits to his Catais, But began, now consummate it-- Make the strait and pass.

Blessed the eyes that shall behold it, When the pointing boom shall veer, Leading through the parted Andes, While the nations cheer!

There at Suez, Europe's mattock Cuts the briny road with skill, And must Darien bid defiance To the pilot still?

Do we breathe this breath of Knowledge Purely to enjoy its zest? Shall the iron arm of science Like a sluggard rest?

Up then, at it! earnest people! Bravely wrought thy scorning blade, But there's fresher fame in store yet, Glory for the spade.

What we want is naught in envy, And for all we pioneer; Let the keels of every nation Through the isthmus steer.

Must the globe be always girded Ere we get to Bramah's priest? Take the tissues of your Lowells Westward to the East.

Ye, that vanquish pain and distance, Ye, enmeshing Time with wire, Court ye patiently forever Yon Antarctic ire?

Shall the mariner forever Double the impending capes, While his longsome and retracing Needless course he shapes?

What was daring for our fathers, To defy those billows fierce, Is but tame for their descendants; We are bid to pierce.

Ye that fight with printing armies, Settle sons on forlorn track, As the Romans flung their eagles, But to win them back.

Who, undoubting, worship boldness, And, if baffled, bolder rise, Shall we lag when grandeur beckons To this good emprize?

Let the vastness not appal us; Greatness is thy destiny. Let the doubters not recall us: Venture suits the free.

Like a seer, I see her throning, WINLAND strong in freedom's health, Warding peace on both the waters, Widest Commonwealth.

Crowned with wreaths that still grow greener, Guerdon for untiring pain, For the wise, the stout, and steadfast: Rend the land in twain.

Cleave America asunder, This is worthy work for thee. Hark! The seas roll up imploring "Make the ocean free."

FRANCIS LIEBER.

The famine in Ireland in 1847 awakened much sympathy in the United States, and the ship Jamestown, laden with food, was dispatched to Cork, making a remarkably quick passage.

THE WAR SHIP OF PEACE

[1847]

Sweet land of song, thy harp doth hang Upon the willow now, While famine's blight and fever's pang Stamps mis'ry on thy brow; Yet take thy harp and raise thy voice, Though weak and low it be, And let thy sinking heart rejoice In friends still left to thee.

Look out! look out! across the sea That girds thy em'rald shore, A ship of war is bound to thee, But with no war-like store. Her thunders sleep; 'tis mercy's breath That wafts her o'er the sea; She goes not forth to deal out death, But bears new life to thee.

Thy wasted hands can scarcely strike The chords of grateful praise, Thy plaintive tone is now unlike The voice of prouder days; Yet, e'en in sorrow, tuneful still, Let Erin's voice proclaim In bardic praise on ev'ry hill Columbia's glorious name.

SAMUEL LOVER.

On June 8, 1848, Henry Clay was defeated by Zachary Taylor for the Whig nomination for the presidency.

ON THE DEFEAT OF HENRY CLAY

[June 8, 1848]

Fallen? How fallen? States and empires fall; O'er towers and rock-built walls, And perished nations, floods to tempests call With hollow sound along the sea of time: The great man never falls. He lives, he towers aloft, he stands sublime-- _They fall_ who give him not The honor here that suits his future name-- They die and are forgot. O Giant loud and blind! the great man's fame Is his own shadow and not cast by thee-- A shadow that shall grow As down the heaven of time the sun descends, And on the world shall throw His god-like image, till it sinks where blends Time's dim horizon with Eternity.

WILLIAM WILBERFORCE LORD.

Margaret Fuller Ossoli, her husband, the Marquis Ossoli, and their child, were drowned off Fire Island, July 16, 1850, while returning from Europe in the ship Elizabeth. The ship was driven ashore in a storm, and broken up by the waves.

ON THE DEATH OF M. D'OSSOLI AND HIS WIFE, MARGARET FULLER

[July 16, 1850]

Over his millions Death has lawful power, But over thee, brave D'Ossoli! none, none. After a longer struggle, in a fight Worthy of Italy, to youth restored, Thou, far from home, art sunk beneath the surge Of the Atlantic; on its shore; in reach Of help; in trust of refuge; sunk with all Precious on earth to thee--a child, a wife! Proud as thou wert of her, America Is prouder, showing to her sons how high Swells woman's courage in a virtuous breast. She would not leave behind her those she loved; Such solitary safety might become Others; not her; not her who stood beside The pallet of

the wounded, when the worst Of France and Perfidy assailed the walls Of unsuspicious Rome. Rest, glorious soul, Renowned for the strength of genius, Margaret! Rest with the twain too dear! My words are few, And shortly none will hear my failing voice, But the same language with more full appeal Shall hail thee. Many are the sons of song Whom thou hast heard upon thy native plains Worthy to sing of thee: the hour is come; Take we our seats and let the dirge begin.

WALTER SAVAGE LANDOR.

The following verses from _Punch_ describe various events of 1851--the winning of the international yacht race by the America; the project for a canal across the isthmus--and comment upon the ingenuity of some Yankee inventions.

THE LAST APPENDIX TO "YANKEE DOODLE"

[_Punch_, 1851]

Yankee Doodle sent to Town His goods for exhibition; Everybody ran him down, And laugh'd at his position. They thought him all the world behind; A goney, muff, or noodle; Laugh on, good people,--never mind-- Says quiet Yankee Doodle. _Chorus_--Yankee Doodle, keep it up, Yankee Doodle Dandy! Mind the music and the step, And with the girls be handy!

Yankee Doodle had a craft, A rather tidy clipper, And he challenged, while they laughed, The Britishers to whip her. Their whole yacht-squadron she outsped, And that on their own water; Of all the lot she went ahead, And they came nowhere arter.

O'er Panamà there was a scheme Long talked of, to pursue a Short route--which many thought a dream-- By Lake Nicaragua. John Bull discussed the plan on foot, With slow irresolution, While Yankee Doodle went and put It into execution.

A steamer of the Collins line, A Yankee Doodle's notion, Has also quickest cut the brine Across the Atlantic Ocean. And British Agents, no ways slow Her merits to discover, Have been and bought her--just to tow The Cunard packets over.

Your gunsmiths of their skill may crack, But that again don't mention: I guess that Colts' revolvers whack Their very first invention. By Yankee Doodle, too, you're beat Downright in Agriculture, With his machine for reaping wheat, Chawed up as by a vulture.

You also fancied, in your pride, Which truly is tarnation, Them British locks of yourn defied The rogues of all creation; But Chubbs' and Bramah's Hobbs has picked, And you must now be viewed all As having been completely licked By glorious Yankee Doodle.

DANIEL WEBSTER

[Died October 24, 1852]

When life hath run its largest round Of toil and triumph, joy and woe, How brief a storied page is found To compass all its outward show!

The world-tried sailor tires and droops; His flag is rent, his keel forgot; His farthest voyages seem but loops That float from life's entangled knot.

But when within the narrow space Some larger soul hath lived and wrought, Whose sight was open to embrace The boundless realms of deed and thought,--

When, stricken by the freezing blast, A nation's living pillars fall, How rich the storied page, how vast, A word, a whisper, can recall!

No medal lifts its fretted face, Nor speaking marble cheats your eye; Yet, while these pictured lines I trace, A living image passes by:

A roof beneath the mountain pines; The cloisters of a hill-girt plain; The front of life's embattled lines; A mound beside the heaving main.

These are the scenes: a boy appears; Set life's round dial in the sun. Count the swift arc of seventy years, His frame is dust; his task is done.

Yet pause upon the noontide hour, Ere the declining sun has laid His bleaching rays on manhood's power, And look upon the mighty shade.

No gloom that stately shape can hide, No change uncrown his brow: behold! Dark, calm, large-fronted, lightning-eyed, Earth has no double from its mould!

Ere from the fields by valor won The battle-smoke had rolled away, And bared the blood-red setting sun, His eyes were opened on the day.

His land was but a shelving strip, Black with the strife that made it free; He lived to see its banners dip Their fringes in the Western sea.

The boundless prairies learned his name, His words the mountain echoes knew; The Northern breezes swept his fame From icy lake to warm bayou.

In toil he lived; in peace he died; When life's full cycle was complete, Put off his robes of power and pride, And laid them at his Master's feet.

His rest is by the storm-swept waves Whom life's wild tempests roughly tried, Whose heart was like the streaming caves Of ocean, throbbing at his side.

Death's cold white hand is like the snow Laid softly on the furrowed hill, It hides the broken seams below, And leaves the summit brighter still.

In vain the envious tongue upbraids; His name a nation's heart shall keep Till morning's latest sunlight fades On the blue tablet of the deep!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

In 1854 a survey was ordered of the Isthmus of Darien, and Lieutenant Isaac G. Strain was placed in charge of the work. His party was reduced to great extremities in crossing the isthmus, but bore their sufferings with a heroism seldom surpassed.

THE FLAG

AN INCIDENT OF STRAIN'S EXPEDITION

[1854]

I never have got the bearings quite, Though I've followed the course for many a year, If he was crazy, clean outright, Or only what you might say was "queer."

He was just a simple sailor man. I mind it as well as yisterday, When we messed aboard of the old Cyane. Lord! how the time does slip away! That was five and thirty year ago, And I never expect such times again, For sailors wasn't afraid to stow Themselves on a Yankee vessel then. He was only a sort of bosun's mate, But every inch of him taut and trim; Stars and anchors and togs of state Tailors don't build for the like of him. He flew a no-account sort of name, A reg'lar fo'castle "Jim" or "Jack," With a plain "McGinnis" abaft the same, Giner'ly reefed to simple "Mack." Mack, we allowed, was sorter queer,-- Ballast or compass wasn't right. Till he licked four Juicers one day, a fear Prevailed that he hadn't larned to fight. But I reckon the Captain knowed his man, When he put the flag in his hand the day That we went ashore from the old Cyane, On a madman's cruise for Darien Bay.

Forty days in the wilderness We toiled and suffered and starved with Strain, Losing the number of many a mess In the Devil's swamps of the Spanish Main. All of us starved, and many died. One laid down, in his dull despair; His stronger messmate went to his side-- We left them both in the jungle there. It was hard to part with shipmates so; But standing by would have done no good. We heard them moaning all day, so slow We dragged along through the weary wood. McGinnis, he suffered the worst of all; Not that he ever piped his eye Or wouldn't have answered to the call If they'd sounded it for "All hands to die." I guess 'twould have sounded for him before, But the grit inside of him kept him strong, Till we met relief on the river shore; And we all broke down when it came along.

All but McGinnis. Gaunt and tall, Touching his hat, and standing square: "Captain, the Flag."--And that was all; He just keeled over and foundered there. "The Flag?" We thought he had lost his head-- It mightn't be much to lose at best-- Till we came, by and by, to dig his bed, And we found it folded around his breast. He laid so calm and smiling there, With the flag wrapped tight about his heart; Maybe he saw his course all fair, Only--_we_ couldn't read the chart.

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

On February 16, 1857, Elisha Kent Kane, explorer of the Arctic, died at Havana, Cuba, whither he had gone in the hope of regaining a health shattered by his sufferings in the north.

KANE

Aloft upon an old basaltic crag, Which, scalp'd by keen winds that defend the Pole, Gazes with dead face on the seas that roll Around the secret of the mystic zone, A mighty nation's star-bespangled flag Flutters alone, And underneath, upon the lifeless front Of that drear cliff, a simple name is traced; Fit type of him who, famishing and gaunt, But with a rocky purpose in his soul, Breasted the gathering snows, Clung to the drifting floes, By want beleaguer'd, and by winter chased, Seeking the brother

lost amid that frozen waste.

Not many months ago we greeted him, Crown'd with the icy honors of the North, Across the land his hard-won fame went forth, And Maine's deep woods were shaken limb by limb; His own mild Keystone State, sedate and prim, Burst from decorous quiet as he came; Hot Southern lips with eloquence aflame Sounded his triumph. Texas, wild and grim, Proffer'd its horny hand. The large-lung'd West, From out its giant breast, Yell'd its frank welcome. And from main to main, Jubilant to the sky, Thunder'd the mighty cry, HONOR TO KANE!

In vain, in vain beneath his feet we flung The reddening roses! All in vain we pour'd The golden wine, and round the shining board Sent the toast circling, till the rafters rung With the thrice-tripled honors of the feast! Scarce the buds wilted and the voices ceased Ere the pure light that sparkled in his eyes, Bright as auroral fires in Southern skies, Faded and faded! And the brave young heart That the relentless Arctic winds had robb'd Of all its vital heat, in that long quest For the lost captain, now within his breast More and more faintly throbb'd. His was the victory; but as his grasp Closed on the laurel crown with eager clasp, Death launch'd a whistling dart; And ere the thunders of applause were done His bright eyes closed forever on the sun! Too late, too late the splendid prize he won In the Olympic race of Science and of Art! Like to some shatter'd berg that, pale and lone, Drifts from the white North to a tropic zone, And in the burning day Wastes peak by peak away, Till on some rosy even It dies with sunlight blessing it; so he Tranquilly floated to a Southern sea, And melted into heaven.

He needs no tears, who lived a noble life; We will not weep for him who died so well, But we will gather round the hearth, and tell The story of his strife; Such homage suits him well, Better than funeral pomp or passing bell. What tale of peril and self-sacrifice! Prison'd amid the fastnesses of ice, With hunger howling o'er the wastes of snow! Night lengthening into months, the ravenous floe Crunching the massive ships, as the white bear Crunches his prey. The insufficient share Of loathsome food, The lethargy of famine, the despair Urging to labor, nervelessly pursued, Toil done with skinny arms, and faces hued Like pallid masks, while dolefully behind Glimmer'd the fading embers of a mind! That awful hour, when through the prostrate band Delirium stalk'd, laying his burning hand Upon the ghastly foreheads of the crew. The whispers of rebellion, faint and few At first, but deepening ever till they grew Into black thoughts of murder; such the throng Of horrors bound the hero. High the song Should be that hymns the noble part he play'd! Sinking himself, yet ministering aid To all around him. By a mighty will Living defiant of the wants that kill, Because his death would seal his comrades' fate; Cheering with ceaseless and inventive skill Those Polar waters, dark and desolate. Equal to every trial, every fate, He stands, until Spring, tardy with relief, Unlocks the icy gate, And the pale prisoners thread the world once more, To the steep cliffs of Greenland's pastoral shore Bearing their dying chief.

Time was when he should gain his spurs of gold From royal hands, who woo'd the knightly state; The knell of old formalities is toll'd, And the world's knights are now self-consecrate. No grander episode doth chivalry hold In all its annals, back to

Charlemagne, Than that lone vigil of unceasing pain, Faithfully kept through hunger and through cold, By the good Christian knight, ELISHA KANE!

FITZ-JAMES O'BRIEN.

On September 12, 1857, the Central America was lost at sea in a great storm off Cape Hatteras. Captain William Lewis Herndon, of the navy, was in command. His tranquil courage preserved discipline up to the last, and until his passengers, officers, and crew were all in the boats. Seeing that the last boat was already overloaded, Captain Herndon refused to add to its danger, and, ordering it off, went down with his ship.

HERNDON

[September 12, 1857]

Ay, shout and rave, thou cruel sea, In triumph o'er that fated deck, Grown holy by another grave-- Thou hast the captain of the wreck.

No prayer was said, no lesson read, O'er him; the soldier of the sea: And yet for him, through all the land, A thousand thoughts to-night shall be.

And many an eye shall dim with tears, And many a cheek be flushed with pride; And men shall say, There died a man, And boys shall learn how well he died.

Ay, weep for him, whose noble soul Is with the God who made it great; But weep not for so proud a death,-- We could not spare so grand a fate.

Nor could Humanity resign That hour which bade her heart beat high, And blazoned Duty's stainless shield, And set a star in Honor's sky.

O dreary night! O grave of hope! O sea, and dark, unpitying sky! Full many a wreck these waves shall claim Ere such another heart shall die.

Alas, how can we help but mourn When hero bosoms yield their breath! A century itself may bear But once the flower of such a death;

So full of manliness, so sweet With utmost duty nobly done; So thronged with deeds, so filled with life, As though with death that life begun.

It _has_ begun, true gentleman! No better life we ask for thee; Thy Viking soul and woman heart Forever shall a beacon be,--

A starry thought to veering souls, To teach it is not best to live; To show that life has naught to match Such knighthood as the grave can give.

S. WEIR MITCHELL.

In 1857 Commodore Josiah Tattnall was appointed flag-officer of the Asiatic station, and, finding China at war with the allied English and French fleets, went to the scene of operations at Pei-ho. Just before an engagement, his flagship grounded and was towed off by the English boats; and when he saw the English in trouble shortly afterwards, he sailed in to their assistance, exclaiming, "Blood is thicker than

water!"

BLOOD IS THICKER THAN WATER

[June 25, 1859]

Ebbed and flowed the muddy Pei-Ho by the gulf of Pechili, Near its waters swung the yellow dragon-flag; Past the batteries of China, looking westward we could see Lazy junks along the lazy river lag; Villagers in near-by Ta-Kou toiled beneath their humble star, On the flats the ugly mud fort lay and dreamed; While the Powhatan swung slowly at her station by the bar, While the Toey-Wan with Tattnall onward steamed.

Lazy East and lazy river, fort of mud in lazy June, English gunboats through the waters slowly fare, With the dragon-flag scarce moving in the lazy afternoon O'er the mud-heap storing venom in the glare. We were on our way to Peking, to the Son of Heaven's throne, White with peace was all our mission to his court, Peaceful, too, the English vessels on the turbid stream bestrown Seeking passage up the Pei-Ho past the fort.

By the bar lay half the English, while the rest, with gallant Hope, Wrestled with the slipping ebb-tide up the stream; They had cleared the Chinese irons, reached the double chain and rope, Where the ugly mud fort scowled upon their beam-- _Boom!_ the heavens split asunder with the thunder of the fight As the hateful dragon made its faith a mock; Every cannon spat its perfidy, each casemate blazed its spite, Crashing down upon the English, shock on shock.

In his courage Rason perished, brave McKenna fought and fell; Scores were dying as they'd lived, like valiant men; And the meteor flag that upward prayed to Heaven from that hell, Wept below for those who ne'er should weep again. Far away the English launches near the Powhatan swung slow, All despairing, useless, out of reach of war, Knew their comrades in the battle, felt them reel beneath the blow, Lying helpless 'gainst the ebb-tide by the bar.

On the Toey-Wan stood Tattnall, Stephen Trenchard by his side-- "Old Man" Tattnall, he who dared at Vera Cruz,-- Saw here, crippled by the cannon; saw there, throttled by the tide, Men of English blood and speech--could he refuse? _I'll be damned_, says he to Trenchard, _if old Tattnall's standing by, Seeing white men butchered here by such a foe. Where's my barge? No side-arms, mind you! See those English fight and die-- Blood is thicker, sir, than water. Let us go._

Quick we man the boat, and quicker plunge into that devil's brew-- "An official call," and Tattnall went in state. Trenchard's hurt, our flag in ribbons, and the rocking barge shot through, Hart, our coxswain, dies beneath the Chinese hate; But the cheers those English give us as we gain their Admiral's ship Make the shattered boat and weary arms seem light-- Then the rare smile from "Old" Tattnall, and Hope's hearty word and grip, Lying wounded, bleeding, brave in hell's despite.

Tattnall nods, and we go forward, find a gun no longer fought-- What is peace to us when all its crew lie dead? One bright English lad brings powder and a wounded man

the shot, And we scotch that Chinese dragon, tail and head. Hands are shaken, faith is plighted, sounds our Captain's cheery call, In a British boat we speed us fast and far; And the Toey-Wan and Tattnall down the ebb-tide slide and fall To the launches lying moaning by the bar.

Eager for an English vengeance, battle-light on every face, See the Clustered Stars lead on the Triple Cross! Cheering, swinging into action, valiant Hope takes heart of grace From the cannon's cloudy roar, the lanyards' toss How they fought, those fighting English! How they cheered the Toey-Wan, Cheered our sailors, cheered "Old" Tattnall, grim and gray! And their cheers ring down the ages as they rang beneath the sun O'er those bubbling, troubled waters far away.

Ebbs and flows the muddy Pei-Ho by the gulf of Pechili, Idly floats beside the stream the dragon-flag; Past the batteries of China, looking westward still you see Lazy junks along the lazy river lag. Let the long, long years drip slowly on that lost and ancient land, Ever dear one scene to hearts of gallant men; There's a hand-clasp and a heart-throb, there's a word we understand: _Blood is thicker, sir, than water_, now as then.

WALLACE RICE.

In the fall of 1860 the Prince of Wales, travelling as Baron Renfrew, paid a visit to the United States, lasting from September 21 to October 20. He was the recipient of many attentions, and a great ball was given in his honor at the Academy of Music in New York city. While the ball was in progress, a portion of the floor gave way, but no one was injured.

BARON RENFREW'S BALL

[October, 1860]

'Twas a grand display was the prince's ball, A pageant or fête, or what you may call A brilliant coruscation, Where ladies and knights of noble worth Enchanted a prince of royal birth By a royal demonstration.

Like queens arrayed in their regal guise, They charmed the prince with dazzling eyes, Fair ladies of rank and station, Till the floor gave way, and down they sprawled, In a tableaux style, which the artists called A floor-all decoration.

At the prince's feet like flowers they were laid, In the brightest bouquet ever made, For a prince's choice to falter-- Perplexed to find, where all were rare, Which was the fairest of the fair To cull for a queenly altar.

But soon the floor was set aright, And Peter Cooper's face grew bright, When, like the swell of an organ, All hearts beat time to the first quadrille, And the prince confessed to a joyous thrill As he danced with Mrs. Morgan.

Then came the waltz--the Prince's Own-- And every bar and brilliant tone Had music's sweetest grace on; But the prince himself ne'er felt its charm Till he slightly clasped, with circling arm, That lovely girl, Miss Mason.

But ah! the work went bravely on, And meek-eyed Peace a trophy won By the magic art of the dancers; For the daring prince's next exploit Was to league with Scott's Camilla Hoyt, And overcome the Lancers.

Besides these three, he deigned to yield His hand to Mrs. M. B. Field, Miss Jay and Miss Van Buren; Miss Russell, too, was given a place-- All beauties famous for their grace From Texas to Lake Huron.

With Mrs. Kernochan he "lanced," With Mrs. Edward Cooper danced, With Mrs. Belmont capered; With fair Miss Fish, in fairy rig, He tripped a sort of royal jig, And next Miss Butler favored.

And thus, 'mid many hopes and fears, By the brilliant light of the chandeliers, Did they gayly quaff and revel; Well pleased to charm a royal prince-- The only one from old England since George Washington was a rebel.

And so the fleeting hours went by, And watches stopped--lest Time should fly-- Or that they winding wanted; Old matrons dozed, and papas smiled, And many a fair one was beguiled As the prince danced on, undaunted.

'Tis now a dream--the prince's ball, Its vanished glories, one and all, The scenes of the fairy tales; For Cinderella herself was there, And Barnum keeps for trial fair The beautiful slipper deposited there By his highness, the Prince of Wales.

CHARLES GRAHAM HALPINE.

PART IV

THE CIVIL WAR

BATTLE-HYMN OF THE REPUBLIC

Mine eyes have seen the glory of the coming of the Lord: He is trampling out the vintage where the grapes of wrath are stored; He hath loosed the fateful lightning of his terrible swift sword: His truth is marching on.

I have seen Him in the watch-fires of a hundred circling camps; They have builded Him an altar in the evening dews and damps; I can read his righteous sentence by the dim and flaring lamps. His day is marching on.

I have read a fiery gospel, writ in burnished rows of steel: "As ye deal with my contemners, so with you my grace shall deal; Let the Hero, born of woman, crush the serpent with his heel, Since God is marching on."

He has sounded forth the trumpet that shall never call retreat; He is sifting out the hearts of men before his judgment-seat: Oh! be swift, my soul, to answer Him! be jubilant, my feet! Our God is marching on.

In the beauty of the lilies Christ was born across the sea, With a glory in his bosom that transfigures you and me: As He died to make men holy, let us die to make men

free, While God is marching on.

JULIA WARD HOWE.

CHAPTER I

THE SLAVERY QUESTION

Negro slavery in the United States began in 1619, when a cargo of Africans was sold in Virginia. It gradually spread to all the states, but by the beginning of the nineteenth century it had been abolished in Massachusetts, Pennsylvania, New Hampshire, Connecticut, Rhode Island, Vermont, New York, and New Jersey. The ordinance of 1787 forbade slavery in the Northwest; but the purchase of Louisiana in 1803 added greatly to slave territory. The fight over the admission of Missouri (1817-21), resulting in the "Missouri Compromise," did much to intensify bitterness of feeling. Finally, in December, 1833, the American Anti-Slavery Society was organized at Philadelphia, with a platform of principles formulated by William Lloyd Garrison.

TO WILLIAM LLOYD GARRISON

[Read at the Convention which formed the American Anti-Slavery Society, in Philadelphia, December, 1833.]

Champion of those who groan beneath Oppression's iron hand: In view of penury, hate, and death, I see thee fearless stand. Still bearing up thy lofty brow, In the steadfast strength of truth, In manhood sealing well the vow And promise of thy youth.

Go on, for thou hast chosen well; On in the strength of God! Long as one human heart shall swell Beneath the tyrant's rod. Speak in a slumbering nation's ear, As thou hast ever spoken, Until the dead in sin shall hear, The fetter's link be broken!

I love thee with a brother's love, I feel my pulses thrill, To mark thy spirit soar above The cloud of human ill. My heart hath leaped to answer thine, And echo back thy words, As leaps the warrior's at the shine And flash of kindred swords!

They tell me thou art rash and vain, A searcher after fame; That thou art striving but to gain A long-enduring name; That thou hast nerved the Afric's hand And steeled the Afric's heart, To shake aloft his vengeful brand, And rend his chain apart.

Have I not known thee well, and read Thy mighty purpose long? And watched the trials which have made Thy human spirit strong? And shall the slanderer's demon breath Avail with one like me, To dim the sunshine of my faith And earnest trust in thee?

Go on, the dagger's point may glare Amid thy pathway's gloom; The fate which sternly threatens there Is glorious martyrdom! Then onward with a martyr's zeal; And wait thy sure reward When man to man no more shall kneel, And God alone be Lord!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

Branches of this society multiplied rapidly, and in order to counteract their influence, a great pro-slavery meeting was held at Charleston, S. C., September 4, 1835. The newspaper report that "the clergy of all denominations attended in a body, lending their sanction to the proceedings, and adding by their presence to the impressive character of the scene," drew a fiery protest from Whittier.

CLERICAL OPPRESSORS

[September 4, 1835]

Just God! and these are they Who minister at thine altar, God of Right! Men who their hands with prayer and blessing lay On Israel's Ark of light!

What! preach, and kidnap men? Give thanks, and rob thy own afflicted poor? Talk of thy glorious liberty, and then Bolt hard the captive's door?

What! servants of thy own Merciful Son, who came to seek and save The homeless and the outcast, fettering down The tasked and plundered slave!

Pilate and Herod, friends! Chief priests and rulers, as of old, combine! Just God and holy! is that church, which lends Strength to the spoiler, thine?

Paid hypocrites, who turn Judgment aside, and rob the Holy Book Of those high words of truth which search and burn In warning and rebuke;

Feed fat, ye locusts, feed! And, in your tasselled pulpits, thank the Lord That, from the toiling bondman's utter need, Ye pile your own full board.

How long, O Lord! how long Shall such a priesthood barter truth away, And in Thy name, for robbery and wrong At Thy own altars pray?

Is not Thy hand stretched forth Visibly in the heavens, to awe and smite? Shall not the living God of all the earth, And heaven above, do right?

Woe, then, to all who grind Their brethren of a common Father down! To all who plunder from the immortal mind Its bright and glorious crown!

Woe to the priesthood! woe To those whose hire is with the price of blood; Perverting, darkening, changing, as they go, The searching truths of God!

Their glory and their might Shall perish; and their very names shall be Vile before all the people, in the light Of a world's liberty.

Oh, speed the moment on When Wrong shall cease, and Liberty and Love And Truth and Right throughout the earth be known As in their home above.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

In April, 1848, an attempt was made to abduct seventy-seven slaves from Washington in the schooner Pearl. The slaves were speedily recaptured and sold South, while their defenders barely escaped with their lives from an infuriated mob. The Abolitionists in Congress determined to evoke from that body some expression of sentiment on the subject. On the 20th of April Senator Hale introduced a resolution

implying sympathy with the negroes. It stirred the slaveholders to unusual intemperance of language.

THE DEBATE IN THE SENNIT

SOT TO A NUSRY RHYME

[April 20, 1848]

"Here we stan' on the Constitution, by thunder! It's a fact o' wich ther's bushels o' proofs; Fer how could we trample on 't so, I wonder, Ef't worn't thet it's ollers under our hoofs?" Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he; "Human rights haint no more Right to come on this floor, No more'n the man in the moon," sez he.

"The North haint no kind o' bisness with nothin', An' you've no idee how much bother it saves; We aint none riled by their frettin' an' frothin', We're _used_ to layin' the string on our slaves," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- Sez Mister Foote, "I should like to shoot The holl gang, by the gret horn spoon!" sez he.

"Freedom's keystone is Slavery, thet ther's no doubt on, It's sutthin' thet's--wha' d'ye call it?--divine,-- An' the slaves thet we ollers _make_ the most out on Air them north o' Mason an' Dixon's line," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- "Fer all thet," sez Mangum, "'Twould be better to hang 'em An' so git red on 'em soon," sez he.

"The mass ough' to labor an' we lay on soffies, Thet's the reason I want to spread Freedom's aree; It puts all the cunninest on us in office, An' reelises our Maker's orig'nal idee," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- "Thet's ez plain," sez Cass, "Ez thet some one's an ass, It's ez clear ez the sun is at noon," sez he.

"Now don't go to say I'm the friend of oppression, But keep all your spare breath fer coolin' your broth, Fer I ollers hev strove (at least thet's my impression) To make cussed free with the rights o' the North," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- "Yes," sez Davis o' Miss., "The perfection o' bliss Is in skinnin' thet same old coon," sez he.

"Slavery's a thing thet depends on complexion, It's God's law thet fetters on black skins don't chafe; Ef brains wuz to settle it (horrid reflection!) Wich of our onnable body'd be safe?" Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- Sez Mister Hannegan, Afore he began agin, "Thet exception is quite oppertoon," sez he.

"Gen'nle Cass, Sir, you needn't be twitchin' your collar, _Your_ merit's quite clear by the dut on your knees, At the North we don't make no distinctions o' color; You can all take a lick at our shoes wen you please," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- Sez Mister Jarnagin, "They wun't hev to larn agin, They all on 'em know the old toon," sez he.

"The slavery question aint no ways bewilderin', North an' South hev one int'rest, it's plain to a glance; No'thern men, like us patriarchs, don't sell their childrin, But they _du_ sell themselves, ef they git a good chance," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- Sez Atherton here, "This is gittin' severe, I wish I could dive like a loon," sez he.

"It'll break up the Union, this talk about freedom, An' your fact'ry gals (soon ez we split) 'll make head, An' gittin' some Miss chief or other to lead 'em, 'll go to work raisin' permiscoous Ned," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- "Yes, the North," sez Colquitt, "Ef we Southeners all quit, Would go down like a busted balloon," sez he.

"Jest look wut is doin', wut annyky's brewin' In the beautiful clime o' the olive an' vine, All the wise aristoxy's atumblin' to ruin, An' the sankylot's drorin' an' drinkin' their wine," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- "Yes," sez Johnson, "in France They're beginnin' to dance Beëlzebub's own rigadoon," sez he.

"The South's safe enough, it don't feel a mite skeery, Our slaves in their darkness an' dut air tu blest Not to welcome with proud hallylugers the ery Wen our eagle kicks yourn from the naytional nest," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- "Oh," sez Westcott o' Florida, "Wut treason is horrider Than our priv'leges tryin' to proon?" sez he.

"It's 'coz they're so happy, thet, wen crazy sarpints Stick their nose in our bizness, we git so darned riled; We think it's our dooty to give pooty sharp hints, Thet the last crumb of Eden on airth sha'n't be spiled," Sez John C. Calhoun, sez he;-- "Ah," sez Dixon H. Lewis, "It perfectly true is Thet slavery's airth's grettest boon," sez he.

JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL.

On March 7, 1850, Daniel Webster delivered in the Senate his famous speech on slavery, in which he declared for the exclusion of slavery from new territory, but called attention to the pledge which had been given to permit slavery south of the line of 36° 30´, and gave his support to the fugitive slave bill introduced by a Virginia senator. The speech created a sensation; Webster was overwhelmed with abuse, and made the target for one of the greatest poems of denunciation in the language.

ICHABOD

[March 7, 1850]

So fallen! so lost! the light withdrawn Which once he wore! The glory from his gray hairs gone Forevermore!

Revile him not, the Tempter hath A snare for all; And pitying tears, not scorn and wrath, Befit his fall!

Oh, dumb be passion's stormy rage, When he who might Have lighted up and led his age, Falls back in night.

Scorn! would the angels laugh, to mark A bright soul driven, Fiend-goaded, down the endless dark, From hope and heaven!

Let not the land once proud of him Insult him now, Nor brand with deeper shame his dim, Dishonored brow.

But let its humbled sons, instead, From sea to lake, A long lament, as for the dead, In sadness make.

Of all we loved and honored, naught Save power remains; A fallen angel's pride of thought, Still strong in chains.

All else is gone; from those great eyes The soul has fled; When faith is lost, when honor dies, The man is dead!

Then, pay the reverence of old days To his dead fame; Walk backward, with averted gaze, And hide the shame!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The feeling at the North against slavery was soon intensified in bitterness by the execution of the fugitive slave law, which, in a way, made Northern states participants in the detested traffic. On April 3, 1851, a fugitive slave named Thomas Sims was arrested at Boston, adjudged to his owner, and put on board a vessel bound for Savannah. Other efforts to enforce the law proved abortive, and it was soon evident that it was, to all intents and purposes, a dead letter.

THE KIDNAPPING OF SIMS

[April 3, 1851]

Souls of the patriot dead On Bunker's height who bled! The pile, that stands On your long-buried bones-- Those monumental stones-- Should not suppress the groans This day demands.

For Freedom there ye stood; There gave the earth your blood; There found your graves; That men of every clime, Faith, color, tongue, and time, Might, through your death sublime, Never be slaves.

Over your bed, so low, Heard ye not, long ago, A voice of power Proclaim to earth and sea, That where ye sleep should be A home for Liberty Till Time's last hour?

Hear ye the chains of slaves, Now clanking round your graves? Hear ye the sound Of that same voice that calls From out our Senate halls, "Hunt down those fleeing thralls, With horse and hound!"

That voice your sons hath swayed! 'Tis heard, and is obeyed! This gloomy day Tells you of ermine stained, Of Justice's name profaned, Of a poor bondman chained And borne away!

Over Virginia's Springs, Her eagles spread their wings, Her Blue Ridge towers-- That voice--once heard with awe-- Now asks, "Who ever saw, Up there, a higher law Than this of ours?"

Must we obey that voice? When God or man's the choice, Must we postpone Him, who from Sinai spoke? Must we wear slavery's yoke? Bear of her lash the stroke, And prop her throne?

Lashed with her hounds, must we Run down the poor who flee From Slavery's hell? Great God! when we do this Exclude us from thy bliss; At us let angels hiss From heaven that fell!

JOHN PIERPONT.

Abolition agitation was given new fuel when, on May 30, 1854, Congress passed the famous Kansas-Nebraska Bill, setting off the southern portion of Nebraska into a new territory called Kansas, and leaving the question of slavery or no-slavery to be decided by its inhabitants. The fight for Kansas began at once. Slaveholders from Missouri poured into the new territory, and in New England an Emigrant Aid Society was formed, which started large parties of Free-Soilers to Kansas. The first party started in July, 1854, and John G. Whittier sent them a hymn, which was sung over and over during the long journey.

THE KANSAS EMIGRANTS

[July, 1854]

We cross the prairie as of old The pilgrims crossed the sea, To make the West, as they the East, The homestead of the free!

We go to rear a wall of men On Freedom's southern line, And plant beside the cotton-tree The rugged Northern pine!

We're flowing from our native hills As our free rivers flow: The blessing of our Mother-land Is on us as we go.

We go to plant her common schools On distant prairie swells, And give the Sabbaths of the wild The music of her bells.

Upbearing, like the Ark of old, The Bible in our van, We go to test the truth of God Against the fraud of man.

No pause, nor rest, save where the streams That feed the Kansas run, Save where our Pilgrim gonfalon Shall flout the setting sun!

We'll tread the prairie as of old Our fathers sailed the sea, And make the West, as they the East, The homestead of the free!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The pro-slavery men soon resorted to violence. In December fifteen hundred Missourians laid siege to Lawrence, where most of the Free-Soilers had settled. The Free-Soilers threw up earthworks and mustered six hundred men to defend them, among them John Brown and his four sons from Osawatomie. One Free-Soiler, Thomas Barber, was killed under discreditable circumstances; but the Missourians were persuaded to withdraw before there were further hostilities.

BURIAL OF BARBER

[December 6, 1855]

Bear him, comrades, to his grave; Never over one more brave Shall the prairie grasses weep, In the ages yet to come, When the millions in our room, What we sow in tears, shall reap.

Bear him up the icy hill, With the Kansas, frozen still As his noble heart, below, And the land he came to till With a freeman's thews and will, And his poor hut roofed with snow!

One more look of that dead face, Of his murder's ghastly trace! One more kiss, O widowed one! Lay your left hands on his brow, Lift your right hands up, and vow That his work shall yet be done.

Patience, friends! The eye of God Every path by Murder trod Watches, lidless, day and night; And the dead man in his shroud, And his widow weeping loud, And our hearts, are in His sight.

Every deadly threat that swells With the roar of gambling hells, Every brutal jest and jeer, Every wicked thought and plan Of the cruel heart of man, Though but whispered, He can hear!

We in suffering, they in crime, Wait the just award of time, Wait the vengeance that is due; Not in vain a heart shall break, Not a tear for Freedom's sake Fall unheeded: God is true.

While the flag with stars bedecked Threatens where it should protect, And the Law shakes hands with Crime, What is left us but to wait, Match our patience to our fate, And abide the better time?

Patience, friends! The human heart Everywhere shall take our part, Everywhere for us shall pray; On our side are nature's laws, And God's life is in the cause That we suffer for to-day.

Well to suffer is divine; Pass the watchword down the line, Pass the countersign: "Endure." Not to him who rashly dares, But to him who nobly bears, Is the victor's garland sure.

Frozen earth to frozen breast, Lay our slain one down to rest; Lay him down in hope and faith, And above the broken sod, Once again, to Freedom's God, Pledge ourselves for life or death,

That the State whose walls we lay, In our blood and tears, to-day, Shall be free from bonds of shame, And our goodly land untrod By the feet of Slavery, shod With cursing as with flame!

Plant the Buckeye on his grave, For the hunter of the slave In its shadow cannot rest; And let martyr mound and tree Be our pledge and guaranty Of the freedom of the West!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

Affairs in Kansas went from bad to worse. Bands of armed emigrants poured into the state from the south, and such disorder followed that on August 25, 1856, the governor proclaimed the territory in a state of insurrection. On September 14 a force of twenty-five hundred Missourians again attacked Lawrence, but were beaten off.

THE DEFENCE OF LAWRENCE

[September 14, 1856]

All night upon the guarded hill, Until the stars were low, Wrapped round as with Jehovah's will, We waited for the foe; All night the silent sentinels Moved by like gliding ghosts; All night the fancied warning bells Held all men to their posts.

We heard the sleeping prairies breathe, The forest's human moans, The hungry gnashing of the teeth Of wolves on bleaching bones; We marked the roar of rushing fires, The neigh of frightened steeds, The voices as of far-off lyres Among the river reeds.

We were but thirty-nine who lay Beside our rifles then; We were but thirty-nine, and they Were twenty hundred men. Our lean limbs shook and reeled about, Our feet were gashed and bare, And all the breezes shredded out Our garments in the air.

* * * * *

They came: the blessed Sabbath day, That soothed our swollen veins, Like God's sweet benediction, lay On all the singing plains; The valleys shouted to the sun, The great woods clapped their hands, And joy and glory seemed to run Like rivers through the lands.

And then our daughters and our wives, And men whose heads were white, Rose sudden into kingly lives And walked forth to the fight; And we drew aim along our guns And calmed our quickening breath, Then, as is meet for Freedom's sons, Shook loving hands with Death.

And when three hundred of the foe Rode up in scorn and pride, Whoso had watched us then might know That God was on our side; For all at once a mighty thrill Of grandeur through us swept, And strong and swiftly down the hill Like Gideons we leapt.

And all throughout that Sabbath day A wall of fire we stood, And held the baffled foe at bay, And streaked the ground with blood. And when the sun was very low They wheeled their stricken flanks, And passed on, wearily and slow, Beyond the river banks.

Beneath the everlasting stars We bended child-like knees, And thanked God for the shining scars Of His large victories. And some, who lingered, said they heard Such wondrous music pass As though a seraph's voice had stirred The pulses of the grass.

RICHARD REALF.

A bill for the admission of Kansas under a constitution permitting slavery was introduced in Congress in February, 1858, and occasioned one of the most acrimonious debates ever heard at the Capital. In the House, a fist fight occurred between Keitt of South Carolina, and Grow of Pennsylvania. The bill was passed on May 4.

THE FIGHT OVER THE BODY OF KEITT

A FRAGMENT FROM THE GREAT AMERICAN EPIC, THE WASHINGTONIAD

[March, 1858]

Sing, O goddess, the wrath, the ontamable dander of Keitt-- Keitt of South Carolina, the clear grit, the tall, the ondaunted-- Him that hath wopped his own niggers till Northerners all unto Keitt Seem but as niggers to wop, and hills of the smallest potatoes. Late and long was the fight on the Constitution of Kansas; Daylight passed into dusk, and dusk into lighting of gas-lamps;-- Still on the floor of the house the heroes unwearied were fighting. Dry grew palates and tongues with excitement and expectoration, Plugs were becoming exhausted, and Representatives also. Who led on to the war the anti-Lecomptonite phalanx? Grow, hitting straight from the shoulder, the Pennsylvania Slasher; Him followed Hickman, and Potter the wiry, from woody Wisconsin; Washburne stood with his brother,--Cadwallader stood with Elihu; Broad Illinois sent the one, and woody Wisconsin the other. Mott came mild as new milk, with gray hairs under his broad brim, Leaving the first chop location and water privilege near it, Held by his fathers of old on the willow-fringed banks of Ohio. Wrathy Covode, too, I saw, and Montgomery ready for mischief. Who against these to the floor led on the Lecomptonite legions? Keitt of South Carolina, the clear grit, the tall, the ondaunted-- Keitt and Reuben Davis, the ra'al hoss of wild Mississippi; Barksdale, wearer of wigs, and Craige from North Carolina; Craige and scorny McQueen, and Owen, and Lovejoy, and Lamar, These Mississippi sent to the war, "_tres juncti in uno_." Long had raged the warfare of words; it was four in the morning; Whittling and expectoration and liquorin' all were exhausted, When Keitt, tired of talk, bespake Reu. Davis, "O Reuben, Grow's a tarnation blackguard, and I've concluded to clinch him." This said, up to his feet he sprang, and loos'ning his choker, Straighted himself for a grip, as a b'ar-hunter down in Arkansas Squares to go in at the b'ar, when the dangerous varmint is cornered. "Come out, Grow," he cried, "you Black Republican puppy, Come on the floor, like a man, and darn my eyes, but I'll show you"-- Him answered straight-hitting Grow, "Wall now, I calkilate, Keitt, No nigger-driver shall leave his plantation in South Carolina, Here to crack his cow-hide round this child's ears, if he knows it." Scarce had he spoke when the hand, the chiválrous five fingers of Keitt, Clutched at his throat,--had they closed, the speeches of Grow had been ended,-- Never more from a stump had he stirred up the free and enlightened;-- But though smart Keitt's mauleys, the mauleys of Grow were still smarter; Straight from the shoulder he shot,--not Owen Swift or Ned Adams Ever put in his right with more delicate feeling of distance. As drops hammer on anvil, so dropped Grow's right into Keitt Just where the jugular runs to the point at which Ketch ties his drop-knot;-- Prone like a log sank Keitt, his dollars rattled about him. Forth sprang his friends o'er the body; first Barksdale, waving-wig-wearer, Craige and McQueen and Davis, the ra'al hoss of wild Mississippi; Fiercely they gathered round Grow, catawampously up as to chaw him; But without Potter they reckoned, the wiry from woody Wisconsin; He, striking out right and left, like a catamount varmint and vicious, Dashed to the rescue, and with him the Washburnes, Cadwallader, Elihu; Slick into Barksdale's bread-basket walked Potter's one,

two,--hard and heavy; Barksdale fetched wind in a trice, dropped Grow, and let out at Elihu. Then like a fountain had flowed the claret of Washburne the elder, But for Cadwallader's care,--Cadwallader, guard of his brother, Clutching at Barksdale's nob, into Chancery soon would have drawn it. Well was it then for Barksdale, the wig that waved over his forehead: Off in Cadwallader's hands it came, and, the wearer releasing, Left to the conqueror naught but the scalp of his bald-headed foeman. Meanwhile hither and thither, a dove on the waters of trouble, Moved Mott, mild as new milk, with his gray hair under his broad brim, Preaching peace to deaf ears, and getting considerably damaged. Cautious Covode in the rear, as dubious what it might come to, Brandished a stone-ware spittoon 'gainst whoever might seem to deserve it,-- Little it mattered to him whether Pro- or Anti-Lecompton, So but he found in the Hall a foeman worthy his weapon! So raged the battle of men, till into the thick of the _mêlée_, Like to the heralds of old, stepped the Sergeant-at-Arms and the Speaker.

Only a few days later, on May 19, occurred an affair which threw the country into convulsion. A Georgian named Charles A. Hamilton gathered together a gang of twenty-five Missourians, attacked the Free-Soilers in the neighborhood of Marais des Cygnes, took eleven prisoners, marched them off to a gulch and shot them. The pursuit of the assassins was so half-hearted that they all escaped.

LE MARAIS DU CYGNE

[May 19, 1858]

A blush as of roses Where rose never grew! Great drops on the bunch-grass, But not of the dew! A taint in the sweet air For wild bees to shun! A stain that shall never Bleach out in the sun!

Back, steed of the prairies! Sweet song-bird, fly back! Wheel hither, bald vulture! Gray wolf, call thy pack! The foul human vultures Have feasted and fled; The wolves of the Border Have crept from the dead.

From the hearths of their cabins, The fields of their corn, Unwarned and unweaponed, The victims were torn,-- By the whirlwind of murder Swooped up and swept on To the low, reedy fen-lands, The Marsh of the Swan.

With a vain plea for mercy No stout knee was crooked; In the mouths of the rifles Right manly they looked. How paled the May sunshine, O Marais du Cygne! On death for the strong life, On red grass for green!

In the homes of their rearing, Yet warm with their lives, Ye wait the dead only, Poor children and wives! Put out the red forge-fire, The smith shall not come; Unyoke the brown oxen, The ploughman lies dumb.

Wind slow from the Swan's Marsh, O dreary death-train, With pressed lips as bloodless As lips of the slain! Kiss down the young eyelids, Smooth down the gray hairs; Let tears quench the curses That burn through your prayers.

Strong man of the prairies, Mourn bitter and wild! Wail, desolate woman! Weep, fatherless child! But the grain of God springs up From ashes beneath, And the crown

of his harvest Is life out of death.

Not in vain on the dial The shade moves along, To point the great contrasts Of right and of wrong: Free homes and free altars, Free prairie and flood,-- The reeds of the Swan's Marsh, Whose bloom is of blood!

On the lintels of Kansas That blood shall not dry; Henceforth the Bad Angel Shall harmless go by; Henceforth to the sunset, Unchecked on her way, Shall Liberty follow The march of the day.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

Prominent among the Kansas Free-Soilers was John Brown, a leader in the guerrilla warfare. United States troops were finally thrown into the territory to preserve peace, and Brown, looking around for new fields, decided to strike a blow in Virginia. On the night of October 16, 1859, at the head of a small company, he surprised and captured the arsenal at Harper's Ferry. He was attacked next day by an overwhelming force of militia and United States marines, his men either killed or captured, and he himself taken prisoner. He was tried for treason and murder in the first degree, was found guilty and hanged December 2, 1859. The men who had been captured with him were hanged a few days later.

HOW OLD BROWN TOOK HARPER'S FERRY

[October 16, 1859]

John Brown in Kansas settled, like a steadfast Yankee farmer, Brave and godly, with four sons, all stalwart men of might. There he spoke aloud for freedom, and the Border-strife grew warmer, Till the Rangers fired his dwelling, in his absence, in the night; And Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Came homeward in the morning--to find his house burned down.

Then he grasped his trusty rifle and boldly fought for freedom; Smote from border unto border the fierce, invading band; And he and his brave boys vowed--so might Heaven help and speed 'em!-- They would save those grand old prairies from the curse that blights the land; And Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Said, "Boys, the Lord will aid us!" and he shoved his ramrod down.

And the Lord _did_ aid these men, and they labored day and even, Saving Kansas from its peril; and their very lives seemed charmed, Till the ruffians killed one son, in the blessed light of Heaven,-- In cold blood the fellows slew him, as he journeyed all unarmed; Then Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Shed not a tear, but shut his teeth, and frowned a terrible frown!

Then they seized another brave boy,--not amid the heat of battle, But in peace, behind his ploughshare,--and they loaded him with chains, And with pikes, before their horses, even as they goad their cattle, Drove him cruelly, for their sport, and at last blew out his brains; Then Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Raised his right hand up to Heaven, calling Heaven's vengeance down.

And he swore a fearful oath, by the name of the Almighty, He would hunt this ravening evil that had scathed and torn him so; He would seize it by the vitals; he would crush it day and night; he Would so pursue its footsteps, so return it blow for blow, That Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Should be a name to swear by, in backwoods or in town!

Then his beard became more grizzled, and his wild blue eye grew wilder, And more sharply curved his hawk's-nose, snuffing battle from afar; And he and the two boys left, though the Kansas strife waxed milder, Grew more sullen, till was over the bloody Border War, And Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Had gone crazy, as they reckoned by his fearful glare and frown.

So he left the plains of Kansas and their bitter woes behind him, Slipt off into Virginia, where the statesmen all are born, Hired a farm by Harper's Ferry, and no one knew where to find him, Or whether he'd turned parson, or was jacketed and shorn; For Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Mad as he was, knew texts enough to wear a parson's gown.

He bought no ploughs and harrows, spades and shovels, and such trifles; But quietly to his rancho there came, by every train, Boxes full of pikes and pistols, and his well-beloved Sharp's rifles; And eighteen other madmen joined their leader there again. Says Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, "Boys, we've got an army large enough to march and take the town!

"Take the town, and seize the muskets, free the negroes and then arm them; Carry the County and the State, ay, and all the potent South. On their own heads be the slaughter, if their victims rise to harm them-- These Virginians! who believed not, nor would heed the warning mouth." Says Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, "The world shall see a Republic, or my name is not John Brown."

'Twas the sixteenth of October, on the evening of a Sunday: "This good work," declared the captain, "shall be on a holy night!" It was on a Sunday evening, and before the noon of Monday, With two sons, and Captain Stephens, fifteen privates--black and white, Captain Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Marched across the bridged Potomac, and knocked the sentry down;

Took the guarded armory-building, and the muskets and the cannon; Captured all the county majors and the colonels, one by one; Scared to death each gallant scion of Virginia they ran on, And before the noon of Monday, I say, the deed was done. Mad Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, With his eighteen other crazy men, went in and took the town.

Very little noise and bluster, little smell of powder made he; It was all done in the midnight, like the Emperor's _coup d'état_. "Cut the wires! Stop the rail-cars! Hold the streets and bridges!" said he, Then declared the new Republic, with himself for guiding star,-- This Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown; And the bold two thousand citizens ran off and left the town.

Then was riding and railroading and expressing here and thither; And the Martinsburg Sharpshooters and the Charlestown Volunteers, And the Shepherdstown

and Winchester militia hastened whither Old Brown was said to muster his ten thousand grenadiers. General Brown! Osawatomie Brown! Behind whose rampant banner all the North was pouring down.

But at last, 'tis said, some prisoners escaped from Old Brown's durance, And the effervescent valor of the Chivalry broke out, When they learned that nineteen madmen had the marvellous assurance-- Only nineteen--thus to seize the place and drive them straight about; And Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Found an army come to take him, encamped around the town.

But to storm, with all the forces I have mentioned, was too risky; So they hurried off to Richmond for the Government Marines, Tore them from their weeping matrons, fired their souls with Bourbon whiskey, Till they battered down Brown's castle with their ladders and machines; And Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Received three bayonet stabs, and a cut on his brave old crown.

Tallyho! the old Virginia gentry gather to the baying! In they rushed and killed the game, shooting lustily away; And whene'er they slew a rebel, those who came too late for slaying, Not to lose a share of glory, fired their bullets in his clay; And Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, Saw his sons fall dead beside him, and between them laid him down.

How the conquerors wore their laurels; how they hastened on the trial; How Old Brown was placed, half dying, on the Charlestown court-house floor; How he spoke his grand oration, in the scorn of all denial; What the brave old madman told them,--these are known the country o'er. "Hang Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown," Said the judge, "and all such rebels!" with his most judicial frown.

But, Virginians, don't do it! for I tell you that the flagon, Filled with blood of Old Brown's offspring, was first poured by Southern hands; And each drop from Old Brown's life-veins, like the red gore of the dragon, May spring up a vengeful Fury, hissing through your slave-worn lands! And Old Brown, Osawatomie Brown, May trouble you more than ever, when you've nailed his coffin down!

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

November, 1859.

THE BATTLE OF CHARLESTOWN

[December 2, 1859]

Fresh palms for the Old Dominion! New peers for the valiant Dead! Never hath showered her sunshine On a field of doughtier dread-- Heroes in buff three thousand, And a single scarred gray head!

Fuss, and feathers, and flurry-- Clink, and rattle, and roar-- The old man looks around him On meadow and mountain hoar; The place, he remarks, is pleasant, I had not seen it before.

Form, in your boldest order, Let the people press no nigher! Would ye have them hear to his words-- The words that may spread like fire?

'Tis a right smart chance to test him (Here we are at the gallows-tree), So knot the noose--pretty tightly-- Bandage his eyes, and we'll see (For we'll keep him waiting a little), If he tremble in nerve or knee.

There, in a string, we've got him! (Shall the music bang and blow?) The chivalry wheels and marches, And airs its valor below.

Look hard in the blindfold visage (He can't look back), and inquire (He has stood there nearly a quarter), If he doesn't begin to tire?

Not yet! how long will he keep us, To see if he quail or no? I reckon it's no use waiting, And 'tis time that we had the show.

For the trouble--we can't see why-- Seems with us, and not with him, As he stands 'neath the autumn sky, So strangely solemn and dim! But high let our standard flout it! "Sic Semper"--the drop comes down-- And (woe to the rogues that doubt it!) There's an end of old John Brown!

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

BROWN OF OSSAWATOMIE

[December 2, 1859]

John Brown of Ossawatomie spake on his dying day: "I will not have to shrive my soul a priest in Slavery's pay. But let some poor slave-mother whom I have striven to free, With her children, from the gallows-stair put up a prayer for me!"

John Brown of Ossawatomie, they led him out to die; And lo! a poor slave-mother with her little child pressed nigh. Then the bold, blue eye grew tender, and the old harsh face grew mild, As he stooped between the jeering ranks and kissed the negro's child!

The shadows of his stormy life that moment fell apart; And they who blamed the bloody hand forgave the loving heart. That kiss from all its guilty means redeemed the good intent, And round the grisly fighter's hair the martyr's aureole bent!

Perish with him the folly that seeks through evil good! Long live the generous purpose unstained with human blood! Not the raid of midnight terror, but the thought which underlies; Not the borderer's pride of daring, but the Christian's sacrifice.

Nevermore may yon Blue Ridges the Northern rifle hear, Nor see the light of blazing homes flash on the negro's spear. But let the free-winged angel Truth their guarded passes scale, To teach that right is more than might, and justice more than mail!

So vainly shall Virginia set her battle in array; In vain her trampling squadrons knead the winter snow with clay. She may strike the pouncing eagle, but she dares not harm the dove; And every gate she bars to Hate shall open wide to Love!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

In the North, Brown was considered a sainted martyr--an estimate as untrue as the Southern one--and "John Brown's Body" became the most popular marching song in the war which was to follow. Charles Sprague Hall is said to have been the author of the verses.

GLORY HALLELUJAH! OR JOHN BROWN'S BODY

John Brown's body lies a-mould'ring in the grave, John Brown's body lies a-mould'ring in the grave, John Brown's body lies a-mould'ring in the grave, His soul is marching on! _Chorus_--Glory! Glory Hallelujah! Glory! Glory Hallelujah! Glory! Glory Hallelujah! His soul is marching on.

He's gone to be a soldier in the army of the Lord! His soul is marching on.

John Brown's knapsack is strapped upon his back. His soul is marching on.

His pet lambs will meet him on the way, And they'll go marching on.

They'll hang Jeff Davis on a sour apple tree, As they go marching on.

Now for the Union let's give three rousing cheers, As we go marching on. Hip, hip, hip, hip, Hurrah!

CHARLES SPRAGUE HALL.

A variant of the John Brown song was written by Miss Edna Dean Proctor, and is certainly more coherent and intelligible than the lines which formed a marching song for over a million men.

JOHN BROWN

John Brown died on the scaffold for the slave; Dark was the hour when we dug his hallowed grave; Now God avenges the life he gladly gave, Freedom reigns to-day! Glory, glory hallelujah, Glory, glory hallelujah, Glory, glory hallelujah, Freedom reigns to-day!

John Brown sowed and the harvesters are we; Honor to him who has made the bondsman free; Loved evermore shall our noble ruler be, Freedom reigns to-day!

John Brown's body lies mouldering in the grave; Bright o'er the sod let the starry banner wave; Lo! for the million he perilled all to save, Freedom reigns to-day!

John Brown's body through the world is marching on; Hail to the hour when oppression shall be gone; All men will sing in the better day's dawn, Freedom reigns to-day!

John Brown dwells where the battle's strife is o'er; Hate cannot harm him, nor sorrow stir him more; Earth will remember the martyrdom he bore, Freedom reigns to-day!

John Brown's body lies mouldering in the grave; John Brown lives in the triumph of the brave; John Brown's soul not a higher joy can crave, Freedom reigns to-day!

EDNA DEAN PROCTOR.

JOHN BROWN: A PARADOX

Compassionate eyes had our brave John Brown, And a craggy stern forehead, a militant frown; He, the storm-bow of peace. Give him volley on volley, The fool who redeemed us once of our folly, And the smiter that healed us, our right John Brown!

Too vehement, verily, was John Brown! For waiting is statesmanlike; his the renown Of the holy rash arm, the equipper and starter Of freedmen; aye, call him fanatic and martyr: He can carry both halos, our plain John Brown.

A scandalous stumbling-block was John Brown, And a jeer; but ah! soon from the terrified town, In his bleeding track made over hilltop and hollow, Wise armies and councils were eager to follow, And the children's lips chanted our lost John Brown.

Star-led for us, stumbled and groped John Brown, Star-led, in the awful morasses to drown; And the trumpet that rang for a nation's upheaval, From the thought that was just, thro' the deed that was evil, Was blown with the breath of this dumb John Brown!

Bared heads and a pledge unto mad John Brown! Now the curse is allayed, now the dragon is down, Now we see, clear enough, looking back at the onset, Christianity's flood-tide and Chivalry's sunset In the old broken heart of our hanged John Brown!

LOUISE IMOGEN GUINEY.

The summer of 1860 swung around, and on April 23 the National Democratic Convention met at Charleston, S. C. Antagonism at once developed between the delegates from the South and from the North, the committee on resolutions could not agree, and after a week of bitter debate the Northern platform was adopted and the Southern delegates withdrew in a body. It was the first step toward secession. The convention adjourned to meet at Baltimore, where Stephen A. Douglas was nominated for the presidency.

LECOMPTON'S BLACK BRIGADE

A SONG OF THE CHARLESTON CONVENTION

[April 23, 1860]

Single-handed, and surrounded by Lecompton's black brigade, With the treasury of a nation drained to pay for hireling aid; All the weapons of corruption--the bribe, the threat, the lie-- All the forces of his rivals leagued to make this one man die, Yet smilingly he met them, his heart and forehead bare, And they quailed beneath the lightnings of his blue eye's sudden glare; For all behind him thronging the mighty people came, With looks of fiery eagerness and words of leaping flame-- "A Douglas

and a Douglas!" Hark to the people's cry, Shaking the earth beneath their feet, And thundering through the sky.

Crooked and weak, but envious as the witches of Macbeth, Came old and gray Buchanan a-hungering for his death; And full of mortal strategy, with green and rheumy eyes, John Slidell--he of Houmas--each poisoned arrow tries. With cold and stony visage, lo! Breckinridge is there, While old Joe Lane keeps flourishing his rusty sword in air; But still the "Little Giant" holds unmoved his fearless way, While the great waves of the people behind him rock and sway-- "A Douglas and a Douglas! No hand but his can guide, In such a strait, our ship of state Across the stormy tide."

A poisonous reptile, many-scaled and with most subtle fang, Crawled forward Caleb Cushing, while behind his rattles rang; And, mounted on a charger of hot and glossy black, The Alabamian Yancey dashes in with fell attack: Lo! Bayard is aroused, and quits his favorite cards and dice, While Jeff Davis plots with Bigler full many a foul device; But, smiling still, against them all their One Foe holds his own, While louder still and louder, the cry behind has grown-- "A Douglas and a Douglas, Who every base trick spurns; The people's will is sovereign still, And that to Douglas turns."

Half horse, half alligator, here from Mississippi's banks The blatant Barry caracoles and spurs along the ranks; From Arkansaw comes Burrows, with his "toothpick" in its sheath, While that jaundiced Georgian, Jackson, shows his grim and ugly teeth; And Barksdale barks his bitterest bark, and curls his stunted tail, And snarls like forty thousand curs beneath a storm of hail; But smiling now--almost a laugh--the Douglas marches on, While many million voices rise in chorus like to one-- "A Douglas and a Douglas" Louder the war-song grows: "God speed the man who fights so well Against a thousand foes."

Long and fierce was the encounter beneath the burning sky, Fierce were the threatening gestures--the words rang shrill and high; In a struggle most protracted, after seven and fifty shocks, Like those old gigantic combats in which Titans fought with rocks (And with "rocks," but of a different kind, no doubt Buchanan fought), This first pitched battle of the war unto its end was brought; And smiling still, with stainless plume and eye as clear as day, The "Little Giant" held his own through all that murderous fray: "A Douglas and a Douglas!" Still louder grows the roar Which swells and floats from myriad throats Like waves on some wild shore.

Oh! a cheer for Colonel Flournoy, who to help our chief did press, May memory perish if his name we cease to love and bless! And a cheer for all the good and true who faced the music's note, Who seized old Hydra in his den, and shook him by the throat. Though our country stand forever, from her record ne'er will fade The glory of that combat with Lecompton's black brigade; And when June comes with her roses, at Baltimore we'll crown The "Little Giant," who has met and struck corruption down. So a Douglas and a Douglas! While hearts have smiles and tears, Your name will glow, your praise shall flow, Through all the coming years.

CHARLES GRAHAM HALPINE.

While the Democrats were thus divided, the Republicans had met at Chicago, adopted a platform protesting against the extension of slavery in the territories, and nominated for President Abraham Lincoln, of Illinois. On November 6, 1860, Lincoln was elected President, receiving one hundred and eighty electoral votes.

LINCOLN, THE MAN OF THE PEOPLE

When the Norn-Mother saw the Whirlwind Hour, Greatening and darkening as it hurried on, She bent the strenuous heavens and came down To make a man to meet the mortal need. She took the tried clay of the common road-- Clay warm yet with the genial heat of Earth, Dashed through it all a strain of prophecy; Then mixed a laughter with the serious stuff. It was a stuff to wear for centuries, A man that matched the mountains, and compelled The stars to look our way and honor us.

The color of the ground was in him, the red earth; The tang and odor of the primal things-- The rectitude and patience of the rocks; The gladness of the wind that shakes the corn; The courage of the bird that dares the sea; The justice of the rain that loves all leaves; The pity of the snow that hides all scars; The loving-kindness of the wayside well; The tolerance and equity of light That gives as freely to the shrinking weed As to the great oak flaring to the wind-- To the grove's low bill as to the Matterhorn That shoulders out the sky.

And so he came. From prairie cabin up to Capitol, One fair Ideal led our chieftain on. Forevermore he burned to do his deed With the fine stroke and gesture of a king. He built the rail-pile as he built the State, Pouring his splendid strength through every blow, The conscience of him testing every stroke, To make his deed the measure of a man.

So came the Captain with a mighty heart: And when the step of Earthquake shook the house, Wrenching the rafters from their ancient hold, He held the ridgepole up, and spiked again The rafters of the Home. He held his place-- Held the long purpose like a growing tree-- Held on through blame and faltered not at praise. And when he fell in whirlwind, he went down As when a kingly cedar green with boughs Goes down with a great shout upon the hills, And leaves a lonesome place against the sky.

EDWIN MARKHAM.

Lincoln's election was the signal the South had been awaiting. On December 20, 1860, the state of South Carolina unanimously passed an ordinance of secession, and a week later, the state troops seized Castle Pinckney and Fort Moultrie, in Charleston harbor, and took possession of the United States arsenal at Charleston, with seventy-five thousand stands of arms.

BROTHER JONATHAN'S LAMENT FOR SISTER CAROLINE

She has gone,--she has left us in passion and pride,-- Our stormy-browed sister, so long at our side! She has torn her own star from our firmament's glow, And turned on her brother the face of a foe!

O Caroline, Caroline, child of the sun, We can never forget that our hearts have been one,-- Our foreheads both sprinkled in Liberty's name, From the fountain of blood with the finger of flame!

You were always too ready to fire at a touch; But we said: "She is hasty,--she does not mean much." We have scowled when you uttered some turbulent threat; But Friendship still whispered: "Forgive and forget."

Has our love all died out? Have its altars grown cold? Has the curse come at last which the fathers foretold? Then Nature must teach us the strength of the chain That her petulant children would sever in vain.

They may fight till the buzzards are gorged with their spoil,-- Till the harvest grows black as it rots in the soil, Till the wolves and the catamounts troop from their caves, And the shark tracks the pirate, the lord of the waves:

In vain is the strife! When its fury is past, Their fortunes must flow in one channel at last, As the torrents that rush from the mountains of snow Roll mingled in peace through the valleys below.

Our Union is river, lake, ocean, and sky; Man breaks not the medal when God cuts the die! Though darkened with sulphur, though cloven with steel, The blue arch will brighten, the waters will heal!

O Caroline, Caroline, child of the sun, There are battles with fate that can never be won! The star-flowering banner must never be furled, For its blossoms of light are the hope of the world!

Go, then, our rash sister, afar and aloof,-- Run wild in the sunshine away from our roof; But when your heart aches and your feet have grown sore, Remember the pathway that leads to our door!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

Georgia, Alabama, Florida, North Carolina, Mississippi, and Louisiana followed South Carolina's lead in seceding and seizing United States forts and arsenals. On February 4, 1861, the first Confederate congress met at Montgomery, Ala., and a few days later, Jefferson Davis, of Mississippi, was chosen President, and Alexander H. Stephens, of Georgia, Vice-President, of the Confederate States.

JEFFERSON D.

You're a traitor convicted, you know very well! Jefferson D., Jefferson D.! You thought it a capital thing to rebel, Jefferson D.! But there's one thing I'll say: You'll discover some day, When you see a stout cotton cord hang from a tree, There's an accident happened you didn't foresee, Jefferson D.!

What shall be found upon history's page? Jefferson D., Jefferson D.! When a student explores the republican age! Jefferson D.! He will find, as is meet, That at Judas's feet You sit in your shame, with the impotent plea, That you hated the land and the law of the free, Jefferson D.!

What do you see in your visions at night, Jefferson D., Jefferson D.? Does the spectacle furnish you any delight, Jefferson D.? Do you feel in disgrace The black cap o'er your face, While the tremor creeps down from your heart to your knee, And freedom, insulted, approves the decree, Jefferson D.?

Oh! long have we pleaded, till pleading is vain, Jefferson D., Jefferson D.! Your hands are imbrued with the blood of the slain, Jefferson D.! And at last, for the right, We arise in our might, A people united, resistless, and free, And declare that rebellion no longer shall be! Jefferson D.!

H. S. CORNWELL.

Davis was inaugurated on February 18, 1861, and declared in his inaugural that the attitude of the Southern States was purely one of self-defence. "All we want," he said, "is to be let alone."

THE OLD COVE

"All we ask is to be let alone."

[February 18, 1861]

As vonce I valked by a dismal svamp, There sot an Old Cove in the dark and damp, And at everybody as passed that road A stick or a stone this Old Cove throwed. And venever he flung his stick or his stone, He'd set up a song of "Let me alone."

"Let me alone, for I loves to shy These bits of things at the passers-by-- Let me alone, for I've got your tin And lots of other traps snugly in;-- Let me alone, I'm riggin' a boat To grab votever you've got afloat;-- In a veek or so I expects to come And turn you out of your 'ouse and 'ome;-- I'm a quiet Old Cove," says he, with a groan: "All I axes is--Let me alone."

Just then came along on the self-same vay, Another Old Cove, and began for to say-- "Let you alone! That's comin' it strong!-- You've _ben_ let alone a darned sight too long;-- Of all the sarce that ever I heerd! Put down that stick! (You may well look skeered.) Let go that stone! If you once show fight, I'll knock you higher than ary kite. You must hev a lesson to stop your tricks, And cure you of shying them stones and sticks,-- And I'll hev my hardware back and my cash, And knock your scow into tarnal smash, And if ever I catches you round my ranch, I'll string you up to the nearest branch.

"The best you can do is to go to bed, And keep a decent tongue in your head; For I reckon, before you and I are done, You'll wish you had left honest folks alone." The Old Cove stopped, and t'other Old Cove He sot quite still in his cypress grove, And he looked at his stick revolvin' slow Whether 'twere safe to shy it or no,-- And he grumbled on, in an injured tone, "All that I axed vos, _let me alone_."

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

Texas, by a majority of over three to one, voted to join the Confederacy, and seized more than a million dollars' worth of government munitions. Some were saved by the

Union troops, notably those at Fort Duncan.

A SPOOL OF THREAD

[March, 1861]

Well, yes, I've lived in Texas since the spring of '61; And I'll relate the story, though I fear, sir, when 'tis done, 'Twill be little worth your hearing, it was such a simple thing, Unheralded in verses that the grander poets sing.

There had come a guest unbidden, at the opening of the year, To find a lodgment in our hearts, and the tenant's name was fear; For secession's drawing mandate was a call for men and arms, And each recurring eventide but brought us fresh alarms.

They had notified the General that he must yield to fate, And all the muniments of war surrender to the state, But he sent from San Antonio an order to the sea To convey on board the steamer all the fort's artillery.

Right royal was his purpose, but the foe divined his plan, And the wily Texans set a guard to intercept the man Detailed to bear the message; they placed their watch with care That neither scout nor citizen should pass it unaware.

Well, this was rather awkward, sir, as doubtless you will say, But the Major, who was chief of staff, resolved to have his way Despite the watchful provost guard; so he asked his wife to send, With a box of knick-knacks, a letter to her friend; And the missive held one sentence I remember to this day: "The thread is for your neighbor, Mr. French, across the way."

He dispatched a youthful courier. Of course, as you will know, The Texans searched him thoroughly and ordered him to show The contents of the letter. They read it o'er and o'er, But failed to find the message they had hindered once before.

So it reached the English lady, and she wondered at the word, But gave the thread to Major French, explaining that she heard He wished a spool of cotton, and great was his surprise At such a trifle sent, unasked, through leagues of hostile spies.

"There's some hidden purpose, doubtless, in the curious gift," he said. Then he tore away the label, and inside the spool of thread Was Major Nichol's order, bidding him convey to sea All the arms and ammunition from Fort Duncan's battery. "Down to Brazon speed your horses," thus the Major's letter ran, "Shift equipments and munitions, and embark them if you can."

Yes, the transfer was effected, for the ships lay close at hand, Ere the Texans guessed their purpose, they had vanished from the land. Do I know it for a fact, sir? 'Tis no story that I've read-- I was but a boy in war time, and I carried him the thread.

SOPHIE E. EASTMAN.

On March 4, 1861, Abraham Lincoln was inaugurated President of the United States. In his address he stated that he had no intention of interfering with slavery in the states; but that acts of violence within any state against the authority of the United States were insurrectionary and would be repressed. In the Confederate

States this announcement was construed to mean war.

GOD SAVE OUR PRESIDENT

[March 4, 1861]

All hail! Unfurl the Stripes and Stars! The banner of the free! Ten times ten thousand patriots greet The shrine of Liberty! Come, with one heart, one hope, one aim, An undivided band, To elevate, with solemn rites, The ruler of our land!

Not to invest a potentate With robes of majesty,-- Not to confer a kingly crown, Nor bend a subject knee. We bow beneath no sceptred sway, Obey no royal nod:-- Columbia's sons, erect and free, Kneel only to their God!

Our ruler boasts no titled rank, No ancient, princely line,-- No regal right to sovereignty, Ancestral and divine. A patriot,--at his country's call, Responding to her voice; One of the people,--he becomes A sovereign by our choice!

And now, before the mighty pile We've reared to Liberty, He swears to cherish and defend The charter of the free! God of our country! seal his oath With Thy supreme assent. God save the Union of the States! God save our President!

FRANCIS DEHAES JANVIER.

CHAPTER II

THE GAUNTLET

In the fall of 1860 Major Robert Anderson was selected to command the little garrison at Fort Moultrie, in Charleston harbor. In spite of his entreaties, no reinforcements were sent him, and on the night of December 26 he abandoned Fort Moultrie, which his little force was incapable of defending, and moved to Fort Sumter, where he remained in spite of the state's protests.

BOB ANDERSON, MY BEAU

(Miss Columbia Sings)

Bob Anderson, my beau, Bob, when we were first aquent, You were in Mex-i-co, Bob, because by order sent; But now you are in Sumter, Bob, because you chose to go; And blessings on you anyhow, Bob Anderson, my beau!

Bob Anderson, my beau, Bob, I really don't know whether I ought to like you so, Bob, considering that feather; I don't like standing armies, Bob, as very well you know, But _I love a man that dares to act_, Bob Anderson, my beau.

Fort Moultrie was seized by the South Carolina troops, which were assembled in force under command of General Pierre T. Beauregard, and it was decided to bombard Sumter.

ON FORT SUMTER

It was a noble Roman, In Rome's imperial day, Who heard a coward croaker Before the battle say-- "They're safe in such a fortress; There is no way to shake it"-- "On, on!" exclaimed the hero, "I'LL FIND A WAY, OR MAKE IT!"

Is FAME your aspiration? Her path is steep and high; In vain he seeks the temple, Content to gaze and sigh; The crowded town is waiting, But he _alone_ can take it Who says, with "SOUTHERN FIRMNESS," "I'LL FIND A WAY, OR MAKE IT!"

Is GLORY your ambition? There is no royal road; Alike we all must labor, Must climb to her abode; Who feels the thirst for _glory_, In Helicon may slake it, If he has but the "SOUTHERN WILL," "TO FIND A WAY, OR MAKE IT!"

Is Sumter worth the getting? It must be bravely sought; With wishing and with fretting The boon cannot be bought; To _all_ the prize is open, But only he can take it Who says, with "SOUTHERN COURAGE," "I'LL FIND A WAY, OR MAKE IT!"

In all impassioned warfare, The tale has ever been, That victory crowns the valiant, The brave are they who win. Though strong is "_Sumter Fortress_," A HERO still may take it, Who says, with "SOUTHERN DARING," "I'LL FIND A WAY, OR MAKE IT!"

Charleston, S. C., _Mercury_.

On April 11 Beauregard summoned Anderson to surrender. Anderson promptly refused, and at 4.30 o'clock on the morning of April 12, 1861, the first gun against Sumter was fired. The fort answered promptly, and a terrific bombardment continued all day. The fort's ammunition was exhausted by the 13th, and Major Anderson accepted the terms of evacuation offered by General Beauregard. On the afternoon of Sunday, April 14, the little garrison marched out of the fort with colors flying and drums beating. Not a man had been killed on either side.

SUMTER

[April 12, 1861]

Came the morning of that day When the God to whom we pray Gave the soul of Henry Clay To the land; How we loved him, living, dying! But his birthday banners flying Saw us asking and replying Hand to hand.

For we knew that far away, Round the fort in Charleston Bay, Hung the dark impending fray, Soon to fall; And that Sumter's brave defender Had the summons to surrender Seventy loyal hearts and tender-- (Those were all!)

And we knew the April sun Lit the length of many a gun-- Hosts of batteries to the one Island crag; Guns and mortars grimly frowning, Johnson, Moultrie, Pinckney, crowning, And ten thousand men disowning The old flag.

Oh, the fury of the fight Even then was at its height! Yet no breath, from noon till night, Reached us here; We had almost ceased to wonder, And the day had faded under, When the echo of the thunder Filled each ear!

Then our hearts more fiercely beat, As we crowded on the street, Hot to gather and repeat All the tale; All the doubtful chances turning, Till our souls with shame were burning, As if twice our bitter yearning Could avail!

Who had fired the earliest gun? Was the fort by traitors won? Was there succor? What was done Who could know? And once more our thoughts would wander To the gallant, lone commander, On his battered ramparts grander Than the foe.

Not too long the brave shall wait: On their own heads be their fate, Who against the hallowed State Dare begin; Flag defied and compact riven! In the record of high Heaven How shall Southern men be shriven For the sin!

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

THE BATTLE OF MORRIS' ISLAND

A CHEERFUL TRAGEDY

[April 12, 1861]

I

The morn was cloudy and dark and gray, When the first Columbiad blazed away, Showing that there was the d--l to pay With the braves on Morris' Island; They fired their cannon again and again, Hoping that Major Anderson's men Would answer back, but 'twas all in vain At first, on Morris' Island: Hokee pokee, winkee wum, Shattering shot and thundering bomb, Fiddle and fife and rattling drum, At the battle of Morris' Island!

II

At length, as rose the morning sun, Fort Sumter fired a single gun, Which made the chivalry want to run Away from Morris' Island; But they had made so much of a boast Of their fancy batteries on the coast, That each felt bound to stick to his post Down there on Morris' Island.

III

Then there was firing in hot haste; The chivalry stripped them to the waist, And, brave as lions, they sternly faced --Their grog, on Morris' Island! The spirit of Seventy-six raged high, The cannons roared and the men grew dry-- 'Twas marvellous like the Fourth of July, That fight on Morris' Island.

IV

All day they fought, till the night came down; It rained; the fellows were tired and blown, And they wished they were safely back to town, Away from Morris' Island. One

can't expect the bravest men To shoot their cannons off in the rain, So all grew peaceful and still again, At the works on Morris' Island.

V

But after the heroes all had slept, To his gun each warrior swiftly leapt, Brisk, as the numerous fleas that crept In the sand on Morris' Island; And all that day they fired their shot, Heated in furnaces, piping hot, Hoping to send Fort Sumter to pot And glory to Morris' Island.

VI

Finally, wearying of the joke, Starved with hunger and blind with smoke From blazing barracks of pine and oak, Set fire from Morris' Island, The gallant Anderson struck his flag And packed his things in a carpet-bag, While cheers from bobtail, rag, and tag, Arose on Morris' Island.

VII

Then came the comforting piece of fun Of counting the noses one by one, To see if anything had been done On glorious Morris' Island: "Nobody hurt!" the cry arose; There was not missing a single nose, And this was the sadly ludicrous close Of the battle of Morris' Island.

VIII

But, gentle gunners, just wait and see What sort of a battle there yet will be; You'll hardly escape so easily, Next time on Morris' Island! There's a man in Washington with a will, Who won't mind shooting a little "to kill," If it proves that We Have a Government Still, Even on Morris' Island! Hokee pokee, winkee wum, Shattering shot and thundering bomb, Look out for the battle that's yet to come Down there on Morris' Island!

Anderson's total force numbered one hundred and twenty-eight. The South Carolina army opposed to him numbered about six thousand, and was made up largely of the best blood of the state. Planters and their sons, men of wealth and family, did not scruple to serve in the ranks. Their sweethearts and wives turned out in gala attire to witness their triumph, and when the fort surrendered, Charleston gave itself up to joy.

SUMTER--A BALLAD OF 1861

'Twas on the twelfth of April, Before the break of day. We heard the guns of Moultrie Give signal for the fray.

Anon across the waters There boomed the answering gun, From north and south came flash on flash; The battle had begun.

The mortars belched their deadly food And spiteful whizz'd the balls, A fearful storm of iron hailed On Sumter's doomèd walls.

We watched the meteor flight of shell, And saw the lightning flash-- Saw where each fiery missile fell, And heard the sullen crash.

The morn was dark and cloudy Yet till the sun arose, No answer to our gallant boys Came booming from our foes.

Then through the dark and murky clouds The morning sunlight came, And forth from Sumter's frowning walls Burst sudden sheets of flame.

Then shot and shell flew thick and fast, The war-dogs howling spoke, And thundering came their angry roar, Through wreathing clouds of smoke.

Again to fight for liberty Our gallant sons had come, They smiled when came the bugle call, And laughed when tapped the drum.

From cotton and from corn field, From desk and forum, too, From work bench and from anvil came Our gallant boys and true!

A hireling band had come to awe, Our chains to rivet fast; Yon lofty pile scowls on our homes Seaward the hostile mast.

But gallant freemen man our guns,-- No mercenary host, Who barter for their honor's price, And of their baseness boast.

Now came our stately matrons, And maidens, too, by scores; Oh! Carolina's beauty shone Like love-lights on her shores.

See yonder, anxious gazing, Alone a matron stands, The tear-drop glistening on each lid, And tightly clasped her hands.

For there, exposed to deadly fire, Her husband and her son-- "Father," she spoke, and heavenward look'd, "Father, thy will be done."

See yonder group of maidens, No joyous laughter now, For cares lie heavy on each heart And cloud each anxious brow;

For brothers dear and lovers fond Are there amid the strife; Tearful the sister's anxious gaze-- Pallid the promised wife.

Yet breathed no heart one thought of fear, Prompt at their country's call, They yielded forth their dearest hopes, And gave to honor all!

Now comes a message from below-- Oh! quick the tidings tell-- "At Moultrie and Fort Johnson, too, And Morris', all are well!"

Then mark the joyous bright'ning; See how each bosom swells; That friends and loved ones all are safe, Each to the other tells.

All day the shot flew thick and fast, All night the cannon roared, While wreathed in smoke stern Sumter stood And vengeful answer poured.

Again the sun rose, bright and clear, 'Twas on the thirteenth day, While, lo! at prudent distance moored, Five hostile vessels lay.

With choicest Abolition crews,-- The bravest of _their_ brave,-- They'd come to pull our Crescent down And dig Secession's grave.

"See, see, how Sumter's banner trails, They're signalling for aid. See you no boats of armed men? Is yet no movement made?"

Now densest smoke and lurid flames Burst out o'er Sumter's walls; "The fort's on fire," is the cry, Again for aid he calls.

See you no boats or vessels yet? Dare they not risk _one_ shot; To make report grandiloquent Of aid they rendered not?

Nor boat, nor vessel, leaves the fleet, "Let the old Major burn, We'll boast of what we would have done, If but--on our return."

Go back, go back, ye cravens; Go back the way ye came; Ye gallant, _would-be_ men-of-war, Go! to your country's shame.

'Mid fiery storm of shot and shell, 'Mid smoke and roaring flame, See how Kentucky's gallant son Does honor to her name!

See how he answers gun for gun-- Hurrah! his flag is down! The white! the white! Oh see it wave! Is echoed all around.

God save the gallant Anderson, All honor to his name, A soldier's duty nobly done, He's earned a hero's fame.

Now ring the bells a joyous peal, And rend with shouts the air, We've torn the hated banner down, And placed the Crescent there.

All honor to our gallant boys, Bring forth the roll of fame, And there in glowing lines inscribe Each patriot hero's name.

Spread, spread the tidings far and wide, Ye winds take up the cry, "Our soil's redeemed from hateful yoke, We'll keep it pure or die."

Columbia, S. C., _Banner_.

Very different was the reception of the news at the North. At last war had begun. The time for argument and compromise and entreaty was past. The time for action was at hand.

THE FIGHT AT SUMTER

'Twas a wonderful brave fight! Through the day and all night, March! Halt! Left! Right! So they formed: And one thousand to ten, The bold Palmetto men Sumter stormed.

The smoke in a cloud Closed her in like a shroud, While the cannon roared aloud From the Port; And the red cannon-balls Ploughed the gray granite walls Of the Fort.

Sumter's gunners at their places, With their gunpowdered faces, Shook their shoulders from their braces, And stripped Stark and white to the waist, Just to give the foe a taste, And be whipped.

In the town, through every street, Tramp, tramp, went the feet, For they said the Federal fleet Hove in sight; And down the wharves they ran, Every woman, child, and man, To the fight.

On the fort the old flag waved, And the barking batteries braved, While the bold seven thousand raved As they fought; For each blinding sheet of flame From her cannon thundered shame!-- So they thought.

And strange enough to tell, Though the gunners fired well, And the balls ploughed red as hell Through the dirt; Though the shells burst and scattered, And the fortress walls were shattered,-- _None were hurt_.

But the fort--so hot she grew, As the cannon-balls flew, That each man began to stew At his gun; They were not afraid to die, But this making Patriot pie Was not fun.

So, to make the story short, The traitors got the fort After thirty hours' sport With the balls; But the victory is not theirs, Though their brazen banner flares From the walls.

It were better they should dare The lion in his lair, Or defy the grizzly bear In his den, Than to wake the fearful cry That is rising up on high From our men.

To our banner we are clinging, And a song we are singing, Whose chorus is ringing From each mouth; 'Tis "The old Constitution And a stern retribution To the South."

Vanity Fair, April 27, 1861.

SUMTER

So, they _will_ have it! The Black Witch (curse on her) Always had won her Greediest demand--for we gave it-- All but our honor!

Thirty hours thundered Siege-guns and mortars-- (Flames in the quarters!) One to a hundred Stood our brave Forters!

No more of parties!-- Let them all moulder-- Here's work that's bolder! Forward, my hearties! Shoulder to shoulder.

Sight o'er the trunnion-- Send home the rammer-- Linstock and hammer! Speak for the Union! Tones that won't stammer!

Men of Columbia, Leal hearts from Annan, Brave lads of Shannon! We are all one to-day-- On with the cannon!

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

Nor was there any hesitation as to what that action should be. On Monday, April 15, 1861, President Lincoln issued a call for seventy-five thousand militia to suppress combinations obstructing the execution of the laws in seven of the Southern states.

THE GREAT BELL ROLAND

SUGGESTED BY THE PRESIDENT'S CALL FOR VOLUNTEERS

I

Toll! Roland, toll! --High in St. Bavon's tower, At midnight hour, The great bell Roland spoke, And all who slept in Ghent awoke. --What meant its iron stroke? Why caught each man his blade? Why the hot haste he made? Why echoed every street With tramp of thronging feet-- All flying to the city's wall? It was the call Known well to all, That Freedom stood in peril of some foe: And even timid hearts grew bold Whenever Roland tolled, And every hand a sword could hold;-- For men Were patriots then, Three hundred years ago!

II

Toll! Roland, toll! Bell never yet was hung, Between whose lips there swung So true and brave a tongue! --If men be patriots still, At thy first sound True hearts will bound, Great souls will thrill-- Then toll! and wake the test In each man's breast, And let him stand confess'd!

III

Toll! Roland, toll! --Not in St. Bavon's tower At midnight hour,-- Nor by the Scheldt, nor far-off Zuyder Zee; But here--this side the sea!-- And here in broad, bright day! Toll! Roland, toll! For not by night awaits A brave foe at the gates, But Treason stalks abroad--inside!--at noon! Toll! Thy alarm is not too soon! To arms! Ring out the Leader's call! Reëcho it from East to West, Till every dauntless breast Swell beneath plume and crest! Toll! Roland, toll! Till swords from scabbards leap! Toll! Roland, toll! --What tears can widows weep Less bitter than when brave men fall? Toll! Roland, toll! Till cottager from cottage-wall Snatch pouch and powder-horn and gun-- The heritage of sire to son, Ere half of Freedom's work was done! Toll! Roland, toll! Till son, in memory of his sire, Once more shall load and fire! Toll! Roland, toll! Till volunteers find out the art Of aiming at a traitor's heart!

IV

Toll! Roland, toll! --St. Bavon's stately tower Stands to this hour,-- And by its side stands Freedom yet in Ghent; For when the bells now ring, Men shout, "God save the King!" Until the air is rent! --Amen!--So let it be; For a true king is he Who keeps his people free. Toll! Roland, toll! This side the sea! No longer they, but we, Have now such need of thee! Toll! Roland, toll! And let thy iron throat Ring out its warning note, Till Freedom's perils be outbraved, And Freedom's flag, wherever waved, Shall overshadow none enslaved! Toll! till from either ocean's strand, Brave men shall clasp each other's hand, And shout, "God save our native land!" --And love the land which God hath saved! Toll! Roland, toll!

THEODORE TILTON.

Independent, April 18, 1861.

MEN OF THE NORTH AND WEST[7]

Men of the North and West, Wake in your might, Prepare, as the rebels have done, For the fight! You cannot shrink from the test; Rise! Men of the North and West!

They have torn down your banner of stars; They have trampled the laws; They have stifled the freedom they hate, For no cause! Do you love it or slavery best? Speak! Men of the North and West.

They strike at the life of the State: Shall the murder be done? They cry: "We are two!" And you: "We are one!" You must meet them, then, breast to breast; On! Men of the North and West!

Not with words; they laugh them to scorn, And tears they despise; But with swords in your hands and death In your eyes! Strike home! leave to God all the rest; Strike! Men of the North and West.

RICHARD HENRY STODDARD.

[7] From Poetical Writings of Richard Henry Stoddard; copyright, 1880, by Charles Scribner's Sons.

OUT AND FIGHT

Out and fight! The clouds are breaking, Far and wide the red light streams, North and west see millions waking From their night-mare, doubting dreams. War is coming. As the thunder 'Mid the mountain caverns rolls, Driving rains in torrents under, So the wild roar wakes our souls.

Out and fight! The time is over For all truce and compromise, Words of calm are words of folly, Peaceful dreams are painted lies; Sumter's flames in Southern waters Are the first wild beacon light, And on Northern hills reflected Give the signal for the fight.

Out and fight! Endure no longer Goading insult, brazen guilt; Be the battle to the knife blade, And the knife blade to the hilt, Till the sacred zone of Freedom Girds the whole Atlantic strand, And the braggart and the Gascon Be extinguished from the land.

CHARLES GODFREY LELAND.

Vanity Fair, April 27, 1861.

NO MORE WORDS

No more words; Try it with your swords! Try it with the arms of your bravest and your best! You are proud of your manhood, now put it to the test; Not another word; Try it

by the sword!

No more notes; Try it by the throats Of the cannon that will roar till the earth and air be shaken; For they speak what they mean, and they cannot be mistaken; No more doubt; Come--fight it out!

No child's play! Waste not a day; Serve out the deadliest weapons that you know; Let them pitilessly hail on the faces of the foe; No blind strife; Waste not one life.

You that in the front Bear the battle's brunt-- When the sun gleams at dawn on the bayonets abreast, Remember 'tis for government and country you contest; For love of all you guard, Stand, and strike hard!

You at home that stay From danger far away, Leave not a jot to chance, while you rest in quiet ease; Quick! forge the bolts of death; quick! ship them o'er the seas; If War's feet are lame, Yours will be the blame.

You, my lads, abroad, "Steady!" be your word; You, at home, be the anchor of your soldiers young and brave; Spare no cost, none is lost, that may strengthen or may save; Sloth were sin and shame, Now play out the game!

FRANKLIN LUSHINGTON.

"At the darkest hour in the history of the republic," Emerson wrote, "when it looked as if the nation would be dismembered, pulverized into its original elements, the attack on Fort Sumter crystallized the North into a unit, and the hope of mankind was saved."

OUR COUNTRY'S CALL

Lay down the axe; fling by the spade; Leave in its track the toiling plough; The rifle and the bayonet-blade For arms like yours were fitter now; And let the hands that ply the pen Quit the light task, and learn to wield The horseman's crooked brand, and rein The charger on the battle-field.

Our country calls; away! away! To where the blood-stream blots the green. Strike to defend the gentlest sway That Time in all his course has seen. See, from a thousand coverts--see, Spring the armed foes that haunt her track; They rush to smite her down, and we Must beat the banded traitors back.

Ho! sturdy as the oaks ye cleave, And moved as soon to fear and flight, Men of the glade and forest! leave Your woodcraft for the field of fight. The arms that wield the axe must pour An iron tempest on the foe; His serried ranks shall reel before The arm that lays the panther low.

And ye, who breast the mountain-storm By grassy steep or highland lake, Come, for the land ye love, to form A bulwark that no foe can break. Stand, like your own gray cliffs that mock The whirlwind, stand in her defence; The blast as soon shall move the rock As rushing squadrons bear ye thence.

And ye, whose homes are by her grand Swift rivers, rising far away, Come from the depth of her green land, As mighty in your march as they; As terrible as when the

rains Have swelled them over bank and borne, With sudden floods to drown the plains And sweep along the woods uptorn.

And ye, who throng, beside the deep, Her ports and hamlets of the strand, In number like the waves that leap On his long-murmuring marge of sand-- Come like that deep, when, o'er his brim He rises, all his floods to pour, And flings the proudest barks that swim, A helpless wreck, against the shore!

Few, few were they whose swords of old Won the fair land in which we dwell, But we are many, we who hold The grim resolve to guard it well. Strike, for that broad and goodly land, Blow after blow, till men shall see That Might and Right move hand in hand, And glorious must their triumph be!

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

The people of the South were also wildly enthusiastic for the war. Prompted by the belief that they must arm to defend their property and their liberties, they rose as one man. All hearts were in the cause.

DIXIE

Southrons, hear your country call you! Up, lest worse than death befall you! To arms! To arms! To arms, in Dixie! Lo! all the beacon-fires are lighted,-- Let all hearts be now united! To arms! To arms! To arms, in Dixie! Advance the flag of Dixie! Hurrah! hurrah! For Dixie's land we take our stand, And live and die for Dixie! To arms! To arms! And conquer peace for Dixie! To arms! To arms! And conquer peace for Dixie!

Hear the Northern thunders mutter! Northern flags in South winds flutter! Send them back your fierce defiance! Stamp upon the accursed alliance!

Fear no danger! Shun no labor! Lift up rifle, pike, and sabre! Shoulder pressing close to shoulder, Let the odds make each heart bolder!

How the South's great heart rejoices At your cannons' ringing voices! For faith betrayed, and pledges broken, Wrongs inflicted, insults spoken.

Strong as lions, swift as eagles, Back to their kennels hunt these beagles! Cut the unequal bonds asunder! Let them hence each other plunder!

Swear upon your country's altar Never to submit or falter, Till the spoilers are defeated, Till the Lord's work is completed!

Halt not till our Federation Secures among earth's powers its station! Then at peace, and crowned with glory, Hear your children tell the story!

If the loved ones weep in sadness, Victory soon shall bring them gladness,-- To arms! Exultant pride soon vanish sorrow; Smiles chase tears away to-morrow. To arms! To arms! To arms, in Dixie! Advance the flag of Dixie! Hurrah! hurrah! For Dixie's land we take our stand, And live or die for Dixie! To arms! To arms! And conquer peace for Dixie! To arms! To arms! And conquer peace for Dixie!

ALBERT PIKE.

A CRY TO ARMS

Ho, woodsmen of the mountain-side! Ho, dwellers in the vales! Ho, ye who by the chafing tide Have roughened in the gales! Leave barn and byre, leave kin and cot, Lay by the bloodless spade; Let desk and case and counter rot, And burn your books of trade!

The despot roves your fairest lands; And till he flies or fears, Your fields must grow but armèd bands, Your sheaves be sheaves of spears! Give up to mildew and to rust The useless tools of gain, And feed your country's sacred dust With floods of crimson rain!

Come with the weapons at your call-- With musket, pike, or knife; He wields the deadliest blade of all Who lightest holds his life. The arm that drives its unbought blows With all a patriot's scorn, Might brain a tyrant with a rose Or stab him with a thorn.

Does any falter? Let him turn To some brave maiden's eyes, And catch the holy fires that burn In those sublunar skies. Oh, could you like your women feel, And in their spirit march, A day might see your lines of steel Beneath the victor's arch!

What hope, O God! would not grow warm When thoughts like these give cheer? The lily calmly braves the storm, And shall the palm-tree fear? No! rather let its branches court The rack that sweeps the plain; And from the lily's regal port Learn how to breast the strain.

Ho, woodsmen of the mountain-side! Ho, dwellers in the vales! Ho, ye who by the roaring tide Have roughened in the gales! Come, flocking gayly to the fight, From forest, hill, and lake; We battle for our country's right, And for the lily's sake!

HENRY TIMROD.

"WE CONQUER OR DIE"

The war drum is beating, prepare for the fight, The stern bigot Northman exults in his might; Gird on your bright weapons, your foemen are nigh, And this be our watchword, "We conquer or die."

The trumpet is sounding from mountain to shore, Your swords and your lances must slumber no more, Fling forth to the sunlight your banner on high, Inscribed with the watchword, "We conquer or die."

March on the battlefield, there to do or dare, With shoulder to shoulder, all danger to share, And let your proud watchword ring up to the sky, Till the blue arch reëchoes, "We conquer or die."

Press forward undaunted nor think of retreat, The enemy's host on the threshold to meet; Strike firm, till the foeman before you shall fly, Appalled by the watchword, "We conquer or die."

Go forth in the pathway our forefathers trod; We, too, fight for freedom--our Captain is God, Their blood in our veins, with their honors we vie, Theirs, too, was the

watchword, "We conquer or die."

We strike for the South--Mountain, Valley, and Plain, For the South we will conquer again and again; Her day of salvation and triumph is nigh, Ours, then, be the watchword, "We conquer or die."

JAMES PIERPONT.

"CALL ALL"

Whoop! the Doodles have broken loose, Roaring round like the very deuce! Lice of Egypt, a hungry pack,-- After 'em, boys, and drive 'em back.

Bull-dog, terrier, cur, and fice, Back to the beggarly land of ice; Worry 'em, bite 'em, scratch and tear Everybody and everywhere.

Old Kentucky is caved from under, Tennessee is split asunder, Alabama awaits attack, And Georgia bristles up her back.

Old John Brown is dead and gone! Still his spirit is marching on,-- Lantern-jawed, and legs, my boys, Long as an ape's from Illinois!

Want a weapon? Gather a brick, Club or cudgel, or stone or stick; Anything with a blade or butt, Anything that can cleave or cut.

Anything heavy, or hard, or keen! Any sort of slaying machine! Anything with a willing mind, And the steady arm of a man behind.

Want a weapon? Why, capture one! Every Doodle has got a gun, Belt, and bayonet, bright and new; Kill a Doodle, and capture two!

Shoulder to shoulder, son and sire! All, call all! to the feast of fire! Mother and maiden, and child and slave, A common triumph or a single grave.

Rockingham, Va., _Register_, 1861.

THE BONNIE BLUE FLAG

Come, brothers! rally for the right! The bravest of the brave Sends forth her ringing battle-cry Beside the Atlantic wave! She leads the way in honor's path; Come, brothers, near and far, Come rally round the Bonnie Blue Flag That bears a single star!

We've borne the Yankee trickery, The Yankee gibe and sneer, Till Yankee insolence and pride Know neither shame nor fear; But ready now with shot and steel Their brazen front to mar, We hoist aloft the Bonnie Blue Flag That bears a single star.

Now Georgia marches to the front, And close beside her come Her sisters by the Mexique Sea, With pealing trump and drum; Till answering back from hill and glen The rallying cry afar, A Nation hoists the Bonnie Blue Flag That bears a single star.

By every stone in Charleston Bay, By each beleaguered town, We swear to rest not, night nor day, But hunt the tyrants down! Till bathed in valor's holy blood The gazing world afar Shall greet with shouts the Bonnie Blue Flag That bears the cross and

star!

ANNIE CHAMBERS KETCHUM.

The Southern women were carried away by enthusiasm and excitement. They believed the South invincible, and regarded the men who did not rush to enlist as cowards and traitors.

"I GIVE MY SOLDIER BOY A BLADE!"

I give my soldier boy a blade, In fair Damascus fashioned well: Who first the glittering falchion swayed, Who first beneath its fury fell, I know not; but I hope to know, That, for no mean or hireling trade. To guard no feeling base or low-- I give my soldier boy the blade!

Cool, calm, and clear--the lucid flood In which its tempering work was done;-- As calm, as clear, in wind and wood, Be thou where'er it sees the sun! For country's claim at honor's call, For outraged friend, insulted maid, At mercy's voice to bid it fall-- I give my soldier boy the blade!

The eye which marked its peerless edge, The hand that weighed its balanced poise, Anvil and pincers, forge and wedge, Are gone with all their flame and noise; Yet still the gleaming sword remains! So, when in dust I low am laid, Remember by these heartfelt strains, I give my soldier boy the blade!

CHAPTER III

THE NORTH GETS ITS LESSON

On Wednesday, April 16, 1861, the Sixth Massachusetts left Boston for Washington. Three days later it reached Baltimore, and started to march to the Camden Street station to take train for its destination.

THE NINETEENTH OF APRIL

[1861]

This year, till late in April, the snow fell thick and light: Thy truce-flag, friendly Nature, in clinging drifts of white, Hung over field and city: now everywhere is seen, In place of that white quietness, a sudden glow of green.

The verdure climbs the Common, beneath the leafless trees, To where the glorious Stars and Stripes are floating on the breeze. There, suddenly as spring awoke from winter's snow-draped gloom, The Passion-Flower of Seventy-Six is bursting into bloom.

Dear is the time of roses, when earth to joy is wed, And garden-plat and meadow wear one generous flush of red; But now in dearer beauty, to her ancient colors true, Blooms the old town of Boston in red and white and blue.

Along the whole awakening North are those bright emblems spread; A summer noon of patriotism is burning overhead: No party badges flaunting now, no word of clique or clan; But "Up for God and Union!" is the shout of every man.

Oh, peace is dear to Northern hearts; our hard-earned homes more dear; But Freedom is beyond the price of any earthly cheer; And Freedom's flag is sacred; he who would work it harm, Let him, although a brother, beware our strong right arm!

A brother! ah, the sorrow, the anguish of that word! The fratricidal strife begun, when will its end be heard? Not this the boon that patriot hearts have prayed and waited for;-- We loved them, and we longed for peace: but they would have it war.

Yes; war! on this memorial day, the day of Lexington, A lightning-thrill along the wires from heart to heart has run. Brave men we gazed on yesterday, to-day for us have bled: Again is Massachusetts blood the first for Freedom shed.

To war,--and with our brethren, then,--if only this can be! Life hangs as nothing in the scale against dear Liberty! Though hearts be torn asunder, for Freedom we will fight: Our blood may seal the victory, but God will shield the Right!

LUCY LARCOM.

Baltimore was in a frenzy, the streets were crowded with Southern sympathizers, and an attack upon the troops soon began. A desperate fight followed, in which three soldiers were killed and about twenty wounded. Nine citizens of Baltimore were killed, and many wounded--how many is not known.

THROUGH BALTIMORE

[April 19, 1861]

'Twas Friday morn: the train drew near The city and the shore. Far through the sunshine, soft and clear, We saw the dear old flag appear, And in our hearts arose a cheer For Baltimore.

Across the broad Patapsco's wave, Old Fort McHenry bore The starry banner of the brave, As when our fathers went to save, Or in the trenches find a grave At Baltimore.

Before us, pillared in the sky, We saw the statue soar Of Washington, serene and high:-- Could traitors view that form, nor fly? Could patriots see, nor gladly die For Baltimore?

"O city of our country's song! By that swift aid we bore When sorely pressed, receive the throng Who go to shield our flag from wrong, And give us welcome, warm and strong, In Baltimore!"

We had no arms; as friends we came, As brothers evermore, To rally round one sacred name-- The charter of our power and fame: We never dreamed of guilt and shame In Baltimore.

The coward mob upon us fell: McHenry's flag they tore: Surprised, borne backward by the swell, Beat down with mad, inhuman yell, Before us yawned a traitorous hell In Baltimore!

The streets our soldier-fathers trod Blushed with their children's gore; We saw the craven rulers nod, And dip in blood the civic rod-- Shall such things be, O righteous God, In Baltimore?

No, never! By that outrage black, A solemn oath we swore, To bring the Keystone's thousands back, Strike down the dastards who attack, And leave a red and fiery track Through Baltimore!

Bow down, in haste, thy guilty head! God's wrath is swift and sore: The sky with gathering bolts is red,-- Cleanse from thy skirts the slaughter shed, Or make thyself an ashen bed, O Baltimore!

BAYARD TAYLOR.

The secessionists of Maryland were wild with wrath; but a Federal force under General Butler soon occupied Annapolis and Baltimore, the Union spirit of the state asserted itself, and there was never any further danger of its joining the Confederacy.

MY MARYLAND

The despot's heel is on thy shore, Maryland! His torch is at thy temple door, Maryland! Avenge the patriotic gore That flecked the streets of Baltimore, And be the battle-queen of yore, Maryland, my Maryland!

Hark to an exiled son's appeal, Maryland! My Mother State, to thee I kneel, Maryland! For life and death, for woe and weal, Thy peerless chivalry reveal, And gird thy beauteous limbs with steel, Maryland, my Maryland!

Thou wilt not cower in the dust, Maryland! Thy beaming sword shall never rust, Maryland! Remember Carroll's sacred trust, Remember Howard's warlike thrust, And all thy slumberers with the just, Maryland, my Maryland!

Come! 'tis the red dawn of the day, Maryland! Come with thy panoplied array, Maryland! With Ringgold's spirit for the fray, With Watson's blood at Monterey, With fearless Lowe and dashing May, Maryland, my Maryland!

Dear Mother, burst the tyrant's chain, Maryland! Virginia should not call in vain, Maryland! She meets her sisters on the plain,-- "_Sic semper!_" 'tis the proud refrain That baffles minions back amain, Maryland! Arise in majesty again, Maryland, my Maryland!

Come! for thy shield is bright and strong, Maryland! Come! for thy dalliance does thee wrong, Maryland! Come to thine own heroic throng Stalking with Liberty along, And chant thy dauntless slogan-song, Maryland, my Maryland!

I see the blush upon thy cheek, Maryland! For thou wast ever bravely meek, Maryland! But lo! there surges forth a shriek, From hill to hill, from creek to creek, Potomac calls to Chesapeake, Maryland, my Maryland!

Thou wilt not yield the Vandal toll, Maryland! Thou wilt not crook to his control, Maryland! Better the fire upon thee roll, Better the shot, the blade, the bowl, Than crucifixion of the soul, Maryland, my Maryland!

I hear the distant thunder hum, Maryland! The Old Line's bugle, fife, and drum, Maryland! She is not dead, nor deaf, nor dumb; Huzza! she spurns the Northern scum! She breathes! She burns! She'll come! She'll come! Maryland, my Maryland!

JAMES RYDER RANDALL.

On May 24, 1861, a Union force under Colonel Ephraim E. Ellsworth occupied Alexandria, Va. Over an inn called the Marshall House Ellsworth saw a Confederate flag flying and went in person to take it down. As he descended the stairs with the flag in his arms, the proprietor of the inn, a violent secessionist named Jackson, fired upon and killed him instantly. Jackson was shot a moment later by Francis E. Brownell, a New York Zouave.

ELLSWORTH

[May 24, 1861]

Who is this ye say is slain? Whose voice answers not again? Ellsworth, shall we call in vain On thy name to-day? No! from every vale and hill Our response all hearts shall thrill, "Ellsworth's fame is with us still, Ne'er to pass away!"

Bring that rebel banner low, Hoisted by a treacherous foe: 'Twas for that they dealt the blow, Laid him in the dust. Raise aloft, that all may see His loved flag of Liberty. Forward, then, to victory, Or perish if we must!

Hark to what Columbia saith: "Mourn not for his early death, With each patriot's dying breath Strength renewed is given To the cause of truth and right, To the land for which they fight. After darkness cometh light,-- Such the law of Heaven."

So we name him not in vain, Though he comes not back again! For his country he was slain; Ellsworth's blood shall rise To our gracious Saviour--King: 'Tis a holy gift we bring; Such a sacred offering God will not despise.

COLONEL ELLSWORTH[8]

It fell upon us like a crushing woe, Sudden and terrible. "Can it be?" we said, "That he from whom we hoped so much, is dead, Most foully murdered ere he met the foe?" Why not? The men that would disrupt the State By such base plots as theirs--frauds, thefts, and lies-- What code of honor do they recognize? They thirst for blood to satisfy their hate, _Our_ blood: so be it; but for every blow Woe shall befall them; not in their wild way, But stern and pitiless, we will repay, Until, like swollen streams, _their_ blood shall flow; And should we pause; the thought of Ellsworth slain, Will steel our aching hearts to strike again!

RICHARD HENRY STODDARD.

[8] From Poetical Writings of Richard Henry Stoddard; copyright, 1880, by Charles Scribner's Sons.

ON THE DEATH OF "JACKSON"

[May 24, 1861]

Not where the battle red Covers with fame the dead,-- Not where the trumpet calls Vengeance for each that falls,-- Not with his comrades dear, Not there--he fell not there.

He grasps no brother's hand, He sees no patriot band; Daring alone the foe He strikes--then waits the blow, Counting his life not dear, His was no heart to fear!

Shout! shout, his deed of glory! Tell it in song and story; Tell it where soldiers brave Rush fearless to their grave; Tell it--a magic spell In that great deed shall dwell.

Yes! he hath won a name Deathless for aye to fame; Our flag baptized in blood, Always, as with a flood, Shall sweep the tyrant band Whose feet pollute our land.

Then, freemen, raise the cry, As freemen live or die! Arm! arm you for the fight! His banner in your sight; And this your battle-cry, "Jackson and victory!"

General Butler, meanwhile, had been sent with reinforcements to Fortress Monroe, and after making that important post secure, began various offensive measures against the Confederate posts in the neighborhood, manned largely by Virginians.

THE VIRGINIANS OF THE VALLEY

The knightliest of the knightly race That, since the days of old, Have kept the lamp of chivalry Alight in hearts of gold; The kindliest of the kindly band That, rarely hating ease, Yet rode with Spotswood round the land, And Raleigh round the seas;

Who climbed the blue Virginian hills Against embattled foes, And planted there, in valleys fair, The lily and the rose; Whose fragrance lives in many lands, Whose beauty stars the earth, And lights the hearths of happy homes With loveliness and worth.

We thought they slept!--the sons who kept The names of noble sires, And slumbered while the darkness crept Around their vigil-fires; But aye the "Golden Horseshoe" knights Their old Dominion keep, Whose foes have found enchanted ground, But not a knight asleep!

FRANCIS ORRERY TICKNOR.

On the night of June 9, 1861, Butler dispatched two expeditions against Great and Little Bethel, two churches on the Yorktown road, which had been strongly fortified. The columns got confused in the darkness, and fired upon each other. In the battle which followed, the same mistake was made, and the Union forces finally retreated, having suffered heavily.

BETHEL

[June 10, 1861]

We mustered at midnight, in darkness we formed, And the whisper went round of a fort to be stormed; But no drum-beat had called us, no trumpet we heard, And no voice of command, but our colonel's low word-- "Column! Forward!"

And out, through the mist, and the murk of the morn, From the beaches of Hampton our barges were borne; And we heard not a sound, save the sweep of the oar, Till the word of our colonel came up from the shore-- "Column! Forward!"

With hearts bounding bravely, and eyes all alight, As ye dance to soft music, so trod we that night; Through the aisles of the greenwood, with vines overarched, Tossing dew-drops, like gems, from our feet, as we marched-- "Column! Forward!"

As ye dance with the damsels, to viol and flute, So we skipped from the shadows, and mocked their pursuit; But the soft zephyrs chased us, with scents of the morn, As we passed by the hay-fields and green waving corn-- "Column! Forward!"

For the leaves were all laden with fragrance of June, And the flowers and the foliage with sweets were in tune; And the air was so calm, and the forest so dumb, That we heard our own heart-beats, like taps of a drum-- "Column! Forward!"

Till the lull of the lowlands was stirred by the breeze, And the buskins of morn brushed the tops of the trees, And the glintings of glory that slid from her track By the sheen of our rifles were gayly flung back-- "Column! Forward!"

And the woodlands grew purple with sunshiny mist, And the blue-crested hill-tops with roselight were kissed, And the earth gave her prayers to the sun in perfumes, Till we marched as through gardens, and trampled on blooms-- "Column! Forward!"

Ay, trampled on blossoms, and seared the sweet breath Of the greenwood with low-brooding vapors of death; O'er the flowers and the corn we were borne like a blast, And away to the forefront of battle we passed-- "Column! Forward!"

For the cannon's hoarse thunder roared out from the glades, And the sun was like lightning on banners and blades, When the long line of chanting Zouaves, like a flood, From the green of the woodlands rolled, crimson as blood-- "Column! Forward!"

While the sound of their song, like the surge of the seas, With the "Star-Spangled Banner" swelled over the leas; And the sword of Duryea, like a torch, led the way, Bearing down on the batteries of Bethel that day-- "Column! Forward!"

Through green tasselled cornfields our columns were thrown, And like corn by the red scythe of fire we were mown; While the cannon's fierce ploughings new-furrowed the plain, That our blood might be planted for Liberty's grain-- "Column! Forward!"

Oh! the fields of fair June have no lack of sweet flowers, But their rarest and best breathe no fragrance like ours; And the sunshine of June, sprinkling gold on the corn, Hath no harvest that ripeneth like Bethel's red morn-- "Column! Forward!"

When our heroes, like bridegrooms, with lips and with breath, Drank the first kiss of Danger and clasped her in death; And the heart of brave Winthrop grew mute with his lyre, When the plumes of his genius lay moulting in fire-- "Column! Forward!"

Where he fell shall be sunshine as bright as his name, And the grass where he slept shall be green as his fame; For the gold of the pen and the steel of the sword Write his deeds--in his blood--on the land he adored-- "Column! Forward!"

And the soul of our comrade shall sweeten the air, And the flowers and the grass-blades his memory upbear; While the breath of his genius, like music in leaves, With the corn-tassels whispers, and sings in the sheaves-- "Column! Forward!"

A. J. H. DUGANNE.

Among the Union dead was Major Theodore Winthrop. He had pressed eagerly forward, and as he sprang upon a log to get a view of the position, was shot through the head.

DIRGE

FOR ONE WHO FELL IN BATTLE

[June 10, 1861]

Room for a Soldier! lay him in the clover; He loved the fields, and they shall be his cover; Make his mound with hers who called him once her lover: Where the rain may rain upon it, Where the sun may shine upon it, Where the lamb hath lain upon it, And the bee will dine upon it.

Bear him to no dismal tomb under city churches; Take him to the fragrant fields, by the silver birches, Where the whippoorwill shall mourn, where the oriole perches: Make his mound with sunshine on it, Where the bee will dine upon it, Where the lamb hath lain upon it, And the rain will rain upon it.

Busy as the busy bee, his rest should be the clover; Gentle as the lamb was he, and the fern should be his cover; Fern and rosemary shall grow my soldier's pillow over: Where the rain may rain upon it, Where the sun may shine upon it, Where the lamb hath lain upon it, And the bee will dine upon it.

Sunshine in his heart, the rain would come full often Out of those tender eyes which evermore did soften; He never could look cold, till we saw him in his coffin: Make his mound with sunshine on it, Where the wind may sigh upon it, Where the moon may stream upon it, And Memory shall dream upon it.

"Captain or Colonel,"--whatever invocation Suit our hymn the best, no matter for thy station,-- On thy grave the rain shall fall from the eyes of a mighty nation! Long as the sun doth shine upon it Shall grow the goodly pine upon it, Long as the stars do gleam upon it Shall Memory come to dream upon it.

THOMAS WILLIAM PARSONS.

About fifty thousand Union troops had meanwhile been collected along the Potomac--a force which seemed to most people at the North quite sufficient to crush the rebellion. "On to Richmond!" was the cry, and popular clamor demanded that the advance be begun at once.

WAIT FOR THE WAGON

[July 1, 1861]

A hundred thousand Northmen, In glittering war array, Shout, "Onward now to Richmond! We'll brook no more delay; Why give the traitors time and means To fortify the way With stolen guns, in ambuscades? Oh! answer us, we pray." _Chorus of Chieftains_-- You must wait for the wagons, The real army wagons, The fat contract wagons, Bought in the red-tape way.

Now, if for army wagons, Not for compromise you wait, Just ask them of the farmers Of any Union state; And if you need ten thousand, Sound, sound, though second-hand, You'll find upon the instant A supply for your demand. _Chorus_-- No! wait for the wagons, The new army wagons, The fat contract wagons, Till the fifteenth of July.

No swindling fat contractors Shall block the people's way, Nor rebel compromisers-- 'Tis treason's reckoning day. Then shout again our war-cry, To Richmond onward move! We now can crush the traitors, And that we mean to prove! _Chorus_-- No! wait for the wagons, The fat contract wagons; If red-tape so wills it, Wait till the Judgment-day.

During the months of June and July, the Confederate forces had been assembling at Manassas Junction, about thirty miles from Washington. General Beauregard was in command, and had distributed them along a little stream called Bull Run, where they had thrown up strong intrenchments. On July 15, 1861, yielding to the popular clamor, General Scott ordered the forward movement of the Union army. On July 17 the army reached Fairfax Court-House, and next day a division moved forward to Centreville and attacked the Confederates intrenched along Bull Run. A sharp engagement resulted, and the Federals fell back.

At two o'clock on the morning of Sunday, July 21, 1861, the Union Army again moved forward for a grand attack. Each army numbered about thirty thousand men. The skirmishers soon got into touch, and the Confederates were driven back, but were rallied by the example of General T. J. Jackson, who with his brigade was "standing like a stonewall," as General Bee exclaimed, giving him his immortal sobriquet. The Union advance was checked, heavy reinforcements came up for the Confederates, and the Union regiments were finally swept from the field.

UPON THE HILL BEFORE CENTREVILLE

[July 21, 1861]

I'll tell you what I heard that day: I heard the great guns far away, Boom after boom. Their sullen sound Shook all the shuddering air around; And shook, ah me! my shrinking ear, And downward shook the hanging tear That, in despite of manhood's pride, Rolled o'er my face a scalding tide. And then I prayed. O God! I prayed, As never stricken saint, who laid His hot cheek to the holy tomb Of Jesus, in the midnight gloom.

"What saw I?" Little. Clouds of dust; Great squares of men, with standards thrust Against their course; dense columns crowned With billowing steel. Then bound on bound, The long black lines of cannon poured Behind the horses, streaked and gored With sweaty speed. Anon shot by, Like a lone meteor of the sky, A single horseman; and he shone His bright face on me, and was gone. All these with rolling drums, with cheers, With songs familiar to my ears, Passed under the far-hanging cloud, And vanished, and my heart was proud!

For mile on mile the line of war Extended; and a steady roar, As of some distant stormy sea, On the south wind came up to me. And high in air, and over all, Grew, like a fog, that murky pall, Beneath whose gloom of dusty smoke The cannon flamed, the bombshell broke. And the sharp rattling volley rang, And shrapnel roared, and bullets sang, And fierce-eyed men, with panting breath, Toiled onward at the work of death. I could not see, but knew too well, That underneath that cloud of hell, Which still grew more by great degrees, Man strove with man in deeds like these.

But when the sun had passed his stand At noon, behold! on every hand The dark brown vapor backward bore, And fainter came the dreadful roar From the huge sea of striving men. Thus spoke my rising spirit then: "Take comfort from that dying sound, Faint heart, the foe is giving ground!" And one, who taxed his horse's powers, Flung at me, "Ho! the day is ours!" And scoured along. So swift his pace, I took no memory of his face. Then turned I once again to Heaven; All things appeared so just and even; So clearly from the highest Cause Traced I the downward-working laws-- Those moral springs, made evident, In the grand, triumph-crowned event. So half I shouted, and half sang, Like Jephtha's daughter, to the clang Of my spread, cymbal-striking palms, Some fragments of thanksgiving psalms.

Meanwhile a solemn stillness fell Upon the land. O'er hill and dell Failed every sound. My heart stood still, Waiting before some coming ill. The silence was more sad and dread, Under that canopy of lead, Than the wild tumult of the war That raged a little while before. All Nature, in her work of death, Paused for one last, despairing breath; And, cowering to the earth, I drew From her strong breast my strength anew.

When I arose, I wondering saw Another dusty vapor draw, From the far right, its sluggish way Toward the main cloud, that frowning lay Against the western sloping sun: And all the war was re-begun, Ere this fresh marvel of my sense Caught from my mind significance. And then--why ask me? O my God! Would I had lain beneath the sod, A patient clod, for many a day, And from my bones and mouldering clay The rank field grass and flowers had sprung, Ere the base sight, that struck and stung My very soul, confronted me, Shamed at my own humanity. O happy dead! who early fell, Ye have no wretched tale to tell Of causeless fear and coward flight, Of victory snatched beneath your sight, Of martial strength and honor lost, Of mere life bought at any cost, Of the deep, lingering mark of shame, Forever scorched on brow and name, That no new deeds, however bright, Shall banish from men's loathful sight!

Ye perished in your conscious pride, Ere this vile scandal opened wide A wound that cannot close nor heal. Ye perished steel to levelled steel, Stern votaries of the god of war, Filled with his godhead to the core! Ye died to live, these lived to die,

Beneath the scorn of every eye! How eloquent your voices sound From the low chambers under ground! How clear each separate title burns From your high-set and laurelled urns! While these, who walk about the earth, Are blushing at their very birth! And, though they talk, and go, and come, Their moving lips are worse than dumb. Ye sleep beneath the valley's dew, And all the nation mourns for you; So sleep till God shall wake the lands! For angels, armed with fiery brands, Await to take you by the hands.

The right-hand vapor broader grew; It rose, and joined itself unto The main cloud with a sudden dash. Loud and more near the cannon's crash Came toward me, and I heard a sound As if all hell had broken bound-- A cry of agony and fear. Still the dark vapor rolled more near, Till at my very feet it tossed, The vanward fragments of our host. Can man, Thy image, sink so low, Thou, who hast bent Thy tinted bow Across the storm and raging main; Whose laws both loosen and restrain The powers of earth, without whose will No sparrow's little life is still? Was fear of hell, or want of faith, Or the brute's common dread of death The passion that began a chase, Whose goal was ruin and disgrace? What tongue the fearful sight may tell? What horrid nightmare ever fell Upon the restless sleep of crime-- What history of another time-- What dismal vision, darkly seen By the stern-featured Florentine, Can give a hint to dimly draw The likeness of the scene I saw?

I saw, yet saw not. In that sea, That chaos of humanity, No more the eye could catch and keep A single point, than on the deep The eye may mark a single wave, Where hurrying myriads leap and rave. Men of all arms, and all costumes, Bare-headed, decked with broken plumes; Soldiers and officers, and those Who wore but civil-suited clothes; On foot or mounted--some bestrode Steeds severed from their harnessed load; Wild mobs of white-topped wagons, cars, Of wounded, red with bleeding scars; The whole grim panoply of war Surged on me with a deafening roar! All shades of fear, disfiguring man, Glared through their faces' brazen tan. Not one a moment paused, or stood To see what enemy pursued. With shrieks of fear, and yells of pain, With every muscle on the strain, Onward the struggling masses bore. Oh! had the foemen lain before, They'd trampled them to dust and gore, And swept their lines and batteries As autumn sweeps the windy trees! Here one cast forth his wounded friend, And with his sword or musket-end Urged on the horses; there one trod Upon the likeness of his God, As if 'twere dust; a coward here Grew valiant with his very fear, And struck his weaker comrade prone, And struggled to the front alone. All had one purpose, one sole aim, That mocked the decency of shame,-- To fly, by any means to fly; They cared not how, they asked not why. I found a voice. My burning blood Flamed up. Upon a mound I stood; I could no more restrain my voice Than could the prophet of God's choice. "Back, animated dirt!" I cried, "Back, on your wretched lives, and hide Your shame beneath your native clay! Or if the foe affrights you, slay Your own base selves; and, dying, leave Your children's tearful cheeks to grieve, Not quail and blush, when you shall come, Alive, to their degraded home! Your wives will look askance with scorn; Your boys, and infants yet unborn, Will curse you to God's holy face! Heaven holds no pardon in its grace For cowards. Oh! are such as ye The guardians of our liberty? Back, if one trace of manhood still May nerve your arm and brace your will! You stain your country in the eyes Of Europe and her monarchies!

The despots laugh, the peoples groan; Man's cause is lost and overthrown! I curse you, by the sacred blood That freely poured its purple flood Down Bunker's heights, on Monmouth's plain, From Georgia to the rocks of Maine! I curse you, by the patriot band Whose bones are crumbling in the land! By those who saved what these had won In the high name of Washington!" Then I remember little more. As the tide's rising waves, that pour Over some low and rounded rock, The coming mass, with one great shock, Flowed o'er the shelter of my mound, And raised me helpless from the ground. As the huge shouldering billows bear, Half in the sea and half in air, A swimmer on their foaming crest, So the foul throng beneath me pressed, Swept me along, with curse and blow, And flung me--where, I ne'er shall know.

When I awoke, a steady rain Made rivulets across the plain; And it was dark--oh, very dark. I was so stunned as scarce to mark The ghostly figures of the trees, Or hear the sobbing of the breeze That flung the wet leaves to and fro. Upon me lay a dismal woe, A boundless, superhuman grief, That drew no promise of relief From any hope. Then I arose, As one who struggles up from blows By unseen hands; and as I stood Alone, I thought that God was good, To hide, in clouds and driving rain, Our low world from the angel train, Whose souls filled heroes when the earth Was worthy of their noble birth. By that dull instinct of the mind, Which leads aright the helpless blind, I struggled onward, till the dawn Across the eastern clouds had drawn A narrow line of watery gray; And full before my vision lay The great dome's gaunt and naked bones Beneath whose crown the nation thrones Her queenly person. On I stole, With hanging head and abject soul, Across the high embattled ridge, And o'er the arches of the bridge. So freshly pricked my sharp disgrace, I feared to meet the human face, Skulking, as any woman might, Who'd lost her virtue in the night, And sees the dreadful glare of day Prepare to light her homeward way, Alone, heart-broken, shamed, undone, I staggered into Washington! Since then long sluggish days have passed, And on the wings of every blast Have come the distant nations' sneers To tingle in our blushing ears. In woe and ashes, as was meet, We wore the penitential sheet. But now I breathe a purer air, And from the depths of my despair Awaken to a cheering morn, Just breaking through the night forlorn, A morn of hopeful victory. Awake, my countrymen, with me! Redeem the honor which you lost. With any blood, at any cost! I ask not how the war began, Nor how the quarrel branched and ran To this dread height. The wrong or right Stands clear before God's faultless sight. I only feel the shameful blow, I only see the scornful foe, And vengeance burns in every vein To die, or wipe away the stain. The war-wise hero of the west, Wearing his glories as a crest, Of trophies gathered in your sight, Is arming for the coming fight. Full well his wisdom apprehends The duty and its mighty ends; The great occasion of the hour, That never lay in human power Since over Yorktown's tented plain The red cross fell, nor rose again. My humble pledge of faith I lay, Dear comrade of my school-boy day, Before thee, in the nation's view, And if thy prophet prove untrue, And from our country's grasp be thrown The sceptre and the starry crown. And thou, and all thy marshalled host Be baffled and in ruin lost; Oh! let me not outlive the blow That seals my country's overthrow!

And, lest this woful end come true, Men of the North, I turn to you. Display your vaunted flag once more, Southward your eager columns pour! Sound trump, and fife,

and rallying drum; From every hill and valley come. Old men, yield up your treasured gold! Can liberty be priced and sold? Fair matrons, maids, and tender brides Gird weapons to your lovers' sides; And though your hearts break at the deed, Give them your blessing and God-speed; Then point them to the field of flame, With words like those of Sparta's dame; And when the ranks are full and strong, And the whole army moves along, A vast result of care and skill, Obedient to the master will; And your young hero draws the sword, And gives the last commanding word That hurls your strength upon the foe-- Oh! let them need no second blow. Strike, as your fathers struck of old; Through summer's heat, and winter's cold; Through pain, disaster, and defeat; Through marches tracked with bloody feet; Through every ill that could befall The holy cause that bound them all! Strike as they struck for liberty! Strike as they struck to make you free! Strike for the crown of victory!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

MANASSAS

[July 21, 1861]

They have met at last--as storm-clouds Meet in heaven, And the Northmen back and bleeding Have been driven; And their thunders have been stilled, And their leaders crushed or killed, And their ranks with terror thrilled, Rent and riven!

Like the leaves of Vallambrosa They are lying; In the moonlight, in the midnight, Dead and dying; Like those leaves before the gale, Swept their legions, wild and pale; While the host that made them quail Stood, defying.

When aloft in morning sunlight Flags were flaunted, And "swift vengeance on the rebel" Proudly vaunted: Little did they think that night Should close upon their shameful flight, And rebels, victors in the fight, Stand undaunted.

But peace to those who perished In our passes! Light be the earth above them; Green the grasses! Long shall Northmen rue the day When they met our stern array, And shrunk from battle's wild affray At Manassas.

CATHERINE M. WARFIELD.

A BATTLE BALLAD

TO GENERAL J. E. JOHNSTON

A summer Sunday morning, July the twenty-first, In eighteen hundred sixty-one, The storm of battle burst.

For many a year the thunder Had muttered deep and low, And many a year, through hope and fear, The storm had gathered slow.

Now hope had fled the hopeful, And fear was with the past; And on Manassas' cornfields The tempest broke at last.

A wreath above the pine-tops, The booming of a gun; A ripple on the cornfields, And the battle was begun.

A feint upon our centre, While the foeman massed his might, For our swift and sure destruction, With his overwhelming "right."

All the summer air was darkened With the tramping of their host; All the Sunday stillness broken By the clamor of their boast.

With their lips of savage shouting, And their eyes of sullen wrath, Goliath, with the weaver-beam, The champion of Gath.

Are they men who guard the passes, On our "left" so far away? In the cornfields, O Manassas! Are they _men_ who fought to-day?

Our _boys_ are brave and gentle, And their brows are smooth and white; Have they grown to _men_, Manassas, In the watches of a night?

Beyond the grassy hillocks There are tents that glimmer white; Beneath the leafy covert There is steel that glistens bright.

There are eyes of watchful reapers Beneath the summer leaves, With a glitter as of sickles Impatient for the sheaves.

They are men who guard the passes, They are men who bar the ford; Stands our David at Manassas, The champion of the Lord.

They are men who guard our altars, And beware, ye sons of Gath, The deep and dreadful silence Of the lion in your path.

Lo! the foe was mad for slaughter, And the whirlwind hurtled on; But our _boys_ had grown to heroes, They were _lions_, every one.

And they stood a wall of iron, And they shone a wall of flame, And they beat the baffled tempest To the caverns whence it came.

And Manassas' sun descended On their armies crushed and torn, On a battle bravely ended, On a nation grandly born.

The laurel and the cypress, The glory and the grave, We pledge to thee, O Liberty! The life-blood of the brave.

FRANCIS ORRERY TICKNOR.

Retreat soon turned to flight and flight to panic. A great crowd of officials and civilians, male and female, had driven out from Washington to the battlefield to witness a victory which they considered certain. They were furnished with passes, and picnicked and wined and jested and watched the distant conflict. Suddenly the Union army gave way, the Confederates dashed forward in pursuit, and soldiers and civilians were mixed together in one panic-stricken mob.

THE RUN FROM MANASSAS JUNCTION

[July 21, 1861]

Yankee Doodle went to war, On his little pony; What did he go fighting for, Everlasting goney! Yankee Doodle was a chap Who bragged and swore tarnation, He stuck a feather in his cap, And called it Federation. Yankee Doodle, keep it up, Yankee Doodle, dandy, Mind the music and the step, And with the girls be handy.

Yankee Doodle, he went forth To conquer the seceders, All the journals of the North, In most ferocious leaders, Breathing slaughter, fire, and smoke, Especially the latter, His rage and fury to provoke, And vanity to flatter.

Yankee Doodle, having floored His separated brothers, He reckoned his victorious sword Would turn against us others; Secession first he would put down, Wholly and forever, And afterward, from Britain's crown, He Canada would sever.

England offering neutral sauce To goose as well as gander, Was what made Yankee Doodle cross, And did inflame his dander. As though with choler drunk he fumed, And threatened vengeance martial, Because Old England had presumed To steer a course impartial.

Yankee Doodle bore in mind, When warfare England harassed, How he, unfriendly and unkind, Beset her and embarrassed; He put himself in England's place, And thought this injured nation Must view his trouble with a base Vindictive exultation.

We for North and South alike Entertain affection; These for negro slavery strike; Those for forced protection. Yankee Doodle is the pot, Southerner the kettle; Equal morally, if not Men of equal mettle.

Yankee Doodle, near Bull Run, Met his adversary. First he thought the fight he'd won, Fact proved quite contrary. Panic-struck he fled, with speed Of lightning glib with unction, Of slippery grease, in full stampede, From famed Manassas Junction.

As he bolted, no ways slow, Yankee Doodle hallooed, "We are whipped!" and fled, although No pursuer followed. Sword and gun right slick he threw Both away together, In his cap, to public view, Showing the white feather.

Yankee Doodle, Doodle, do, Whither are you flying, "A cocked hat we've been licked into, And knocked to Hades," crying? Well, to Canada, sir-ree, Now that, by secession, I am driven up a tree, To seize that there possession.

Yankee Doodle, be content, You've had a lenient whipping; Court not further punishment By enterprise of stripping Those neighbors, whom if you assail, They'll surely whip you hollow; Moreover, when you've turned your tail, Won't hesitate to follow.

The flight of the Union forces was watched with exultation by Jefferson Davis, who was at Confederate headquarters, and who at once wired news of the victory to the Confederate Congress at Richmond. Throughout the South, the news was naturally received with deep rejoicing.

ON TO RICHMOND

AFTER SOUTHEY'S "MARCH TO MOSCOW"

Major-General Scott An order had got To push on the column to Richmond; For loudly went forth, From all parts of the North, The cry that an end of the war must be made In time for the regular yearly Fall Trade: Mr. Greeley spoke freely about the delay, The Yankees "to hum" were all hot for the fray; The chivalrous Grow Declared they were slow,-- And therefore the order To march from the border And make an excursion to Richmond.

Major-General Scott Most likely was not Very loth to obey this instruction, I wot; In his private opinion The Ancient Dominion Deserved to be pillaged, her sons to be shot, And the reason is easily noted; Though this part of the earth Had given him birth, And medals and swords, Inscribed in fine words, It never for Winfield had voted. Besides, you must know, that our First of Commanders Had sworn quite as hard as the army in Flanders, With his finest of armies and proudest of navies, To wreak his old grudge against Jefferson Davis. Then, "Forward the column," he said to McDowell; And the Zouaves with a shout, Most fiercely cried out, "To Richmond or h-ll!" (I omit here the vowel) And Winfield he ordered his carriage and four, A dashing turnout, to be brought to the door, For a pleasant excursion to Richmond.

Major-General Scott Had there on the spot A splendid array To plunder and slay; In the camp he might boast Such a numerous host, As he never had yet In the battlefield set; Every class and condition of Northern society Were in for the trip, a most varied variety: In the camp he might hear every lingo in vogue, "The sweet German accent, the rich Irish brogue." The buthiful boy From the banks of the Shannon Was there to employ His excellent cannon; And besides the long files of dragoons and artillery, The Zouaves and Hussars, All the children of Mars-- There were barbers and cooks, And writers of books,-- The _chef de cuisine_ with his French bill of fare, And the artists to dress the young officers' hair. And the scribblers were ready at once to prepare An eloquent story Of conquest and glory; And servants with numberless baskets of Sillery, Though Wilson, the Senator, followed the train, At a distance quite safe, to "conduct the _Champagne_!" While the fields were so green and the sky was so blue, There was certainly nothing more pleasant to do, On this pleasant excursion to Richmond.

In Congress the talk, as I said, was of action, To crush out _instanter_ the traitorous faction. In the press, and the mess, They would hear nothing less Than to make the advance, spite of rhyme or of reason, And at once put an end to the insolent treason. There was Greeley, And Ely, And bloodthirsty Grow, And Hickman (the rowdy, not Hickman the beau), And that terrible Baker Who would seize of the South every acre, And Webb, who would drive us all into the Gulf, or Some nameless locality smelling of sulphur; And with all this bold crew, Nothing would do, While the fields were so green, and the sky was so blue, But to march on directly to Richmond.

Then the gallant McDowell Drove madly the rowel Of spur that had never been "won" by him, In the flank of his steed, To accomplish a deed, Such as never before had been done by him; And the battery called Sherman's Was wheeled into line While the beer-drinking Germans From Neckar and Rhine, With minie and yager, Come on with a swagger, Full of fury and lager (The day and the pageant were equally fine). Oh! the fields were so green, and the sky was so blue, Indeed 'twas a spectacle

pleasant to view, As the column pushed onward to Richmond.

Ere the march was begun, In a spirit of fun, General Scott in a speech Said the army should teach The Southrons the lesson the laws to obey, And just before dusk of the third or fourth day, Should joyfully march into Richmond.

He spoke of their drill, And their courage and skill, And declared that the ladies of Richmond would rave O'er such matchless perfection, and gracefully wave In rapture their delicate kerchiefs in air At their morning parades on the Capitol Square.

But alack! and alas! Mark what soon came to pass, When this army, in spite of his flatteries, Amid war's loudest thunder, Must stupidly blunder Upon those accursed "masked batteries." Then Beauregard came, Like a tempest of flame, To consume them in wrath, In their perilous path; And Johnson bore down in a whirlwind to sweep Their ranks from the field, Where their doom had been sealed, As the storm rushes over the face of the deep; While swift on the centre our President pressed, And the foe might descry, In the glance of his eye, The light that once blazed upon Diomede's crest. McDowell! McDowell! weep, weep for the day, When the Southrons you met in their battle array; To your confident hosts with its bullets and steel, 'Twas worse than Culloden to luckless Lochiel. Oh! the generals were green, and old Scott is now blue, And a terrible business, McDowell, to you, Was that pleasant excursion to Richmond.

JOHN R. THOMPSON.

At the North news of the defeat caused a bitter discouragement, which soon gave place to determination to push the war through. On July 22, 1861, Congress authorized the enlistment of five hundred thousand men. The term of enlistment was for three years, or during the war, and the North girded itself anew for the conflict.

CAST DOWN, BUT NOT DESTROYED

Oh, Northern men--true hearts and bold-- Unflinching to the conflict press! Firmly our country's flag uphold, Till traitorous foes its sway confess!

Not lightly was our freedom bought, By many a martyr's cross and grave; Six weary years our fathers fought, 'Midst want and peril, sternly brave.

And thrice six years, with tightening coil, Still closer wound by treacherous art, Men--children of our common soil-- Have preyed upon the nation's heart!

Yet still it beats, responsive, deep, Its strong pulse throbbing through the land, Gathering a human flood, to sweep Resistless, o'er the rebel band!

Firmly resolved to win success, We'll tread the path our fathers trod, Unflinching to the conflict press, And, fearless, trust our cause to God!

New York _Evening Post_, July 26, 1861.

The North soon had another bitter pill to swallow. On May 13, 1861, Great Britain issued a proclamation of neutrality, recognizing the Confederacy as a belligerent power. England's sympathy, because of close trade relations, was with the South, and the Southern people counted on her eventually recognizing their independence.

SHOP AND FREEDOM

[May 13, 1861]

Though with the North we sympathize, It must not be forgotten That with the South we've stronger ties, Which are composed of cotton, Whereof our imports 'mount unto A sum of many figures; And where would be our calico, Without the toil of niggers?

The South enslaves those fellow-men Whom we love all so dearly; The North keeps commerce bound again, Which touches us more nearly. Thus a divided duty we Perceive in this hard matter-- Free trade, or sable brothers free? Oh, will we choose the latter!

London _Punch_.

James M. Mason and John Slidell were appointed commissioners from the Confederacy to England and France; they reached Havana on a little steamer that had run the blockade, and took passage for Southampton in the British mail steamship Trent. On November 8, 1861, in the Bahama Channel, the Trent was overhauled by the American man-of-war San Jacinto, Captain Wilkes. She was compelled to stop, and Mason and Slidell and their secretaries were taken from her by force.

THE C. S. A. COMMISSIONERS

[November, 1861]

Ye jolly Yankee gentlemen, who live at home in ease, How little do ye think upon the dangers of the seas! The winds and waves, the whales and sharks, you've heard of long ago, But there are things much worse than these, as presently I'll show. If you're a true-bred Union man, go joyful where you please; Beneath the glorious Stars and Stripes cross safe the stormy seas; But look out for San Jacintos that may catch you on your way, If you're acting as Commissioner for the noble C. S. A.

And now you'll guess my subject, and what my song's about; But I'd not have put them into rhyme, if _they_ hadn't first put out; For they _put out_ of Charleston, when the night was drear and dark, And then they put out all the lights, that they might not be a mark; And then they did put out to sea (though here there seems a hitch, For what could they expect to see when the night was black as pitch?), But they somehow 'scaped the Union ships, and hoped on some fine day To land in Europe and to "blow" about the C. S. A.

They safely got to Cuba and landed in Havana; Described the power and glory of New Orleans and Savannah; Declared that running the blockade was a thing by no means hard, And boasted of the vic'tries won by their valiant Beauregard; Davis's skill in government could never be surpassed-- The amazing strokes of genius by which he cash amassed; Foreign bankers would acknowledge, ere a month had passed away, That the true financial paradise was in the C. S. A.

* * * * *

Some days are passed, and pleasantly, upon Bermuda's Isle, The sun is shining bright and fair, and nature seems to smile; The breezes moved the British flag that fluttered o'er the Trent, And the ripples rose to lave her sides, as proudly on she went. Mason and Slidell, on deck, thought all their dangers past, And poked each other's ribs and laughed, as they leant against the mast: "Haven't the Yankees just been done uncommonly nice, eh? They've got most money, but the brains are in the C. S. A.!"

You have heard the ancient proverb, and, though old, it's very good, Which hints "it's better not to crow until you've left the wood." And so it proved with these two gents; for at that moment--souse! A cannon-shot fell splash across the steamer's bows. The San Jacinto came up close, and though rather rude, 'tis true, Good Wilkes he hailed the Trent and said, "I'll thank you to heave to; If you don't give up two rascals, I must blow you right away. Mason and Slidell they're named, and they're from the C. S. A."

The British captain raged and swore; but then what could he do? It scarcely would be worth his while to be blown up, he knew; Wilkes's marines, with bayonets fixed, were standing on the Trent, So he gave up the traitors, and o'er the side they went. Wilkes, having got them, wished they'd feel pleasant and at home, So offered his best cabins, if their ladies chose to come; But they shook their heads and merely smiled, I'm sorry for to say, Conjugality's at a discount down in the C. S. A.

They coolly said unto their lords, "Our dresses all are new; What on earth would be the use of going back with you? And though we're very sorry that your plans are undone, We mean to pass the winter in Paris and in London. 'Stead of bothering you, and sharing your prison beds and fetters, We'll write each mail from Europe the most delightful letters; Tell you of all we've done and seen, at party, ball, or play, To cheer your hearts, poor martyrs, to _cotton_ and C. S. A."

So the two vessels parted; the San Jacinto went To unload her precious cargo, while the captain of the Trent, Having lost a (probable) _douceur_ which had seemed within his grip, We presume, for consolation, retired and took a nip. The ladies talked of the affair less with a tear than smile; Their lords and masters took their way to Warren's Fort the while; And gratis lodged and boarded there, they may think for many a day That brains are sometimes northward found as well's in C. S. A.

The prisoners were taken to Fort Warren, in Boston harbor, and the North went wild with delight. It was understood that Great Britain would have to be reckoned with, but no one seemed to care. Wilkes was complimented and banquetted and lionized, and the House of Representatives gave him a vote of thanks.

DEATH OF THE LINCOLN DESPOTISM

'Twas out upon mid ocean that the San Jacinto hailed An English neutral vessel, while on her course she sailed; They sent her traitor Fairfax, to board her with his crew, And beard the "British lion" with his "Yankee-doodle-doo." The Yankees took her

passengers, and put them on their ship, And swore that base secession could not give them the slip; But England says she'll have them, if Washington must fall, So Lincoln and his "nigger craft" must certainly feel small.

Of all the "Yankee notions" that ever had their birth, The one of searching neutrals affords the greatest mirth-- To the Southrons; but the Yankees will ever hate the fame Which gives to Wilkes and Fairfax their never-dying name. Throughout the North their Captain Wilkes received his meed of praise, For doing--in these civilized--the deeds of darker days; But England's guns will thunder along the Yankee coast, And show the abolitionists too soon they made their boast.

Then while Old England's cannon are booming on the sea, Our Johnson, Smith, and Beauregard dear Maryland will free, And Johnston in Kentucky will whip the Yankees too, And start them to the lively tune of "Yankee-doodle-doo." Then down at Pensacola, where the game is always "Bragg," The "Stars and Stripes" will be pulled down and in the dust be dragged; For Pickens can't withstand us when Braxton is the cry, And there you'll see the Yankees, with their usual speed, will fly.

On the coast of Dixie's kingdom there are batteries made by Lee, And covered up with cotton, which the Yankees want to see; But when they go to take it, they'll find it will not do, And start upon the "double-quick" to "Yankee-doodle-doo." Then Evans and his cavalry will follow in their track, And drive them in the Atlantic, or safely bring them back, And hold them till Abe Lincoln and all his Northern scum Shall own our independence of "Yankee-Doodledom."

Richmond _Dispatch_.

News of the seizure reached England November 27, 1861. A cabinet meeting was at once held, the act of Captain Wilkes was declared to be "a clear violation of the law of nations," the release of Mason and Slidell was demanded, together with a suitable apology for the aggression. England began to make extensive naval preparations, and eight thousand troops were sent to Canada.

JONATHAN TO JOHN

[December, 1861]

It don't seem hardly right, John, When both my hands was full, To stump me to a fight, John,-- Your cousin, tu, John Bull! Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess We know it now," sez he, "The Lion's paw is all the law, Accordin' to J. B., Thet's fit for you an' me!"

You wonder why we're hot, John? Your mark wuz on the guns, The neutral guns, thet shot, John, Our brothers an' our sons: Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess There's human blood," sez he, "By fits an' starts, in Yankee hearts, Though 't may surprise J. B. More 'n it would you an' me."

Ef _I_ turned mad dogs loose, John, On _your_ front-parlor stairs, Would it jest meet your views, John, To wait an' sue their heirs? Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess, I on'y guess," sez he, "Thet ef Vattel on _his_ toes fell, 'Twould kind o' rile J. B., Ez wal

ez you an' me!"

Who made the law thet hurts, John, _Heads I win--ditto tails_? "J. B." was on his shirts, John, Onless my memory fails. Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess (I'm good at thet)," sez he, "Thet sauce for goose ain't _jest_ the juice For ganders with J. B., No more 'n with you or me!"

When your rights was our wrongs, John, You didn't stop for fuss,-- Britanny's trident prongs, John, Was good 'nough law for us. Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess, Though physic's good," sez he, "It doesn't foller thet he can swaller Prescriptions signed 'J. B.,' Put up by you an' me."

We own the ocean, tu, John: You mus'n' take it hard, Ef we can't think with you, John, It's jest your own back yard. Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess Ef _thet's_ his claim," sez he, "The fencin'-stuff 'll cost enough To bust up friend J. B., Ez wal ez you an' me!"

Why talk so dreffle big, John, Of honor when it meant You didn't care a fig, John, But jest for _ten per cent_? Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess He's like the rest," sez he: "When all is done, it's number one Thet's nearest to J. B., Ez wal ez t' you an' me!"

We give the critters back, John, Cos Abram thought 'twas right; It warn't your bullyin' clack, John, Provokin' us to fight. Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess We've a hard row," sez he, "To hoe jest now; but thet, somehow, May happen to J. B., Ez wal ez you an' me!"

We ain't so weak an' poor, John, With twenty million people, An' close to every door, John, A school-house an' a steeple. Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess It is a fact," sez he, "The surest plan to make a Man Is, think him so, J. B., Ez much ez you or me!"

Our folks believe in Law, John; An' it's fer her sake, now, They've left the axe an' saw, John, The anvil an' the plough. Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess, Ef 'twarn't fer law," sez he, "There'd be one shindy from here to Indy; An' _thet_ don't suit J. B. (When 't ain't 'twixt you an' me!)"

We know we've got a cause, John, Thet's honest, just, an' true; We thought 'twould win applause, John, If nowheres else, from you. Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess His love of right," sez he, "Hangs by a rotten fibre o' cotton: There's natur' in J. B., Ez wal ez in you an' me!"

The South says, "_Poor folks down!_" John, An' "_All men up!_" say we,-- White, yaller, black, an' brown, John: Now which is your idee? Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess John preaches wal," sez he; "But, sermon thru, an' come to _du_, Why, there's the old J. B. A-crowdin' you an' me!"

Shall it be love, or hate, John? It's you thet's to decide; Ain't _your_ bonds held by Fate, John, Like all the world's beside? Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess Wise men forgive," sez he, "But not forgit; an' some time yit Thet truth may strike J. B., Ez wal ez you an' me!"

God means to make this land, John, Clear thru, from sea to sea, Believe an' understand, John, The _wuth_ o' bein' free. Ole Uncle S. sez he, "I guess God's price is high," sez he; "But nothin' else than wut he sells Wears long, an' thet J. B. May larn,

like you an' me!"

JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL.

England was clearly in the right in her contention; Wilkes's act was disavowed, and Mason and Slidell were delivered to an English steamer at Provincetown. All danger of war with England was for the time being avoided.

A NEW SONG TO AN OLD TUNE

John Bull, Esquire, my jo John, When we were first acquent, You acted very much as now You act about the Trent. You stole my bonny sailors, John, My bonny ships also, You're aye the same fierce beast to me, John Bull, Esquire, my jo!

John Bull, Esquire, my jo John, Since we were linked together, Full many a jolly fight, John, We've had with one another. Now must we fight again, John? Then at it let us go! And God will help the honest heart, John Bull, Esquire, my jo.

John Bull, Esquire, my jo John, A century has gone by, Since you called me your slave, John, Since I at you let fly. You want to fight it out again-- That war of waste and woe; You'll find me much the same old coon, John Bull, Esquire, my jo.

John Bull, Esquire, my jo John, If lying loons have told That I have lost my pluck, John, And fight not as of old; You'd better not believe it, John, Nor scorn your ancient foe; For I've seen weaker days than this, John Bull, Esquire, my jo.

John Bull, Esquire, my jo John, Hear this my language plain: I never smote you unprovoked, I never smote in vain. If you want peace, peace let it be! If war, be pleased to know, Shots in my locker yet remain, John Bull, Esquire, my jo!

CHAPTER IV

THE GRAND ARMY OF THE POTOMAC

The defeat at Bull Run showed the necessity for a thorough reorganization of the Army of the Potomac, and George B. McClellan, who had made a successful campaign in Western Virginia, was summoned to Washington and placed in command. At the end of two months, he had under him a splendidly equipped and disciplined force of over a hundred thousand men. The pickets were gradually extended, and little skirmishes with the enemy took place almost daily.

CIVIL WAR

"Rifleman, shoot me a fancy shot Straight at the heart of yon prowling vidette; Ring me a ball in the glittering spot That shines on his breast like an amulet!"

"Ah, captain! here goes for a fine-drawn bead, There's music around when my barrel's in tune!" Crack! went the rifle, the messenger sped, And dead from his horse fell the ringing dragoon.

"Now, rifleman, steal through the bushes, and snatch From your victim some trinket to handsel first blood; A button, a loop, or that luminous patch That gleams in the moon like a diamond stud!"

"O captain! I staggered, and sunk on my track, When I gazed on the face of that fallen vidette, For he looked so like you, as he lay on his back, That my heart rose upon me, and masters me yet.

"But I snatched off the trinket,--this locket of gold; An inch from the centre my lead broke its way, Scarce grazing the picture, so fair to behold, Of a beautiful lady in bridal array."

"Ha! rifleman, fling me the locket!--'tis she, My brother's young bride, and the fallen dragoon Was her husband--Hush! soldier, 'twas Heaven's decree, We must bury him there, by the light of the moon!

"But, hark! the far bugles their warnings unite; War is a virtue,--weakness a sin; There's a lurking and loping around us to-night Load again, rifleman, keep your hand in!"

CHARLES DAWSON SHANLY.

McClellan at last began preparations for a grand advance into Virginia, troops were sent across the Potomac in great numbers--then, suddenly, the orders were countermanded and the troops brought back across the river. The army had increased to one hundred and fifty thousand men, but for nearly two months the public ear was daily irritated by the report, "All quiet along the Potomac."

THE PICKET-GUARD

[November, 1861]

"All quiet along the Potomac," they say, "Except now and then a stray picket Is shot, as he walks on his beat to and fro, By a rifleman hid in the thicket. 'Tis nothing: a private or two, now and then, Will not count in the news of the battle; Not an officer lost--only one of the men, Moaning out, all alone, the death rattle."

All quiet along the Potomac to-night, Where the soldiers lie peacefully dreaming; Their tents in the rays of the clear autumn moon, Or the light of the watch-fire, are gleaming. A tremulous sigh of the gentle night-wind Through the forest leaves softly is creeping, While the stars up above, with their glittering eyes, Keep guard, for the army is sleeping.

There's only the sound of the lone sentry's tread As he tramps from the rock to the fountain, And thinks of the two in the low trundle-bed Far away in the cot on the mountain. His musket falls slack; his face, dark and grim, Grows gentle with memories tender, As he mutters a prayer for the children asleep-- For their mother--may Heaven defend her!

The moon seems to shine just as brightly as then, That night, when the love yet unspoken Leaped up to his lips--when low-murmured vows Were pledged to be ever

unbroken. Then drawing his sleeve roughly over his eyes, He dashes off tears that are welling, And gathers his gun closer up to its place As if to keep down the heart-swelling.

He passes the fountain, the blasted pine-tree; The footstep is lagging and weary; Yet onward he goes, through the broad belt of light, Towards the shade of the forest so dreary. Hark! was it the night-wind that rustled the leaves? Was it moonlight so wondrously flashing? It looked like a rifle ... "Ha! Mary, good-by!" The red life-blood is ebbing and plashing.

All quiet along the Potomac to-night-- No sound save the rush of the river, While soft falls the dew on the face of the dead-- The picket's off duty forever!

ETHEL LYNN BEERS.

Despite the size and efficiency of the "Grand Army," nothing was done and nothing attempted. It was evident that McClellan, though a perfect organizer and disciplinarian, lacked the qualities of aggressive leadership, and the discontent of the country found constant and angry expression.

TARDY GEORGE

[January, 1862]

What are you waiting for, George, I pray? To scour your cross-belts with fresh pipe-clay? To burnish your buttons, to brighten your guns; Or wait you for May-day and warm spring suns? Are you blowing your fingers because they are cold, Or catching your breath ere you take a hold? Is the mud knee-deep in valley and gorge? What are you waiting for, tardy George?

Want you a thousand more cannon made, To add to the thousand now arrayed? Want you more men, more money to pay? Are not two millions enough per day? Wait you for gold and credit to go, Before we shall see your martial show; Till Treasury Notes will not pay to forge? What are you waiting for, tardy George?

Are you waiting for your hair to turn, Your heart to soften, your bowels to yearn A little more toward "our Southern friends," As at home and abroad they work their ends? "Our Southern friends!" whom you hold so dear That you do no harm and give no fear, As you tenderly take them by the gorge-- What are you waiting for, tardy George?

Now that you've marshalled your whole command, Planned what you would, and changed what you planned; Practised with shot and practised with shell, Know to a hair where every one fell, Made signs by day and signals by night; Was it all done to keep out of a fight? Is the whole matter too heavy a charge? What are you waiting for, tardy George?

Shall we have more speeches, more reviews? Or are you waiting to hear the news; To hold up your hands in mute surprise, When France and England shall "recognize"? Are you too grand to fight traitors small? Must you have a nation to cope withal? Well, hammer the anvil and blow the forge-- You'll soon have a dozen, tardy George.

Suppose for a moment, George, my friend-- Just for a moment--you condescend To use the means that are in your hands, The eager muskets and guns and brands; Take one bold step on the Southern sod, And leave the issue to watchful God! For now the nation raises its gorge, Waiting and watching you, tardy George.

I should not much wonder, George, my boy, If Stanton get in his head a toy, And some fine morning, ere you are out, He send you all "to the right about"-- You and Jomini, and all the crew Who think that war is nothing to do But to drill and cypher, and hammer and forge-- What are you waiting for, tardy George?

Finally, President Lincoln demanded that this great army do something, and it was decided to advance again against the Confederates at Manassas. The advance began on March 9, 1862, and when the army reached Manassas, it found that the Confederates had removed all their stores and munitions and abandoned the position. Whereupon the Grand Army marched back to the Potomac.

HOW McCLELLAN TOOK MANASSAS

[March 10, 1862]

Heard ye how the bold McClellan, He, the wether with the bell on; He, the head of all the asses-- Heard ye how he took Manassas?

When the Anaconda plucky Flopped its tail in old Kentucky; When up stream the gunboats paddled, And the thieving Floyd skedaddled, Then the chief of all the asses Heard the word: Go, take Manassas!

Forty brigades wait around him, Forty blatant trumpets sound him, As the pink of all the heroes Since the time of fiddling Neros. "Now's the time," cry out the masses, "Show your pluck and take Manassas!"

Contrabands come flocking to him: "Lo! the enemy flies--pursue him!" "No," says George, "don't start a trigger On the word of any nigger; Let no more of the rascals pass us, _I_ know all about Manassas."

When at last a prowling Yankee-- No doubt long, and lean, and lanky-- Looking out for new devices, Took the wooden guns as prizes, Says he: "I sweow, ere daylight passes I'll take a peep at famed Manassas."

Then up to the trenches boldly Marched he--they received him coldly; Nary reb was there to stop him. Gathering courage, in he passes: "Jerusalem! I've took Manassas."

Bold McClellan heard the story: "Onward, men, to fields of glory; Let us show the rebel foemen, When we're READY we're not slow, men; Wait no more for springing grasses-- Onward! onward! to Manassas!"

Baggage trains were left behind him, In his eagerness to find them; Upward the balloons ascended, To see which way the rebels trended; Thirty miles away his glasses Swept the horizon round Manassas.

Out of sight, the foe, retreating, Answered back no hostile greeting; None could tell, as off he paddled, Whitherward he had skedaddled. Then the chief of all the

asses Cried: "Hurrah! I've got Manassas."

Future days will tell the wonder, How the mighty Anaconda Lay supine along the border, With the mighty Mac to lord her: Tell on shaft and storied brasses How he took the famed Manassas.

McClellan, meanwhile, had decided that the proper way to take Richmond was to remove his army to Fortress Monroe and advance up the peninsula. The change of base was accomplished by April 3, 1862, and the advance began, the army encountering no obstacle save almost impassable mud. McClellan, however, firmly believed that an immense force of Confederates was massed before him and proceeded so cautiously that he scarcely moved at all, and the impatience of the people deepened into anger and disgust.

WANTED--A MAN

Back from the trebly crimsoned field Terrible words are thunder-tost; Full of the wrath that will not yield, Full of revenge for battles lost! Hark to their echo, as it crost The Capital, making faces wan: "End this murderous holocaust; Abraham Lincoln, give us a MAN!

"Give us a man of God's own mould, Born to marshal his fellow-men; One whose fame is not bought and sold At the stroke of a politician's pen; Give us the man of thousands ten, Fit to do as well as to plan; Give us a rallying-cry, and then, Abraham Lincoln, give us a MAN!

"No leader to shirk the boasting foe, And to march and countermarch our brave, Till they fall like ghosts in the marshes low, And swamp-grass covers each nameless grave; Nor another, whose fatal banners wave Aye in Disaster's shameful van; Nor another, to bluster, and lie, and rave;-- Abraham Lincoln, give us a MAN!

"Hearts are mourning in the North, While the sister rivers seek the main, Red with our life-blood flowing forth-- Who shall gather it up again? Though we march to the battle-plain Firmly as when the strife began, Shall all our offering be in vain?-- Abraham Lincoln, give us a MAN!

"Is there never one in all the land, One on whose might the Cause may lean? Are all the common ones so grand, And all the titled ones so mean? What if your failure may have been In trying to make good bread from bran, From worthless metal a weapon keen?-- Abraham Lincoln, find us a MAN!

"Oh, we will follow him to the death, Where the foeman's fiercest columns are! Oh, we will use our latest breath, Cheering for every sacred star! His to marshal us high and far; Ours to battle, as patriots can When a Hero leads the Holy War!-- Abraham Lincoln, give us a MAN!"

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

Finally, after infinite preparation, McClellan's batteries were ready to open on the Confederate works at Yorktown, but on May 4, 1862, it was discovered that the works had been abandoned. Hooker's and Kearny's cavalry began a vigorous pursuit of the

Confederates, caught up with them at Williamsburg and captured the works there, after a severe engagement.

THE GALLANT FIGHTING "JOE"

[May 4, 5, 1862]

From Yorktown on the fourth of May The rebels did skedaddle, And to pursue them on their way Brave Hooker took the saddle. "I'll lead you on, brave boys," he said, "Where danger points the way;" And drawing forth his shining blade, "Move onward!" he did say.

Chorus--Then we'll shout hurrah for Hooker, boys, The gallant fighting Joe; We'll follow him with heart and hand, Wherever he does go.

"Forward, March!" then was the word That passed from front to rear, When all the men with one accord Gave a loud and hearty cheer. And then with Hooker at our head, We marched in order good, Till darkness all around us spread, When we lay down in the wood.

Early next morn by break of day, The rain in torrents fell; "This day," brave Hooker he did say, "Your valor it will tell. Williamsburg is very near, Be steady every man, Let every heart be filled with cheer, And I will take the van."

The gallant Massachusetts men Fought well and nobly, too, As did the men from good old Penn., And Jersey, ever true, And Sickles' men like lions brave, Their courage did display, For gallantly they did behave On the battle-field that day.

The men from Mass. and good old Penn. That morn the fight began, And like true, noble-hearted men, Most nobly they did stand. When Jersey's sons, the bold, the brave, Not fearing lead nor steel, Their gallant comrades for to save, Dashed boldly to the field.

By every means the rebels sought To stand the Jerseys' fire, But soon for them it was too hot, And they quickly did retire. But getting reënforced again With numbers very great, The gallant band of Jerseymen Were forced for to retreat.

"Now, Sickles' men," Hooker did say, "Move out to the advance; If you your courage would display, Now you have got a chance. The foe have forced us to give way, They number six to one, But still, my lads, we'll gain the day, And I will lead you on."

Excelsior then the foremost stood, Not knowing dread nor fear, And met the rebels in the woods, With a loud and hearty cheer. Volley after volley flew, Like hail the balls did fly, And Hooker cried: "My heroes true, We'll conquer or we'll die."

Our ammunition being gone, Brave Hooker then did say: "Reënforcements fast are coming on, My lads, do not give way. Keep good your ground, our only chance Is t' remain upon the field. And if the rebels dare advance, We'll meet them with the steel."

'Twas then brave Kearny did appear, Who ne'er to foe would yield, To him we gave a hearty cheer, As he rushed on the field. "Now, charge! my lads," then Hooker cried,

"Our work will soon be done, For with brave Kearny by our side, The rebels we'll make run."

And since that time we all do know The battles he hath won; He beat the rebels at Bristow, And chased them to Bull Run; And had we a few more loyal men Like the gallant fighting "Joe," The war would soon be at an end, Then home we all would go.

Singing, hurrah, hurrah, for Hooker's boys, The gallant Fighting Joe, We'll follow him with heart and hand, Wherever he does go.

JAMES STEVENSON.

The advance continued slowly, and on May 31, 1862, a portion of the army reached Fair Oaks. Here the Confederates attacked with force, and would have won a decisive victory but for the timely arrival of dashing "Phil" Kearny, who rallied the Union forces, led them forward, and swept the Confederates from the field.

KEARNY AT SEVEN PINES

[May 31, 1862]

So that soldierly legend is still on its journey,-- That story of Kearny who knew not to yield! 'Twas the day when with Jameson, fierce Berry, and Birney, Against twenty thousand he rallied the field. Where the red volleys poured, where the clamor rose highest, Where the dead lay in clumps through the dwarf oak and pine, Where the aim from the thicket was surest and nighest,-- No charge like Phil Kearny's along the whole line.

When the battle went ill, and the bravest were solemn, Near the dark Seven Pines, where we still held our ground, He rode down the length of the withering column, And his heart at our war-cry leapt up with a bound; He snuffed, like his charger, the wind of the powder,-- His sword waved us on and we answered the sign; Loud our cheer as we rushed, but his laugh rang the louder. "There's the devil's own fun, boys, along the whole line!"

How he strode his brown steed! How we saw his blade brighten In the one hand still left,--and the reins in his teeth! He laughed like a boy when the holidays heighten, But a soldier's glance shot from his visor beneath. Up came the reserves to the mellay infernal, Asking where to go in,--through the clearing or pine? "Oh, anywhere! Forward! 'Tis all the same, Colonel: You'll find lovely fighting along the whole line!"

Oh, evil the black shroud of night at Chantilly, That hid him from sight of his brave men and tried! Foul, foul sped the bullet that clipped the white lily, The flower of our knighthood, the whole army's pride! Yet we dream that he still,--in that shadowy region Where the dead form their ranks at the wan drummer's sign,-- Rides on, as of old, down the length of his legion, And the word still is "Forward!" along the whole line.

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

For nearly a month after this battle, the Army of the Potomac lay along the Chickahominy, within a few miles of Richmond, while the Confederates concentrated their forces, under Robert E. Lee, for the defence of the city. On June 14, 1862, General J. E. B. Stuart, with a force of fifteen hundred cavalry, circled the Union position, destroyed stores, seized mules and horses, took nearly two hundred prisoners, and returned leisurely to Richmond. Captain Latané was killed in a skirmish during this expedition.

THE BURIAL OF LATANÉ

[June 14, 1862]

The combat raged not long, but ours the day; And, through the hosts that compassed us around, Our little band rode proudly on its way, Leaving one gallant comrade, glory-crowned, Unburied on the field he died to gain-- Single of all his men, amid the hostile slain.

One moment on the battle's edge he stood-- Hope's halo, like a helmet, round his hair; The next beheld him, dabbled in his blood, Prostrate in death--and yet, in death how fair! Even thus he passed through the red gates of strife, From earthly crowns and palms, to an immortal life.

A brother bore his body from the field, And gave it unto strangers' hands, that closed The calm blue eyes on earth forever sealed, And tenderly the slender limbs composed: Strangers, yet sisters, who, with Mary's love, Sat by the open tomb, and, weeping, looked above.

A little child strewed roses on his bier-- Pale roses, not more stainless than his soul, Nor yet more fragrant than his life sincere, That blossomed with good actions--brief, but whole; The aged matron and the faithful slave Approached with reverent feet the hero's lowly grave.

No man of God might say the burial rite Above the "rebel"--thus declared the foe That blanched before him in the deadly fight; But woman's voice, with accents soft and low, Trembling with pity--touched with pathos--read Over his hallowed dust the ritual for the dead.

"'Tis sown in weakness, it is raised in power!" Softly the promise floated on the air, While the low breathings of the sunset hour Came back responsive to the mourner's prayer. Gently they laid him underneath the sod, And left him with his fame, his country, and his God!

Let us not weep for him, whose deeds endure! So young, so brave, so beautiful! He died As he had wished to die; the past is sure; Whatever yet of sorrow may betide Those who still linger by the stormy shore, Change cannot harm him now, nor fortune touch him more.

JOHN R. THOMPSON.

Meanwhile, McDowell's corps had been ordered forward from the Shenandoah valley to coöperate with McClellan, but was harassed by the Confederate cavalry

under Turner Ashby and Stonewall Jackson, which was handled with the utmost brilliancy and daring.

THE CHARGE BY THE FORD

Eighty and nine with their captain Rode on the enemy's track, Rode in the gray of the morning: Nine of the ninety came back.

Slow rose the mist from the river, Lighter each moment the way: Careless and tearless and fearless Galloped they on to the fray.

Singing in tune, how the scabbards Loud on the stirrup-irons rang, Clinked as the men rose in saddle, Fell as they sank with a clang.

What is it moves by the river, Jaded and weary and weak, Gray-backs--a cross on their banner-- Yonder the foe whom they seek.

Silence! They see not, they hear not, Tarrying there by the marge: _Forward! Draw sabre! Trot! Gallop! Charge!_ like a hurricane, _charge!_

Ah! 'twas a man-trap infernal-- Fire like the deep pit of hell! Volley on volley to meet them, Mixed with the gray rebel's yell.

Ninety had ridden to battle, Tracing the enemy's track,-- Ninety had ridden to battle, Nine of the ninety came back.

Honor the name of the ninety; Honor the heroes who came Scatheless from five hundred muskets, Safe from the lead-bearing flame.

Eighty and one of the troopers Lie on the field of the slain-- Lie on the red field of honor: Honor the nine who remain!

Cold are the dead there, and gory, There where their life-blood was spilt, Back come the living, each sabre Red from the point to the hilt.

Give them three cheers and a tiger! Let the flags wave as they come! Give them the blare of the trumpet! Give them the roll of the drum!

THOMAS DUNN ENGLISH.

Skirmish after skirmish was fought, in one of which, at Harrisonburg, on June 6, 1862, Ashby was killed. But the Confederates succeeded in their object, for McDowell's junction with McClellan was indefinitely delayed.

DIRGE FOR ASHBY

[June 6, 1862]

Heard ye that thrilling word-- Accent of dread-- Flash like a thunderbolt, Bowing each head,-- Crash through the battle dun, Over the booming gun,-- "_Ashby, our bravest one,-- Ashby is dead!_"

Saw ye the veterans-- Hearts that had known Never a quail of fear, Never a groan,-- Sob 'mid the fight they win,-- Tears their stern eyes within,-- "Ashby, our Paladin, Ashby is gone!"

Dash--dash the tear away,-- Crush down the pain! "_Dulce et decus_" be Fittest refrain! Why should the dreary pall Round him be flung at all? Did not our hero fall Gallantly slain?

Catch the last word of cheer Dropt from his tongue; Over the volley's din, Loud be it rung,-- "_Follow me! follow me!_"-- Soldier, oh! could there be Pæan or dirge for thee Loftier sung!

Bold as the Lion-heart, Dauntless and brave; Knightly as knightliest Bayard could crave; Sweet with all Sidney's grace, Tender as Hampden's face;-- Who--who shall fill the space Void by his grave?

'Tis not _one_ broken heart, Wild with dismay; Crazed with her agony, Weeps o'er his clay: Ah! from a thousand eyes Flow the pure tears that rise; Widowed Virginia lies Stricken to-day!

Yet though that thrilling word-- Accent of dread-- Falls like a thunderbolt, Bowing each head,-- Heroes! be battle done Bravelier every one, Nerved by the thought alone-- _Ashby is dead!_

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

McClellan continued to waste his time in complaints and reproaches to the government at Washington, and the Confederates prepared to take the offensive. Their advance began June 26, 1862, and McClellan promptly began to retreat. Finally, on July 1, at Malvern Hill, the Union army turned and repulsed the Confederates, after a severe engagement. McClellan, instead of advancing, issued an order to "fall still farther back."

MALVERN HILL

[July 1, 1862]

Ye elms that wave on Malvern Hill In prime of morn and May, Recall ye how McClellan's men Here stood at bay? While deep within yon forest dim Our rigid comrades lay-- Some with the cartridge in their mouth, Others with fixed arms lifted South-- Invoking so The cypress glades? Ah wilds of woe!

The spires of Richmond, late beheld Through rifts in musket-haze, Were closed from view in clouds of dust On leaf-walled ways, Where streamed our wagons in caravan; And the Seven Nights and Days Of march and fast, retreat and fight, Pinched our grimed faces to ghastly plight-- Does the elm wood Recall the haggard beards of blood?

The battle-smoked flag, with stars eclipsed, We followed (it never fell!)-- In silence husbanded our strength-- Received their yell; Till on this slope we patient turned With cannon ordered well; Reverse we proved was not defeat; But ah, the sod what

thousands meet!-- Does Malvern Wood Bethink itself, and muse and brood?

We elms of Malvern Hill Remember everything; But sap the twig will fill: Wag the world how it will, Leaves must be green in Spring.

HERMAN MELVILLE.

A MESSAGE

[July 1, 1882]

Was there ever message sweeter Than that one from Malvern Hill, From a grim old fellow,--you remember? Dying in the dark at Malvern Hill. With his rough face turned a little, On a heap of scarlet sand, They found him, just within the thicket, With a picture in his hand,--

With a stained and crumpled picture Of a woman's aged face; Yet there seemed to leap a wild entreaty, Young and living--tender--from the face When they flashed a lantern on it, Gilding all the purple shade, And stooped to raise him softly,-- "That's my mother, sir," he said.

"Tell her"--but he wandered, slipping Into tangled words and cries,-- Something about Mac and Hooker, Something dropping through the cries About the kitten by the fire, And mother's cranberry-pies; and there The words fell, and an utter Silence brooded in the air.

Just as he was drifting from them, Out into the dark, alone (Poor old mother, waiting for your message, Waiting with the kitten, all alone!), Through the hush his voice broke,--"Tell her-- Thank you, Doctor--when you can,-- Tell her that I kissed her picture, And wished I'd been a better man."

Ah, I wonder if the red feet Of departed battle-hours May not leave for us their searching Message from those distant hours. Sisters, daughters, mothers, think you, Would your heroes now or then, Dying, kiss your pictured faces, Wishing they'd been better men?

ELIZABETH STUART PHELPS.

So ended McClellan's attempt to capture Richmond. He had lost seventy-five thousand men and had accomplished nothing. President Lincoln made a personal visit to inspect the army, then issued a call for three hundred thousand more troops.

THREE HUNDRED THOUSAND MORE

[July 2, 1862]

We are coming, Father Abraham, three hundred thousand more, From Mississippi's winding stream and from New England's shore; We leave our ploughs and workshops, our wives and children dear, With hearts too full for utterance, with but a silent tear; We dare not look behind us, but steadfastly before: We are coming, Father Abraham, three hundred thousand more!

If you look across the hill-tops that meet the northern sky, Long moving lines of rising dust your vision may descry; And now the wind, an instant, tears the cloudy veil aside, And floats aloft our spangled flag in glory and in pride, And bayonets in the sunlight gleam, and bands brave music pour: We are coming, Father Abraham, three hundred thousand more!

If you look all up our valleys where the growing harvests shine, You may see our sturdy farmer boys fast forming into line; And children from their mother's knees are pulling at the weeds, And learning how to reap and sow against their country's needs; And a farewell group stands weeping at every cottage door: We are coming, Father Abraham, three hundred thousand more!

You have called us, and we're coming, by Richmond's bloody tide To lay us down, for Freedom's sake, our brothers' bones beside, Or from foul treason's savage grasp to wrench the murderous blade, And in the face of foreign foes its fragments to parade. Six hundred thousand loyal men and true have gone before: We are coming, Father Abraham, three hundred thousand more!

JAMES SLOAN GIBBONS.

Meanwhile the Army of Virginia had been formed for the defence of Washington, and placed under the command of General Pope. He at once endeavored to secure the valley of the Shenandoah, and on August 9, 1862, fought a fierce but indecisive battle with Jackson at Cedar Mountain.

CEDAR MOUNTAIN

[August 9, 1862]

Ring the bells, nor ring them slowly; Toll them not,--the day is holy! Golden-flooded noon is poured In grand libation to the Lord.

No mourning mothers come to-day Whose hopeless eyes forget to pray: They each hold high the o'erflowing urn, And bravely to the altar turn.

Ye limners of the ancient saint! To-day another virgin paint; Where with the lily once she stood Show now the new beatitude.

To-day a mother crowned with pain, Of silver beauty beyond stain, Clasping a flower for our land A-sheathèd in her hand.

Each pointed leaf with sword-like strength, Guarding the flower throughout its length; Each sword has won a sweet release To the flower of beauty and of peace.

Ring the bells, nor ring them slowly, To the Lord the day is holy; To the young dead we consecrate These lives that now we dedicate.

ANNIE FIELDS.

Lee's army, released from Richmond by McClellan's retreat, hastened to face Pope, while Jackson got in Pope's rear, captured Manassas Junction, cut Pope's communications, formed a junction with Longstreet, and on August 30, 1862,

defeated the Union forces at the second battle of Bull Run.

"OUR LEFT"

[August 30, 1862]

From dawn to dark they stood That long midsummer day, While fierce and fast The battle blast Swept rank on rank away.

From dawn to dark they fought, With legions torn and cleft; And still the wide Black battle tide Poured deadlier on "Our Left."

They closed each ghastly gap; They dressed each shattered rank; They knew--how well-- That freedom fell With that exhausted flank.

"Oh, for a thousand men Like these that melt away!" And down they came, With steel and flame, Four thousand to the fray!

Right through the blackest cloud Their lightning path they cleft; And triumph came With deathless fame To our unconquered "Left."

Ye of your sons secure, Ye of your dead bereft-- Honor the brave Who died to save Your all upon "Our Left."

FRANCIS ORRERY TICKNOR.

On the following day, Jackson again attacked at Chantilly, an indecisive action lasting all day. During the battle, General Philip Kearny pushed forward to reconnoitre and came upon a Confederate outpost which summoned him to surrender. Instead, he clapped spurs to his horse and endeavored to escape, but was shot and killed.

DIRGE FOR A SOLDIER

[September 1, 1862]

Close his eyes; his work is done! What to him is friend or foeman, Rise of moon, or set of sun, Hand of man, or kiss of woman? Lay him low, lay him low, In the clover or the snow! What cares he? he cannot know: Lay him low!

As man may, he fought his fight, Proved his truth by his endeavor; Let him sleep in solemn night, Sleep forever and forever. Lay him low, lay him low, In the clover or the snow! What cares he? he cannot know: Lay him low!

Fold him in his country's stars, Roll the drum and fire the volley! What to him are all our wars, What but death-bemocking folly? Lay him low, lay him low, In the clover or the snow! What cares he? he cannot know: Lay him low!

Leave him to God's watching eye; Trust him to the hand that made him. Mortal love weeps idly by: God alone has power to aid him. Lay him low, lay him low, In the clover or the snow! What cares he? he cannot know: Lay him low!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

Pope's shattered army was withdrawn within the defences of Washington, where McClellan's forces soon joined it. The latter was given command of the forces at the capital, and recruits were hurried forward to fill the broken ranks.

THE REVEILLE

Hark! I hear the tramp of thousands, And of armèd men the hum; Lo! a nation's hosts have gathered Round the quick-alarming drum,-- Saying: "Come, Freemen, come! Ere your heritage be wasted," said the quick-alarming drum.

"Let me of my heart take counsel: War is not of life the sum; Who shall stay and reap the harvest When the autumn days shall come?" But the drum Echoed: "Come! Death shall reap the braver harvest," said the solemn-sounding drum.

"But when won the coming battle, What of profit springs therefrom? What if conquest, subjugation, Even greater ills become?" But the drum Answered: "Come! You must do the sum to prove it," said the Yankee-answering drum.

"What if, 'mid the cannons' thunder, Whistling shot and bursting bomb, When my brothers fall around me, Should my heart grow cold and numb?" But the drum Answered: "Come! Better there in death united than in life a recreant,--Come!"

Thus they answered--hoping, fearing, Some in faith and doubting some, Till a trumpet-voice proclaiming, Said: "My chosen people, come!" Then the drum, Lo! was dumb; For the great heart of the nation, throbbing, answered: "Lord, we come!"

BRET HARTE.

Never was the Republic in greater danger. A month before, Lee had been desperately defending Richmond against two armies; now he had defeated them both and was ready to invade the North. He pushed forward with decision and celerity, and by September 7, 1862, his whole army had crossed the Potomac into Maryland.

BEYOND THE POTOMAC

[September 7, 1862]

They slept on the field which their valor had won, But arose with the first early blush of the sun, For they knew that a great deed remained to be done, When they passed o'er the river.

They arose with the sun, and caught life from his light,-- Those giants of courage, those Anaks in fight,-- And they laughed out aloud in the joy of their might, Marching swift for the river.

On! on! like the rushing of storms through the hills; On! on! with a tramp that is firm as their wills; And the one heart of thousands grows buoyant, and thrills, At the thought of the river.

Oh, the sheen of their swords! the fierce gleam of their eyes! It seemed as on earth a new sunlight would rise, And, king-like, flash up to the sun in the skies, O'er their

path to the river.

But their banners, shot-scarred, and all darkened with gore, On a strong wind of morning streamed wildly before, Like the wings of death-angels swept fast to the shore, The green shore of the river.

As they march, from the hillside, the hamlet, the stream, Gaunt throngs whom the foemen had manacled, teem, Like men just aroused from some terrible dream, To cross sternly the river.

They behold the broad banners, blood-darkened, yet fair, And a moment dissolves the last spell of despair, While a peal, as of victory, swells on the air, Rolling out to the river.

And that cry, with a thousand strange echoings, spread, Till the ashes of heroes were thrilled in their bed, And the deep voice of passion surged up from the dead, "_Ay, press on to the river!_"

On! on! like the rushing of storms through the hills, On! on! with a tramp that is firm as their wills, And the one heart of thousands grows buoyant, and thrills, As they pause by the river.

Then the wan face of Maryland, haggard and worn, At this sight lost the touch of its aspect forlorn, And she turned on the foemen, full-statured in scorn, Pointing stern to the river.

And Potomac flowed calmly, scarce heaving her breast, With her low-lying billows all bright in the west, For a charm as from God lulled the waters to rest Of the fair rolling river.

Passed! passed! the glad thousands march safe through the tide; Hark, foeman, and hear the deep knell of your pride, Ringing weird-like and wild, pealing up from the side Of the calm-flowing river!

'Neath a blow swift and mighty the tyrant may fall; Vain! vain! to his gods swells a desolate call; Hath his grave not been hollowed, and woven his pall, Since they passed o'er the river?

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

McClellan undertook a timorous and blundering pursuit, calling constantly for more men and even proposing that Washington be abandoned, if that should be necessary to reinforce his army. On September 13, 1862, Lee's army passed through Frederick, and it was then that the incident recorded in "Barbara Frietchie" is said to have occurred.

BARBARA FRIETCHIE

[September 13, 1862]

Up from the meadows rich with corn, Clear in the cool September morn,

The clustered spires of Frederick stand Green-walled by the hills of Maryland.

Round about them orchards sweep, Apple and peach tree fruited deep,

Fair as the garden of the Lord To the eyes of the famished rebel horde,

On that pleasant morn of the early fall When Lee marched over the mountain-wall;

Over the mountains winding down, Horse and foot, into Frederick town.

Forty flags with their silver stars, Forty flags with their crimson bars,

Flapped in the morning wind: the sun Of noon looked down, and saw not one.

Up rose old Barbara Frietchie then, Bowed with her fourscore years and ten;

Bravest of all in Frederick town, She took up the flag the men hauled down;

In her attic window the staff she set, To show that one heart was loyal yet.

Up the street came the rebel tread, Stonewall Jackson riding ahead.

Under his slouched hat left and right He glanced; the old flag met his sight.

"Halt!"--the dust-brown ranks stood fast. "Fire!"--out blazed the rifle-blast.

It shivered the window, pane and sash; It rent the banner with seam and gash.

Quick, as it fell, from the broken staff Dame Barbara snatched the silken scarf.

She leaned far out on the window-sill, And shook it forth with a royal will.

"Shoot, if you must, this old gray head, But spare your country's flag," she said.

A shade of sadness, a blush of shame, Over the face of the leader came;

The nobler nature within him stirred To life at that woman's deed and word;

"Who touches a hair of yon gray head Dies like a dog! March on!" he said.

All day long through Frederick street Sounded the tread of marching feet:

All day long that free flag tost Over the heads of the rebel host.

Ever its torn folds rose and fell On the loyal winds that loved it well;

And through the hill-gaps sunset light Shone over it with a warm good-night.

Barbara Frietchie's work is o'er, And the Rebel rides on his raids no more.

Honor to her! and let a tear Fall, for her sake, on Stonewall's bier.

Over Barbara Frietchie's grave, Flag of Freedom and Union, wave!

Peace and order and beauty draw Round thy symbol of light and law;

And ever the stars above look down On thy stars below in Frederick town!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The main body of the Confederates was finally encountered at Antietam, and on September 17, 1862, a savage action was fought, which left Lee badly shattered.

MARTHY VIRGINIA'S HAND

[September 17, 1862]

"There, on the left!" said the colonel; the battle had shuddered and faded away,
Wraith of a fiery enchantment that left only ashes and blood-sprinkled clay--
"Ride to the left and examine that ridge, where the enemy's sharpshooters stood.
Lord, how they picked off our men, from the treacherous vantage-ground of the wood!
But for their bullets, I'll bet, my batteries sent them something as good.
Go and explore, and report to me then, and tell me how many we killed.
Never a wink shall I sleep till I know our vengeance was duly fulfilled."

Fiercely the orderly rode down the slope of the cornfield--scarred and forlorn,
Rutted by violent wheels, and scathed by the shot that had ploughed it in scorn;
Fiercely, and burning with wrath for the sight of his comrades crushed at a blow,
Flung in broken shapes on the ground like ruined memorials of woe;
These were the men whom at daybreak he knew, but never again could know.
Thence to the ridge, where roots out-thrust, and twisted branches of trees
Clutched the hill like clawing lions, firm their prey to seize.

"What's your report?" and the grim colonel smiled when the orderly came back at last.
Strangely the soldier paused: "Well, they were punished." And strangely his face looked, aghast.
"Yes, our fire told on them; knocked over fifty--laid out in line of parade.
Brave fellows, Colonel, to stay as they did! But one I 'most wished hadn't stayed.
Mortally wounded, he'd torn off his knapsack; and then, at the end, he prayed--
Easy to see, by his hands that were clasped; and the dull, dead fingers yet held
This little letter--his wife's--from the knapsack. A pity those woods were shelled!"

Silent the orderly, watching with tears in his eyes as his officer scanned
Four short pages of writing. "What's this, about 'Marthy Virginia's hand'?"
Swift from his honeymoon he, the dead soldier, had gone from his bride to the strife;
Never they met again, but she had written him, telling of that new life,
Born in the daughter, that bound her still closer and closer to him as his wife.
Laying her baby's hand down on the letter, around it she traced a rude line:
"If you would kiss the baby," she wrote, "you must kiss this outline of mine."

There was the shape of the hand on the page, with the small, chubby fingers outspread.
"Marthy Virginia's hand, for her pa,"--so the words on the little palm said.
Never a wink slept the colonel that night, for the vengeance so blindly fulfilled.
Never again woke the old battle-glow when the bullets their death-note shrilled.
Long ago ended the struggle, in union of brotherhood happily stilled;
Yet from that field of Antietam, in warning and token of love's command,
See! there is lifted the hand of a baby--Marthy Virginia's hand!

GEORGE PARSONS LATHROP.

It was McClellan's first victory, and his partisans hailed him as another Alexander; but he permitted a great opportunity to slip through his fingers. Instead of attacking next day, he remained inactive, and Lee made good his escape across the Potomac.

THE VICTOR OF ANTIETAM

[September 17, 1862]

When tempest winnowed grain from bran, And men were looking for a man, Authority called you to the van, McClellan! Along the line the plaudits ran, As later when Antietam's cheers began.

Through storm-cloud and eclipse must move Each cause and man, dear to the stars and Jove; Nor always can the wisest tell Deferred fulfilment from the hopeless knell-- The struggler from the floundering ne'er-do-well. A pall-cloth on the Seven Days fell, McClellan-- Unprosperously heroical! Who could Antietam's wreath foretell?

Authority called you; then, in mist And loom of jeopardy--dismissed. But staring peril soon appalled; You, the Discarded, she recalled-- Recalled you, nor endured delay; And forth you rode upon a blasted way, Arrayed Pope's rout, and routed Lee's array, McClellan! Your tent was choked with captured flags that day, McClellan. Antietam was a telling fray.

Recalled you; and she heard your drum Advancing through the ghastly gloom. You manned the wall, you propped the Dome, You stormed the powerful stormer home, McClellan! Antietam's cannon long shall boom.

At Alexandria, left alone, McClellan-- Your veterans sent from you, and thrown To fields and fortunes all unknown-- What thoughts were yours, revealed to none, While faithful still you labored on-- Hearing the far Manassas gun! McClellan, Only Antietam could atone.

You fought in the front (an evil day, McClellan)-- The forefront of the first assay; The Cause went sounding, groped its way; The leadsmen quarrelled in the bay; Quills thwarted swords; divided sway; The rebel flushed in his lusty May; You did your best, as in you lay, McClellan. Antietam's sun-burst sheds a ray.

Your medalled soldiers love you well, McClellan! Name your name, their true hearts swell; With you they shook dread Stonewall's spell, With you they braved the blended yell Of rebel and maligner fell; With you in fame or shame they dwell, McClellan! Antietam-braves a brave can tell.

And when your comrades (now so few, McClellan,-- Such ravage in deep files they rue) Meet round the board, and sadly view The empty places; tribute due They render to the dead--and you! Absent and silent o'er the blue; The one-armed lift the wine to _you_, McClellan, And great Antietam's cheers renew.

HERMAN MELVILLE.

On October 1, 1862, President Lincoln issued to McClellan a peremptory order to pursue Lee. Twenty days were spent in correspondence before that order was obeyed. McClellan had exhausted the patience even of the President. On November 5 he was relieved from command, and General A. E. Burnside appointed to replace him. The latter paused to get the army in hand and then moved down the Rappahannock toward Fredericksburg, where Lee was strongly intrenched. On December 11 the

Union army managed to cross the Potomac in the face of a heavy fire.

THE CROSSING AT FREDERICKSBURG

[December 11, 1862]

I lay in my tent at mid-day, Too full of pain to die, When I heard the voice of Burnside, And an answering shout reply.

I heard the voice of the General,-- 'Twas firm, though low and sad; But the roar that followed his question Laughed out till the hills were glad.

"O comrade, open the curtain, And see where our men are bound, For my heart is still in my bosom At that terrible, mirthful sound.

"And hark what the General orders, For I could not catch his words; But what means that hurry and movement, That clash of muskets and swords?"

"Lie still, lie still, my Captain, 'Tis a call for volunteers; And the noise that vexes your fever Is only our soldiers' cheers."

"Where go they?" "Across the river." "O God! and must I lie still, While that drum and that measured trampling Move from me far down the hill?

"How many?" "I judge, four hundred." "Who are they? I'll know to a man." "Our own Nineteenth and Twentieth, And the Seventh Michigan."

"Oh, to go, but to go with my comrades! Tear the curtain away from the hook; For I'll see them march down to their glory, If I perish by the look!"

They leaped in the rocking shallops. Ten offered where one could go; And the breeze was alive with laughter Till the boatmen began to row.

Then the shore, where the rebels harbored, Was fringed with a gush of flame, And buzzing, like bees, o'er the water The swarms of their bullets came.

In silence, how dread and solemn! With courage, how grand and true! Steadily, steadily onward The line of the shallops drew.

Not a whisper! Each man was conscious He stood in the sight of death; So he bowed to the awful presence, And treasured his living breath.

'Twixt death in the air above them, And death in the waves below, Through balls and grape and shrapnel They moved--my God, how slow!

And many a brave, stout fellow, Who sprang in the boats with mirth, Ere they made that fatal crossing Was a load of lifeless earth.

And many a brave, stout fellow, Whose limbs with strength were rife, Was torn and crushed and shattered,-- A hopeless wreck for life.

But yet the boats moved onward; Through fire and lead they drove, With the dark, still mass within them, And the floating stars above.

So loud and near it sounded, I started at the shout, As the keels ground on the gravel, And the eager men burst out.

Cheer after cheer we sent them, As only armies can,-- Cheers for old Massachusetts, Cheers for young Michigan!

They formed in line of battle; Not a man was out of place. Then with levelled steel they hurled them Straight in the rebels' face.

"Oh, help me, help me, comrade! For tears my eyelids drown, As I see their smoking banners Stream up the smoking town.

"And see the noisy workmen O'er the lengthening bridges run, And the troops that swarm to cross them When the rapid work be done.

"For the old heat, or a new one, Flames up in every vein; And with fever or with passion I am faint as death again.

"If this is death, I care not! Hear me, men, from rear to van!-- One more cheer for Massachusetts, And one more for Michigan!"

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

On the morning of December 13, 1862, the Union army advanced to the attack. The Confederate advance lines were driven back, but rallied and drove back their assailants with heavy loss. Assault after assault was repulsed, and Burnside was finally compelled to withdraw with a loss of fifteen thousand men. He was relieved of command soon afterwards.

AT FREDERICKSBURG

[December 13, 1862]

God send us peace, and keep red strife away; But should it come, God send us men and steel! The land is dead that dare not face the day When foreign danger threats the common weal.

Defenders strong are they that homes defend; From ready arms the spoiler keeps afar. Well blest the country that has sons to lend From trades of peace to learn the trade of war.

Thrice blest the nation that has every son A soldier, ready for the warning sound; Who marches homeward when the fight is done, To swing the hammer and to till the ground.

Call back that morning, with its lurid light, When through our land the awful war-bell tolled; When lips were mute, and women's faces white As the pale cloud that out from Sumter rolled.

Call back that morn: an instant all were dumb, As if the shot had struck the Nation's life; Then cleared the smoke, and rolled the calling drum, And men streamed in to meet the coming strife.

They closed the ledger and they stilled the loom, The plough left rusting in the prairie farm; They saw but "Union" in the gathering gloom; The tearless women helped the men to arm;

Brigades from towns--each village sent its band: German and Irish--every race and faith; There was no question then of native land, But--love the Flag and follow it to death.

No need to tell their tale: through every age The splendid story shall be sung and said; But let me draw one picture from the page-- For words of song embalm the hero dead.

* * * * *

The smooth hill is bare, and the cannons are planted, Like Gorgon fates shading its terrible brow; The word has been passed that the stormers are wanted, And Burnside's battalions are mustering now. The armies stand by to behold the dread meeting; The work must be done by a desperate few; The black-mouthèd guns on the height give them greeting-- From gun-mouth to plain every grass blade in view. Strong earthworks are there, and the rifles behind them Are Georgia militia--an Irish brigade-- Their caps have green badges, as if to remind them Of all the brave record their country has made.

The stormers go forward--the Federals cheer them; They breast the smooth hillside--the black mouths are dumb; The riflemen lie in the works till they near them, And cover the stormers as upward they come. Was ever a death-march so grand and so solemn? At last, the dark summit with flame is enlined; The great guns belch doom on the sacrificed column, That reels from the height, leaving hundreds behind. The armies are hushed--there is no cause for cheering: The fall of brave men to brave men is a pain. Again come the stormers! and as they are nearing The flame-sheeted rifle-lines, reel back again. And so till full noon come the Federal masses-- Flung back from the height, as the cliff flings a wave; Brigade on brigade to the death-struggle passes, No wavering rank till it steps on the grave.

Then comes a brief lull, and the smoke-pall is lifted, The green of the hillside no longer is seen; The dead soldiers lie as the sea-weed is drifted, The earthworks still held by the badges of green. Have they quailed? is the word. No: again they are forming-- Again comes a column to death and defeat! What is it in these who shall now do the storming That makes every Georgian spring to his feet?

"O God! what a pity!" they cry in their cover, As rifles are readied and bayonets made tight; "'Tis Meagher and his fellows! their caps have green clover; 'Tis Greek to Greek now for the rest of the fight!" Twelve hundred the column, their rent flag before them, With Meagher at their head, they have dashed at the hill! Their foemen are proud of the country that bore them; But, Irish in love, they are enemies still. Out rings the fierce word, "Let them have it!" the rifles Are emptied point-blank in the hearts of the foe: It is green against green, but a principle stifles The Irishman's love in the Georgian's blow. The column has reeled, but it is not defeated; In front of the guns they re-form and attack; Six times they have done it, and six times retreated; Twelve hundred they came, and two hundred go back. Two hundred go back with the

chivalrous story; The wild day is closed in the night's solemn shroud; A thousand lie dead, but their death was a glory That calls not for tears--the Green Badges are proud!

Bright honor be theirs who for honor were fearless, Who charged for their flag to the grim cannon's mouth; And honor to them who were true, though not tearless,-- Who bravely that day kept the cause of the South. The quarrel is done--God avert such another; The lesson it brought we should evermore heed: Who loveth the Flag is a man and a brother, No matter what birth or what race or what creed.

JOHN BOYLE O'REILLY.

FREDERICKSBURG

The increasing moonlight drifts across my bed, And on the churchyard by the road, I know It falls as white and noiselessly as snow.... 'Twas such a night two weary summers fled; The stars, as now, were waning overhead. Listen! Again the shrill-lipped bugles blow Where the swift currents of the river flow Past Fredericksburg; far off the heavens are red With sudden conflagration: on yon height, Linstock in hand, the gunners hold their breath; A signal-rocket pierces the dense night, Flings its spent stars upon the town beneath: Hark!--the artillery massing on the right, Hark!--the black squadrons wheeling down to Death!

THOMAS BAILEY ALDRICH.

Major-General Joseph Hooker was placed in command, and the Grand Army of the Potomac, of which so much had been expected, went into winter quarters on the Rappahannock.

BY THE POTOMAC

The soft new grass is creeping o'er the graves By the Potomac; and the crisp ground-flower Tilts its blue cup to catch the passing shower; The pine-cone ripens, and the long moss waves Its tangled gonfalons above our braves. Hark, what a burst of music from yon bower!-- The Southern nightingale that hour by hour In its melodious summer madness raves. Ah, with what delicate touches of her hand, With what sweet voice of bird and rivulet And drowsy murmur of the rustling leaf Would Nature soothe us, bidding us forget The awful crime of this distracted land And all our heavy heritage of grief.

THOMAS BAILEY ALDRICH.

THE WASHERS OF THE SHROUD

Along a river-side, I know not where, I walked one night in mystery of dream; A chill creeps curdling yet beneath my hair, To think what chanced me by the pallid gleam Of a moon-wraith that waned through haunted air.

Pale fireflies pulsed within the meadow-mist Their halos, wavering thistle downs of light; The loon, that seemed to mock some goblin tryst, Laughed; and the echoes, huddling in affright, Like Odin's hounds, fled baying down the night.

Then all was silent, till there smote my ear A movement in the stream that checked my breath: Was it the slow plash of a wading deer? But something said, "This water is of Death! The Sisters wash a shroud,--ill thing to hear!"

I, looking then, beheld the ancient Three Known to the Greek's and to the Northman's creed, That sit in shadow of the mystic Tree, Still crooning, as they weave their endless brede, One song: "Time was, Time is, and Time shall be."

No wrinkled crones were they, as I had deemed, But fair as yesterday, to-day, to-morrow, To mourner, lover, poet, ever seemed; Something too high for joy, too deep for sorrow, Thrilled in their tones, and from their faces gleamed.

"Still men and nations reap as they have strawn," So sang they, working at their task the while; "The fatal raiment must be cleansed ere dawn: For Austria? Italy? the Sea-Queen's isle? O'er what quenched grandeur must our shroud be drawn?

"Or is it for a younger, fairer corse, That gathered States like children round his knees, That tamed the waves to be his posting-horse, Feller of forests, linker of the seas, Bridge-builder, hammerer, youngest son of Thor's?

"What make we, murmur'st thou? and what are we? When empires must be wound, we bring the shroud, The time-old web of the implacable Three: Is it too coarse for him, the young and proud? Earth's mightiest deigned to wear it,--why not he?"

"Is there no hope?" I moaned, "so strong, so fair! Our Fowler whose proud bird would brook erewhile No rival's swoop in all our western air! Gather the ravens, then, in funeral file For him, life's morn yet golden in his hair?

"Leave me not hopeless, ye unpitying dames! I see, half seeing. Tell me, ye who scanned The stars, Earth's elders, still must noblest aims Be traced upon oblivious ocean-sands? Must Hesper join the wailing ghosts of names?"

"When grass-blades stiffen with red battle-dew, Ye deem we choose the victor and the slain: Say, choose we them that shall be leal and true To the heart's longing, the high faith of brain? Yet there the victory lies, if ye but knew.

"Three roots bear up Dominion: Knowledge, Will,-- These twain are strong, but stronger yet the third,-- Obedience,--'tis the great tap-root that still, Knit round the rock of Duty, is not stirred, Though Heaven-loosed tempests spend their utmost skill.

"Is the doom sealed for Hesper? 'Tis not we Denounce it, but the Law before all time: The brave makes danger opportunity; The waverer, paltering with the chance sublime, Dwarfs it to peril: which shall Hesper be?

"Hath he let vultures climb his eagle's seat To make Jove's bolts purveyors of their maw? Hath he the Many's plaudits found more sweet Than Wisdom? held Opinion's wind for Law? Then let him hearken for the doomster's feet!

"Rough are the steps, slow-hewn in flintiest rock, States climb to power by; slippery those with gold Down which they stumble to eternal mock: No chafferer's hand shall long the sceptre hold, Who, given a Fate to shape, would sell the block.

"We sing old Sagas, songs of weal and woe, Mystic because too cheaply understood; Dark sayings are not ours; men hear and know, See Evil weak, see strength alone in Good, Yet hope to stem God's fire with walls of tow.

"Time Was unlocks the riddle of Time Is, That offers choice of glory or of gloom; The solver makes Time Shall Be surely his. But hasten, Sisters! for even now the tomb Grates its slow hinge and calls from the abyss."

"But not for him," I cried, "not yet for him, Whose large horizon, westering, star by star Wins from the void to where on Ocean's rim The sunset shuts the world with golden bar, Not yet his thews shall fail, his eye grow dim!

"His shall be larger manhood, saved for those That walk unblenching through the trial-fires; Not suffering, but faint heart, is worst of woes, And he no base-born son of craven sires, Whose eye need blench confronted with his foes.

"Tears may be ours, but proud, for those who win Death's royal purple in the foeman's lines; Peace, too, brings tears; and mid the battle-din, The wiser ear some text of God divines, For the sheathed blade may rust with darker sin.

"God, give us peace! not such as lulls to sleep, But sword on thigh, and brow with purpose knit! And let our Ship of State to harbor sweep, Her ports all up, her battle-lanterns lit, And her leashed thunders gathering for their leap!"

So cried I with clenched hands and passionate pain, Thinking of dear ones by Potomac's side; Again the loon laughed mocking, and again The echoes bayed far down the night and died, While waking I recalled my wandering brain.

JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL.

October, 1861.

CHAPTER V

THE WAR IN THE WEST

While the Army of the Potomac in the east was imitating the manoeuvres of the King of France, stirring times were enacting in the west. Missouri was torn with dissension. The state had voted against secession in February, but the governor, C. F. Jackson, was doing everything he could to throw it into the Confederacy. General Nathaniel Lyon raised a force of loyalists, and a number of skirmishes ensued.

THE LITTLE DRUMMER[9]

'Tis of a little drummer, The story I shall tell; Of how he marched to battle, Of all that there befell, Out in the west with Lyon (For once the name was true!) For whom the

little drummer beat His _rat-tat-too_.

Our army rose at midnight, Ten thousand men as one, Each slinging off his knapsack And snatching up his gun. "_Forward!_" and off they started, As all good soldiers do, When the little drummer beats for them The _rat-tat-too_.

Across a rolling country, Where the mist began to rise; Past many a blackened farmhouse, Till the sun was in the skies; Then we met the rebel pickets, Who skirmished and withdrew, While the little drummer beat, and beat The _rat-tat-too_.

Along the wooded hollows The line of battle ran, Our centre poured a volley, And the fight at once began; For the rebels answered shouting, And a shower of bullets flew; But still the little drummer beat His _rat-tat-too_.

He stood among his comrades, As they quickly formed the line, And when they raised their muskets He watched the barrels shine. When the volley rang, he started, For war to him was new; But still the little drummer beat His _rat-tat-too_.

It was a sight to see them, That early autumn day, Our soldiers in their blue coats, And the rebel ranks in gray; The smoke that rolled between them, The balls that whistled through, And the little drummer as he beat His _rat-tat-too_!

His comrades dropped around him,-- By fives and tens they fell, Some pierced by minie bullets, Some torn by shot and shell; They played against our cannon, And a caisson's splinters flew; But still the little drummer beat His _rat-tat-too_!

The right, the left, the centre,-- The fight was everywhere; They pushed us here,--we wavered,-- We drove and broke them there. The graybacks fixed their bayonets, And charged the coats of blue, But still the little drummer beat His _rat-tat-too_!

"Where is our little drummer?" His nearest comrades say, When the dreadful fight is over, And the smoke has cleared away. As the rebel corps was scattering He urged them to pursue, So furiously he beat, and beat The _rat-tat-too_!

He stood no more among them, For a bullet, as it sped, Had glanced and struck his ankle, And stretched him with the dead! He crawled behind a cannon, And pale and paler grew; But still the little drummer beat His _rat-tat-too_!

They bore him to the surgeon, A busy man was he: "A drummer boy--what ails him?" His comrades answered, "See!" As they took him from the stretcher A heavy breath he drew, And his little fingers strove to beat The _rat-tat-too_!

The ball had spent its fury: "A scratch!" the surgeon said, As he wound the snowy bandage Which the lint was staining red. "I must leave you now, old fellow!" "Oh, take me back with you, For I know the men are missing me And the _rat-tat-too_!"

Upon his comrade's shoulder They lifted him so grand, With his dusty drum before him, And his drumsticks in his hand! To the fiery front of battle, That nearer, nearer drew,-- And evermore he beat, and beat His _rat-tat-too_!

The wounded as he passed them Looked up and gave a cheer; And one in dying blessed him, Between a smile and tear. And the graybacks--they are flying Before the

coats of blue, For whom the little drummer beats His _rat-tat-too_.

When the west was red with sunset, The last pursuit was o'er; Brave Lyon rode the foremost, And looked the name he bore. And before him on his saddle, As a weary child would do, Sat the little drummer, fast asleep, With his _rat-tat-too_.

RICHARD HENRY STODDARD.

[9] From Poetical Writings of Richard Henry Stoddard; copyright, 1880, by Charles Scribner's Sons.

Hostilities culminated on August 10, 1861, in a pitched battle at Wilson's Creek, in which, through bad management, the Union forces were defeated and Lyon himself was killed.

THE DEATH OF LYON

[August 10, 1861]

Sing, bird, on green Missouri's plain, The saddest song of sorrow; Drop tears, O clouds, in gentlest rain Ye from the winds can borrow; Breathe out, ye winds, your softest sigh, Weep, flowers, in dewy splendor, For him who knew well how to die, But never to surrender.

Up rose serene the August sun Upon that day of glory; Up curled from musket and from gun The war-cloud, gray and hoary; It gathered like a funeral pall, Now broken, and now blended, Where rang the bugle's angry call, And rank with rank contended.

Four thousand men, as brave and true As e'er went forth in daring, Upon the foe that morning threw The strength of their despairing. They feared not death--men bless the field That patriot soldiers die on; Fair Freedom's cause was sword and shield, And at their head was Lyon.

Their leader's troubled soul looked forth From eyes of troubled brightness; Sad soul! the burden of the North Had pressed out all its lightness. He gazed upon the unequal fight, His ranks all rent and gory, And felt the shadows close like night Round his career of glory.

"General, come lead us!" loud the cry From a brave band was ringing-- "Lead us, and we will stop, or die, That battery's awful singing!" He spurred to where his heroes stood-- Twice wounded, no one knowing-- The fire of battle in his blood And on his forehead glowing.

Oh! cursed for aye that traitor's hand, And cursed that aim so deadly, Which smote the bravest of the land, And dyed his bosom redly. Serene he lay, while past him pressed The battle's furious billow, As calmly as a babe may rest Upon its mother's pillow.

So Lyon died; and well may flowers His place of burial cover, For never had this land of ours A more devoted lover. Living, his country was his bride; His life he gave her, dying; Life, fortune, love, he nought denied To her, and to her sighing.

Rest, patriot, in thy hillside grave, Beside her form who bore thee! Long may the land thou diedst to save Her bannered stars wave o'er thee! Upon her history's brightest page, And on fame's glowing portal, She'll write thy grand, heroic age, And grave thy name immortal.

HENRY PETERSON.

John C. Frémont had been placed in command of the department and advanced against the Confederates at the head of a strong force. On October 23, 1861, he detached a squadron of cavalry under Major Charles Zagonyi to reconnoitre the Confederate position at Springfield. Zagonyi found the Confederates two thousand strong, but charged them at the head of his hundred and fifty men, routed them, cut them to pieces, and drove them from the city. The charge was one of the most remarkable in history. The Confederates finally withdrew from the state.

ZAGONYI

[October 25, 1861]

Bold Captain of the Body-Guard, I'll troll a stave to thee! My voice is somewhat harsh and hard, And rough my minstrelsy. I've cheered until my throat is sore For how Dupont at Beaufort bore; Yet here's a cheer for thee!

I hear thy jingling spurs and reins, Thy sabre at thy knee; The blood runs lighter through my veins, As I before me see Thy hundred men with thrusts and blows Ride down a thousand stubborn foes, The foremost led by thee.

With pistol snap and rifle crack-- Mere _salvos_ fired to honor thee-- Ye plunge, and stamp, and shoot, and hack The way your swords make free; Then back again,--the path is wide This time,--ye gods! it was a ride, The ride they took with thee!

No guardsman of the whole command Halts, quails, or turns to flee; With bloody spur and steady hand They gallop where they see Thy daring plume stream out ahead O'er flying, wounded, dying, dead; They can but follow thee.

So, Captain of the Body-Guard, I pledge a health to thee! I hope to see thy shoulders starred, My Paladin; and we Shall laugh at fortune in the fray Whene'er you lead your well-known way To death or victory!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

Kentucky was another state divided against itself. For a time, it endeavored to preserve neutrality, but finally chose the Union side. On January 19, 1862, the battle of Somerset was fought, resulting in a Union victory.

BATTLE OF SOMERSET

[January 19, 1862]

I gazed, and lo! Afar and near, With hastening speed, now there, now here, The horseman rode with glittering spear-- 'Twas awful to behold!

Ten thousand men, in dread array-- On every hill and mound they lay-- A dreadful sight it was that day To see the front they formed.

The polished sabres, waving high, Flashed brightly in the morning sky; While, beaming on the dazzled eye, The glittering bayonets shone.

All, all was hushed among the trees, Save now and then a gentle breeze, Which stirr'd the brown and serried leaves That in the forest lay.

But what is that which greets mine eye? Is it Columbia's sons I spy? Hark! hark! I hear their battle cry-- Their shouts of victory!

Still hotter does the conflict grow; While dealing death in every blow, McCook charged on the routed foe His daring little band.

Rest, patriots, rest; the conflict's o'er, Your erring brethren punished sore; Oh, would they'd fight their friends no more, And cease this bloody strife.

CORNELIUS C. CULLEN.

The Confederate loss was very heavy, and in one respect irreparable, for General Felix K. Zollicoffer was killed while reconnoitring the Union position.

ZOLLICOFFER

[January 19, 1862]

First in the fight, and first in the arms Of the white-winged angels of glory, With the heart of the South at the feet of God, And his wounds to tell the story;

For the blood that flowed from his hero heart, On the spot where he nobly perished, Was drunk by the earth as a sacrament In the holy cause he cherished!

In Heaven a home with the brave and blessed, And for his soul's sustaining The apocalyptic eyes of Christ-- And nothing on earth remaining,

But a handful of dust in the land of his choice, A name in song and story-- And fame to shout with immortal voice Dead on the field of Glory!

HENRY LYNDEN FLASH.

Near the southern line of Kentucky, the Confederates held two strong forts, Henry and Donelson, and on February 2, 1862, a Union force under General Ulysses S. Grant moved forward to attack them. The army was supported by a fleet of gunboats, and Fort Henry surrendered to the fleet before the land forces came up. The gunboat Essex led the attack and suffered severely, among her dead being Lieutenant S. B. Brittan, Jr., a boy of not quite seventeen.

BOY BRITTAN

[February 6, 1862]

I

Boy Brittan--only a lad--a fair-haired boy--sixteen, In his uniform, Into the storm--into the roaring jaws of grim Fort Henry-- Boldly bears the Federal flotilla-- Into the battle storm!

II

Boy Brittan is master's mate aboard of the Essex-- There he stands, buoyant and eager-eyed, By the brave captain's side; Ready to do and dare. _Aye, aye, sir!_ always ready-- In his country's uniform. _Boom! Boom!_ and now the flag-boat sweeps, and now the Essex, Into the battle storm!

III

Boom! Boom! till river and fort and field are overclouded By battle's breath; then from the fort a gleam And a crashing gun, and the Essex is wrapt and shrouded In a scalding cloud of steam!

IV

But victory! victory! Unto God all praise be ever rendered, Unto God all praise and glory be! See, Boy Brittan! see, boy, see! They strike! Hurrah! the fort has just surrendered! Shout! Shout! my boy, my warrior boy! And wave your cap and clap your hands for joy! Cheer answer cheer and bear the cheer about-- Hurrah! Hurrah! for the fiery fort is ours; And "Victory!" "Victory!" "Victory!" Is the shout. Shout--for the fiery fort, and the field, and the day are ours-- The day is ours--thanks to the brave endeavor Of heroes, boy, like thee! The day is ours--the day is ours! Glory and deathless love to all who shared with thee, And bravely endured and dared with thee-- The day is ours--the day is ours-- Forever! Glory and Love for one and all; but--but--for thee-- Home! Home! a happy "Welcome--welcome home" for thee! And kisses of love for thee-- And a mother's happy, happy tears, and a virgin's bridal wreath of flowers-- For thee!

V

Victory! Victory!... But suddenly wrecked and wrapt in seething steam, the Essex Slowly drifted out of the battle's storm; Slowly, slowly down--laden with the dead and the dying; And there, at the captain's feet, among the dead and the dying, The shot-marred form of a beautiful boy is lying-- There in his uniform!

VI

Laurels and tears for thee, boy, Laurels and tears for thee! Laurels of light, moist with the precious dew Of the inmost heart of the nation's loving heart, And blest by the balmy breath of the beautiful and the true; Moist--moist with the luminous breath

of the singing spheres And the nation's starry tears! And tremble-touched by the pulse-like gush and start Of the universal music of the heart, And all deep sympathy. Laurels and tears for thee, boy, Laurels and tears for thee-- Laurels of light and tears of love forever more-- For thee!

VII

And laurels of light, and tears of truth, And the mantle of immortality; And the flowers of love and of immortal youth, And the tender heart-tokens of all true ruth-- And the everlasting victory! And the breath and bliss of Liberty; And the loving kiss of Liberty; And the welcoming light of heavenly eyes, And the over-calm of God's canopy; And the infinite love-span of the skies That cover the valleys of Paradise-- For all of the brave who rest with thee; And for one and all who died with thee, And now sleep side by side with thee; And for every one who lives and dies, On the solid land or the heaving sea, Dear warrior-boy--like thee.

VIII

O the victory--the victory Belongs to thee! God ever keeps the brightest crown for such as thou-- He gives it now to thee! O young and brave, and early and thrice blest-- Thrice, thrice, thrice blest! Thy country turns once more to kiss thy youthful brow, And takes thee--gently--gently to her breast; And whispers lovingly, "God bless thee--bless thee now-- My darling, thou shalt rest!"

FORCEYTHE WILLSON.

The fall of Fort Donelson, soon afterwards, opened the way to the south and it was decided to advance against Corinth, Miss., with Pittsburg Landing as the base of operations. By the first of April, 1862, five divisions had been concentrated there, but the Confederates had also massed a great army near by, and on the morning of Sunday, April 6, moved forward to the attack, took their opponents by surprise, and drove them back to the river. The Confederate leader, Albert Sidney Johnston, was killed during the battle.

ALBERT SIDNEY JOHNSTON

[April 6, 1862]

I hear again the tread of war go thundering through the land, And Puritan and Cavalier are clinching neck and hand, Round Shiloh church the furious foes have met to thrust and slay, Where erst the peaceful sons of Christ were wont to kneel and pray.

The wrestling of the ages shakes the hills of Tennessee, With all their echoing mounts a-throb with war's wild minstrelsy; A galaxy of stars new-born round the shield of Mars, And set against the Stars and Stripes the flashing Stars and Bars.

'Twas Albert Sidney Johnston led the columns of the Gray, Like Hector on the plains of Troy his presence fired the fray; And dashing horse and gleaming sword spake out his royal will As on the slopes of Shiloh field the blasts of war blew shrill.

"Down with the base invaders," the Gray shout forth the cry, "Death to presumptuous rebels," the Blue ring out reply; All day the conflict rages and yet again all day, Though Grant is on the Union side he cannot stem nor stay.

They are a royal race of men, these brothers face to face, Their fury speaking through their guns, their frenzy in their pace; The sweeping onset of the Gray bears down the sturdy Blue, Though Sherman and his legions are heroes through and through.

Though Prentiss and his gallant men are forcing scaur and crag, They fall like sheaves before the scythes of Hardee and of Bragg; Ah, who shall tell the victor's tale when all the strife is past, When man and man in one great mould the men who strive are cast.

As when the Trojan hero came from that fair city's gates, With tossing mane and flaming crest to scorn the scowling fates, His legions gather round him and madly charge and cheer, And fill the besieging armies with wild disheveled fear;

Then bares his breast unto the dart the daring spearsman sends, And dying hears his cheering foes, the wailing of his friends, So Albert Sidney Johnston, the chief of belt and scar, Lay down to die at Shiloh and turned the scales of war.

Now five and twenty years are gone, and lo, to-day they come, The Blue and Gray in proud array with throbbing fife and drum; But not as rivals, not as foes, as brothers reconciled, To twine love's fragrant roses where the thorns of hate grew wild.

They tell the hero of three wars, the lion-hearted man, Who wore his valor like a star--uncrowned American; Above his heart serene and still the folded Stars and Bars, Above his head like mother-wings, the sheltering Stripes and Stars.

Aye, five and twenty years, and lo, the manhood of the South Has held its valor stanch and strong as at the cannon's mouth, With patient heart and silent tongue has kept its true parole, And in the conquests born of peace has crowned its battle roll.

But ever while we sing of war, of courage tried and true, Of heroes wed to gallant deeds, or be it Gray or Blue, Then Albert Sidney Johnston's name shall flash before our sight Like some resplendent meteor across the sombre night.

America, thy sons are knit with sinews wrought of steel, They will not bend, they will not break, beneath the tyrant's heel; But in the white-hot flame of love, to silken cobwebs spun, They whirl the engines of the world, all keeping time as one.

To-day they stand abreast and strong, who stood as foes of yore, The world leaps up to bless their feet, heaven scatters blessings o'er; Their robes are wrought of gleaming gold, their wings are freedom's own, The trampling of their conquering hosts shakes pinnacle and throne.

Oh, veterans of the Blue and Gray, who fought on Shiloh field, The purposes of God are true, His judgment stands revealed; The pangs of war have rent the veil, and lo, His high decree: One heart, one hope, one destiny, one flag from sea to sea.

KATE BROWNLEE SHERWOOD.

ALBERT SIDNEY JOHNSTON

SHILOH

His soul to God! on a battle-psalm! A soldier's plea to Heaven! From the victor wreath to the shining Palm; From the battle's core to the central calm, And peace of God in Heaven.

Oh, Land! in your midnight of mistrust The golden gates flew wide, And the kingly soul of your wise and just Passed in light from the house of dust To the Home of the Glorified!

FRANCIS ORRERY TICKNOR.

Buell's army came up during the night, and Grant was able next day to assume the offensive and drive the enemy from the field. Johnston's death left Beauregard commander-in-chief of the Confederate forces.

BEAUREGARD

Our trust is now in thee, Beauregard! In thy hand the God of Hosts Hath placed the sword; And the glory of thy fame Has set the world aflame-- Hearts kindle at thy name, Beauregard!

The way that lies before Is cold and hard; We are led across the desert By the Lord! But the cloud that shines by night To guide our steps aright, Is the pillar of thy might, Beauregard!

Thou hast watched the southern heavens Evening starred, And chosen thence thine emblems, Beauregard; And upon thy banner's fold Is that starry cross enrolled, Which no Northman shall behold Shamed or scarred.

By the blood that crieth loudly From the sword, We have sworn to keep around it Watch and ward, And the standard of thine hand Yet shall shine above a land, Like its leader, free and grand, Beauregard!

MRS. C. A. WARFIELD.

The advance against Corinth was continued, and on May 30, 1862, the Union army entered the city, which the Confederates had evacuated. On October 3, 4, the Confederates attempted to recapture it, but were repulsed with heavy loss. The Eighth Wisconsin carried a live eagle in place of a flag, and during the battle the great bird circled and circled above the field.

THE EAGLE OF CORINTH

[October 3, 4, 1862]

Did you hear of the fight at Corinth, How we whipped out Price and Van Dorn? Ah, that day we earned our rations (Our cause was God's and the Nation's, Or we'd have come out forlorn!)-- A long and terrible day! And at last, when night grew gray, By the hundreds, there they lay (Heavy sleepers, you'd say), That wouldn't wake on the morn.

Our staff was bare of a flag, We didn't carry a rag In those brave marching days;-- Ah, no, but a finer thing! With never a cord or string, An eagle of ruffled wing, And an eye of awful gaze. The grape it rattled like hail, The minies were dropping like rain, The first of a thunder shower; The wads were blowing like chaff (There was pounding like floor and flail, All the front of our line!), So we stood it hour after hour; But our eagle, he felt fine! 'Twould have made you cheer and laugh, To see, through that iron gale, How the old fellow'd swoop and sail Above the racket and roar,-- To right and to left he'd soar, But ever came back, without fail, And perched on his standard-staff.

All that day, I tell you true, They had pressed us steady and fair, Till we fought in street and square (The affair, you might think, looked blue),-- But we knew we had them there! Our batteries were few, Every gun, they'd have sworn, they knew, But, you see, there were one or two We had fixed for them, unaware.

They reckon they've got us now! For the next half hour 'twill be warm-- Aye, aye, look yonder!--I vow, If they weren't Secesh, how I'd love them! Only see how grandly they form (Our eagle whirling above them), To take Robinett by storm! They're timing!--it can't be long-- Now for the nub of the fight! (You may guess that we held our breath.) By the Lord, 'tis a splendid sight! A column two thousand strong Marching square to the death!

On they came in solid column, For once no whooping nor yell (Ah, I dare say they felt solemn!)-- Front and flank, grape and shell, Our batteries pounded away! And the minies hummed to remind 'em They had started on no child's play!

Steady they kept a-going, But a grim wake settled behind 'em From the edge of the _abattis_ (Where our dead and dying lay Under fence and fallen tree), Up to Robinett, all the way The dreadful swath kept growing! 'Twas butternut mixed with gray.

Now for it, at Robinett! Muzzle to muzzle we met (Not a breath of bluster or brag, Not a lisp for quarter or favor)-- Three times, there, by Robinett, With a rush, their feet they set On the logs of our parapet, And waved their bit of a flag-- What could be finer or braver! But our cross-fire stunned them in flank, They melted, rank after rank (O'er them, with terrible poise, Our Bird did circle and wheel!)-- Their whole line began to waver-- Now for the bayonet, boys! On them with the cold steel!

Ah, well--you know how it ended-- We did for them, there and then, But their pluck throughout was splendid. (As I said before, I could love them!) They stood to the last, like men-- Only a handful of them Found the way back again. Red as blood, o'er the town, The angry sun went down, Firing flagstaff and vane-- And our eagle,--as for

him, There, all ruffled and grim, He sat, o'erlooking the slain!

Next morning, you'd have wondered How we had to drive the spade! There, in great trenches and holes (Ah, God rest their poor souls!), We piled some fifteen hundred, Where that last charge was made! Sad enough, I must say. No mother to mourn and search, No priest to bless or to pray-- We buried them where they lay, Without a rite of the church-- But our eagle, all that day, Stood solemn and still on his perch.

'Tis many a stormy day Since, out of the cold bleak north, Our great war-eagle sailed forth To swoop o'er battle and fray. Many and many a day O'er charge and storm hath he wheeled, Foray and foughten field, Tramp, and volley, and rattle!-- Over crimson trench and turf, Over climbing clouds of surf, Through tempest and cannon-wrack, Have his terrible pinions whirled (A thousand fields of battle! A million leagues of foam!);-- But our bird shall yet come back, He shall soar to his eyrie-home, And his thunderous wings be furled, In the gaze of a gladdened world, On the nation's loftiest dome.

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

One more struggle closed the campaign. On December 29, 1862, the armies of Bragg and Rosecrans met at Murfreesboro, Tenn., and for four days a desperate battle raged, which ended finally in the Confederates falling back and leaving their antagonists in possession of the field.

THE BATTLE OF MURFREESBORO

[December 31, 1862]

Ere Murfreesboro's thunders rent the air-- With cannon booming 'mid the trumpet's blare-- Cane Hill and David Mills, stern battles, too, Had carried death to hosts in Gray and Blue. But here, more deadly, war's wild torrent rushed, And victory, at first, the Rebels flushed. The "right wing" gone, and troops in panic, lo! The battle seemed already lost. But, No. Brave Rosecrans cried out--"Now stop retreat! We'll turn to victory this sore defeat! We must and shall this battle--Soldiers!--win! Now silence yonder batt'ry, to begin! And all re-form and meet the yelling foe! Stand firm and fire a volley! Back he'll go. If not, present your bayonets, and Charge! 'Tis needless on these orders to enlarge; But--Comrades!--here we conquer or we die!" And all that Rosecrans desired was done; And Murfreesboro's battle thus was won. Hail! to that New Year's Day in 'Sixty-three, And to that morrow which brought victory. Hail! to the courage of the Boys in Blue, Who fought so grandly, to their Country true.

KINAHAN CORNWALLIS.

Among the wounded, on the Confederate side, was Isaac Giffen, a native of East Tennessee. He was terribly injured, and was taken by Dr. Francis O. Ticknor into his home and nursed back to life. He fell in one of the battles before Atlanta.

LITTLE GIFFEN

Out of the focal and foremost fire, Out of the hospital walls as dire, Smitten of grape-shot and gangrene (Eighteenth battle and _he_ sixteen)-- Spectre such as you seldom see, Little Giffen of Tennessee.

"Take him--and welcome!" the surgeons said, "Little the doctor can help the dead!" So we took him and brought him where The balm was sweet on the summer air; And we laid him down on a wholesome bed-- Utter Lazarus, heel to head!

And we watched the war with bated breath-- Skeleton Boy against skeleton Death. Months of torture, how many such! Weary weeks of the stick and crutch; And still a glint in the steel-blue eye Told of a spirit that wouldn't die.

And didn't. Nay, more! in death's despite The crippled skeleton learned to write. "Dear Mother," at first of course; and then "Dear Captain," inquiring about "the men." Captain's answer: "Of eighty and five, Giffen and I are left alive."

Word of gloom from the war one day: "Johnston's pressed at the front, they say!" Little Giffen was up and away; A tear--his first--as he bade good-by, Dimmed the glint of his steel-blue eye. "I'll write, if spared!" There was news of the fight; But none of Giffen--he did not write.

I sometimes fancy that, were I king Of the princely knights of the Golden Ring, With the song of the minstrel in mine ear, And the tender legend that trembles here, I'd give the best, on his bended knee, The whitest soul of my chivalry, For Little Giffen of Tennessee.

FRANCIS ORRERY TICKNOR.

Both the Union and Confederate armies were in need of rest and reorganization, and for a time hostilities ceased. Grant paused to collect his forces and to prepare for a manoeuvre of the first importance.

THE BATTLE AUTUMN OF 1862

The flags of war like storm-birds fly, The charging trumpets blow; Yet rolls no thunder in the sky, No earthquake strives below.

And, calm and patient, Nature keeps Her ancient promise well, Though o'er her bloom and greenness sweeps The battle's breath of hell.

And still she walks in golden hours Through harvest-happy farms, And still she wears her fruits and flowers Like jewels on her arms.

What mean the gladness of the plain, This joy of eve and morn, The mirth that shakes the beard of grain And yellow locks of corn?

Ah! eyes may well be full of tears, And hearts with hate are hot; But even-paced come round the years, And Nature changes not.

She meets with smiles our bitter grief, With songs our groans of pain; She mocks with tint of flower and leaf The war-field's crimson stain.

Still, in the cannon's pause, we hear Her sweet thanksgiving-psalm; Too near to God for doubt or fear, She shares the eternal calm.

She knows the seed lies safe below The fires that blast and burn; For all the tears of blood we sow She waits the rich return.

She sees with clearer eye than ours The good of suffering born,-- The hearts that blossom like her flowers, And ripen like her corn.

Oh, give to us, in times like these, The vision of her eyes; And make her fields and fruited trees Our golden prophecies!

Oh, give to us her finer ear! Above this stormy din, We too would hear the bells of cheer Ring peace and freedom in.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

CHAPTER VI

THE COAST AND THE RIVER

At the opening of the Civil War, the United States had proclaimed a blockade of all Southern ports. But places like Pamlico Sound and Port Royal had so many outlets that they could not be blockaded effectually, and finally, in November, 1861, a combined sea and land attack captured the latter place and gave the Union fleet a good harbor in the South.

AT PORT ROYAL

[November 7, 1861]

The tent-lights glimmer on the land, The ship-lights on the sea; The night-wind smooths with drifting sand Our track on lone Tybee.

At last our grating keels outslide, Our good boats forward swing; And while we ride the land-locked tide, Our negroes row and sing.

For dear the bondman holds his gifts Of music and of song: The gold that kindly Nature sifts Among his sands of wrong;

The power to make his toiling days And poor home-comforts please; The quaint relief of mirth that plays With sorrow's minor keys.

Another glow than sunset's fire Has filled the west with light, Where field and garner, barn and byre, Are blazing through the night.

The land is wild with fear and hate, The rout runs mad and fast; From hand to hand, from gate to gate The flaming brand is passed.

The lurid glow falls strong across Dark faces broad with smiles: Not theirs the terror, hate, and loss That fire yon blazing piles.

With oar-strokes timing to their song, They weave in simple lays The pathos of remembered wrong, The hope of better days,--

The triumph-note that Miriam sung, The joy of uncaged birds: Softening with Afric's mellow tongue Their broken Saxon words.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The campaign along the North Carolina coast was vigorously pressed, and fort after fort was captured, until the Northern troops were so firmly in possession that their control of that portion of the coast was never afterwards seriously threatened.

READY

Loaded with gallant soldiers, A boat shot in to the land, And lay at the right of Rodman's Point, With her keel upon the sand.

Lightly, gayly, they came to shore, And never a man afraid; When sudden the enemy opened fire, From his deadly ambuscade.

Each man fell flat on the bottom Of the boat; and the captain said: "If we lie here, we all are captured, And the first who moves is dead!"

Then out spoke a negro sailor, No slavish soul had he: "Somebody's got to die, boys, And it might as well be me!"

Firmly he rose, and fearlessly Stepped out into the tide; He pushed the vessel safely off, Then fell across her side:

Fell, pierced by a dozen bullets, As the boat swung clear and free;-- But there wasn't a man of them that day Who was fitter to die than he!

PHOEBE CARY.

Especially important was the capture of Newberne, on the Neuse River, where the Confederates were strongly intrenched. The Union forces under Burnside advanced to the attack on the morning of March 14, 1862, and succeeded in carrying the works. The loss on both sides was heavy, and would have been heavier still on the Union side, but for the quick wit of Kady Brownell.

THE DAUGHTER OF THE REGIMENT

(FIFTH RHODE ISLAND)

[March 14, 1862]

Who with the soldiers was stanch danger-sharer,-- Marched in the ranks through the shriek of the shell? Who was their comrade, their brave color-bearer? Who but the resolute Kady Brownell!

Over the marshland and over the highland, Where'er the columns wound, meadow or dell, Fared she, this daughter of little Rhode Island,-- She, the intrepid one, Kady Brownell!

While the mad rout at Manassas was surging, When those around her fled wildly, or fell, And the bold Beauregard onward was urging, Who so undaunted as Kady Brownell!

When gallant Burnside made dash upon Newberne, Sailing the Neuse 'gainst the sweep of the swell, Watching the flag on the heaven's broad blue burn, Who higher hearted than Kady Brownell?

In the deep slough of the springtide debarking, Toiling o'er leagues that are weary to tell, Time with the sturdiest soldiery marking, Forward, straight forward, strode Kady Brownell.

Reaching the lines where the army was forming, Forming to charge on those ramparts of hell, When from the wood came her regiment swarming, What did she see there--this Kady Brownell?

See! why she saw that their friends thought them foemen; Muskets were levelled, and cannon as well! Save them from direful destruction would no men? Nay, but this woman would,--Kady Brownell!

Waving her banner she raced for the clearing; Fronted them all, with her flag as a spell; Ah, what a volley--a volley of cheering-- Greeted the heroine, Kady Brownell!

Gone (and thank God!) are those red days of slaughter! Brethren again we in amity dwell; Just one more cheer for the Regiment's Daughter!-- Just one more cheer for her, Kady Brownell!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

The Federals had succeeded in partially destroying the navy yard at Norfolk at the outbreak of the war, but the Confederates succeeded in raising one vessel, the Merrimac. This they rebuilt, converted into an iron-clad, armed with ten rifled guns, and named the Virginia. A cast-iron ram was fitted to the bow. The vessel was completed in March, 1862, and on the 8th cast loose and steamed down the river.

THE TURTLE

[March 8, 1862]

Cæsar, afloat with his fortunes! And all the world agog Straining its eyes At a thing that lies In the water, like a log! It's a weasel! a whale! I see its tail! It's a porpoise! a pollywog!

Tarnation! it's a _turtle_! And blast my bones and skin, My hearties, sink her, Or else you'll think her A regular terror-pin!

The frigate poured a broadside! The bombs they whistled well, But--hit old Nick With a sugar stick! It didn't phase her shell!

Piff, from the creature's larboard-- And dipping along the water A bullet hissed From a wreath of mist Into a Doodle's quarter!

Raff, from the creature's starboard-- _Rip_, from his ugly snorter, And the Congress and The Cumberland Sunk, and nothing--shorter.

Now, here's to you, Virginia, And you are bound to win! By your rate of bobbing round And your way of pitchin' in-- For you are a cross Of the old sea-hoss And a regular terror-pin.

At Newport News lay the United States 50-gun frigate Congress, the 24-gun sloop Cumberland, and the frigates St. Lawrence, Roanoke, and Minnesota. In command of the Cumberland was Lieutenant George Upham Morris, and at noon the Merrimac was seen from the Cumberland's deck advancing to the attack. Shot and shell were poured upon her without effect. She steamed straight on and plunged her ram into the Cumberland's side. Morris fought his ship until she sank under him.

THE ATTACK

[March 8, 1862]

In Hampton Roads, the airs of March were bland, Peace on the deck and in the fortress sleeping, Till, in the look-out of the Cumberland, The sailor, with his well-poised glass in hand, Descried the iron island downward creeping.

A sudden wonder seized on land and bay, And Tumult, with her train, was there to follow; For still the stranger kept its seaward way, Looking a great leviathan blowing spray, Seeking with steady course his ocean wallow.

And still it came, and largened on the sight; A floating monster; ugly and gigantic; In shape, a wave, with long and shelving height, As if a mighty billow, heaved at night, Should turn to iron in the mid-Atlantic.

Then ship and fortress gazed with anxious stare, Until the Cumberland's cannon, silence breaking, Thundered its guardian challenge, "Who comes there?" But, like a rock-flung echo in the air, The shot rebounded, no impression making.

Then roared a broadside; though directed well, On, like a nightmare, moved the shape defiant; The tempest of our pounding shot and shell Crumbled to harmless nothing, thickly fell From off the sounding armor of the giant!

Unchecked, still onward through the storm it broke, With beak directed at the vessel's centre; Then through the constant cloud of sulphurous smoke Drove, till it struck the warrior's wall of oak, Making a gateway for the waves to enter.

Struck, and to note the mischief done, withdrew, And then, with all a murderer's impatience, Rushed on again, crushing her ribs anew, Cleaving the noble hull well-nigh in two, And on it sped its fiery imprecations.

Swift through the vessel swept the drowning swell, With splash, and rush, and guilty rise appalling; While sinking cannon rung their own loud knell. Then, cried the traitor, from his sulphurous cell, "Do you surrender?" Oh, those words were galling!

How spake our captain to his comrades then? It was a shout from out a soul of splendor, Echoed from lofty maintop, and again Between-decks, from the lips of dying men, "Sink! sink, boys, sink! but never say surrender!"

Down went the ship! Down, down; but never down Her sacred flag to insolent dictator. Weep for the patriot heroes, doomed to drown; Pledge to the sunken Cumberland's renown. She sank, thank God! unsoiled by foot of traitor!

THOMAS BUCHANAN READ.

THE CUMBERLAND

[March 8, 1862]

At anchor in Hampton Roads we lay, On board of the Cumberland, sloop-of-war; And at times from the fortress across the bay The alarum of drums swept past, Or a bugle blast From the camp on the shore.

Then far away to the south uprose A little feather of snow-white smoke, And we knew that the iron ship of our foes Was steadily steering its course To try the force Of our ribs of oak.

Down upon us heavily runs, Silent and sullen, the floating fort; Then comes a puff of smoke from her guns, And leaps the terrible death, With fiery breath, From each open port.

We are not idle, but send her straight Defiance back in a full broadside! As hail rebounds from a roof of slate, Rebounds our heavier hail From each iron scale Of the monster's hide.

"Strike your flag!" the rebel cries In his arrogant old plantation strain. "Never!" our gallant Morris replies: "It is better to sink than to yield!" And the whole air pealed With the cheers of our men.

Then, like a kraken huge and black, She crushed our ribs in her iron grasp! Down went the Cumberland all a wrack, With a sudden shudder of death, And the cannon's breath For her dying gasp.

Next morn, as the sun rose over the bay, Still floated our flag at the mainmast head. Lord, how beautiful was Thy day! Every waft of the air Was a whisper of prayer, Or a dirge for the dead.

Ho! brave hearts that went down in the seas! Ye are at peace in the troubled stream; Ho! brave land! with hearts like these, Thy flag, that is rent in twain, Shall be one again, And without a seam!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

ON BOARD THE CUMBERLAND

[March 8, 1862]

"Stand to your guns, men!" Morris cried. Small need to pass the word; Our men at quarters ranged themselves, Before the drum was heard.

And then began the sailors' jests: "What thing is that, I say?" "A long-shore meeting-house adrift Is standing down the bay!"

A frown came over Morris' face; The strange, dark craft he knew; "That is the iron Merrimac, Manned by a rebel crew.

"So shot your guns, and point them straight; Before this day goes by, We'll try of what her metal's made." A cheer was our reply.

"Remember, boys, this flag of ours Has seldom left its place; And where it falls, the deck it strikes Is covered with disgrace.

"I ask but this: or sink or swim, Or live or nobly die, My last sight upon earth may be To see that ensign fly!"

Meanwhile the shapeless iron mass Came moving o'er the wave, As gloomy as a passing hearse, As silent as the grave.

Her ports were closed, from stem to stern No sign of life appeared. We wondered, questioned, strained our eyes, Joked,--everything but feared.

She reached our range. Our broadside rang, Our heavy pivots roared; And shot and shell, a fire of hell, Against her sides we poured.

God's mercy! from her sloping roof The iron tempest glanced, As hail bounds from a cottage-thatch, And round her leaped and danced;

Or, when against her dusky hull We struck a fair, full blow, The mighty, solid iron globes Were crumbled up like snow.

On, on, with fast increasing speed, The silent monster came; Though all our starboard battery Was one long line of flame.

She heeded not, nor gun she fired, Straight on our bow she bore; Through riving plank and crashing frame Her furious way she tore.

Alas! our beautiful, keen bow, That in the fiercest blast So gently folded back the seas, They hardly felt we passed!

Alas! Alas! My Cumberland, That ne'er knew grief before, To be so gored, to feel so deep The tusk of that sea-boar!

Once more she backward drew a space, Once more our side she rent; Then, in the wantonness of hate, Her broadside through us sent.

The dead and dying round us lay, But our foeman lay abeam; Her open portholes maddened us; We fired with shout and scream.

We felt our vessel settling fast, We knew our time was brief; "The pumps, the pumps!" But they who pumped, And fought not, wept with grief.

"Oh, keep us but an hour afloat! Oh, give us only time To be the instruments of heaven Against the traitors' crime!"

From captain down to powder-boy, No hand was idle then; Two soldiers, but by chance aboard, Fought on like sailor-men.

And when a gun's crew lost a hand, Some bold marine stepped out, And jerked his braided jacket off, And hauled the gun about.

Our forward magazine was drowned; And up from the sick-bay Crawled out the wounded, red with blood, And round us gasping lay.

Yes, cheering, calling us by name, Struggling with failing breath, To keep their shipmates at the port, While glory strove with death.

With decks afloat, and powder gone, The last broadside we gave From the guns' heated iron lips Burst out beneath the wave.

So sponges, rammers, and handspikes-- As men-of-war's men should-- We placed within their proper racks, And at our quarters stood.

"Up to the spar-deck! Save yourselves!" Cried Selfridge. "Up, my men! God grant that some of us may live To fight yon ship again!"

We turned--we did not like to go; Yet staying seemed but vain, Knee-deep in water; so we left; Some swore, some groaned with pain.

We reached the deck. Here Randall stood: "Another turn, men--so!" Calmly he aimed his pivot-gun: "Now, Tenney, let her go!"

It did our sore hearts good to hear The song our pivot sang, As rushing on, from wave to wave, The whirring bomb-shell sprang.

Brave Randall leaped upon the gun, And waved his cap in sport; "Well done! well aimed! I saw that shell Go through an open port."

It was our last, our deadliest shot; The deck was overflown; The poor ship staggered, lurched to port, And gave a living groan.

Down, down, as headlong through the waves Our gallant vessel rushed, A thousand gurgling, watery sounds Around my senses gushed.

Then I remember little more; One look to heaven I gave, Where, like an angel's wing, I saw Our spotless ensign wave.

I tried to cheer, I cannot say Whether I swam or sank; A blue mist closed around my eyes, And everything was blank.

When I awoke, a soldier-lad, All dripping from the sea, With two great tears upon his cheeks, Was bending over me.

I tried to speak. He understood The wish I could not speak. He turned me. There, thank God! the flag Still fluttered at the peak!

And there, while thread shall hang to thread, O let that ensign fly! The noblest constellation set Against our northern sky.

A sign that we who live may claim The peerage of the brave; A monument, that needs no scroll, For those beneath the wave!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

THE CUMBERLAND

Some names there are of telling sound, Whose vowelled syllables free Are pledge that they shall ever live renowned; Such seems to be A Frigate's name (by present glory spanned)-- The Cumberland. Sounding name as e'er was sung, Flowing, rolling on the tongue-- Cumberland! Cumberland!

She warred and sunk. There's no denying That she was ended--quelled; And yet her flag above her fate is flying, As when it swelled Unswallowed by the swallowing sea: so grand-- The Cumberland. Goodly name as e'er was sung, Roundly rolling on the tongue-- Cumberland! Cumberland!

What need to tell how she was fought-- The sinking flaming gun-- The gunner leaping out the port-- Washed back, undone! Her dead unconquerably manned The Cumberland. Noble name as e'er was sung, Slowly roll it on the tongue-- Cumberland! Cumberland!

Long as hearts shall share the flame Which burned in that brave crew, Her fame shall live--outlive the victor's name; For this is due. Your flag and flag-staff shall in story stand-- Cumberland! Sounding name as e'er was sung, Long they'll roll it on the tongue-- Cumberland! Cumberland!

HERMAN MELVILLE.

The Merrimac then drew off and subjected the Congress to such a terrific fire that the frigate was forced to surrender. After heavily damaging the other vessels of the fleet, the Merrimac withdrew, intending to complete their destruction in the morning.

HOW THE CUMBERLAND WENT DOWN

[March 8, 1862]

Gray swept the angry waves O'er the gallant and the true, Rolled high in mounded graves O'er the stately frigate's crew-- Over cannon, over deck, Over all that ghastly wreck,-- When the Cumberland went down.

Such a roar the waters rent As though a giant died, When the wailing billows went Above those heroes tried; And the sheeted foam leaped high, Like white ghosts against the sky,-- As the Cumberland went down.

O shrieking waves that gushed Above that loyal band, Your cold, cold burial rushed O'er many a heart on land! And from all the startled North A cry of pain broke forth, When the Cumberland went down.

And forests old, that gave A thousand years of power To her lordship of the wave And her beauty's regal dower, Bent, as though before a blast, When plunged her pennoned mast, And the Cumberland went down.

And grimy mines that sent To her their virgin strength, And iron vigor lent To knit her lordly length, Wildly stirred with throbs of life, Echoes of that fatal strife, As the Cumberland went down.

Beneath the ocean vast, Full many a captain bold, By many a rotting mast, And admiral of old, Rolled restless in his grave As he felt the sobbing wave, When the Cumberland went down.

And stern Vikings that lay A thousand years at rest, In many a deep blue bay Beneath the Baltic's breast, Leaped on the silver sands, And shook their rusty brands, As the Cumberland went down.

S. WEIR MITCHELL.

But when, on the morning of March 9, 1862, the Merrimac steamed out again into Hampton Roads, a new antagonist confronted her--the Monitor, Ericsson's eccentric boat, which had arrived from New York the night before. The ships approached each other, like David and Goliath. A battle followed, unique in naval warfare, the first duel of ironclads the world had ever seen. It ended in the Merrimac retreating to Norfolk, badly damaged.

THE CRUISE OF THE MONITOR

[March 9, 1862]

Out of a Northern city's bay, 'Neath lowering clouds, one bleak March day, Glided a craft--the like, I ween, On ocean's crest was never seen Since Noah's float, that ancient boat, Could o'er a conquered deluge gloat.

No raking masts, with clouds of sail, Bent to the breeze, or braved the gale; No towering chimney's wreaths of smoke Betrayed the mighty engine's stroke; But low and dark, like the crafty shark, Moved in the waters this novel bark.

The fishers stared as the flitting sprite Passed their huts in the misty light, Bearing a turret huge and black, And said, "The old sea-serpent's back, Carting away by light of day, Uncle Sam's fort from New York Bay."

Forth from a Southern city's dock, Our frigates' strong blockade to mock, Crept a monster of rugged build, The work of crafty hands, well skilled-- Old Merrimac, with an iron back Wooden ships would find hard to crack.

Straight to where the Cumberland lay, The mail-clad monster made its way; Its deadly prow struck deep and sure, And the hero's fighting days were o'er. Ah! many the braves who found their graves, With that good ship, beneath the waves!

But with their fate is glory wrought, Those hearts of oak like heroes fought With desperate hope to win the day, And crush the foe that 'fore them lay. Our flag up run, the last-fired gun, Tokens how bravely duty was done.

Flushed with success, the victor flew, Furious, the startled squadron through: Sinking, burning, driving ashore, Until that Sabbath day was o'er, Resting at night to renew the fight With vengeful ire by morning's light.

Out of its den it burst anew, When the gray mist the sun broke through, Steaming to where, in clinging sands, The frigate Minnesota stands, A sturdy foe to overthrow, But in woful plight to receive a blow.

But see! Beneath her bow appears A champion no danger fears; A pigmy craft, that seems to be To this new lord who rules the sea, Like David of old to Goliath bold--Youth and giant, by Scripture told.

Round the roaring despot playing, With willing spirit, helm obeying, Spurning the iron against it hurled, While belching turret rapid whirled, And swift shot's seethe, with smoky wreath, Told that the shark was showing his teeth--

The Monitor fought. In grim amaze The Merrimacs upon it gaze, Cowering 'neath the iron hail, Crashing into their coat of mail; They swore "this craft, the devil's shaft, Looked like a cheese-box on a raft."

Hurrah! little giant of '62! Bold Worden with his gallant crew Forces the fight; the day is won; Back to his den the monster's gone With crippled claws and broken jaws, Defeated in a reckless cause.

Hurrah for the master mind that wrought, With iron hand, this iron thought! Strength and safety with speed combined, Ericsson's gift to all mankind; To curb abuse, and chains to loose, Hurrah for the Monitor's famous cruise!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

The reign of terror created by the Merrimac was at an end, and the ship herself did not last long. On May 10, 1862, the Confederates were forced to abandon Norfolk, and the Merrimac was blown up. On December 30 the Monitor foundered in a gale off Hatteras.

THE SINKING OF THE MERRIMACK

[May, 1862]

Gone down in the flood, and gone out in the flame! What else could she do, with her fair Northern name? Her font was a river whose last drop is free: That river ran boiling with wrath to the sea, To hear of her baptismal blessing profaned; A name that was Freedom's, by treachery stained.

'Twas the voice of our free Northern mountains that broke In the sound of her guns, from her stout ribs of oak: 'Twas the might of the free Northern hand you could feel In her sweep and her moulding, from topmast to keel: When they made her speak treason (does Hell know of worse?), How her strong timbers shook with the shame of her curse!

Let her go! Should a deck so polluted again Ever ring to the tread of our true Northern men? Let the suicide-ship thunder forth, to the air And the sea she has blotted, her groan of despair! Let her last heat of anguish throb out into flame! Then sink them together,--the ship and the name!

LUCY LARCOM.

The work of the gunboats on the Mississippi at the investment of Fort Henry and Fort Donelson has been already mentioned. In April, 1862, a blow was aimed at the very heart of the Confederacy, when a fleet under command of David Glasgow Farragut advanced up the river against the formidable forts below New Orleans. After five days' bombardment, the fleet ran past the forts and attacked the Confederate ships before the city.

THE RIVER FIGHT

[April 18, 1862]

Do you know of the dreary land, If land such region may seem, Where 'tis neither sea nor strand, Ocean, nor good, dry land, But the nightmare marsh of a dream? Where the Mighty River his death-road takes, 'Mid pools and windings that coil like snakes, A hundred leagues of bayous and lakes, To die in the great Gulf Stream?

No coast-line clear and true, Granite and deep-sea blue, On that dismal shore you pass, Surf-worn boulder or sandy beach,-- But ooze-flats as far as the eye can reach, With shallows of water-grass; Reedy Savannahs, vast and dun, Lying dead in the dim March sun; Huge, rotting trunks and roots that lie Like the blackened bones of shapes gone by, And miles of sunken morass.

No lovely, delicate thing Of life o'er the waste is seen But the cayman couched by his weedy spring, And the pelican, bird unclean, Or the buzzard, flapping with heavy wing, Like an evil ghost o'er the desolate scene.

Ah! many a weary day With our Leader there we lay. In the sultry haze and smoke, Tugging our ships o'er the bar, Till the spring was wasted far, Till his brave heart almost broke. For the sullen river seemed As if our intent he dreamed,-- All his sallow mouths did spew and choke.

But ere April fully passed All ground over at last And we knew the die was cast,-- Knew the day drew nigh To dare to the end one stormy deed, Might save the land at her sorest need, Or on the old deck to die!

Anchored we lay,--and a morn the more, To his captains and all his men Thus wrote our old commodore (He wasn't Admiral then):-- "GENERAL ORDERS: Send your to'gallant masts down, Rig in each flying jib-boom! Clear all ahead for the loom Of traitor fortress and town, Or traitor fleet bearing down.

"In with your canvas high; We shall want no sail to fly! Topsail, foresail, spanker, and jib (With the heart of oak in the oaken rib), Shall serve us to win or die!

"Trim every sail by the head (So shall you spare the lead), Lest if she ground, your ship swing round, Bows in shore, for a wreck. See your grapnels all clear with pains, And a solid kedge in your port main-chains, With a whip to the main yard: Drop it heavy and hard When you grapple a traitor deck!

"On forecastle and on poop Mount guns, as best you may deem. If possible, rouse them up (For still you must bow the stream). Also hoist and secure with stops Howitzers firmly in your tops, To fire on the foe abeam.

"Look well to your pumps and hose; Have water tubs fore and aft, For quenching flame in your craft, And the gun crew's fiery thirst. See planks with felt fitted close, To plug every shot-hole tight. Stand ready to meet the worst! For, if I have reckoned aright, They will serve us shot, Both cold and hot, Freely enough to-night.

"Mark well each signal I make (Our life-long service at stake, And honor that must not lag!),-- Whate'er the peril and awe, In the battle's fieriest flaw, Let never one ship withdraw Till the orders come from the flag!"

* * * * *

Would you hear of the river fight? It was two of a soft spring night; God's stars looked down on all; And all was clear and bright But the low fog's clinging breath; Up the River of Death Sailed the great Admiral.

On our high poop-deck he stood, And round him ranged the men Who have made their birthright good Of manhood once and again,-- Lords of helm and of sail, Tried in tempest and gale, Bronzed in battle and wreck. Bell and Bailey grandly led Each his line of the Blue and Red; Wainwright stood by our starboard rail; Thornton fought the deck. And I mind me of more than they, Of the youthful, steadfast ones, That have shown them worthy sons Of the seamen passed away. Tyson conned our helm that day; Watson stood by his guns.

What thought our Admiral then, Looking down on his men? Since the terrible day (Day of renown and tears!),-- When at anchor the Essex lay,-- Holding her foes at bay,-- When a boy by Porter's side he stood, Till deck and plank-sheer were dyed with blood; 'Tis half a hundred years,-- Half a hundred years to a day!

Who could fail with him? Who reckon of life or limb? Not a pulse but beat the higher! There had you seen, by the starlight dim, Five hundred faces strong and grim: The Flag is going under fire! Right up by the fort, With her helm hard aport, The Hartford is going under fire!

The way to our work was plain. Caldwell had broken the chain (Two hulks swung down amain Soon as 'twas sundered). Under the night's dark blue, Steering steady and true, Ship after ship went through, Till, as we hove in view, "Jackson" out-thundered!

Back echoed "Philip!" ah! then Could you have seen our men. How they sprung in the dim night haze, To their work of toil and of clamor! How the boarders, with sponge and rammer And their captains, with cord and hammer, Kept every muzzle ablaze. How the guns, as with cheer and shout-- Our tackle-men hurled them out-- Brought up on the water-ways!

First, as we fired at their flash, 'Twas lightning and black eclipse, With a bellowing roll and crash. But soon, upon either bow, What with forts and fire-rafts and ships (The whole fleet was hard at it now), All pounding away!--and Porter Still thundering with shell and mortar,-- 'T was the mighty sound and form!

(Such you see in the far South, After long heat and drought, As day draws nigh to even, Arching from north to south, Blinding the tropic sun, The great black bow

comes on, Till the thunder-veil is riven,-- When all is crash and levin, And the cannonade of heaven Rolls down the Amazon!)

But, as we worked along higher, Just where the river enlarges, Down came a pyramid of fire,-- It was one of your long coal barges. (We had often had the like before.) 'T was coming down on us to larboard, Well in with the eastern shore; And our pilot, to let it pass round (You may guess we never stopped to sound), Giving us a rank sheer to starboard, Ran the Flag hard and fast aground!

'T was nigh abreast of the Upper Fort, And straightway a rascal ram (She was shaped like the Devil's dam) Puffed away for us, with a snort, And shoved it, with spiteful strength, Right alongside of us to port. It was all of our ship's length,-- A huge, crackling Cradle of the Pit! Pitch-pine knots to the brim, Belching flame red and grim, What a roar came up from it!

Well, for a little it looked bad: But these things are, somehow, shorter, In the acting than in the telling; There was no singing out or yelling, Or any fussing and fretting, No stampede, in short; But there we were, my lad, All afire on our port quarter, Hammocks ablaze in the netting, Flames spouting in at every port, Our fourth cutter burning at the davit (No chance to lower away and save it).

In a twinkling, the flames had risen Halfway to maintop and mizzen, Darting up the shrouds like snakes! Ah, how we clanked at the brakes, And the deep, steaming pumps throbbed under, Sending a ceaseless flow.

Our topmen, a dauntless crowd, Swarmed in rigging and shroud: There ('twas a wonder!) The burning ratlines and strands They quenched with their bare, hard hands; But the great guns below Never silenced their thunder.

At last, by backing and sounding, When we were clear of grounding, And under headway once more, The whole rebel fleet came rounding The point. If we had it hot before, 'Twas now from shore to shore, One long, loud, thundering roar,-- Such crashing, splintering, and pounding, And smashing as you never heard before!

But that we fought foul wrong to wreck, And to save the land we loved so well, You might have deemed our long gun-deck Two hundred feet of hell!

For above all was battle, Broadside, and blaze, and rattle, Smoke and thunder alone (But, down in the sick-bay, Where our wounded and dying lay, There was scarce a sob or a moan).

And at last, when the dim day broke, And the sullen sun awoke, Drearily blinking O'er the haze and the cannon smoke, That ever such morning dulls,-- There were thirteen traitor hulls On fire and sinking!

Now, up the river!--though mad Chalmette Sputters a vain resistance yet, Small helm we gave her our course to steer,-- 'Twas nicer work than you well would dream, With cant and sheer to keep her clear Of the burning wrecks that cumbered the stream.

The Louisiana, hurled on high, Mounts in thunder to meet the sky! Then down to the depths of the turbid flood,-- Fifty fathom of rebel mud! The Mississippi comes

floating down, A mighty bonfire from off the town; And along the river, on stocks and ways, A half-hatched devil's brood is ablaze,-- The great Anglo-Norman is all in flames (Hark to the roar of her trembling frames!), And the smaller fry that Treason would spawn Are lighting Algiers like an angry dawn!

From stem to stern, how the pirates burn, Fired by the furious hands that built! So to ashes forever turn The suicide wrecks of wrong and guilt!

But as we neared the city, By field and vast plantation (Ah! millstone of our nation!), With wonder and with pity, What crowds we there espied Of dark and wistful faces, Mute in their toiling places, Strangely and sadly eyed. Haply 'mid doubt and fear, Deeming deliverance near (One gave the ghost of a cheer!).

And on that dolorous strand, To greet the victor brave, One flag did welcome wave-- Raised, ah me! by a wretched hand, All outworn on our cruel land,-- The withered hand of a slave!

But all along the levee, In a dark and drenching rain (By this 'twas pouring heavy), Stood a fierce and sullen train, A strange and frenzied time! There were scowling rage and pain, Curses, howls, and hisses, Out of Hate's black abysses,-- Their courage and their crime All in vain--all in vain!

For from the hour that the Rebel Stream With the Crescent City lying abeam, Shuddered under our keel, Smit to the heart with self-struck sting, Slavery died in her scorpion-ring And Murder fell on his steel.

'Tis well to do and dare; But ever may grateful prayer Follow, as aye it ought, When the good fight is fought, When the true deed is done. Aloft in heaven's pure light (Deep azure crossed on white), Our fair Church pennant waves O'er a thousand thankful braves, Bareheaded in God's bright sun.

Lord of mercy and frown, Ruling o'er sea and shore, Send us such scene once more! All in line of battle When the black ships bear down On tyrant fort and town, 'Mid cannon cloud and rattle; And the great guns once more Thunder back the roar Of the traitor walls ashore, And the traitor flags come down.

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

THE BALLAD OF NEW ORLEANS

[April 24, 1862]

Just as the hour was darkest, Just between night and day, From the flag-ship shone the signal, "Get the squadrons under way."

Not a sound but the tramp of sailors, And the wheeling capstan's creak, Arose from the busy vessels As the anchors came apeak.

The men worked on in silence, With never a shout or cheer, Till 'twas whispered from bow to quarter: "Start forward! all is clear."

Then groaned the ponderous engine, Then floundered the whirling screw; And as ship joined ship, the comrades Their lines of battle drew.

The moon through the fog was casting A blur of lurid light, As the captain's latest order Was flashed into the night.

"Steam on! and whatever fortune May follow the attack, Sink with your bows still northward No vessel must turn back!"

'Twas hard when we heard that order To smother a rising shout; For it wakened the life within us, And we burned to give it out.

All wrapped in the foggy darkness, Brave Bailey moved ahead; And stem after stern, his gunboats To the starboard station led.

Next Farragut's stately flag-ship To port her head inclined; And midmost, and most in danger, Bell's squadron closed behind.

Ah! many a prayer was murmured For the homes we ne'er might see; And the silence and night grew dreadful With the thought of what must be.

For many a tall, stout fellow Who stood at his quarters then, In the damp and dismal moonlight, Never saw the sun again.

Close down by the yellow river In their oozy graves they rot; Strange vines and strange weeds grow o'er them, And their far homes know them not.

But short was our time of musing; For the rebel forts discerned That the whole great fleet was moving, And their batteries on us turned.

Then Porter burst out from his mortars, In jets of fiery spray, As if a volcano had opened Where his leaf-clad vessels lay.

Howling and screeching and whizzing The bomb-shells arched on high, And then, like gigantic meteors, Dropped swiftly from the sky.

Dropped down on the low, doomed fortress A plague of iron death, Shattering earth and granite to atoms With their puffs of sulphurous breath.

The whole air quaked and shuddered As the huge globes rose and fell, And the blazing shores looked awful As the open gates of hell.

Fort Jackson and Fort Saint Philip, And the battery on the right, By this time were flashing and thundering Out into the murky night.

Through the hulks and the cables, sundered By the bold Itasca's crew, Went Bailey in silence, though round him The shells and the grape-shot flew.

No answer he made to their welcome, Till abeam Saint Philip bore, Then, oh, but he sent them a greeting In his broadsides' steady roar!

Meanwhile, the old man, in the Hartford, Had ranged to Fort Jackson's side; What a sight! he slowed his engines Till he barely stemmed the tide;

Yes, paused in that deadly tornado Of case-shot and shell and ball, Not a cable's length from the fortress, And he lay there, wood to wall.

Have you any notion, you landsmen, Who have seen a field-fight won, Of canister, grape-shot, and shrapnel Hurled out from a ten-inch gun?

I tell you, the air is nigh solid With the howling iron flight; And 'twas such a tempest blew o'er us Where the Hartford lay that night.

Perched aloft in the forward rigging, With his restless eyes aglow, Sat Farragut, shouting his orders To the men who fought below.

And the fort's huge faces of granite Were splintered and rent in twain, And the masses seemed slowly melting, Like snow in a torrid rain.

Now quicker and quicker we fired, Till between us and the foe A torrent of blazing vapor Was leaping to and fro;

While the fort, like a mighty caldron, Was boiling with flame and smoke, And the stone flew aloft in fragments, And the brick into powder broke.

So thick fell the clouds o'er the river, You hardly could see your hand; When we heard, from the foremast rigging, Old Farragut's sharp command:

"Full ahead! Steam across to Saint Philip! Starboard battery, mind your aim! Forecastle there, shift your pivots! Now, Give them a taste of the same!"

Saint Philip grew faint in replying, Its voice of thunder was drowned; "But ha! what is this? Back the engines! Back, back, the ship is aground!"

Straight down the swift current came sweeping A raft, spouting sparks and flame; Pushed on by an iron-clad rebel, Under our port side it came.

At once the good Hartford was blazing, Below, aloft, fore and aft. "We are lost!" "No, no; we are moving!" Away whirled the crackling raft.

The fire was soon quenched. One last broadside We gave to the surly fort; For above us the rebel gunboats Were wheeling like devils at sport.

And into our vacant station Had glided a bulky form; 'Twas Craven's stout Brooklyn, demanding Her share of the furious storm.

We could hear the shot of Saint Philip Ring on her armor of chain, And the crash of her answering broadside, Taking and giving again.

We could hear the low growl of Craven, And Lowry's voice clear and calm, While they swept off the rebel ramparts As clean as your open palm.

Then ranging close under our quarter, Out burst from the smoky fogs The queen of the waves, the Varuna, The ship of bold Charley Boggs.

He waved his blue cap as he passed us; The blood of his glorious race, Of Lawrence, the hero, was burning Once more in a living face.

Right and left flashed his heavy pieces, Rams, gunboats--it mattered not; Wherever a rebel flag floated Was a target for his shot.

All burning and sinking around him Lay five of the foe; but he, The victor, seemed doomed with the vanquished, When along dashed gallant Lee.

And he took up the bloody conflict, And so well his part he bore, That the river ran fire behind him, And glimmered from shore to shore.

But while powder would burn in a cannon, Till the water drowned his deck, Boggs pounded away with his pivots From his slowly settling wreck.

I think our great captains in Heaven, As they looked upon those deeds, Were proud of the flower of that navy, Of which they planted the seeds.

Paul Jones, the knight-errant of ocean, Decatur, the lord of the seas, Hull, Lawrence, and Bainbridge, and Biddle, And Perry, the peer of all these!

If Porter beheld his descendant, With some human pride on his lip, I trust, through the mercy of Heaven, His soul was forgiven that slip.

And thou, living veteran, Old Ironsides, The last of the splendid line, Thou link 'twixt the old and new glory, I know what feelings were thine!

When the sun looked over the tree-tops, We found ourselves--Heaven knows how--Above the grim forts; and that instant A smoke broke from Farragut's bow.

And over the river came floating The sound of the morning gun; And the stars and stripes danced up the halyards, And glittered against the sun.

Oh, then what a shout from the squadrons! As flag followed flag, till the day Was bright with the beautiful standard, And wild with the victors' huzza!

But three ships were missing. The others Had passed through that current of flame; And each scar on their shattered bulwarks Was touched by the finger of Fame.

Below us, the forts of the rebels Lay in the trance of despair; Above us, uncovered and helpless, New Orleans clouded the air.

Again, in long lines we went steaming Away towards the city's smoke; And works were deserted before us, And columns of soldiers broke.

In vain the town clamored and struggled; The flag at our peak ruled the hour; And under its shade, like a lion, Were resting the will and the power.

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

The Varuna, after sinking five Confederate vessels, was herself sunk. Every ship of the Federal fleet suffered severely, but on the afternoon of April 25, 1862, the fleet dropped anchor off New Orleans.

THE VARUNA

[Sunk April 24, 1862]

Who has not heard of the dauntless Varuna? Who has not heard of the deeds she has done? Who shall not hear, while the brown Mississippi Rushes along from the snow to the sun?

Crippled and leaking she entered the battle, Sinking and burning she fought through the fray; Crushed were her sides and the waves ran across her, Ere, like a death-wounded lion at bay, Sternly she closed in the last fatal grapple, Then in her triumph moved grandly away.

Five of the rebels, like satellites round her, Burned in her orbit of splendor and fear; One, like the Pleiad of mystical story, Shot, terror-stricken, beyond her dread sphere.

We who are waiting with crowns for the victors, Though we should offer the wealth of our store, Load the Varuna from deck down to kelson, Still would be niggard, such tribute to pour On courage so boundless. It beggars possession,-- It knocks for just payment at heaven's bright door!

Cherish the heroes who fought the Varuna; Treat them as kings if they honor your way; Succor and comfort the sick and the wounded; Oh! for the dead let us all kneel to pray!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

New Orleans was panic-stricken. Many of the better class of citizens fled, and the town was given over to the mob. Drums were beaten, soldiers scampered hither and thither, and women ran through the streets demanding that the city be burned. The cotton on the levee was set on fire, and the torch was put to the wharves and shipping. Finally, on April 29, 1862, after a lot of silly rhodomontade, the city surrendered.

THE SURRENDER OF NEW ORLEANS

[April 29, 1862]

All day long the guns at the forts, With far-off thunders and faint retorts, Had told the city that down the bay The fleet of Farragut's war-ships lay; But now St. Philip and Jackson grim Were black and silent below the rim Of the southern sky, where the river sped Like a war-horse scenting the fight ahead.

And we of the city, the women, and men Too old for facing the battle then, Saw all the signs of our weakness there With a patience born of a great despair. The river gnawed its neglected bank, The weeds in the unused streets grew rank, And flood and famine threatened those Who stayed there braving greater woes.

Under the raking of shot and shell The river fortresses fighting fell; The Chalmette batteries then boomed forth, But the slim, straight spars of the ships of the North Moved steadily on in their river-road, Like a tide that up from the ocean flowed.

Then load after load, and pile upon pile, Lining the wharves for many a mile, Out of the cotton-presses and yards, With a grim industry which naught retards, The bales were carried and swiftly placed By those who knew there was need of haste, And the torch was laid to the cotton so. Up from that bonfire the glare and glow Was seen by the watchers far away, And weeping and wailing those watchers say, "The city is lost! O men at the front, Braving the fortunes of war, and the brunt Of battle bearing with

fearful cost, The city you loved and left is lost!"

Ah, memories crowding so thick and fast, Ye were the first; is this the last? We gave with clamor our first great gift, With shouts which up to the heavens lift; We gave with silence our last best yield, Our last, best gleaning for Shiloh's field. With mute devotion we saw them go; But when the banners were furled and low, And the solid columns were thinned by war, We wondered what we had given for.

And oh, the day when with muffled drum We saw our dear, dead Johnston come! The blood of our slain ones seemed to pour From the eyes that should see them come no more. We measured our grief by each gallant deed; We measured our loss by our direful need; Our dead dreams rose from the vanquished past, And across the future their shadows cast. Our brave young hope, like a fallen tear, We laid on the grave of our Chevalier.

And that last wild night! the east was red So long 'fore the day had left its bed. With white, set faces, and smileless lips, We fired our vessels, we fired our ships. We saw the sails of the red flame lift O'er each fire-cargo we set adrift; To Farragut's fleet we sent them down, A warm, warm welcome from the town.

But, alas, how quickly came the end! For down the river, below the bend, Like a threatening finger shook each mast Of the Yankee ships as they steamed up fast. Grim and terrible, black with men, Oh, for the Mississippi then! And--God be merciful!--there she came, A drifting wreck, a ship of flame.

What a torch to light the stripes and stars That had braved our forts and harbor bars! What a light, by which we saw vainly slip Our hopes to their death in that sinking ship!

We shrieked with rage, and defeat, and dread, As down the river that phantom sped; But on the deck of a Yankee ship, One grim old tar, with a smiling lip, Patted the big black breech of his gun, As one who silently says, "Well done!"

To-day the graves that were new are old, And a story done is a story told; But we of the city, the women and men, And boys unfitted for fighting then, Remember the day when our flag went down, And the stars and stripes waved over the town. Ah me! the bitter goes with the sweet, And a victory means another defeat; For, bound in Nature's inflexible laws, A glory for one is another's _Lost Cause_.

MARION MANVILLE.

The national flag was hoisted over the mint, but was torn down and dragged through the streets in derision by a gang of men led by William B. Mumford. Mumford was captured and hanged for treason.

MUMFORD

THE MARTYR OF NEW ORLEANS

[May, 1862]

Where murdered Mumford lies Bewailed in bitter sighs, Low bowed beneath the flag he loved Martyrs of Liberty, Defenders of the Free! Come, humbly nigh, And learn to die!

Ah, Freedom on that day Turned fearfully away, While pitying angels lingered near, To gaze upon the sod Red with a martyr's blood; And woman's tear Fell on his bier!

Oh, God! that he should die Beneath a Southern sky! Upon a felon's gallows swinging, Murdered by tyrant hand,-- While round a helpless band, On _Butler's_ name Poured scorn and shame.

But hark! loud pæans fly From earth to vaulted sky, He's crowned at Freedom's holy throne! List! sweet-voiced Israfel Tolls for the martyr's knell! Shout Southrons high, Our battle cry!

Come all of Southern blood, Come kneel to Freedom's God! Here at her crimson altar swear! Accursed forever more The flag that Mumford tore, And o'er his grave Our colors wave.

INA M. PORTER.

The behavior of the women was especially insulting and culminated when one of them spat in the face of a Union officer. General Butler thereupon issued his famous Order No. 28, providing that any woman who insulted an officer or soldier of the United States should be treated as a woman of the town. The order was received with hysteria throughout the South, but it brought the people of New Orleans to their senses.

BUTLER'S PROCLAMATION

[May 15, 1862]

Ay! drop the treacherous mask! throw by The cloak that veiled thine instincts fell, Stand forth, thou base, incarnate Lie, Stamped with the signet brand of hell! At last we view thee as thou art, A trickster with a demon's heart.

Off with disguise! no quarter now To rebel honor! thou wouldst strike Hot blushes up the anguished brow, And murder Fame and Strength alike. Beware! ten million hearts aflame Will burn with hate thou canst not tame!

We know thee now! we know thy race! Thy dreadful purpose stands revealed Naked, before the nation's face! Comrades! let Mercy's font be sealed, While the black banner courts the wind, And cursed be he who lags behind!

O soldiers, husbands, brothers, sires! Think that each stalwart blow ye give Shall quench the rage of lustful fires, And bid your glorious women live Pure from a wrong whose tainted breath Were fouler than the foulest death.

O soldiers, lovers, Christians, men! Think that each breeze that floats and dies O'er the red field, from mount or glen, Is burdened with a maiden's sighs-- And each false soul that turns to flee, Consigns his love to infamy!

Think! and strike home! the fabled might Of Titans were a feeble power To that with which your arms should smite In the next awful battle-hour! And deadlier than the bolts of heaven Should flash your fury's fatal leven!

No pity! let your thirsty bands Drink their warm fill at caitiff veins; Dip deep in blood your wrathful hands, Nor pause to wipe those crimson stains. Slay! slay! with ruthless sword and will-- The God of vengeance bids you "kill!"

Yes! but there's _one who shall not die In battle harness_! One for whom Lurks in the darkness silently Another and a sterner doom! A warrior's end should crown the brave-- For _him_, swift cord! and felon grave!

As loathsome, charnel vapors melt, Swept by invisible winds to naught, So, may this fiend of lust and guilt Die like nightmare's hideous thought! Naught left to mark the mother's name, Save--immortality of shame!

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

CHAPTER VII

EMANCIPATION

Slavery had caused the war, and as the months passed, the President and his advisers became more and more convinced that the emancipation of the negroes would go far to end it. On August 31, 1861, John C. Frémont, in command of the Western Department, issued a proclamation freeing the slaves of secessionists in Missouri, but the President promptly countermanded it.

TO JOHN C. FRÉMONT

[August 31, 1861]

Thy error, Frémont, simply was to act A brave man's part, without the statesman's tact, And, taking counsel but of common sense, To strike at cause as well as consequence. Oh, never yet since Roland wound his horn At Roncesvalles, has a blast been blown Far-heard, wide-echoed, startling as thine own, Heard from the van of freedom's hope forlorn! It had been safer, doubtless, for the time, To flatter treason, and avoid offence To that Dark Power whose underlying crime Heaves upward its perpetual turbulence. But if thine be the fate of all who break The ground for truth's seed, or forerun their years Till lost in distance, or with stout hearts make A lane for freedom through the level spears, Still take thou courage! God has spoken through thee, Irrevocable, the mighty words, Be free! The land shakes with them, and the slave's dull ear Turns from the rice-swamp stealthily to hear. Who would recall them now must first arrest The winds that blow down from the free Northwest, Ruffling the Gulf; or like a scroll roll back The Mississippi to its upper springs. Such words fulfil their prophecy, and lack But the full time to harden into things.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The slaves were, however, from the outbreak of hostilities, declared to be "contraband of war," and not returnable to their masters. On April 16, 1862, the President approved a bill freeing the slaves in the District of Columbia and compensating their owners.

ASTRÆA AT THE CAPITOL

ABOLITION OF SLAVERY IN THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA, 1862

[April 16, 1862]

When first I saw our banner wave Above the nation's council-hall, I heard beneath its marble wall The clanking fetters of the slave!

In the foul market-place I stood, And saw the Christian mother sold, And childhood with its locks of gold, Blue-eyed and fair with Saxon blood.

I shut my eyes, I held my breath, And, smothering down the wrath and shame That set my Northern blood aflame, Stood silent,--where to speak was death.

Beside me gloomed the prison-cell Where wasted one in slow decline For uttering simple words of mine, And loving freedom all too well.

The flag that floated from the dome Flapped menace in the morning air; I stood a perilled stranger where The human broker made his home.

For crime was virtue: Gown and Sword And Law their threefold sanction gave, And to the quarry of the slave Went hawking with our symbol-bird.

On the oppressor's side was power; And yet I knew that every wrong, However old, however strong, But waited God's avenging hour.

I knew that truth would crush the lie,-- Somehow, sometime, the end would be; Yet scarcely dared I hope to see The triumph with my mortal eye.

But now I see it! In the sun A free flag floats from yonder dome, And at the nation's hearth and home The justice long delayed is done.

Not as we hoped, in calm of prayer, The message of deliverance comes, But heralded by roll of drums On waves of battle-troubled air!

Midst sounds that madden and appall, The song that Bethlehem's shepherds knew! The harp of David melting through The demon-agonies of Saul!

Not as we hoped; but what are we? Above our broken dreams and plans God lays, with wiser hand than man's, The corner-stones of liberty.

I cavil not with Him: the voice That freedom's blessed gospel tells Is sweet to me as silver bells, Rejoicing! yea, I will rejoice!

Dear friends still toiling in the sun; Ye dearer ones who, gone before, Are watching from the eternal shore The slow work by your hands begun,

Rejoice with me! The chastening rod Blossoms with love; the furnace heat Grows cool beneath His blessed feet Whose form is as the Son of God!

Rejoice! Our Marah's bitter springs Are sweetened; on our ground of grief Rise day by day in strong relief The prophecies of better things.

Rejoice in hope! The day and night Are one with God, and one with them Who see by faith the cloudy hem Of Judgment fringed with Mercy's light!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

At last the President resolved to throw down the gauntlet, and on September 22, 1862, proclaimed that all slaves should be freed in such states as were in rebellion against the United States on January 1, 1863. The South continued in rebellion, and the proclamation went into effect on the first day of the new year.

BOSTON HYMN

[January 1, 1863]

The word of the Lord by night To the watching Pilgrims came, As they sat by the seaside, And filled their hearts with flame.

God said, I am tired of kings, I suffer them no more; Up to my ear the morning brings The outrage of the poor.

Think ye I made this ball A field of havoc and war, Where tyrants great and tyrants small Might harry the weak and poor?

My angel--his name is Freedom-- Choose him to be your king; He shall cut pathways east and west, And fend you with his wing.

Lo! I uncover the land, Which I hid of old time in the West, As the sculptor uncovers the statue When he has wrought his best;

I show Columbia, of the rocks Which dip their foot in the seas, And soar to the air-borne flocks Of clouds and the boreal fleece.

I will divide my goods; Call in the wretch and slave; None shall rule but the humble, And none but Toil shall have.

I will have never a noble, No lineage counted great; Fishers and choppers and ploughmen Shall constitute a state.

Go, cut down trees in the forest And trim the straightest boughs; Cut down trees in the forest And build me a wooden house.

Call the people together, The young men and the sires, The digger in the harvest-field, Hireling and him that hires;

And here in a pine state-house They shall choose men to rule In every needful faculty, In church and state and school.

Lo, now! if these poor men Can govern the land and sea, And make just laws below the sun, As planets faithful be.

And ye shall succor men; 'Tis nobleness to serve; Help them who cannot help again: Beware from right to swerve.

I break your bonds and masterships, And I unchain the slave: Free be his heart and hand henceforth As wind and wandering wave.

I cause from every creature His proper good to flow; As much as he is and doeth, So much he shall bestow.

But, laying hands on another, To coin his labor and sweat, He goes in pawn to his victim For eternal years in debt.

To-day unbind the captive, So only are ye unbound; Lift up a people from the dust, Trump of their rescue, sound!

Pay ransom to the owner And fill the bag to the brim. Who is the owner? The slave is owner And ever was. Pay him.

O North! give him beauty for rags, And honor, O South! for his shame; Nevada! coin thy golden crags With Freedom's image and name.

Up! and the dusky race That sat in darkness long,-- Be swift their feet as antelopes, And as behemoth strong.

Come, East and West and North, By races, as snowflakes, And carry my purpose forth, Which neither halts nor shakes.

My will fulfilled shall be, For, in daylight or in dark, My thunderbolt has eyes to see His way home to the mark.

RALPH WALDO EMERSON.

THE PROCLAMATION

[January 1, 1863]

Saint Patrick, slave to Milcho of the herds Of Ballymena, wakened with these words: "Arise, and flee Out from the land of bondage, and be free!"

Glad as a soul in pain, who hears from heaven The angels singing of his sins forgiven, And, wondering, sees His prison opening to their golden keys,

He rose a man who laid him down a slave, Shook from his locks the ashes of the grave, And outward trod Into the glorious liberty of God.

He cast the symbols of his shame away; And, passing where the sleeping Milcho lay, Though back and limb Smarted with wrong, he prayed, "God pardon him!"

So went he forth; but in God's time he came To light on Uilline's hills a holy flame; And, dying, gave The land a saint that lost him as a slave.

O dark, sad millions, patiently and dumb Waiting for God, your hour, at last, has come, And freedom's song Breaks the long silence of your night of wrong!

Arise and flee! shake off the vile restraint Of ages; but, like Ballymena's saint, The oppressor spare, Heap only on his head the coals of prayer.

Go forth, like him! like him return again, To bless the land whereon in bitter pain Ye toiled at first, And heal with freedom what your slavery cursed.

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The Emancipation Proclamation was received with little enthusiasm except in New England, and early in 1863 certain politicians proposed to form a new Union, excluding the New England states because of their hostility to slavery and consequent obnoxiousness to the South.

TREASON'S LAST DEVICE

[January 19, 1863]

"Who deserves greatness Deserves your hate.... Yon common cry of curs, whose breath I loathe As reek o' the rotten fens."

CORIOLANUS.

"Hark! hark! the dogs do bark."

NURSERY RHYME.

Sons of New England, in the fray, Do you hear the clamor behind your back? Do you hear the yelping of Blanche and Tray? Sweetheart, and all the mongrel pack? Girded well with her ocean crags, Little our mother heeds their noise; Her eyes are fixed on crimsoned flags: But you--do you hear it, Yankee boys?

Do you hear them say that the patriot fire Burns on her altars too pure and bright, To the darkened heavens leaping higher, Though drenched with the blood of every fight? That in the light of its searching flame Treason and tyrants stand revealed, And the yielding craven is put to shame On Capitol floor or foughten field?

Do you hear the hissing voice, which saith That she--who bore through all the land The lyre of Freedom, the torch of Faith, And young Invention's mystic wand-- Should gather her skirts and dwell apart, With not one of her sisters to share her fate,-- A Hagar, wandering sick at heart? A pariah, bearing the Nation's hate?

Sons, who have peopled the distant West, And planted the Pilgrim vine anew, Where, by a richer soil carest, It grows as ever its parent grew,-- Say, do you hear,--while the very bells Of your churches ring with her ancient voice, And the song of your children sweetly tells How true was the land of your fathers' choice,--

Do you hear the traitors who bid you speak The word that shall sever the sacred tie? And ye, who dwell by the golden Peak, Has the subtle whisper glided by? Has it crost the immemorial plains To coasts where the gray Pacific roars, And the Pilgrim blood in the people's veins Is pure as the wealth of their mountain ores?

Spirits of sons who, side by side, In a hundred battles fought and fell, Whom now no East and West divide, In the isles where the shades of heroes dwell,-- Say, has it reached your glorious rest, And ruffled the calm which crowns you there,-- The shame that recreants have confest The plot that floats in the troubled air?

Sons of New England, here and there, Wherever men are still holding by The honor our fathers left so fair,-- Say, do you hear the cowards' cry? Crouching among her grand old crags, Lightly our mother heeds their noise, With her fond eyes fixed on distant flags; But you--do you hear it, Yankee boys?

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

On January 31, 1865, Congress adopted an amendment to the constitution forever abolishing slavery in the United States. On December 18, 1865, it was announced that the amendment had been ratified by the requisite number of states.

LAUS DEO!

On hearing the bells ring on the passage of the constitutional amendment abolishing slavery.

It is done! Clang of bell and roar of gun Send the tidings up and down. How the belfries rock and reel! How the great guns, peal on peal, Fling the joy from town to town!

Ring, O bells! Every stroke exulting tells Of the burial hour of crime. Loud and long, that all may hear, Ring for every listening ear Of Eternity and Time!

Let us kneel: God's own voice is in that peal, And this spot is holy ground. Lord, forgive us! What are we, That our eyes this glory see, That our ears have heard the sound!

For the Lord On the whirlwind is abroad; In the earthquake He has spoken; He has smitten with His thunder The iron walls asunder, And the gates of brass are broken!

Loud and long Lift the old exulting song; Sing with Miriam by the sea, He has cast the mighty down; Horse and rider sink and drown; "He hath triumphed gloriously!"

Did we dare, In our agony of prayer, Ask for more than He has done? When was ever His right hand Over any time or land Stretched as now beneath the sun?

How they pale, Ancient myth and song and tale, In this wonder of our days, When the cruel rod of war Blossoms white with righteous law And the wrath of man is praise!

Blotted out! All within and all about Shall a fresher life begin; Freer breathe the universe As it rolls its heavy curse On the dead and buried sin!

It is done! In the circuit of the sun Shall the sound thereof go forth. It shall bid the sad rejoice, It shall give the dumb a voice, It shall belt with joy the earth!

Ring and swing, Bells of joy! On morning's wing Send the song of praise abroad! With a sound of broken chains Tell the nations that He reigns, Who alone is Lord and God!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

CHAPTER VIII

THE "GRAND ARMY'S" SECOND CAMPAIGN

After its defeat at Fredericksburg, the Grand Army of the Potomac had gone into winter quarters. General Joseph Hooker was appointed to command it and found it weak and shaken. Meanwhile, the Confederate cavalry was busy, especially the guerrillas under John S. Mosby, who, in March, 1863, made a daring and successful raid upon the Union lines.

MOSBY AT HAMILTON

[March 16, 1863]

Down Loudon Lanes, with swinging reins And clash of spur and sabre, And bugling of the battle horn, Six score and eight we rode at morn, Six score and eight of Southern born, All tried in love and labor.

Full in the sun at Hamilton, We met the South's invaders; Who, over fifteen hundred strong, 'Mid blazing homes had marched along All night, with Northern shout and song To crush the rebel raiders.

Down Loudon Lanes, with streaming manes, We spurred in wild March weather; And all along our war-scarred way The graves of Southern heroes lay, Our guide-posts to revenge that day, As we rode grim together.

Old tales still tell some miracle Of saints in holy writing-- But who shall say while hundreds fled Before the few that Mosby led, Unless the noblest of our dead Charged with us then when fighting?

While Yankee cheers still stunned our ears, Of troops at Harper's Ferry, While Sheridan led on his Huns, And Richmond rocked to roaring guns, We felt the South still had some sons She would not scorn to bury.

MADISON CAWEIN.

A few days after Mosby's exploit, a desperately contested battle occurred at Kelly's Ford, Va., when the National troops under General W. W. Averill attacked and were defeated by a Confederate force under General Fitzhugh Lee. Among the Confederate dead was General John Pelham.

JOHN PELHAM

[March 17, 1863]

Just as the spring came laughing through the strife, With all its gorgeous cheer, In the bright April of historic life, Fell the great cannoneer.

The wondrous lulling of a hero's breath His bleeding country weeps; Hushed in the alabaster arms of Death, Our young Marcellus sleeps.

Nobler and grander than the Child of Rome Curbing his chariot steeds, The knightly scion of a Southern home Dazzled the land with deeds.

Gentlest and bravest in the battle-brunt, The champion of the truth, He bore his banner to the very front Of our immortal youth.

A clang of sabres 'mid Virginian snow, The fiery pang of shells,-- And there's a wail of immemorial woe In Alabama dells.

The pennon drops that led the sacred band Along the crimson field; The meteor blade sinks from the nerveless hand Over the spotless shield.

We gazed and gazed upon that beauteous face; While round the lips and eyes, Couched in their marble slumber, flashed the grace Of a divine surprise.

O mother of a blessed soul on high! Thy tears may soon be shed; Think of thy boy with princes of the sky Among the Southern dead!

How must he smile on this dull world beneath, Fevered with swift renown,-- He, with the martyr's amaranthine wreath Twining the victor's crown!

JAMES RYDER RANDALL.

By the middle of April, 1863, Hooker had his army in shape to advance, and on the 28th began to cross the Rappahannock for the purpose of attacking Lee, who held a strong position in the rear of Fredericksburg. On April 30 Hooker's army was all across and bivouacked that night at Chancellorsville.

HOOKER'S ACROSS

[May 1, 1863]

Hooker's across! Hooker's across! Standards and guidons and lance-pennons toss Over the land where he points with his blade, Bristle the hill-top, and fill up the glade. Who would not follow a leader whose blood Has swelled, like our own, the battle's red flood? Who bore what we suffered, our wound and our pain,-- Bore them with patience, and dares them again? Hooker's across!

Hooker's across! Hooker's across! River of death, you shall make up our loss! Out of your channel we summon each soul, Over whose body your dark billows roll; Up from your borders we summon the dead, From valleys and hills where they struggled and bled, To joy in the vengeance the traitors shall feel At the roar of our guns and the rush of our steel! Hooker's across!

Hooker's across! Hooker's across! Fears to the wind, with our standards, we toss, Moving together, straight on, with one breath, Down to the outburst of passion and death. Oh, in the depths of our spirits we know If we fail now in the face of the foe, Flee from the field with our flag soiled and dim, We may return, but 'twill not be with him! Hooker's across!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

Lee at once prepared to fight, and a little past midnight on May 1, 1863, he put Stonewall Jackson's column in motion toward Chancellorsville. Jackson had long since proved himself one of the South's most able generals, and his command had been increased to thirty-three thousand men, every one of whom fairly idolized him.

STONEWALL JACKSON'S WAY

Come, stack arms, men! Pile on the rails, Stir up the camp-fire bright; No growling if the canteen fails, We'll make a roaring night. Here Shenandoah brawls along, There burly Blue Ridge echoes strong, To swell the Brigade's rousing song Of "Stonewall Jackson's way."

We see him now--the queer slouched hat Cocked o'er his eye askew; The shrewd, dry smile; the speech so pat, So calm, so blunt, so true. The "Blue-Light Elder" knows 'em well; Says he, "That's Banks--he's fond of shell; Lord save his soul! we'll give him--" well! That's "Stonewall Jackson's way."

Silence! ground arms! kneel all! caps off! Old Massa's goin' to pray. Strangle the fool that dares to scoff! Attention! it's his way. Appealing from his native sod, _In forma pauperis_ to God: "Lay bare Thine arm; stretch forth Thy rod! Amen!" That's "Stonewall's way."

He's in the saddle now. Fall in! Steady! the whole brigade! Hill's at the ford, cut off; we'll win His way out, ball and blade! What matter if our shoes are worn? What matter if our feet are torn? "Quick step! we're with him before morn!" That's "Stonewall Jackson's way."

The sun's bright lances rout the mists Of morning, and, by George! Here's Longstreet, struggling in the lists, Hemmed in an ugly gorge. Pope and his Dutchmen, whipped before; "Bay'nets and grape!" hear Stonewall roar; "Charge, Stuart! Pay off Ashby's score!" In "Stonewall Jackson's way."

Ah! Maiden, wait and watch and yearn For news of Stonewall's band! Ah! Widow, read, with eyes that burn, That ring upon thy hand. Ah! Wife, sew on, pray on, hope on; Thy life shall not be all forlorn; The foe had better ne'er been born That gets in "Stonewall's way."

JOHN WILLIAMSON PALMER.

The battle began early in the morning and the Union army was soon forced to take refuge behind its works and assume the defensive. The Confederates also paused, waiting for reinforcements. The men slept on their arms that night, and arose at dawn, ready to renew the conflict.

But the Confederates did not attack until late in the afternoon. Jackson had made a long flanking movement, and just as twilight fell, he burst from the woods in overwhelming force and routed the Federal right wing. For an instant it seemed that all was lost, but at this critical moment the Eighth Pennsylvania cavalry got in touch with the Confederate flank and charged.

KEENAN'S CHARGE

[May 2, 1863]

The sun had set; The leaves with dew were wet-- Down fell a bloody dusk On the woods, that second of May, Where "Stonewall's" corps, like a beast of prey, Tore through with angry tusk.

"They've trapped us, boys!" Rose from our flank a voice. With rush of steel and smoke On came the rebels straight, Eager as love and wild as hate; And our line reeled and broke;

Broke and fled. Not one stayed,--but the dead! With curses, shrieks, and cries, Horses and wagons and men Tumbled back through the shuddering glen, And above us the fading skies.

There's one hope, still,-- Those batteries parked on the hill! "Battery, wheel!" ('mid the roar), "Pass pieces; fix prolonge to fire Retiring. Trot!" In the panic dire A bugle rings "Trot!"--and no more.

The horses plunged, The cannon lurched and lunged, To join the hopeless rout. But suddenly rose a form Calmly in front of the human storm, With a stern commanding shout:

"Align those guns!" (We knew it was Pleasanton's.) The cannoneers bent to obey, And worked with a will at his word, And the black guns moved as if _they_ had heard. But, ah, the dread delay!

"To wait is crime; O God, for ten minutes' time!" The general looked around. There Keenan sat, like a stone, With his three hundred horse alone, Less shaken than the ground.

"Major, your men?" "Are soldiers, general." "Then, Charge, major! Do your best; Hold the enemy back at all cost, Till my guns are placed;--else the army is lost. You die to save the rest!"

By the shrouded gleam of the western skies, Brave Keenan looked into Pleasanton's eyes For an instant--clear, and cool, and still; Then, with a smile, he said: "I will."

"Cavalry, charge!" Not a man of them shrank. Their sharp, full cheer, from rank on rank, Rose joyously, with a willing breath,-- Rose like a greeting hail to death.

Then forward they sprang, and spurred, and clashed; Shouted the officers, crimson-sashed; Rode well the men, each brave as his fellow, In their faded coats of the blue and yellow; And above in the air, with an instinct true, Like a bird of war their pennon flew.

With clank of scabbards and thunder of steeds, And blades that shine like sunlit reeds, And strong brown faces bravely pale, For fear their proud attempt shall fail, Three hundred Pennsylvanians close On twice ten thousand gallant foes.

Line after line the troopers came To the edge of the wood that was ringed with flame; Rode in, and sabred, and shot,--and fell: Nor came one back his wounds to tell. And full in the midst rose Keenan, tall In the gloom, like a martyr awaiting his fall, While the circle-stroke of his sabre, swung 'Round his head, like a halo there, luminous hung.

Line after line, aye, whole platoons, Struck dead in their saddles, of brave dragoons, By the maddened horses were onward borne And into the vortex flung, trampled and torn; As Keenan fought with his men, side by side. So they rode, till there were no more to ride.

But over them, lying there shattered and mute, What deep echo rolls? 'Tis a death-salute From the cannon in place; for, heroes, you braved Your fate not in vain; the army was saved!

Over them now,--year following year,-- Over their graves the pine-cones fall, And the whippoorwill chants his spectre-call; But they stir not again; they raise no cheer: They have ceased. But their glory shall never cease, Nor their light be quenched in the light of peace. The rush of their charge is resounding still, That saved the army at Chancellorsville.

GEORGE PARSONS LATHROP.

The regiment was greatly outnumbered, and was hurled back terribly shattered, Major Peter Keenan being among the killed. But the Confederate advance had been checked long enough for Pleasanton to get his artillery into position, and he opened with deadly effect.

The Confederates paused in the face of the terrible fire, and Jackson and his staff pushed forward on a personal reconnoissance. As he was returning to his lines, he and his companions were mistaken for Union troops by his own men and were fired upon. Jackson fell, pierced by three bullets.

"THE BRIGADE MUST NOT KNOW, SIR!"

[May 2, 1863]

"Who've ye got there?"--"Only a dying brother, Hurt in the front just now." "Good boy! he'll do. Somebody tell his mother Where he was killed, and how."

"Whom have you there?"--"A crippled courier, Major, Shot by mistake, we hear. He was with Stonewall." "Cruel work they've made here; Quick with him to the rear!"

"Well, who comes next?"--"Doctor, speak low, speak low, sir; Don't let the men find out! It's Stonewall!"--"God!"--"The brigade must not know, sir, While there's a foe about!"

Whom have we here--shrouded in martial manner, Crowned with a martyr's charm? A grand dead hero, in a living banner, Born of his heart and arm:

The heart whereon his cause hung--see how clingeth That banner to his bier! The arm wherewith his cause struck--hark! how ringeth His trumpet in their rear!

What have we left? His glorious inspiration, His prayers in council met. Living, he laid the first stones of a nation; And dead, he builds it yet.

Early on the morning of Sunday, May 3, 1863, the Confederates again attacked, and after two days' heavy fighting, drove the Union army back across the river, with a loss of seventeen thousand men. But the Confederate victory was almost outweighed by the loss of Stonewall Jackson, who died May 10.

STONEWALL JACKSON

[May 10, 1863]

Not midst the lightning of the stormy fight, Nor in the rush upon the vandal foe, Did kingly Death, with his resistless might, Lay the great leader low.

His warrior soul its earthly shackles broke In the full sunshine of a peaceful town; When all the storm was hushed, the trusty oak That propped our cause went down.

Though his alone the blood that flecks the ground, Recalling all his grand, heroic deeds, Freedom herself is writhing in the wound, And all the country bleeds.

He entered not the nation's Promised Land At the red belching of the cannon's mouth, But broke the House of Bondage with his hand-- The Moses of the South!

O gracious God! not gainless is the loss: A glorious sunbeam gilds thy sternest frown; And while his country staggers 'neath the Cross, He rises with the Crown!

HENRY LYNDEN FLASH.

THE DYING WORDS OF STONEWALL JACKSON[10]

"Order A. P. Hill to prepare for battle." "Tell Major Hawks to advance the commissary train." "Let us cross the river and rest in the shade."

The stars of Night contain the glittering Day And rain his glory down with sweeter grace Upon the dark World's grand, enchanted face-- All loth to turn away.

And so the Day, about to yield his breath, Utters the stars unto the listening Night, To stand for burning fare-thee-wells of light Said on the verge of death.

O hero-life that lit us like the sun! O hero-words that glittered like the stars And stood and shone above the gloomy wars When the hero-life was done!

The phantoms of a battle came to dwell I' the fitful vision of his dying eyes-- Yet even in battle-dreams, he sends supplies To those he loved so well.

His army stands in battle-line arrayed: His couriers fly: all's done: now God decide! --And not till then saw he the Other Side Or would accept the shade.

Thou Land whose sun is gone, thy stars remain! Still shine the words that miniature his deeds. O thrice-beloved, where'er thy great heart bleeds, Solace hast thou for pain!

SIDNEY LANIER.

[10] From Poems by Sidney Lanier; copyright, 1884, 1891, by Mary D. Lanier; published by Charles Scribner's Sons.

UNDER THE SHADE OF THE TREES

What are the thoughts that are stirring his breast? What is the mystical vision he sees? --"Let us pass over the river, and rest Under the shade of the trees."

Has he grown sick of his toils and his tasks? Sighs the worn spirit for respite or ease? Is it a moment's cool halt that he asks Under the shade of the trees?

Is it the gurgle of waters whose flow Ofttime has come to him, borne on the breeze, Memory listens to, lapsing so low, Under the shade of the trees?

Nay--though the rasp of the flesh was so sore, Faith, that had yearnings far keener than these, Saw the soft sheen of the Thitherward Shore Under the shade of the trees;--

Caught the high psalms of ecstatic delight-- Heard the harps harping, like soundings of seas-- Watched earth's assoilèd ones walking in white Under the shade of the trees.

Oh, was it strange he should pine for release, Touched to the soul with such transports as these,-- He who so needed the balsam of peace, Under the shade of the trees?

Yea, it was noblest for him--it was best (Questioning naught of our Father's decrees), There to pass over the river and rest Under the shade of the trees!

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

Lee waited only to rest his forces and then, for the second time, invaded Maryland, crossing the Shenandoah at Front Royal. On June 13, 1863, the army appeared before Winchester, scattered the Union force stationed there, and swept resistlessly down the Shenandoah Valley, raiding into Pennsylvania as far as Chambersburg.

THE BALLAD OF ISHMAEL DAY

[June, 1863]

One summer morning a daring band Of Rebels rode into Maryland, Over the prosperous, peaceful farms, Sending terror and strange alarms, The clatter of hoofs and the clang of arms.

Fresh from the South, where the hungry pine They ate like Pharaoh's starving kine; They swept the land like devouring surge, And left their path, to the farthest verge, Bare as the track of the locust scourge.

"The Rebels are coming!" far and near Rang the tidings of dread and fear; Some paled and cowered and sought to hide; Some stood erect in their fearless pride; And

women shuddered and children cried.

But others--vipers in human form Stinging the bosom that kept them warm-- Welcomed with triumph the thievish band, Hurried to offer the friendly hand, As the Rebels rode into Maryland.

Made them merry with food and wine, Clad them in garments, rich and fine, For rags and hunger to make amends, Flattered them, praised them with selfish ends; "Leave us scathless, for we are friends."

Could traitors trust a traitor? No! Little they favor friend or foe, But gathered the cattle the farms across, Flinging back, with a scornful toss, "If ye are friends ye can bear the loss!"

Flushed with triumph, and wine, and prey, They neared the dwelling of Ishmael Day, A sturdy veteran, gray and old, With heart of a patriot, firm and bold, Strong and steadfast--unbribed, unsold.

And Ishmael Day, his brave head bare, His white locks tossed by the morning air, Fearless of danger, or death, or scars, Went out to raise by the farm-yard bars The dear old flag of the stripes and stars.

Proudly, steadily, up it flew, Gorgeous with crimson, white and blue, His withered hand as he shook it freer, May have trembled, but not with fear, While shouting the rebels drew more near.

"Halt!" They had seen the hated sign Floating free from old Ishmael's line-- "Lower that rag!" was their wrathful cry; "Never!" rung Ishmael Day's reply, "Fire if it please you--I can but die."

One, with a loud, defiant laugh, Left his comrades and neared the staff. "Down!" came the fearless patriot's cry, "Dare to lower that flag and die! One must bleed for it--you or I."

But caring not for the stern command, He drew the halliards with daring hand; Ping! went the rifle ball--down he came, Under the flag he had tried to shame-- Old Ishmael Day took careful aim!

Seventy winters and three had shed Their snowy glories on Ishmael's head. Though cheeks may wither and locks grow gray, His fame shall be fresh and young alway-- Honor be to old Ishmael Day!

Hooker, meanwhile, was almost wholly in the dark concerning the position of Lee's army, until it was partially revealed to him on June 17, 1863, when Kilpatrick's cavalry charged and drove back the Confederate cavalry as it emerged from Ashby's Gap. Still he hesitated, and the whole of western Pennsylvania appeared to be at the mercy of the invaders.

RIDING WITH KILPATRICK

[June 17, 1863]

Dawn peered through the pines as we dashed at the ford; Afar the grim guns of the infantry roared; There were miles yet of dangerous pathway to pass, And Mosby might menace, and Stuart might mass; But we mocked every doubt, laughing danger to scorn, As we quaffed with a shout from the wine of the morn. Those who rode with Kilpatrick to valor were born!

How we chafed at delay! How we itched to be on! How we yearned for the fray where the battle-reek shone! It was _forward_, not _halt_, stirred the fire in our veins, When our horses' feet beat to the click of the reins; It was _charge_, not _retreat_, we were wonted to hear; It was _charge_, not _retreat_, that was sweet to the ear; Those who rode with Kilpatrick had never felt fear!

At last the word came, and troop tossed it to troop; Two squadrons deployed with a falcon-like swoop; While swiftly the others in echelons formed, For there, just ahead, was the line to be stormed. The trumpets rang out; there were guidons a-blow; The white summer sun set our sabres a-glow; Those who rode with Kilpatrick charged straight at the foe!

We swept like a whirlwind; we closed; at the shock The sky seemed to reel and the earth seemed to rock; Steel clashed upon steel with a deafening sound, While a redder than rose-stain encrimsoned the ground; If we gave back a space from the fierce pit of hell, We were rallied again by a voice like a bell. Those who rode with Kilpatrick rode valiantly well!

Rang sternly his orders from out of the wrack: _Re-form there, New Yorkers! You, "Harris Light," back! Come on, men of Maine! We will conquer or fall! Now, forward, boys, forward! and follow me all!_ A Bayard in boldness, a Sidney in grace, A lion to lead and a stag-hound to chase-- Those who rode with Kilpatrick looked Death in the face!

Though brave were our foemen, they faltered and fled; Yet that was no marvel when such as he led! Long ago, long ago, was that desperate day! Long ago, long ago, strove the Blue and the Gray! Praise God that the red sun of battle is set! That our hand-clasp is loyal and loving--and yet, Those who rode with Kilpatrick can never forget!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

This sudden and seemingly irresistible invasion created panic throughout the North. Troops were hurried forward, and Hooker at last started in pursuit with a hundred thousand men, but was relieved of command on June 27, 1863, and General George G. Meade appointed in his place. Lee was concentrating his army at Gettysburg, and his advance guard got into touch with the Union forces on the morning of July 1. The first day's fighting ended in the Federals being swept backward to their position on Cemetery Hill. The battle continued with undiminished fury throughout the second day; and on the third, Lee determined to renew the assault and Meade decided to stay and receive it. The entire morning was consumed in preparation. Then the Confederates charged in a line three miles long, with General George Pickett and his Virginians in the van. A terrific struggle followed, ending in the repulse of the Confederates, who withdrew in good order from the field.

GETTYSBURG

[July 3, 1863]

Wave, wave your glorious battle-flags, brave soldiers of the North, And from the field your arms have won to-day go proudly forth! For none, O comrades dear and leal,--from whom no ills could part, Through the long years of hopes and fears, the nation's constant heart,-- Men who have driven so oft the foe, so oft have striven in vain, Yet ever in the perilous hour have crossed his path again,-- At last we have our hearts' desire, from them we met have wrung A victory that round the world shall long be told and sung! It was the memory of the past that bore us through the fray, That gave the grand old Army strength to conquer on this day!

O now forget how dark and red Virginia's rivers flow, The Rappahannock's tangled wilds, the glory and the woe; The fever-hung encampments, where our dying knew full sore How sweet the north-wind to the cheek it soon shall cool no more; The fields we fought, and gained, and lost; the lowland sun and rain That wasted us, that bleached the bones of our unburied slain! There was no lack of foes to meet, of deaths to die no lack, And all the hawks of heaven learned to follow on our track; But henceforth, hovering southward, their flight shall mark afar The paths of yon retreating hosts that shun the northern star.

At night, before the closing fray, when all the front was still, We lay in bivouac along the cannon-crested hill. Ours was the dauntless Second Corps; and many a soldier knew How sped the fight, and sternly thought of what was yet to do. Guarding the centre there, we lay, and talked with bated breath Of Buford's stand beyond the town, of gallant Reynold's death, Of cruel retreats through pent-up streets by murderous volleys swept,-- How well the Stone, the Iron, Brigades their bloody outposts kept: 'Twas for the Union, for the Flag, they perished, heroes all, And we swore to conquer in the end, or even like them to fall.

And passed from mouth to mouth the tale of that grim day just done, The fight by Round Top's craggy spur,--of all the deadliest one; It saved the left: but on the right they pressed us back too well, And like a field in Spring the ground was ploughed with shot and shell. There was the ancient graveyard, its hummocks crushed and red, And there, between them, side by side, the wounded and the dead: The mangled corpses fallen above,--the peaceful dead below, Laid in their graves, to slumber here, a score of years ago; It seemed their waking, wandering shades were asking of our slain, What brought such hideous tumult now where they so still had lain!

Bright rose the sun of Gettysburg that morrow morning-tide, And call of trump and roll of drum from height to height replied. Hark! from the east already goes up the rattling din; The Twelfth Corps, winning back their ground, right well the day begin! They whirl fierce Ewell from their front! Now we of the Second pray, As right and left the brunt have borne, the centre might to-day. But all was still from hill to hill for many a breathless hour, While for the coming battle-shock Lee gathered in his power; And back and forth our leaders rode, who knew not rest or fear, And along the lines, where'er they came, went up the ringing cheer.

'Twas past the hour of nooning; the Summer skies were blue; Behind the covering timber the foe was hid from view; So fair and sweet with waving wheat the pleasant valley lay, It brought to mind our Northern homes and meadows far away; When the whole western ridge at once was fringed with fire and smoke; Against our lines from sevenscore guns the dreadful tempest broke! Then loud our batteries answer, and far along the crest, And to and fro the roaring bolts are driven east and west; Heavy and dark around us glooms the stifling sulphur-cloud, And the cries of mangled men and horse go up beneath its shroud.

The guns are still: the end is nigh: we grasp our arms anew; O now let every heart be stanch and every aim be true! For look! from yonder wood that skirts the valley's further marge, The flower of all the Southern host move to the final charge. By Heaven! it is a fearful sight to see their double rank Come with a hundred battle-flags,--a mile from flank to flank! Tramping the grain to earth, they come, ten thousand men abreast; Their standards wave,--their hearts are brave,--they hasten not, nor rest, But close the gaps our cannon make, and onward press, and nigher, And, yelling at our very front, again pour in their fire!

Now burst our sheeted lightnings forth, now all our wrath has vent! They die, they wither; through and through their wavering lines are rent. But these are gallant, desperate men, of our own race and land. Who charge anew, and welcome death, and fight us hand to hand: Vain, vain! give way, as well ye may--the crimson die is cast! Their bravest leaders bite the dust, their strength is failing fast; They yield, they turn, they fly the field: we smite them as they run; Their arms, their colors are our spoil; the furious fight is done! Across the plain we follow far and backward push the fray; Cheer! cheer! the grand old Army at last has won the day!

Hurrah! the day has won the cause! No gray-clad host henceforth Shall come with fire and sword to tread the highways of the North! 'Twas such a flood as when ye see along the Atlantic shore, The great Spring-tide roll grandly in with swelling surge and roar: It seems no wall can stay its leap or balk its wild desire Beyond the bound that Heaven hath fixed to higher mount, and higher; But now, when whitest lifts its crest, most loud its billows call, Touched by the Power that led them on, they fall, and fall, and fall. Even thus, unstayed upon his course, to Gettysburg the foe His legions led, and fought, and fled, and might no further go.

Full many a dark-eyed Southern girl shall weep her lover dead; But with a price the fight was ours,--we too have tears to shed! The bells that peal our triumph forth anon shall toll the brave, Above whose heads the cross must stand, the hillside grasses wave! Alas! alas! the trampled grass shall thrive another year, The blossoms on the apple-boughs with each new Spring appear, But when our patriot-soldiers fall, Earth gives them up to God; Though their souls rise in clearer skies, their forms are as the sod; Only their names and deeds are ours,--but, for a century yet, The dead who fell at Gettysburg the land shall not forget.

God send us peace! and where for aye the loved and lost recline Let fall, O South, your leaves of palm,--O North, your sprigs of pine! But when, with every ripened year, we keep the harvest-home, And to the dear Thanksgiving-feast our sons and

daughters come,-- When children's children throng the board in the old homestead spread, And the bent soldier of these wars is seated at the head, Long, long the lads shall listen to hear the gray-beard tell Of those who fought at Gettysburg and stood their ground so well: "'Twas for the Union and the Flag," the veteran shall say, "Our grand old Army held the ridge, and won that glorious day!"

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

THE HIGH TIDE AT GETTYSBURG

[July 3, 1863]

A cloud possessed the hollow field, The gathering battle's smoky shield: Athwart the gloom the lightning flashed, And through the cloud some horsemen dashed, And from the heights the thunder pealed.

Then, at the brief command of Lee, Moved out that matchless infantry, With Pickett leading grandly down, To rush against the roaring crown Of those dread heights of destiny.

Far heard above the angry guns, A cry of tumult runs: The voice that rang through Shiloh's woods, And Chickamauga's solitudes: The fierce South cheering on her sons!

Ah, how the withering tempest blew Against the front of Pettigrew! A Khamsin wind that scorched and singed, Like that infernal flame that fringed The British squares at Waterloo!

A thousand fell where Kemper led; A thousand died where Garnett bled; In blinding flame and strangling smoke, The remnant through the batteries broke, And crossed the works with Armistead.

"Once more in Glory's van with me!" Virginia cried to Tennessee: "We two together, come what may, Shall stand upon those works to-day!" The reddest day in history.

Brave Tennessee! In reckless way Virginia heard her comrade say: "Close round this rent and riddled rag!" What time she set her battle flag Amid the guns of Doubleday.

But who shall break the guards that wait Before the awful face of Fate? The tattered standards of the South Were shrivelled at the cannon's mouth, And all her hopes were desolate.

In vain the Tennesseean set His breast against the bayonet; In vain Virginia charged and raged, A tigress in her wrath uncaged, Till all the hill was red and wet!

Above the bayonets, mixed and crossed, Men saw a gray, gigantic ghost Receding through the battle-cloud, And heard across the tempest loud The death-cry of a nation lost!

The brave went down! Without disgrace They leaped to Ruin's red embrace; They only heard Fame's thunders wake, And saw the dazzling sunburst break In smiles on

Glory's bloody face!

They fell, who lifted up a hand And bade the sun in heaven to stand; They smote and fell, who set the bars Against the progress of the stars, And stayed the march of Motherland.

They stood, who saw the future come On through the fight's delirium; They smote and stood, who held the hope Of nations on that slippery slope, Amid the cheers of Christendom!

God lives! He forged the iron will, That clutched and held that trembling hill! God lives and reigns! He built and lent The heights for Freedom's battlement, Where floats her flag in triumph still!

Fold up the banners! Smelt the guns! Love rules. Her gentler purpose runs. A mighty mother turns in tears, The pages of her battle years, Lamenting all her fallen sons!

WILL HENRY THOMPSON.

GETTYSBURG

[July 1, 2, 3, 1863]

There was no union in the land, Though wise men labored long With links of clay and ropes of sand To bind the right and wrong.

There was no temper in the blade That once could cleave a chain; Its edge was dull with touch of trade And clogged with rust of gain.

The sand and clay must shrink away Before the lava tide: By blows and blood and fire assay The metal must be tried.

Here sledge and anvil met, and when The furnace fiercest roared, God's undiscerning workingmen Reforged His people's sword.

Enough for them to ask and know The moment's duty clear-- The bayonets flashed it there below, The guns proclaimed it here:

To do and dare, and die at need, But while life lasts, to fight-- For right or wrong a simple creed, But simplest for the right.

They faltered not who stood that day And held this post of dread; Nor cowards they who wore the gray Until the gray was red.

For every wreath the victor wears The vanquished half may claim; And every monument declares A common pride and fame.

We raise no altar stones to Hate, Who never bowed to Fear: No province crouches at our gate, To shame our triumph here.

Here standing by a dead wrong's grave The blindest now may see, The blow that liberates the slave But sets the master free!

When ills beset the nation's life Too dangerous to bear, The sword must be the surgeon's knife, Too merciful to spare.

O Soldier of our common land, 'Tis thine to bear that blade Loose in the sheath, or firm in hand, But ever unafraid.

When foreign foes assail our right, One nation trusts to thee-- To wield it well in worthy fight-- The sword of Meade and Lee!

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

Lee commenced his retreat next morning, and was able to gain the Potomac, with his whole train, virtually without molestation. But the North was too rejoiced by the withdrawal of the invaders to mourn at their escape.

THE BATTLE-FIELD

GETTYSBURG

Those were the conquered, still too proud to yield-- These were the victors, yet too poor for shrouds! Here scarlet Slaughter slew her countless crowds Heaped high in ranks where'er the hot guns pealed. The brooks that wandered through the battlefield Flowed slowly on in ever-reddening streams; Here where the rank wheat waves and golden gleams, The dreadful squadrons, thundering, charged and reeled. Within the blossoming clover many a bone Lying unsepulchred, has bleached to white; While gentlest hearts that only love had known, Have ached with anguish at the awful sight; And War's gaunt Vultures that were lean, have grown Gorged in the darkness in a single night!

LLOYD MIFFLIN.

Among the thousands who took part in that terrific three days' struggle none was more remarkable than old John Burns, a veteran of the War of 1812 and of the Mexican War, who, rejected at the outbreak of the Civil War on account of his age, nevertheless shouldered his rifle and helped repel the invaders, when they approached his home at Gettysburg.

JOHN BURNS OF GETTYSBURG

Have you heard the story that gossips tell Of Burns of Gettysburg? No? Ah, well: Brief is the glory that hero earns, Briefer the story of poor John Burns: He was the fellow who won renown,-- The only man who didn't back down When the rebels rode through his native town; But held his own in the fight next day, When all his townsfolk ran away. That was in July, sixty-three,-- The very day that General Lee, Flower of Southern chivalry, Baffled and beaten, backward reeled From a stubborn Meade and a barren field.

I might tell how, but the day before, John Burns stood at his cottage door, Looking down the village street, Where, in the shade of his peaceful vine, He heard the low of

his gathered kine, And felt their breath with incense sweet; Or I might say, when the sunset burned The old farm gable, he thought it turned The milk that fell like a babbling flood Into the milk-pail, red as blood! Or how he fancied the hum of bees Were bullets buzzing among the trees. But all such fanciful thoughts as these Were strange to a practical man like Burns, Who minded only his own concerns, Troubled no more by fancies fine Than one of his calm-eyed, long-tailed kine, Quite old-fashioned and matter-of-fact, Slow to argue, but quick to act. That was the reason, as some folks say, He fought so well on that terrible day.

And it was terrible. On the right Raged for hours the heady fight, Thundered the battery's double bass,-- Difficult music for men to face; While on the left--where now the graves Undulate like the living waves That all that day unceasing swept Up to the pits the rebels kept-- Round-shot ploughed the upland glades, Sown with bullets, reaped with blades; Shattered fences here and there Tossed their splinters in the air; The very trees were stripped and bare; The barns that once held yellow grain Were heaped with harvests of the slain; The cattle bellowed on the plain, The turkeys screamed with might and main, The brooding barn-fowl left their rest With strange shells bursting in each nest.

Just where the tide of battle turns, Erect and lonely, stood old John Burns. How do you think the man was dressed? He wore an ancient, long buff vest, Yellow as saffron,--but his best; And, buttoned over his manly breast, Was a bright blue coat with a rolling collar, And large gilt buttons,--size of a dollar,-- With tails that the country-folk called "swaller." He wore a broad-brimmed, bell-crowned hat, White as the locks on which it sat. Never had such a sight been seen For forty years on the village green, Since old John Burns was a country beau, And went to the "quiltings" long ago.

Close at his elbows all that day, Veterans of the Peninsula, Sunburnt and bearded, charged away; And striplings, downy of lip and chin,-- Clerks that the Home-Guard mustered in,-- Glanced, as they passed, at the hat he wore, Then at the rifle his right hand bore; And hailed him, from out their youthful lore, With scraps of a slangy repertoire: "How are you, White Hat?" "Put her through!" "Your head's level!" and "Bully for you!" Called him "Daddy,"--begged he'd disclose The name of his tailor who made his clothes, And what was the value he set on those; While Burns, unmindful of jeer or scoff, Stood there picking the rebels off,-- With his long brown rifle, and bell-crowned hat, And the swallow-tails they were laughing at.

'Twas but a moment, for that respect Which clothes all courage their voices checked; And something the wildest could understand Spake in the old man's strong right hand, And his corded throat, and the lurking frown Of his eyebrows under his old bell-crown; Until, as they gazed, there crept an awe Through the ranks in whispers, and some men saw, In the antique vestments and long white hair, The Past of the Nation in battle there; And some of the soldiers since declare That the gleam of his old white hat afar, Like the crested plume of the brave Navarre, That day was their oriflamme of war.

So raged the battle. You know the rest: How the rebels, beaten and backward pressed, Broke at the final charge and ran. At which John Burns--a practical man-- Shouldered his rifle, unbent his brows, And then went back to his bees and cows.

That is the story of old John Burns; This is the moral the reader learns: In fighting the battle, the question's whether You'll show a hat that's white, or a feather.

BRET HARTE.

Never was the Union nearer dissolution than it was on the eve of Gettysburg. A counter-revolution had been planned, but Lee was defeated and the plot failed. A force of four thousand raiders, under John H. Morgan, had dashed across Kentucky, into Indiana and Ohio, expecting support from the peace faction; but the result of Gettysburg spoiled all that, and Morgan and his men were surrounded and captured while trying to get back across the Ohio River.

KENTUCKY BELLE

Summer of 'sixty-three, sir, and Conrad was gone away-- Gone to the county-town, sir, to sell our first load of hay-- We lived in the log house yonder, poor as you've ever seen; Röschen there was a baby, and I was only nineteen.

Conrad, he took the oxen, but he left Kentucky Belle. How much we thought of Kentuck, I couldn't begin to tell-- Came from the Blue-Grass country; my father gave her to me When I rode North with Conrad, away from Tennessee.

Conrad lived in Ohio--a German he is, you know-- The house stood in broad corn-fields, stretching on, row after row. The old folks made me welcome; they were kind as kind could be; But I kept longing, longing, for the hills of Tennessee.

Oh! for a sight of water, the shadowed slope of a hill! Clouds that hang on the summit, a wind that never is still! But the level land went stretching away to meet the sky-- Never a rise, from north to south, to rest the weary eye!

From east to west no river to shine out under the moon, Nothing to make a shadow in the yellow afternoon: Only the breathless sunshine, as I looked out, all forlorn; Only the "rustle, rustle," as I walked among the corn.

When I fell sick with pining, we didn't wait any more, But moved away from the corn-lands, out to this river shore-- The Tuscarawas it's called, sir--off there's a hill, you see-- And now I've grown to like it next best to the Tennessee.

I was at work that morning. Some one came riding like mad Over the bridge and up the road--Farmer Rouf's little lad. Bareback he rode; he had no hat; he hardly stopped to say, "Morgan's men are coming, Frau; they're galloping on this way.

"I'm sent to warn the neighbors. He isn't a mile behind; He sweeps up all the horses--every horse that he can find. Morgan, Morgan the raider, and Morgan's terrible men, With bowie-knives and pistols, are galloping up the glen!"

The lad rode down the valley, and I stood still at the door; The baby laughed and prattled, playing with spools on the floor; Kentuck was out in the pasture; Conrad, my

man, was gone. Near, nearer, Morgan's men were galloping, galloping on!

Sudden I picked up baby, and ran to the pasture-bar. "Kentuck!" I called--"Kentucky!" She knew me ever so far! I led her down the gully that turns off there to the right, And tied her to the bushes; her head was just out of sight.

As I ran back to the log house, at once there came a sound-- The ring of hoofs, galloping hoofs, trembling over the ground-- Coming into the turnpike, out from the White-Woman Glen-- Morgan, Morgan the raider, and Morgan's terrible men.

As near they drew and nearer, my heart beat fast in alarm; But still I stood in the doorway with baby on my arm. They came; they passed; with spur and whip in haste they sped along-- Morgan, Morgan the raider, and his band, six hundred strong.

Weary they looked and jaded, riding through night and through day; Pushing on East to the river, many long miles away, To the border-strip where Virginia runs up into the West, And fording the Upper Ohio before they could stop to rest.

On like the wind they hurried, and Morgan rode in advance; Bright were his eyes like live coals, as he gave me a sideways glance; I was just breathing freely, after my choking pain, When the last one of the troopers suddenly drew his rein.

Frightened I was to death, sir; I scarce dared look in his face, As he asked for a drink of water, and glanced around the place. I gave him a cup and he smiled--'twas only a boy, you see; Faint and worn, with dim blue eyes; and he'd sailed on the Tennessee.

Only sixteen he was, sir--a fond mother's only son-- Off and away with Morgan before his life has begun! The damp drops stood on his temples--drawn was the boyish mouth; And I thought me of the mother waiting down in the South.

Oh! pluck was he to the backbone, and clear grit through and through; Boasted and bragged like a trooper, but the big words wouldn't do;-- The boy was dying, sir, dying, as plain as plain could be, Worn out by his ride with Morgan up from the Tennessee.

But when I told the laddie that I too was from the South, Water came in his dim eyes, and quivers around his mouth. "Do you know the Blue-Grass country?" he wistful began to say; Then swayed like a willow-sapling, and fainted dead away.

I had him into the log house, and worked and brought him to; I fed him and I coaxed him, as I thought his mother'd do; And when the lad grew better, and the noise in his head was gone, Morgan's men were miles away, galloping, galloping on.

"Oh, I must go," he muttered; "I must be up and away! Morgan--Morgan is waiting for me! Oh, what will Morgan say?" But I heard a sound of tramping and kept him back from the door-- The ringing sound of horses' hoofs that I had heard before.

And on, on, came the soldiers--the Michigan cavalry-- And fast they rode, and black they looked, galloping rapidly,-- They had followed hard on Morgan's track; they had followed day and night; But of Morgan and Morgan's raiders they had never caught a sight.

And rich Ohio sat startled through all those summer days; For strange, wild men were galloping over her broad highways-- Now here, now there, now seen, now gone, now north, now east, now west, Through river-valleys and corn-land farms, sweeping away her best.

A bold ride and a long ride! But they were taken at last. They almost reached the river by galloping hard and fast; But the boys in blue were upon them ere ever they gained the ford, And Morgan, Morgan the raider, laid down his terrible sword.

Well, I kept the boy till evening--kept him against his will-- But he was too weak to follow, and sat there pale and still. When it was cool and dusky--you'll wonder to hear me tell-- But I stole down to that gully, and brought up Kentucky Belle.

I kissed the star on her forehead--my pretty gentle lass-- But I knew that she'd be happy back in the old Blue Grass. A suit of clothes of Conrad's, with all the money I had, And Kentuck, pretty Kentuck, I gave to the worn-out lad.

I guided him to the southward as well as I knew how; The boy rode off with many thanks, and many a backward bow; And then the glow it faded, and my heart began to swell, As down the glen away she went, my lost Kentucky Belle!

When Conrad came in the evening, the moon was shining high; Baby and I were both crying--I couldn't tell him why-- But a battered suit of rebel gray was hanging on the wall, And a thin old horse, with drooping head, stood in Kentucky's stall.

Well, he was kind, and never once said a hard word to me; He knew I couldn't help it--'twas all for the Tennessee. But, after the war was over, just think what came to pass-- A letter, sir; and the two were safe back in the old Blue Grass.

The lad had got across the border, riding Kentucky Belle; And Kentuck she was thriving, and fat, and hearty, and well; He cared for her, and kept her, nor touched her with whip or spur. Ah! we've had many horses since, but never a horse like her!

CONSTANCE FENIMORE WOOLSON.

Part of the same plot was the draft riot which broke out in New York City on July 13, 1863. It lasted four days, and four hundred people were killed by the rioters. The draft was temporarily suspended, but was quietly resumed in August.

THE DRAFT RIOT

IN THE UNIVERSITY TOWER: NEW YORK, July, 1863

Is it the wind, the many-tongued, the weird, That cries in sharp distress about the eaves? Is it the wind whose gathering shout is heard With voice of peoples myriad like the leaves? Is it the wind? Fly to the casement, quick, And when the roar comes thick, Fling wide the sash, Await the crash!

Nothing. Some various solitary cries,-- Some sauntering woman's short hard laugh, Or honester, a dog's bark,--these arise From lamplit street up to this free flagstaff: Nothing remains of that low threatening sound; The wind raves not the eaves around. Clasp casement to,-- You heard not true.

Hark there again! a roar that holds a shriek! But not without--no, from below it comes: What pulses up from solid earth to wreck A vengeful word on towers and lofty domes? What angry booming doth the trembling ear, Glued to the stone wall, hear-- So deep, no air Its weight can bear?

Grieve! 'tis the voice of ignorance and vice,-- The rage of slaves who fancy they are free: Men who would keep men slaves at any price, Too blind their own black manacles to see. Grieve! 'tis that grisly spectre with a torch, Riot--that bloodies every porch, Hurls justice down And burns the town.

CHARLES DE KAY.

On November 19, 1863, a portion of the battle-field of Gettysburg was consecrated as a national military cemetery. It was there that President Lincoln's famous Gettysburg address, prepared almost on the spur of the moment, was delivered. He said:--

"Fourscore and seven years ago our fathers brought forth on this continent a new nation, conceived in liberty, and dedicated to the proposition that all men are created equal. Now we are engaged in a great civil war, testing whether that nation, or any nation so conceived and so dedicated, can long endure. We are met on a great battle-field of that war. We have come to dedicate a portion of that field as a final resting-place for those who here gave their lives that that nation might live. It is altogether fitting and proper that we should do this. But in a larger sense, we cannot dedicate, we cannot consecrate, we cannot hallow this ground. The brave men, living and dead, who struggled here, have consecrated it far above our poor power to add or detract. The world will little note, nor long remember, what we say here, but it can never forget what they did here. It is for us, the living, rather, to be dedicated here to the unfinished work which they who fought here have thus far so nobly advanced. It is rather for us to be here dedicated to the great task remaining before us;--that from these honored dead, we take increased devotion to that cause for which they gave the last full measure of devotion;--that we here highly resolve that these dead shall not have died in vain, that this nation, under God, shall have a new birth of freedom, and that government of the people, by the people, for the people, shall not perish from the earth."

LINCOLN AT GETTYSBURG

From the "Gettysburg Ode"

[November 19, 1863]

After the eyes that looked, the lips that spake Here, from the shadows of impending death, Those words of solemn breath, What voice may fitly break The silence, doubly hallowed, left by him? We can but bow the head, with eyes grown dim, And, as a Nation's litany, repeat The phrase his martyrdom hath made complete, Noble as then, but now more sadly sweet; "Let us, the Living, rather dedicate Ourselves to the unfinished work, which they Thus far advanced so nobly on its way, And save the perilled State! Let us, upon this field where they, the brave, Their last

full measure of devotion gave, Highly resolve they have not died in vain!-- That, under God, the Nation's later birth Of Freedom, and the people's gain Of their own Sovereignty, shall never wane And perish from the circle of the earth!" From such a perfect text, shall Song aspire To light her faded fire, And into wandering music turn Its virtue, simple, sorrowful, and stern? His voice all elegies anticipated; For, whatsoe'er the strain, We hear that one refrain: "We consecrate ourselves to them, the Consecrated!"

BAYARD TAYLOR.

CHAPTER IX

WITH GRANT ON THE MISSISSIPPI

Grant had a brief repose after his victories at Shiloh and Corinth; then he addressed himself to the capture of Vicksburg. The Confederates had made a second Gibraltar of the place, and so long as they held it had command of the Mississippi. Early in April, 1863, he collected his army at New Carthage, just below Vicksburg, and on the night of April 16, Porter's fleet ran past the batteries, the object of this perilous enterprise being to afford means for carrying the troops across the river and for covering the movement.

RUNNING THE BATTERIES

(As observed from the anchorage above Vicksburg, April, 1863)

A moonless night--a friendly one; A haze dimmed the shadowy shore As the first lampless boat slid silent on; Hist! and we spake no more; We but pointed, and stilly, to what we saw.

We felt the dew, and seemed to feel The secret like a burden laid. The first boat melts; and a second keel Is blent with the foliaged shade-- Their midnight rounds have the rebel officers made?

Unspied as yet. A third--a fourth-- Gunboat and transport in Indian file Upon the war-path, smooth from the North; But the watch may they hope to beguile? The manned river-batteries stretch far mile on mile.

A flame leaps out; they are seen; Another and another gun roars; We tell the course of the boats through the screen By each further fort that pours, And we guess how they jump from their beds on those shrouded shores.

Converging fires. We speak, though low: "That blastful furnace can they thread?" "Why, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego Came out all right, we read; The Lord, be sure, he helps his people, Ned."

How we strain our gaze. On bluffs they shun A golden growing flame appears-- Confirms to a silvery steadfast one: "The town is afire!" crows Hugh; "three cheers!" Lot stops his mouth: "Nay, lad, better three tears."

A purposed light; it shows our fleet; Yet a little late in its searching ray, So far and strong that in phantom cheat Lank on the deck our shadows lay; The shining flag-ship stings their guns to furious play.

How dread to mark her near the glare And glade of death the beacon throws Athwart the racing waters there; One by one each plainer grows, Then speeds a blazoned target to our gladdened foes.

The impartial cresset lights as well The fixed forts to the boats that run; And, plunged from the ports, their answers swell Back to each fortress dun; Ponderous words speaks every monster gun.

Fearless they flash through gates of flame, The salamanders hard to hit, Though vivid shows each bulky frame; And never the batteries intermit, Nor the boat's huge guns; they fire and flit.

Anon a lull. The beacon dies. "Are they out of that strait accurst?" But other flames now dawning rise, Not mellowly brilliant like the first, But rolled in smoke, whose whitish volumes burst.

A baleful brand, a hurrying torch Whereby anew the boats are seen-- A burning transport all alurch! Breathless we gaze; yet still we glean Glimpses of beauty as we eager lean.

The effulgence takes an amber glow Which bathes the hillside villas far; Affrighted ladies mark the show Painting the pale magnolia-- The fair, false, Circe light of cruel War.

The barge drifts doomed, a plague-struck one, Shoreward in yawls the sailors fly. But the gauntlet now is nearly run, The spleenful forts by fits reply, And the burning boat dies down in morning's sky.

All out of range. Adieu, Messieurs! Jeers, as it speeds, our parting gun. So burst we through their barriers And menaces every one; So Porter proves himself a brave man's son.

HERMAN MELVILLE.

The army was at once taken across the river and on May 19, 1863, a general assault was made on the town. This was repulsed with severe loss, and Grant thereupon settled down for a regular siege.

BEFORE VICKSBURG

[May 18-July 4, 1863]

While Sherman stood beneath the hottest fire, That from the lines of Vicksburg gleamed, And bomb-shells tumbled in their smoky gyre, And grape-shot hissed, and case-shot screamed; Back from the front there came, Weeping and sorely lame, The merest child, the youngest face Man ever saw in such a fearful place.

Stifling his tears, he limped his chief to meet; But when he paused, and tottering stood, Around the circle of his little feet There spread a pool of bright, young blood. Shocked at his doleful case, Sherman cried, "Halt! front face! Who are you? Speak, my gallant boy!" "A drummer, sir:--Fifty-fifth Illinois."

"Are you not hit?" "That's nothing. Only send Some cartridges: our men are out; And the foe press us." "But, my little friend--" "Don't mind me! Did you hear that shout? What if our men be driven? Oh, for the love of Heaven, Send to my Colonel, General dear!" "But you?" "Oh, I shall easily find the rear."

"I'll see to that," cried Sherman; and a drop, Angels might envy, dimmed his eye, As the boy, toiling towards the hill's hard top, Turned round, and with his shrill child's cry Shouted, "Oh, don't forget! We'll win the battle yet! But let our soldiers have some more, More cartridges, sir,--calibre fifty-four!"

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

The place was completely invested and a terrific bombardment maintained until July 3, 1863, when the town surrendered, and on the next day, the Confederate troops in the place, to the number of twenty-seven thousand, laid down their arms.

VICKSBURG

For sixty days and upwards, A storm of shell and shot Rained round us in a flaming shower, But still we faltered not. "If the noble city perish," Our grand young leader said, "Let the only walls the foe shall scale Be ramparts of the dead!"

For sixty days and upwards, The eye of heaven waxed dim; And e'en throughout God's holy morn, O'er Christian prayer and hymn, Arose a hissing tumult, As if the fiends in air Strove to engulf the voice of faith In the shrieks of their despair.

There was wailing in the houses, There was trembling on the marts, While the tempest raged and thundered, 'Mid the silent thrill of hearts; But the Lord, our shield, was with us, And ere a month had sped, Our very women walked the streets With scarce one throb of dread.

And the little children gambolled, Their faces purely raised, Just for a wondering moment, As the huge bombs whirled and blazed; Then turned with silvery laughter To the sports which children love, Thrice-mailed in the sweet, instinctive thought That the good God watched above.

Yet the hailing bolts fell faster, From scores of flame-clad ships, And about us, denser, darker, Grew the conflict's wild eclipse, Till a solid cloud closed o'er us, Like a type of doom and ire, Whence shot a thousand quivering tongues Of forked and vengeful fire.

But the unseen hands of angels Those death-shafts warned aside, And the dove of heavenly mercy Ruled o'er the battle tide: In the houses ceased the wailing, And through the war-scarred marts The people strode, with step of hope, To the music in their hearts.

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

Just at noon of July 4, 1863, the Stars and Stripes was run up over the court-house, and the Union troops, seeing it, started to sing "The Battle-Cry of Freedom." By mid-afternoon the possession of the post was absolute and the Union fleet lay at the levee.

THE BATTLE-CRY OF FREEDOM

Yes, we'll rally round the flag, boys, we'll rally once again, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom, We will rally from the hill-side, we'll gather from the plain, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom. _Chorus_--The Union forever, hurrah! boys, hurrah! Down with the traitor, up with the star, While we rally round the flag, boys, rally once again, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom.

We are springing to the call of our brothers gone before, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom, And we'll fill the vacant ranks with a million freemen more, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom.

We will welcome to our numbers the loyal, true, and brave, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom, And altho' they may be poor, not a man shall be a slave, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom.

So we're springing to the call from the East and from the West, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom, And we'll hurl the rebel crew from the land we love the best, Shouting the battle-cry of freedom.

GEORGE FREDERICK ROOT.

Meanwhile, General Banks had been besieging Port Hudson, a position scarcely less formidable than Vicksburg, and on May 24, 1863, had driven the Confederates within their inner line of intrenchments. Three days later, a general assault took place, in which the First and Second Louisiana, colored troops, bore a prominent part.

THE BLACK REGIMENT

[May 27, 1863]

Dark as the clouds of even, Ranked in the western heaven, Waiting the breath that lifts All the dead mass, and drifts Tempest and falling brand Over a ruined land,-- So still and orderly, Arm to arm, knee to knee, Waiting the great event, Stands the black regiment.

Down the long dusky line Teeth gleam and eyeballs shine; And the bright bayonet, Bristling and firmly set, Flashed with a purpose grand, Long ere the sharp command Of the fierce rolling drum Told them their time had come, Told them what work was sent For the black regiment.

"Now," the flag-sergeant cried, "Though death and hell betide, Let the whole nation see If we are fit to be Free in this land; or bound Down, like the whining

hound,-- Bound with red stripes of pain In our old chains again!" Oh, what a shout there went From the black regiment!

"Charge!" trump and drum awoke; Onward the bondmen broke; Bayonet and sabre-stroke Vainly opposed their rush. Through the wild battle's crush, With but one thought aflush, Driving their lords like chaff, In the guns' mouths they laugh; Or at the slippery brands, Leaping with open hands, Down they tear man and horse, Down in their awful course; Trampling with bloody heel Over the crashing steel, All their eyes forward bent, Rushed the black regiment.

"Freedom!" their battle-cry,-- "Freedom! or leave to die!" Ah! and they meant the word, Not as with us 'tis heard, Not a mere party shout: They gave their spirits out; Trusted the end to God, And on the gory sod Rolled in triumphant blood. Glad to strike one free blow, Whether for weal or woe; Glad to breathe one free breath, Though on the lips of death; Praying,--alas! in vain! That they might fall again, So they could once more see That burst to liberty! This was what "freedom" lent To the black regiment.

Hundreds on hundreds fell; But they are resting well; Scourges, and shackles strong Never shall do them wrong. Oh, to the living few, Soldiers, be just and true! Hail them as comrades tried; Fight with them side by side; Never, in field or tent, Scorn the black regiment!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

Shortly after the fall of Vicksburg, Grant was severely injured by a fall from a horse, and it was some months before he could take the field again. Most of his troops were sent to reinforce the Army of the Cumberland, under Rosecrans, which was operating against the Confederates under Bragg, in Tennessee. Chattanooga was occupied by the Union forces on September 16, 1863. Rosecrans pushed forward to the Chickamauga valley, where, on September 18, Bragg attacked in force. The battle raged for two days, the Union line was broken, and General Thomas and his division were isolated on a slope of Missionary Ridge. Assault after assault was delivered against him, but he stood like a rock, and at sundown still held the position.

THE BALLAD OF CHICKAMAUGA

[September 19, 20, 1863]

By Chickamauga's crooked stream the martial trumpets blew; The North and South stood face to face, with War's dread work to do. O lion-strong, unselfish, brave, twin athletes battle-wise, Brothers yet enemies, the fire of conflict in their eyes, All banner-led and bugle-stirred, they set them to the fight, Hearing the god of slaughter laugh from mountain height to height.

The ruddy, fair-haired, giant North breathed loud and strove amain; The swarthy shoulders of the South did heave them to the strain; An earthquake shuddered underfoot, a cloud rolled overhead: And serpent-tongues of flame cut through and lapped and twinkled red, Where back and forth a bullet-stream went singing like a breeze, What time the snarling cannon-balls to splinters tore the trees.

"Make way, make way!" a voice boomed out, "I'm marching to the sea!" The answer was a rebel yell and Bragg's artillery. Where Negley struck, the cohorts gray like storm-tossed clouds were rent; Where Buckner charged, a cyclone fell, the blue to tatters went; The noble Brannan cheered his men, Pat Cleburne answered back, And Lytle stormed, and life was naught in Walthall's bloody track.

Old Taylor's Ridge rocked to its base, and Pigeon Mountain shook; And Helm went down, and Lytle died, and broken was McCook. Van Cleve moved like a hurricane, a tempest blew with Hood, Awful the sweep of Breckenridge across the flaming wood. Never before did battle-roar such chords of thunder make, Never again shall tides of men over such barriers break.

"Stand fast, stand fast!" cried Rosecrans; and Thomas said, "I will!" And, crash on crash, his batteries dashed their broadsides down the hill. Brave Longstreet's splendid rush tore through whatever barred its track, Till the Rock of Chickamauga hurled the roaring columns back, And gave the tide of victory a red tinge of defeat, Adding a noble dignity to that hard word, retreat.

Two days they fought, and evermore those days shall stand apart, Keynotes of epic chivalry within the nation's heart. Come, come, and set the carven rocks to mark this glorious spot; Here let the deeds of heroes live, their hatreds be forgot. Build, build, but never monument of stone shall last as long As one old soldier's ballad borne on breath of battle-song.

MAURICE THOMPSON.

THOMAS AT CHICKAMAUGA

[September 19, 20, 1863]

It was that fierce contested field when Chickamauga lay Beneath the wild tornado that swept her pride away; Her dimpling dales and circling hills dyed crimson with the flood That had its sources in the springs that throb with human blood.

"_Go say to General Hooker to reinforce his right!_" Said Thomas to his aide-de-camp, when wildly went the fight; In front the battle thundered, it roared both right and left, But like a rock "Pap" Thomas stood upon the crested cleft.

"_Where will I find you, General, when I return?_" The aide Leaned on his bridle-rein to wait the answer Thomas made; The old chief like a lion turned, his pale lips set and sere, And shook his mane, and stamped his foot, and fiercely answered, "_Here!_"

The floodtide of fraternal strife rolled upward to his feet, And like the breakers on the shore the thunderous clamors beat; The sad earth rocked and reeled with woe, the woodland shrieked in pain, And hill and vale were groaning with the burden of the slain.

Who does not mind that sturdy form, that steady heart and hand, That calm repose and gallant mien, that courage high and grand?-- O God, who givest nations men to meet their lofty needs, Vouchsafe another Thomas when our country prostrate

bleeds!

They fought with all the fortitude of earnest men and true-- The men who wore the rebel gray, the men who wore the blue; And those, they fought most valiantly for petty state and clan, And these, for truer Union and the brotherhood of man.

They come, those hurling legions, with banners crimson-splashed, Against our stubborn columns their rushing ranks are dashed, Till 'neath the blistering iron hail the shy and frightened deer Go scurrying from their forest haunts to plunge in wilder fear.

Beyond, our lines are broken; and now in frenzied rout The flower of the Cumberland has swiftly faced about; And horse and foot and color-guard are reeling, rear and van, And in the awful panic man forgets that he is man.

Now Bragg, with pride exultant above our broken wings, The might of all his army against "Pap" Thomas brings; They're massing to the right of him, they're massing to the left, Ah, God be with our hero, who holds the crested cleft!

Blow, blow, ye echoing bugles! give answer, screaming shell! Go, belch your murderous fury, ye batteries of hell! Ring out, O impious musket! spin on, O shattering shot,-- Our smoke-encircled hero, he hears but heeds ye not!

Now steady, men! now steady! make one more valiant stand, For gallant Steedman's coming, his forces well in hand! Close up your shattered columns, take steady aim and true, The chief who loves you as his life will live or die with you!

By solid columns, on they come; by columns they are hurled, As down the eddying rapids the storm-swept booms are whirled; And when the ammunition fails--O moment drear and dread-- The heroes load their blackened guns from rounds of soldiers dead.

God never set His signet on the hearts of braver men, Or fixed the goal of victory on higher heights than then; With bayonets and muskets clubbed, they close the rush and roar; Their stepping-stones to glory are their comrades gone before.

O vanished majesty of days not all forgotten yet, We consecrate unto thy praise one hour of deep regret; One hour to them whose days were years of glory that shall flood The Nation's sombre night of tears, of carnage, and of blood!

O vanished majesty of days, when men were gauged by worth, Set crowned and dowered in the way to judge the sons of earth; When all the little great fell down before the great unknown, And priest put off the hampering gown and coward donned his own!

O vanished majesty of days that saw the sun shine on The deeds that wake sublimer praise than Ghent or Marathon; When patriots in homespun rose--where one was called for, ten-- And heroes sprang full-armored from the humblest walks of men!

O vanished majesty of days! Rise, type and mould to-day. And teach our sons to follow on where duty leads the way; That whatsoever trial comes, defying doubt and fear, They in the thickest fight shall stand and proudly answer, "_Here!_"

KATE BROWNLEE SHERWOOD.

Rosecrans could not reinforce Thomas, and at four o'clock General James A. Garfield was intrusted with the perilous task of taking him an order to withdraw. Garfield got to Thomas safely and the retreat began at sundown. The Confederates attempted no pursuit.

GARFIELD'S RIDE AT CHICKAMAUGA

[September 20, 1863]

Again the summer-fevered skies, The breath of autumn calms; Again the golden moons arise On harvest-happy farms. The locusts pipe, the crickets sing Among the falling leaves, And wandering breezes sigh, and bring The harp-notes of the sheaves.

Peace smiles upon the hills and dells; Peace smiles upon the seas; And drop the notes of happy bells Upon the fruited trees. The broad Missouri stretches far Her commerce-gathering arms, And multiply on Arkansas The grain-encumbered farms.

Old Chattanooga, crowned with green, Sleeps 'neath her walls in peace; The Argo has returned again, And brings the Golden Fleece. O nation! free from sea to sea, In union blessed forever, Fair be their fame who fought for thee By Chickamauga River.

The autumn winds were piping low, Beneath the vine-clad eaves; We heard the hollow bugle blow Among the ripened sheaves. And fast the mustering squadrons passed Through mountain portals wide, And swift the blue brigades were massed By Chickamauga's tide.

It was the Sabbath; and in awe We heard the dark hills shake, And o'er the mountain turrets saw The smoke of battle break. And 'neath the war-cloud, gray and grand, The hills o'erhanging low, The Army of the Cumberland, Unequal, met the foe!

Again, O fair September night! Beneath the moon and stars, I see, through memories dark and bright, The altar-fires of Mars. The morning breaks with screaming guns From batteries dark and dire. And where the Chickamauga runs Red runs the muskets' fire.

I see bold Longstreet's darkening host Sweep through our lines of flame, And hear again, "The right is lost!" Swart Rosecrans exclaim. "But not the left!" young Garfield cries; "From that we must not sever, While Thomas holds the field that lies On Chickamauga River!"

Oh! on that day of clouded gold, How, half of hope bereft, The cannoneers, like Titans, rolled Their thunders on the left! I see the battle-clouds again, With glowing autumn splendors blending: It seemed as if the gods with men Were on Olympian heights contending.

Through tongues of flame, through meadows brown, Dry valley roads concealed, Ohio's hero dashes down Upon the rebel field. And swift, on reeling charger borne, He threads the wooded plain, By twice a hundred cannon mown, And reddened with the slain.

But past the swathes of carnage dire, The Union guns he hears, And gains the left, begirt with fire, And thus the heroes cheers-- "While stands the left, yon flag o'erhead, Shall Chattanooga stand!" "Let the Napoleons rain their lead!" Was Thomas's command.

Back swept the gray brigades of Bragg; The air with victory rung; And Wurzel's "Rally round the flag!" 'Mid Union cheers was sung. The flag on Chattanooga's height In twilight's crimson waved, And all the clustered stars of white Were to the Union saved.

O chief of staff! the nation's fate That red field crossed with thee, The triumph of the camp and state, The hope of liberty! O nation! free from sea to sea, With union blessed forever, Not vainly heroes fought for thee By Chickamauga River.

In dreams I stand beside the tide Where those old heroes fell: Above the valleys long and wide Sweet rings the Sabbath bell. I hear no more the bugle blow, As on that fateful day! I hear the ringdove fluting low, Where shaded waters stray.

On Mission Ridge the sunlight streams Above the fields of fall, And Chattanooga calmly dreams Beneath her mountain-wall. Old Lookout Mountain towers on high, As in heroic days, When 'neath the battle in the sky Were seen its summits blaze.

'T was ours to lay no garlands fair Upon the graves "unknown": Kind Nature sets her gentians there, And fall the sear leaves lone. Those heroes' graves no shaft of Mars May mark with beauty ever; But floats the flag of forty stars By Chickamauga River.

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

This defeat brought Grant into the field again, though he was still on crutches. The Confederates held a strong position on Missionary Ridge and Lookout Mountain, and Grant prepared to attack. On November 24, 1863, Hooker's brigade moved forward to the northern face of Lookout Mountain, drove the enemy from their rifle pits and intrenchments, and then started after them up the slope. The mountain was enveloped in a dense fog, and into this Hooker's men disappeared. During the night the Confederates delivered a savage assault, but were beaten off. At dawn, when the Union troops scaled the palisades, they found the intrenchments at the top deserted, and unfurled the Stars and Stripes from the summit of Pulpit Rock. The Confederates were dislodged next day from Missionary Ridge and were soon in full retreat.

THE BATTLE OF LOOKOUT MOUNTAIN

[November 24, 1863]

"Give me but two brigades," said Hooker, frowning at fortified Lookout; "And I'll engage to sweep yon mountain clear of that mocking rebel rout." At early morning came an order, that set the General's face aglow: "Now," said he to his staff, "draw out my soldiers! Grant says that I may go."

Hither and thither dashed each eager Colonel, to join his regiment, While a low rumor of the daring purpose ran on from tent to tent. For the long roll was sounding

through the valley, and the keen trumpet's bray, And the wild laughter of the swarthy veterans, who cried, "We fight to-day!"

The solid tramp of infantry, the rumble of the great jolting gun, The sharp, clear order, and the fierce steeds neighing, "Why's not the fight begun?" All these plain harbingers of sudden conflict broke on the startled ear; And last arose a sound that made your blood leap, the ringing battle-cheer.

The lower works were carried at one onset; like a vast roaring sea Of steel and fire, our soldiers from the trenches swept out the enemy; And we could see the gray-coats swarming up from the mountain's leafy base, To join their comrades in the higher fastness,--for life or death the race!

Then our long line went winding up the mountain, in a huge serpent-track, And the slant sun upon it flashed and glimmered as on a dragon's back. Higher and higher the column's head pushed onward, ere the rear moved a man; And soon the skirmish-lines their straggling volleys and single shots began.

Then the bald head of Lookout flamed and bellowed, and all its batteries woke, And down the mountain poured the bomb-shells, puffing into our eyes their smoke; And balls and grape-shot rained upon our column, that bore the angry shower As if it were no more than that soft dropping which scarcely stirs the flower.

Oh, glorious courage that inspires the hero, and runs through all his men! The heart that failed beside the Rappahannock, it was itself again! The star that circumstance and jealous faction shrouded in envious night Here shone with all the splendor of its nature, and with a freer light!

Hark, hark! there go the well-known crashing volleys, the long-continued roar That swells and falls, but never ceases wholly until the fight is o'er. Up towards the crystal gates of heaven ascending, the mortal tempest beat, As if they sought to try their cause together before God's very feet.

We saw our troops had gained a footing almost beneath the topmost ledge, And back and forth the rival lines went surging upon the dizzy edge. We saw, sometimes, our men fall backward slowly, and groaned in our despair; Or cheered when now and then a stricken rebel plunged out in open air, Down, down, a thousand empty fathoms dropping,--his God alone knows where!

At eve thick haze upon the mountain gathered, with rising smoke stained black, And not a glimpse of the contending armies shone through the swirling rack. Night fell o'er all; but still they flashed their lightnings and rolled their thunders loud, Though no man knew upon which side was going that battle in the cloud.

Night--what a night!--of anxious thought and wonder, but still no tidings came From the bare summit of the trembling mountain, still wrapped in mist and flame. But towards the sleepless dawn, stillness, more dreadful than the fierce sound of war, Settled o'er Nature, as if she stood breathless before the morning star.

As the sun rose, dense clouds of smoky vapor boiled from the valley's deeps, Dragging their torn and ragged edges slowly up through the tree-clad steeps; And

rose and rose, till Lookout, like a vision, above us grandly stood, And over his bleak crags and storm-blanched headlands burst the warm golden flood.

Thousands of eyes were fixed upon the mountain, and thousands held their breath, And the vast army, in the valley watching, seemed touched with sudden death. High o'er us soared great Lookout, robed in purple, a glory on his face, A human meaning in his hard, calm features, beneath that heavenly grace.

Out on a crag walked something--what? an eagle, that treads yon giddy height? Surely no man! but still he clambered forward into the full, rich light. Then up he started, with a sudden motion, and from the blazing crag Flung to the morning breeze and sunny radiance the dear old starry flag!

Ah! then what followed? Scarred and war-worn soldiers, like girls, flushed through their tan, And down the thousand wrinkles of the battles a thousand tear-drops ran. Men seized each other in returned embraces, and sobbed for very love; A spirit, which made all that moment brothers, seemed falling from above.

And as we gazed, around the mountain's summit our glittering files appeared, Into the rebel works we saw them moving; and we--we cheered, we cheered! And they above waved all their flags before us, and joined our frantic shout, Standing, like demigods, in light and triumph upon their own Lookout!

GEORGE HENRY BOKER.

THE BATTLE IN THE CLOUDS

[November 24, 1863]

Where the dews and the rains of heaven have their fountain, Like its thunder and its lightning our brave burst on the foe, Up above the clouds on Freedom's Lookout Mountain Raining life-blood like water on the valleys down below. Oh, green be the laurels that grow, Oh, sweet be the wild-buds that blow, In the dells of the mountain where the brave are lying low.

Light of our hope and crown of our story, Bright as sunlight, pure as starlight shall their deed of daring glow. While the day and the night out of heaven shed their glory, On Freedom's Lookout Mountain whence they routed Freedom's foe. Oh, soft be the gales when they go Through the pines on the summit where they blow, Chanting solemn music for the souls that passed below.

WILLIAM DEAN HOWELLS.

By the autumn of 1862, the Union forces had established themselves firmly on the North Carolina coast, and early in the following year preparations were made to attack Charleston, the very head and front of the Confederacy.

CHARLESTON

[April, 1863]

Calm as that second summer which precedes The first fall of the snow, In the broad sunlight of heroic deeds, The city bides the foe.

As yet, behind their ramparts, stern and proud, Her bolted thunders sleep,-- Dark Sumter, like a battlemented cloud, Looms o'er the solemn deep.

No Calpe frowns from lofty cliff or scaur To guard the holy strand; But Moultrie holds in leash her dogs of war Above the level sand.

And down the dunes a thousand guns lie couched, Unseen, beside the flood,-- Like tigers in some Orient jungle crouched, That wait and watch for blood.

Meanwhile, through streets still echoing with trade, Walk grave and thoughtful men, Whose hands may one day wield the patriot's blade As lightly as the pen.

And maidens, with such eyes as would grow dim Over a bleeding hound, Seem each one to have caught the strength of him Whose sword she sadly bound.

Thus girt without and garrisoned at home, Day patient following day, Old Charleston looks from roof and spire and dome, Across her tranquil bay.

Ships, through a hundred foes, from Saxon lands And spicy Indian ports, Bring Saxon steel and iron to her hands, And summer to her courts.

But still, along yon dim Atlantic line, The only hostile smoke Creeps like a harmless mist above the brine, From some frail floating oak.

Shall the spring dawn, and she, still clad in smiles, And with an unscathed brow, Rest in the strong arms of her palm-crowned isles, As fair and free as now?

We know not; in the temple of the Fates God has inscribed her doom: And, all untroubled in her faith, she waits The triumph or the tomb.

HENRY TIMROD.

On April 7, 1863, a strong squadron under Admiral Dupont attempted to enter the harbor and reduce Fort Sumter, but got such a warm reception that it was forced to withdraw. One ship was sunk and the others badly damaged.

THE BATTLE OF CHARLESTON HARBOR

[April 7, 1863]

Two hours, or more, beyond the prime of a blithe April day, The Northmen's mailed "Invincibles" steamed up fair Charleston Bay; They came in sullen file, and slow, low-breasted on the wave, Black as a midnight front of storm, and silent as the grave.

A thousand warrior-hearts beat high as those dread monsters drew More closely to the game of death across the breezeless blue, And twice ten thousand hearts of those who watch the scene afar, Thrill in the awful hush that bides the battle's broadening star.

Each gunner, moveless by his gun, with rigid aspect stands, The reedy linstocks firmly grasped in bold, untrembling hands, So moveless in their marbled calm, their

stern, heroic guise, They look like forms of statued stone with burning human eyes!

Our banners on the outmost walls, with stately rustling fold, Flash back from arch and parapet the sunlight's ruddy gold,-- They mount to the deep roll of drums, and widely echoing cheers, And then, once more, dark, breathless, hushed, wait the grim cannoneers.

Onward, in sullen file, and slow, low-glooming on the wave, Near, nearer still, the haughty fleet glides silent as the grave, When shivering the portentous calm o'er startled flood and shore, Broke from the sacred Island Fort the thunder-wrath of yore!

Ha! brutal Corsairs! though ye come thrice-cased in iron mail, Beware the storm that's opening now, God's vengeance guides the hail! Ye strive, the ruffian types of Might, 'gainst law and truth and Right; Now quail beneath a sturdier Power, and own a mightier Might!

The storm has burst! and while we speak, more furious, wilder, higher, Dart from the circling batteries a hundred tongues of fire; The waves gleam red, the lurid vault of heaven seems rent above-- Fight on, O knightly gentlemen! for faith, and home, and love!

There's not, in all that line of flame, one soul that would not rise To seize the victor's wreath of blood, though death must give the prize; There's not, in all this anxious crowd that throngs the ancient town, A maid who does not yearn for power to strike one foeman down!

The conflict deepens! ship by ship the proud Armada sweeps, Where fierce from Sumter's raging breast the volleyed lightning leaps; And ship by ship, raked, overborne, ere burned the sunset light, Crawls in the gloom of baffled hate beyond the field of fight!

O glorious Empress of the Main! from out thy storied spires Thou well mayst peal thy bells of joy, and light thy festal fires,-- Since Heaven this day hath striven for thee, hath nerved thy dauntless sons, And thou in clear-eyed faith hast seen God's angels near the guns!

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

It was evident that the fleet by itself could accomplish nothing, and a land attack was therefore planned against Fort Wagner, a very strong work, fully garrisoned by veterans. It was stormed on the evening of July 18, 1863, the Fifty-Fourth Massachusetts (colored), Colonel Robert Gould Shaw, leading. He was killed in the first assault and his regiment was decimated. The Confederates buried Shaw "in a pit under a heap of his niggers."

BURY THEM

(WAGNER, July 18, 1863)

Bury the Dragon's Teeth! Bury them deep and dark! The incisors swart and stark, The molars heavy and dark-- And the one white Fang underneath!

Bury the Hope Forlorn! Never shudder to fling, With its fellows dusky and worn, The strong and beautiful thing (Pallid ivory and pearl!) Into the horrible Pit-- Hurry it in, and hurl All the rest over it!

Trample them, clod by clod, Stamp them in dust amain! The cuspids, cruent and red, That the Monster, Freedom, shed On the sacred, strong Slave-Sod-- They never shall rise again!

Never?--what hideous growth Is sprouting through clod and clay? What Terror starts to the day? A crop of steel, on our oath! How the burnished stamens glance!-- Spike, and anther, and blade, How they burst from the bloody shade, And spindle to spear and lance!

There are tassels of blood-red Maize-- How the horrible Harvest grows! 'Tis sabres that glint and daze-- 'Tis bayonets all ablaze Uprearing in dreadful rows!

For one that we buried there, A thousand are come to air! Ever, by door-stone and hearth, They break from the angry earth-- And out of the crimson sand, Where the cold white Fang was laid, Rises a terrible Shade, The Wraith of a sleepless Brand!

And our hearts wax strange and chill, With an ominous shudder and thrill, Even here, on the strong Slave-Sod, Lest, haply, we be found (Ah, dread no brave hath drowned!) Fighting against Great God.

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

Heavy siege batteries were at once erected by the Union forces and on August 17, 1863, a terrific bombardment began against Sumter and Wagner, and continued uninterruptedly. Ten days later Sumter had been reduced to a shapeless mass of ruins, and Fort Wagner was captured soon afterwards, but the city itself still stood unshaken.

TWILIGHT ON SUMTER[11]

[1863]

Still and dark along the sea Sumter lay; A light was overhead, As from burning cities shed, And the clouds were battle-red, Far away. Not a solitary gun Left to tell the fort had won Or lost the day! Nothing but the tattered rag Of the drooping rebel flag, And the sea-birds screaming round it in their play.

How it woke one April morn Fame shall tell; As from Moultrie, close at hand, And the batteries on the land, Round its faint but fearless band Shot and shell Raining hid the doubtful light; But they fought the hopeless fight Long and well (Theirs the glory, ours the shame!), Till the walls were wrapped in flame, Then their flag was proudly struck, and Sumter fell!

Now--oh, look at Sumter now, In the gloom! Mark its scarred and shattered walls. (Hark! the ruined rampart falls!) There's a justice that appals In its doom; For this

blasted spot of earth Where rebellion had its birth Is its tomb! And when Sumter sinks at last From the heavens, that shrink aghast, Hell shall rise in grim derision and make room!

RICHARD HENRY STODDARD.

[11] From Poetical Writings of Richard Henry Stoddard; copyright, 1880, by Charles Scribner's Sons.

CHAPTER X

THE FINAL STRUGGLE

A survey of the field at the opening of the fourth year of the war shows how steadily the North had been gaining the advantage--an advantage due to superior numbers and greater resources rather than to brilliant generalship. The Union forces in the field numbered eight hundred thousand, while the Confederates had scarcely half as many, and were compelled to stand on the defensive. The North hoped to crush them by one mighty effort.

PUT IT THROUGH

[1864]

Come, Freemen of the land, Come, meet the last demand,-- Here's a piece of work in hand; Put it through! Here's a log across the way, We have stumbled on all day; Here's a ploughshare in the clay,-- Put it through!

Here's a country that's half free, And it waits for you and me To say what its fate shall be; Put it through! While one traitor thought remains, While one spot its banner stains, One link of all its chains,-- Put it through!

Hear our brothers in the field, Steel your swords as theirs are steeled, Learn to wield the arms they wield,-- Put it through! Lock the shop and lock the store, And chalk this upon the door,-- "We've enlisted for the war!" Put it through!

For the birthrights yet unsold, For the history yet untold, For the future yet unrolled, Put it through! Lest our children point with shame On the fathers' dastard fame, Who gave up a nation's name, Put it through!

EDWARD EVERETT HALE.

Grant was made lieutenant-general, and prepared to advance on Richmond, while the task of taking Atlanta was intrusted to Sherman. Sherman began his advance without delay, and was before Atlanta by the middle of July, 1864. On the 20th the Confederates made a desperate sally, but were driven back.

LOGAN AT PEACH TREE CREEK

A VETERAN'S STORY

[July 20, 1864]

You know that day at Peach Tree Creek, When the Rebs with their circling, scorching wall Of smoke-hid cannon and sweep of flame Drove in our flanks, back! back! and all Our toil seemed lost in the storm of shell-- That desperate day McPherson fell!

Our regiment stood in a little glade Set round with half-grown red oak trees-- An awful place to stand, in full fair sight, While the minie bullets hummed like bees, And comrades dropped on either side-- That fearful day McPherson died!

The roar of the battle, steady, stern, Rung in our ears. Upon our eyes The belching cannon smoke, the half-hid swing Of deploying troops, the groans, the cries, The hoarse commands, the sickening smell-- That blood-red day McPherson fell!

But we stood there!--when out from the trees, Out of the smoke and dismay to the right Burst a rider--His head was bare, his eye Had a blaze like a lion fain for fight; His long hair, black as the deepest night, Streamed out on the wind. And the might Of his plunging horse was a tale to tell, And his voice rang high like a bugle's swell; "Men, the enemy hem us on every side; We'll whip 'em yet! Close up that breach-- Remember your flag--don't give an inch! The right flank's gaining and soon will reach-- Forward boys, and give 'em hell!"-- Said Logan after McPherson fell.

We laughed and cheered and the red ground shook, As the general plunged along the line Through the deadliest rain of screaming shells; For the sound of his voice refreshed us all, And we filled the gap like a roaring tide, And saved the day McPherson died!

But that was twenty years ago, And part of a horrible dream now past. For Logan, the lion, the drums throb low And the flag swings low on the mast; He has followed his mighty chieftain through The mist-hung stream, where gray and blue One color stand, And North to South extends the hand. It's right that deeds of war and blood Should be forgot, but, spite of all, I think of Logan, now, as he rode That day across the field; I hear the call Of his trumpet voice--see the battle shine In his stern, black eyes, and down the line Of cheering men I see him ride, As on the day McPherson died.

HAMLIN GARLAND.

On July 22, 1864, Sherman ordered a general assault, which lasted two days, with heavy losses on both sides. General McPherson was killed by a Confederate sharpshooter about noon of the first day.

A DIRGE FOR McPHERSON

KILLED IN FRONT OF ATLANTA

[July 22, 1864]

Arms reversed and banners craped-- Muffled drums; Snowy horses sable-draped-- McPherson comes. _But, tell us, shall we know him more, Lost-Mountain and lone Kenesaw?_

Brave the sword upon the pall-- A gleam in gloom; So a bright name lighteth all McPherson's doom.

Bear him through the chapel-door-- Let priest in stole Pace before the warrior Who led. Bell--toll!

Lay him down within the nave, The Lesson read-- Man is noble, man is brave, But man's--a weed.

Take him up again and wend Graveward, nor weep: There's a trumpet that shall rend This Soldier's sleep.

Pass the ropes the coffin round, And let descend; Prayer and volley--let it sound McPherson's end. _True fame is his, for life is o'er-- Sarpedon of the mighty war._

HERMAN MELVILLE.

Hostilities continued about Atlanta for nearly a month, and finally, on September 2, 1864, the Confederates evacuated the city. A few days later, they suddenly attacked Allatoona, where General Corse was stationed with a small garrison. Sherman heard the thunder of the guns from the top of Kenesaw Mountain, and signalled Corse the famous message, "Hold out; relief is coming!" Corse did hold out and the Confederates finally withdrew.

WITH CORSE AT ALLATOONA

[October 5, 1864]

It was less than two thousand we numbered, In the fort sitting up on the hill; That night not a soldier that slumbered; We watched by the starlight until Daybreak showed us all of their forces; About us their gray columns ran, To left and to right they were round us, Five thousand if there was a man.

"Surrender your fort," bawled the rebel; "Five minutes I give, or you're dead." "Not a man," answered Corse, in his treble, "Perhaps you can _take_ us instead!" Then pealed forth their cannon infernal; We fought them outside of the pass, Two hours, the time seemed eternal; The dead lay in lines on the grass.

But who cared for dead or for dying? The fort we were there to defend, And across from yon far mountain flying, Came a message, "Hold on to the end; Hold on to the fort." It was Sherman, Who signalled from Kenesaw's height, Far over the heads of our foemen, "Hold on--I am coming to-night."

Quick fluttered our flag to the signal, We answered him back with a will, And fired on the gray-coated rebels That charged up the slope of the hill. "Load double," cried Corse, "every cannon; Who cares for their ten to our one?" We looked at the swift-coming rebels, And answered their yell with a gun.

With the grape from our fort in their faces, They rush to the ramparts, but stop; Ah! few of the gray-columned army That day left alive at the top. On the parapets, too, lie our wounded, Each porthole a grave for the dead; No room for our cannon, the corpses Fill up the embrasures instead.

Again through the cannon's red weather They charge up the hill and the pass, Their dead and our dead lie together Out there on the slope in the grass. A crash from our rifles--they falter; A gleam from our steel--it is by. "Recall and retreat," sound their bugles; We cheer from the fort as they fly.

Once more and the signal is flying-- "How many the wounded and dead?" "Six hundred," says Corse, "with the dying," The blood streaming down from his head. "But what of that? Look! the old banner Shines out there as peaceful and still As if there had not been a battle This morning up there on the hill."

SAMUEL H. M. BYERS.

ALLATOONA

[October 5, 1864]

Winds that sweep the southern mountains, And the leafy river shore, Bear ye now a prouder burden Than ye ever learned before! And the heart blood fills The heart, till it thrills At the story Of the terror and the glory Of this battle of the Allatoona hills!

Echo it from the purple mountain To the gray resounding shore! 'Tis as sad and proud a burden As ye ever learned before. How they fell like grass When the mowers pass! And the dying, When the foe were flying, Swelled the cheering of the heroes of the pass.

Sweep it o'er the hills of Georgia, To the mountains of the north! Teach the coward and the doubter What the blood of man is worth! Toss the flags as ye pass! Let their stained and tattered mass Tell the story Of the terror and the glory Of the battle of the Allatoona Pass!

Sherman now prepared for a manoeuvre which was destined to be the most famous of the war. He determined to destroy Atlanta, and, marching through the heart of Georgia, to capture one or more of the important seaport towns. On November 16, 1864, the famous "march to the sea" began.

SHERMAN'S MARCH TO THE SEA

Our camp-fires shone bright on the mountain That frowned on the river below, As we stood by our guns in the morning, And eagerly watched for the foe; When a rider came out of the darkness That hung over mountain and tree, And shouted: "Boys, up and be ready! For Sherman will march to the sea."

Then cheer upon cheer for bold Sherman Went up from each valley and glen, And the bugles reëchoed the music That came from the lips of the men; For we knew that the stars in our banner More bright in their splendor would be, And that blessings

from Northland would greet us When Sherman marched down to the sea.

Then forward, boys! forward to battle! We marched on our wearisome way, We stormed the wild hills of Resaca, God bless those who fell on that day! Then Kenesaw, dark in its glory, Frowned down on the flag of the free, And the East and the West bore our standard And Sherman marched on to the sea.

Still onward we pressed till our banners Swept out from Atlanta's grim walls, And the blood of the patriot dampened The soil where the traitor flag falls. We paused not to weep for the fallen, Who slept by each river and tree, Yet we twined them a wreath of the laurel As Sherman marched down to the sea.

Oh, proud was our army that morning, That stood where the pine darkly towers, When Sherman said: "Boys, you are weary, But to-day fair Savannah is ours!" Then sang we the song of our chieftain, That echoed o'er river and lea, And the stars in our banner shone brighter When Sherman marched down to the sea.

SAMUEL H. M. BYERS.

Through the heart of Georgia the army moved, leaving behind a path of ruin forty miles in width. Some of this destruction was no doubt necessary, but much of it seems to have been wanton and without reason.

THE SONG OF SHERMAN'S ARMY

A pillar of fire by night, A pillar of smoke by day, Some hours of march--then a halt to fight, And so we hold our way; Some hours of march--then a halt to fight, As on we hold our way.

Over mountain and plain and stream, To some bright Atlantic bay, With our arms aflash in the morning beam, We hold our festal way; With our arms aflash in the morning beam, We hold our checkless way!

There is terror wherever we come, There is terror and wild dismay When they see the Old Flag and hear the drum Announce us on our way; When they see the Old Flag and hear the drum Beating time to our onward way.

Never unlimber a gun For those villainous lines in gray; Draw sabres! and at 'em upon the run! 'Tis thus we clear our way; Draw sabres, and soon you will see them run, As we hold our conquering way.

The loyal, who long have been dumb, Are loud in their cheers to-day; And the old men out on their crutches come, To see us hold our way; And the old men out on their crutches come, To bless us on our way.

Around us in rear and flanks, Their futile squadrons play, With a sixty-mile front of steady ranks, We hold our checkless way; With a sixty-mile front of serried ranks, Our banner clears the way.

Hear the spattering fire that starts From the woods and the copses gray, There is just enough fighting to quicken our hearts, As we frolic along the way! There is just enough fighting to warm our hearts, As we rattle along the way.

Upon different roads, abreast, The heads of our columns gay, With fluttering flags, all forward pressed, Hold on their conquering way; With fluttering flags to victory pressed, We hold our glorious way.

Ah, traitors! who bragged so bold In the sad war's early day, Did nothing predict you should ever behold The Old Flag come this way? Did nothing predict you should yet behold Our banner come back this way?

By heaven! 'tis a gala march, 'Tis a picnic or a play; Of all our long war 'tis the crowning arch, Hip, hip! for Sherman's way! Of all our long war this crowns the arch-- For Sherman and Grant, hurrah!

CHARLES GRAHAM HALPINE.

MARCHING THROUGH GEORGIA

Bring the good old bugle, boys, we'll sing another song-- Sing it with a spirit that will start the world along-- Sing it as we used to sing it fifty thousand strong, While we were marching through Georgia. _Chorus_--"Hurrah! Hurrah! we bring the jubilee! Hurrah! Hurrah! the flag that makes you free!" So we sang the chorus from Atlanta to the sea, While we were marching through Georgia.

How the darkeys shouted when they heard the joyful sound! How the turkeys gobbled which our commissary found! How the sweet potatoes even started from the ground, While we were marching through Georgia.

Yes, and there were Union men who wept with joyful tears, When they saw the honored flag they had not seen for years; Hardly could they be restrained from breaking forth in cheers, While we were marching through Georgia.

"Sherman's dashing Yankee boys will never reach the coast!" So the saucy rebels said--and 'twas a handsome boast, Had they not forgot, alas! to reckon on a host, While we were marching through Georgia.

So we made a thoroughfare for Freedom and her train, Sixty miles in latitude--three hundred to the main; Treason fled before us, for resistance was in vain, While we were marching through Georgia.

HENRY CLAY WORK.

ETHIOPIA SALUTING THE COLORS

Who are you dusky woman, so ancient hardly human, With your woolly-white and turban'd head, and bare bony feet? Why rising by the roadside here, do you the colors greet?

('Tis while our army lines Carolina's sands and pines, Forth from thy hovel door thou Ethiopia com'st to me, As under doughty Sherman I march toward the sea.)

_Me master years a hundred since from my parents sunder'd, A little child, they caught me as the savage beast is caught, Then hither me across the sea the cruel

slaver brought._

No further does she say, but lingering all the day, Her high-borne turban'd head she wags, and rolls her darkling eye, And courtesies to the regiments, the guidons moving by.

What is it fateful woman, so blear, hardly human? Why wag your head with turban bound, yellow, red and green? Are the things so strange and marvellous you see or have seen?

WALT WHITMAN.

The invasion brought panic to the South, and Beauregard hastened to oppose it. But Sherman pressed on irresistibly, beating down all opposition, reached Savannah, and on December 22, 1864, marched into the city, which had been abandoned by the Confederates. On Christmas day, he telegraphed President Lincoln, "I beg to present to you, as a Christmas gift, the city of Savannah."

SHERMAN'S IN SAVANNAH

[December 22, 1864]

Like the tribes of Israel, Fed on quails and manna, Sherman and his glorious band Journeyed through the rebel land, Fed from Heaven's all-bounteous hand, Marching on Savannah!

As the moving pillar shone, Streamed the starry banner All day long in rosy light, Flaming splendor all the night, Till it swooped in eagle flight Down on doomed Savannah!

Glory be to God on high! Shout the loud Hosanna! Treason's wilderness is past, Canaan's shore is won at last, Peal a nation's trumpet-blast,-- Sherman's in Savannah!

Soon shall Richmond's tough old hide Find a tough old tanner! Soon from every rebel wall Shall the rag of treason fall, Till our banner flaps o'er all As it crowns Savannah!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

SAVANNAH

[December 23, 1864]

Thou hast not drooped thy stately head, Thy woes a wondrous beauty shed! Not like a lamb to slaughter led, But with the lion's monarch tread, Thou comest to thy battle bed, Savannah! O Savannah!

Thine arm of flesh is girded strong; The blue veins swell beneath thy wrong; To thee the triple cords belong Of woe and death and shameless wrong, And spirit vaunted long, too long! Savannah! O Savannah!

No blood-stains spot thy forehead fair; Only the martyrs' blood is there; It gleams upon thy bosom bare, It moves thy deep, deep soul to prayer, And tunes a dirge for thy sad ear, Savannah! O Savannah!

Thy clean white hand is opened wide For weal or woe, thou Freedom Bride; The sword-sheath sparkles at thy side, Thy plighted troth, whate'er betide, Thou hast but Freedom for thy guide, Savannah! O Savannah!

What though the heavy storm-cloud lowers, Still at thy feet the old oak towers; Still fragrant are thy jessamine bowers, And things of beauty, love, and flowers Are smiling o'er this land of ours, My sunny home, Savannah!

There is no film before thy sight,-- Thou seest woe and death and night, And blood upon thy banner bright; But in thy full wrath's kindled might What carest thou for woe or night? My rebel home, Savannah!

Come--for the crown is on thy head! Thy woes a wondrous beauty shed; Not like a lamb to slaughter led, But with the lion's monarch tread, Oh! come unto thy battle bed, Savannah! O Savannah!

ALETHEA S. BURROUGHS.

Sherman paused at Savannah to fortify the place and get his army into shape, after its march of two hundred and fifty miles; then, on January 15, 1865, he started northward into South Carolina.

CAROLINA

[January, 1865]

The despot treads thy sacred sands, Thy pines give shelter to his bands, Thy sons stand by with idle hands, Carolina! He breathes at ease thy airs of balm, He scorns the lances of thy palm; Oh! who shall break thy craven calm, Carolina! Thy ancient fame is growing dim, A spot is on thy garment's rim; Give to the winds thy battle-hymn, Carolina!

Call on thy children of the hill, Wake swamp and river, coast and rill, Rouse all thy strength and all thy skill, Carolina! Cite wealth and science, trade and art, Touch with thy fire the cautious mart, And pour thee through the people's heart, Carolina! Till even the coward spurns his fears, And all thy fields, and fens, and meres Shall bristle like thy palm with spears, Carolina!

I hear a murmur as of waves That grope their way through sunless caves, Like bodies struggling in their graves, Carolina! And now it deepens; slow and grand It swells, as, rolling to the land, An ocean broke upon thy strand, Carolina! Shout! Let it reach the startled Huns! And roar with all thy festal guns! It is the answer of thy sons, Carolina!

HENRY TIMROD.

Every man in the state was called to arms, but the Union forces met with only a weak and ineffective resistance. On February 16, 1865, Columbia was occupied; and

catching fire accidentally next day, was totally destroyed. The fall of Columbia left Charleston exposed and the Confederate troops hastened to get away while they could.

CHARLESTON

[February, 1865]

Calmly beside her tropic strand, An empress, brave and loyal, I see the watchful city stand, With aspect sternly royal; She knows her mortal foe draws near, Armored by subtlest science, Yet deep, majestical, and clear, Rings out her grand defiance. Oh, glorious is thy noble face, Lit up by proud emotion, And unsurpassed thy stately grace, Our warrior Queen of Ocean!

First from thy lips the summons came, Which roused our South to action, And, with the quenchless force of flame Consumed the demon, Faction; First, like a rush of sovereign wind, That rends dull waves asunder, Thy prescient warning struck the blind, And woke the deaf with thunder; They saw, with swiftly kindling eyes, The shameful doom before them, And heard, borne wild from northern skies, The death-gale hurtling o'er them:

Wilt thou, whose virgin banner rose, A morning star of splendor, Quail when the war-tornado blows, And crouch in base surrender? Wilt thou, upon whose loving breast Our noblest chiefs are sleeping, Yield thy dead patriots' place of rest To scornful alien keeping? No! while a life-pulse throbs for fame, Thy sons will gather round thee, Welcome the shot, the steel, the flame, If honor's hand hath crowned thee.

Then fold about thy beauteous form The imperial robe thou wearest, And front with regal port the storm Thy foe would dream thou fearest; If strength, and will, and courage fail To cope with ruthless numbers, And thou must bend, despairing, pale, Where thy last hero slumbers, Lift the red torch, and light the fire Amid those corpses gory, And on thy self-made funeral pyre, Pass from the world to glory.

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

The cotton in the town was burned, many houses caught fire, and a magazine exploded, killing two hundred people. The city was virtually a ruin when the last of the Confederate troops--"poor old Dixie's bottom dollar"--left the city.

ROMANCE

"Talk of pluck!" pursued the Sailor, Set at euchre on his elbow, "I was on the wharf at Charleston, Just ashore from off the runner.

"It was gray and dirty weather, And I heard a drum go rolling, Rub-a-dubbing in the distance, Awful dour-like and defiant.

"In and out among the cotton, Mud, and chains, and stores, and anchors, Tramped a squad of battered scarecrows-- Poor old Dixie's bottom dollar!

"Some had shoes, but all had rifles, Them that wasn't bald was beardless, And the drum was rolling 'Dixie,' And they stepped to it like men, sir!

"Rags and tatters, belts and bayonets, On they swung, the drum a-rolling, Mum and sour. It looked like fighting, And they meant it too, by thunder!"

WILLIAM ERNEST HENLEY.

The excitement of the people mounted to hysteria; there were those who advised that the city be destroyed and that its inhabitants die fighting on its ashes. But calmer counsel prevailed and Charleston, on February 18, 1865, was surrendered without resistance.

THE FOE AT THE GATES

[CHARLESTON, 1865]

Ring round her! children of her glorious skies, Whom she hath nursed to stature proud and great; Catch one last glance from her imploring eyes, Then close your ranks and face the threatening fate.

Ring round her! with a wall of horrent steel Confront the foe, nor mercy ask nor give; And in her hour of anguish let her feel That ye can die whom she has taught to live.

Ring round her! swear, by every lifted blade, To shield from wrong the mother who gave you birth; That never violent hand on her be laid, Nor base foot desecrate her hallowed hearth.

Curst be the dastard who shall halt or doubt! And doubly damned who casts one look behind! Ye who are men! with unsheathed sword, and shout, Up with her banner! give it to the wind!

Peal your wild slogan, echoing far and wide, Till every ringing avenue repeat The gathering cry, and Ashley's angry tide Calls to the sea-waves beating round her feet.

Sons, to the rescue! spurred and belted, come! Kneeling, with clasp'd hands, she invokes you now By the sweet memories of your childhood's home, By every manly hope and filial vow,

To save her proud soul from that loathèd thrall Which yet her spirit cannot brook to name; Or, if her fate be near, and she must fall, Spare her--she sues--the agony and shame.

From all her fanes let solemn bells be tolled; Heap with kind hands her costly funeral pyre, And thus, with pæan sung and anthem rolled, Give her unspotted to the God of Fire.

Gather around her sacred ashes then, Sprinkle the cherished dust with crimson rain, Die! as becomes a race of free-born men, Who will not crouch to wear the bondman's chain.

So, dying, ye shall win a high renown, If not in life, at least by death, set free; And send her fame through endless ages down-- The last grand holocaust of Liberty.

JOHN DICKSON BRUNS.

While Sherman was accomplishing his task in this triumphant manner, Grant was hammering away at Richmond. Late in February, 1864, a strong force under Kilpatrick was detached to raid around Richmond and if possible release the Union prisoners at Belle Isle and in Libby prison. They reached the outer fortifications, but were repulsed, Major Ulric Dahlgren being among the killed.

ULRIC DAHLGREN

[March 2, 1864]

A flash of light across the night, An eager face, an eye afire! O lad so true, you yet may rue The courage of your deep desire!

"Nay, tempt me not; the way is plain-- 'Tis but the coward checks his rein; For there they lie, And there they cry, For whose dear sake 'twere joy to die!"

He bends unto his saddlebow, The steeds they follow two and two; Their flanks are wet with foam and sweat, Their riders' locks are damp with dew.

"O comrades, haste! the way is long, The dirge it drowns the battle-song; The hunger preys, The famine slays, An awful horror veils our ways!"

Beneath the pall of prison wall The rush of hoofs they seem to hear; From loathsome guise they lift their eyes, And beat their bars and bend their ear.

"Ah, God be thanked! our friends are nigh; He wills it not that thus we die; O fiends accurst Of Want and Thirst, Our comrades gather,--do your worst!"

A sharp affright runs through the night, An ambush stirred, a column reined; The hurrying steed has checked his speed, His smoking flanks are crimson stained.

O noble son of noble sire, Thine ears are deaf to our desire! O knightly grace Of valiant race, The grave is honor's trysting-place!

O life so pure! O faith so sure! O heart so brave, and true, and strong! With tips of flame is writ your name, In annaled deed and storied song!

It flares across the solemn night, It glitters in the radiant light; A jewel set, Unnumbered yet, In our Republic's coronet!

KATE BROWNLEE SHERWOOD.

On May 1, 1864, a general advance was ordered, and two days later the Army of the Potomac, one hundred and thirty thousand strong, advanced into the Wilderness, south of the Rapidan. There, on May 5, Lee hurled his forces upon them. On the second day, Lee seized the colors of a Texas regiment and started to lead an assault in person. The men remonstrated and promised to carry the position if Lee would retire. The troops advanced shouting, "Lee to the rear!" and kept their word.

LEE TO THE REAR

[May 6, 1864]

Dawn of a pleasant morning in May Broke through the Wilderness cool and gray; While perched in the tallest tree-tops, the birds Were carolling Mendelssohn's "Songs without Words."

Far from the haunts of men remote, The brook brawled on with a liquid note; And Nature, all tranquil and lovely, wore The smile of the spring, as in Eden of yore.

Little by little, as daylight increased, And deepened the roseate flush in the East-- Little by little did morning reveal Two long glittering lines of steel;

Where two hundred thousand bayonets gleam, Tipped with the light of the earliest beam, And the faces are sullen and grim to see In the hostile armies of Grant and Lee.

All of a sudden, ere rose the sun, Pealed on the silence the opening gun-- A little white puff of smoke there came, And anon the valley was wreathed in flame.

Down on the left of the Rebel lines, Where a breastwork stands in a copse of pines, Before the Rebels their ranks can form, The Yankees have carried the place by storm.

Stars and Stripes on the salient wave, Where many a hero has found a grave, And the gallant Confederates strive in vain The ground they have drenched with their blood, to regain.

Yet louder the thunder of battle roared-- Yet a deadlier fire on the columns poured; Slaughter infernal rode with Despair, Furies twain, through the murky air.

Not far off, in the saddle there sat A gray-bearded man in a black slouched hat; Not much moved by the fire was he, Calm and resolute Robert Lee.

Quick and watchful he kept his eye On the bold Rebel brigades close by,-- Reserves that were standing (and dying) at ease, While the tempest of wrath toppled over the trees.

For still with their loud, deep, bull-dog bay, The Yankee batteries blazed away, And with every murderous second that sped A dozen brave fellows, alas! fell dead.

The grand old graybeard rode to the space Where Death and his victims stood face to face, And silently waved his old slouched hat-- A world of meaning there was in that!

"Follow me! Steady! We'll save the day!" This was what he seemed to say; And to the light of his glorious eye The bold brigades thus made reply:

"We'll go forward, but you must go back"-- And they moved not an inch in the perilous track: "Go to the rear, and we'll send them to hell!" And the sound of the battle was lost in their yell.

Turning his bridle, Robert Lee Rode to the rear. Like waves of the sea, Bursting the dikes in their overflow, Madly his veterans dashed on the foe.

And backward in terror that foe was driven, Their banners rent and their columns riven, Wherever the tide of battle rolled Over the Wilderness, wood and wold.

Sunset out of a crimson sky Streamed o'er a field of ruddier dye, And the brook ran on with a purple stain, From the blood of ten thousand foemen slain.

Seasons have passed since that day and year-- Again o'er its pebbles the brook runs clear, And the field in a richer green is drest Where the dead of a terrible conflict rest.

Hushed is the roll of the Rebel drum, The sabres are sheathed, and the cannon are dumb; And Fate, with his pitiless hand, has furled The flag that once challenged the gaze of the world;

But the fame of the Wilderness fight abides; And down into history grandly rides, Calm and unmoved as in battle he sat, The gray-bearded man in the black slouched hat.

JOHN RANDOLPH THOMPSON.

For two weeks a frightful struggle raged. The Union losses were fearful, but on May 11, 1864, Grant wired to the Secretary of War, "I propose to fight it out on this line, if it takes all summer."

CAN'T

How history repeats itself You'll say when you remember Grant, Who, in his boyhood days, once sought Throughout the lexicon for "can't."

He could not find the word that day, The earnest boy whose name was Grant; He never found it through long years, With all their power to disenchant.

No hostile host could give him pause; Rivers and mountains could not daunt; He never found that hindering word-- The steadfast man whose name was Grant.

HARRIET PRESCOTT SPOFFORD.

Grant used his cavalry most effectively, and he had a dashing leader in "Phil" Sheridan. Early in May, 1864, Sheridan and a strong force was sent on a raid around the Confederate lines, and on the 12th encountered General J. E. B. Stuart in force at Yellow Tavern. A sharp engagement followed, in which Stuart was killed.

OBSEQUIES OF STUART

[May 12, 1864]

We could not pause, while yet the noontide air Shook with the cannonade's incessant pealing, The funeral pageant fitly to prepare-- A nation's grief revealing.

The smoke, above the glimmering woodland wide That skirts our southward border in its beauty, Marked where our heroes stood and fought and died For love and faith and duty.

And still, what time the doubtful strife went on, We might not find expression for our sorrow; We could but lay our dear dumb warrior down, And gird us for the morrow.

One weary year agone, when came a lull With victory in the conflict's stormy closes, When the glad Spring, all flushed and beautiful, First mocked us with her roses,

With dirge and bell and minute-gun, we paid Some few poor rites--an inexpressive token Of a great people's pain--to Jackson's shade, In agony unspoken.

No wailing trumpet and no tolling bell, No cannon, save the battle's boom receding, When Stuart to the grave we bore, might tell, With hearts all crushed and bleeding.

The crisis suited not with pomp, and she Whose anguish bears the seal of consecration Had wished his Christian obsequies should be Thus void of ostentation.

Only the maidens came, sweet flowers to twine Above his form so still and cold and painless, Whose deeds upon our brightest records shine, Whose life and sword were stainless.

They well remembered how he loved to dash Into the fight, festooned from summer bowers; How like a fountain's spray his sabre's flash Leaped from a mass of flowers.

And so we carried to his place of rest All that of our great Paladin was mortal: The cross, and not the sabre, on his breast, That opes the heavenly portal.

No more of tribute might to us remain; But there will still come a time when Freedom's martyrs A richer guerdon of renown shall gain Than gleams in stars and garters.

I hear from out that sunlit land which lies Beyond these clouds that gather darkly o'er us, The happy sounds of industry arise In swelling peaceful chorus.

And mingling with these sounds, the glad acclaim Of millions undisturbed by war's afflictions, Crowning each martyr's never-dying name With grateful benedictions.

In some fair future garden of delights, Where flowers shall bloom and song-birds sweetly warble, Art shall erect the statues of our knights In living bronze and marble.

And none of all that bright heroic throng Shall wear to far-off time a semblance grander, Shall still be decked with fresher wreaths of song, Than this beloved commander.

The Spanish legend tells us of the Cid, That after death he rode, erect, sedately, Along his lines, even as in life he did, In presence yet more stately;

And thus our Stuart, at this moment, seems To ride out of our dark and troubled story Into the region of romance and dreams, A realm of light and glory;

And sometimes, when the silver bugles blow, That ghostly form, in battle reappearing, Shall lead his horsemen headlong on the foe, In victory careering!

JOHN RANDOLPH THOMPSON.

Grant was overwhelming the Confederates by weight of numbers, and pushed slowly on. To divert him, Lee threw a portion of his army into the Shenandoah valley, and started again to invade Maryland and Pennsylvania. A body of Union troops contested their passage at Snicker's Ferry and a sharp skirmish followed.

A CHRISTOPHER OF THE SHENANDOAH

ISLAND FORD, SNICKER'S GAP, JULY 18, 1864

TOLD BY THE ORDERLY

Mute he sat in the saddle,--mute 'midst our full acclaim, As three times over we gave to the mountain echo his name. Then, "But I couldn't do less!" in a murmur remonstrant came.

This was the deed his spirit set and his hand would not shun, When the vale of the Shenandoah had lost the glow of the sun, And the evening cloud and the battle smoke were blending in one.

Retreating and ever retreating, the bank of the river we gained, Hope of the field was none, and choice but of flight remained, When there at the brink of the ford his horse he suddenly reined.

For his vigilant eye had marked where, close by the oozy marge, Half-parted its moorings, there lay a battered and oarless barge. "Quick! gather the wounded in!" and the flying stayed at his charge.

They gathered the wounded in whence they fell by the river-bank, Lapped on the gleaming sand, or aswoon, 'mid the rushes dank; And they crowded the barge till its sides low down in the water sank.

The river was wide, was deep, and heady the current flowed, A burdened and oarless craft!--straight into the stream he rode By the side of the barge, and drew it along with its moaning load.

A moaning and ghastly load--the wounded--the dying--the dead! For ever upon their traces followed the whistling lead, Our bravest the mark, yet unscathed and undaunted, he pushed ahead.

Alone? Save for one that from love of his leader or soldierly pride (Hearing his call for aid, and seeing that none replied), Plunged and swam by the crazy craft on the other side.

But Heaven! what weary toil! for the river is wide, is deep; The current is swift, and the bank on the further side is steep. 'Tis reached at last, and a hundred of ours to the rescue leap.

Oh, they cheered as he rose from the stream and the water-drops flowed away! "But I couldn't do less!" in the silence that followed we heard him say; Then the wounded cheered, and the swooning awoke in the barge where they lay.

And I?--Ah, well, I swam by the barge on the other side; But an orderly goes wherever his leader chooses to ride. Come life or come death I couldn't do less than follow his guide.

EDITH M. THOMAS.

The Confederate cavalry pushed on toward the Susquehanna, sacked Chambersburg, and filled all western Pennsylvania with panic. Grant at once got together a large force to repel this invasion, and placed it under command of General Sheridan. On September 19, 1864, the Confederates attacked his troops at Winchester, but Sheridan beat them off and punished them so severely that he supposed they had enough. With that impression, he went to Washington on official business, leaving his men strongly posted on Cedar Creek. There, on the morning of October 19, the Confederates attacked them, front, flank, and rear.

SHERIDAN AT CEDAR CREEK

[October 19, 1864]

Shoe the steed with silver That bore him to the fray, When he heard the guns at dawning-- Miles away; When he heard them calling, calling-- Mount! nor stay: Quick, or all is lost; They've surprised and stormed the post, They push your routed host-- Gallop! retrieve the day.

House the horse in ermine-- For the foam-flake blew White through the red October; He thundered into view; They cheered him in the looming, Horseman and horse they knew. The turn of the tide began, The rally of bugles ran, He swung his hat in the van; The electric hoof-spark flew.

Wreathe the steed and lead him-- For the charge he led Touched and turned the cypress Into amaranths for the head Of Philip, king of riders, Who raised them from the dead. The camp (at dawning lost) By eve, recovered--forced, Rang with laughter of the host As belated Early fled.

Shroud the horse in sable-- For the mounds they heap! There is firing in the Valley, And yet no strife they keep; It is the parting volley, It is the pathos deep. There is glory for the brave Who lead, and nobly save, But no knowledge in the grave Where the nameless followers sleep.

HERMAN MELVILLE.

Sheridan, returning from Washington, had slept at Winchester the night of October 18, 1864, and early next morning heard the sounds of the battle. He mounted his horse and started for the field, reached there just in time to rally his retreating troops, turned a defeat into a decisive victory, and drove the invaders pell-mell back to Virginia.

SHERIDAN'S RIDE

[October 19, 1864]

Up from the South, at break of day, Bringing to Winchester fresh dismay, The affrighted air with a shudder bore, Like a herald in haste to the chieftain's door, The terrible grumble, and rumble, and roar, Telling the battle was on once more, And Sheridan twenty miles away.

And wider still those billows of war Thundered along the horizon's bar; And louder yet into Winchester rolled The roar of that red sea uncontrolled, Making the blood of the listener cold, As he thought of the stake in that fiery fray, With Sheridan twenty miles away.

But there is a road from Winchester town, A good, broad highway leading down: And there, through the flush of the morning light, A steed as black as the steeds of night Was seen to pass, as with eagle flight; As if he knew the terrible need, He stretched away with his utmost speed. Hills rose and fell, but his heart was gay, With Sheridan fifteen miles away.

Still sprang from those swift hoofs, thundering south, The dust like smoke from the cannon's mouth, Or the trail of a comet, sweeping faster and faster, Foreboding to traitors the doom of disaster. The heart of the steed and the heart of the master Were beating like prisoners assaulting their walls, Impatient to be where the battle-field calls; Every nerve of the charger was strained to full play, With Sheridan only ten miles away.

Under his spurning feet, the road Like an arrowy Alpine river flowed, And the landscape sped away behind Like an ocean flying before the wind; And the steed, like a bark fed with furnace ire, Swept on, with his wild eye full of fire; But, lo! he is nearing his heart's desire; He is snuffing the smoke of the roaring fray, With Sheridan only five miles away.

The first that the general saw were the groups Of stragglers, and then the retreating troops; What was done? what to do? a glance told him both. Then striking his spurs with a terrible oath, He dashed down the line, mid a storm of huzzas, And the wave of retreat checked its course there, because The sight of the master compelled it to pause. With foam and with dust the black charger was gray; By the flash of his eye, and the red nostril's play, He seemed to the whole great army to say: "I have brought you Sheridan all the way From Winchester down to save the day."

Hurrah! hurrah for Sheridan! Hurrah! hurrah for horse and man! And when their statues are placed on high Under the dome of the Union sky, The American soldier's Temple of Fame, There, with the glorious general's name, Be it said, in letters both bold and bright: "Here is the steed that saved the day By carrying Sheridan into the fight, From Winchester--twenty miles away!"

THOMAS BUCHANAN READ.

Grant, meanwhile, steadily tightened his grip on Richmond, and Lee at last perceived that to hold the capital longer would be to sacrifice his army. He withdrew during the night of April 2, 1865, and the Union troops entered the city unopposed next day.

THE YEAR OF JUBILEE

[Sung by the negro troops as they entered Richmond]

Say, darkeys, hab you seen de massa, Wid de muffstash on he face, Go long de road some time dis mornin', Like he gwine leabe de place? He see de smoke way up de ribber Whar de Lincum gunboats lay; He took he hat an' leff berry sudden, And I spose he's runned away. De massa run, ha, ha! De darkey stay, ho, ho! It mus' be now de kingdum comin', An' de yar ob jubilo.

He six foot one way an' two foot todder, An' he weigh six hundred poun'; His coat so big he couldn't pay de tailor, An' it won't reach half way roun'; He drill so much dey calls him cap'n, An' he git so mighty tanned, I spec he'll try to fool dem Yankees, For to tink he contraband. De massa run, ha, ha! De darkey stay, ho, ho! It mus' be now de kingdum comin', An' de yar ob jubilo.

De darkeys got so lonesome libb'n In de log hut on de lawn, Dey moved dere tings into massa's parlor For to keep it while he gone. Dar's wine an' cider in de kitchin, An' de darkeys dey hab some, I spec it will be all fiscated. When de Lincum sojers come. De massa run, ha, ha! De darkey stay, ho, ho! It mus' be now de kingdum comin', An' de yar ob jubilo.

De oberseer he makes us trubble, An' he dribe us roun' a spell, We lock him up in de smoke-house cellar, Wid de key flung in de well. De whip am lost, de han'-cuff broke, But de massy hab his pay; He big an' ole enough for to know better Dan to went an' run away. De massa run, ha, ha! De darkey stay, ho, ho! It mus' be now de kingdum comin', An' de yar ob jubilo.

HENRY CLAY WORK.

VIRGINIA CAPTA

APRIL, 1865

Unconquer'd captive!--close thine eye, And draw the ashen sackcloth o'er, And in thy speechless woe deplore The fate that would not let thee die!

The arm that wore the shield, strip bare; The hand that held the martial rein, And hurled the spear on many a plain,-- Stretch--till they clasp the shackles there!

The foot that once could crush the crown, Must drag the fetters, till it bleed Beneath their weight:--thou dost not need It now, to tread the tyrant down.

Thou thought'st him vanquished--boastful trust!-- His lance, in twain--his sword, a wreck,-- But with his heel upon thy neck, He holds _thee_ prostrate in the dust!

Bend though thou must, beneath his will, Let not one abject moan have place; But with majestic, silent grace, Maintain thy regal bearing still.

Look back through all thy storied past, And sit erect in conscious pride: No grander heroes ever died-- No sterner, battled to the last!

Weep, if thou wilt, with proud, sad mien, Thy blasted hopes--thy peace undone,-- Yet brave, live on,--nor seek to shun Thy fate, like Egypt's conquer'd Queen.

Though forced a captive's place to fill In the triumphal train,--yet there, Superbly, like Zenobia, wear Thy chains,--_Virginia Victrix_ still!

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

Tidings of the fall of Richmond went over the North with lightning speed, and in every city, every town and hamlet, public demonstrations were held.

THE FALL OF RICHMOND

THE TIDINGS RECEIVED IN THE NORTHERN METROPOLIS (APRIL, 1865)

What mean these peals from every tower, And crowds like seas that sway? The cannon reply; they speak the heart Of the People impassioned, and say-- A city in flags for a city in flames, Richmond goes Babylon's way-- _Sing and pray_.

O weary years and woeful wars, And armies in the grave; But hearts unquelled at last deter The helmed dilated Lucifer-- Honor to Grant the brave, Whose three stars now like Orion's rise When wreck is on the wave-- _Bless his glaive_.

Well that the faith we firmly kept, And never our aim forswore For the Terrors that trooped from each recess When fainting we fought in the Wilderness, And Hell made loud hurrah; But God is in Heaven, and Grant in the Town, And Right through Might is Law-- _God's way adore_.

HERMAN MELVILLE.

Lee, meanwhile, was trying desperately to escape the force which Grant had sent in pursuit of him. His army was dreadfully shattered and without supplies; his horses were too weak to draw the cannon; and he soon found himself surrounded by a vastly superior force. To fight would have been folly; instead, he sent forward a white flag, and surrendered at two o'clock on the afternoon of Palm Sunday, April 9, 1865.

THE SURRENDER AT APPOMATTOX

[April 9, 1865]

As billows upon billows roll, On victory victory breaks; Ere yet seven days from Richmond's fall And crowning triumph wakes The loud joy-gun, whose thunders run By sea-shore, streams, and lakes. The hope and great event agree In the sword that Grant received from Lee.

The warring eagles fold the wing, But not in Cæsar's sway; Not Rome o'ercome by Roman arms we sing, As on Pharsalia's day, But Treason thrown, though a giant grown, And Freedom's larger play. All human tribes glad token see In the close of the wars of Grant and Lee.

HERMAN MELVILLE.

Grant was generous with the fallen enemy; too generous, some of the patriot politicians thought, in releasing Lee and his officers on parole; but Grant insisted that the terms he had given be carried out to the letter.

LEE'S PAROLE

"Well, General Grant, have you heard the news? How the orders are issued and ready to send For Lee, and the men in his staff-command, To be under arrest,--now the war's at an end?"

"How so? Arrested for what?" he cried. "Oh, for trial as traitors, to be shot, or hung." The chief's eye flashed with a sudden ire, And his face grew crimson as up he sprung. "Orderly, fetch me my horse," he said. Then into the saddle and up the street, As if the battle were raging ahead, Went the crash of the old war-charger's feet.

"What is this I am told about Lee's arrest,-- Is it true?"--and the keen eyes searched his soul. "It _is_ true, and the order will be enforced!" "_My_ word was given in their parole At Richmond, and that parole Has not been broken,--nor has my word, Nor _will be_ until there is better cause For breaking than this I have lately heard."

"Do you know, sir, whom you have thus addressed? I am the War Department's head--" "And I--am General Grant! At your peril order arrests!" he said.

* * * * *

A friend is a friend, as we reckon worth, Who will throw the gauntlet in friendship's fight; But a man is a man in peace or war Who will stake his all for an enemy's right. 'Twas a hard-fought battle, but quickly won,-- As a fight must be when 'tis soul to soul,-- And 'twas years ago; but that honored word Preserved the North in the South's parole.

MARION MANVILLE.

In disbanding his army, Lee issued a farewell address, copies of which are still treasured in many a Southern home. Even in the North, he has come to be recognized as the great general and true gentleman he really was.

ROBERT E. LEE

A gallant foeman in the fight, A brother when the fight was o'er, The hand that led the host with might The blessed torch of learning bore.

No shriek of shells nor roll of drums, No challenge fierce, resounding far, When reconciling Wisdom comes To heal the cruel wounds of war.

Thought may the minds of men divide, Love makes the heart of nations one, And so, thy soldier grave beside, We honor thee, Virginia's son.

JULIA WARD HOWE.

CHAPTER XI

WINSLOW AND FARRAGUT

During the Civil War, the Confederates commissioned a large number of privateers to prey upon Northern commerce, the most famous of which was the Alabama, commanded by Raphael Semmes. Semmes had orders to sink, burn, and destroy everything flying the Stars and Stripes, and carried them out in the most thorough-going way. On June 11, 1864, the Alabama entered the harbor of Cherbourg, France. Three days later, the United States sloop-of-war Kearsarge, Captain John A. Winslow, appeared in the offing, and both ships prepared for battle. The Alabama steamed out of the harbor on the morning of Sunday, June 19, and was soon reduced to a wreck by the deadly fire from the Kearsarge. She sank while trying to run inshore.

THE EAGLE AND VULTURE

[June, 1864]

In Cherbourg Roads the pirate lay One morn in June, like a beast at bay, Feeling secure in the neutral port, Under the guns of the Frenchman's fort; A thieving vulture; a coward thing; Sheltered beneath a despot's wing.

But there outside, in the calm blue bay, Our ocean-eagle, the Kearsarge, lay; Lay at her ease on the Sunday morn, Holding the Corsair ship in scorn; With captain and crew in the might of their right, Willing to pray, but more eager to fight.

Four bells are struck, and this thing of night, Like a panther, crouching with fierce affright, _Must_ leap from his cover, and, come what may, _Must_ fight for his life, or steal away! So, out of the port with his braggart air, With flaunting flags, sailed the proud Corsair.

The Cherbourg cliffs were all alive With lookers-on, like a swarming hive; While compelled to do what he dared not shirk, The pirate went to his desperate work; And Europe's tyrants looked on in glee, As they thought of our Kearsarge sunk in the sea.

But our little bark smiled back at them A smile of contempt, with that Union gem, The American banner, far floating and free, Proclaiming her champions were out on the sea; Were out on the sea, and abroad on the land, Determined to win under God's command.

Down came the vulture; our eagle sat still, Waiting to strike with her iron-clad bill; Convinced by the glow of his glorious cause, He could crumple his foe in the grasp of his claws.

"Clear the decks," then said Winslow, words measured and slow; "Point the guns, and prepare for the terrible blow; And whatever the fate to ourselves may be, We will sink in the ocean this pest of the sea."

The decks were all cleared, and the guns were all manned, Awaiting to meet this Atlantic brigand; When, lo! roared a broadside; the ship of the thief Was torn, and wept blood in that moment of grief.

Another! another! another! And still The broadsides went in with a hearty good will, Till the pirate reeled wildly, as staggering and drunk, And down to his own native regions he sunk.

Down, down, forty fathoms beneath the blue wave, And the hopes of old Europe lie in the same grave; While Freedom, more firm, stands upon her own sod, And for heroes like Winslow is shouting, "Thank God!"

THOMAS BUCHANAN READ.

KEARSARGE AND ALABAMA

[June 19, 1864]

It was early Sunday morning, in the year of sixty-four, The Alabama she steam'd out along the Frenchman's shore. Long time she cruised about, Long time she held her sway, But now beneath the Frenchman's shore she lies off Cherbourg Bay. Hoist up the flag, and long may it wave Over the Union, the home of the brave. Hoist up the flag, and long may it wave, God bless America, the home of the brave!

The Yankee cruiser hove in view, the Kearsarge was her name, It ought to be engraved in full upon the scroll of fame; Her timbers made of Yankee oak, And her crew of Yankee tars. And o'er her mizzen peak she floats the glorious stripes and stars.

A challenge unto Captain Semmes, bold Winslow he did send! "Bring on your Alabama, and to her we will attend, For we think your boasting privateer Is not so hard to whip; And we'll show you that the Kearsarge is not a merchant ship."

It was early Sunday morning, in the year of sixty-four, The Alabama she stood out and cannons loud did roar; The Kearsarge stood undaunted, and quickly she replied And let a Yankee 'leven-inch shell go tearing through her side.

The Kearsarge then she wore around and broadside on did bear, With shot and shell and right good-will, her timbers she did tear; When they found that they were sinking, down came the stars and bars, For the rebel gunners could not stand the glorious stripes and stars.

The Alabama she is gone, she'll cruise the seas no more, She met the fate she well deserved along the Frenchman's shore; Then here is luck to the Kearsarge, we know what she can do, Likewise to Captain Winslow and his brave and gallant crew. Hoist up the flag, and long may it wave Over the Union, the home of the brave! Hoist up the flag, and long may it wave, God bless America, the home of the brave!

KEARSARGE

[June 19, 1864]

Sunday in Old England: In gray churches everywhere The calm of low responses, The sacred hush of prayer.

Sunday in Old England: And summer winds that went O'er the pleasant fields of Sussex, The garden lands of Kent,

Stole into dim church windows And passed the oaken door, And fluttered open prayer-books With the cannon's awful roar.

Sunday in New England: Upon a mountain gray The wind-bent pines are swaying Like giants at their play;

Across the barren lowlands, Where men find scanty food, The north wind brings its vigor To homesteads plain and rude.

Ho, land of pine and granite! Ho, hardy northland breeze! Well have you trained the manhood That shook the Channel seas,

When o'er those storied waters The iron war-bolts flew, And through Old England's churches The summer breezes blew;

While in our other England Stirred one gaunt rocky steep, When rode her sons as victors, Lords of the lonely deep.

S. WEIR MITCHELL.

LONDON, July 20, 1864.

THE ALABAMA

She has gone to the bottom! the wrath of the tide Now breaks in vain insolence o'er her; No more the rough seas like a queen shall she ride, While the foe flies in terror before her!

Now captive or exiled, or silent in death, The forms that so bravely did man her; Her deck is untrod, and the gale's stirring breath Flouts no more the red cross of her banner!

She is down 'neath the waters, but still her bright name Is in death, as in life, ever glorious, And a sceptre all barren the conqueror must claim, Though he boasts the proud title "Victorious."

Her country's lone champion, she shunned not the fight, Though unequal in strength, bold and fearless; And proved in her fate, though not matchless in might, In daring at least she was peerless.

No trophy hung high in the foe's hated hall Shall speak of her final disaster, Nor tell of the danger that could not appall, Nor the spirit that nothing could master!

The death-shot has sped--she has grimly gone down, But left her destroyer no token, And the mythical wand of her mystic renown, Though the waters o'erwhelm, is unbroken.

For lo! ere she settles beneath the dark wave On her enemies' cheeks spreads a pallor, As another deck summons the swords of the brave To gild a new name with their valor.

Her phantom will yet haunt the wild roaring breeze, Causing foemen to start and to shudder, While their commerce still steals like a thief o'er the seas, And trembles from bowsprit to rudder.

The spirit that shed on the wave's gleaming crest The light of a legend romantic Shall live while a sail flutters over the breast Of thy far-bounding billows, Atlantic!

And as long as one swift keel the strong surges stems, Or "poor Jack" loves his song and his story, Shall shine in tradition the valor of Semmes And the brave ship that bore him to glory!

MAURICE BELL.

Mobile and Wilmington were the only important Confederate ports still open, and early in August, 1864, Admiral Farragut appeared off Mobile with a fleet of eighteen vessels. The entrance to the harbor was strongly defended by forts on both sides, but Farragut determined to run past them. On August 5 the fleet advanced, but the Tecumseh, leading the fleet, struck a torpedo and sank instantly, carrying down nearly all her crew, including T. A. M. Craven, her commander, who drew aside from the ladder that the pilot might pass first.

CRAVEN

[August 5, 1864]

Over the turret, shut in his ironclad tower, Craven was conning his ship through smoke and flame; Gun to gun he had battered the fort for an hour. Now was the time for a charge to end the game.

There lay the narrowing channel, smooth and grim, A hundred deaths beneath it, and never a sign; There lay the enemy's ships, and sink or swim The flag was flying, and he was head of the line.

The fleet behind was jamming: the monitor hung Beating the stream; the roar for a moment hushed; Craven spoke to the pilot; slow she swung; Again he spoke, and right for the foe she rushed

Into the narrowing channel, between the shore And the sunk torpedoes lying in treacherous rank; She turned but a yard too short; a muffled roar, A mountainous wave, and she rolled, righted, and sank.

Over the manhole, up in the ironclad tower, Pilot and captain met as they turned to fly: The hundredth part of a moment seemed an hour, For one could pass to be saved, and one must die.

They stood like men in a dream; Craven spoke,-- Spoke as he lived and fought, with a captain's pride: "After you, Pilot." The pilot woke, Down the ladder he went, and Craven died.

All men praise the deed and the manner; but we-- We set it apart from the pride that stoops to the proud, The strength that is supple to serve the strong and free, The grace of the empty hands and promises loud;

Sidney thirsting a humbler need to slake, Nelson waiting his turn for the surgeon's hand, Lucas crushed with chains for a comrade's sake, Outram coveting right before command,

These were paladins, these were Craven's peers, These with him shall be crowned in story and song, Crowned with the glitter of steel and the glimmer of tears, Princes of courtesy, merciful, proud, and strong.

HENRY NEWBOLT.

Farragut, who had lashed himself to the shrouds of his flagship, the Hartford, observed the Brooklyn, which preceded him, recoil as the Tecumseh sank. "What's the trouble?" he signalled. "Torpedoes!" answered the Brooklyn. "Damn the torpedoes!" shouted Farragut. "Go ahead, Captain Drayton! Four bells!" and the Hartford cleared the Brooklyn and took the lead.

FARRAGUT

(MOBILE BAY, August 5, 1864)

Farragut, Farragut, Old Heart of Oak, Daring Dave Farragut, Thunderbolt stroke, Watches the hoary mist Lift from the bay, Till his flag, glory-kissed, Greets the young day.

Far, by gray Morgan's walls, Looms the black fleet. Hark, deck to rampart calls With the drums' beat! Buoy your chains overboard, While the steam hums; Men! to the battlement, Farragut comes.

See, as the hurricane Hurtles in wrath Squadrons of clouds amain Back from its path! Back to the parapet, To the guns' lips, Thunderbolt Farragut Hurls the black ships.

Now through the battle's roar Clear the boy sings, "By the mark fathoms four," While his lead swings. Steady the wheelmen five "Nor' by East keep her," "Steady," but two alive: How the shells sweep her!

Lashed to the mast that sways Over red decks, Over the flame that plays Round the torn wrecks, Over the dying lips Framed for a cheer, Farragut leads his ships, Guides the line clear.

On by heights cannon-browed, While the spars quiver; Onward still flames the cloud Where the hulks shiver. See, yon fort's star is set, Storm and fire past. Cheer him, lads--Farragut, Lashed to the mast!

Oh! while Atlantic's breast Bears a white sail, While the Gulf's towering crest Tops a green vale, Men thy bold deeds shall tell, Old Heart of Oak, Daring Dave Farragut, Thunderbolt stroke!

WILLIAM TUCKEY MEREDITH.

On went the flagship across the line of torpedoes, but not one of them exploded, and a moment later one of the most daring feats in the naval history of the world had been safely accomplished. The line of battle was re-formed, the forts and Confederate fleet savagely attacked, and by nine o'clock the Union fleet was in the bay.

THROUGH FIRE IN MOBILE BAY

[August 5, 1864]

I'd weave a wreath for those who fought In blue upon the waves, I drop a tear for all who sleep Down in the coral caves, And proudly do I touch my cap Whene'er I meet to-day A man who sail'd with Farragut Thro' fire in Mobile Bay.

Oh, what a gallant sight it was As toward the foe we bore! Lashed to the mast, unflinching, stood Our grand old Commodore. I see him now above the deck, Though time has cleared away The battle smoke that densely hung Above old Mobile Bay.

Torpedoes to the right and left, Torpedoes straight ahead! The stanch Tecumseh sinks from sight, The waves receive her dead. But on we press, thro' lead and iron, On, on with pennons gay, Whilst glory holds her wreath above Immortal Mobile Bay.

The rebel forts belch fire and death, But what care we for them? Our onward course, with Farragut To guide us, nought can stem. The Hartford works her dreaded guns, The Brooklyn pounds away, And proudly flies the flag of stars Aloft o'er Mobile Bay.

Behold yon moving mass of iron Beyond the Ossipee; To fight the fleet with courage grim Steams forth the Tennessee. We hem her in with battle fire-- How furious grows the fray, Until Surrender's flag she flies Above red Mobile Bay.

We count our dead, we count our scars, The proudest ever won; We cheer the flag that gayly flies Victorious in the sun. No longer in the rigging stands The hero of the day, For he has linked his name fore'er To deathless Mobile Bay.

Thus I would weave a wreath for all Who fought with us that time, And I'd embalm that glorious day Forevermore in rhyme. The stars above will rise and set, The years will pass away, But brighter all the time shall grow The fame of Mobile Bay.

He sleeps, the bluff old Commodore Who led with hearty will; But ah! methinks I see him now, Lashed to the rigging still. I know that just beyond the tide, In God's own glorious day, He waits to greet the gallant tars Who fought in Mobile Bay.

The ships were brought to anchor and breakfast was being served, when the great Confederate ram, Tennessee, was seen advancing at full speed, to attack the whole fleet. A terrific struggle followed, in which nearly every one of the Union ships was badly damaged; but the Tennessee at last became unmanageable and was forced to surrender. The task of reducing the forts remained. This was completed in a few days and the port of Mobile was effectually closed.

THE BAY FIGHT

(MOBILE HARBOR, August 5, 1864)

Three days through sapphire seas we sailed, The steady Trade blew strong and free, The Northern Light his banners paled, The Ocean Stream our channels wet, We rounded low Canaveral's lee, And passed the isles of emerald set In blue Bahama's turquoise sea.

By reef and shoal obscurely mapped, The hauntings of the gray sea-wolf, The palmy Western Key lay lapped In the warm washing of the Gulf.

But weary to the hearts of all The burning glare, the barren reach Of Santa Rosa's withered beach, And Pensacola's ruined wall.

And weary was the long patrol, The thousand miles of shapeless strand, From Brazos to San Blas that roll Their drifting dunes of desert sand.

Yet coastwise as we cruised or lay, The land-breeze still at nightfall bore, By beach and fortress-guarded bay, Sweet odors from the enemy's shore,

Fresh from the forest solitudes, Unchallenged of his sentry lines,-- The bursting of his cypress buds, And the warm fragrance of his pines.

Ah, never braver bark and crew, Nor bolder Flag a foe to dare, Had left a wake on ocean blue Since Lion-Heart sailed Trenc-le-mer!

But little gain by that dark ground Was ours, save, sometime, freer breath For friend or brother strangely found, 'Scaped from the drear domain of death.

And little venture for the bold, Or laurel for our valiant Chief, Save some blockaded British thief, Full fraught with murder in his hold,

Caught unawares at ebb or flood, Or dull bombardment, day by day, With fort and earthwork, far away, Low couched in sullen leagues of mud.

A weary time,--but to the strong The day at last, as ever, came; And the volcano, laid so long, Leaped forth in thunder and in flame!

"_Man your starboard battery!_" Kimberly shouted;-- The ship, with her hearts of oak, Was going, 'mid roar and smoke, On to victory; None of us doubted, No, not our dying-- Farragut's Flag was flying!

Gaines growled low on our left, Morgan roared on our right; Before us, gloomy and fell, With breath like the fume of hell, Lay the dragon of iron shell, Driven at last to the fight!

Ha, old ship! do they thrill, The brave two hundred scars You got in the River-Wars? That were leeched with clamorous skill (Surgery savage and hard), Splinted with bolt and beam, Probed in scarfing and seam, Rudely linted and tarred With oakum and boiling pitch, And sutured with splice and hitch, At the Brooklyn Navy Yard!

Our lofty spars were down, To bide the battle's frown (Wont of old renown)-- But every ship was drest In her bravest and her best, As if for a July day; Sixty flags and three, As we floated up the bay-- At every peak and mast-head flew The brave Red, White, and Blue,-- We were eighteen ships that day.

With hawsers strong and taut, The weaker lashed to port, On we sailed two by two-- That if either a bolt should feel Crash through caldron or wheel, Fin of bronze, or sinew of steel, Her mate might bear her through.

Forging boldly ahead, The great Flag-Ship led, Grandest of sights! On her lofty mizzen flew Our leader's dauntless Blue, That had waved o'er twenty fights. So we went with the first of the tide, Slowly, 'mid the roar Of the rebel guns ashore And the thunder of each full broadside.

Ah, how poor the prate Of statute and state We once held these fellows! Here on the flood's pale green, Hark how he bellows, Each bluff old Sea-Lawyer! Talk to them, Dahlgren, Parrott, and Sawyer!

On, in the whirling shade Of the cannon's sulphury breath, We drew to the Line of Death That our devilish Foe had laid,-- Meshed in a horrible net, And baited villainous well, Right in our path were set Three hundred traps of hell!

And there, O sight forlorn! There, while the cannon Hurtled and thundered (Ah, what ill raven Flapped o'er the ship that morn!),-- Caught by the under-death, In the drawing of a breath Down went dauntless Craven, He and his hundred!

A moment we saw her turret, A little heel she gave, And a thin white spray went o'er her, Like the crest of a breaking wave;-- In that great iron coffin, The channel for their grave, The fort their monument (Seen afar in the offing), Ten fathom deep lie Craven And the bravest of our brave.

Then in that deadly track A little the ships held back, Closing up in their stations;-- There are minutes that fix the fate Of battles and of nations (Christening the generations), When valor were all too late. If a moment's doubt be harbored;-- From the main-top, bold and brief, Came the word of our grand old chief: "_Go on!_"--'twas all he said,-- Our helm was put to starboard, And the Hartford passed ahead.

Ahead lay the Tennessee, On our starboard bow he lay, With his mail-clad consorts three (The rest had run up the bay): There he was, belching flame from his bow, And the steam from his throat's abyss Was a Dragon's maddened hiss; In sooth a most cursed craft!-- In a sullen ring, at bay, By the Middle-Ground they lay, Raking us fore and aft.

Trust me, our berth was hot, Ah, wickedly well they shot-- How their death-bolts howled and stung! And the water-batteries played With their deadly cannonade Till the air around us rung; So the battle raged and roared;-- Ah, had you been aboard To have seen the fight we made! How they leapt, the tongues of flame, From the cannon's fiery lip! How the broadsides, deck and frame, Shook the great ship!

And how the enemy's shell Came crashing, heavy and oft, Clouds of splinters flying aloft And falling in oaken showers;-- But ah, the pluck of the crew! Had you stood on

that deck of ours, You had seen what men may do.

Still, as the fray grew louder, Boldly they worked and well-- Steadily came the powder, Steadily came the shell. And if tackle or truck found hurt, Quickly they cleared the wreck-- And the dead were laid to port, All a-row, on our deck.

Never a nerve that failed, Never a cheek that paled, Not a tinge of gloom or pallor;-- There was bold Kentucky's grit, And the old Virginian valor, And the daring Yankee wit. There were blue eyes from turfy Shannon, There were black orbs from palmy Niger,-- But there alongside the cannon, Each man fought like a tiger!

A little, once, it looked ill, Our consort began to burn-- They quenched the flames with a will, But our men were falling still, And still the fleet were astern.

Right abreast of the Fort In an awful shroud they lay, Broadsides thundering away, And lightning from every port; Scene of glory and dread! A storm-cloud all aglow With flashes of fiery red, The thunder raging below, And the forest of flags o'erhead!

So grand the hurly and roar, So fiercely their broadsides blazed, The regiments fighting ashore Forgot to fire as they gazed.

There, to silence the foe, Moving grimly and slow, They loomed in that deadly wreath, Where the darkest batteries frowned,-- Death in the air all round, And the black torpedoes beneath!

And now, as we looked ahead, All for'ard, the long white deck Was growing a strange dull red,-- But soon, as once and again Fore and aft we sped (The firing to guide or check), You could hardly choose but tread On the ghastly human wreck (Dreadful gobbet and shred That a minute ago were men!)

Red, from mainmast to bitts! Red, on bulwark and wale, Red, by combing and hatch, Red, o'er netting and vail!

And ever, with steady con, The ship forged slowly by,-- And ever the crew fought on, And their cheers rang loud and high.

Grand was the sight to see How by their guns they stood, Right in front of our dead, Fighting square abreast-- Each brawny arm and chest All spotted with black and red, Chrism of fire and blood!

Worth our watch, dull and sterile, Worth all the weary time, Worth the woe and the peril, To stand in that strait sublime!

Fear? A forgotten form! Death? A dream of the eyes! We were atoms in God's great storm That roared through the angry skies.

One only doubt was ours, One only dread we knew,-- Could the day that dawned so well Go down for the Darker Powers? _Would_ the fleet get through? And ever the shot and shell Came with the howl of hell, The splinter-clouds rose and fell, And the long line of corpses grew,-- _Would_ the fleet win through?

They are men that never will fail (How aforetime they've fought!), But Murder may yet prevail,-- They may sink as Craven sank. Therewith one hard fierce thought,

Burning on heart and lip, Ran like fire through the ship; _Fight_ her, to the last plank!

A dimmer renown might strike If Death lay square alongside,-- But the old Flag has no like, She must fight, whatever betide;-- When the War is a tale of old, And this day's story is told, They shall hear how the Hartford died!

But as we ranged ahead, And the leading ships worked in, Losing their hope to win, The enemy turned and fled-- And one seeks a shallow reach! And another, winged in her flight, Our mate, brave Jouett, brings in;-- And one, all torn in the fight, Runs for a wreck on the beach, Where her flames soon fire the night.

And the Ram, when well up the Bay, And we looked that our stems should meet (He had us fair for a prey), Shifting his helm midway, Sheered off, and ran for the fleet; There, without skulking or sham, He fought them gun for gun; And ever he sought to ram, But could finish never a one.

From the first of the iron shower Till we sent our parting shell, 'Twas just one savage hour Of the roar and the rage of hell.

With the lessening smoke and thunder, Our glasses around we aim,-- What is that burning yonder? Our Philippi--aground and in flame!

Below, 'twas still all a-roar, As the ships went by the shore, But the fire of the Fort had slacked (So fierce their volleys had been),-- And now with a mighty din, The whole fleet came grandly in, Though sorely battered and wracked.

So, up the Bay we ran, The Flag to port and ahead,-- And a pitying rain began To wash the lips of our dead.

A league from the Fort we lay, And deemed that the end must lag,-- When lo! looking down the Bay, There flaunted the Rebel Rag;-- The Ram is again under way And heading dead for the Flag!

Steering up with the stream, Boldly his course he lay, Though the fleet all answered his fire, And, as he still drew nigher, Ever on bow and beam Our Monitors pounded away; How the Chickasaw hammered away!

Quickly breasting the wave, Eager the prize to win, First of us all the brave Monongahela went in Under full head of steam;-- Twice she struck him abeam, Till her stem was a sorry work (She might have run on a crag!), The Lackawanna hit fair, He flung her aside like cork, And still he held for the Flag.

High in the mizzen shroud (Lest the smoke his sight o'erwhelm), Our Admiral's voice rang loud; "Hard-a-starboard your helm! _Starboard, and run him down!_" Starboard it was,--and so, Like a black squall's lifting frown, Our mighty bow bore down On the iron beak of the Foe.

We stood on the deck together, Men that had looked on death In battle and stormy weather; Yet a little we held our breath, When, with the hush of death, The great ships drew together.

Our Captain strode to the bow, Drayton, courtly and wise, Kindly cynic, and wise (You hardly had known him now, The flame of fight in his eyes!),-- His brave heart

eager to feel How the oak would tell on the steel!

But, as the space grew short, A little he seemed to shun us; Out peered a form grim and lanky, And a voice yelled, "_Hard-a-port! Hard-a-port!--here's the damned Yankee Coming right down on us!_"

He sheered, but the ships ran foul With a gnarring shudder and growl; He gave us a deadly gun; But as he passed in his pride (Rasping right alongside!), The old Flag, in thunder-tones Poured in her port broadside, Rattling his iron hide And cracking his timber-bones!

Just then, at speed on the Foe, With her bow all weathered and brown, The great Lackawanna came down Full tilt, for another blow;-- We were forging ahead, She reversed--but, for all our pains, Rammed the old Hartford, instead, Just for'ard the mizzen chains!

Ah! how the masts did buckle and bend, And the stout hull ring and reel, As she took us right on end! (Vain were engine and wheel, She was under full steam)-- With the roar of a thunder-stroke Her two thousand tons of oak Brought up on us, right abeam!

A wreck, as it looked, we lay (Rib and plank-sheer gave way To the stroke of that giant wedge!)-- Here, after all, we go-- The old ship is gone!--ah, no, But cut to the water's edge.

Never mind then,--at him again! His flurry now can't last long; He'll never again see land,-- Try that on _him_, Marchand! On him again, brave Strong!

Heading square at the hulk, Full on his beam we bore; But the spine of the huge Sea-Hog Lay on the tide like a log, He vomited flame no more.

By this, he had found it hot;-- Half the fleet, in an angry ring, Closed round the hideous thing, Hammering with solid shot, And bearing down, bow on bow; He has but a minute to choose,-- Life or renown?--which now Will the Rebel Admiral lose?

Cruel, haughty, and cold, He ever was strong and bold; Shall he shrink from a wooden stem? He will think of that brave band He sank in the Cumberland; Ay, he will sink like them.

Nothing left but to fight Boldly his last sea-fight! Can he strike? By Heaven, 'tis true! Down comes the traitor Blue, And up goes the captive White!

Up went the White! Ah, then The hurrahs that once and again Rang from three thousand men All flushed and savage with fight! Our dead lay cold and stark; But our dying, down in the dark, Answered as best they might, Lifting their poor lost arms, And cheering for God and Right!

Ended the mighty noise, Thunder of forts and ships. Down we went to the hold, Oh, our dear dying boys! How we pressed their poor brave lips (Ah, so pallid and cold!) And held their hands to the last (Those who had hands to hold).

Still thee, O woman heart! (So strong an hour ago); If the idle tears must start, 'Tis not in vain they flow.

They died, our children dear. On the drear berth-deck they died,-- Do not think of them here-- Even now their footsteps near The immortal, tender sphere (Land of love and cheer! Home of the Crucified!).

And the glorious deed survives; Our threescore, quiet and cold, Lie thus, for a myriad lives And treasure-millions untold (Labor of poor men's lives, Hunger of weans and wives, Such is war-wasted gold).

Our ship and her fame to-day Shall float on the storied Stream When mast and shroud have crumbled away, And her long white deck is a dream.

One daring leap in the dark, Three mortal hours, at the most,-- And hell lies stiff and stark On a hundred leagues of coast.

For the mighty Gulf is ours,-- The bay is lost and won, An Empire is lost and won! Land, if thou yet hast flowers, Twine them in one more wreath Of tenderest white and red (Twin buds of glory and death!), For the brows of our brave dead, For thy Navy's noblest son.

Joy, O Land, for thy sons, Victors by flood and field! The traitor walls and guns Have nothing left but to yield (Even now they surrender!).

And the ships shall sail once more, And the cloud of war sweep on To break on the cruel shore;-- But Craven is gone, He and his hundred are gone.

The flags flutter up and down At sunrise and twilight dim, The cannons menace and frown,-- But never again for him, Him and the hundred.

The Dahlgrens are dumb, Dumb are the mortars; Never more shall the drum Beat to colors and quarters,-- The great guns are silent.

O brave heart and loyal! Let all your colors dip;-- Mourn him proud ship! From main deck to royal. God rest our Captain, Rest our lost hundred!

Droop, flag and pennant! What is your pride for? Heaven, that he died for, Rest our Lieutenant, Rest our brave threescore!

* * * * *

O Mother Land! this weary life We led, we lead, is 'long of thee; Thine the strong agony of strife, And thine the lonely sea.

Thine the long decks all slaughter-sprent, The weary rows of cots that lie With wrecks of strong men, marred and rent, 'Neath Pensacola's sky.

And thine the iron caves and dens Wherein the flame our war-fleet drives; The fiery vaults, whose breath is men's Most dear and precious lives!

Ah, ever when with storm sublime Dread Nature clears our murky air, Thus in the crash of falling crime Some lesser guilt must share.

Full red the furnace fires must glow That melt the ore of mortal kind; The mills of God are grinding slow, But ah, how close they grind!

To-day the Dahlgren and the drum Are dread Apostles of His Name; His kingdom here can only come By chrism of blood and flame.

Be strong: already slants the gold Athwart these wild and stormy skies: From out this blackened waste, behold What happy homes shall rise!

But see thou well no traitor gloze, No striking hands with Death and Shame, Betray the sacred blood that flows So freely for thy name.

And never fear a victor foe-- Thy children's hearts are strong and high; Nor mourn too fondly; well they know On deck or field to die.

Nor shalt thou want one willing breath, Though, ever smiling round the brave, The blue sea bear us on to death, The green were one wide grave.

HENRY HOWARD BROWNELL.

One more naval action remains to be recorded. The blockading fleet on the Carolina coast had been constantly threatened by the Confederate ram Albemarle. Finally, late in October, 1864, Lieutenant William B. Cushing undertook to destroy it. On the night of October 27, he entered Plymouth harbor in a small boat, with a crew of thirteen men, approached the ram, and despite a hail of bullets, exploded a torpedo under its bow, sinking it. Cushing and most of his men escaped by leaping into the water.

"ALBEMARLE" CUSHING

[October 27, 1864]

Joy in rebel Plymouth town, in the spring of sixty-four, When the Albemarle down on the Yankee frigates bore, With the saucy Stars and Bars at her main; When she smote the Southfield dead, and the stout Miami quailed, And the fleet in terror fled when their mighty cannon hailed Shot and shell on her iron back in vain, Till she slowly steamed away to her berth at Plymouth pier, And their quick eyes saw her sway with her great beak out of gear, And the color of their courage rose again.

All the summer lay the ram, Like a wounded beast at bay, While the watchful squadron swam In the harbor night and day, Till the broken beak was mended, and the weary vigil ended, And her time was come again to smite and slay.

Must they die, and die in vain, Like a flock of shambled sheep? Then the Yankee grit and brain Must be dead or gone to sleep, And our sailors' gallant story of a hundred years of glory Let us sell for a song, selling cheap!

Cushing, scarce a man in years, But a sailor thoroughbred, "With a dozen volunteers I will sink the ram," he said. "At the worst 'tis only dying." And the old commander, sighing, "'Tis to save the fleet and flag--go ahead!"

* * * * *

Bright the rebel beacons blazed On the river left and right; Wide awake their sentries gazed Through the watches of the night; Sharp their challenge rang, and

fiery came the rifle's quick inquiry, As the little launch swung into the light.

Listening ears afar had heard; Ready hands to quarters sprung, The Albemarle awoke and stirred, And her howitzers gave tongue; Till the river and the shore echoed back the mighty roar, When the portals of her hundred-pounders swung.

Will the swordfish brave the whale, Doubly girt with boom and chain? Face the shrapnel's iron hail? Dare the livid leaden rain? Ah! that shell has done its duty; it has spoiled the Yankee's beauty; See her turn and fly with half her madmen slain.

High the victor's taunting yell Rings above the battle roar, And they bid her mock farewell As she seeks the farther shore, Till they see her sudden swinging, crouching for the leap and springing Back to boom and chain and bloody fray once more.

Now the Southern captain, stirred By the spirit of his race, Stops the firing with a word, Bids them yield, and offers grace. Cushing, laughing, answers, "No! we are here to fight!" and so Swings the dread torpedo spar to its place.

Then the great ship shook and reeled, With a wounded, gaping side, But her steady cannon pealed Ere she settled in the tide, And the Roanoke's dull flood ran full red with Yankee blood, When the fighting Albemarle sunk and died.

Woe in rebel Plymouth town when the Albemarle fell, And the saucy flag went down that had floated long and well, Nevermore from her stricken deck to wave. For the fallen flag a sigh, for the fallen foe a tear! Never shall their glory die while we hold our glory dear, And the hero's laurels live on his grave. Link their Cooke's with Cushing's name; proudly call them both our own; Claim their valor and their fame for America alone-- Joyful mother of the bravest of the brave!

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

AT THE CANNON'S MOUTH

DESTRUCTION OF THE RAM ALBEMARLE BY THE TORPEDO-LAUNCH, OCTOBER 27, 1864

Palely intent, he urged his keel Full on the guns, and touched the spring; Himself involved in the bolt he drove Timed with the armed hull's shot that stove His shallop--die or do! Into the flood his life he threw, Yet lives--unscathed--a breathing thing To marvel at. He has his fame; But that mad dash at death, how name?

Had Earth no charm to stay the Boy From the martyr-passion? Could he dare Disdain the Paradise of opening joy Which beckons the fresh heart everywhere?

Life has more lures than any girl For youth and strength; puts forth a share Of beauty, hinting of yet rarer store; And ever with unfathomable eyes, Which bafflingly entice, Still strangely does Adonis draw. And life once over, who shall tell the rest? Life is, of all we know, God's best. What imps these eagles then, that they Fling disrespect on life by that proud way In which they soar above our lower clay.

Pretence of wonderment and doubt unblest: In Cushing's eager deed was shown A spirit which brave poets own-- That scorn of life which earns life's crown; Earns, but

not always wins; but _he_-- The star ascended in his nativity.

HERMAN MELVILLE.

CHAPTER XII

THE MARTYR PRESIDENT

In November, 1864, Abraham Lincoln was re-elected President, carrying twenty-two out of the twenty-five states of the Union. He had grown ever dearer to the hearts of the American people, and the country had come to trust and love him.

LINCOLN

Chained by stern duty to the rock of state, His spirit armed in mail of rugged mirth, Ever above, though ever near to earth, Yet felt his heart the cruel tongues that sate Base appetites, and foul with slander, wait Till the keen lightnings bring the awful hour When wounds and suffering shall give them power. Most was he like to Luther, gay and great, Solemn and mirthful, strong of heart and limb. Tender and simple too; he was so near To all things human that he cast out fear, And, ever simpler, like a little child, Lived in unconscious nearness unto Him Who always on earth's little ones hath smiled.

S. WEIR MITCHELL.

On the evening of April 14, 1865, the President attended a performance of "Our American Cousin," at Ford's Theatre, at Washington. The play was drawing to a close, when suddenly the audience was startled by a pistol shot, and an instant later saw a man leap from the President's box to the stage. The man was John Wilkes Booth, an actor. He had shot the President through the head, and the latter died next day without regaining consciousness.

O CAPTAIN! MY CAPTAIN!

[April 14, 1865]

O Captain! my Captain! our fearful trip is done, The ship has weathered every rack, the prize we sought is won, The port is near, the bells I hear, the people all exulting, While follow eyes the steady keel, the vessel grim and daring; But O heart! heart! heart! O the bleeding drops of red, Where on the deck my Captain lies, Fallen cold and dead.

O Captain! my Captain! rise up and hear the bells; Rise up--for you the flag is flung--for you the bugle trills, For you bouquets and ribboned wreaths--for you the shores a-crowding, For you they call, the swaying mass, their eager faces turning; Here Captain! dear father! This arm beneath your head! It is some dream that on the deck You've fallen cold and dead.

My Captain does not answer, his lips are pale and still, My father does not feel my arm, he has no pulse nor will, The ship is anchored safe and sound, its voyage closed

and done, From fearful trip the victor ship comes in with object won; Exult O shores, and ring O bells! But I with mournful tread, Walk the deck my Captain lies, Fallen cold and dead.

WALT WHITMAN.

THE DEAD PRESIDENT

Were there no crowns on earth, No evergreen to wreathe a hero's wreath, That he must pass beyond the gates of death, Our hero, our slain hero, to be crowned? Could there on our unworthy earth be found Naught to befit his worth?

The noblest soul of all! When was there ever, since our Washington, A man so pure, so wise, so patient--one Who walked with this high goal alone in sight, To speak, to do, to sanction only Right, Though very heaven should fall!

Ah, not for him we weep; What honor more could be in store for him? Who would have had him linger in our dim And troublesome world, when his great work was done-- Who would not leave that worn and weary one Gladly to go to sleep?

For us the stroke was just; We were not worthy of that patient heart; We might have helped him more, not stood apart, And coldly criticised his works and ways-- Too late now, all too late--our little praise Sounds hollow o'er his dust.

Be merciful, O our God! Forgive the meanness of our human hearts, That never, till a noble soul departs, See half the worth, or hear the angel's wings Till they go rustling heavenward as he springs Up from the mounded sod.

Yet what a deathless crown Of Northern pine and Southern orange-flower, For victory, and the land's new bridal-hour, Would we have wreathed for that beloved brow! Sadly upon his sleeping forehead now We lay our cypress down.

O martyred one, farewell! Thou hast not left thy people quite alone, Out of thy beautiful life there comes a tone Of power, of love, of trust, a prophecy, Whose fair fulfilment all the earth shall be, And all the Future tell.

EDWARD ROWLAND SILL.

ABRAHAM LINCOLN

ASSASSINATED GOOD FRIDAY, 1865

"Forgive them, for they know not what they do!" He said, and so went shriven to his fate,-- Unknowing went, that generous heart and true. Even while he spoke, the slayer lay in wait, And when the morning opened Heaven's gate There passed the whitest soul a nation knew. Henceforth all thoughts of pardon are too late; They, in whose cause that arm its weapon drew, Have murdered Mercy. Now alone shall stand Blind Justice, with the sword unsheathed she wore. Hark, from the eastern to the western strand, The swelling thunder of the people's roar: What words they murmur,--Fetter not her hand! So let it smite, such deeds shall be no more!

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

The assassin escaped into Maryland, where he found a temporary refuge, but the country was alarmed, pursuers were close upon his trail, and on April 25, 1865, he was brought to bay in a barn. He refused to surrender and was shot by a sergeant named Boston Corbett.

PARDON

WILKES BOOTH--APRIL 26, 1865

Pains the sharp sentence the heart in whose wrath it was uttered, Now thou art cold; Vengeance, the headlong, and Justice, with purpose close muttered, Loosen their hold.

Death brings atonement; he did that whereof ye accuse him,-- Murder accurst; But from that crisis of crime in which Satan did lose him, Suffered the worst.

Harshly the red dawn arose on a deed of his doing, Never to mend; But harsher days he wore out in the bitter pursuing And the wild end.

So lift the pale flag of truce, wrap those mysteries round him, In whose avail Madness that moved, and the swift retribution that found him, Falter and fail.

So the soft purples that quiet the heavens with mourning, Willing to fall, Lend him one fold, his illustrious victim adorning With wider pall.

Back to the cross, where the Saviour uplifted in dying Bade all souls live, Turns the reft bosom of Nature, his mother, low sighing, Greatest, forgive!

JULIA WARD HOWE.

On Wednesday, April 19, 1865, a simple funeral service was held over the body of Lincoln at the White House, and for two days thereafter the body lay in state in the rotunda of the Capitol.

THE DEAR PRESIDENT

Abraham Lincoln, the Dear President, Lay in the Round Hall at the Capitol, And there the people came to look their last.

There came the widow, weeded for her mate; There came the mother, sorrowing for her son; There came the orphan, moaning for its sire.

There came the soldier, bearing home his wound; There came the slave, who felt his broken chain; There came the mourners of a blacken'd Land.

Through the dark April day, a ceaseless throng, They pass'd the coffin, saw the sleeping face, And, blessing it, in silence moved away.

And one, a poet, spoke within his heart: "It harm'd him not to praise him when alive, And me it cannot harm to praise him dead.

"Too oft the muse has blush'd to speak of men-- No muse shall blush to speak her best of him, And still to speak her best of him is dumb.

"O lofty wisdom's low simplicity! O awful tenderness of noted power!-- No man e'er held so much of power so meek.

"He was the husband of the husbandless, He was the father of the fatherless: Within his heart he weigh'd the common woe.

"His call was like a father's to his sons! As to a father's voice, they, hearing, came-- Eager to offer, strive, and bear, and die.

"The mild bond-breaker, servant of his Lord, He took the sword, but in the name of Peace, And touched the fetter, and the bound was free.

"Oh, place him not among the historic kings, Strong, barbarous chiefs and bloody conquerors, But with the Great and pure Republicans:

"Those who have been unselfish, wise, and good, Bringers of Light and Pilots in the dark, Bearers of Crosses, Servants of the World.

"And always, in his Land of birth and death, Be his fond name--warm'd in the people's hearts-- Abraham Lincoln, the Dear President."

JOHN JAMES PIATT.

ABRAHAM LINCOLN

Oh, slow to smite and swift to spare, Gentle and merciful and just! Who, in the fear of God, didst bear The sword of power, a nation's trust!

In sorrow by thy bier we stand, Amid the awe that hushes all, And speak the anguish of a land That shook with horror at thy fall.

Thy task is done; the bond are free: We bear thee to an honored grave, Whose proudest monument shall be The broken fetters of the slave.

Pure was thy life; its bloody close Hath placed thee with the sons of light, Among the noble host of those Who perished in the cause of Right.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

Then the funeral train started for Lincoln's home at Springfield, Ill., stopping at Philadelphia, New York, and other towns along the route, great crowds everywhere gathering to honor the dead President.

ABRAHAM LINCOLN[12]

Not as when some great Captain falls, In battle, where his Country calls, Beyond the struggling lines That push his dread designs

To doom, by some stray ball struck dead: Or, in the last charge, at the head Of his determined men, Who _must_ be victors then.

Nor as when sink the civic great, The safer pillars of the State, Whose calm, mature, wise words Suppress the need of swords.

With no such tears as e'er were shed Above the noblest of our dead Do we to-day deplore The Man that is no more.

Our sorrow hath a wider scope, Too strange for fear, too vast for hope, A wonder, blind and dumb, That waits--what is to come!

Not more astounded had we been If Madness, that dark night, unseen, Had in our chambers crept, And murdered while we slept!

We woke to find a mourning earth, Our Lares shivered on the hearth, The roof-tree fallen, all That could affright, appall!

Such thunderbolts, in other lands, Have smitten the rod from royal hands, But spared, with us, till now, Each laurelled Cæsar's brow.

No Cæsar he whom we lament, A Man without a precedent, Sent, it would seem, to do His work, and perish, too.

Not by the weary cares of State, The endless tasks, which will not wait, Which, often done in vain, Must yet be done again:

Not in the dark, wild tide of war, Which rose so high, and rolled so far, Sweeping from sea to sea In awful anarchy:

Four fateful years of mortal strife, Which slowly drained the nation's life (Yet for each drop that ran There sprang an armèd man!).

Not then; but when, by measures meet By victory, and by defeat, By courage, patience, skill, The people's fixed, "_We will!_"

Had pierced, had crushed Rebellion dead, Without a hand, without a head, At last, when all was well, He fell, O how he fell!

The time, the place, the stealing shape, The coward shot, the swift escape, The wife, the widow's scream,-- It is a hideous Dream!

A dream? What means this pageant, then? These multitudes of solemn men, Who speak not when they meet, But throng the silent street?

The flags half-mast that late so high Flaunted at each new victory? (The stars no brightness shed, But bloody looks the red!)

The black festoons that stretch for miles, And turn the streets to funeral aisles? (No house too poor to show The nation's badge of woe.)

The cannon's sudden, sullen boom, The bells that toll of death and doom, The rolling of the drums, The dreadful car that comes?

Cursed be the hand that fired the shot, The frenzied brain that hatched the plot, Thy country's Father slain By thee, thou worse than Cain!

Tyrants have fallen by such as thou, And good hath followed--may it now! (God lets bad instruments Produce the best events.)

But he, the man we mourn to-day, No tyrant was: so mild a sway In one such weight who bore Was never known before.

Cool should he be, of balanced powers, The ruler of a race like ours, Impatient, headstrong, wild, The Man to guide the Child.

And this _he_ was, who most unfit (So hard the sense of God to hit) Did seem to fill his place; With such a homely face,

Such rustic manners, speech uncouth (That somehow blundered out the truth), Untried, untrained to bear The more than kingly care.

Ah! And his genius put to scorn The proudest in the purple born, Whose wisdom never grew To what, untaught, he knew,

The People, of whom he was one: No gentleman, like Washington (Whose bones, methinks, make room, To have him in their tomb!).

A laboring man, with horny hands, Who swung the axe, who tilled his lands, Who shrank from nothing new, But did as poor men do.

One of the People! born to be Their curious epitome; To share yet rise above Their shifting hate and love.

Common his mind (it seemed so then), His thoughts the thoughts of other men: Plain were his words, and poor, But now they will endure!

No hasty fool, of stubborn will, But prudent, cautious, pliant still; Who since his work was good Would do it as he could.

Doubting, was not ashamed to doubt, And, lacking prescience, went without: Often appeared to halt, And was, of course, at fault;

Heard all opinions, nothing loath, And, loving both sides, angered both: Was--_not_ like Justice, blind, But watchful, clement, kind.

No hero this of Roman mould, Nor like our stately sires of old: Perhaps he was not great, But he preserved the State!

O honest face, which all men knew! O tender heart, but known to few! O wonder of the age, Cut off by tragic rage!

Peace! Let the long procession come, For hark, the mournful, muffled drum, The trumpet's wail afar, And see, the awful car!

Peace! Let the sad procession go, While cannon boom and bells toll slow. And go, thou sacred car, Bearing our woe afar!

Go, darkly borne, from State to State, Whose loyal, sorrowing cities wait To honor all they can The dust of that good man.

Go, grandly borne, with such a train As greatest kings might die to gain. The just, the wise, the brave, Attend thee to the grave.

And you, the soldiers of our wars, Bronzed veterans, grim with noble scars, Salute him once again, Your late commander--slain!

Yes, let your tears indignant fall, But leave your muskets on the wall; Your country needs you now Beside the forge--the plough.

(When Justice shall unsheathe her brand, If Mercy may not stay her hand, Nor would we have it so, _She_ must direct the blow.)

And you, amid the master-race, Who seem so strangely out of place, Know ye who cometh? He Who hath declared ye free.

Bow while the body passes--nay, Fall on your knees, and weep, and pray! Weep, weep--I would ye might-- Your poor black faces white!

And, children, you must come in bands, With garlands in your little hands, Of blue and white and red, To strew before the dead.

So sweetly, sadly, sternly goes The Fallen to his last repose. Beneath no mighty dome, But in his modest home;

The churchyard where his children rest, The quiet spot that suits him best, There shall his grave be made, And there his bones be laid.

And there his countrymen shall come, With memory proud, with pity dumb, And strangers far and near, For many and many a year.

For many a year and many an age, While History on her ample page The virtues shall enroll Of that Paternal Soul.

RICHARD HENRY STODDARD.

[12] From Poetical Writings of Richard Henry Stoddard; copyright, 1880, by Charles Scribner's Sons.

During those twenty days, the one thought uppermost in men's minds was the martyred President. The desire for vengeance alternated with grief. It was generally believed that the conspiracy had been concocted by the Confederate authorities, and magnanimity toward a beaten foe gave place to hatred.

PARRICIDE

ABRAHAM LINCOLN--APRIL 14, 1865

O'er the warrior gauntlet grim Late the silken glove we drew, Bade the watch-fires slacken dim In the dawn's auspicious hue. Stayed the armèd heel; Stilled the clanging steel; Joys unwonted thrilled the silence through.

Glad drew near the Easter tide; And the thoughts of men anew Turned to Him who spotless died For the peace that none shall rue. Out of mortal pain This abiding strain Issued: "Peace, my peace, I give to you."

Musing o'er the silent strings, By their apathy opprest, Waiting for the spirit wings, To be touched and soul-possessed, "I am dull," I said: "Treason is not dead; Still in ambush lurks that shivering guest."

Then a woman's shriek of fear Smote us in its arrowy flight; And a wonder wild and drear Did the hearts of men unite. Has the seed of crime Reached its flowering-time, That it shoots to this audacious height?

Then, as frosts the landscape change, Stiffening from the summer's glow, Grew the jocund faces strange, Lay the loftiest emblem low: Kings are of the past, Suffered still to last; These twin crowns the present did bestow.

Fair assassin, murder white, With thy serpent speed avoid Each unsullied household light, Every conscience unalloyed. Neither heart nor home Where good angels come Suffer thee in nearness to abide.

Slanderer of the gracious brow, The untiring blood of youth, Servant of an evil now, Of a crime that beggars ruth, Treason was thy dam, Wolfling, when the Lamb, The Anointed, met thy venomed tooth.

With the righteous did he fall, With the sainted doth he lie; While the gibbet's vultures call Thee, that, 'twixt the earth and sky, Disavowed of both In their Godward troth, Thou mayst make thy poor amend, and die.

If it were my latest breath, Doomed his bloody end to share, I would brand thee with his death As a deed beyond despair. Since the Christ was lost For a felon's cost, None like thee of vengeance should beware.

Leave the murderer, noble song, Helpless in the toils of fate: To the just thy meeds belong, To the martyr, to the state. When the storm beats loud Over sail and shroud, Tunefully the seaman cheers his mate.

Never tempest lashed the wave But to leave it fresher calm; Never weapon scarred the brave But their blood did purchase balm. God hath writ on high Such a victory As uplifts the nation with its psalm.

Honor to the heart of love, Honor to the peaceful will, Slow to threaten, strong to move, Swift to render good for ill! Glory crowns his end, And the captive's friend From his ashes makes us freemen still.

JULIA WARD HOWE.

The feeling throughout the South was one of sorrow and indignation. In England, too, the act was condemned, and London _Punch_, which had delighted in caricaturing the President, published a full-page cartoon, depicting itself in the act of laying a wreath upon his bier--a cartoon which was followed by some spirited verses from _Punch's_ editor, Tom Taylor, confessing that the English attitude toward Lincoln and the North had been a mistaken one.

ABRAHAM LINCOLN

You lay a wreath on murdered Lincoln's bier, _You_, who, with mocking pencil, wont to trace, Broad for the self-complaisant British sneer, His length of shambling limb, his furrowed face,

His gaunt, gnarled hands, his unkempt, bristling hair, His garb uncouth, his bearing ill at ease, His lack of all we prize as debonair, Of power or will to shine, of art to please;

You, whose smart pen backed up the pencil's laugh, Judging each step as though the way were plain; Reckless, so it could point its paragraph Of chief's perplexity, or people's pain,--

Beside this corpse, that bears for winding-sheet The Stars and Stripes he lived to rear anew, Between the mourners at his head and feet, Say, scurrile jester, is there room for _you_?

Yes, he had lived to shame me from my sneer, To lame my pencil, and confute my pen; To make me own this hind of Princes peer, This rail-splitter a true-born king of men.

My shallow judgment I had learned to rue, Noting how to occasion's height he rose, How his quaint wit made home-truth seem more true, How, iron-like, his temper grew by blows;

How humble, yet how hopeful, he could be; How, in good fortune and in ill, the same; Nor bitter in success, nor boastful he, Thirsty for gold, nor feverish for fame.

He went about his work--such work as few Ever had laid on head and heart and hand-- As one who knows, where there's a task to do, Man's honest will must Heaven's good grace command;

Who trusts the strength will with the burden grow, That God makes instruments to work His will, If but that will we can arrive to know, Nor tamper with the weights of good and ill.

So he went forth to battle, on the side That he felt clear was Liberty's and Right's, As in his peasant boyhood he had plied His warfare with rude Nature's thwarting mights,--

The uncleared forest, the unbroken soil, The iron bark that turns the lumberer's axe, The rapid, that o'erbears the boatman's toil, The prairie, hiding the mazed wanderer's tracks,

The ambushed Indian, and the prowling bear,-- Such were the needs that helped his youth to train: Rough culture--but such trees large fruit may bear, If but their stocks be of right girth and grain.

So he grew up, a destined work to do, And lived to do it: four long-suffering years' Ill-fate, ill-feeling, ill-report, lived through, And then he heard the hisses change to cheers,

The taunts to tribute, the abuse to praise, And took both with the same unwavering mood; Till, as he came on light, from darkling days, And seemed to touch the goal from where he stood,

A felon hand, between the goal and him, Reached from behind his back, a trigger prest-- And those perplexed and patient eyes were dim, Those gaunt, long-laboring

limbs were laid to rest.

The words of mercy were upon his lips, Forgiveness in his heart and on his pen, When this vile murderer brought swift eclipse To thoughts of peace on earth, good will to men.

The Old World and the New, from sea to sea, Utter one voice of sympathy and shame. Sore heart, so stopped when it at last beat high! Sad life, cut short just as its triumph came!

A deed accurst! Strokes have been struck before By the assassin's hand, whereof men doubt If more of horror or disgrace they bore; But thy foul crime, like Cain's, stands darkly out,

Vile hand, that brandest murder on a strife, Whate'er its grounds, stoutly and nobly striven, And with the martyr's crown, crownest a life With much to praise, little to be forgiven.

TOM TAYLOR.

CHAPTER XIII

PEACE

The surrender of Lee at Appomattox virtually ended the war. The only considerable Confederate force left in the field was that under command of Johnston, and it surrendered to Sherman on April 26, 1865.

"STACK ARMS!"

"_Stack Arms!_" I've gladly heard the cry When, weary with the dusty tread Of marching troops, as night drew nigh, I sank upon my soldier bed, And calmly slept; the starry dome Of heaven's blue arch my canopy, And mingled with my dreams of home The thoughts of Peace and Liberty.

"_Stack Arms!_" I've heard it when the shout Exulting ran along our line, Of foes hurled back in bloody rout, Captured, dispersed; its tones divine Then came to mine enraptured ear, Guerdon of duty nobly done, And glistened on my cheek the tear Of grateful joy for victory won.

"_Stack Arms!_" In faltering accents, slow And sad, it creeps from tongue to tongue, A broken, murmuring wail of woe, From manly hearts by anguish wrung. Like victims of a midnight dream, We move, we know not how nor why; For life and hope like phantoms seem, And it would be relief--to die!

JOSEPH BLYNTH ALSTON.

Jefferson Davis, who had fled from Richmond, was captured on May 11, 1865, near the Ocmulgee River, in Georgia, and on May 26, when Kirby Smith formally surrendered, the last vestige of armed resistance to the national government disappeared. Davis was confined at Fortress Monroe until 1868, the South, of course,

considering him a martyr.

JEFFERSON DAVIS

"Our hearts, our hopes, our prayers, our tears, Our faith triumphant o'er our fears, Are all with thee, are all with thee."

LONGFELLOW.

Calm martyr of a noble cause, Upon thy form in vain The Dungeon shuts its cankered jaws, And clasps its cankered chain; For thy free spirit walks abroad, And every pulse is stirred With the old deathless glory thrill, Whene'er thy name is heard.

The same that lit each Grecian eye, Whene'er it rested on The wild pass of Thermopylæ-- The plain of Marathon; And made the Roman's ancient blood Bound fiercely as he told, "How well Horatio kept the bridge, In the brave days of old."

The same that makes the Switzer's heart With silent rapture swell, When in each Alpine height he sees A monument to Tell: The same that kindles Irish veins When Emmet's name is told; What Bruce to Caledonia is, Kosciusko to the Pole--

Art thou to us!--thy deathless fame, With Washington entwined, Forever in each Southern heart Is hallowed and enshrined;-- And though the tyrant give thy form To shameful death--'twere vain; It would but shed a splendor round The gibbet and the chain.

Only less sacred in our eyes, Thus blest and purified, Than the dear cross on which our Lord Was shamed and crucified, Would the vile gallows tree become, And through all ages shine, Linked with the glory of thy name, A relic and a shrine!

WALKER MERIWETHER BELL.

It was for the South a sad awakening from the dream which had been so entrancing and which seemed so certain to come true. Their land was ravaged, their people were ruined, their best and bravest dead.

IN THE LAND WHERE WE WERE DREAMING

Fair were our visions! Oh, they were as grand As ever floated out of faerie land; Children were we in single faith, But God-like children, whom nor death Nor threat nor danger drove from honor's path, In the land where we were dreaming.

Proud were our men, as pride of birth could render; As violets, our women pure and tender; And when they spoke, their voices did thrill Until at eve the whip-poor-will, At morn the mocking-bird, were mute and still, In the land where we were dreaming.

And we had graves that covered more of glory Than ever tracked tradition's ancient story; And in our dream we wove the thread Of principles for which had bled And suffered long our own immortal dead, In the land where we were dreaming.

Though in our land we had both bond and free, Both were content; and so God let them be; Till envy coveted our land, And those fair fields our valor won; But little recked we, for we still slept on, In the land where we were dreaming.

Our sleep grew troubled and our dreams grew wild-- Red meteors flashed across our heaven's field; Crimson the moon; between the Twins Barbed arrows fly, and then begins Such strife as when disorder's Chaos reigns, In the land where we were dreaming.

Down from her sun-lit heights smiled Liberty And waved her cap in sign of Victory-- The world approved, and everywhere, Except where growled the Russian bear, The good, the brave, the just gave us their prayer In the land where we were dreaming.

We fancied that a Government was ours-- We challenged place among the world's great powers; We talked in sleep of Rank, Commission, Until so life-like grew our vision That he who dared to doubt but met derision, In the land where we were dreaming.

We looked on high; a banner there was seen, Whose field was blanched and spotless in its sheen-- Chivalry's cross its Union bears, And veterans swearing by their scars Vowed they would bear it through a hundred wars, In the land where we were dreaming.

A hero came amongst us as we slept; At first he lowly knelt--then rose and wept; Then gathering up a thousand spears He swept across the field of Mars; Then bowed farewell and walked beyond the stars, In the land where we were dreaming.

We looked again: another figure still Gave hope, and nerved each individual will-- Full of grandeur, clothed with power, Self-poised, erect, he ruled the hour With stern, majestic sway--of strength a tower, In the land where we were dreaming.

As, while great Jove, in bronze, a warder God, Gazed eastward from the Forum where he stood, Rome felt herself secure and free, So, "Richmond's safe," we said, while we Beheld a bronzèd hero--God-like Lee, In the land where we were dreaming.

As wakes the soldier when the alarum calls-- As wakes the mother when the infant falls-- As starts the traveller when around His sleeping couch the fire-bells sound-- So woke our nation with a single bound, In the land where we were dreaming.

Woe! woe is me! the startled mother cried-- While we have slept our noble sons have died! Woe! woe is me! how strange and sad That all our glorious vision's fled, And left us nothing real but the dead, In the land where we were dreaming.

DANIEL B. LUCAS.

ACCEPTATION

I

We do accept thee, heavenly Peace! Albeit thou comest in a guise Unlooked for--undesired, our eyes Welcome through tears the sweet release From war, and

woe, and want,--surcease, For which we bless thee, blessèd Peace!

II

We lift our foreheads from the dust; And as we meet thy brow's clear calm, There falls a freshening sense of balm Upon our spirits. Fear--distrust-- The hopeless present on us thrust-- We'll meet them as we can, and _must_.

III

War has not wholly wrecked us: still Strong hands, brave hearts, high souls are ours-- Proud consciousness of quenchless powers-- A Past whose memory makes us thrill-- Futures uncharactered, to fill With heroisms--if we will.

IV

Then courage, brothers!--Though each breast Feel oft the rankling thorn, despair, That failure plants so sharply there-- No pain, no pang shall be confest: We'll work and watch the brightening west, And leave to God and Heaven the rest.

MARGARET JUNKIN PRESTON.

THE CONQUERED BANNER

Furl that Banner, for 'tis weary; Round its staff 'tis drooping dreary; Furl it, fold it--it is best; For there's not a man to wave it, And there's not a sword to save it, And there's not one left to lave it In the blood which heroes gave it; And its foes now scorn and brave it; Furl it, hide it--let it rest!

Take that Banner down! 'tis tattered; Broken is its staff and shattered, And the valiant hosts are scattered Over whom it floated high. Oh, 'tis hard for us to fold it, Hard to think there's none to hold it, Hard that those who once unrolled it Now must furl it with a sigh!

Furl that Banner--furl it sadly; Once ten thousands hailed it gladly, And ten thousands wildly, madly Swore it should forever wave-- Swore that foeman's sword should never Hearts like theirs entwined dissever, And that flag should float forever O'er their freedom, or their grave!

Furl it! for the hands that grasped it, And the hearts that fondly clasped it, Cold and dead are lying low; And that Banner--it is trailing, While around it sounds the wailing Of its people in their woe;

For, though conquered, they adore it-- Love the cold, dead hands that bore it! Weep for those who fell before it! Pardon those who trailed and tore it! But, oh, wildly they deplore it, Now who furl and fold it so!

Furl that Banner! True, 'tis gory, Yet 'tis wreathed around with glory, And 'twill live in song and story Though its folds are in the dust! For its fame on brightest pages,

Penned by poets and by sages, Shall go sounding down the ages-- Furl its folds though now we must!

Furl that Banner, softly, slowly; Treat it gently--it is holy, For it droops above the dead; Touch it not--unfold it never; Let it droop there, furled forever,-- For its people's hopes are fled.

ABRAM J. RYAN.

At the North, too, Peace was welcome. The North, while suffering less poignantly than the South, had drunk deeply of the bitter cup. It had lost over three hundred and fifty thousand men.

PEACE

Daybreak upon the hills! Slowly, behind the midnight murk and trail Of the long storm, light brightens, pure and pale, And the horizon fills.

Not bearing swift release,-- Not with quick feet of triumph, but with tread August and solemn, following her dead, Cometh, at last, our Peace.

Over thick graves grown green, Over pale bones that graveless lie and bleach, Over torn human hearts her path doth reach, And Heaven's dear pity lean.

O angel sweet and grand! White-footed, from beside the throne of God, Thou movest, with the palm and olive-rod, And day bespreads the land!

His Day we waited for! With faces to the East, we prayed and fought; And a faint music of the dawning caught, All through the sounds of War.

Our souls are still with praise! It is the dawning; there is work to do: When we have borne the long hours' burden through, Then we will pæans raise.

God give us, with the time, His strength for His large purpose to the world! To bear before Him, in its face unfurled, His gonfalon sublime!

Ay, we _are_ strong! Both sides The misty river stretch His army's wings: Heavenward, with glorious wheel, one flank He flings; And one front still abides!

Strongest where most bereft! His great ones He doth call to more command. For whom He hath prepared it, they shall stand On the Right Hand and Left!

ADELINE D. T. WHITNEY.

PEACE

O Land, of every land the best-- O Land, whose glory shall increase; Now in your whitest raiment drest For the great festival of Peace:

Take from your flag its fold of gloom, And let it float undimmed above, Till over all our vales shall bloom The sacred colors that we love.

On mountain high, in valley low, Set Freedom's living fires to burn; Until the midnight sky shall show A redder pathway than the morn.

Welcome, with shouts of joy and pride, Your veterans from the war-path's track; You gave your boys, untrained, untried; You bring them men and heroes back!

And shed no tear, though think you must With sorrow of the martyred band; Not even for him whose hallowed dust Has made our prairies holy land.

Though by the places where they fell, The places that are sacred ground, Death, like a sullen sentinel, Paces his everlasting round.

Yet when they set their country free And gave her traitors fitting doom, They left their last great enemy, Baffled, beside an empty tomb.

Not there, but risen, redeemed, they go Where all the paths are sweet with flowers; They fought to give us Peace and lo! They gained a better Peace than ours.

PHOEBE CARY.

On May 24, 1865, the united armies of Grant and Sherman, two hundred thousand strong, were reviewed at Washington by President Johnson and his cabinet.

A SECOND REVIEW OF THE GRAND ARMY

[May 24, 1865]

I read last night of the Grand Review In Washington's chiefest avenue,-- Two hundred thousand men in blue, I think they said was the number,-- Till I seemed to hear their trampling feet, The bugle blast and the drum's quick beat, The clatter of hoofs in the stony street, The cheers of people who came to greet, And the thousand details that to repeat Would only my verse encumber,-- Till I fell in a revery, sad and sweet, And then to a fitful slumber.

When, lo! in a vision I seemed to stand In the lonely Capitol. On each hand Far stretched the portico, dim and grand Its columns ranged, like a martial band Of sheeted spectres, whom some command Had called to a last reviewing. And the streets of the city were white and bare; No footfall echoed across the square; But out of the misty midnight air I heard in the distance a trumpet blare, And the wandering night-winds seemed to bear The sound of a far tattooing.

Then I held my breath with fear and dread; For into the square, with a brazen tread, There rode a figure whose stately head O'erlooked the review that morning, That never bowed from its firm-set seat When the living column passed its feet, Yet now rode steadily up the street To the phantom bugle's warning:

Till it reached the Capitol square, and wheeled, And there in the moonlight stood revealed A well-known form that in State and field Had led our patriot sires: Whose face was turned to the sleeping camp, Afar through the river's fog and damp, That showed no flicker, nor waning lamp, Nor wasted bivouac fires.

And I saw a phantom army come, With never a sound of fife or drum, But keeping time to a throbbing hum Of wailing and lamentation: The martyred heroes of Malvern Hill, Of Gettysburg and Chancellorsville, The men whose wasted figures fill The patriot graves of the nation.

And there came the nameless dead,--the men Who perished in fever-swamp and fen, The slowly-starved of the prison-pen; And, marching beside the others, Came the dusky martyrs of Pillow's fight, With limbs enfranchised and bearing bright: I thought--perhaps 'twas the pale moonlight-- They looked as white as their brothers!

And so all night marched the Nation's dead, With never a banner above them spread, Nor a badge, nor a motto brandishèd; No mark--save the bare uncovered head Of the silent bronze Reviewer; With never an arch save the vaulted sky; With never a flower save those that lie On the distant graves--for love could buy No gift that was purer or truer.

So all night long swept the strange array; So all night long, till the morning gray, I watch'd for one who had passed away, With a reverent awe and wonder,-- Till a blue cap waved in the lengthening line, And I knew that one who was kin of mine Had come; and I spake--and lo! that sign Awakened me from my slumber.

BRET HARTE.

The work of disbandment began at once, and the troops were sent home as rapidly as possible; they laid by the musket, took up the spade or hammer, and returned once more to the occupations of peace.

WHEN JOHNNY COMES MARCHING HOME

When Johnny comes marching home again, Hurrah! hurrah! We'll give him a hearty welcome then, Hurrah! hurrah! The men will cheer, the boys will shout, The ladies, they will all turn out, And we'll all feel gay, When Johnny comes marching home.

The old church-bell will peal with joy, Hurrah! hurrah! To welcome home our darling boy, Hurrah! hurrah! The village lads and lasses say, With roses they will strew the way; And we'll all feel gay, When Johnny comes marching home.

Get ready for the jubilee, Hurrah! hurrah! We'll give the hero three times three, Hurrah! hurrah! The laurel-wreath is ready now To place upon his loyal brow, And we'll all feel gay, When Johnny comes marching home.

Let love and friendship on that day, Hurrah! hurrah! Their choicest treasures then display, Hurrah! hurrah! And let each one perform some part, To fill with joy the warrior's heart; And we'll all feel gay, When Johnny comes marching home.

PATRICK SARSFIELD GILMORE.

DRIVING HOME THE COWS

Out of the clover and blue-eyed grass, He turned them into the river-lane; One after another he let them pass, Then fastened the meadow-bars again.

Under the willows, and over the hill, He patiently followed their sober pace; The merry whistle for once was still, And something shadowed the sunny face.

Only a boy! and his father had said He never could let his youngest go: Two already were lying dead Under the feet of the trampling foe.

But after the evening work was done, And the frogs were loud in the meadow-swamp, Over his shoulder he slung his gun, And stealthily followed the foot-path damp,

Across the clover, and through the wheat, With resolute heart and purpose grim, Though cold was the dew on his hurrying feet, And the blind bat's flitting startled him.

Thrice since then had the lanes been white, And the orchards sweet with apple-bloom; And now, when the cows came back at night, The feeble father drove them home.

For news had come to the lonely farm That three were lying where two had lain; And the old man's tremulous, palsied arm Could never lean on a son's again.

The summer day grew cold and late. He went for the cows when the work was done; But down the lane, as he opened the gate, He saw them coming, one by one,--

Brindle, Ebony, Speckle, and Bess, Shaking their horns in the evening wind; Cropping the buttercups out of the grass,-- But who was it following close behind?

Loosely swung in the idle air The empty sleeve of army blue; And worn and pale, from the crisping hair, Looked out a face that the father knew.

For Southern prisons will sometimes yawn, And yield their dead unto life again; And the day that comes with a cloudy dawn In golden glory at last may wane.

The great tears sprang to their meeting eyes; For the heart must speak when the lips are dumb; And under the silent evening skies, Together they followed the cattle home.

KATE PUTNAM OSGOOD.

On July 21, 1865, services were held at Cambridge, Mass., in commemoration of the three hundredth anniversary of Harvard College. Addresses were made by General Meade and General Devens, and an ode written for the occasion was read by James Russell Lowell. This ode, perhaps the greatest ever delivered in America, forms a fitting close to the history of the Civil War.

ODE RECITED AT THE HARVARD COMMEMORATION

[July 21, 1865]

I

Weak-winged is song, Nor aims at that clear-ethered height Whither the brave deed climbs for light: We seem to do them wrong, Bringing our robin's-leaf to deck their hearse Who in warm life-blood wrote their nobler verse, Our trivial song to honor those who come With ears attuned to strenuous trump and drum, And shaped in squadron-strophes their desire, Live battle-odes whose lines were steel and fire: Yet sometimes feathered words are strong, A gracious memory to buoy up and save From Lethe's dreamless ooze, the common grave Of the unventurous throng.

II

To-day our Reverend Mother welcomes back Her wisest Scholars, those who understood The deeper teaching of her mystic tome, And offered their fresh lives to make it good: No lore of Greece or Rome, No science peddling with the names of things, Or reading stars to find inglorious fates, Can lift our life with wings Far from Death's idle gulf that for the many waits, And lengthen out our dates With that clear fame whose memory sings In manly hearts to come, and nerves them and dilates: Nor such thy teaching, Mother of us all! Not such the trumpet-call Of thy diviner mood, That could thy sons entice From happy homes and toils, the fruitful nest Of those half-virtues which the world calls best, Into War's tumult rude; But rather far that stern device The sponsors chose that round thy cradle stood In the dim, unventured wood, The VERITAS that lurks beneath The letter's unprolific sheath, Life of whate'er makes life worth living, Seed-grain of high emprise, immortal food, One heavenly thing whereof earth hath the giving.

III

Many loved Truth, and lavished life's best oil Amid the dust of books to find her, Content at last, for guerdon of their toil, With the cast mantle she hath left behind her. Many in sad faith sought for her, Many with crossed hands sighed for her; But these, our brothers, fought for her, At life's dear peril wrought for her, So loved her that they died for her, Tasting the raptured fleetness Of her divine completeness: Their higher instinct knew Those love her best who to themselves are true, And what they dare to dream of, dare to do; They followed her and found her Where all may hope to find, Not in the ashes of the burnt-out mind, But beautiful, with danger's sweetness round her. Where faith made whole with deed Breathes its awakening breath Into the lifeless creed, They saw her plumed and mailed, With sweet, stern face unveiled, And all-repaying eyes, look proud on them in death.

IV

Our slender life runs rippling by, and glides Into the silent hollow of the past; What is there that abides To make the next age better for the last? Is earth too poor to give us Something to live for here that shall outlive us? Some more substantial boon Than such as flows and ebbs with Fortune's fickle moon? The little that we see From doubt is never free; The little that we do Is but half-nobly true; With our laborious hiving What men call treasure, and the gods call dross, Life seems a jest of Fate's contriving,

Only secure in every one's conniving, A long account of nothings paid with loss, Where we poor puppets, jerked by unseen wires, After our little hour of strut and rave, With all our pasteboard passions and desires, Loves, hates, ambitions, and immortal fires, Are tossed pell-mell together in the grave. But stay! no age was e'er degenerate, Unless men held it at too cheap a rate, For in our likeness still we shape our fate. Ah, there is something here Unfathomed by the cynic's sneer, Something that gives our feeble light A high immunity from Night, Something that leaps life's narrow bars To claim its birthright with the hosts of heaven; A seed of sunshine that can leaven Our earthy dulness with the beams of stars And glorify our clay With light from fountains elder than the Day; A conscience more divine than we, A gladness fed with secret tears, A vexing, forward-reaching sense Of some more noble permanence; A light across the sea, Which haunts the soul and will not let it be, Still beaconing from the heights of undegenerate years.

V

Whither leads the path To ampler fates that leads? Not down through flowery meads, To reap an aftermath Of youth's vainglorious weeds, But up the steep, amid the wrath And shock of deadly-hostile creeds, Where the world's best hope and stay By battle's flashes gropes a desperate way, And every turf the fierce foot clings to bleeds. Peace hath her not ignoble wreath, Ere yet the sharp, decisive word Light the black lips of cannon, and the sword Dreams in its easeful sheath; But some day the live coal behind the thought, Whether from Baäl's stone obscene, Or from the shrine serene Of God's pure altar brought, Bursts up in flame; the war of tongue and pen Learns with what deadly purpose it was fraught, And, helpless in the fiery passion caught, Shakes all the pillared state with shock of men: Some day the soft Ideal that we wooed Confronts us fiercely, foe-beset, pursued, And cries reproachful: "Was it, then, my praise, And not myself was loved? Prove now thy truth; I claim of thee the promise of thy youth; Give me thy life, or cower in empty phrase, The victim of thy genius, not its mate!" Life may be given in many ways, And loyalty to Truth be sealed As bravely in the closet as the field, So bountiful is Fate; But then to stand beside her, When craven churls deride her, To front a lie in arms and not to yield, This shows, methinks, God's plan And measure of a stalwart man, Limbed like the old heroic breeds, Who stands self-poised on manhood's solid earth, Not forced to frame excuses for his birth, Fed from within with all the strength he needs.

VI

Such was he, our Martyr-Chief, Whom late the Nation he had led, With ashes on her head, Wept with the passion of an angry grief: Forgive me, if from present things I turn To speak what in my heart will beat and burn, And hang my wreath on his world-honored urn. Nature, they say, doth dote, And cannot make a man Save on some worn-out plan, Repeating us by rote: For him her Old-World moulds aside she threw, And, choosing sweet clay from the breast Of the unexhausted West, With stuff untainted shaped a hero new, Wise, steadfast in the strength of God, and true How beautiful to see Once more a shepherd of mankind indeed, Who loved his charge, but

never loved to lead; One whose meek flock the people joyed to be, Not lured by any cheat of birth, But by his clear-grained human worth, And brave old wisdom of sincerity! They knew that outward grace is dust; They could not choose but trust In that sure-footed mind's unfaltering skill, And supple-tempered will That bent like perfect steel to spring again and thrust. His was no lonely mountain-peak of mind Thrusting to thin air o'er our cloudy bars, A sea-mark now, now lost in vapors blind; Broad prairie rather, genial, level-lined, Fruitful and friendly for all human kind, Yet also nigh to heaven and loved of loftiest stars, Nothing of Europe here, Or, then, of Europe fronting mornward still, Ere any names of Serf and Peer Could Nature's equal scheme deface And thwart her genial will; Here was a type of the true elder race, And one of Plutarch's men talked with us face to face. I praise him not; it were too late; And some innative weakness there must be In him who condescends to victory Such as the Present gives, and cannot wait, Safe in himself as in a fate. So always firmly he: He knew to bide his time, And can his fame abide, Still patient in his simple faith sublime, Till the wise years decide. Great captains, with their guns and drums, Disturb our judgment for the hour, But at last silence comes; These all are gone, and, standing like a tower, Our children shall behold his fame, The kindly-earnest, brave, foreseeing man, Sagacious, patient, dreading praise, not blame, New birth of our new soil, the first American.

VII

Long as man's hope insatiate can discern Or only guess some more inspiring goal Outside of Self, enduring as the pole, Along whose course the flying axles burn Of spirits bravely-pitched, earth's manlier brood; Long as below we cannot find The meed that stills the inexorable mind; So long this faith to some ideal Good, Under whatever mortal names it masks, Freedom, Law, Country, this ethereal mood That thanks the Fates for their severer tasks, Feeling its challenged pulses leap, While others skulk in subterfuges cheap, And, set in Danger's van, has all the boon it asks, Shall win man's praise and woman's love, Shall be a wisdom that we set above All other skills and gifts to culture dear, A virtue round whose forehead we inwreathe Laurels that with a living passion breathe When other crowns grow, while we twine them, sear. What brings us thronging these high rites to pay, And seal these hours the noblest of our year, Save that our brothers found this better way?

VIII

We sit here in the Promised Land That flows with Freedom's honey and milk; But 'twas they won it, sword in hand, Making the nettle danger soft for us as silk. We welcome back our bravest and our best;-- Ah me! not all! some come not with the rest, Who went forth brave and bright as any here! I strive to mix some gladness with my strain, But the sad strings complain, And will not please the ear: I sweep them for a pæan, but they wane Again and yet again Into a dirge, and die away, in pain. In these brave ranks I only see the gaps, Thinking of dear ones whom the dumb turf wraps, Dark to the triumph which they died to gain: Fitlier may others greet the living, For me the past is unforgiving; I with uncovered head Salute the sacred dead,

Who went, and who return not.--Say not so! 'Tis not the grapes of Canaan that repay, But the high faith that failed not by the way; Virtue treads paths that end not in the grave; No ban of endless night exiles the brave; And to the saner mind We rather seem the dead that stayed behind. Blow, trumpets, all your exultations blow! For never shall their aureoled presence lack; I see them muster in a gleaming row, With ever-youthful brows that nobler show; We find in our dull road their shining track; In every nobler mood We feel the orient of their spirit glow, Part of our life's unalterable good, Of all our saintlier aspiration; They come transfigured back, Secure from change in their high-hearted ways, Beautiful evermore, and with the rays Of morn on their white Shields of Expectation!

IX

But is there hope to save Even this ethereal essence from the grave? What ever 'scaped Oblivion's subtle wrong Save a few clarion names, or golden threads of song? Before my musing eye The mighty ones of old sweep by, Disvoicèd now and insubstantial things, As noisy once as we; poor ghosts of kings, Shadows of empire wholly gone to dust, And many races, nameless long ago, To darkness driven by that imperious gust Of ever-rushing Time that here doth blow: O visionary world, condition strange, Where naught abiding is but only Change, Where the deep-bolted stars themselves still shift and range! Shall we to more continuance make pretence? Renown builds tombs; a life-estate is Wit; And, bit by bit, The cunning years steal all from us but woe; Leaves are we, whose decays no harvest sow. But, when we vanish hence, Shall they lie forceless in the dark below, Save to make green their little length of sods, Or deepen pansies for a year or two, Who now to us are shining-sweet as gods? Was dying all they had the skill to do? That were not fruitless: but the Soul resents Such short-lived service, as if blind events Ruled without her, or earth could so endure; She claims a more divine investiture Of longer tenure than Fame's airy rents; Whate'er she touches doth her nature share; Her inspiration haunts the ennobled air, Gives eyes to mountains blind, Ears to the deaf earth, voices to the wind, And her clear trump sings succor everywhere By lonely bivouacs to the wakeful mind; For soul inherits all that soul could dare: Yea, Manhood hath a wider span And larger privilege of life than man. The single deed, the private sacrifice, So radiant now through proudly-hidden tears, Is covered up erelong from mortal eyes With thoughtless drift of the deciduous years; But that high privilege that makes all men peers, That leap of heart whereby a people rise Up to a noble anger's height, And, flamed on by the Fates, not shrink, but grow more bright, That swift validity in noble veins, Of choosing danger and disdaining shame, Of being set on flame By the pure fire that flies all contact base, But wraps its chosen with angelic might, These are imperishable gains, Sure as the sun, medicinal as light, These hold great futures in their lusty reins And certify to earth a new imperial race.

X

Who now shall sneer? Who dare again to say we trace Our lines to a plebeian race? Roundhead and Cavalier! Dumb are those names erewhile in battle loud;

Dream-footed as the shadow of a cloud, They flit across the ear: That is best blood that hath most iron in 't. To edge resolve with, pouring without stint For what makes manhood dear. Tell us not of Plantagenets, Hapsburgs, and Guelfs, whose thin bloods crawl Down from some victor in a border-brawl! How poor their outworn coronets, Matched with one leaf of that plain civic wreath Our brave for honor's blazon shall bequeath, Through whose desert a rescued Nation sets Her heel on treason, and the trumpet hears Shout victory, tingling Europe's sullen ears With vain resentments and more vain regrets!

XI

Not in anger, not in pride, Pure from passion's mixture rude Ever to base earth allied, But with far-heard gratitude, Still with heart and voice renewed, To heroes living and dear martyrs dead, The strain should close that consecrates our brave. Lift the heart and lift the head! Lofty be its mood and grave, Not without a martial ring, Not without a prouder tread And a peal of exultation: Little right has he to sing Through whose heart in such an hour Beats no march of conscious power, Sweeps no tumult of elation! 'Tis no Man we celebrate, By his country's victories great, A hero half, and half the whim of Fate, But the pith and marrow of a Nation Drawing force from all her men, Highest, humblest, weakest, all, For her time of need, and then Pulsing it again through them, Till the basest can no longer cower. Feeling his soul spring up divinely tall, Touched but in passing by her mantle-hem. Come back, then, noble pride, for 'tis her dower! How could poet ever tower, If his passions, hopes, and fears, If his triumphs and his tears, Kept not measure with his people? Boom, cannon, boom to all the winds and waves! Clash out, glad bells, from every rocking steeple! Banners, adance with triumph, bend your staves! And from every mountain-peak, Let beacon-fire to answering beacon speak, Katahdin tell Monadnock, Whiteface he, And so leap on in light from sea to sea, Till the glad news be sent Across a kindling continent, Making earth feel more firm and air breathe braver: "Be proud! for she is saved, and all have helped to save her! She that lifts up the manhood of the poor, She of the open soul and open door, With room about her hearth for all mankind! The fire is dreadful in her eyes no more; From her bold front the helm she doth unbind, Sends all her handmaid armies back to spin, And bids her navies, that so lately hurled Their crashing battle, hold their thunders in, Swimming like birds of calm along the unharmful shore. No challenge sends she to the elder world. That looked askance and hated; a light scorn Plays o'er her mouth, as round her mighty knees She calls her children back, and waits the morn Of nobler day, enthroned between her subject seas."

XII

Bow down, dear Land, for thou hast found release! Thy God, in these distempered days, Hath taught thee the sure wisdom of His ways, And through thine enemies hath wrought thy peace! Bow down in prayer and praise! No poorest in thy borders but may now Lift to the juster skies a man's enfranchised brow. O Beautiful! my Country! ours once more! Smoothing thy gold of war-dishevelled hair O'er such sweet brows as

never other wore, And letting thy set lips, Freed from wrath's pale eclipse, The rosy edges of their smile lay bare, What words divine of lover or of poet Could tell our love and make thee know it, Among the Nations bright beyond compare? What were our lives without thee? What all our lives to save thee? We reck not what we gave thee; We will not dare to doubt thee, But ask whatever else, and we will dare!

JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL.

PART V

THE PERIOD OF EXPANSION

THE EAGLE'S SONG

The lioness whelped, and the sturdy cub Was seized by an eagle and carried up, And homed for a while in an eagle's nest, And slept for a while on an eagle's breast; And the eagle taught it the eagle's song: "To be stanch, and valiant, and free, and strong!"

The lion whelp sprang from the eyrie nest, From the lofty crag where the queen birds rest; He fought the King on the spreading plain, And drove him back o'er the foaming main. He held the land as a thrifty chief, And reared his cattle, and reaped his sheaf, Nor sought the help of a foreign hand, Yet welcomed all to his own free land!

Two were the sons that the country bore To the Northern lakes and the Southern shore; And Chivalry dwelt with the Southern son, And Industry lived with the Northern one. Tears for the time when they broke and fought! Tears was the price of the union wrought! And the land was red in a sea of blood, Where brother for brother had swelled the flood!

And now that the two are one again, Behold on their shield the word "Refrain!" And the lion cubs twain sing the eagle's song: "To be stanch, and valiant, and free, and strong!" For the eagle's beak, and the lion's paw, And the lion's fangs, and the eagle's claw, And the eagle's swoop, and the lion's might, And the lion's leap, and the eagle's sight, Shall guard the flag with the word "Refrain!" Now that the two are one again!

RICHARD MANSFIELD.

CHAPTER I

RECONSTRUCTION AND AFTER

The war was over, but three great questions remained to be settled. How were the people of the South to be regarded? How was the Union to be reconstructed? What was to be done with the three millions of negroes who had been given their freedom? These were the questions which came before the Thirty-Ninth Congress.

TO THE THIRTY-NINTH CONGRESS

O people-chosen! are ye not Likewise the chosen of the Lord, To do His will and speak His word?

From the loud thunder-storm of war Not man alone hath called ye forth, But He, the God of all the earth!

The torch of vengeance in your hands He quenches; unto Him belongs The solemn recompense of wrongs.

Enough of blood the land has seen, And not by cell or gallows-stair Shall ye the way of God prepare.

Say to the pardon-seekers: Keep Your manhood, bend no suppliant knees, Nor palter with unworthy pleas.

Above your voices sounds the wail Of starving men; we shut in vain Our eyes to Pillow's ghastly stain.

What words can drown that bitter cry? What tears wash out the stain of death? What oaths confirm your broken faith?

From you alone the guaranty Of union, freedom, peace, we claim; We urge no conqueror's terms of shame.

Alas! no victor's pride is ours; We bend above our triumphs won Like David o'er his rebel son.

Be men, not beggars. Cancel all By one brave, generous action: trust Your better instincts, and be just!

Make all men peers before the law, Take hands from off the negro's throat, Give black and white an equal vote.

Keep all your forfeit lives and lands, But give the common law's redress To labor's utter nakedness.

Revive the old heroic will; Be in the right as brave and strong As ye have proved yourselves in wrong.

Defeat shall then be victory, Your loss the wealth of full amends, And hate be love, and foes be friends.

Then buried be the dreadful past, Its common slain be mourned, and let All memories soften to regret.

Then shall the Union's mother-heart Her lost and wandering ones recall, Forgiving and restoring all,--

And Freedom break her marble trance Above the Capitolian dome, Stretch hands, and bid ye welcome home!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

Few men could have been worse fitted for the delicate task of reconstruction than Andrew Johnson. But even his policy, narrow as it was, was not narrow enough to suit the radical Republicans in Congress.

"MR. JOHNSON'S POLICY OF RECONSTRUCTION"

SOME COMMENT FROM THE BOYS IN BLUE

"His policy," do you say? By heaven, who says so lies in his throat! 'Twas our policy, boys, from our muster-day, Through skirmish and bivouac, march and fray-- "His policy," do you say?

"His policy"--do but note! 'Tis a pitiful falsehood for you to say. Did he bid all the stars in our banner float? Was it he shouted Union from every throat Through the long war's weary day?

"His policy"--how does it hap? Has the old word "Union" no meaning, pray? What meant the "U. S." upon every cap-- Upon every button, belt, and strap? 'Twas our policy all the way.

"His policy?" That may do For a silly and empty political brag; But 'twas held by every Boy in Blue When he lifted his right hand, stanch and true, And swore to sustain the flag.

We are with him none the less-- He works for the same great end we sought; We feel for the South in its deep distress, And to get the old Union restored we press-- 'Twas for this we enlisted and fought.

Be it his or whose it may, 'Tis the policy, boys, that we avow; There were noble hearts in the ranks of gray As they proved on many a bloody day, And we would not oppress them now.

"Let us all forgive and forget:" It was thus Grant spoke to General Lee, When, with wounds still raw and bayonets wet, The chiefs of the two great armies met Beneath the old apple-tree.

CHARLES GRAHAM HALPINE.

The leader of this coterie was Thaddeus Stevens. He declared the South was in a state of anarchy, demanded that it be placed under military rule and that suffrage be extended to the negroes. In February, 1868, he introduced a resolution that "Andrew Johnson, President of the United States, be impeached of high crimes and misdemeanors in office," but at the trial which followed the proceedings were shown to have been actuated by partisan bitterness and the President was acquitted. The verdict was a heavy blow to Stevens. He had burned himself out and died in August.

THADDEUS STEVENS

DIED AUG. 11, 1868

An eye with the piercing eagle's fire, Not the look of the gentle dove; Not his the form that men admire, Nor the face that tender women love.

Working first for his daily bread With the humblest toilers of the earth; Never walking with free, proud tread-- Crippled and halting from his birth.

Wearing outside a thorny suit Of sharp, sarcastic, stinging power; Sweet at the core as sweetest fruit, Or inmost heart of fragrant flower.

Fierce and trenchant, the haughty foe Felt his words like a sword of flame; But to the humble, poor, and low Soft as a woman's his accents came.

Not his the closest, tenderest friend-- No children blessed his lonely way; But down in his heart until the end The tender dream of his boyhood lay.

His mother's faith he held not fast; But he loved her living, mourned her dead, And he kept her memory to the last As green as the sod above her bed.

He held as sacred in his home Whatever things she wrought or planned, And never suffered change to come To the work of her "industrious hand."

For her who pillowed first his head He heaped with a wealth of flowers the grave, While he chose to sleep in an unmarked bed, By his Master's humblest poor--the slave!

Suppose he swerved from the straightest course-- That the things he should not do he did-- That he hid from the eyes of mortals, close, Such sins as you and I have hid?

Or suppose him worse than you; what then? Judge not, lest you be judged for sin! One said who knew the hearts of men: Who loveth much shall a pardon win.

The Prince of Glory for sinners bled; His soul was bought with a royal price; And his beautified feet on flowers may tread To-day with his Lord in Paradise.

PHOEBE CARY.

The South's condition meanwhile was pitiful indeed. Negroes, led by "carpet-baggers" from the North, secured the ascendancy in state government. Millions of dollars were wasted or stolen, and it looked for a time as though a great section of the country was doomed to negro domination.

SOUTH CAROLINA TO THE STATES OF THE NORTH

ESPECIALLY TO THOSE THAT FORMED A PART OF THE ORIGINAL THIRTEEN

I lift these hands with iron fetters banded: Beneath the scornful sunlight and cold stars I rear my once imperial forehead branded By alien shame's immedicable scars; Like some pale captive, shunned by all the nations, I crouch unpitied, quivering and apart-- Laden with countless woes and desolations, The life-blood freezing round a broken heart!

About my feet, splashed red with blood of slaughters, My children gathering in wild, mournful throngs, Despairing sons, frail infants, stricken daughters, Rehearse the awful burden of their wrongs; Vain is their cry, and worse than vain their pleading: I turn from stormy breasts, from yearning eyes, To mark where Freedom's outraged form receding, Wanes in chill shadow down the midnight skies!

I wooed her once in wild tempestuous places, The purple vintage of my soul outpoured, To win and keep her unrestrained embraces, What time the olive-crown o'ertopped the sword; Oh! northmen, with your gallant heroes blending, Mine, in old years, for this sweet goddess died; But now--ah! shame, all other shame transcending! _Your_ pitiless hands have torn her from my side.

What! 'tis a tyrant-party's treacherous action-- Your hand is clean, your conscience clear, ye sigh; Ay! but ere now your sires had throttled faction, Or, pealed o'er half the world their battle-cry; Its voice outrung from solemn mountain-passes Swept by wild storm-winds of the Atlantic strand, To where the swart Sierras' sullen grasses Droop in low languors of the sunset-land!

Never, since earthly States began their story, Hath any suffered, bided, borne like me: At last, recalling all mine ancient glory, I vowed my fettered Commonwealth to free: Even at the thought, beside the prostrate column Of chartered rights, which blasted lay and dim-- Uprose my noblest son with purpose solemn, While, host on host, his brethren followed _him_:

Wrong, grasped by _truth_, arraigned by _law_ (whose sober Majestic mandates rule o'er change and time)-- Smit by the _ballot_, like some flushed October, Reeled in the Autumn rankness of his crime; Struck, tortured, pierced--but not a blow returning. The steadfast phalanx of my honored braves Planted their bloodless flag where sunrise burning, Flashed a new splendor o'er our martyrs' graves!

What then? Oh, sister States! what welcome omen Of love and concord crossed our brightening blue, The foes we vanquished, are they not _your_ foemen, Our laws upheld, your sacred safeguards, too? Yet scarce had victory crowned our grand endeavor, And peace crept out from shadowy glooms remote-- Than--as if bared to blast all hope forever, Your tyrant's sword shone glittering at my throat!

Once more my bursting chains were reunited, Once more barbarian plaudits wildly rung O'er the last promise of deliverance blighted, The prostrate purpose and the palsied tongue: Ah! faithless sisters, 'neath my swift undoing, Peers the black presage of your wrath to come; Above your heads are signal clouds of ruin, Whose lightnings flash, whose thunders are not dumb!

There towers a judgment-seat beyond our seeing; There lives a Judge, whom none can bribe or blind; Before whose dread decree, your spirit fleeing, May reap the whirlwind, having sown the wind: I, in that day of justice, fierce and torrid, When blood--_your_ blood--outpours like poisoned wine, _Pointing to these chained limbs, this blasted forehead, May mock your ruin, as ye mocked at mine_!

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

But the white people of the South rallied at last, asserted their supremacy, and seized the reins of government. The famous Ku-Klux Klan was organized and spread terror among the negroes, by its sure and swift administration of punishment--just and unjust.

KU-KLUX

We have sent him seeds of the melon's core, And nailed a warning upon his door; By the Ku-Klux laws we can do no more.

Down in the hollow, 'mid crib and stack, The roof of his low-porched house looms black, Not a line of light at the doorsill's crack.

Yet arm and mount! and mask and ride! The hounds can sense though the fox may hide! And for a word too much men oft have died.

The clouds blow heavy towards the moon. The edge of the storm will reach it soon. The killdee cries and the lonesome loon.

The clouds shall flush with a wilder glare Than the lightning makes with his angled flare, When the Ku-Klux verdict is given there.

In the pause of the thunder rolling low, A rifle's answer--who shall know From the wind's fierce hurl and the rain's black blow?

Only the signature written grim At the end of the message brought to him,-- A hempen rope and a twisted limb.

So arm and mount! and mask and ride! The hounds can sense though the fox may hide! And for a word too much men oft have died.

MADISON CAWEIN.

The North kept its hands off and permitted the South to work out its own destiny--which it did blindly and blunderingly enough. Yet bravely, too; for it had only ashes to build from. But from the ashes a new land arose, and a better one.

THE REAR GUARD

The guns are hushed. On every field once flowing With war's red flood May's breath of peace is shed, And, spring's young grass and gracious flowers are growing Above the dead.

Ye gray old men whom we this day are greeting, Honor to you, honor and love and trust! Brave to the brave. Your soldier hands are meeting Across their dust.

Bravely they fought who charged when flags were flying In cannon's crash, in screech and scream of shell; Bravely they fell, who lay alone and dying In battle's hell.

Honor to them! Far graves to-day are flinging Up through the soil peace-blooms to meet the sun, And daisied heads to summer winds are singing Their long "well done."

Our vanguard, they. They went with hot blood flushing At battle's din, at joy of bugle's call. They fell with smiles, the flood of young life gushing, Full brave the fall!

But braver ye who, when the war was ended, And bugle's call and wave of flag were done, Could come back home, so long left undefended. Your cause unwon,

And twist the useless sword to hook of reaping, Rebuild the homes, set back the empty chair And brave a land where waste and want were keeping Guard everywhere.

All this you did, your courage strong upon you, And out of ashes, wreck, a new land rose, Through years of war no braver battle won you, 'Gainst fiercer foes.

And now to-day a prospered land is cheering And lifting up her voice in lusty pride For you gray men, who fought and wrought, not fearing Battle's red tide.

Our rear guard, ye whose step is slowing, slowing, Whose ranks, earth-thinned, are filling otherwhere, Who wore the gray--the gray, alas! still showing On bleaching hair.

For forty years you've watched this land grow stronger, For forty years you've been its bulwark, stay; Tarry awhile; pause yet a little longer Upon the way.

And set our feet where there may be no turning, And set our faces straight on duty's track, Where there may be for stray, strange goods no yearning Nor looking back.

And when for you the last tattoo has sounded, And on death's silent field you've pitched your tent, When, bowed through tears, the arc of life has rounded To full content,

We that are left will count it guerdon royal, Our heritage no years can take away, That we were born of those, unflinching, loyal, Who wore the gray.

IRENE FOWLER BROWN.

The bitterness which the great struggle had engendered gradually gave place to a kindlier feeling. As early as 1867, the women of Columbus, Miss., decorated alike the graves of Confederate and Union soldiers, an action which was the first of many such.

THE BLUE AND THE GRAY

[1867]

By the flow of the inland river, Whence the fleets of iron have fled, Where the blades of the grave-grass quiver, Asleep are the ranks of the dead: Under the sod and the dew, Waiting the judgment-day; Under the one, the Blue, Under the other, the Gray.

These in the robings of glory, Those in the gloom of defeat, All with the battle-blood gory, In the dusk of eternity meet: Under the sod and the dew, Waiting the judgment-day; Under the laurel, the Blue, Under the willow, the Gray.

From the silence of sorrowful hours The desolate mourners go, Lovingly laden with flowers Alike for the friend and the foe: Under the sod and the dew Waiting the judgment-day; Under the roses, the Blue, Under the lilies, the Gray.

So with an equal splendor, The morning sun-rays fall, With a touch impartially tender, On the blossoms blooming for all: Under the sod and the dew, Waiting the judgment-day; Broidered with gold, the Blue, Mellowed with gold, the Gray.

So, when the summer calleth, On forest and field of grain, With an equal murmur falleth The cooling drip of the rain: Under the sod and the dew, Waiting the judgment-day; Wet with the rain, the Blue, Wet with the rain, the Gray.

Sadly, but not with upbraiding, The generous deed was done, In the storm of the years that are fading No braver battle was won: Under the sod and the dew, Waiting the judgment-day; Under the blossoms, the Blue, Under the garlands, the Gray.

No more shall the war-cry sever, Or the winding rivers be red; They banish our anger forever When they laurel the graves of our dead! Under the sod and the dew, Waiting the judgment-day; Love and tears for the Blue, Tears and love for the Gray.

FRANCIS MILES FINCH.

When the South was swept by yellow fever a few years later, the North rushed to its relief in a way which showed how completely old animosities had been forgotten.

THE STRICKEN SOUTH TO THE NORTH

When ruthful time the South's memorial places-- Her heroes' graves--had wreathed in grass and flowers; When Peace ethereal, crowned by all her graces, Returned to make more bright the summer hours; When doubtful hearts revived, and hopes grew stronger; When old sore-cankering wounds that pierced and stung, Throbbed with their first, mad, feverous pain no longer, While the fair future spake with flattering tongue; When once, once more she felt her pulses beating To rhythms of healthful joy and brave desire; Lo! round her doomed horizon darkly meeting, A pall of blood-red vapors veined with fire!

Oh! ghastly portent of fast-coming sorrows! Of doom that blasts the blood and blights the breath, Robs youth and manhood of all golden morrows-- And life's clear goblet brims with wine of death!-- Oh! swift fulfilment of this portent dreary! Oh! nightmare rule of ruin, racked by fears, Heartbroken wail, and solemn _miserere_, Imperious anguish, and soul-melting tears! Oh! faith, thrust downward from celestial splendors, Oh! love grief-bound, with palely-murmurous mouth! Oh! agonized by life's supreme surrenders-- Behold her now--the scourged and suffering South!

No balm in Gilead? nay, but while her forehead, Pallid and drooping, lies in foulest dust, There steals across the desolate spaces torrid, A voice of manful cheer and heavenly trust, A hand redeeming breaks the frozen starkness Of palsied nerve, and dull, despondent brain; Rolls back the curtain of malignant darkness, And shows the eternal blue of heaven again-- Revealing there, o'er worlds convulsed and shaken, That face whose mystic tenderness enticed To hope new-born earth's lost bereaved,

forsaken! Ah! still beyond the tempest smiles the Christ!

Whose voice? Whose hand? Oh, thanks divinest Master, Thanks for those grand emotions which impart Grace to the North to feel the South's disaster, The South to bow with touched and cordial heart! Now, now at last the links which war had broken Are welded fast, at mercy's charmed commands; Now, now at last the magic words are spoken Which blend in one two long-divided lands! O North! you came with warrior strife and clangor; You left our South one gory burial ground; But love, more potent than your haughtiest anger, Subdues the souls which hate could only wound!

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

On July 29, 1866, the first submarine cable was completed between Ireland and Newfoundland, the enterprise having been undertaken and carried through by Cyrus West Field.

HOW CYRUS LAID THE CABLE

[July 29, 1866]

Come, listen all unto my song; It is no silly fable; 'Tis all about the mighty cord They call the Atlantic Cable.

Bold Cyrus Field he said, says he, "I have a pretty notion That I can run a telegraph Across the Atlantic Ocean."

Then all the people laughed, and said They'd like to see him do it; He might get half-seas over, but He never could go through it.

To carry out his foolish plan He never would be able; He might as well go hang himself With his Atlantic Cable.

But Cyrus was a valiant man, A fellow of decision; And heeded not their mocking words, Their laughter and derision.

Twice did his bravest efforts fail, And yet his mind was stable; He wa'n't the man to break his heart Because he broke his cable.

"Once more, my gallant boys!" he cried; "_Three times!_--you know the fable (I'll make it _thirty_," muttered he, "But I will lay the cable!").

Once more they tried,--hurrah! hurrah! What means this great commotion? The Lord be praised! the cable's laid Across the Atlantic Ocean!

Loud ring the bells,--for, flashing through Six hundred leagues of water, Old Mother England's benison Salutes her eldest daughter!

O'er all the land the tidings speed, And soon, in every nation, They'll hear about the cable with Profoundest admiration!

Now, long live President and Queen; And long live gallant Cyrus; And may his courage, faith, and zeal With emulation fire us;

And may we honor evermore The manly, bold, and stable; And tell our sons, to make them brave, How Cyrus laid the cable!

JOHN GODFREY SAXE.

THE CABLE HYMN

O lonely bay of Trinity, O dreary shores, give ear! Lean down unto the white-lipped sea The voice of God to hear!

From world to world His couriers fly, Thought-winged and shod with fire; The angel of His stormy sky Rides down the sunken wire.

What saith the herald of the Lord? "The world's long strife is done; Close wedded by that mystic cord, Its continents are one.

"And one in heart, as one in blood, Shall all her peoples be; The hands of human brotherhood Are clasped beneath the sea.

"Through Orient seas, o'er Afric's plain And Asian mountains borne, The vigor of the Northern brain Shall nerve the world outworn.

"From clime to clime, from shore to shore, Shall thrill the magic thread; The new Prometheus steals once more The fire that wakes the dead."

Throb on, strong pulse of thunder! beat From answering beach to beach; Fuse nations in thy kindly heat, And melt the chains of each!

Wild terror of the sky above, Glide tamed and dumb below! Bear gently, Ocean's carrier-dove, Thy errands to and fro.

Weave on, swift shuttle of the Lord, Beneath the deep so far, The bridal robe of earth's accord, The funeral shroud of war!

For lo! the fall of Ocean's wall Space mocked and time outrun; And round the world the thought of all Is as the thought of one!

The poles unite, the zones agree, The tongues of striving cease; As on the Sea of Galilee The Christ is whispering, Peace!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

The most notable accomplishment of Johnson's administration was the purchase from Russia in 1867 of the territory of Alaska. The price paid was $7,200,000, and the cession was formally made on June 20.

AN ARCTIC VISION

[June 20, 1867]

Where the short-legged Esquimaux Waddle in the ice and snow, And the playful Polar bear Nips the hunter unaware; Where by day they track the ermine, And by night another vermin,-- Segment of the frigid zone, Where the temperature alone

Warms on St. Elias' cone; Polar dock, where Nature slips From the ways her icy ships; Land of fox and deer and sable, Shore end of our western cable,-- Let the news that flying goes Thrill through all your Arctic floes, And reverberate the boast From the cliffs off Beechey's coast, Till the tidings, circling round Every bay of Norton Sound, Throw the vocal tide-wave back To the isles of Kodiac. Let the stately Polar bears Waltz around the pole in pairs, And the walrus, in his glee, Bare his tusk of ivory; While the bold sea-unicorn Calmly takes an extra horn; All ye Polar skies, reveal your Very rarest of parhelia; Trip it, all ye merry dancers, In the airiest of "Lancers"; Slide, ye solemn glaciers, slide, One inch farther to the tide, Nor in rash precipitation Upset Tyndall's calculation. Know you not what fate awaits you, Or to whom the future mates you? All ye icebergs make salaam,-- You belong to Uncle Sam!

On the spot where Eugene Sue Led his wretched Wandering Jew, Stands a form whose features strike Russ and Esquimaux alike. He it is whom Skalds of old In their Runic rhymes foretold; Lean of flank and lank of jaw, See the real Northern Thor! See the awful Yankee leering Just across the Straits of Behring; On the drifted snow, too plain, Sinks his fresh tobacco stain, Just beside the deep inden- Tation of his Number 10.

Leaning on his icy hammer Stands the hero of this drama, And above the wild-duck's clamor, In his own peculiar grammar, With its linguistic disguises, Lo, the Arctic prologue rises: "Wall, I reckon 'tain't so bad, Seein' ez 'twas all they had; True, the Springs are rather late And early Falls predominate; But the ice crop's pretty sure, And the air is kind o' pure; 'Tain't so very mean a trade, When the land is all surveyed. There's a right smart chance for fur-chase All along this recent purchase, And, unless the stories fail, Every fish from cod to whale; Rocks, too; mebbe quartz; let's see,-- 'Twould be strange if there should be,-- Seems I've heerd such stories told; Eh!--why, bless us,--yes, it's gold!"

While the blows are falling thick From his California pick, You may recognize the Thor Of the vision that I saw,-- Freed from legendary glamour, See the real magician's hammer.

BRET HARTE.

ALASKA

Ice built, ice bound, and ice bounded, Such cold seas of silence! such room! Such snow-light, such sea-light, confounded With thunders that smite like a doom! Such grandeur! such glory! such gloom! Hear that boom! Hear that deep distant boom Of an avalanche hurled Down this unfinished world!

Ice seas! and ice summits! ice spaces In splendor of white, as God's throne! Ice worlds to the pole! and ice places Untracked, and unnamed, and unknown! Hear that boom! Hear the grinding, the groan Of the ice-gods in pain! Hear the moan Of yon ice mountain hurled Down this unfinished world.

JOAQUIN MILLER.

Friday, September 24, 1869, witnessed one of the greatest panics ever known in the United States, when Jay Gould and a few associates managed to drive the price of gold up to 162-1/2.

ISRAEL FREYER'S BID FOR GOLD

FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 24, 1869

Zounds! how the price went flashing through Wall Street, William, Broad Street, New! All the specie in all the land Held in one Ring by a giant hand-- For millions more it was ready to pay, And throttle the Street on hangman's-day. Up from the Gold Pit's nether hell, While the innocent fountain rose and fell, Loud and higher the bidding rose, And the bulls, triumphant, faced their foes. It seemed as if Satan himself were in it: Lifting it--one per cent a minute-- Through the bellowing broker, there amid, Who made the terrible, final bid! High over all, and ever higher, Was heard the voice of Israel Freyer,-- A doleful knell in the storm-swept mart,-- "Five millions more! and for any part I'll give One Hundred and Sixty!"

Israel Freyer--the Government Jew-- Good as the best--soaked through and through With credit gained in the year he sold Our Treasury's precious hoard of gold; Now through his thankless mouth rings out The leaguers' last and cruellest shout! Pity the shorts? Not they, indeed, While a single rival's left to bleed! Down come dealers in silks and hides, Crowding the Gold Room's rounded sides, Jostling, trampling each other's feet, Uttering groans in the outer street; Watching, with upturned faces pale, The scurrying index mark its tale; Hearing the bid of Israel Freyer,-- That ominous voice, would it never tire? "Five millions more!--for any part (If it breaks your firm, if it cracks your heart), I'll give One Hundred and Sixty!"

One Hundred and Sixty! Can't be true! What will the bears-at-forty do? How will the merchants pay their dues? How will the country stand the news? What'll the banks--but listen! hold! In screwing upward the price of gold To that dangerous, last, particular peg, They have killed their Goose with the Golden Egg! Just there the metal came pouring out, All ways at once, like a water-spout, Or a rushing, gushing, yellow flood, That drenched the bulls wherever they stood! Small need to open the Washington main, Their coffer-dams were burst with the strain! It came by runners, it came by wire, To answer the bid of Israel Freyer, It poured in millions from every side, And almost strangled him as he cried,-- "I'll give One Hundred and Sixty!"

Like Vulcan after Jupiter's kick, Or the aphoristical Rocket's stick, Down, down, down, the premium fell, Faster than this rude rhyme can tell! Thirty per cent the index slid, Yet Freyer still kept making his bid,-- "One Hundred and Sixty for any part!" --The sudden ruin had crazed _his_ heart, Shattered his senses, cracked his brain, And left him crying again and again,-- Still making his bid at the market's top (Like the Dutchman's leg that never could stop), "One Hundred and Sixty--Five Millions more!" Till they dragged him, howling, off the floor. The very last words that seller and buyer Heard from the mouth of Israel Freyer-- A cry to remember long as they live-- Were, "I'll take Five Millions more! I'll give-- I'll give One Hundred and

Sixty!"

Suppose (to avoid the appearance of evil) There's such a thing as a Personal Devil, It would seem that his Highness here got hold, For once, of a bellowing Bull in Gold! Whether bull or bear, it wouldn't much matter Should Israel Freyer keep up his clatter On earth or under it (as, they say, He is doomed) till the general Judgment Day, When the Clerk, as he cites him to answer for 't, Shall bid him keep silence in that Court! But it matters most, as it seems to me, That my countrymen, great and strong and free, So marvel at fellows who seem to win, That if even a Clown can only begin By stealing a railroad, and use its purse For cornering stocks and gold, or--worse-- For buying a Judge and Legislature, And sinking still lower poor human nature, The gaping public, whatever befall, Will swallow him, tandem, harlots, and all! While our rich men drivel and stand amazed At the dust and pother his gang have raised, And make us remember a nursery tale Of the four-and-twenty who feared one snail.

What's bred in the bone will breed, you know; Clowns and their trainers, high and low, Will cut such capers, long as they dare, While honest Poverty says its prayer. But tell me what prayer or fast can save Some hoary candidate for the grave, The market's wrinkled Giant Despair, Muttering, brooding, scheming there,-- Founding a college or building a church Lest Heaven should leave him in the lurch! Better come out in the rival way, Issue your scrip in open day, And pour your wealth in the grimy fist Of some gross-mouthed, gambling pugilist; Leave toil and poverty where they lie, Pass thinkers, workers, artists, by, Your pot-house fag from his counters bring And make him into a Railway King! Between such Gentiles and such Jews Little enough one finds to choose: Either the other will buy and use, Eat the meat and throw him the bone, And leave him to stand the brunt alone.

--Let the tempest come, that's gathering near, And give us a better atmosphere!

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

On October 8 and 9, 1871, Chicago, which had grown to be the greatest city in the West, was almost entirely destroyed by fire. An area of three and a half square miles was burned over; two hundred people were killed and a hundred thousand rendered homeless.

CHICAGO

[October 8-10, 1871]

Men said at vespers: "All is well!" In one wild night the city fell; Fell shrines of prayer and marts of gain Before the fiery hurricane.

On threescore spires had sunset shone, Where ghastly sunrise looked on none. Men clasped each other's hands, and said: "The City of the West is dead!"

Brave hearts who fought, in slow retreat, The fiends of fire from street to street, Turned, powerless, to the blinding glare, The dumb defiance of despair.

A sudden impulse thrilled each wire That signalled round that sea of fire; Swift words of cheer, warm heart-throbs came; In tears of pity died the flame!

From East, from West, from South and North, The messages of hope shot forth, And, underneath the severing wave, The world, full-handed, reached to save.

Fair seemed the old; but fairer still The new, the dreary void shall fill With dearer homes than those o'erthrown, For love shall lay each corner-stone.

Rise, stricken city! from thee throw The ashen sackcloth of thy woe; And build, as to Amphion's strain, To songs of cheer thy walls again!

How shrivelled in thy hot distress The primal sin of selfishness! How instant rose, to take thy part, The angel in the human heart!

Ah! not in vain the flames that tossed Above thy dreadful holocaust; The Christ again has preached through thee The Gospel of Humanity!

Then lift once more thy towers on high, And fret with spires the western sky, To tell that God is yet with us, And love is still miraculous!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

CHICAGO

Blackened and bleeding, helpless, panting, prone, On the charred fragments of her shattered throne Lies she who stood but yesterday alone.

Queen of the West! by some enchanter taught To lift the glory of Aladdin's court, Then lose the spell that all that wonder wrought.

Like her own prairies by some chance seed sown, Like her own prairies in one brief day grown, Like her own prairies in one fierce night mown.

She lifts her voice, and in her pleading call We hear the cry of Macedon to Paul, The cry for help that makes her kin to all.

But haply with wan fingers may she feel The silver cup hid in the proffered meal, The gifts her kinship and our loves reveal.

BRET HARTE.

The whole country rallied to the aid of the stricken city. An Aid and Relief Society was at once formed, and within a month had received subscriptions aggregating three and a half millions.

CHICAGO

Gaunt in the midst of the prairie, She who was once so fair; Charred and rent are her garments, Heavy and dark like cerements; Silent, but round her the air Plaintively wails, "Miserere!"

Proud like a beautiful maiden, Art-like from forehead to feet, Was she till pressed like a leman Close to the breast of the demon, Lusting for one so sweet, So were her shoulders laden.

Friends she had, rich in her treasures: Shall the old taunt be true,-- Fallen, they turn their cold faces, Seeking new wealth-gilded places, Saying we never knew Aught of her smiles or her pleasures?

Silent she stands on the prairie, Wrapped in her fire-scathed sheet: Around her, thank God, is the Nation, Weeping for her desolation, Pouring its gold at her feet, Answering her "Miserere!"

JOHN BOYLE O'REILLY.

Only second to the Chicago fire in destructiveness was that which visited Boston in the following year. It started on Saturday evening, November 9, 1872, and sixty-five acres were laid waste before it was controlled.

BOSTON

[November 9, 1872]

O broad-breasted Queen among Nations! O Mother, so strong in thy youth! Has the Lord looked upon thee in ire, And willed thou be chastened by fire, Without any ruth?

Has the Merciful tired of His mercy, And turned from thy sinning in wrath, That the world with raised hand sees and pities Thy desolate daughters, thy cities, Despoiled on their path?

One year since thy youngest was stricken: Thy eldest lies stricken to-day. Ah! God, was Thy wrath without pity, To tear the strong heart from our city, And cast it away?

O Father! forgive us our doubting; The stain from our weak souls efface; Thou rebukest, we know, but to chasten, Thy hand has but fallen to hasten Return to Thy grace.

Let us rise purified from our ashes As sinners have risen who grieved; Let us show that twice-sent desolation On every true heart in the nation Has conquest achieved.

JOHN BOYLE O'REILLY.

The district burned contained the finest business blocks in the city, and the loss was estimated at $80,000,000. For a time, it seemed that the famous "Old South" would be destroyed.

THE CHURCH OF THE REVOLUTION

"The Old South stands."

Loud through the still November air The clang and clash of fire-bells broke; From street to street, from square to square, Rolled sheets of flame and clouds of smoke. The marble structures reeled and fell, The iron pillars bowed like lead; But one lone

spire rang on its bell Above the flames. Men passed, and said, "The Old South stands!"

The gold moon, 'gainst a copper sky, Hung like a portent in the air, The midnight came, the wind rose high, And men stood speechless in despair. But, as the marble columns broke, And wider grew the chasm red,-- A seething gulf of flame and smoke,-- The firemen marked the spire and said, "The Old South stands!"

Beyond the harbor, calm and fair, The sun came up through bars of gold, Then faded in a wannish glare, As flame and smoke still upward rolled. The princely structures, crowned with art, Where Commerce laid her treasures bare; The haunts of trade, the common mart, All vanished in the withering air,-- "The Old South stands!"

"The Old South must be levelled soon To check the flames and save the street; Bring fuse and powder." But at noon The ancient fane still stood complete. The mitred flame had lipped the spire, The smoke its blackness o'er it cast; Then, hero-like, men fought the fire, And from each lip the watchword passed,-- "The Old South stands!"

All night the red sea round it rolled, And o'er it fell the fiery rain: And, as each hour the old clock told, Men said, "'Twill never strike again!" But still the dial-plate at morn Was crimsoned in the rising light. Long may it redden with the dawn, And mark the shading hours of night! Long may it stand!

Long may it stand! where help was sought In weak and dark and doubtful days: Where freedom's lessons first were taught, And prayers of faith were turned to praise; Where burned the first Shekinah's flame In God's new temples of the free; Long may it stand, in freedom's name, Like Israel's pillar by the sea! Long may it stand!

HEZEKIAH BUTTERWORTH.

The nation rushed to Boston's aid just as it had done to Chicago's, and the city soon rose from her ashes greater than ever.

AFTER THE FIRE

While far along the eastern sky I saw the flags of Havoc fly, As if his forces would assault The sovereign of the starry vault And hurl Him back the burning rain That seared the cities of the plain, I read as on a crimson page The words of Israel's sceptred sage:--

For riches make them wings, and they Do as an eagle fly away.

O vision of that sleepless night, What hue shall paint the mocking light That burned and stained the orient skies Where peaceful morning loves to rise, As if the sun had lost his way And dawned to make a second day,-- Above how red with fiery glow, How dark to those it woke below!

On roof and wall, on dome and spire, Flashed the false jewels of the fire; Girt with her belt of glittering panes, And crowned with starry-gleaming vanes, Our northern

queen in glory shone With new-born splendors not her own, And stood, transfigured in our eyes, A victim decked for sacrifice!

The cloud still hovers overhead, And still the midnight sky is red; As the lost wanderer strays alone To seek the place he called his own, His devious footprints sadly tell How changed the pathways known so well; The scene, how new! The tale, how old Ere yet the ashes have grown cold!

Again I read the words that came Writ in the rubric of the flame: Howe'er we trust to mortal things, Each hath its pair of folded wings; Though long their terrors rest unspread Their fatal plumes are never shed; At last, at last, they stretch in flight, And blot the day and blast the night!

Hope, only Hope, of all that clings Around us, never spreads her wings; Love, though he break his earthly chain, Still whispers he will come again; But Faith that soars to seek the sky Shall teach our half-fledged souls to fly, And find, beyond the smoke and flame, The cloudless azure whence they came!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

On May 16, 1874, the bursting of a reservoir dam at Williamsburg, Mass., caused a disastrous flood, costing one hundred and forty lives and the loss of $1,500,000 in property. The loss of life would have been far greater but for the heroism of a milkman named Collins Graves, who rode forward in front of the flood, giving warning.

THE RIDE OF COLLINS GRAVES

[May 16, 1874]

No song of a soldier riding down To the raging fight from Winchester town; No song of a time that shook the earth With the nations' throe at a nation's birth; But the song of a brave man, free from fear As Sheridan's self or Paul Revere; Who risked what they risked, free from strife And its promise of glorious pay,--his life!

The peaceful valley has waked and stirred, And the answering echoes of life are heard; The dew still clings to the trees and grass, And the early toilers smiling pass, As they glance aside at the white-walled homes, Or up the valley, where merrily comes The brook that sparkles in diamond rills As the sun comes over the Hampshire hills.

What was it passed like an ominous breath-- Like a shiver of fear, or a touch of death? What was it? The valley is peaceful still, And the leaves are afire on top of the hill; It was not a sound, nor a thing of sense,-- But a pain, like the pang of the short suspense That thrills the being of those who see At their feet the gulf of Eternity.

The air of the valley has felt the chill; The workers pause at the door of the mill; The housewife, keen to the shivering air, Arrests her foot on the cottage stair, Instinctive taught by the mother-love, And thinks of the sleeping ones above.

Why start the listeners? Why does the course Of the mill-stream widen? Is it a horse-- "Hark to the sound of the hoofs!" they say-- That gallops so wildly Williamsburg way?

God! what was that, like a human shriek From the winding valley? Will nobody speak? Will nobody answer those women who cry As the awful warnings thunder by?

Whence come they? Listen! and now they hear The sound of the galloping horse-hoofs near; They watch the trend of the vale, and see The rider who thunders so menacingly, With waving arms and warning scream To the home-filled banks of the valley stream. He draws no rein, but he shakes the street With a shout and the ring of the galloping feet, And this the cry he flings to the wind,-- "_To the hills for your lives! The flood is behind!_"

He cries and is gone, but they know the worst,-- The breast of the Williamsburg dam has burst! The basin that nourished their happy homes Is changed to a demon. It comes! it comes!

A monster in aspect, with shaggy front Of shattered dwellings to take the brunt Of the homes they shatter;--white-maned and hoarse, The merciless Terror fills the course Of the narrow valley, and rushing raves, With death on the first of its hissing waves, Till cottage and street and crowded mill Are crumbled and crushed. But onward still, In front of the roaring flood, is heard The galloping horse and the warning word. Thank God! the brave man's life is spared! From Williamsburg town he nobly dared To race with the flood, and take the road In front of the terrible swath it mowed.

For miles it thundered and crashed behind, But he looked ahead with a steadfast mind: "_They must be warned!_" was all he said, As away on his terrible ride he sped.

When heroes are called for, bring the crown To this Yankee rider; send him down On the stream of time with the Curtius old; His deed, as the Roman's, was brave and bold; And the tale can as noble a thrill awake, For he offered his life for the people's sake!

JOHN BOYLE O'REILLY.

CHAPTER II

THE YEAR OF A HUNDRED YEARS

The year 1876 marked the completion of the first century of independence, and it was decided to celebrate it in a worthy manner. The city of Philadelphia, where the country had been born, was fittingly selected as the place for the celebration.

OUR FIRST CENTURY

It cannot be that men who are the seed Of Washington should miss fame's true applause; Franklin did plan us; Marshall gave us laws; And slow the broad scroll grew

a people's creed-- Union and Liberty! then at our need, Time's challenge coming, Lincoln gave it pause, Upheld the double pillars of the cause, And dying left them whole--our crowning deed.

Such was the fathering race that made all fast, Who founded us, and spread from sea to sea A thousand leagues the zone of liberty, And built for man this refuge from his past, Unkinged, unchurched, unsoldiered; shamed were we, Failing the stature that such sires forecast!

GEORGE EDWARD WOODBERRY.

The celebration took the form of a great industrial exposition, at which the arts and industries of the whole world were represented. The exposition was opened on May 10, 1876, more than a hundred thousand people being present. Wagner had composed a march for the occasion and Whittier's "Centennial Hymn" was sung by a chorus of a thousand voices.

CENTENNIAL HYMN

I

Our fathers' God! from out whose hand The centuries fall like grains of sand, We meet to-day, united, free, And loyal to our land and Thee, To thank Thee for the era done, And trust Thee for the opening one.

II

Here, where of old, by Thy design, The fathers spake that word of Thine Whose echo is the glad refrain Of rended bolt and falling chain, To grace our festal time, from all The zones of earth our guests we call.

III

Be with us while the New World greets The Old World thronging all its streets, Unveiling all the triumphs won By art or toil beneath the sun; And unto common good ordain This rivalship of hand and brain.

IV

Thou, who hast here in concord furled The war flags of a gathered world, Beneath our Western skies fulfil The Orient's mission of good-will, And, freighted with love's Golden Fleece, Send back its Argonauts of peace.

V

For art and labor met in truce, For beauty made the bride of use, We thank Thee; but, withal, we crave The austere virtues strong to save, The honor proof to place or gold,

The manhood never bought nor sold!

VI

Oh make Thou us, through centuries long, In peace secure, in justice strong; Around our gift of freedom draw The safeguards of Thy righteous law: And, cast in some diviner mould, Let the new cycle shame the old!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

"The restored South chanted the praises of the Union in the words of Sidney Lanier, the Georgia poet." The poem was written as a cantata, the music for which was composed by Dudley Buck.

THE CENTENNIAL MEDITATION OF COLUMBIA[13]

1776-1876

From this hundred-terraced height, Sight more large with nobler light Ranges down yon towering years. Humbler smiles and lordlier tears Shine and fall, shine and fall, While old voices rise and call Yonder where the to-and-fro Weltering of my Long-Ago Moves about the moveless base Far below my resting-place.

Mayflower, Mayflower, slowly hither flying, Trembling westward o'er yon balking sea, Hearts within _Farewell dear England_ sighing, Winds without _But dear in vain_ replying, Gray-lipp'd waves about thee shouted, crying "No! It shall not be!"

Jamestown, out of thee-- Plymouth, thee--thee, Albany-- Winter cries, _Ye freeze_: away! Fever cries, _Ye burn_: away! Hunger cries, _Ye starve_: away! Vengeance cries, _Your graves shall stay_!

Then old Shapes and Masks of Things, Framed like Faiths or clothed like Kings, Ghosts of Goods once fleshed and fair, Grown foul Bads in alien air-- War, and his most noisy lords, Tongued with lithe and poisoned swords-- Error, Terror, Rage, and Crime, All in a windy night of time Cried to me from land and sea, _No! Thou shalt not be!_

Hark! Huguenots whispering _yea_ in the dark, Puritans answering _yea_ in the dark! _Yea_ like an arrow shot true to his mark, Darts through the tyrannous heart of Denial. Patience and Labor and solemn-souled Trial, Foiled, still beginning, Soiled, but not sinning. Toil through the stertorous death of the Night, Toil when wild brother-wars new-dark the Light, Toil, and forgive, and kiss o'er, and replight.

Now Praise to God's oft-granted grace, Now Praise to Man's undaunted face, Despite the land, despite the sea, I was: I am: and I shall be-- How long, Good Angel, O how long? Sing me from Heaven a man's own song!

"Long as thine Art shall love true love, Long as thy Science truth shall know, Long as thine Eagle harms no Dove, Long as thy Law by law shall grow, Long as thy God is God above, Thy brother every man below, So long, dear Land of all my love, Thy name shall shine, thy fame shall glow!"

O Music, from this height of time my Word unfold: In thy large signals all men's hearts Man's heart behold: Mid-heaven unroll thy chords as friendly flags unfurled, And wave the world's best lover's welcome to the world.

SIDNEY LANIER.

[13] From Poems by Sidney Lanier; copyright, 1884, 1891, by Mary D. Lanier; published by Charles Scribner's Sons.

President Grant then declared the exposition open. It was a success from the very start, and great crowds were every day in attendance.

CENTENNIAL HYMN

1876

Through calm and storm the years have led Our nation on, from stage to stage-- A century's space--until we tread The threshold of another age.

We see where o'er our pathway swept A torrent-stream of blood and fire, And thank the Guardian Power who kept Our sacred League of States entire.

Oh, chequered train of years, farewell! With all thy strifes and hopes and fears! Yet with us let thy memories dwell, To warn and teach the coming years.

And thou, the new-beginning age, Warned by the past, and not in vain, Write on a fairer, whiter page, The record of thy happier reign.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT.

On July 4, 1876, simple but impressive exercises were held in the public square in the rear of Independence Hall, where, a century before, a great throng had awaited the promulgation of the "Declaration."

WELCOME TO THE NATIONS

PHILADELPHIA, JULY 4, 1876

Bright on the banners of lily and rose Lo! the last sun of our century sets! Wreathe the black cannon that scowled on our foes, All but her friendships the nation forgets! All but her friends and their welcome forgets! These are around her; but where are her foes? Lo, while the sun of her century sets, Peace with her garlands of lily and rose!

Welcome! a shout like the war trumpet's swell Wakes the wild echoes that slumber around! Welcome! it quivers from Liberty's bell; Welcome! the walls of her temple resound! Hark! the gray walls of her temple resound! Fade the far voices o'er hillside and dell; Welcome! still whisper the echoes around; Welcome! still trembles on Liberty's bell!

Thrones of the continent! isles of the sea! Yours are the garlands of peace we entwine; Welcome, once more, to the land of the free, Shadowed alike by the palm and the pine; Softly they murmur, the palm and the pine, "Hushed is our strife, in the land of the free;" Over your children their branches entwine Thrones of the continents! isles of the sea!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

"The National Ode" was read by its author, Bayard Taylor, whose deep voice and impressive delivery added appreciably to the majesty of the lines.

THE NATIONAL ODE

INDEPENDENCE SQUARE, PHILADELPHIA, JULY 4, 1876

I-1

Sun of the stately Day, Let Asia into the shadow drift, Let Europe bask in thy ripened ray, And over the severing ocean lift A brow of broader splendor! Give light to the eager eyes Of the Land that waits to behold thee rise; The gladness of morning lend her, With the triumph of noon attend her, And the peace of the vesper skies! For, lo! she cometh now With hope on the lip and pride on the brow, Stronger, and dearer, and fairer, To smile on the love we bear her,-- To live, as we dreamed her and sought her, Liberty's latest daughter! In the clefts of the rocks, in the secret places, We found her traces; On the hills, in the crash of woods that fall, We heard her call; When the lines of battle broke, We saw her face in the fiery smoke; Through toil, and anguish, and desolation, We followed, and found her With the grace of a virgin Nation As a sacred zone around her! Who shall rejoice With a righteous voice, Far-heard through the ages, if not she? For the menace is dumb that defied her, The doubt is dead that denied her, And she stands acknowledged, and strong, and free!

II-1

Ah, hark! the solemn undertone, On every wind of human story blown. A large, divinely-moulded Fate Questions the right and purpose of a State, And in its plan sublime Our eras are the dust of Time. The far-off Yesterday of power Creeps back with stealthy feet, Invades the lordship of the hour, And at our banquet takes the unbidden seat. From all unchronicled and silent ages Before the Future first begot the Past, Till History dared, at last, To write eternal words on granite pages; From Egypt's tawny drift, and Assur's mound, And where, uplifted white and far, Earth highest yearns to meet a star, And Man his manhood by the Ganges found,-- Imperial heads, of old millennial sway, And still by some pale splendor crowned, Chill as a corpse-light in our full-orbed day, In ghostly grandeur rise And say, through stony lips and vacant eyes: "Thou that assertest freedom, power, and fame, Declare to us thy claim!"

I-2

On the shores of a Continent cast, She won the inviolate soil By loss of heirdom of all the Past, And faith in the royal right of Toil! She planted homes on the savage sod: Into the wilderness lone She walked with fearless feet, In her hand the divining-rod, Till the veins of the mountains beat With fire of metal and force of stone! She set the speed of the river-head To turn the mills of her bread; She drove her ploughshare deep Through the prairie's thousand-centuried sleep, To the South, and West, and North, She called Pathfinder forth, Her faithful and sole companion Where the flushed Sierra, snow-starred, Her way to the sunset barred, And the nameless rivers in thunder and foam Channelled the terrible canyon! Nor paused, till her uttermost home Was built, in the smile of a softer sky And the glory of beauty still to be, Where the haunted waves of Asia die On the strand of the world-wide sea!

II-2

The race, in conquering, Some fierce, Titanic joy of conquest knows; Whether in veins of serf or king, Our ancient blood beats restless in repose. Challenge of Nature unsubdued Awaits not Man's defiant answer long; For hardship, even as wrong, Provokes the level-eyed heroic mood. This for herself she did; but that which lies, As over earth the skies, Blending all forms in one benignant glow,-- Crowned conscience, tender care, Justice that answers every bondman's prayer, Freedom where Faith may lead and Thought may dare, The power of minds that know, Passion of hearts that feel, Purchased by blood and woe, Guarded by fire and steel,-- Hath she secured? What blazon on her shield, In the clear Century's light Shines to the world revealed, Declaring nobler triumph, born of Right?

I-3

Foreseen in the vision of sages, Foretold when martyrs bled, She was born of the longing of ages, By the truth of the noble dead And the faith of the living fed! No blood in her lightest veins Frets at remembered chains, Nor shame of bondage has bowed her head. In her form and features still The unblenching Puritan will, Cavalier honor, Huguenot grace, The Quaker truth and sweetness, And the strength of the danger-girdled race Of Holland, blend in a proud completeness. From the homes of all, where her being began, She took what she gave to Man; Justice, that knew no station, Belief, as soul decreed, Free air for aspiration, Free force for independent deed! She takes, but to give again, As the sea returns the rivers in rain; And gathers the chosen of her seed From the hunted of every crown and creed. Her Germany dwells by a gentler Rhine; Her Ireland sees the old sunburst shine; Her France pursues some dream divine; Her Norway keeps his mountain pine; Her Italy waits by the western brine; And, broad-based under all, Is planted England's oaken-hearted mood, As rich in fortitude As e'er went worldward from the island-wall! Fused in her candid light, To one strong race all races here unite: Tongues melt in hers, hereditary foemen Forget their sword and slogan, kith and clan: 'Twas glory, once, to be a Roman: She makes it glory, now, to be a man!

II-3

Bow down! Doff thine æonian crown! One hour forget The glory, and recall the debt: Make expiation, Of humbler mood, For the pride of thine exultation O'er peril conquered and strife subdued. But half the right is wrested When victory yields her prize, And half the marrow tested When old endurance dies. In the sight of them that love thee, Bow to the Greater above thee! He faileth not to smite The idle ownership of Right, Nor spares to sinews fresh from trial, And virtue schooled in long denial, The tests that wait for thee In larger perils of prosperity. Here, at the Century's awful shrine, Bow to thy Father's God, and thine!

I-4

Behold! she bendeth now, Humbling the chaplet of her hundred years. There is a solemn sweetness on her brow, And in her eyes are sacred tears. Can she forget, In present joy, the burden of her debt, When for a captive race She grandly staked, and won, The total promise of her power begun, And bared her bosom's grace To the sharp wound that inly tortures yet? Can she forget The million graves her young devotion set, The hands that clasp above, From either side, in sad, returning love? Can she forget, Here, where the Ruler of to-day, The Citizen of to-morrow, And equal thousands to rejoice and pray Beside these holy walls are met, Her birth-cry, mixed of keenest bliss and sorrow? Where, on July's immortal morn Held forth, the People saw her head And shouted to the world: "The King is dead, But, lo! the Heir is born!" When fire of Youth, and sober trust of Age, In Farmer, Soldier, Priest, and Sage, Arose and cast upon her Baptismal garments,--never robes so fair Clad prince in Old-World air,-- Their lives, their fortunes, and their sacred honor!

II-4

Arise! Recrown thy head, Radiant with blessings of the Dead! Bear from this hallowed place The prayer that purifies thy lips, The light of courage that defies eclipse, The rose of Man's new morning on thy face! Let no iconoclast Invade thy rising Pantheon of the Past, To make a blank where Adams stood, To touch the Father's sheathed and sacred blade, Spoil crowns on Jefferson and Franklin laid, Or wash from Freedom's feet the stain of Lincoln's blood! Hearken, as from that haunted Hall Their voices call: "We lived and died for thee; We greatly dared that thou might'st be: So, from thy children still We claim denials which at last fulfil, And freedom yielded to preserve thee free!" Beside clear-hearted Right That smiles at Power's uplifted rod, Plant Duties that requite, And Order that sustains, upon thy sod, And stand in stainless might Above all self, and only less than God!

III-1

Here may thy solemn challenge end, All-proving Past, and each discordance die Of doubtful augury, Or in one choral with the Present blend, And that half-heard, sweet harmony Of something nobler that our sons may see! Though poignant memories burn Of days that were, and may again return, When thy fleet foot, O Huntress of the Woods, The slippery brinks of danger knew, And dim the eyesight grew That was so sure in thine old solitudes,-- Yet stays some richer sense Won from the mixture of

thine elements, To guide the vagrant scheme, And winnow truth from each conflicting dream! Yet in thy blood shall live Some force unspent, some essence primitive, To seize the highest use of things; For Fate, to mould thee to her plan, Denied thee food of kings, Withheld the udder and the orchard-fruits, Fed thee with savage roots, And forced thy harsher milk from barren breasts of man!

III-2

O sacred Woman-Form, Of the first People's need and passion wrought,-- No thin, pale ghost of Thought, But fair as Morning and as heart's-blood warm,-- Wearing thy priestly tiar on Judah's hills; Clear-eyed beneath Athene's helm of gold; Or from Rome's central seat Hearing the pulses of the Continents beat In thunder where her legions rolled; Compact of high heroic hearts and wills, Whose being circles all The selfless aims of men, and all fulfils; Thyself not free, so long as one is thrall; Goddess, that as a Nation lives, And as a Nation dies, That for her children as a man defies, And to her children as a mother gives,-- Take our fresh fealty now! No more a Chieftainess, with wampum-zone And feather-cinctured brow,-- No more a new Britannia, grown To spread an equal banner to the breeze, And lift thy trident o'er the double seas; But with unborrowed crest, In thine own native beauty dressed,-- The front of pure command, the unflinching eye, thine own!

III-3

Look up, look forth, and on! There's light in the dawning sky: The clouds are parting, the night is gone: Prepare for the work of the day! Fallow thy pastures lie, And far thy shepherds stray, And the fields of thy vast domain Are waiting for purer seed Of knowledge, desire, and deed, For keener sunshine and mellower rain! But keep thy garments pure: Pluck them back, with the old disdain, From touch of the hands that stain! So shall thy strength endure. Transmute into good the gold of Gain, Compel to beauty thy ruder powers, Till the bounty of coming hours Shall plant, on thy fields apart, With the oak of Toil, the rose of Art! Be watchful, and keep us so: Be strong, and fear no foe: Be just, and the world shall know! With the same love love us, as we give; And the day shall never come, That finds us weak or dumb To join and smite and cry In the great task, for thee to die, And the greater task, for thee to live!

BAYARD TAYLOR.

Richard Henry Lee, grandson of the mover of the Declaration, came to the front with the original document in his hands, and read its sonorous sentences. William M. Evarts delivered an oration and "Our National Banner," words by Dexter Smith, music by Sir Julius Benedict, was sung.

OUR NATIONAL BANNER

[July 4, 1876]

O'er the high and o'er the lowly Floats that banner bright and holy In the rays of Freedom's sun, In the nation's heart embedded, O'er our Union newly wedded, One in all, and all in one.

Let that banner wave forever, May its lustrous stars fade never, Till the stars shall pale on high; While there's right the wrong defeating, While there's hope in true hearts beating, Truth and freedom shall not die.

As it floated long before us, Be it ever floating o'er us, O'er our land from shore to shore: There are freemen yet to wave it, Millions who would die to save it, Wave it, save it, evermore.

DEXTER SMITH.

The exposition closed November 10, 1876. It had served to draw all sections of the country more closely together, and to establish the industrial position of the United States among the nations of the world.

AFTER THE CENTENNIAL

(A HOPE)

Before our eyes a pageant rolled Whose banners every land unfurled; And as it passed, its splendors told The art and glory of the world.

The nations of the earth have stood With face to face and hand in hand, And sworn to common brotherhood The sundered souls of every land.

And while America is pledged To light her Pharos towers for all, While her broad mantle, starred and edged With truth, o'er high and low shall fall;

And while the electric nerves still belt The State and Continent in one,-- The discords of the past shall melt Like ice beneath the summer sun.

O land of hope! thy future years Are shrouded from our mortal sight; But thou canst turn the century's fears To heralds of a cloudless light!

The sacred torch our fathers lit No wild misrule can ever quench; Still in our midst wise judges sit, Whom party passion cannot blench.

From soul to soul, from hand to hand Thy sons have passed that torch along, Whose flame by Wisdom's breath is fanned Whose staff is held by runners strong.

O Spirit of immortal truth, Thy power alone that circles all Can feed the fire as in its youth-- Can hold the runners lest they fall!

CHRISTOPHER PEARSE CRANCH.

CHAPTER III

THE CONQUEST OF THE PLAINS

The Indians had long since ceased to be a serious menace to the United States, and the policy of the government for many years had been to settle them upon various selected tracts of land west of the Mississippi. But the population of the West was increasing very rapidly, the completion of the railway to the Pacific having given it a great impetus.

THE PACIFIC RAILWAY

FINISHED, MAY 10, 1869

"And a Highway shall there be."

'Tis "_Done_"--the wondrous thoroughfare Type of that Highway all divine! No ancient wonder can compare With this, in grandeur of design. For, 'twas no visionary scheme To immortalize the builder's name; No impulse rash, no transient dream Of some mere worshipper of Fame.

Rare common sense conceived the plan, For working out a lasting good-- The full development of Man; The growth of human brotherhood! And lo! by patient toil and care, The work with rare success is crowned; And nations, yet to be, will share In blessings that shall e'er abound.

Across a continent's expanse, The lengthening track now runs secure, O'er which the Iron Horse shall prance, So long as earth and time endure! His course extends from East to West-- From where Atlantic billows roar, To where the quiet waters rest, Beside the far Pacific shore.

Proud commerce, by Atlantic gales Tossed to and fro,--her canvas rent-- Will gladly furl her wearied sails, And glide across a continent. Through smiling valleys, broad and free, O'er rivers wide, or mountain-crest, Her course shall swift and peaceful be, Till she has reached the farthest West.

And e'en the treasures of the East, Diverted from their wonted track,-- With safety gained, with speed increased,-- Will follow in her footsteps back. And thus the Nations, greatly blest, Will share another triumph, won, That links yet closer East and West-- The rising and the setting sun!

This glorious day with joy we greet! May Faith abound, may Love increase, And may this highway, now complete, Be the glad harbinger of Peace! God bless the Work, that it may prove The source of greater good in store, When Man shall heed the law of Love, And Nations shall learn war no more.

C. R. BALLARD.

During the autumn of 1874, gold was discovered in the Black Hills Sioux reservation and explorers rushed in; a still worse grievance was the wanton destruction of bison by hunters and excursionists. Driven to frenzy, at last, tribe after tribe of savages took up arms, and started on a career of murder and rapine.

AFTER THE COMANCHES

Saddle! saddle! saddle! Mount, mount, and away! Over the dim green prairie, Straight on the track of day; Spare not spur for mercy, Hurry with shout and thong, Fiery and tough is the mustang, The prairie is wide and long.

Saddle! saddle! saddle! Leap from the broken door, Where the brute Comanche entered, And the white-foot treads no more! The hut is burnt to ashes, There are dead men stark outside, And only a long torn ringlet Left of the stolen bride.

Go like the east wind's howling, Ride with death behind, Stay not for food or slumber, Till the thieving wolves ye find! They came before the wedding, Swifter than prayer or priest; The bride-men danced to bullets, The wild dogs ate the feast.

Look to rifle and powder, Buckle the knife-belt sure; Loose the coil of the lasso, And make the loop secure; Fold the flask in the poncho, Fill the pouch with maize, And ride as if to-morrow Were the last of living days.

Saddle! saddle! saddle! Redden spur and thong, Ride like the mad tornado, The track is lonely and long, Spare not horse nor rider, Fly for the stolen bride! Bring her home on the crupper, A scalp on either side.

It was decided to transfer the Sioux to another reservation, but, under the advice of Sitting Bull, they refused to stir. A detachment under Lieutenant-Colonel George A. Custer was sent against them, and came suddenly upon their encampment on June 25, 1876. A terrific fight followed, in which Custer and all of his men were killed.

DOWN THE LITTLE BIG HORN

June 25, 1876

Down the Little Big Horn (O troop forlorn!), Right into the camp of the Sioux (What was the muster?), Two hundred and sixty-two Went into the fight with Custer, Went out of the fight with Custer, Went out at a breath, Stanch to the death! Just from the canyon emerging, Saw they the braves of Sitting Bull surging, Two thousand and more, Painted and feathered, thirsting for gore, Did they shrink and turn back (Hear how the rifles crack!), Did they pause for a life, For a sweetheart or wife?

And one in that savage throng (His revenge had waited long), Pomped with porcupine quills, His deerskins beaded and fringed, An eagle's plume in his long black hair, His tall lance fluttering in the air, Glanced at the circling hills-- His cheeks flushed with a keen surmise, A demon's hate in his eyes Remembering the hour when he cringed, A prisoner thonged, Chief Rain-in-the-Face (There was a sachem wronged!) Saw his enemy's heart laid bare, Feasted in thought like a beast in his lair.

Cavalry, cavalry (Tramp of the hoof, champ of the bit), Horses prancing, cavorting, Shying and snorting, Accoutrements rattling (Children at home are prattling), Gallantly, gallantly, "Company dismount!" From the saddle they swing, With their steeds form a ring (Hear how the bullets sing!), Who can their courage recount?

Do you blanch at their fate? (Who would hesitate?) Two hundred and sixty-two Immortals in blue, Standing shoulder to shoulder, Like some granite boulder You must blast to displace (Were they of a valiant race?)-- Two hundred and sixty-two, And never a man to say, "I rode with Custer that day." Give the savage his triumph and bluster, Give the hero to perish with Custer, To his God and his comrades true.

Closing and closing, Nearer the redskins creep; With cunning disposing, With yell and with whoop (There are women shall weep!), They gather and swoop, They come like a flood, Maddened with blood, They shriek, plying the knife (Was there one begged for his life?), Where but a moment ago Stood serried and sternly the foe, Now fallen, mangled below.

Down the Little Big Horn (Tramp of the hoof, champ of the bit), A single steed in the morn, Comanche, seven times hit, Comes to the river to drink; Lists for the sabre's clink, Lists for the voice of his master (O glorious disaster!), Comes, sniffing the air, Gazing, lifts his head, But his master lies dead. (Who but the dead were there?) But stay, what was the muster? Two hundred and sixty-two (Two thousand and more the Sioux!) Went into the fight with Custer, Went out of the fight with Custer; For never a man can say, "I rode with Custer that day--" Went out like a taper, Blown by a sudden vapor, Went out at a breath, True to the death!

FRANCIS BROOKS.

LITTLE BIG HORN

[June 25, 1876]

Beside the lone river, That idly lay dreaming, Flashed sudden the gleaming Of sabre and gun In the light of the sun As over the hillside the soldiers came streaming.

One peal of the bugle In stillness unbroken That sounded a token Of soul-stirring strife, Savage war to the knife, Then silence that seemed like defiance unspoken.

But out of an ambush Came warriors riding, Swift ponies bestriding, Shook rattles and shells, With a discord of yells. That fired the hearts of their comrades in hiding.

Then fierce on the wigwams The soldiers descended, And madly were blended, The red man and white In a hand-to-hand fight, With the Indian village assailed and defended.

And there through the passage Of battle-torn spaces, From dark lurking-places, With blood-curdling cry And their knives held on high, Rushed Amazon women with wild, painted faces.

Then swung the keen sabres And flashed the sure rifles Their message that stifles The shout in red throats, While the reckless blue-coats Laughed on 'mid the fray as men laugh over trifles.

Grim cavalry troopers Unshorn and unshaven, And never a craven In ambuscade caught, How like demons they fought Round the knoll on the prairie that marked their last haven.

But the Sioux circled nearer The shrill war-whoop crying, And death-hail was flying, Yet still they fought on Till the last shot was gone, And all that remained were the dead and the dying.

A song for their death, and No black plumes of sorrow, This recompense borrow, Like heroes they died Man to man--side by side; We lost them to-day, we shall meet them to-morrow.

And on the lone river, Has faded the seeming Of bright armor gleaming, But there by the shore With the ghosts of no-more The shades of the dead through the ages lie dreaming.

ERNEST MCGAFFEY.

CUSTER'S LAST CHARGE

[June 25, 1876]

Dead! Is it possible? He, the bold rider, Custer, our hero, the first in the fight, Charming the bullets of yore to fly wider, Far from our battle-king's ringlets of light! Dead, our young chieftain, and dead, all forsaken! No one to tell us the way of his fall! Slain in the desert, and never to waken, Never, not even to victory's call!

Proud for his fame that last day that he met them! All the night long he had been on their track, Scorning their traps and the men that had set them, Wild for a charge that should never give back. There on the hilltop he halted and saw them,-- Lodges all loosened and ready to fly; Hurrying scouts with the tidings to awe them, Told of his coming before he was nigh.

All the wide valley was full of their forces, Gathered to cover the lodges' retreat!-- Warriors running in haste to their horses, Thousands of enemies close to his feet! Down in the valleys the ages had hollowed, There lay the Sitting Bull's camp for a prey! Numbers! What recked he? What recked those who followed-- Men who had fought ten to one ere that day?

Out swept the squadrons, the fated three hundred, Into the battle-line steady and full; Then down the hillside exultingly thundered, Into the hordes of the old Sitting Bull! Wild Ogalallah, Arapahoe, Cheyenne, Wild Horse's braves, and the rest of their crew, Shrank from that charge like a herd from a lion,-- Then closed around, the grim horde of wild Sioux!

Right to their centre he charged, and then facing-- Hark to those yells! and around them, O see! Over the hilltops the Indians come racing, Coming as fast as the waves of the sea! Red was the circle of fire around them; No hope of victory, no ray of light, Shot through that terrible black cloud without them, Brooding in death over Custer's last fight.

Then did he blench? Did he die like a craven, Begging those torturing fiends for his life? Was there a soldier who carried the Seven Flinched like a coward or fled from the strife? No, by the blood of our Custer, no quailing! There in the midst of the Indians they close, Hemmed in by thousands, but ever assailing, Fighting like tigers,

all 'bayed amid foes!

Thicker and thicker the bullets came singing; Down go the horses and riders and all; Swiftly the warriors round them were ringing, Circling like buzzards awaiting their fall. See the wild steeds of the mountain and prairie, Savage eyes gleaming from forests of mane; Quivering lances with pennons so airy, War-painted warriors charging amain.

Backward, again and again, they were driven, Shrinking to close with the lost little band; Never a cap that had worn the bright Seven Bowed till its wearer was dead on the strand. Closer and closer the death circle growing, Ever the leader's voice, clarion clear, Rang out his words of encouragement glowing, "We can but die once, boys,--we'll sell our lives dear!"

Dearly they sold them like Berserkers raging, Facing the death that encircled them round; Death's bitter pangs by their vengeance assuaging, Marking their tracks by their dead on the ground. Comrades, our children shall yet tell their story,-- Custer's last charge on the old Sitting Bull; And ages shall swear that the cup of his glory Needed but that death to render it full.

FREDERICK WHITTAKER.

CUSTER

[June 25, 1876]

What! shall that sudden blade Leap out no more? No more thy hand be laid Upon the sword-hilt smiting sore? O for another such The charger's rein to clutch,-- One equal voice to summon victory, Sounding thy battle-cry, Brave darling of the soldiers' choice! Would there were one more voice!

O gallant charge, too bold! O fierce, imperious greed To pierce the clouds that in their darkness hold Slaughter of man and steed! Now, stark and cold, Among thy fallen braves thou liest, And even with thy blood defiest The wolfish foe: But ah, thou liest low, And all our birthday song is hushed indeed!

Young lion of the plain, Thou of the tawny mane! Hotly the soldiers' hearts shall beat, Their mouths thy death repeat, Their vengeance seek the trail again Where thy red doomsmen be; But on the charge no more shall stream Thy hair,--no more thy sabre gleam,-- No more ring out thy battle-shout, Thy cry of victory!

Not when a hero falls The sound a world appalls: For while we plant his cross There is a glory, even in the loss: But when some craven heart From honor dares to part, Then, then, the groan, the blanching cheek, And men in whispers speak, Nor kith nor country dare reclaim From the black depths his name.

Thou, wild young warrior, rest, By all the prairie winds caressed! Swift was thy dying pang; Even as the war-cry rang Thy deathless spirit mounted high And sought Columbia's sky:-- There, to the northward far, Shines a new star, And from it blazes down The light of thy renown!

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

July 10, 1876.

The Indians were led by Rain-in-the-Face. The year before, he had been arrested by Captain Tom Custer at Standing Rock, and had threatened to eat the latter's heart. The Captain was among the killed, and Rain-in-the-Face is said to have made good his threat. Mr. Longfellow is mistaken in saying that Colonel George Custer was thus mutilated. His body was not disfigured in any way.

THE REVENGE OF RAIN-IN-THE-FACE

[June 25, 1876]

In that desolate land and lone, Where the Big Horn and Yellowstone Roar down their mountain path, By their fires the Sioux Chiefs Muttered their woes and griefs And the menace of their wrath.

"Revenge!" cried Rain-in-the-Face, "Revenge upon all the race Of the White Chief with yellow hair!" And the mountains dark and high From their crags reëchoed the cry Of his anger and despair.

In the meadow, spreading wide By woodland and river-side The Indian village stood; All was silent as a dream, Save the rushing of the stream And the blue-jay in the wood.

In his war paint and his beads, Like a bison among the reeds, In ambush the Sitting Bull Lay with three thousand braves Crouched in the clefts and caves, Savage, unmerciful!

Into the fatal snare The White Chief with yellow hair And his three hundred men Dashed headlong, sword in hand; But of that gallant band Not one returned again.

The sudden darkness of death Overwhelmed them like the breath And smoke of a furnace fire: By the river's bank, and between The rocks of the ravine, They lay in their bloody attire.

But the foemen fled in the night, And Rain-in-the-Face, in his flight, Uplifted high in air As a ghastly trophy, bore The brave heart, that beat no more, Of the White Chief with yellow hair.

Whose was the right and the wrong? Sing it, O funeral song, With a voice that is full of tears, And say that our broken faith Wrought all this ruin and scathe, In the Year of a Hundred Years.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

One survivor there was, and only one, Comanche, the horse ridden by Captain Miles Keogh. He was found several miles from the battlefield, and had been wounded seven times. By order of the Secretary of War, a soldier was detailed to take care of him as long as he lived, and no one was ever afterwards permitted to ride him.

MILES KEOGH'S HORSE

On the bluff of the Little Big-Horn, At the close of a woful day, Custer and his Three Hundred In death and silence lay.

Three Hundred to Three Thousand! They had bravely fought and bled; For such is the will of Congress When the White man meets the Red.

The White men are ten millions, The thriftiest under the sun; The Reds are fifty thousand, And warriors every one.

So Custer and all his fighting men Lay under the evening skies, Staring up at the tranquil heaven With wide, accusing eyes.

And of all that stood at noonday In that fiery scorpion ring, Miles Keogh's horse at evening Was the only living thing.

Alone from that field of slaughter, Where lay the three hundred slain, The horse Comanche wandered, With Keogh's blood on his mane.

And Sturgis issued this order, Which future times shall read, While the love and honor of comrades Are the soul of the soldier's creed.

He said-- _Let the horse Comanche Henceforth till he shall die, Be kindly cherished and cared for By the Seventh Cavalry._

He shall do no labor; he never shall know The touch of spur or rein; Nor shall his back be ever crossed By living rider again.

And at regimental formation Of the Seventh Cavalry, Comanche draped in mourning and led By a trooper of Company I,

Shall parade with the Regiment! Thus it was Commanded and thus done, By order of General Sturgis, signed By Adjutant Garlington.

Even as the sword of Custer, In his disastrous fall, Flashed out a blaze that charmed the world And glorified his pall.

This order, issued amid the gloom, That shrouds our army's name, When all foul beasts are free to rend And tear its honest fame.

Shall prove to a callous people That the sense of a soldier's worth, That the love of comrades, the honor of arms, Have not yet perished from earth.

JOHN HAY.

The government rushed a large force to the scene, and finally, after painful fighting and toilsome marches stretching over many months, the Indians were brought to terms. Rain-in-the-Face afterwards professed himself a man of peace, and in 1886 tried to enter Hampton Institute. He was killed during the Sioux outbreak in 1890.

ON THE BIG HORN

[1886]

The years are but half a score, And the war-whoop sounds no more With the blast of bugles, where Straight into a slaughter pen, With his doomed three hundred men, Rode the chief with the yellow hair.

O Hampton, down by the sea! What voice is beseeching thee For the scholar's lowliest place? Can this be the voice of him Who fought on the Big Horn's rim? Can this be Rain-in-the-Face?

His war-paint is washed away, His hands have forgotten to slay; He seeks for himself and his race The arts of peace and the lore That give to the skilled hand more Than the spoils of war and chase.

O chief of the Christ-like school! Can the zeal of thy heart grow cool When the victor scarred with fight Like a child for thy guidance craves, And the faces of hunters and braves Are turning to thee for light?

The hatchet lies overgrown With grass by the Yellowstone, Wind River and Paw of Bear; And, in sign that foes are friends, Each lodge like a peace-pipe sends Its smoke in the quiet air.

The hands that have done the wrong To right the wronged are strong, And the voice of a nation saith: "Enough of the war of swords, Enough of the lying words And shame of a broken faith!"

The hills that have watched afar The valleys ablaze with war Shall look on the tasselled corn; And the dust of the grinded grain, Instead of the blood of the slain, Shall sprinkle thy banks, Big Horn!

The Ute and the wandering Crow Shall know as the white men know, And fare as the white men fare; The pale and the red shall be brothers, One's rights shall be as another's, Home, School, and House of Prayer!

O mountains that climb to snow, O river winding below, Through meadows by war once trod, O wild, waste lands that await The harvest exceeding great, Break forth into praise of God!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

In 1886 another somewhat serious uprising took place among the Apaches, a band of hostiles taking the war-path under the chief, Geronimo. General Nelson A. Miles, after a long pursuit, succeeded in capturing them.

THE "GREY HORSE TROOP"

All alone on the hillside-- Larry an' Barry an' me; Nothin' to see but the sky an' the plain, Nothin' to see but the drivin' rain, Nothin' to see but the painted Sioux, Galloping, galloping: "Whoop--whuroo! The divil in yellow is down in the mud!" Sez Larry to Barry, "I'm losin' blood."

"Cheers for the Greys!" yells Barry; "Second Dragoons!" groans Larry; Hurrah! hurrah! for Egan's Grey Troop! Whoop! ye divils--ye've got to whoop; Cheer for the

troopers who die: sez I-- "Cheer for the troop that never shall die!"

All alone on the hillside-- Larry an' Barry an' me; Flat on our bellies, an' pourin' in lead-- Seven rounds left, an' the horses dead-- Barry a-cursin' at every breath; Larry beside him, as white as death; Indians galloping, galloping by, Wheelin' and squealin' like hawks in the sky!

"Cheers for the Greys!" yells Barry; "Second Dragoons!" groans Larry; Hurrah! hurrah! for Egan's Grey Troop! Whoop! ye divils--ye've got to whoop; Cheer for the troopers who die: sez I-- "Cheer for the troop that never shall die!"

All alone on the hillside-- Larry an' Barry an' me; Two of us livin' and one of us dead-- Shot in the head, and God!--how he bled! "Larry's done up," sez Barry to me; "Divvy his cartridges! Quick! gimme three!" While nearer an' nearer an' plainer in view, Galloped an' galloped the murderin' Sioux.

"Cheers for the Greys!" yells Barry; "Cheer--" an' he falls on Larry. Alas! alas! for Egan's Grey Troop! The Red Sioux, hovering stoop to swoop; Two out of three lay dead, while I Cheered for the troop that never shall die.

All alone on the hillside-- Larry an' Barry an' me; An' I fired an' yelled till I lost my head, Cheerin' the livin', cheerin' the dead, Swingin' my cap, I cheered until I stumbled and fell. Then over the hill There floated a trumpeter's silvery call, An' Egan's Grey Troop galloped up, that's all.

Drink to the Greys,--an' Barry! Second Dragoons,--an' Larry! Here's a bumper to Egan's Grey Troop! Let the crape on the guidons droop; Drink to the troopers who die, while I Drink to the troop that never shall die!

ROBERT W. CHAMBERS.

Geronimo was sent to Fort Pickens, Florida, where he was kept in captivity for the remainder of his life.

GERONIMO

Beside that tent and under guard In majesty alone he stands, As some chained eagle, broken-winged, With eyes that gleam like smouldering brands,-- A savage face, streaked o'er with paint, And coal-black hair in unkempt mane, Thin, cruel lips, set rigidly,-- A red Apache Tamerlane.

As restless as the desert winds, Yet here he stands like carven stone, His raven locks by breezes moved And backward o'er his shoulders blown; Silent, yet watchful as he waits Robed in his strange, barbaric guise, While here and there go searchingly The cat-like wanderings of his eyes.

The eagle feather on his head Is dull with many a bloody stain, While darkly on his lowering brow Forever rests the mark of Cain. Have you but seen a tiger caged And sullen through his barriers glare? Mark well his human prototype, The fierce Apache fettered there.

ERNEST MCGAFFEY.

In 1889 the territory known as Oklahoma was opened to settlement, and again the Indians saw their hunting-grounds invaded by the white man, while they themselves were compelled to remove to a new reservation. Sitting Bull again advised resistance, and was killed while trying to escape arrest. A squaw of the tribe, made desperate by the removal, killed her baby and committed suicide.

THE LAST RESERVATION

Sullen and dark, in the September day, On the bank of the river They waited the boat that would bear them away From their poor homes forever.

For progress strides on, and the order had gone To these wards of the nation, "Give us land and more room," was the cry, "and move on To the next reservation."

With her babe, she looked back at the home 'neath the trees From which they were driven, Where the smoke of the last camp fire, borne on the breeze, Rose slowly toward heaven.

Behind her, fair fields, and the forest and glade, The home of her nation; Around her, the gleam of the bayonet and blade Of civilization.

Clasping close to her bosom the small dusky form, With tender caressing, She bent down, on the cheek of her babe soft and warm A mother's kiss pressing.

There's a splash in the river--the column moves on, Close-guarded and narrow, With hardly more note of the two that are gone Than the fall of a sparrow.

Only an Indian! Wretched, obscure, To refinement a stranger, And a babe, that was born, in a wigwam as poor And rude as a manger.

Moved on--to make room for the growth in the West Of a brave Christian nation, Moved on--and, thank God, forever at rest In the last reservation.

WALTER LEARNED.

That was the last of the Indian outbreaks. Although there are still more than two hundred thousand Indians in the United States, by far the greater part of them have adopted the dress and customs of the white man and are engaged in peaceful occupations. The remainder are content to live in idleness upon the government's bounty.

INDIAN NAMES

Ye say they all have pass'd away, That noble race and brave, That their light canoes have vanish'd From off the crested wave; That, 'mid the forests where they roam'd, There rings no hunter's shout; But their name is on your waters, Ye may not wash it out.

'Tis where Ontario's billow Like ocean's surge is curl'd; Where strong Niagara's thunders wake The echo of the world; Where red Missouri bringeth Rich tribute from the West, And Rappahannock sweetly sleeps On green Virginia's breast.

Ye say their conelike cabins, That cluster'd o'er the vale, Have fled away like wither'd leaves Before the autumn's gale: But their memory liveth on your hills, Their baptism on your shore; Your everlasting rivers speak Their dialect of yore.

Old Massachusetts wears it Within her lordly crown, And broad Ohio bears it 'Mid all her young renown; Connecticut hath wreathed it Where her quiet foliage waves, And bold Kentucky breathes it hoarse, Through all her ancient caves.

Wachusett hides its lingering voice Within his rocky heart, And Alleghany graves its tone Throughout his lofty chart; Monadnock on his forehead hoar Doth seal the sacred trust: Your mountains build their monument, Though ye destroy their dust.

LYDIA HUNTLEY SIGOURNEY.

CHAPTER IV

THE SECOND ASSASSINATION

On the fourth day of March, 1881, James Abram Garfield, Republican, was inaugurated President of the United States. He had served with distinction in the Civil War and afterwards in Congress and seemed destined to enjoy a peaceful and prosperous administration. But on July 1 he was shot down at Washington by Charles J. Guiteau, a half-crazed, disappointed office-seeker. The President fought manfully for life, but blood poisoning developed, and death followed on September 19.

REJOICE

"Bear me out of the battle, for lo! I am sorely wounded."

From out my deep, wide-bosomed West, Where unnamed heroes hew the way For worlds to follow, with stern zest,-- Where gnarled old maples make array, Deep-scarred from red men gone to rest,-- Where pipes the quail, where squirrels play Through tossing trees, with nuts for toy, A boy steps forth, clear-eyed and tall, A bashful boy, a soulful boy, Yet comely as the sons of Saul,-- A boy, all friendless, poor, unknown, Yet heir-apparent to a throne.

II

Lo! Freedom's bleeding sacrifice! So, like some tall oak tempest-blown, Beside the storied stream he lies Now at the last, pale-browed and prone. A nation kneels with streaming eyes, A nation supplicates the throne, A nation holds him by the hand, A nation sobs aloud at this: The only dry eyes in the land Now at the last, I think, are his. Why, we should pray, God knoweth best, That this grand, patient soul should rest.

III

The world is round. The wheel has run Full circle. Now behold a grave Beneath the old loved trees is done. The druid oaks lift up, and wave A solemn welcome back. The brave Old maples murmur, every one, "Receive him, Earth!" In centre land, As in the centre of each heart, As in the hollow of God's hand, The coffin sinks. And with it part All party hates! Now, not in vain He bore his peril and hard pain.

IV

Therefore, I say, rejoice! I say, The lesson of his life was much,-- This boy that won, as in a day, The world's heart utterly; a touch Of tenderness and tears: the page Of history grows rich from such; His name the nation's heritage,-- But oh! as some sweet angel's voice Spake this brave death that touched us all. Therefore, I say, Rejoice! Rejoice! Run high the flags! Put by the pall! Lo! all is for the best for all!

JOAQUIN MILLER.

THE BELLS AT MIDNIGHT

[September 19, 1881]

In their dark House of Cloud The three weird sisters toil till time be sped; One unwinds life, one ever weaves the shroud, One waits to part the thread.

I

CLOTHO

How long, O sister, how long Ere the weary task is done? How long, O sister, how long Shall the fragile thread be spun?

LACHESIS

'Tis mercy that stays her hand, Else she had cut the thread; She is a woman too, Like her who kneels by his bed!

ATROPOS

Patience! the end is come; He shall no more endure: See! with a single touch!-- My hand is swift and sure!

II

Two Angels pausing in their flight.

FIRST ANGEL

Listen! what was it fell An instant ago on my ear-- A sound like the throb of a bell From yonder darkling sphere!

SECOND ANGEL

The planet where mortals dwell! I hear it not ... yes, I hear; How it deepens--a sound of dole!

FIRST ANGEL

Listen! It is the knell Of a passing soul-- The midnight lamentation Of some stricken nation For a Chieftain's soul! It is just begun, The many-throated moan ... Now the clangor swells As if a million bells Had blent their tones in one! Accents of despair Are these to mortal ear; But all this wild funereal music blown And sifted through celestial air Turns to triumphal pæans here! Wave upon wave the silvery anthems flow; Wave upon wave the deep vibrations roll From that dim sphere below. Come, let us go-- Surely, some chieftain's soul!

THOMAS BAILEY ALDRICH.

J. A. G.

Our sorrow sends its shadow round the earth. So brave, so true! A hero from his birth! The plumes of Empire moult, in mourning draped, The lightning's message by our tears is shaped.

Life's vanities that blossom for an hour Heap on his funeral car their fleeting flower. Commerce forsakes her temples, blind and dim, And pours her tardy gold, to homage him.

The notes of grief to age familiar grow Before the sad privations all must know; But the majestic cadence which we hear To-day, is new in either hemisphere.

What crown is this, high hung and hard to reach, Whose glory so outshines our laboring speech? The crown of Honor, pure and unbetrayed; He wins the spurs who bears the knightly aid.

While royal babes incipient empire hold, And, for bare promise, grasp the sceptre's gold, This man such service to his age did bring That they who knew him servant, hailed him king.

In poverty his infant couch was spread; His tender hands soon wrought for daily bread; But from the cradle's bound his willing feet The errand of the moment went to meet.

When learning's page unfolded to his view, The quick disciple straight a teacher grew; And, when the fight of freedom stirred the land, Armed was his heart and resolute his hand.

Wise in the council, stalwart in the field! Such rank supreme a workman's hut may yield. His onward steps like measured marbles show, Climbing the height where

God's great flame doth glow.

Ah! Rose of joy, that hid'st a thorn so sharp! Ah! Golden woof that meet'st a severed warp! Ah! Solemn comfort that the stars rain down! The hero's garland his, the martyr's crown.

JULIA WARD HOWE.

MIDNIGHT--SEPTEMBER 19, 1881

Once in a lifetime, we may see the veil Tremble and lift, that hides symbolic things; The Spirit's vision, when the senses fail, Sweeps the weird meaning that the outlook brings.

Deep in the midst of turmoil, it may be-- A crowded street, a forum, or a field,-- The soul inverts the telescope to see To-day's events in future's years revealed.

Back from the present, let us look at Rome: Behold, what Cato meant, what Brutus said, Hark! the Athenians welcome Cimon home! How clear they are, those glimpses of the dead!

But we, hard toilers, we who plan and weave Through common days the web of common life, What word, alas! shall teach us to receive The mystic meaning of our peace and strife?

Whence comes our symbol? Surely, God must speak-- No less than He can make us heed or pause: Self-seekers we, too busy or too weak To search beyond our daily lives and laws.

From things occult our earth-turned eyes rebel; No sound of Destiny can reach our ears; We have no time for dreaming--Hark! a knell-- A knell at midnight! All the nation hears!

A second grievous throb! The dreamers wake-- The merchant's soul forgets his goods and ships; The weary workmen from their slumbers break; The women raise their eyes with quivering lips;

The miner rests upon his pick to hear; The printer's type stops midway from the case; The solemn sound has reached the roysterer's ear, And brought the shame and sorrow to his face.

Again it booms! O Mystic Veil, upraise! --Behold, 'tis lifted! On the darkness drawn, A picture lined with light! The people's gaze, From sea to sea, beholds it till the dawn!

A death-bed scene--a sinking sufferer lies, Their chosen ruler, crowned with love and pride; Around, his counsellors, with streaming eyes; His wife, heart-broken, kneeling by his side:

Death's shadow holds her--it will pass too soon; She weeps in silence--bitterest of tears; He wanders softly--Nature's kindest boon; And as he murmurs, all the country hears:

For him the pain is past, the struggle ends; His cares and honors fade--his younger life In peaceful Mentor comes, with dear old friends; His mother's arms take home his dear young wife.

He stands among the students, tall and strong, And teaches truths republican and grand; He moves--ah, pitiful--he sweeps along O'er fields of carnage leading his command!

He speaks to crowded faces--round him surge Thousands and millions of excited men; He hears them cheer--sees some vast light emerge-- Is borne as on a tempest--then--ah, then,

The fancies fade, the fever's work is past; A deepened pang, then recollection's thrill; He feels the faithful lips that kiss their last, His heart beats once in answer, and is still!

The curtain falls: but hushed, as if afraid, The people wait, tear-stained, with heaving breast; 'Twill rise again, they know, when he is laid With Freedom, in the Capitol, at rest.

JOHN BOYLE O'REILLY.

For two days, September 22 and 23, the body lay in state in the rotunda of the Capitol. Then, in a long train crowded with the most illustrious of his countrymen, the dead President was borne to Cleveland, Ohio, and buried on September 26, in a beautiful cemetery overlooking the waters of Lake Erie.

AT THE PRESIDENT'S GRAVE

All summer long the people knelt And listened at the sick man's door: Each pang which that pale sufferer felt Throbbed through the land from shore to shore;

And as the all-dreaded hour drew nigh, What breathless watching, night and day! What tears, what prayers! Great God on high, Have we forgotten how to pray!

O broken-hearted, widowed one, Forgive us if we press too near! Dead is our husband, father, son,-- For we are all one household here.

And not alone here by the sea, And not in his own land alone, Are tears of anguish shed with thee-- In this one loss the world is one.

EPITAPH

A man not perfect, but of heart So high, of such heroic rage, That even his hopes became a part Of earth's eternal heritage.

RICHARD WATSON GILDER.

The public rage against the assassin knew no bounds. Only by the utmost vigilance was his life saved from the attacks upon it. He was brought to trial and found guilty of murder in January, 1882, and was executed June 30.

ON THE DEATH OF PRESIDENT GARFIELD

I

Fallen with autumn's falling leaf Ere yet his summer's noon was past, Our friend, our guide, our trusted chief,-- What words can match a woe so vast!

And whose the chartered claim to speak The sacred grief where all have part, Where sorrow saddens every cheek And broods in every aching heart?

Yet Nature prompts the burning phrase That thrills the hushed and shrouded hall, The loud lament, the sorrowing praise, The silent tear that love lets fall.

In loftiest verse, in lowliest rhyme, Shall strive unblamed the minstrel choir,-- The singers of the new-born time, And trembling age with outworn lyre.

No room for pride, no place for blame,-- We fling our blossoms on the grave, Pale,--scentless,--faded,--all we claim, This only,--what we had we gave.

Ah, could the grief of all who mourn Blend in one voice its bitter cry, The wail to heaven's high arches borne Would echo through the caverned sky.

II

O happiest land, whose peaceful choice Fills with a breath its empty throne! God, speaking through thy people's voice, Has made that voice for once his own.

No angry passion shakes the state Whose weary servant seeks for rest, And who could fear that scowling hate Would strike at that unguarded breast?

He stands, unconscious of his doom, In manly strength, erect, serene; Around him Summer spreads her bloom; He falls,--what horror clothes the scene!

How swift the sudden flash of woe Where all was bright as childhood's dream! As if from heaven's ethereal bow Had leaped the lightning's arrowy gleam.

Blot the foul deed from history's page; Let not the all-betraying sun Blush for the day that stains an age When murder's blackest wreath was won.

III

Pale on his couch the sufferer lies, The weary battle-ground of pain: Love tends his pillow; Science tries Her every art, alas! in vain.

The strife endures how long! how long! Life, death, seem balanced in the scale, While round his bed a viewless throng Await each morrow's changing tale.

In realms the desert ocean parts What myriads watch with tear-filled eyes, His pulse-beats echoing in their hearts, His breathings counted with their sighs!

Slowly the stores of life are spent, Yet hope still battles with despair; Will Heaven not yield when knees are bent? Answer, O thou that hearest prayer!

But silent is the brazen sky; On sweeps the meteor's threatening train, Unswerving Nature's mute reply, Bound in her adamantine chain.

Not ours the verdict to decide Whom death shall claim or skill shall save; The hero's life though Heaven denied, It gave our land a martyr's grave.

Nor count the teaching vainly sent How human hearts their griefs may share,-- The lesson woman's love has lent, What hope may do, what faith can bear!

Farewell! the leaf-strown earth enfolds Our stay, our pride, our hopes, our fears, And autumn's golden sun beholds A nation bowed, a world in tears.

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

PRESIDENT GARFIELD

"E venni dal martirio a questa pace."

PARADISO, xv, 148.

These words the poet heard in Paradise, Uttered by one who, bravely dying here In the true faith, was living in that sphere Where the celestial cross of sacrifice Spread its protecting arms athwart the skies; And set thereon, like jewels crystal clear, The souls magnanimous, that knew not fear, Flashed their effulgence on his dazzled eyes. Ah me! how dark the discipline of pain, Were not the suffering followed by the sense Of infinite rest and infinite release! This is our consolation; and again A great soul cries to us in our suspense, "I came from martyrdom unto this peace!"

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

The hundredth anniversary of the surrender of the British at Yorktown was celebrated on October 19, 1881. The lyric for the occasion was written by Paul Hamilton Hayne.

YORKTOWN CENTENNIAL LYRIC

[October 19, 1881]

Hark! hark! down the century's long reaching slope To those transports of triumph, those raptures of hope, The voices of main and of mountain combined In glad resonance borne on the wings of the wind, The bass of the drum and the trumpet that thrills Through the multiplied echoes of jubilant hills. And mark how the years melting upward like mist Which the breath of some splendid enchantment has kissed, Reveal on the ocean, reveal on the shore The proud pageant of conquest that graced them of yore, When blended forever in love as in fame See, the standard which stole from the starlight its flame, And type of all chivalry, glory, romance, The lilies, the luminous lilies of France.

Oh, stubborn the strife ere the conflict was won! And the wild whirling war wrack half stifled the sun. The thunders of cannon that boomed on the lea, But reëchoed far thunders pealed up from the sea, Where guarding his sea lists, a knight on the waves,

Bold De Grasse kept at bay the bluff bull-dogs of Graves. The day turned to darkness, the night changed to fire, Still more fierce waxed the combat, more deadly the ire, Undimmed by the gloom, in majestic advance, Oh, behold where they ride o'er the red battle tide, Those banners united in love as in fame, The brave standard which drew from the starbeams their flame, And type of all chivalry, glory, romance, The lilies, the luminous lilies of France.

No respite, no pause; by the York's tortured flood, The grim Lion of England is writhing in blood. Cornwallis may chafe and coarse Tarleton aver, As he sharpens his broadsword and buckles his spur, "This blade, which so oft has reaped rebels like grain, Shall now harvest for death the rude yeomen again." Vain boast! for ere sunset he's flying in fear, With the rebels he scouted close, close in his rear, While the French on his flank hurl such volleys of shot That e'en Gloucester's redoubt must be growing too hot. Thus wedded in love as united in fame, Lo! the standard which stole from the starlight its flame, And type of all chivalry, glory, romance, The lilies, the luminous lilies of France.

O morning superb! when the siege reached its close; See! the sundawn outbloom, like the alchemist's rose! The last wreaths of smoke from dim trenches upcurled, Are transformed to a glory that smiles on the world. Joy, joy! Save the wan, wasted front of the foe, With his battle-flags furled and his arms trailing low;-- Respect for the brave! In stern silence they yield, And in silence they pass with bowed heads from the field. Then triumph transcendent! so Titan of tone That some vowed it must startle King George on his throne.

When Peace to her own, timed the pulse of the land, And the war weapon sank from the war-wearied hand, Young Freedom upborne to the height of the goal She had yearned for so long with deep travail of soul, A song of her future raised, thrilling and clear, Till the woods leaned to hearken, the hill slopes to hear:-- Yet fraught with all magical grandeurs that gleam On the hero's high hope, or the patriot's dream, What future, though bright, in cold shadow shall cast The proud beauty that haloes the brow of the past. Oh! wedded in love, as united in fame, See the standard which stole from the starlight its flame, And type of all chivalry, glory, romance, The lilies, the luminous lilies of France.

PAUL HAMILTON HAYNE.

On May 24, 1883, the great bridge spanning the East River and connecting Brooklyn with New York City was opened to the public, having been thirteen years in process of construction.

THE BROOKLYN BRIDGE

[May 24, 1883]

A granite cliff on either shore: A highway poised in air; Above, the wheels of traffic roar; Below, the fleets sail fair;-- And in and out, forevermore, The surging tides of ocean pour, And past the towers the white gulls soar, And winds the sea-clouds bear.

O peerless this majestic street, This road that leaps the brine! Upon its heights twin cities meet, And throng its grand incline,-- To east, to west, with swiftest feet, Though ice may crash and billows beat, Though blinding fogs the wave may greet Or golden summer shine.

Sail up the Bay with morning's beam, Or rocky Hellgate by,-- Its columns rise, its cables gleam, Great tents athwart the sky! And lone it looms, august, supreme, When, with the splendor of a dream, Its blazing cressets gild the stream Till evening shadows fly.

By Nile stand proud the pyramids, But they were for the dead; The awful gloom that joy forbids, The mourners' silent tread, The crypt, the coffin's stony lids,-- Sad as a soul the maze that thrids Of dark Amenti, ere it rids Its way of judgment dread.

This glorious arch, these climbing towers, Are all for life and cheer! Part of the New World's nobler dowers; Hint of millennial year That comes apace, though evil lowers,-- When loftier aims and larger powers Will mould and deck this earth of ours, And heaven at length bring near!

Unmoved its cliffs shall crown the shore; Its arch the chasm dare; Its network hang the blue before, As gossamer in air; While in and out, forevermore, The surging tides of ocean pour, And past its towers the white gulls soar And winds the sea-clouds bear!

EDNA DEAN PROCTOR.

BROOKLYN BRIDGE

No lifeless thing of iron and stone, But sentient, as her children are, Nature accepts you for her own, Kin to the cataract and the star.

She marks your vast, sufficing plan, Cable and girder, bolt and rod, And takes you, from the hand of man, For some new handiwork of God.

You thrill through all your chords of steel Responsive to the living sun; And quickening in your nerves you feel Life with its conscious currents run.

Your anchorage upbears the march Of time and the eternal powers. The sky admits your perfect arch, The rock respects your stable towers.

CHARLES G. D. ROBERTS.

The first week in September, 1886, a destructive earthquake shook the eastern portion of the United States, Charleston, S. C., suffering a tremendous shock which snuffed out scores of lives and rendered seven eighths of the houses unfit for habitation.

CHARLESTON

1886

Is this the price of beauty! Fairest, thou, Of all the cities of the sunrise sea, Yet thrice art stricken. First, war harried thee; Then the dread circling tempest drove its plough Right through thy palaces; and now, O now! A sound of terror, and thy children flee Into the night and death. O Deity! Thou God of war and whirlwind, whose dark brow, Frowning, makes tremble sea and solid land! These are thy creatures who to heaven cry While hell roars 'neath them, and its portals ope; To thee they call,--to thee who bidst them die, Who hast forgotten to withhold thy hand,-- For thou, Destroyer, art man's only Hope!

RICHARD WATSON GILDER.

On September 9 and 11, 1886, the American yacht Mayflower defeated the English yacht Galatea in the international races for the America's cup.

MAYFLOWER

Thunder our thanks to her--guns, hearts, and lips! Cheer from the ranks to her, Shout from the banks to her,-- Mayflower! Foremost and best of our ships.

Mayflower! Twice in the national story Thy dear name in letters of gold-- Woven in texture that never grows old-- Winning a home and winning glory! Sailing the years to us, welcomed for aye; Cherished for centuries, dearest to-day. Every heart throbs for her, every flag dips-- Mayflower! First and last--best of our ships!

White as a seagull she swept the long passage. True as the homing-bird flies with its message. Love her? O, richer than silk every sail of her. Trust her? more precious than gold every nail of her. Write we down faithfully every man's part in her; Greet we all gratefully every true heart in her. More than a name to us, sailing the fleetest, Symbol of that which is purest and sweetest. More than a keel to us, steering the straightest: Emblem of that which is freest and greatest. More than a dove-bosomed sail to the windward: Flame passing on while the night-clouds fly hindward. Kiss every plank of her! None shall take rank of her; Frontward or weatherward, none can eclipse. Thunder our thanks to her! Cheer from the banks to her! Mayflower! Foremost and best of our ships!

JOHN BOYLE O'REILLY.

On October 28, 1886, Bartholdi's statue of Liberty Enlightening the World, a gift to America from the people of France, was unveiled on Bedloe's Island, in New York Harbor.

FAIREST OF FREEDOM'S DAUGHTERS

Read at the dedication of the Bartholdi Statue, New York Harbor, October 28, 1886

Night's diadem around thy head, The world upon thee gazing, Beneath the eye of heroes dead Thy queenly form up-raising. Lift up, lift up thy torch on high, Fairest of Freedom's daughters! Flash it against thine own blue sky, Flash it across the waters!

Stretch up to thine own woman's height, Thine eye lit with truth's lustre, As though from God, Himself a-light, Earth's hopes around thee cluster. The stars touch with thy forehead fair; At them thy torch was lighted. They grope to find where truth's ways are, The nations long benighted.

Thou hast the van in earth's proud march, To thee all nations turning; Thy torch against thine own blue arch, In answer to their yearning! Show them the pathway thou hast trod, The chains which thou hast broken; Teach them thy trust in man and God, The watchwords thou hast spoken.

Not here is heard the Alp-herd's horn, The mountain stillness breaking; Nor do we catch the roseate morn, The Alpine summits waking. Is Neckar's vale no longer fair, That German hearts are leaving? Ah! German hearts from hearthstones tear, In thy proud star believing.

Has Rhineland lost her grape's perfume, Her waters green and golden? And do her castles no more bloom With legends rare and olden? Why leave, strong men, the Fatherland? Why cross the cold blue ocean? Truth's torch in thine uplifted hand, Ha! kindles their devotion.

God, home, and country be thy care, Thou queen of all the ages! Belting the earth is this one prayer: Unspotted be thy pages! Lift up, lift up thy torch on high, Fairest of Freedom's daughters! Flash it against thine own blue sky, Flash it across the waters!

JEREMIAH EAMES RANKIN.

LIBERTY ENLIGHTENING THE WORLD

Warden at ocean's gate, Thy feet on sea and shore, Like one the skies await When time shall be no more! What splendors crown thy brow? What bright dread angel Thou, Dazzling the waves before Thy station great?

"My name is Liberty! From out a mighty land I face the ancient sea, I lift to God my hand; By day in Heaven's light, A pillar of fire by night, At ocean's gate I stand Nor bend the knee.

"The dark Earth lay in sleep. Her children crouched forlorn, Ere on the western steep I sprang to height, reborn: Then what a joyous shout The quickened lands gave out, And all the choir of morn Sang anthems deep.

"Beneath yon firmament. The New World to the Old My sword and summons sent, My azure flag unrolled: The Old World's hands renew Their strength; the form ye view Came from a living mould In glory blent.

"O ye, whose broken spars Tell of the storms ye met, Enter! fear not the bars Across your pathway set; Enter at Freedom's porch, For you I lift my torch, For you my coronet Is rayed with stars.

"But ye that hither draw To desecrate my fee, Nor yet have held in awe The justice that makes free,-- Avaunt, ye darkling brood! By Right my house hath stood: My name is Liberty, My throne is Law."

O wonderful and bright, Immortal Freedom, hail! Front, in thy fiery might, The midnight and the gale; Undaunted on this base Guard well thy dwelling-place: Till the last sun grow pale Let there be Light!

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

THE BARTHOLDI STATUE

1886

The land, that, from the rule of kings, In freeing us, itself made free, Our Old World Sister, to us brings Her sculptured Dream of Liberty:

Unlike the shapes on Egypt's sands Uplifted by the toil-worn slave, On Freedom's soil with freemen's hands We rear the symbol free hands gave.

O France, the beautiful! to thee Once more a debt of love we owe: In peace beneath thy Colors Three, We hail a later Rochambeau!

Rise, stately Symbol! holding forth Thy light and hope to all who sit In chains and darkness! Belt the earth With watch-fires from thy torch up-lit!

Reveal the primal mandate still Which Chaos heard and ceased to be, Trace on mid-air th' Eternal Will In signs of fire: "Let man be free!"

Shine far, shine free, a guiding light To Reason's ways and Virtue's aim, A lightning-flash the wretch to smite Who shields his license with thy name!

JOHN GREENLEAF WHITTIER.

On September 18, 1887, the one hundredth anniversary of the adoption of the Constitution of the United States was suitably observed at Philadelphia. President Grover Cleveland, Justice Samuel Freeman Miller, and John Adams Kasson delivered addresses, and "The New Hail Columbia" was sung by a chorus of two thousand voices.

ADDITIONAL VERSES TO HAIL COLUMBIA

Written at the request of the committee for the Constitutional Centennial Celebration at Philadelphia, 1887.

Look our ransomed shores around, Peace and safety we have found! Welcome, friends who once were foes! Welcome, friends who once were foes, To all the conquering years have gained,-- A nation's rights, a race unchained! Children of the day new-born! Mindful of its glorious morn, Let the pledge our fathers signed Heart to heart forever bind!

While the stars of heaven shall burn, While the ocean tides return, Ever may the circling sun Find the Many still are One!

Graven deep with edge of steel, Crowned with Victory's crimson seal, All the world their names shall read! All the world their names shall read, Enrolled with his, the

Chief that led The hosts whose blood for us was shed. Pay our sires their children's debt, Love and honor, nor forget Only Union's golden key Guards the Ark of Liberty!

While the stars of heaven shall burn, While the ocean tides return, Ever may the circling sun Find the Many still are One!

Hail, Columbia! strong and free, Throned in hearts from sea to sea! Thy march triumphant still pursue Thy march triumphant still pursue With peaceful stride from zone to zone, Till Freedom finds the world her own! Blest in Union's holy ties, Let our grateful song arise, Every voice its tribute lend, All in loving chorus blend!

While the stars in heaven shall burn, While the ocean tides return, Ever shall the circling sun Find the Many still are One!

OLIVER WENDELL HOLMES.

Following this came the recital by James Edward Murdock of the "New National Hymn," the Marine Band leading the people and the singers in the chorus.

NEW NATIONAL HYMN

Hail, Freedom! thy bright crest And gleaming shield, thrice blest, Mirror the glories of a world thine own. Hail, heaven-born Peace! our sight, Led by thy gentle light, Shows us the paths with deathless flowers strewn. Peace, daughter of a strife sublime, Abide with us till strife be lost in endless time. _Chorus_--Thy sun is risen, and shall not set, Upon thy day divine; Ages, of unborn ages, yet, America, are thine.

Her one hand seals with gold The portals of night's fold, Her other, the broad gates of dawn unbars; O'er silent wastes of snows, Crowning her lofty brows, Gleams high her diadem of northern stars; While, clothed in garlands of warm flowers, Round Freedom's feet the South her wealth of beauty showers.

Sweet is the toil of peace, Sweet is the year's increase, To loyal men who live by Freedom's laws; And in war's fierce alarms God gives stout hearts and arms To freemen sworn to save a rightful cause. Fear none, trust God, maintain the right, And triumph in unbroken Union's might.

Welded in war's fierce flame, Forged on the hearth of fame, The sacred Constitution was ordained; Tried in the fire of time, Tempered in woes sublime, An age was passed and left it yet unstained. God grant its glories still may shine, While ages fade, forgotten, in time's slow decline!

Honor the few who shared Freedom's first fight, and dared To face war's desperate tide at the full flood; Who fell on hard-won ground, And into Freedom's wound Poured the sweet balsam of their brave hearts' blood. They fell; but o'er that glorious grave Floats free the banner of the cause they died to save.

In radiance heavenly fair, Floats on the peaceful air That flag that never stooped from victory's pride; Those stars that softly gleam, Those stripes that o'er us stream, In war's grand agony were sanctified; A holy standard, pure and free, To light the home of peace, or blaze in victory.

Father, whose mighty power Shields us through life's short hour, To Thee we pray,--Bless us and keep us free: All that is past forgive; Teach us, henceforth, to live, That, through our country, we may honor Thee; And, when this mortal life shall cease, Take Thou, at last, our souls to Thine eternal peace.

FRANCIS MARION CRAWFORD.

On March 15, 1889, a destructive hurricane visited the Samoan Islands. There were in the harbor of Apia, at the time one English, three German, and three American war-ships, sent there to safeguard the interests of their respective countries. The English ship, the Calliope, succeeded in steaming out of the harbor, the crew of the American flagship Trenton cheering her as she passed. The Trenton was wrecked a few minutes later, as were the five other ships in the harbor.

IN APIA BAY

(_Morituri vos salutamus_)

Ruin and death held sway That night in Apia Bay, And smote amid the loud and dreadful gloom. But, Hearts, no longer weep The salt unresting sleep Of the great dead, victorious in their doom.

Vain, vain the strait retreat That held the fated fleet, Trapped in the two-fold threat of sea and shore! Fell reefs on either hand, And the devouring strand! Above, below, the tempest's deafening roar!

What mortal hand shall write The horror of that night, The desperate struggle in that deadly close, The yelling of the blast, The wild surf, white, aghast, The whelming seas, the thunder and the throes!

How the great cables surged, The giant engines urged, As the brave ships the unequal strife waged on! Not hope, not courage flagged; But the vain anchors dragged, Down on the reefs they shattered, and were gone!

And now were wrought the deeds Whereof each soul that reads Grows manlier, and burns with prouder breath,-- Heroic brotherhood, The loving bonds of blood, Proclaimed from high hearts face to face with death.

At length, the English ship Her cables had let slip, Crowded all steam, and steered for the open sea, Resolved to challenge Fate, To pass the perilous strait, And wrench from jaws of ruin Victory.

With well-tried metals strained, In the storm's teeth she gained, Foot by slow foot made head, and crept toward life. Across her dubious way The good ship Trenton lay, Helpless, but thrilled to watch the splendid strife.

Helmless she lay, her bulk A blind and wallowing hulk, By her strained hawsers only held from wreck, But dauntless each brave heart Played his immortal part In strong endurance on the reeling deck.

They fought Fate inch by inch,-- Could die, but could not flinch; And, biding the inevitable doom, They marked the English ship, Baffling the tempest's grip, Forge

hardly forth from the expected tomb.

Then, with exultant breath, These heroes waiting death, Thundered across the storm a peal of cheers,-- To the triumphant brave A greeting from the grave, Whose echo shall go ringing down the years.

"To you, who well have won, From us, whose course is run, Glad greeting, as we face the undreaded end!" The memory of those cheers Shall thrill in English ears Where'er this English blood and speech extend.

No manlier deed comes down, Blazoned in broad renown, From men of old who lived to dare and die! The old fire yet survives, Here in our modern lives, Of splendid chivalry and valor high!

CHARLES GEORGE DOUGLAS ROBERTS.

AN INTERNATIONAL EPISODE

[March 15, 1889]

We were ordered to Samoa from the coast of Panama, And for two long months we sailed the unequal sea, Till we made the horseshoe harbor with its curving coral bar, Smelt the good green smell of grass and shrub and tree. We had barely room for swinging with the tide-- There were many of us crowded in the bay: Three Germans, and the English ship, beside Our three--and from the Trenton, where she lay, Through the sunset calms and after, We could hear the shrill, sweet laughter Of the children's voices on the shore at play.

We all knew a storm was coming, but, dear God! no man could dream Of the furious hell-horrors of that day: Through the roar of winds and waters we could hear wild voices scream-- See the rocking masts reel by us through the spray. In the gale we drove and drifted helplessly, With our rudder gone, our engine-fires drowned, And none might hope another hour to see; For all the air was desperate with the sound Of the brave ships rent asunder-- Of the shrieking souls sucked under, 'Neath the waves, where many a good man's grave was found.

About noon, upon our quarter, from the deeper gloom afar, Came the English man-of-war Calliope: "We have lost our anchors, comrades, and, though small the chances are, We must steer for safety and the open sea." Then we climbed aloft to cheer her as she passed Through the tempest and the blackness and the foam: "Now God speed you, though the shout should be our last, Through the channel where the maddened breakers comb, Through the wild sea's hill and hollow, On the path we cannot follow, To your women and your children and your home."

Oh! remember it, good brothers. We two people speak one tongue, And your native land was mother to our land; But the head, perhaps, is hasty when the nation's heart is young, And we prate of things we do not understand. But the day when we stood face to face with death (Upon whose face few men may look and tell), As long as you could hear, or we had breath, Four hundred voices cheered you out of hell! By the will of that stern chorus, By the motherland which bore us, Judge if we do not love

each other well.

CAROLINE DUER.

On May 31, 1889, western Pennsylvania was visited by one of the worst catastrophes in the history of the country. A flood from a broken reservoir overwhelmed Johnstown, Conemaugh, and a number of smaller towns, destroying over two thousand lives and property to the value of ten million dollars.

BY THE CONEMAUGH

[May 31, 1889]

Foreboding sudden of untoward change, A tight'ning clasp on everything held dear, A moan of waters wild and strange, A whelming horror near; And, 'midst the thund'rous din a voice of doom,-- "Make way for me, O Life, for Death make room!

"I come like the whirlwind rude, 'Gainst all thou hast cherished warring; I come like the flaming flood From a crater's mouth outpouring; I come like the avalanche gliding free-- And the Power that sent thee forth, sends me!

"Where thou hast builded with strength secure, My hand shall spread disaster; Where thou hast barr'd me, with forethought sure, Shall ruin flow the faster; I come to gather where thou hast sowed,-- But I claim of thee nothing thou hast not owed!

"On my mission of mercy forth I go Where the Lord of Being sends me; His will is the only will I know, And my strength is the strength He lends me; Thy loved ones I hide 'neath my waters dim, But I cannot hide them away from Him!"

FLORENCE EARLE COATES.

The reservoir was known to be weak, and the people below had been warned of the danger yet remained where they were. When, just before the break, Engineer John G. Parke galloped down the valley, shouting to all to run for their lives, it was too late.

THE MAN WHO RODE TO CONEMAUGH

[May 31, 1889]

Into the town of Conemaugh, Striking the people's souls with awe, Dashed a rider, aflame and pale, Never alighting to tell his tale, Sitting his big bay horse astride. "Run for your lives to the hills!" he cried; "Run to the hills!" was what he said, As he waved his hand and dashed ahead.

"Run for your lives to the hills!" he cried, Spurring his horse, whose reeking side Was flecked with foam as red as flame. Whither he goes and whence he came Nobody knows. They see his horse Plunging on in his frantic course, Veins distended and nostrils wide, Fired and frenzied at such a ride. Nobody knows the rider's name-- Dead forever to earthly fame. "Run to the hills! to the hills!" he cried; "Run for your lives to the mountain side!"

"Stop him! he's mad! just look at him go! 'Tain't safe," they said, "to let him ride so." "He thinks he can scare us," said one, with a laugh, "But Conemaugh folks don't swallow no chaff; 'Tain't nothing, I'll bet, but the same old leak In the dam above the South Fork Creek." Blind to their danger, callous of dread, They laughed as he left them and dashed ahead. "Run for your lives to the hills!" he cried, Lashing his horse in his desperate ride.

Down through the valley the rider passed, Shouting, and spurring his horse on fast; But not so fast did the rider go As the raging, roaring, mighty flow Of the million feet and the millions more Of water whose fury he fled before. On he went, and on it came, The flood itself a very flame Of surging, swirling, seething tide, Mountain high and torrents wide. God alone might measure the force Of the Conemaugh flood in its V-shaped course. Behind him were buried under the flood Conemaugh town and all who stood Jeering there at the man who cried, "Run for your lives to the mountain side!"

On he sped in his fierce, wild ride. "Run to the hills! to the hills!" he cried. Nearer, nearer raged the roar Horse and rider fled before. Dashing along the valley ridge, They came at last to the railroad bridge. The big horse stood, the rider cried, "Run for your lives to the mountain side!" Then plunged across, but not before The mighty, merciless mountain roar Struck the bridge and swept it away Like a bit of straw or a wisp of hay. But over and under and through that tide The voice of the unknown rider cried, "Run to the hills! to the hills!" it cried,-- "Run for your lives to the mountain side!"

JOHN ELIOT BOWEN.

It is said that another hero named Daniel Periton rode in front of the flood giving warning, and was finally caught by it and drowned.

A BALLAD OF THE CONEMAUGH FLOOD

[May 31, 1889]

The windows of Heaven were open wide, The storm cloud broke, and the people cried, Will Conemaugh dam hold out? But the great folks down at Johnstown played, They ate, they drank, they were nought afraid, For Conemaugh dam holds Conemaugh lake, By Conemaugh dam their pleasure they take, Fine catching are Conemaugh trout.

The four mile lake at the back of its wall Is growing to five, and the rains still fall, And the flood by night and by day Is burrowing deep thro' buttress and mound, Fresh waters spring and spurt from the ground; While God is thundering out of His cloud The fountain voices are crying aloud, Away to the hills! away!

Away to the hills! leave altar and shrine, Away to the hills! leave table and wine, Away from the trade and your tills; Let the strong man speed with the weakest child, And the mother who just on her babe has smiled Be carried, leave only the dead on their biers, No time for the tomb, and no time for tears; Away, away to the hills!

Daniel Periton heard the wail Of the waters gathering over the vale, With sorrow for city and field,-- Felt already the mountain quake 'Twixt living and dead. For the brethren's sake Daniel Periton dared to ride Full in front of the threatening tide, And what if the dam do yield?

To a man it is given but once to die, Though the flood break forth he will raise his cry For the thousands there in the town. At least, some child may be saved by his voice, Some lover may still in the sun rejoice, Some man that has fled, when he wins his breath, Shall bless the rider who rode thro' death, For his fellows' life gave his own.

He leapt to his horse that was black as night, He turned not left and he turned not right, Down to the valley he dashed; He heard behind him a thunderous boom, The dam had burst and he knew his doom; "Fly, fly for your lives!" it was all he spoke; "Fly, fly, for the Conemaugh dam has broke!" And the cataract after him crashed.

They saw a man with the God in his face, Pale from the desperate whirlwind pace, They heard an angel cry. And the steed's black mane was flecked as he flew, And its flanks were red with the spur's red dew, Into the city and out of the gate, Rider and ridden were racing with fate, Wild with one agony.

"Flash on the news that the dam has burst," And one looked forth, and she knew the worst, "My last message!" she said. The words at her will flashed on before Periton's call and the torrent's roar; And not in vain had Periton cried, His heart had caught a brave heart to his side, As bold for the saving he sped.

The flood came down and its strong arms took The city, and all together shook, Tower and church and street, Like a pack of cards that a player may crush, The houses fell in the whirlpool rush, Rose and floated and jammed at the last, Then a fierce flame fed by the deluge blast Wove them a winding-sheet.

God have mercy! was ever a pyre Lit like that of the flood's fierce fire! Cattle and men caught fast, Prisoners held between life and death, While the flame struck down with its sulphurous breath, And the flood struck up with its strong, cold hand, No hope from the water, no help from the land, And the torrent thundering past!

Daniel Periton, still he rides, By the heaving flank and the shortening strides, The race must be well-nigh won. "Away to the hills!" but the cataract's bound Has caught and has dashed him from saddle to ground,-- And the man who saw the end of the race, Saw a dark, dead horse, and a pale dead face, Did they hear Heaven's great "Well done"?

HARDWICK DRUMMOND RAWNSLEY.

In charge of the telegraph office at Johnstown was a Mrs. Ogle. She stayed at her post, sending message after message of warning down the valley until she herself was overwhelmed and swept away.

CONEMAUGH

"Fly to the mountain! Fly!" Terribly rang the cry. The electric soul of the wire Quivered like sentient fire. The soul of the woman who stood Face to face with the flood Answered to the shock Like the eternal rock. For she stayed With her hand on the wire, Unafraid, Flashing the wild word down Into the lower town. Is there a lower yet and another? Into the valley she and none other Can hurl the warning cry: "Fly to the mountain! Fly! The water from Conemaugh Has opened its awful jaw. The dam is wide On the mountain-side!"

"Fly for _your_ life, oh, fly!" They said. She lifted her noble head: "I can stay at my post, and die."

Face to face with duty and death, Dear is the drawing of human breath. "Steady, my hand! Hold fast To the trust upon thee cast. Steady, my wire! Go, say That death is on the way! Steady, strong wire! Go, save! Grand is the power you have!"

Grander the soul that can stand Behind the trembling hand; Grander the woman who dares; Glory her high name wears. "_This message is my last!_" Shot over the wire, and passed To the listening ear of the land. The mountain and the strand Reverberate the cry: "_Fly for your lives, oh, fly! I stay at my post, and die._"

The torrent took her. God knows all. Fiercely the savage currents fall To muttering calm. Men count their dead. The June sky smileth overhead. God's will we neither read nor guess. Poorer by one more hero less, We bow the head, and clasp the hand: "Teach us, altho' we die, to stand."

ELIZABETH STUART PHELPS WARD.

On May 1, 1893, the most remarkable exposition ever held in America opened at Chicago, to celebrate the four hundredth anniversary of the discovery of America. The group of exposition buildings soon became known as "The White City."

"THE WHITE CITY"

I

Greece was; Greece is no more. Temple and town Have crumbled down; Time is the fire that hath consumed them all. Statue and wall In ruin strew the universal floor.

II

Greece lives, but Greece no more! Its ashes breed The undying seed Blown westward till, in Rome's imperial towers, Athens reflowers; Still westward--lo, a veiled and virgin shore!

III

Say not, "Greece is no more." Through the clear morn On light winds borne Her white-winged soul sinks on the New World's breast. Ah! happy West-- Greece flowers anew, and all her temples soar!

IV

One bright hour, then no more Shall to the skies These columns rise. But though art's flower shall fade, again the seed Onward shall speed, Quickening the land from lake to ocean's roar.

V

Art lives, though Greece may never From the ancient mold As once of old Exhale to heaven the inimitable bloom; Yet from that tomb Beauty walks forth to light the world forever!

RICHARD WATSON GILDER.

On February 2, 1894, the famous old corvette, Kearsarge, which destroyed the Confederate cruiser Alabama, off Cherbourg, during the Civil War, was wrecked on Roncador reef in the Caribbean Sea.

THE KEARSARGE

[February 2, 1894]

In the gloomy ocean bed Dwelt a formless thing, and said, In the dim and countless eons long ago, "I will build a stronghold high, Ocean's power to defy, And the pride of haughty man to lay low."

Crept the minutes for the sad, Sped the cycles for the glad, But the march of time was neither less nor more; While the formless atom died, Myriad millions by its side, And above them slowly lifted Roncador.

Roncador of Caribee, Coral dragon of the sea, Ever sleeping with his teeth below the wave; Woe to him who breaks the sleep! Woe to them who sail the deep! Woe to ship and man that fear a shipman's grave!

Hither many a galleon old, Heavy-keeled with guilty gold, Fled before the hardy rover smiting sore; But the sleeper silent lay Till the preyer and his prey Brought their plunder and their bones to Roncador.

Be content, O conqueror! Now our bravest ship of war, War and tempest who had often braved before, All her storied prowess past, Strikes her glorious flag at last To the formless thing that builded Roncador.

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

In 1896 Tennessee celebrated the one hundredth anniversary of her admission to the Union, by an exposition held at Nashville.

TENNESSEE

PRIZE CENTENNIAL ODE

[June 1, 1896]

She is touching the cycle,--her tender tread Is soft on the hearts of her hallowed dead, And she proudly stands where her sons have bled For God and Tennessee;

Where the love of her women set the seal Of the warrior's faith for the country's weal, With hand on the rifle and hand on the wheel, By the altars of Tennessee.

They have builded well for the niche of fame, Through the sleet of want and the heat of blame, But the courage of heroes tried the flame, As they builded Tennessee.

'Twas up to the port-holes and down in the dust, Not the weight of might, but the force of must, With faith and rifle-bore free from rust, They were building Tennessee.

'Twas up in the saddle and off to the fight, Where arrow and tomahawk shrieked in the light; But the sinews of pioneers won for the right,-- The bulwarks of Tennessee.

* * * * *

She was true when they pressed like a shadowy fate,-- Her royal foes at her unbarred gate,-- And as true when were menaced her Rights of State,-- The mother,--Tennessee.

And she gave of her life for the stars and bars, As she gave of her sons for the earlier wars, And the breast of her motherhood wears the scars, For the manhood of Tennessee.

But she wrought again, in the strength of might, In the face of defeat and a yielded right, The Cloth of Gold from the loom of night,-- The mantle of Tennessee.

She has given all that she held most dear, With a Spartan hope and a Spartan fear,-- Crowned in her statehood "Volunteer,"-- Glorious Tennessee!

She has rounded the cycle,--the tale is told; The circlet is iron, the clasp is gold; And the leaves of a wonderful past unfold The garland of Tennessee.

And her garments gleam in the sunlit years, And the songs of her children fill her ears; And the listening heart of the great world hears The pæans of Tennessee!

VIRGINIA FRASER BOYLE.

On May 31, 1897, a monument to the memory of Robert Gould Shaw, who fell at the head of his colored regiment during the Civil War, was unveiled on Boston Common. The monument, designed by Augustus Saint-Gaudens, is perhaps the most noteworthy of its kind in America.

AN ODE

ON THE UNVEILING OF THE SHAW MEMORIAL ON BOSTON COMMON

May 31, 1897

I

Not with slow, funereal sound Come we to this sacred ground; Not with wailing fife and solemn muffled drum, Bringing a cypress wreath To lay, with bended knee, On the cold brows of Death-- Not so, dear God, we come, But with the trumpets' blare And shot-torn battle-banners flung to air, As for a victory!

Hark to the measured tread of martial feet, The music and the murmurs of the street! No bugle breathes this day Disaster and retreat!-- Hark, how the iron lips Of the great battle-ships Salute the City from her azure Bay!

II

Time was--time was, ah, unforgotten years!-- We paid our hero tribute of our tears. But now let go All sounds and signs and formulas of woe: 'Tis Life, not Death, we celebrate; To Life, not Death, we dedicate This storied bronze, whereon is wrought The lithe immortal figure of our thought, To show forever to men's eyes, Our children's children's children's eyes, How once he stood In that heroic mood, He and his dusky braves So fain of glorious graves!-- One instant stood, and then Drave through that cloud of purple steel and flame, Which wrapt him, held him, gave him not again, But in its trampled ashes left to Fame An everlasting name!

III

That was indeed to live-- At one bold swoop to wrest From darkling death the best That death to life can give. He fell as Roland fell That day at Roncevaux, With foot upon the ramparts of the foe! A pæan, not a knell, For heroes dying so! No need for sorrow here, No room for sigh or tear, Save such rich tears as happy eyelids know. See where he rides, our Knight! Within his eyes the light Of battle, and youth's gold about his brow; Our Paladin, our Soldier of the Cross, Not weighing gain with loss-- World-loser, that won all Obeying duty's call! Not his, at peril's frown, A pulse of quicker beat; Not his to hesitate And parley hold with Fate, But proudly to fling down His gauntlet at her feet. O soul of loyal valor and white truth, Here, by this iron gate, Thy serried ranks about thee as of yore, Stand thou for evermore In thy undying youth! The tender heart, the eagle eye! Oh, unto him belong The homages of Song; Our praises and the praise Of coming days To him belong-- To him, to him, the dead that shall not die!

THOMAS BAILEY ALDRICH.

The years 1897 and 1898 witnessed a great rush of gold-seekers to Alaska, where placer gold in large quantities had been discovered, the year before, in the Yukon district on Klondike Creek.

THE KLONDIKE

[1898]

Never mind the day we left, or the way the women clung to us; All we need now is the last way they looked at us. Never mind the twelve men there amid the cheering-- Twelve men or one man, 'twill soon be all the same; For this is what we know: we are five men together, Five left o' twelve men to find the golden river.

Far we came to find it out, but the place was here for all of us; Far, far we came, and here we have the last of us. We that were the front men, we that would be early, We that had the faith, and the triumph in our eyes: We that had the wrong road, twelve men together,-- Singing when the devil sang to find the golden river.

Say the gleam was not for us, but never say we doubted it; Say the wrong road was right before we followed it. We that were the front men, fit for all forage,-- Say that while we dwindle we are front men still; For this is what we know to-night: we're starving here together-- Starving on the wrong road to find the golden river.

Wrong, we say, but wait a little: hear him in the corner there; He knows more than we, and he'll tell us if we listen there-- He that fought the snow-sleep less than all the others Stays awhile yet, and he knows where he stays: Foot and hand a frozen clout, brain a freezing feather, Still he's here to talk with us and to the golden river.

"Flow," he says, "and flow along, but you cannot flow away from us; All the world's ice will never keep you far from us; Every man that heeds your call takes the way that leads him-- The one way that's his way, and lives his own life: Starve or laugh, the game goes on, and on goes the river; Gold or no, they go their way--twelve men together.

"Twelve," he says, "who sold their shame for a lure you call too fair for them-- You that laugh and flow to the same word that urges them: Twelve who left the old town shining in the sunset, Left the weary street and the small safe days: Twelve who knew but one way out, wide the way or narrow: Twelve who took the frozen chance and laid their lives on yellow.

"Flow by night and flow by day, nor ever once be seen by them; Flow, freeze, and flow, till time shall hide the bones of them: Laugh and wash their names away, leave them all forgotten, Leave the old town to crumble where it sleeps; Leave it there as they have left it, shining in the valley,-- Leave the town to crumble down and let the women marry.

"Twelve of us or five," he says, "we know the night is on us now: Five while we last, and we may as well be thinking now: Thinking each his own thought, knowing, when the light comes, Five left or none left, the game will not be lost. Crouch or sleep, we go the way, the last way together: Five or none, the game goes on, and on goes the river.

"For after all that we have done and all that we have failed to do, Life will be life and the world will have its work to do: Every man who follows us will heed in his own fashion The calling and the warning and the friends who do not know: Each will hold an icy knife to punish his heart's lover, And each will go the frozen way to find the golden river."

There you hear him, all he says, and the last we'll ever get from him. Now he wants to sleep, and that will be the best for him. Let him have his own way--no, you needn't shake him-- Your own turn will come, so let the man sleep. For this is what we know: we are stalled here together-- Hands and feet and hearts of us, to find the golden river.

And there's a quicker way than sleep?... Never mind the looks of him: All he needs now is a finger on the eyes of him. You there on the left hand, reach a little over-- Shut the stars away, or he'll see them all night: He'll see them all night and he'll see them all to-morrow, Crawling down the frozen sky, cold and hard and yellow.

Won't you move an inch or two--to keep the stars away from him? --No, he won't move, and there's no need of asking him. Never mind the twelve men, never mind the women; Three while we last, we'll let them all go; And we'll hold our thoughts north while we starve here together, Looking each his own way to find the golden river.

EDWIN ARLINGTON ROBINSON.

CHAPTER V

THE WAR WITH SPAIN

For three centuries and a half, Spain held possession of the island of Cuba, although she had lost, long before, her possessions in North and South America. The Cubans desired freedom, for the Spanish yoke was a galling one, and as early as 1822 sympathy with this desire was openly expressed in the United States.

APOSTROPHE TO THE ISLAND OF CUBA

[November, 1822]

There is blood on thy desolate shore, Thou island of plunder and slaves! Thy billows are purpled with gore, And murder has crimsoned thy waves; The vengeance of nations will come, And wrath shall be rained on thy head, And in terror thy voice shall be dumb, When they ask for their brothers who bled. Thy hand was not stirred, when their life-blood was spilt; And therefore that hand must partake in the guilt.

Thou art guilty or weak,--and the rod Should be wrenched from thy palsied hand; By the pirate thy green fields are trod, And his steps have polluted thy land; Unmoved is thy heart and thine eye, When our dear ones are tortured and slain; But their blood with a terrible cry, Calls on vengeance, and calls not in vain; If Europe regard not--our land shall awake, And thy walls and thy turrets shall tremble and shake.

The voice of a world shall be heard, And thy faith shall be tried by the call; And that terrible voice shall be feared, And obeyed--or the proud one shall fall. Enough of our life has been shed, In watching and fighting for thee; If thy foot linger still--on thy head The guilt and the vengeance shall be: We have sworn that the spirit of ALLEN shall lead, And our wrath shall not rest, till we finish the deed.

JAMES GATES PERCIVAL.

The people of Cuba revolted against their Spanish rulers in 1848, and kept up a guerilla warfare for some years. In August, 1851, a filibustering expedition, led by Narciso Lopez, sailed from New Orleans. The expedition was captured, and most of its members were executed, among them Lopez himself, and Colonel William L. Crittenden, of Kentucky, who, with fifty others, was shot at Havana, August 16.

THE GALLANT FIFTY-ONE

WHO FORMED PART OF THE LOPEZ EXPEDITION AND WERE EXECUTED BY THE SPANISH AUTHORITIES IN HAVANA

[August 16, 1851]

Freedom called them--up they rose, Grasped their swords and showered blows On the heads of Freedom's foes-- And Freedom's foes alone. Fate decreed that they should die; Pitying angels breathed a sigh; Freedom wildly wept on high, For the gallant Fifty-one!

There they stood in proud array; None for mercy there would pray; None would coward looks betray-- All stood forth with fearless eye, Showing by their dauntless air, What their noble souls could dare; Showing to the tyrants there, How Freedom's sons could die. None there strove their fate to shun-- Gallant band of Fifty-one!

Then a voice the stillness broke: 'Twas their gallant leader spoke, Scorning to receive Death's stroke, Kneeling humbly on the sod! Gazing calmly on the dead, Whose life-blood had just been shed, Proudly then the words he said, "Americans kneel but to God!" Perished thus Kentucky's son-- Leader of the Fifty-one.

Rejoice! sons of Thermopylæ! Kindred spirits join with thee, Who fell in fight for Liberty, For Freedom's sacred name. Future days their deeds shall tell, How they nobly fought and fell, Youthful bosoms proudly swell At mention of their fame-- Rays of light from Freedom's sun, Gallant band of Fifty-one!

Honor's rays will ever shed Glory 'round their hallowed bed. Though their hearts are cold and dead, Though their sands of life have run, Still their names revered will be, Among the noble and the free-- Glorious sons of Liberty; Gallant band of Fifty-one!

HENRY LYNDEN FLASH.

Spain at last found it necessary to put the whole island under martial law, and American sympathy grew more outspoken.

CUBA

[1870]

Is it naught? Is it naught That the South-wind brings her wail to our shore, That the spoilers compass our desolate sister? Is it naught? Must we say to her, "Strive no more," With the lips wherewith we loved her and kissed her? With the mocking lips

wherewith we said, "Thou art the dearest and fairest to us Of all the daughters the sea hath bred, Of all green-girdled isles that woo us!" Is it naught?

Must ye wait? Must ye wait, Till they ravage her gardens of orange and palm, Till her heart is dust, till her strength is water? Must ye see them trample her, and be calm As priests when a virgin is led to slaughter? Shall they smite the marvel of all lands,-- The nation's longing, the Earth's completeness,-- On her red mouth dropping myrrh, her hands Filled with fruitage and spice and sweetness? Must ye wait?

In the day, in the night, In the burning day, in the dolorous night, Her sun-browned cheeks are stained with weeping. Her watch-fires beacon the misty height:-- Why are her friends and lovers sleeping? "Ye, at whose ear the flatterer bends, Who were my kindred before all others,-- Hath he set your hearts afar, my friends? Hath he made ye alien, my brothers, Day and night?"

Hear ye not? Hear ye not From the hollow sea the sound of her voice; The passionate far-off tone which sayeth: "Alas, my brothers! alas, what choice,-- The lust that shameth, the sword that slayeth? They bind me! they rend my delicate locks; They shred the beautiful robes I won me! My round limbs bleed on the mountain rocks: Save me, ere they have quite undone me!" Hear ye not?

Speak at last! Speak at last! In the might of your strength, in the strength of your right, Speak out at last to the treacherous spoiler! Say: "Will ye harry her in our sight? Ye shall not trample her down, nor soil her! Loose her bonds! let her rise in her loveliness,-- Our virginal sister; or, if ye shame her, Dark Amnon shall rue for her sore distress, And her sure revenge shall be that of Tamar!" Speak at last!

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

Then in 1873 came what was certain to come, sooner or later, an outrage by Spain against the United States. The Virginius, a vessel of American register, was captured on the high seas by a Spanish gunboat, taken to a Cuban port, and some fifty of her officers and crew, Americans for the most part, summarily shot. America was wild with rage, but Spain was permitted to settle by paying an indemnity.

THE GOSPEL OF PEACE

[1873]

Ay, let it rest! And give us peace. 'Tis but another blot On Freedom's fustian flag, and gold Will gild the unclean spot.

Yes, fold the hands, and bear the wrong As Christians over-meek, And wipe away the bloody stain, And turn the other cheek.

What boots the loss of freemen's blood Beside imperilled gold? Is honor more than merchandise? And cannot pride be sold?

Let Cuba groan, let patriots fall; Americans may die; Our flag may droop in foul disgrace, But "Peace!" be still our cry.

Ay, give us peace! And give us truth To nature, to resign The counterfeit which Freedom wears Upon her banner fine.

Remove the Stars,--they light our shame; But keep the Stripes of gore And craven White, to tell the wrong A prudent nation bore.

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

The insurrection in Cuba dragged on, its horrors steadily increasing, and at last, in 1875, the American government intimated that if Spain did not stop the war, foreign intervention might become necessary. Spain took the hint and ended the struggle by granting Cuba certain reforms.

CUBA

Isle of a summer sea, Fragrant with Eden's flowers, God meant thee to be free, And wills thee to be _ours_!

The blood of generous hearts Has freely drenched thy soil; That blood but strength imparts, Which tyrants cannot foil!

Within thy fair retreat, 'Mid victory and flame, Thy sons shall yet repeat Huzzas in Freedom's name!

Yet, where his ashes rest, Whose eye revealed a world, From towers and mountain crest, Our flag shall be unfurled!

In truth, it is but just, That Freedom's hand should hold, Confided to her trust, The key to lands of gold!

HARVEY RICE.

But with a cynical disregard of good faith, Spain kept only such of her promises as she pleased; increased abuses followed, and in 1895 revolution flamed out again. Under such leaders as Gomez, Maceo, and Garcia, the revolutionists soon gained control of most of the provinces.

CUBA TO COLUMBIA

[April, 1896]

A voice went over the waters-- A stormy edge of the sea-- Fairest of Freedom's daughters, Have you no help for me? Do you not hear the rusty chain Clanking about my feet? Have you not seen my children slain, Whether in cell or street? Oh, if you were sad as I, And I as you were strong, You would not have to call or cry-- You would not suffer long!

"Patience?"--have I not learned it, Under the crushing years? Freedom--have I not earned it, Toiling with blood and tears? "Not of you?"--my banners wave Not on Egyptian shore, Or by Armenia's mammoth grave-- But at your very door! Oh, if you were needy as I, And I as you were strong, You should not suffer, bleed, and die, Under the hoofs of wrong!

Is it that you have never Felt the oppressor's hand, Fighting, with fond endeavor, To cling to your own sweet land? Were you not half dismayed, There in the century's night, Till to your view a sister's aid Came, like a flash of light? Oh, what gift could ever be grand Enough to pay the debt, If out of the starry Western land, Should come my Lafayette!

WILL CARLETON.

American sympathy was soon awakened, and grew rapidly in strength. This was increased when Spain placed Valeriano Weyler in command in Cuba. Weyler had an evil reputation for cruelty and extortion, and at once proceeded to make it more evil by exterminating the "pacificos," or quiet people who were taking no active part in the war.

CUBA LIBRE

Comes a cry from Cuban water-- From the warm, dusk Antilles-- From the lost Atlanta's daughter, Drowned in blood as drowned in seas; Comes a cry of purpled anguish-- See her struggles, hear her cries! Shall she live, or shall she languish? Shall she sink, or shall she rise?

She shall rise, by all that's holy! She shall live and she shall last; Rise as we, when crushed and lowly, From the blackness of the past. Bid her strike! Lo, it is written Blood for blood and life for life. Bid her smite, as she is smitten; Stars and stripes were born of strife.

Once we flashed her lights of freedom, Lights that dazzled her dark eyes Till she could but yearning heed them, Reach her hands and try to rise. Then they stabbed her, choked her, drowned her Till we scarce could hear a note. Ah! these rusting chains that bound her! Oh! these robbers at her throat!

And the kind who forged these fetters? Ask five hundred years for news. Stake and thumbscrew for their betters! Inquisitions! Banished Jews! Chains and slavery! What reminder Of one red man in that land? Why, these very chains that bind her Bound Columbus, foot and hand!

Shall she rise as rose Columbus, From his chains, from shame and wrong-- Rise as Morning, matchless, wondrous-- Rise as some rich morning song-- Rise a ringing song and story, Valor, Love personified? Stars and stripes espouse her glory, Love and Liberty allied.

JOAQUIN MILLER.

The situation of Americans in Havana began to cause uneasiness, and it was decided to send a ship of war to that port. The battleship Maine was selected for this duty, and reached Havana on the morning of January 24, 1898.

THE PARTING OF THE WAYS[14]

Untrammelled Giant of the West, With all of Nature's gifts endowed, With all of Heaven's mercies blessed, Nor of thy power unduly proud-- Peerless in courage, force, and skill, And godlike in thy strength of will,--

Before thy feet the ways divide: One path leads up to heights sublime; The other downward slopes, where bide The refuse and the wrecks of Time. Choose then, nor falter at the start, O choose the nobler path and part!

Be thou the guardian of the weak, Of the unfriended, thou the friend; No guerdon for thy valor seek, No end beyond the avowèd end. Wouldst thou thy godlike power preserve, Be godlike in the will to serve!

JOSEPH B. GILDER.

On the morning of February 16, 1898, the news flashed over the country that on the previous evening the Maine had been blown up at her anchorage, and that two hundred and sixty-four men and two officers had been killed.

THE MEN OF THE MAINE

[February 15, 1898]

Not in the dire, ensanguined front of war, Conquered or conqueror, 'Mid the dread battle-peal, did they go down To the still under-seas, with fair Renown To weave for them the hero-martyr's crown. They struck no blow 'Gainst an embattled foe; With valiant-hearted Saxon hardihood They stood not as the Essex sailors stood, So sore bestead in that far Chilian bay; Yet no less faithful they, These men who, in a passing of the breath, Were hurtled upon death.

No warning the salt-scented sea-wind bore, No presage whispered from the Cuban shore Of the appalling fate That in the tropic night-time lay in wait To bear them whence they shall return no more. Some lapsed from dreams of home and love's clear star Into a realm where dreams eternal are; And some into a world of wave and flame Wherethrough they came To living agony that no words can name. Tears for them all, And the low-tunèd dirge funereal!

Their place is now With those who wear, green-set about the brow, The deathless immortelles,-- The heroes torn and scarred Whose blood made red the barren ocean dells, Fighting with him the gallant Ranger bore, Daring to do what none had dared before, To wave the New World banner, freedom-starred, At England's very door! Yea, with such noble ones their names shall stand As those who heard the dying Lawrence speak His burning words upon the Chesapeake, And grappled in the hopeless hand-to-hand; With those who fell on Erie and Champlain Beneath the pouring, pitiless battle-rain: With such as these, our lost men of the Maine!

What though they faced no storm of iron hail That freedom and the right might still prevail? The path of duty it was theirs to tread To death's dark vale through ways of travail led, And they are ours--our dead! If it be true that each loss holds a gain, It must be ours through saddened eyes to see From out this tragic holocaust of pain The whole land bound in closer amity!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

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THE WORD OF THE LORD FROM HAVANA

[February 16, 1898]

Thus spake the Lord: Because ye have not heard, Because ye have given no heed To my people in their need,

Because the oppressed cried From the dust where he died, And ye turned your face away From his cry in that day,

Because ye have bought and sold That which is above gold, Because your brother is slain While ye get you drunk with gain,

(Behold, these are my people, I have brought them to birth, On whom the mighty have trod, The kings of the earth, Saith the Lord God!)

Because ye have fawned and bowed down Lest the spoiler frown, And the wrongs that the spoiled have borne Ye have held in scorn,

Therefore with rending and flame I have marred and smitten you, Therefore I have given you to shame, That the nations shall spit on you.

Therefore my Angel of Death Hath stretched out his hand on you, Therefore I speak in my wrath, Laying command on you;

(Once have I bared my sword, And the kings of the earth gave a cry; Twice have I bared my sword, That the kings of the earth should die; Thrice shall I bare my sword, And ye shall know my name, that it is I!)

Ye who held peace less than right When a king laid a pitiful tax on you, Hold not your hand from the fight When freedom cries under the axe on you!

(I who called France to you, call you to Cuba in turn! Repay--lest I cast you adrift and you perish astern!)

Ye who made war that your ships Should lay to at the beck of no nation, Make war now on Murder, that slips The leash of her hounds of damnation!

Ye who remembered the Alamo, Remember the Maine!

RICHARD HOVEY.

HALF-MAST

[February 16, 1898]

On every schoolhouse, ship, and staff From 'Frisco clear to Marblehead, Let droop the starry banner now, In sorrow for our sailors dead.

Half-mast! Half-mast! o'er all the land; The verdict wait; your wrath restrain; Half-mast for all that gallant band-- The sailors of the Maine!

Not till a treachery is proved His sword the patriot soldier draws; War is the last alternative-- Be patient till ye know the cause.

Meanwhile--Half-mast o'er all the land! The verdict wait; your wrath restrain; Half-mast! for all that gallant band-- The martyrs of the Maine!

LLOYD MIFFLIN.

THE FIGHTING RACE

[February 16, 1898]

"Read out the names!" and Burke sat back, And Kelly drooped his head, While Shea--they call him Scholar Jack-- Went down the list of the dead. Officers, seamen, gunners, marines, The crews of the gig and yawl, The bearded man and the lad in his teens, Carpenters, coal passers--all. Then, knocking the ashes from out his pipe, Said Burke in an offhand way: "We're all in that dead man's list by Cripe! Kelly and Burke and Shea." "Well, here's to the Maine, and I'm sorry for Spain," Said Kelly and Burke and Shea.

"Wherever there's Kellys there's trouble," said Burke. "Wherever fighting's the game, Or a spice of danger in grown man's work." Said Kelly, "you'll find my name." "And do we fall short," said Burke, getting mad, "When it's touch and go for life?" Said Shea, "It's thirty-odd years, bedad, Since I charged to drum and fife Up Marye's Heights, and my old canteen Stopped a rebel ball on its way; There were blossoms of blood on our sprigs of green-- Kelly and Burke and Shea-- And the dead didn't brag." "Well, here's to the flag!" Said Kelly and Burke and Shea.

"I wish 'twas in Ireland, for there's the place," Said Burke, "that we'd die by right, In the cradle of our soldier race, After one good stand-up fight. My grandfather fell on Vinegar Hill, And fighting was not his trade; But his rusty pike's in the cabin still, With Hessian blood on the blade." "Aye, aye," said Kelly, "the pikes were great When the word was 'clear the way!' We were thick on the roll in ninety-eight-- Kelly and Burke and Shea." "Well, here's to the pike and the sword and the like!" Said Kelly and Burke and Shea.

And Shea, the scholar, with rising joy, Said, "We were at Ramillies; We left our bones at Fontenoy And up in the Pyrenees; Before Dunkirk, on Landen's plain, Cremona, Lille, and Ghent; We're all over Austria, France, and Spain, Wherever they pitched a tent. We've died for England from Waterloo To Egypt and Dargai; And still there's enough for a corps or crew, Kelly and Burke and Shea." "Well, here's to good honest fighting blood!" Said Kelly and Burke and Shea.

"Oh, the fighting races don't die out, If they seldom die in bed, For love is first in their hearts, no doubt," Said Burke; then Kelly said: "When Michael, the Irish Archangel, stands, The angel with the sword, And the battle-dead from a hundred lands Are ranged in one big horde, Our line, that for Gabriel's trumpet waits, Will

stretch three deep that day, From Jehoshaphat to the Golden Gates-- Kelly and Burke and Shea." "Well, here's thank God for the race and the sod!" Said Kelly and Burke and Shea.

JOSEPH I. C. CLARKE.

A wave of fierce wrath swept over the American people; but Captain Sigsbee, of the destroyed ship, asked that judgment be suspended until the cause of the accident had been investigated.

ON THE EVE OF WAR

O God of Battles, who art still The God of Love, the God of Rest, Subdue thy people's fiery will, And quell the passions in their breast! Before we bathe our hands in blood We lift them to thy Holy Rood.

The waiting nations hold their breath To catch the dreadful battle-cry; And in the silence as of death The fateful hours go softly by. Oh, hear thy people where they pray, And shrive our souls before the fray!

Before the sun of peace shall set, We kneel apart a solemn while; Pity the eyes with sorrow wet, But pity most the lips that smile. The night comes fast; we hear afar The baying of the wolves of war.

Not lightly, oh, not lightly, Lord, Let this our awful task begin; Speak from thy throne a warning word Above the angry factions' din. If _this_ be thy Most Holy will, Be with us still,--be with us still!

DANSKE DANDRIDGE.

Good Friday, 1898.

Spain, without waiting for investigation, announced that the Maine had been blown up by an explosion of her magazines, due to the carelessness of her officers. The American people waited in ominous silence for the investigation to be concluded.

TO SPAIN--A LAST WORD

Iberian! palter no more! By thine hands, thine alone, they were slain! Oh, 'twas a deed in the dark-- Yet mark! We will show you a way--only one--by which ye may blot out the stain!

Build them a monument whom to death-sleep, in their sleep, ye betrayed! Proud and stern let it be-- Cuba free! So, only, the stain shall be razed--so, only, the great debt be paid!

EDITH M. THOMAS.

Meanwhile, the sailor dead were buried in the cemetery at Havana, with impressive ceremony. They were afterwards disinterred and placed in the military cemetery at Arlington on the Potomac.

THE MARTYRS OF THE MAINE

And they have thrust our shattered dead away in foreign graves, Exiled forever from the port the homesick sailor craves! They trusted once in Spain, They're trusting her again! And with the holy care of our own sacred slain! No, no, the Stripes and Stars Must wave above our tars. Bring them home!

On a thousand hills the darling dead of all our battles lie, In nooks of peace, with flowers and flags, but now they seem to cry From out their bivouac: "Here every good man Jack Belongs. Nowhere but here--with us. So bring them back." And on the Cuban gales, A ghostly rumor wails, "Bring us home!"

Poltroon, the people that neglects to guard the bones, the dust, The reverenced relics its warriors have bequeathed in trust! But heroes, too, were these Who sentinell'd the seas And gave their lives, to shelter us in careless ease. Shall we desert them, slain, And proffer them to Spain As alien mendicants,--these martyrs of our Maine? No! Bring them home!

RUPERT HUGHES.

At last, the investigation was ended, and showed that the Maine had been blown up from the outside, probably by a submarine mine, exploded by men who wore the uniform of Spain. The report reached Congress March 28, 1898, and on April 11 President McKinley asked Congress for authority to establish an independent government in Cuba.

EL EMPLAZADO

El Emplazado, the Summoned, the Doomed One, Spain whom the nations denounce and abhor, Robe thy dismay in the black sanbenito, Come to the frowning tribunal of war.

Curst were thy minions, their roster and scutcheon, Alvas, Alfonsos, Archarchons of hate; Pillared on bigotry, pride, and extortion, Topples to ruin thy mansion of state.

Violence, Cruelty, Intrigue, and Treason. These the false courtiers who flattered thy throne; Empires, thy sisters, forbode thee disaster, Even thy children their mother disown.

Suppliant Cuba, thy daughter forsaken, Famished and bleeding and buffeted sore, Ghastly from gashes and stabs of thy rancor, Binds up her wounds at an alien door.

Courts and corregidors erst at thy bidding Banished or butchered Moresco and Jew; Ghosts from all Christendom, shades of the Martyrs Flock from the sepulchre thee to pursue.

Wrath of retributive Justice o'ertakes thee! Brand of time's malison blisters thy brow: Armed cabelleros and crowned kings of Bourbon, All are unable to succor thee now.

El Emplazado, the Summoned, the Doomed One! God's Inquisition condemns thee to-day! Earth-shaking cannon-bolts thunder thy sentence,-- Heaven reëchoes the auto-da-fé.

WILLIAM HENRY VENABLE.

On April 19, 1898, Congress adopted a resolution declaring that Spanish rule in Cuba must cease, recognizing the independence of the Cubans, and empowering the President to use the entire land and naval forces of the United States to drive Spain from the island. It was, in effect, a declaration of war.

BATTLE SONG

When the vengeance wakes, when the battle breaks, And the ships sweep out to sea; When the foe is neared, when the decks are cleared, And the colors floating free; When the squadrons meet, when it's fleet to fleet And front to front with Spain, From ship to ship, from lip to lip, Pass on the quick refrain, "Remember, remember the Maine!"

When the flag shall sign, "Advance in line; Train ships on an even keel;" When the guns shall flash and the shot shall crash And bound on the ringing steel; When the rattling blasts from the armored masts Are hurling their deadliest rain, Let their voices loud, through the blinding cloud, Cry ever the fierce refrain, "Remember, remember the Maine!"

God's sky and sea in that storm shall be Fate's chaos of smoke and flame, But across that hell every shot shall tell, Not a gun can miss its aim; Not a blow shall fail on the crumbling mail, And the waves that engulf the slain Shall sweep the decks of the blackened wrecks, With the thundering, dread refrain, "Remember, remember the Maine!"

ROBERT BURNS WILSON.

England was the only country in Europe whose sympathies were openly with the United States. In France, Italy, and elsewhere, the hostility to America was bitter and outspoken.

GREETING FROM ENGLAND

America! dear brother land! While yet the shotted guns are mute, Accept a brotherly salute, A hearty grip of England's hand.

To-morrow, when the sulphurous glow Of war shall dim the stars above, Be sure the star of England's love Is over you, come weal or woe.

Go forth in hope! Go forth in might! To all your nobler self be true, That coming times may see in you The vanguard of the hosts of light.

Though wrathful justice load and train Your guns, be every breach they make A gateway pierced for mercy's sake That peace may enter in and reign.

Then, should the hosts of darkness band Against you, lowering thunderously, Flash the word "Brother" o'er the sea, And England at your side shall stand,

Exulting! For, though dark the night And sinister with scud and rack, The hour that brings us back to back But harbingers the larger light.

London _Chronicle_, April 22, 1898.

Diplomatic relations between Spain and the United States were at once severed, and on April 25, 1898, Congress formally declared that war with the Kingdom of Spain had existed since April 21. The first blow was to be struck with surprising suddenness.

BATTLE CRY

[May 1, 1898]

The loud drums are rolling, the mad trumpets blow! To battle! the war is begun and we go To humble the pride of an arrogant foe!

The ensign and standard which wave for the Crown Of Castile and Aragon--trample them down! Granada and Leon and haughty Navarre Shall lower their banner to Cuba's lone star!

Now under Old Glory, the Blue and the Gray United march shoulder to shoulder away, To meet the Hidalgos in furious fray.

With musket and haversack ready are we To tramp the globe over, to sweep every sea, From isles of dead Philip to Florida's Key.

We think of the Maine and our hot bosoms swell With rage of love's sorrow, which vengeance must quell, And then we are ready to storm gates of Hell.

Our flag streams aloft by the tempest unfurled! We strike for a Continent;--nay, for the World! Mene, Tekel, Upharsin! the thunder is hurled!

The ensign and standard which wave for the Crown Of Castile and Aragon--trample them down! Granada and Leon and haughty Navarre Shall lower their banner to Cuba's lone star!

WILLIAM HENRY VENABLE.

Thousands of miles away, across the Pacific, lay another island dependency of Spain, the Philippines. The Navy Department, with singular foresight, had been gradually increasing the Asiatic squadron, commanded by Commodore George Dewey, and that officer was carefully preparing for the work he saw before him. The fleet was assembled at Hong Kong, and on April 26, 1898, came a cablegram to Dewey stating that war had commenced and ordering him to proceed at once to the Philippines and capture or destroy the Spanish fleet there. At two o'clock the next afternoon, the American fleet started on its six-hundred-mile journey. It reached Manila on the night of April 30, and steamed straight into the harbor.

JUST ONE SIGNAL

[May 1, 1898]

The war-path is true and straight, It knoweth no left or right; Why ponder and wonder and vacillate? The way to fight is to fight.

The officer of the deck Had climbed to a perch aloft, And he leaned far out and he craned his neck, And his tones were gentle and soft: "I see," he whispered, "off there to port, Through the night shade's lesser black, The darker blur of the outer fort, Preparing for the attack." They signalled it so, and sharp and short The answer was signalled back: "Keep on."

Again from the upper air Came the quiet voice of the guide: "The admiral's flagship's over there, Two miles on the starboard side. It's a long, long way for the best of eyes, But I know her by moon or sun, I know by her lines and I know her size-- And there goes her warning gun." "That boat will make a most excellent prize," Said the admiral, "when we've won. Keep on."

The whispering came again: "I think by the hints and signs Appearing ahead of us now and then That we're getting among their mines. Ten fathom in front, as the search-lights show, I fancy that I can detect The line of their outermost works--Ah, no! It is nearer than I'd suspect." The message was sent to the admiral so, And he answered to this effect: "Keep on."

The haze of the dawning day Slid into the shades of night, And he called: "Off there in the upper bay, They're lining their ships for a fight. I think they are training on us--" No more He said, for the dawn was lit By the blaze of a gun from the neighboring shore, And he fell to the deck, hard hit. They signalled: "The first man struck." As before The admiral answered it: "Keep on."

The sun came over the hills As wishing a world-wide weal. And the guns were fired with the aim that kills, And steel pierced the heart of steel. And the line of shore was the fringe of hell, And the centre of hell was the sea, And the woe was the woe no tongue may tell, And no eye view tearlessly, And over that crater of bomb and shell The signal continued to be: "Keep on."

O Lawrence, whose passing cry Grows ever the more sublime, And thou, O Nile King, whose words shall die When we learn of the death of time, We send you the third of a glorious three; We send you a battle shout That echoes up from the blood-thick sea And up from the wreck and rout And down from the staff on the high cross-tree Where the flag is signalling out: "Keep on."

The war-path is true and straight, It knoweth no left or right; Mars loves not the man who would deviate,-- For the way to fight is to fight.

A shot from Corregidor and another from El Fraile told that the fleet was discovered, but the ships glided quietly on, and at dawn the Spanish fleet was seen anchored under the batteries of Cavité. Dewey steamed straight for them; the Spanish ships were sunk, one after another, by the deadly fire of the American gunners, and by noon the Spanish fleet had been destroyed, the shore batteries

silenced, and a white flag floated over the citadel of Cavité. Dewey had not lost a man, and had won the greatest naval battle since Trafalgar.

DEWEY AT MANILA

[May 1, 1898]

'Twas the very verge of May When the bold Olympia led Into Bocagrande Bay Dewey's squadron, dark and dread,-- Creeping past Corregidor, Guardian of Manila's shore.

Do they sleep who wait the fray? Is the moon so dazzling bright That our cruisers' battle-gray Melts into the misty light?... Ah! the red flash and the roar! Wakes at last Corregidor!

All too late their screaming shell Tears the silence with its track; This is but the _gate_ of hell, We've no leisure to turn back. Answer, Concord!--then once more Slumber on, Corregidor!

And as, like a slowing tide, Onward still the vessels creep, Dewey, watching, falcon-eyed, Orders,--"Let the gunners sleep; For we meet a foe at four Fiercer than Corregidor."

Well they slept, for well they knew What the morrow taught us all,-- He was wise (as well as true) Thus upon the foe to fall. Long shall Spain the day deplore Dewey ran Corregidor.

May is dancing into light As the Spanish Admiral From a dream of phantom fight Wakens at his sentry's call. Shall he leave Cavité's lee, Hunt the Yankee fleet at sea?

O Montojo, to thy deck, That to-day shall float its last! Quick! To quarters! Yonder speck Grows a hull of portent vast. Hither, toward Cavité's lee Comes the Yankee hunting thee!

Not for fear of hidden mine Halts our doughty Commodore. He, of old heroic line, Follows Farragut once more, Hazards all on victory, Here within Cavité's lee.

If he loses, all is gone; He will win because he must. And the shafts of yonder dawn Are not quicker than his thrust. Soon, Montojo, he shall be With thee in Cavité's lee.

Now, Manila, to the fray! Show the hated Yankee host This is not a holiday,-- Spanish blood is more than boast. Fleet and mine and battery, Crush him in Cavité's lee!

Lo, hell's geysers at our fore Pierce the plotted path--in vain, Nerving every man the more With the memory of the Maine! Now at last our guns are free Here within Cavité's lee.

"Gridley," says the Commodore, "You may fire when ready." Then Long and loud, like lions' roar When a rival dares the den, Breaks the awful cannonry Full across Cavité's lee.

Who shall tell the daring tale Of our Thunderbolt's attack, Finding, when the chart should fail, By the lead his dubious track, Five ships following faithfully Five times o'er Cavité's lee;

Of our gunners' deadly aim; Of the gallant foe and brave Who, unconquered, faced with flame, Seek the mercy of the wave,-- Choosing honor in the sea Underneath Cavité's lee?

Let the meed the victors gain Be the measure of their task. Less of flinching, stouter strain, Fiercer combat--who could ask? And "surrender,"--'twas a word That Cavité ne'er had heard.

Noon,--the woful work is done! Not a Spanish ship remains; But, of their eleven, none Ever was so truly Spain's! Which is prouder, they or we, Thinking of Cavité's lee?

ENVOY

But remember, when we've ceased Giving praise and reckoning odds, Man shares courage with the beast, Wisdom cometh from the gods. Who would win, on land or wave, Must be wise as well as brave.

ROBERT UNDERWOOD JOHNSON.

DEWEY AND HIS MEN

[May 1, 1898]

Glistering high in the midnight sky the starry rockets soar To crown the height so soon to be uncrowned, Corregidor; And moaning into the middle night resounds the answering shock From Fraile's island battery within the living rock; Like Farragut before him, so Dewey down the bay, Past fort and mine, in single line, holds on toward Cavité.

When the earth was new a raven flew o'er the sea on a perilous quest, By his broad black pinions buoyed up as he sought him a spot to rest; So to-day from British China sweeps our Commodore 'mid the cheers Of England's dauntless ships of steel, and into the night he steers, With never a home but the furrowy foam and never a place for ease Save the place he'll win by the dint and din of his long, lean batteries.

A misty dawn on the May-day shone, yet the enemy sees afar On our ships-of-war great flags flung out as bright as the morning star; Then the cannon of Spain crash over the main and their splendor flecks the ports As the crackling thunder rolls along the frowning fleet and forts; But the Olympia in her majesty leads up the broadening bay And behind her come gaunt ships and dumb toward crested Cavité.

All pearl and rose the dawnlight glows, and ruddy and gray the gloom Of battle over their squadron sinks as we sweep like a vast simoom; When our broadsides flash and ring at last--in a hoarsening, staggering crush On the arsenal and fleet in wrath our lurid lightnings rush. Malate knows us, Cavité, Cañacoa crazed with hate; But

Corregidor shall speak no more, El Fraile fears his fate.

Montojo fights as fought the knights by the Cid Campeador; He leaves his flagship all afire, the Cuba takes him o'er The Don Antonio roars and fumes, the Austria lights and lifts; From Sangley to Manila Mole the battle vapor drifts; But the Queen Christine in one great blast dies as becomes her name, Her funeral shroud a pillar of cloud all filagreed with flame.

From peak to peak our quick flags speak, the rattling chorus ends; And cheer on cheer rolls over the sea at the word the signal sends. From Commodore to powder-boy, from bridge to stoker's den, No battle rips have found our ships, nor wounds nor death our men. We cheer and rest, we rest and cheer; and ever above the tides The flag that knows no conquering foes in newer glory rides.

When the reek of war is rolled afar by the breezes down the bay We turn our deadly guns again on the walls of Cavité. The Spaniard dreamed of victory--his final hope is flown As winged destruction up and down our batteries have strown-- In horrid havoc, red and black, the storm throbs on amain Till in the glare of carnage there fade all the flags of Spain.

In old Madrid sad eyes are hid for an empire sore bestead: Manila's mad with misery, Havana sick with dread, As the great bells toll each gallant soul Castile shall see no more, Toll Fraile's rock a thing for sport, toll lost Corregidor-- Spain's fortresses are fluttering with banners blanched and pale; Her admiralty in agony lies shattered, steam and sail.

And the home we sought was cheaply bought, for no mother, wife, nor maid From Maine to Loma Point bewails the lad for whom she prayed; Now everywhere, from Florida to the blue Vancouver Straits, The flag we've flown abroad is thrown, and a word of cheer awaits. The ships and men that never failed the nation from her birth Have done again all ships and men may do upon this earth.

Glistering high in the noontide sky the starry banners soar To crown anew the height so soon uncrowned, Corregidor. They bring the promise of the free to Philip's jewelled isles, And hearts oppressed thrill hard with hope whene'er that promise smiles; For the spirit of Old Ironsides broods o'er that tropic day And the wildfire lights as Dewey fights on the broad Manila Bay.

WALLACE RICE.

"OFF MANILLY"

Aye, lads, aye, we fought 'em, And we sent 'em to the bottom, And you'll say that I'm a-talkin' like a silly; I hear your cheers and jokes, But, lads, them's human folks What is soakin' in the water off Manilly.

Aye, lads, and when we shot It's just as like as not We hit some mother's heart in old Granady. She didn't sink no Maine, 'Way over there in Spain, But she won't never see her laddy's body.

I kin see a black-eyed gal, Somethin' like my little Sal, What is cryin' out her eyes in old Sevilly; There's a widow in Madrid With a pore little kid, And his daddy has

went down off Manilly.

Aye, lads, aye, we fought 'em, And we sent 'em to the bottom, And I hopes you won't be thinkin' I'm a booby, But that little black-eyed gal, What reminds me so of Sal, She didn't never do no harm to Cuby.

And if instead of Sanchy, It had been "the hated Yankee," Which you know, my lads, is me and Jack, and Billy, You know who would be cryin' For us fellers, what was dyin' And a-soakin' in the water off Manilly.

EDMUND VANCE COOKE.

MANILA BAY

From keel to fighting top, I love Our Asiatic fleet, I love our officers and crews Who'd rather fight than eat. I love the breakfast ordered up When enemies ran short, But most I love our chaplain With his head out of the port.

Now, a naval chaplain cannot charge As chaplains can on land, With his Bible in his pocket, His revolver in his hand, He must wait and help the wounded, No danger must he court; So our chaplain helped the wounded With his head out of the port.

Beneath his red and yellow, At bay the Spaniard stood Till the yellow rose in fire And the crimson sank in blood. And till the last fouled rifle Sped its impotent retort, Our chaplain watched the Spaniard With his head out of the port.

Then here's our admiral on the bridge Above the bursting shell; And here's our sailors who went in For victory or hell, And here's the ships and here's the guns, That silenced fleet and fort; But don't forget our chaplain With his head out of the port.

ARTHUR HALE.

May 1, 1898.

A BALLAD OF MANILA BAY

Your threats how vain, Corregidor; Your rampired batteries, feared no more; Your frowning guard at Manila gate,-- When our Captain went before!

Lights out. Into the unknown gloom From the windy, glimmering, wide sea-room Challenging fate in that dark strait We dared the hidden doom.

But the death in the deep awoke not then; Mine and torpedo they spoke not then; From the heights that loomed on our passing line The thunders broke not then.

Safe through the perilous dark we sped, Quiet each ship as the quiet dead, Till the guns of El Fraile roared--too late, And the steel prows forged ahead.

Mute each ship as the mute-mouth grave, A ghost leviathan cleaving the wave; But deep in its heart the great fires throb, The travailing engines rave.

The ponderous pistons urge like fate, The red-throat furnaces roar elate, And the sweating stokers stagger and swoon In a heat more fierce than hate.

So through the dark we stole our way Past the grim warders and into the bay, Past Kalibuyo, and past Salinas,-- And came at the break of day

Where strong Cavité stood to oppose,-- Where, from a sheen of silver and rose, A thronging of masts, a soaring of towers, The beautiful city arose.

How fine and fair! But the shining air With a thousand shattered thunders there Flapped and reeled. For the fighting foe-- We had caught him in his lair.

Surprised, unready, his proud ships lay Idly at anchor in Bakor Bay:-- Unready, surprised, but proudly bold, Which was ever the Spaniard's way.

Then soon on his pride the dread doom fell, Red doom,--for the ruin of shot and shell Lit every vomiting, bursting hulk With a crimson reek of hell.

But to the brave though beaten, hail! All hail to them that dare and fail! To the dauntless boat that charged our fleet And sank in the iron hail!

* * * * *

Manila Bay! Manila Bay! How proud the song on our lips to-day! A brave old song of the true and strong, And the will that has its way;

Of the blood that told in the days of Drake When the fight was good for the fighting's sake! For the blood that fathered Farragut Is the blood that fathered Blake;

And the pride of the blood will not be undone While war's in the world and a fight to be won. For the master now, as the master of old, Is "the man behind the gun."

The dominant blood that daunts the foe, That laughs at odds, and leaps to the blow,-- It is Dewey's glory to-day, as Nelson's A hundred years ago!

CHARLES GEORGE DOUGLAS ROBERTS.

THE BATTLE OF MANILA

A FRAGMENT

[May 1, 1898]

By Cavité on the bay 'Twas the Spanish squadron lay; And the red dawn was creeping O'er the city that lay sleeping To the east, like a bride, in the May. There was peace at Manila, In the May morn at Manila,-- When ho, the Spanish admiral Awoke to find our line Had passed by gray Corregidor, Had laughed at shoal and mine, And flung to the sky its banners With "Remember" for the sign!

With the ships of Spain before In the shelter of the shore, And the forts on the right, They drew forward to the fight, And the first was the gallant Commodore In the bay of Manila, In the doomed bay of Manila-- With succor half the world away, No port beneath that sky, With nothing but their ships and guns And Yankee pluck to try, They had left retreat behind them, They had come to win or die!

* * * * *

For we spoke at Manila, We said it at Manila, Oh be ye brave, or be ye strong, Ye build your ships in vain; The children of the sea queen's brood Will not give up the main; We hold the sea against the world As we held it against Spain.

Be warned by Manila, Take warning by Manila, Ye may trade by land, ye may fight by land, Ye may hold the land in fee; But not go down to the sea in ships To battle with the free; For England and America Will keep and hold the sea!

RICHARD HOVEY.

This remarkable victory amazed the world, and set America wild with excitement and enthusiasm. Dewey became a popular hero, and Congress made haste to revive the grade of admiral and to confer it upon him.

DEWEY IN MANILA BAY

He took a thousand islands and he didn't lose a man (Raise your heads and cheer him as he goes!)-- He licked the sneaky Spaniard till the fellow cut and ran, For fighting's part of what a Yankee knows.

He fought 'em and he licked 'em, without any fuss or flam (It was only his profession for to win), He sank their boats beneath 'em, and he spared 'em as they swam, And then he sent his ambulances in.

He had no word to cheer him and had no bands to play, He had no crowds to make his duty brave; But he risked the deep torpedoes at the breaking of the day, For he knew he had our self-respect to save.

He flew the angry signal crying justice for the Maine, He flew it from his flagship as he fought. He drove the tardy vengeance in the very teeth of Spain, And he did it just because he thought he ought.

He busted up their batteries and sank eleven ships (He knew what he was doing, every bit); He set the Maxims going like a hundred cracking whips, And every shot that crackled was a hit.

He broke 'em and he drove 'em, and he didn't care at all, He only liked to do as he was bid; He crumpled up their squadron and their batteries and all,-- He knew he had to lick 'em and he did.

And when the thing was finished and they flew the frightened flag, He slung his guns and sent his foot ashore, And he gathered in their wounded, and he quite forgot to brag, For he thought he did his duty, nothing more.

Oh, he took a thousand islands and he didn't lose a man (Raise your heads and cheer him as he goes!)-- He licked the sneaky Spaniard till the fellow cut and ran, For fighting's part of what a Yankee knows!

R. V. RISLEY.

Another fleet, and a much more powerful one than Dewey's, had been collected at Key West, under command of Admiral Sampson, ready to proceed to Cuba, and on

April 21 orders came for it to sail. On the morning of April 22, it put to sea and steamed slowly off toward Havana.

"MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN"

[April 22, 1898]

Behold, we have gathered together our battleships, near and afar; Their decks they are cleared for action, their guns they are primed for war. From the East to the West there is hurry; in the North and the South a peal Of hammers in fort and ship-yard, and the clamor and clang of steel; And the rush and roar of engines, and clanking of derrick and crane,-- Thou art weighed in the scales and found wanting, the balance of God, O Spain!

Behold, I have stood on the mountains, and this was writ in the sky: "She is weighed in the scales and found wanting, the balance God holds on high!" The balance He once weighed Babylon, the Mother of Harlots, in: One scale holds thy pride and power and empire, begotten of sin, Heavy with woe and torture, the crimes of a thousand years, Mortared and welded together with fire and blood and tears; In the other, for justice and mercy, a blade with never a stain, Is laid the Sword of Liberty, and the balance dips, O Spain!

Summon thy vessels together! great is thy need for these! Cristobal Colon, Vizcaya, Oquendo, Marie Therese. Let them be strong and many, for a vision I had by night, That the ancient wrongs thou hast done the world came howling to the fight; From the New World shores they gathered, Inca and Aztec, slain, To the Cuban shot but yesterday, and our own dead seamen, Spain!

Summon thy ships together, gather a mighty fleet! For a strong young nation is arming that never hath known defeat. Summon thy ships together, there on thy blood-stained sands! For a shadowy army gathers with manacled feet and hands, A shadowy host of sorrows and of shames, too black to tell, That reach with their horrible wounds for thee to drag thee down to hell; Myriad phantoms and spectres, thou warrest against in vain! Thou art weighed in the scales and found wanting, the balance of God, O Spain!

MADISON CAWEIN.

A blockade was proclaimed of Havana and a number of other ports. But no attempt was made to enter the harbor, which was crammed with mines and defended by strong fortifications.

THE SPIRIT OF THE MAINE

In battle-line of sombre gray Our ships-of-war advance, As Red Cross Knights in holy fray Charged with avenging lance. And terrible shall be thy plight, O fleet of cruel Spain! Forever in our van doth fight The spirit of the Maine!

As when beside Regillus Lake The Great Twin Brethren came A righteous fight for Rome to make Against the Deed of Shame-- So now a ghostly ship shall doom The fleet of treacherous Spain: Before her guilty soul doth loom The Spirit of the Maine!

A wraith arrayed in peaceful white, As when asleep she lay Above the traitorous mine that night Within Havana Bay, She glides before the avenging fleet, A sign of woe to Spain, Brave though her sons, how shall they meet The Spirit of the Maine!

TUDOR JENKS.

Spain also had a fleet, and a strong one, on the ocean. It had been gathered together at the Cape Verde Islands, and on April 29, 1898, it put to sea, and steamed westward into the Atlantic, for a destination which could only be conjectured.

THE DRAGON OF THE SEAS[15]

They say the Spanish ships are out To seize the Spanish main; Reach down the volume, boy, and read The story o'er again.

How when the Spaniard had the might, He drenched the earth, like rain, With human blood, and made it death To sail the Spanish main.

With torch and steel, and stake and rack, He trampled out all truce, Until Queen Bess her leashes slipt, And turned her sea-dogs loose.

God! how they sprang! And how they tore! The Grenvilles, Hawkins, Drake! Remember, boy, they were your sires! They made the Spaniard quake.

They sprang, like lions, for their prey, Straight for the throat, amain! By twos, by scores, where'er they caught They fought the ships of Spain.

When Spain, in dark Ulloa's bay, Broke doubly-plighted faith, Bold Hawkins fought his way through fire For great Elizabeth.

A bitter malt Spain brewed that day-- She drained it to the lees; Her faithless guns that morn awoke The Dragon of the Seas.

From sea to sea he ravaged far, A scourge with flaming breath-- Where'er the Spaniard sailed his ships Sailed Francis Drake and Death.

No port was safe against his ire, Secure no furthest shore; The fairest day oft sank in fire Before the Dragon's roar.

He made th' Atlantic surges red Round every Spanish keel; Piled Spanish decks with Spanish dead, The noblest of Castile.

From Del Fuego's beetling coast To sleety Hebrides, He hounded down the Spanish host, And swept the flaming seas.

He fought till on Spain's inmost lakes 'Mid orange bowers set, La Mancha's daughters feared to sail Lest they the Dragon met.

King Philip, of his raven reft, As forfeit claimed his head. The great Queen laughed his wrath to scorn, And knighted Drake instead.

And gave him ships and sent him forth To clear the Spanish main For England and for England's brood, And sink the fleets of Spain.

And well he wrought his mighty work, Till on that fatal day, He met his only conqueror, In Nombre Dios Bay.

There, in his shotted hammock swung, Amid the surges' sweep, He waits the lookouts' signal Across the quiet deep.

And dreams of dark Ulloa's bay And Spanish treachery; And how he tracked Magellan far Across the unknown sea.

But if Spain fires a single shot Upon the Spanish main, She'll come to deem the Dragon dead Has waked to life again.

THOMAS NELSON PAGE.

[15] From "The Coast of Bohemia"; copyright 1888, 1906, by Charles Scribner's Sons.

THE SAILING OF THE FLEET

Two fleets have sailed from Spain. The one would seek What lands uncharted ocean might conceal. Despised, condemned, and pitifully weak, It found a world for Leon and Castile.

The other, mighty, arrogant, and vain, Sought to subdue a people who were free. Ask of the storm-gods where its galleons be,-- Whelmed 'neath the billows of the northern main!

A third is threatened. On the westward track, Once gloriously traced, its vessels speed, With gold and crimson battle-flags unfurled. On Colon's course, but to Sidonia's wrack, Sure fated, if so need shall come to need, For Sons of Drake are lords of Colon's world.

A portion of the American fleet started off to look for the Spaniards, and the remainder engaged in various minor operations off the Cuban coast. On May 11 a party rowed in and cut the cables at Cienfuegos, under a heavy fire.

"CUT THE CABLES"

AN INCIDENT OF CIENFUEGOS

[May 11, 1898]

"Cut the cables!" the order read, And the men were there; there was no delay. The ships hove to in Cienfuegos Bay,-- The Windom, Nashville, Marblehead,-- Beautiful, grim, and alert were they, It was midway, past in the morning gray. "Cut the cables!" the order said-- Over the clouds of the dashing spray, The guns were trained and ready for play; Picked from the Nashville, Winslow led,-- Grim death waits ashore, they say; "Lower the boats, Godspeed, give way." Did "our untried navy lads" obey? Away to their perilous work they sped.

Now, steady the keel, keep stroke the oar! They must go in close, they must find the wires; Grim death is alert on that watching shore, That deadly shore of the

"Hundred Fires." In the lighthouse tower,--along the ledge,-- In the blockhouse, waiting,--the guns are there; On the lowland, too, in the tall, dry sedge; They are holding the word till the boats draw near. One hundred feet from the water's edge, Dazzling clear is the sunlit air; Quick, my men,--the moments are dear! Two hundred feet from the rifle-pit, And our "untried" lads still show no fear-- When they open now they're sure to hit; No question, even by sign, they ask, In silence they bend to their dangerous task.

Quick now!--the shot from a smokeless gun Cuts close and spatters the glistening brine; Now follows the roar of the battle begun, But the boys were bent in the blazing sun Like peaceful fishermen, "wetting a line." They searched the sea while a shrieking blast Swept shoreward, swift as the lightning flies,-- While the fan-like storm of the shells went past Like a death-wing clearing the hissing skies. Like a sheltering wing,--for the hurricane came From our own good guns, and the foe might tell What wreck was wrought by their deadly aim; For the foe went down where the hurricane fell. It shattered the blockhouse, levelled the tower, It ripped the face of the smoking hill, It beat the battle back, hour by hour, And then, for a little, our guns were still. For a little, but that was the fatal breath,-- That moment's lull in the friendly crash,-- For the long pit blazed with a vicious flash, And eight fell,--two of them done to death.

Once more the screen of the screaming shot With its driving canopy covered the men, While they dragged, and grappled, and, faltering not, Still dragged, and searched, and grappled again. And they stayed right there till the work was done, The cables were found and severed, each one, With an eighty-foot gap, and the "piece" hauled in, And stowed in place,--then, under the din Of that deafening storm, that had swept the air For three long hours, they turned from shore ("Steady the keel" there; "stroke" the oar), To the smoke-wreathed ships, and, under the guns, They went up the side,--our "untried" ones.

Quiet, my brave boys; hats off, all! They are here, our "untried" boys in blue. Steady the block, now, all hands haul! Slow on the line there!--look to that crew! Six lads hurt!--and the colors there? Wrap two of them?--hold! Ease back the bow! Slow, now, on the line!--slack down with care! Steady! they're back on their own deck now! The cables are cut, sir, eighty-foot spread, Six boys hurt, and--two of them dead. Half-mast the colors! there's work to do! There are two red marks on the starboard gun, There is still some work that is not quite done, For our "untried" boys that are tried and true. It wasn't all play when they cut the wires,-- Well named is that bay of the "Hundred Fires."

ROBERT BURNS WILSON.

June 2, 1898.

A few days later, on May 24, 1898, the battleship Oregon arrived at Jupiter Inlet, Florida, after one of the most remarkable voyages in history. On March 9 the ship, then at San Francisco, was ordered to circle South America and join the Atlantic squadron, and the journey of nearly fifteen thousand miles was accomplished without starting a rivet.

THE RACE OF THE OREGON

Lights out! And a prow turned towards the South, And a canvas hiding each cannon's mouth, And a ship like a silent ghost released Is seeking her sister ships in the East.

A rush of water, a foaming trail, An ocean hound in a coat of mail, A deck long-lined with the lines of fate, She roars good-by at the Golden Gate.

On! On! Alone without gong or bell, But a burning fire, like the fire of hell, Till the lookout starts as his glasses show The white cathedral of Callao.

A moment's halt 'neath the slender spire; Food, food for the men, and food for the fire. Then out to the sea to rest no more Till her keel is grounded on Chili's shore.

South! South! God guard through the unknown wave, Where chart nor compass may help or save, Where the hissing wraiths of the sea abide And few may pass through the stormy tide.

North! North! For a harbor far away, For another breath in the burning day; For a moment's shelter from speed and pain, And a prow to the tropic sea again.

Home! Home! With the mother fleet to sleep Till the call shall rise o'er the awful deep; And the bell shall clang for the battle there, And the voice of guns is the voice of prayer!

* * * * *

One more to the songs of the bold and free, When your children gather about your knee; When the Goths and Vandals come down in might As they came to the walls of Rome one night; When the lordly William of Deloraine Shall ride by the Scottish lake again; When the Hessian spectres shall flit in air As Washington crosses the Delaware; When the eyes of babes shall be closed in dread As the story of Paul Revere is read; When your boys shall ask what the guns are for, Then tell them the tale of the Spanish war, And the breathless millions that looked upon The matchless race of the Oregon.

JOHN JAMES MEEHAN.

BATTLE-SONG OF THE OREGON

The billowy headlands swiftly fly The crested path I keep, My ribboned smoke stains many a sky, My embers dye the deep; A continent has hardly space-- Mid-ocean little more, Wherein to trace my eager race While clang the alarums of war.

I come, the warship Oregon, My wake a whitening world, My cannon shotted, thundering on With battle-flags unfurled. My land knows no successful foe-- Behold, to sink or save, From stoker's flame to gunner's aim The race that rules the wave!

A nation's prayers my bulwark are Though ne'er so wild the sea; Flow time or tide, come storm or star, Throbs my machinery. Lands Spain has lost forever peer From every lengthening coast, Till rings the cheer that proves me near The flag of Columbia's host.

Defiantly I have held my way From the vigorous shore where Drake Dreamed a New Albion in the day He left New Spain a-quake; His shining course retraced, I fight The self-same foe he fought, All earth to light with signs of might Which God our Captain wrought.

Made mad, from Santiago's mouth Spain's ships-of-battle dart: My bulk comes broadening from the south, A hurricane at heart; Its desperate armories blaze and boom, Its ardent engines beat; And fiery doom finds root and bloom Aboard of the Spanish fleet....

The hundredweight of the Golden Hind With me are ponderous tons, The ordnance great her deck that lined Would feed my ravening guns, Her spacious reach in months and years I've shrunk to nights and days; Yet in my ears are ringing cheers Sir Frank himself would raise:

For conquereth not mine engines' breath Nor sides steel-clad and strong, Nor bulk, nor rifles red with death: To Spain, too, these belong; What made that old Armada break This newer victory won: Jehovah spake by the sons of Drake At each incessant gun.

I come, the warship Oregon, My wake a whitening world, My cannon shotted, thundering on With battle-flags unfurled. My land knows no successful foe-- Behold, to sink or save, From stoker's flame to gunner's aim The race that rules the wave!

WALLACE RICE.

A few days before, Sampson's fleet had bombarded San Juan, Porto Rico, ineffectually, and then came word that the Spanish squadron had slipped into the harbor of Santiago, Cuba, to coal and refit. It was not until May 29 that its presence there was discovered by the Americans, who proceeded at once to blockade the harbor.

STRIKE THE BLOW

The four-way winds of the world have blown, And the ships have ta'en the wave; The legions march to the trumps' shrill call 'Neath the flag of the free and brave. The hounds of the sea Have trailed the foe, They have trailed and tracked him down,-- Then wait no longer, but strike, O land, With the dauntless strength of thy strong right hand, Strike the blow!

The armored fleets, with their grinning guns, Have the Spaniard in his lair; They have tracked him down where the ramparts frown, And they'll halt and hold him there. They have steamed in his wake, They have seen him go, They have bottled and corked him up; Then send him home to the under-foam, Till the wide sea shakes to the far blue dome; Strike the blow!

The Cuban dead and the dying call, The children starved in the light Of the aid that waits till the hero deed Breaks broad on the tyrant's might. The starved and the weak In their hour of woe Are calling, land, on thee; Then why delay in thy dauntless sway? On, on, to the charge of the freedom-way, Strike the blow!

They have ta'en the winds of the Carib seas, Thy fleets that know not fear; Their ribs of steel have yearned to reel In the dance of the cannoneer. Thy sons of the blue That wait to go Would leap with a will to the charge, Then send them the word so long deferred; They have listened late, but they have not heard; Strike the blow!

They have listened late in the desolate land, They have looked through brimming eyes, And starving women have held dead babes To their heart with a thousand sighs. On, on to the end, O land, the foe Beneath thy sword shall fall, Thy ships of steel have tracked them home, Ye are king of the land and king of the foam. Strike the blow!

On June 1, 1898, a great portion of Sampson's fleet was off the harbor, and it was decided to block the entrance by sinking the collier Merrimac in the channel. The enterprise was intrusted to Lieutenant Richmond Pearson Hobson, and a crew of eight volunteers.

EIGHT VOLUNTEERS

Eight volunteers! on an errand of death! Eight men! Who speaks? Eight men to go where the cannon's hot breath Burns black the cheeks.

Eight men to man the old Merrimac's hulk; Eight men to sink the old steamer's black bulk, Blockade the channel where Spanish ships skulk,-- Eight men! Who speaks? "Eight volunteers!" said the Admiral's flags!

Eight men! Who speaks? Who will sail under El Morro's black crags?-- Sure death he seeks. Who is there willing to offer his life? Willing to march to this music of strife,-- Cannon for drum and torpedo for fife? Eight men! Who speaks?

Eight volunteers! on an errand of death! Eight men! Who speaks? Was there a man who in fear held his breath? With fear-paled cheeks? From ev'ry war-ship ascended a cheer! From ev'ry sailor's lips burst the word "Here!" Four thousand heroes their lives volunteer! Eight men! Who speaks?

LANSING C. BAILEY.

It was impossible to get the boat ready that night, but at last, at 3:30 on the morning of June 2, she stood away for the harbor. The Spaniards saw her as she entered and rained a storm of fire upon her. A moment later, torn by her own torpedoes and those of the enemy, she sank to the bottom. Hobson and his men were taken prisoners by the Spaniards.

THE MEN OF THE MERRIMAC

[June 3, 1898]

Hail to Hobson! Hail to Hobson! hail to all the valiant set! Clausen, Kelly, Deignan, Phillips, Murphy, Montagu, Charette! Howsoe'er we laud and laurel we shall be their debtors yet! Shame upon us, shame upon us, should the nation e'er forget!

Though the tale be worn with the telling, let the daring deed be sung! Surely never brighter valor, since this wheeling world was young, Thrilled men's souls to more than wonder, till praise leaped from every tongue!

Trapped at last the Spanish sea-fox in the hill-locked harbor lay; Spake the Admiral from his flagship, rocking off the hidden bay, "We must close yon open portal lest he slip by night away!"

"Volunteers!" the signal lifted; rippling through the fleet it ran; Was there ever deadlier venture? was there ever bolder plan? Yet the gallant sailors answered, answered well-nigh to a man!

Ere the dawn's first rose-flush kindled, swiftly sped the chosen eight Toward the batteries grimly frowning o'er the harbor's narrow gate; Sooth, he holds his life but lightly who thus gives the dare to Fate.

They had passed the outer portal where the guns grinned, tier o'er tier, When portentous Morro thundered, and Socapa echoed clear, And Estrella joined the chorus pandemoniac to hear.

Heroes without hands to waver, heroes without hearts to quail, There they sank the bulky collier 'mid the hurtling Spanish hail; Long shall float our starry banner if such lads beneath it sail!

Hail to Hobson! hail to Hobson! hail to all the valiant set! Clausen, Kelly, Deignan, Phillips, Murphy, Montagu, Charette! Howsoe'er we laud and laurel we shall be their debtors yet! Shame upon us, shame upon us, should the nation e'er forget!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

THE VICTORY-WRECK[16]

[June 3, 1898]

O stealthily-creeping Merrimac, Hush low your fiery breath; You who gave life to ships of strife Are sailing unto your death!-- "I am ready and dressed for burial, Beneath the Cuban wave; But still I can fight for God and right, While resting in my grave!"

O men that are sailing the Merrimac, Your hearts are beating high; But send a prayer through the smoking air, To your Captain in the sky!-- "We know there is death in every breath, As we cling to the gunless deck; And grand will be our voyage, if we Can make of our ship a wreck!"

Now drop the bower of the Merrimac, And swing her to the tide. Now scuttle her, braves, and bid the waves Sweep into her shattered side!-- "Through a flying hell of shot and shell, We passed Death, with a sneer; We wrenched our life from a novel strife, And even our foemen cheer!"

WILL CARLETON.

Examination showed that the channel had not been blocked. The Merrimac had gone too far in, and had sunk lengthwise of the channel instead of across it. So the Spanish ships were not yet "corked."

HOBSON AND HIS MEN

[June 3, 1898]

Hobson went towards death and hell, Hobson and his men, Unregarding shot and shell, And the rain of fire that fell; Calm, undaunted, fearless, bold, Every heart a heart of gold, Steadfast, daring, uncontrolled,-- Hobson and his men.

Hobson came from death and hell, Hobson and his men, Shout the tidings, ring the bell, Let the pealing anthems swell; Back from wreck and raft and wave, From the shadow of the grave, Every honor to the brave.-- Hobson and his men.

ROBERT LOVEMAN.

[16] From "Songs of Two Centuries," published by Harper & Brothers.

Meanwhile, nearer home, things were moving slowly enough, for the War Department developed a startling unpreparedness and inefficiency. Two hundred thousand volunteers were called for, but, though every state responded instantly, the work of mobilizing these troops was conducted in so bungling a fashion that, by the beginning of June, only three regiments, in addition to the regulars, had reached the rendezvous at Tampa, Florida.

THE CALL TO THE COLORS

"Are you ready, O Virginia, Alabama, Tennessee? People of the Southland, answer! For the land hath need of thee." "Here!" from sandy Rio Grande, Where the Texan horsemen ride; "Here!" the hunters of Kentucky Hail from Chatterawah's side; Every toiler in the cotton, Every rugged mountaineer, Velvet-voiced and iron-handed, Lifts his head to answer, "Here! Some remain who charged with Pickett, Some survive who followed Lee; They shall lead their sons to battle For the flag, if need there be."

"Are you ready, California, Arizona, Idaho? 'Come, oh, come, unto the colors!' Heard you not the bugle blow?" Falls a hush in San Francisco In the busy hives of trade; In the vineyards of Sonoma Fall the pruning knife and spade; In the mines of Colorado Pick and drill are thrown aside; Idly in Seattle harbor Swing the merchants to the tide; And a million mighty voices Throb responsive like a drum, Rolling from the rough Sierras, "You have called us, and we come."

O'er Missouri sounds the challenge-- O'er the great lakes and the plain; "Are you ready, Minnesota? Are you ready, men of Maine?" From the woods of Ontonagon, From the farms of Illinois, From the looms of Massachusetts, "We are ready, man and boy." Axemen free, of Androscoggin, Clerks who trudge the cities' paves, Gloucester men who drag their plunder From the sullen, hungry waves, Big-boned Swede and large-limbed German, Celt and Saxon swell the call, And the Adirondacks echo: "We are ready, one and all."

Truce to feud and peace to faction! All forgot is party zeal When the war-ships clear for action, When the blue battalions wheel. Europe boasts her standing armies,--Serfs who blindly fight by trade; We have seven million soldiers, And a soul guides every blade. Laborers with arm and mattock, Laborers with brain and pen, Railroad prince and railroad brakeman Build our line of fighting men. Flag of righteous wars! close mustered Gleam the bayonets, row on row, Where thy stars are sternly clustered, With their daggers towards the foe!

ARTHUR GUITERMAN.

ESSEX REGIMENT MARCH

WRITTEN FOR THE EIGHTH MASSACHUSETTS UNITED STATES VOLUNTEER INFANTRY IN THE SPANISH WAR

Once more the Flower of Essex is marching to the wars; We are up to serve the Country wherever fly her Stars; Ashore, afloat, or far or near, to her who bore us true, We will do a freeman's duty as we were born to do. Lead the van, and may we lead it, God of armies, till the wrong shall cease; Speed the war, and may we speed it To the sweet home-coming, God of peace!

Our fathers fought their battles, and conquered for the right, Three hundred years victorious from every stubborn fight; And still the Flower of Essex from the ancient stock puts forth, Where the bracing blue sea-water strings the sinews of the North.

The foe on field, the foe on deck to us is all the same; With both the Flower of Essex has played a winning game; We threw them on the village green, we cowed them in Algiers, And ship to ship we shocked them in our first great naval years.

We rowed the Great Commander o'er the ice-bound Delaware, When the Christmas snow was falling in the dark and wintry air; And still the Flower of Essex, like the heroes gone before, Where the tide of danger surges shall take the laboring oar.

The Flower that first lay bleeding along by Bloody Brook Full oft hath Death upgathered in war's red reaping-hook; Its home is on our headlands; 'tis sweeter than the rose; But sweetest in the battle's breath the Flower of Essex blows.

At the best a dear home-coming, at the worst a soldier's grave, Beating the tropic jungle, ploughing the dark blue wave; But while the Flower of Essex from the granite rock shall come, None but the dead shall cease to fight till all go marching home.

March onward to the leaguer wherever it may lie; The Colors make the Country whatever be the sky; Where round the Flag of Glory the storm terrific blows, We march, we sail, whoever fail, the Flower of Essex goes.

GEORGE EDWARD WOODBERRY.

THE GATHERING

We are coming, Cuba,--coming; our starry banner shines Above the swarming legions, sweeping downward to the sea. From Northern hill, and Western plain, and towering

Southern pines The serried hosts are gathering,--and Cuba shall be free.

We are coming, Cuba,--coming. Thy sturdy patriots brave, Who fight as fought our fathers in the old time long ago, Shall see the Spanish squadrons sink beneath the whelming wave, And plant their own loved banner on the ramparts of their foe.

We are coming, Cuba,--coming. Across the billow's foam Our gallant ships are bearing our bravest down to thee, While earnest prayers are rising from every freeman's home That freedom's God may lead them on, and Cuba shall be free.

HERBERT B. SWETT.

It was evident that an army was badly needed to support the fleet at Santiago, and on June 7, 1898, the force at Tampa was ordered to embark for that place, under command of General William Shafter. Everything was confusion, and it was not until June 14 that the transports finally made their way down the bay.

COMRADES

Now from their slumber waking,-- The long sleep men thought death-- The War Gods rise, inhaling deep The cannon's fiery breath! Their mighty arms uplifted, Their gleaming eyes aglow With the steadfast light of battle, As it blazed long years ago!

Now from the clouds they summon The Captains of the Past, Still sailing in their astral ships The star-lit spaces vast; And from Valhalla's peaceful plains The Great Commanders come, And marshal again their armies To the beat of the muffled drum.

His phantom sails unfurling McDonough sweeps amain Where once his Yankee sailors fought The battle of Champlain! And over Erie's waters, Again his flagship sweeps, While Perry on the quarter-deck His endless vigil keeps.

Silent as mists that hover When twilight shadows fall, The ghosts of the royal armies Foregather at the call; And their glorious chiefs are with them, From conflicts lost or won, As they gather round one mighty shade, The shade of Washington!

* * * * *

Side by side with the warships That sail for the hostile fleet, The ships of the Past are sailing And the dauntless comrades meet; And standing shoulder to shoulder, The armèd spirits come, And march with our own battalions To the beat of the muffled drum!

HENRY R. DORR.

The fleet reached Santiago June 20, and Shafter decided to move directly upon the city. But the army had lost or forgotten its lighters and launches, so the task of disembarking it fell upon the navy and was admirably performed. Next morning, General Joseph Wheeler, with four squadrons of dismounted cavalry, was ordered forward. Two of these squadrons were composed of the "Rough Riders," under command of Leonard Wood and Theodore Roosevelt.

WHEELER'S BRIGADE AT SANTIAGO

Beneath the blistering tropical sun The column is standing ready, Awaiting the fateful command of one Whose word will ring out To an answering shout To prove it alert and steady. And a stirring chorus all of them sung With singleness of endeavor, Though some to "The Bonny Blue Flag" had swung And some to "The Union For Ever."

The order came sharp through the desperate air And the long ranks rose to follow, Till their dancing banners shone more fair Than the brightest ray Of the Cuban day On the hill and jungled hollow; And to "Maryland" some in the days gone by Had fought through the combat's rumble, And some for "Freedom's Battle-Cry" Had seen the broad earth crumble.

Full many a widow weeps in the night Who had been a man's wife in the morning; For the banners we loved we bore to the height Where the enemy stood As a hero should, His valor his country adorning; But drops of pride with your tears of grief, Ye American women, mix ye! For the North and South, with a Southron chief, Kept time to the tune of "Dixie."

WALLACE RICE.

After great confusion and several days' delay, the remainder of the army came up, and on the afternoon of June 30 a general advance was ordered. By dawn of July 1 the troops were in position and the attack began.

DEEDS OF VALOR AT SANTIAGO

[July 1, 1898]

Who cries that the days of daring are those that are faded far, That never a light burns planet-bright to be hailed as the hero's star? Let the deeds of the dead be laurelled, the brave of the elder years, But a song, we say, for the men of to-day, who have proved themselves their peers!

High in the vault of the tropic sky is the garish eye of the sun, And down with its crown of guns afrown looks the hilltop to be won; There is the trench where the Spaniard lurks, his hold and his hiding-place, And he who would cross the space between must meet death face to face.

The black mouths belch and thunder, and the shrapnel shrieks and flies; Where are the fain and the fearless, the lads with the dauntless eyes? Will the moment find them wanting! Nay, but with valor stirred! Like the leashed hound on the coursing-ground they wait but the warning word.

"Charge!" and the line moves forward, moves with a shout and a swing, While sharper far than the cactus-thorn is the spiteful bullet's sting. Now they are out in the open, and now they are breasting the slope, While into the eyes of death they gaze as into the eyes of hope.

Never they wait nor waver, but on they clamber and on, With "Up with the flag of the Stripes and Stars, and down with the flag of the Don!" What should they bear through the shot-rent air but rout to the ranks of Spain, For the blood that throbs in their hearts is the blood of the boys of Anthony Wayne!

See, they have taken the trenches! Where are the foemen? Gone! And now "Old Glory" waves in the breeze from the heights of San Juan! And so, while the dead are laurelled, the brave of the elder years, A song, we say, for the men of to-day who have proved themselves their peers.

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

The morning was consumed in blundering about under the Spanish fire, trying vainly to carry out the orders of a general lying in a hammock far in the rear. Finally, the subordinate commanders acted for themselves; Lawton, Ludlow, and Chaffee took the fort of El Caney, and the Rough Riders charged San Juan.

THE CHARGE AT SANTIAGO

[July 1, 1898]

With shot and shell, like a loosened hell, Smiting them left and right, They rise or fall on the sloping wall Of beetling bush and height! They do not shrink at the awful brink Of the rifle's hurtling breath, But onward press, as their ranks grow less, To the open arms of death!

Through a storm of lead, o'er maimed and dead, Onward and up they go, Till hand to hand the unflinching band Grapple the stubborn foe. O'er men that reel, 'mid glint of steel, Bellow or boom of gun, They leap and shout over each redoubt Till the final trench is won!

O charge sublime! Over dust and grime Each hero hurls his name In shot or shell, like a molten hell, To the topmost heights of fame! And prone or stiff, under bush and cliff, Wounded or dead men lie, While the tropic sun on a grand deed done Looks with his piercing eye!

WILLIAM HAMILTON HAYNE.

PRIVATE BLAIR OF THE REGULARS

[July 1, 1898]

It was Private Blair, of the regulars, before dread El Caney, Who felt with every throb of his wound the life-tide ebb away; And as he dwelt in a fevered dream on the home of his youthful years, He heard near by the moan and sigh of two of the volunteers.

He raised him up and gazed at them, and likely lads they were, But when he bade them pluck up heart he found they could not stir. Then a bullet ploughed the sodden loam, and his fearless face grew dark, For he saw through the blur a sharpshooter who made the twain his mark.

And his strength leaped into his limbs again, and his fading eye burned bright; And he gripped his gun with a steady hand and glanced along the sight; Then another voice in that choir of fire outspake with a deadly stress, And in the trench at El Caney there lurked a Spaniard less.

But still the moans of the volunteers went up through the murky air, And there kindled the light of a noble thought in the brain of Private Blair. The flask at his side, he had drained it dry in the blistering scorch and shine, So, unappalled, he crept and crawled in the face of the firing line.

The whirring bullets sped o'erhead, and the great shells burst with a roar, And the shrapnel tore the ground around like the tusks of the grisly boar; But on he went, with his high intent, till he covered the space between, And came to the place where the Spaniard lay and clutched his full canteen.

Then he writhed him back o'er the bloody track, while Death drummed loud in his ears, And pressed the draught he would fain have quaffed to the lips of the volunteers. _Drink!_ cried he; _don't think of me, for I'm only a regular, While you have homes in the mother-land where your waiting loved ones are_.

Then his soul was sped to the peace of the dead. All praise to the men who dare, And honor be from sea to sea to the deed of Private Blair!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

The fort on San Juan was carried and held all the next day, despite Spanish attacks. But Shafter was alarmed and considered withdrawing the army, though strongly opposed by General Wheeler, who had been in the thick of the fighting from the very first.

WHEELER AT SANTIAGO

Into the thick of the fight he went, pallid and sick and wan, Borne in an ambulance to the front, a ghostly wisp of a man; But the fighting soul of a fighting man, approved in the long ago, Went to the front in that ambulance, and the body of Fighting Joe.

Out from the front they were coming back, smitten of Spanish shells-- Wounded boys from the Vermont hills and the Alabama dells; "Put them into this ambulance; I'll ride to the front," he said, And he climbed to the saddle and rode right on, that little old ex-Confed.

From end to end of the long blue ranks rose up the ringing cheers, And many a powder-blackened face was furrowed with sudden tears, As with flashing eyes and gleaming sword, and hair and beard of snow, Into the hell of shot and shell rode little old Fighting Joe!

Sick with fever and racked with pain, he could not stay away, For he heard the song of the yester-year in the deep-mouthed cannon's bay-- He heard in the calling song of the guns there was work for him to do, Where his country's best blood splashed and flowed 'round the old Red, White and Blue.

Fevered body and hero heart! this Union's heart to you Beats out in love and reverence--and to each dear boy in blue Who stood or fell 'mid the shot and shell, and cheered in the face of the foe, As, wan and white, to the heart of the fight rode little old Fighting Joe!

JAMES LINDSAY GORDON.

Then, suddenly, sorrow gave place to joy, and discouragement to enthusiasm for a great victory won. At nine o'clock on the morning of Sunday, July 3, 1898, the Spanish fleet came rushing out of the harbor in a mad effort to escape. The American ships closed in, and a battle to the death began, which ended in the total destruction of the Spanish fleet.

SPAIN'S LAST ARMADA

[July 3, 1898]

They fling their flags upon the morn, Their safety's held a thing for scorn, As to the fray the Spaniards on the wings of war are borne; Their sullen smoke-clouds writhe and reel, And sullen are their ships of steel, All ready, cannon, lanyards, from the fighting-tops to keel.

They cast upon the golden air One glancing, helpless, hopeless prayer, To ask that swift and thorough be the victory falling there; Then giants with a cheer and sigh Burst forth to battle and to die Beneath the walls of Morro on that morning in July.

The Teresa heads the haughty train To bear the Admiral of Spain, She rushes, hurtling, whitening, like the summer hurricane; El Morro glowers in his might; Socapa crimsons with the fight, The Oquendo's lunging lightning blazes through her sombre night.

In desperate and eager dash The Vizcaya hurls her vivid flash, As wild upon the waters her enormous batteries crash; Like spindrift scuds the fleet Colon, And, on her bubbling wake bestrown, Lurch, hungry for the slaughter, El Furor and El Pluton.

Round Santiago's armored crest, Serene, in their gray valor dressed, Our behemoths lie quiet, watching well from south and west; Their keen eyes spy the harbor-reek; The signals dance, the signals speak; Then breaks the blasting riot as our broadsides storm and shriek!

Quick, poising on her eagle-wings, The Brooklyn into battle swings; The wide sea falls and wonders as the titan Texas springs; The Iowa in monster-leaps Goes bellowing above the deeps; The Indiana thunders as her terror onward sweeps.

And, hovering near and hovering low Until the moment strikes to go, In gallantry the Gloucester swoops down on her double foe; She volleys--the Furor falls lame; Again--and the Pluton's aflame, Hurrah, on high she's tossed her! Gone the grim destroyers' fame!

And louder yet and louder roar The Oregon's black cannon o'er The clangor and the booming all along the Cuban shore. She's swifting down her valkyr-path, Her

sword sharp for the aftermath, With levin in her glooming, like Jehovah in His wrath.

Great ensigns snap and shine in air Above the furious onslaught where Our sailors cheer the battle, danger but a thing to dare; Our gunners speed, as oft they've sped, Their hail of shrilling, shattering lead, Swift-sure our rifles rattle, and the foeman's decks are red.

Like baying bloodhounds lope our ships, Adrip with fire their cannons' lips; We scourge the fleeing Spanish, whistling weals from scorpion-whips; Till, livid in the ghastly glare, They tremble on in dread despair, And thoughts of victory vanish in the carnage they must bear.

Where Cuban coasts in beauty bloom, Where Cuban breakers swirl and boom, The Teresa's onset slackens in a scarlet spray of doom; Near Nimanima's greening hill The streaming flames cry down her will, Her vast hull blows and blackens, prey to every mortal ill.

On Juan Gonzales' foaming strand The Oquendo plunges 'neath our hand, Her armaments all strangled, and her hope a showering brand; She strikes and grinds upon the reef, And, shuddering there in utter grief, In misery and mangled, wastes away beside her chief.

The Vizcaya nevermore shall ride From out Aserradero's tide, With hate upon her forehead ne'er again she'll pass in pride; Beneath our fearful battle-spell She moaned and struggled, flared and fell, To lie a-gleam and horrid, while the piling fires swell.

Thence from the wreck of Spain alone Tears on the terrified Colon, In bitter anguish crying, like a storm-bird forth she's flown; Her throbbing engines creak and thrum; She sees abeam the Brooklyn come, For life she's gasping, flying; for the combat is she dumb.

Till then the man behind the gun Had wrought whatever must be done-- Here, now, beside our boilers is the fight fought out and won; Where great machines pulse on and beat, A-swelter in the humming heat The Nation's nameless toilers make her mastery complete.

The Cape o' the Cross casts out a stone Against the course of the Colon, Despairing and inglorious on the wind her white flag's thrown; Spain's last Armada, lost and wan, Lies where Tarquino's stream rolls on, As round the world, victorious, looms the dreadnaught Oregon.

The sparkling daybeams softly flow To glint the twilight afterglow, The banner sinks in splendor that in battle ne'er was low; The music of our country's hymn Rings out like songs of seraphim, Fond memories and tender fill the evening fair and dim;

Our huge ships ride in majesty Unchallenged o'er the glittering sea, Above them white stars cluster, mighty emblem of the free; And all a-down the long sea-lane The fitful bale-fires wax and wane To shed their lurid lustre on the empire that was Spain.

WALLACE RICE.

SANTIAGO

[July 3, 1898]

In the stagnant pride of an outworn race The Spaniard sail'd the sea: Till we haled him up to God's judgment-place-- And smashed him by God's decree!

Out from the harbor, belching smoke, Came dashing seaward the Spanish ships-- And from all our decks a great shout broke, Then our hearts came up and set us a-choke For joy that we had them at last at grips!

No need for signals to get us away-- We were off at score, with our screws a-gleam! Through the blistering weeks we'd watched the bay And our captains had need not a word to say-- Save to bellow and curse down the pipes for steam!

Leading the pack in its frightened flight The Colon went foaming away to the west-- Her tall iron bulwarks, black as night, And her great black funnels, sharp in sight 'Gainst the green-clad hills in their peace and rest.

Her big Hontaria blazed away At the Indiana, our first in line. The short-ranged shot drenched our decks with spray-- While our thirteen-inchers, in answering play, Ripped straight through her frame to her very spine!

* * * * *

Straight to its end went our winning fight With the thunder of guns in a mighty roar. Our hail of iron, casting withering blight, Turning the Spanish ships in their flight To a shorter death on the rock-bound shore.

The Colon, making her reckless race With the Brooklyn and Oregon close a-beam, Went dashing landward--and stopped the chase By grinding her way to her dying-place In a raging outburst of flame and steam.

So the others, facing their desperate luck, Drove headlong on to their rock-dealt death-- The Vizcaya, yielding before she struck, The riddled destroyers, a huddled ruck, Sinking, and gasping for drowning breath.

So that flying battle surged down the coast, With its echoing roar from the Cuban land; So the dying war-ships gave up the ghost; So we shattered and mangled the Philistine host-- So the fight was won that our Sampson planned!

THOMAS A. JANVIER.

The American battleships were practically uninjured, and the fleet had lost only two men, one killed and one injured, both on the Brooklyn. The Spanish loss was 350 killed or drowned, 160 wounded, and 1774 taken prisoners.

THE FLEET AT SANTIAGO

[July 3, 1898]

The heart leaps with the pride of their story. Predestinate lords of the sea! They are heirs of the flag and its glory, They are sons of the soil it keeps free; For their

deeds the serene exaltation Of a cause that was stained with no shame, For their dead the proud tears of a nation, Their fame shall endure with its fame.

The fervor that grim, unrelenting, The founders in homespun had fired, With blood the free compact cementing, Was the flame that their souls had inspired. They were sons of the dark tribulations, Of the perilous days of the birth Of a nation sprung free among nations, A new hope to the children of earth!

They were nerved by the old deeds of daring, Every tale of Decatur they knew, Every ship that, the bright banner bearing, Shot to keep it afloat in the blue; They were spurred by the splendor undying Of Somer's fierce fling in the bay, And the Watchword that Lawrence died crying, And of Cushing's calm courage were they.

By the echo of guns at whose thunder Old monarchies crumbled and fell, When the warships were shattered asunder And their pennants went down in the swell; By the strength of the race that, unfearing, Faces death till the death of the last, Or has sunk with the fierce Saxon cheering, Its colors still nailed to the mast--

So they fought--and the stern race immortal Of Cromwell and Hampton and Penn Has thrown open another closed portal, Stricken chains from a new race of men. So they fought, so they won, so above them Blazed the light of a consecrate aim; Empty words! Who may tell how we love them, How we thrill with the joy of their fame!

CHARLES E. RUSSELL.

Particularly gallant was the part played by the Gloucester, a converted yacht with no armor, under Commander Wainwright. She was lying inshore near the harbor mouth, and opened with her little rapid-fire guns on the great battleships as they swept past; then, the moment the Spanish destroyers, Furor and Pluton, appeared, she rushed straight upon them with absolute disregard of the shore batteries. Within twenty minutes, the Pluton went down in deep water and the Furor was beached and sunk.

THE DESTROYER OF DESTROYERS

[July 3, 1898]

From Santiago, spurning the morrow, Spain's ships come steaming, big with black sorrow: Over the ocean, first on our roster, Runs Richard Wainwright, glad on the Gloucester. Boast him, and toast him! Wainwright! The Gloucester!

Great ships and gaunt ships, steel-clad and sable, Roll on resplendent, monsters of fable: Crash all our cannon, quick Maxims rattle. Red death and ruin rush through the battle; Red death and dread death Ravage and rattle.

Speed on Spain's cruisers, towers of thunder: Calm rides the Gloucester, though the waves wonder; Morro roars at her, enemies looming On their wakes heave her, vast through the glooming; Thunders and wonders Speak from the glooming.

Sped are Spain's cruisers; then 'mid the clangor Dart her destroyers, lurid with anger; Shouts Richard Wainwright, quivers the Gloucester: Where the Furor goes

Wainwright has crossed her. Boast him, and toast him! Wainwright! The Gloucester!

Wide to the westward El Furor flutters; Hid in bright vapors there Wainwright mutters; Under Socapa races the faster, Smiles at Spain's gunners, laughs at disaster; Aiming and flaming Faster and faster.

Wide to the westward El Pluton plunges; At her with rapiers now Wainwright lunges! Swords of fierce scarlet, blades blue as lightning; Rapid guns snapping, little guns brightening; Four-pounders, six-pounders, Lunging like lightning.

Done the destroyers, blazing and bursting; Berserker Wainwright rides to their worsting; Seethe the Pluton's sides, soon to exhaust her; Flames the Furor's deck, doomed by the Gloucester. Boast him, and toast him! Wainwright! The Gloucester!

Where the Pluton lies lifts the red leven-- Fire-clouds prodigious dash against Heaven; Where the Pluton lay void swells the ocean; Shattered and sunken, spent her devotion; Waves where wet graves were, Deep in the ocean.

Shrieking toward Cuba, agonized, broken, El Furor's hasting, her fate bespoken; There in the shallows 'mid the white surges Her guns, deserted, moan out their dirges; Swelling and knelling Through the white surges.

Wainwright in mercy does his endeavor: Some he shall rescue; more rest for ever-- Say a prayer for them, one kindly _Ave_. Spain weeps her wounded, wails a lost navy; Fails them, bewails them, Says them an _Ave_.

Off Santiago, when from beleaguer Rushed forth Cervera, daring and eager, Who stood Spain's onset? Who met and tossed her? Wainwright, the Maine's man, glad on the Gloucester! Boast him, and toast him! Wainwright! The Gloucester!

WALLACE RICE.

The evolutions of the Brooklyn, under Commodore Winfield Scott Schley, have been the subject of bitter controversy. Schley, finding himself too near the Spaniards, made a wide turn away from them, wishing, he afterwards alleged, to preserve his ship, which was the fastest of our squadron, to head off any of the Spanish ships which might escape.

THE BROOKLYN AT SANTIAGO

[July 3, 1898]

'Twixt clouded heights Spain hurls to doom Ships stanch and brave, Majestic, forth they flash and boom Upon the wave.

El Morro raises eyes of hate Far out to sea, And speeds Cervera to his fate With cannonry.

The Brooklyn o'er the deep espies His flame-wreathed side: She sets her banners on the skies In fearful pride.

On, to the harbor's mouth of fire, Fierce for the fray, She darts, an eagle from his eyre, Upon her prey.

She meets the brave Teresa there-- Sigh, sigh for Spain!-- And beats her clanging armor bare With glittering rain.

The bold Vizcaya's lightnings glance Into the throng Where loud the bannered Brooklyn chants Her awful song.

Down swoops, in one tremendous curve, Our Commodore; His broadsides roll, the foemen swerve Toward the shore.

In one great round his Brooklyn turns And, girdling there This side and that with glory, burns Spain to despair.

Frightful in onslaught, fraught with fate Her missiles hiss: The Spaniard sees, when all too late, A Nemesis.

The Oquendo's diapason swells; Then, torn and lame, Her portholes turn to yawning wells, Geysers of flame.

Yet fierce and fiercer breaks and cries Our rifles' dread: The doomed Teresa shudders--lies Stark with her dead.

How true the Brooklyn's battery speaks Eulate knows, As the Vizcaya staggers, shrieks Her horrent woes.

Sideward she plunges: nevermore Shall Biscay feel Her heart throb for the ship that wore Her name in steel.

The Oquendo's ports a moment shone, As gloomed her knell; She trembles, bursts--the ship is gone Headlong to hell.

The fleet Colon in lonely flight-- Spain's hope, Spain's fear!-- Sees, and it lends her wings of fright, Schley's pennant near.

The fleet Colon scuds on alone-- God, how she runs!-- And ever hears behind her moan The Brooklyn's guns.

Our ruthless cannon o'er the flood Roar and draw nigh; Spain's ensign stained with gold and blood, Falls from on high.

The world she gave the World has passed-- Gone, with her power-- Dead, 'neath the Brooklyn's thunder-blast, In one great hour.

The bannered Brooklyn! gallant crew, And gallant Schley! Proud is the flag his sailors flew Along the sky.

Proud is his country: for each star Our Union wears, The fighting Brooklyn shows a scar-- So much he dares.

God save us war upon the seas; But, if it slip, Send such a chief, with men like these, On such a ship!

WALLACE RICE.

The Oregon, which had arrived from her fifteen-thousand-mile voyage from San Francisco, also took a conspicuous part in the battle, and did splendid service.

THE RUSH OF THE OREGON

They held her South to Magellan's mouth, Then East they steered her, forth Through the farther gate of the crafty strait, And then they held her North.

Six thousand miles to the Indian Isles! And the Oregon rushed home, Her wake a swirl of jade and pearl, Her bow a bend of foam.

And when at Rio the cable sang, "There is war!--grim war with Spain!" The swart crews grinned and stroked their guns And thought on the mangled Maine.

In the glimmered gloom of the engine-room There was joy to each grimy soul, And fainting men sprang up again And piled the blazing coal.

Good need was there to go with care: But every sailor prayed Or gun for gun, or six to one To meet them, unafraid.

Her goal at last! With joyous blast She hailed the welcoming roar Of hungry sea-wolves curved along The strong-hilled Cuban shore.

Long nights went by. Her beamèd eye, Unwavering, searched the bay Where trapped and penned for a certain end The Spanish squadron lay.

Out of the harbor a curl of smoke-- A watchful gun rang clear. Out of the channel the squadron broke Like a bevy of frightened deer.

Then there was shouting for "steam, more steam!" And fires glowed white and red; And guns were manned, and ranges planned, And the great ships leaped ahead.

Then there was roaring of chorusing guns, Shatter of shell, and spray; And who but the rushing Oregon Was fiercest in chase and fray!

For her mighty wake was a seething snake; Her bow was a billow of foam; Like the mailèd fists of an angry wight Her shot drove crashing home!

Pride of the Spanish navy, ho! Flee like a hounded beast! For the Ship of the Northwest strikes a blow For the Ship of the far Northeast!

In quivering joy she surged ahead, Aflame with flashing bars, Till down sunk the Spaniard's gold and red And up ran the Clustered Stars.

"Glory to share"? Aye, and to spare; But the chiefest is hers by right Of a rush of fourteen thousand miles For the chance of a bitter fight!

ARTHUR GUITERMAN.

The high quality of American marksmanship was never more conclusively shown than in this battle. The Spanish ships were literally blown to pieces. Here, as at Manila, the victory had been won by "the men behind the guns."

THE MEN BEHIND THE GUNS

A cheer and salute for the Admiral, and here's to the Captain bold, And never forget the Commodore's debt when the deeds of might are told! They stand to the deck

through the battle's wreck when the great shells roar and screech-- And never they fear when the foe is near to practise what they preach: But off with your hat and three times three for Columbia's true-blue sons, The men below who batter the foe--the men behind the guns!

Oh, light and merry of heart are they when they swing into port once more, When, with more than enough of the "green-backed stuff," they start for their leave-o'-shore; And you'd think, perhaps, that the blue-bloused chaps who loll along the street Are a tender bit, with salt on it, for some fierce "mustache" to eat-- Some warrior bold, with straps of gold, who dazzles and fairly stuns The modest worth of the sailor boys--the lads who serve the guns.

But say not a word till the shot is heard that tells the fight is on, Till the long, deep roar grows more and more from the ships of "Yank" and "Don," Till over the deep the tempests sweep of fire and bursting shell, And the very air is a mad Despair in the throes of a living hell; Then down, deep down, in the mighty ship, unseen by the midday suns, You'll find the chaps who are giving the raps--the men behind the guns!

Oh, well they know how the cyclones blow that they loose from their cloud of death, And they know is heard the thunder-word their fierce ten-incher saith! The steel decks rock with the lightning shock, and shake with the great recoil, And the sea grows red with the blood of the dead and reaches for his spoil-- But not till the foe has gone below or turns his prow and runs, Shall the voice of peace bring sweet release to the men behind the guns!

JOHN JEROME ROONEY.

Admiral Pasquale de Cervera, in command of the Spanish fleet, knew from the first how desperate the venture was. He made it only because forced to do so by direct orders from Madrid, the Spanish authorities fearing that Santiago would be taken and the whole fleet be made captive.

CERVERA

Hail to thee, gallant foe! Well hast thou struck thy blow-- Hopeless of victory-- Daring unequal strife, Valuing more than life Honor and chivalry.

Forth from the harbor's room Rushing to meet thy doom, Lit by the day's clear light. "Out to the waters free! Out to the open sea! There should a sailor fight."

Where the red battle's roar Beats on the rocky shore, Thunders proclaiming How the great cannon's breath Hurls forth a dreadful death, Smoking and flaming.

While her guns ring and flash, See each frail vessel dash, Though our shots rend her, Swift through the iron rain, Bearing the flag of Spain, Scorning surrender.

Hemmed in 'twixt foe and wreck, Blood soaks each slippery deck, Still madly racing, Till their ships burn and reel, Crushed by our bolts of steel, Firing and chasing.

Driven to the rocks at last, Now heels each shattered mast, Flames the blood drinking, Each with her load of dead, Wrapped in that shroud of red, Silenced and sinking.

Vanquished! but not in vain: Ancient renown of Spain, Coming upon her. Once again lives in thee, All her old chivalry, All her old honor.

Ever her past avers, When wealth and lands were hers, Though she might love them, Die for their keeping, yet Spain, in her pride, has set Honor above them.

BERTRAND SHADWELL.

Santiago surrendered a few days later and an army of occupation, under General Nelson A. Miles, landed at Porto Rico and took possession of the island, after a few sharp skirmishes. In the Philippines, operations against Manila were pushed vigorously forward, and on August 13, after sharp actions at Malate, Singalon, and Ermita, the city was captured. Among the killed at Malate was Sergeant J. A. McIlrath, Battery H, Third Artillery Regulars.

McILRATH OF MALATE

[August 13, 1898]

Yes, yes, my boy, there's no mistake, You put the contract through! You lads with Shafter, I'll allow, Were heroes tried and true;

But don't forget the men who fought About Manila Bay, And don't forget brave McIlrath Who died at Malate.

The night was black, save where the forks Of tropic lightning ran, When, with a long deep thunder-roar, The typhoon storm began.

Then, suddenly above the din, We heard the steady bay Of volleys from the trenches where The Pennsylvanias lay.

The Tenth, we thought, could hold their own Against the feigned attack, And, if the Spaniards dared advance Would pay them doubly back.

But soon we marked the volleys sink Into a scattered fire-- And now we heard the Spanish guns Boom nigher yet and nigher!

Then, like a ghost, a courier Seemed past our picket tossed, With wild hair streaming in his face-- "We're lost--we're lost--we're lost!"

"Front, front--in God's name--front!" he cried: "Our ammunition's gone!" He turned a face of dazed dismay-- And through the night sped on!

"Men, follow me!" cried McIlrath, Our acting sergeant then; And when he gave the word he knew He gave the word to men!

Twenty there--not one man more-- But down the sunken road We dragged the guns of Battery H, Nor even stopped to load!

Sudden, from the darkness poured A storm of Mauser hail-- But not a man there thought to pause, Nor any man to quail!

Ahead, the Pennsylvanias' guns In scattered firing broke; The Spanish trenches, red with flame, In fiercer volleys spoke!

Down with a rush our twenty came-- The open field we passed-- And in among the hard-pressed Tenth We set our feet at last!

Up, with a leap, sprang McIlrath, Mud-spattered, worn and wet, And, in an instant, there he stood High on the parapet!

"Steady, boys! we've got 'em now-- Only a minute late! It's all right, lads--we've got 'em whipped-- Just give 'em volleys straight!"

Then, up and down the parapet With head erect he went, As cool as when he sat with us Beside our evening tent!

Not one of us, close sheltered there Down in the trench's pen, But felt that we would rather die Than shame or grieve him then!

The fire so close to being quenched In panic and defeat, Leaped forth, by rapid volleys sped, In one long deadly sheet!

A cheer went up along the line As breaks the thunder-call-- But, as it rose, great God, we saw Our gallant sergeant fall!

He sank into our outstretched arms Dead--but immortal grown; And Glory brightened where he fell, And valor claimed her own!

JOHN JEROME ROONEY.

Spain had had enough. She recognized the folly of struggling further, and made overtures for peace. On August 12 a protocol was signed and hostilities ceased. Eight days later, the American squadron steamed into New York harbor.

WHEN THE GREAT GRAY SHIPS COME IN[17]

NEW YORK HARBOR, August 20, 1898

To eastward ringing, to westward winging, o'er mapless miles of sea, On winds and tides the gospel rides that the furthermost isles are free, And the furthermost isles make answer, harbor, and height, and hill, Breaker and beach cry each to each, "'Tis the Mother who calls! Be still!" Mother! new-found, beloved, and strong to hold from harm, Stretching to these across the seas the shield of her sovereign arm, Who summoned the guns of her sailor sons, who bade her navies roam, Who calls again to the leagues of main, and who calls them this time Home!

And the great gray ships are silent, and the weary watchers rest, The black cloud dies in the August skies, and deep in the golden west Invisible hands are limning a glory of crimson bars, And far above is the wonder of a myriad wakened stars! Peace! As the tidings silence the strenuous cannonade, Peace at last! is the bugle blast the length of the long blockade, And eyes of vigil weary are lit with the glad release, From ship to ship and from lip to lip it is "Peace! Thank God for peace."

Ah, in the sweet hereafter Columbia still shall show The sons of these who swept the seas how she bade them rise and go,-- How, when the stirring summons smote on her children's ear, South and North at the call stood forth, and the whole land answered, "Here!" For the soul of the soldier's story and the heart of the sailor's song Are all of those who meet their foes as right should meet with wrong, Who fight their guns till the foeman runs, and then, on the decks they trod, Brave faces raise, and give the praise to the grace of their country's God!

Yes, it is good to battle, and good to be strong and free, To carry the hearts of a people to the uttermost ends of sea, To see the day steal up the bay where the enemy lies in wait, To run your ship to the harbor's lip and sink her across the strait:-- But better the golden evening when the ships round heads for home, And the long gray miles slip swiftly past in a swirl of seething foam, And the people wait at the haven's gate to greet the men who win! Thank God for peace! Thank God for peace, when the great gray ships come in!

GUY WETMORE CARRYL.

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FULL CYCLE

Spain drew us proudly from the womb of night, A lusty man-child of the Western wave,-- Who now, full-grown, smites the old midwife down, And thrusts her deep in a dishonored grave.

JOHN WHITE CHADWICK.

Peace commissioners from the two countries met at Paris in October, and a treaty of peace was signed on December 10, 1898. Spain relinquished all sovereignty over Cuba, and ceded Porto Rico, Guam, and the Philippine Islands to the United States, receiving in payment for the latter the sum of twenty million dollars.

BREATH ON THE OAT

Free are the Muses, and where freedom is They follow, as the thrushes follow spring, Leaving the old lands songless there behind; Parnassus disenchanted suns its woods, Empty of every nymph; wide have they flown; And now on new sierras think to set Their wandering court, and thrill the world anew, Where the Republic babbling waits its speech; For but the prelude of its mighty song As yet has sounded. Therefore, would I woo Apollo to the land I love, 'tis vain; Unknown he spies on us; and if my verse Ring not the empyrean round and round, 'Tis that the feeble oat is few of stops. The noble theme awaits the nobler bard. Then how all air will quire to it, and all The great dead listen, America!--For lo, Diana of the nations hath she lived Remote, and hoarding her own happiness In her own land, the land that seemed her first An exile, where her bark was cast away, Till maiden grew the backward-hearted child, And on that sea whose waves were memories Turned her young shoulder, looked with steadfast eyes Upon her wilderness, her woods, her streams; Inland she ran, and

gathering virgin joy Followed her shafts afar from humankind. And if sometimes her isolation drooped And yearning woke in her, she put it forth With a high boast and with a sick disdain; Actæons fleeing, into antlers branched The floating tresses of her fancy, and far Her arrows smote them with a bleeding laugh. O vain and virgin, O the fool of love! Now children not her own are at her knee. For stricken by her path lay one that vexed Her maiden calm; she reached a petulant hand; And the old nations drew sharp breath and looked. The two-edged sword, how came it in her hand? The sword that slays the holder if he withhold, That none can take, or having taken drop, The sword is in thy hand, America! The wrath of God, that fillets thee with lightnings, America! Strike then; the sword departs. Ah God, once more may men crown drowsy days With glorious death, upholding a great cause! I deemed it fable; not of them am I. Yet if they loved thee on the loud May-day Who with unexultant thunder wreathed the flag, With thunder and with victory, if they Who on the third most famous of our Fourths Along the seaboard mountains swept, a storm Unleashed, whose tread spurned not the wrecks of Spain, If these thy sons have loved thee, and have set Santiago and Manila like new stars Crowding thy field of blue, new terror perched Like eagles on thy banners, oh, not less I love thee, who but prattle in the prime Of birds of passage over river and wood Thine also, piping little charms to lure, Uncaptured and unflying, the wings of song.

JOSEPH RUSSELL TAYLOR.

But the United States was still involved in a struggle altogether unforeseen and repugnant to many of her citizens. The Philippines had been bought from Spain, and with them the United States had taken over just such an insurrection as Spain had encountered in Cuba.

THE ISLANDS OF THE SEA

God is shaping the great future of the Islands of the Sea; He has sown the blood of martyrs and the fruit is liberty; In thick clouds and in darkness He has sent abroad His word; He has given a haughty nation to the cannon and the sword.

He has seen a people moaning in the thousand deaths they die; He has heard from child and woman a terrible dark cry; He has given the wasted talent of the steward faithless found To the youngest of the nations with His abundance crowned.

He called her to do justice where none but she had power; He called her to do mercy to her neighbor at the door; He called her to do vengeance for her own sons foully dead; Thrice did He call unto her ere she inclined her head.

She has gathered the vast Midland, she has searched her borders round; There has been a mighty hosting of her children on the ground; Her search-lights lie along the sea, her guns are loud on land; To do her will upon the earth her armies round her stand.

The fleet, at her commandment, to either ocean turns; Belted around the mighty world her line of battle burns; She has loosed the hot volcanoes of the ships of flaming hell; With fire and smoke and earthquake shock her heavy vengeance fell.

O joyfullest May morning when before our guns went down The Inquisition priesthood and the dungeon-making crown, While through red lights of battle our starry dawn burst out, Swift as the tropic sunrise that doth with glory shout!

Be jubilant, free Cuba, our feet are on thy soil; Up mountain road, through jungle growth, our bravest for thee toil; There is no blood so precious as their wounds pour forth for thee; Sweet be thy joys, free Cuba,--sorrows have made thee free.

Nor Thou, O noble Nation, who wast so slow to wrath, With grief too heavy-laden follow in duty's path; Not for ourselves our lives are; not for Thyself art Thou; The Star of Christian Ages is shining on Thy brow.

Rejoice, O mighty Mother, that God hath chosen Thee To be the western warder of the Islands of the Sea; He lifteth up, He casteth down, He is the King of Kings, Whose dread commands o'er awe-struck lands are borne on eagle's wings.

GEORGE EDWARD WOODBERRY.

The people of the Philippines had fought against Spanish sovereignty much as the people of Cuba had. A band of them, under Emilio Aguinaldo, had assisted at the capture of Manila, in the fond hope that the defeat of the Spaniards would mean Philippine independence. Instead, they found that they had merely traded masters. At once they took up arms against the Americans.

BALLADE OF EXPANSION

1899

Time was he sang the British Brute, The ruthless lion's grasping greed, The European Law of Loot, The despot's devastating deed; But now he sings the heavenly creed Of saintly sword and friendly fist, He loves you, though he makes you bleed-- The Ethical Expansionist!

He loves you, Heathen! Though his foot May kick you like a worthless weed From that wild field where you have root, And scatter to the winds your seed; He's just the government you need; If you object, why, he'll insist, And, on your protest, "draw a bead"-- The Ethical Expansionist!

He'll take you to him _coûte que coûte_! He'll win you, though you fight and plead. His guns shall urge his ardent suit, Relentless fire his cause shall speed. In time you'll learn to write and read (That is, if you should then exist!), You won't, if you his course impede-- The Ethical Expansionist!

ENVOI

Heathen, you must, you shall be freed! It's really useless to resist; To save your life, you'd better heed The Ethical Expansionist!

HILDA JOHNSON.

Misguided they no doubt were, and the warfare they waged was of the cruelest kind; but to employ against them the troops of a Republic, to shoot them down as "rebels," occasioned in the United States a great outburst of indignation.

"REBELS"

Shoot down the rebels--men who dare To claim their native land! Why should the white invader spare A dusky heathen band?

You bought them from the Spanish King, You bought the men he stole; You bought perchance a ghastlier thing-- The Duke of Alva's soul!

"Freedom!" you cry, and train your gun On men who would be freed, And in the name of Washington Achieve a Weyler's deed.

Boast of the benefits you spread, The faith of Christ you hold; Then seize the very soil you tread And fill your arms with gold.

Go, prostitute your mother-tongue, And give the "rebel" name To those who to their country clung, Preferring death to shame.

And call him "loyal," him who brags Of countrymen betrayed-- The patriot of the money-bags, The loyalist of trade.

Oh, for the good old Roman days Of robbers bold and true, Who scorned to oil with pious phrase The deeds they dared to do--

The days before degenerate thieves Devised the coward lie Of blessings that the enslaved receives Whose rights their arms deny!

I hate the oppressor's iron rod, I hate his murderous ships, But most of all I hate, O God, The lie upon his lips!

Nay, if they still demand recruits To curse Manila Bay, Be men; refuse to act like brutes And massacre and slay.

Or if you will persist to fight With all a soldier's pride, Why, then be rebels for the right By Aguinaldo's side!

ERNEST CROSBY.

But the administration felt that it had gone too far to draw back; spellbinders raised the shout that wherever the flag was raised it must remain; new regiments were shipped to the Philippines and the war against the natives pushed vigorously.

ON A SOLDIER FALLEN IN THE PHILIPPINES

Streets of the roaring town, Hush for him, hush, be still! He comes, who was stricken down Doing the word of our will. Hush! Let him have his state. Give him his soldier's crown. The grists of trade can wait Their grinding at the mill, But he cannot wait for his honor, now the trumpet has been blown. Wreathe pride now for his granite brow, lay love on his breast of stone.

Toll! Let the great bells toll Till the clashing air is dim, Did we wrong this parted soul? We will make it up to him. Toll! Let him never guess What work we set him to. Laurel, laurel, yes; He did what we bade him do. Praise, and never a whispered hint but the fight he fought was good; Never a word that the blood on his sword was his country's own heart's blood.

A flag for the soldier's bier Who dies that his land may live; Oh, banners, banners here, That he doubt not nor misgive! That he heed not from the tomb The evil days draw near When the nation, robed in gloom, With its faithless past shall strive. Let him never dream that his bullet's scream went wide of its island mark, Home to the heart of his sinning land where she stumbled and sinned in the dark.

WILLIAM VAUGHN MOODY.

On February 5, 1899, General Ricarti's division of the Filipino army was encountered near Santa Ana, and completely routed. It was at this battle that Lieutenant Charles E. Kilbourne, Jr., and Lieutenant W. G. Miles performed the exploits described in the following poems.

THE BALLAD OF PACO TOWN

[February 5, 1899]

In Paco town and in Paco tower, At the height of the tropic noonday hour, Some Tagal riflemen, half a score, Watched the length of the highway o'er, And when to the front the troopers spurred, Whiz-z! whiz-z! how the Mausers whirred!

From the opposite walls, through crevice and crack, Volley on volley went ringing back Where a band of regulars tried to drive The stinging rebels out of their hive; "Wait, till our cannon come, and then," Cried a captain, striding among his men, "We'll settle that bothersome buzz and drone With a merry little tune of our own!"

The sweltering breezes seemed to swoon, And down the _calle_ the thickening flames Licked the roofs in the tropic noon. Then through the crackle and glare and heat, And the smoke and the answering acclaims Of the rifles, far up the village street Was heard the clatter of horses' feet, And a band of signalmen swung in sight, Hasting back from the ebbing fight That had swept away to the left and right.

"Ride!" yelled the regulars, all aghast, And over the heads of the signalmen, As they whirled in desperate gallop past, The bullets a vicious music made, Like the whistle and whine of the midnight blast On the weltering wastes of the ocean when The breast of the deep is scourged and flayed.

It chanced in the line of the fiercest fire A rebel bullet had clipped the wire That led, from the front and the fighting, down To those that stayed in Manila town; This gap arrested the watchful eye Of one of the signalmen galloping by, And straightway, out of the plunge and press, He reined his horse with a swift caress

And a word in the ear of the rushing steed; Then back with never a halt nor heed Of the swarming bullets he rode, his goal The parted wire and the slender pole That stood where the deadly tower looked down On the rack and ruin of Paco town.

Out of his saddle he sprang as gay As a schoolboy taking a holiday; Wire in hand up the pole he went With never a glance at the tower, intent Only on that which he saw appear As the line of his duty plain and clear. To the very crest he climbed, and there, While the bullets buzzed in the scorching air Clipped his clothing, and scored and stung The slender pole-top to which he clung, Made the wire that was severed sound, Slipped in his careless way to the ground, Sprang to the back of his horse, and then Was off, this bravest of signalmen.

Cheers for the hero! While such as he, Heedless alike of wounds and scars, Fight for the dear old Stripes and Stars, Down through the years to us shall be Ever and ever the victory!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

THE DEED OF LIEUTENANT MILES

[February 5, 1899]

When you speak of dauntless deeds, When you tell of stirring scenes, Tell this story of the isles Where the endless summer smiles,-- Tell of young Lieutenant Miles In the far-off Philippines!

'Twas the Santa Ana fight!-- All along the Tagal line From the thickets dense and dire Gushed the fountains of their fire; You could mark their rifles' ire, You could hear their bullets whine.

Little wonder there was pause! Some were wounded, some were dead "Call Lieutenant Miles!" He came, In his eyes a fearless flame. "Yonder blockhouse is our aim!" The battalion leader said.

"You must take it--how you will; You must break this damnèd spell!" "Volunteers!" cried Miles. 'Twas vain, For that narrow tropic lane 'Twixt the bamboo and the cane Was a very lane of hell.

There were five stood forth at last; God above, but they were men! "Come!" exultantly he saith!-- Did they falter? Not a breath! Down the path of hurtling death The Lieutenant led them then.

Two have fallen--now a third! Forward dash the other three; In the onrush of that race Ne'er a swerve or stay of pace. And the Tagals--dare they face Such a desperate company?

Panic gripped them by the throat,-- Every Tagal rifleman; And as though they seemed to see In those charging foemen three An avenging destiny, Fierce and fast and far they ran.

So a salvo for the six! So a round of ringing cheers! Heroes of the distant isles Where the endless summer smiles,-- Gallant young Lieutenant Miles And his valiant volunteers!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

So the war went on, with massacre, ambush, and lonely murder. The conquest of the islands was proving a costly one, but the administration held that it must be carried through, at whatever sacrifice. It was a war in which victory and defeat alike brought only sorrow and disgust.

AGUINALDO

(PATRIOT AND EMPIRE)

When arms and numbers both have failed To make the hunted patriot yield, Nor proffered riches have prevailed To tempt him to forsake the field, By spite and baffled rage beguiled, Strike at his mother and his child.

O land where freedom loved to dwell, Which shook'st the despot on his throne, And o'er the beating floods of hell Hope's beacon to the world hast shown, How art thou fallen from thy place! O thing of shame!--O foul disgrace!

Thy home was built upon the height Above the murky clouds beneath, In the blue heaven's freest light, Thy sword flashed ever from its sheath, The weak and the oppressed to save-- To smite the tyrant--free the slave.

Thy place was glorious--sublime. What devil tempts thee to descend To conquest, robbery and crime? O shameful fate! Is this the end? Thy hands have now the damning stain Of human blood--for love of gain.

With weak hypocrisy's thin veil, Seek not in vain to blind thine eyes; Nor shall deceitful prayers prevail. Pray not--for fear the dead should rise From 'neath their conquered country's sod And cry against thee unto God.

BERTRAND SHADWELL.

The capture of Aguinaldo, March 23, 1901, put a virtual end to organized resistance; though sporadic outbreaks continued for several years. As late as March, 1906, such an affair occurred, a band of Moros, men, women, and children, being surrounded and killed on the summit of a crater at Dajo, no prisoners being taken.

THE FIGHT AT DAJO

[March 7, 1906]

There are twenty dead who're sleeping near the slopes of Bud Dajo, 'Neath the shadow of the crater where the bolos laid them low, And their comrades feel it bitter, and their cheeks grow hot with shame, When they read the sneering comments which have held them up to blame.

They were told to scale the mountain and they stormed its beetling crest, Spite of all the frantic Moros, though they did their level best, Though the bullets whistled thickly, and the cliff was lined with foes, Though the campilans were flashing and the kriss gave deadly blows.

There was little time for judging ere they met in deadly strife What the sex might be that rushing waved aloft the blood-stained knife; For the foe was drunk with frenzy and the women in the horde Thought that paradise was certain could they kill first with the sword.

They'd been freely offered mercy, but they'd scorned the proffered gift, For their priests had told them Allah promised victory sure and swift. They were foolish and their folly cost the lives of wife and son, But they fought their fight like heroes; there were none that turned to run.

Though they'd robbed and slain and ravaged, though their crimes had mounted high, Though 'tis true that naught became them like the death they chose to die, One would think to read the papers that the troops who scaled their fort Were a lot of brutal ruffians shooting girls and babes for sport.

More than one who's sleeping soundly 'neath the shade of Bud Dajo Lost his life while giving succor to the one who dealt the blow, Yet his comrades feel more bitter and they give a far worse name To the men who dubbed them "butchers" and have smirched the army's fame.

ALFRED E. WOOD.

The Philippines, meanwhile, had been placed under a civil government; but no promise was given them of ultimate independence. Their commerce was crippled by the high tariff party in control of Congress; and while their condition was vastly better than it had been under Spanish rule, it was not such as a Republic, working for their good, might have made it. The acquisition and conquest of the islands is believed by many intelligent and patriotic persons to be one of the darkest blots upon American history.

AN ODE IN TIME OF HESITATION

(WRITTEN AFTER SEEING AT BOSTON THE STATUE OF ROBERT GOULD SHAW, KILLED WHILE STORMING FORT WAGNER, JULY 18, 1863, AT THE HEAD OF THE FIRST ENLISTED NEGRO REGIMENT, THE FIFTY-FOURTH MASSACHUSETTS)

I

Before the living bronze Saint-Gaudens made Most fit to thrill the passer's heart with awe, And set here in the city's talk and trade To the good memory of Robert Shaw, This bright March morn I stand And hear the distant spring come up the land; Knowing that what I hear is not unheard Of this boy soldier and his negro band, For all their gaze is fixed so stern ahead, For all the fatal rhythm of their tread. The land they died to save from death and shame Trembles and waits, hearing the spring's great name, And by her pangs these resolute ghosts are stirred.

II

Through street and mall the tides of people go Heedless; the trees upon the Common show No hint of green; but to my listening heart The still earth doth impart Assurance of her jubilant emprise, And it is clear to my long-searching eyes That love at last has might upon the skies. The ice is runnelled on the little pond; A telltale patter drips from off the trees; The air is touched with southland spiceries, As if but yesterday it tossed the frond Of pendent mosses where the live oaks grow Beyond Virginia and the Carolines, Or had its will among the fruits and vines Of aromatic isles asleep beyond Florida and the Gulf of Mexico.

III

Soon shall the Cape Ann children laugh in glee, Spying the arbutus, spring's dear recluse; Hill lads at dawn shall hearken the wild goose Go honking northward over Tennessee; West from Oswego to Sault Saint-Marie, And on to where the Pictured Rocks are hung, And yonder where, gigantic, wilful, young, Chicago sitteth at the northwest gates, With restless violent hands and casual tongue Moulding her mighty fates, The Lakes shall robe them in ethereal sheen; And like a larger sea, the vital green Of springing wheat shall vastly be outflung Over Dakota and the prairie states. By desert people immemorial On Arizonan mesas shall be done Dim rites unto the thunder and the sun; Nor shall the primal gods lack sacrifice More splendid, when the white Sierras call Unto the Rockies straightway to arise And dance before the unveiled ark of the year, Clashing their windy cedars as for shawms, Unrolling rivers clear For flutter of broad phylacteries; While Shasta signals to Alaskan seas That watch old sluggish glaciers downward creep To fling their icebergs thundering from the steep, And Mariposa through the purple calms Gazes at far Hawaii crowned with palms Where East and West are met,-- A rich seal on the ocean's bosom set To say that East and West are twain, With different loss and gain: The Lord hath sundered them; let them be sundered yet.

IV

Alas! what sounds are these that come Sullenly over the Pacific seas,-- Sounds of ignoble battle, striking dumb The season's half-awakened ecstasies? Must I be humble, then, Now when my heart hath need of pride? Wild love falls on me from these sculptured men; By loving much the land for which they died I would be justified. My spirit was away on pinions wide To soothe in praise of her its passionate mood And ease it of its ache of gratitude. Too sorely heavy is the debt they lay On me and the companions of my day. I would remember now My country's goodliness, make sweet her name. Alas! what shade art thou Of sorrow or of blame Liftest the lyric leafage from her brow, And pointest a slow finger at her shame?

V

Lies! lies! It cannot be! The wars we wage Are noble, and our battles still are won By justice for us, ere we lift the gage. We have not sold our loftiest heritage. The proud republic hath not stooped to cheat And scramble in the market-place of war; Her

forehead weareth yet its solemn star. Here is her witness: this, her perfect son, This delicate and proud New England soul Who leads despisèd men, with just-unshackled feet, Up the large ways where death and glory meet, To show all peoples that our shame is done, That once more we are clean and spirit-whole.

VI

Crouched in the sea fog on the moaning sand All night he lay, speaking some simple word From hour to hour to the slow minds that heard, Holding each poor life gently in his hand And breathing on the base rejected clay Till each dark face shone mystical and grand Against the breaking day; And lo, the shard the potter cast away Was grown a fiery chalice, crystal-fine, Fulfilled of the divine Great wine of battle wrath by God's ring-finger stirred. Then upward, where the shadowy bastion loomed Huge on the mountain in the wet sea light, Whence now, and now, infernal flowerage bloomed, Bloomed, burst, and scattered down its deadly seed,-- They swept, and died like freemen on the height, Like freemen, and like men of noble breed; And when the battle fell away at night By hasty and contemptuous hands were thrust Obscurely in a common grave with him The fair-haired keeper of their love and trust. Now limb doth mingle with dissolvèd limb In nature's busy old democracy To flush the mountain laurel when she blows Sweet by the southern sea, And heart with crumbled heart climbs in the rose:-- The untaught hearts with the high heart that knew This mountain fortress for no earthly hold Of temporal quarrel, but the bastion old Of spiritual wrong, Built by an unjust nation sheer and strong, Expugnable but by a nation's rue And bowing down before that equal shrine By all men held divine, Whereof his band and he were the most holy sign.

VII

O bitter, bitter shade! Wilt thou not put the scorn And instant tragic question from thine eyes? Do thy dark brows yet crave That swift and angry stave-- Unmeet for this desirous morn-- That I have striven, striven to evade? Gazing on him, must I not deem they err Whose careless lips in street and shop aver As common tidings, deeds to make his cheek Flush from the bronze, and his dead throat to speak? Surely some elder singer would arise, Whose harp hath leave to threaten and to mourn Above this people when they go astray. Is Whitman, the strong spirit, overworn? Has Whittier put his yearning wrath away? I will not and I dare not yet believe! Though furtively the sunlight seems to grieve, And the spring-laden breeze Out of the gladdening west is sinister With sounds of nameless battle overseas; Though when we turn and question in suspense If these things be indeed after these ways, And what things are to follow after these, Our fluent men of place and consequence Fumble and fill their mouths with hollow phrase, Or for the end-all of deep arguments Intone their dull commercial liturgies-- I dare not yet believe! My ears are shut! I will not hear the thin satiric praise And muffled laughter of our enemies, Bidding us never sheathe our valiant sword Till we have changed our birthright for a gourd Of wild pulse stolen from a barbarian's hut; Showing how wise it is to cast away The symbols of our spiritual sway, That so our hands with better ease May wield the driver's whip and

grasp the jailer's keys.

VIII

Was it for this our fathers kept the law? This crown shall crown their struggle and their ruth? Are we the eagle nation Milton saw Mewing its mighty youth, Soon to possess the mountain winds of truth, And be a swift familiar of the sun Where aye before God's face His trumpets run? Or have we but the talons and the maw, And for the abject likeness of our heart Shall some less lordly bird be set apart?-- Some gross-billed wader where the swamps are fat? Some gorger in the sun? Some prowler with the bat?

IX

Ah no! We have not fallen so. We are our fathers' sons: let those who lead us know! 'Twas only yesterday sick Cuba's cry Came up the tropic wind, "Now help us, for we die!" Then Alabama heard, And rising, pale, to Maine and Idaho Shouted a burning word; Proud state with proud impassioned state conferred, And at the lifting of a hand sprang forth, East, west, and south, and north, Beautiful armies. Oh, by the sweet blood and young Shed on the awful hill slope at San Juan, By the unforgotten names of eager boys Who might have tasted girls' love and been stung With the old mystic joys And starry griefs, now the spring nights come on, But that the heart of youth is generous,-- We charge you, ye who lead us, Breathe on their chivalry no hint of stain! Turn not their new-world victories to gain! One least leaf plucked for chaffer from the bays Of their dear praise, One jot of their pure conquest put to hire, The implacable republic will require; With clamor, in the glare and gaze of noon, Or subtly, coming as a thief at night, But surely, very surely, slow or soon That insult deep we deeply will requite. Tempt not our weakness, our cupidity! For save we let the island men go free, Those baffled and dislaurelled ghosts Will curse us from the lamentable coasts Where walk the frustrate dead. The cup of trembling shall be drainèd quite, Eaten the sour bread of astonishment, With ashes of the hearth shall be made white Our hair, and wailing shall be in the tent: Then on your guiltier head Shall our intolerable self-disdain Wreak suddenly its anger and its pain; For manifest in that disastrous light We shall discern the right And do it, tardily.--O ye who lead, Take heed! Blindness we may forgive, but baseness we will smite.

WILLIAM VAUGHN MOODY.

CHAPTER VI

THE NEW CENTURY

No country in the world entered upon the twentieth century with brighter prospects of peace, happiness, and prosperity than did the United States.

A TOAST TO OUR NATIVE LAND

Huge and alert, irascible yet strong, We make our fitful way 'mid right and wrong. One time we pour out millions to be free, Then rashly sweep an empire from the sea! One time we strike the shackles from the slaves, And then, quiescent, we are ruled by knaves. Often we rudely break restraining bars, And confidently reach out toward the stars.

Yet under all there flows a hidden stream Sprung from the Rock of Freedom, the great dream Of Washington and Franklin, men of old Who knew that freedom is not bought with gold. This is the Land we love, our heritage, Strange mixture of the gross and fine, yet sage And full of promise,--destined to be great. Drink to Our Native Land! God Bless the State!

ROBERT BRIDGES.

But the very first year, a bolt from the blue fell upon her. In May, 1901, a great industrial exposition, known as the "Pan-American," was opened at Buffalo, New York. It was especially notable for its electrical display and came to be known as "The Dream City," or "The City of Light."

BUFFALO

[1901]

A transient city, marvellously fair, Humane, harmonious, yet nobly free, She built for pure delight and memory. At her command, by lake and garden rare, Pylon and tower majestic rose in air, And sculptured forms of grace and symmetry. Then came a thought of God, and, reverently,-- "Let there be Light!" she said; and Light was there. O miracle of splendor! Who could know That Crime, insensate, egoist and blind, Destructive, causeless, caring but to smite, Would in its dull Cimmerian gropings find A sudden way to fill those courts with woe, And swallow up that radiance in night?

FLORENCE EARLE COATES.

September 5 was set aside as President's Day. The attendance was very large, and President William McKinley spoke to an audience of thirty thousand people. The next afternoon a reception was held, at which all were invited to pass in line and shake hands with the President. In the line was a man whose right hand was bandaged with a handkerchief. The handkerchief concealed a revolver. As the President stretched out his hand, the assassin fired twice, one bullet penetrating the President's abdomen.

McKINLEY

[September 6, 1901]

'Tis not the President alone Who, stricken by that bullet, fell; The assassin's shot that laid him prone Pierced a great nation's heart as well; And when the baleful tidings sped From lip to lip throughout the crowd, Then, as they deemed their ruler dead, 'Twas Liberty that cried aloud.

Ay, Liberty! for where the foam Of oceans twain marks out the coast 'Tis there, in Freedom's very home, That anarchy has maimed its host; There 'tis that it has turned to bite The hand that fed it; there repaid A country's welcome with black spite; There, Judas-like, that land betrayed.

For 'tis no despot that's laid low, But a free nation's chosen chief; A free man, stricken by a blow Base, dastardly, past all belief. And Tyranny exulting hears The tidings flashed across the sea; While stern Repression hugs her fears, And mouths them in a harsh decree.

Meanwhile the cloud, though black as death, Is lined with hopes, hopes light as life, And Liberty that, scant of breath, Had watched the issue of the strife, Fills the glad air with grateful cries To find the sun no more obscured, And with new yearnings in her eyes Climbs to her watch-tower--reassured.

London _Truth_.

Surgical aid was at hand. It was found that the bullet had passed through the stomach; both wounds were sewed up, and five days later the President was pronounced out of danger. The next day, he showed signs of a relapse, and sank steadily until death came early on the morning of Saturday, September 14.

FAITHFUL UNTO DEATH

[September 14, 1901]

His work is done, his toil is o'er; A martyr for our land he fell-- The land he loved, that loved him well; Honor his name for evermore!

Let all the world its tribute pay, For glorious shall be his renown; Though duty's was his only crown, Yet duty's path is glory's way.

For he was great without pretence; A man of whom none whispered shame, A man who knew nor guile nor blame; Good in his every influence.

On battle-field, in council-hall, Long years with sterling service rife He gave us, and at last his life-- Still unafraid at duty's call.

Let the last solemn pageant move, The nation's grief to consecrate To him struck down by maniac hate Amid a mighty nation's love;

And though the thought it solace gives, Beside the martyr's grave to-day We feel 'tis almost hard to say: "God reigns and the Republic lives!"

RICHARD HANDFIELD TITHERINGTON.

THE COMFORT OF THE TREES

Gentle and generous, brave-hearted, kind, And full of love and trust was he, our chief; He never harmed a soul! Oh, dull and blind And cruel, the hand that smote, beyond belief! Strike him? It could not be! Soon should we find 'Twas but a torturing dream--our sudden grief! Then sobs and wailings down the northern wind Like the

wild voice of shipwreck from a reef! By false hope lulled (his courage gave us hope!) By day, by night we watched,--until unfurled At last the word of fate!--Our memories Cherish one tender thought in their sad scope: He, looking from the window on this world, Found comfort in the moving green of trees.

RICHARD WATSON GILDER.

OUTWARD BOUND

Farewell! for now a stormy morn and dark The hour of greeting and of parting brings; Already on the rising wind yon bark Spreads her impatient wings.

Too hasty keel, a little while delay! A moment tarry, O thou hurrying dawn! For long and sad will be the mourners' day When their beloved is gone.

But vain the hands that beckon from the shore: Alike our passion and our grief are vain. Behind him lies our little world: before The illimitable main.

Yet, none the less, about his moving bed Immortal eyes a tireless vigil keep-- An angel at the feet and at the head Guard his untroubled sleep.

Two nations bowed above a common bier, Made one forever by a martyred son-- One in their agony of hope and fear, And in their sorrow one.

And thou, lone traveller, of a waste so wide, The uncharted seas that all must pass in turn, May the same star that was so long thy guide O'er thy last voyage burn.

No eye can reach where through yon sombre veil That bark to its eternal haven fares; No earthly breezes swell its shadowy sail: Only our love and prayers.

EDWARD SYDNEY TYLEE.

Theodore Roosevelt, Vice-President, succeeded to the Presidency. The greatest project which the new administration undertook was the construction of a ship canal across the Isthmus of Panama. This enterprise had been agitated as early as 1826, and in 1879 a French company under Ferdinand de Lesseps had secured a concession from Colombia and started to work. At the end of ten years, the company had exhausted its resources and work ceased.

PANAMA

Here the oceans twain have waited All the ages to be mated,-- Waited long and waited vainly, Though the script was written plainly: "This, the portal of the sea, Opes for him who holds the key; Here the empire of the earth Waits in patience for its birth."

But the Spanish monarch, dimly Seeing little, answered grimly: "North and South the land is Spain's; As God gave it, it remains. He who seeks to break the tie, By mine honor, he shall die!"

So the centuries rollèd on, And the gift of great Colon, Like a spendthrift's heritage, Dwindled slowly, age by age, Till the flag of red and gold Fell from hands unnerved and old, And the granite-pillared gate Waited still the key of fate.

Who shall hold that magic key But the child of destiny, In whose veins has mingled long All the best blood of the strong? He who takes his place by grace Of no single tribe or race, But by many a rich bequest From the bravest and the best. Sentinel of duty, here Must he guard a hemisphere.

Let the old world keep its ways; Naught to him its blame or praise; Naught its greed, or hate, or fear; For all swords be sheathèd here.

Yea, the gateway shall be free Unto all, from sea to sea; And no fratricidal slaughter Shall defile its sacred water; But--the hand that ope'd the gate shall forever hold the key!

JAMES JEFFREY ROCHE.

The United States was naturally looked to to carry on the project. The matter was brought before Congress, and in 1902 the French company was bought out for the sum of forty million dollars. The Republic of Panama was organized, when Colombia hesitated over the concession, and control of the canal route was thus secured.

DARIEN

A.D. 1513-A.D. 1901

[The American Senate has ratified the isthmus treaty.--WASHINGTON TELEGRAM.]

"Silent upon a peak in Darien," The Spanish steel red in his conquering hand, While golden, green and gracious the vast land Of that new world comes sudden into ken-- Stands Nuñez da Balboa. North and south He sees at last the full Pacific roll In blue and silver on each shelf and shoal, And the white bar of the broad river's mouth, And the long, ranked palm-trees. "Queen of Heaven," he cried, "To-day thou giv'st me this for all my pain, And I the glorious guerdon give to Spain, A new earth and new sea to be her pride, War ground and treasure-house." And while he spoke The world's heart knew a mightier dawn was broke.

"Silent, upon a peak in Darien"-- Four hundred years being fled, a Greater stood On that same height; and did behold the flood Of blue waves leaping; Mother of all men! Wise Nature! And she spake, "The gift I gave To Nuñez da Balboa could not keep Spain from her sins; now must the ages sweep To larger legend, tho' her own was brave. Here on this ridge I do foresee fresh birth. That which departed shall bring side by side, The sea shall sever what hills did divide; Shall link in love." And there was joy on earth; Whilst England and Columbia, quitting fear, Kissed--and let in the eager waters there.

EDWIN ARNOLD.

PANAMA

HOME OF THE DOVE-PLANT OR HOLY GHOST FLOWER

I

What time the Lord drew back the sea And gave thee room, slight Panama, "I will not have thee great," said he, "But thou shalt bear the slender key Of both the gates I builded me, And all the great shall come to thee For leave to pass, O Panama!" (Flower of the Holy Ghost, white dove, Breathe sweetness where he wrought in love.)

II

His oceans call across the land: "How long, how long, fair Panama, Wilt thou the shock of tides withstand, Nor heed us sobbing by the strand? Set wide thy gates on either hand, That we may search through saltless sand-- May clasp and kiss, O Panama!" (Flower of the deep-embosomed dove, So should his mighty nations love.)

III

Out-peal his holy temple-clocks: It is thine hour, glad Panama. Now shall thy key undo the locks; The strong shall cleave thy sunken rocks; Swung loose and floating from their docks, The world's white fleets shall come in flocks To thread thy straits, O Panama! (Flower of the tropics, snowy dove, Forbid, unless they come in love.)

IV

How beautiful is thy demesne! Search out thy wealth, proud Panama: Thy gold, thy pearls of silver sheen, Thy fruitful palms, thy thickets green; Load thou the ships that ride between; Attire thee as becomes a queen: The great ones greet thee, Panama! (Flower of the white and peaceful dove, Let all men pass who come in love.)

AMANDA T. JONES.

A working organization was perfected, improved machinery got into place, and when, in the fall of 1906, President Roosevelt visited the Isthmus, he found the dirt flying in a most satisfactory way. The canal was finally opened to commerce in April, 1916.

A SONG OF PANAMA

[1906]

"Chuff! chuff! chuff!" An' a mountain-bluff Is moved by the shovel's song; "Chuff! chuff! chuff!" Oh, the grade is rough A liftin' the landscape along!

We are ants upon a mountain, but we're leavin' of our dent, An' our teeth-marks bitin' scenery they will show the way we went; We're a liftin' half creation, an' we're changin' it around, Just to suit our playful purpose when we're diggin' in the ground.

"Chuff! chuff! chuff!" Oh, the grade is rough, An' the way to the sea is long; "Chuff! chuff! chuff!" an' the engines puff In tune to the shovel's song!

We're a shiftin' miles like inches, and we grab a forest here Just to switch it over yonder so's to leave an angle clear; We're a pushin' leagues o' swamps aside so's we can hurry by-- An' if we had to do it we would probably switch the sky!

"Chuff! chuff! chuff!" Oh, it's hard enough When you're changin' a job gone wrong; "Chuff! chuff! chuff!" an' there's no rebuff To the shovel a singin' its song!

You hears it in the mornin' an' you hears it late at night-- It's our battery keepin' action with support o' dynamite; Oh, you gets it for your dinner, an' the scenery skips along In a movin' panorama to the chargin' shovel's song!

"Chuff! chuff! chuff!" an' it grabs the scruff Of a hill an' boosts it along; "Chuff! chuff! chuff!" Oh, the grade is rough, But it gives to the shovel's song!

This is a fight that's fightin', an' the battle's to the death; There ain't no stoppin' here to rest or even catch your breath; You ain't no noble hero, an' you leave no gallant name-- You're a fightin' Nature's army, an' it ain't no easy game!

"Chuff! chuff! chuff!" Oh, the grade is rough, An' the way to the end is long, "Chuff! chuff! chuff!" an' the engines puff As we lift the landscape along!

ALFRED DAMON RUNYON.

In 1904 an industrial exposition to commemorate the one hundredth anniversary of the purchase of Louisiana from France was held at St. Louis, and was attended by millions of people. The official hymn was written by Edmund Clarence Stedman, and was sung on the opening day by a chorus of five hundred voices.

HYMN OF THE WEST

O Thou, whose glorious orbs on high Engird the earth with splendor round, From out thy secret place draw nigh The courts and temples of this ground; Eternal Light, Fill with thy might These domes that in thy purpose grew, And lift a nation's heart anew!

Illumine Thou each pathway here, To show the marvels God hath wrought! Since first thy people's chief and seer Looked up with that prophetic thought, Bade Time unroll The fateful scroll, And empire unto Freedom gave From cloudland height to tropic wave.

Poured through the gateways of the North Thy mighty rivers join their tide, And, on the wings of morn sent forth, Their mists the far-off peaks divide. By Thee unsealed, The mountains yield Ores that the wealth of Ophir shame, And gems enwrought of seven-hued flame.

Lo, through what years the soil hath lain At thine own time to give increase-- The greater and the lesser grain, The ripening boll, the myriad fleece! Thy creatures graze Appointed ways; League after league across the land The ceaseless herds obey thy hand.

Thou, whose high archways shine most clear Above the plenteous Western plain, Thine ancient tribes from round the sphere To breathe its quickening air are fain: And smiles the sun To see made one Their brood throughout Earth's greenest space,

Land of the new and lordlier race!

EDMUND CLARENCE STEDMAN.

Particularly noteworthy was the growing sentiment of friendship between England and America. Not so many years before, the two countries had seemed on the verge of war, but all such clouds had long since been swept away.

BRITANNIA TO COLUMBIA

What is the voice I hear On the wind of the Western Sea? Sentinel, listen from out Cape Clear, And say what the voice may be. "'Tis a proud, free people calling aloud to a people proud and free.

"And it says to them, 'Kinsmen, hail! We severed have been too long; Now let us have done with a wornout tale, The tale of an ancient wrong, And our friendship last long as love doth last, and be stronger than death is strong!'"

Answer them, sons of the selfsame race, And blood of the selfsame clan, Let us speak with each other, face to face, And answer as man to man, And loyally love and trust each other as none but free men can.

Now fling them out to the breeze, Shamrock, thistle, and rose, And the Star-Spangled Banner unfurl with these, A message to friends and foes, Wherever the sails of peace are seen and wherever the war wind blows.

A message to bond and thrall to wake, For wherever we come, we twain, The throne of the tyrant shall rock and quake And his menace be void and vain, For you are lords of a strong young land and we are lords of the main.

Yes, this is the voice on the bluff March gale, "We severed have been too long; But now we have done with a wornout tale, The tale of an ancient wrong, And our friendship shall last long as love doth last and be stronger than death is strong."

ALFRED AUSTIN.

Within the United States a similar change was taking place. The old sectional lines of North and South were being forgotten, as a new generation arose, and the proposal to return to the South her captured battle flags--a proposal which, a few years before, had met with frenzied protest from fire-alarm patriots--received general and hearty approval.

THOSE REBEL FLAGS

DISCUSSED BY "ONE OF THE YANKS"

Shall we send back the Johnnies their bunting, In token, from Blue to the Gray, That "Brothers-in-blood" and "Good Hunting" Shall be our new watchword to-day? In olden times knights held it knightly To return to brave foemen the sword; Will the Stars and the Stripes gleam less brightly If the old Rebel flags are restored?

Call it sentiment, call it misguided To fight to the death for "a rag"; Yet, trailed in the dust, derided, The true soldier still loves his flag! Does love die, and must honor perish When colors and causes are lost? Lives the soldier who ceases to cherish The blood-stains and valor they cost?

Our battle-fields, safe in the keeping Of Nature's kind, fostering care, Are blooming,--our heroes are sleeping,-- And peace broods perennial there. All over our land rings the story Of loyalty, fervent and true; "One flag," and that flag is "Old Glory," Alike for the Gray and the Blue.

Why cling to those moth-eaten banners? What glory or honor to gain While the nation is shouting hosannas, Uniting her sons to fight Spain? Time is ripe, and the harvest worth reaping, Send the Johnnies their flags f. o. b., Address to the care and safe-keeping Of that loyal "old Reb," Fitzhugh Lee!

Yes, send back the Johnnies their bunting, With greetings from Blue to the Gray; We are "Brothers-in-blood," and "Good Hunting" Is America's watchword to-day.

JOHN H. JEWETT.

On February 24, 1905, Congress directed that the flags be returned, and they now rest in the capitols of the various Southern States.

THE SONG OF THE FLAGS

ON THEIR RETURN TO THE STATES OF THE CONFEDERACY

[February 24, 1905]

We loved the wild clamor of battle, The crash of the musketry's rattle, The bugle and drum; We have drooped in the dust, long and lonely; The blades that flashed joy are rust only, The far-rolling war music dumb.

God rest the true souls in death lying, For whom overhead proudly flying We challenged the foe. The storm of the charge we have breasted, On the hearts of our dead we have rested, In the pride of a day, long ago.

Ah, surely the good of God's making Shall answer both those past awaking And life's cry of pain; But we nevermore shall be tossing On surges of battle where crossing The swift-flying death bearers rain.

Again in the wind we are streaming, Again with the war lust are dreaming The call of the shell. What gray heads look up at us sadly? Are these the stern troopers who madly Rode straight at the battery's hell?

Nay, more than the living have found us, Pale spectres of battle around us; The gray line is dressed. Ye hear not, but they who are bringing Your symbols of honor are singing The song of death's bivouac rest.

Blow forth on the south wind to greet us, O star flag! once eager to meet us When war lines were set. Go carry to far fields of glory The soul-stirring thrill of the story, Of days when in anger we met.

Ah, well that we hung in the churches In quiet, where God the heart searches, That under us met Men heard through the murmur of praying The voice of the torn banners saying, "Forgive, but ah, never forget."

S. WEIR MITCHELL.

The territories of the West were clamoring for admission to statehood, and finally, in the summer of 1906, Oklahoma and the Indian Territory were admitted as one state. Arizona and New Mexico were offered joint statehood, but the former refused to link her destinies with her sister territory.

ARIZONA

No beggar she in the mighty hall where her bay-crowned sisters wait, No empty-handed pleader for the right of a free-born state, No child, with a child's insistence, demanding a gilded toy, But a fair-browed, queenly woman, strong to create or destroy-- Wise for the need of the sons she has bred in the school where weaklings fail, Where cunning is less than manhood, and deeds, not words, avail-- With the high, unswerving purpose that measures and overcomes, And the faith in the Farthest Vision that builded her hard-won homes.

Link her, in her clean-proved fitness, in her right to stand alone-- Secure for whatever future in the strength that her past has won-- Link her, in her morning beauty, with another, however fair? And open your jealous portal and bid her enter there With shackles on wrist and ankle, and dust on her stately head, And her proud eyes dim with weeping? No! Bar your doors instead And seal them fast forever! but let her go her way-- Uncrowned if you will, but unshackled, to wait for a larger day.

Ay! Let her go bare-handed, bound with no grudging gift, Back to her own free spaces where her rock-ribbed mountains lift Their walls like a sheltering fortress--back to her house and blood. And we of her blood will go our way and reckon your judgment good. We will wait outside your sullen door till the stars you wear grow dim As the pale dawn-stars that swim and fade o'er our mighty Cañon's rim. We will lift no hand for the bays ye wear, nor covet your robes of state-- But ah! by the skies above us all, we will shame ye while we wait!

We will make ye the mold of an empire here in the land ye scorn, While ye drowse and dream in your well-housed ease that States at your nod are born. Ye have blotted your own beginnings, and taught your sons to forget That ye did not spring fat-fed and old from the powers that bear and beget. But the while ye follow your smooth-made roads to a fireside safe of fears, Shall come a voice from a land still young, to sing in your age-dulled ears The hero song of a strife as fine as your fathers' fathers knew, When they dared the rivers of unmapped wilds at the will of a bark canoe--

The song of the deed in the doing, of the work still hot from the hand; Of the yoke of man laid friendly-wise on the neck of a tameless land. While your merchandise is weighing, we will bit and bridle and rein The floods of the storm-rocked mountains and lead them down to the plain; And the foam-ribbed, dark-hued waters, tired from that mighty race, Shall lie at the feet of palm and vine and know their appointed place; And out of that subtle union, desert and mountain-flood, Shall be homes for a nation's choosing, where no home else had stood.

We will match the gold of your minting, with its mint-stamp dulled and marred By the tears and blood that have stained it and the hands that have clutched too hard, With the gold that no man has lied for--the gold no woman has made The price of her truth and honor, plying a shameless trade-- The clean, pure gold of the mountains, straight from the strong, dark earth, With no tang or taint upon it from the hour of its primal birth. The trick of the money-changer, shifting his coins as he wills, Ye may keep--no Christ was bartered for the wealth of our lavish hills.

"Yet we are a little people--too weak for the cares of state!" Let us go our way! When ye look again, ye shall find us, mayhap, too great. Cities we lack--and gutters where children snatch for bread; Numbers--and hordes of starvelings, toiling but never fed. Spare pains that would make us greater in the pattern that ye have set; We hold to the larger measure of the men that ye forget-- The men who, from trackless forests and prairies lone and far, Hewed out the land where ye sit at ease and grudge us our fair-won star.

"There yet be men, my masters," though the net that the trickster flings Lies wide on the land to its bitter shame, and his cunning parleyings Have deafened the ears of Justice, that was blind and slow of old. Yet time, the last Great Judge, is not bought, or bribed, or sold; And Time and the Race shall judge us--not a league of trafficking men, Selling the trust of the people, to barter it back again; Palming the lives of millions as a handful of easy coin, With a single heart to the narrow verge where craft and statecraft join.

SHARLOT M. HALL.

On the morning of Wednesday, April 18, 1906, an appalling calamity visited California, and especially the great city of San Francisco. At a few minutes past five o'clock a severe earthquake shock desolated the cities of the central coast region, snuffed out hundreds of lives, and destroyed millions of dollars' worth of property.

SAN FRANCISCO

[April 18, 1906]

Such darkness as when Jesus died! Then sudden dawn drave all before. Two wee brown tomtits, terrified, Flashed through my open cottage door; Then instant out and off again And left a stillness like to pain-- Such stillness, darkness, sudden dawn I never knew or looked upon!

This ardent, Occidental dawn Dashed San Francisco's streets with gold, Just gold and gold to walk upon, As he of Patmos sang of old. And still, so still, her streets, her

steeps, As when some great soul silent weeps; And oh, that gold, that gold that lay Beyond, above the tarn, brown bay!

And then a bolt, a jolt, a chill, And Mother Earth seemed as afraid; Then instant all again was still, Save that my cattle from the shade Where they had sought firm, rooted clay, Came forth loud lowing, glad and gay, Knee-deep in grasses to rejoice That all was well, with trumpet voice.

Not so yon city--darkness, dust, Then martial men in swift array, Then smoke, then flames, then great guns thrust To heaven, as if pots of clay-- Cathedral, temple, palace, tower-- An hundred wars in one wild hour! And still the smoke, the flame, the guns The piteous wail of little ones!

The mad flame climbed the costly steep, But man, defiant, climbed the flame. What battles where the torn clouds keep! What deeds of glory in God's name! What sons of giants--giants, yea-- Or beardless lad or veteran gray. Not Marathon nor Waterloo Knew men so daring, dauntless, true.

Three days, three nights, three fearful days Of death, of flame, of dynamite, Of God's house thrown a thousand ways; Blown east by day, blown west by night-- By night? There was no night. Nay, nay, The ghoulish flame lit nights that lay Crouched down between this first, last day. I say those nights were burned away!

And jealousies were burned away, And burned were city rivalries, Till all, white crescenting the bay, Were one harmonious hive of bees. Behold the bravest battle won! The City Beautiful begun: One solid San Francisco, one, The fairest sight beneath the sun.

JOAQUIN MILLER.

In San Francisco, fire followed the shock; the water-mains had been broken, and the flames were soon utterly beyond control, and raged for two days, destroying the business and principal residence portions of the city--an area of four square miles. The loss of life reached a thousand, the property loss three hundred million dollars.

SAN FRANCISCO

Who now dare longer trust thy mother hand? So like thee thou hadst not another child; The favorite flower of all thy Western sand, She looked up, Nature, in thy face and smiled, Trustful of thee, all-happy in thy care. She was thine own, not to be lured away Down joyless paths of men. Happy as fair, Held to thy heart--that was she yesterday. To-day the sea is sobbing her sweet name; She cannot answer--she that loved thee best, That clung to thee till Hell's own shock and flame Wrenched her, swept her, from thy forgetting breast. Day's darling, playmate of thy wind and sun-- Mother, what hast thou done, what hast thou done!

JOHN VANCE CHENEY.

The whole country rushed to the relief of the stricken state; the Californians met their losses bravely, and started at once to build a greater San Francisco.

TO SAN FRANCISCO

If we dreamed that we loved Her aforetime, 'twas the ghost of a dream; for I vow By the splendor of God in the highest, we never have loved Her till now.

When Love bears the trumpet of Honor, oh, highest and clearest he calls, With the light of the flaming of towers, and the sound of the rending of walls. When Love wears the purple of Sorrow, and kneels at the altar of Grief, Of the flowers that spring in his footsteps, the white flower of Service is chief. And as snow on the snow of Her bosom, as a star in the night of Her hair, We bring to our Mother such token as the time and the elements spare.

If we dreamed that we loved Her aforetime, adoring we kneel to Her now, When the golden fruit of the ages falls, swept by the wind from the bough. The beautiful dwelling is shattered, wherein, as a queen at the feast, In gems of the barbaric tropics and silks of the ultimate East, Our Mother sat throned and triumphant, with the wise and the great in their day. They were captains, and princes, and rulers; but She, She was greater than they.

We are sprung from the builders of nations; by the souls of our fathers we swear, By the depths of the deeps that surround Her, by the height of the heights she may dare, Though the Twelve league in compact against Her, though the sea gods cry out in their wrath, Though the earth gods, grown drunk of their fury, fling the hilltops abroad in Her path, Our Mother of masterful children shall sit on Her throne as of yore, With Her old robes of purple about Her, and crowned with the crowns that She wore.

She shall sit at the gates of the world, where the nations shall gather and meet, And the East and the West at Her bidding shall lie in a leash at Her feet.

S. J. ALEXANDER.

The regeneration was moral as wall as physical, for not only was the town rebuilt, but it was rescued from the corrupt ring which, for years, had kept control of the city government.

RESURGE SAN FRANCISCO

Behold her Seven Hills loom white Once more as marble-builded Rome. Her marts teem with a touch of home And music fills her halls at night; Her streets flow populous, and light Floods every happy, hopeful face; The wheel of fortune whirls apace And old-time fare and dare hold sway. Farewell the blackened, toppling wall, The bent steel gird, the sombre pall-- Farewell forever, let us pray; Farewell, forever and a day!

JOAQUIN MILLER.

On June 24, 1908, Grover Cleveland, twice President of the United States, died at his home in Princeton, N. J., at the age of seventy-one. His death called forth a remarkable tribute from men of all parties and in all walks of life--a tribute to his

stainless service of the state, to his honesty, courage, and fidelity. Lowell had called him "the most typical American since Lincoln."

GROVER CLEVELAND

[1837-1908]

Bring cypress, rosemary and rue For him who kept his rudder true; Who held to right the people's will, And for whose foes we love him still.

A man of Plutarch's marble mold, Of virtues strong and manifold, Who spurned the incense of the hour, And made the nation's weal his dower.

His sturdy, rugged sense of right Put selfish purpose out of sight; Slowly he thought, but long and well, With temper imperturbable.

Bring cypress, rosemary and rue For him who kept his rudder true; Who went at dawn to that high star Where Washington and Lincoln are.

JOEL BENTON.

One feature of the country's growth has awakened great uneasiness. Over a million emigrants have been landing every year upon her shores, and the feeling has grown that America must cease to be an asylum for the ignorance and vice of Europe.

UNGUARDED GATES

Wide open and unguarded stand our gates, Named of the four winds, North, South, East, and West; Portals that lead to an enchanted land Of cities, forests, fields of living gold, Vast prairies, lordly summits touched with snow, Majestic rivers sweeping proudly past The Arab's date-palm and the Norseman's pine-- A realm wherein are fruits of every zone, Airs of all climes, for lo! throughout the year The red rose blossoms somewhere--a rich land, A later Eden planted in the wilds, With not an inch of earth within its bound But if a slave's foot press it sets him free. Here, it is written, Toil shall have its wage, And Honor honor, and the humblest man Stand level with the highest in the law. Of such a land have men in dungeons dreamed, And with the vision brightening in their eyes Gone smiling to the fagot and the sword.

Wide open and unguarded stand our gates, And through them presses a wild motley throng-- Men from the Volga and the Tartar steppes, Featureless figures of the Hoang-Ho, Malayan, Scythian, Teuton, Kelt, and Slav, Flying the Old World's poverty and scorn; These bringing with them unknown gods and rites, Those, tiger passions, here to stretch their claws. In street and alley what strange tongues are loud, Accents of menace alien to our air, Voices that once the Tower of Babel knew!

O Liberty, white Goddess! is it well To leave the gates unguarded? On thy breast Fold Sorrow's children, soothe the hurts of fate, Lift the down-trodden, but with hands of steel Stay those who to thy sacred portals come To waste the gifts of freedom. Have a care Lest from thy brow the clustered stars be torn And trampled in the dust. For so of old The thronging Goth and Vandal trampled Rome, And where the

temples of the Cæsars stood The lean wolf unmolested made her lair.

THOMAS BAILEY ALDRICH.

The first decade of the new century has witnessed a long stride forward toward better government. State and Nation have asserted the right to regulate railroad rates, to abolish gambling, to supervise the sale of poisons and intoxicants, to protect the people from impure food, from quackery and swindling, and to break up combinations in restraint of trade.

NATIONAL SONG

America, my own! Thy spacious grandeurs rise Faming the proudest zone Pavilioned by the skies; Day's flying glory breaks Thy vales and mountains o'er, And gilds thy streams and lakes From ocean shore to shore.

Praised be thy wood and wold, Thy corn and wine and flocks, The yellow blood of gold Drained from thy cañon rocks; Thy trains that shake the land, Thy ships that plough the main, Triumphant cities grand Roaring with noise of gain.

Earth's races look to Thee: The peoples of the world Thy risen splendors see And thy wide flag unfurled; Thy sons, in peace or war, That emblem who behold, Bless every shining star, Cheer every streaming fold!

Float high, O gallant flag, O'er Carib Isles of palm, O'er bleak Alaskan crag, O'er far-off lone Guam; Where Mauna Loa pours Black thunder from the deeps; O'er Mindanao's shores, O'er Luzon's coral steeps.

Float high, and be the sign Of love and brotherhood,-- The pledge, by right divine Of Power, to do good; For aye and everywhere, On continent and wave, Armipotent to dare, Imperial to save!

WILLIAM HENRY VENABLE.

Especially significant has been the awakening of the public conscience, the growing intolerance of corruption in office, the demand for honesty in public as in private life, and the realization of the fact that the great public service corporations are accountable to the people and amenable to law.

AD PATRIAM

To deities of gauds and gold, Land of our Fathers, do not bow! But unto those beloved of old Bend thou the brow!

Austere they were of front and form; Rigid as iron in their aim; Yet in them pulsed a blood as warm And pure as flame;--

Honor, whose foster-child is Truth; Unselfishness in place and plan; Justice, with melting heart of ruth; And Faith in man.

Give these our worship; then no fears Of future foes need fright thy soul; Triumphant thou shalt mount the years Toward thy high goal!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

O LAND BELOVED

From "My Country"

O Land beloved! My Country, dear, my own! May the young heart that moved For the weak words atone; The mighty lyre not mine, nor the full breath of song! To happier sons shall these belong. Yet doth the first and lonely voice Of the dark dawn the heart rejoice, While still the loud choir sleeps upon the bough; And never greater love salutes thy brow Than his, who seeks thee now. Alien the sea and salt the foam Where'er it bears him from his home; And when he leaps to land, A lover treads the strand; Precious is every stone; No little inch of all the broad domain But he would stoop to kiss, and end his pain, Feeling thy lips make merry with his own; But oh, his trembling reed too frail To bear thee Time's All-Hail!

Faint is my heart, and ebbing with the passion of thy praise! The poets come who cannot fail; Happy are they who sing thy perfect days! Happy am I who see the long night ended. In the shadows of the age that bore me, All the hopes of mankind blending, Earth awaking, heaven descending, While the new day steadfastly Domes the blue deeps over thee! Happy am I who see the Vision splendid In the glowing of the dawn before me, All the grace of heaven blending, Man arising, Christ descending, While God's hand in secrecy Builds thy bright eternity.

GEORGE EDWARD WOODBERRY.

So America faces the future unafraid,--confident that her problems will be wisely solved, that a splendid destiny awaits her, and that "government of the people, by the people, for the people, shall not perish from the earth."

THE REPUBLIC

From "The Building of the Ship"

Thou, too, sail on, O Ship of State! Sail on, O Union, strong and great! Humanity with all its fears, With all the hopes of future years, Is hanging breathless on thy fate! We know what Master laid thy keel, What Workmen wrought thy ribs of steel, Who made each mast, and sail, and rope, What anvils rang, what hammers beat, In what a forge and what a heat Were shaped the anchors of thy hope! Fear not each sudden sound and shock, 'Tis of the wave and not the rock; 'Tis but the flapping of the sail, And not a rent made by the gale! In spite of rock and tempest's roar, In spite of false lights on the shore, Sail on, nor fear to breast the sea! Our hearts, our hopes, are all with thee, Our hearts, our hopes, our prayers, our tears, Our faith triumphant o'er our fears, Are all with thee,--are all with thee!

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW.

CHAPTER VII

THE WORLD WAR

For generations Americans had been taught by the provincially minded to glory in their "splendid isolation," but the more discerning perceived that steam and electricity were making the world smaller and smaller, and that economic causes were drawing its nations more and more closely together. They perceived, too, that the democratic theory of government to which America was consecrated had two staunch champions in western Europe, France and England, and two implacable enemies, Germany and Austria; and when, on August 1, 1914, the rulers of these two empires decreed the war which they hoped would lead to world power, many Americans felt most keenly that their country's place was by the side of France and England in their battle for human freedom.

SONNETS WRITTEN IN THE FALL OF 1914

Awake, ye nations, slumbering supine, Who round enring the European fray! Heard ye the trumpet sound? "The Day! the Day! The last that shall on England's empire shine! The Parliament that broke the Right Divine Shall see her realm of reason swept away, And lesser nations shall the sword obey-- The sword o'er all carve the great world's design!" So on the English Channel boasts the foe On whose imperial brow death's helmet nods. Look where his hosts o'er bloody Belgium go, And mix a nation's past with blazing sods! A kingdom's waste! a people's homeless woe! Man's broken Word, and violated gods!

Far fall the day when England's realm shall see The sunset of dominion! Her increase Abolishes the man-dividing seas, And frames the brotherhood on earth to be! She, in free peoples planting sovereignty, Orbs half the civil world in British peace; And though time dispossess her, and she cease, Rome-like she greatens in man's memory. Oh, many a crown shall sink in war's turmoil, And many a new republic light the sky, Fleets sweep the ocean, nations till the soil, Genius be born and generations die, Orient and Occident together toil, Ere such a mighty work man rears on high!

Hearken, the feet of the Destroyer tread The wine-press of the nations; fast the blood Pours from the side of Europe; in full flood On the Septentrional watershed The rivers of fair France are running red! England, the mother-eyrie of our brood, That on the summit of dominion stood, Shakes in the blast: heaven battles overhead! Lift up thy head, O Rheims, of ages heir That treasured up in thee their glorious sum; Upon whose brow, prophetically fair, Flamed the great morrow of the world to come; Haunt with thy beauty this volcanic air Ere yet thou close, O Flower of Christendom!

As when the shadow of the sun's eclipse Sweeps on the earth, and spreads a spectral air, As if the universe were dying there, On continent and isle the darkness dips, Unwonted gloom, and on the Atlantic slips; So in the night the Belgian cities flare Horizon-wide; the wandering people fare Along the roads, and load the fleeing ships. And westward borne that planetary sweep, Darkening o'er England and her times to be, Already steps upon the ocean-deep! Watch well, my country, that unearthly sea, Lest when thou thinkest not, and in thy sleep, Unapt for war, that

gloom enshadow thee!

GEORGE EDWARD WOODBERRY.

American opinion was especially aroused by Germany's cynical disregard of her pledge to preserve the neutrality of Belgium, and by the outrages which crimsoned every step of the invasion of that little kingdom.

ABRAHAM LINCOLN WALKS AT MIDNIGHT

[In Springfield, Illinois]

It is portentous, and a thing of state That here at midnight, in our little town, A mourning figure walks, and will not rest, Near the old court-house pacing up and down.

Or by his homestead, or in shadowed yards He lingers where his children used to play; Or through the market, on the well-worn stones He stalks until the dawn-stars burn away.

A bronzed, lank man! His suit of ancient black, A famous high top-hat and plain worn shawl Make him the quaint great figure that men love, The prairie-lawyer, master of us all.

He cannot sleep upon his hillside now. He is among us:--as in times before! And we who toss and lie awake for long Breathe deep, and start, to see him pass the door.

His head is bowed. He thinks on men and kings. Yea, when the sick world cries, how can he sleep? Too many peasants fight, they know not why, Too many homesteads in black terror weep.

The sins of all the war-lords burn his heart. He sees the dreadnaughts scouring every main. He carries on his shawl-wrapped shoulders now The bitterness, the folly and the pain.

He cannot rest until a spirit-dawn Shall come;--the shining hope of Europe free: The league of sober folk, the Workers' Earth Bringing long peace to Cornland, Alp, and Sea.

It breaks his heart that kings must murder still, That all his hours of travail here for men Seem yet in vain. And who will bring white peace That he may sleep upon his hill again?

VACHEL LINDSAY.

On sea, as well as on land, the same policy of "frightfulness" was followed, and German submarines and raiders, finding it dangerous to attack British battleships, turned their attention to unarmed merchantmen. On February 28, 1915, an American vessel, the William P. Frye, carrying wheat from Seattle to Queenstown, was sunk by a German raider in the South Atlantic.

THE "WILLIAM P. FRYE"

[February 28, 1915]

I saw her first abreast the Boston Light At anchor; she had just come in, turned head, And sent her hawsers creaking, clattering down. I was so near to where the hawse-pipes fed The cable out from her careening bow, I moved up on the swell, shut steam and lay Hove to in my old launch to look at her. She'd come in light, a-skimming up the Bay Like a white ghost with topsails bellying full; And all her noble lines from bow to stern Made music in the wind; it seemed she rode The morning air like those thin clouds that turn Into tall ships when sunrise lifts the clouds From calm sea-courses.

There, in smoke-smudged coats, Lay funnelled liners, dirty fishing craft, Blunt cargo-luggers, tugs, and ferry-boats. Oh, it was good in that black-scuttled lot To see the Frye come lording on her way Like some old queen that we had half forgot Come to her own. A little up the Bay The Fort lay green, for it was springtime then; The wind was fresh, rich with the spicy bloom Of the New England coast that tardily Escapes, late April, from an icy tomb. The State-House glittered on old Beacon Hill, Gold in the sun.... 'Twas all so fair awhile; But she was fairest--this great square-rigged ship That had blown in from some far happy isle Or from the shores of the Hesperides.

They caught her in a South Atlantic road Becalmed, and found her hold brimmed up with wheat; "Wheat's contraband," they said, and blew her hull To pieces, murdered one of our staunch fleet, Fast dwindling, of the big old sailing ships That carry trade for us on the high sea And warped out of each harbor in the States. It wasn't law, so it seems strange to me-- A big mistake. Her keel's struck bottom now And her four masts sunk fathoms, fathoms deep To Davy Jones. The dank seaweed will root On her oozed decks, and the cross-surges sweep Through the set sails; but never, never more Her crew will stand away to brace and trim, Nor sea-blown petrels meet her thrashing up To windward on the Gulf Stream's stormy rim; Never again she'll head a no'theast gale, Or like a spirit loom up, sliding dumb, And ride in safe beyond the Boston Light, To make the harbor glad because she's come.

JEANNE ROBERT FOSTER.

The crowning outrage came on May 7, 1915, when the great Cunard steamship Lusitania was torpedoed without warning off the coast of Ireland, and 1153 men, women, and children drowned. Of these, 114 were Americans.

THE WHITE SHIPS AND THE RED

[May 7, 1915]

With drooping sail and pennant That never a wind may reach, They float in sunless waters Beside a sunless beach. Their mighty masts and funnels Are white as driven snow, And with a pallid radiance Their ghostly bulwarks glow.

Here is a Spanish galleon That once with gold was gay, Here is a Roman trireme Whose hues outshone the day. But Tyrian dyes have faded, And prows that once were bright With rainbow stains wear only Death's livid, dreadful white.

White as the ice that clove her That unforgotten day, Among her pallid sisters The grim Titanic lay. And through the leagues above her She looked aghast, and said: "What is this living ship that comes Where every ship is dead?"

The ghostly vessels trembled From ruined stern to prow; What was this thing of terror That broke their vigil now? Down through the startled ocean A mighty vessel came, Not white, as all dead ships must be, But red, like living flame!

The pale green waves about her Were swiftly, strangely dyed, By the great scarlet stream that flowed From out her wounded side. And all her decks were scarlet And all her shattered crew. She sank among the white ghost ships And stained them through and through.

The grim Titanic greeted her. "And who art thou?" she said; "Why dost thou join our ghostly fleet Arrayed in living red? We are the ships of sorrow Who spend the weary night, Until the dawn of Judgment Day, Obscure and still and white."

"Nay," said the scarlet visitor, "Though I sink through the sea, A ruined thing that was a ship, I sink not as did ye. For ye met with your destiny By storm or rock or fight, So through the lagging centuries Ye wear your robes of white.

"But never crashing iceberg Nor honest shot of foe, Nor hidden reef has sent me The way that I must go. My wound that stains the waters, My blood that is like flame, Bear witness to a loathly deed, A deed without a name.

"I went not forth to battle, I carried friendly men, The children played about my decks, The women sang--and then-- And then--the sun blushed scarlet And Heaven hid its face, The world that God created Became a shameful place!

"My wrong cries out for vengeance, The blow that sent me here Was aimed in hell. My dying scream Has reached Jehovah's ear. Not all the seven oceans Shall wash away that stain; Upon a brow that wears a crown I am the brand of Cain."

When God's great voice assembles The fleet on Judgment Day, The ghosts of ruined ships will rise In sea and strait and bay. Though they have lain for ages Beneath the changeless flood, They shall be white as silver, But one--shall be like blood.

JOYCE KILMER.

No event since the sinking of the Maine in Havana Harbor had so stirred the country with rage and horror. The contention of the Germans that they were fighting for the freedom of the seas was indignantly scouted.

MARE LIBERUM

You dare to say with perjured lips, "We fight to make the ocean free"? _You_, whose black trail of butchered ships Bestrews the bed of every sea Where German submarines have wrought Their horrors! Have you never thought,-- What you call freedom, men call piracy!

Unnumbered ghosts that haunt the wave Where you have murdered, cry you down; And seamen whom you would not save Weave now in weed-grown depths a crown Of shame for your imperious head,-- A dark memorial of the dead,-- Women and children whom you sent to drown.

Nay, not till thieves are set to guard The gold, and corsairs called to keep O'er peaceful commerce watch and ward, And wolves to herd the helpless sheep, Shall men and women look to thee, Thou ruthless Old Man of the Sea, To safeguard law and freedom on the deep!

In nobler breeds we put our trust: The nations in whose sacred lore The "Ought" stands out above the "Must," And honor rules in peace and war. With these we hold in soul and heart, With these we choose our lot and part, Till liberty is safe on sea and shore.

HENRY VAN DYKE.

President Woodrow Wilson warned Germany that the United States could not stand idly by in the event of further contemptuous disregard of American rights, and Germany promised to restrict her submarine warfare; but a great portion of the country felt there was already more than sufficient cause for war, and many Americans entered the French aviation corps and Foreign Legion, or went to Canada and enlisted there, in order to take their stand at once beside the nations which were battling for human liberty.

ODE IN MEMORY OF THE AMERICAN VOLUNTEERS FALLEN FOR FRANCE

[To have been read before the statue of Lafayette and Washington in Paris, on Decoration Day, May 30, 1916]

I

Ay, it is fitting on this holiday, Commemorative of our soldier dead, When--with sweet flowers of our New England May Hiding the lichened stones by fifty years made gray-- Their graves in every town are garlanded, That pious tribute should be given too To our intrepid few Obscurely fallen here beyond the seas. Those to preserve their country's greatness died; But by the death of these Something that we can look upon with pride Has been achieved, nor wholly unreplied Can sneerers triumph in the charge they make That from a war where Freedom was at stake America withheld and, daunted, stood aside.

II

Be they remembered here with each reviving spring, Not only that in May, when life is loveliest, Around Neuville-Saint-Vaast and the disputed crest Of Vimy, they, superb, unfaltering, In that fine onslaught that no fire could halt, Parted impetuous to their first assault; But that they brought fresh hearts and springlike too To that high

mission, and 'tis meet to strew With twigs of lilac and spring's earliest rose The cenotaph of those Who in the cause that history most endears Fell in the sunny morn and flower of their young years.

III

Yet sought they neither recompense nor praise, Nor to be mentioned in another breath Than their blue-coated comrades whose great days It was their pride to share--ay, share even to the death! Nay, rather, France, to you they rendered thanks (Seeing they came for honor, not for gain), Who, opening to them your glorious ranks, Gave them that grand occasion to excel, That chance to live the life most free from stain And that rare privilege of dying well.

IV

O friends! I know not since that war began From which no people nobly stands aloof If in all moments we have given proof Of virtues that were thought American. I know not if in all things done and said All has been well and good, Or if each one of us can hold his head As proudly as he should, Or, from the pattern of those mighty dead Whose shades our country venerates to-day, If we've not somewhat fallen and somewhat gone astray. But you to whom our land's good name is dear, If there be any here Who wonder if her manhood be decreased, Relaxed its sinews and its blood less red Than that at Shiloh and Antietam shed, Be proud of these, have joy in this at least, And cry: "Now, heaven be praised That in that hour that most imperilled her, Menaced her liberty who foremost raised Europe's bright flag of freedom, some there were Who, not unmindful of the antique debt, Came back the generous path of Lafayette; And when of a most formidable foe She checked each onset, arduous to stem-- Foiled and frustrated them-- On these red fields where blow with furious blow Was countered, whether the gigantic fray Rolled by the Meuse or at the Bois Sabot, Accents of ours were in the fierce mêlée; And on that furthest rim of hallowed ground Where the forlorn, the gallant charge expires, When the slain bugler has long ceased to sound, And on the tangled wires The last wild rally staggers, crumbles, stops, Withered beneath the shrapnel's iron showers:-- Now heaven be thanked, we gave a few brave drops; Now heaven be thanked, a few brave drops were ours."

V

There, holding still, in frozen steadfastness, Their bayonets toward the beckoning frontiers, They lie--our comrades--lie among their peers, Clad in the glory of fallen warriors, Grim clusters under thorny trellises, Dry, furthest foam upon disastrous shores, Leaves that made last year beautiful, still strewn Even as they fell, unchanged, beneath the changing moon; And earth in her divine indifference Rolls on, and many paltry things and mean Prate to be heard and caper to be seen. But they are silent, calm; their eloquence Is that incomparable attitude; No human presences their witness are, But summer clouds and sunset crimson-hued, And showers and night winds and the northern star. Nay, even our salutations seem

profane, Opposed to their Elysian quietude; Our salutations coming from afar, From our ignobler plane And undistinction of our lesser parts: Hail, brothers, and farewell; you are twice blest, brave hearts. Double your glory is who perished thus, For you have died for France and vindicated us.

ALAN SEEGER.

Germany lived up to her agreement only in partial and grudging fashion, and the climax came on January 31, 1917, when the German Government announced that an unrestricted submarine warfare against all ships encountered on the seas would begin next day. President Wilson at once handed the German Ambassador his passports, and on April 2, after the sinking of three American ships without warning, appeared before Congress and asked that war be declared. After thirteen hours of debate, the Senate passed the necessary resolution; the House concurred on April 5, and the next day the President issued a proclamation declaring that "a state of war exists between the United States and the Imperial German Government."

REPUBLIC TO REPUBLIC

1776-1917

France! It is I answering. America! And it shall be remembered not only in our lips but in our hearts And shall awaken forever familiar and new as the morning That we were the first of all lands To be lovers, To run to each other with the incredible cry Of recognition. Bound by no ties of nearness or of knowledge But of the nearness of the heart, You chose me then-- And so I choose you now By the same nearness-- And the name you called me then I call you now-- O Liberty, my Love!

WITTER BYNNER.

The Entente Powers welcomed their new ally with bursting hearts, for a decisive victory, which was becoming more and more hopeless, now seemed assured.

TO THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

Brothers in blood! They who this wrong began To wreck our commonwealth, will rue the day When first they challenged freemen to the fray, And with the Briton dared the American. Now are we pledged to win the Rights of man; Labor and Justice now shall have their way, And in a League of Peace--God grant we may-- Transform the earth, not patch up the old plan.

Sure is our hope since he who led your nation Spake for mankind, and ye arose in awe Of that high call to work the world's salvation; Clearing your minds of all estranging blindness In the vision of Beauty and the Spirit's law, Freedom and Honor and sweet Loving-kindness.

ROBERT BRIDGES.

One of the first acts of the government was to seize all enemy ships in American ports--which, of course, included Hawaii, Porto Rico and the Philippines. These were

at once overhauled and put into service under American command.

THE CAPTIVE SHIPS AT MANILA

Our keels are furred with tropic weed that clogs the crawling tides And scarred with crust of salt and rust that gnaws our idle sides; And little junks they come and go, and ships they sail at dawn; And all the outbound winds that blow they call us to be gone, As yearning to the lifting seas our gaunt flotilla rides, Drifting aimless to and fro, Sport of every wind a-blow, Swinging to the ebb and flow Of lazy tropic tides.

And once we knew the clean seaways to sail them pridefully; And once we met the clean sea winds and gave them greeting free; And honest craft, they spoke us fair, who'd scorn to speak us now; And little craft, they'd not beware to cross a German bow When yet the flag of Germany had honor on the sea. And now, of all that seaward fare, What ship of any port is there But would dip her flag to a black corsair Ere she'd signal such as we!

Yet we are ribbed with Norseland steel and fleshed with Viking pine, That's fashioned of the soil which bred the hosts of Charlemagne; And clad we are with rusting pride of stays and links and plates That lay within the mountain side where Barbarossa waits-- The mighty Frederick thralled in sleep, held by the ancient sign, While yet the ravens circle wide Above that guarded mountain side, Full fed with carrion from the tide Of swinish, red rapine!

Oh, we have known the German men when German men were true, And we have borne the German flag when honor was her due; But sick we are of honest scorn from honest merchant-men-- The winds they call us to be gone down to the seas again-- Down to the seas where waves lift white and gulls they sheer in the blue, Shriven clean of our blood-bought scorn By a foeman's flag--ay, proudly borne! Cleaving out in the good red dawn-- Out again to the blue!

DOROTHY PAUL.

Every effort was bent toward getting an army into the field in the shortest possible time. General John J. Pershing was appointed to command the American Expeditionary Forces, and started for France. The National Guard was mobilized, volunteers called for, and the First Division of regulars was loaded on transports and, on June 14, headed out to sea.

THE ROAD TO FRANCE

Thank God our liberating lance Goes flaming on the way to France! To France--the trail the Gurkhas found! To France--old England's rallying ground! To France--the path the Russians strode! To France--the Anzac's glory road! To France--where our Lost Legion ran To fight and die for God and man! To France--with every race and breed That hates Oppression's brutal creed!

Ah France--how could our hearts forget The path by which came Lafayette? How could the haze of doubt hang low Upon the road of Rochambeau? At last, thank God!

At last we see There is no tribal Liberty! No beacon lighting just our shores! No Freedom guarding but our doors! The flame she kindled for our sires Burns now in Europe's battle fires! The soul that led our fathers west Turns back to free the world's oppressed!

Allies, you have not called in vain; We share your conflict and your pain. "Old Glory," through new stains and rents, Partakes of Freedom's sacraments. Into that hell his will creates We drive the foe--his lusts, his hates. Last come, we will be last to stay, Till Right has had her crowning day. Replenish, comrades, from our veins, The blood the sword of despot drains, And make our eager sacrifice Part of the freely-rendered price You pay to lift humanity-- You pay to make our brothers free! See, with what proud hearts we advance To France!

DANIEL HENDERSON.

General Pershing, with his staff, reached England early in June, and crossed to France a few days later. On the Fourth of July, a parade of American troops took place in Paris, proceeding to the Picpus cemetery, where General Pershing placed a wreath on the tomb of Lafayette. Legend has it that he said simply, "Lafayette, we are here."

PERSHING AT THE TOMB OF LAFAYETTE

[July 4, 1917]

They knew they were fighting our war. As the months grew to years Their men and their women had watched through their blood and their tears For a sign that we knew, we who could not have come to be free Without France, long ago. And at last from the threatening sea The stars of our strength on the eyes of their weariness rose, And he stood among them, the sorrow-strong hero we chose To carry our flag to the tomb of that Frenchman whose name A man of our country could once more pronounce without shame. What crown of rich words would he set for all time on this day? The past and the future were listening what he would say-- Only this, from the white-flaming heart of a passion austere, Only this--ah, but France understood! "Lafayette, we are here!"

AMELIA JOSEPHINE BURR.

An army of at least 2,000,000 men was needed at once; to secure it with the least possible disturbance of the country's economic life, Congress passed a bill providing for a selective draft of all men between twenty-one and thirty. Great training-camps were built, and by September, the training of the National Army was in full swing, while the National Guard regiments, which had already had some training, were started on their way to France.

YOUR LAD, AND MY LAD

Down toward the deep-blue water, marching to throb of drum, From city street and country lane the lines of khaki come; The rumbling guns, the sturdy tread, are full of

grim appeal, While rays of western sunshine flash back from burnished steel. With eager eyes and cheeks aflame the serried ranks advance; And your dear lad, and my dear lad, are on their way to France.

A sob clings choking in the throat, as file on file sweep by, Between those cheering multitudes, to where the great ships lie; The batteries halt, the columns wheel, to clear-toned bugle-call, With shoulders squared and faces front they stand a khaki wall. Tears shine on every watcher's cheek, love speaks in every glance; For your dear lad, and my dear lad, are on their way to France.

Before them, through a mist of years, in soldier buff or blue, Brave comrades from a thousand fields watch now in proud review; The same old Flag, the same old Faith--the Freedom of the World-- Spells Duty in those flapping folds above long ranks unfurled. Strong are the hearts which bear along Democracy's advance, As your dear lad, and my dear lad, go on their way to France.

The word rings out; a million feet tramp forward on the road, Along that path of sacrifice o'er which their fathers strode. With eager eyes and cheeks aflame, with cheers on smiling lips, These fighting men of '17 move onward to their ships. Nor even love may hold them back, or halt that stern advance, As your dear lad, and my dear lad, go on their way to France.

RANDALL PARRISH.

Germany had boasted that we could never get an army to Europe past her submarines, but so efficient was the system of protection worked out by the navy, that only one loaded transport was sunk. Early in February, 1918, the Tuscania, carrying 2179 American soldiers, was torpedoed off the north coast of Ireland. British destroyers rescued all but about two hundred before the ship sank. Nearly all the bodies were washed ashore and were tenderly buried.

A CALL TO ARMS

[February 5, 1918]

It is I, America, calling! Above the sound of rivers falling, Above the whir of the wheels and the chime of bells in the steeple --Wheels, rolling gold into the palms of the people-- Bells ringing silverly clear and slow To church-going, leisurely steps on pavements below. Above all familiar sounds of the life of a nation I shout to you a name. And the flame of that name is sped Like fire into hearts where blood runs red-- The hearts of the land burn hot to the land's salvation As I call across the long miles, as I, America, call to my nation _Tuscania! Tuscania!_ Americans, remember the _Tuscania_!

Shall we not remember how they died In their young courage and loyalty and pride, Our boys--bright-eyed, clean lads of America's breed, Hearts of gold, limbs of steel, flower of the nation indeed? How they tossed their years to be Into icy waters of a winter sea That we whom they loved--that the world which they loved should be free? Ready, ungrudging, they died, each one thinking, likely, as the moment was come Of the dear, starry flag, worth dying for, and then of dear faces at home; Going

down in good order, with a song on their lips of the land of the free and the brave Till each young, deep voice stopped--under the rush of a wave. Was it like that? And shall their memory ever grow pale? Not ever, till the stars in the flag of America fail. It is I, America, who swear it, calling Over the sound of that deep ocean's falling, _Tuscania! Tuscania!_ Arm, arm, Americans! Remember the _Tuscania_!

Very peacefully they are sleeping In friendly earth, unmindful of a nation's weeping, And the kindly, strange folk that honored the long, full graves, we know; And the mothers know that their boys are safe, now, from the hurts of a savage foe; It is for us who are left to make sure and plain That these dead, our precious dead, shall not have died in vain; So that I, America, young and strong and not afraid, I set my face across that sea which swallowed the bodies of the sons I made, I set my eyes on the still faces of boys washed up on a distant shore And I call with a shout to my own to end this horror forevermore! In the boys' names I call a name, And the nation leaps to fire in its flame And my sons and my daughters crowd, eager to end the shame-- It is I, America, calling, Hoarse with the roar of that ocean falling, _Tuscania! Tuscania!_ Arm, arm, Americans! And remember, remember, the _Tuscania_!

MARY RAYMOND SHIPMAN ANDREWS.

Meanwhile, in France, the Americans were already taking part in the war. About the middle of October, the First division had been sent into a heretofore quiet sector of the trenches beyond Einville, in Lorraine. On October 25, we took our first prisoner; a few days later, we had our first wounded; and finally before dawn on the morning of November 3, came a swift German raid in which three Americans were killed, five wounded and eleven taken prisoner. The three, whose names were Corporal James D. Gresham, Private Thomas F. Enright, and Private Merle D. Hay, were buried at Bathlemont next day, with touching ceremonies.

THE FIRST THREE

[November 3, 1917]

"Somewhere in France," upon a brown hillside, They lie, the first of our brave soldiers slain; Above them flowers, now beaten by the rain, Yet emblematic of the youths who died In their fresh promise. They who, valiant-eyed, Met death unfaltering have not fallen in vain; Remembrance hallows those who thus attain The final goal; their names are glorified. Read then the roster!--Gresham! Enright! Hay!-- No bugle call shall rouse them when the flower Of morning breaks above the hills and dells, For they have grown immortal in an hour, And we who grieve and cherish them would lay Upon their hillside graves our immortelles!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

TO AMERICA, ON HER FIRST SONS FALLEN IN THE GREAT WAR

Now you are one with us, you know our tears, Those tears of pride and pain so fast to flow; You too have sipped the first strange draught of woe; You too have tasted of our hopes and fears; Sister across the ocean, stretch your hand, Must we not love you more, who learn to understand?

There are new graves in France, new quiet graves; The first-fruit of a Nation great and free, Full of rich fire of life and chivalry. Lie quietly, though tide of battle laves Above them; sister, sister, see our tears, We mourn with you, who know so well the bitter years.

Now do you watch with us; your pain of loss Lit by a wondrous glow of love and power That flowers, star-like at the darkest hour Lighting the eternal message of the Cross; They gain their life who lose it, earth shall rise Anew and cleansed, because of life's great sacrifice.

And that great band of souls your dead have met, Who saved the world in centuries past and gone, Shall find new comrades in their valiant throng; O, Nation's heart that cannot e'er forget, Is not death but the door to life begun To those who hear far Heaven cry, "Well done!"

E. M. WALKER.

Training proceeded rapidly, and the sectors where its final stages took place became more and more lively as the Americans were gradually given a freer and freer hand.

ROUGE BOUQUET

[March 7, 1918]

In a wood they call the Rouge Bouquet There is a new-made grave to-day, Built by never a spade nor pick Yet covered with earth ten metres thick. There lie many fighting men, Dead in their youthful prime, Never to laugh nor love again Nor taste the Summertime. For Death came flying through the air And stopped his flight at the dugout stair. Touched his prey and left them there, Clay to clay. He hid their bodies stealthily In the soil of the land they fought to free And fled away. Now over the grave abrupt and clear Three volleys ring; And perhaps their brave young spirits hear The bugle sing: "Go to sleep! Go to sleep! Slumber well where the shell screamed and fell Let your rifles rest on the muddy floor, You will not need them any more. Danger's past; Now at last, Go to sleep!"

There is on earth no worthier grave To hold the bodies of the brave Than this place of pain and pride Where they nobly fought and nobly died. Never fear but in the skies Saints and angels stand Smiling with their holy eyes On this new-come band. St. Michael's sword darts through the air And touches the aureole on his hair As he sees them stand saluting there, His stalwart sons: And Patrick, Brigid, Columkill Rejoice that in veins of warriors still The Gael's blood runs. And up to Heaven's doorway floats, From the wood called Rouge Bouquet, A delicate cloud of bugle notes That softly say: "Farewell! Farewell! Comrades true, born anew, peace to you! Your souls shall be where the heroes are And your memory shine like the morning-star. Brave

and dear, Shield us here. Farewell!"

JOYCE KILMER.

The great summons came in the spring of 1918, for on March 21 the Germans began a series of terrific attacks which they believed would end the war. On March 31 an official note announced that "the Star-Spangled Banner will float beside the French and English flags in the plains of Picardy." On April 17 the order came for the First Division to move into the battle area.

MARCHING SONG

[April 17, 1918]

When Pershing's men go marching into Picardy. Marching, marching into Picardy-- With their steel aslant in the sunlight and their great gray hawks a-wing And their wagons rumbling after them like thunder in the Spring--

Tramp, tramp, tramp, tramp Till the earth is shaken-- Tramp, tramp, tramp, tramp Till the dead towns waken! And flowers fall and shouts arise from Chaumont to the sea-- When Pershing's men go marching, marching into Picardy.

Women of France, do you see them pass to the battle in the North? And do you stand in the doorways now as when your own went forth? Then smile to them and call to them, and mark how brave they fare Upon the road to Picardy that only youth may dare!

Tramp, tramp, tramp, tramp, Foot and horse and caisson-- Tramp, tramp, tramp, tramp, Such is Freedom's passion-- And oh, take heart, ye weary souls that stand along the Lys, For the New World is marching, marching into Picardy!

April's sun is in the sky and April's in the grass-- And I doubt not that Pershing's men are singing as they pass-- For they are very young men, and brave men, and free, And they know why they are marching, marching into Picardy.

Tramp, tramp, tramp, tramp, Rank and file together-- Tramp, tramp, tramp, tramp, Through the April weather. And never Spring has thrust such blades against the light of dawn As yonder waving stalks of steel that move so shining on!

I have seen the wooden crosses at Ypres and Verdun, I have marked the graves of such as lie where the Marne waters run, And I know their dust is stirring by hill and vale and lea, And their souls shall be our captains who march to Picardy.

Tramp, tramp, tramp, tramp, Hope shall fail us never-- Tramp, tramp, tramp, tramp, Forward, and forever! And God is in His judgment seat, and Christ is on His tree-- And Pershing's men are marching, marching into Picardy.

DANA BURNET.

On June 2, the Second and Third Divisions met and checked the enemy at Château-Thierry. The Marne offensive was followed sharply by another on the part of the British, with whom our Twenty-Seventh Division was fighting, and on August 8

the Twenty-Seventh broke through the famous Hindenburg line.

OUR MODEST DOUGHBOYS

[August 8, 1918]

Said the Captain: "There was wire A mile deep in No Man's Land, And the concentrated fire Was all mortal nerve could stand; But these huskies craved the chance To go out and leave their bones!" _"The climate's quite some damp in France," Said Private Thomas Jones._

Said the Major: "What is more, At the point where we attacked, Tough old veterans loudly swore Hindy's line could not be cracked. But the 27th said, 'Hindenburg! That guy's a myth!'" _"I slept last night in a reg'lar bed," Said Private Johnny Smith._

Said the Colonel: "They had placed Pillboxes on the crests. I can safely say we faced Maybe thousands of those nests. But our doughboys took one height Seven times in that hell's hail." _"And were the cooties thick? Good night!" Said Private William Dale._

Said the General: "We were told Anything we'd start they'd stop-- That the Boche would knock us cold When we slid across the top. But the 7th with a yell Made the Prussian Guards back down." _"You oughta lamped the smile on Nell!" Said Private Henry Brown._

Said the Sergeant: "Every shell Seemed to whine, 'Old scout, you're dead!' And I thought I'd gone to hell In a blizzard of hot lead. But each bloomin' gunner stuck At his post by his machine." _"Our orders said to hold it, Buck!" Said Private Peter Green._

Said the Chaplain: "Talk of pep! They were there! And, may I add, When we clambered up the step That last fight, we only had Eighty men of Company D-- Every one, I'll say, a man!" _"And am I glad I'm home? Ah, oui!" Said Private Mike McCann._

CHARLTON ANDREWS.

Early in September eight American divisions were concentrated on the Lorraine front and organized into the First American Army. On September 12 an assault in force was made against the St. Mihiel salient, which had threatened France for four years. Twenty-four hours later the salient was ours, together with 15,000 prisoners.

SEICHEPREY

[September 12, 1918]

A handful came to Seicheprey When winter woods were bare, When ice was in the trenches And snow was in the air. The foe looked down on Seicheprey And laughed to see them there.

The months crept by at Seicheprey The growing handful stayed, With growling guns at midnight, At dawn, the lightning raid, And learned, in Seicheprey trenches,

How war's red game is played.

September came to Seicheprey; A slow-wrought host arose And rolled across the trenches And whelmed its sneering foes, And left to shattered Seicheprey Unending, sweet repose.

Two weeks later we began our greatest battle in an attack on the strong German positions running from the Meuse westward through the Argonne forest. It was in this battle that perhaps the most remarkable single exploit of the war was performed, when Corporal Alvin C. York, a young giant from the mountains of Tennessee, who had been sent forward with a small squad to clean up some machine-gun nests, killed single-handed twenty-eight Germans, and came back with 132 prisoners.

A BALLAD OF REDHEAD'S DAY

[October 8, 1918]

Talk of the Greeks at Thermopylæ! They fought like mad till the last was dead; But Alvin C. York, of Tennessee, Stayed cool to the end though his hair was red, Stayed mountain cool, yet blazed that gray October the Eighth as Redhead's Day.

With rifle and pistol and redhead nerve He captured one hundred and thirty-two; A battalion against him, he did not swerve From the Titans' task they were sent to do--Fourteen men under Sergeant Early And York, the blacksmith, big and burly.

Sixteen only, but fighters all, They dared the brood of a devil's nest, And three of those that did not fall Were wounded and out of the scrap; the rest Were guarding a bunch of Boche they'd caught, When both were trapped by a fresh onslaught.

Excepting York, who smiled "Amen," And, spotting the nests of spitting guns, Potted some twenty birds, and then Did with his pistol for eight more Huns Who thought they could crush a Yankee alive In each red pound of two hundred and five.

That was enough for kill-babe Fritz: Ninety in all threw up their hands, Suddenly tender as lamb at the Ritz, Milder than sheep to a York's commands; And back to his line he drove the herd, Gathering more on the way--Absurd!

Absurd, but true--ay, gospel fact; For here was a man with a level head, Who, scorning to fail for the help he lacked, Helped himself till he won instead; An elder was he in the Church of Christ, Immortal at thirty; his faith sufficed.

RICHARD BUTLER GLAENZER.

While our Argonne offensive was in progress, the French and English had been striking mighty blows at other portions of the German line, and everywhere the enemy was in retreat. Realizing that their power was broken and to save themselves from imminent disaster, the Germans asked for an armistice. It was offered on terms so drastic that many thought the Germans would not sign, but they did, and at eleven o'clock on the morning of November 11, 1918, firing ceased all along the front.

VICTORY BELLS

I heard the bells across the trees, I heard them ride the plunging breeze Above the roofs from tower and spire, And they were leaping like a fire, And they were shining like a stream With sun to make its music gleam. Deep tones as though the thunder tolled, Cool voices thin as tinkling gold, They shook the spangled autumn down From out the tree-tops of the town; They left great furrows in the air And made a clangor everywhere As of metallic wings. They flew Aloft in spirals to the blue Tall tent of heaven and disappeared. And others, swift as though they feared The people might not heed their cry Went shouting VICTORY up the sky. They did not say that war is done, Only that glory has begun Like sunrise, and the coming day Will burn the clouds of war away. There will be time for dreams again, And home-coming for weary men.

GRACE HAZARD CONKLING.

America had lost nearly fifty thousand men killed in battle, and immediately after the armistice, work was begun gathering together their bodies, scattered over many battlefields, and re-interring them in beautiful cemeteries, where their graves would be perpetually cared for and honored.

EPICEDIUM

IN MEMORY OF AMERICA'S DEAD IN THE GREAT WAR

No more for them shall Evening's rose unclose, Nor Dawn's emblazoned panoplies be spread; Alike, the Rain's warm kiss, and stabbing snows, Unminded, fall upon each hallowed head. But the Bugles as they leap and wildly sing, Rejoice, ... remembering.

The guns' mad music their young years have known-- War's lullabies that moaned on Flanders Plain; To-night the wind walks on them, still as stone, Where they lie huddled close as riven grain. But the Drums, reverberating, proudly roll-- They love a Soldier's soul!

With arms outflung, and eyes that laughed at Death, They drank the wine of sacrifice and loss; For them a life-time spanned a burning breath, And Truth they visioned, clean of earthly dross. But the Fifes--can ye not hear their lusty shriek? They know, and now they speak!

The lazy drift of cloud, the noon-day hum Of vagrant bees, the lark's untrammeled song Shall gladden them no more, who now lie dumb In Death's strange sleep, yet once were swift and strong. But the Bells that to all living listeners peal, With joy their deeds reveal!

They have given their lives, with bodies bruised and broken, Upon their Country's altar they have bled; They have left, as priceless heritage, a token That Honor lives forever with the dead. And the Bugles, as their rich notes rise and fall-- They answer, knowing all.

J. CORSON MILLER.

THE DEAD

Think you the dead are lonely in that place? They are companioned by the leaves and grass, By many a beautiful and vanished face, By all the strange and lovely things that pass. Sunsets and dawnings and the starry vast, The swinging moon, the tracery of trees-- These they shall know more perfectly at last, They shall be intimate with such as these. 'Tis only for the living Beauty dies, Fades and drifts from us with too brief a grace, Beyond the changing tapestry of skies Where dwells her perfect and immortal face. For us the passage brief;--the happy dead Are ever by great beauty visited.

DAVID MORTON.

THE UNRETURNING

For us, the dead, though young, For us, who fought and bled, Let a last song be sung, And a last word be said!

Dreams, hopes, and high desires, That leaven and uplift, On sacrificial fires We offered as a gift.

We gave, and gave our all, In gladness, though in pain; Let not a whisper fall That we have died in vain!

CLINTON SCOLLARD.

To America's soldier dead was added, on January 6, 1919, a valiant and righteous warrior, Theodore Roosevelt, whose sudden death at the age of sixty-one was a shock to the whole country.

THE STAR

[January 6, 1919]

Great soul, to all brave souls akin, High bearer of the torch of truth, Have you not gone to marshal in Those eager hosts of youth?

Flung outward by the battle's tide, They met in regions dim and far; And you--in whom youth never died-- Shall lead them, as a star!

MARION COUTHOUY SMITH.

Arrangements for sending home the American army were begun immediately after the armistice, and within a few months a steady stream of khaki-clad troops was flowing through the port of Brest, bound for America.

BREST LEFT BEHIND

The sun strikes gold the dirty street, The band blares, the drums insist, And brown legs twinkle and muscles twist-- Pound!--Pound!--the rhythmic feet. The laughing street-boys shout, And a couple of hags come out To grin and bob and clap. Stiff rusty

black their dresses, And crispy white their Breton cap, Prim on white, smooth tresses.

Wait!... Wait!... While dun clouds droop Over the sunlit docks, Over the wet gray rocks And mast of steamer and sloop, And the old squat towers, Damp gray and mossy brown, Where lovely Ann looked down And dreamed rich dreams through long luxurious hours.

Sudden and swift, it rains! Familiar, fogging, gray; It blots the sky away And cuts the face with biting little pains. We grunt and poke shoes free of muddy cakes, Watching them messing out Upon the dock in thick brown lakes-- "No more French mud!" the sergeant cries, And someone swears, and someone sighs, And the neat squads swing about.

Silent the looming hulk above-- No camouflage this time-- She's white and tan and black! Hurry, bend, climb, Push forward, stagger back! How clean the wide deck seems, The bunks, how trim; And, oh, the musty smell of ships! Faces are set and grim, Thinking of months, this hope was pain; And eyes are full of dreams, And gay little tunes come springing to the lips-- Home, home, again, again!

She's moving now, Across the prow The dusk-soft harbor bursts Into a shivering bloom of light From warehouse, warship, transport, tramp, And countless little bobbing masts Each flouts the night With eager boastful lamp-- Bright now, now dimmer, dimmer, Fewer and fewer glimmer. Only the lights that mark the passing shore, Lofty and lonely star the gray-- Then are no more. We are alone with dusk and creamy spray.

The captain coughs, remembering the rain. The major coughs remembering the mud. Some shudder at the horror of dark blood, Or wine-wet kisses, lewd. Some sigh, remembering new loves and farewell pain. Some smile, remembering old loves to be renewed. Silent, we stare across the deepening night. France vanishing!--Swift, swift, the curling waves-- Fights and despair, And faces fair; Proud heads held high For Victory; And flags above friends' graves.

The group buzzes, rustles, hums, Then stiffens as the colonel comes, A burly figure in the mellow light, With haughty, kingly ways. He does not scan the night, Nor hissing spray that flies, But his cold old glance plays Along the level of our eyes.

"I don't see very many tears," he says.

JOHN CHIPMAN FARRAR.

America went wild in welcoming them, as they arrived division after division. There were parades and celebrations; but with surprising swiftness the divisions were demobilized and the men returned to civil life.

TO THE RETURNING BRAVE

Victorious knights without reproach or fear-- As close as man is ever to the stars!-- Our welcome met you on the ocean drear In loud, free winds and sunset's golden bars. Here, at our bannered gate Love, honor, laurels wait. Though you be humble, we are proud, and, in your stead, elate.

Fame shall not tire to tell, no sordid stain Lies on your purpose, on your record none. No broken word, no violated fane, No winning one could wish had ne'er been won. You were our message sent To the torn Continent: That with its hope and faith henceforth our faith and hope are blent.

You of our new, our homespun chivalry, Here is your welcome--in all women's eyes, The envious handclasp, romping children's glee, Music, and color, and glad tears that rise. Here every voice of Peace Shall bruit our joy, nor cease To vie with shotless guns to shout your blameless victories.

But, though you are a part of all men's pride, And from your fortitude new nations date, Oh, lay not yet your sacred steel aside, But save it for the still-imperiled State. You who have bound a girth Of new hope round the Earth, Should its firm bond be loosened here, what were your struggle worth?

A redder peril dogs the path of war; With fire and poison wanton children play; And fickle crowds toward new pretenders pour Who summon demons they can never lay. Already we can hear, Importunately near, The snarling of the savage crew, half fury and half jeer.

Then hang not up your arms till you have taught The ungrateful guests about our hearth and board That in your swift encounter has been wrought A keener edge to our reluctant sword. You who know well the price Of the great sacrifice, Your courage saved us once; pray Heaven, it need not save us twice.

And those who come not back, who mutely lie By Marne or Meuse or tangled Argonne wood: _Were it to lose the gain_, (let them reply!) _Would we recall their spirits if we could?_ Open your ranks and save Their places with the brave, That Liberty may greet you all, her shields of land and wave.

ROBERT UNDERWOOD JOHNSON.

Amid all the celebrations, there was always the consciousness of those who would not return, in body, at least, but whose spirits would never be severed from America's.

THE RETURN

Golden through the golden morning, Who is this that comes With the pride of banners lifted, With the roll of drums?

With the self-same triumph shining In the ardent glance, That divine, bright fate defiance That you bore to France.

You! But o'er your grave in Flanders Blow the winter gales; Still for sorrow of your going All life's laughter fails.

Borne on flutes of dawn the answer: "O'er the foam's white track, God's work done, so to our homeland Comes her hosting back.

"Come the dead men with the live men From the marshes far, From the mounds in no man's valley, Lit by cross nor star.

"Come to blend with hers the essence Of their strength and pride, All the radiance of the dreaming For whose truth they died."

So the dead men with the live men Pass, an hosting fair, And the stone is rolled forever From the soul's despair.

ELEANOR ROGERS COX.

One distinguished visitor was welcomed by the American people as they welcomed their own sons--King Albert, of Belgium, who made an extensive tour of the United States in the summer of 1919.

KING OF THE BELGIANS

How spoke the King, in his crucial hour victorious? The words of a high decision, few, but glorious.

What was the choice he made, that all fear surmounted? The choice of a man--that leaves not the soul uncounted.

What did the King, in bitter defeat and sorrow? He stood as a god, foreseeing a great to-morrow.

How fought the King? In silent and stern persistence; Patience and power within, and hope in the distance.

What was the gift he won, in the fire that tried him? The deathless love of his own, who fought beside him.

What is his crown, the noblest of all for wearing? The homage of hearts that beat for his splendid bearing.

Robe and sceptre and crown--what are these for holding? Vesture and sign for his spirit's royal moulding.

What speaks he now, in the hour of faith victorious? Words of a quiet gladness, few, but glorious.

Then, as we greet him, what shall be ours to render? Silence that shines, and speech that is proud and tender!

MARION COUTHOUY SMITH.

Meanwhile, at Paris, the Peace Conference, under the leadership of President Woodrow Wilson, who had broken all precedents by going to Europe, was struggling with the peace treaty. For America, the great conflict had been a war to end war, and the President insisted that provisions to establish a League of Nations should be made an integral part of the treaty.

THE FAMILY OF NATIONS

With that pathetic impudence of youth, America, half-formed, gigantic and uncouth, Stretching great limbs, in something of surprise Beholds new meaning written on the

skies.

Out of the granite, Time has reared a State Haughty and fearless, awkward, passionate-- For all his dreaming and his reckless boast, Betrayed by those whom he has trusted most.

Years of stern peril knit that welded frame, Banded those arms and set that heart aflame, Burdened those loins with vigor of increase, Gave to his hand a weapon forged to peace.

He cannot turn the discovering hour aside, He feels the stir that will not be denied, And in the family the Nations plan Forgets the boy and finds himself a man!

WILLARD WATTLES.

After months of struggle and negotiation, this purpose was achieved, and on July 10, 1919, the President laid the treaty before the Senate for confirmation. Strong opposition to the League of Nations developed immediately, on the ground that it interfered with America's independence and freedom of action, and various "reservations" were proposed, limiting America's participation. These the President refused to accept, and finally, after eight months of bitter debate, largely partisan and personal, the Senate rejected the treaty March 19, 1920.

THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

Lo, Joseph dreams his dream again, And Joan leads her armies in the night, And somewhere near, the Master from His cross Lifts his hurt hands and heals the world again! For from the great red welter of the world, Out from the tides of its red suffering Comes the slow sunrise of the ancient dream-- Is flung the glory of its bright imagining. See how it breaks in beauty on the world, Shivers and shudders on its trembling way-- Shivers and waits and trembles to be born!

America, young daughter of the gods, swing out, Strong in the beauty of virginity, Fearless in thine unquestioned leadership, And hold the taper to the nations' torch, And light the hearthfires of the halls of home. Thine must it be to break an unpathed way, To lift the torch for world's in-brothering-- To bring to birth this child of all the earth, Formed of the marriage of all nations; Else shall we go, the head upon the breast, A Cain without a country, a Judas at the board!

MARY SIEGRIST.

BEYOND WARS

FOR THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS

Then will a quiet gather round the door, And settle on those evening fields again, Where women watch the slow, home-coming men Across brown acres hoofed and hurt no more, The sound of children's feet be on the floor, When lamps are lit, and stillness deeper falls, Unbroken, save where cattle in their stalls Keep munching

patiently upon their store.

Only a scar beside the pasture gate, A torn and naked tree upon the hill, What times remembered, will remind them still Of long disastrous days they knew of late; Till these, too, yield for sweet, accustomed things,-- And a man ploughs, a woman sews and sings.

DAVID MORTON.

It was a revival of the old idea of "splendid isolation" on the part of men whose gaze was backward and who had learned nothing from the war. To all others, however, it is evident that America must take her place with the other peoples of the earth at the council-table of the League of Nations, and do her part toward the establishment of peace and liberty throughout the world.

"WHEN THERE IS PEACE"

"When there is Peace, our land no more Will be the land we knew of yore." Thus do our facile seers foretell The truth that none can buy or sell And e'en the wisest must ignore.

When we have bled at every pore, Shall we still strive for gear and store? Will it be heaven? Will it be hell? When there is Peace?

This let us pray for, this implore: That, all base dreams thrust out at door, We may in loftier aims excel And, like men waking from a spell, Grow stronger, nobler, than before, When there is Peace.

AUSTIN DOBSON.

AFTER THE WAR

After the war--I hear men ask--what then? As though this rock-ribbed world, sculptured with fire, And bastioned deep in the ethereal plan, Can never be its morning self again Because of this brief madness, man with man; As though the laughing elements should tire, The very seasons in their order reel; As though indeed yon ghostly golden wheel Of stars should cease from turning, or the moon Befriend the night no more, or the wild rose Forget the world, and June be no more June.

How many wars and long-forgotten woes Unnumbered, nameless, made a like despair In hearts long stilled; how many suns have set On burning cities blackening the air,-- Yet dawn came dreaming back, her lashes wet With dew, and daisies in her innocent hair. Nor shall, for this, the soul's ascension pause, Nor the sure evolution of the laws That out of foulness lift the flower to sun, And out of fury forge the evening star.

Deem not Love's building of the world undone-- Far Love's beginning was, her end is far; By paths of fire and blood her feet must climb, Seeking a loveliness she scarcely knows, Whose meaning is beyond the reach of Time.

RICHARD LE GALLIENNE.

NOTES AND INDEXES

NOTES

Page 3. THE STORY OF VINLAND. The discovery of America by the Norsemen is as well authenticated as any other fact of tenth-century history, and much better authenticated than most. There can be no doubt of the substantial accuracy of the Icelandic chronicle, and Mr. Lanier has followed it very closely.

Page 3. _Stout Are Marson._ Are Marsson. The stories concerning him and "Huitramannaland" are believed to be purely fanciful, an embroidery of fiction upon the historical background of the chronicles. There is no evidence that the Norsemen ever got farther south than Cape Cod, or, at most, Point Judith.

Page 7. _Mid-ships with iron keel._ The Norse boats had neither "iron keel" nor "ribs of steel." Keel and ribs were made of oak, and no evidence has been found of metallic sheathing. The size of these ships is usually underestimated. They were larger, stronger, and more seaworthy than those of Columbus. There is one in the museum at Christiania seventy-eight feet long, seventeen feet beam, and nearly six feet in depth. She carried a crew of at least thirty-five men. Henry Hudson's Half Moon carried a crew of only sixteen.

Page 7. _The lofty tower._ The old stone tower at Newport, around whose origin controversy raged for many years, but which is now believed to have been built by Benedict Arnold, governor of Newport, about 1676, for a windmill. The reader is referred to Palfrey's "History of New England," i, 57; Fiske's "Discovery of America," i, 214; and Drake's "New England Legends and Folk-lore," 393.

Page 7. _Beyond the limits he had vainly set._ The Pillars of Hercules, Gibraltar and Cape Serra.

Page 9. _St. Stephen's cloistered hall._ The conference was held at the Dominican convent of St. Stephen, at Salamanca.

Page 10. _Cordova's sage._ Seneca.

Page 12. _The far-seeing Marchioness._ Beatriz de Bobadilla, Marchioness of Moya, the bosom friend of the Queen, and a devoted admirer of Columbus. She happened to be with the Queen when Santangel rushed in demanding audience and told of Columbus's departure, and added her eloquence to his.

Page 14. _Pedro Gutierrez._ Pilot of the Santa Maria.

Page 14. _Sanchez of Segovia._ Roderigo Sanchez, inspector-general of the armament.

Page 16. _A Castilla y á Leon._ "To Castile and Leon Columbus gave a new world." This was the motto annexed to the coat of arms granted to Columbus.

Page 21. _The shining Cèpango._ Cipango was the name given by Marco Polo to an island east of Asia, supposed to be the modern Japan. It was Cipango which Columbus and all the voyagers for half a century after him were seeking.

Page 25. _Old Las Casas._ Bartolomé de las Casas (1474-1566), a Spanish Dominican, celebrated as a defender of the Indians against their Spanish conquerors.

Page 30. _Moscoso._ Luis de Moscoso, who took charge of the expedition after De Soto's death.

Page 30. _Six thousand of our foemen._ The native loss was greatly exaggerated. It probably did not exceed five hundred.

Page 30. _And eighty-two of Spain._ The Spanish loss was 170. The scene of the battle is supposed to have been what is now known as Choctaw Bluff, in Clarke County, Alabama.

Page 31. _The cities of the Zuñi._ Coronado's expedition reached Cibola early in July, 1540, and a few days later carried it by storm and subdued the whole district, but found no treasure. A detailed account of the expedition will be found in Winsor's "Narrative and Critical History of America," ii, 473-503.

Page 34. _Good Bernard._ Bernard of Cluny, a French Benedictine monk of the twelfth century, author of "De Contemptu Mundi," popularly known through Neale's translation, "Jerusalem the Golden."

Page 34. _Do not fear._ The last words Gilbert is known to have spoken were the famous "We are as near to heaven by sea as by land." These are said to have been heard on board the companion ship, the Hind, a short time before the Squirrel disappeared.

Page 38. POCAHONTAS. This imaginative tale, from which all other narratives of the event are derived, appears in the second chapter of the third book of Smith's "The Generall Historie of Virginia, New England, and the Summer Isles" (London, 1622), and is as follows:--

"At last they brought him to _Meronoco moco_, where was Powhatan, their emperor. Here more than two hundred of these grim courtiers stood wondering at him as he had been a monster, till Powhatan and his train had put themselves in their greatest braveries. Before a fire, upon a seat like a bedstead, he sat covered with a great robe, made of Rarowcun skins, and all the tails hanging by. On either hand did sit a young wench of 16 or 18 years, and along on each side of the house, two rows of men, and behind them as many women, with all their heads and shoulders painted red; many of their heads bedecked with the white down of birds; but every one with something: and a great chain of white beads about their necks. At his entrance before the King, all the people gave a great shout. The queen of _Appamatuck_ was appointed to bring him water to wash his hands, and another brought him a bunch of feathers, instead of a towel to dry them: having feasted him after their best barbarous manner they could, a long consultation was held, but the conclusion was, two great stones were brought before Powhatan; then as many as could laid hand on him, dragged him to them, and thereon laid his head, and being ready with their clubs to beat out his brains, Pocahontas, the king's dearest daughter, when no entreaty could prevail, got his head in her arms, and laid her own upon his to save him from death: whereat the emperor was contented he should live to make him hatchets, and her

bells, beads, and copper: for they thought him as well of all occupations as themselves. For the king himself will make his own robes, shoes, bows, arrows, pots; plant, hunt, or do anything so well as the rest.

"They say he bore a pleasant show, But sure his heart was sad, For who can pleasant be, and rest, That lives in fear and dread: And having life suspected, doth It still suspected lead."

In spite of which, it is generally agreed among historians that no such incident ever occurred. One can only remark that Smith seems to have had a genius for imaginative detail worthy of Defoe.

Page 40. _Richard Rich_ was a soldier and adventurer who accompanied Captain Newport in the Sea Venture, and experienced all the dangers and hardships of that remarkable voyage. He finally got back to England in 1610, and on the first day of October, published this poem, his object being, as he says in a brief and broadly humorous preface, to "spread the truth" about the new colony, whose attractions had so impressed him that he was resolved to return thither with Captain Newport in the following year. He speaks of another book of his soon to be issued, also devoted to a description of the colony, but no copy of it has ever been discovered, nor is anything known concerning Rich's subsequent adventures. A copy of his "Newes from Virginia" was found in 1864 in Lord Charlemont's collection, and is now in the Huth Library.

Page 40. _Gates._ Sir Thomas Gates, lieutenant-general of the new company.

Page 40. _Newport._ Christopher Newport (1565?-1617) had had an adventurous career as a corsair in the West Indies, where he sacked four Spanish towns, and destroyed no less than twenty Spanish vessels.

Page 40. _Eleaven months._ June 2, 1609-May 24, 1610.

Page 40. _Inhabited by hogges._ The descendants, presumably, of those left by the Spaniards.

Page 40. _Two only._ Six of the company died on the island.

Page 40. _A son and daughter._ These details are confirmed in "A True Repertory of the Wracke and Redemption of Sir Thomas Gates upon and from the Islands of the Bermudas," or from Silas Jourdan's "Discovery of the Barmudas ... by Sir T. Gates ... with divers others" (1610); to both of which Shakespeare is said to have been indebted for the groundwork of "The Tempest."

Page 43. THE MARRIAGE OF POCAHONTAS. There is some doubt as to whether the marriage occurred in 1613 or 1614. The former has been the more generally accepted date, but the compiler has adopted the latter on the authority of Mr. Wyndham Robertson, who has made an exhaustive study of the question, the results of which were embodied in a paper read before the Virginia Historical Society in 1860. Mr. Robertson proves pretty conclusively that April 5, 1614, is the correct date.

Page 43. _Sparkling-Water._ The English meaning of Pocahontas.

Page 45. _The town shall not rise from its ashes again._ Jamestown, at the time it was burned, consisted of a church, state-house, and about eighteen dwellings, mostly of brick. Only the tower of the church and a few chimneys were left standing.

Page 45. BACON'S EPITAPH. This remarkable poem has been preserved in an anonymous "History of Bacon's and Ingram's Rebellion," known as "The Burwell Papers," and printed by the Massachusetts Historical Society in 1814. The "Burwell Papers" have been attributed to a planter named Cotton of Acquia Creek, but this is only conjecture, and there seems to be absolutely no clue to the authorship of the elegy, which will probably always remain one of the literary mysteries of America.

Page 48. THE DOWNFALL OF PIRACY. This is thought to be one of the ballads referred to by Benjamin Franklin in his autobiography. He says: "I now took a fancy to poetry, and made some little pieces. My brother, thinking it might turn to account, encouraged me, and put me on composing occasional ballads. One was called 'The Lighthouse Tragedy,' and contained an account of the drowning of Captain Worthilake, with his two daughters; the other was a sailor song on the taking of Teach (or Blackbeard) the pirate."

It had been thought for many years that both of these ballads were lost, but "The Downfall of Piracy" was discovered by Dr. Edward Everett Hale in a volume entitled "Some Real Sea-Songs," edited by Mr. John Ashton, and published in London. There is, in Dr. Hale's opinion, no doubt that it is one of the Franklin ballads. The news of the fight probably reached Boston about the first of January, 1719, and the ballad was no doubt written soon after. Of "The Lighthouse Tragedy" no trace has been found.

Page 50. _'Twas Juet spoke._ Robert Juet accompanied Hudson as mate on his previous voyage, and on this one acted as clerk. He kept a curious journal of the voyage, which has been preserved in Purchas's third volume.

Page 52. THE PRAISE OF NEW NETHERLAND. The full title, in English, is "The Praise of New Netherland: wherein are briefly and truly shown the excellent qualities which it possesses in the purity of the air, fertility of the soil, production of the cattle, abundance of game and fish, with its advantages for navigation and commerce." It was printed at Amsterdam "for Jacobus Van Der Fuyk, bookseller in the Still-Alley, Anno 1661." Steendam had returned to Amsterdam, it is thought only on a visit, at the time of the publication of this poem. It is dedicated to "The Honorable Cornelis van Ruyven, councillor and secretary of the Hon. West India Company there. Faithful and very upright Promoter of New Netherland."

Page 54. _Noch vaster._ A play upon words, a whimsical device adopted by Steendam. Steendam means "stone dam," and _noch vaster_, "still firmer." Notwithstanding which he seems to have been "a man of very unsettled purposes of life."

Page 58. _Bartholomew Gosnold's 'headlands.'_ Gosnold commanded an expedition which, in 1602, discovered Cape Cod and Martha's Vineyard, both of which were named by him.

Page 63. THE EXPEDITION TO WESSAGUSSET. Mr. Longfellow has followed the account of this expedition given in Winslow's Relation of "Standish's Expedition against the Indians of Weymouth." He has, however, turned the incident of Standish's killing of the chiefs, Pecksuot and Wituwamat, into a much more open and heroic piece of conduct than the chronicle admits. The killing really occurred in a room into which Standish and a few of his men had enticed them. This was the first Indian blood shed by the Pilgrims. A general battle followed in the open field, from which the Indians fled and in which no lives were lost.

"Concerning the killing of those poor Indians," wrote Robinson of Leyden (December 16, 1623), "of which we heard first by report and since by more certain relation, O how happy a thing had it been, if you had converted some before you had killed any!"

Page 65. NEW ENGLAND'S ANNOYANCES. These verses are undoubtedly of a very early date, probably about 1630. Rufus W. Griswold, in his introduction to "The Poets and Poetry of America" (Philadelphia, 1854), calls them "the first verses by a colonist," a statement which is, of course, impossible of proof. They appeared originally in the Massachusetts Historical Collections, with the statement that they were "taken memoriter, in 1785, from the lips of an old lady at the advanced age of 96."

Page 73. ANNE HUTCHINSON'S EXILE. The basis of the famous Antinomian controversy, as it was called, was the promulgation, by Mrs. Hutchinson, of "two dangerous errors: first, that the person of the Holy Ghost dwells in a justified person; second, that no sanctification can help to evidence to us our justification." The words are Winthrop's. To these two doctrines Mrs. Hutchinson attached so much importance that she undertook the public ministration of them. Sir Harry Vane, the young governor of the colony, was one of her converts, but in May, 1637, Winthrop was chosen governor instead of Vane, and at once took steps to suppress the Antinomians, which resulted in the banishment of the more prominent among them.

Page 73. _The father._ William Hutchinson, who had accompanied his family from England.

Page 73. _The boys and girls._ There were fifteen children, so that Portsmouth, which they founded, started off with a larger population than most towns of the period.

Page 75. _In the ruler's seat._ Underhill was chosen governor of the "Passataquack men" in October, 1638.

Page 83. _Pettaquamscut town._ South Kingston, Rhode Island. The Narragansett stronghold lay sixteen miles away, in what is now the town of North Kingston.

Page 83. _George Fox._ Founder of the Society of Friends, who visited America in 1671-72.

Page 84. _Connecticut had sent her men._ Of the army of a thousand, five hundred and twenty-seven were furnished by Massachusetts, and the remainder by Connecticut and Plymouth.

Page 85. ON A FORTIFICATION AT BOSTON BEGUN BY WOMEN. This poem occurs on pages 30-31 of "New England's Crisis," and not, as Duyckinck states, at the beginning. The author, Benjamin Tompson, "learned schoolmaster and physician, and ye renowned poet of New England," as the epitaph upon his tombstone puts it, was born at Braintree, Massachusetts, July 14, 1642, graduated from Harvard in 1662, and after serving as master of the Boston Latin School and Cambridge Preparatory School, died at Cambridge in 1675.

Page 85. _Sudbury's battle._ The Indian attack was made early in the morning of April 21, and lasted practically all the day. News of it soon reached the neighboring towns, and relief parties were started forward. The Indians were on the lookout for them. A party of eleven men from Concord walked into an ambush and only one escaped; eighteen troopers from Boston finally got into the town with a loss of four; and a party of fifty from Marlboro, under Captain Samuel Wadsworth, were caught in an adroitly prepared trap, out of which but thirteen came alive.

Page 99. _Charles of Estienne._ Charles de St. Estienne was a son of Claude de la Tour, a nobleman who, in 1610, had been forced by poverty to seek his fortune in the New World. They came to Port Royal, shared in the vicissitudes of the little settlement, and were among those who took to the woods after its destruction by the English. Among the fugitives was the Sieur de Biencourt, who held a grant to the country about Port Royal. They built some rude cabins, cultivated little patches of ground, and raised a fort of logs and earth near Cape Sable, which they called Fort St. Louis. Biencourt died in 1623, and Charles de la Tour took command of the fort and assumed control of Biencourt's property, claiming that Biencourt had so willed it. Another fort was built on the River St. John, and La Tour was appointed by the king lieutenant-governor over Fort Louis, Port la Tour, and dependencies.

At about the same time, Richelieu sent out an expedition to take formal possession of New France, and named Isaac de Launay de Razilly governor of all Acadia. He made his settlement at La Hève, on the Atlantic coast of Nova Scotia, but died in 1635, and his deputy, Charles de Menou, Chevalier D'Aulnay, asserted his right to command in the colony. Thereupon began between him and Charles de la Tour that famous struggle for the possession of Acadia which forms so romantic a passage in American history.

Page 101. _Pentagoet shall rue._ La Tour was unable to avenge himself, but time did it for him. D'Aulnay was drowned in 1650, and La Tour was appointed governor of Acadia. In 1653 he married D'Aulnay's widow, Jeanne de Motin.

Page 105. PENTUCKET. The Indian name for Haverhill.

Page 106. LOVEWELL'S FIGHT. This ballad, which is of extraordinary interest as the oldest American war ballad extant, was preserved in "The | History | of the | Wars of New England with the Eastern Indians, | or a | Narrative | of their continued perfidy and cruelty, | from the 10th of August, 1703, | to the Peace renewed 13th of July, 1713, | and from the 25th of July, 1722, | to their Submission 15th December, 1725, | which was Ratified August 5th, 1726. | By Samuel Penhallow, Esqr. | Boston, 1726." This was reprinted at Cincinnati, Ohio, in 1859, and the ballad occurs on page

129.

Page 106. _Of worthy Captain Lovewell._ Not much is known of Lovewell. He was a son of Zaccheus Lovewell, an ensign in the army of Oliver Cromwell, who had come to America and settled at Dunstable, where he died at the great age of one hundred and twenty years,--"the oldest white man who ever died in New Hampshire." He left three sons, the youngest of whom was John, the hero of Pigwacket. At the time of the fight, he was about thirty-three years of age, and had a wife and two or three children. After the Indian attack on Dunstable in 1624, he and some others petitioned the House of Representatives at Boston to make some provision for a force to be sent against the savages. The Representatives voted that all such volunteers should be paid two shillings and sixpence a day, and promised large rewards for the scalps of male Indians old enough to fight. A company of thirty was raised, with Lovewell as captain, and captured one prisoner and took one scalp. A second expedition brought back ten scalps and some other booty, and the third expedition culminated in the battle at Pigwacket.

Page 106. _'Twas nigh unto Pigwacket._ The old name for Fryeburg. Pigwacket was at the time the principal village of the Ossipe tribe. Also spelled Pequawket.

Page 108. _They killed Lieutenant Robbins._ Robbins was a native of Chelmsford. He was so badly wounded that he had to be left on the ground. He desired his companions to charge his gun and leave it with him, saying, "As the Indians will come in the morning to scalp me, I will kill one more of them if I can."

Page 108. _Good young Frye._ Jonathan Frye, the chaplain of the company, was the only son of Captain James Frye, of Andover, and had graduated at Harvard only two years before. It is a curious commentary on the taste of the time that he should be commended for scalping Indians, as well as killing them; the scalping, however, was the result not of ferocity but of the large rewards offered by the Boston legislature for these trophies.

Page 108. _Wymans Captain made._ Ensign Seth Wymans, or Wyman, belonged in Woburn, and commanded through the day, after the fall of his superiors at the first fire. He so distinguished himself that he was given a captain's commission, and his admiring townsmen presented him with a silver-hilted sword.

Page 108. LOVEWELL'S FIGHT. From Collections, | Historical and Miscellaneous; | and | Monthly Literary Journal: | [table of contents] Edited by J. Farmer and J. B. Moore. | Concord: | Published by J. B. Moore. | 1824. Vol. iii, page 94.

Page 108. _Anon, there eighty Indians rose._ Penhallow says seventy, Hutchinson eighty, Williamson sixty-three, and Belknap forty-one.

Page 111. THE BRITISH LYON ROUSED. From Tilden's | miscellaneous | Poems, | on | Divers Occasions; | Chiefly to Animate & Rouse | the | Soldiers. | Printed 1756. The little volume from which this poem was taken is one of the most interesting published before the Revolution. For a long time nothing whatever was known of the author, not even his first name. But that was subsequently discovered by Mr. J. H. Trumbull, and communicated to the "New York Historical Magazine," iv, 72, by him.

This account seems to have been overlooked by all of Tilden's biographers. Appleton's Cyclopædia of American Biography fails to give his first name, nor does any history or cyclopædia of American literature with which the compiler is familiar.

Page 112. THE SONG OF BRADDOCK'S MEN. This spirited song has been preserved by Mr. Winthrop Sargent in his excellent monograph upon the Braddock expedition, published by the Pennsylvania Historical Society in 1855. Mr. Sargent states that it was composed in Chester County, Pennsylvania, while the army was on the march in the early autumn of 1755, and that there is no doubt of its authenticity. He does not say where he discovered it.

Page 112. BRADDOCK'S FATE. It will be noticed that these verses were composed just six weeks after the battle which they describe, and the author must have sat down to them at once upon hearing the news of the defeat.

Page 113. _Old sixty-six._ The author.

Page 114. _North America._ It is worthy of note that in all colonial and revolutionary poetry, America is rhymed with such words as day, say, and away.

Page 114. _Telesem._ A name which Tilden gave to this form of verse.

Page 118. Of _Wolfe's brave deeds._ General James Wolfe, who commanded a brigade, and took the leading part in the assaults on the fortress, on one occasion plunging into the sea at the head of his grenadiers, and capturing a battery which commanded the beach.

Page 118. _Amherst's patriot name._ Jeffrey (afterwards Baron) Amherst, commander-in-chief of the land forces, fourteen thousand strong. He was hotly criticised by Wolfe for his blundering conduct of the campaign.

Page 119. _The tartans of Grant's Highlanders._ Major Grant, of the Highlanders, had obtained permission to reconnoitre the fort, and set out with about eight hundred men. He reached the fort on September 14, but, relying on his supposed superior numbers, divided his force in such a way that the different parts could not support each other. He was defeated in detail, his force cut to pieces, and himself taken prisoner. His loss was nearly three hundred.

Page 119. _Loyalhanna._ Westmoreland County, Pennsylvania.

Page 121. _Ned Botwood._ Edward Botwood, sergeant in the grenadiers of the Forty-seventh, or Lascelles' Regiment. He was the author of the verses given here, which were written on the eve of the expedition's departure from Louisburg, and continued popular with the British troops throughout the Revolution. He was killed during an unsuccessful assault, July 31.

Page 122. _Then Wolfe he took his leave._ A short time before leaving for America, Wolfe had become engaged to Katherine, daughter of Robert Lowther.

Page 122. _A parley._ This is, of course, purely imaginary. There was no parley.

Page 122. _Then instant from his horse._ Wolfe was not on horseback.

Page 129. THE VIRGINIA SONG. When David Garrick wrote "Hearts of Oak" as an expression of English patriotism, he little dreamed that he was furnishing ammunition for England's enemies. It was to the air of that song that the most popular of the colonial patriotic songs were written, and it was probably better known than any of our national songs are to us to-day. Such versions as "The Virginia Song," "The Patriot's Appeal," "The Massachusetts Song," and "The Liberty Song" were printed on broadside sheets and in newspaper columns and sung in village meeting and city street throughout the land, awakening immense enthusiasm.

Page 131. THE LIBERTY POLE. From "The Procession with the Standard of Faction, a Cantata," a four-page folio preserved in the Du Simitière collection of broadsides.

Page 132. _Who carry caps and pouches._ "Pouches," perhaps a survival of the days of the hand-grenade.

Page 132. CRISPUS ATTUCKS. Attucks was a resident of Framingham, and there is some difference of opinion as to whether he was a mulatto or half-breed Indian. His only claim to remembrance is that he happened to be in the path of a British bullet on that March day in Boston.

Page 135. A NEW SONG CALLED THE GASPEE. The author of this old ballad is unknown. It was rescued from oblivion by Mr. John S. Taylor, who printed it in his "Sketches of Newport and its Vicinity," New York, 1842.

Page 138. _Tremble! for know, I, Thomas Gage._ Gage was the last royal governor of Massachusetts, and the best hated.

Page 139. _Against Virginia's hostile land._ Patrick Henry's famous speech, delivered in 1764 before the House of Burgesses, had never ceased to ring in the ears of royalty, and the people of Virginia had long been regarded as a "rebellious band that must be broken."

Page 139. _Hail, Middlesex!_ A small number of the people of Middlesex County, Virginia, early in 1774, had adopted some Royalist "resolves," an event which gave rise to the following epigram by a "Lady of Pennsylvania":--

To manhood he makes a vain pretence Who wants both manly form and sense; 'Tis but the form and not the matter, According to the schoolmen's clatter; From such a creature, Heaven defend her! Each lady cries, no _neuter gender_! But when a number of such creatures, With women's hearts and manly features, Their country's generous schemes perplex, I own I hate this Middle-sex.

Page 139. _To Murray bend the humble knee._ John Murray, Earl of Dunmore, royal governor of Virginia, 1770-1775.

Page 139. _Mesech Weare._ Weare was president of the state of New Hampshire in 1776. His verses were set to a psalm tune and widely sung.

Page 140. _In spite of Rice._ This refers to the extensive donations sent from the other colonies to the people of Boston.

Page 140. _Rivington's New York Gazetteer._ This paper, the principal vehicle of Royalist poetry during the Revolution, was established by James Rivington, a bookseller, in 1773, and printed at his "ever open and uninfluenced press." In the autumn of 1775 his printing outfit was destroyed by a patriot mob; but he was soon afterwards appointed King's Printer for the colony, furnished with a new outfit, and started "Rivington's New York Loyal Gazette." At the close of the war he changed its title to "Rivington's Gazette and Universal Advertiser," but it died of starvation in 1783.

Page 141. LIBERTY TREE. On August 14, 1765, an effigy representing Andrew Oliver, distributer of stamps for Boston, was found hanging from a great elm opposite the Boylston Market. A mob gathered when the sheriff tried to take down the effigy, the stamp office was demolished, and Oliver himself was compelled to repair to the tree and resign his commission. It was thenceforward called the Liberty Tree. Liberty trees were afterwards consecrated in many other New England towns.

Page 143. _Since mad Lee now commands us._ Major-General Charles Lee, that eccentric, morose, and ill-fated genius, characterized by Thomas Paine as "above all monarchs and below all scum."

Page 143. MASSACHUSETTS SONG OF LIBERTY. This song, to the air "Hearts of Oak," became almost as popular as "Adams and Liberty" did at a later day. Mrs. Mercy Warren, to whom it is attributed, published a volume of "Poems, Dramatic and Miscellaneous" (Boston, 1790), dedicated to Washington.

Page 144. TO THE BOSTON WOMEN. From Upcott, iv, 339.

Page 144. PAUL REVERE'S RIDE. It is possible that Mr. Longfellow derived the story, as told in the poem, from Revere's account of the adventure in a letter to Dr. Jeremy Belknap, printed in Mass. Hist. Coll. v. The publication of the poem called out a long controversy as to the accuracy of its details.

Page 147. _Then Devens looked._ Richard Devens, a member of the Committee of Safety, of which Hancock and Warren were the leading spirits.

Page 147. _Then haste ye, Prescott and Revere._ Dr. Samuel Prescott, of Concord, joined Revere and Dawes at Lexington and started with them for Concord. They were stopped by a British patrol. Prescott escaped by leaping his horse over the roadside wall and spurred on to Concord, while his companions were taken prisoners, but soon released.

Page 147. _The red-coats fire, the homespuns fall._ Eight Americans were killed, four near the spot where the battle monument now stands, and four others while escaping over the fences. Their names, as recorded on the monument, were Robert Monroe, Jonas Parker, Samuel Hadley, Jonathan Harrington, Jr., Isaac Muzzy, Caleb Harrington, and John Brown, of Lexington, and Asahel Porter, of Woburn.

Page 148. NEW ENGLAND'S CHEVY CHASE. As Lord Percy, at the head of the relief column, marched through Roxbury, his bands playing "Yankee Doodle" in derision of the opponents he was soon to meet, he observed a boy who seemed to be exceedingly amused. He stopped and asked the boy why he was so merry. "To think,"

said the boy, "how you will dance by and by to Chevy Chase." Percy, who was very superstitious, was worried by the remark all day. Its point will be appreciated when it is remembered that Percy was a lineal descendant of the Earl Percy who was slain at Chevy Chase.

Page 149. _We saw Davis fall dead._ Captain Isaac Davis, of the Acton company. He and Abner Hosmer were killed as the Americans charged the British stationed at the North Bridge. "I haven't a man that's afraid to go!" he had exclaimed as he wheeled his company into line for the charge.

Page 150. _We'd rather have spent it this way than to home._ One of the veterans of the fight made this very remark to Edward Everett.

Page 153. _Of man for man the sacrifice._ The British lost 65 killed, 180 wounded, 28 captured; the Americans, 59 killed, 39 wounded, 5 missing.

Page 158. _King David._ See 2 Samuel v, 23, 24.

Page 159. _Yankee Doodle._ Accounts of the origin of "Yankee Doodle" are many and various. The air is very old, and nearly every country in Europe claims it. It probably reached England from Holland, and in the days of Charles I was used for some verses about Lydia Lockett and Kittie Fisher, gay ladies of the town. Afterwards, when Cromwell rode into Oxford on a pony, with his single plume fastened into a sort of knot called a "macaroni," the Cavaliers used the same air for their derisive verses. The story goes that this fact was recalled by Dr. Richard Shuckburg, of the Seventeenth Foot, when the queerly garbed provincial levies presented themselves, in June, 1755, at the camp at Albany, to take part in the campaign against the French. He wrote down the notes of the air and got the regimental band to play it. It was taken up by the Americans and became instantly popular. Verses innumerable have been attached to the air, the best known of which are "The Yankee's Return from Camp" and "The Battle of the Kegs."

Page 160. _Edward Bangs._ This is upon the authority of Dr. Edward Everett Hale, who states that "an autograph note of Judge Dawes, of the Harvard class of 1777, addressed to my father, says that the author of the well-known lines was Edward Bangs, who graduated with him. Mr. Bangs had, as a college boy, joined the Middlesex farmers in the pursuit of April 19, 1775. He was afterward a judge in Worcester County."

Page 160. TOM GAGE'S PROCLAMATION. General Gage's proclamation, issued June 12, 1775, was as follows:--

"Whereas the infatuated multitudes, who have long suffered themselves to be conducted by certain well-known incendiaries and traitors, in a fatal progression of crimes against the constitutional authority of the state, have at length proceeded to avowed rebellion, and the good effects which were expected to arise from the patience and lenity of the king's government have been often frustrated, and are now rendered hopeless by the influence of the same evil counsels, it only remains for those who are entrusted with the supreme rule, as well for the punishment of the guilty as the protection of the well-affected, to prove that they do not bear the sword

in vain."

Page 162. THE BALLAD OF BUNKER HILL. An unsigned copy of these verses, apparently an authentic Revolutionary ballad, but really written by Dr. Hale in 1845, was "discovered," about 1858, among some old manuscripts at Millbury, Mass., and reproduced in the "Historical Magazine," iii, 311. Dr. Hale had himself lost all trace of the poem, until he came across it in the first edition of this compilation.

Page 163. GRANDMOTHER'S STORY OF BUNKER-HILL BATTLE. Dr. Holmes himself says:--

"The story of Bunker Hill battle is told as literally in accordance with the best authorities as it would have been if it had been written in prose instead of in verse. I have often been asked what steeple it was from which the little group I speak of looked upon the conflict. To this I answer that I am not prepared to speak authoritatively, but that the reader may take his choice among all the steeples standing at that time in the northern part of the city. Christ Church in Salem Street is the one I always think of, but I do not insist upon its claim. As to the personages who made up the small company that followed the old corporal, it would be hard to identify them, but by ascertaining where the portrait by Copley is now to be found, some light may be thrown on their personality."

It has been pointed out that the belfry could hardly have been that of Christ Church, since tradition has it that General Gage himself watched the battle from that vantage point.

The poem was first published in 1875, in connection with the centenary of the battle which it describes.

Page 167. THE BATTLE OF BUNKER HILL. This "popular" ballad was written and printed as a broadside for the purpose of encouraging recruiting for the English army. There are many versions of it, as well as parodies composed by Yankee sympathizers.

Page 169. _'Twas then he took his gloomy way._ Washington's journey was, as a matter of fact, a kind of triumph.

Page 169. _Lawyer Close._ Washington's aide, Major Lee.

Page 170. _Like Esop's greedy cur._ Fable 118. A dog crossing a rivulet, with a piece of meat in his mouth, saw his own shadow; and believing it to be another dog with a larger piece of meat, snatched at it, with the result that he lost his own piece.

Page 173. A POEM CONTAINING SOME REMARKS ON THE PRESENT WAR, etc., is from Poems | upon | Several Occasions, | viz. | I. A POEM on the Enemy's first coming | to _Boston_; the burning of _Charles-_ | _town_; the Fight at _Bunker_-Hill, &c. | II. The WIDOW'S Lamentation. | III. _Nebuchadnezzar's_ DREAM. | IV. Against OPPRESSION. | V. An heroic POEM on the taking of Gen. | _Burgoyne_, &c. | Boston: Printed for the AUTHOR, 1779. | It is an 8vo of sixteen pages, the first poem being printed in double column. A note at the end of the volume is signed "A Friend to Liberty."

Page 176. EMANCIPATION FROM BRITISH DEPENDENCE. The following explanatory note is from Duyckinck's edition of Freneau:--

"Sir James Wallace, Admiral Graves, and Captain Montague were British naval officers, employed on our coast. The Viper and Rose were vessels in the service. Lord Dunmore, the last Royal governor of Virginia, had recently, in April, 1775, removed the public stores from Williamsburg, and, in conjunction with a party of adherents, supported by the naval force on the station, was making war on the province. William Tryon, the last Royal governor of New York, discerning the signs of the times, took refuge on board the Halifax packet in the harbor, and left the city in the middle of October, 1775."

Page 177. _Rodney_, who was one of the Delaware delegates to the Continental Congress, had obtained leave of absence for a journey through the southern part of the state to prepare the people for a change of government. His colleagues, Thomas McKean and George Read, were divided on the question, and the former, knowing Rodney to be favorable to the declaration, sent him a message urging his return. By great exertion Rodney arrived just in time for the final discussion, and his affirmative vote secured the consent of the Delaware delegation to the declaration, and effected that unanimity among the colonies which was essential to the success of the measure.

Page 180. THE AMERICAN PATRIOT'S PRAYER. This poem was formerly ascribed to Thomas Paine, but recent authority has rejected this on the basis of internal evidence.

Page 183. THE MARYLAND BATTALION. At the opening of the Revolution, the young men of Baltimore organized the "Baltimore Independent Company," and elected Mordecai Gist captain. This was afterwards increased to a battalion, of which Gist was appointed major. The battalion checked the advance of Cornwallis at the battle of Long Island, and saved a portion of Stirling's command from capture. Two hundred and fifty-nine were left dead on the field.

Page 183. _Grant._ The British general who commanded the left wing. He had declared in the House of Commons that the Americans would not fight, and that he could march from one end of the continent to the other with five thousand men.

Page 183. _Stirling._ William Alexander, commonly called Lord Stirling, eldest son of James Alexander Stirling, who had fled to America upon the discovery of the Jacobite conspiracy of 1715.

Page 184. _Knowlton._ Thomas Knowlton, lieutenant-colonel of a regiment of rangers selected from the Connecticut troops. He was killed at the battle of Harlem Heights, as was Major Leitch, who had been sent to his aid.

Page 185. NATHAN HALE. Nathan Hale was a great-grandson of John Hale, first minister of Beverly, Massachusetts. He was born in 1755, and graduated from Yale in 1773. Little is known of his personal history.

Page 188. TRENTON AND PRINCETON. From McCarty's "National Song Book," iii, 88. McCarty says it was written from the dictation of an old lady who had heard it sung during the Revolution.

Page 204. LORD NORTH'S RECANTATION. These verses were written by "a gentleman of Chester," England, and first appeared in the "London Evening Post."

Page 205. GENERAL HOWE'S LETTER. From Upcott, v, 45.

Page 208. BRITISH VALOR DISPLAYED; OR, THE BATTLE OF THE KEGS. This ballad was occasioned by a real incident. Certain machines in the form of kegs, charged with gunpowder, were sent down the river to annoy the British shipping then at Philadelphia. The danger of these machines being discovered, the British manned the wharfs and shipping and discharged their small-arms and cannons at everything they saw floating in the river during the ebb tide.--Author's note.

David Bushnell, inventor of the American torpedo, constructed the machines, which were so arranged as to explode on coming in contact with anything. Hopkinson's verses, which swept from colony to colony, did much to relieve the strain of those early months of 1778, and were perhaps worth as much, in tonic and inspiration, as the winning of a battle would have been.

Page 208. _Sir William._ Sir William Howe, commanding the British army.

Page 208. _Mrs. Loring._ Wife of Joshua Loring, the notorious commissary of prisoners.

Page 208. _Sir Erskine._ Sir William Erskine.

Page 214. _King Hancock at their head._ John Hancock commanded the second line of Massachusetts militia in this movement.

Page 214. _Bold Pigot._ Sir Robert Pigot commanded the British forces in Rhode Island.

Page 216. BETTY ZANE. Elizabeth Zane was about eighteen years of age at the time she performed this exploit, and had just returned to Fort Henry from Philadelphia, where she had completed her education. She lived until 1847.

Page 216. _Betty's brothers._ Ebenezer and Silas.

Page 217. THE WYOMING MASSACRE. This ballad was printed, apparently for the first time, in Charles Miner's "History of Wyoming" (Philadelphia, 1845), where it is stated that it was written shortly after the tragedy by Mr. "Uriah Terry, of Kingston." In McCarty's "National Song Book" (iii, 344) it is said to have been written "by a person then resident near the field of battle."

Page 219. THE CRUISE OF THE FAIR AMERICAN. The war song of the Salem Privateersmen during the Revolution, and preserved in Griswold's manuscript collection of "American Historical Ballads." It was taken down from the mouths of Hawthorne's surviving shipmates early in the last century.

Page 219. _Bold Hawthorne._ Daniel Hawthorne, grandfather of Nathaniel Hawthorne.

Page 223. THE YANKEE MAN-OF-WAR. This, one of the very best of American sea-songs, was first published by Commodore Luce, in his collection of "Naval Songs."

He states that it was taken down from the recitation of a sailor. Internal evidence would indicate that it was composed by a member of the Ranger's crew.

Page 224. PAUL JONES--A NEW SONG. This is Number 613, vol. iii, of the Roxburghe collection of broadsides.

Page 224. _As Green, Jemmy Twitcher._ Captain Green was a noted pirate, and Jemmy Twitcher was the name given to the notorious John, Lord Sandwich.

Page 224. _Pierce._ Captain Richard Pearson. He was knighted as a reward for his fight with Jones. The latter remarked, upon hearing of it, "Should I fall in with him again, I'll make a lord of him."

Page 225. _The Alliance bore down and the Richard did rake._ The Alliance was commanded by Pierre Landais, a Frenchman, and his actions have never been satisfactorily explained. He had held his ship aloof at the opening of the battle, disregarding Jones's orders, but came up later only to pour three or four broadsides into the Richard, killing or wounding many of her crew and almost sinking her. She then drew off and awaited the result of the battle.

Page 225. _Full forty guns Serapis bore._ She really carried fifty against the Richard's forty-two. Besides, she was a new frigate, only four months out, while the Richard was old and unseaworthy. The Serapis carried 320 men, the Richard 304.

Page 226. _Bold Pallas soon the Countess took._ The Countess of Scarborough struck to the Pallas after a gallant two hours' battle.

Page 226. _In the Hyder Ali._ Hyder Ali was an Indian prince who defeated the English in 1767 and subsequently caused them so much annoyance that he was very popular with American patriots.

Page 229. _The Hope._ The ship Hope and the brig Constance, which were with the South Carolina, were also taken.

Page 229. _Sir Henry Clinton._ Clinton was left in command of New York city, when Howe started on his expedition for the capture of Philadelphia.

Page 230. _Braving the death that his heart foretold._ Wayne was convinced that he would not survive the attack on Stony Point, but nevertheless led the assault in person. He was struck in the head by a bullet, but insisted on being borne into the fort with his men.

Page 232. THE MODERN JONAS. A pasquinade printed as a broadside and stuck up in New York city. "Old Knyp" was General Knyphausen; "Old Clip," General Robertson; and "Yankee Farms," Connecticut Farms.

Page 233. THE COW-CHACE. The last canto of this poem was published in "Rivington's Royal Gazette" on the day that André was captured. These are the only verses he is known to have published. The original copy is still in existence, and has the following stanza upon it, under André's signature:--

When the epic strain was sung, The poet by the neck was hung, And to his cost he finds too late The dung-born tribe decides his fate.

The poem was afterwards published by Rivington as an 8vo of 69 pages.

"The Cow-Chace," in its early editions, had the following explanatory notes:--

Tanner: General Wayne's _legal_ occupation.

Mumps: A disorder prevalent in the Rebel lines.

Yan Van Poop: Who kept a dram-shop.

Jade: A New England name for a horse, mare, or gelding.

Bodies: A cant appellation given among the soldiery to the corps that have the honor to guard his majesty's person.

Cunningham: Provost-Marshal of New York.

The shot will not go thro':

Five Refugees ('tis true) were found Stiff on the block-house floor, But then 'tis thought the shot went round, And in at the back door.

Frost-bit Alexander: Earl of Stirling.

The frantic priest: Caldwell, a minister at Elizabethtown.

One pretty marquis: Lafayette, a French coxcomb in the rebel service.

Page 237. _John Paulding._ Paulding was born in New York city in 1758 and died in 1818. His capture of André was his one famous exploit. With him at the time were two comrades, named Isaac Van Wart and David Williams. They were given medals by Congress and an annuity of two hundred dollars.

Page 239. _And then, at last, a transatlantic grave._ In 1821 André's remains were removed to England and placed in Westminster Abbey.

Page 240. _Sir Hal._ Sir Henry Clinton.

Page 241. _Congo._ The American Congress.

Page 242. _The reverend Mather._ Moses Mather, D.D.

Page 245. HYMN OF THE MORAVIAN NUNS OF BETHLEHEM. The banner of Pulaski's legion was embroidered by the Moravian sisters of Bethlehem, who helped to support their house by needlework. It is preserved in the cabinet of the Maryland Historical Society at Baltimore.

Page 245. _Martial cloak and shroud for thee._ The banner was made to be carried on a lance and was only twenty inches square. It could not have been used as a shroud.

Page 246. _Brave Maitland push'd in._ Colonel Maitland brought a large body of British troops from Beaufort to Prevost's aid.

Page 246. _Moncrieffe._ Major Moncrieff was the engineer who planned Savannah's defences.

Page 246. _Who attempted to murder his king._ In 1771 Pulaski attempted to kidnap Stanislaus, King of Poland.

Page 250. _South Mount._ Sumter's home near Camden, South Carolina.

Page 259. _Two birds of his feather._ Howe and Burgoyne.

Page 259. _Poor Charley._ Cornwallis.

Page 260. _A murder'd Hayne._ Isaac Hayne, hanged by the British, August 4, 1781.

Page 262. _And Whitehead._ William Whitehead, poet laureate 1751-1785.

Page 263. _Thus he._ Cincinnatus.

Page 269. _No taxes we'll pay._ Shays and his followers demanded decreased taxes and a paper currency.

Page 269. _Here's a pardon for Wheeler, Shays, Parsons, and Day._ Wheeler, Parsons, and Day were associates of Shays. All of them fled from the state, but were afterwards pardoned.

Page 271. _So they went to Federal Street._ The convention was held in a church on Long Lane, which was afterwards christened Federal Street in honor of the event.

Page 273. THE FIRST AMERICAN CONGRESS. From "The Columbiad."

Page 274. THE VOW OF WASHINGTON. Read in New York, April 30, 1889, at the centennial celebration of Washington's inauguration.

Page 276. ADAMS AND LIBERTY. Mr. Charles Prentiss, in his preface to the collected works of Robert Treat Paine, published at Boston in 1812, gives the following account of the writing of "Adams and Liberty":--

"In June, 1798, at the request of the 'Massachusetts Charitable Fire Society,' Mr. Paine wrote his celebrated political song of 'Adams and Liberty.' It may appear singular that politics should have any connection with an institution of benevolence: but the great object of the anniversary being to obtain charitable donations, the more various and splendid were the attractions, the more crowded the attendance: and of course, the more ample the accumulation for charity.

"There was, probably, never a political song more sung in America than this; and one of more poetical merit was, perhaps, never written: an anecdote deserves notice respecting one of the best stanzas in it. Mr. Paine had written all he intended; and being in the house of Major Russell, editor of the 'Centinel,' showed him the verses. It was highly approved, but pronounced imperfect; as Washington was omitted. The sideboard was replenished, and Paine was about to help himself; when Major Russell familiarly interfered, and insisted, in his humorous manner, that he should not slake his thirst till he had written an additional stanza, in which Washington should be introduced. Paine marched back and forth a few minutes, and suddenly starting, called for a pen. He immediately wrote the following sublime stanza [the one beginning "Should the tempest of war overshadow our land"].

"The sale of this song yielded him a profit of about seven hundred and fifty dollars. It was read by all; and there was scarcely in New England, a singer, that could not sing this song. Nor was its circulation confined to New England: it was sung at theatres, and on public and private occasions, throughout the United States; and republished and applauded in Great Britain."

Page 277. HAIL COLUMBIA. The following letter from Joseph Hopkinson, son of Francis Hopkinson, is quoted by Rev. R. W. Griswold, in his "Poets and Poetry of America":--

"It ["Hail Columbia"] was written in the summer of 1798, when war with France was thought to be inevitable. Congress was then in session in Philadelphia, deliberating upon that important subject, and acts of hostility had actually taken place. The contest between England and France was raging, and the people of the United States were divided into parties for the one side or the other, some thinking that policy and duty required us to espouse the cause of republican France, as she was called; while others were for connecting ourselves with England, under the belief that she was the great preservative power of good principles and safe government. The violation of our rights by both belligerents was forcing us from the just and wise policy of President Washington, which was to do equal justice to both, to take part with neither, but to preserve a strict and honest neutrality between them. The prospect of a rupture with France was exceedingly offensive to the portion of the people who espoused her cause, and the violence of the spirit of party has never risen higher, I think not so high, in our country, as it did at that time, upon that question. The theatre was then open in our city. A young man belonging to it, whose talent was as a singer, was about to take his benefit. I had known him when he was at school. On this acquaintance, he called on me one Saturday afternoon, his benefit being announced for the following Monday. His prospects were very disheartening; but he said that if he could get a patriotic song adapted to the tune of the 'President's March,' he did not doubt of a full house; that the poets of the theatrical corps had been trying to accomplish it, but had not succeeded. I told him I would try what I could do for him. The object of the author was to get up an _American spirit_, which should be independent of and above the interests, passions, and policy of both belligerents: and look and feel exclusively for our own honour and rights. No allusion is made to France or England, or the quarrel between them: or to the question, which was most at fault in their treatment of us: of course the song found favour with both parties, for both were Americans; at least neither could disavow the sentiments and feelings it inculcated."

Page 278. YE SONS OF COLUMBIA: AN ODE. From "Original Poems by Thomas Green Fessenden, Esq., author of Terrible Tractoration, or Caustic's Petition to the Royal College of Physicians, and Democracy Unveiled. Philadelphia: Printed at the Lorenzo Press of E. Bronson. 1806." The following note to this poem appears in the first edition: "The above Ode was written, set to musick, and sung on a publick occasion in Rutland, Vermont, July, 1798. At that time the armament, which afterwards sailed to Egypt, under Buonaparte, lay at Toulon: its destination was not known in America, but many supposed that it was intended to waft the blessings of

French Liberty to the United States." Fessenden seems to have been possessed of an acute hatred of the French, due, perhaps, to his residence in England. Three other poems in this little book are devoted to denouncing Napoleon, the Jacobins, and the "sans culotte"--of which latter phrase he was singularly fond.

Page 283. _So the common sailor died._ James did not die. He recovered from his wounds, served through the second war with England and lived till about 1840.

Page 283. SKIPPER IRESON'S RIDE. Whittier heard the story of Skipper Ireson in 1828, when he was a student at Haverhill Academy. It was told him by a schoolmate from Marblehead, and he began at once to write the ballad, but it was not published until 1857, when it appeared in the second number of the "Atlantic Monthly."

Mr. Samuel Roads, Jr., in his "History of Marblehead," contended that Ireson was in no way responsible for the abandonment of the disabled ship, and Whittier, in writing to Mr. Roads, says: "I have now no doubt that thy version of Skipper Ireson's ride is the correct one. My verse was founded solely on a fragment of rhyme which I heard from one of my early schoolmates, a native of Marblehead. I supposed the story to which it referred dated back at least a century. I knew nothing of the participants, and the narrative of the ballad was pure fancy. I am glad for the sake of truth and justice that the real facts are given in thy book. I certainly would not knowingly do injustice to any one, dead or living."

The use of dialect in the refrain was suggested by Lowell, the editor of the "Atlantic" at the time.

Page 285. THE TIMES. McCarty's "National Song Book" (Philadelphia, 1861) is a real treasure-house of ballads written during the second war with England. "The Times" is from this source, as are many of the other ballads quoted here.

Page 287. HULL'S SURRENDER. This ballad was copied from a broadside in the possession of the library of Harvard University. It is so tattered that one stanza, the last, is indecipherable and had to be omitted.

Page 289. _Commanded by Dacres the grandee O._ Captain (afterward Rear-Admiral of the Red) James Richard Dacres.

Page 292. _Where Brock, the proud insulter, rides._ Sir Isaac Brock. He had received Hull's surrender less than two months before. He was pierced by three bullets as he led his troops into battle at Queenstown and died where he fell.

Page 298. _Brave Chauncey._ Captain Isaac Chauncey.

Page 302. _We mourn, indeed, a hero lost!_ Captain William Burrows, of the Enterprise, and Captain Blythe, of the Boxer, both fell during the action, and were buried side by side at Portland.

Page 303. _And whether like Yeo, boys, they'd taken affright._ Sir James Lucas Yeo, who had been defeated by Captain Isaac Chauncey and was afterwards blockaded by him in Kingston Harbor.

Page 304. _Thought it best from his well-peppered ship to depart._ The Lawrence was so severely shot up early in the action, that Perry transferred his flag to the Niagara. He afterwards returned to the Lawrence to receive the surrender of the surviving British officers.

Page 306. _And Tecumseh fell prostrate before him._ The honor of having killed Tecumseh was claimed for Colonel Richard Malcolm Johnston, but the claim was never conclusively established.

Page 306. _Walbach._ John Batiste de Barth, Baron de Walbach, a German veteran who had come to America on a visit in 1798. He enlisted in the American army, won steady promotion, and died in 1857 with the rank of brigadier-general.

Page 309. _Four gallant ships._ The Ramillies 74, commanded by Sir Thomas Hardy; the Pactolus 38, the Despatch 22, and a bombship.

Page 313. _Downie._ George Downie, commander of the British fleet. He was killed during the action.

Page 313. _Macomb._ General Alexander Macomb, in command of the American land force. His army, consisting of about fifteen hundred regulars and some detachments of militia, was greatly outnumbered by the British.

Page 315. _To serve me just like Drummond._ Sir Gordon Drummond, who lost a large part of his force by the explosion of a mine, while assaulting Fort Erie.

Page 315. _Old Ross, Cockburn, and Cochrane too._ Robert Ross, selected by Wellington to command the troops sent to this country in 1814. He was killed while leading the advance toward Baltimore, after having sacked Washington. Sir George Cockburn, second in command of the fleet, who had become notorious for his raids along the American coast. Sir Alexander Cochrane, in command of the British fleet on the American station.

Page 315. _General Winder._ General William Henry Winder, in command of the American militia at the battle of Bladensburg.

Page 317. THE STAR-SPANGLED BANNER. The poem was really written at white heat, for Key made his first draft while the fight was actually in progress, and corrected it at Baltimore next day. It was at once struck off as a broadside, and was received with great enthusiasm. The air, from which it is inseparable, was selected almost at random, from a volume of flute music, by an actor named Ferdinand Durang, and was known as "Anacreon in Heaven." Additional stanzas have been written for the poem from time to time, but none of them are in any way notable except those written during the Civil War by Oliver Wendell Holmes:

When our land is illumined with liberty's smile, If a foe from within strike a blow at her glory, Down, down with the traitor who dares to defile The flag of her stars and the page of her story! By the millions unchained Who their birthright have gained We will keep her bright blazon forever unstained; And the star-spangled banner in triumph shall wave While the land of the free is the home of the brave.

Page 321. _Take our wounded and our dead._ The American loss was two killed and seven wounded, while the British lost 120 killed and 180 wounded.

Page 323. _For I went down with Carroll._ William Carroll, major-general of Tennessee militia.

Page 324. _'Twas Pakenham in person._ Sir Edward Michael Pakenham. He had succeeded Ross in the command of Wellington's veterans, and, like his predecessor, was killed while leading his men against the enemy.

Page 325. _And came, with Gibbs to head it._ Sir Samuel Gibbs, second in command to Pakenham.

Page 325. _It is the Baratarian._ The headquarters of Jean Lafitte, the freebooter, at Barataria, had been broken up only a short time before, and many of his band captured and imprisoned. They were subsequently released, and under three of Lafitte's lieutenants, Dominique, You, and Bluche, hastened to Jackson's aid before New Orleans, where they did good service, especially with the artillery.

Page 325. _Keane was sorely wounded._ Baron John Keane, in command of the third brigade.

Page 327. _Our captain._ Charles Stewart. He held the remarkable record of being seventy-one years in the service, and senior officer for seventeen years. He lived until 1869. His daughter was the mother of Charles Stewart Parnell.

Page 335. _Oyo._ The Indian name for the Ohio.

Page 337. _Blanny._ A popular corruption of Blennerhassett.

Page 337. _Our General brave._ Major-General Buell.

Page 337. _I have the Baron in my head._ The only system of military tactics then in use among the officers in the western country was that of Baron Steuben.

Page 337. _The Deputy._ Governor Return Jonathan Meigs.

Page 338. _'Twas half a kneel of Indian meal._ A kneel is equal to two quarts.

Page 338. _Tyler, they say, lies at Belpré._ Comfort Tyler was one of Burr's chief lieutenants.

Page 338. _The Cor'ner._ Joel Bowen.

Page 338. _Instead of sword, he seized his board._ Buell was a tailor by trade.

Page 343. _Good Junipero._ Father Junipero Serra, the famous head of the missionaries in California.

Page 343. _The Visitador._ José de Galvez, Visitador General of New Spain.

Page 344. _Viscaino._ Sebastian Viscaino, who conducted a Spanish exploring expedition along the California coast in 1602-03.

Page 345. "THE DAYS OF 'FORTY-NINE." Half a century ago, this song was widely popular, and yet to-day it is almost impossible to find an authentic copy. There is a

version in Upham's "Notes of a Voyage to California," but it is anything but convincing. The version given here was contributed to "Out West" by Florence Gleason, of Bakersfield, California, and has the ear-marks of authenticity.

Page 351. CONCORD HYMN. The first quatrain of this poem is inscribed on the Battle Monument at Concord. Emerson's grandfather, William Emerson, was minister at Concord in 1775, and from his pulpit strongly advocated resistance to the British. When the day of trial came, he took his place among "the embattled farmers." "Let us stand our ground," he said to the minute-men; "if we die, let us die here." The fight took place near his own house, the home afterwards of Emerson and of Hawthorne, and celebrated by the latter as "The Old Manse."

Page 353. OLD TIPPECANOE. From "The Harrison Log Cabin Song Book," Columbus [Ohio], 1840.

Page 356. _A thousand Mexicans lay dead._ A careful estimate places the Mexican loss at about five hundred. Six of the Texans, including Travis, Bowie, and Crockett, were taken alive, but were immediately put to death by Santa Anna's order.

Page 357. _Save the gasp of a woman._ While every man of the garrison was killed, three women survived, one of whom was Mrs. Almerion Dickinson, wife of a lieutenant belonging to the garrison. Three children also survived.

Page 358. _We slew and slew till the sun set red._ Houston reported the Mexican loss to be 630 killed, 208 wounded, 730 captured. The wounded were, however, counted among the prisoners. The American loss was 2 killed and 23 wounded. Santa Anna himself was captured next day.

Page 362. _Rio Bravo._ Rio Bravo del Norte, "Rapid River of the North," is a Spanish name for the Rio Grande.

Page 366. THE ANGELS OF BUENA VISTA. A letter-writer from Mexico during the Mexican War, when detailing some of the incidents at the terrible fight of Buena Vista, mentioned that Mexican women were seen hovering near the field of death, for the purpose of giving aid and succor to the wounded. One poor woman was found surrounded by the maimed and suffering of both armies, ministering to the wants of Americans as well as Mexicans with impartial tenderness.--Author's note.

Page 369. _Guvener B._ George Nixon Briggs was the Whig governor of Massachusetts from 1844 to 1851.

Page 369. _John P. Robinson._ John Paul Robinson (1799-1864) was a resident of Lowell, a lawyer of considerable ability and a thorough classical scholar. Late in the gubernatorial contest of 1847 it was rumored that Robinson, heretofore a zealous Whig, and a delegate to the recent Springfield convention, had gone over to the Democratic or, as it was then styled, the "Loco" camp. The editor of the "Boston Palladium" wrote to him to learn the truth, and Robinson replied in an open letter avowing his intention to vote for Cushing.

Page 369. _Gineral C._ General Caleb Cushing.

Page 384. BATTLE HYMN OF THE REPUBLIC. This, perhaps the loftiest strain of American patriotism, was inspired by a visit which Mrs. Howe paid to Washington in December, 1861. She heard the troops singing "John Brown's Body," and, at the suggestion of James Freeman Clarke, determined to write some worthy words to go with that air. The words were written almost at once, and were taken back to Boston by Mrs. Howe. She gave them to James T. Fields, editor of the "Atlantic Monthly," and they were published in the issue of that magazine for February, 1862, being given the entire first page. Mr. Fields furnished the title. Strangely enough, the poem attracted little attention, until a copy of a newspaper containing it was smuggled into Libby Prison. Chaplain Charles C. McCabe read it there, and presently the whole prison was singing it. After his release, Chaplain McCabe continued to call attention to the song, and its merits were soon widely recognized. President Roosevelt has suggested that it deserves to be the national anthem.

Page 386. _Mr. Foote._ Henry S. Foote was Senator from Mississippi from 1847 to 1852. He was a member of the Confederate Congress.

Page 386. _Mangum._ W. P. Mangum (1792-1861) was Senator from North Carolina from 1831 to 1837, and again from 1841 to 1847.

Page 387. _Cass._ Lewis Cass (1782-1866) was Senator from Michigan from 1845 to 1848, and candidate for the presidency on the Democratic ticket in 1848. After his defeat by Taylor he was, in 1849, returned to the Senate to fill out his unexpired term. He was Buchanan's Secretary of State until the famous message of December, 1860, when he resigned.

Page 387. _Davis._ Jefferson Davis, the President of the Confederate States, was a Senator from Mississippi from 1847 to 1850.

Page 387. _Hannegan._ Edward A. Hannegan was Senator from Indiana from 1843 to 1849.

Page 387. _Jarnagin._ Spencer Jarnagin represented the state of Tennessee in the Senate from 1841 to 1847.

Page 387. _Atherton._ Charles G. Atherton (1804-53) was Senator from New Hampshire from 1843 to 1849.

Page 387. _Colquitt._ W. T. Colquitt (1799-1855) was Senator from Georgia from 1843 to 1849.

Page 387. _Johnson._ Reverdy Johnson was Senator from Maryland, 1845-49.

Page 387. _Westcott._ James D. Westcott, Senator from Florida, 1845-49.

Page 387. _Lewis._ Dixon H. Lewis, Senator from Alabama, 1844-48.

Page 388. ICHABOD. This poem was the outcome of the surprise and grief and forecast of evil consequences which I felt on reading the seventh of March speech of Daniel Webster in support, of the "compromise," and the Fugitive Slave Law.... But death softens all resentments, and the consciousness of a common inheritance of frailty and weakness modifies the severity of judgment. Years after, in "The Lost

Occasion," I gave utterance to an almost universal regret that the great statesman did not live to see the flag which he loved trampled under the feet of Slavery, and, in view of this desecration, make his last days glorious in defence of "Liberty and Union, one and inseparable."--Author's note.

Page 391. _Beyond the river banks._ The Wakarusa.

Page 391. _Keitt._ Laurence Massillon Keitt, Congressman from South Carolina, 1852-60. Killed at the battle of Cold Harbor, 1862.

Page 391. _The anti-Lecomptonite phalanx._ Lecompton was the capital of the territory of Kansas, and a pro-slavery constitution was framed there at a constitutional convention which lasted from September 5 to November 7, 1857. It was rejected by the people of Kansas early in the following year.

Page 394. _Captain Stephens._ Aaron Dwight Stephens. He was a captain only in the sense that he was to be given that position in the negro army which Brown expected to organize.

Page 395. _With his eighteen other crazy men._ There were either twenty-two or twenty-three men in the party.

Page 395. _So they hurried off to Richmond for the Government Marines._ The marines arrived by train from Washington. Strangely enough, they were under command of Colonel Robert E. Lee and Lieutenant J. E. B. Stuart.

Page 395. _Fired their bullets in his clay._ The bodies of some of the dead were atrociously maltreated.

Page 395. _How they hastened on the trial._ The trial began October 26 and ended November 2. The proceedings, though swift, were not unseemly nor unduly summary, considering the excitement of the Virginians and their fear that a rescue would be attempted from the North.

Page 403. GOD SAVE OUR PRESIDENT. These verses were written in 1857, and the music for them was composed a year later by George Felix Benkert. It was played by the Marine Band at the first inauguration of Lincoln, immediately after the inaugural address.

Page 411. DIXIE. Dan Emmett, the once-famous negro minstrel, was the author of the original "Dixie," which was written in 1859. It is said he got the air from an old plantation melody. It was soon appropriated by the South and became the most popular of all the Southern war songs. The words used, however, were not Emmett's, which were mere doggerel, but General Albert Pike's, as given in the text. Since the war, "Dixie" has grown as popular in the North as in the South. Many verses have been set to the air, but none of them, besides Emmett's and Pike's, has gained any popularity.

Page 411. A CRY TO ARMS. The unusual poetic merit of the Southern poems at the opening of the war is worth remarking. This, as the war progressed, gave place in large part to mere hysteria, while the poetic quality of Northern verse, poor enough at first, grew steadily better. This may perhaps be explained by the fact that the

South was the more in earnest when the war began, while the earnestness of the North deepened as it went on.

Page 415. MY MARYLAND. This poem, which divided with "Dixie" popularity among the Southern troops, was written by Mr. Randall immediately upon hearing of the outbreak at Baltimore. The form of the poem was suggested by Mangan's "Karamanian Exile":--

I see thee ever in my dreams, Karaman! Thy hundred hills, thy thousand streams, Karaman, O Karaman!

It was wedded to the old college air "Lauriger Horatius," by Miss Hattie Cary, of Baltimore.

In affecting contrast to the reception given the Sixth Massachusetts in 1861 was that given it in 1898, when it passed through Baltimore on its way to Cuba. The historic regiment was met at the station by the mayor; school children drawn up along the line of march pelted the soldiers with flowers; each soldier was given a little box containing cake, fruit, and a love-letter; and a great motto was strung across the streets reading, "Let the welcome of '98 efface the memory of '61."

Page 424. _To General J. E. Johnston._ General Johnston, who had been stationed at Winchester with the Army of the Shenandoah, marched rapidly to Beauregard's aid, when the latter was attacked at Manassas, and upon his arrival left Beauregard, whom he ranked, in tactical command of the field, and assumed responsibility and general charge of the battle.

Page 435. WANTED--A MAN. This poem is said to have so impressed President Lincoln that he read it to his Cabinet.

Page 444. BARBARA FRIETCHIE. This poem was written in strict conformity to the account of the incident as I had it from respectable and trustworthy sources. It has since been the subject of a good deal of conflicting testimony, and the story was probably incorrect in some of its details. It is admitted by all that Barbara Frietchie was no myth, but a worthy and highly esteemed gentlewoman, intensely loyal and a hater of the Slavery Rebellion, holding her Union flag sacred and keeping it with her Bible; that when the Confederates halted before her house, and entered her dooryard, she denounced them in vigorous language, shook her cane in their faces, and drove them out; and when General Burnside's troops followed close upon Jackson's, she waved her flag and cheered them. It is stated that May Quantrell, a brave and loyal lady in another part of the city, did wave her flag in sight of the Confederates. It is possible that there has been a blending of the two incidents.--Author's note.

Page 449. _'Tis Meagher and his fellows._ Brigadier-General Thomas F. Meagher commanded the second brigade of the first division of the right grand division. It was called the "Irish Brigade," and Meagher himself had organized it. After Chancellorsville, it was so decimated that it was incorporated with other regiments.

Page 449. _The wild day is closed._ Burnside's attempt to carry the heights behind Fredericksburg by storm was perhaps the most insane of the war. In spite of

McClellan's lack of promptness, thoroughness, and vigor, and a sort of incapacity of doing anything until an ideal completeness of preparation was reached, he was in many ways the best commander the Army of the Potomac ever had. Pope, Burnside, and Hooker were admittedly his inferiors.

Page 458. THE EAGLE OF CORINTH. The finest thing I ever saw was a live American eagle, carried by the Eighth Wisconsin, in the place of a flag. It would fly off over the enemy during the hottest of the fight, then would return and seat himself upon his pole, clap his pinions, shake his head, and start again. Many and hearty were the cheers that arose from our lines as the old fellow would sail around, first to the right, then to the left, and always return to his post, regardless of the storm of leaden hail that was around him.--Letter from an Illinois Volunteer.

At the close of the war, the eagle was presented to Governor Lewis, of Wisconsin, and provided with a suite of rooms in the State House Park at Madison.

Page 461. READY. The incident described in this poem occurred probably during the first week of April, 1863. Rodman's Point is a strip of land projecting into the Pimlico River just below Washington, North Carolina.

Page 462. _Kady Brownell._ On April 25, 1861, the New York "Herald," in referring to the passage of the second detachment of Rhode Island troops through New York city, said: "The volunteers bring along with them two very prepossessing young women, named Martha Francis and Katey Brownell, both of Providence, who propose to act as 'daughters of the regiment,' after the French plan."

Page 467. THE CRUISE OF THE MONITOR. The contract for the construction of the Monitor was given to John Ericsson, of New York, on October 4, 1861. It was to be an iron-plated raft, 172 feet over all, 41-1/2 feet beam, and 11-1/8 feet depth of hold, carrying a revolving iron turret containing two 11-inch Dahlgren guns. The ironclad was launched January 30, 1862, an extraordinary feat in naval construction, and was handed over to the government February 19, its cost being $275,000. At eleven o'clock on the morning of March 6, the queer craft started for Hampton Roads, to meet the Merrimac, word of whose completion had reached the United States government. That the vessel did not founder on the voyage was little less than a miracle, but at nine o'clock on the evening of March 8, the Monitor reached Fort Monroe, her progress up the bay being lighted by the burning frigate Congress.

Page 468. _Bold Worden._ The Monitor was commanded by Lieutenant John Lorimer Worden, while the Merrimac was in charge of Lieutenant Catesby Jones, his superior. Captain Franklin Buchanan, having been wounded by a rifle bullet the day before. Worden was injured during the action by a shell exploding against the sight-hole of the pilot house, and was succeeded by Lieutenant Samuel Dana Greene.

Page 468. THE RIVER FIGHT. The fleet which Farragut took upon this desperate venture consisted of nine gunboats and eight sloops of war. The defences of New Orleans were of the most formidable kind, the river being guarded by Forts Jackson and St. Philip, mounting 116 guns, and by a strong fleet of gunboats and ironclads, under command of Commodore J. K. Mitchell. The river was also barred by a great raft thrown across it under the guns of the forts, and a large number of long flatboats,

filled with pine knots, were held in readiness by the Confederates to be fired and sent down the swift current into the midst of the Union fleet. In spite of all this, after the terrific fight was over, it was found that the Union loss was only thirty-seven killed and one hundred and forty-seven wounded. The Confederate loss was never accurately determined.

Admiral Farragut was so impressed with Brownell's poem that he sought out the author and a warm friendship followed. When Mobile was captured, Brownell was a guest of the Admiral on board his flagship, the Hartford, and the result was another spirited poem, "The Bay Fight," which appears elsewhere in this collection.

Page 471. _Our fair Church pennant waves._ The church pennant is made of white bunting on which is sewn a cross of blue.

Page 478. _Beside me gloomed the prison-cell._ The reference is to Dr. Reuben Crandall, of Washington, who, in 1834, was arrested and confined in the old city prison until his health was destroyed, his offence having been in lending to a brother physician a copy of Whittier's pamphlet, "Justice and Expediency."

Page 483. STONEWALL JACKSON'S WAY. "These verses," according to William Gilmore Simms, "were found, stained with blood, in the breast of a dead soldier of the old Stonewall Brigade, after one of Jackson's battles in the Shenandoah Valley." Though widely copied, their authorship remained unknown for nearly a quarter of a century.

Page 493. _John Burns._ John Burns was seventy years of age in 1863. He had been among the first to volunteer for the War of 1812, and was present at the battles of Plattsburg, Queenstown, and Lundy's Lane. He served through the war with Mexico, and volunteered promptly for the Civil War, was rejected because of his age, served for a time as a teamster, but was finally sent home to Gettysburg, where his townsmen made him constable to keep him busy and contented. When, in June, 1863, the Confederates occupied the town, Burns had to be locked up for asserting his civil authority in opposition to that of the Confederate provost guard. As soon as the Confederates left the town, Burns busied himself arresting Confederate stragglers. When the preliminary skirmishing at Gettysburg began, Burns borrowed a rifle and ammunition from a wounded Union soldier, went to the front, and offered his services as volunteer. The colonel of the Seventh Wisconsin loaned him a long-range rifle, which he used with deadly effect all day, but he was badly wounded when the Union troops were forced back, was captured by the Confederates, and narrowly escaped being hanged as an un-uniformed combatant. He lived in his little home on the battlefield until 1872, and was visited by thousands and thousands of pilgrims to the scene of the great struggle.

Page 500. THE BATTLE-CRY OF FREEDOM. The popularity of the songs sung by the armies of both North and South seems to have been in direct ratio to their maudlin sentimentality. Most popular of all was the song known as "When this Cruel War is Over." It was heard in every camp, north and south, many times a day, the Southern soldiers inserting "gray" for "blue" in the sixth line of the first stanza with a cheerful disregard of the rhyme. It was sung in public gatherings, in the home--in

fact, it is doubtful if any other song was ever upon so many American tongues. This wide appeal gives it, in a way, a historic interest, which warrants its inclusion here.

WHEN THIS CRUEL WAR IS OVER

Dearest love, do you remember When we last did meet, How you told me that you loved me, Kneeling at my feet? Oh, how proud you stood before me, In your suit of blue, When you vowed to me and country Ever to be true.

Chorus--Weeping, sad and lonely, Hopes and fears how vain; Yet praying when this cruel war is over, Praying that we meet again.

When the summer breeze is sighing Mournfully along, Or when autumn leaves are falling, Sadly breathes the song. Oft in dreams I see thee lying On the battle plain, Lonely, wounded, even dying, Calling, but in vain.

If, amid the din of battle, Nobly you should fall, Far away from those who love you, None to hear you call, Who would whisper words of comfort? Who would soothe your pain? Ah, the many cruel fancies Ever in my brain!

But our country called you, darling, Angels cheer your way! When our nation's sons are fighting, We can only pray. Nobly strike for God and country, Let all nations see How we love the starry banner, Emblem of the free.

CHARLES CARROLL SAWYER.

Page 506. _Out on a crag walked something._ The flag was unfurled from Pulpit Rock, on the extreme point of the mountain overlooking Chattanooga. It was from that "pulpit" that Jefferson Davis, three days before, had addressed his troops, assuring them that all was well with the Confederacy.

Page 506. THE BATTLE IN THE CLOUDS. "The day had been one of dense mists and rains, and much of General Hooker's battle was fought above the clouds, on the top of Lookout Mountain."--General Meigs's Report.

Page 508. _And the one white Fang underneath._ Robert Gould Shaw was only twenty-five years of age when he was killed at the head of his regiment at Fort Wagner. He had enlisted as a private at the outbreak of the war, and soon rose to a captaincy. He was appointed colonel of the Fifty-Fourth Massachusetts, the first regiment of colored troops from a free state, April 17, 1863, and went to his death with them three months later. See also "Ode on the Unveiling of the Shaw Memorial," page 603, and "An Ode in Time of Hesitation," page 646.

Page 510. LOGAN AT PEACH TREE CREEK. Mr. Garland is mistaken in stating that McPherson was killed at the battle of Peachtree Creek, which was fought on July 20, 1864. He was killed two days later, at what is known as the battle of Atlanta. While hastening to join his troops, who had just been attacked by the Confederates, he ran full into the enemy's skirmish line and was shot while trying to escape. Sherman at once ordered General John A. Logan to assume command of the Army of the Tennessee, and it was largely due to General Logan's skill and determination that the Union army was saved from serious disaster in the desperate battle which

followed.

Page 512. SHERMAN'S MARCH TO THE SEA. General Sherman, in his Memoirs, says that on the afternoon of February 17, 1865, while overhauling his pockets, according to his custom, to read more carefully the various notes and memoranda received during the day, he found a paper which had been given him by a Union prisoner who had escaped from Columbia. It proved to be "Sherman's March to the Sea," composed by Adjutant S. H. M. Byers, of the Fifth Iowa Infantry, while a prisoner at Columbia. General Sherman was so impressed by the verses that he immediately sent for their author and attached him to his staff.

Page 513. MARCHING THROUGH GEORGIA. General Sherman makes no reference in his Memoirs to these verses and would have been glad to replace them with Adjutant Byers's song. They were, however, widely popular and, indeed, still hold an honored place at every reunion of Civil War veterans.

Page 517. _O noble son of noble sire._ Ulric Dahlgren was the son of John Adolph Dahlgren, perhaps the greatest chief of ordnance the Navy Department has ever had. Ulric was only twenty-two years of age at the time of his death. He had lost a leg at Gettysburg the year before, but had returned to active service upon his recovery although compelled to walk on crutches. He had planned the expedition in which he lost his life.

Page 519. _When Stuart to the grave we bore._ The loss of Stuart was one of the most serious the Confederacy had sustained since the death of Stonewall Jackson. He was, in many respects, the most brilliant cavalry leader developed on either side during the war, though it was alleged that his unauthorized absence from the field of Gettysburg contributed greatly to the defeat of Lee's army.

Page 522. THE YEAR OF JUBILEE. A remarkable evidence of the elasticity of spirit shown by the losers in the great struggle is the fact that this song, which one would suppose would be particularly offensive to them, became even more popular in the South than in the North.

Page 524. THE SURRENDER AT APPOMATTOX. Lee's army, at the time of the surrender, consisted of about twenty-eight thousand men, nearly half of whom were without arms. His army had had little to eat for several days except parched corn, and was upon the verge of starvation. Immediately after the surrender, Grant sent twenty-five thousand rations into the Confederate lines.

Page 524. LEE'S PAROLE. Grant's behavior was marked throughout with the greatest delicacy. He did not ask Lee's sword, promptly stopped salutes which were started after the surrender, did not require the Confederates to march out and stack arms, and did not enter their lines. The terms of surrender were so liberal that many partisans at the North took violent exception to them.

Page 525. _The Cherbourg cliffs were all alive._ A great throng had gathered to witness the fight, which had been advertised as a sort of gala event, excursions even being run from Paris. The sympathies of the crowd were all with the Alabama.

Page 525. _When, lo! roared a broadside._ The firing of the Kearsarge was a magnificent exhibition of gunnery. She fired 173 missiles, nearly all of which took effect. The Alabama fired 370, of which only 28 struck. The Kearsarge's 11-inch shells were aimed a little below the water line, with such deadly effect that the Alabama sank in a little more than an hour after going into action.

Page 526. KEARSARGE. On Sunday morning, June 19, 1864, the noise of the cannons during the fight between the Kearsarge and the Alabama was heard in English churches near the Channel.--Author's note.

Page 527. _Though unequal in strength._ The Kearsarge had a displacement of 1031 tons, carried a crew of 163, and mounted seven guns, throwing 366 pounds. The Alabama was of 1016 tons displacement, carried a crew of 149 and eight guns, throwing 328 pounds. The ships were remarkably well matched.

Page 527. _Shall shine in tradition the valor of Semmes._ A bitter controversy followed the fight as to whether the Alabama actually surrendered. The preponderance of evidence shows that her colors were hauled down and a white flag displayed a few minutes before she sank. The British steam yacht Deerhound picked up forty-two men, including Semmes and fourteen officers, and made off with them to Southampton. The British Government afterwards refused to surrender these men. It is consoling to reflect that England's aid to Confederate privateers cost her, in the end, over fifteen million dollars.

Page 527. CRAVEN. Craven has been called the Sidney of the American navy. His pilot's name was John Collins, and as the Tecumseh was going down, he and Craven met at the foot of the ladder leading to the top of the turret. Craven stepped back, saying, "After you, Pilot." As the pilot reached the top round of the ladder, the vessel seemed "to drop from under him," and no one followed. A buoy marks the spot.

Page 528. _Sidney._ Sir Philip Sidney, who is said to have refused a cup of water while lying mortally wounded on the battlefield of Zutphen, in order to give it to a wounded soldier.

Page 528. _Nelson._ Admiral Horatio Nelson. The reference is to the Battle of the Nile, where Nelson was severely wounded.

Page 528. _Lucas._ A young English captain, who was imprisoned by Hyder Ali in 1780. To relieve a wounded comrade, Captain Baird, he assumed two sets of chains.

Page 528. _Outram._ Sir James Outram, who, in admiration for the brilliant deeds of his subordinate, General Havelock, conceded him the glory of relieving Lucknow, in 1857, waiving his own rank and tendering his services as a volunteer.

Page 530. THE BAY FIGHT. Farragut took only a short vacation after his triumphant "River Fight," and began at once to prepare for another desperate encounter. The defences of Mobile were among the strongest in the South. Three forts, mounting seventy-one guns, guarded the channel, which was further defended by a double row of torpedoes, one hundred and eighty in number. Besides this, there was in the bay itself a Confederate fleet of four vessels, one of which was the great ram Tennessee.

Farragut's fleet was the most formidable collection of war vessels that had ever been assembled under command of one man. It surpassed in power for destruction the combined English, French, and Spanish fleets at Trafalgar. Yet, in spite of the desperate nature of the struggle which followed, the loss was less than in many a skirmish on land, that in the Union fleet being 52 killed and 170 wounded, besides 93 drowned in the Tecumseh, while the Confederate loss was only 12 killed and 20 wounded.

Page 535. "ALBEMARLE" CUSHING. Lieutenant Cushing was only twenty-one years of age at the time he sunk the Albemarle, one of the most brilliant and gallant exploits of the war. The deed was rendered extremely difficult by the fact that the Albemarle had been surrounded by a cordon of timber, and Cushing actually drove his launch at full speed over this in order to reach the Albemarle's side. He received the thanks of Congress and was made lieutenant-commander as a reward for his heroism.

Page 539. PARDON. John Wilkes Booth was a son of Junius Brutus Booth and was twenty-six years old at the time of the assassination. His success as an actor had never been notable. There is some dispute as to whether he was hit by the bullet which Boston Corbett fired at him, or whether he shot himself. At any rate, he was brought out of the barn in which he had been cornered with a bullet in the base of his brain, and with his body paralyzed. He died the following morning. Eight accomplices were arrested, tried by a military commission, and found guilty. Four, one a woman, were hanged, and the others, with one exception, sentenced to hard labor for life.

Page 542. _Treason is not dead._ The charge and specification on which the conspirators were arraigned declared that they were "incited and encouraged" to the crime by Jefferson Davis, and a reward of one hundred thousand dollars was offered for his arrest. There was at no time any trustworthy evidence implicating Davis.

Page 559. _Pillow's ghastly stain._ Fort Pillow, situated on the Mississippi River about forty miles above Memphis, was captured, April 12, 1864, by a large Confederate force under General N. B. Forrest. The garrison consisted of 295 white and 262 colored troops, of whom 221 were killed and 130 wounded. Most of the killed and wounded were negroes, many of whom were shot down after the fort had been captured. There is no evidence, however, that the massacre, if it can be called such, was premeditated, and General Forrest seems to have stopped it as promptly as he could.

Page 559. "MR. JOHNSON'S POLICY OF RECONSTRUCTION." The "policy" consisted of two papers, one a proclamation of amnesty granting a pardon for treason to all, with some exceptions, who should take an oath to support the Constitution and the Union and to obey all laws and proclamations which had been made with reference to the emancipation of the slaves; the second an executive order intrusting the state governments to the people who had taken this oath. That the plan did not succeed was due in no small part to the folly of the newly constituted legislatures in immediately proceeding to pass various restrictive laws aimed at the negro, the effect of which would be to deprive him, in large part, of his newly acquired freedom.

Page 560. _Crippled and halting from his birth._ Stevens had a club foot, and was compelled to use a cane in walking.

Page 563. THE BLUE AND THE GRAY. The poem grew out of an item which appeared in the New York "Tribune," in 1867: "The women of Columbus, Mississippi, animated by nobler sentiments than many of their sisters, have shown themselves impartial in their offerings made to the memory of the dead. They strewed flowers alike on the graves of the Confederate and of the National soldiers." The poem, prefaced by this item, was first published in the "Atlantic Monthly" for September, 1867, and at once attracted wide attention.

Page 565. HOW CYRUS LAID THE CABLE. Mr. Field had been working at this project since 1854. In 1858 he had succeeded in laying a cable across the ocean, and it was in operation from August 17 to September 4, when the signals became unintelligible and finally ceased altogether. The story of his perseverance and final success is an inspiring one.

Page 565. _O lonely bay of Trinity._ The American end of the cable was landed at Trinity Bay, Newfoundland.

Page 568. _Small need to open the Washington main._ Gould had persuaded President Grant that a rise in gold while the crops were moving would advantage the country, and early in September the treasury department was instructed to sell only gold sufficient to buy bonds for the sinking fund. Gould saw that the "Washington main" could not be kept closed indefinitely, however, and unloaded secretly, leaving his partner, "Jim" Fisk, to look out for himself. Fisk's broker, Speyers, continued to run up the price of gold, until his bid reached 163-1/2, when the market broke, the price falling almost instantly to 133. Fisk saved himself by coolly repudiating his contracts.

Page 580. DOWN THE LITTLE BIG HORN. Custer, who was thirty-seven years old at the time of his death, had served with great distinction through the Civil War. He was bitterly censured for accepting battle upon the Little Big Horn, and accused of disobedience of orders, but no basis for this accusation was ever clearly shown.

Page 580. _Just from the canyon emerging._ Custer and the five companies with him advanced without hesitation into the jaws of death, for they were outnumbered twelve to one. They dismounted and planted themselves on two little hills a short distance apart. The Indians stampeded their horses, waited till their ammunition was exhausted, and then overwhelmed them.

Page 580. _Sitting Bull._ Sitting Bull, who commanded the Indians, was a Sioux chief and was born about 1837. He was killed during the Sioux outbreak of December, 1890.

Page 583. _In ambush the Sitting Bull._ There was no ambush. The battle was fought in the open, from high ground. Custer's surprise lay not in finding the Indians before him, but in finding them so fatally numerous.

Page 584. _The brave heart._ Two days after the battle, a detachment of cavalry discovered the bodies of Custer and his five companies. Custer alone had not been

mutilated. He had been shot in the left temple, and lay as though peacefully sleeping.

Page 593. THE BROOKLYN BRIDGE. The bridge had been begun January 3, 1870, and was not wholly completed at the time of its opening in 1883. Its cost was about twenty million dollars.

Page 615. _Bocagrande._ The main channel into Manila Bay south of Corregidor Island. It means, literally, "large mouth."

Page 616. _Montojo._ Admiral Patricio Montojo y Pasarou, commander of the Spanish naval forces in the Philippines.

Page 616. _Gridley._ Charles Vernon Gridley (1845-1898), captain of Admiral Dewey's flagship, the Olympia.

Page 626. EIGHT VOLUNTEERS. Besides Hobson, the volunteers were Osborn Deignan, a coxswain of the Merrimac; George F. Phillips, a machinist of the Merrimac; John Kelly, a water-tender of the Merrimac; George Charette, a gunner's mate of the New York; Daniel Montagu, a seaman of the Brooklyn; J. C. Murphy, a coxswain of the Iowa; and Randolph Clausen, a coxswain of the New York.

Page 628. _Once more the Flower of Essex._ See "The Lamentable Ballad of the Bloody Brook," page 82.

Page 631. WHEELER AT SANTIAGO. "Fighting Joe" Wheeler was one of the most active and successful cavalry leaders of the Confederacy. The death of General J. E. B. Stuart, in 1864, made him senior cavalry general of the Confederate armies. He served in Congress after the war, and volunteered for active service on the outbreak of the war with Spain. He was given command of a cavalry brigade, and his presence before Santiago was of inestimable value.

Page 633. _Near Nimanima's greening hill._ The cove, six and a half miles from the entrance to Santiago harbor, where the Infanta Maria Teresa was beached. Juan Gonzales is seven miles and Aserradero fifteen miles from Santiago.

Page 633. _The Cape o' the Cross._ Cape Cruz, at the southwestern extremity of Cuba.

Page 641. _Who on the third most famous of our Fourths._ July 4, 1776, the Declaration of Independence adopted. July 4, 1863, announcement of the victory at Gettysburg. July 4, 1898, announcement of the victory at Santiago.

Page 645. AGUINALDO. Emilio Aguinaldo was born in 1870, of Chinese and Tagalog parentage. He received a good education, became interested in military affairs, and was one of the leaders of the outbreak against Spanish authority in 1896. At the beginning of the Spanish-American war, Admiral Dewey sent for Aguinaldo, who arrived at Cavité a few days after the destruction of the Spanish fleet. He at once began the organization of the Filipino troops, and soon afterwards proclaimed himself dictator of the so-called Filipino Republic. He stoutly resisted the American occupation which followed the peace, but was captured in 1901, and finally took the oath of allegiance to the United States.

Page 645. _Strike at his mother and his child._ Aguinaldo's family was captured by the United States troops and held prisoners until his submission.

Page 645. _When they read the sneering comments._ The fact that no prisoners were taken at the fight at Dajo, and that many women and children were among the killed, caused much bitter comment. The poem gives the army's side of the controversy.

Page 646. _Before the living bronze Saint-Gaudens made._ See "Bury Them," page 508, and "An Ode on the Unveiling of the Shaw Memorial," page 603.

Page 650. _The assassin's shot._ The assassin was a young Pole named Leon Czolgosz, who proclaimed himself an anarchist. He was tried speedily, sentenced to electrocution, and executed October 28.

Page 651. "_Silent upon a peak in Darien._" From Keats's sonnet, "On First Looking into Chapman's Homer."

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Transcriber's Note:

Obvious typographical errors were repaired, but valid and consistently used archaics spellings were retained (for example, scimetar).

P. 10, Columbus to Ferdinand, stanza 13: "Ere this was found"; multiple other poem sources read "Ere this was known".

P. 294, The United States and the Macedonian, stanza 6: "To Carden then, in tones so bland,"--this line was missing in the original text, but was verified in other poem sources.

P. 354, The Death of Harrison, end of stanza 4: The last two lines of this stanza, verified in other poem sources, were missing from the original text, which closed the stanza with--"On!--on with his ashes!--HE LEFT BUT HIS PLOUGH!":